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DOMINIONS 6 RESEARCH PROJECT

# The Dominions 6 Knowledge Library

Reader's guide and Foundation Books I-XIV: rulesets, turn resolution, economy, statecraft, Pretenders, dominion, blessings, armies, battle, magic, strategy, nations, modding, AI scaffolds, maps, scenarios, and the Dominions Enhanced/Divinitus technical encyclopaedia; plus the practical operations, interface, setup, orders, and hosting manual; plus the systematic unit-class, ability, experience, heroic-ability, and condition reference; plus the versioned base-game object reference for spells, items, summons, Pretenders, Thrones, sites, mercenaries, independents, and special dominions; plus the complete official patch history and its evidence ledger; plus the searchable command and terminology lexicon. Book VII includes 35 Early Age and 37 Middle Age dossiers

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Linked reader's edition: beginner-readable, expert-useful, source-verifiable, and paired with the searchable website.

# Contents

This reader-facing edition begins with a concordance, linked learning paths, and a research-priority register. It then presents the complete hosting model and turn-and-economy field reference, followed by foundations for economy, Pretenders, battle, magic, and strategy. Book VII includes complete source-backed dossiers for all 35 Early Age and 37 Middle Age nations. Book VIII covers source architecture, objects, events, diplomacy reactions, AI scaffolds, maps, compatibility, and release testing. Book IX inventories Dominions Enhanced 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE from the supplied source files, separating explicit definitions, official engine rules, combined-load-order deductions, and unresolved runtime questions. It includes the complete DE global and blessing layers, Divinitus event architecture, cross-mod identity analysis, and a practical verification register. The inherited Edition 28 work resolves the category-level perception matrix, records the live Invisibility value against superseded manual wording, advances ability-stacking evidence, and publishes a controlled Hall-of-Fame observation protocol. It preserves the direct, practical house style across the complete reader corpus and the exact evidence, tables, formulas, citations, and research boundaries. Repeated internal baselines, source inventories, formulas, and essays have been consolidated under one authoritative chapter each. Book X then supplies the player-facing operating layer: game creation, joining and hosting, interface controls, recruitment and army workflow, strategic orders, a guided first campaign, troubleshooting, and campaign administration. Book XI adds the retrieval layer for unit classes, movement and command tags, defensive and offensive abilities, experience, the Hall of Fame, heroic traits, lasting conditions, counters, and current patch corrections. Book XII adds the versioned object-reference method and a 4,196-record website data layer covering spells, items, summon relations, Pretender forms, Thrones, sites, mercenary companies, independent-coverage status, realm-expanded spell access, and special dominion systems without duplicating the strategic teaching in Books II-VI. Book XIII adds the official version spine: official update announcements and a versioned change ledger, with a release chronology, source hashes, editorial classifications, canonical maintenance links, a stale-guide repair method, and a command chronology. Book XIV supplies the retrieval and reconciliation layer for command terminology: 1,609 distinct tokens from the official modding, event, and map manuals; 97 controlled aliases; all 226 patch-note tokens reconciled, including five official 6.36 patch-only commands; context-sensitive command domains; syntax and source locators; documentation-status distinctions; and explicit handling of manual-version drift and official spelling discrepancies. The project archive and evidence ledger remain separate from the published book.

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# Reader's Guide and Concordance

## The retrieval layer

The Knowledge Library is large enough that most players will not read it from front to back. Its fourteen books answer different questions, and one game situation can easily touch several of them. A failed battle might begin with an interface mistake or an economic shortage, then run through unit classes, scripting, fatigue, and conditions before becoming a wider campaign problem. A Pretender design might begin with scales, but its value can depend on the chosen form, research timing, mage recruitment, the patch that established the current rule, and the likely date of the first war.

This guide joins those subjects together without explaining them a second time. Every entry points to the chapter that owns the full rule or method, and definitions here stay short for that reason. If a summary appears to disagree with the linked chapter, the chapter takes priority.

The guide serves five purposes:

- 1

give a new player a controlled route through the library;
- 2

let an experienced player move directly from a live problem to the relevant rule;
- 3

provide an alphabetical concordance and expanded glossary;
- 4

define the content model used for website publication;
- 5

separate research that can be resolved from reliable sources from questions that still require engine evidence.

## How the links behave

Every major heading now has a stable destination. The identifiers are shared by the PDF bookmarks, the website index, and the machine-readable export. A heading can move to a different page in a later edition without breaking a link, provided its subject and destination identifier remain the same.

The linked table of contents remains the complete structural map. The concordance is the practical one: it begins with the question at hand, not the order in which the books were written.

# Part I: Reading Paths

## Path A: The first complete game

This route supplies enough structure to play a full game without demanding mastery of every spell, special ability, or diplomatic edge case. The order is intentional: timing and economy come before Pretender theory because a design cannot be judged without knowing what a turn and a province can actually produce.

| Stage      | Read                                                                              | What should be understood before moving on                                                            |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Operate | Book X - ruleset and local continuity, creating the world, and the main interface | The correct game is installed, the essential screens are legible, and orders can be submitted safely. |

| Stage              | Read                                                                                                                                              | What should be understood before moving on                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2. Ruleset         | Book I - baseline and evidence                                                                                                                    | Which patch and mods govern the game, and how confirmed rules differ from doctrine or pending tests.                                                                             |
| 3. Turn            | Book I - six-phase hosting model and the complete 63-step sequence                                                                                | Orders are simultaneous when submitted but sequential when resolved.                                                                                                             |
| 4. Province        | Book II - the economic model, income, and recruitment constraints                                                                                 | Gold, resources, Recruitment Points, infrastructure, and time are separate constraints.                                                                                          |
| 5. Read a unit     | Book XI - unit-reading method, unit classes, and ability register                                                                                 | Classes, leadership, movement, abilities, experience, and conditions are read as one current state.                                                                              |
| 6. Expansion army  | Book IV - what a battle decides, unit roles, and orders and scripts                                                                               | A unit card is not a plan; placement, leadership, morale, and target contact determine whether statistics are delivered.                                                         |
| 7. Pretender       | Book III - Pretender design as a national system, scales, and blessings                                                                           | The design should solve national problems rather than maximize an isolated chassis.                                                                                              |
| 8. Research        | Book V - research as strategic planning and battlefield magic by function                                                                         | Research is a response tree whose branches must be deliverable by actual mages and gems.                                                                                         |
| 9. Campaign        | Book VI - expansion and first contact, borders and infrastructure, and recovery                                                                   | Winning a battle matters only if the result can be converted into position, forts, research, or victory.                                                                         |
| 10. Guided play    | Book X - guided first campaign and turn audit                                                                                                     | The foundation is translated into a repeatable opening, first contact, first war, siege, and post-game review.                                                                   |
| 11. Live reference | Turn and Economy Quick Reference, Book XI's master register, Book XII's object register, Book XIII's patch ledger, and Book XIV's command lexicon | Common timing, economy, unit-state, object, current-version, and official mod-language facts can be checked without reopening full chapters or treating an old guide as current. |

The first pass can stop once the current question has been answered. Controlled tests, complete object inventories, and specialist essays can wait until they are actually needed.

## Path B: The first multiplayer game

Single-player fundamentals still matter, but multiplayer adds hidden intentions, negotiated borders, reputation, timing attacks, and the possibility that an apparently efficient action creates a coalition.

- 1 Complete stages 1-8 of Path A.
- 2 Read [joining and hosting](#) and the [submission protocol](#).
- 3 Read [scouting, intelligence, and uncertainty](#).
- 4 Read [raiding and counter-raiding](#).
- 5 Read [timing attacks and power spikes](#).
- 6 Read [diplomacy, treaties, and reputation](#).
- 7 Read [Thrones, Cataclysm, and endgame conversion](#).
- 8 Use the [campaign decision framework](#) before committing to a major war.

The central multiplayer habit is to calculate political cost alongside material gain. Territory, globals, Thrones, visible research, border dominion, and repeated treaty behaviour all alter how other players price the threat.

## Path C: Returning after a long break

This route is for a player who remembers the game but not the current version or the exact order of operations.

- 1 Read [Book I's current baseline](#).
- 2 Review [Book XIII's release spine](#) and [player-facing changes](#) for the period missed.
- 3 Review [Book X's current operational additions](#).
- 4 Review [current-version corrections in battle, magic, and strategy](#).
- 5 Review [Book XI's ability-facing patch notes](#) and [master register](#).
- 6 Use [Book XII's versioned object layer](#) for exact spell, item, summon, Pretender, Throne, site, mercenary, and special-dominion lookups.
- 7 Keep the [hosting spine](#), [provincial gold](#), [recruitment gates](#), and [siege calculation](#) open during the first turns.
- 8 Revisit only the chapter belonging to the nation or mechanic currently being used.
- 9 If DE and Divinitus are enabled, read the [frozen combined baseline](#) before trusting an older build or guide.

## Path D: Expert rules lookup

The expert route begins by finding the chapter that owns the answer.

| Question                                            | Primary destination                                                                              | Secondary destination                                             |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Create or join a game                               | <a href="#">Book X - creating the world</a>                                                      | <a href="#">Book X - joining and hosting</a>                      |
| Interface or shortcut                               | <a href="#">Book X - main interface</a>                                                          | <a href="#">Book X - current additions</a>                        |
| Strategic order procedure                           | <a href="#">Book X - order reference</a>                                                         | <a href="#">Underlying system in Books I-VI</a>                   |
| Submit or administer turns                          | <a href="#">Book X - turn submission</a>                                                         | <a href="#">Book X - hosting runbook</a>                          |
| Operational failure                                 | <a href="#">Book X - troubleshooting</a>                                                         | <a href="#">Path E</a>                                            |
| Unit class or leadership requirement                | <a href="#">Book XI - unit classes</a>                                                           | <a href="#">Book IV - command and squads</a>                      |
| Unfamiliar ability or icon                          | <a href="#">Book XI - master register</a>                                                        | <a href="#">Book XI - unit-reading method</a>                     |
| Experience or heroic ability                        | <a href="#">Book XI - experience</a>                                                             | <a href="#">Book XI - Hall of Fame</a>                            |
| Affliction or condition                             | <a href="#">Book XI - conditions</a>                                                             | <a href="#">Book IV - affliction resolution</a>                   |
| Exact spell or item record                          | <a href="#">Book XII - spells or items and artifacts</a>                                         | <a href="#">Book V - strategic magic</a>                          |
| Summon or summoned-unit relation                    | <a href="#">Book XII - summons</a>                                                               | <a href="#">Book V - summoning</a>                                |
| Pretender form availability                         | <a href="#">Book XII - Pretender forms</a>                                                       | <a href="#">Book III - national design system</a>                 |
| Throne, site, mercenary, or special dominion record | <a href="#">Book XII - Thrones and sites, mercenaries and independents, or special dominions</a> | <a href="#">Strategic interpretation in Books II, III, and VI</a> |
| Official change by version or subject               | <a href="#">Book XIII - official patch ledger</a>                                                | <a href="#">Current rule in the linked canonical book</a>         |
| Repair an old or undated guide                      | <a href="#">Book XIII - stale-guide repair</a>                                                   | <a href="#">Book XIII - classification model</a>                  |
| Command introduction or patch history               | <a href="#">Book XIII - command chronology</a>                                                   | <a href="#">Book XIV - patch reconciliation</a>                   |
| Exact command syntax, context, or manual locator    | <a href="#">Book XIV - command lexicon</a>                                                       | <a href="#">Book VIII - object and parser method</a>              |
| Exact hosting order                                 | <a href="#">Book I - complete hosting sequence</a>                                               | <a href="#">Field hosting spine</a>                               |
| Income or fort economics                            | <a href="#">Book II - gold, income, and upkeep</a>                                               | <a href="#">Field provincial gold</a>                             |
| Recruitment bottleneck                              | <a href="#">Book II - resources and recruitment</a>                                              | <a href="#">Field recruitment gates</a>                           |
| Pretender design                                    | <a href="#">Book III - national design system</a>                                                | <a href="#">Book VII - Pretender families in a dossier</a>        |



| Question                       | Primary destination                 | Secondary destination                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bless legality or activation   | Book III - blessings                | Book IX - exact DE blessing layer                                                                                                          |
| Melee result                   | Book IV - melee resolution          | Book IV - protection and damage                                                                                                            |
| Rout or retreat                | Book IV - morale, rout, and retreat | Book VI - army preservation                                                                                                                |
| Battle spell arithmetic        | Book IV - battlefield magic         | Book V - spell package design                                                                                                              |
| Research branch                | Book V - research planning          | Book VI - strategic response tree                                                                                                          |
| Communion failure              | Book V - communions                 | Book IV - fatigue                                                                                                                          |
| Ritual, dome, or global        | Book V - rituals, domes, or globals | Book I - hosting timing                                                                                                                    |
| Campaign conversion            | Book VI - campaign conduct          | Book II - economic state                                                                                                                   |
| Nation analysis                | Book VII - dossier method           | MA Arcoscephale, MA Marignon, MA Pyrène, MA Ulm, MA Man, MA Abysia, MA Pythium, MA Eriu, MA Agarthia, MA Uruk, MA Ashdod, or MA T'ien Ch'i |
| Mod syntax or validation       | Book XIV - syntax and lookup        | Book VIII - parser model, testing, and release engineering                                                                                 |
| DE/Divinitus exact source fact | Book IX - technical encyclopaedia   | Book IX - source inventory                                                                                                                 |
| Collision or load order        | Book IX - collision matrix          | Book VIII - compatibility engineering                                                                                                      |

## Path E: Diagnosing a failed turn

When a turn fails, trace the causes in order instead of starting with the most frustrating result.

- 1 Confirm the ruleset. Check patch, mods, load order, map, age, and game settings against [Book I's baseline rules](#).
- 2 Find the resolution step. Use [the hosting sequence](#) to identify when the expected action should have happened.
- 3 Check operation and legality. Use [Book X's troubleshooting route](#), then confirm paths, gems, laboratory, movement route, commander status, recruitment capacity, target, and order.
- 4 Check the binding resource. Use [Book II's constraint model](#) for gold, resources, Recruitment Points, Commander Points, Holy Points, supplies, or infrastructure.
- 5 Check tactical delivery. Use [Book IV's resolution order](#), [scripting](#), fatigue, morale, and targeting chapters.
- 6 Check strategic conversion. Use [Book VI's campaign decision framework](#) to decide whether the result was a local loss, a recoverable exchange, or a campaign failure.
- 7 Check evidence status. If the exact behaviour is listed in the research register, preserve the report as evidence. Do not force a confident explanation where the current record does not support one.

## Path F: Modding, source inspection, and website work

- 1 Read [the object-and-parser model](#).
- 2 Read [identifier allocation and collision safety](#).
- 3 Read [Book XII's object identity, provenance, and hashing method](#).
- 4 Read [Book XIII's command chronology and safe treatment of post-manual commands](#).
- 5 Use [Book XIV's complete command locator](#), [evidence ladder](#), and [patch reconciliation](#) before treating a token as complete syntax.
- 6 Choose the relevant object chapter in Books VIII, IX, or XII.
- 7 Apply [compatibility engineering](#) before combining releases.
- 8 Apply [testing, validation, and release engineering](#).

9 Use the website schema described later in this guide rather than scraping prose into unversioned pages.

# Part II: Navigation by Problem

## Game operation and hosting

| Problem                                            | Start here                                                  | Continue here                                       |
|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| The correct map, mod, or save directory is unclear | <a href="#">Ruleset, installation, and local continuity</a> | <a href="#">Book VIII - user data and packaging</a> |
| A new game needs reproducible settings             | <a href="#">Creating the world</a>                          | <a href="#">Host setup sheet</a>                    |
| A lobby game cannot be joined                      | <a href="#">Official lobby workflow</a>                     | <a href="#">Cannot find or join the game</a>        |
| The interface control or shortcut is unclear       | <a href="#">The main interface</a>                          | <a href="#">Current operational additions</a>       |
| A turn may not have been received                  | <a href="#">Turn submission and revision</a>                | <a href="#">A turn staled</a>                       |
| Troops, items, or gems are in the wrong place      | <a href="#">Recruitment, army setup, and inventories</a>    | <a href="#">Troubleshooting by symptom</a>          |
| A special strategic order is unclear               | <a href="#">Strategic order reference</a>                   | <a href="#">Linked mechanics in Books I-VI</a>      |
| A first full campaign needs structure              | <a href="#">A guided first campaign</a>                     | <a href="#">Path A</a>                              |
| The host needs a fair administrative standard      | <a href="#">Hosting as a competitive institution</a>        | <a href="#">Dispute handling</a>                    |

## Units, abilities, experience, and conditions

| Problem                                                       | Start here                                             | Continue here                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| A unit's type is unclear                                      | <a href="#">Unit classes and status tags</a>           | <a href="#">How classes overlap</a>               |
| An army cannot be assigned to its commander                   | <a href="#">Three leadership pools</a>                 | <a href="#">Army compatibility audit</a>          |
| A movement icon appears to permit an unusual route            | <a href="#">Movement, terrain, water, and position</a> | <a href="#">Book VI - movement and logistics</a>  |
| An unfamiliar ability needs a quick definition                | <a href="#">Master ability and condition register</a>  | <a href="#">How to read an ability</a>            |
| A counter is needed for a special defence or aura             | <a href="#">Counter-construction matrix</a>            | <a href="#">Book IV - counter construction</a>    |
| Veteran value or star thresholds are unclear                  | <a href="#">Experience and veteran units</a>           | <a href="#">Official experience thresholds</a>    |
| A Hall-of-Fame formula is being treated as certain            | <a href="#">What is officially established</a>         | <a href="#">Community-derived heroic families</a> |
| An affliction, disease, curse, or horror mark needs treatment | <a href="#">Conditions and lasting state</a>           | <a href="#">Book IV - lasting loss</a>            |

## Base-game object lookup

| Problem                                                      | Start here                              | Continue here                          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| A spell's school, path, cost, or delivery type is unclear    | Spell records                           | Book V - paths, schools, and access    |
| A forge target, artifact, or barding record needs comparison | Item records                            | Book V - forging, items, and artifacts |
| A ritual's summoned result is unclear                        | Summon relations                        | Book XII - shape graphs                |
| A Pretender form needs to be filtered by age or nation       | Pretender-form records                  | Book III - design audit                |
| A Throne or magic site needs an exact identity               | Thrones and sites                       | Book VI - endgame conversion           |
| A mercenary company or independent option needs checking     | Mercenaries and independent recruitment | Book VI - expansion                    |
| A nation's dominion changes the ordinary rules               | Special dominion systems                | Book III - dominion                    |
| A website record needs provenance or refresh instructions    | Publication contract                    | Verification and maintenance           |

## Version history and stale-guide repair

| Problem                                       | Start here                  | Continue here                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| An old guide conflicts with current play      | Stale-guide repair workflow | Current rule in the linked canonical book       |
| A change needs to be found by release         | Complete release spine      | Official patch ledger method                    |
| A patch category appears uncertain            | Classification confidence   | Open the linked official announcement           |
| A mechanic has changed several times          | Player-facing change survey | Search the JSON ledger by domain and named term |
| A mod command may postdate the manual         | Command chronology          | Book XIV - patch reconciliation                 |
| A patch token differs from the current manual | Controlled exceptions       | Book XIV - evidence ladder                      |
| A command is listed but not fully explained   | Documentation-status model  | Book XIV - safe lookup workflow                 |
| A new release needs to be ingested            | Safe feed update            | Website uses                                    |

## Economy and state

| Problem                                     | Start here                           | Continue here                                            |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Income is lower than expected               | Income formula                       | Tax trace, unrest                                        |
| A unit cannot be recruited                  | The binding constraint               | Recruitment Points, resources, Commander and Holy Points |
| A fort appears inefficient                  | Infrastructure as delayed conversion | Fort resource draw, fort-now test                        |
| An army is starving                         | Supplies and supply usage            | Strategic logistics                                      |
| A siege is taking too long                  | Siege and fort control               | Siege as a campaign clock, field calculation             |
| Province Defence is being misused           | Province Defence                     | PD as delay and information                              |
| Gem income feels disconnected from strategy | Sites, gems, and magical capital     | Gem logistics                                            |

## Pretenders, dominion, scales, and blessings

| Problem                                  | Start here                                       | Continue here                               |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| A design has too many unrelated goals    | <a href="#">The design in one model</a>          | <a href="#">Design audit</a>                |
| Awake, dormant, or imprisoned is unclear | <a href="#">Awakening, time, and the opening</a> | <a href="#">Opening tests</a>               |
| Dominion is collapsing                   | <a href="#">Dominion and religious territory</a> | <a href="#">Campaign dominion</a>           |
| Scale trade-offs are unclear             | <a href="#">Scales</a>                           | <a href="#">Economic consequences</a>       |
| A bless looks powerful but unaffordable  | <a href="#">Blessings</a>                        | <a href="#">Sacred capacity audit</a>       |
| The god has died                         | <a href="#">Pretender death and recall</a>       | <a href="#">Campaign recovery</a>           |
| DE changes invalidate a vanilla build    | <a href="#">Book IX - global rules</a>           | <a href="#">Book IX - blessing revision</a> |

## Armies and battle

| Problem                                          | Start here                                           | Continue here                                |
|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| A strong unit underperformed                     | <a href="#">Reading a unit</a>                       | <a href="#">Formation, fatigue, morale</a>   |
| Troops arrived in the wrong shape                | <a href="#">Army organisation</a>                    | <a href="#">Formations and contact</a>       |
| The script broke                                 | <a href="#">Orders, scripts, and spellcasting AI</a> | <a href="#">Battle-magic planning</a>        |
| Melee arithmetic is disputed                     | <a href="#">Melee resolution</a>                     | <a href="#">Protection and damage</a>        |
| Missiles hit the wrong target                    | <a href="#">Missile combat</a>                       | <a href="#">Formation and contact</a>        |
| The army routed while still large                | <a href="#">Morale, fear, rout, and retreat</a>      | <a href="#">Army preservation</a>            |
| A thug or supercombatant seems invincible        | <a href="#">Thugs and remote force</a>               | <a href="#">Damage families and counters</a> |
| A battlefield spell produced a surprising result | <a href="#">Battlefield magic arithmetic</a>         | <a href="#">Magic package design</a>         |

## Magic

| Problem                                          | Start here                                     | Continue here                                        |
|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Research feels aimless                           | <a href="#">Research as strategic planning</a> | <a href="#">Research as a campaign response tree</a> |
| A spell is known but cannot be delivered         | <a href="#">Paths and access</a>               | <a href="#">Gems and logistics, boosters</a>         |
| Gems disappear too quickly                       | <a href="#">Gem spending</a>                   | <a href="#">Reserve policy</a>                       |
| A communion is killing its slaves                | <a href="#">Communions</a>                     | <a href="#">Fatigue</a>                              |
| Remote magic is being intercepted or blocked     | <a href="#">Domes and remote attacks</a>       | <a href="#">Ritual timing</a>                        |
| A global is politically dangerous                | <a href="#">Global enchantments</a>            | <a href="#">Timing attacks and deterrence</a>        |
| A booster chain does not reach the expected path | <a href="#">Forging, items, and artifacts</a>  | <a href="#">Booster reference</a>                    |
| A level-nine plan is becoming a trap             | <a href="#">Legendary magic</a>                | <a href="#">Victory conversion</a>                   |

## Strategy and campaign

| Problem                               | Start here                    | Continue here        |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------|
| Expansion results vary wildly         | Expansion testing             | Battle diagnosis     |
| The border is too wide                | Map structure and borders     | Raiding fronts       |
| Research is collapsing under invasion | Research under invasion       | Recovery             |
| Raids gain provinces but lose the war | Raiding and counter-raiding   | Campaign conversion  |
| A power spike is visible too early    | Timing attacks and deterrence | Information denial   |
| A treaty is ambiguous                 | Diplomacy and treaties        | Diplomacy records    |
| A Throne opportunity may end the game | Throne arithmetic             | Throne-rush sequence |
| The army won but the campaign stalled | Victory conversion            | Economic conversion  |

## Nations, mods, and combined rulesets

| Problem                                               | Start here                       | Continue here                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| A nation guide lists strengths but gives no method    | Nation dossier method            | Evidence architecture         |
| Mage randoms are being described as guaranteed access | Probability method               | Mystic worked example         |
| A mod object behaves unlike its visible card          | Object and parser model          | Copy and selection semantics  |
| Two mods claim the same ID                            | Compatibility engineering        | DE/Divinitus collision matrix |
| An event chain has become unreliable                  | Event modding as a state machine | Divinitus event architecture  |
| The AI needs scenario guidance                        | AI scaffolding                   | Behavioural sampling          |
| A map changes strategic balance                       | Maps and scenario design         | Map structure and borders     |
| A public guide may be using the wrong mod version     | Frozen baseline                  | Versioned knowledge essay     |

# Part III: Alphabetical Subject Concordance

The concordance lists the best first destination, not every occurrence. Related chapters are included where a subject has a separate mechanical, strategic, or modding treatment.

### A

- Abilities: [Book XI - master ability and condition register](#); combat resolution is in [Book IV](#).
- Abysia: [Book VII - Middle Age Abysia dossier](#); direct routes cover its roster, mages, random paths, capital sites, national spells, artifact, research, matchups, and open questions.
- Agartha: [Book VII - Middle Age Agartha dossier](#); direct routes cover its roster, mages, random paths, capital sites, national rituals, Golem Cult boundary, heroes, research, matchups, and open questions.
- Accuracy and spell deviation: [Book IV - battlefield spell accuracy](#).
- Administration: [Book II - infrastructure and administration](#); see also fort resource draw.

- Afflictions: [Book XI](#) - conditions and lasting state; exact battle resolution and healing are in [Book IV](#).
- Ages: [Book I](#) - eras and national identity.
- AI scaffolds: [Book VIII](#) - AI scaffolding without false claims.
- Alchemy: [Book V](#) - alchemy.
- Anakites: [Book VII](#) - Ashdod roster; capital recruitment and sacred-force planning are separated under [capital sites](#) and [research](#).
- Alteration discounts: [Book V](#) - [research](#) and [site discounts](#).
- Angelic summons: [Book VII](#) - Pythium national rituals; caster and treasury limits remain visible in [Pythium's open evidence boundary](#).
- Anathemant: [Book VII](#) - Alysian commander and mage portfolio; the pinned Dragon random is separated from its manual display under [random paths](#).
- Arch Theurg: [Book VII](#) - Pythium commander and mage portfolio; the pinned random distribution is separated from its manual display under [random paths](#).
- Army composition: [Book IV](#) - [army organisation](#).
- Army preservation: [Book VI](#) - [army preservation](#) and [force regeneration](#).
- Ashdod: [Book VII](#) - Middle Age Ashdod dossier; direct routes cover its [roster](#), [mages](#), [random paths](#), [capital sites](#), [national magic](#), [item boundary](#), [heroes](#), [research](#), [matchups](#), and [open questions](#).
- Army rout: [Book IV](#) - [army rout](#).
- Arcoscephale: [Book VII](#) - Middle Age Arcoscephale dossier.
- Armour: [Book IV](#) - [armour](#) and [protection](#); mod construction is in [Book VIII](#).
- Artifacts: [Book XII](#) - [item](#) and [artifact records](#); [strategy](#) and [access](#) in [Book V](#) - [artifacts](#) and [artifact races](#).
- Assassination: [Book VI](#) - [assassins](#) and [remote force](#); [timing](#) is in [Book I](#).
- Automatic IDs: [Book VIII](#) - [automatic allocation](#) and [Book IX](#) - [automatic Divinitus objects](#).
- Avalon: [Book VII](#) - Middle Age Man dossier; direct routes cover its [mages](#) and [commanders](#), [random paths](#), and [national spells](#).
- Awakening: [Book III](#) - [awakening](#), [time](#), and [the opening](#).

## B

- Banquet for the Dead: [Book VII](#) - Ashdod national spell and ritual reconciliation; costs and printed minimums remain separate from unresolved live summon variation.
- Battle groups: [Book IV](#) - [battle groups](#).
- Battlefield enchantments: [Book IV](#) - [battlefield enchantments](#); strategic selection is in [Book V](#).
- Battlefield magic: [Book IV](#) - [battlefield magic](#).
- Battle scripting: [Book IV](#) - [orders](#), [scripts](#), and [spellcasting AI](#).
- Berserk: [Book XI](#) - Ambidextrous, Clumsy, and Berserker; battle consequences are in [Book IV](#).
- Bean Sidhe: [Book VII](#) - Eriu commander and mage portfolio; its pinned random set is separated from the manual display under Eriu random paths.
- Blacksteel: [Book VII](#) - Ulm national item portfolio.
- Bless design: [Book III](#) - [blessings](#); DE changes are in [Book IX](#).
- Blood Hunting: [Book II](#) - [Blood Hunting](#); field checks are in [the quick reference](#).
- Blood slaves: [Book V](#) - [Blood slaves](#).
- Bodyguards: [Book XI](#) - [bodyguards](#) and [Warning](#); assassination defence is in [Book VI](#).
- Boosters: [Book V](#) - [booster reference](#).
- Borders: [Book VI](#) - [borders](#).
- Breakpoints: [Book V](#) - [research breakpoints](#).

## C

- Call Malakh: [Book VII - Ashdod national spell and ritual reconciliation](#); repeatable caster access is separated from unresolved retinue and shape behaviour.
- City States, Uruk: [Book VII - Middle Age Uruk dossier](#).
- Call God: [Book III - Call God](#).
- Capital-only recruitment: [Book I - capital-only](#) and [Book II - recruitment restrictions](#).
- Cathedral of the Spheres: [Book VII - Pythium capital sites](#); ritual spending and caster access are under [Pythium's national rituals](#).
- Cataclysm: [Book VI - Cataclysm](#).
- Chassis: [Book III - chassis roles](#).
- Chamber of the Broken Seal: [Book VII - Agartha capital sites](#); its Death income and Shard Guard recruitment are kept separate from ordinary forts.
- Chorus: [Book VII - Man national spells and caster access](#); general communion rules remain in [Book V](#).
- Clouds: [Book IV - clouds and persistent area effects](#).
- Coalitions: [Book VI - coalition formation](#).
- Cold and heat: [Book III - Heat and Cold](#); battlefield resistance is in [Book IV](#).
- Combat gems: [Book V - battlefield gem spending](#).
- Commander Points: [Book II - Commander Points and Holy Points](#).
- Command context: [Book XIV - context is part of syntax](#); parser consequences remain in [Book VIII](#).
- Command lexicon: [Book XIV - official command and terminology locator](#).
- Command patch history: [Book XIII - command chronology](#); present syntax reconciliation is in [Book XIV](#).
- Communion: [Book V - communions, Sabbaths, Choruses, and Grand Communion](#).
- Conditions: [Book XI - conditions and lasting state](#).
- Compatibility patches: [Book VIII - compatibility patch structure](#).
- Construction: [Book II - construction and timing](#); magical Construction is covered in [Book V](#).
- Contact Lar: [Book VII - Pythium national rituals](#); the missing Nature caster and treasury remain explicit access boundaries.
- Contact timing: [Book IV - formations, placement, and contact](#).
- Corpses: [Book II - corpses as provincial stock](#); order entry remains in [Book X](#).
- Counter-raiding: [Book VI - counter-raiding as a system](#).
- Critical hits: [Book IV - critical hits](#).
- Crone of Avalon: [Book VII - Avalon random-path distributions](#); the current-display question remains in [Man's open evidence boundary](#).
- Cu Sidhe: [Book VII - Eriu national spell and ritual reconciliation](#); its caster and Glamour-gem requirements remain part of the access plan.

## D

- Dirge for the Dead: [Book VII - Ashdod national spell and ritual reconciliation](#); caster and gem requirements are source-backed while live outcomes remain open.
- Dawn set: [Book VII - Uruk national item boundary](#); the Headdress, Shield, and Sword retain separate object records.
- Damage: [Book IV - protection, damage, and survival](#).
- Damage reversal: [Book IV - damage reversal](#).
- Disease: [Book XI - disease and old age](#); battle consequences are in [Book IV](#).
- Daoine Sidhe: [Book VII - Eriu roster](#); capital recruitment, sacred status, and Glamour are separated from unresolved battle outcomes.
- Dispel: [Book V - Dispel](#).
- Divinitus: [Book IX - Divinitus encyclopaedia](#).
- Divine institutions: [Book IX - capital institutions](#).
- Dominion: [Book III - dominion and religious territory](#).

- Dominion kill: Book III - dominion elimination.
- Dominions Enhanced: Book IX - DE global rules.
- Domes: Book V - domes, remote attacks, and magic movement.
- DRN: Book IV - the open-ended random roll.

## E

- Enkidu: Book VII - Uruk roster; ordinary-fort, province, capital, and underwater availability remain distinct.
- Enkidu Shaman: Book VII - Uruk commander and mage portfolio; its random masks are separated under Uruk random paths.
- Entu: Book VII - Uruk commander and mage portfolio; its capital-only random paths are reconciled under Uruk random paths.
- Economy: Book II - the economic model.
- Empowerment: Book V - empowerment.
- Encumbrance: Book IV - encumbrance.
- Endgame conversion: Book VI - victory conversion.
- Eriu: Book VII - Middle Age Eriu dossier; direct routes cover its roster, mages, random paths, recruitment geography, national magic, items, research, matchups, and open questions.
- Event codes and variables: Book VIII - codes and variables; exact combined registries are in Book IX.
- Event chains: Book VIII - event chains.
- Event modding: Book VIII - event modding as a state machine.
- Evidence labels: Book I - evidence standard.
- Experience: Book XI - experience and veteran units.
- Expansion: Book VI - expansion and first contact.
- Expansion testing: Book VI - expansion testing.

## F

- Fatigue: Book IV - fatigue, recovery, and collapse.
- Fear: Book XI - Awe, Sun Awe, Fear, and Dread; morale resolution is in Book IV.
- Fire, cold, shock, and poison: Book IV - resistances and special damage.
- First campaign: Book X - guided first campaign.
- First contact: Book VI - first contact; first-game procedure is in Book X.
- First fort: Book II - fort-now test.
- First war: Book VI - from expansion to the first war.
- Fir Bolg: Book VII - Eriu roster; highland, mountain, and capital availability is mapped under recruitment geography.
- Formation Fighter: Book IV - Formation Fighter.
- Formations: Book IV - formations, placement, and contact.
- Forts: Book II - infrastructure and administration.
- Friendly fire: Book IV - friendly fire.

## G

- Giants, Ashdod: Book VII - Ashdod roster; logistics, recruitment packages, and matchup limits remain separated in the dossier.
- Great Temple of the Moon: Book VII - Uruk capital sites and recruitment geography.
- Gates and planes: Book VIII - gates and multiple planes.
- Gem income: Book II - sites, gems, and magical capital.



- Gem logistics: Book V - gems, slaves, and magical logistics.
- Gem reserves: Book V - gem reserves.
- Geas: Book VII - Eriu national magic and Man national spells; targeting and resistance outcomes remain game-state questions.
- Golem Crafter: Book VII - Agartha commander and mage portfolio; its fixed ritual access is mapped under national rituals.
- Golem Cult: Book VII - Agartha national rules; exact Hit Point scaling and affected ownership classes remain open.
- Global enchantments: Book V - global enchantments and Dispel wars.
- Gossamer Cloth: Book VII - Eriu national item reconciliation; displayed rebate cost remains open while the printed path and effect are retained.
- Global slots: Book V - global slots.
- Glamour: Book V - Glamour.
- Grand Communion: Book V - Grand Communion; Pythium's strategic ritual use is separated from ordinary battlefield communion in Book VII.
- Grand Hierophant: Book VII - Divinitus and the Grand Hierophant.

## H

- Headdress of the Bull: Book VII - Uruk national item boundary; its printed restriction remains separate from live forge-display questions.
- Harassment: Book IV - harassment.
- Halls of the Oracles: Book VII - Agartha capital sites and recruitment geography.
- Healing: Book IV - afflictions, regeneration, and healing.
- Hellscape: Book VII - Abysian national spells and caster access; native F4 access remains conditional in Abysia's open evidence boundary.
- Heroic abilities: Book XI - Hall of Fame and heroic abilities.
- Horror marks: Book XI - curse and Horror Mark.
- Hidden paths: Book V - hidden and indirect access.
- Hydras: Book VII - Pythium roster; capital recruitment and the unresolved poison-cloud and head boundaries are under capital sites and open questions.
- Holy Points: Book II - Commander Points and Holy Points.
- Hosting: Book I - complete engine sequence; multiplayer administration is in Book X.
- Hosting failures: Book X - troubleshooting by symptom; engine-order diagnosis is in Book I.

## I

- Immortality: Book XI - immortality, reformation, and extra lives; return timing is in Book I.
- Incarnate blessings: Book III - Incarnate effects.
- Income: Book II - gold, income, and upkeep; field formula is in the quick reference.
- Independents: Book XII - current coverage boundary and evaluation; strategy in Book VI - independent province classes.
- Infernal Breeding: Book VII - Abysian national spells and caster access; current output distributions remain in Abysia's open evidence boundary.
- Information denial: Book VI - information denial.
- Infrastructure: Book II - infrastructure and administration.
- Initiative: Book VI - initiative.
- Interface: Book X - main interface.
- Inspector data: Book XII - object-reference method and maintenance; modded-data use in Book IX - website and inspector layer.
- Iron Angel: Book VII - Ulm national spells and caster access.

- Item forging: Book XII - item records; access and strategy in Book V - forging, items, and artifacts.

## K

- Kulullu: Book VII - Uruk roster; underwater recruitment and operations are separated under capital sites and recruitment geography and open questions.

## L

- Laboratories: Book II - laboratories; order timing is in Book I.
- Lava Warrior: Book VII - Abysian roster by job; capital recruitment and the Fire sites are under capital sites.
- Living Mercury: Book VII - Agarthan national rituals; Water-gem funding and construct behaviour remain separate evidence questions.
- Leadership: Book XI - three leadership pools; army organisation is in Book IV.
- Legendary magic: Book V - legendary and level-nine magic.
- Life drain: Book IV - life drain.
- Load order: Book VIII - load order and Book IX - combined load order.
- Lobby: Book X - official lobby workflow.
- Logistics: Book VI - logistics, supply, and operational reach.
- Logrian Wise Man: Book VII - Avalon random-path distributions; roster context is in Man's mage portfolio.

## M

- Mage-turns: Book V - mage-turn economy.
- Magic access: Book V - paths, schools, and access.
- Magic Duel: Book V - Magic Duel.
- Magic phase: Book I - magic and special threats.
- Magic Being: Book XI - Magic Being.
- Magic Resistance: Book IV - Magic Resistance contests.
- Mashmashu: Book VII - Uruk commander and mage portfolio; its two random slots are separated under Uruk random paths.
- Man: Book VII - Middle Age Man dossier; direct routes cover its roster, mages, random paths, national spells, item boundary, research, matchups, and open questions.
- Marignon: Book VII - Middle Age Marignon dossier.
- Maps: Book VIII - maps and scenario design; strategic interpretation is in Book VI.
- Master Smith: Book VII - Ulm smith paths and probabilities.
- Manual version drift: Book XIV - evidence ladder and version drift; release chronology is in Book XIII.
- Melee: Book IV - melee resolution.
- Mercenaries: Book XII - mercenary company records; economic timing in Book II - mercenaries.
- Mindless units: Book XI - Mindless; battle-wide routing is in Book IV.
- Milesian Mage: Book VII - Eriu commander and mage portfolio; its F/A/E/N random distribution begins under Eriu random paths.
- Missile combat: Book IV - missile combat.
- Message substitutions: Book XIV - double-hash substitutions.
- Mod object IDs: Book VIII - identifiers, allocation, and collision safety.
- Mod testing: Book VIII - testing, validation, and release engineering.
- Morale: Book IV - morale, fear, rout, and retreat.
- Mount Seir: Book VII - Ashdod capital sites and recruitment geography.

- Mother of Avalon: [Book VII - Avalon random-path distributions](#); recruitment and role context is in [Man's mage portfolio](#).
- Mound of Ancient Kings: [Book VII - Eriu capital sites and recruitment geography](#); its Nature and Glamour income is kept separate from ordinary-fort recruitment.
- Mushussu: [Book VII - Uruk roster](#); rider-and-mount behaviour remains in [Uruk's open evidence boundary](#).
- Mounted units: [Book IV - mounted units](#).
- Movement: [Book VI - movement and interception](#); order procedure is in [Book X](#), and hosting timing is in [Book I](#).
- Mystics: [Book VII - Mystic random structure](#).

## N

- NAPs: [Book VI - NAP doctrine](#).
- Nation dossiers: [Book VII - nation dossier method](#); current unmodded dossiers cover [MA Arcoscephale](#), [MA Marignon](#), [MA Pyrène](#), [MA Ulm](#), [MA Man](#), [MA Abysia](#), [MA Pythium](#), [MA Eriu](#), [MA Agartha](#), [MA Uruk](#), [MA Ashdod](#), and [MA T'ien Ch'i](#).
- National spells: [Book XII - spell restrictions](#); strategic access in [Book V - national and restricted magic](#).
- Nexus: [Book V - global enchantments](#).

## O

- Olm Conclave: [Book VII - Agartha national rituals](#); the caster threshold and twenty-Water-gem cost are separated from the summoned commander's later path access.
- Oracle of the Ancients: [Book VII - Agartha mage portfolio](#); its pinned second random is isolated under [Oracle random paths](#).
- O'al Kan's Sceptre: [Book VII - Abysian national item boundary](#); general artifact and forge-cost rules remain in [Book V](#).
- Object copying: [Book VIII - selection, copying, and inheritance](#).
- Object limits: [Book VIII - identifier limits](#).
- Obstacles: [Book IV - obstacles](#).
- Orders: [Book IV - orders, scripts, and spellcasting AI](#).
- Order of operations: [Book I - hosting sequence](#) and [Book IV - melee resolution order](#).
- Overcasting globals: [Book V - overcasting](#).

## P

- Patch history: [Book XIII - official release spine and patch ledger](#); current command reconciliation is in [Book XIV](#), while current rules remain in their linked foundation books.
- Paralysis: [Book IV - paralysis](#).
- Patrol: [Book II - patrolling](#); detection doctrine is in [Book VI](#).
- Penetration: [Book IV - penetration](#).
- Penumbrals and Umbrals: [Book VII - Agartha national rituals](#); Death thresholds, costs, and printed summon counts are listed separately.
- Pillage: [Book II - pillaging and raiding](#); campaign use is in [Book VI](#).
- Planes: [Book VIII - gates and multiple planes](#).
- Poison: [Book IV - poison](#).
- Population: [Book II - population, unrest, pillage, patrol, and Blood Hunting](#).
- Power spikes: [Book VI - timing attacks, power spikes, and deterrence](#).
- Precision: [Book IV - missile deviation and spell accuracy](#).
- Preaching: [Book III - preaching](#); timing is in [Book I](#).

- Pretender design: Book III - Pretender design as a national system; exact forms and availability in Book XII.
- Priest Smith: Book VII - Ulm commander and mage portfolio.
- Pythium: Book VII - Middle Age Pythium dossier; direct routes cover its roster, mages, random paths, capital sites, national rituals, items, research, matchups, and open questions.
- Province Defence: Book II - Province Defence; operational doctrine is in Book VI.
- Protection: Book IV - protection, damage, and survival.
- Pyrène: Book VII - Middle Age Pyrène dossier.

## R

- Raid orders: Book VI - raid mechanics.
- Raiding: Book VI - raiding and counter-raiding.
- Random paths: Book VII - path probability and thresholds.
- Recruitment Points: Book II - Recruitment Points; field bands are in the quick reference.
- Regeneration: Book XI - regeneration families; combat arithmetic is in Book IV.
- Remote attacks: Book V - domes, remote attacks, and magic movement.
- Rephaite Sage: Book VII - Ashdod commander and mage portfolio; its ordinary randoms and access limits are isolated under Ashdod random paths.
- Repel: Book IV - repel.
- Research: Book V - research as strategic planning.
- Research response trees: Book VI - research as a strategic response tree.
- Rhuax and Barathrus Pacts: Book VII - Agartha national rituals; each pact retains its own path, gem, and summon requirement.
- Resistances: Book IV - resistances and special damage.
- Retreat: Book IV - retreat destination.
- Rituals: Book V - rituals and strategic magic.
- Roots of the Earth: Book VII - Agartha capital sites; its Fire and Earth income is separated from the other two capital sites.
- Rout: Book IV - morale, fear, rout, and retreat.
- Rulesets: Book I - rulesets must never be silently merged.

## S

- Sabbaths and Choruses: Book V - communions, Sabbaths, Choruses, and Grand Communions.
- Sacreds: Book III - sacred capacity.
- Salamander: Book VII - Abysian roster by job; commander roles are under Abysia's mage and commander portfolio.
- Scales: Book III - scales.
- Scenario design: Book VIII - maps and scenario design.
- Schools: Book V - paths, schools, and access.
- Shard Wights: Book VII - Agartha national rituals; the printed minimum remains separate from unresolved extra-path scaling.
- Scouting: Book VI - scouting, intelligence, and uncertainty.
- Serpent Cataphracts: Book VII - Pythium roster; rider-and-mount outcomes remain in Pythium's open evidence boundary.
- Singing Sword: Book VII - Eriu national item reconciliation; the printed Entrancement effect is separated from displayed rebate cost.
- Scrying: Book V - scrying.
- Siege: Book II - siege and fort control; orders are in Book X, and field arithmetic is in the quick reference.

- Sites: Book XII - Throne and site records; economic meaning in Book II - sites, gems, and magical capital.
- Size: Book IV - size, mounts, trampling, and movement.
- Smouldercone: Book VII - Abysia's capital sites and recruitment queues.
- Special dominions: Book XII - official system register; design and religious interpretation in Book III - special dominions.
- Spell fatigue: Book IV - spell fatigue.
- Spellcasting AI: Book IV - orders, scripts, and spellcasting AI.
- Spellsingers: Book VII - Man national spells and caster access and Eriu's mage portfolio; the wider Chorus framework is in Book V, while Eriu-specific outcomes remain open.
- Squads: Book IV - commanders, squads, leadership, and army organisation.
- Starvation: Book II - supplies, logistics, and starvation.
- Strange Fire: Book VII - Ashdod national spell and ritual reconciliation; targeting and live results remain in Ashdod's open evidence boundary.
- Stealth: Book VI - patrol and stealth.
- Submission: Book X - turn submission and revision.
- Storming: Book II - siege and fort control; battle context is in Book IV.
- Summons: Book XII - summon relations; magical planning in Book V - summoning.
- Supply: Book II - supplies, logistics, and starvation.
- Swamps of Pythia: Book VII - Pythium capital sites; Hydra Tamer and hydra recruitment remain separated from the Cathedral queue.

## T

- Targeting: Book IV - targeting orders and spell targeting.
- Talmai Elder: Book VII - Ashdod commander and mage portfolio; its random structure is separated under Ashdod random paths.
- Taskmasters: Book XI - Taskmaster and Beast Master; squad morale is in Book IV.
- Template commands: Book XIV - templates describe a grammar and template alias locator.
- Tempo: Book VI - tempo.
- Theurgs: Book VII - Pythium commander and mage portfolio; randoms, communions, and national ritual thresholds have their own direct routes.
- Theurg Communicants: Book VII - Pythium roster; the automatic Communion Slave field remains explicitly unresolved under open questions.
- Thrones: Book XII - exact Throne records; strategic conversion in Book VI - Thrones, Cataclysm, and endgame conversion.
- Throne rush: Book VI - throne-rush sequence.
- Timing attacks: Book VI - timing attacks, power spikes, and deterrence.
- The Twin Cities: Book VII - Ashdod capital sites and recruitment geography.
- Trample: Book XI - Trample ability; exact resolution is in Book IV.
- Tuatha: Book VII - Eriu commander and mage portfolio; the manual's one random marker and the pinned hidden second roll are separated under Eriu random paths.
- Turn resolution: Book I - complete hosting sequence.
- Turn audit: Book X - end-of-turn audit.

## U

- Umu-apkallu: Book VII - Uruk national ritual reconciliation; its printed path and gem requirements remain distinct from unresolved summon scaling.
- Uruk: Book VII - Middle Age Uruk dossier; direct routes cover its roster, mages, random paths, capital sites, national rituals, national items, heroes, research, matchups, and open questions.

- [Ulm: Book VII - Middle Age Ulm dossier](#); direct routes cover its roster, smiths, national spells, national items, research, matchups, and open questions.
- [Unit classes: Book XI - unit classes and status tags](#).
- [Underwater play: Book IX - underwater and cross-terrain systems](#).
- [Unrest: Book II - population, unrest, pillage, patrol, and Blood Hunting](#).
- [Upkeep: Book II - upkeep](#); timing is in [Book I](#).

## V

- [Versioning: Book XIII - official patch ledger](#); modded-ruleset consequences are in [Book IX - versioned knowledge](#).
- [Victory conditions: Book VI - Thrones and endgame conversion](#).

## W

- [Wall integrity: Book II - siege and fort control](#).
- [Warlock: Book VII - Abyssian random-path distribution](#); recruitment and Blood-Astral roles are under [Abyssia's mage portfolio](#).
- [Weapons: Book IV - weapon profiles](#); mod construction is in [Book VIII](#).
- [Wise Man, Logrian: Book VII - Avalon random-path distributions](#); recruitment and role context is in [Man's mage portfolio](#).
- [Wish: Book V - Wish](#).
- [World effects: Book I - world effects and hidden conflict](#).

## Z

- [Zamzummite: Book VII - Ashdod commander and mage portfolio](#); its random paths and national-ritual access are separated under [Ashdod random paths](#) and [national magic](#).
- [Zones of control: Book IV - zones of control](#).

# Part IV: Expanded Glossary

This glossary is an orientation layer. Each primary link leads to the fuller rules treatment.

| Term           | Working definition                                                                                                             | Primary anchor                                               | Related anchors                                                                                                          |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Administration | A fort percentage used in income and adjacent resource draw calculations.                                                      | <a href="#">b2-part-vi-infrastructure-and-administration</a> | <a href="#">b2-fort-resource-draw</a> ; <a href="#">field-base-and-final-income</a>                                      |
| Affliction     | A persistent injury or impairment usually gained through damage, age, disease, or special effects.                             | <a href="#">b11-61-afflictions</a>                           | <a href="#">b4-part-xiii-afflictions-regeneration-and-lasting-loss</a> ; <a href="#">b11-37-recuperation-and-healers</a> |
| Army           | A convenient name for commanders and assigned troops operating together; not always one indivisible rules object.              | <a href="#">b1-army</a>                                      | <a href="#">b4-part-iii-commanders-squads-leadership-and-army-organisation</a>                                           |
| Army rout      | The battle-wide morale collapse that can force remaining units to retreat even when individual squads have not already routed. | <a href="#">b4-army-rout</a>                                 | <a href="#">b4-part-xi-morale-fear-rout-and-re-treat</a>                                                                 |
| Artifact       | A unique magic item that only one copy can normally exist at a time.                                                           | <a href="#">b12-22-artifacts-as-a-world-state-race</a>       | <a href="#">b5-artifacts</a> ; <a href="#">b5-artifact-races</a>                                                         |

| Term            | Working definition                                                                                                             | Primary anchor                                              | Related anchors                                                  |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ascension Point | A victory point supplied by a claimed Throne of Ascension.                                                                     | b6-throne-arithmetic                                        | b1-throne-of-ascension                                           |
| Assassin        | A commander or effect that initiates a restricted battle against a target commander.                                           | b6-part-ix-thugs-supercombatants-assassins-and-remote-force | b1-assassinations-resolve-before-conventional-movement           |
| Automatic ID    | An object identity assigned by the loader when a mod creates an object without a fixed numeric ID.                             | b8-automatic-allocation                                     | b9-19-4-automatic-id-collision-risk                              |
| Awakening       | The process and timing by which a dormant or imprisoned Pretender becomes active.                                              | b3-part-iii-awakening-time-and-the-opening                  | b3-awakening-points                                              |
| Battle group    | A force that enters and resolves one tactical battle together; several forces in a province may not always form one group.     | b4-battle-groups                                            | b1-retreats-belong-to-battle-groups                              |
| Battle magic    | Spells cast during tactical battle under scripting, range, targeting, gem, fatigue, and AI constraints.                        | b4-part-xiv-battlefield-magic                               | b5-part-vi-battlefield-magic-by-function                         |
| Bless           | The collection of effects granted to a blessed sacred unit or commander.                                                       | b3-part-vi-blessings                                        | b9-8-de-blessing-revision                                        |
| Blood slave     | A Blood-magic resource with unit-like and logistical properties distinct from ordinary gems.                                   | b5-blood-slaves                                             | b2-blood-hunting                                                 |
| Bodyguard       | A unit assigned to protect a commander in an assassination battle, subject to bodyguard limits and arrival rules.              | b11-28-bodyguards-and-warning                               | b6-assassination-defence                                         |
| Booster         | An item, spell, shape, site, or effect that increases effective magic-path access.                                             | b5-booster-reference                                        | b5-hidden-and-indirect-access                                    |
| Breakpoint      | A research level or access threshold at which a usable strategic or battlefield package becomes available.                     | b5-research-breakpoints                                     | b6-part-v-research-as-a-strategic-response-tree                  |
| Call God        | The priestly process used to return a dead Pretender, governed by rules distinct from ordinary resurrection.                   | b3-call-god                                                 | b3-part-vii-pretender-death-recall-and-divine-continuity         |
| Capital-only    | A restriction tying recruitment or another feature to a nation's original capital.                                             | b1-capital-only                                             | b2-recruitment-restrictions                                      |
| Cataclysm       | An endgame mechanism that increases late-game pressure and horror activity under relevant game settings.                       | b6-cataclysm                                                | b6-part-xii-thrones-cataclysm-and-endgame-conversion             |
| Chassis         | The Pretender's physical form, including cost, paths, slots, statistics, movement, and special abilities.                      | b3-chassis-roles                                            | b3-part-ii-chassis-paths-and-design-capabilities; b12-pretenders |
| Collision       | A conflict in which mods claim or alter the same identifier, code, variable, name reference, or dependent object incompatibly. | b8-part-xi-compatibility-engineering                        | b9-19-combined-load-order-and-collision-matrix                   |



| Term                 | Working definition                                                                                                                                  | Primary anchor                                               | Related anchors                                                |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Command              | A single-hash instruction whose practical meaning depends on its object language, arguments, selector state, and manual context.                    | b14-syntax                                                   | b14-context; b8-part-i-the-object-and-parser-model             |
| Command template     | An official grammar such as (terrain) or a numeric range that generates literal command spellings under stated restrictions.                        | b14-syntax                                                   | b14-complete-locator                                           |
| Commander            | A unit that can receive strategic orders and may lead troops, cast spells, preach, patrol, build, or perform other commander actions.               | b1-commander                                                 | b4-part-iii-commanders-squads-leadership-and-army-organisation |
| Commander Point      | A local recruitment capacity used by commanders, separate from gold, resources, and ordinary Recruitment Points.                                    | b2-commander-points-and-holy-points                          | field-commander-points                                         |
| Condition            | A temporary or persistent unit state that changes action, statistics, targeting, recovery, loyalty, or future risk.                                 | b11-60-conditions-are-state-not-favour-text                  | b11-part-xi-conditions-and-lasting-state                       |
| Documentation status | The evidence class distinguishing a full official definition, reference-only entry, prose mention, derived template alias, or patch reconciliation. | b14-evidence                                                 | b1-evidence-standard; b13-classification-model                 |
| Communion            | A battlefield magical network in which masters gain paths while slaves receive distributed fatigue and certain master-cast personal effects.        | b5-part-vii-communions-sabbath-choruses-and-grand-communions | b5-designing-a-safe-communion                                  |
| Counter              | A capability that attacks a necessary layer of an enemy plan rather than merely naming a theoretically favourable unit or spell.                    | b4-part-xv-counter-construction-and-battle-analysis          | b6-counter-portfolios                                          |
| Critical hit         | A fatigue-influenced combat result that can reduce the protection applied against damage.                                                           | b4-critical-hits                                             | b4-part-ix-protection-damage-and-survival                      |
| Dominion             | A Pretender's religious territorial influence, carrying scales and interacting with gods, provinces, units, events, and elimination.                | b3-part-iv-dominion-and-religious-territory                  | b6-dominion-as-campaign-pressure                               |
| Dome                 | A province-centred magical defence that may intercept or interfere with remote spells and attacks.                                                  | b5-part-ix-domes-remote-attacks-and-magic-movement           | b5-layered-domes                                               |
| DRN                  | The open-ended Dominions Random Number roll used in many opposed checks and damage calculations.                                                    | b4-the-open-ended-random-roll                                | b1-randomness-and-the-dominions-random-number                  |
| Event                | A hosting-time occurrence selected from conditions, rarity, state, targets, codes, variables, and effects.                                          | b1-event                                                     | b8-part-vii-event-modding-as-a-state-machine                   |
| Event code           | An identifier used to coordinate, restrict, or connect event logic; collisions can corrupt chains across mods.                                      | b8-codes-and-variables                                       | b9-19-combined-load-order-and-collision-matrix                 |



| Term               | Working definition                                                                                                               | Primary anchor                                | Related anchors                                                |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Event variable     | Stored event state used by modded event systems to remember counters, flags, or progression.                                     | b8-codes-and-variables                        | b8-event-chains                                                |
| Experience         | Unit-specific development gained over time and through battle, producing star bonuses at defined thresholds.                     | b11-54-experience-thresholds                  | b11-56-veteran-preservation                                    |
| Expansion party    | A commander and troop package intended to capture independent provinces at an acceptable cost and tempo.                         | b6-expansion-party-roles                      | b6-expansion-testing                                           |
| Fatigue            | An accumulating combat burden that reduces performance, increases vulnerability to critical hits, and can cause unconsciousness. | b4-part-x-fatigue-recovery-and-collapse       | b4-fatigue-as-offence                                          |
| Fear               | An effect that pressures enemy morale and can accelerate rout without directly killing every target.                             | b4-fear                                       | b4-part-xi-morale-fear-rout-and-retreat                        |
| Fort               | A fortified location that changes recruitment, administration, resource draw, supply, ownership, siege, and retreat behaviour.   | b2-part-vi-infrastructure-and-administration  | b2-part-viii-siege-and-fort-control                            |
| Formation          | A squad arrangement that changes density, frontage, contact time, exposure, and movement through the battlefield.                | b4-part-v-formations-placement-and-contact    | b4-formation-fighter                                           |
| Gem                | A magical resource associated with a non-Blood path and used for rituals, forging, empowerment, and some battle spells.          | b1-gem                                        | b5-part-iv-gems-slaves-and-magical-logistics                   |
| Global enchantment | A persistent ritual effect with broad world impact and political consequences.                                                   | b5-part-x-global-enchantments-and-dispel-wars | b1-global-enchantment                                          |
| Grand Communion    | A special strategic or large-scale communion system with rules distinct from an ordinary battlefield communion.                  | b5-grand-communions-are-different             | b5-part-vii-communions-sabbaths-choruses-and-grand-communions  |
| Harassment         | A melee pressure mechanic in which repeated attackers can degrade a defender's effective defence.                                | b4-harassment                                 | b4-part-vii-melee-resolution                                   |
| Holy Point         | A local recruitment capacity used by some sacred or holy commanders and units.                                                   | b2-commander-points-and-holy-points           | field-holy-points                                              |
| Heroic ability     | A growing special trait received by an eligible non-Pretender commander while in the Hall of Fame.                               | b11-57-what-is-officially-established         | b11-58-community-derived-heroic-families                       |
| Horror Mark        | A persistent, stackable hidden mark that creates a monthly risk of a horror attack and makes the bearer a preferred target.      | b11-63-curse-and-horror-mark                  | b11-42-damage-reversal-blood-vengeance-curses-and-horror-marks |
| Host               | To resolve submitted turns; also the computer or service performing that resolution.                                             | b1-host                                       | b1-the-complete-63-step-hosting-sequence                       |

| Term                 | Working definition                                                                                                                  | Primary anchor                         | Related anchors                                     |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Incarnate            | A blessing condition generally requiring the Pretender to be active for the marked effect to function.                              | b3-incarnate-effects                   | b3-how-blessings-work                               |
| Inspector            | A structured data viewer used to inspect game or mod objects; its version and load order determine what it can prove.               | b12-part-i-the-object-reference-method | b9-24-website-and-inspector-schema; b12-maintenance |
| Laboratory           | Infrastructure required for research and most rituals and forging; construction finishes too late for earlier same-turn uses.       | b2-laboratories                        | b1-building-construction                            |
| Leadership           | Commander capacity and type governing troop assignment, morale effects, and special troop compatibility.                            | b11-24-three-leadership-pools          | b4-special-leadership                               |
| Load order           | The order in which enabled mods are applied, determining which later definitions overwrite or extend earlier ones.                  | b8-load-order                          | b9-19-combined-load-order-and-collision-matrix      |
| Mage-turn            | One mage's opportunity to research, forge, cast, move, search, patrol, or perform another mutually exclusive order.                 | b5-mage-turn-opportunity-cost          | b2-gem-income-and-mage-turn-economy                 |
| Mercenary company    | A named, time-limited force bid for during hosting, represented by a commander, troops, price, availability, and continuity fields. | b12-44-mercenary-company-records       | b2-mercenaries                                      |
| Magic phase          | Community shorthand for the early hosting steps containing rituals, magical movement, remote attacks, and associated battles.       | b1-magic-phase                         | b1-phase-ii-magic-and-special-threats               |
| Magic Being          | A unit class requiring magic leadership unless an overlapping undead or demon tag makes undead leadership take precedence.          | b11-11-magic-being                     | b11-8-classes-can-overlap                           |
| Magic Resistance     | A defence statistic used in opposed checks against many spells and supernatural effects.                                            | b4-magic-resistance-contests           | b4-penetration                                      |
| Message substitution | A case-sensitive double-hash token inserted inside supported event or enchantment text rather than issued as a mod command.         | b14-syntax                             | b8-messages-can-carry-required-object-names         |
| Mindless             | A leadership and morale category with special command, routing, and survival behaviour.                                             | b11-12-mindless                        | b4-mindless-troops                                  |
| Mod                  | A loaded modification, usually defined through .dm commands, that can add or alter data within engine-defined limits.               | b1-mod                                 | b8-part-i-the-object-and-parser-model               |
| Movement phase       | Community shorthand for the hosting steps resolving friendly movement, other movement, movement battles, and storming.              | b1-movement-phase                      | b1-movement-and-conquest                            |
| NAP                  | A non-aggression pact whose exact meaning depends on explicit player convention unless the game setting makes it binding.           | b6-non-aggression-pacts                | b6-binding-diplomacy                                |

| Term              | Working definition                                                                                                                                                 | Primary anchor                                      | Related anchors                                                                |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Object ID         | A numeric or automatic identity used by the engine, data layer, or mod loader to distinguish and reference an object.                                              | b12-1-an-object-is-an-identity-not-merely-a-name    | b8-part-ii-identifiers-allocation-and-collision-safety;<br>b8-object-lifecycle |
| Patch record      | One source-linked entry representing an official update bullet together with derived classification, domains, commands, canonical destinations, and stable hashes. | b13-11-one-official-bullet-becomes-one-patch-record | b13-classification-model;<br>b13-domain-map                                    |
| Path              | A level of magical skill in Fire, Air, Water, Earth, Astral, Death, Nature, Glamour, Blood, or Holy.                                                               | b1-path                                             | b5-part-ii-paths-schools-and-access                                            |
| Penetration       | A bonus applied to the attacking side of relevant Magic Resistance contests.                                                                                       | b4-penetration                                      | b4-magic-resistance-contests                                                   |
| Pillage           | A strategic order that converts population and order into immediate damage, unrest, and sometimes resources or gold.                                               | b2-pillaging-and-raiding                            | b6-pillage-as-a-campaign-tool                                                  |
| Plane             | A distinct strategic map layer such as the surface, caves, or another connected world.                                                                             | b1-plane                                            | b8-gates-and-multiple-planes                                                   |
| Population        | A province value influencing income, supplies, recruitment capacity, events, and the effects of pillaging or Blood Hunting.                                        | b2-population                                       | b2-part-vii-population-unrest-pillage-patrol-and-blood-hunting                 |
| Pretender         | The designed god of a nation or team, providing dominion, scales, blessings, paths, and a physical chassis.                                                        | b1-pretender                                        | b3-part-i-pretender-design-as-a-national-system; b12-pretenders                |
| Province Defence  | Locally purchased automatic defence that appears when a province is attacked and cannot move as a normal army.                                                     | b2-part-ix-province-defence                         | b6-province-defence-as-delay-and-information                                   |
| Recruitment Point | A local capacity that limits ordinary troop recruitment independently of gold and resources.                                                                       | b2-recruitment-points                               | field-recruitment-points                                                       |
| Regeneration      | Exact-percentage recovery of hit points during battle, with body-class, affliction, and damage-tempo interactions.                                                 | b11-35-regeneration-families                        | b4-regeneration                                                                |
| Remote attack     | A ritual or effect that attacks a distant province or commander without conventional movement.                                                                     | b5-part-ix-domes-remote-attacks-and-magic-movement  | b1-remote-attacks-and-magic-battles                                            |
| Repel             | A weapon-length interaction allowing a defender to threaten or deter an incoming shorter-reach melee attack.                                                       | b4-repel                                            | b4-part-vii-melee-resolution                                                   |
| Research point    | A contribution toward progress in a school; research resolves very early during hosting.                                                                           | b1-research-point                                   | b5-the-research-formula                                                        |
| Ritual            | A strategic spell cast outside tactical battle.                                                                                                                    | b1-ritual                                           | b5-part-viii-rituals-and-strategic-magic                                       |
| Rout              | A unit or squad state in which it attempts to leave battle because morale has failed.                                                                              | b1-rout                                             | b4-part-xi-morale-fear-rout-and-re-treat                                       |

| Term                | Working definition                                                                                                           | Primary anchor                                       | Related anchors                                                              |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sacred              | A unit eligible to receive a blessing and often affected by special recruitment or upkeep rules.                             | b1-sacred                                            | b3-sacred-capacity                                                           |
| Scale               | One value in the dominion pairs governing Order, Production, temperature, Growth, Fortune, and Magic.                        | b1-scale                                             | b3-part-v-scales                                                             |
| School              | A research category that unlocks spells at successive levels.                                                                | b5-research-schools                                  | b5-part-iii-research-as-strategic-planning                                   |
| Siege strength      | The attacking contribution used against a fort's walls during siege resolution.                                              | field-siege-calculation                              | b2-part-viii-siege-and-fort-control                                          |
| Site                | A province feature that can provide gems, gold, recruitment, discounts, rituals, unrest, disease, or other effects.          | b12-part-vi-thrones-and-magic-sites                  | b1-site; b2-part-x-sites-gems-and-magical-capital                            |
| Size point          | A unit of battlefield-square occupancy used by unit size and formation density.                                              | b1-size-point                                        | b4-square-capacity                                                           |
| Special dominion    | A national or Pretender rule that changes what dominion does beyond ordinary candle and scale effects.                       | b12-part-viii-special-dominion-systems               | b3-special-dominions; b3-test-p11-special-dominions                          |
| Spell fatigue       | Fatigue generated by spellcasting after spell cost, caster skill, gems, and other modifiers.                                 | b4-spell-fatigue                                     | b5-fatigue-and-overcasting                                                   |
| Squad               | A tactical troop group assigned to a commander and given one formation and order set.                                        | b1-squad                                             | b4-squads                                                                    |
| Starvation          | The post-battle condition caused by insufficient supplies, producing disease, morale, and attritional consequences.          | b2-starvation                                        | b1-starvation-is-late                                                        |
| Stealth             | The ability to move or remain hidden in hostile territory, opposed by patrol and detection effects.                          | b6-patrol-and-stealth                                | b1-sneaking-discovery-can-cause-a-late-battle                                |
| Summon relation     | A versioned link from a summoning spell to the unit, unit group, or selection rule that produces its result.                 | b12-24-a-summon-record-is-a-relationship             | b5-summoning                                                                 |
| Supply              | Provincial and army logistical capacity used to feed units and modified by terrain, forts, dominion, seasons, and abilities. | b2-part-v-supplies-logistics-and-starvation          | b6-part-vi-logistics-supply-and-operational-reach                            |
| Taskmaster          | A leadership ability that manages slave units and changes their morale handling.                                             | b11-26-taskmaster-beast-master-and-special-followers | b4-taskmasters                                                               |
| Tempo               | The rate at which a position turns present resources and opportunities into initiative before opponents can answer.          | b6-tempo                                             | b6-initiative                                                                |
| Throne of Ascension | A claimable special site providing Ascension Points and other effects toward the configured victory condition.               | b12-36-thrones-are-sites-with-victory-meaning        | b1-throne-of-ascension; b6-part-xii-thrones-cataclysm-and-endgame-conversion |

| Term            | Working definition                                                                                                                      | Primary anchor                                                  | Related anchors                                                |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Thug            | A relatively cheap, equipped commander designed for a bounded independent combat or raiding role.                                       | b6-part-ix-thugs-supercombatants<br>-assassins-and-remote-force | b6-thug-roles                                                  |
| Trample         | A size-based attack produced by moving through smaller units, with displacement, damage, and fatigue consequences.                      | b11-45-trample                                                  | b4-trampling                                                   |
| Unit class      | One of several overlapping type tags that can determine leadership, targeting, supplies, healing, morale, immunity, or movement.        | b11-8-classes-can-overlap                                       | b11-part-ii-unit-classes-and-status-tags                       |
| Unrest          | A province condition that reduces income and administration and interacts with recruitment, events, patrol, pillage, and Blood Hunting. | b1-unrest                                                       | b2-part-vii-population-unrest-pillage-patrol-and-blood-hunting |
| Upkeep          | The recurring gold cost of maintaining units and commanders, paid after income during hosting.                                          | b1-upkeep                                                       | b2-upkeep                                                      |
| Version delta   | An official or verified change between two named ruleset versions, kept separate from the current rule it modifies.                     | b13-3-patch-notes-are-deltas-not-replacement-manuals            | b13-release-timeline;<br>b13-stale-guide-repair                |
| Wall integrity  | The remaining defensive strength of a fort during siege, reduced by besiegers and restored by defenders.                                | b2-part-viii-siege-and-fort-control                             | field-siege-calculation                                        |
| Wish            | A high-level Astral spell offering a defined but partly version-sensitive set of requested outcomes.                                    | b5-wish                                                         | b5-test-18-wish                                                |
| Zone of control | A battlefield movement constraint created by nearby hostile units.                                                                      | b4-zones-of-control                                             | b4-part-v-formations-placement-and-contact                     |

## Part V: Website Publication Model

### The unit of publication

The website should not treat an entire book as one page or every paragraph as an independent fact. The practical unit is a section containing ordered blocks. A section belongs to one versioned ruleset, has one stable destination, and can contain prose, tables, formulas, examples, checklists, claims, and source references.

The hierarchy is:

```
library
book or guide
part
section
content blocks
claims
evidence and sources
```

Each claim can be updated without silently changing the status of the surrounding advice. A strategic recommendation can sit beside an official formula while remaining a different kind of knowledge.

## Required metadata

Every publishable section should carry:

- stable ID and URL slug;
- title, short title, and parent;
- book, part, and display order;
- ruleset and exact version scope;
- evidence status;
- source references and access dates;
- topic tags and audience level;
- related sections;
- unresolved-question IDs where applicable;
- last verified and last edited dates;
- replacement or deprecation links when a section moves.

The machine-readable schema makes these fields explicit. Empty fields remain visible during validation rather than being silently discarded.

## Structured object records

[Book XII](#) adds a second publication unit for facts that are too numerous for readable prose: the object record. The 6.35 register contains 4,196 versioned records across spells, items, summon relations, Pretender forms, Thrones, other sites, mercenary companies, independent-coverage status, and special dominion systems. Each record carries a stable identity, category, ruleset, evidence status, provenance, record hash, source fields, editorial tags, and a canonical [Book XII](#) section.

The object register does not compete with the main explanations. Books II-VI still own economic, religious, magical, and strategic interpretation. Object pages expose exact fields and link to those chapters; the chapters use selected examples and link back to the records. Independent population types and unresolved selection-based summons remain visibly incomplete instead of being filled from obsolete data.

## Structured patch records

[Book XIII](#) adds a third publication unit: the patch record. The 6.36 ledger contains 1,090 records covering all 32 official public update announcements from 6.01 onward. Each record carries release and source identity, official section and bullet locator, source hash, derived change class and confidence, affected domains, commands and named terms, canonical destinations, and a record hash.

The patch record establishes chronology and maintenance impact. It does not replace the official announcement or the current-rule chapter. Source identity is official; classification, materiality, domain routing, and summaries are editorial. The 250 review-recommended classifications remain searchable while their lower interpretive confidence is visible.

## Structured command records

Book XIV adds a fourth publication unit: the command record. The 6.36 lexicon contains 1,609 distinct hash tokens found in the current official Modding, Event Modding, and Map Making manuals. Each record preserves spelling, token kind, documentation status, domains, manual versions and pages, syntax locators, patch relations, cautions, canonical destinations, and a record hash. The same data layer also supplies 97 controlled aliases for official terrain and numeric templates and reconciles all 226 patch-note tokens without silently rewriting historical wording. Five commands introduced by 6.36 are marked official patch-only because the announcement does not supply their full syntax.

Command records are locators rather than copied manual prose. A defined record points to the full official explanation. Reference-only and mention-only records keep documentation gaps visible. Double-hash message substitutions remain a separate token kind, while patch family expressions and spelling discrepancies live in explicit reconciliation relations.

## Content block types

The schema supports:

- 1 prose;
- 2 callout;
- 3 formula;
- 4 table;
- 5 ordered or unordered list;
- 6 worked example;
- 7 checklist;
- 8 quotation within copyright limits;
- 9 source note;
- 10 unresolved research question.

Formulas receive their own IDs, variables, units, rounding notes, evidence status, and worked examples. This prevents a formula from becoming an untraceable sentence copied across several web pages.

## Version and ruleset behaviour

The website must never display an unqualified value when several rulesets are available. A page may compare unmodded Dominions 6, DE, Divinitus, and the frozen combined load order, but every value is attached to its own scope. Historical values remain accessible through version records rather than being overwritten without explanation.

Recommended default labels are:

- dom6-6.36 for the live rules baseline;
- dom6-6.35-data for records pinned to the Inspector snapshot;
- de-2.16;
- divinitus-1.15.3-de;
- de-2.16\_\_divinitus-1.15.3-de with DE loaded first;
- historical with the original version stated;
- experimental with project version and test harness.

## Beginner and expert presentation

The same source section can support two interfaces:

- Guide view shows the explanation, a restrained number of examples, and the next useful section.
- Reference view foregrounds formulas, exact tables, evidence, version scope, exceptions, and related records.

These are views over the same content identity. Maintaining separate beginner and expert articles would recreate the duplication problem solved in Edition 11.

## Search and filtering

At minimum, the website index should support:

- title and full-text search;
- book, topic, ruleset, evidence, and audience filters;
- exact-object lookup by category and numeric ID;
- patch lookup by version range, class, domain, command, named term, and canonical destination;
- command lookup by exact spelling, alias, domain, manual, page, documentation status, patch version, context collision, and token kind;
- unresolved-only and recently-verified views;
- reverse links showing every section that depends on a claim;
- aliases so terms such as PD, Province Defence, and province defense reach the same destination.

The generated content index already records every heading, parent, stable anchor, source file, website path, and source line number. It helps locate material, but it does not replace parsed claims.

# Part VI: Prioritised Foundational Research Register

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## Scope of the active register

The active queue contains questions that can be advanced without asking the player to run bespoke tests. Acceptable routes are current official documentation, official patch records, supplied mod source, current structured data tied to a version, or a published reproduction with enough procedure and evidence to audit. Questions that still depend on undocumented engine behaviour remain visible in a blocked register but do not interrupt the next writing phase.

Priority means:

- P0 - integrity: a wrong answer can invalidate a ruleset, mod load, or large body of derived work;
- P1 - frequent play: the rule affects common economic, combat, magic, or campaign decisions;
- P2 - advanced play: the rule matters regularly to expert planning but less often to a new player;
- P3 - specialist: the rule chiefly affects unusual objects, mod engineering, or edge-case publication.



| ID    | Priority | Domain           | Question                                                                                                              | Why it matters                                                                                                                                | Reliable route                                                                                                                                                                                     | Primary anchor                                | Status    |
|-------|----------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------|
| R-001 | P0       | Versioning       | Which official rules and commands changed after the revision-2 manual and the 6.34, 6.29, and 6.26 auxiliary manuals? | Every later formula and mod claim depends on the correct current baseline.                                                                    | Book XIII supplies the complete official patch side; Book XIV reconciles every patch token against the current auxiliary manuals.                                                                  | b14-patch-reconciliation                      | completed |
| R-002 | P0       | Load order       | What load order did the Divinitus 1.15.3 DE author intend in the public release wording?                              | A reversed order can change hundreds of shared objects.                                                                                       | Project description and version 1.15.0 changelog, audited in the independent integrity report.                                                                                                     | b9-2-3-public-author-sources                  | completed |
| R-003 | P0       | Collision        | What object and dependency chain does the monster 8616 conflict affect under the frozen stack?                        | The collision breaks the identity shared by DE's Ring, Amulet, and Blood Vial helpers and the Divinitus Crystal Priest.                       | Exact source trace, upstream accepted repair, and pinned Inspector resolution in the independent integrity report.                                                                                 | b9-20-4-independent-compatibility-publication | completed |
| R-004 | P0       | Automatic IDs    | What IDs do the 69 automatic Divinitus monsters and 26 automatic spells receive in the frozen load order?             | Stable website records and downstream references require versioned secondary identities.                                                      | Exact-version structured Inspector register in the independent integrity report; engine confirmation remains separately labelled pending.                                                          | b9-20-4-independent-compatibility-publication | completed |
| R-005 | P0       | Source integrity | Which commands in the supplied mods fall outside complete current auxiliary-manual definitions?                       | An unfamiliar command cannot be explained safely until documentation, parser recognition, annotation syntax, and likely errors are separated. | Static command inventory against current official manuals, patch notes, and the pinned parser in the independent integrity report.                                                                 | b9-20-4-independent-compatibility-publication | completed |
| R-006 | P1       | Economy          | What are the current unmodded Growth and Death income percentages?                                                    | Pretender and fort economics depend on the correct scale multiplier.                                                                          | Modding Manual 6.34 defines <code>#deathincome</code> default 2; no official announcement through 6.36 changes it.                                                                                 | b2-growth-and-death-income                    | completed |
| R-007 | P1       | Economy          | What are the current unmodded Order and Turmoil resource percentages?                                                 | Production planning and scale evaluation depend on the current value.                                                                         | Revision-2 main-manual 2% rule checked against the complete official patch ledger through 6.36.                                                                                                    | b2-order-and-turmoil-resources                | completed |
| R-008 | P1       | Economy          | At which steps does the engine round income, resources, Recruitment Points, and fort draw?                            | Close recruitment and fort calculations can change at integer boundaries.                                                                     | The canonical section now separates six rounding subsystems and their operational displays; complete closure still requires published 6.36 boundary reproductions or developer-confirmed formulas. | b2-rounding-formula-display-and-treasury      | queued    |
| R-009 | P1       | Recruitment      | What is the current Commander Point base and how do exceptional modifiers stack?                                      | Commander bottlenecks can determine fort and mage efficiency.                                                                                 | Revision-2 fort bonuses, current 6.35 community base and accumulation reference, official <code>#slowrec</code> and <code>#rpcost</code> semantics, AI exclusions, and patch review through 6.36.  | b2-commander-points                           | completed |

| ID    | Priority | Domain     | Question                                                                                   | Why it matters                                                                     | Reliable route                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Primary anchor                    | Status      |
|-------|----------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------|
| R-010 | P1       | Upkeep     | How are sacred slaves, mounted forms, and shapechanged units charged upkeep?               | Persistent roster costs affect long-war sustainability.                            | The 6.33 observation and pinned 6.35 component fields resolve stacking and mounted decomposition; annual samples exclude a simple final floor, while shape classes and monthly aggregation remain open.                                                                  | b2-upkeep                         | in-progress |
| R-011 | P1       | Unrest     | Which current unrest thresholds reduce Recruitment Points and Commander Points?            | A province can appear affordable while being unable to recruit the planned roster. | Official shutdown and current community reduction claims are preserved; the loss-floor reading now has explicit 1-, 2-, and 3-point candidate thresholds, still awaiting a versioned reproduction.                                                                       | b2-unrest-effects                 | queued      |
| R-012 | P1       | Supply     | What is the exact fort-supply distance arithmetic under current rules?                     | Supply range determines operational reach and siege endurance.                     | Range, maximum distance, and highest-fort selection are separated from the official x6 versus x4 multiplier conflict; a published 6.36 distance series remains required.                                                                                                 | b2-fort-supply-range              | queued      |
| R-013 | P1       | Starvation | Are commanders ever exempt from starvation, and which forms or abilities alter the result? | Commander survival affects retreats, sieges, and remote expeditions.               | Need Not Eat, the 6.18 transformation correction, 6.35 object fields, and the 6.35 equipment-refresh fix resolve explicit immunity and display state; generic priority remains open.                                                                                     | b2-starvation                     | in-progress |
| R-014 | P1       | Pretenders | What is the current awakening-point distribution for dormant and imprisoned Pretenders?    | Opening timing determines whether a design solves expansion or only a later war.   | The June 2026 Dominions 6 page republishes Loggy's model, but source tracing reaches pre-Dominions 6 notes, no 6.x raw sample, and a one-turn range discrepancy. Current reproduction or developer confirmation is still required.                                       | b3-test-p1-awakening-distribution | queued      |
| R-015 | P1       | Dominion   | What are the current checks and order for ordinary dominion spread?                        | Temple, priest, and candle investments depend on the actual spread model.          | Revision-2 official formulas and turn sequence, reconciled with the 6.13 random-preaching correction and later patch history.                                                                                                                                            | b3-sources-of-dominion-spread     | completed   |
| R-016 | P1       | Blessings  | Which blessing tags, values, and activation edge cases differ from the revision-2 manual?  | Small errors can invalidate a Pretender design or sacred package.                  | 6.35 structured bless data plus official rules and patches through 6.36 establish activation gates, automatic blessing, repeatability, overlap, weapon-trigger, item, and mount boundaries; adjacent transformation and cross-source stacking remain separate questions. | b3-the-activation-state-machine   | completed   |

| ID    | Priority | Domain          | Question                                                                                                  | Why it matters                                                                    | Reliable route                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Primary anchor                        | Status      |
|-------|----------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------|
| R-017 | P1       | Pretender death | What are the current Call God thresholds and contribution rules?                                          | Recovery planning after a god's death depends on time-to-return.                  | Official Holy, Disciple-game, Elegist, Recall God, Trinity, and hosting rules are reconciled with published controlled research establishing a fixed 50-point base and per-priest effective-rating - 1/0/+1 variation; detailed routing and placement remain Current Community Reference. | b3-r-017-decision                     | completed   |
| R-018 | P1       | Victory         | How are same-turn Throne claim, province loss, and victory checks ordered in current play?                | The result can decide a game despite later movement or siege outcomes.            | Official steps 8 and 57, full and partial ownership rules, the current conquest rule, and a published same-turn report establish the claimant-death, unfortified-conquest, siege, and fort-storm branches. Exact simultaneous winning-total ties remain separate.                         | b3-same-turn-claim-loss-and-victory   | completed   |
| R-019 | P1       | Combat          | What is the exact current survivor bonus in morale checks?                                                | Rout thresholds influence squad sizing, standards, and casualty tolerance.        | Current community formula supplies round(5 x surviving proportion); a current raw boundary set and separate commander treatment are still required.                                                                                                                                       | b4-test-9-morale-survivor-bonus       | in-progress |
| R-020 | P1       | Combat          | How much fatigue do active units recover while conscious under ordinary conditions?                       | Fatigue breakpoints shape armour, melee endurance, and spell-support value.       | Current community reference supplies one per active round plus Reinvigoration; a frame-by-frame 6.36 reproduction remains required.                                                                                                                                                       | b4-test-12-ordinary-fatigue-recovery  | in-progress |
| R-021 | P1       | Combat          | What is the exact harassment accumulation and decay model?                                                | Defence collapse and swarm counters depend on more than the visible attack value. | Official accumulation is resolved; a Dominions 5 decay constant is retained only as a regression hypothesis for a current instrumented reproduction.                                                                                                                                      | b4-test-2-harassment-decay            | in-progress |
| R-022 | P1       | Combat          | What are the complete current weapon cooldown and combat-speed constants?                                 | Attack rate changes damage delivery, repel exposure, and fatigue pressure.        | Current structured data and published timing reproduction.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | b4-test-3-cooldown-and-combat-speed   | queued      |
| R-023 | P1       | Mounted combat  | What are the full current mounted carry, targeting, and movement calculations?                            | Rider and mount statistics otherwise produce misleading army comparisons.         | Official targeting and component rules are resolved; carry, mixed-component movement, and exceptional modifier order remain open.                                                                                                                                                         | b4-test-7-mounted-targeting           | in-progress |
| R-024 | P1       | Magic           | What thresholds govern optional combat-gem use and refusal?                                               | A scripted spell package can fail because the caster conserves a gem.             | Official 6.12, 6.15, and 6.30 corrections bound the historical thresholds; a current reproducible battle set remains required.                                                                                                                                                            | b5-test-3-combat-gem-spending         | in-progress |
| R-025 | P1       | Magic           | Where does rounding occur in spell fatigue, penetration, communion sharing, forging, and ritual contests? | Boundary values can change caster safety and access ladders.                      | Published current reproductions separated by subsystem.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | b5-part-xvi-controlled-test-programme | queued      |

| ID    | Priority | Domain        | Question                                                                                           | Why it matters                                                                              | Reliable route                                                                                                                              | Primary anchor                        | Status      |
|-------|----------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------|
| R-026 | P1       | Communion s   | What current edge cases govern shared self-buffs, collapse, and automatic communion items?         | Communion failure can destroy the most valuable mage concentration in an army.              | Manual rules and official 6.12-6.30 corrections resolve the core; automatic-item, form-change, and forced-removal behaviour remain open.    | b5-communion-audit                    | in-progress |
| R-027 | P1       | Movement      | What is the exact interception probability and battle location when hostile forces swap provinces? | Movement prediction determines reinforcement and retreat planning.                          | A published chassis-value algorithm supplies a precise hypothesis; a 6.36 map-and-save reproduction remains required.                       | b6-movement-and-interception          | in-progress |
| R-028 | P1       | Patrol        | What are the current patrol-detection distributions across stealth and patrol modifiers?           | Counter-raiding and scout survival depend on risk rather than a binary threshold.           | The official open-ended 2d25 formula has been enumerated directly from D=-60 to +60; exceptional contributors remain regression tests.      | b6-patrol-and-stealth                 | completed   |
| R-029 | P1       | Raiding       | What are the current Raid and pillage output functions?                                            | Economic warfare cannot be compared honestly without expected return and population damage. | Official legality and sequence are resolved; historical exact-output formulas are now 6.36 reproduction predicates rather than current law. | b6-raid-order                         | in-progress |
| R-030 | P1       | Diplomacy     | Which binding-NAP edge cases occur under every diplomacy setting?                                  | Interface-enforced treaties must not be described through informal multiplayer custom.      | Official 6.01-6.30 exceptions are versioned; the complete binding, nonbinding, and absent action matrix remains open.                       | b6-binding-diplomacy                  | in-progress |
| R-031 | P1       | Thrones       | What are the complete current Throne identities and object effects?                                | Endgame plans require exact Ascension Points, defenders, and claimed bonuses.               | Pinned 6.35 structured site data, cross-checked against current official rules.                                                             | b12-thrones-sites                     | completed   |
| R-032 | P2       | Domes         | In what order are layered domes checked, and are their outcomes independent?                       | Remote warfare portfolios depend on cumulative interception risk.                           | Published current controlled reproduction.                                                                                                  | b5-layered-domes                      | queued      |
| R-033 | P2       | Wish          | What vocabulary, aliases, distributions, and restrictions does Wish currently accept?              | Late-game plans can waste rare Astral access on obsolete or ambiguous requests.             | Current official data or versioned published catalogue with reproduction.                                                                   | b5-wish                               | queued      |
| R-034 | P2       | Artifacts     | How are simultaneous artifact forges and global casts resolved at exact ties?                      | Multiplayer races need a defensible risk model.                                             | Official hosting rule or published simultaneous-order reproduction.                                                                         | b5-test-16-artifact-race-and-yearning | queued      |
| R-035 | P2       | Assassination | What are the exact bodyguard, Patience, surprise, and mounted-assassination distributions?         | Commander survival packages depend on more than nominal bodyguard count.                    | Published current controlled reproduction.                                                                                                  | b6-assassination-defence              | queued      |
| R-036 | P2       | Cataclysm     | What is the final current Cataclysm outcome wording and horror interaction?                        | Endgame clocks and coalition decisions depend on the actual failure state.                  | Current official object data and patch notes.                                                                                               | b6-cataclysm                          | queued      |
| R-037 | P2       | Event systems | In what order do several rarity-5 global state machines update the same state?                     | Large overhaul compatibility can fail without any numeric collision.                        | Author documentation or published deterministic harness.                                                                                    | b8-event-execution-and-order          | queued      |

| ID    | Priority | Domain             | Question                                                                                                    | Why it matters                                                                       | Reliable route                                                                                                                                                              | Primary anchor                                  | Status      |
|-------|----------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| R-038 | P2       | Mod parser         | Which cross-mod name-reference categories resolve before or after later definitions?                        | Name references can fail even when numeric IDs do not collide.                       | Official parser documentation or minimal published loader reproduction.                                                                                                     | b8-cross-mod-reference-limits                   | queued      |
| R-039 | P2       | Object inheritance | Which hidden copied attributes are absent from Ctrl+i and ordinary inspector cards?                         | A visible final card may omit inherited behaviour needed for compatibility.          | Exact-version source history plus structured engine export.                                                                                                                 | b8-copied-objects-are-not-self-contained        | queued      |
| R-040 | P2       | Transformations    | Which prophet, mount, heroic, item, and temporary states survive combined transformations?                  | Shape chains can silently lose national or sacred roles.                             | Published current transformation matrix.                                                                                                                                    | b8-shape-regression                             | queued      |
| R-041 | P3       | Events             | What are the current event-variable overflow and negative-value behaviours?                                 | Long event campaigns can corrupt state near numeric boundaries.                      | Official limit documentation or minimal published harness.                                                                                                                  | b8-variable-discipline                          | queued      |
| R-042 | P3       | Performance        | How does hosting time scale with large always-event libraries?                                              | Scenario design needs a practical performance budget.                                | Published hardware, turn, province, and event-count benchmark.                                                                                                              | b8-performance-controls                         | queued      |
| R-043 | P3       | AI                 | How often are AI templates selected and how reliably does the AI use multi-plane gates?                     | Scenario claims should distinguish configured hints from observed behaviour.         | Published behavioural sample tied to version and map.                                                                                                                       | b8-ai-testing-is-behavioural-sampling           | queued      |
| R-044 | P3       | Save compatibility | Which inserted automatic spell and item objects break existing saves?                                       | Release updates need a safe migration policy.                                        | Published version-to-version save matrix.                                                                                                                                   | b8-save-compatibility                           | queued      |
| R-045 | P3       | Networking         | Which filename and dependency mismatches are rejected or silently tolerated by the lobby?                   | Public mod releases need predictable multiplayer installation behaviour.             | Official documentation or published clean-client matrix.                                                                                                                    | b8-network-and-lobby-test                       | queued      |
| R-046 | P0       | Experience         | Does a current five-star unit receive a cumulative +2 or +3 Hit Points from experience?                     | A public veteran calculator must not conceal a version conflict.                     | Official 6.13 changed veteran HP to +1 at each star from the third onward, 6.14 corrected XP HP-stat handling, and the current manual repeats the three increments.         | b11-54-experience-thresholds                    | completed   |
| R-047 | P1       | Heroic abilities   | Which Hall-of-Fame scoring and heroic-growth formulas remain unchanged in 6.36?                             | Old reverse engineering is useful but cannot be represented as current official law. | Edition 28 defines the official boundary and a versioned raw-observation template; current reproducible tests or engine-backed reverse engineering must supply any formula. | b11-57-what-is-officially-established           | in-progress |
| R-048 | P1       | Perception         | How do current perception abilities divide Glamour, Invisibility, Unseen, Illusion, and Spiritform targets? | A false equivalence can invalidate targeting and counter design.                     | Official 6.36 ability definitions, current spell descriptions, and a patch check establish the category division; two narrower runtime edges moved to R-058.                | b11-31-glamour-invisibility-unseen-and-illusion | completed   |

| ID    | Priority | Domain                | Question                                                                                                                                                          | Why it matters                                                                                                           | Reliable route                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Primary anchor                                   | Status      |
|-------|----------|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| R-049 | P1       | Ability stacking      | Which ability sources stack, use best-only, or replace one another across form, item, bless, and spell?                                                           | Duplicate investment can waste gems, design points, and scripts.                                                         | Current definitions confirm best-only Standard and Inspiring Researcher, cumulative experience and Horror Mark, and non-stacking Blur, Displacement, and Invisibility; unlisted abilities remain test-specific. | b11-6-stacking-precidence-and-the-best-only-rule | in-progress |
| R-050 | P2       | Experience            | Which current passive XP exceptions apply to Mindless units, sites, items, arenas, and events?                                                                    | Veteran timing and Hall-of-Fame plans depend on the actual gain sources.                                                 | Controlled monthly observation and current data export.                                                                                                                                                         | b11-53-how-experience-is-gained                  | queued      |
| R-051 | P2       | Unit classes          | Which condition immunities follow from a visible class and which require a separate hidden tag?                                                                   | Visual or taxonomic assumptions can produce false counters.                                                              | Current object export plus controlled spell and condition matrix.                                                                                                                                               | b11-8-classes-can-overlap                        | queued      |
| R-052 | P2       | Mount state           | How do mount loss, Reclaim Mount, automatic return, and shape changes transfer experience and conditions?                                                         | Mounted commanders can change body and function across the turn boundary.                                                | Controlled mounted-commander series under 6.36.                                                                                                                                                                 | b11-38-immortality-reformation-and-extra-lives   | queued      |
| R-053 | P1       | Independents          | What are the complete 6.35 independent population types and their province recruitment rosters?                                                                   | Expansion, fort placement, and off-path recruitment depend on exact independent access.                                  | Exact-version engine or inspector export containing population-type membership.                                                                                                                                 | b12-mercenaries-independents                     | queued      |
| R-054 | P2       | Summons               | Which unit identities satisfy the 25 unresolved selection- or tag-based summon relations?                                                                         | A spell record is incomplete when it names a selector but not the possible summoned units.                               | Exact-version engine export or published reproducible selector resolution.                                                                                                                                      | b12-summons                                      | queued      |
| R-055 | P2       | Object labels         | What are the authoritative human labels for remaining source-native item and site property fields?                                                                | Public filters should be readable without pretending that an inferred label is official.                                 | Current UI wording, official manuals, and exact-version object export compared field by field.                                                                                                                  | b12-maintenance                                  | queued      |
| R-056 | P2       | Patch classification  | Which of the 250 review-recommended patch records need a different fine-grained class or more precise canonical destination?                                      | Source completeness is settled, but accurate filters improve website maintenance and command chronology.                 | Human review of each official source bullet against the Book XIII classification key and canonical ownership map.                                                                                               | b13-editorial-review                             | in-progress |
| R-057 | P2       | Command documentation | Which of the 60 reference-only, nine mention-only, and five 6.36 patch-only tokens can receive verified semantics without inventing undocumented behaviour?       | Search is complete, but a token's official existence is not always a complete behavioural contract.                      | Later official manuals or announcements, developer clarification, or a published minimal reproduction tied to an exact version and object context.                                                              | b14-evidence                                     | queued      |
| R-058 | P1       | Perception edges      | Do Spirit Sight or blindness alter innate Glamour's Mirror Image resolution, and which non-scout information channels reveal Glamour units in friendly provinces? | Category boundaries are documented, but these exact interactions still affect counter selection and strategic detection. | The manual explicitly confirms Arcoscephale dominion scrying and The Eyes of God as narrow channels; reproduce those controls and run the Edition 29 battle and information matrix for the remaining edges.     | b11-31-glamour-invisibility-unseen-and-illusion  | in-progress |

## Blocked engine questions

The following subjects remain outside the active queue until a reliable reproduction, current inspector export, or local executable becomes available:

- unresolved same-turn effects whose official timing list does not define the internal branch;
- final cards produced by occupied-ID `#newmonster` behaviour without an engine export;
- undocumented target-selection weights with no published sample;
- all-AI strategic evaluation weights;
- nation-specific expansion ranges without a reproducible map and independent set;
- private multiplayer outcomes that cannot be independently checked.

These are not requests for the player to perform labour. They are publication limits.

## Research order

R-001 is resolved by Books XIII and XIV. R-002 through R-005 are resolved by the independent DE-Divinitus integrity publication and are cross-linked through [Book IX](#) without absorbing that publication into the encyclopedia. R-006, R-007, R-009, and R-015 through R-018 are resolved in Books II and III at their stated evidence tiers. R-010 and R-013 are in progress; R-008, R-011, R-012, and R-014 remain queued behind reliable reproduction or better structured evidence. Edition 23 supplies their narrow test predicates and safe operational fallbacks. Edition 24 changes the voice of the reader corpus without changing those statuses. Edition 25 advances R-054 and R-055, closes the realm-expansion subtask, and leaves R-053 queued for an exact population-type export. Edition 26 works through R-019 to R-030: R-028 is completed by direct enumeration of the official patrol formula; R-019 to R-021, R-023, R-024, R-026, R-027, R-029, and R-030 are in progress with sharper evidence boundaries and reproducible predicates; R-022 and R-025 remain queued. Edition 27 closes R-046 from the official 6.13-6.14 patch boundary and current manual. R-031 is resolved in the 6.35 object register, while R-057 can advance alongside documentation maintenance.

# Part VII: Maintenance Rules

## Adding a section

When new material is written:

- 1 place it in the book that owns the subject;
- 2 reuse the existing heading destination if the subject is being revised;
- 3 add aliases to the website index rather than creating duplicate glossary entries;
- 4 attach ruleset, evidence, sources, and verification date;
- 5 link related sections without copying their formulas or tables;
- 6 add unresolved behaviour to the research register with a route and priority;
- 7 rebuild and validate the PDF and website exports together.

## Moving or replacing a section

A moved section should keep its destination ID where possible. If the subject has genuinely split, the old ID should become a redirect to a short landing section that explains the new authoritative homes. Silent deletion would break PDF annotations, website links, saved bookmarks, and citations in future dossiers.

## Preventing duplication from returning

Before adding a formula, table, full definition, or technical essay, search the content index by title, alias, and tag. If an authoritative version already exists, the new section should link to it and explain only the new context. Repetition is reserved for field references, worked applications, and deliberately self-contained print tools.



# Foundation Book I: Rulesets, Language, and the Anatomy of a Turn

## Why this volume comes first

Most rules in Dominions 6 are manageable on their own. The difficulty comes from having hundreds of them interact during the same turn. A player may understand recruitment, movement, rituals, battles, dominion, and upkeep separately, then still misread a result because they resolved in an unexpected order.

Book I sets out the language and turn order used throughout the library. It works at three levels:

- New-player level: enough explanation to understand what an order does, when it happens, and why an apparent failure occurred.
- Experienced-player level: exact timing relationships, failure points, and strategic consequences.
- Research level: a versioned record of sources, interpretations, and unresolved edge cases.

Nation-specific builds are left for later books. The examples use ordinary commanders, troops, provinces, rituals, and forts so the same conclusions can be used in any age.

Foundation rule: A strategy should never depend on an unexplained timing assumption. When a plan works only because one action resolves before another, that timing needs to be stated here.

## How to read the library

There is no need to read the whole library before playing. The boxed rules, plain-language summaries, and checklists are enough to support a first campaign. The full chapters become useful when a turn behaves strangely, a multiplayer plan depends on exact timing, or a rule needs to be checked for publication. Source notes and unresolved tests sit alongside the rules so that doubtful points remain visible instead of becoming folklore.

## Where each subject lives

Each rule has one main home. Later books may give a short reminder when the subject crosses into another system, but the full explanation should not be repeated.

| Subject                                                                       | Authoritative home               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| terminology, evidence labels, ruleset versions, and hosting order             | Book I                           |
| order-writing formulas needed at a glance                                     | Turn and Economy Quick Reference |
| provinces, income, recruitment, infrastructure, supply, PD, and siege economy | Book II                          |
| Pretenders, dominion, scales, blessings, and religious systems                | Book III                         |
| formations, combat arithmetic, morale, fatigue, and battle resolution         | Book IV                          |
| research, paths, gems, communions, rituals, items, and magical strategy       | Book V                           |

| Subject                                                                             | Authoritative home              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| expansion, intelligence, logistics, war, diplomacy, and victory conversion          | <a href="#">Book VI</a>         |
| nation-dossier method and faction-specific application                              | <a href="#">Book VII</a> onward |
| mod construction, events, AI scaffolding, maps, testing, and compatibility method   | <a href="#">Book VIII</a>       |
| exact Dominions Enhanced and Divinitus definitions and combined-load-order findings | <a href="#">Book IX</a>         |

The quick reference is the one deliberate exception. It repeats a small number of formulas and timing facts from Books I and II because its purpose is to remain open while orders are written. It should never become the source of a new rule.

## The baseline used by this edition

### Public unmodded baseline

The current public game release recorded by Illwinter on 25 August 2026 is Dominions 6.36, released on 17 August 2026 UTC. The principal rules source remains the Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2. The official documentation page presents that manual as the main reference for the rules and tables of the game.

The preserved manual is 449 PDF pages and has this fingerprint:

65f430fd97c9f27285d63b797b43bc7fe3844241fdf40230b1d25a901ab9f33f

The preserved Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34, is 65 PDF pages and has this fingerprint:

5ac40698e05703f5628db123548c4e6a57fe0ed9bbcb65fb8f72fc589ab309ab

The official Event Modding Manual, version 6.29, remains relevant for event timing, requirements, event chains, and mod-added monthly effects.

### Frozen modded baseline

The working modded library uses:

- 1
- DomEnhanced2\_16.dm - Dominions Enhanced 2.16.
- 2
- Divinitus\_1.15.3\_DE.dm - Divinitus 1.15.3 DE edition.

Dominions Enhanced is loaded first and Divinitus second.

Neither supplied file declares #domversion, so neither states a minimum compatible game version. Their source can be analysed exactly. Complete compatibility with Dominions 6.36 still needs to be tested and cannot be assumed.

### Ruleset labels

Every future article must display one of the following labels.

| Label         | Meaning                                   |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Unmodded 6.36 | The public base game as of 25 August 2026 |
| DE 2.16       | Dominions Enhanced 2.16 without Divinitus |

| Label                         | Meaning                                                                      |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Divinitus 1.15.3 DE           | The supplied Divinitus DE file considered by itself                          |
| DE 2.16 + Divinitus 1.15.3 DE | The exact two-file ruleset in the recorded load order                        |
| Historical                    | Material retained from an older game or mod version                          |
| Experimental                  | A proposed mechanic, test mod, or result not yet part of a published ruleset |

The label applies to the whole article unless a subsection explicitly overrides it.

## Evidence and confidence

### The five evidence labels

| Label            | Meaning                                                                   | Suitable public wording                        |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Official         | Directly stated by Illwinter or visible in current in-game data           | State as a rule and cite the source            |
| Source-confirmed | Directly encoded in the exact relevant mod source                         | State as a rule for that mod version           |
| Reproduced       | Repeated in a documented controlled test                                  | State with the tested setup and result         |
| Community-tested | Supported by a detailed outside investigation but not yet reproduced here | Attribute and preserve the test conditions     |
| Unverified       | Plausible, incomplete, contradictory, historical, or unsupported          | Present only as an open question or hypothesis |

### Evidence priority

The evidence ledger uses the following general hierarchy:

- 1 Current in-game result or exported current game data.
- 2 Current Illwinter manual or official change note.
- 3 Exact mod source for the named version and load order.
- 4 Reproducible controlled test.
- 5 Maintainer explanation.
- 6 Detailed community test or tournament account.
- 7 General guide, video, forum advice, or historical conversation.

The manual does not contain every rule. It is authoritative where it is explicit, while implementation details, targeting decisions, hidden limits, and unusual interactions may still need testing. If an official statement disagrees with repeatable current-game behaviour, both sides of the discrepancy must be recorded.

### Fact, consequence, recommendation

Three different kinds of statement must not be blended together.

- Fact: the hosting sequence resolves recruitment at step 3.
- Consequence: recruited units exist before movement battles at step 26.
- Recommendation: recruiting emergency defenders may save a province that is attacked during the same hosting cycle.

The first statement is an official rule. The second is a direct timing consequence. The third is strategic advice whose value depends on gold, recruitment capacity, the attacking force, and whether the province can recruit an effective defence.

## Citation standard

Every finished chapter should include:

- ruleset and version;
- last verified date;
- primary source;
- manual page or relevant source location;
- evidence label;
- mod-file hash where applicable;
- test record for reproduced claims;
- unresolved questions.

The public TheHoboKingdom edition can keep citations compact. The private research edition retains full fingerprints, links, source extracts, and test conditions.

## Core notation

### Magic paths

| Symbol | Path                 |
|--------|----------------------|
| F      | Fire                 |
| A      | Air                  |
| W      | Water                |
| E      | Earth                |
| S      | Astral               |
| D      | Death                |
| N      | Nature               |
| G      | Glamour              |
| B      | Blood                |
| H      | Holy or priest level |

Path level follows the symbol. S3 means Astral 3. F2A1 means Fire 2 and Air 1. A requirement written as S5E3 requires both Astral 5 and Earth 3 unless stated otherwise.

The letter G is reserved for Glamour. Gems are written in words or with their path, such as 15 fire gems or 15F gems, when the context cannot be mistaken for a path level.

### Research schools

| Short form | School      |
|------------|-------------|
| Conj       | Conjuration |
| Alt        | Alteration  |

| Short form | School                                                    |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Evo        | Evocation                                                 |
| Const      | Construction                                              |
| Ench       | Enchantment                                               |
| Thaum      | Thaumaturgy                                               |
| Blood      | Blood Magic                                               |
| Divine     | Divine spell list rather than an ordinary research school |

Alt 5 means Alteration level 5. Thaum 9, S5E3 means a Thaumaturgy 9 spell requiring Astral 5 and Earth 3.

## Common statistics

| Symbol | Meaning                                                                             |
|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| HP     | Hit points                                                                          |
| STR    | Strength                                                                            |
| ATT    | Attack skill                                                                        |
| DEF    | Defence skill                                                                       |
| PROT   | Protection                                                                          |
| MR     | Magic Resistance                                                                    |
| MOR    | Morale                                                                              |
| PREC   | Precision                                                                           |
| ENC    | Encumbrance                                                                         |
| AP     | Armour-piercing                                                                     |
| AN     | Armour-negating                                                                     |
| AoE    | Area of effect                                                                      |
| PD     | Province Defence                                                                    |
| RP     | Research points or recruitment points; the full term must be written when ambiguous |

## Randomness

DRN means the Dominions Random Number roll. Dominions commonly uses an open-ended roll built from two six-sided dice, with more rolls after high results. The later mathematics material deals with the full probability system. Here, attribute + DRN means the visible attribute does not decide the final result by itself.

Chance statements must distinguish:

- a fixed percentage;
- a percentage per path or priest level;
- a percentage per dominion candle;
- a chance checked once per unit;
- a chance checked once per province;
- a chance checked once per turn;
- an open-ended opposed roll.

## Time

Dominions commonly uses turn, month, and hosting for closely related ideas.

- A turn is the set of orders submitted by all players and the resulting game state.
- A month is the in-world time represented by one turn.
- Hosting is the process that resolves all submitted orders.
- A battle round is a tactical interval inside a battle and must not be confused with a strategic turn.

## Spatial terms

- Province: a territory on the strategic map.
- Location: a distinct place within a province, such as the open province or the interior of a fortress.
- Adjacent: connected by a valid province border or other relevant link.
- Plane: a separate strategic layer such as the main world, cave plane, or Nexus/Void plane.
- Square: a tactical grid space on a battlefield.
- Size point: part of the capacity used by units occupying a battlefield square.

## Essential glossary

### Army

A group of commanders and their assigned troops. The word is convenient but not always a single rules object: different commanders in the same province may have different orders and may fail, move, or fight separately.

### Battle magic

Spells cast during tactical combat. Battle magic is governed by scripting, fatigue, range, targeting, battlefield conditions, and the spellcasting AI.

### Bless

The set of effects granted to blessed sacred units and commanders. Some bless effects are always available when the unit is blessed; Incarnate effects generally depend on the Pretender being active.

### Capital-only

A recruitment or availability restriction tied to the nation's original capital. Conquering another nation's capital does not normally convert its capital-only roster into the conqueror's roster.

### Commander

A unit capable of receiving strategic orders and leading troops. Leadership type and capacity determine which troops can be assigned and what morale effects may apply.

### Communion

A magical network in which masters receive path bonuses and slaves absorb distributed spell fatigue and certain master-cast personal buffs. The exact mechanics belong in the magic volume.

## **Dominion**

The religious influence of a Pretender, shown as candles in provinces. Dominion is both territorial pressure and a carrier for scales, bless conditions, Pretender hit-point modification, special national effects, and elimination.

## **Event**

A hosting-time occurrence selected from event rules. Events may depend on scales, dominion, population, terrain, commanders, sites, orders, globals, variables, and many other conditions. Modded events can form chains and can imitate systems that the ordinary interface does not expose.

## **Fort**

A fortified location within a province. A besieging force may control the province while the defender retains the fort, creating partial ownership.

## **Gem**

A magical resource associated with Fire, Air, Water, Earth, Astral, Death, Nature, or Glamour. Blood slaves fill a similar strategic role for Blood magic but are units/resources with distinct rules.

## **Global enchantment**

A ritual whose ongoing effect applies broadly to the world or to a large strategic system. Casting occurs during the ritual step, while the continuing world effect is processed later in the hosting sequence.

## **Host**

As a verb, to resolve submitted turns. As a noun, the computer or service processing a multiplayer game.

## **Laboratory**

The infrastructure required for research, most forging, and most ritual casting. A new laboratory is completed late in the turn, after that month's research and ritual steps have already passed.

## **Magic phase**

Community shorthand for the early part of hosting in which rituals, magical movement, remote attacks, and resulting battles occur before ordinary movement. It is useful shorthand, but the official sequence divides it into several distinct steps.

## **Magic Resistance**

A defence statistic used by many spells and supernatural effects. An MR check is not automatically a simple percentage; it may involve opposed DRN rolls, penetration bonuses, and path-based modifiers.

## Mage

A commander with one or more magic paths or another ability that permits research, ritual casting, forging, or battle magic. Not every researcher is a conventional mage, and not every mage can perform every magical order.

## Mod

A .dm-based modification loaded by the game. A mod can add or alter many data objects but cannot necessarily rewrite executable-level systems.

## Movement phase

Community shorthand for the part of hosting in which conventional map movement resolves. The official sequence distinguishes friendly movement, other movement, movement battles, and castle storming.

## Path

A level of magical skill in Fire, Air, Water, Earth, Astral, Death, Nature, Glamour, Blood, or Holy magic. Paths determine spell access, research value, item access, and many special interactions.

## Pretender

The god designed for a nation or team. The Pretender supplies dominion, scales, bless design, magic access, and a physical chassis that may be awake, dormant, or imprisoned.

## Province Defence

Locally purchased defence that appears automatically when a province is attacked. It is not a standing army that can move. Its composition and commander structure depend on the nation and investment.

## Recruitment point

A local capacity used when recruiting units. It is distinct from gold and resources, and it can prevent recruitment even when the other costs are affordable.

## Research point

A contribution toward a school of magical research. Research is processed very early during hosting, before assassinations and most forms of death.

## Ritual

A strategic spell ordered outside battle. Rituals can summon units, alter provinces, move commanders, attack remotely, create globals, search, scry, or cause other world-map effects.

## Rout

The state in which a unit or squad attempts to flee battle. Dominions battles are normally decided by morale collapse rather than the literal death of every unit.



## Sacred

A unit capable of receiving a blessing and often subject to recruitment or upkeep advantages. Sacred does not mean permanently blessed; a blessing still needs to be active.

## Scale

One side of the dominion-scale pairs: Order/Turmoil, Production/Sloth, Heat/Cold, Growth/Death, Fortune/Misfortune, and Magic/Drain. Scales affect the world through dominion and can also interact with units, events, sites, and spells.

## Site

A magical or special feature located in a province. Sites may provide gems, gold, recruitment, unrest, disease, discounts, ritual access, or other effects. Some are hidden until found.

## Squad

A tactical group assigned to a commander. Morale, formation, scripting, and leadership penalties are often evaluated at squad level rather than across the entire army.

## Throne of Ascension

A special site that can be claimed by an appropriate priest. Claimed Thrones provide Ascension Points and may grant other effects. The game can end when the configured Ascension requirement is met.

## Unrest

A province condition that reduces effective administration and income and interacts with events, recruitment, patrolling, pillaging, and Blood Hunting.

## Upkeep

The recurring gold cost of maintaining units and commanders. Upkeep is paid after income is collected in the official hosting sequence.

## The central idea: orders are simultaneous, resolution is sequential

Players submit orders without watching the other nations' orders resolve. Hosting then processes every nation's orders through a fixed sequence.

This creates three different kinds of time:

- 1 Planning time: all players choose orders from the same pre-host game state.
- 2 Resolution time: the engine processes different kinds of orders in a fixed sequence.
- 3 Battle time: tactical battles resolve internally after their triggering strategic step.

Players submit their decisions simultaneously, but the engine resolves them in sequence.

This distinction explains many apparently contradictory outcomes:

- a mage contributes research before being assassinated;
- units are recruited before an attacking army arrives;

- a remote attack can strike an army before ordinary movement;
- a new laboratory finishes too late to support research or rituals that month;
- starvation is applied after battles;
- income is collected before upkeep;
- general dominion spread happens after most battles;
- an immortal can be due to return after the victory check has already ended the game.

## A six-phase model of hosting

The official manual lists 63 separate steps. For practical reading, those steps can be grouped into six phases. These phase names are editorial tools; the numbered order remains the authority.

| Phase                                 | Steps | Main contents                                                                                         |
|---------------------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| I. Commitments and production         | 1-9   | Messages, research, recruitment, empowerment, forging, preaching, Thrones, quick orders               |
| II. Magic and special threats         | 10-23 | Rituals, remote attacks, magic battles, searching, awakening, Blood Hunting, Horrors, assassinations  |
| III. Movement and conquest            | 24-27 | Friendly movement, other movement, field battles, castle storming                                     |
| IV. World effects and hidden conflict | 28-33 | Global effects, random events, item/monster effects, event battles, sneak discovery                   |
| V. State, economy, and dominion       | 34-45 | Besiegers, construction, special orders, pillage, income, unrest, starvation, upkeep, dominion, sites |
| VI. Attrition and end-state           | 46-63 | Aging, disease, insanity, mercenaries, heroes, elimination, victory, immortality, aftermath           |

The six-phase model is useful for memory. It must not replace the full sequence when exact timing matters.

## The complete 63-step hosting sequence

Evidence: Official. Primary source: Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2, pages 55-57. Verified: 25 August 2026.

The following table paraphrases the official sequence and adds timing consequences. The step names and order follow the manual; the explanations are written for this library.

| Step | Resolution    | What happens                                                          | Why the timing matters                                                                                                                                                     |
|------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Send messages | Diplomatic messages and attached gold, gems, or items are dispatched. | Transfers occur before events that could kill a courier, capture a province, or remove a commander. The manual states that the early timing makes sent resources reliable. |
| 2    | Research      | Assigned researchers contribute research points.                      | A researcher killed later in the same hosting cycle still contributes for that month.                                                                                      |
| 3    | Recruitment   | Paid troops and commanders are created.                               | New defenders exist before movement battles. They cannot receive new orders during the hosting cycle in which they appear.                                                 |

| Step | Resolution           | What happens                                                                                    | Why the timing matters                                                                                                                         |
|------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4    | Empowerment          | Ordered permanent path increases are applied.                                                   | The path exists before forging and ritual steps, although the empowering commander cannot also perform a second ordinary order that month.     |
| 5    | Forge items          | Completed items enter the nation's magic-item inventory.                                        | Forging occurs before rituals, but an item in the treasury is not the same as an item already equipped by a caster.                            |
| 6    | Preach               | Priests resolve ordinary preaching and adjust dominion.                                         | Preaching can alter dominion before movement battles, unlike general dominion spread at step 42.                                               |
| 7    | Heretic preaching    | Heretics, insane commanders, and shattered-soul commanders apply their religious influence.     | These changes also occur before movement and most battles.                                                                                     |
| 8    | Claim Thrones        | Eligible priests claim Thrones of Ascension.                                                    | A claim is processed before rituals and battles that might remove the claimant later in the month.                                             |
| 9    | Quick special orders | Fast special orders such as entering a site to scry or cultivating pearls resolve.              | These orders precede the main ritual step; their precise value depends on the named order.                                                     |
| 10   | Magic rituals        | Ritual casters perform their rituals in random caster order.                                    | Competing or interacting rituals cannot be assumed to follow nation number, player order, or script order.                                     |
| 11   | Remote attacks       | Rituals that strike hostile armies in remote provinces are applied.                             | An army can be damaged before it performs ordinary movement.                                                                                   |
| 12   | Magic battles        | Battles created by magic resolve, including hostile teleportation and certain movement rituals. | Magical movement can fight before conventional armies move. Retreats from the group of magic battles are placed after all such battles finish. |
| 13   | Lost in other planes | Units become lost in other planes and relevant other-plane battles resolve.                     | Planar displacement is settled before site searching, ordinary movement, and field battles.                                                    |
| 14   | Site searches        | Magical site-search orders resolve.                                                             | A commander can search a province before conventional movement changes the province later in hosting.                                          |
| 15   | Prophets             | New prophets are declared.                                                                      | The prophet exists before Call God, awakening, Blood Hunting, assassinations, and ordinary battles, but after ritual and magic-battle steps.   |
| 16   | Call God             | Priests assigned to Call God contribute to returning a banished Pretender.                      | The recall attempt occurs before ordinary battles can kill those priests that month.                                                           |
| 17   | Awakening            | Dormant or imprisoned Pretenders that are due to awaken enter play.                             | A newly awakened Pretender exists before ordinary movement battles but received no normal order from the prior map state.                      |
| 18   | Blood hunting        | Blood Hunt orders resolve and slaves are collected according to the Blood Hunting rules.        | Blood hunters are exposed to the results before assassinations and conventional movement.                                                      |
| 19   | Horrors              | Units due to be visited by Horrors are attacked or affected.                                    | Horror attacks can remove a commander before assassination and movement steps.                                                                 |
| 20   | Assassinations       | Assassination, seduction, corruption, and similar attempts resolve immediately.                 | Killing a commander here can prevent that commander's army from moving later. The research contribution at step 2 has already been secured.    |

| Step | Resolution                     | What happens                                                                                                         | Why the timing matters                                                                                                                                               |
|------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 21   | Relinquish province            | A province may be transferred to a qualifying non-stealthed ally already present.                                    | Transfer happens before movement, so an ally arriving later in the turn does not satisfy the presence requirement for this order.                                    |
| 22   | Claim mounts                   | Riders without mounts attempt to obtain suitable mounts.                                                             | Mount status is updated before ordinary movement and battles.                                                                                                        |
| 23   | Lone mounts                    | Riderless intelligent mounts or mountless riders may return home or disperse.                                        | Mount cleanup occurs before movement, preventing stale mount states from persisting into field battles.                                                              |
| 24   | Friendly movement              | Movement ending in a friendly province resolves.                                                                     | Reinforcement of an already friendly destination receives priority over hostile arrivals unless an earlier effect intervenes.                                        |
| 25   | Other movement                 | Remaining conventional movement resolves, including Break Siege.                                                     | Hostile movement and movements that change control are processed after friendly movement.                                                                            |
| 26   | Resolve battles                | Field battles caused by conventional movement are fought.                                                            | Province control established here can affect storming, pillage, income, ownership, and later events.                                                                 |
| 27   | Castle storming                | Storm Castle battles resolve.                                                                                        | Storming occurs after movement battles. Retreats from the movement and storming groups are placed only after the relevant battles finish.                            |
| 28   | Global enchantments            | Ongoing global enchantment effects are applied to the world.                                                         | A global is cast at step 10, but its continuing world effect begins here, after movement and castle-storming battles for the month.                                  |
| 29   | Random events                  | Ordinary Fortune, Misfortune, and other eligible random events occur.                                                | These events see the world state produced by magic, movement, battles, storming, and global effects.                                                                 |
| 30   | Resolve battles                | Battles created by random events are fought.                                                                         | Event-created attackers do not fight during the earlier movement battle step.                                                                                        |
| 31   | Magic item and monster effects | Special monthly effects generated by items or monsters occur.                                                        | Items were forged at step 5, while special monthly effects are delayed until this stage. Item-assisted rituals still belong to step 10.                              |
| 32   | Resolve battles                | Battles created by the preceding special effects are fought.                                                         | These battles form a separate retreat group after random-event battles.                                                                                              |
| 33   | Sneak discovery                | Detected stealthy units fight for survival.                                                                          | A stealth force can avoid the ordinary movement battle and still be discovered and attacked later.                                                                   |
| 34   | Change besieger                | When allied forces share a siege, the game determines which ally is the active besieger, favouring the larger force. | Siege ownership and control are settled after field, storming, event, and sneak-discovery battles.                                                                   |
| 35   | Building construction          | Forts, temples, and laboratories finish construction or demolition; fort melting also occurs.                        | New infrastructure is too late for this month's recruitment, research, forging, rituals, preaching, or movement. It becomes useful from the next order phase onward. |
| 36   | Special orders                 | Orders such as Reanimate and Summon Allies resolve.                                                                  | The manual explicitly notes that allies created here are too late for this month's battles.                                                                          |
| 37   | Pillage                        | Pillaging increases unrest and kills population.                                                                     | Pillage occurs immediately before income, so the damage can reduce or remove income from a province captured earlier that month.                                     |

| Step | Resolution           | What happens                                                                                                        | Why the timing matters                                                                                                              |
|------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 38   | Income               | Nations collect provincial income.                                                                                  | New ownership and pillage have already been resolved. Income arrives before upkeep is charged.                                      |
| 39   | Unrest alterations   | Unrest changes from dominion, scales, patrolling, and related systems are applied.                                  | Income was already collected using the earlier state; the new unrest primarily affects the following month.                         |
| 40   | Starvation           | Units without sufficient supplies suffer starvation effects.                                                        | Battles are already over. An army newly without supply fights this month's battles before the new starvation penalties are applied. |
| 41   | Upkeep and desertion | Unit upkeep is charged and desertion occurs.                                                                        | Income is collected first, so the treasury has this month's income available when upkeep is assessed.                               |
| 42   | Dominion spread      | General dominion spread from temples and other sources resolves.                                                    | Most battles have already occurred. New candles from ordinary spread do not retroactively alter those battles.                      |
| 43   | Dominion effects     | Population loss, insanity pressure, temperature movement, and other special dominion effects are applied.           | Dominion first spreads, then its special world effects are calculated from the resulting state.                                     |
| 44   | Site effects         | Sites generate disease, unrest, or other monthly effects.                                                           | Site effects happen after income, upkeep, and dominion effects but before healing and disease resolution.                           |
| 45   | Overpopulation       | If global unit or commander limits are approached, the game removes some common entities.                           | This is an emergency engine-maintenance step rather than ordinary strategic attrition.                                              |
| 46   | Aging                | In midwinter, units age and may acquire age-related afflictions such as disease.                                    | Aging is seasonal and occurs before the healing/disease step.                                                                       |
| 47   | Resolve battles      | Remaining battles generated by previous effects are fought.                                                         | Late world effects can create battles after normal movement, event, and sneak battles.                                              |
| 48   | Heal and disease     | Units heal lost hit points; diseased units instead suffer disease damage and may gain afflictions.                  | A surviving unit may recover after all ordinary battles, while disease can turn survival into a later death.                        |
| 49   | Insanity             | Eligible units may become insane.                                                                                   | Insanity for the next order phase is determined after battles and healing.                                                          |
| 50   | Mercenaries          | Mercenary bids, purchases, and continued contracts are resolved.                                                    | Mercenary availability is decided after income, upkeep, disease, and insanity.                                                      |
| 51   | New random heroes    | Eligible national heroes may appear at the capital.                                                                 | A new hero arrives after all battles and cannot act during the month of arrival.                                                    |
| 52   | Kill lone units      | Non-commanders stranded in enemy territory without a commander are removed.                                         | Troops left behind by commander death or separation cannot persist indefinitely as an uncontrolled hostile stack.                   |
| 53   | Reclaim provinces    | A fort can restore province ownership to its owner or allied team under the stated conditions.                      | Partial ownership can be corrected late in hosting if the fort is not under siege.                                                  |
| 54   | Conscription         | Province Defence is raised to at least one where applicable, and dominion or commander effects that add PD resolve. | Automatic PD appears after battles and therefore protects future turns, not the battle that caused the ownership change.            |
| 55   | Scouting             | Fresh scouting reports are generated.                                                                               | Reports show the end-of-hosting state rather than the exact state seen during earlier movement or battles.                          |

| Step | Resolution         | What happens                                                                                                                           | Why the timing matters                                                                                              |
|------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 56   | Elimination        | Nations meeting elimination conditions are removed.                                                                                    | Elimination is checked after dominion spread and effects, but before the victory check and before immortals reform. |
| 57   | Victory            | Configured victory conditions are checked and the game may end.                                                                        | Later administrative steps cannot rescue a position once victory has been declared.                                 |
| 58   | Update stats       | Hall of Fame and scoregraph information is updated.                                                                                    | Public statistics reflect the completed turn after victory evaluation.                                              |
| 59   | Heroic abilities   | Eligible units gain or improve heroic abilities.                                                                                       | A unit's new heroic benefit is normally available from the following turn.                                          |
| 60   | Reform Immortals   | Immortals due to return reform their bodies.                                                                                           | The victory check has already occurred. An imminent immortal return cannot prevent a game that ended at step 57.    |
| 61   | Reduce PD          | Province Defence is reduced where population cannot support it; the manual gives a requirement of at least 10 population per PD point. | Unsustainable PD can disappear after the victory and scouting checks, altering the next turn's defence.             |
| 62   | Yearning artifacts | Artifacts that newly become yearning change state.                                                                                     | Artifact yearning is an end-of-turn transition rather than an effect applied during forging or battle.              |
| 63   | Aftermath          | The engine validates orders and items, applies necessary shape changes, and performs final cleanup.                                    | The next player turn opens only after these consistency checks and state transitions finish.                        |

## Phase I: commitments and production

### Messages resolve before danger

Messages and attached resources are dispatched at step 1. The rule has an important diplomatic consequence: a trade agreed during the order phase is not interrupted because the sending capital is captured or the supposed courier dies later in hosting.

This makes the act of sending reliable. It does not make the agreement honest. A player can still send less than promised, send the wrong item, or accept payment while making hostile orders.

New-player rule: Resource transfers are processed before almost anything can interfere.

Expert consequence: A nation expecting to be eliminated can still transfer resources before the elimination check. Multiplayer rules may need to address kingmaking or last-turn treasury transfers explicitly.

### Research is secured early

Research occurs at step 2. The official manual explicitly states that a researcher killed or assassinated later in the turn still contributes that month's research.

This timing separates research production from researcher survival:

- the current month's points are earned;
- the researcher may still be lost before the next order phase;
- research enabled at step 2 may make new spells available for later battles in the same hosting cycle, subject to casting orders already submitted and the game's handling of scripted availability.

The last point requires care. A script submitted before hosting cannot safely be assumed to select a spell that was unavailable when orders were written. Research can complete early, but practical same-turn spell use depends on scripting and spell-selection behaviour. That interaction belongs in the magic test suite.

## **Recruitment occurs before invasion**

Recruitment resolves at step 3. Units paid for in the preceding order phase exist before magic attacks, assassinations, ordinary movement, field battles, and storming.

Practical consequences:

- emergency recruits can defend a province attacked that month;
- newly recruited commanders can be present as battlefield commanders;
- new units cannot receive a new strategic order until the following player turn;
- a province captured later does not cancel recruitment already completed;
- a recruitment queue still depends on the gold, resources, recruitment points, and local eligibility checked by the game.

Recruitment timing is one reason a projected attack cannot rely solely on last turn's scouting report. A fort or capital can add another month of defenders before the attack lands.

## **Empowerment and forging are separate commitments**

Empowerment resolves at step 4 and forging at step 5. The sequence does not normally let one commander empower and forge in the same month because both require the commander's order. It does establish that permanent path changes exist before later systems inspect the commander.

A newly forged item enters the national item inventory. It is not automatically equipped by a commander whose orders were already submitted. If a battle or ritual needs a booster, the commander must have it equipped before hosting. Forging it during that hosting is too late.

## **Preaching is not ordinary dominion spread**

Ordinary preaching resolves at step 6 and heretic preaching at step 7. General dominion spread waits until step 42.

This is strategically significant:

- successful preaching can change dominion before battles;
- general temple spread cannot change earlier battle conditions that month;
- heretic and insanity-related religious effects are also early;
- blood sacrifice is a different special order and should not be silently treated as ordinary preaching.

Dominion-dependent hit points, morale, scales, sacred effects, and special national mechanics make this distinction worth testing in controlled battles.

## **Throne claims are early**

Thrones are claimed at step 8, long before the victory check at step 57. A priest who successfully performs the order can establish the claim even if later killed.

The claim does not cause an immediate mid-sequence victory. The remaining hosting steps still resolve before victory is checked.

This creates a dangerous endgame pattern:

- 1 a Throne is claimed at step 8;
- 2 the claimant may lose battles or territory later;
- 3 the game evaluates the configured victory condition at step 57.

Book III resolves the ownership branch at an Official plus Community-tested tier. Killing the claimant after step 8 does not undo the claim. Conquering an unfortified Throne, or storming and conquering the fort that contains one, makes it unclaimed before step 57 and removes its points from the winning total. Merely besieging a fortified Throne does not conquer the fort or unclaim the Throne. Book III retains the evidence and complete state matrix; this chapter owns only the shared turn order.

## Phase II: magic and special threats

### Rituals have random caster order

All ritual casters resolve at step 10 in random order. This is one of the most important expert-level timing rules.

When two rituals interact, no plan should depend on one particular mage resolving first unless the game provides a separate explicit priority. Examples include:

- two commanders attempting to affect the same unique target;
- competing globals;
- rituals that move, kill, transform, or empower a target;
- rituals that alter a province before another ritual checks it;
- ritual combinations that depend on gem availability or a surviving caster.

Random caster order means that a multi-ritual plan should be robust in every plausible order or should be tested to determine whether the particular rituals belong to separate substeps.

Expert rule: "Both happen during the magic phase" does not mean "they happen simultaneously." It often means "the engine resolves them one at a time in an order the player cannot choose."

### Casting a global and receiving its world effect are different steps

A global enchantment is cast during rituals at step 10. The global's continuing world effect is applied at step 28.

This division creates a clear dependency:

- the global can be established before ordinary movement;
- its normal world-processing stage occurs after movement battles and castle storming;
- the spell's immediate casting effect, if any, must be distinguished from its later monthly effect;
- losing a province or caster after step 10 may or may not end a province-centred global before step 28, depending on that global's rules.

Every global guide should record:

- 1 casting requirements;
- 2 immediate casting result;
- 3 ongoing effect step;
- 4 dispel rules;
- 5 termination condition;
- 6 whether it is centred on a province, caster, site, or global slot.



## Remote attacks strike before ordinary movement

Remote army attacks resolve at step 11. A conventional army ordered to leave the targeted province has not yet performed ordinary movement.

This creates several practical uses:

- damage a stack before it marches;
- kill or disable a commander and strand troops;
- force attrition before a later conventional attack;
- attack a force whose destination is uncertain while it is still at its starting location.

There is one important qualification. A commander may leave or arrive through magical movement at step 10, and magic battles occur at step 12. In this context, "before movement" needs to mean "before conventional movement."

## Magic battles are their own battle group

Battles created by magic resolve at step 12. This includes examples such as hostile teleportation and units moved by certain rituals.

Retreats are placed after all battles in the group have resolved. That detail matters when multiple magic battles use adjacent provinces or when a retreat destination is itself affected by another magic battle.

"A battle" is too broad to be a safe unit of analysis. The useful sequence is:

- the step that created the battle;
- the battle group to which it belongs;
- the point at which retreats from that group are placed.

## Site searching precedes conventional conquest

Site searches resolve at step 14. A mage searching a province can complete the order before an enemy conventional army arrives.

The newly found site then exists for later steps, but each site benefit has its own timing:

- gem income is not necessarily granted immediately upon discovery;
- a site effect may be processed at step 44;
- recruitment unlocked by the site cannot be ordered retroactively;
- a conqueror may take control of the newly discovered site later in the same turn.

The distinction between discovering a site and receiving every benefit of that site should be preserved.

## Prophets, recalled gods, and awakening

Prophets are declared at step 15. Call God resolves at step 16. Dormant and imprisoned Pretenders awaken at step 17.

All three occur before ordinary movement and field battles, but after magic battles.

This ordering produces several boundaries:

- a new prophet can defend against a later conventional attack;
- a prophet is not available for an earlier magic battle;
- an awakening Pretender can exist for later defence but generally has no fresh order that month;

- priests calling a god make their contribution before conventional attackers arrive;
- the returned god's exact availability and location must be checked under the Call God rules.

### **Blood Hunting is early enough to be dangerous**

Blood Hunting occurs at step 18, before assassinations and movement. The hunt can generate slaves and unrest before later state-processing steps.

The full economic consequences require the Blood Hunting chapter, but the timing model already establishes that:

- hunters remain in their starting province while hunting;
- a hunter can be assassinated after contributing to the hunt;
- unrest alterations from the broader turn are processed later;
- newly collected slaves exist before later upkeep and income steps, although their immediate availability for already-submitted rituals should not be assumed without testing.

### **Horrors and assassinations can remove movement leaders**

Horror visits occur at step 19 and assassinations at step 20. Both can kill a commander before conventional movement.

An army's movement order belongs to a commander. If that commander dies before step 24 or 25, assigned troops may remain behind, become uncommanded, or eventually be removed if stranded in hostile territory.

A resilient army-movement plan considers:

- redundant commanders;
- bodyguards;
- stealth and assassination threats;
- Horror Marks;
- whether critical troops can be reassigned before hosting;
- whether the loss of a single leader invalidates an entire movement chain.

### **Relinquishing requires an ally already present**

Relinquish Province resolves at step 21. The official description requires the receiving non-stealthed allied commander to already be in the province.

An ally moving into the province at step 24 is too late. A stealthy allied commander does not satisfy the stated condition.

This is a good example of why a plain-language order description is not enough. The order's position in hosting determines which board state it can see.

## **Phase III: movement and conquest**

### **Friendly movement receives its own step**

Movement ending in a friendly province resolves at step 24. Other conventional movement resolves at step 25.

The manual explains the practical purpose: a force trying to enter a friendly province before an enemy arrives normally succeeds unless an earlier event prevents it.

This is not a universal guarantee that every reinforcement arrives safely. Earlier dangers include:

- remote attacks;
- magic battles;
- planar loss;
- Horrors;
- assassination;
- failed movement requirements;
- commander death;
- terrain or movement limitations.

It does mean that an ordinary hostile arrival does not normally prevent valid friendly reinforcement from reaching the province first.

## **"Other movement" contains several different intentions**

Step 25 covers the remaining conventional movements, including Break Siege. It can include:

- invasion of hostile territory;
- movement into independent provinces;
- armies crossing toward a province that changes ownership;
- breaking out of a siege;
- opposing movements that produce a meeting or province battle.

Movement validity depends on the movement rules: map-move allowance, terrain costs, roads, rivers, survival abilities, flying, sailing, planes, army composition, and the slowest or otherwise limiting elements of the force.

[Book I](#) records when movement resolves. The movement and logistics material handles the detailed calculation of whether a move is valid.

## **Field battles occur after both movement steps**

Battles created by conventional movement resolve at step 26. The defender seen in battle may include:

- the pre-existing garrison;
- recruited units from step 3;
- friendly reinforcements from step 24;
- Province Defence;
- commanders or units that did not move;
- magical arrivals from earlier steps, if they survived;
- units altered by early effects.

It may exclude:

- conventional reinforcements whose movement failed;
- commanders killed by Horrors or assassinations;
- allies summoned later at step 36;
- infrastructure completed later at step 35;
- dominion changes that wait for step 42.

## **Castle storming is later than field battle**

Castle storming resolves at step 27. A storming force must survive the month's preceding events and battles before entering the assault.

This ordering matters when:

- a relief army arrives;
- the besiegers fight a field battle;
- an army attempts to break siege;
- assassinations remove storm leaders;
- remote attacks weaken the besiegers;
- multiple allied forces are involved.

Storming is a separate battle step, resolved later than movement battles and governed by its own deployment, wall, gate, and defender rules.

## Retreats belong to battle groups

The manual repeatedly notes that retreats to adjacent provinces occur after all battles in a relevant group have resolved.

This prevents an oversimplified model in which a routed army immediately appears in a neighbouring province while other same-step battles are still being processed.

For expert analysis, a retreat question should record:

- which step caused the battle;
- which other battles shared the step;
- candidate retreat provinces at the time retreats are placed;
- control and hostile forces in those provinces;
- whether the unit was inside or outside a fort;
- whether the route crossed planes or special connections.

## Phase IV: world effects and hidden conflict

### Global effects are late relative to conquest

Ongoing global enchantment effects resolve at step 28, after conventional movement and castle storming.

This means a global cast at step 10 may be visible and active as an enchantment before its normal monthly world effect is processed. If the effect depends on a province, site, caster, or global state that can be lost during movement, the exact spell wording and tests become important.

No global should be described merely as "going off in the magic phase." Its casting and its world tick may be separated by most of the month's major battles.

### Random events see a heavily updated world

Random events occur at step 29. By then, the game has already processed:

- research and recruitment;
- preaching and Throne claims;
- rituals and magical attacks;
- assassinations;
- conventional movement;
- field battles and storming;
- global world effects.

Events can react to a state that did not exist when orders were submitted.

The Event Modding Manual confirms that events can test a wide range of conditions, including:

- era and turn;
- season and month;
- nation;
- treasury and gems;
- research;
- population;
- unrest and PD;
- buildings;
- terrain and plane;
- sites and Thrones;
- dominion and scales;
- particular monsters, Pretenders, priests, mages, and orders;
- global enchantments;
- event codes and variables.

This is why event systems can simulate diplomacy, doctrine, religious activity, or evolving stories without directly rewriting the strategic AI.

### **Event battles resolve separately**

Battles created by random events occur at step 30. A nation can win its movement battle and then face a later event battle in the same province.

Reports should be read in timing order. Two battles in one province during the same month may be caused by different systems and may see different surviving forces.

### **Item and monster effects have a separate monthly tick**

Monthly effects from magic items and monsters resolve at step 31, followed by any battles they cause at step 32.

The manual distinguishes:

- item forging at step 5;
- item-assisted ritual casting at step 10;
- special monthly item or monster effects at step 31.

This prevents a common category error in which every effect attached to an item is assumed to occur when the item is forged or when rituals resolve.

### **Stealth failure can produce a late battle**

Sneak discovery occurs at step 33. A stealthy force may avoid conventional combat because it remained undiscovered, then be exposed and forced to fight later.

Stealth changes what triggers combat. It does not make a force immune to hostile troops.

Expert stealth analysis should distinguish:

- successful sneaking movement;
- patrol detection;
- event-based detection;
- Glamour visibility;

- assassination or spy actions;
- late sneak-discovery battles;
- retreat and survival after discovery.

## Phase V: state, economy, and dominion

### Allied siege leadership is determined after combat

At step 34, the game selects the active besieger when allied armies share a siege. Larger armies take precedence according to the manual.

This decision occurs after the major battle groups. Losses suffered earlier in the month can change which ally counts as the besieger.

### Buildings finish after the month's active systems

Construction and demolition occur at step 35.

A building ordered this month is too late to support:

- step 2 research;
- step 3 recruitment;
- step 5 forging;
- step 6 preaching requirements where a temple matters;
- step 10 ritual casting;
- step 14 site-search orders;
- earlier battles.

The completed structure is principally an investment in the following turn.

This is the first major principle of infrastructure timing:

A building consumes resources in the present to unlock actions in the future.

The economy volume will extend this into fort construction time, administration, recruitment access, laboratory networks, temple spread, and opportunity cost.

### Special-order summons arrive after battle

Special orders such as Reanimate and Summon Allies occur at step 36. The manual explicitly states that allies summoned here do not participate in this month's battles.

This differs from:

- recruitment at step 3;
- ritual summons at step 10;
- event-created units at their event step;
- units arriving through movement.

When a unit appears is as important as how it is created.

### Pillage damages the same month's income

Pillage occurs at step 37, immediately before income at step 38. The official manual explicitly warns that pillaging a newly conquered province can reduce or remove the income collected from it.

This creates a direct trade:

- immediate pillage effects;
- increased unrest;
- population loss;
- reduced current income;
- reduced future economic value;
- possible strategic denial if the province cannot be held.

Pillage should never be evaluated only by its immediate gold or damage result.

## **Income precedes upkeep**

Income is collected at step 38. Upkeep is paid at step 41.

This means the month's provincial income is available before the game assesses unit maintenance. A treasury that appears unable to cover upkeep at the end of the order phase may survive if sufficient income is collected.

Income may already have been altered by:

- conquest;
- pillage;
- ownership;
- unrest existing before step 39;
- population;
- scales and dominion already present;
- sites and other modifiers;
- events or earlier effects.

## **Unrest changes after income**

The broad unrest-alteration step is 39, after income. Patrolling, dominion, scales, and related changes are reflected here.

This suggests a timing distinction between:

- unrest already present when income is collected;
- unrest created directly by pillage at step 37;
- general unrest alterations processed at step 39.

Each unrest source should be tested against income on its own. One slogan cannot safely describe all of them.

## **Starvation follows battle**

Starvation is processed at step 40. The manual states that an army newly without supplies fights its battles before starvation effects are applied.

This does not make supply unimportant. Existing starvation penalties and afflictions may already be present. The rule means that the first new month of shortage does not retroactively weaken battles that occurred earlier in that hosting cycle.

For campaign planning, supply is a delayed threat that compounds over time:

- 1 the army enters or remains in a low-supply situation;
- 2 it fights before the new starvation tick;

- 3 starvation is applied afterward;
- 4 the weakened army enters the next order phase with penalties, disease risk, or afflictions.

### Upkeep and desertion follow income

At step 41, upkeep is charged and desertion occurs.

This timing means conquest and income may fund the army before payment is due. It also means pillage, income loss, or treasury transfers can contribute to a shortfall.

The exact desertion priority and behaviour require a dedicated economy test. A reliable guide should not claim which units desert first without current evidence.

### Dominion spread, then dominion effects

General dominion spread occurs at step 42. Dominion effects follow at step 43.

This produces a clear two-stage model:

- 1 candles spread or contest one another;
- 2 special effects of the resulting dominion state are applied.

Possible effects include:

- population loss;
- insanity;
- temperature movement;
- national or Pretender-specific dominion effects;
- event eligibility;
- other mechanics tied to friendly or hostile candles.

Most conventional battles are already over. Preaching at steps 6 and 7 is the major earlier religious exception.

### Sites apply their monthly effects

Magic-site effects occur at step 44. Disease, unrest, and other site-driven changes are applied after dominion effects.

Site-search discovery occurred at step 14. A newly found site may apply an effect later in the same month, although the timing still needs to be checked for the specific site and effect.

## Phase VI: attrition and end-state

### Aging is seasonal

Aging occurs at step 46 and only during midwinter. Units gain a year and may receive age-related afflictions.

The seasonal condition matters when planning:

- old mages;
- rejuvenation or age modification;
- disease management;
- transformation;
- long campaigns;



- effects that trigger at a particular month.

The Event Modding Manual identifies month 10 as midwinter in its month numbering, but a full calendar reference should be verified in the dedicated time-and-seasons appendix.

## Healing and disease share a late step

At step 48, ordinary units regain lost hit points while diseased units instead suffer disease damage and may gain more afflictions.

This occurs after ordinary battles, global effects, events, item effects, site effects, aging, and any late battles.

Surviving the battle report does not always mean surviving until the next player turn.

## Insanity is determined after healing

Insanity changes occur at step 49. An affected unit enters the next order phase with the resulting behaviour or lost control.

Insanity also appears in earlier steps, including heretic preaching at step 7. It is not confined to one moment in the turn. The step 49 check establishes or changes the condition that will affect later orders.

## Mercenaries and heroes arrive too late to act

Mercenary resolution occurs at step 50 and new random heroes at step 51.

Neither can receive an order or join an earlier battle during the month of arrival. They become assets for the following order phase.

## Lone troops are cleaned up

At step 52, non-commanders left alone in enemy territory are removed.

This can be the delayed consequence of:

- assassination;
- commander death in an earlier battle;
- failed or split movement;
- a commander retreating separately;
- ownership changes;
- units being created without a valid leader.

The lesson goes beyond the cleanup rule. Commander redundancy protects logistics as well as morale.

## End-of-turn ownership can still change

At step 53, a fort can reclaim province ownership under the conditions stated in the manual, including the absence of an active siege.

This reflects the distinction between:

- ownership of the open province;
- ownership of the fortress;
- partial ownership;

- full ownership.

Any guide to events, income, recruitment, or province transfer that says only "owner" must specify which kind of ownership the rule requires.

## Conscription is for the next attack

At step 54, Province Defence can be raised to a minimum and PD-adding dominion or commander effects occur.

This is after every ordinary battle. The new defence cannot save the province from the attack that caused its creation or transfer.

## Scouting reports are end-state reports

Scouting updates at step 55. A report is a view of the state after most monthly transformations, not a recording of every force that passed through the province.

This explains why scouting can omit:

- an army that moved onward;
- units killed in an earlier battle;
- a stealth force not discovered;
- a temporary magical arrival;
- infrastructure or ownership that changed again later.

Intelligence should be dated and treated as a snapshot.

## Elimination precedes victory

Elimination is checked at step 56 and victory at step 57.

Dominion spread and effects have already resolved, so a dominion collapse can matter immediately. Immortal return is still three steps away at step 60.

The sequence prevents a player from assuming that a future recovery effect will be processed before the game decides whether the nation or game has ended.

## Heroic abilities and immortality are post-victory

Statistics update at step 58, heroic abilities at step 59, and immortal reformation at step 60.

These are transitions into the next turn unless the game has already ended.

## Province Defence can be reduced after reports

At step 61, PD is reduced if population cannot support it. The manual states that at least 10 population is required for each PD point.

Because scouting updates at step 55, an edge case exists: the displayed or reported value may need to be checked against the final post-reduction state. The user interface behaviour should be verified in a controlled test.

## Aftermath closes the turn

Artifact yearning occurs at step 62. Final validation, item checks, and shape changes occur at step 63.

Aftermath is a reminder that not every visible state transition has a named strategic order. Shape-changing units, invalid item states, and other cleanup may be corrected only at the end.

## Timing chains every player should know

### Researcher assassination

| Order     | Event                                                     |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| 2         | The mage contributes research                             |
| 20        | The assassination attempt occurs                          |
| 48        | If wounded and surviving, healing or disease is processed |
| Next turn | The nation keeps the research but may have lost the mage  |

Conclusion: Assassination disrupts future research, not the research already produced that month.

### Emergency recruitment against invasion

| Order | Event                                            |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------|
| 3     | Recruits are created                             |
| 24    | Friendly reinforcements may arrive               |
| 25    | The hostile army moves                           |
| 26    | The field battle includes eligible new defenders |

Conclusion: Recruitment and friendly reinforcement can both increase a defence beyond what the attacker saw in the preceding scout report.

### Commander assassination strands an army

| Order | Event                                                    |
|-------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| 20    | The movement commander is assassinated                   |
| 24-25 | The dead commander cannot complete conventional movement |
| 52    | Troops left alone in hostile territory may be removed    |

Conclusion: A cheap assassination can have a strategic effect much larger than the commander's personal value.

### Remote attack before a march

| Order | Event                                             |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------|
| 10    | The attacking ritual is cast                      |
| 11    | Its remote strike hits the army                   |
| 25    | The surviving conventional army attempts movement |
| 26    | It fights any resulting field battle              |

Conclusion: Remote attacks can soften, disorganise, or decapitate an army before its conventional operation.

### Teleportation and conventional invasion

| Order | Event                                |
|-------|--------------------------------------|
| 10    | Magical movement ritual resolves     |
| 12    | Any resulting magic battle is fought |
| 24-25 | Conventional armies move             |
| 26    | Conventional movement battles occur  |

Conclusion: A teleporting force cannot be treated as arriving at the same moment as a marching army. The magical force may fight alone first.

### Constructing a laboratory

| Order     | Event                                             |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------|
| 2         | Research occurs without the unfinished laboratory |
| 5         | Forging occurs without it                         |
| 10        | Rituals occur without it                          |
| 35        | The laboratory finishes                           |
| Next turn | Eligible commanders can use the laboratory        |

Conclusion: A laboratory order is an investment in next month's magic, not a way to enable this month's rituals.

### Pillage after conquest

| Order | Event                                         |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 25    | Invaders move                                 |
| 26    | They win the province                         |
| 37    | A valid Pillage order is processed            |
| 38    | Income is collected from the damaged province |

Conclusion: Pillaging a newly conquered province can sacrifice immediate and future economic value.

### Starvation after combat

| Order     | Event                                                    |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| 26-33     | Ordinary, event, special-effect, and sneak battles occur |
| 40        | New starvation effects are applied                       |
| 48        | Healing or disease is processed                          |
| Next turn | The army begins in its worsened condition                |

Conclusion: An army can fight at its pre-starvation state and still emerge strategically crippled afterward.

## Dominion before and after battle

| Order | Event                                           |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------|
| 6-7   | Preaching and heretic preaching adjust dominion |
| 26-33 | Most battles occur                              |
| 42    | General dominion spread occurs                  |
| 43    | Dominion effects apply                          |

Conclusion: Active preaching can matter before battle. Passive monthly spread generally affects the state after battle.

## Victory before immortal return

| Order | Event                  |
|-------|------------------------|
| 56    | Elimination is checked |
| 57    | Victory is checked     |
| 60    | Due immortals reform   |

Conclusion: A return scheduled for the end of the month cannot undo a game-ending state already recognised at step 57.

## A new player's turn checklist

### Before finalising orders

- Check the treasury after recruitment, construction, forging, and expected transfers.
- Confirm that every army has a commander with the correct normal, magic, or undead leadership.
- Confirm that the slowest movement restriction has not invalidated an army's route.
- Check whether rivers, roads, mountains, forests, swamps, caves, sailing, or planes alter movement.
- Give bodyguards to commanders exposed to assassination.
- Verify that critical mages have the required paths, gems, laboratory, and target.
- Equip boosters before hosting; forging them this turn is too late for the same caster to use them.
- Check whether a ritual target is the starting province or expected destination of an enemy.
- Inspect every fort for recruitment, siege, storm, and repair intentions.
- Confirm that researchers are actually assigned to Research.
- Review starving, diseased, old, insane, or heavily Horror Marked commanders.
- Check dominion and retreat routes around important battles.
- Confirm that a Throne claimant has the required priest level and correct order.
- Recheck diplomacy messages, gold, gems, and items before sending.
- Save or archive the turn file when a test or major operation needs later reconstruction.

### After hosting

- Read messages before changing orders.
- Separate magic battles, movement battles, event battles, and assassination battles.

- Compare recruitment reports with surviving units.
- Check whether movement failed or whether the commander died before movement.
- Inspect new sites, buildings, heroes, mercenaries, globals, and dominion changes.
- Review income, upkeep, unrest, and supply summaries.
- Inspect wounded survivors for disease and new afflictions.
- Check whether stealthy units remained hidden or fought discovery battles.
- Review scouting reports as end-state snapshots.
- Record any result that contradicts the expected hosting sequence.

## Expert operational checklist

For a complex operation, write the dependency chain before submitting orders.

### Target

- What province, fort, army, commander, site, or global must change?
- Which exact end-state counts as success?

### Earliest interference

- Can a message transfer remove required gems or items?
- Can a remote ritual kill or move the target?
- Can a Horror, assassination, or seduction remove a critical commander?

### Magic-phase dependencies

- Which rituals interact?
- Does random ritual order matter?
- Will magical movement fight alone before conventional movement?
- Are retreats from several magic battles competing for the same provinces?

### Movement dependencies

- Is the destination friendly at step 24 or hostile at step 25?
- Could ownership change between planning and movement?
- Is Break Siege involved?
- Is there a valid retreat province after all battles in the group?

### Post-battle dependencies

- Does a global tick at step 28?
- Can a random event or item effect create another battle?
- Will a stealth force face discovery at step 33?
- Does construction finish too late for the intended action?

### Economic dependencies

- Does Pillage reduce the income expected to pay upkeep?
- Is the army supplied before the starvation tick?
- Does income arrive before the planned upkeep obligation?
- Could population loss reduce PD at step 61?

## End-state dependencies

- Can dominion spread eliminate a nation?
- Is victory checked before an expected immortal return?
- Does a hero, mercenary, or summoned ally arrive too late to matter?

## Troubleshooting: why did the order fail?

### "My army did not move"

Check, in order:

- 1 Was the commander killed by a Horror, assassination, magic battle, or remote effect before movement?
- 2 Did the commander become lost in another plane?
- 3 Was the route valid for every unit in the army?
- 4 Did terrain, a river, road status, sailing, flying, or survival ability change the cost?
- 5 Did the destination change from friendly to hostile or otherwise alter the movement category?
- 6 Was the commander performing a different order?
- 7 Was the army inside a fort, besieging, breaking siege, patrolling, or sneaking?
- 8 Did part of the army move while incompatible units remained?
- 9 Was the apparent failure actually movement followed by defeat and retreat?

### "My ritual did not happen"

Check:

- 1 Did the caster have the required laboratory?
- 2 Were the path requirements met after all equipped items and effects?
- 3 Were sufficient gems or slaves available to that caster?
- 4 Was the target legal and correctly selected?
- 5 Did the caster receive the ritual order rather than a battle script or different strategic order?
- 6 Was the ritual blocked, resisted, intercepted, or converted into a battle?
- 7 Did another randomly ordered ritual change the target first?
- 8 Was the expected result an ongoing global effect that waits until step 28?
- 9 Was the spell from a different ruleset or mod version?

### "My new building did nothing"

Construction finishes at step 35. It cannot enable research at step 2, recruitment at step 3, forging at step 5, or rituals at step 10 during that same hosting cycle.

### "My summoned allies missed the battle"

If they came from a special order such as Summon Allies or Reanimate, they arrived at step 36 after the battle steps. Ritual summons follow different timing and must be analysed under the ritual that created them.

### "The battle used different dominion than expected"

Check:

- preaching at step 6;
- heretic preaching at step 7;

- special religious effects;
- the pre-host candle state;
- whether ordinary dominion spread at step 42 occurred only after the battle;
- whether the battle report or later map screen is being used as the reference state.

### **"The province produced less income than expected"**

Check:

- ownership after movement and battle;
- pillage at step 37;
- population;
- unrest already present before the income step;
- dominion and scales;
- sites and events;
- partial ownership caused by a fort;
- whether the figure came from a pre-host projection or the final income report.

### **"The unit survived battle but disappeared"**

Possible causes include:

- a later event or special-effect battle;
- starvation;
- upkeep desertion;
- site or dominion damage;
- disease at step 48;
- lone-unit cleanup at step 52;
- elimination or victory;
- end-of-turn shape or item validation.

## **Ruleset and mod implications**

### **Core sequence versus mod-added content**

Ordinary .dm mods can add or modify:

- units;
- weapons and armour;
- spells;
- items;
- sites;
- nations;
- blessings;
- population types;
- mercenaries;
- events;
- AI templates and preferences;
- many special attributes.

The current modding manuals do not expose a command for rewriting the engine's entire 63-step hosting sequence.

The practical model is:



- the engine retains its main sequence;
- mods insert new content into the steps appropriate to that content;
- a modded ritual still belongs to ritual processing;
- a modded event still belongs to event processing;
- a modded monthly monster or item effect belongs to the relevant special-effect stage;
- mod load order determines the final data definitions used when those steps run.

This conclusion is Official limits plus inference, not proof that no executable-level modification could ever alter hosting.

## Mod load order

The Modding Manual states that complete mods are loaded one at a time. Within a mod, command categories are parsed in an internal order including weapons, armour, units, names, blessings, sites, nations, spells, items, general commands, population types, mercenaries, and events.

When two enabled mods alter the same object, later alterations can overwrite earlier values. The manual warns that overlapping modifications can produce unpredictable behaviour.

For the frozen ruleset, Dominions Enhanced loads before Divinitus. [Book IX](#) owns the exact overlap and collision record, while the Grand Hierophant reconstruction is kept with the Arcoscephale dossier in [Book VII](#). The timing lesson here is simply that load order belongs to the ruleset.

## Event chains and compatibility

The Event Modding Manual warns that event-code collisions between mods can scramble event chains and create severe bugs. It recommends negative event codes in a reserved range and careful compatibility checking.

Both active mods add large event libraries. Their size alone does not prove a collision, but it makes code and variable auditing a foundational requirement. The exact registries and current collision findings are recorded once in [Book IX](#).

## Controlled tests required by Book I

The official sequence is explicit, but several practical interactions still need current-game reproduction.

### Test protocol

Every test should record:

- game version;
- operating ruleset;
- enabled mods and load order;
- map and game settings;
- turn number and season;
- relevant units, IDs, paths, items, sites, and province state;
- exact submitted orders;
- pre-host save;
- messages and battle reports;
- before-and-after screenshots or extracted state;
- number of repetitions;
- conclusion and confidence label.

## Priority timing tests

| #  | Test                                        | Controlled question                                                                                                                                             |
|----|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | Research completion and same-turn scripting | Can a newly completed research level make a pre-scripted spell available in a later battle that month, and how are invalid scripts handled?                     |
| 2  | Preaching and battle dominion               | Does successful step-6 preaching change dominion-dependent battle statistics before a step-26 battle?                                                           |
| 3  | Throne claim-loss regression                | Confirm that later claimant death preserves a completed claim, while unfortified conquest or a successful fort storm makes the Throne unclaimed before step 57. |
| 4  | Forged item availability                    | Can a step-5 forged item influence an already-submitted same-turn ritual or special effect without being equipped beforehand?                                   |
| 5  | Newly discovered site effects               | Does a site discovered at step 14 apply its monthly effect at step 44 in the same month?                                                                        |
| 6  | Assassinated movement commander             | What happens to movement and assigned troops when their only commander dies at step 20?                                                                         |
| 7  | Friendly movement priority                  | Which forces appear in battle when friendly reinforcement and an enemy invasion enter the same province during an ownership change?                             |
| 8  | Global casting versus first world tick      | Which parts of a global occur at casting step 10 and which wait for world-effect step 28?                                                                       |
| 9  | Pillage and same-turn income                | How much income is lost when a newly captured province is pillaged at step 37 before income at step 38?                                                         |
| 10 | Unrest timing                               | Which of pre-existing unrest, pillage unrest, patrol reduction, and dominion-driven unrest changes influence step-38 income?                                    |
| 11 | Starvation timing                           | Does a newly undersupplied army fight at its prior state before receiving the post-host starvation effects?                                                     |
| 12 | Upkeep desertion priority                   | Which units desert first during a controlled treasury shortfall?                                                                                                |
| 13 | Site, dominion, and disease ordering        | How do site disease, dominion effects, aging, regeneration, and existing disease combine in the end-of-turn health sequence?                                    |
| 14 | Scouting before PD reduction                | Do reports or interface values show PD before or after the step-61 population reduction?                                                                        |
| 15 | Victory before immortal return              | Can victory or elimination end the game on the same turn an immortal is due to reform at step 60?                                                               |
| 16 | DE and Divinitus event-code audit           | Do the two supplied files collide in event codes, variables, rarity classes, or order requirements?                                                             |

## Source record

### Primary official sources

- [Illwinter Dominions 6 documentation](#), accessed 25 August 2026.
- [Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2](#), especially pages 13, 47-57, 73-87.
- [Illwinter update record](#), recording Dominions 6.36 on 17 August 2026 UTC.
- [Official Dominions 6.36 announcement](#).
- [Dominions 6 changes from Dominions 5](#).
- [Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34](#), especially pages 3-5 and 63-65.
- [Dominions 6 Event Modding Manual, version 6.29](#), especially pages 2-11.

### Exact mod sources

- [DomEnhanced2\\_16.dm](#), SHA-256 72558697f8dae3a1fccf8fb57b3faccde56c7fe6c05dac6403cefe153faf6c1b.
- [Divinitus\\_1.15.3\\_DE.dm](#), SHA-256 cf7f21900a3812b66edddd831df779743eaf33080aef983f9bdea8ec47642809.

## Verification note

The public base game is version 6.36, while the current official Modding Manual identifies itself as version 6.34 and the Event Modding Manual as version 6.29. This is not automatically a contradiction: auxiliary manuals are updated when their documented interfaces change. It does mean that later patch notes and current-game tests remain necessary whenever a rule could have changed after a manual's stated version.

## DOCUMENT 3 OF 16

# Turn and Economy Quick Reference

## Scope and use

This is the library's field sheet: the small amount of deliberate repetition kept beside the turn screen. Foundation [Book I](#) owns hosting order and Foundation [Book II](#) owns the economic rules. The sheet simply keeps their most-used facts in one place while answering four immediate questions:

- 1 What resolves first?
- 2 What limits recruitment here?
- 3 What will this province actually produce?
- 4 What state change will matter this month rather than next month?

Ruleset: Unmodded Dominions 6.36 unless a modded note is explicitly shown. Primary source: Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2. Verification date: 25 August 2026. Evidence rule: A dagger symbol is not used; uncertainties are written out beside the affected rule.

## The hosting spine

The official hosting sequence contains 63 steps. The following spine preserves the steps that most often decide an order-writing problem.

| Step  | Resolution                                       | Immediate consequence                                                      |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1     | Messages and attached resources                  | Transfers leave before almost every danger or ownership change.            |
| 2     | Research                                         | A researcher killed later still contributes this month.                    |
| 3     | Recruitment                                      | New defenders exist before attacks and movement.                           |
| 4     | Empowerment                                      | Permanent path increases are applied.                                      |
| 5     | Forging                                          | New items enter the national inventory but are not retroactively equipped. |
| 6-8   | Preaching, heretics, Throne claims               | These religious actions precede battles and general dominion spread.       |
| 10    | Rituals                                          | Casters resolve in random order.                                           |
| 11-12 | Remote attacks and magic battles                 | Magical attacks and movement can strike before conventional movement.      |
| 14    | Site searches                                    | Search orders finish before ordinary conquest.                             |
| 15-18 | Prophets, Call God, awakening, Blood Hunting     | These resolve before assassinations and ordinary movement.                 |
| 20    | Assassinations                                   | A killed commander may strand an army before movement.                     |
| 24-25 | Friendly movement, then other movement           | Conventional movement is divided into two steps.                           |
| 26-27 | Movement battles, then castle storming           | A relieving army can fight before a storm attempt.                         |
| 28-33 | Globals, events, effect battles, sneak discovery | Several late battle groups remain after movement.                          |
| 35    | Building construction and demolition             | A new fort, temple, or lab is too late for this month's earlier actions.   |

| Step  | Resolution                                      | Immediate consequence                                                             |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 36    | Special-order allies                            | Reanimated or summoned allies created here are too late for this month's battles. |
| 37    | Pillage                                         | Population and unrest damage precede income.                                      |
| 38    | Income                                          | Gold is collected after conquest and pillage, before upkeep.                      |
| 39    | Unrest alterations                              | Most ordinary unrest reduction is too late to improve this month's income.        |
| 40    | Starvation                                      | Armies fight before newly applied starvation.                                     |
| 41    | Upkeep and desertion                            | This month's income is available before the charge.                               |
| 42-44 | Dominion spread, dominion effects, site effects | Ordinary dominion spread occurs after most battles and the economy.               |
| 48    | Healing and disease                             | Battle survivors heal or suffer disease after the combat sequence.                |
| 54    | Conscription                                    | Automatic minimum PD is created for future turns.                                 |
| 56-57 | Elimination, then victory                       | Both checks occur before immortals reform.                                        |
| 60-63 | Immortals, unsupported PD, artifacts, cleanup   | End-state maintenance prepares the next order phase.                              |

## Provincial gold

### Base and final income

Base income = population / 100

Modified income =  
 (population / 100)  
 x dominion-scale modifiers  
 x (1 + fort Administration / 200)

Final income =  
 modified income / (1 + unrest x 0.02)

The number displayed by the province interface is already modified. Exact intermediate rounding is an implementation detail and should not be reconstructed from the final number when a one-gold difference matters.

### Tax trace

A province produces no income for the turn if it cannot trace an unbroken line of friendly provinces to a friendly fort. In disciple games, allied territory can carry the trace.

This is a collection rule, not a resource rule. A cut tax line can remove gold income without removing the province's local resources, recruitment capacity, or supplies.

### Unrest multipliers

| Unrest | Income retained | Resources retained |
|--------|-----------------|--------------------|
| 0      | 100%            | 100%               |
| 10     | about 83%       | about 91%          |
| 25     | about 67%       | 80%                |

| Unrest | Income retained | Resources retained |
|--------|-----------------|--------------------|
| 50     | 50%             | about 67%          |
| 75     | 40%             | about 57%          |
| 100    | about 33%       | 50%                |
| 150    | 25%             | 40%                |
| 200    | 20%             | about 33%          |

At unrest 100 or greater, ordinary unit and commander recruitment is prohibited.

## Provincial resources

An unfortified province makes only half of its potential resource value available for local recruitment. A fortified province uses its full local potential and may draw a percentage of the potential resources of eligible adjacent provinces.

Final local resource pool =  
calculated resources / (1 + unrest x 0.01)

Fort resource draw is governed by Administration:

- a fort draws its Administration percentage from each eligible adjacent province's potential resources;
- land forts do not draw from sea provinces, and sea forts do not draw from land;
- a fort does not draw from an adjacent province containing another fort;
- a fort does not draw from an enemy-held province;
- two forts may draw from the same third province when that third province is adjacent to both and contains no fort.

Resources are local and do not accumulate. Unused resources vanish at hosting rather than moving to the treasury.

## Recruitment capacity

### Recruitment Points

Start with 20 Recruitment Points, then add the contribution from each population band reached.

| Population band | Contribution from that band |
|-----------------|-----------------------------|
| Base            | 20                          |
| First 5,000     | population in band / 100    |
| 5,001-10,000    | population in band / 200    |
| 10,001-20,000   | population in band / 300    |
| 20,001-40,000   | population in band / 400    |
| Above 40,000    | population in band / 500    |

Example for 6,000 population:

$20 + 5,000/100 + 1,000/200 = 75$  Recruitment Points

The fort's recruitment bonus is applied afterward. Order or Turmoil changes Recruitment Points by 10% per scale step. Exact fractional rounding remains assigned to controlled testing.

## The four recruitment gates

| Gate               | What it limits                               | Common misunderstanding                                             |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Gold               | Units, commanders, buildings, PD, and upkeep | A rich treasury does not create more local resources or points.     |
| Resources          | Equipment-heavy troops in that province      | Resources do not transfer or stockpile.                             |
| Recruitment Points | Ordinary troop throughput                    | Cheap, lightly equipped units can still exhaust local organisation. |
| Commander Points   | Commander throughput                         | Extra gold and resources do not bypass the local commander rate.    |

Sacred recruitment adds a fifth gate: Holy Points. Limited recruits may add a sixth: a unit-specific cap.

## Commander Point ladder

ordinary Commander Points = 1 base + current fort bonus

| Location                          | Total CP |
|-----------------------------------|----------|
| Unfortified province or Palisades | 1        |
| Fortress or Castle                | 2        |
| Citadel or Grand Citadel          | 3        |

Multi-point commanders accumulate progress over more than one month when the local pool is too small. `#slowrec` changes the commander's cost rather than increasing or decreasing the province pool. AI difficulty bonuses do not modify Commander Points or Holy Points.

## Queue behaviour

- Gold must be available when the order is placed.
- A shortage of resources or Recruitment Points can leave units queued for a later month.
- Sacred units can remain queued behind the Holy Point limit.
- A province can hold at most 250 queued units.
- Commander recruitment uses Commander Points; some commanders cost more than one point.
- Recruitment occurs at hosting step 3. A unit appearing then can defend that month but cannot receive a new strategic order until the next order phase.

## Upkeep

The manual's ordinary monthly rule is:

ordinary gold-recruited unit upkeep = gold cost / 15  
sacred or slave upkeep = gold cost / 30

Most summoned units have no upkeep. Exceptions can be assigned additional upkeep. The in-game unit panel commonly presents annual upkeep, equal to twelve monthly charges.

Versioned 6.33 observations establish that Sacred and Slave reductions stack, producing gold cost divided by 60, and that mounted upkeep uses separate rider and mount bases. Patch review through 6.36 finds no later general change. These rules are Community-tested rather than official manual wording. Shapechanged upkeep and fractional monthly aggregation remain unresolved.

Observed annual entries for 7- and 16-gold ordinary units are 6 and 13. Those samples exclude simply flooring the final annual decimal, but do not establish how monthly fractions reach the treasury. Use the Income Overview when the margin is one gold.

Upkeep resolves at step 41, after income at step 38. A nation can spend down to a narrow treasury during the order phase and rely on that month's income for upkeep. Any interruption to income can turn that small margin into desertion.

## Supplies and starvation

### Population supply

| Population band | Base supply                |
|-----------------|----------------------------|
| First 15,000    | 1 supply per 30 population |
| Above 15,000    | 1 supply per 60 population |

Growth or Death modifies this value first. Heat or Cold modifies it second.

### Fort supply projection

Supply from a fort =  
 $(\text{Administration} \times 6) / (\text{distance} + 1)$

The maximum distance is four provinces. Where several forts are in range, only the highest fort contribution is used.

The manual's printed multiplier table and one worked example instead follow  $(\text{Administration} \times 4) / (\text{distance} + 1)$ . Another official adjacent-province example agrees with the multiplier of six. The current community reference follows six, but distance scaling remains scheduled for a versioned test.

### Supply usage

- Size 0 uses no supply.
- Size 1 and Size 2 use one-half supply.
- Larger units normally use Size minus 2.
- Animals use half the ordinary amount.
- A mounted unit consumes supply for both rider and mount.
- Nature magic indirectly contributes 10 supply per path level.
- Update 6.35 fixed stale Supply Usage after magic-item changes; recheck the displayed total after changing relevant equipment.

### Starvation

When usage exceeds available supplies, units whose combined usage is approximately the deficit are selected to starve.

| State                           | Effect                                                                |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| First month selected            | Starving condition, -4 morale, 5% disease chance                      |
| Selected while already starving | 50% disease chance                                                    |
| Appropriate survival skill      | 50% chance to avoid starvation; a further 50% chance to avoid disease |



| State           | Effect                                  |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Supply restored | Starving ends; existing disease remains |

Starvation resolves at step 40, after battles. It usually becomes a problem for the next battle, although disease or an existing Starving condition may already be causing harm.

Need Not Eat is the explicit immunity tag. Official update 6.18 confirms that transformation into a non-eating form removes Starving. Supply consumption and starvation eligibility are distinct: some objects can consume supplies while remaining unable to starve. Commanders are commonly reported to receive feeding priority, but generic commander immunity is not established.

## Fortification table

Each cost and time is for that upgrade stage. Statistics replace the previous fort's values; they do not stack.

| Fort          | Gold  | Months | Admin | Commander Points | Recruitment bonus | Siege storage | Wall  |
|---------------|-------|--------|-------|------------------|-------------------|---------------|-------|
| Palisades     | 1,000 | 5      | 15    | +0               | +50%              | 150           | 200   |
| Fortress      | 600   | 3      | 30    | +1               | +75%              | 750           | 500   |
| Castle        | 600   | 3      | 45    | +1               | +100%             | 2,500         | 1,000 |
| Citadel       | 600   | 3      | 60    | +2               | +125%             | 7,500         | 1,500 |
| Grand Citadel | 1,000 | 5      | 70    | +2               | +150%             | 10,000        | 2,000 |

The standard maximum is Fortress in the Early Age, Castle in the Middle Age, and Citadel in the Late Age. Primitive or advanced national fort access and the Mason ability can alter this.

## Buildings

| Building   | Standard cost  | Constructor      | Principal functions                                                                          |
|------------|----------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fort       | Stage-specific | Any commander    | Protection, resources, supply projection, income through Administration, recruitment bonuses |
| Temple     | 600 gold       | Sacred commander | Dominion spread, preaching bonus, Blood Sacrifice access where applicable                    |
| Laboratory | 600 gold       | Mage             | Research, rituals, national gem/item pool, site functions that require a lab                 |

Nation and terrain exceptions can change these costs.

Construction completes at hosting step 35. A lab finished this month cannot enable step-2 research, step-5 forging, or step-10 rituals during the same month. A temple finishes after preaching and Throne claims. A fort finishes after recruitment and all ordinary battles.

Any commander can demolish a fort or laboratory in one month. Temples cannot be demolished by order; an enemy temple is automatically destroyed when its province is conquered. A fort cannot be demolished while under siege.

## Siege calculation

reduction strength = Strength squared  
 repair strength = Strength squared / 2

Modifiers:

- Flying doubles reduction or repair contribution.
- Mindless defenders contribute one-eighth of calculated repair.
- Animals contribute half repair.
- Undisciplined units contribute half repair.
- Only commanders and units assigned to Maintain Siege contribute.
- Castle Guards and Wall Defenders add repair strength.

The difference between total reduction and repair damages or restores the wall, never above its original integrity. A fort not under siege repairs fully. The defender sees exact wall integrity; an attacker normally receives only a descriptive estimate.

A storm order becomes available after the wall has reached zero and the next order phase opens. Storming resolves after conventional movement battles, so a relief force can defeat or weaken the besiegers before the gate battle.

## Supply inside a siege

fort supply this siege month =  
 Supply Storage / consecutive siege turn

A fort with 300 storage supplies 300, 150, 100, 75, and 60 during the first five consecutive siege months. This storage concerns units inside the besieged fort. Administration's supply projection is a different system.

## Province Defence

The first PD point is free. Buying each later point costs gold equal to the level being purchased.

cumulative cost to PD n =  
 $n(n + 1)/2 - 1$

| PD  | Total gold | Notes                                        |
|-----|------------|----------------------------------------------|
| 1   | 0          | First commander and troops                   |
| 6   | 20         | Cheap raid tax; roster quality still matters |
| 10  | 54         | Official additional-benefit threshold        |
| 15  | 119        | Stealth detection begins                     |
| 20  | 209        | Additional troop and commander types         |
| 25  | 324        | Patrol strength 11                           |
| 30  | 464        | Expensive static commitment                  |
| 40  | 819        | Usually a specialised defence decision       |
| 50  | 1,274      | Severe opportunity cost                      |
| 100 | 5,049      | Hard maximum                                 |

Every full 10 PD reduces unrest by 1 each turn. Beginning at PD 15, patrol strength equals PD - 14; the manual's example gives PD 25 a patrol strength of 11.

PD costs no upkeep and fully returns after a battle if control is retained. It cannot be voluntarily reduced. It requires 10 population per point and is reduced at hosting step 61 when population cannot support it. Capture wipes existing PD. Relinquishing a province in a disciple game reduces it by 25%.

PD is a local delay mechanism and raid tax, not a mobile army. Its national roster, magic support, terrain, attacker's script, and retreat situation determine its actual combat value.

## Magic sites and gems

- Forests, wastes, deep seas, and several unusual terrains tend to have more sites; plains and farms tend to have fewer.
- Hidden sites have difficulty 1 through 4.
- A searching mage finds sites in a path up to that mage's path level.
- Path level 4 is the highest needed for ordinary manual searching.
- Path-search rituals reveal every site of their path in the target province.
- Acashic Knowledge reveals every magic site there.
- A site may provide gems, gold, recruits, entry orders, discounts, unrest, disease, or other effects.
- Harmful site effects can operate while the site is undiscovered.
- A captured national recruitment site may continue to yield gems without granting its former nation's special recruits.
- Some site recruitment requires a laboratory.

Search orders resolve at step 14. Site effects resolve at step 44. Discovery does not retroactively create earlier recruitment or ritual orders.

## Blood Hunting

For an ordinary hunter, the manual gives three checks:

Blood success chance =  $10\% + 30\% \times \text{Blood level}$   
 Population success chance =  $\text{population} / 75$  percent  
 Unrest failure chance =  $\text{unrest} / 4$  percent

If all checks succeed:

slaves found =  $d6 + \text{Blood level}$   
 unrest gained =  $d(\text{slaves} \times 3 + 4)$

If any check fails, no slaves are found and unrest rises by  $d6 - 1$ .

Population reaches a 100% nominal population check at 7,500. A Blood 3 hunter reaches a 100% nominal Blood check. Unrest can still cause failure. Site frequency changes the average yield by 0.5 slaves for every five percentage points away from 50%. Strong friendly dominion reduces the risk of hostile commoners attacking; the manual states that dominion 10 makes such resistance almost disappear.

Blood Hunting is not free gem generation. It converts mage-turns, population, patrol labour, gold income, and attention into slaves.

## Scale effects used in economic calculations

The current unmodded 6.36 baseline uses the following ordinary per-step effects. Growth and Death use the newer official Modding Manual default rather than the stale one-percent entry in the revision-2 main manual.

| Scale step                     | Income | Resources | Recruitment Points | Supplies | Population      |
|--------------------------------|--------|-----------|--------------------|----------|-----------------|
| Order                          | +3%    | +2%       | +10%               | -        | -               |
| Turmoil                        | -3%    | -2%       | -10%               | -        | -               |
| Productivity                   | +3%    | +15%      | -                  | -        | -               |
| Sloth                          | -3%    | -15%      | -                  | -        | -               |
| Heat/Cold away from preference | -5%    | -         | -                  | -10%     | -               |
| Growth                         | +2%    | -         | -                  | +10%     | +0.2% per month |
| Death                          | -2%    | -         | -                  | -10%     | -0.2% per month |

Evidence boundary:

- Modding Manual 6.34 defines the unmodded #deathincome default as 2. No official announcement through 6.36 changes that general default. The current baseline uses 2% income per Growth/Death step; the revision-2 main-manual entry remains only as a documented older conflict.
- The revision-2 main manual gives Order/Turmoil resources as 2% per step, and no later official announcement changes it. Unsourced three-percent tables are not used as current evidence.

Exact integer rounding remains unresolved. A calculation near an integer boundary should still defer to the displayed in-game province value.

## Active mod economy deltas

The exact supplied files define the combined ruleset as Dominions Enhanced 2.16 loaded before Divinitus 1.15.3 DE.

Dominions Enhanced changes these global values:

| Global rule                                 | Unmodded source value | DE 2.16 |
|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------|---------|
| Order/Turmoil income per step               | 3%                    | 4%      |
| Productivity/Sloth income per step          | 3%                    | 4%      |
| Growth/Death income per step                | 2%                    | 2%      |
| Growth/Death population change per step     | 0.2%                  | 0.25%   |
| Fortune/Misfortune event frequency per step | 5%                    | 7%      |

Divinitus does not redefine those five global commands, so its later load position does not reset them.

Both mods contain many object-, site-, event-, item-, unit-, and nation-specific economic effects. A global table cannot safely predict a specific nation until its roster and source overrides are examined.

## Order-writing audit

Before submission:

- Check the treasury after both recruitment and construction.
- Check projected upkeep against income, including isolated provinces.
- Scan local resources and Recruitment Points for greyed-out queues.
- Check Commander Points and Holy Points separately from troop capacity.
- Trace tax lines from vulnerable provinces to a friendly fort.
- Compare army Supply Usage against both the destination and every likely battle province.

- Inspect unrest in recruiting and income-critical provinces.
- Confirm that new infrastructure is not being treated as operational one step too early.
- Distinguish the province outside a fort from the fort interior.
- Confirm which siege commanders remain on Maintain Siege.
- Recalculate PD cost cumulatively rather than valuing only the next point.
- Check whether a site search, Blood Hunt, patrol, or research assignment consumes the mage-turn needed elsewhere.

After hosting:

- Read battle and event reports before changing queues.
- Check for recruitment that remained queued.
- Compare treasury income and upkeep totals.
- Inspect new unrest before projecting the next month's income.
- Check supply, Starving, disease, and attritions on every large army.
- Recheck tax traces and besieged forts.
- Record new sites and whether their benefits require a lab.
- Check wall condition from the correct side's available information.
- Confirm unsupported PD reductions in depopulated provinces.

## Source note and unresolved tests

Official core: Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2, especially pages 21-29, 51-57, and 71-72. Global defaults: Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34. Mod values: exact source of DomEnhanced2\_16.dm and Divinitus\_1.15.3\_DE.dm. Official plus current community evidence: ordinary Commander Point base behaviour, sacred-and-slave upkeep stacking, and mounted upkeep decomposition. Community details retained provisionally: exact unrest reductions to Recruitment Points and Commander Points, and generic commander feeding priority.

Priority reproductions:

- 1 Recruitment Point rounding at population-band and scale boundaries.
- 2 Fort supply at distance zero through four.
- 3 Resource rounding and overlapping fort draw.
- 4 Shapechanged upkeep and fractional monthly aggregation.
- 5 Unrest effects on Recruitment Points and Commander Points.
- 6 Commander feeding priority and starvation eligibility.

Growth/Death income and Order/Turmoil resources are resolved at 2% per step, and the ordinary Commander Point ladder is closed. Future tests of those values are regression checks, not prerequisites for using the published baseline.

## DOCUMENT 4 OF 16

# Foundation Book II: Economy, Provinces, and the Machinery of State

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## Why the economy needs its own book

Dominions 6 presents its economy as a row of numbers: gold, gems, resources, Recruitment Points, supplies, population, unrest, and upkeep. Those numbers do not all work in the same way. Some are national, some belong to one province, some vanish unused, and others can be saved indefinitely. A few are not spendable resources at all; they limit how quickly something else can be turned into useful power.

This is why the richest nation can still fail to raise an army. It is also why a poor province can decide a war by preserving tax trace, feeding a siege, or shortening a reinforcement route. [Book II](#) follows those connections from the province screen to the wider war effort. Ordinary play comes first, followed by the formulas, edge cases, and source disputes needed for closer work.

Foundation rule: Economic value is not the number printed beside a province. It is the useful power that can be converted from that province, through the available infrastructure, before an opponent can interrupt the conversion.

## Edition note

[Book I](#) defines the common Dominions 6.36 baseline and evidence labels. [Book II](#) relies mainly on the revision-2 manual and Modding Manual 6.34. Where those official documents disagree, both readings remain visible. [Book IX](#) owns the exact DE and Divinitus definitions; only their economic consequences are repeated here.

The Edition 23 revision returns to R-008 and R-010 through R-013 without opening another economy volume. It separates every known rounding stage, turns the community unrest wording into explicit candidate thresholds, records what the annual upkeep observations do and do not prove, bounds the two printed fort-supply systems, and incorporates the official 6.35 Supply Usage refresh correction. No uncertain engine rule has been promoted merely because one interpretation is convenient.

## A sensible way through

For a first campaign, begin with the economic model, province anatomy, recruitment gates, supply, and infrastructure. The formula sections, PD curves, siege economics, Blood opportunity costs, and diagnostic ratios are there for closer planning. Source conflicts and controlled tests can be left until a disputed number actually matters.

## Part I: The Economic Model

---

## Dominions as a game of conversion

Territory is not victory by itself. Territory provides inputs which can be converted into military and magical effects:

population and scales  
-> gold, supplies, and recruitment capacity

terrain and forts  
-> resources, infrastructure, and strategic position

gold and local capacity  
-> troops, commanders, buildings, and province defence

labs, mage-turns, and research  
-> spells, items, rituals, summons, and battlefield packages

sites and blood hunting  
-> gems and blood slaves

armies, magic, information, and diplomacy  
-> territory, forts, thrones, and denial

thrones and survival  
-> victory

Every arrow takes time. Every conversion can be interrupted. Much of expert play consists of identifying which arrow is currently limiting the nation.

### Stock, flow, capacity, and position

Four categories keep economic discussions clear.

| Category | Meaning                                          | Examples                                                                     |
|----------|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Stock    | A resource saved for future use                  | Treasury gold, gems, blood slaves, forged items                              |
| Flow     | A recurring gain or loss                         | Monthly income, gem income, upkeep, population growth                        |
| Capacity | A local or national limit on conversion          | Resources, Recruitment Points, Commander Points, Holy Points, mage-turns     |
| Position | Map state that makes conversion possible or safe | Fort network, tax trace, laboratory access, supply reach, defensible borders |

Economic mistakes often begin by treating one category as another. Resources do not accumulate, so they are not a stock. A large treasury does not create recruitment capacity. A fort has a price, but it also changes strategic position and several local limits. A mage is a unit and a recurring choice about how to spend a mage-turn.

### National and local resources

| Resource or limit | Scope                        | Accumulates? | Portable?                                           | Principal uses                                                   |
|-------------------|------------------------------|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Gold              | National treasury            | Yes          | Effectively national                                | Recruitment, buildings, PD, mercenaries, some rituals and events |
| Magic gems        | National pool and commanders | Yes          | Transferable through labs, commanders, and messages | Rituals, forging, combat magic, empowerment                      |

| Resource or limit  | Scope                                 | Accumulates?                                                        | Portable?                                | Principal uses                                                  |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Blood slaves       | National pool and commanders          | Yes                                                                 | Transferable, but with distinct handling | Blood rituals, forging, battle magic, sacrifice                 |
| Resources          | Province                              | No                                                                  | No                                       | Equipping recruits                                              |
| Recruitment Points | Province                              | No                                                                  | No                                       | Ordinary troop throughput                                       |
| Commander Points   | Province                              | No                                                                  | No                                       | Commander throughput                                            |
| Holy Points        | Nation/local sacred queue interaction | Refreshes                                                           | No direct transfer                       | Sacred recruitment                                              |
| Supplies           | Province and army situation           | No strategic stock, except siege storage and temporary pillage food | Army uses local supply                   | Sustaining units                                                |
| Population         | Province                              | Changes over time                                                   | No                                       | Income, Recruitment Points, supplies, PD support, Blood Hunting |
| Mage-turns         | Commander-time                        | No                                                                  | Commander can move                       | Research, site search, forging, rituals, Blood Hunting, combat  |

The table explains why "What can the nation afford?" is incomplete. The more useful question is:

What can be paid for, recruited at the correct location, led, supplied, scripted, and delivered before the relevant deadline?

## The binding constraint

Production is governed by the tightest active limit.

Suppose a fort has:

- 1,000 gold available nationally;
- 120 local resources;
- 80 local Recruitment Points;
- one available Commander Point;
- three Holy Points.

A 10-gold, 5-resource, 10-RP troop is not limited by gold or resources. It is limited to eight by Recruitment Points. A 100-gold commander that costs two Commander Points cannot be recruited there even though the treasury is sufficient. A sacred costing one Holy Point can be limited to three even when every local pool remains.

The bottleneck can change when the recruit mix changes. Adding an expensive armoured unit may convert an RP-limited queue into a resource-limited one. Adding a cheap commander may consume the Commander Point needed for the mage who makes the fort strategically valuable.

## Bottleneck audit

For every major recruitment centre:

- 1 Identify the desired troop and commander package.
- 2 Calculate gold, resources, Recruitment Points, Commander Points, and Holy Points separately.
- 3 Find the first exhausted pool.
- 4 Ask whether a different mix uses otherwise stranded capacity.



## 5 Compare the value of expanding capacity against building another centre.

This is more accurate than optimising a single "gold efficiency" statistic.

## Opportunity cost

The true cost of an action includes the best alternative foregone.

Examples:

- A 600-gold laboratory is also troops not recruited this month.
- A searching mage is research not produced.
- A Blood Hunter is research, forging, or ritual work not performed.
- Province Defence is permanent local defence, but the same gold could have become a mobile army.
- A fort under construction ties up a commander and delays military spending before its benefits begin.
- A mage carrying gems into battle makes those gems unavailable for a ritual and risks losing them.

Opportunity cost changes with time. A laboratory that delays the first expansion party may be disastrous; the same laboratory may be essential once the province's recruitable mage or site income becomes relevant.

## Economic tempo

An investment is measured by more than eventual return.

```
payback time =  
investment cost / recurring net gain
```

This simple ratio is useful but incomplete. Dominions adds:

- construction delay;
- commander-turn cost;
- risk of capture;
- military value during payback;
- capacity unlocked;
- strategic location;
- the possibility that the game ends before repayment.

A fort may never repay its gold through Administration income alone yet still be a strong investment because it recruits mages, concentrates resources, projects supply, protects a laboratory, delays an invasion, and creates a tax-trace anchor.

# Part II: Provinces, Terrain, and Population

## A province is a bundle of systems

A province can contain:

- one or more terrain types;
- population;
- potential and available resources;

- income;
- supplies;
- dominion and scales;
- unrest;
- corpses;
- Province Defence;
- a fort, temple, and laboratory;
- discovered and undiscovered sites;
- recruitable independent or national units;
- commanders and armies;
- partial ownership between the exterior and a besieged fort.

The printed income number is only one part of the province's value.

Provincial roles

| Role                | What makes it valuable                                                    |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Income province     | High population, favourable scales, low unrest, tax trace, Administration |
| Production province | High potential resources, strong fort draw, suitable national roster      |
| Mage centre         | Valuable commander roster, lab, Commander Points, safety                  |
| Logistics node      | Fort supply reach, roads or movement position, defensible route           |
| Site province       | Gem income, recruit access, discounts, ritual or entry functions          |
| Blood province      | Sufficient population, patrol capacity, acceptable economic sacrifice     |
| Buffer province     | Raid tax, warning time, retreat geometry, denial                          |
| Throne province     | Ascension value, special throne effects, strategic obligation             |

One province may fill several roles. Its correct investment level depends on the most important role, not on a universal province template.

Corpses as provincial stock

Unburied corpses are a local provincial stock. They are not gold, population, supplies, or units waiting to be recruited, but several Death effects and reanimation orders can convert them into value. The revision-2 manual names Raven Feast and the raising of undead as ordinary examples.

The stock is deliberately concealed from most observers. Its number is visible when a Death mage or undead priest is present in the province. A nation's ordinary priests can also see it when those priests possess national reanimation. Ermor's Ashen Empire dominion supplies a broader special exception by sensing unburied corpses in covered provinces.

| Question                           | Current verified answer                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What does the number represent?    | Unburied corpses currently available in the province.                                                                    |
| Who normally sees it?              | A Death mage or undead priest in the province.                                                                           |
| Which ordinary priests can see it? | Priests of a nation whose normal priests can reanimate undead.                                                           |
| What consumes it directly?         | Reanimating Soulless reduces the available corpse count; corpse-dependent spells and abilities may have their own rules. |
| What does not require this stock?  | Ordinary Longdead reanimation has no corpse limit under the manual's basic distinction.                                  |

| Question                                                        | Current verified answer                                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Is every battlefield death guaranteed to add one usable corpse? | No general one-for-one rule is stated. Corpse eligibility has changed through patches, so the casualty total is not a safe substitute for the visible stock. |
| Is a universal decay rate documented?                           | No general monthly decay formula is stated in the current official foundation sources used here.                                                             |

The last two limits matter. Version 6.08 specifically changed humanoid apes and dogs so that they leave corpses when killed. That official correction shows that corpse production depends on unit eligibility rather than on a universal "one dead body equals one corpse" rule. Until an exact current production table is available, battle losses should be treated as a clue, not as an exact corpse forecast.

## Corpse-dependent conversions

The manual separates three common reanimation economies:

- Ghouls convert living population into undead, reducing the population left behind.
- Soulless convert unburied corpses and reduce the local corpse stock.
- Longdead can be reanimated without a stated population or corpse ceiling.

Asphodel uses a different branch. Human inhabitants or dead human corpses permit a chance of Manikins and Mandragoras; when those are unavailable, animal-based carrion creatures remain possible. This is a national conversion rule, not a universal reanimation formula.

Operationally, a corpse-dependent plan needs four checks:

- 1 a legal commander, spell, or ability;
- 2 visibility or another reliable reason to believe the local stock exists;
- 3 the correct province at the relevant order or ritual step;
- 4 a comparison between consuming the stock now and reserving it for a stronger conversion later.

[Book X's special-order reference](#) owns the order-entry procedure. Exact spells and summoned objects remain in the [Book XII](#) data layer. [Book II](#) owns the economic reading: corpses are hidden, local, exhaustible in some uses, and valuable only through a legal converter.

## Terrain

The manual characterises terrain by broad tendencies:

| Terrain         | Population tendency | Resource tendency | Site tendency |
|-----------------|---------------------|-------------------|---------------|
| Plains          | Neutral             | Neutral           | Neutral       |
| Mountain Ranges | Neutral             | Excellent         | Many          |
| Forest          | Low                 | High              | Many          |
| Highlands       | Low                 | High              | Neutral       |
| Swamp           | Very low            | Neutral           | Many          |
| Waste           | Extremely low       | Neutral           | Abundant      |
| Farm            | Very high           | Low               | Few           |
| River           | High                | Neutral           | Neutral       |
| Sea             | Low                 | Neutral           | Neutral       |

| Terrain      | Population tendency | Resource tendency | Site tendency |
|--------------|---------------------|-------------------|---------------|
| Deep Sea     | Very low            | High              | Many          |
| Kelp Forest  | High                | Neutral           | Neutral       |
| Gorge        | Low                 | High              | Abundant      |
| Cave         | Low                 | Neutral           | Neutral       |
| Drip Cave    | Neutral             | Excellent         | Neutral       |
| Crystal Cave | Very low            | High              | Abundant      |
| Forest Cave  | High                | Neutral           | Many          |

Multiple terrain types can coexist and their effects add. Terrain also affects movement, survival skills, combat environments, national recruitment, building costs, site pools, and the boundary between land and underwater systems.

### Strategic reading of terrain

Farms often deserve protection because their population supports income, supply, and recruitment capacity. Highlands, forests, mountains, and special caves often make stronger production or search targets. Wastes and unusual terrain may be economically poor in gold yet rich in site opportunity.

This creates a recurring division:

- population-rich terrain funds the state;
- resource-rich terrain equips the army;
- site-rich terrain may fund magic;
- movement terrain determines whether any of that value can be defended.

## Population

Population supplies four fundamental systems:

- 1 base income;
- 2 Recruitment Points;
- 3 provincial supplies;
- 4 support for Province Defence.

It is also consumed or damaged by:

- Death scales and extreme temperatures;
- pillaging;
- some forms of patrolling;
- Blood Hunting and related events;
- hostile dominions and special national effects;
- sites, spells, and random events.

Population is slow capital. A temporary gold gain purchased with permanent population loss can weaken income, recruitment, supply, and PD support for the remainder of the game.

### Growth and decline

The current unmodded 6.36 baseline gives ordinary Growth as:

- population growth of 0.2% per month per step;

- 10% additional supplies per step;
- 2% additional income per step.

Death reverses those values.

The revision-2 main-manual scale table prints 1% income per step, but the newer official Modding Manual 6.34 defines the unmodded #deathincome default as 2. No version 6.35 announcement alters that default. The newer explicit default governs this edition; the old one-percent value remains useful only for identifying stale guides. Dominions Enhanced 2.16 also sets the income change to 2%, while changing population movement to 0.25% per scale step.

## Compounding

Population growth compounds:

```
future population =
current population x (1 + monthly rate)^months
```

The formula illustrates scale, but practical forecasting must account for integer rounding, changing candles and scales, events, patrolling, pillage, and hostile effects.

Growth affects the present month and the province's longer future. Its value rises with:

- early control of populous provinces;
- a long expected game;
- stable dominion;
- protection from raiding and pillage;
- units and forts that can use the resulting recruitment and supply.

Death or destructive economy can still be strategically rational for nations whose population contributes little, whose dominion deliberately kills population, or whose power spike is intended to end the game before the long-term loss dominates.

## Tax trace and the administrative map

Official rule: a province produces no income for the turn if it cannot trace an unbroken chain of friendly provinces to a friendly fort. Disciples can trace through allied provinces.

Tax trace creates an economic network:

- forts are collection anchors;
- friendly province chains are conduits;
- raiding can disconnect rather than merely steal;
- a single captured bridge province can suppress the income of a whole pocket;
- recovering the chain before step 38 can restore collection that month.

The system makes map topology economically meaningful. A low-income corridor can protect the income of several rich provinces.

## Tax-cut warfare

A raid should be evaluated by total denied value:

```
raid value =
direct province denial
+ disconnected income
+ queue disruption
+ commander attention
```

+ movement distortion  
+ information gained  
- raider losses  
- opportunity cost

The direct income printed on the raided province may be the smallest term.

## Part III: Gold, Income, and Upkeep

### Income formula

The official main-manual formula is:

base income = population / 100  
  
modified income =  
(population / 100)  
x dominion-scale modifiers  
x (1 + fort Administration / 200)  
  
final income =  
modified income / (1 + unrest x 0.02)

The province display reports the already modified number.

### Administration

Administration increases provincial income by half its rating:

| Administration | Local income bonus |
|----------------|--------------------|
| 15             | +7.5%              |
| 30             | +15%               |
| 45             | +22.5%             |
| 60             | +30%               |
| 70             | +35%               |

The bonus applies to the province containing the fort, not to neighbouring income.

### Scale interaction

The manual gives:

- Order/Turmoil: 3% income per step;
- Productivity/Sloth: 3% income per step;
- each temperature step away from preference: -5%;
- Growth/Death: 2% per step under the current official Modding Manual default.

The main manual also contains an example saying Order 2 increases income by 4%, conflicting with its own repeated 3%-per-step tables. The tables are the stronger internal evidence; the example is treated as a likely textual error.

## Rounding: formula, display, and treasury

The income formula identifies the factors but not every integer conversion. Three different numbers must be kept apart:

- 1 the unrounded result of a written formula;
- 2 the whole number displayed for the province;
- 3 the amount actually credited to the treasury after all current modifiers and collection rules.

The revision-2 manual does not state whether the engine floors after population, after each scale, after Administration, only at the end, or through some combination of those stages. Community documentation describes the population-derived base as rounded down, but it does not provide a versioned boundary test for the whole chain. R-008 remains open.

For ordinary play, the province display is authoritative. For a forecast near a one-gold boundary, record the displayed value before and after changing exactly one input. Do not reverse-engineer a hidden intermediate from the final integer and then present it as an official rule.

The word rounding conceals several different questions. They should not be allowed to borrow evidence from one another:

| Subsystem          | What is established                                                | What remains open                                                                                   | Safe operational value                                     |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Provincial income  | Official factor chain and unrest divisor                           | Intermediate floors, final conversion, and treasury treatment                                       | Province display and the Income Overview                   |
| Resources          | One worked donor contribution of 13.8 is reduced to 13             | The printed aggregate does not reconcile; fort draw, scale, and unrest stages are not fully ordered | Current province resource pool                             |
| Recruitment Points | Official population bands, fort bonus, and Order/Turmoil modifier  | Band, modifier, and final integer order                                                             | Current spendable RP shown by the recruitment screen       |
| Commander Points   | Ordinary pool and multi-month accumulation                         | Reduction and rounding under unrest                                                                 | Current commander queue progress                           |
| Upkeep             | Official monthly divisors and observed annual whole-number entries | Monthly fractional aggregation and desertion boundary                                               | Income Overview, checked after roster or equipment changes |
| Fort supply        | Range and highest-fort rule                                        | Competing official multipliers and final integer conversion                                         | Displayed province supply                                  |

A floor observed in a resource example does not prove that income is floored at the same stage. A whole annual upkeep entry does not prove that the treasury discards monthly fractions. Whenever a result can decide a deadline, a calculator should keep three fields: the written decimal, the displayed integer, and the evidence status of the conversion between them.

## Unrest is hyperbolic, not linear

Income is divided by  $1 + 0.02U$ , where  $U$  is unrest. This has two important consequences:

- 1 The first unrest points do substantial damage.
- 2 Each later unrest point removes a smaller fraction of the already reduced income.

| Unrest | Multiplier | Income lost |
|--------|------------|-------------|
| 10     | 0.833      | 16.7%       |
| 25     | 0.667      | 33.3%       |
| 50     | 0.500      | 50.0%       |
| 75     | 0.400      | 60.0%       |

| Unrest | Multiplier | Income lost |
|--------|------------|-------------|
| 100    | 0.333      | 66.7%       |
| 200    | 0.200      | 80.0%       |

Unrest 100 is more severe than the income multiplier suggests because it also stops recruitment.

## Income timing

Income is hosting step 38.

Before income:

- ordinary battles and storming have resolved;
- random events and several late battles have resolved;
- buildings complete at step 35;
- pillage resolves at step 37.

After income:

- ordinary unrest alterations resolve at step 39;
- starvation resolves at step 40;
- upkeep resolves at step 41.

This timing means:

- a province captured through ordinary movement can pay its new owner that month if collection conditions are met;
- pillage can damage the same month's income;
- patrol and Order reductions at step 39 usually improve the next month's income, not the current collection;
- upkeep can use the income collected moments earlier.

## Treasury discipline

The treasury must cover several different horizons:

| Horizon               | Typical commitments                                                        |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Immediate order phase | Recruitment, buildings, PD, mercenary bids, gold-cost rituals or events    |
| Hosting income step   | Expected provincial income after conquest, trace, pillage, and unrest      |
| Hosting upkeep step   | Recurring unit and commander costs                                         |
| Contingency reserve   | Emergency recruitment, fort repair decisions, diplomacy, unexpected events |

Planning to exactly zero before uncertain income is a risk decision. The danger is highest when:

- tax traces are exposed;
- capitals or rich forts may be besieged;
- unrest is rising;
- pillage or raiding is expected;
- mercenary contracts or events can change expenditure;
- a large sacred or cavalry force obscures the apparent upkeep calculation.



# Upkeep

The manual states:

ordinary upkeep = gold cost / 15 per month  
sacred or slave upkeep = gold cost / 30 per month

Most summoned units are exempt. Some exceptions carry additional upkeep.

## Annual display

The detailed unit interface commonly displays annual upkeep:

annual upkeep = monthly upkeep x 12

A 30-gold ordinary unit costs 2 gold per month and displays 24 per year.

## Sacred slaves

The manual says Sacred units and Slaves each pay half upkeep. A current-game discussion published on 21 December 2025, under the 6.33 release, identifies their interaction explicitly: the two reductions stack, producing a divisor of 60. The R'lyeh Slave Priest is the clean example because the current structured row carries both the Sacred and Slave tags.

sacred slave upkeep = gold cost / 60 per month

The official announcements for 6.34 through 6.36 contain no general upkeep change. The stacking rule is published here as Community-tested under 6.33; current through 6.36 by patch review. It is not wording taken from the revision-2 manual.

## Mounted upkeep is component-based

A mounted card can hide more than one upkeep basis. Rider and mount are separate objects, and each component keeps its own base cost and its own Sacred or Slave status. The visible recruitment price is consequently not always enough to reconstruct upkeep.

The 6.33 observation gives a direct check:

| Mounted card    | Rider basis | Mount basis | Observed annual split | Total annual upkeep |
|-----------------|-------------|-------------|-----------------------|---------------------|
| Logrian Cavalry | 10 ordinary | 20 ordinary | 8 + 16                | 24                  |

The pinned 6.35 object snapshot supplies further examples of the underlying component structure:

| Mounted card              | Rider object                      | Mount object                       | Consequence                                                              |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mouflon Cataphract        | base-cost adjustment 15, Slave    | base-cost adjustment 25, not Slave | the Slave reduction applies to the rider, not automatically to the mount |
| Sacred Serpent Cataphract | base-cost adjustment 15, Sacred   | base-cost adjustment 30, Sacred    | both components receive their own Sacred reduction                       |
| Logrian Cavalry           | base-cost adjustment 10, ordinary | base-cost adjustment 20, ordinary  | the component total reproduces the observed 24 gold per year             |

These examples do not establish a universal shortcut from the displayed recruitment price. They establish the opposite: inspect both component cards when cavalry upkeep matters. Patch 6.31 also fixed mounts that could desert separately when the treasury was empty, further confirming that

mount state participates in economic resolution even though that bug does not define the upkeep formula.

Added upkeep and shape changes

The Modding Manual defines #addupkeep as increasing the gold basis used for upkeep. It belongs to the object that carries it. Mounted objects need to be checked component by component; one combined modifier should not be applied to the whole recruitment card.

Shapechanged upkeep remains unresolved. The manuals define many shape relations and advise fixed gold costs for shapechanging Pretenders, but they do not say which form supplies the monthly upkeep basis for every temporary, voluntary, seasonal, death, or world shape. A current transformation matrix must compare the Income Overview before and after each shape class. Until then, a transformed commander's visible annual entry is the operational value. R-010 remains in progress.

Reading the annual line

The December 2025 observation also records ordinary annual values of 6 for a 7-gold unit and 13 for a 16-gold unit. Those are consistent with multiplying monthly upkeep by twelve and displaying a whole number. The sample does not distinguish every possible rounding rule, and the national treasury may retain fractional liabilities that the annual line hides. Annual display rounding must not be reused as proof of monthly treasury rounding.

The same observation gives enough cases to exclude one tempting shortcut:

| Ordinary gold basis | Exact monthly formula | Exact annual equivalent | Observed annual line | What the observation proves                      |
|---------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| 7                   | 7/15                  | 5.6                     | 6                    | The annual line is not simply floored at the end |
| 10                  | 10/15                 | 8.0                     | 8                    | Exact integers survive unchanged                 |
| 16                  | 16/15                 | 12.8                    | 13                   | The annual line is not simply floored at the end |

These cases are compatible with ordinary nearest-integer rounding and with a ceiling rule; they do not distinguish between them. Nor do they reveal whether twelve fractional monthly charges are accumulated precisely, rounded as a group, or represented through another internal unit. The annual line is a readable estimate of burden, while the treasury change remains the decisive measurement for a zero-margin budget.

Upkeep as force structure

Upkeep does more than tax army size. It decides which forces can remain permanently mobilised.

- Gold-recruited elite armies preserve battlefield quality but continually consume income.
- Summoned forces shift the burden toward gems and mage-turns.
- Sacred troops can be capital- or Holy-limited but cheaper to maintain.
- Militia-like troops may be cheap to recruit yet expensive relative to their battlefield effect.
- Commanders, scouts, priests, and logistical specialists add recurring cost without always appearing in a front-line count.

The relevant comparison is lifecycle cost:

```
lifecycle gold cost =
recruitment cost
+ expected months of upkeep
+ replacement and support cost
```

A unit that survives for thirty months can cost far more through upkeep than through recruitment.

## Part IV: Resources and Recruitment

### Resources are local industrial capacity

Resources represent the materials and labour needed to equip recruits. They:

- belong to a province;
- refresh each month;
- do not stockpile;
- cannot be moved through the treasury;
- are spent only by local recruitment.

Unused resources are lost opportunity, not saved wealth.

### Potential and available resources

An unfortified province uses half its potential resources locally. A fort:

- 1 raises the host province to its full local potential;
- 2 draws its Administration percentage from eligible neighbouring provinces' potential resources.

Unrest then reduces availability:

```
final resources =
resources / (1 + unrest x 0.01)
```

At unrest 100, half remain, but recruitment is prohibited entirely.

### Fort resource draw

The manual's restrictions are exact:

- land cannot draw from sea, nor sea from land;
- a neighbouring province with a fort does not contribute;
- an enemy province does not contribute;
- eligible shared neighbours can contribute to more than one fort.

The manual's worked example demonstrates that draw uses the neighbour's potential resources, not the half-sized pool visible in an unfortified neighbour.

### Production geometry

A production fort should be evaluated by:

```
fort resource value =
full local potential
+ Administration% of each eligible adjacent potential
- expected disruption
```

Expected disruption includes:

- future adjacent forts removing donors;
- hostile raids changing ownership;
- unrest;
- land/sea boundaries;
- a roster unable to use the extra resources;
- supply or gold limits that prevent full production.

## Fort spacing

Dense fort networks increase recruitment sites, Commander Points, laboratories, siege resistance, and tax anchors. They can also remove resource draw between adjacent fortified provinces.

This is not a simple argument for wide spacing. The correct spacing balances:

- mage production;
- troop production;
- resource donors;
- travel time;
- defensibility;
- supply projection;
- capital and Throne protection;
- the expected duration of the game.

## Recruitment Points

Recruitment Points model the province's ability to organise ordinary troop production.

Start at 20, then add population-band contributions:

```
RP(population) =
20
+ min(pop, 5,000) / 100
+ min(max(pop - 5,000, 0), 5,000) / 200
+ min(max(pop - 10,000, 0), 10,000) / 300
+ min(max(pop - 20,000, 0), 20,000) / 400
+ max(pop - 40,000, 0) / 500
```

The fort's recruitment bonus is applied afterward. Order or Turmoil changes the result by 10% per step.

## Population examples before fort and scales

| Population | Calculation               | Recruitment Points before rounding |
|------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------|
| 0          | 20                        | 20                                 |
| 1,000      | 20 + 1,000/100            | 30                                 |
| 5,000      | 20 + 5,000/100            | 70                                 |
| 6,000      | 20 + 50 + 1,000/200       | 75                                 |
| 10,000     | 20 + 50 + 5,000/200       | 95                                 |
| 20,000     | 20 + 50 + 25 + 10,000/300 | 128.33                             |
| 40,000     | prior + 20,000/400        | 178.33                             |
| 50,000     | prior + 10,000/500        | 198.33                             |

The declining contribution per additional inhabitant means population has diminishing marginal effect on RP even while remaining valuable for income and supplies.

## Official-versus-historical conflict

Older community pages preserve a different formula with a lower base and different population bands. Foundation [Book II](#) uses the revision-2 main manual formula. Historical formulas must not be used as proof of current Dominions 6 behaviour.

## Rounding

The manual gives formulas and examples but does not fully document every rounding stage:

- population band;
- scale modifier;
- fort bonus;
- final displayed and spendable total.

Until reproduced, calculations should be treated as capacity estimates near fractional boundaries. The interface remains the final operational value.

## Commander Points

Commander Points limit local commander production. The current ordinary pool is:

Commander Point pool = 1 base point + current fort bonus

| Recruitment location | Base | Fort bonus | Ordinary total |
|----------------------|------|------------|----------------|
| No fort              | 1    | 0          | 1              |
| Palisades            | 1    | +0         | 1              |
| Fortress             | 1    | +1         | 2              |
| Castle               | 1    | +1         | 2              |
| Citadel              | 1    | +2         | 3              |
| Grand Citadel        | 1    | +2         | 3              |

The fort bonuses are official revision-2 values. The one-point unfortified base and multi-turn accumulation are stated by the current community commander reference, last updated under 6.35; no 6.36 announcement changes the system. This closes R-009 at Official plus Community-tested evidence.

The distinction between the pool and the cost is essential. The Modding Manual defines a simple commander as normally costing one point, permits explicit Recruitment Point costs, and defines `#slowrec` as doubling the Commander Points needed for that commander. A two-point commander in a one-point province is not illegal. The queue invests capacity over multiple months until the cost is met.

months to complete, before disruption = ceiling(commander cost / local CP per month)

| Commander cost | 1 CP location | 2 CP location | 3 CP location                               |
|----------------|---------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------|
| 1              | 1 month       | 1 month       | 1 month                                     |
| 2              | 2 months      | 1 month       | 1 month, with 1 point unused for that order |

| Commander cost | 1 CP location | 2 CP location | 3 CP location |
|----------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
| 3              | 3 months      | 2 months      | 1 month       |
| 4              | 4 months      | 2 months      | 2 months      |

The table describes an uninterrupted single order. Queue state, a change of recruit, unrest, ownership, or loss of eligibility can alter the actual completion date.

## What does not multiply Commander Points

- Fort statistics replace the previous stage; their bonuses do not stack across upgrades.
- AI difficulty bonuses apply to income, resources, ordinary Recruitment Points, and magic, but the manual explicitly excludes commander recruitment rate and Holy Points.
- #slowrec changes the commander's cost, not the province's pool.
- A recruitable commander supplied by a site changes roster access; the site commands do not by themselves add Commander Points.
- Unrest is a separate local reduction question retained under R-011.

Commander Points are often the real reason to build a fort. A nation may have enough gold to recruit more mages but no place capable of producing them.

## Commander-turn accounting

Gold measures purchase price; Commander Points measure time on the production line. A 400-gold, four-point mage and four 100-gold, one-point commanders may consume the same gold, but they do not create the same schedule. Any comparison should record both:

```
gold per completed commander
commander-months per completed commander
```

A higher fort is most valuable when it changes a roster's calendar: two-point mages every month instead of every second month, or four-point mages every second month instead of every fourth. That throughput can outweigh the fort's direct Administration income.

## Holy Points

Sacred recruitment consumes Holy Points in addition to ordinary costs. The manual ties the ordinary sacred recruitment limit to maximum dominion. Temples, national rules, Pretender design, sites, and mod commands can alter the system.

Holy Points create several strategic distinctions:

- a sacred may be affordable but unavailable;
- sacred queues can accumulate behind the cap;
- buying ordinary troops can use local resources and RP left stranded by the Holy limit;
- higher maximum dominion can be both religious resilience and production capacity;
- capital-only sacreds concentrate risk at the capital even when other forts have spare resources.

## Queue mechanics and diagnosis

Recruitment orders can fail or wait for different reasons:

| Symptom                               | Likely gate                                                               |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Unit cannot be added                  | Insufficient treasury, ineligible location, unrest 100+, or limit reached |
| Unit remains queued                   | Resource, RP, Holy Point, or limited-recruit shortage                     |
| Commander does not appear             | Commander Point shortage, eligibility, gold, or recruitment disruption    |
| Resources remain while queue stalls   | RP, Holy, commander, or unit-specific cap                                 |
| RP remains while queue stalls         | Resources, Holy, or local eligibility                                     |
| Province captured yet recruits fought | Recruitment resolved at step 3 before movement battle                     |
| Recruits trapped inside fort          | Recruitment completed before siege control changed                        |

The queue should be read as a production plan constrained by several ledgers, not as a single purchase list.

## Part V: Unrest and Coercive Economy

### What unrest does

Officially, unrest:

- reduces income;
- reduces resources;
- prevents recruitment at 100 or greater;
- reduces Blood Hunting success;
- obstructs patrol detection;
- is capped at the lesser of 500 or population divided by 10.

It can rise through:

- random events;
- spies and agitators;
- Blood Hunting;
- sites;
- targeted spells;
- globals;
- pillaging;
- hostile dominion and special effects.

It can fall through:

- patrolling;
- Province Defence;
- Order;
- sites;
- events;
- other national, unit, or magical effects.

## Income and resource damage

```
income multiplier = 1 / (1 + 0.02 x unrest)
resource multiplier = 1 / (1 + 0.01 x unrest)
```

Income is twice as sensitive in the denominator. At unrest 50, the province retains half its income but about two-thirds of its resources.

## Recruitment shutdown

At unrest 100, no ordinary units or commanders can be recruited. This creates a production-denial objective:

- unrest attacks can neutralise a fort without breaching its walls;
- Blood Hunting can disable its own patrol and recruitment base;
- a province may still show resources while being unable to recruit;
- reducing unrest at step 39 is too late to restore step-3 recruitment that month.

## The unrest cap

```
maximum unrest = min(500, population / 10)
```

A province with zero population cannot retain unrest. Population loss can reduce the numerical cap while destroying nearly every ordinary economic reason to own the province.

## Patrolling

The main manual gives individual patrol strength as:

```
individual patrol strength =
(Precision + Map Move) / 20
```

Flying units use 30 in place of Map Move. Commanders are doubled. Undisciplined and Mindless units are halved.

The total search strength is reduced by half the province's unrest, capped at 100, and gains Province Defence patrol strength beginning at PD 15.

The same patrol force must often satisfy several tasks:

- lower unrest;
- protect Blood Hunters;
- discover scouts, spies, and raiders;
- remain strong enough to survive a discovery battle;
- avoid destroying too much population.

High nominal patrol strength is not the same as a safe patrol. A stealth force that is discovered may still defeat the patrol.

## Community sub-formulas

Current community documentation describes a multi-stage unrest reduction process involving:

- 1 a baseline affected by friendly candles and PD;
- 2 an Order/Turmoil-dependent proportional reduction;
- 3 patrolling.



It also reports that unrest reduces Recruitment Points and Commander Points by one percent per point, with the Commander Point reduction rounded down. The current page states the result but does not publish a 6.36 boundary table, save, or test setup. The precise breakpoints remain queued under R-011.

That wording admits two materially different readings for a small integer pool: round down the amount lost, or round down the capacity remaining. For a one-point Commander Point pool, the first reading preserves the point until the recruitment shutdown; the second can remove it as soon as unrest rises above zero. The page does not state which intermediate is rounded and does not provide the small-pool observations needed to decide between them.

If the intended community rule is "round down the amount lost," its test predictions are:

| Ordinary pool | First predicted loss | Second predicted loss | Capacity before unrest 100 |
|---------------|----------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------|
| 1             | Unrest 100           | -                     | 1                          |
| 2             | Unrest 50            | Unrest 100            | 1 from unrest 50-99        |
| 3             | Unrest 34            | Unrest 67             | 1 from unrest 67-99        |

This is a candidate boundary table, not a promoted game rule. Its value is diagnostic: a single version-labelled observation at one of those thresholds can support or reject the interpretation far more efficiently than an anecdote from a high-unrest province.

This distinction matters most for the tiny Commander Point pool. A one-point rounding decision can change a mage from a one-month recruit into a multi-month project. Until the breakpoints are reproduced, use three tiers of certainty:

| Claim                                                                | Publication state           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Unrest 100 or more prohibits ordinary unit and commander recruitment | Official                    |
| Unrest reduces ordinary Recruitment Points before shutdown           | Current community reference |
| Unrest also reduces Commander Points                                 | Current community reference |
| Exact first-loss threshold for a 1-, 2-, or 3-point pool             | Test pending                |

The recruitment screen is authoritative for orders. A written forecast near an unrest boundary should preserve a spare month rather than assuming the most favourable rounding.

## Pillaging and raiding

Pillage:

- raises unrest;
- kills population;
- reduces supplies;
- gives gold and temporary food to the pillaging army;
- becomes stronger with larger, faster, and larger-sized forces;
- particularly favours barbarians and units with Fear.

The temporary supplies last one month.

A Raid combines movement with reduced-strength pillage. It requires a commander with Pillager and an army with Map Move 20 or more. Only Pillager units contribute, at half pillage strength, and the force must win any resulting battle before pillaging succeeds.

## Strategic uses

Pillage and raid actions can:

- suppress income before step 38;
- raise a fort province toward recruitment shutdown;
- damage future population and supplies;
- feed an army for the current month;
- force patrols and defensive movement;
- create tax-trace breaks.

They can also destroy value that the attacker expects to conquer. The action is most coherent when denial matters more than future ownership.

# Part VI: Supplies, Armies, and Logistics

## Supply is a location check

Supply is not a national stock. An army consumes the supply available in its current situation.

The decisive logistical questions are:

- Where will the army be when starvation resolves?
- Which fort projects the highest supply there?
- What scales and population will remain after conquest, battle, and pillage?
- Is the army outside a fort, inside a fort, or trapped in a siege?
- Which units consume supply despite appearing small or inexpensive?

## Population-based supply

```
base population supply =  
first 15,000 / 30  
+ population above 15,000 / 60
```

Growth or Death modifies the result first. Temperature deviation modifies it second.

| Population | Base supply before scales |
|------------|---------------------------|
| 3,000      | 100                       |
| 7,500      | 250                       |
| 15,000     | 500                       |
| 21,000     | 600                       |
| 30,000     | 750                       |

The lower marginal supply above 15,000 mirrors the declining RP value of very large populations.

## Fort-based supply

The manual's stated formula is:

```
fort supply =  
(Administration x 6) / (Distance + 1)
```

The maximum distance is four. Only the largest nearby fort contribution applies.

### Official internal conflict

The same manual also prints a distance multiplier table of 400%, 200%, 133%, 100%, and 80% at distance zero through four. Those percentages correspond to  $\text{Administration} \times 4 / (\text{Distance} + 1)$ , not the printed multiplier of six. Its worked example gives only 30 supply from an Administration-30 Castle at distance three, agreeing with the table but disagreeing with the formula, which produces 45.

| Distance | Printed Admin x 6 formula for Admin 30 | Printed percentage table for Admin 30 |
|----------|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| 0        | 180                                    | 120                                   |
| 1        | 90                                     | 60                                    |
| 2        | 60                                     | about 40                              |
| 3        | 45                                     | 30                                    |
| 4        | 36                                     | 24                                    |

A second official sentence says an Administration-50 fort contributes 150 to an adjacent province. That agrees with the multiplier-of-six formula at distance one and disagrees with the percentage table. The manual contains two internally coherent calculations, each supported by at least one example.

The current community population reference uses the multiplier-of-six formula and gives a Palisades example at distance two. It is useful corroboration but not a published controlled reproduction across all five distances. R-012 remains open.

These three representations cannot all be correct under the same definition of distance. The safe publication policy is:

- preserve the formula as the stated rule;
- describe the example conflict;
- use the in-game displayed supply for operational orders;
- reproduce every distance from zero through four in 6.36.

For forecasts, the two printed systems can be carried as a documentary interval:

```
lower printed candidate = Administration x 4 / (Distance + 1)  
upper printed candidate = Administration x 6 / (Distance + 1)
```

This interval is not a claim that the executable must lie between the two. It is a compact way to expose how much of a supply plan depends on the unresolved multiplier. The disagreement is a constant one-third of the larger candidate, so an army that fits only under  $\times 6$  is not safely supplied by the documents alone. The range, the four-province limit, and the rule that only the single highest nearby fort contribution applies are not part of the conflict.

## Supply usage

The main manual describes usage by physical size:

| Unit     | Ordinary supply use |
|----------|---------------------|
| Size 0   | 0                   |
| Size 1-2 | 0.5                 |
| Size 3   | 1                   |
| Size 4   | 2                   |
| Size 5   | 3                   |
| Size 6   | 4                   |

Animals use half the ordinary amount. Rider and mount both consume supply. Nature magic indirectly contributes 10 supply per path level.

Special abilities, forms, national rules, and modded effects can change ordinary expectations.

## Starvation selection and effects

When usage exceeds supply, the engine selects troops whose combined usage is approximately the deficit.

First selection:

- the unit becomes Starving;
- morale falls by 4;
- disease chance is 5%.

Selection while already Starving:

- disease chance rises to 50%.

Appropriate survival skill:

- 50% chance to be completely unaffected;
- a separate 50% chance to avoid disease.

When supply becomes sufficient, Starving ends. Disease does not.

## Timing

Starvation resolves at step 40, after all ordinary battles and immediately before upkeep. A newly overextended army normally fights this month's battle without the new Starving condition, then carries the penalty into the next order phase.

This makes starvation a delayed logistical debt. It is easy to ignore after a victory and expensive when the next battle arrives.

## Commander uncertainty

Commanders are commonly described as being fed before troops. That is a priority claim, not the same thing as categorical immunity. The main manual does not grant all commanders a general exemption, and no current controlled sample has exhausted the troop pool and shown the commander-selection boundary. Generic commander immunity remains test pending.

The wording fed first is safest read as a ranking within the eligible selection pool. It cannot support never starves: once the deficit exceeds the consumption of lower-priority eligible units, the selection process must either reach commanders, leave part of the deficit unmatched, or apply another undocumented exception. No source in the current evidence set demonstrates which branch occurs. Animals being described as fed last is the same kind of priority claim, not proof that every animal starves before any ordinary troop.

## Need Not Eat is the decisive explicit tag

The official Modding Manual gives a firmer rule for individual objects: `#neednoteat` means the monster consumes no supplies and cannot starve. It also explains how to create a creature that still consumes supplies but cannot starve, proving that consumption and starvation eligibility are distinct properties.

The pinned 6.35 object snapshot reinforces that distinction:

- 985 rows carry Need Not Eat;
- 47 rows combine Need Not Eat with Appetite;
- several Undead and Demon rows do not carry the Need Not Eat field explicitly.

Object counts include helpers and non-recruitable forms, so they are not army demographics. Their value is structural: class labels such as Undead, Demon, Inanimate, or commander cannot safely substitute for the actual food and starvation fields.

Official update 6.18 adds the transformation boundary: changing into a non-eating entity removes the Starving condition. The correction does not document the reverse direction, temporary battle shapes, or a universal commander-priority rule. R-013 remains in progress.

Official update 6.35 repaired Supply Usage failing to refresh when magic items were changed. The supply formula did not change, but the correction affects how evidence should be gathered. Screenshots or observations from earlier versions may show a stale usage total after equipment changes. Under the 6.36 baseline, recheck the current Supply Usage after equipping or removing any item that affects size, appetite, supply production, a mount, or a form. The corrected display is the intended operational total, although it still does not prove selection priority.

## Logistics audit for unusual units

For any expensive commander, mount, transformed unit, or summoned army, inspect in this order:

- 1 current Supply Usage;
- 2 Need Not Eat or Appetite on every component;
- 3 rider and mount separately;
- 4 current Starving and Disease conditions;
- 5 survival skill in the destination terrain;
- 6 whether a shape change occurred before starvation resolution;
- 7 the displayed fort and population supply in the destination.

This avoids the two most common category errors: assuming that a unit which consumes supply must be able to starve, and assuming that a unit which cannot starve contributes no supply burden.

## Siege supply

A besieged fort uses Supply Storage divided by the number of consecutive siege turns:

```
available interior supply =  
storage / siege turn number
```

Example for 300 storage:

| Siege turn | Interior supply |
|------------|-----------------|
| 1          | 300             |
| 2          | 150             |
| 3          | 100             |
| 4          | 75              |
| 5          | 60              |
| 10         | 30              |

This is different from Administration-based supply projection. Storage sustains defenders inside the fort; Administration helps the surrounding province network.

Siege logistics as a clock

Even an unbreached wall can become untenable through:

- falling interior supplies;
- cumulative starvation;
- disease;
- upkeep and lost exterior income;
- inability to recruit or move normally;
- the approach of a storm force.

The fort's wall clock and supply clock should be tracked separately.

Part VII: Infrastructure

Forts, temples, and laboratories

Each building converts a province in a different dimension.

| Building   | Converts the province into                                   |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fort       | A protected recruitment, resource, tax, and logistics node   |
| Temple     | A dominion-production and preaching node                     |
| Laboratory | A research, ritual, forging, gem, item, and site-access node |

The standard temple and laboratory each cost 600 gold. Fort stages have separate costs and times. Nations and terrain can alter all of these.

Construction timing

Buildings complete at hosting step 35.

This is later than:

- research at step 2;
- recruitment at step 3;

- forging at step 5;
- preaching and Throne claims at steps 6-8;
- rituals at step 10;
- site searching at step 14;
- ordinary battles and storming at steps 26-27.

This gives the following results:

- a new lab cannot support research, forging, or ritual casting that month;
- a new temple cannot improve that month's ordinary preaching;
- a new fort cannot expand this month's recruitment or protect against battles already fought;
- infrastructure is operational from the following order phase.

## Construction and demolition

Officially:

- any commander can construct a fort;
- a sacred commander is required for a temple;
- a mage is required for a laboratory;
- any commander can demolish a fort or laboratory;
- demolition takes one month;
- temples cannot be demolished by order;
- enemy temples are destroyed automatically upon conquest;
- a fort cannot be demolished while under siege.

The construction order itself consumes the commander's month. The economic cost includes both gold and commander-time.

## Standard fort progression

| Fort          | Stage cost | Stage time | Admin | Commander Points | Recruitment bonus | Storage | Wall  |
|---------------|------------|------------|-------|------------------|-------------------|---------|-------|
| Palisades     | 1,000      | 5          | 15    | +0               | +50%              | 150     | 200   |
| Fortress      | 600        | 3          | 30    | +1               | +75%              | 750     | 500   |
| Castle        | 600        | 3          | 45    | +1               | +100%             | 2,500   | 1,000 |
| Citadel       | 600        | 3          | 60    | +2               | +125%             | 7,500   | 1,500 |
| Grand Citadel | 1,000      | 5          | 70    | +2               | +150%             | 10,000  | 2,000 |

Statistics replace the previous stage rather than adding to it.

The standard maximum is:

- Early Age: Fortress;
- Middle Age: Castle;
- Late Age: Citadel.

Primitive and advanced national access can differ. Masons can construct one level above the ordinary national limit. A Grand Citadel requires Citadel access and a Mason.

## Fort valuation

A fort can create:

- 1 full local resource use;
- 2 adjacent resource draw;
- 3 local income through Administration;
- 4 Recruitment Point bonus;
- 5 Commander Point bonus;
- 6 regional supply;
- 7 siege storage;
- 8 wall integrity and protected interior;
- 9 national recruitment access;
- 10 a tax-trace anchor;
- 11 a secure laboratory or temple location;
- 12 a movement and reinforcement node.

No single payback formula captures all twelve.

### Fort question set

Before construction:

- Which units and commanders become recruitable?
- Which local pool will bind after the fort is complete?
- How many adjacent potential resources are eligible?
- Does another planned fort remove a major donor?
- What tax region will this fort anchor?
- What routes and provinces fall within supply range?
- How many turns until the first new mage or army leaves?
- Can the province be held during construction?
- Is the builder's command-turn scarce?
- What military force is delayed by the gold payment?

## Laboratories

Official functions:

- permit Research;
- permit ritual casting;
- permit access to the national pool of gems, slaves, and items;
- serve as gem collection points;
- enable site functions that require a lab.

Laboratories are strategic concentration points. Losing one can strand mages away from the national pool even when the nation still owns gems elsewhere.

### Laboratory risk

A lab attracts:

- researchers;
- gems and slaves;
- forged items;
- ritual casters;



- valuable site recruits.

The 600-gold structure can protect assets worth far more than its price. Defence should be based on the value concentrated there, not only the cost of replacing the laboratory.

## Temples

Official functions:

- ordinary dominion spread for most nations;
- preaching bonus;
- Blood Sacrifice access where the nation allows it;
- religious and national mechanics tied to temple count or location.

Only one temple can exist in a province. Capture destroys an enemy temple automatically.

Temples belong fully to the dominion volume, but their economic effect begins here:

- they cost gold and sacred commander-time;
- maximum dominion and Holy Points can affect sacred throughput;
- temple loss can weaken recruitment, candles, preaching, and special national systems;
- temples in exposed provinces can be destroyed without a separate demolition delay.

## Part VIII: Siege and Fort Control

### Province exterior and fort interior

A besieged province can have divided control:

- the besieger controls the exterior;
- the defender retains the fort interior;
- armies, laboratories, temples, and recruitment must be interpreted by location and ownership rules rather than a single flag.

This partial ownership affects:

- income and recruitment;
- movement and retreat;
- assassination and stealth;
- supply;
- siege contribution;
- the eventual reclaim-province step.

### Reducing walls

Official formulas:

reduction strength = Strength squared  
repair strength = Strength squared / 2

Flying doubles both contributions.

Repair penalties:

- Mindless: one-eighth of calculated value;

- Animal: half;
- Undisciplined: half.

Only forces whose commanders remain on Maintain Siege contribute.

## Squaring rewards strength

Strength-squared means one stronger unit can contribute more than several weaker units with the same total linear Strength.

| Strength | Reduction contribution | Base repair contribution |
|----------|------------------------|--------------------------|
| 5        | 25                     | 12.5                     |
| 10       | 100                    | 50                       |
| 15       | 225                    | 112.5                    |
| 20       | 400                    | 200                      |
| 30       | 900                    | 450                      |

Flying doubles the result. Special siege abilities and modded values can further alter practical contribution.

## Wall resolution

Each turn:

- total reduction is compared with total repair;
- the difference damages or repairs wall integrity;
- repair cannot exceed original wall integrity;
- an unbesieged damaged fort fully restores.

The defender receives exact wall information. The attacker normally receives a descriptive estimate, creating an information problem around the storm date.

## Storm timing

A fort can be stormed only after wall integrity reaches zero and the next order phase presents the Storm Castle order.

Storming resolves at step 27, after movement battles at step 26. This has several immediate consequences:

- 1 a relieving army may arrive;
- 2 the besiegers fight it first;
- 3 surviving storm commanders and assigned troops attack the fort;
- 4 a storm commander killed before the gate battle contributes no troops to the storm.

Maintain Siege and Storm Castle are commander orders. A commander performing another action does not supply siege strength merely because it remains in the province.

## Fort defenders

Forts supply Castle Guards and Wall Defenders:

- their number depends on fort level;

- they replenish for each fight like PD;
- they add repair strength;
- Wall Defenders have unlimited ammunition, extra range, and wall protection;
- they are fort defence, not the same system as Province Defence.

The shared word "defence" is a recurring source of confusion:

| Term                             | Meaning                                                 |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Province Defence                 | Gold-purchased local force attached to province control |
| Wall integrity or fort Defence   | Damage required before storming                         |
| Castle Guards and Wall Defenders | Fort-generated troops in a storm battle                 |
| Unit Defence skill               | Tactical chance to avoid melee attacks                  |

## Part IX: Province Defence

### Cost curve

The first point is free. Every later point costs its new level.

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{total cost to PD } n &= \\
 2 + 3 + \dots + n &= \\
 = n(n + 1)/2 - 1
 \end{aligned}$$

| PD  | Total cost | Additional cost from prior listed row |
|-----|------------|---------------------------------------|
| 1   | 0          | -                                     |
| 5   | 14         | 14                                    |
| 6   | 20         | 6                                     |
| 10  | 54         | 34                                    |
| 15  | 119        | 65                                    |
| 20  | 209        | 90                                    |
| 25  | 324        | 115                                   |
| 30  | 464        | 140                                   |
| 40  | 819        | 355                                   |
| 50  | 1,274      | 455                                   |
| 100 | 5,049      | 3,775                                 |

The convex curve means "another ten PD" is not a consistent investment. Going from 1 to 10 costs 54; going from 40 to 50 costs 455.

### What PD provides

Officially:

- level 1 provides a commander and troops;
- further levels add troops;
- level 20 adds new commander and troop types;

- additional benefits occur at 10, 15, and 20;
- every full 10 points reduces unrest by 1 per turn;
- stealth detection begins at 15;
- patrol strength is PD - 14 from that point;
- maximum PD is 100;
- no upkeep is charged;
- the force fully returns after battle if the province is retained.

The actual roster is national. One nation's PD may deter a raider that walks through another nation's equal investment.

## Population support and permanence

Each PD point requires 10 population. Unsupported PD is reduced at hosting step 61.

PD cannot be voluntarily lowered. It is reduced by:

- insufficient population;
- capture, which wipes it;
- disciple-game relinquishment, which removes 25%;
- special exceptions for some populationless nations.

Because the spending is irreversible while control is retained, excessive PD can trap gold in the wrong place after a border moves.

## Roles of PD

### Raid tax

Low or moderate PD forces an attacker to bring a credible commander and force rather than a single opportunist.

### Alarm and information

A battle report reveals attacker composition, script, and direction. Even a losing PD force can improve the next decision.

### Unrest control

Every ten points creates recurring unrest reduction, though buying PD solely for this purpose must be compared with a mobile patrol.

### Stealth detection

From 15 onward PD contributes patrol strength. Detection is not capture; the revealed stealth force may still win.

### Battle support

PD can combine with a local army, fort defenders, terrain, and battle magic. Its expendability can buy time for mages whose spells decide the fight.

## Why PD is not an army

PD:

- cannot move;
- cannot choose a different strategic target;
- cannot retreat into a future offensive;
- may have poor leadership, morale, equipment, or formation;
- scales in gold cost faster than it scales in quality;
- disappears on capture.

High PD can still be correct at a throne, capital approach, blood centre, or mage concentration. The decision must price the attack it is intended to defeat.

### Community thresholds

Some guides recommend values such as 6 or 11 to prevent particular event outcomes or deter generic raiders. Such numbers are rules of thumb, not universal mechanics. Event pools, nation, mods, map settings, and attacker design can change the result.

## Part X: Sites, Gems, and Magical Capital

---

### Site frequency and terrain

The main manual states that sites are more common in terrain such as:

- forests;
- wastes;
- deep seas;
- mountains and unusual cave terrain.

They are less common in plains and farmlands.

This is a probability, not a guarantee. Search planning should combine:

- terrain;
- path availability;
- prior searches;
- national site frequency;
- opportunity cost of the mage-turn;
- value of remote search spells;
- safety of the searching mage.

### Search difficulty

Hidden sites have difficulty 1 through 4. A mage manually searching a path finds sites in that path up to the mage's level. Path 4 is the highest ordinary requirement.

Examples:

- N1 finds difficulty-1 Nature sites.

- N3 finds difficulty 1-3 Nature sites.
- N4 finds every Nature site detectable by ordinary path search.
- An N3 mage says nothing about Fire, Death, or Glamour sites.

Remote path-search rituals reveal all sites of their path. Acashic Knowledge reveals all paths.

## Site benefits and harms

Sites may provide:

- monthly gems;
- gold;
- resources or supplies;
- units and commanders;
- laboratories, temples, forts, or discounts;
- rituals or enter-site orders;
- path bonuses;
- scale or dominion effects;
- unrest, disease, population loss, or other harms.

A harmful undiscovered site can still operate. Discovery explains a problem; it does not necessarily create it.

## Ownership and national recruitment

A captured site that recruits another nation's national unit does not normally grant that recruit to the conqueror. The conqueror can still collect the site's gem income where applicable.

Some sites require a laboratory before recruitment or another function becomes available.

## Gem income and mage-turn economy

Gems accumulate nationally and can be converted into:

- rituals;
- summons;
- forged items;
- empowerment;
- battle magic;
- global enchantments;
- trades and diplomacy.

The site-search decision has an expected-value structure:

```
expected search value =  
probability of discovery  
x expected monthly and strategic value  
x expected remaining turns  
- mage-turn cost  
- travel and risk
```

The formula is not intended to assign fake precision. It identifies the relevant terms. A single rare site can dominate the average, and information about a searched path has future value even when nothing is found.

## Search records

Every serious game benefits from recording:

- province;
- terrain;
- path searched;
- manual or remote method;
- path level;
- discovered sites;
- remaining unsearched paths;
- laboratory requirement;
- hostile or passive effects.

Without a record, mages repeat searches or leave valuable paths untouched.

# Part XI: Blood Economy

## Blood slaves are produced, not passively collected

Blood magic substitutes an active extraction system for ordinary gem-site income. Blood Hunting consumes a commander order and damages the province through unrest and possible population loss or attacks.

The economic chain is:

```
blood mage-turns
+ suitable population
+ patrol strength
+ dominion security
-> blood slaves
-> forging, rituals, summons, battle magic, and sacrifice
```

## Official hunting checks

The main manual gives:

```
Blood check success =
10% + 30% x Blood level

population check success =
population / 75 percent

unrest failure chance =
unrest / 4 percent
```

All three must succeed.

If they do:

```
slaves = d6 + Blood level
unrest gained = d(slaves x 3 + 4)
```

If any fails:

```
slaves = 0
unrest gained = d6 - 1
```

At 7,500 population, the population check reaches a nominal 100%. At Blood 3, the Blood check reaches a nominal 100%. Existing unrest can still cause failure.

Site frequency changes average yield by 0.5 slaves for every five percentage points away from 50%.

## Dominion and retaliation

Commoners may attack Blood Hunters. Strong friendly dominion makes the sacrifice appear religiously legitimate; the manual states that dominion 10 leaves almost no resistance.

The risk extends beyond lost slaves:

- the hunter can be injured or killed;
- bodyguards consume gold, supply, and patrol capacity;
- a hidden enemy can exploit the concentration;
- hostile dominion can make a previously safe centre unstable.

## The blood-province cycle

A functioning centre balances:

- 1 hunters create slaves and unrest;
- 2 patrols remove unrest and detect hostile infiltrators;
- 3 population and income absorb the damage;
- 4 labs provide pool access and ritual logistics;
- 5 forts or armies protect the investment;
- 6 replacement hunters and patrollers sustain throughput.

If patrol strength is insufficient, unrest reduces success, income, resources, and eventually recruitment. Adding more hunters can then reduce total output.

### Rule of thumb versus rule

Community guides often estimate that roughly 25 patrol strength supports each Blood-3-equivalent hunter under ordinary conditions. This is a planning heuristic, not an official fixed ratio. Patrol efficiency, population loss, unrest, dominion, site frequency, hunter abilities, and national mechanics change the result.

## Measuring the blood economy

Useful records:

| Measure                         | Purpose                              |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Slaves per hunter-turn          | Compares extraction efficiency       |
| Unrest before and after hosting | Reveals patrol shortfall             |
| Population trend                | Detects hidden long-term collapse    |
| Lost research per month         | Prices mage-turn diversion           |
| Patrol gold and upkeep          | Prices support force                 |
| Hunter and lab losses           | Prices security failures             |
| Slaves converted to effects     | Distinguishes stockpiling from power |



The goal is not the largest slave count. It is the most decisive magical output produced without collapsing the rest of the state.

## Part XII: Economic Timing Through Hosting

### The state-economy chain

The most important monthly sequence is:

| Step  | Event                       | Economic reading                                                             |
|-------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 3     | Recruitment                 | Existing infrastructure and local capacity create units first.               |
| 18    | Blood Hunting               | Slaves and hunting unrest are generated early.                               |
| 24-27 | Movement, battles, storming | Control and siege state change.                                              |
| 29-33 | Events and later battles    | Income provinces can still be altered.                                       |
| 35    | Construction                | New buildings become part of the end-state, too late for earlier production. |
| 37    | Pillage                     | Immediate population, unrest, and supply damage occurs.                      |
| 38    | Income                      | Collection uses the post-conquest, post-pillage state and tax trace.         |
| 39    | Unrest changes              | Patrolling, Order, and related adjustments primarily prepare next month.     |
| 40    | Starvation                  | Armies acquire logistical penalties after battle.                            |
| 41    | Upkeep                      | Recurring military costs are charged after income.                           |
| 42-44 | Dominion and site effects   | Longer-term provincial state changes arrive.                                 |
| 53-54 | Reclaim and conscription    | Late ownership correction and automatic PD prepare the next turn.            |
| 61    | Unsupported PD reduction    | Population-depleted provinces lose excess PD at the end.                     |

### Worked timing cases

#### Emergency recruitment under attack

- Units are queued during the order phase.
- Recruitment resolves at step 3.
- An enemy army arrives and fights at step 26.
- The new units defend.
- They had no opportunity to receive a new strategic order.

#### New laboratory under invasion

- A mage is ordered to build a lab.
- Research, forging, rituals, and battles all occur before step 35.
- The lab completes only if the builder and province still satisfy the construction result.
- Its practical magical use begins next order phase.

### Pillage before collection

- A province changes hands at step 26.
- The winner pillages at step 37 if the relevant order succeeds.
- Pillage damage occurs before income at step 38.
- The new owner may collect less than the pre-battle province panel suggested.

### Patrol after income

- A Blood Hunt at step 18 raises unrest.
- Income is collected at step 38.
- Patrol and ordinary unrest alterations occur at step 39.
- The province may pay reduced income this month even if the patrol restores order moments later.

### Siege relief before storm

- The wall was already at zero when orders were written.
- A relief army moves and battles at step 26.
- Surviving storm commanders attack at step 27.
- Defeating or killing them in the relief battle prevents or weakens the storm.

## Part XIII: Strategic Frameworks

### Expansion income versus expansion burden

A conquered province can provide:

- income;
- resources;
- Recruitment Points;
- supplies;
- independents;
- sites;
- tax trace;
- movement position.

It also creates:

- a border to defend;
- unrest to manage;
- commander travel;
- potential tax isolation;
- a target for raids;
- a possible need for PD, patrol, lab, temple, or fort.

The correct expansion measure is not provinces per turn alone. It is useful, connected, defensible economic mass acquired per loss and per commander-turn.

### Infrastructure tempo

Infrastructure has a delay chain:

```
decide and pay
-> construction months
-> completion at step 35
-> next order phase
-> first enabled recruitment or magical order
-> travel to the war
```

A fort whose first mage reaches the front in twelve months belongs to a different strategic horizon than emergency troops recruited now.

## Fort-now test

Build when most of the following are true:

- the commander or troop roster is valuable;
- capacity will be used continuously;
- the location anchors tax or supply;
- the province can be defended through construction;
- the expected game horizon allows military conversion;
- no nearer timing attack requires the gold;
- resource geometry is favourable;
- the nation needs another mage or commander stream.

Delay when:

- the war is decided before completion;
- the site cannot be held;
- the desired roster remains gold-limited elsewhere;
- adjacent forts remove most resource gain;
- the builder or gold has a more urgent conversion.

## Mage-turn accounting

A mage can usually do one major strategic job per month:

- research;
- search;
- forge;
- cast a ritual;
- Blood Hunt;
- build a lab;
- move;
- participate in battle;
- perform a special order.

The cost of a ritual is not limited to gems. It also includes:

```
ritual cost =
gems
+ caster-turn
+ laboratory and position requirements
+ risk
+ research or other work displaced
```

This accounting becomes decisive for small mage corps and Blood nations.

## Static and mobile gold

Gold can become:

- static power: PD, forts, temples, labs;
- mobile power: troops, commanders, mercenaries;
- productive power: mages, researchers, infrastructure;
- religious power: temples, priests, sacred throughput;
- insurance: treasury reserve.

An efficient state carries a deliberate mix. Too much static power loses the field. Too much mobile power can lack replacement, research, and safe logistics. Too much productive power can die before repayment.

## Denial and recovery

Economic warfare targets conversion rather than ownership alone.

High-value actions include:

- cutting a tax trace;
- besieging a mage fort;
- raising unrest to 100;
- killing the patrols of a blood centre;
- taking a lab with stored items or positioned casters;
- forcing an army into poor supply;
- damaging population that supports PD and RP;
- building an adjacent fort that changes resource geometry;
- repeatedly raiding the same reconstruction corridor.

Recovery priorities:

- 1 restore tax trace and province control;
- 2 prevent recruitment shutdown;
- 3 preserve or rebuild irreplaceable mage production;
- 4 feed armies and halt disease;
- 5 reconnect labs and gem access;
- 6 replace mobile defence before rebuilding luxury infrastructure.

# Part XIV: New-Player Operational Guide

---

## First-turn provincial reading

For each owned province:

- 1 Read population, income, resources, supplies, unrest, terrain, and PD.
- 2 Identify whether income has a valid fort trace.
- 3 Check the recruit roster before buying infrastructure.
- 4 Note site searches already completed.
- 5 Compare the province's best role with its exposed position.

## Recruitment checklist

- Is the unit recruitable here?
- Is gold available now?
- Are resources sufficient?
- Are Recruitment Points sufficient?
- Is a commander using the local Commander Point?
- Is the unit sacred or limited?
- Will unrest reach or remain at 100?
- Is the army's future supply sufficient?
- Is there leadership for the recruited troop type?
- Does the queue create a usable army package?

## Army logistics checklist

- Current Supply Usage.
- Destination population and scales.
- Highest nearby fort contribution.
- Expected pillage or ownership change.
- Survival skills.
- Mounted and large-unit consumption.
- Existing Starving or disease conditions.
- Siege interior versus exterior.
- Retreat province supply.

## Building checklist

- Correct constructor type.
- Gold after recruitment and reserve.
- Completion date.
- Step-35 timing.
- Province security.
- Roster or magical function unlocked.
- Tax, supply, and resource geometry.
- Commander-turn cost.

## End-of-host checklist

- Income and upkeep totals.
- Queued recruits.
- New unrest.
- Tax-trace breaks.
- Starving and diseased units.
- Fort wall and siege duration.
- New sites and lab requirements.
- Population losses.
- PD reductions.
- Empty or overloaded recruitment centres.

# Part XV: Expert Diagnostics

## Warning indicators

| Indicator                              | Likely problem                                                                         |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Large treasury, weak army              | Local capacity, commander throughput, logistics, or delayed conversion                 |
| Resources unused every month           | RP, gold, Holy limit, or unsuitable roster                                             |
| RP unused every month                  | Resources, sacred cap, or recruit-mix problem                                          |
| Mages available but research stagnant  | Movement, searching, forging, hunting, combat, or lab denial                           |
| Income drops without province loss     | Tax trace, unrest, scales, dominion, event, or Administration change                   |
| Blood output falls as hunters increase | Unrest and patrol saturation                                                           |
| Armies win then decay                  | Supply debt and disease                                                                |
| Fort never produces enough             | Wrong roster, resource geometry, gold shortage, Commander Points, exposure             |
| High PD still loses                    | National roster, magic, morale, raider design, or convex overinvestment                |
| Siege stalls unexpectedly              | Commanders left Maintain Siege, defender repair, strength composition, relief activity |

## Ratios worth recording

No ratio is universal, but consistent tracking reveals a nation's own failure modes.

- upkeep as a percentage of gross income;
- unspent resources and RP at major forts;
- commander slots used per turn;
- research per mage-turn;
- gems converted per month;
- slave yield per hunter-turn;
- unrest change per blood centre;
- turns from fort payment to first useful output;
- gold lost to disconnected tax regions;
- mobile army value versus static PD spending;
- siege reduction per supplied unit.

## Decision ledger

For major investments, record:

| Field      | Example question                                      |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Goal       | What military or magical capability is being created? |
| Cost       | Gold, gems, mage-turns, commander-turns, upkeep       |
| Bottleneck | Which local or national pool limits output?           |
| Completion | When does the first useful effect occur?              |

| Field       | Example question                                                |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Risk        | What raid, siege, assassination, or diplomacy can interrupt it? |
| Alternative | What is the best use of the same resources?                     |
| Exit        | Can the investment be repurposed if the front changes?          |

This turns economic planning into falsifiable reasoning rather than habit.

## Part XVI: Modded Economy

### Read the global layer once

[Book IX, Section 7](#) is the authoritative table for DE's six global commands. It records the exact source values, their vanilla defaults, and the result under the frozen load order. The Turn and Economy Quick Reference repeats only the final values because they are needed during play.

The economic consequence is straightforward. DE changes the income weight of Order/Turmoil, Productivity/Sloth, and Growth/Death; changes monthly population movement under Growth and Death; and strengthens the event-frequency effect of Fortune and Misfortune. Divinitus does not later redefine those globals.

### Local changes still decide the real economy

The global layer is only the starting point. The two mods also alter unit costs and upkeep, recruitment limits, sites, event income, supplies, forts, temples, research output, gem flow, and national mechanics. Those changes belong to the final object or nation, not to a universal economy formula.

Accordingly, a modded economic claim needs a ruleset label and an object boundary. "Growth is worth more under DE" is a global statement. "This fort produces more useful mages" requires the final national roster, costs, site access, and any Divinitus event layer. [Book IX](#) and the machine-readable catalogue provide that source record; nation dossiers provide the strategic application.

## Part XVII: Contradictions and Controlled Tests

### Known documentary conflicts

#### Growth and Death income

- Main manual revision 2: 1% income per step.
- Modding Manual 6.34: default #deathincome 2.
- Official announcements through 6.36: no later change to the general default.

Publication state: resolved for unmodded 6.36 at 2% per step. The newer explicit official default supersedes the older table entry. DE 2.16 independently pins the same income value.

## Order and Turmoil resources

- Main manual revision 2: 2% resources per step.
- Official announcements through 6.36: no general change to this scale effect.
- Unsourced or historical three-percent tables do not override the official value.

Publication state: resolved for the unmodded 6.36 publication baseline at 2% per step. Integer rounding remains part of the separate R-008 question.

## Fort supply distance

- Main-manual formula:  $(\text{Administration} \times 6) / (\text{Distance} + 1)$ .
- Printed multiplier table: 400%, 200%, 133%, 100%, 80%, equivalent to a multiplier of four.
- Worked example: Administration 30, described as three provinces away, adds 30 and agrees with the table.
- Adjacent example: Administration 50 adds 150 and agrees with the multiplier-of-six formula.

Publication state: internally inconsistent. The current community reference follows the multiplier-of-six formula, but a versioned reproduction at distances zero through four is still required.

## Recruitment Points

- Revision-2 main manual: base 20 and five listed bands.
- Older community reference: different base and bands.

Publication state: revision-2 formula wins; verify rounding only.

## PD 15 patrol strength wording

The manual says detection starts at 15 and that each point "above 15" adds one patrol strength, then gives PD 25 as patrol strength 11. The example corresponds to PD - 14, counting level 15 as one.

Publication state: use the numerical example and formula PD - 14; note wording discrepancy.

# Controlled-test programme

## Test E1: scale-income matrix

Create identical provinces under every Order/Turmoil, Productivity/Sloth, temperature, and Growth/Death value. Record:

- population;
- fort Administration;
- unrest;
- displayed income;
- treasury change;
- rounding.

Run unmodded and the frozen combined mod set.

## Test E2: resource matrix

Use a fixed terrain and resource value. Vary:

- Order/Turmoil;
- Productivity/Sloth;



- unrest;
- fort stage;
- adjacent fort;
- shared resource donor;
- enemy ownership;
- land/sea boundary.

Record potential, displayed, spendable, and queue behaviour.

### Test E3: Recruitment Point boundaries

Test population immediately below, at, and above:

- 5,000;
- 10,000;
- 20,000;
- 40,000.

Apply every fort bonus and Order/Turmoil step. Determine each rounding stage.

### Test E4: Commander and Holy Points

The ordinary base and fort ladder are now closed. The remaining test should isolate exceptional interaction. Record unfortified and each standard fort stage, then vary:

- one-, two-, three-, and four-point commanders;
- #slowrec and an explicit #rpcost test object;
- site recruitment without changing the fort;
- unrest immediately around every visible Commander Point loss;
- sacred queues;
- temple and maximum-dominion changes.

The baseline prediction is one point plus the current fort bonus. AI difficulty must not alter Commander Points or Holy Points.

### Test E5: upkeep

Use units with:

- ordinary gold recruitment;
- Sacred;
- Slave;
- Sacred and Slave;
- rider and mount;
- summons;
- #addupkeep.

Compare the detailed annual display, monthly treasury charge, and base object costs. The 6.33 published observation already predicts divisor 60 for Sacred Slaves and separate rider/mount bases. Concentrate the new test on:

- monthly fractional aggregation;
- a Slave rider with an ordinary mount;
- a Sacred rider with an ordinary mount;
- a pair where both components are Sacred;
- voluntary, battle-only, seasonal, and death transformations;

- whether #addupkeep follows the active or persistent form.

### Test E6: supply distance

Place an Administration-known fort at each distance zero through four from a fixed province. Remove population supply where possible. Record displayed and consumed supply. Repeat with two forts in range.

### Test E7: starvation

Test:

- troops and commanders;
- survival skills;
- animals;
- mounts;
- Need Not Eat with zero usage;
- Need Not Eat combined with Appetite or negative supply production;
- transformation into a non-eating form and back;
- existing Starving;
- siege interior;
- restoration of supply.

Record selection priority, Supply Usage, Starving, morale, disease, and recovery. Separate "fed first" from "cannot be selected."

### Test E8: unrest resolution

Vary:

- candles;
- Order/Turmoil;
- PD;
- patrol strength;
- population;
- Blood Hunters.

Record income, resources, RP, Commander Points, recruitment eligibility, and end-turn unrest.

For Commander Points, test every unrest integer around the first and second visible loss from ordinary pools of one, two, and three. The purpose is to distinguish rounding of the reduction from rounding of the remaining capacity.

### Test E9: construction timing

Complete a lab, temple, and fort during threatened turns. Verify:

- research;
- ritual and forging access;
- preaching;
- recruitment;
- fort protection;
- tax trace and Administration income;
- demolition edge cases.

## Test E10: siege contribution

Vary Strength, Flying, Mindless, Animal, Undisciplined, siege abilities, and commander orders. Record exact wall changes from both sides.

## Test record format

| Field            | Required entry                                       |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Test ID          | Stable identifier such as E6-03                      |
| Game version     | Exact patch                                          |
| Ruleset          | Unmodded or exact mod list and order                 |
| Map and province | Reproducible setup                                   |
| Starting state   | Population, scales, unrest, buildings, units         |
| Orders           | Every relevant order                                 |
| Prediction       | Formula and expected result                          |
| Observation      | Interface, message, treasury, battle, or wall result |
| Repetitions      | Count and variation                                  |
| Conclusion       | Supported, contradicted, or unresolved               |
| Artifacts        | Save, turn file, screenshot, source diff             |

# Part XVIII: Essays

## Essay I: The Economics of Forts and Mages

A fort is often evaluated as if it were a bank: pay gold now, receive additional income later, and ask how many turns are needed to break even. That calculation is useful only as a lower bound. A Dominions fort is simultaneously an industrial concentrator, recruitment licence, tax office, supply depot, laboratory shelter, siege obstacle, and movement node.

Its most valuable output is frequently a commander slot. A nation whose power depends on mages does not become stronger merely because the treasury grows. Gold must pass through a fort's Commander Points and national roster before it becomes research or battlefield magic. If the existing forts already consume every commander slot, the marginal value of another fort can exceed its Administration income by an order of magnitude.

The opposite error is to treat every possible mage fort as mandatory. A fort begun during an immediate war may not produce its first useful mage until after the decisive campaign. Construction takes months, resolves late in hosting, and then begins a sequence of recruitment and travel. The gold and builder are absent from the present front throughout that delay.

The correct question is not whether forts are economically efficient in the abstract. It is whether this fort converts current resources into the capability needed at the time and place it will matter. A safe high-resource province with valuable mages, strong tax geometry, and central supply position may justify investment without a short cash payback. An exposed province with redundant recruits and poor donors may not justify even a superficially attractive income bonus.

Fort networks also shape one another. Adjacent fortified provinces stop donating resources to each other, while a shared unfortified donor can feed both. Dense forts provide more mage streams and protection but may reduce the resource concentration required for elite troops. The best geometry is national: mage-heavy nations often favour more production centres than resource-hungry troop nations can fully equip.

A fort is a promise about future conversion. Its value depends on whether the nation can keep that promise.

## Essay II: Population Is Strategic Capital

Population looks passive. It sits in a province and produces a little gold each month, but it also supports income, Recruitment Points, supplies, and PD. Damaging it can strike the treasury, troop throughput, army logistics, and static defence at the same time.

This makes population loss qualitatively different from an ordinary expense. Gold spent can be earned again from an intact economy. Population destroyed by pillage, patrolling, Death, Blood Hunting, or hostile effects reduces the machinery that would have produced future gold and capacity.

The value is nevertheless not uniform. The first population bands contribute more Recruitment Points and supplies per inhabitant than later bands. A small province can lose its ability to support meaningful PD quickly, while a huge farm province may retain considerable capacity after the same absolute loss. Terrain, dominion stability, game length, and national mechanics all change the horizon.

Blood magic demonstrates the tension most clearly. A Blood nation converts population and mage-turns into slaves, then converts slaves into effects that may dwarf the foregone income. Refusing all population damage would misunderstand the nation's power. Ignoring the damage would eventually shut down recruitment and tax collection. Mastery lies in choosing which provinces become extraction zones, supporting them with patrols, and spending the slaves quickly enough that the sacrifice becomes strategic advantage.

Population is capital with a location and a lifespan. It is most valuable when connected, protected, and given enough time to grow. It is expendable only when the return arrives before the loss matters.

## Essay III: The Hidden Price of Static Defence

Province Defence is attractive because it has no upkeep, restores after successful battles, and requires no commander management. Those strengths conceal a convex cost curve and absolute immobility.

The first points are cheap. They tax careless raids, generate reports, and can combine with a real army. Later points become dramatically more expensive while remaining tied to one province. The gold that raises PD from 40 to 50 could fund several commanders, a laboratory, or a significant mobile force. Once purchased, PD cannot voluntarily be recovered or moved.

This does not make high PD irrational. A capital approach, Throne, blood centre, or mage fort can have enough concentrated value that static defence is exactly correct. National PD rosters also vary wildly. Battlefield magic can make disposable bodies valuable, and the need to force an attacker into a full army can protect an entire region.

The mistake is to value PD by the number alone. Its return is the attack it prevents, delays, reveals, or defeats. If no plausible enemy force is affected, the investment is decorative. If the attacker must reveal a major army, consume gems, or delay a campaign, even losing PD may have succeeded.

Static defence buys local certainty. Mobile armies buy choices. A healthy state knows which one the province requires.

## Essay IV: Logistics After Victory

The most dangerous logistical moment often comes after a successful battle. The army has moved into hostile terrain, the province may be pillaged or depopulated, the fort may still belong to the enemy, and the new supply state is easy to overlook because the battle report is positive.

Starvation resolves after battle. That timing allows an army to win first and acquire its -4 morale penalty afterward. The next turn begins with a force that looks victorious but may already carry Starving, disease risk, damaged units, and an uncertain retreat path. If the next battle follows immediately, the logistical debt becomes tactical collapse.

Fort supply projection and siege storage are separate. A nearby high-Administration fort can sustain provinces outside its walls, but a besieged garrison consumes a declining fraction of interior storage. A large relieving army may also worsen local supply even while saving the fort.

Operational planning needs to extend one turn beyond contact. Before an attack, calculate the destination's supply under the state expected after conquest, not the state currently shown. Include temperature, Growth or Death, population damage, mounts, animals, large units, and the possibility that the enemy fort remains.

Winning the battle secures a position. Supplying the survivors converts it into a campaign.

## Essay V: Unrest as Administrative Warfare

Unrest is often treated as a local nuisance to be patrolled away. Its actual effect is to attack the conversion machinery of a province.

The income formula loses one-third of output by unrest 25 and half by unrest 50. Resources decline more slowly, but at unrest 100 recruitment stops completely. Blood Hunting becomes less reliable, patrolling becomes harder, and community evidence suggests local recruitment capacities may also fall continuously.

Because unrest alteration normally occurs after income, restoration has a one-month lag. A province can be pacified at step 39 only after paying reduced income at step 38. Reaching recruitment shutdown is worse: step-39 recovery cannot retroactively restore recruitment that already failed at step 3.

This makes unrest a weapon against fortified production. Walls do not prevent spies, sites, spells, hunting mistakes, or some globals from degrading the province. A high-value fort at 100 unrest can retain its physical infrastructure while losing the reason it was built.

Administratively resilient nations do more than patrol after the damage. They keep baseline unrest low, maintain spare patrol capacity, protect Blood centres, identify hostile infiltrators, and avoid placing every economic function in the same vulnerable province.

## Essay VI: Conversion, Not Accumulation

A full treasury and gem stockpile create options, but they do not fight. A large research total creates spell access, but access does not script a mage or supply the gems. A broad empire creates potential income, but disconnected provinces may collect nothing. Dominions rewards stockpiling only when a later conversion justifies the delay.

Every stored resource should have a plausible route:

- gold to commander and troop production;
- gems to a research breakpoint, item, ritual, or battlefield package;
- blood slaves to a defined Blood power;
- population and safe time to infrastructure;
- information to a movement, diplomacy, or scripting decision.

Premature conversion is also dangerous. Troops create upkeep, gems carried into battle can be lost, and a fort begun too early can remove the army needed to defend it. The central skill is timing: retain flexibility until the strategic question is clear, then convert fast enough to decide it.

The pinnacle of economic play is not owning the largest numbers. It is reaching the decisive battlefield, ritual, or Throne state with the right power one turn before the opponent.

## Essay VII: The Month Hidden Inside a Single Point

Dominions displays most of its economy as integers, which makes one point look trivial. At a production boundary, one point can be an entire month.

Commander Points are the clearest case. A two-point mage in a two-point fort appears every month. Reduce the usable pool to one and the same mage appears every second month. Nothing on the mage card has changed: not price, paths, Research Points, or battlefield value. Yet a twelve-month plan has fallen from twelve mages to six. The missing point is not one unit of capacity; it is half the production stream.

Recruitment Points can behave similarly when a queue sits just above the local total. One missing point may delay a complete army package, strand unused resources, and postpone expansion or a relief force. A single point of supply can decide whether another unit enters the starvation selection pool. A single point of income can determine whether the treasury pays every component of a mounted army without desertion risk.

This is why exact rounding matters, but also why false precision is dangerous. A spreadsheet can calculate decimals the engine never exposes and place the apparent total on the favourable side of a boundary. If the internal rounding stage is unknown, more decimal places do not create more knowledge.

The practical response is to plan in layers. Use the official formula for direction, the current interface for the operative integer, and a reserve when one point controls a deadline. Record the boundary if it repeats often enough to matter. A reliable player does not need every hidden rounding rule memorised; a reliable player knows when an unverified rounding rule is carrying the entire plan.

## Part XIX: Sources and Open Questions

## Primary official sources

- [Dominions 6 documentation](#)
- [Dominions 6 Manual](#), revision 2
- [Dominions 6 Modding Manual](#), version 6.34
- [Dominions 6 official changes](#)
- [Illwinter home and current release record](#)

Principal manual sections:

- Province attributes and economy, pages 21-29.
- Strategic orders, especially Blood Hunting, sieges, construction, demolition, pillage, and raids, pages 50-54.
- Turn resolution, pages 55-57.
- Sieges and storming, pages 71-72.
- Dominion scales and extreme scales in the Dominion chapter.

## Community sources used as leads

- [Current Commander Point reference](#)
- [Illwiki unrest reference](#)
- [Illwiki starvation reference](#)
- [Illwiki supplies reference](#)
- [Current population and fort-supply reference](#)
- [Illwiki Province Defence reference](#)
- [Illwiki fort reference](#)
- [Illwiki Blood Hunting reference](#)
- [Illwiki generic Blood guide](#)
- [December 2025 in-game upkeep observations](#)

Community pages are not treated as final authority. Several retain historical Dominions 5 material or conflict with current official text. They are used to locate edge cases and testable claims. The upkeep discussion has firmer limits than a general guide because it records the observation date, annual values shown in game, a mounted component example, and the manual rule being checked. Its claims remain Community-tested evidence, below an official rule or an archived controlled save.

## Mod sources

The economic discussion uses the supplied DE 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE files. Their hashes, order, and exact global commands are recorded in [Book IX](#).

## Open questions

- fort-supply distance arithmetic;
- exact rounding in income, resources, RP, and fort draw;
- shapechanged upkeep and monthly fractional aggregation;
- full unrest effects on RP and Commander Points;
- generic commander feeding priority and starvation eligibility;
- national and object-specific effects from DE and Divinitus.

For the unmodded 6.36 publication baseline, Growth/Death income and Order/Turmoil resources use 2% per step. The ordinary Commander Point pool is one plus the current fort bonus. At the stated

Community-tested tier, Sacred and Slave reductions stack and mounted upkeep uses separate component bases. No 6.36 announcement changes those rules. Until the remaining questions are reproduced under the current game, close calculations should state their exact uncertainties instead of hiding them inside a rounded recommendation.



## DOCUMENT 5 OF 16

# Foundation Book III: Pretenders, Dominion, Scales, and Blessings

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## The design problem

Pretender design is the first strategic decision in a game of Dominions 6 and one of the last decisions that can be judged in isolation. A design determines more than the strength of a god. It determines when that strength exists, which sacred units justify their cost, how quickly faith spreads, what kind of provinces the nation creates, which divine spells its priests know, and which magical paths are available when the national roster runs out of answers.

The design screen asks a larger question than "Which Pretender is strongest?"

Foundation rule: A Pretender design is a contract between the nation's roster, the map, the expected war schedule, and the intended route to victory.

The chapters begin with the unmodded design screen, then follow the consequences through awakening, dominion, scales, blessings, priesthood, death, and team play. Exact arithmetic is included when it helps settle a choice.

## Edition note

[Book I](#) owns the common Dominions 6.36 baseline and evidence vocabulary. The revision-2 manual remains the main rules source here, but its printed blessing appendix predates several official balance changes. The structured object snapshot behind the current bless table is still pinned to the Inspector's 6.35 commit; the 6.36 announcement changes a Pretender-loading bug, not any listed bless cost or effect. Current values, historical values, and the one-version data lag are stated separately so they cannot be quietly blended together. Edition 22 reconciled Call God and same-turn Throne ownership. Edition 23 traces the newly republished awakening model back to its pre-Dominions 6 source and keeps it below current-version proof. [Book IX](#) is the authoritative source for DE 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE changes.

## Finding the useful layer

A new player can move from the one-model design summary through awakening, dominion, scales, blessings, and the final audit. Detailed point curves, dominion checks, sacred throughput, special dominions, disciples, and god-death mechanics support more demanding designs. The test programme is mainly for cases where the interface and documentation do not settle the same question.

# Part I: Pretender Design as a National System

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## The design in one model

The unmodded design begins with 450 points before paying for the physical form. Those points are allocated across four linked budgets:

450 design points  
 - physical form  
 - purchased magic  
 - dominion strength and scales  
 + deferred-awakening points  
 = unspent remainder

The arithmetic is simple. The strategic valuation is not.

| Budget              | Immediate result                                                 | Long-term consequence                                                                         |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Physical form       | Body, slots, statistics, abilities, starting paths, scale limits | Determines personal roles, survivability, mobility, and path-buying efficiency                |
| Magic               | Personal paths and bless-point pool                              | Determines research or ritual access, forging, divine spell family, and sacred enhancements   |
| Dominion and scales | Candles, provincial tendencies, sacred recruitment capacity      | Shapes economy, faith conflict, terrain, events, population, research, and religious survival |
| Awakening           | Availability date                                                | Trades immediate agency for design points and changes when Incarnate blessings operate        |

These budgets cannot be evaluated independently. An imprisoned god may buy a powerful Incarnate blessing that is unavailable during expansion. An awake monster may defeat independents but leave no useful magic or economy after its expansion role ends. Excellent scales may produce gold that a low-resource or Holy-limited roster cannot convert. High paths may purchase many bless points while satisfying none of the prerequisites needed by the sacred roster.

## The five obligations

A complete design should state how it addresses five obligations:

- 1 Expansion: how provinces are taken reliably and at an acceptable loss rate.
- 2 Economy: which scales and dominion support the planned recruitment and research.
- 3 Sacred plan: whether sacred units are central, supplementary, or mostly irrelevant.
- 4 Magic access: which national weaknesses the Pretender repairs or which strengths it accelerates.
- 5 Timing: when the design becomes stronger than the alternatives whose points were spent elsewhere.

A design need not solve every obligation through the Pretender. It must show where each solution comes from.

## Begin with the nation, not the god

Before opening the Pretender screen, record:

- recruitable sacred troops and commanders;
- capital-only, fort-only, terrain-only, foreign, and summonable sacreds;
- Holy Point and Commander Point bottlenecks;
- ordinary expansion troops and commanders;
- national mage paths, randoms, and missing paths;
- early research packages;
- gold, resource, and Recruitment Point demand;
- temperature preference and scale limits;

- special dominion rules;
- expected map and lobby settings.

The purpose is to identify problems before selecting an attractive solution.

## Roster questions

| Question                                              | Why it changes the design                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Are the principal sacreds massed or elite?            | Flat bonuses scale with body count; survival and percentage effects often gain value on expensive bodies |
| Are sacreds capital-only?                             | A powerful bless may apply to too few units to justify its design cost                                   |
| Are sacred commanders strategically important?        | Passive leadership, stealth, recuperation, or magic-related blessings may matter outside battle          |
| Can ordinary troops expand reliably?                  | If yes, an awake expander is optional rather than compulsory                                             |
| Is the nation gold-, resource-, RP-, or Holy-limited? | Scales should support the actual bottleneck                                                              |
| Which magic paths are missing?                        | Pretender paths may open boosters, summons, rituals, or counters unavailable nationally                  |
| Does the nation need an early battlefield caster?     | Awakening time and chassis mobility become central                                                       |
| Does the nation possess a special dominion?           | Candles and temples may become economic or military infrastructure                                       |

## Lobby questions

Pretender value changes with:

- independent strength;
- map size and terrain;
- number of players;
- team or disciple rules;
- research speed;
- site frequency;
- magic-resource settings;
- throne distribution and points required;
- diplomacy rules;
- starting provinces;
- mods and load order.

A design that is excellent on a crowded, high-independent-strength map may be wasteful in a spacious game with weak independents. An imprisoned research-and-access design may mature comfortably on a slow diplomatic map and arrive too late in a knife-fight.

## Chassis roles

Physical forms should be compared by the jobs they can perform, not by a single tier list.

## Expansion chassis

An expansion chassis personally captures independent provinces during the opening.

Requirements usually include:

- sufficient protection or avoidance;

- a way to prevent chip damage from accumulating;
- enough offence to end battles before fatigue or attrition wins;
- resistance to common independent threats;
- acceptable map movement;
- a script that works without unavailable research or equipment.

An expander is an economic asset only while its conquest produces more value than the alternative use of its design points and commander-turns.

## **Bless anchor**

A bless anchor buys the paths and bless points required by the sacred plan. Its own combat performance may be secondary.

The anchor must answer:

- which sacreds receive the benefit;
- how many can be recruited;
- when they can be blessed;
- whether the decisive effects are Incarnate;
- which counters remain;
- whether the same paths have a useful later role.

## **Scales anchor**

A scales anchor spends relatively little on personal power so that the nation can afford strong dominion and favourable scales. It is commonly dormant or imprisoned, but awakening and form are separate choices.

The design succeeds when the nation can convert the improved economy into more useful power than a direct bless or awake form would have supplied.

## **Rainbow and access chassis**

A rainbow distributes points across several paths to:

- obtain efficient early path levels;
- expand the bless-point pool;
- search for sites;
- forge cross-path items;
- provide ritual access;
- open booster chains;
- diversify divine spells.

The danger is diffuse capability without a timetable. "Can eventually cast many things" is not a plan until the required research, gems, boosters, laboratories, and safe commander-turns are named.

## **Ritual platform**

A ritual platform buys one or more high paths for a defined strategic package:

- global enchantments;
- remote attacks;
- large summons;
- mobility rituals;
- high-path forging;

- late-game access.

Its value depends on the earliest realistic casting date, not only the final path display.

## **Battlefield caster**

A battlefield caster supplies spells the national roster cannot cast at the required time. It needs:

- arrival before the relevant war;
- sufficient combat speed or cast time;
- fatigue management;
- gems and research;
- protection from assassination, seeking arrows, remote attacks, and battlefield counters;
- a retreat or immortality plan.

## **Thug or supercombatant platform**

A thug or supercombatant design intends to fight armies, raid, hold positions, or force specialised counters. Personal statistics alone are insufficient. The design must cover:

- damage types and attack volume;
- fatigue;
- mundane and magical defence;
- elemental and physical resistances;
- magic resistance;
- control effects;
- anti-undead or anti-demon tools where relevant;
- mobility;
- recovery from afflictions;
- escape and death consequences.

## **Immobile oracle**

Immobile forms often purchase magic efficiently and may have strong dominion or special sites. They trade away conventional movement.

Some can move by teleportation, while others are too large for particular transport effects. Mobility must be checked for the exact form.

## **Shape-changer**

Dragons and other shape-changers can separate casting and combat forms. The manual notes that a dragon may appear as a humanoid wizard until changing shape or being wounded.

The two forms should be audited separately:

- paths and casting convenience;
- slots;
- movement;
- protection and attacks;
- regeneration or recuperation;
- transformation conditions;
- whether an affliction or shape loss changes the planned role.

## Trinity

A Trinity consists of three entities. According to the manual:

- the members share part of their magical power;
- separated members lose some magic;
- a lone member loses more;
- exact penalties vary by Trinity;
- each member can research, though at reduced ability;
- a dead member can be Called God in half the ordinary time.

Trinities create parallel commander-turns and map presence at the price of coordination and reduced separated power. Every proposed Trinity design needs exact-form testing; the category does not guarantee identical behaviour.

## Immortal and dominion-immortal forms

These forms alter the cost of personal risk.

- Immortal: normally reforms regardless of ordinary-plane dominion.
- Dominion Immortal: normally reforms after death in friendly dominion.
- Neither: requires Call God after death unless another special rule applies.

Soul destruction and death on a remote plane can bypass ordinary reform. Immortality reduces some consequences of death; it does not make every battle strategically free.

## Chassis comparison sheet

| Field                  | Record                                                                 |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Form and nation        | Exact form, age, nation, and ruleset                                   |
| Base point cost        | Points removed before all other purchases                              |
| Starting paths         | Innate path levels in each form                                        |
| New Path Cost          | Cost of opening an absent path                                         |
| Starting dominion      | Base candle value                                                      |
| Scale-limit changes    | Direction and amount                                                   |
| Awakening restrictions | Ordinary, minimum prison, maximum prison, or other                     |
| Movement               | Map Move, terrain survival, sailing, teleport eligibility              |
| Combat shell           | HP, protection, defence, MR, resistances, recuperation, regeneration   |
| Slots                  | Hands, head, body, feet, misc, special restrictions                    |
| Special mechanics      | Shape change, Trinity, immortality, freespawn, sites, dominion effects |
| Opening job            | Expansion, research, site search, forging, ritual, deterrence          |
| Middle-game job        | Named repeatable use                                                   |
| Failure condition      | What makes the investment non-functional                               |

# Part II: Exact Design-Point Arithmetic

## Physical-form cost

Every form has an inherent point cost. The cost is paid from the initial 450.

points after form = 450 - form cost

A Phoenix costing 110, for example, leaves 340 before magic, dominion, scales, and awakening are applied.

Form cost cannot be judged without its embedded value:

- starting magic;
- cheaper or more expensive new paths;
- starting dominion;
- scale-limit adjustments;
- combat statistics;
- slots;
- mobility;
- special abilities;
- national availability.

## Magic-path costs

The official cost for each path level added by the player is:

| Added level number | Marginal cost | Cumulative cost |
|--------------------|---------------|-----------------|
| 1st                | 8             | 8               |
| 2nd                | 16            | 24              |
| 3rd                | 24            | 48              |
| 4th                | 32            | 80              |
| 5th                | 40            | 120             |
| 6th                | 48            | 168             |
| 7th                | 56            | 224             |
| 8th                | 64            | 288             |
| 9th                | 72            | 360             |
| 10th               | 80            | 440             |

These are levels added by the design, not the displayed final path.

If a form begins with Nature 2, raising it to Nature 3 is the first purchased level in that path and costs 8. Raising it from Nature 2 to Nature 6 adds four levels and costs:

$8 + 16 + 24 + 32 = 80$

## Opening a new path

If the form begins with no level in a path:

- 1 the first level costs the form's New Path Cost;
- 2 the second added level costs 16;
- 3 the third costs 24;
- 4 the sequence then continues normally.

The New Path Cost replaces the ordinary 8-point first purchase. It does not replace the entire path curve.

### Official worked example

The Carrion Dragon begins with Death 1 and Nature 1. Raising it to Death 4 and Nature 4 adds three levels in each:

Death:  $8 + 16 + 24 = 48$   
Nature:  $8 + 16 + 24 = 48$

Opening Fire at a New Path Cost of 80 and raising it to Fire 2 adds:

Fire:  $80 + 16 = 96$

Total:

$48 + 48 + 96 = 192$  design points

### Magic-purchase audit

For every path, record:

| Path    | Innate | Purchased | Final | Cost | Purpose |
|---------|--------|-----------|-------|------|---------|
| Fire    |        |           |       |      |         |
| Air     |        |           |       |      |         |
| Water   |        |           |       |      |         |
| Earth   |        |           |       |      |         |
| Astral  |        |           |       |      |         |
| Death   |        |           |       |      |         |
| Nature  |        |           |       |      |         |
| Glamour |        |           |       |      |         |
| Blood   |        |           |       |      |         |

"Purpose" should be specific: a blessing prerequisite, a named booster chain, a site-search threshold, a combat spell, a ritual, or a divine-spell family. A path bought only because it looks flexible is a candidate for removal.

### Dominion-strength costs

Every form begins with at least Dominion 1 and may be raised to Dominion 10. Each candle added above the form's base costs progressively more:

| Added candle number | Marginal cost | Cumulative cost |
|---------------------|---------------|-----------------|
| 1st                 | 7             | 7               |
| 2nd                 | 14            | 21              |
| 3rd                 | 21            | 42              |
| 4th                 | 28            | 70              |
| 5th                 | 35            | 105             |
| 6th                 | 42            | 147             |



| Added candle number | Marginal cost | Cumulative cost |
|---------------------|---------------|-----------------|
| 7th                 | 49            | 196             |
| 8th                 | 56            | 252             |
| 9th                 | 63            | 315             |

For  $n$  added candles:

$$\text{cumulative cost} = 7n(n + 1) / 2$$

The accelerating curve matters. Raising an already high starting dominion is often much cheaper than buying the same final score on a low-dominion form.

## What initial dominion changes

Initial dominion contributes to:

- the maximum dominion ceiling;
- the chance that temple checks succeed;
- capital-only sacred recruitment through Holy Points;
- Pretender and Prophet statistics in friendly or hostile dominion;
- the speed at which scales tend to establish;
- resistance to hostile faith;
- survival against a dominion kill;
- several special national mechanics.

High dominion means more than "more candles." It improves several connected parts of the nation while consuming a steep share of the design budget.

## Scale-point costs

Each favourable scale step costs 40 points. Each unfavourable step grants 40.

$$\text{scale-point change} = -40 \times \text{favourable steps} + 40 \times \text{unfavourable steps}$$

Temperature is measured relative to national preference during design. Only the first three clicks away from that preference grant points.

The ordinary design window is -2 to +2. National and Pretender scale-limit adjustments can pull that window in one direction. Province scales can reach -5 to +5 during play.

## Scale-limit movement

A +1 Growth Limit does more than add one Growth option. It shifts the whole design window:

- Growth maximum rises by one;
- Death maximum in the opposite direction falls by one.

National and Pretender adjustments in the same direction overlap rather than automatically stacking without limit. Exact nation-form combinations should be checked in the design screen.

## Awakening points

| State      | Point change | Ordinary arrival           |
|------------|--------------|----------------------------|
| Awake      | +0           | Present from the beginning |
| Dormant    | +150         | Approximately turns 10-13  |
| Imprisoned | +350         | Approximately turns 28-42  |

The official manual intentionally gives ranges rather than a guaranteed turn. It also says that Disciples awaken in about half the time of their Pretender. That wording does not define an exact Disciple range or a rounding rule.

## Planning with an unknown distribution

The range is enough to build a robust opening, but not enough to calculate an expected arrival.

| Design     | Safe planning assumption                                           | What must work before arrival                                                                              |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Awake      | The god is available immediately                                   | Its first several orders, expansion targets, and acceptable risks                                          |
| Dormant    | The nation may wait until the late end of turns 10-13              | Expansion, research, and sacred use through the whole dormant window                                       |
| Imprisoned | The nation may wait until the late end of turns 28-42              | The first expansion cycle and a substantial part of the first war without the chassis or Incarnate effects |
| Disciple   | Roughly half the Pretender delay, with no published exact rounding | The disciple nation must not depend on a single inferred half-turn                                         |

Do not substitute the midpoint for an average. The official range does not say that every turn is equally likely, and an arrival process with repeated rolls can be heavily weighted without changing its visible minimum and maximum. For practical design work:

- 1 budget the army and research plan to survive the latest official arrival;
- 2 prepare a useful first order for every plausible arrival turn;
- 3 treat an early arrival as extra tempo rather than as a requirement;
- 4 evaluate an Incarnate blessing as two armies: the pre-awakening army and the post-awakening army.

Older reverse-engineering notes propose repeated exploding-die checks rather than a uniform draw. A Dominions 6 community Pretender page, revised on 16 June 2026, now republishes the same model and attributes it to Loggy:  $9 + d4!$  for Dormant,  $27 + d20!$  for Imprisoned, and bases of 4 and 13 for the corresponding Disciple rolls. It says a new exploding roll is made each month and the result is compared with the current turn.

The newer page label does not create a new current-version test. The wording and constants can be traced to Loggy's older miscellaneous reverse-engineering notes and to copies published years before Dominions 6. The current page supplies neither raw 6.x outcomes nor an executable trace, and its usual displayed ranges of turns 11-14 and 29-42 are shifted from the revision-2 manual's approximate 10-13 and 28-42 wording. That may be a turn-label convention, an editorial carry-over, or a real version difference; the available sources do not decide which.

The exploding-die model remains a current community research hypothesis with historical provenance and is not promoted to a Dominions 6.36 rule. It is more specific than assuming a uniform draw and helps define a decisive reproduction, but it is not safe input for an exact probability calculator. R-014 stays queued until a sufficiently large current sample, a current engine-backed trace, or developer confirmation establishes both the distribution and the displayed-turn convention.

## Total-budget worksheet

```

450
- form cost
- purchased magic
- added dominion
- favourable scales
+ unfavourable scales
+ awakening grant
= remainder

```

The final screen should be checked against the worksheet. Form-specific restrictions, national scale limits, bonus bless points, and mod changes can make a generic calculator incomplete.

# Part III: Awakening, Time, and the Opening

## Awake

An awake Pretender can contribute from turn one.

Possible opening jobs:

- expand personally;
- research;
- search;
- forge once research permits;
- cast early rituals;
- lead or bless an army;
- deter an early attack;
- establish a special site or dominion effect.

The opportunity cost is the 150 or 350 points not obtained from delay.

An awake design should specify its monthly orders. "Available" is not the same as "productive."

## Awake-expander ledger

Record:

- provinces taken;
- turns saved relative to an ordinary expansion party;
- gold and commander-turns freed;
- wounds and afflictions;
- additional gear or research required;
- enemy counters revealed;
- time spent returning, healing, or waiting.

The correct comparison is not the expander's kill count. It is the territory and tempo created after subtracting its design cost and risk.

## Dormant

Dormant grants 150 points and usually arrives near the end of the initial expansion phase.

Common uses:

- moderate Incarnate bless arriving before the first planned war;
- mid-game combat or ritual chassis;
- strong scales with a still-relevant physical god;
- path access not needed during the first ten turns.

Risks:

- an early war begins before arrival;
- the sacred plan requires Incarnate effects for expansion;
- the nation cannot exploit the purchased paths immediately on awakening;
- the arrival location or laboratory network is poorly prepared.

## Imprisoned

Imprisoned grants 350 points and may remain absent until turns 28-42.

Common uses:

- high scales;
- broad or deep magic;
- large bless-point pools;
- late-game path access;
- a powerful Incarnate package deliberately deferred.

The design transfers power from the opening to the economy, blessing, or later magic. That transfer is only favourable if the nation survives and converts the points before the game's decisive wars.

### The Incarnate trap

An imprisoned god can buy an Incarnate blessing, but the effect remains inactive while the god is imprisoned or dead. The sacred roster may fight for several dozen turns with only the non-Incarnate portion.

The design audit should split the bless into:

| Phase                                      | Available effects                         |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Before awakening                           | Innate and ordinary non-Incarnate effects |
| God alive and present                      | Full bless, including Incarnate effects   |
| God dead or absent under the effect's rule | Incarnate portion disabled                |

## Timing comparison

| Question                  | Awake                   | Dormant | Imprisoned      |
|---------------------------|-------------------------|---------|-----------------|
| Helps turn-one expansion? | Yes, if capable         | No      | No              |
| Incarnate bless active?   | Yes while alive/present | Delayed | Heavily delayed |

| Question                | Awake                                        | Dormant                       | Imprisoned                                                     |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Extra design points     | 0                                            | 150                           | 350                                                            |
| Early personal research | Possible                                     | None                          | None                                                           |
| Early personal risk     | Highest                                      | Deferred                      | Deferred longest                                               |
| Best justification      | Immediate actions worth more than 150 points | Mid-game arrival matches plan | Nation can carry the opening and exploit the large point grant |

## Arrival preparation

Before a delayed god awakens:

- 1

preserve a suitable laboratory;
- 2

reserve the needed gems;
- 3

complete required research;
- 4

forge planned equipment;
- 5

choose a safe operating province;
- 6

prepare priests and sacred armies if Incarnate effects matter;
- 7

identify the first three commander-turns after arrival.

An arrival without orders is delayed power followed by idle power.

# Part IV: Dominion

## Dominion in plain language

Dominion is religious control. Province ownership is military and administrative control. The two layers are independent.

A nation can:

- own a province under enemy dominion;
- spread dominion through provinces it does not own;
- conquer a continent without spreading its faith;
- lose by losing every friendly candle even while retaining forts and armies.

Friendly dominion is displayed as positive candles. Enemy dominion is effectively negative from the observing nation's perspective.

Foundation rule: Armies take provinces. Religious infrastructure makes those provinces part of the god's world.

## Sources of dominion spread

The manual gives the following sources:

| Source        | Checks                                        |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Pretender     | One automatic increase plus two temple checks |
| Home province | One temple check                              |

| Source         | Checks                                   |
|----------------|------------------------------------------|
| Prophet        | One temple check                         |
| Temple         | One temple check                         |
| Disciple       | One temple check                         |
| Claimed Throne | One to seven checks, depending on Throne |

A check does not guarantee a candle. It attempts to create, increase, propagate, or contest dominion according to the local state.

## Religious hosting order

The official turn sequence separates direct priest orders from ordinary passive spread:

| Step | Religious operation | Consequence                                                                                                        |
|------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6    | Preaching           | Priest orders adjust local dominion. Since version 6.13, commanders performing this order resolve in random order. |
| 7    | Heretic preaching   | Heretics, insane commanders, and shattered-soul commanders reduce dominion.                                        |
| 8    | Claim Thrones       | Valid Throne claims resolve before movement and battle.                                                            |
| 42   | Dominion spread     | Pretender, capital, Prophet, temple, Disciple, Throne, and sacrifice-generated spread resolves.                    |
| 43   | Dominion effects    | Population death, insanity, temperature spread, and similar effects use the resulting religious state.             |
| 56   | Elimination         | A nation without provinces or dominion is removed.                                                                 |
| 57   | Victory             | The game checks whether a victory condition has been fulfilled.                                                    |

This closes the ordinary R-015 model at the official-rules tier: the sources, check probabilities, local resolution rules, cross-water reroll, and hosting stage are all stated officially. The manual does not publish the random-number stream or the internal iteration order among simultaneous passive sources, so neither is inferred.

## Maximum dominion

The maximum is:

```
maximum dominion =
initial Pretender dominion
+ floor(temples / (5 x players on team))
```

For a solo nation, every five temples raise the maximum by one. For a two-player team, every ten team temples do so.

Example:

```
initial dominion 3
12 temples
2 players on team

maximum = 3 + floor(12 / 10) = 4
```

The ceiling matters because it affects:

- maximum candle strength reached by ordinary temple spread;

- temple-check success chance;
- resistance in dominion conflict;
- the relay behaviour of strong friendly provinces.

Preaching uses a separate local cap and can exceed what a weak maximum would ordinarily establish.

## Temple-check chance

The official chance that a temple check succeeds is:

$$50\% + 5\% \times \text{maximum dominion}$$

| Maximum dominion | Check chance |
|------------------|--------------|
| 1                | 55%          |
| 3                | 65%          |
| 5                | 75%          |
| 7                | 85%          |
| 9                | 95%          |
| 10               | 100%         |

Temples have two network effects:

- 1 each adds another check;
- 2 each threshold of five per team member can raise the maximum, improving every ordinary check.

The value of a temple network is not linear around the threshold.

## Resolving a successful check

### Neutral province

A successful check adds one friendly candle.

### Province with friendly dominion

At U friendly candles, the chance to add another candle locally is:

$$30\% - 3\% \times U$$

If the local increase fails, the check propagates to a random neighbouring province.

High-candle provinces tend to relay pressure outward instead of endlessly concentrating it.

| Friendly candles | Local increase chance |
|------------------|-----------------------|
| 1                | 27%                   |
| 3                | 21%                   |
| 5                | 15%                   |
| 7                | 9%                    |
| 9                | 3%                    |

## Province with enemy dominion

At E enemy candles:

chance to reduce enemy dominion =  
 $50\% + 5\% \times \text{maximum dominion} - 5\% \times E$

| Maximum dominion | Enemy candles | Reduction chance |
|------------------|---------------|------------------|
| 5                | 1             | 70%              |
| 5                | 5             | 50%              |
| 7                | 5             | 60%              |
| 9                | 8             | 55%              |

Dense hostile candles form a religious wall. High maximum dominion pushes against it more effectively.

## Land and sea

When propagation randomly selects a neighbouring province across a land-sea boundary, the manual gives a 50% chance to reroll the destination. Faith crosses the boundary less readily than it spreads within the same environment.

## Dominion as a network

Dominion spread has three behaviours:

- 1 creation in neutral provinces;
- 2 consolidation in weak friendly provinces;
- 3 propagation from strong friendly provinces.

This means a rear temple can influence a frontier through a chain of strong provinces, while a single weak or hostile province can absorb repeated checks.

Useful religious infrastructure is shaped by:

- temple count;
- maximum-dominion thresholds;
- adjacency;
- sea boundaries;
- hostile candle depth;
- local preaching;
- special dominion effects;
- vulnerability of temples to raids.

## Preaching

Preaching acts only in the priest's province and does not use the ordinary maximum-dominion ceiling.

In neutral or friendly dominion:

success chance =  $30\% \times \text{effective Holy level}$

Against E enemy candles:



success chance =  
 $30\% \times \text{effective Holy level} - 5\% \times E$

minimum = 5%

A temple in the province adds 0.5 to effective Holy level for the chance and cap.

The maximum local dominion that preaching can establish is:

preaching cap =  $2 \times \text{effective Holy level}$

## Preaching examples

| Priest | Temple? | Effective H | Neutral chance | Cap |
|--------|---------|-------------|----------------|-----|
| H1     | No      | 1.0         | 30%            | 2   |
| H1     | Yes     | 1.5         | 45%            | 3   |
| H2     | No      | 2.0         | 60%            | 4   |
| H2     | Yes     | 2.5         | 75%            | 5   |
| H3     | Yes     | 3.5         | 105%           | 7   |

Values above 100% should be treated as automatic for ordinary practical use, but exact engine handling remains a candidate for reproduction.

## Inquisitors

An Inquisitor counts double Holy level when preaching in enemy dominion. In neutral or friendly dominion, ordinary Holy level is used.

An H2 Inquisitor in enemy dominion preaches as effective H4 before a possible temple bonus.

## Heretics

A Heretic reduces dominion locally rather than establishing a rival faith.

chance to reduce = Heretic value  $\times$  20%

Heretics can erode friendly candles as well as enemy candles. Their position and allegiance require careful handling.

## Blood sacrifice

An eligible priest in a temple may sacrifice blood slaves.

- maximum slaves sacrificed equals Holy level;
- each slave creates one temple check;
- the priest must have the national ability to sacrifice;
- the order consumes a priest-turn and slaves.

Blood sacrifice converts the blood economy directly into religious pressure. Its value rises when:

- the nation already hunts efficiently;
- dominion survival is threatened;
- a throne or special dominion effect depends on local candles;
- the temple network can project the additional checks;
- the sacrificed slaves are worth less than the military or ritual consequences prevented.

## Dying dominion

Early and Late Age Mictlan use a special dying-dominion system.

According to the manual:

- home-province, Prophet, and temple spread do not operate normally;
- Pretender checks are only half as effective;
- blood sacrifice is the essential spread mechanism.

This changes temple construction from passive religious infrastructure into sacrifice stations. A Mictlan design that ignores blood-sacrifice logistics is structurally incomplete.

## Prophets

A Prophet:

- becomes H3, or raises an already H3-or-higher commander by one;
- spreads dominion like a temple;
- gains +2 Attack, Defence, and Precision;
- receives dominion-dependent statistic changes.

Current community references also describe Prophets as automatically blessed, sacred, Morale 30, and upkeep-free, with a replacement delay after death. These details should be checked in 6.36 before being promoted to Official in this library.

## Prophet roles

- battlefield-wide Divine Blessing if H3;
- mobile preaching;
- dominion source;
- Holy access beyond the ordinary roster;
- throne claiming when the other conditions are met;
- combat leadership or thug role on a suitable chassis.

Prophetising a fragile scout can gain cheap mobile H3. Prophetising a robust sacred commander can create a battle piece. The correct choice depends on whether Holy access, survivability, movement, stealth, or equipment matters most.

## Thrones of Ascension

A claimed Throne:

- contributes dominion checks;
- may grant scales, blessings, sites, paths, gems, units, or other effects;
- contributes Ascension Points;
- changes the strategic value of its province.

The revision-2 manual says claimed Thrones spread one to seven checks depending on the Throne. Current community data commonly describes a claimed Throne as generating a number of guaranteed checks equal to its level. That exact success behaviour remains Test Pending.

Claiming normally requires:

- ownership of the province;
- a Pretender or Disciple, a Prophet, or an H3-or-higher priest;

- the Claim Throne order;
- a legal claimant when the order resolves at hosting step 8.

If a fort is present, a besieger cannot claim through its walls. The besieged owner may still claim. A Throne becomes unclaimed when another nation conquers its province and, where present, its fort.

## Same-turn claim, loss, and victory

The official hosting sequence and the current ownership rule answer the central R-018 cases when read together. The claim is processed early, but victory is tested against the state that survives to the end of hosting.

| Hosting point | Relevant change                                                                                                |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 8             | A legal Claim Throne order establishes the claim.                                                              |
| 10-27         | Ritual attacks, assassinations, movement battles, and castle storming can kill the claimant or change control. |
| 53            | An unbesieged fort may reclaim its province under the official partial-ownership rule.                         |
| 56            | Elimination is checked.                                                                                        |
| 57            | The game checks the victory conditions.                                                                        |

The resulting state matrix is more useful than the vague instruction to "hold until hosting."

| Same-turn result after a successful step-8 claim            | State at the victory check                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Claimant is killed later, but the nation retains the Throne | The claim remains; a claimant does not need to survive after the claim has resolved. |
| An unfortified Throne province is conquered                 | The Throne becomes unclaimed and its Ascension Points do not survive to step 57.     |
| A fortified Throne is merely placed under siege             | The defender still owns the fort and the Throne remains claimed.                     |
| The fortified Throne is stormed and conquered               | The Throne becomes unclaimed before victory is checked.                              |

This is a mixed Official plus Community-tested conclusion. The manual establishes steps 8 and 57 and the rules for full and partial province ownership. The current community Throne reference states that conquest of the province and fort, if present, unclaims the Throne. A published same-turn report independently records the claimant-death and province-loss branches. No official update through 6.36 changes that sequence.

R-018 is complete at that evidence tier. It does not settle every adjacent victory question. In particular, an exact simultaneous tie between different nations at the winning Ascension total still needs a current controlled reproduction before any tie-break rule is published as law.

## Dominion effects on units

### Ordinary troops

All units receive:

- +1 Morale in friendly dominion;
- -1 Morale in enemy dominion.

## Pretender and Prophet

For each friendly candle, the Pretender and Prophet receive:

- +1 Strength;
- +0.5 Magic Resistance;
- +10% Hit Points.

Enemy candles reverse these changes. Hit Points do not fall below 10% through this effect.

Dominion changes whether a god or Prophet can safely take a fight. A combat report from Dominion 8 cannot be transferred unchanged to Dominion -4.

## Scale convergence inside dominion

For each scale in a province, the official chance to move one step toward the god's selected scales is:

```
5% x local candles
+ 10% x absolute difference
```

Example:

```
local dominion = 6
current Order = -1
target Order = +2
difference = 3

chance = 5 x 6 + 10 x 3 = 60%
```

Current community documentation reports that a chance above 100% can move the scale two steps. The manual describes a one-step movement. The additional step requires controlled reproduction.

## Dominion elimination

If a Pretender has no friendly dominion anywhere, the nation is eliminated.

The nation may still possess:

- provinces;
- armies;
- forts;
- a treasury;
- a living Pretender.

None prevents religious extinction.

## Dominion-kill warning indicators

- no safe rear candle core;
- capital under deep enemy dominion;
- low maximum dominion;
- few temples;
- temple thresholds just below the next maximum increase;
- priests absent from threatened provinces;
- land-sea spread barriers;
- enemy blood sacrifice or Inquisitors;
- Pretender deaths that reduce dominion strength;
- simultaneous temple raids.

# Part V: Scales

## Scales in plain language

Scales describe the material and metaphysical tendencies of a god's dominion.

The six pairs are:

| Positive end | Negative end | Principal systems                                       |
|--------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Order        | Turmoil      | Income, resources, recruitment, unrest recovery, events |
| Productivity | Sloth        | Resources and income                                    |
| Heat         | Cold         | Climate, income, supply, movement, fatigue environment  |
| Growth       | Death        | Population, income, supply, aging, terrain at extremes  |
| Fortune      | Misfortune   | Event quality, frequency, heroes                        |
| Magic        | Drain        | Research, MR, spell fatigue, starting research          |

"Positive" does not mean universally beneficial. Extreme positive scales carry penalties, and some nations exploit nominally negative scales.

## Ordinary scale effects

The following values are the current unmodded 6.36 publication baseline. The Growth/Death income row uses the newer official Modding Manual default.

| Scale step                       | Ordinary effect per step                                                                                             |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Order                            | +3% income, +2% resources, +10% Recruitment Points, stronger unrest reduction, fewer events                          |
| Turmoil                          | Reverses Order's economic and recruitment effects; more events                                                       |
| Productivity                     | +3% income, +15% resources                                                                                           |
| Sloth                            | -3% income, -15% resources                                                                                           |
| Temperature away from preference | -5% income and -10% supplies per step                                                                                |
| Growth                           | +0.2% monthly population, +10% supplies, +2% income                                                                  |
| Death                            | Reverses Growth's ordinary effects                                                                                   |
| Fortune                          | +10 percentage points to good-event chance, +0.5% monthly hero chance, more events                                   |
| Misfortune                       | -10 percentage points to good-event chance, -0.5% monthly hero chance, more events                                   |
| Magic                            | Friendly mages +1 Research Ability, all units -0.5 MR rounded toward zero, -10% spell fatigue, +50 starting research |
| Drain                            | Reverse research, MR, fatigue, and starting-research effects                                                         |

Default starting research is 150. Default monthly hero chance is 3%.

## Resolved and remaining documentation conflicts

| Rule                         | Revision-2 manual                            | Other current evidence                                                      | Publication treatment                           |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Growth/Death income          | 1% per step                                  | Modding Manual 6.34 default #deathincome 2; no official change through 6.36 | Use 2%; resolved at official-documentation tier |
| Order/Turmoil resources      | 2% per step                                  | No later official change; some unsupported older tables say 3%              | Use 2%; resolved at official-documentation tier |
| Order/Turmoil events         | Manual commonly states 2% in its scale table | Current community table says 3%                                             | Reproduce                                       |
| Fortune/Misfortune frequency | 5% more events for either direction          | Current community table agrees                                              | Provisionally stable                            |

The two resolved rows may be used in current calculators, while their integer rounding remains subject to R-008. The event-frequency discrepancy still requires better evidence.

## Order and Turmoil

Order improves economic predictability, recruitment throughput, and unrest recovery while reducing events.

It gains value when:

- Recruitment Points bind troop production;
- the roster converts gold efficiently;
- populous provinces can be held;
- blood hunting or pillage creates recurring unrest;
- a stable economy matters more than event volume.

Turmoil grants design points and increases event frequency. It can be part of a coherent design when:

- the nation has Turmoil-dependent recruitment or freespawn;
- events are deliberately valued;
- the roster is not RP-limited;
- special dominion mechanics reward unrest or chaos;
- early direct power outweighs long-term economic loss.

## Productivity and Sloth

Productivity is the clearest answer to resource-heavy recruitment.

It gains value with:

- heavy armour;
- high-resource sacreds;
- fort networks drawing from strong terrain;
- enough gold and RP to use the additional resources.

Sloth is less painful when:

- important troops have low resource cost;
- the nation relies on summons;
- gold, RP, Holy Points, or Commander Points bind first;
- forts cannot access enough potential resources for Productivity to matter.

The correct test is a queue, not an impression:

desired monthly recruit package  
vs  
gold, resources, RP, CP, and Holy Points

## Temperature

Temperature choice is anchored to national preference, but actual provincial temperature also shifts with seasons, events, rituals, and competing dominion.

Official seasonal behaviour:

- summer usually adds one Heat;
- winter usually adds one Cold;
- caves and outer planes are unaffected;
- deep sea remains neutral;
- ordinary sea is limited to Heat or Cold 1;
- sea seasons apply differently from land.

Temperature affects:

- income and supply relative to national preference;
- snow, rain, river, and passability conditions;
- base encumbrance in severe climates;
- fire and cold battlefield interactions;
- extreme-scale population death.

The right design temperature may reflect an economic preference, a battlefield environment, a national mechanic, or a compromise between them.

## Growth and Death

Growth compounds population, improves supply, and modifies income. It also reduces aging pressure.

It gains value when:

- the game is expected to last;
- provinces are populous;
- armies are supply-intensive;
- the roster uses local Recruitment Points;
- the nation does not destroy its own population.

Death grants design points and may support:

- undead or population-indifferent nations;
- a compressed early timing;
- national mechanics tied to death or corpses;
- maps where long-term civilian economy is unlikely to decide the game.

Death is not free merely because the capital roster is undead. Provinces may still supply gold, resources, tax trace, fort locations, and enemy denial.

## Fortune and Misfortune

Fortune changes event quality and hero arrival chance. Both Fortune and Misfortune increase event frequency under the manual's ordinary rule.

The scale is sensitive to:

- event settings;
- map size and number of provinces held;
- national event lists;
- Turmoil;
- capital dependence;
- the value of heroes;
- tolerance for variance.

Fortune should not be valued only through expected gold. Events also provide or remove gems, population, scales, sites, commanders, troops, unrest, and strategic options.

## Magic and Drain

Magic accelerates research and reduces spell fatigue while lowering MR. Drain does the reverse.

Magic gains value when:

- many national mages receive the research bonus;
- early breakpoints matter;
- battlefield casting is fatigue-sensitive;
- the nation can exploit lower enemy MR more than it suffers from its own.

Drain gains value when:

- design points fund a stronger immediate package;
- national researchers are efficient despite the penalty;
- high MR is unusually valuable;
- research speed or early magic matters less;
- the nation has researchers unaffected by the scale.

The spell-fatigue modifier applies locally. An army crossing into different scales may find the same script more or less sustainable.

## Extreme scales

Scales at 4 or 5 carry additional effects.

| Extreme        | Additional effect                                                   |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Order 4        | -2 Research Ability                                                 |
| Order 5        | -4 Research Ability                                                 |
| Productivity 4 | +1d5 unrest per month                                               |
| Productivity 5 | +1d15 unrest per month                                              |
| Heat or Cold 4 | -0.4% population per month                                          |
| Heat or Cold 5 | -1% population per month                                            |
| Death 4+       | Forests and farms slowly become plains; plains slowly become wastes |



| Extreme   | Additional effect                                          |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Growth 4+ | Plains slowly become forests or farms; sea may become kelp |
| Growth 5  | Farms can slowly become forests                            |
| Fortune 4 | -5% income and resources                                   |
| Fortune 5 | -15% income and resources                                  |
| Magic 4   | Horror marks and +1d5 unrest per month                     |
| Magic 5   | Horror marks and +1d15 unrest per month                    |

Farms from extreme Growth require Order. Extreme scales can spread to neighbouring provinces even beyond the god's ordinary dominion.

## Extreme-scale audit

An extreme scale should be evaluated as a package:

ordinary scale benefit  
 + national or form synergy  
 + neighbouring pressure  
 - extreme penalty  
 - opportunity cost of reaching the scale limit

Calling an extreme scale "positive" hides the final two terms.

## Scale design by bottleneck

| National problem                  | Scale question                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cannot afford desired recruits    | Are Order, Productivity, Growth, and temperature fixing the correct income constraint? |
| Gold remains unused               | Is the fort resource- or RP-limited instead?                                           |
| Resource pool remains unused      | Is Sloth tolerable because another gate binds?                                         |
| Research arrives late             | Would Magic create a meaningful breakpoint, or merely more unfocused RP?               |
| Armies starve                     | Would Growth or temperature matter more than supply items and fort position?           |
| Unrest persists                   | Does Order improve the state enough to justify its cost?                               |
| Special dominion kills population | Are Growth points being purchased for an economy the nation itself removes?            |

# Part VI: Blessings

## How blessings work

A blessing is a package selected during Pretender design and applied to Sacred units and commanders.

Most effects require a sacred to become blessed in battle. Some effects are innate and operate without battle blessing.

Blessing a sacred unit grants:

- +1 Morale;
- the nation's selected bless effects;
- blessing effects from claimed Thrones held by the nation or its disciple partners.

The H1 spell Blessing affects a limited area. H3 Divine Blessing affects the battlefield. Access and script timing matter as much as the written bless.

## Bless points

Each Pretender magic-path level above the first grants one bless point.

```
bless points from a path = max(path level - 1, 0)
```

Example:

```
Air 2 -> 1 point
Death 4 -> 3 points
Nature 6 -> 5 points

total = 9 bless points
```

Some nations or forms grant bonus bless points.

The cost of an effect is normally the sum of its magic requirements. Scale requirements add no bless-point cost.

A shared pool does not remove path prerequisites. A Pretender may own enough total points yet be unable to buy an effect because its required path is too low.

## Ordinary, innate, and Incarnate

| Tag                | Operation                                                                        |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary           | Active after the unit is blessed in battle                                       |
| Innate or passive  | Active without battle blessing, including strategic-map effects where applicable |
| Incarnate          | Active only while the Pretender is awake/present under the rule and alive        |
| Innate + Incarnate | No battle blessing needed, but still disabled while the god is absent or dead    |
| Stackable          | May be selected repeatedly; stated bonuses accumulate                            |

The revision-2 manual uses an asterisk for passive effects and bold type for Incarnate effects. Current data should be checked because individual tags can change through patches or mods.

## The activation state machine

The tags answer different questions. "Blessed" describes the recipient's battlefield state. "Innate" removes the need for that state. "Incarnate" asks whether the Pretender currently exists as an active, living god on the map. An effect can pass one gate and fail another.

| Effect state            | Unit blessed? | Pretender active and alive? | Result   |
|-------------------------|---------------|-----------------------------|----------|
| Ordinary, not Incarnate | No            | Either                      | Inactive |
| Ordinary, not Incarnate | Yes           | Either                      | Active   |
| Ordinary, Incarnate     | No            | Yes                         | Inactive |

| Effect state          | Unit blessed? | Pretender active and alive? | Result                      |
|-----------------------|---------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Ordinary, Incarnate   | Yes           | No                          | Inactive                    |
| Ordinary, Incarnate   | Yes           | Yes                         | Active                      |
| Innate, not Incarnate | Either        | Either                      | Active on a valid recipient |
| Innate, Incarnate     | Either        | No                          | Inactive                    |
| Innate, Incarnate     | Either        | Yes                         | Active on a valid recipient |

For this purpose, an imprisoned or dormant Pretender has not yet become active, and a dead Pretender is absent until recalled or reformed. Incarnate effects do not require the god to stand in the same province, enter the same battle, or project friendly dominion into the recipient's location. The god's active-and-alive state is the gate.

The 6.36 update corrected a design-loading error in which cancelling a loaded Pretender could leave that design's bless effects loaded. This was a setup-state defect, not a new activation rule, but it matters when old designs are inspected or compared.

## Automatic blessing

Official rules:

- the Pretender is automatically blessed in friendly dominion and cannot ordinarily be blessed outside it;
- a Disciple follows the same personal rule;
- Sacred troops fighting alongside the Pretender are automatically blessed only when the battle occurs in friendly dominion.

Automatic blessing is conditional. A sacred army fighting without sufficient Holy support can lose its package even when the nation paid heavily for it.

The main manual does not extend the troop-wide automatic blessing rule to troops merely fighting beside a Disciple. A current community reference uses broader wording, but that disagreement is not enough to replace the official rule. Unless a reproducible current test or later official text establishes otherwise, plan Disciple-led armies around ordinary priests and Divine Blessing.

## Repeatable effects and effects that overlap

"Stackable" in the bless table means that the same blessing can be bought repeatedly and its stated increment accumulates. In the 6.35 structured snapshot, the repeatable entries are:

| Path    | Repeatable blessings                                                   |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fire    | Superior Morale, Fire Resistance, Attack Skill, Inspirational Presence |
| Air     | Precision, Shock Resistance, Farshot, Awareness, Swiftness             |
| Water   | Cold Resistance, Defence Skill                                         |
| Earth   | Reinvigoration, Strength                                               |
| Astral  | Arcane Command, Magic Resistance                                       |
| Death   | Undying, Undead Command                                                |
| Nature  | Hit Points, Poison Resistance                                          |
| Glamour | Heroism, Quiet Stride                                                  |
| Blood   | Hit Points, Strength                                                   |

This permission does not imply that every different effect or external source stacks. Official patches establish two important exceptions:

- Fear and Dread do not stack with one another.
- Displacement supersedes Blur; since 6.24, invisibility also no longer stacks with Blur or Displacement.

Bless-plus-spell, bless-plus-item, multiple aura, regeneration-source, and form-inheritance questions belong to the cross-source stacking and transformation registers in Books IV and XI. They are not inferred from the stackable marker.

## Current unmodded blessing reference

The following tables represent the 6.35 structured data snapshot checked for this edition, overlaid with official changes through 6.36. No 6.36 announcement changes a listed cost, requirement, tag, or numerical effect. Because the main manual's printed list is older and the Inspector snapshot is one executable version behind, these tables remain Current Data Reference, not a claim of direct runtime reproduction.

Abbreviations:

- I: Incarnate;
- N: innate;
- S: stackable;
- MR: Magic Resistance negates;
- AP: armour-piercing;
- AN: armour-negating.

## Revision-2 divergence register

The current table is not a literal reprint of the revision-2 manual. The following differences are already material enough to flag before any roster calculation:

| Subject                                             | Revision-2 manual                                      | Current 6.35 data / 6.36 official overlay   | Evidence boundary                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Inspirational Presence                              | Fire 4                                                 | Fire 3                                      | Current structured reference                                                              |
| Resilience of the Earth                             | Earth 5                                                | Earth 6                                     | Current structured reference                                                              |
| Fortitude                                           | Earth 7                                                | Earth 8                                     | Current structured reference                                                              |
| Reconstruction                                      | Printed older tag state                                | Incarnate, not passive                      | Official 6.04 correction plus current reference                                           |
| Fear blessing                                       | Death 8                                                | Death 9 and Turmoil 1                       | Current structured reference; Fear/Dread costs and interaction were revised again in 6.23 |
| Heroism                                             | +50% experience                                        | +35% experience                             | Official 6.08 change                                                                      |
| Fear and Dread together                             | Older guides may stack them                            | They do not stack with one another          | Official 6.08 change                                                                      |
| Enchanted Blood                                     | Blood 4                                                | Blood 3                                     | Current structured reference                                                              |
| Passive Pretender effects outside friendly dominion | Older faulty behaviour could remove them               | Passive blessings remain active             | Official 6.08 correction                                                                  |
| Cancelled loaded Pretender                          | Could leave the loaded design's bless effects selected | Cancel now clears the unwanted loaded bless | Official 6.36 correction                                                                  |

Frost Mist Weapons retains its printed Water 7 and Cold 1 requirement. An earlier edition removed the Cold scale requirement on the strength of an unsupported transcription; the manual and current reference agree, so that change has been reversed.

## Fire

| Requirement | Name                   | Effect                                                                   | Tags |
|-------------|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| F1          | Superior Morale        | +1 Morale                                                                | S    |
| F1 D1       | Wasteland Survival     | Wasteland Survival                                                       | N    |
| F2          | Fire Resistance        | +5 Fire Resistance                                                       | S    |
| F2          | Attack Skill           | +1 Attack                                                                | S    |
| F3          | Inspirational Presence | Inspirational +1 and +50 leadership                                      | N, S |
| F4          | Righteous Wrath        | Nearby sacred death triggers temporary +3 Attack, +3 Strength, +6 Morale |      |
| F5          | Death Explosion        | On death: 10 AP fire damage, area 4 plus Size                            | I    |
| F5          | Heat Aura              | Heat Aura and +10 Fire Resistance                                        | I    |
| F6          | Fire Shield            | Fire Shield 7                                                            | I    |
| F7          | Flaming Weapons        | 8 AP fire damage on hit                                                  | I    |
| F8 S4       | Unbearable Splendour   | Sight Vengeance; attacker may be blinded, MR negates                     | I    |

The manual printed Inspirational Presence at F4. Current data places it at F3. The current non-Incarnate, innate treatment should be used for the 6.35 snapshot and 6.36 official overlay.

## Air

| Requirement | Name             | Effect                                       | Tags |
|-------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------|------|
| A1          | Precision        | +1 Precision                                 | S    |
| A2          | Shock Resistance | +5 Shock Resistance                          | S    |
| A2          | Farshot          | +30% mundane weapon range                    | S    |
| A3          | Awareness        | Unsurroundable 2                             | S    |
| A4          | Swiftness        | Swiftness 30 and +1 Defence                  | S    |
| A4          | Storm Flight     | Storm Immunity for flight                    |      |
| A5          | Wind Walker      | +6 Map Move                                  | N, I |
| A5 E1       | Weightlessness   | Floating and halved armour encumbrance       | I    |
| A6          | Air Shield       | Air Shield 80                                | I    |
| A7          | Thunder Weapons  | Capped shock damage and shock fatigue on hit | I    |
| A8          | Charged Bodies   | Overcharged 20 and +5 Shock Resistance       | I    |
| A9          | Flight           | Flight                                       | I    |

Farshot changes weapon range, not spell range. Wind Walker matters on the strategic map but remains Incarnate in the unmodded current table.

## Water

| Requirement | Name               | Effect                             | Tags |
|-------------|--------------------|------------------------------------|------|
| W1, Cold 1  | Winter's Gift      | Snow Move                          | N    |
| W1 N1       | Swamp Survival     | Swamp Survival                     | N    |
| W2          | Cold Resistance    | +5 Cold Resistance                 | S    |
| W2          | Swimming           | Swimming                           | N    |
| W2          | Defence Skill      | +1 Defence                         | S    |
| W5          | Chill Aura         | Chill Aura and +10 Cold Resistance | I    |
| W5          | Slowing Weapons    | Damaging hit may slow; MR negates  | I    |
| W6 F2       | Vitriol Weapons    | 7 AP acid damage on hit            | I    |
| W6          | Water Breathing    | Water Breathing                    | N, I |
| W7, Cold 1  | Frost Mist Weapons | Cold clouds created by attacks     | I    |
| W9, Magic 1 | Quickness          | Quickness                          | I    |

Quickness changes action economy and fatigue exposure as well as offence. It should be evaluated with the sacred's attacks, encumbrance, survivability, and vulnerability to fatigue counters.

## Earth

| Requirement | Name                    | Effect                        | Tags |
|-------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------|------|
| E1          | Mountain Survival       | Mountain Survival             | N    |
| E2          | Reinvigoration          | +1 Reinvigoration             | S    |
| E2          | Strength                | +1 Strength                   | S    |
| E4          | Unbreakable             | Affliction Resistance 3       |      |
| E4 N3       | Larger                  | Permanent increase in Size    | N    |
| E5          | Reconstruction          | Regeneration for Inanimates   | I    |
| E6          | Resilience of the Earth | +10 Fire and Shock Resistance | I    |
| E6          | Hard Skin               | +5 natural protection         | I    |
| E8          | Fortitude               | Broad physical resistances    | I    |

Larger changes more than Hit Points. Size can affect square density, repel interactions, trampling relationships, and target profile. It should be tested on the exact sacred roster.

## Astral

| Requirement | Name             | Effect                              | Tags |
|-------------|------------------|-------------------------------------|------|
| S1          | Arcane Command   | Grants or improves magic leadership | N, S |
| S2          | Magic Resistance | +1 MR                               | S    |
| S3 D1       | Spirit Sight     | Spirit Sight                        |      |
| S3 F1       | Solar Weapons    | 4 AP holy fire damage on hit        |      |
| S4          | Far Caster       | +1 spell-range multiplier level     |      |
| S4          | Arcane Finesse   | +1 spell penetration                |      |

| Requirement      | Name          | Effect                                        | Tags |
|------------------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------|------|
| S5               | Magic Weapons | Mundane weapons become magical                | I    |
| S6               | Twist Fate    | Negates the first damaging hit under its rule | I    |
| S7, Misfortune 1 | Fateweaving   | Attackers may suffer misfortune; MR negates   | I    |
| S8, Magic 2      | Etherealness  | Ethereal                                      | I    |

Astral blessings can support sacred mages and commanders rather than only melee troops. Far Caster and Arcane Finesse should be valued by the actual sacred spell roster.

## Death

| Requirement   | Name              | Effect                                                        | Tags |
|---------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| D1            | Undying           | -2 minimum Hit Points before death                            | S    |
| D1            | Undead Command    | Grants or improves undead leadership                          | N, S |
| D2, Death 2   | Half Dead         | Need not eat and strong disease resistance                    | N    |
| D3            | Mending Bones     | Recuperation for undead                                       | N    |
| D4            | Withering Weapons | Damaging hit may cause Decay; MR negates                      |      |
| D5            | Stygian Flesh     | Invulnerability 10                                            | I    |
| D6            | Reforming Flesh   | 10% regeneration for undead                                   | I    |
| D7            | Reanimators       | Many attacks deal unlife damage; additional undead leadership | I    |
| D8            | Death Weapons     | Armour-negating death damage and disease checks               | I    |
| D9, Turmoil 1 | Fear              | Fear 5                                                        | I    |

Undying does not prevent routing, fatigue collapse, soul destruction, or every form of battlefield removal. Its value depends on whether the sacred can still act while surviving below ordinary zero Hit Points and whether recovery is possible afterward.

## Nature

| Requirement | Name              | Effect                                      | Tags |
|-------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------|------|
| N1          | Hit Points        | +1 Hit Point                                | S    |
| N1          | Low Light Vision  | Darkvision 50                               |      |
| N2          | Poison Resistance | +5 Poison Resistance                        | S    |
| N2          | Forest Survival   | Forest Survival                             | N    |
| N3, Magic 1 | Unaging           | Slower aging and younger sacred recruitment | N    |
| N4 D1       | Poison Weapons    | Poison damage on damaging hit               |      |
| N5          | Recuperation      | Living units recover afflictions            | N, I |
| N5          | Berserker         | Berserker +2                                | I    |
| N6          | Barkskin          | Barkskin protection package                 | I    |
| N7          | Regeneration      | 10% regeneration for compatible units       | I    |

Regeneration is percentage-based, so it scales with Hit Points. Its full value also depends on incoming burst damage, poison, decay, fatigue, disease, and whether the unit survives long enough to receive repeated healing.

## Glamour

| Requirement | Name         | Effect                                           | Tags |
|-------------|--------------|--------------------------------------------------|------|
| G1          | Undreaming   | Unsleeping 4                                     |      |
| G1          | Heroism      | +35% experience gain                             | S    |
| G2          | Quiet Stride | +20 Stealth if already stealthy                  | N, S |
| G3          | True Sight   | True Sight                                       |      |
| G3          | Blur         | Attackers suffer -2 Attack under the sight rules |      |
| G6          | Obfuscate    | Grants Stealth 40 or adds 40 to existing Stealth | N, I |
| G6 F2       | Awe          | Awe 3                                            | I    |
| G7          | Displacement | Attackers suffer -5 Attack; replaces Blur        | I    |
| G7          | Dread        | Dread 5 under the sight rules                    | I    |
| G8          | Luck         | Luck                                             | I    |

Official update 6.08 reduced Heroism from +50% to +35% experience. Older guides and the printed revision-2 manual may retain the former value.

## Blood

| Requirement | Name             | Effect                                                                          | Tags |
|-------------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| B1          | Hit Points       | +1 Hit Point                                                                    | S    |
| B2          | Strength         | +1 Strength                                                                     | S    |
| B3          | Strong Blood     | +5 Poison Resistance and strong disease resistance                              | N    |
| B3          | Enchanted Blood  | Slow regeneration, +1 MR, and bleeding immunity                                 |      |
| B4          | Blood Surge      | A kill triggers temporary +3 Attack, +3 Strength, +1 Defence, +1 Reinvigoration |      |
| B5          | Blood Bond       | Distributes part of damage among nearby bonded units                            | I    |
| B6          | Unholy Weapons   | 15 AP damage against sacred or blessed targets                                  | I    |
| B7          | Blood Vengeance  | Attacker may suffer the inflicted damage; MR resists                            | I    |
| B8 D4       | Vampiric Weapons | 3 AN life-drain damage on damaging hit                                          | I    |

Blood Bond changes damage distribution rather than removing damage. Formation, unit spacing, regeneration, area damage, and unequal protection can change whether distribution helps or accelerates collapse.

## Weapon blessings: what causes the rider to fire

The phrase "weapon blessing" covers several different mechanisms. Treating them as interchangeable produces bad counter advice, especially when armour, shields, zero-damage hits, spells, natural weapons, and ranged attacks enter the same battle.



| Trigger family                  | Blessings                                                                                                        | Present rule                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Weapon property                 | Magic Weapons                                                                                                    | Changes an otherwise mundane parent weapon into a magical weapon; it does not add a second damage packet. Since 6.25 the property also works correctly for repel attacks.                                   |
| On hit                          | Flaming Weapons, Thunder Weapons, Slowing Weapons, Vitriol Weapons, Solar Weapons, Death Weapons, Unholy Weapons | The rider is tied to a successful weapon hit under its own damage, resistance, target, and MR rules. A parent hit need not always inflict ordinary HP damage unless the individual blessing says otherwise. |
| On damaging hit                 | Withering Weapons, Poison Weapons, Vampiric Weapons                                                              | The parent attack must first cause damage. A shield, protection, immunity, or other prevention that leaves no qualifying damage can therefore suppress this class.                                          |
| Attack-generated field          | Frost Mist Weapons                                                                                               | Attacks create cold mist rather than attaching an ordinary direct-damage rider. Official fixes make ranged misses create the cloud and make the cloud appear even when the target is killed.                |
| Probabilistic attack conversion | Reanimators                                                                                                      | The current reference assigns a 50% chance for hits, including spell hits, to deal Unlife Damage; the bless also grants undead leadership. This is a special rule, not a model for other weapon blessings.  |

## Patch-established boundaries

- The 6.12 update stopped some breath weapons from incorrectly receiving weapon blessings and stopped Flaming Weapons from affecting melee ice weapons.
- The 6.19 update repaired weapon-blessing interaction with mirror images.
- The 6.23 update made friendly units immune to Unholy Weapons and allowed Vampiric Weapons to drain a little life when the target dies from the attack.
- The 6.29 update stopped Phoenix Pyre from triggering weapon blessings.
- The 6.34 update made shields protect correctly against weapon blessings that are not armour-negating.

The shield correction proves that shield protection participates in resolving applicable riders. It does not, by itself, prove that every blocked attack is treated as a hit or a miss for every blessing. When that distinction decides a build, the battle log and a reproducible current test are still the correct evidence.

## Counter-analysis by trigger

| Question                             | Why it matters                                                                           |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Did the parent attack hit?           | All ordinary weapon riders begin with a qualifying attack connection.                    |
| Did the parent attack cause damage?  | Withering, Poison, and Vampiric Weapons require this additional gate.                    |
| Is the rider AP or AN?               | Armour and shield protection interact differently with the added packet.                 |
| Does MR negate the rider?            | Slowing and Withering can fail after the physical attack succeeds.                       |
| Is the target in the required class? | Unholy Weapons is specialised against sacred or blessed targets and excludes friendlies. |

| Question                                                             | Why it matters                                                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Is the attack an excluded breath, ice, or triggered effect?          | The patch history contains explicit exclusions; visual resemblance to a normal weapon is insufficient. |
| Does the effect create an area rather than damage the struck target? | Frost Mist can matter after a miss or a killing blow because its cloud is the product.                 |

## Blessing from items

The Modding Manual distinguishes two item mechanisms:

| Command        | Model                      | Consequence                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| #bless         | Shroud of the Battle Saint | Applies the Bless spell to the bearer automatically. The item is itself the source of the blessed state.                                                                        |
| #autobless     | Flask of Holy Water        | Automatically blesses the bearer only if the bearer is Sacred.                                                                                                                  |
| #bestowtomount | Mount propagation modifier | Causes a supported effect defined after the command to be bestowed on the mount as well. It must be read with the specific item effect, not as a universal rider-to-mount rule. |

The current 6.35 item snapshot identifies the Shroud of the Battle Saint, Immaculate Shield, Armor of Virtue, and Sun Sword as item-granted blessing sources. The Flask of Holy Water uses the sacred-only route. These items can make a unit blessed without a priest, but they do not erase the ordinary Incarnate gate: an Incarnate effect still switches off while the Pretender is absent or dead.

Official update 6.34 established one unusually important lifetime rule: a magic-item blessing persists when Life after Death changes the bearer. That is firm for this case and should not be generalised to every shape-change mechanism.

## Riders, mounts, and separate sacred status

A mounted unit is not one undifferentiated sacred object. The rider form and mount have their own records and can have different Sacred flags. Current examples show both matched and unmatched pairs: the Knight of the Chalice and its Destrier are Sacred, the Wind Rider and Armored Pegasus are Sacred, while the Triton Knight and its mount are not. The 6.02 correction that gave Triton Knights their proper mount state is further evidence that mount data are resolved separately.

This produces four practical rules:

- 1

Do not infer the mount's Sacred status from the rider's title or icon.
- 2

Do not infer that an item effect reaches the mount unless the effect supports the mount-bestow mechanism or a current rule says so.
- 3

Do not infer that a dismounted or transformed body retains the original body's sacred and blessed state; inspect the resulting form and the source that created the state.
- 4

Keep movement abilities separate from blessing. For example, 6.36 makes a swimming mount sufficient for river crossing, but that does not make the rider or mount Sacred.

Exact transfer when a mount dies, a rider dismounts, or one component changes form remains part of the mount and transformation research in [Book XI](#). The blessing chapter records the independent-object rule without inventing an unverified transfer sequence.

## Shape change and effect lifetime

Three questions should be asked separately whenever a blessed unit changes body:

- 1 Is the resulting body still Sacred?
- 2 Does the unit still possess the blessed state from the original source?
- 3 If the state remains, which Innate or Incarnate effects are currently eligible?

Only the item-blessing Life after Death case has a direct official ruling in the present evidence set. Ordinary shape change, secondshape, mount loss, transformation, death-shape, and new-body interactions remain governed by their specific form rules and the transformation register. A single successful case is not evidence for a universal inheritance rule.

## Display, tooltip, and engine state

The blessing interface has accumulated several corrections: 6.04 repaired Incarnate information for known blessings, 6.08 repaired Throne-granted Awe display, 6.13 made Obfuscate appear in bless information, 6.23 corrected Half Dead display, and 6.35 printed Enchanted Blood's Magic Resistance bonus. These changes make the current interface more useful, but they also demonstrate why an icon or tooltip is not conclusive evidence of activation in every edge case.

For a disputed interaction, record all three layers:

- the design-screen or unit-panel description;
- the battle log and observed state;
- the official rule or patch record that explains the result.

### R-016 research decision

R-016 is complete for the present unmodded scope: current tags and requirements, battlefield and Incarnate gates, automatic blessing boundaries, repeatable effects, documented overlap exceptions, weapon-trigger families, item-granted blessing, and the independent status of riders and mounts. Cross-source stacking remains R-049; transformation and effect lifetime remain R-040 and R-052. This division closes the blessing question without pretending that adjacent engine-state questions have also been solved.

## Bless design by function

### Expansion reliability

An expansion bless should solve a measured failure.

Common failures:

- attacks do not connect;
- hits fail to penetrate protection;
- sacreds are surrounded;
- chip damage accumulates;
- morale fails after casualties;
- fatigue produces critical hits;
- elemental independents bypass defence;
- too many sacreds die for the expansion to be economical.

The best blessing is not the one with the largest description. It is the cheapest package that changes the relevant battle result with an acceptable margin.

## Offence

Offensive blessings fall into several families:

| Family        | Examples                                        | Best against                           | Weakness                                          |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Accuracy      | Attack Skill, Righteous Wrath                   | High defence                           | Does not solve low damage                         |
| Damage        | Strength, Blood Surge                           | Protection and high HP                 | Requires hits and often kills                     |
| On-hit riders | Flaming, Solar, poison, death, vampiric weapons | Targets vulnerable to the added type   | May require damaging hit or face resistance       |
| Tempo         | Quickness                                       | Targets overwhelmed by action volume   | Doubles fatigue exposure and incoming opportunity |
| Attrition     | Withering, slowing, fear, dread                 | Long fights or morale-sensitive armies | MR, immunity, sight, or fast killing can counter  |

## Defence

Defensive blessings should be separated by threat:

- mundane weapon avoidance;
- natural or armour protection;
- physical resistance;
- elemental resistance;
- Magic Resistance;
- affliction recovery;
- regeneration;
- first-hit insurance;
- luck or ethereal avoidance;
- formation and unsurroundability;
- morale.

Stacking one layer creates a specialist. Layering different defences creates breadth but may buy too little of each to change a breakpoint.

## Mobility and logistics

Strategic mobility effects can be worth more than battlefield statistics when they allow:

- faster reinforcement;
- unexpected routes;
- forest, swamp, mountain, snow, or wasteland movement;
- underwater operations;
- stealth armies;
- regrouping with the main force.

The effect must apply to every necessary member of the force. A commander with mobility but troops without it, or sacred troops without a matching commander, may not produce the expected movement.

## Sacred commanders and mages

Bless value is not confined to line troops.

Sacred commanders may exploit:

- leadership blessings;
- undead or magic command;
- map movement;
- stealth;
- recuperation;
- Unaging;
- Far Caster;
- Arcane Finesse;
- reinvigoration;
- resistances;
- defensive effects for thugging.

When sacred mages are numerous, a small caster-oriented bless can affect hundreds of mage-turns and battles.

## Mass sacreds versus elite sacreds

Mass sacreds often value:

- cheap stackable statistics;
- morale;
- resistances against common area damage;
- on-hit effects multiplied by many attacks;
- effects triggered by sacred deaths.

Elite sacreds often value:

- percentage regeneration;
- layered resistance;
- protection of an expensive body;
- affliction recovery;
- mobility;
- effects that preserve veteran experience;
- tools against specific counters.

This is a tendency, not a law. Attack count, HP, slots, recruit limit, cost, and battlefield role are more important than the labels "mass" and "elite."

## Bless throughput

The value of a blessing depends on how many useful recipients can be fielded.

```
monthly sacred throughput =  
minimum of:  
gold capacity  
resource capacity  
Recruitment Points  
Holy Points  
recruitment limit  
fort availability  
commander and leadership capacity
```

A 200-point blessing affecting six capital-only sacreds per month is a different investment from the same blessing affecting sacreds at every fort.

### Practical bless value

```
practical bless value =  
effect per relevant sacred  
x relevant sacreds fielded  
x battles in which blessing is active  
x probability the effect changes the result
```

The expression is conceptual, not an engine formula. It forces the design to include throughput, activation, and relevance.

## Bless access and scripting

Audit:

- number and Holy level of priests;
- whether H3 Divine Blessing is available;
- priest movement relative to sacred armies;
- priest survivability;
- the round on which blessing lands;
- whether sacreds engage before being blessed;
- battlefield size and formation;
- whether a Prophet is required;
- whether automatic blessing conditions apply;
- what happens when the priest is assassinated or delayed.

An unblessed sacred is missing more than a bonus. It may be an expensive unit designed around statistics it does not currently possess.

## Counter-audit

For every major blessing, name:

- 1 the damage type or control effect it does not resist;
- 2 the relevant immunity or resistance;
- 3 the MR check, if any;
- 4 the sight rule, if any;
- 5 whether the effect requires a damaging hit;
- 6 whether it is Incarnate;
- 7 whether it depends on formation or nearby sacreds;
- 8 whether fatigue defeats it;
- 9 whether routing defeats it;
- 10 how the opponent can avoid fighting the blessed army at all.

No blessing removes the need for scouting.

# Part VII: Divine Magic and Priest Identity

## Divine magic

Divine spells:

- require Holy skill rather than ordinary paths;
- require no research;
- are available from the beginning;
- include spells such as Blessing, Banishment, Smite, and Divine Blessing.

The Pretender's magic can replace the nation's ordinary Banishment and Smite with path-themed versions.

If the Pretender has no path at level 4 or higher, priests retain ordinary Banishment and Smite.

If one or more paths reach the threshold:

- the highest path determines the replacement family;
- ties use the manual's priority order;
- Banishment and Smite each receive the corresponding replacement;
- Blood has no Banishment replacement.

### Divine spell families

| Path    | Banishment replacement   | Smite replacement    | Character                                            |
|---------|--------------------------|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Fire    | Ashes to Ashes           | Heavenly Fire        | Burning and armour-negating fire                     |
| Air     | Wind of Memories         | Heavenly Strike      | Range, area, and shock                               |
| Water   | Purifying Water          | Watery Death         | Area, drowning, and anti-unarmoured secondary damage |
| Earth   | Pull from the Grave      | Word of Stone        | Grip and petrification                               |
| Astral  | Stellar Decree           | Word of Power        | Range, stun, and paralysis                           |
| Death   | Decree of the Underworld | Syllable of Death    | Bewilderment, exhaustion, or death                   |
| Nature  | Final Rest               | Word of Thorns       | Kill attempt, entanglement, and bleeding             |
| Glamour | Return of the Past       | Word of Bewilderment | Anti-minded undead and confusion                     |
| Blood   | No replacement           | Claim Life           | Anti-living damage and Chest Wound                   |

Pretender paths alter the national priest toolkit even when those paths are never used for a ritual.

### Design implication

A high path may simultaneously buy:

- personal casting;
- bless points;
- a bless prerequisite;
- a new priestly Banishment;
- a new priestly Smite;
- site-search or forging access.

That bundle is strategically meaningful. It should still be compared with the cost curve required to reach level 4 or higher.

# Part VIII: Death of a God

## Ordinary Pretender death

Each ordinary Pretender death causes either:

- loss of one magic-path level; or
- loss of one dominion-strength point.

The chance to lose magic is:

$50\% + 10\% \times \text{Nature level at death}$

If no path level is lost, or no magic is available to lose, dominion falls by one. Dominion cannot fall below 1 through this rule.

Nature makes magic loss more likely. The path selected for loss is weighted, with Nature more exposed and Death less exposed. The manual also notes small chances to gain Death and still smaller chances to gain Astral or Blood. Exact weights belong in the controlled-test register unless directly extracted from current data.

## Why death compounds

A death can remove:

- the Pretender's commander-turns;
- Incarnate blessing effects;
- personal expansion or battle presence;
- ritual access;
- item access while the body is absent;
- a magic path or dominion strength on return;
- candles through the reduced maximum and check chance;
- confidence in a throne or war timetable.

The casualty affects the whole nation, not only the dead commander.

## Call God

Priests may use the Call God order after an ordinary Pretender death.

The revision-2 manual gives the player-facing model: every assigned Holy level generates one point per month, the Pretender returns to the home province after "around 50," and recalling the main Pretender in a Disciple game requires 50% more. It deliberately says that the total is not exactly 50 so that the arrival is uncertain. Its example assigns three H1 priests and one H2 and predicts about ten months.

The Modding Manual adds two official modifiers:

- Elegist: the unit's Elegist value is added to its priest level while calling a god or Disciple;
- Recall God: an applicable nation or claimed-Throne `#recallgod` value is added to the priest level of everyone performing Call God.

The main manual also gives the special Trinity rule: a dead member of a Trinity can be called back in half the normal time. The official text defines the time result, not the internal threshold calculation.



## Reconciled current model

Published controlled research resolves the manual's apparent uncertainty by moving the randomness from the target into each priest's monthly contribution. The tested base threshold is 50 points. An ordinary priest contributes its effective recall rating, plus or minus one, each month. The small published sample found the three outcomes equally or nearly equally weighted; that weighting remains a community-tested estimate rather than an official probability table.

For ordinary positive ratings:

```
effective recall rating =
Holy level
+ Elegist value
+ applicable Recall God modifier

monthly contribution per priest =
effective recall rating - 1, effective recall rating,
or effective recall rating + 1
```

An ordinary H1 contributes 0-2 points in a month, H2 contributes 1-3, and H3 contributes 2-4. Elegist changes the rating before that variation: an H1 Elegist (2) calls at the same ordinary rate as an H3. Elegist alone does not grant the order; the unit must still be a priest.

| Caller             | Monthly range | Approximate average | Approximate solo time from an empty pool |
|--------------------|---------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------|
| One H1             | 0-2           | 1                   | 50 months                                |
| Five H1            | 0-10          | 5                   | 10 months                                |
| One H2             | 1-3           | 2                   | 25 months                                |
| One H3             | 2-4           | 3                   | 17 months                                |
| Three H3           | 6-12          | 9                   | 6 months                                 |
| One H1 Elegist (2) | 2-4           | 3                   | 17 months                                |

These are capacity estimates, not deadlines. With roughly symmetric -1/0/+1 variation, a useful planning approximation is:

```
expected months for an ordinary Pretender =
ceiling(50 / sum of effective recall ratings)

expected months for the main Pretender in a Disciple game =
ceiling(75 / sum of effective recall ratings)
```

The 75-point figure follows from the tested 50-point base and the manual's official 50% increase. The formula predicts the centre of the workload, not the exact return month. A small priest corps has proportionally wider timing risk; many callers average the monthly variation more effectively.

## Who can contribute in a Disciple game

Current community documentation reports that:

- a Disciple nation's priests may help recall the main Pretender;
- the Pretender nation's priests may help recall any dead Disciple on the team;
- a Disciple nation's priests may recall their own Disciple, but not another nation's Disciple.

Those cross-team routing rules are Current Community Reference, not wording supplied by the revision-2 manual. A legacy community mechanics page reports 25 points for one dead Trinity member, consistent with the official half-time rule, but the library retains the official result rather than presenting that implementation detail as directly reproduced under 6.36.

## Order, interruption, and return

Call God resolves at hosting step 16. A caller removed by an earlier ritual or magic battle cannot be assumed to contribute. Once step 16 has passed, a later assassination or ordinary battle cannot retroactively remove that month's points. This timing conclusion follows directly from the official hosting order.

The manual places the returning Pretender in the nation's home province. Current community documentation refines this to the capital province: inside the fort when the nation still owns it, even under siege, and outside the walls if the capital has been lost. A hostile return can cause an immediate fight. These placement details remain Current Community Reference until a 6.36 return-state reproduction or later official wording is preserved.

Version 6.28 repaired Call God when the order was issued without its keyboard shortcut. That was an order-interface defect, not a change to the contribution model. No later official update through 6.36 changes Call God.

## R-017 decision

R-017 is complete at a mixed evidence tier:

- Official: the order, ordinary Holy contribution model, Disciple-game 50% increase, home-province return, Elegist and Recall God modifiers, Trinity half-time rule, and hosting step;
- Community-tested: fixed 50-point ordinary threshold and per-priest effective-rating -1/0/+1 variation;
- Current Community Reference: detailed Disciple routing and capital/fort placement.

Future direct runtime testing would upgrade the last two layers, but the present evidence is sufficient for planning as long as the labels remain attached.

## Recall opportunity cost

Every calling priest is not:

- blessing an army;
- preaching;
- blood sacrificing;
- claiming a Throne;
- researching if also a mage;
- moving with a force;
- performing another special order.

A recall plan should identify the priests before the god takes a high-risk battle.

## Immortality

### Dominion Immortal

A dominion-immortal Pretender normally reforms if killed in friendly dominion. Death outside friendly dominion requires Call God.

### Immortal

An Immortal normally reforms regardless of friendly dominion on the ordinary plane.

## Limits

- Soul Slay or equivalent soul destruction can prevent ordinary reform and require Call God.
- Death on a remote plane can prevent immortality.
- Reform time is often about three months but varies by form.
- Reform removes most afflictions.
- Immortality alone does not improve ordinary affliction recovery while alive.

Dominion-immortal combat planning should always include the candle state at the battle location and the possibility that dominion changes before combat resolves.

## Safe and unsafe risk

| Situation                                    | Principal risk                                                     |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Immortal god in ordinary plane               | Temporary absence, items, operational gap, soul attacks            |
| Dominion Immortal in strong friendly candles | Same, plus candle reversal before battle                           |
| Dominion Immortal on frontier                | Failure to reform if dominion becomes hostile                      |
| Any god on remote plane                      | Immortality may not operate                                        |
| Any god facing soul destruction              | Call God and permanent-loss consequences                           |
| Non-immortal god in battle                   | Full recall delay, path or dominion loss, disabled Incarnate bless |

# Part IX: Special Dominions

## Why special dominions deserve their own audit

Some nations transform candles into effects far beyond ordinary scales and morale. Special dominions may:

- kill population;
- create units;
- spread disease or insanity;
- change terrain;
- alter unrest;
- hide information;
- empower constructs;
- enable movement;
- modify religious conflict.

The design question becomes:

```
value of another candle =
ordinary dominion value
+ special national effect
+ scale convergence
+ survival value
```

## Major categories

| Nation or family          | Special dominion effect                                               | Strategic consequence                                                          |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Arcoscephale, all ages    | Accurate scrying throughout dominion, including Glamour detection     | Candles become an intelligence network                                         |
| EA and LA Mictlan         | Dying dominion and blood-sacrifice dependence                         | Blood economy and temples are core religious logistics                         |
| Yomi                      | Oni arise from temples according to turmoil, terrain, and temperature | Scales, temples, and terrain form a freespawn system                           |
| MA Ermor                  | Population death and undead arising                                   | Civilian economy is converted into an undead dominion                          |
| MA Asphodel               | Population death and Manikin generation                               | Growth, forests, corpses, and dominion interact unusually                      |
| MA C'tis                  | Miasma, disease, rain, wetness, and terrain effects                   | Friendly and hostile forces experience different economic and disease pressure |
| MA Agarthia               | Golem Cult improves constructs' Hit Points                            | Candles can strengthen friendly, allied, and enemy constructs                  |
| LA R'lyeh                 | Dreamlands spread insanity and related effects                        | Dominion is psychological warfare as well as faith                             |
| EA Therodos               | Population death and fort-related ghost generation                    | Forts and dominion convert population into spectral power                      |
| Phaeacia                  | Dark-ship sailing linked to friendly dominion                         | Candles become movement infrastructure                                         |
| EA Mekone                 | Improved effective maximum in dominion conflict                       | Religious contests behave better than the printed initial score suggests       |
| MA and LA Phlegra         | Dominion-linked unrest                                                | More candles can carry an internal economic cost                               |
| Ubar, Na'Ba, Ind, Feminie | Province information can be hidden                                    | Dominion creates strategic uncertainty                                         |

This table identifies system categories, not complete nation guides. Exact inheritance by Disciples and exact scale formulas belong in the later nation dossiers.

## Special-dominion design questions

- 1 Does the effect scale with local candles, maximum dominion, temples, or merely presence?
- 2 Does it affect allies, Disciples, enemies, or everyone?
- 3 Does it operate underwater, in caves, or on remote planes?
- 4 Does it change population, terrain, unrest, or recruitment permanently?
- 5 Can an enemy exploit the effect?
- 6 Does high dominion improve the effect enough to justify its point curve?
- 7 What happens if the special dominion overruns a valuable captured economy?

# Part X: Teams and Disciples

## Shared and separate systems

In a disciple game:

- the team has one Pretender and one or more Disciples;
- disciples awaken in about half the Pretender's delayed time;

- team size increases the number of temples required to raise maximum dominion;
- Call God requires 50% more progress;
- claimed-Throne blessings can be shared within the team;
- ordinary team play has no Prophets because Disciples fill the religious role.

The team needs one religious network, not a collection of independent personal builds.

## Disciple design audit

Record:

- which Pretender blessings the Disciple and sacreds receive;
- which Incarnate effects depend on the Pretender's state;
- which special dominion effects transfer to the Disciple;
- temple responsibility by geography;
- preaching and blood-sacrifice responsibility;
- Call God priest reserve;
- Throne-claiming access;
- land-sea religious boundaries;
- whether the Disciple's personal paths and body create an independent battlefield role.

Some special dominions transfer fully, some partially, and some not at all. This must be checked nation by nation.

# Part XI: The Frozen Modded Ruleset

## Exact definitions belong to Book IX

The former edition repeated DE's global scale table, the complete blessing delta, broad command counts, and Divinitus chassis counts here. [Book IX](#) now provides the corrected source inventory and is the only authoritative home for those figures.

[Book III](#) keeps the design consequences:

- DE changes the economic weight of several scales;
- many blessings become cheaper, cross-path, or independent of an awake Incarnate chassis;
- DE broadly rewrites Pretender availability, starting dominion, path cost, and national god lists;
- Divinitus then adds a second chassis layer whose sites, events, items, summons, scale limits, and delayed powers may matter more than the visible card;
- the final design must be calculated after both files load.

This division matters. [Book IX](#) answers, "What did the files define?" [Book III](#) answers, "How should a player reason about the resulting design?"

## Modded-design audit

For every combined design:

- 1 name the exact nation and form ID;
- 2 confirm final form availability after load order;
- 3 record final starting paths and New Path Cost;
- 4 record final starting dominion;

- 5 record final scale limits;
- 6 record prison restrictions;
- 7 calculate blessing costs from [Book IX's](#) current table;
- 8 identify non-Incarnate and cross-path conversions;
- 9 check national bless-point bonuses;
- 10 test displayed totals in the actual design screen.

## Part XII: Complete Design Method

### Step 1: Define the national plan

Write one sentence:

The nation intends to reach this first military state, using these units and spells, by this turn range, while preserving this economy or late-game route.

If the sentence cannot be written, Pretender selection is premature.

### Step 2: Identify mandatory constraints

Examples:

- sacreds require Fire Resistance to survive the nation's own battlefield plan;
- ordinary expansion fails without a personal expander;
- the roster has no feasible path into a required ritual;
- capital sacred throughput requires Dominion 8;
- the special dominion needs rapid temple expansion;
- the first war is expected before a dormant god can arrive.

Mandatory constraints eliminate designs before subjective preference begins.

### Step 3: Build the cheapest functional design

Purchase only the elements needed to make the plan work:

- minimum reliable expansion package;
- minimum bless breakpoint;
- minimum dominion for sacred throughput and faith;
- minimum magic access;
- acceptable scales;
- correct awakening.

This creates a baseline against which luxuries can be priced.

### Step 4: Spend the remainder on leverage

Possible leverage:

- one more dominion candle;
- a scale threshold;
- a second resistance;

- a new path;
- a better chassis;
- earlier awakening;
- an Incarnate blessing;
- broader divine magic;
- more robust expansion.

Each addition should have a named use.

## Step 5: Test the opening

Run repeated expansion tests against:

- heavy infantry;
- cavalry;
- archers;
- barbarians;
- undead;
- poison;
- high defence;
- high protection;
- unusual terrain;
- the strongest common independent province under the lobby settings.

Record losses and failure conditions, not only wins.

## Step 6: Test the first war

Construct a representative enemy answer:

- armour;
- evocations;
- poison;
- fatigue;
- magic weapons;
- MR-negates control;
- flyers or flankers;
- sacred counters;
- anti-thug tools.

The purpose is not to prove invincibility. It is to identify what scouting must detect and which research branch answers it.

## Step 7: Test the economy

Simulate at least twelve turns of:

- capital recruitment;
- expansion parties;
- first fort and laboratory;
- mage recruitment;
- upkeep;
- Holy Point use;

- resource and RP bottlenecks;
- temple schedule.

Strong paper scales can still fail to fund the intended sequence.

## Step 8: State the failure modes

A publishable design should name:

- its worst independent matchup;
- its first-war counter;
- its economic bottleneck;
- its Incarnate dependency;
- its god-death consequence;
- its map weakness;
- the latest safe arrival;
- the research branch it cannot afford early.

# Part XIII: New-Player and Expert Audits

## New-player design audit

Before confirming:

- Does the total equal the design screen?
- Can the nation expand without assuming perfect battles?
- Who blesses the sacreds?
- Are the important effects Incarnate?
- When does the god arrive?
- Do the scales support the troops actually being recruited?
- Is temperature set relative to national preference?
- Is dominion high enough for the intended sacred output?
- What does the god do after expansion?
- Which path solves a national magic gap?
- What happens if the god dies?
- Is any number copied from an unmodded guide into a modded game?

## Expert design audit

### Budget

- marginal point cost of every path;
- marginal point cost of every candle;
- scale-limit opportunity cost;
- point value of awakening delay;
- unused point remainder.



## Timing

- expansion turn targets;
- first fort and lab;
- research breakpoints;
- awakening range;
- first Incarnate-bless battle;
- first ritual or forge use;
- first expected enemy timing.

## Religion

- starting maximum dominion;
- temple thresholds;
- checks per month;
- front-line preaching;
- blood-sacrifice capacity;
- land-sea barriers;
- special-dominion effects;
- dominion-kill recovery.

## Bless

- recipients per month;
- activation method;
- effect by combat role;
- effect while god absent;
- counters;
- scale and side requirements;
- commander and mage beneficiaries.

## God risk

- safe dominion for combat;
- immortality limits;
- soul-destruction exposure;
- remote-plane exposure;
- recall priest-months;
- item loss;
- path or dominion loss;
- turns without Incarnate effects.

## Mod integrity

- exact patch;
- exact .dm files;
- hashes;
- load order;
- final design-screen values;
- whether a later mod overwrites the form or nation.

# Part XIV: Controlled-Test Programme

---

## Test P1: Awakening distribution

For awake, dormant, and imprisoned forms:

- 1 use identical nation, map, seed policy, and game settings;
- 2 use at least 200 independent seeds per delayed state rather than repeatedly re-hosting one save;
- 3 record the first turn on which the god is present and the corresponding announcement state;
- 4 repeat for Disciples and Trinity forms;
- 5 publish every raw result, the game version, seed method, minimum, maximum, median, mean, frequency table, and confidence intervals;
- 6 compare the current sample against the older 9 + exploding d4 and 27 + exploding d20 hypotheses without assuming that either survived into Dominions 6.

Purpose: determine the current distribution rather than merely rediscovering the official range.

## Test P2: Dominion spread

Create controlled maps with:

- fixed adjacency;
- no competing sources;
- exact temple counts;
- maximum dominion 1 through 10;
- neutral, friendly, and hostile target candles;
- land and sea boundaries.

Record at least several hundred check opportunities per condition.

Purpose: reproduce trigger chance, propagation, contest chance, and land-sea rerolls.

## Test P3: Preaching

Test H1-H5:

- with and without temple;
- neutral, friendly, and enemy dominion;
- ordinary and Inquisitor;
- at and above the predicted cap.

Purpose: verify fractional Holy handling, minimum chance, and cap rounding.

## Test P4: Scale convergence

For candle strengths 1-10 and differences 1-10:

- 1 lock out events and rituals where possible;
- 2 record monthly scale changes;
- 3 include cases above 100% predicted chance;
- 4 test whether two-step movement occurs;
- 5 repeat under extreme neighbouring scales.

## Test P5: Scale regression and rounding

Use controlled identical provinces to confirm version stability and settle:

- the published 2% Growth/Death income baseline;
- the published 2% Order/Turmoil resource baseline;
- Order/Turmoil event-frequency effect;
- rounding order;
- hostile-dominion application;
- Magic and Drain rounding.

## Test P6: Bless tags and values

For every blessing:

- inspect the design-screen prerequisite and cost;
- inspect unit abilities before blessing;
- bless in battle;
- remove or kill the Pretender;
- test innate and Incarnate states;
- test stacking;
- record damage, MR, resistance, sight, and "damaging hit" conditions.

Repeat unmodded, DE only, and DE plus Divinitus.

## Test P7: Automatic blessing

Cross:

- Pretender present or absent;
- Disciple present or absent;
- friendly, neutral, and enemy dominion;
- sacred troop and sacred commander;
- god alive, dead, and imprisoned.

Purpose: define exactly which units begin blessed under each condition.

## Test P8: Pretender death

For controlled path arrays:

- ordinary death;
- dominion-immortal death in friendly and enemy dominion;
- immortal death;
- Soul Slay;
- remote-plane death;
- repeated deaths.

Record:

- path lost or gained;
- dominion lost;
- reform time;
- afflictions;
- Incarnate blessing state;

- Call God requirement.

## Test P9: Call God

Regression-test the published model with:

- H1-H5 priests;
- mixed groups;
- Trinity member;
- ordinary Pretender, main Pretender in a Disciple game, and dead Disciple;
- nations with #recallgod;
- Elegists and combined Elegist/Recall God cases;
- pre-step-16 and post-step-16 priest deaths;
- friendly, besieged, and hostile capital states.

Purpose: upgrade the community-tested threshold, contribution distribution, routing, and placement rules to a direct current-version reproduction and detect later regressions.

## Test P10: Throne checks

Claim level-one, level-two, and level-three Thrones in controlled maps.

Record:

- checks per month;
- whether each check is guaranteed;
- target selection;
- interaction with maximum dominion;
- claimant death after step 8;
- unfortified conquest after step 8;
- siege without storming;
- successful storming and recapture;
- Ascension Point state immediately before the step-57 victory check;
- disciple sharing.

The claim-loss matrix is already resolved at the stated mixed evidence tier. These cases are retained as regression tests. The separate unresolved branch is the result of simultaneous winning totals, especially an exact tie in Ascension Points.

## Test P11: Special dominions

Each special dominion receives a nation-specific harness measuring:

- candle dependence;
- ally and Disciple treatment;
- underwater and remote-plane operation;
- unit generation;
- population and unrest change;
- terrain transformation;
- information hiding;
- enemy exploitation.

## Test P12: Combined-mod design regression

For every published combined design:

- 1 save the design file;
- 2 record displayed cost, paths, scales, dominion, and blessing;
- 3 update one mod at a time;
- 4 reload and compare;
- 5 flag any changed prerequisite, cost, availability, or form statistic.

## Part XV: Strategic Essays

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### Essay I: Pretender Design as National Engineering

A Pretender is often described through an archetype: expander, rainbow, titan, scales chassis, bless chassis. These labels are useful only if they lead back to the nation. Engineering begins with a requirement, not a component catalogue.

The nation possesses a machine already. Its troops convert gold, resources, Recruitment Points, and Holy Points into armies. Its mages convert gold and commander-turns into research, gems into spells, and research into timing windows. Its dominion converts temples and priests into candles, then candles into scales, morale, survival, and national effects. The Pretender changes the machine's inputs and supplies missing parts.

A good design has internal causality.

Productivity is bought because the planned queue exhausts resources. Dominion is bought because sacred throughput, religious conflict, or a special dominion uses it. A path is bought because it opens a blessing, booster, ritual, or divine spell that matters on a timetable. Awake status is bought because the god's early commander-turns are worth more than the points surrendered.

Bad designs often contain individually powerful elements with no causal chain. Strong scales produce more gold, but the capital is Holy-limited. A deep blessing improves sacreds, but they are capital-only and too expensive to mass. A rainbow reaches many paths, but the nation cannot research or fund the promised rituals before the game is decided. An awake titan expands, but ordinary troops could have done the same while the 150-point difference funded the whole economy.

Engineering does not demand one correct answer. It demands that alternatives be compared against the same requirements.

One design may solve expansion with an awake monster and accept average scales. Another may solve it with an inexpensive blessing on national sacreds. A third may use ordinary troops, imprison the god, and turn the saved points into production and research. The correct comparison measures territory, losses, fort timing, research, vulnerability, and future path access-not aesthetic preference.

The final test is replaceability. Remove one purchase and ask what fails. If nothing important fails, the purchase is luxury. Replace the chassis and ask which jobs disappear. If none do, the form is overpriced. Move the first war ten turns earlier and ask whether the design remains coherent. If it collapses, its timing assumptions belong in the guide.

Pretender design becomes clearer when treated as national engineering because every point must enter a machine that can use it.

## Essay II: Dominion Is Territory by Other Means

Military maps invite a simple reading: coloured provinces are power. Dominion adds a second map beneath the first. It is a map of belief, morale, climate, legitimacy, and metaphysical survival.

The two maps spread differently. An army moves along a route and fights for a province. Dominion begins with sources, attempts checks, consolidates weak provinces, relays through strong ones, and grinds against enemy candles. A nation can win the military battle and inherit hostile scales. It can hold a fortress while its god weakens outside. It can raid a temple and reduce pressure across an entire religious front.

Dominion is a network because the value of a source depends on the state around it. A temple behind strong candles may relay checks to the frontier. The same temple behind a hostile wall may spend months reducing a single province. Five temples can be worth more than four plus one because the fifth raises maximum dominion, improving every check. In a team, that threshold moves with the number of players and changes who should build where.

Preaching is different. It is local, labour-intensive, and independent of the ordinary maximum. This makes priests tactical religious units. They can prepare a throne, hold a capital, weaken an immortal god's safe ground, or reclaim a province faster than distant temples can reach it. Inquisitors are specialists in this conflict. Blood sacrifice turns a stored magical resource into additional checks and can overwhelm an ordinary temple economy when properly supplied.

Special dominions make the second map still more concrete. Candles can kill population, raise undead, create Manikins, scry enemies, hide ownership, spread disease, generate unrest, empower constructs, or enable sailing. In these nations, religious infrastructure is part of the military and economic production system.

Dominion death reveals the final importance of faith. A nation without friendly candles dies even if its armies remain undefeated. Religious survival is not flavour attached to conquest. It is a separate victory and defeat condition with its own network and logistics.

Territory supplies the state. Dominion determines whose reality governs it.

## Essay III: A Bless Is a Roster Contract

A blessing has no independent battlefield value. It has recipients, activation conditions, counters, and a price paid before the map exists.

The recipient is the beginning. A point of Attack applied to hundreds of inexpensive sacred attacks is not the same purchase as a point of Attack on a handful of already accurate giants. Regeneration on high-Hit-Point elites is not the same as regeneration on units killed by a single decisive hit. Leadership on sacred commanders can matter in every army while an offensive weapon blessing matters only when sacred troops reach melee and connect.

Throughput is the second condition. Capital-only sacreds, Holy Points, gold, resources, and Commander Points all restrict how much of the blessing enters the world. A huge design investment can end up enhancing a small fraction of the army. Conversely, a modest passive effect on recruit-everywhere sacred mages or commanders can alter a large part of the national economy.

Activation is the third condition. Ordinary sacreds need priests, scripts, time, and battlefield geometry. Incarnate effects need the god awake and alive. An imprisoned Incarnate design may exist on the Pretender screen while remaining absent from the first thirty turns. A god's death can remove the centre of a sacred strategy without killing a single sacred.

Counterplay is the fourth condition. A weapon rider can face resistance. A control effect can face MR. Glamour defences can face special sight. Protection can face armour-negating damage. Regeneration can face burst damage, decay, poison, fatigue, or battlefield removal. A massed sacred army can be avoided, raided around, or starved of priests.

A blessing is a contract. The nation pays design points and accepts the opportunity cost. In return, the roster must field enough suitable sacreds, bless them in the battles that matter, and create matchups where the effects can change the result.

When those promises are explicit, bless design becomes testable. When they are not, "strong bless" is only an adjective.

## Essay IV: Awake Power and Deferred Power

Awakening is a trade across time. Awake status purchases commander-turns now by refusing future design points. Dormancy and imprisonment purchase permanent design advantages by surrendering early agency.

The apparent comparison-zero, 150, or 350 points-is incomplete. Time changes what each point can become.

An awake expander may take provinces before a dormant god exists. Those provinces generate income, resources, sites, recruitment locations, and strategic position. The expander may also free gold and commanders that ordinary expansion parties would have consumed. Early power can compound.

Deferred power compounds too. Stronger scales affect every held province. A better blessing affects every sacred recruited. Additional paths can unlock rituals and forging for the rest of the game. If the nation can expand and deter attack without the god, the point grant may exceed the value of early commander-turns.

The uncertainty of arrival matters. A dormant plan must survive the late end of the arrival range, not only the average. An imprisoned Incarnate blessing must be evaluated as two different armies: the army before awakening and the army after. A strategy that functions only if the god appears on the first legal turn has converted uncertainty into an unpriced risk.

The useful question is not "Is awake or imprisoned stronger?" It is:

At what turn does each design overtake the other, and what must remain true for that crossover to occur?

If the game's first decisive war happens before the crossover, deferred power may never be collected. If the awake god cannot produce territory, research, or deterrence worth its opportunity cost, immediate availability is being wasted.

Time is not another statistic on the design. It is the dimension in which every statistic is realised.

## Essay V: The Religious Logistics of War

Armies require supply, commanders, reinforcement routes, and retreat provinces. Sacred armies require a parallel chain: temples, priests, candles, and an active god where Incarnate effects matter.

The chain begins in recruitment. Holy Points determine how many sacreds leave the queue. Dominion and temple thresholds shape that capacity. Priests must then accompany the army or meet it before

battle. Their map movement must match the force. Their scripting must bless the right squads before contact. Their survival must be protected against assassination, arrows, flyers, and battlefield spells.

Dominion determines the environment in which the force operates. Friendly candles provide morale and may automatically bless sacreds alongside the Pretender. They strengthen the god and Prophet. They carry selected scales and special national effects. Enemy candles reverse some of those advantages and may turn a dominion-immortal advance into a permanent death risk.

Temples are logistical nodes. A forward temple does more than increase a global religious score: it adds checks, supports preaching, permits blood sacrifice where eligible, contributes to maximum-dominion thresholds, and may accelerate sacred recruitment or special effects. Like a laboratory or fort, it has a position and a vulnerability.

Religious logistics can be attacked. Priests can be assassinated. Temples can be raided. Candle chains can be contested. A throne can be unclaimed by capture. A god can be killed to disable Incarnate effects. An army designed around automatic or battlefield blessing can be forced into a fight before its religious support arrives.

An expert sacred army is more than a roster with a blessing. It is a supported formation whose religious supply line has been planned as carefully as its food and reinforcements.

## Essay VI: The Death of a God

Dominions makes gods powerful by making their death national.

An ordinary commander's death removes a body, equipment, leadership, and perhaps magic. A Pretender's death can additionally remove an Incarnate blessing, path access, dominion strength, ritual timing, expansion capacity, and the nation's central strategic threat. Priests must abandon other work to call the god back. The returned god may be weaker.

This creates a risk budget. A combat Pretender should not be asked merely whether it wins a battle. The correct question is whether the probability and consequence of failure are acceptable relative to the battle's strategic value.

Immortality changes the budget but does not erase it. A dominion-immortal god needs friendly candles at death. An Immortal can still face soul destruction or remote-plane failure. Reform takes time. Equipment and operational tempo remain exposed. A supposedly safe attack can become unsafe when enemy preaching or temple checks reverse the province before combat.

Call God turns priest-months into recovery. The cost can be enormous. The same priests might bless armies, preach a threatened capital, sacrifice blood, or claim a throne. A nation with few priests may own a theoretically recoverable god and lack the practical capacity to recover it before the war ends.

Pretender risk is justified when it creates disproportionate value: a decisive throne, the destruction of an irreplaceable army, the relief of a capital, or a timing window no ordinary force can exploit. It is poorly justified when the god fights a battle that mundane troops could win or raids a province worth less than the risk imposed on the entire national plan.

A god is not preserved by refusing every battle. A god is preserved by spending divine risk only where divine power is necessary.

## Part XVI: Reference Checklists



## One-page Pretender worksheet

| Section                           | Decision |
|-----------------------------------|----------|
| Nation and ruleset                |          |
| Lobby assumptions                 |          |
| First military state              |          |
| Expansion method                  |          |
| Chassis and role                  |          |
| Awakening                         |          |
| Initial and maximum dominion plan |          |
| Scale package                     |          |
| Paths and exact purposes          |          |
| Bless package                     |          |
| Sacred recipients per month       |          |
| Blessing access                   |          |
| First research breakpoints        |          |
| First three god orders            |          |
| Temple schedule                   |          |
| God-death and recall plan         |          |
| Principal counters                |          |
| Test results                      |          |

## Monthly dominion audit

- Current maximum dominion.
- Temples until next threshold.
- Friendly-candle core.
- Enemy candle fronts.
- Capitals or Thrones at religious risk.
- Preachers and Inquisitors assigned.
- Blood-sacrifice sites and slave budget.
- Special-dominion damage or benefit.
- Incarnate blessing active or inactive.
- Dominion-immortal safe operating area.

## Bless battle audit

- Sacred units began blessed?
- Which round did Blessing or Divine Blessing resolve?
- Which effects were innate?
- Which effects were Incarnate?
- Was the Pretender alive and present as required?
- Did damage riders require a damaging hit?
- Which effects faced MR?
- Which resistances or sight abilities countered the package?

- Did fatigue, morale, or formation fail first?
- Were the casualties economically replaceable?

## Publication checklist

- State base patch and manual revision.
- State mods and load order.
- Separate manual, current-data, and modded values.
- Name every current-value conflict.
- State awakening assumptions as ranges.
- State sacred throughput.
- State Incarnate dependence.
- State priest and blessing access.
- State god-death consequences.
- Link tests when an edge case decides the recommendation.

# Sources and Open Questions

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## Principal sources

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2, especially Pretender design, Dominion, Divine Magic, Bless Effects, scale effects, Thrones, and Call God.
- [Illwinter Dominions 6 documentation](#).
- [Illwinter Dominions 6 changes](#).
- [Illwinter current release record](#).
- [Official 6.08 Steam announcement](#).
- [Official Dominions 6.36 announcement](#).
- [Current Dominions 6 blessing reference](#).
- [Current Dominions 6 scales reference](#).
- [Current Dominions 6 Pretender reference](#).
- [Current Dominions 6 Pretender-design reference](#), including the 16 June 2026 republication of the awakening model.
- [Loggy's miscellaneous reverse-engineering notes](#), used to trace the awakening formula's pre-Dominions 6 provenance.
- [Current Dominions 6 Elegist reference](#).
- [Published Call God research notes](#).
- [Current Dominions 6 Throne reference](#).
- [Published same-turn Throne claim report](#).
- [Legacy Pretender and awakening mechanics page](#), retained only as a historical test hypothesis where it identifies an older game baseline.
- Dominions 6 Modding Manual 6.34.
- Dominions 6 Inspector, 6.35 data commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.
- Supplied `DomEnhanced2_16.dm`.
- Supplied `Divinitus_1.15.3_DE.dm`.

## Open questions

Cross-source stacking, shape inheritance, mount-transfer lifetime, Order/Turmoil event frequency, economic rounding, awakening distributions, simultaneous-victory ties, and special-dominion inheritance remain assigned to their research registers or controlled tests. Same-turn Throne ownership and the practical Call God model are resolved at their stated mixed evidence tiers. Modded blessing costs and chassis definitions should be taken from [Book IX](#) rather than from older copies of this chapter.

# Foundation Book IV: Armies and Battle

## Why battles need a systems view

Dominions 6 battles are not decided by a single comparison between two armies. They are decided by a sequence of contacts, checks, delays, target choices, damage rolls, fatigue thresholds, morale failures, and retreat outcomes. A force can possess more gold value, more bodies, and more nominal damage yet still lose because it reaches the wrong part of the field, exhausts itself, exposes its commanders, or begins routing before its strength can be applied.

Foundation rule: An army is not a collection of units. It is a timed delivery system for damage, control, morale pressure, and magic.

The early chapters make the Army Setup screen and battle replay readable. Later chapters deal with formation timing, combat arithmetic, counter design, and the difference between winning one battle and preserving a force for the next. The manual explains much of the arithmetic unusually well, but it does not expose every targeting weight, pathfinding choice, cooldown, or rounding step. Hidden values stay labelled as such.

## Edition note

The ruleset and evidence terms come from [Book I](#). [Book IV](#) owns battlefield resolution: hit checks, damage, protection, fatigue, morale, retreat, and the combat side of spellcasting. [Book V](#) uses those rules to build magical strategy rather than printing them again. Exact DE and Divinitus object changes belong to [Book IX](#) and the later nation dossiers.

## Current-version corrections that matter

Several post-manual changes materially affect battle analysis:

| Version | Current rule or correction                                                                      | Practical consequence                                                           |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6.23    | Fear can reduce morale by no more than the Fear value, with an absolute maximum reduction of 10 | Older descriptions can overstate rapid morale collapse                          |
| 6.23    | Floating mounts are no longer impeded by non-floating riders                                    | Mixed rider-and-mount movement should be judged from the current unit           |
| 6.23    | Spellcasters do not receive the multiple-weapon fatigue penalty                                 | Armed mages should not be analysed with the ordinary extra-weapon fatigue rule  |
| 6.25    | Fatigue from flying and trampling was corrected for non-mounted units                           | Old replays or tests may understate the cost of repeated mobility and trampling |
| 6.25    | Battlefield-wide spells cannot normally be cast indoors; holy spells are excepted               | Fort interiors and many assassination fields require different spell plans      |
| 6.31    | Regeneration now follows its percentage accurately rather than old hit-point brackets           | Current healing estimates should use the displayed percentage                   |
| 6.34    | Temporary battle effects are correctly removed from Twiceborn units                             | Persistent-state assumptions from older replays can be wrong                    |
| 6.35    | Innate spellcasters no longer skip their script after recovering from unconsciousness           | Script evaluation for innate casters must use current behaviour                 |

| Version | Current rule or correction                                              | Practical consequence                                                     |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6.35    | Units that automatically regain mounts now do so at the end of the turn | Post-battle mount recovery affects the next turn's readiness              |
| 6.36    | Rust now takes effect even when the attack causes no HP damage          | Zero final damage does not prove that an equipment-degrading rider failed |

Patch corrections do not invalidate the manual's combat structure. They identify the places where an otherwise sound model produces the wrong current result.

## Finding the right section

For the first few battles, concentrate on reading unit cards, forming squads, protecting commanders, placing the line, understanding fatigue and morale, and reviewing the replay. The deeper combat chapters become valuable when a matchup turns on shields, repel, trampling, magic resistance, contact geometry, or a precise rout threshold.

# Part I: What a Battle Decides

## Victory is normally a rout

A Dominions battle is generally fought until one side leaves the field. It is not necessary to kill every enemy. Squads rout when they fail morale checks, all eligible troops rout when their eligible commanders are gone, and an army automatically routs after losing 75% of its weighted total hit points.

This produces four different outcomes that the word "win" can conceal:

| Outcome             | Field result                                                | Strategic result                                     |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Clean victory       | Enemy routs with few friendly losses                        | Force remains ready to expand, raid, or fight again  |
| Pyrrhic victory     | Enemy routs after severe friendly losses                    | Province gained, campaign tempo lost                 |
| Productive defeat   | Friendly force routs after destroying valuable enemy assets | Field lost, exchange may still improve the war       |
| Catastrophic defeat | Command, mages, or retreat routes fail                      | Army value is destroyed rather than merely displaced |

Kills are an incomplete measure. A spell that causes no direct kills may still win by exhausting, immobilising, frightening, or separating an army. A cheap line can succeed by holding long enough for decisive magic, even if it dies. A killer with an impressive summary can still fail strategically by chasing irrelevant bodies while the centre collapses.

## The five layers of battle

Every battle can be read through five layers:

- 1
- Delivery: whether a unit, weapon, spell, or aura reaches a relevant target.
- 2
- Conversion: whether contact becomes a hit, failed resistance check, damage, fatigue, or control effect.

- 3 Persistence: whether the effect survives protection, resistance, regeneration, recovery, or replacement.
- 4 Cohesion: whether squads and command remain functional under casualties, fear, fatigue, and displacement.
- 5 Preservation: whether the surviving force retreats safely, retains mounts and commanders, and can fight again.

Most poor diagnoses stop at conversion: "the weapon could not hurt the armour." Expert diagnosis starts earlier and ends later. The weapon may never have reached the armoured target. The armour may have worked until fatigue enabled armour-defeating hits. The troops may have routed while still physically healthy. The retreat may have converted a recoverable loss into annihilation.

## The open-ended random roll

Dominions commonly uses a DRN, an open-ended two-die roll:

DRN = 2d6, open-ended

When a die shows 6, one is subtracted, the die is rolled again, and the new result is added. Another 6 continues the process. Extreme results are rare, but they remain possible.

The actor normally has to exceed the opposing value. At equal listed values, the actor's chance is about 46%, not 50%, because a tied result fails unless the particular rule awards ties differently.

| Acting value minus opposing value | Approximate success |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------|
| -10                               | 3%                  |
| -8                                | 6%                  |
| -6                                | 11%                 |
| -4                                | 18%                 |
| -2                                | 30%                 |
| 0                                 | 46%                 |
| +2                                | 62%                 |
| +4                                | 76%                 |
| +6                                | 86%                 |
| +8                                | 92%                 |
| +10                               | 95%                 |

This curve creates three lessons:

- small statistical advantages matter;
- no ordinary advantage produces certainty;
- repetition turns modest probability into reliable pressure.

An extra point of Attack, Defence, morale, penetration, or resistance is not a decorative improvement. Its value depends on the current difference and on how many times the comparison occurs.

## Long battles

The ordinary expectation is that one force breaks well before the hard limit. When it does not:

| Battle turn | Event                                                                                                                        |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 100         | Twilight: battle enchantments and temporary magic effects end; berserk ends; Precision suffers -2; Glamour magic receives +1 |
| 150         | Attacker routs; Darkness imposes -3 Attack, Defence, and Precision, or daylight replaces it in a night battle                |
| 170         | Defender routs                                                                                                               |
| 200         | All remaining units are killed                                                                                               |

The attacker carries a long-battle clock. Stall plans, fatigue traps, regeneration contests, and endless summoning must be judged against role and side. A plan that "cannot lose" in ordinary exchanges can still lose to that clock.

## Part II: Reading a Unit

### A stat line is a conditional promise

A unit's displayed statistics describe what it can do before formation, fatigue, leadership, terrain, blesses, spells, injuries, and the enemy intervene. The useful question is not "Is this unit good?" It is:

Under the expected battlefield conditions, which job can this unit perform repeatedly and at acceptable cost?

### The first-pass unit card

For a first evaluation, record:

| Field            | Main question                                                                            |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hit Points       | How much damage can the body absorb, and how does HP weighting affect rout?              |
| Size             | How many fit in a square, what can be reached, displaced, mounted, or trampled?          |
| Strength         | How much melee damage, carrying capacity, siege force, and trample damage is available?  |
| Attack           | How reliably do directed melee attacks beat Defence?                                     |
| Defence          | How reliably are directed melee attacks avoided before harassment and fatigue?           |
| Protection       | How much physical damage is removed, and where are helmet and armour coverage weak?      |
| Precision        | How tightly do missiles and spells cluster around the target square?                     |
| Morale           | How long does the squad remain coherent under losses and fear?                           |
| Magic Resistance | How well are binary magical effects resisted?                                            |
| Encumbrance      | How quickly do attacks and spellcasting degrade the unit?                                |
| Combat Speed     | How quickly does the unit cross the field and finish movement cooldowns?                 |
| Map Move         | How useful is the unit in the campaign rather than one isolated battle?                  |
| Resistances      | Which elemental, poison, sleep, or other damage families are reduced?                    |
| Weapons          | Reach, attack and defence modifiers, damage type, number of attacks, and special effects |

| Field             | Main question                                                             |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Armour and shield | Body and head protection, Defence penalties, Parry, and shield Protection |
| Abilities         | The rules that may dominate the ordinary statistics                       |

## Build the effective line

The displayed line should be converted into an effective line for the planned battle:

effective Attack  
 = displayed Attack  
 + weapon and spell modifiers  
 - fatigue penalty  
 - underwater or injury penalties  
 - multiple-weapon penalty

effective Defence  
 = displayed Defence  
 + weapon and spell modifiers  
 - armour and shield penalties already represented where displayed  
 - fatigue penalty  
 - harassment  
 - rout penalty

The same method applies to morale, protection, speed, and resistance. A Defence 16 unit that expects to reach 60 fatigue and receive six rapid attacks is not a Defence 16 problem. A Protection 20 unit facing armour-negating shock is not a Protection 20 target. A Morale 15 squad led badly, mixed improperly, and placed in a sparse line may begin the battle far below the headline value.

## Roles rather than tiers

Common battlefield roles include:

| Role          | Primary success condition                                               | Common failure                                                   |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Line holder   | Occupies contact space long enough for the plan to mature               | Dies or routs before support resolves                            |
| Damage dealer | Converts attacks into relevant damage quickly                           | Attacks the wrong defence layer or cannot reach                  |
| Flanker       | Reaches exposed sides or rear                                           | Targeting, zones of control, or congestion redirects it          |
| Screen        | Absorbs arrows, charges, spells, or first contact cheaply               | Causes friendly obstruction or premature army rout               |
| Missile unit  | Applies damage or effects before melee contact                          | Range, Precision, shields, armour, or friendly fire              |
| Tramper       | Converts size, speed, and mass into repeated displacement and AP damage | Fatigue, high Defence, anti-large damage, or friendly congestion |
| Bodyguard     | Prevents assassination or rear access to a commander                    | Too few, badly placed, or inappropriate against area effects     |
| Buffer        | Raises friendly effective statistics before contact                     | Casts too late, wrong targets, or is interrupted                 |
| Controller    | Restricts movement, actions, morale, or targeting                       | Resistance, immunity, range, or poor spell selection             |
| Finisher      | Exploits fatigue, rout, or broken protection                            | Arrives before the target is softened                            |
| Summoner      | Adds bodies, time, and replacement HP during battle                     | Exhausts, summons too slowly, or feeds rout weighting            |
| Commander     | Maintains leadership, formation, morale, and orders                     | Exposed command death collapses the army                         |

A unit can occupy several roles, but every additional assumption increases the ways the plan can fail.



## Cost must include the campaign

Gold, resources, Recruitment Points, Holy Points, Commander Points, fort access, mage turns, gems, and map mobility all belong in unit valuation. A body that is exceptionally efficient in one battle may still be a poor campaign unit if it is capital-limited, slow to recruit, unable to reach the front, or dependent on a scarce mage package.

# Part III: Command, Squads, and Army Construction

## Squads are the unit of morale and orders

A commander can lead up to five squads. Each squad receives its own formation, position, and order, and calculates morale separately. Dividing an army into squads is a tactical choice, not clerical organisation.

Splitting troops can:

- produce different target orders;
- stagger contact;
- protect specialised troops behind a screen;
- create flank or rear starting positions;
- prevent one local morale failure from routing every similar unit;
- allow a standard or inspirational commander to support the intended group.

Splitting also carries costs:

- leadership morale bonuses can fall when too many squads are assigned;
- small squads make special morale conditions more relevant;
- more scripts and positions create more opportunities for error;
- a commander's death can still remove every squad under that command from coherent control.

## Leadership and squad morale

The manual defines leadership bands:

| Base Leadership | Squad allowance before penalty | Morale effect                                                     |
|-----------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 10              | One squad already penalised    | -1 with one squad; another -1 to all squads for each extra squad  |
| 50              | Two squads                     | 0 for one or two; -1 to all for each further squad                |
| 100             | Three squads                   | +1 for up to three; each squad above three reduces the bonus by 1 |
| 150             | Four squads                    | +2 for up to four; a fifth reduces all to +1                      |
| 200             | Five squads                    | +3 to all five                                                    |

These morale effects use the commander's base leadership band. Experience can increase capacity without moving the commander into a better morale band.

Experience modifies leadership capacity:

| Experience level | Normal leadership bonus | Poor leader bonus |
|------------------|-------------------------|-------------------|
| 1                | +25                     | +5                |
| 2                | +50                     | +10               |
| 3                | +50                     | +10               |
| 4                | +50                     | +10               |
| 5                | +50                     | +10               |

This distinction matters when a veteran commander can physically hold a large force but still supplies the original weak morale environment.

## Special leadership

Undead and demons require undead leadership. Magic beings require magic leadership. A unit that is both undead and magical uses undead leadership for command.

Mixing categories can reduce morale:

- one undisciplined unit makes the squad undisciplined and imposes -1 morale;
- mixing undead and living units imposes -1 morale;
- mixing demons with ordinary units imposes -1 morale.

An army can fit under the displayed numeric capacity while still being illegally or badly commanded.

## Command redundancy

If every eligible commander is killed or routed, the troops rout. A large army under one fragile commander has a single structural hit point.

Command redundancy asks:

- How many eligible commanders can remain if the front commander dies?
- Are they protected from arrows, flyers, assassins, remote damage, and area effects?
- Are magical, undead, and ordinary troops each backed by the correct leadership?
- If a commander retreats, will its troops have a safe route?
- Does a redundant commander carry enough leadership to prevent an immediate secondary failure?

Redundancy is not obtained merely by adding an unrelated scout. The replacement must be eligible to command the affected units and must survive in a relevant position.

## Standards, inspiration, and taskmasters

Squad morale can receive:

- home-province bonus;
- friendly-dominion bonus;
- leadership-band modifier;
- Inspiration;
- the highest applicable Standard;
- +1 while blessed.

Standards and Inspiration are not substitutes for correct formation and command. They improve the morale comparison after the triggering condition occurs. They do not prevent command death, excessive fatigue, paralysis, or an automatic 75% army rout.

Taskmasters are primarily relevant to slave leadership and the specific units they govern. A label such as "slave", "undisciplined", "mindless", or "magic being" must be read as an engine category with its own command implications, not as flavour text.

The command audit

Before every important battle:

- 1
- Count squads under every commander.
- 2
- Check the commander's base leadership band.
- 3
- Check ordinary, magic, and undead capacity separately.
- 4
- Remove harmful mixing unless it serves a deliberate purpose.
- 5
- Confirm at least one practical command backup.
- 6
- Protect the commanders whose loss triggers the widest collapse.
- 7
- Verify that retreating commanders have friendly destinations.

Part IV: Formation, Density, and Placement

The square

A battlefield square normally holds ten size points. Three size-3 humans fit because nine size points are used. Formation Fighter permits greater density.

Density changes:

- the number of melee attacks that can be delivered from a square;
- vulnerability to area effects, trampling, clouds, and missiles;
- the amount of space occupied by the line;
- congestion behind the line;
- the rate at which replacements reach contact;
- missile hit probability through size points in the target square.

There is no universally best density. Dense troops convert frontage into attacks; sparse troops convert frontage into area coverage and reduced clustering.

Formation types

| Formation   | Shape         | Requirement           | Morale effect | Main use                                      |
|-------------|---------------|-----------------------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Box         | Compact block | Any disciplined squad | 0             | Depth, compact defence, concentrated movement |
| Line        | One rank      | Good commander        | 0             | Maximum frontage and simultaneous contact     |
| Double line | Two ranks     | Good commander        | 0             | Balance of frontage and replacement depth     |

| Formation   | Shape                   | Requirement                   | Morale effect | Main use                                    |
|-------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Sparse line | Line with empty squares | Good commander                | -1            | Wide screen, reduced clustering             |
| Skirmish    | Checkerboard            | Any; forced for undisciplined | -1            | Separation, missile or area-risk management |

Skirmisher removes the -1 morale penalty from skirmish and sparse line. Tight Rein allows a commander's undisciplined units to use disciplined formations and specific orders.

## Frontage and depth

A wide line places more weapons into early contact, which is valuable when:

- the squad wins individual exchanges;
- weapon reach or repel rewards simultaneous coverage;
- the plan needs to envelop a smaller formation;
- the enemy relies on a narrow, high-value centre.

Depth is valuable when:

- the front rank will die or fatigue;
- replacements must sustain a holding action;
- the force is protecting a compact magical core;
- the enemy uses flyers or rearward pressure;
- the formation must absorb displacement.

The trade is temporal. Width spends bodies early. Depth reserves bodies for later.

## Placement is a timing instruction

The Army Setup position determines where a squad begins, not where it is guaranteed to fight. A rear squad on Attack Rear may meet a screening unit. A forward mage can still spend several actions preparing a spell. A fast unit behind a slow block can waste its speed in congestion.

Placement should answer:

- Which squad should make first contact?
- Which should still be unengaged on turns three, five, or ten?
- Which friendly square blocks another unit's path?
- Which commander is visible to flyers or missiles?
- Where will a summoned unit appear relative to the line?
- If the enemy deploys at the opposite extreme, does the timing still work?

## Staggered contact

Staggering is created through position, speed, formation, and Hold orders. It can:

- let buffs resolve before the valuable line enters danger;
- make a cheap screen absorb the first charge;
- prevent every squad from suffering the same opening area spell;
- create fresh troops against an already fatigued enemy;
- keep a finisher away from the initial harassment.

It can also fail by feeding squads separately into a stronger enemy. A stagger is useful only if the earlier wave creates time or degradation that the later wave can exploit.

### Formation checklist

- Does width or depth serve the unit's actual weapon and role?
- Does the chosen formation impose a morale penalty?
- Can the commander legally provide that formation?
- Is friendly congestion likely?
- Does density worsen the expected enemy counter?
- Will rear or flank placement expose command?
- Is the contact schedule robust to enemy deployment on either side?

## Part V: Orders and Scripting

### Squad orders

General squad orders include:

| Order                  | Behaviour                                                                                  |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| None                   | The combat AI decides                                                                      |
| Attack                 | Advance and fight toward the selected target category                                      |
| Fire                   | Use missile weapons against the selected target category                                   |
| Guard Commander        | Remain near and protect the commander; eligible guards may appear in assassination battles |
| Hold and Attack        | Hold for two rounds, firing if able, then attack                                           |
| Hold and Fire          | Hold for two rounds, then fire and move into range as required                             |
| Fire and Keep Distance | Fire while attempting to preserve distance                                                 |
| Retreat                | Behave as routing and attempt to leave                                                     |

The common target categories are:

- none or random;
- Archers;
- Cavalry or fast units;
- Fliers;
- Large Monsters, normally size 7 or greater and otherwise size 6;
- Closest;
- Rearmost.

Target orders express preference rather than a teleporting command. Zones of control, blocked paths, range, target availability, and the unit's current contact can prevent the preferred target from being reached.

## "Rear" is not a destination

Attack Rear selects a rearward target according to the engine's targeting and pathing. It does not guarantee commander assassination. The squad can:

- collide with a screen;
- be caught by zones of control;
- choose a rear troop block rather than a commander;
- take a path altered by obstacles;
- lose its target and retarget.

Rear pressure is a system made from mobility, placement, survival, and target access. The order is one component.

## Hold is exactly two rounds

Hold and Attack and Hold and Fire delay for two rounds. They do not create an indefinite wait. A plan requiring a longer delay must use starting distance, speed, obstacles, spell timing, or a different unit rather than assuming that repeated holding exists for squads.

## Commander scripts

A commander can receive five specific orders followed by a general order.

Specific orders include:

- Hold one turn;
- Hold or Fire a weapon;
- Hold or Cast an AI-selected spell;
- Cast a named spell;
- Attack one turn;
- Fly Attack one turn.

General orders include:

- Stay Behind Troops;
- Attack;
- Cast Spells;
- Advance and Cast;
- Retreat.

If a named spell lacks the required gems or a valid target in range, the caster can fall back to an AI-selected spell. A script is a preferred branch, not an infallible playback.

## Conservative gem use

Conservative gem use makes a mage spend gems sparingly and primarily on scripted spells. It can prevent waste in routine fights, but it can also withhold power from an unscripted emergency. The setting belongs in the battle plan:

- scripted gem expenditure;
- intended post-script behaviour;
- expected enemy strength;
- value of gems compared with the force at risk.

"Save gems" is not automatically conservative when the result is the loss of the mage carrying them.

## Script construction

A robust script is built in this order:

- 1 State the battle objective. Hold, kill, rout, delay, break a siege, extract a raider, or destroy a specific asset.
- 2 State the enemy defence layers. Protection, Defence, shields, resistance, MR, regeneration, size, morale, mobility.
- 3 Assign answers. Each important defence layer needs a delivery mechanism.
- 4 Create the contact schedule. Decide which friendly element meets the enemy first.
- 5 Place enabling effects before dependent effects. Accuracy, resistance, mobility, protection, path boosts, and battlefield conditions often need sequencing.
- 6 Write failure branches. Named spell unavailable, target out of range, caster interrupted, screen destroyed, enemy deploys elsewhere.
- 7 Set gem policy.
- 8 Protect command and retreat.
- 9 Test both attacker and defender sides.

## Timing templates

### Screen and strike

- cheap or resistant screen forward;
- decisive troops delayed or placed behind;
- buffers script enabling effects;
- damage package begins as contact fixes the enemy.

Failure: the screen routs so early that morale or pathing disrupts the strike.

### Armour break

- hold the line;
- apply armour-piercing, armour-negating, rust, Strength, or fatigue pressure;
- commit ordinary damage after the protection layer has been weakened.

Failure: the anti-armour component targets the wrong bodies or arrives after the line collapses.

### Fatigue collapse

- survive early damage;
- impose heat, cold, shock, spell fatigue, trampling cost, repeated attack cost, or exhaustion;
- exploit falling Attack and Defence;
- finish unconscious targets.

Failure: the enemy kills faster than fatigue accumulates or possesses sufficient resistance and reinvigoration.

### Morale break

- cause heavy losses or fear near selected squads;
- remove leadership or standards;

- force repeated checks;
- preserve enough mobile pressure to turn rout into strategic loss.

Failure: mindless, berserk, high-morale, or well-led troops ignore the intended pressure.

### Rear disruption

- occupy the main line;
- send suitable mobile units around or over it;
- threaten fragile command and casters;
- prevent the rear force from being intercepted or stranded.

Failure: Attack Rear is treated as a guarantee rather than a pathfinding preference.

## Script audit

- Are all named spells researched?
- Does each caster have the correct gems?
- Are path boosts active before the spell that requires them?
- Is the target likely to exist and be in range?
- Does the spell work underwater, indoors, in a storm, or in the current plane?
- What does the mage do after the fifth order?
- Will fatigue make the final scripted spell impossible or suicidal?
- Are duplicated battlefield enchantments wasting actions?
- Is every commander protected during preparation time?
- Does the plan survive an enemy Hold, flank deployment, or fast charge?

# Part VI: Movement, Contact, and Time

## Combat speed and cooldown

A move of one square costs roughly one point of combat speed; diagonal movement costs about 50% more. Units act individually. After moving or striking they receive a cooldown. A strike generally creates a long cooldown of about a round; movement creates a shorter cooldown influenced mainly by combat speed with some randomness.

When adjacent units are ready, the one whose cooldown finishes first attacks. Combat speed affects more than time to contact. It influences:

- path crossing;
- replacement into gaps;
- disengaged movement;
- how quickly a unit acts after a step;
- whether a fast unit can exploit a displaced or newly exposed square.

It does not multiply melee attacks as though every point were an attack-speed statistic.

## Zones of control

An adjacent enemy creates a zone of control that normally halts movement. Routing units ignore zones of control.



Zones of control turn screens into spatial tools. A cheap body can stop or redirect a more valuable unit even if it cannot defeat that unit. Conversely, a fast flanker that touches the wrong enemy may lose its strategic role.

## Displacement

A unit at least three size points larger than each displaced unit can enter an otherwise full square by displacing smaller occupants, at an additional cost of one combat-speed point. Non-routing trampleers avoid displacing friendly units because doing so would harm them.

Displacement can:

- break a neat line;
- expose units behind it;
- create congestion;
- change targeting and adjacency;
- move victims even when trample damage is avoided.

## Obstacles and battlefield terrain

Obstacles, gates, walls, caves, water, storms, darkness, and indoor battlefields can alter legal movement and spell use. The manual establishes the large rules but not every pathfinding weight. Exact obstacle navigation belongs to map-specific observation and tests.

Treat battlefield terrain as a component of the script:

- Can the wide line physically deploy?
- Will large units fit through a gate?
- Can flyers operate under the current condition?
- Is the battle indoors, preventing most battlefield-wide magic?
- Does darkness penalise the army more than its opponent?
- Is the weather changing fire, cold, Precision, or storm-dependent abilities?

# Part VII: Melee Resolution

## The hit check

For a directed melee attack:

```
Attack roll = Attack + DRN - fatigue penalty  
Defence roll = Defence + DRN - fatigue penalty
```

The attacker must exceed the defender. The defender wins ties.

Fatigue penalties are:

```
Defence penalty = floor(Fatigue / 10)  
Attack penalty = floor(Fatigue / 20)
```

Defence collapses twice as quickly as Attack. This asymmetry is one reason fatigue turns stable lines into sudden massacres.

## Damage and protection

After a hit:

Damage roll = Strength + weapon Damage + DRN  
 Protection roll = relevant Protection + DRN  
 + shield Protection on a shield hit

Damage is inflicted only when the damage roll exceeds the protection roll.

The displayed damage figure for a weapon may already incorporate Strength and weapon rules in the interface. The formula explains resolution; it should not be used to add Strength twice to a value already presented as final damage.

## Shields: avoidance and absorption

A shield has:

- Defence implications included in the unit's effective Defence;
- a Parry value;
- a Protection value.

If the attack beats Defence but not Defence plus Parry, it is a shield hit and shield Protection is added to the protection roll. If it also beats Defence plus Parry, it is a clean hit and the shield does not add Protection.

Shields create two defensive layers:

- 1 a wider band in which an attack strikes the shield;
- 2 added protection when that occurs.

They are not a flat chance to cancel all attacks.

## Armour-defeating protection rolls

An unusually low protection die can produce an armour-defeating hit that bypasses 25% of protection:

| Target state               | Protection die results that qualify |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Below 50 fatigue           | 2                                   |
| 50 or more fatigue         | 2-3                                 |
| 100 or more fatigue        | 2-4                                 |
| Immobilised or unconscious | Treated as 100 fatigue              |

Protection remains valuable, but fatigue increases the tail risk that heavy armour is partly bypassed. This is another mechanism by which fatigue converts time into lethality.

## Shield damage

Shield resistance is:

shield resistance = shield Protection + 5 if magical

Break force uses the incoming damage before ordinary protection:

- slashing attacks receive +50% for shield breaking;

- blunt attacks receive +25%;
- at three times resistance, the shield is damaged;
- at five times resistance, it breaks;
- a damaged shield hit again has a 25% chance to break.

A damaged shield loses 20% of its Protection; a broken shield loses 50%. Damaged magical shields repair after battle, but a broken magical shield is permanently destroyed. Mundane shields require spare provincial resources for repair.

## Hit locations and reach

The ordinary hit-location distribution is:

| Location | Chance |
|----------|--------|
| Torso    | 50%    |
| Arms     | 20%    |
| Legs     | 20%    |
| Head     | 10%    |

Reach limits which locations can be struck:

- head requires attacker size plus weapon length at least target size;
- torso requires one less;
- arms require two less.

Some low-bodied monsters are easier to reach. An attacker significantly larger than the target shifts the normal distribution toward head hits: head rises to 20% and legs fall to 10%. For mounted attackers, mount size is used for this comparison.

Damage to an arm, leg, or non-essential head is capped at half the target's maximum HP during melee resolution. Location still matters greatly because affliction type and armour coverage depend on it.

## Weapon damage types

| Type                          | Effect                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Blunt                         | +25% damage on head hits before protection; +25% shield-breaking force                                                                |
| Slashing                      | +25% damage after protection; +50% shield-breaking force; can sever a struck limb or head when the hit costs at least half maximum HP |
| Piercing                      | Reduces protection by 15%                                                                                                             |
| Armour Piercing               | Reduces protection by 50%                                                                                                             |
| Piercing plus Armour Piercing | Total protection reduction of 65%                                                                                                     |
| Armour Negating               | Ignores ordinary protection entirely                                                                                                  |

Two-handed weapons add 125% of Strength rather than the ordinary Strength contribution to damage.

Weapons with several damage types can select among them according to the weapon definition. A label such as slash/pierce should not be analysed as if both protection modifications always apply simultaneously.

## Underwater weapon penalties

Underwater:

- slashing and blunt attacks receive an Attack penalty equal to weapon length;
- piercing attacks receive no such penalty;
- mixed piercing weapons halve the penalty;
- flails receive another -1.

A weapon that works well on land can become a liability underwater even when the unit itself can breathe.

## Multiple weapons and attacks

A unit wielding several ordinary weapons suffers an Attack penalty equal to the sum of their lengths. Ambidextrous offsets this penalty. Bonus and natural weapons do not create the ordinary multiple-weapon penalty.

Each additional wielded weapon after the first adds one Encumbrance. Current official rules exempt spellcasters from the multiple-weapon fatigue penalty, but not from every possible attack interaction of the weapons themselves.

Multiple attacks matter because they:

- create more hit checks;
- create more harassment;
- can threaten multiple units;
- trigger more defensive and strikeback effects;
- spend fatigue and expose the attacker to repel interactions.

## Harassment

Every directed melee attack against a unit gives one point of harassment penalty. Each point reduces Defence by one. The penalty decays over time by a percentage rather than disappearing all at once.

- a weapon with multiple attacks gives harassment per attack;
- ranged and area-effect attacks do not;
- rider and mount are separate harassment targets.

Harassment is why a crowd of weak attackers can make a high-Defence elite vulnerable to the attack that matters. The weak attacks need not cause damage to create value.

The precise Dominions 6 decay function is not stated in the manual. A published Dominions 5 result multiplied the remaining penalty by 95% every 16/375 of a round, removing roughly 70% over a fully idle round. That old value is a useful regression-test hypothesis, not a Dominions 6 rule. Edition 27 leaves the current decay test pending.

## Repel

When the defender's weapon is longer, it automatically attempts to repel the directed melee attack.

The sequence is:

- 1 a repel attack-and-defence comparison occurs;
- 2 if the repel attack would hit, the attacker makes a morale comparison;
- 3 failure aborts the attack;
- 4 success permits a repel damage roll;
- 5 if the repel causes any damage, it is capped at one and the original attack then continues.

The morale comparison is:

```
attacker = Morale + DRN - weapon-length difference  
repeller = 10 + DRN + half the margin by which the repel attack won
```

The repelling unit acquires a lingering -2 repel penalty after repeated repel attempts; it decays with time. Size-6 or larger giants count their weapons as one length longer for repel.

Repel combines Attack, weapon length, morale, and tempo. A long weapon on an inaccurate, exhausted unit is not automatically good at repelling attacks.

## Melee resolution order

The manual gives this useful order:

- 1 Determine target, including rider or mount.
- 2 Resolve early strikeback effects such as Awe or petrifying gaze; abort if the attacker becomes immobilised.
- 3 Resolve repel.
- 4 Resolve later strikeback effects such as Slimer, Sight Vengeance, or Horror Mark Attacker; abort if immobilised.
- 5 Resolve Attack against Defence.
- 6 Resolve damage against protection.
- 7 Resolve defensive abilities such as Mirror Image, Protective Force, Luck, or Mossbody.
- 8 Apply limb damage cap.
- 9 Apply redistribution such as Damage Reversal, Blood Bond, or Vengeance.
- 10 Deal damage, including shield consequences.

If damage redistribution kills the attacker at step nine, the attack is not retroactively cancelled.

# Part VIII: Missiles and Ranged Delivery

## Deviation

A projectile begins to deviate when range exceeds roughly half Precision minus two.

The manual gives:

```
deviation = range x 1.25 / Precision
```

Precision above 10 receives double value for the excess: Precision 12 is treated as 14 for this purpose.

The formula is best read as expected scatter around a targeted square rather than a direct chance to hit one individual.

## The square hit check

After a projectile reaches a square, a target is selected with size weighting. The hit comparison is:

```
attacker = DRN + half the size points in the square + 2 if the weapon is magical  
defender = DRN + twice shield Parry - Fatigue / 20
```

The attacker must exceed the defender.

This produces several non-obvious results:

- crowded squares are easier to hit;
- large bodies attract more hits within a square;
- shields are central missile defence;
- fatigue reduces missile defence;
- magical missiles gain accuracy at the square-hit stage.

## Ranged damage

Missile damage then uses the ordinary damage-versus-protection structure. Many missiles add half Strength rather than full Strength. Crossbows and similar weapons often gain armour-piercing properties. Lightning is commonly armour negating; fire is commonly armour piercing. The actual weapon definition controls the result.

Missiles can hit friendly units. Screens, line width, range, and the timing of melee contact all affect friendly-fire risk.

## Evaluating archery

Archery value is the product of:

```
number of shots  
x probability of relevant square delivery  
x probability of hitting a body  
x probability of defeating protection  
x strategic value of the target
```

"Many arrows" can be useful without many kills if they:

- damage shields;
- interrupt casters;
- inflict poison or elemental effects;
- remove fragile command;
- force the enemy into a resistant but less efficient composition.

They can also be almost irrelevant against the wrong armour and shield layer.

## Ranged audit

- Is the target category likely to select the intended units?
- Is range beyond the accurate envelope?
- Are friendly troops about to enter the target squares?

- Are shields, Air Shield, protection, resistance, or mist negating the package?
- Does ammunition last long enough?
- Does Hold and Fire change the contact schedule usefully?
- Would a wider or sparser formation improve delivery or survival?

# Part IX: Mounts, Trampling, and Size

## Rider and mount are separate

Dominions 6 treats rider and mount as separate targets with separate HP, statistics, attacks, morale interactions, and afflictions. Area effects and lightning can hit both.

An evaluation of cavalry asks:

- what protects the rider;
- what protects the mount;
- which attacks each performs;
- what happens if one component routs or dies;
- whether equipment affects one or both;
- how replacement and mount recovery work after battle.

## Hitting mounted units

The mount becomes more likely to be targeted when much larger than the rider:

| Mount size advantage | Additional mount targeting rule |
|----------------------|---------------------------------|
| 3                    | 25%                             |
| 4                    | 50%                             |
| 5 or more            | 75%                             |

Otherwise:

- missiles have a 50% chance to target the mount;
- if mount size is at least reach plus two, the mount is targeted;
- otherwise mount chance is  $30\% + 10\% \times \text{mount size} - 10\% \times \text{reach}$ , with a 10% minimum.

Trample always targets the mount. Area effects and lightning hit both components.

These targeting rules are official. The remaining mounted research question concerns carry, mixed-component movement, and the order in which every exceptional modifier is applied; it no longer treats ordinary target selection as wholly unknown.

## Mounted combat

Both rider and mount can attack. A rider using a two-handed weapon while mounted receives -3 Attack. Skilled Rider improves the mount's morale and Defence; the amount of usable Defence is affected by mount armour Encumbrance.

Magic items on the rider do not automatically apply every effect to the mount. The item or effect must say so. Mount armour uses the barding slot where available.

## Mounted morale

Fear can affect rider and mount. If the rider routs, the mount leaves with the rider. If only the mount breaks, the rider can be thrown and the mount routs. Falling damage is an open-ended armour-negating comparison based on size difference; chariots avoid ordinary falling damage.

A normal riderless mount routs. A mount with the relevant bravery can remain. The battle summary and replay should be inspected at component level because "cavalry loss" may mean a dead rider, lost mount, or temporary separation.

## Mount recovery

A surviving rider without a mount can claim a matching riderless mount. Otherwise the rider returns home and can be recruited again at half cost while retaining identity, experience, and afflictions. Suitable intelligent mounts can return in a similar fashion.

Mounted commanders remain and can use Reclaim Mount or claim a suitable unit. Some units automatically regain mounts. As of 6.35, automatic recovery occurs at the end of the turn, ensuring the new turn begins mounted.

## Trampling

A trampler entering a square displaces the smaller units to adjacent squares. Each victim checks:

Defence - floor(Fatigue / 10) against 3d6

On failure:

trample damage = 7 + trampler Size

The damage is armour piercing. An ethereal trampler deals half normal trample damage. A victim that passes the Defence check is still displaced and takes one damage. A trampled unit always takes at least one damage regardless of protection.

Trampling is simultaneously:

- movement;
- displacement;
- repeated Defence pressure;
- armour-piercing damage;
- fatigue expenditure;
- formation disruption.

## Trample failure modes

Tramplers are vulnerable to:

- high Defence before fatigue;
- targets too large to trample;
- anti-large weapons and concentrated damage;
- cold, shock, and other fatigue pressure;
- poor morale;
- congestion around friendly troops;
- repeated trampling cost;
- mount targeting when the trampler is a mount.



Trampling weak units can look dominant while exhausting the trampler for the decisive contact.

## Part X: Fatigue, Recovery, and Collapse

### The hidden battle economy

Fatigue is a stock accumulated by actions and effects. It reduces combat performance before it causes unconsciousness:

```
Defence penalty = floor(Fatigue / 10)
Attack penalty = floor(Fatigue / 20)
```

At 50 fatigue, Defence has fallen by 5 and Attack by 2. At 90, the penalties are 9 and 4. A unit can remain upright while its original stat line has ceased to exist.

### Gaining fatigue

Ordinary melee attacks add current Encumbrance. Spellcasting adds:

```
listed spell fatigue / (1 + path skill above minimum)
+ base Encumbrance
+ twice armour Encumbrance
```

The listed spell component is divided by excess path skill. The Encumbrance component is not.

Other sources include:

- flying and trampling;
- heat or cold effects;
- shock and fatigue damage;
- bleeding;
- special weapons, spells, and auras;
- extreme battlefield conditions.

### Thresholds

| Fatigue         | Consequence                                              |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Every 10        | -1 Defence                                               |
| Every 20        | -1 Attack                                                |
| 50+             | More protection rolls can become armour defeating        |
| 100             | Unit falls unconscious                                   |
| Below 100 again | Unit can regain consciousness                            |
| 200             | Additional fatigue damage begins converting to HP damage |

An unconscious unit recovers five fatigue per turn until it falls below 100. Reinvigoration and battle effects can accelerate recovery according to their rules. The manual does not fully specify ordinary recovery while a unit remains active.

The current community reference states that every active unit removes one fatigue per combat round and then adds its Reinvigoration. This is the best current working rule, but the page does not publish a version-matched frame-by-frame reproduction. Edition 27 therefore labels it current community reference, while the five-point unconscious rule remains official.

At 200 fatigue, each further 50 fatigue damage produces one HP damage. A smaller remainder produces a chance equal to two percent per fatigue point.

## Fatigue as offence

Fatigue warfare can defeat protection without directly ignoring it:

- 1 Defence falls.
- 2 More attacks hit.
- 3 Armour-defeating protection results become more frequent.
- 4 The unit falls unconscious.
- 5 Further fatigue converts into damage.
- 6 The stationary target receives concentrated attacks.

This is why reinvigoration, low Encumbrance, resistance, and relief effects are offensive enablers as well as defensive statistics.

## Fatigue budget

For a key unit, estimate:

```
starting fatigue
+ scripted action costs
+ expected contact costs
+ environmental and enemy pressure
- recovery
= fatigue at decisive turn
```

The number need not be exact to expose a bad plan. A mage expected to cast five expensive spells in heavy armour or a trampler expected to cross the field and overrun many squares may already be committed past useful performance.

# Part XI: Morale, Fear, Rout, and Retreat

## Squad morale

Squad morale begins from the members' average and receives applicable modifiers:

- +1 in the home province;
- +1 in friendly dominion;
- leadership-band modifier;
- Inspiration;
- the highest applicable Standard;
- +1 while blessed;
- temporary magic morale.

Magic morale can range from -10 to +1. Negative magic morale recovers gradually, approximately one point every two rounds; positive magic morale persists.

## When squads check

A squad can check morale when:

- it suffers heavy losses since its last check and has at least 20% overall casualties;
- it has four or fewer members and any member is damaged that round;
- it is exposed to nearby Fear;
- Terror or a similar effect forces a check;
- the army has lost at least 50% of its weighted total HP, causing checks each turn thereafter.

At most one ordinary morale check occurs for a squad in a round.

For this purpose, a wound is a damage event that leaves a unit at no more than 80% of normal HP. Heavy losses are one wound per two squad members.

## The morale comparison

The manual gives:

morale roll = squad Morale + DRN + survivor bonus from 0 to 5  
fear roll = 14 + DRN

The squad routs when the fear roll is greater. Under this wording, a tie is safe.

The current community formula is:

survivor bonus = nearest whole number of  
(5 x surviving proportion of the original squad)

That matches the manual's 0-5 description, but the published page does not supply a current raw test set and notes uncertainty for commanders. Edition 27 therefore records the formula as a current community reference, not an official or reproduced result. Boundary rounding and commander handling remain test pending.

## Army-level rout

At 50% weighted army HP loss, surviving squads begin checking every turn. At 75%, the army automatically routs.

The army total weights some bodies differently:

| Body type        | HP weight |
|------------------|-----------|
| Ordinary unit    | 100%      |
| Mount            | 25%       |
| Province Defence | 25%       |
| Slave            | 50%       |

This weighting affects how a screen, summon, mount, or PD contingent contributes to army-wide collapse. It does not tell whether that body is tactically useful.

## Fear

Fear can reduce magic morale and force squad or individual checks. Current official rules cap morale reduction at the Fear effect's value and at an absolute ten points.

Fear is strongest when combined with:

- existing casualties;
- command loss;
- fatigue;
- weak leadership;
- small squads;
- blocked or dangerous retreat.

It is weaker against mindless units, berserk behaviour, high morale, strong leadership, and effects that prevent or mitigate fear.

Frighten-like limited effects can reduce morale by no more than their stated amount and do not automatically create every broader Fear interaction. Exact effect text matters.

## Routing units

A routing unit suffers -4 Defence and spends its activity moving toward a friendly battlefield edge. It ignores zones of control. Poison, burning, bleeding, and similar pending damage can still kill it after it leaves.

Mindless units do not rout normally. Without eligible leadership, they can become immobile, attack adjacent enemies, and have a one-third chance per turn to dissolve. Magic or undead troops without the required leadership rout.

## Retreat destination

Each commander has a 75% chance to make a smart retreat. A commander in native terrain receives a second 50% chance after failure.

A smart commander:

- retreats into a friendly fort in the same province if available;
- otherwise chooses a random friendly adjacent province.

A failed smart retreat chooses a random adjacent province, including an enemy province. A unit retreating into enemy territory is killed.

Troops attempt to follow their commander with a morale check:

- squad morale bonus counts double;
- undisciplined units suffer -3;
- skirmish morale penalty applies.

Leaderless troops or troops that fail to follow make individual smart checks at 50%, with the native-terrain second chance still applying.

## Retreat while defending a fort

Units retreating while defending their fort hide inside if the battle is won and they made a smart retreat. If the battle is lost, all such units are killed. Non-smart defenders are killed. Commanders are always smart in this special case, and lone units gain another 50% opportunity.

## Preservation audit

Before committing:

- Which adjacent provinces are friendly?
- Is a friendly fort available?
- Are retreat provinces likely to be cut this turn?
- Are commanders native to the terrain?
- Are undisciplined troops likely to follow?
- Will poison, burning, or bleeding kill retreaters?
- Is a fort defence an all-or-nothing trap?
- Does a nominal victory preserve the force for the next operation?

# Part XII: Resistances and Special Damage

## Resistance

Elemental resistance works like an additional protection layer against its damage family, followed by percentage reduction. Each point corresponds to twice that percentage; resistance 50 gives immunity.

For elemental fatigue effects, resistance counts at double strength when reducing the fatigue component.

Resistance is not interchangeable with protection:

- armour negation can ignore protection but not the relevant resistance;
- poison resistance reduces initial poison application but not the later duration of poison already received;
- immunity thresholds and special interactions differ by damage family.

## Fire and burning

Fire is commonly armour piercing. The chance to catch fire is:

pre-protection fire damage x 4%

Fire fatigue counts as one-third for this ignition calculation.

A burning unit suffers  $(1dSize) / 2$  damage, rounded up, each round: a size-8 unit rolls 1d8, then halves the result. Fire Resistance 5 halves burning damage. The chance to extinguish is:

25% + Fire Resistance + 5% per Cold scale + 100% in rain

with a minimum of 1%. Fire vulnerability is negative resistance. Fire Resistance 10 or more, chill aura, Mistform, and Ethereal prevent burning.

## Cold and freezing

A freezing unit suffers 2d6 additional fatigue each round until it thaws.

The thaw chance is:

25% + Cold Resistance + 5% per Heat scale

with a minimum of 1%. Cold Resistance 10 or more, heat aura, and Ethereal prevent freezing.

Fire and cold affect both damage and fatigue.

## Bleeding

Profuse bleeding inflicts:

10 fatigue + 5% of maximum HP per round

The chance to stop is 10% plus regeneration. Underwater combat halves the chance that bleeding stops; it does not halve the listed damage.

## Poison

Poison is stored and then applied over time, approximately ten percent of the remaining total per round as evenly as possible.

Poison also reduces Attack and Defence by 25% for each full maximum-HP dose currently stored, capped at 50%. The penalty falls as stored poison is consumed.

Poison Resistance reduces the initial amount. It does not shorten poison already received.

This delay makes poison strategically unusual:

- the victim may win the immediate exchange and die afterward;
- battle summaries can conceal post-contact lethality;
- retreating poison victims can be lost after leaving;
- regeneration and healing do not simply erase the stored schedule.

## Shock and stun

Shock can stun. The chance is:

5% + half the percentage of maximum HP lost to the hit

Shock Resistance protects against shock damage and receives the elemental-resistance treatment against fatigue effects. Twist Fate and similar effects must be evaluated with current patch behaviour rather than old assumptions.

## Acid and rust

Iron equipment can rust:

- rust chance is pre-protection acid damage times 4%;
- armour can be damaged based on damage before armour after shield interaction;
- rusty weapons have a chance to become damaged when used.

A damaged weapon suffers -2 damage, or -1 if blunt. Rust converts repeated minor exposure into declining equipment quality. Since 6.36, the rust effect can apply even when the attack causes no HP damage; inspect equipment state rather than using the health bar as a proxy for the secondary effect.

## Life drain

Full life drain:

- heals half the damage;
- removes fatigue equal to twice the damage;
- can raise HP to 150% of maximum plus ten.

Weapons with partial life drain treat only the first five points of damage as drain; further damage is ordinary. Lifeless targets take only 25% of the post-protection drain result and do not heal the attacker. A lifeless attacker can still receive the ordinary benefit of its own life-draining attack.

## Paralysis

Paralysis duration is:

$$(\text{damage} - \text{Size}) / 2$$

Repeated paralysis uses the larger duration and can add limited damage from the overlap. Size acts as a defence even when ordinary protection is not the main check.

## False damage

Illusions and many Glamour effects cause false damage. It:

- can kill when real plus false damage reaches HP;
- causes no ordinary afflictions except death;
- is not healed by regeneration, life drain, or ordinary healing;
- does not trigger Damage Reversal, Blood Vengeance, or Blood Bond;
- dissipates at two per round if all enemy Glamour mages are dead.

Current official rules make false damage count toward HP-based rout. A force can be routed by damage that later disappears.

## Clouds and auras

Cloud effects are armour negating and decay by roughly one level per round. Clouds of the same type do not ordinarily overlap; they spread and can increase level only within their limits. Heat and frost clouds cancel one another.

Monster auras commonly create level-one clouds that can accumulate to level two. Spells and items can create stronger clouds.

Clouds transform position and time into damage. The important questions are:

- who occupies the square;
- how long they remain;
- what resistance applies;
- whether the cloud moves, spreads, cancels, or decays;
- whether friendly troops are also exposed.

# Part XIII: Afflictions, Regeneration, and Lasting Loss

## Affliction chance

When a hit causes damage, the basic chance of an affliction equals the percentage of maximum HP lost to that blow. A hit taking 20% of maximum HP produces a 20% base chance. Damage beyond 100% can produce several affliction opportunities.

The chance that an affliction is major is:

affliction chance / 1.5

capped at 33%.

Regeneration reduces affliction risk. Since 6.31, regeneration follows its displayed percentage accurately rather than the older HP brackets.

## Location pools

| Location | Minor examples                   | Major examples                |
|----------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Any      | Battle Fright, Profuse Bleeding  | -                             |
| Head     | Eye Loss, Mute                   | Dementia, Feebleminded, Blind |
| Chest    | Chest Wound, Never-Healing Wound | Diseased                      |
| Arm      | Weakened                         | Lost Arm                      |
| Leg      | Limp                             | Crippled                      |

Profuse Bleeding is temporary. Most other afflictions persist until an eligible healing mechanism succeeds.

## Campaign consequences

Affliction valuation depends on the unit:

- lost limbs can remove weapons or slots;
- lost eyes impair Precision and combat;
- feeblemindedness can destroy a mage's strategic value;
- battle fright undermines command and morale;
- limp and cripple reduce map movement;
- disease creates ongoing attrition.

Troops with a limp can become crippled during long marches. Crippled troops can die while marching. An army that wins but accumulates movement injuries may cease to be an operational army.



## Healing categories

Recuperation, healer abilities, immortality interactions, transformation, and specific sites or spells do not all heal the same afflictions under the same conditions. Undead and lifeless beings are commonly excluded from ordinary affliction healing. Item-caused afflictions can require removal of the item.

The safe method is to inspect the exact ability and target category rather than use "healing" as one universal mechanic.

## Part XIV: Battle Magic within the Army

### Scope

The complete spell, communion, ritual, and research system belongs in Foundation [Book V](#). This part establishes the combat mechanics required to understand an army that includes mages.

### Preparation and recovery

Most spells have a casting time of about one round:

- approximately half is preparation;
- approximately half is recovery.

Battle enchantments and gem-costing spells often take longer. If the caster is damaged during preparation, interruption chance is:

percentage of maximum HP lost + 25%

Combat Caster and Mindless halve this chance. Innate spellcasters require no preparation and ignore ordinary casting-time differences. As of 6.35, an innate caster that falls unconscious and later recovers continues its script correctly.

### Spell accuracy

Spell delivery resembles missile delivery:

spell aiming Precision = caster Precision + spell Precision

Range, scatter, target-square density, area, and friendly position all matter. A spell with excellent listed damage can be a poor answer if it arrives late, lands unpredictably, or covers the wrong area.

### Magic resistance

When "Magic resistance negates" applies:

caster penetration  
= 11 + DRN + half additional skill above the spell requirement

target resistance  
= Magic Resistance + DRN + half target skill in the spell path

The caster wins ties.

"Easily negates" gives the caster -4 penetration. "Hard to resist" gives +4.

Excess path skill and relevant boosters improve penetration, while path-skilled targets can receive extra resistance against effects in that path.

## Spell fatigue

For a spell with listed fatigue:

```
path fatigue
= listed fatigue / (1 + caster skill - minimum required skill)

casting encumbrance
= base Encumbrance + 2 x armour Encumbrance
```

The Encumbrance cost is paid per cast and is not reduced by excess skill. Heavy armour can make a high-path mage collapse even when the printed spell cost appears manageable.

## Battle enchantments

Battle enchantments can affect the whole battlefield or continuously alter the battle. They end when their caster dies. At Twilight, all battle enchantments and temporary magical effects are removed.

Current indoor rules prevent most battlefield-wide spells from being cast indoors; holy battlefield-wide spells are excepted. A fort-storming plan must distinguish gate, exterior, and interior conditions.

## Magic as a package

A useful battlefield-magic package identifies:

| Component  | Question                                                             |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Research   | Is every required spell available now?                               |
| Access     | Which mages can cast it without hypothetical boosters?               |
| Gems       | How many battles can the package sustain?                            |
| Timing     | On which turn does each effect resolve?                              |
| Delivery   | Which square or target category receives it?                         |
| Protection | How does the caster survive preparation?                             |
| Fatigue    | What remains after the script?                                       |
| Redundancy | What happens if one caster dies or is interrupted?                   |
| Counter    | Which resistance, battlefield condition, or enemy script defeats it? |

## The fifth-order problem

After five specific orders, the general order governs. Many battle plans are excellent for five actions and incoherent thereafter. The post-script state must be designed:

- should the mage remain behind troops;
- advance to reach targets;
- continue casting;
- conserve gems;
- retreat after a task;
- avoid walking into melee?

The sixth action is often where a nominal support mage becomes an expensive casualty.

## Part XV: Sieges, Storming, and Battle Context

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### Siege arithmetic

The wall-reduction formulas, repair modifiers, and supply progression belong to [Book II](#) and the field reference. [Book IV](#) begins where the battle problem starts: only the correct siege orders contribute, and reaching zero wall integrity makes storming available on the next relevant order.

### Storm sequence

Storming occurs after any other battle in the province. A relieving or intercepting battle can weaken or destroy the besieger before the fort assault.

If a commander ordered to Storm Castle is killed before the storming battle, troops under that commander do not participate in the storm.

This creates a two-battle problem:

- preserve storm commanders through the exterior battle;
- retain enough force and scripting for the fort battle;
- account for changed gems, fatigue resets, casualties, and command structure;
- respect indoor restrictions.

### Gates and constrained contact

Fort battles compress frontage and change pathing. Large formations can be delayed by gates, while concentrated area effects can gain value. Exact fort layouts vary and should be inspected in the replay or test game.

A storm script copied from an open field is suspect until it answers:

- which units pass through the gate first;
- where the command core begins;
- whether battlefield-wide magic is legal;
- how defenders exploit interior depth;
- where retreating defenders go.

### Siege supply

A fort's storage is divided by the number of consecutive siege turns. Storage 300 yields 300, 150, 100, 75, then 60 supply in the first five months. Starvation and disease can weaken a garrison before the storm without changing its roster.

The battle card should include starvation, disease, fatigue-related afflictions, and any shortage of replacement equipment.

# Part XVI: Counter Construction

## Counters are layered

A counter should state which layer it attacks:

| Enemy layer              | Candidate answers                                                                   |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| High Defence             | Harassment, area effects, trampling, immobilisation, fatigue                        |
| High Protection          | Armour piercing, armour negating, Strength, rust, fatigue, MR effects               |
| Shields                  | High Attack for clean hits, shield breaking, area effects, armour negation          |
| Regeneration             | Burst damage, decay, disease where applicable, paralysis, control, morale           |
| High MR                  | More penetration, non-MR damage, fatigue, mundane control                           |
| Elemental resistance     | Different damage family, physical damage, MR effects, morale                        |
| Massed low-HP troops     | Area damage, clouds, trampling, fear                                                |
| Giants                   | Anti-large damage, repeated attacks, control, poison where relevant                 |
| Flyers and rear pressure | Bodyguards, rear screens, protected redundancy, anti-air or area control            |
| Mages                    | Fast contact, missiles, interruption, assassins, battlefield conditions, resistance |
| Summon spam              | Area damage, fatigue control, source elimination, long-battle clock                 |
| Fear                     | Morale, leadership, standards, mindless or berserk counters, source removal         |
| Tramplers                | Defence, size, fatigue, anti-large damage, spacing                                  |

The counter must then pass four tests:

- 1 Access: the nation can produce it in time.
- 2 Delivery: it reaches the intended target.
- 3 Scale: enough instances exist for the enemy force.
- 4 Survival: it remains functional until its work is done.

## Avoid nominal counters

An armour-negating spell is not a counter to armour if:

- research is not complete;
- only one fragile caster can use it;
- the caster lacks range;
- the target resists or kills the caster first;
- the gem cost cannot be sustained;
- the spell AI selects something else;
- indoor conditions prohibit the package.

The correct unit of strategy is the delivered package, not the tooltip.

## Counter-counter planning

After selecting the answer, ask how the opponent adapts:

- changes formation;
- adds resistance;
- changes deployment;
- attacks the caster;
- uses decoys;
- splits the army;
- changes battlefield conditions;
- refuses the battle.

An expert plan is not one unbeatable script. It is a branch with a tolerable response to the most likely counter.

## Part XVII: Battle Replay as Evidence

### Why the summary is insufficient

The summary reports numbers present, kills, and losses. It does not by itself explain:

- who made first contact;
- which spells were interrupted;
- where fatigue crossed a threshold;
- whether a shield or resistance worked;
- which squad failed morale first;
- why a target order redirected;
- whether a commander or mount died before the apparent collapse;
- which damage occurred after retreat.

Kills reward the last damaging event, not every enabling action.

### First replay method

For a new player:

- 1 Pause at deployment.
- 2 Use F1 to inspect all units and commanders.
- 3 Use F2 to inspect weather and dominion.
- 4 Identify the first-contact squads.
- 5 Watch once at normal speed without chasing individuals.
- 6 Watch again with battle-log detail increased.
- 7 Select a key unit and use its combat log.
- 8 Record the first irreversible failure.

Useful replay controls include pause, speed changes, grid display, F1 unit list, F2 weather and dominion, and battle-log detail levels one through four.

## The first irreversible failure

The decisive event is often earlier than the visible rout:

- a buff was interrupted;
- a screen made contact one round early;
- a commander stood inside an area effect;
- tramlers became exhausted on decoys;
- missiles stopped when melee geometry changed;
- an MR spell failed repeatedly;
- a squad's leadership penalty lowered its margin;
- a retreat province was enemy-controlled.

Finding the earliest event that made later failure likely produces a reusable lesson. Recording only the final kill does not.

## Replay worksheet

| Stage            | Record                                                         |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Deployment       | Side, positions, formations, squad sizes, command              |
| Conditions       | Weather, scales, darkness, storm, indoor or underwater         |
| Opening          | First spells, first shots, first movement                      |
| Contact          | Turn and location of each squad's contact                      |
| Degradation      | Fatigue, poison, rust, afflictions, lost mounts, shield damage |
| Cohesion         | First morale check, first rout, commander loss                 |
| Resolution       | Automatic rout, long-battle event, or decisive destruction     |
| Retreat          | Destinations, post-retreat deaths, trapped units               |
| Strategic result | Province, gems, mages, commanders, readiness next turn         |

## Do not learn from one roll

Open-ended dice produce tails. A controlled comparison should be repeated enough times to distinguish a structural advantage from one improbable result. The goal is not to eliminate randomness. It is to learn whether the plan remains acceptable across it.

# Part XVIII: Active Mod Ruleset

## What the supplied files establish

The frozen combined ruleset loads:

- 1 DomEnhanced2\_16.dm;
- 2 Divinitus\_1.15.3\_DE.dm.

Direct source counts demonstrate the scale of object-level battle changes.

| Command family             | DE 2.16 | Divinitus 1.15.3 DE |
|----------------------------|---------|---------------------|
| New monsters               | 3,553   | 346                 |
| Selected existing monsters | 4,227   | 373                 |
| New weapons                | 389     | 34                  |
| Selected existing weapons  | 142     | 0                   |
| Selected spells            | 2,816   | 17                  |
| New spell blocks           | 0       | 26                  |
| Attack edits               | 2,038   | 276                 |
| Defence edits              | 2,114   | 278                 |
| Protection edits           | 1,612   | 238                 |
| Morale edits               | 1,692   | 229                 |
| Encumbrance edits          | 1,186   | 163                 |
| Mount assignments          | 178     | 9                   |
| Skilled Rider edits        | 437     | 1                   |
| Trample assignments        | 39      | 12                  |

Counts are syntactic occurrences, not numbers of distinct final objects. Repeated selections, copied statistics, inherited fields, and later load-order edits can change the effective count.

## What the files do not establish

The supplied .dm files create and alter monsters, weapons, spells, items, sites, nations, blessings, and object abilities. They do not present a global rewrite of the engine's DRN, ordinary Attack-versus-Defence equation, ten-size-point square capacity, 75% army-rout rule, or general retreat algorithm.

Accordingly:

- the foundation mechanics remain the starting model;
- every unit, weapon, spell, mount, and Pretender must be read from the effective combined data;
- unmodded balance conclusions cannot be transferred merely because the core formula is unchanged;
- Divinitus loads second and can overwrite shared selections made by DE.

## Modded battle-analysis rule

For a combined guide:

```
engine mechanic
+ effective DE object
+ later Divinitus overwrite
+ national availability
+ current patch correction
= claim that can be published
```

The name of an object is not enough. A DE or Divinitus version may share a familiar name while changing damage, paths, fatigue, attack count, resistances, abilities, or recruitment.

## Foundation versus faction work

Book IV does not declare any specific modded faction or god optimal. It supplies the method used later:

- 1 extract the final combined roster;
- 2 classify roles;
- 3 calculate effective combat lines;
- 4 build packages;
- 5 test scripts;
- 6 record match-ups and counters.

# Part XIX: Controlled-Test Programme

## Test standard

Every test record should include:

- Dominions version;
- exact mod list and load order;
- map and province;
- attacker and defender;
- unit IDs and quantities;
- commander statistics and orders;
- formations and positions;
- gems and items;
- weather, scales, dominion, terrain, and indoor state;
- random seed if available;
- number of repetitions;
- result distribution;
- replay or log notes.

Change one important variable at a time.

## Test 1: DRN tie direction

Purpose: verify tie behaviour in Attack, MR, and morale checks.

Method:

- create equal-value opposed cases;
- use the highest battle-log detail;
- record explicit equal totals;
- confirm which side wins each rule's tie.

## Test 2: Harassment decay

Purpose: measure the hidden decay rate.

Method:

- expose one high-Defence unit to a known burst of harmless directed attacks;



- stop new attacks through controlled spacing;
- inspect Defence or logs over time;
- repeat across different initial penalties.
- compare the result with the historical Dominions 5 hypothesis of a 5% reduction every 16/375 of a round without assuming that value survived into Dominions 6.

## Test 3: Cooldown and combat speed

Purpose: distinguish movement time, recovery, and attack cadence.

Method:

- compare otherwise identical units with controlled Combat Speed;
- record timestamps for steps and attacks;
- repeat with diagonal movement and no movement.

## Test 4: Formation Fighter density

Purpose: document exact square capacity at several ability values and sizes.

Method:

- deploy uniform squads in each formation;
- count bodies per square;
- repeat with mixed sizes.

## Test 5: Repel sequence

Purpose: confirm current repel bonuses, lingering penalty, giant length, and magic-weapon interaction.

Method:

- use non-damaging or highly protected targets;
- vary weapon length, Attack, morale, size, and interval between attacks;
- record repel rolls at log level four.

## Test 6: Shield damage and repair

Purpose: verify current rounding and post-battle repair.

Method:

- strike known mundane and magical shields with controlled slash and blunt damage;
- record damaged and broken thresholds;
- vary available provincial resources;
- inspect the next turn.

## Test 7: Mounted targeting

Purpose: reproduce target weights for rider, mount, reach, missiles, and area effects.

Method:

- use fixed rider size and several mount sizes;
- count hundreds of directed attacks;
- repeat with different weapon lengths and missiles.

## Test 8: Trample fatigue

Purpose: measure current flying and trampling fatigue after the 6.25 correction.

Method:

- compare mounted and non-mounted tramplers;
- control Encumbrance, distance, number of victims, and resistance;
- record fatigue per displacement.

## Test 9: Morale survivor bonus

Purpose: derive the manual's 0-5 survivor bonus.

Method:

- create squads at controlled original and remaining sizes;
- force identical checks;
- extract morale totals from detailed logs;
- test the current community hypothesis round( $5 \times$  surviving proportion) at every rounding boundary;
- test commanders separately from squads.

## Test 10: Army HP rout weights

Purpose: verify mounts, slaves, and PD weighting in mixed armies.

Method:

- construct armies with one weighted category at a time;
- cause controlled casualties;
- record the first 50% checks and 75% automatic rout.

## Test 11: Retreat intelligence

Purpose: confirm smart-retreat rates and priority.

Method:

- provide a fort, friendly province, and enemy province;
- repeat commander retreats in native and non-native terrain;
- separately test leaderless troops and undisciplined followers.

## Test 12: Ordinary fatigue recovery

Purpose: resolve active-unit recovery not fully specified by the manual.

Method:

- give controlled fatigue without further actions;
- compare active, unconscious, reinvigorated, and spellcasting units;

- log fatigue every round.
- test the current community hypothesis of one point per active round plus Reinvigoration against the official five-point unconscious recovery.

## Test 13: Regeneration and rounding

Purpose: reproduce the post-6.31 percentage rule.

Method:

- use several maximum HP values and regeneration percentages;
- inflict constant damage;
- record healing across many rounds.

## Test 14: False damage and rout

Purpose: verify current HP-rout contribution and dissipation.

Method:

- apply only false damage;
- kill all hostile Glamour mages at controlled times;
- record morale triggers and two-per-round removal.

## Test 15: Indoor battlefield magic

Purpose: catalogue which whole-field effects remain legal.

Method:

- attempt ordinary, holy, start-of-battle, innate, and item-created field effects in fort interiors and assassination maps;
- record script fallback and gem use.

## Test 16: Modded regression suite

Purpose: detect future DE or Divinitus changes that invalidate published packages.

Method:

- preserve a small set of representative battles;
- rerun after each mod update;
- compare unit IDs, final fields, scripts, and outcomes;
- classify differences as source edits, load-order overwrites, or engine changes.

# Part XX: Operational Checklists

---

## Pre-battle audit

## Objective

- What must the battle accomplish?
- Is taking the province enough?
- Which enemy assets matter most?
- What friendly losses are acceptable?

## Command

- Are all troop categories legally led?
- Are squad-count morale penalties understood?
- Is there useful command redundancy?
- Are key commanders protected?

## Formation

- Which squad contacts first?
- Is width, depth, or spacing appropriate?
- Are undisciplined restrictions active?
- Will friendly units obstruct one another?

## Script

- Are spells researched and gems carried?
- Are targets in range?
- What happens after five orders?
- What happens if the named spell fails?
- Are indoor, underwater, storm, or darkness restrictions checked?

## Defence layers

- What answers Protection?
- What answers Defence?
- What answers shields?
- What answers resistance and MR?
- What answers regeneration, size, flight, fear, or mindlessness?

## Persistence

- When does fatigue become dangerous?
- Can the line survive until the decisive turn?
- Are poison, bleeding, clouds, or rust cumulative threats?

## Preservation

- Where will the army retreat?
- Are routes friendly after simultaneous movement?
- Is the fort battle an annihilation risk?
- Can the force fight again next turn?

## Post-battle audit

- 1 What was the first irreversible failure?
- 2 Did placement produce the intended contact order?

- 3 Which scripts completed?
- 4 Which spells were interrupted or replaced by AI choices?
- 5 When did key units cross 50 or 100 fatigue?
- 6 Which squad routed first and why?
- 7 Did command loss trigger a general collapse?
- 8 Did the counter attack the correct defence layer?
- 9 Which losses occurred during retreat or from delayed damage?
- 10 What is the smallest change likely to improve the result?

## New-player minimum

Before ending a turn with an important army:

- assign every troop to a legal commander;
- separate units that need different orders;
- choose formations deliberately;
- protect commanders;
- check mage gems and scripts;
- inspect likely retreat provinces;
- view the replay even after an easy victory.

## Part XXI: Essays

### Essay I: Morale and the Shape of Defeat

Dominions gives armies bodies, weapons, armour, and magic, but it ends most battles through cohesion. This is not a cosmetic concession to realism. It is the mechanism that connects local violence to army-level outcomes.

A soldier's HP asks whether the body can continue. Squad morale asks whether a group still accepts the battle. Command asks whether that group remains part of an army. Army HP asks whether the whole force has absorbed so much destruction that continued resistance is no longer possible. Retreat then asks whether defeat remains recoverable.

These layers explain why two identical casualty totals can have different results. Ten losses spread among several large, well-led squads may be tolerable. The same losses concentrated in a small forward squad can trigger a rout, expose a flank, and place fear next to another squad. The second squad then checks under worse conditions. Once movement turns away from the enemy, Defence falls, zones of control no longer matter, and the enemy converts retreat into further damage.

Morale has geometry. A fear aura beside one squad is not the same as a global numerical debuff. A standard supports a particular command structure. A commander killed behind the line can matter more than a warrior killed at the front. A sparse formation's -1 seems modest until it moves an already marginal squad down the DRN curve.

The strategic conclusion is not as simple as "buy morale." The army needs a controlled way to fail. Squads can be divided so that one rout stays local. Command can be duplicated. Valuable troops can be kept from taking the first casualty threshold. Fear can be attacked at its source. Retreat provinces can be preserved so a rout displaces the army instead of destroying it.

The strongest armies are not those that never fail a morale check. Random rolls and extreme effects make that impossible. They are armies whose first failure does not automatically become total defeat.

## Essay II: Fatigue, the Hidden Battle Economy

Gold buys the unit and resources equip it, but fatigue determines how long the purchased statistics remain real.

A fresh high-Defence unit can look nearly untouchable. Every ten fatigue removes one Defence. Directed attacks add harassment. At fifty fatigue, the same body suffers five less Defence and a broader range of armour-defeating protection results. At one hundred it falls unconscious. The transition is not gradual in battlefield effect: a stable formation can appear to hold, then collapse rapidly as many members cross the same thresholds.

Fatigue also binds ordinary troops and mages into one system. Heavy armour protects a caster from arrows but charges twice its armour Encumbrance on every spell. A trampler destroys light infantry but pays for movement and trampling. A berserker produces more offence but continues accumulating cost. Fire, cold, shock, bleeding, and spell effects can attack the fatigue stock even when direct HP damage is unimpressive.

This makes time a resource. A cheap screen may buy three rounds for buffs, or force the enemy to spend three rounds attacking and building Encumbrance fatigue. A resistant line does not need an immediate kill if every exchange makes the next one more favourable. Reinvigoration does more than extend endurance; it preserves Attack, Defence, casting, and the reliability of protection.

A proper comparison between two units includes their fatigue over time. "Who wins the first attack?" is often less important than "Who still has a functioning stat line on the tenth?"

## Essay III: Formation Is the Management of Time

Formation appears spatial, but its principal strategic effect is temporal. It decides how many bodies enter contact now, how many wait, which square receives area damage, how long replacements take to arrive, and when a fast unit becomes trapped behind a slow one.

A line spends frontage early. It seeks simultaneous contact and converts many weapons into immediate checks. A box stores bodies behind the first rank. It may accept less initial damage output in exchange for depth and protection of the centre. A sparse line spreads risk and coverage but pays morale and density costs. A skirmish pattern gives each square room yet can allow enemies to penetrate or surround.

Placement adds another time instruction. Forward deployment advances the squad's personal clock. Hold adds two rounds. Combat speed changes travel and cooldown. The enemy's placement changes the actual meeting point. The resulting schedule determines whether a buff precedes contact, whether arrows receive three volleys or one, and whether a finisher arrives against fresh or fatigued targets.

This is why copying a formation without copying its purpose fails. "Put infantry in a line" is not a rule. A line is correct when early frontage is worth more than depth and clustering risk. "Put mages at the rear" is incomplete. The rear can be exposed to flyers, and excessive distance can place spells out of range.

Formation is best designed as a timeline: first contact, second contact, decisive effect, expected rout. The map is the clock face.

## Essay IV: Protection Is a Probability Distribution

Protection is often treated as subtraction: damage fifteen against protection twenty should do nothing. Dominions instead rolls both sides, permits open-ended results, distinguishes body and head, applies weapon types, includes shield hits, and allows low protection rolls to become armour defeating.

Protection changes the damage distribution. It reduces ordinary damage and makes severe results rarer, but it does not create a hard wall. The tail can still contain clean shield bypasses, head hits, high damage rolls, armour-piercing reductions, and armour defeat caused by fatigue.

This perspective improves both defence and offence. Adding protection to an already protected unit may still matter if it removes many ordinary wounds and their affliction chances. Against that unit, a large number of weak attacks may be poor at direct damage but valuable for harassment and fatigue. A smaller number of armour-negating attacks may attack the correct layer but fail if their delivery is unreliable.

The important question becomes: which part of the distribution must change? If ordinary hits are killing the line, more protection or shields may work. If rare head hits kill expensive sacreds, helmet coverage, Luck, body count, or regeneration may matter. If fatigue is widening the armour-defeating tail, reinvigoration may preserve effective protection better than another armour point.

The defence layer is never just the number printed beside the shield icon.

## Essay V: Scripting under Uncertainty

A Dominions script is neither direct control nor a prophecy. It is a commitment made before seeing exact enemy deployment and resolved through range, targets, pathing, fatigue, damage, and AI fallback.

This makes scripting a form of robust planning. A brittle script succeeds brilliantly in one anticipated battle and fails when the enemy deploys one formation-width away. A robust script may sacrifice theoretical perfection to retain useful behaviour across several plausible enemy plans.

Robustness begins with dependencies. If spell four requires spell one to boost a path, the caster must survive the preparation time, spend the correct fatigue, and still have a legal target. If a screen must hold for three rounds, its morale and matchup must support that duration. If a flier must kill commanders, the path must remain open and the flier must ignore irrelevant rear targets.

Failure branches should be written deliberately. When the target is absent, what will the AI cast? When the caster is interrupted, does the army still have resistance? When the enemy holds, do friendly damage spells fire into empty space or remain useful? After five orders, does the mage stay safe?

The ideal script is not the one with the most exact sequence. It is the one whose likely deviations remain acceptable.

## Essay VI: Winning the Battle, Saving the Army

Field victory is one event in a campaign. The surviving commanders, mages, mounts, gems, afflictions, and retreat routes determine whether the event creates lasting advantage.

An army that wins with its commanders dead can become stranded or badly organised. A force that routs into friendly territory may remain a strategic asset. A cavalry army can retain riders while losing

mounts and tempo. Poison and bleeding can kill units after their visible escape. A failed fort defence can annihilate every unit that had nowhere to retreat.

Preservation begins before battle. Friendly adjacent provinces are part of army design. Command redundancy protects against battlefield collapse and the reorganisation that follows. Gem expenditure should reflect the value at risk. A commander carrying a laboratory's worth of gems is a caster and a moving treasury.

There are moments when preservation should be sacrificed. Destroying a unique enemy global caster, breaking a throne defence, or exhausting the only relief army may justify severe losses. The decision should be explicit. "The replay said victory" is not a strategic valuation.

The useful post-battle question is: how much future action did this result purchase? Provinces, siege turns, mage survival, research continuity, and readiness belong in the answer.

## Essay VII: Combined Arms as Counter Architecture

Combined arms is sometimes described as variety for its own sake. In Dominions it is better understood as a set of linked answers to layered defences.

A conventional line may hold space but fail against heavy armour. Mages may negate armour but require time and protection. Archers may interrupt the enemy's mages but fail against shields. Flyers may threaten command but need the centre fixed in place. Fear may rout ordinary troops but do little to mindless bodies. Each component covers a failure mode of another.

Combined arms works when every component follows the same timing plan. A screen that dies before the debuff resolves has not supported the mage. A flanker that arrives before the centre engages can be surrounded. An armour-breaking effect cast after the damage line routs is irrelevant.

Combined arms also imposes organisational costs: more commander types, more scripts, more recruitment gates, more research branches, and more ways to misdeploy. Variety becomes strength only when every component has a named job and a dependency it satisfies.

The aim is not maximum variety. We want the smallest useful combination: enough distinct mechanisms to answer the expected defences, all delivered on one coherent clock.

## Sources and Open Questions

### Principal sources

- Illwinter, Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2, especially the statistics, special abilities, Army Setup, Combat, afflictions, sieges, retreats, and Battle Magic sections.
- Illwinter, Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34.
- [Illwinter Dominions 6 documentation](#).
- [Illwinter Dominions 6 changes](#).
- [Dominions 6 official Steam page](#).
- Supplied DomEnhanced2\_16.dm.
- Supplied Divinitus\_1.15.3\_DE.dm.

Current community references are used to identify test questions and terminology, not to override the manual or current official corrections without evidence.



## Open questions

The following still require controlled current-game tests:

- exact harassment decay;
- complete cooldown constants;
- Formation Fighter capacity at every value and mixed size;
- current-version reproduction of the survivor-bonus rounding boundaries and commander handling;
- frame-by-frame current-version confirmation of active-unit fatigue recovery outside the manual's explicit unconscious rule;
- some obstacle and targeting weights;
- full mounted carry and movement arithmetic;
- precise current rounding in shield damage, regeneration, paralysis, and several special effects;
- effective combined data for every DE and Divinitus object.

Until then, they remain research tasks rather than confident approximations.

# Foundation Book V: Magic

## What magic asks of a nation

Magic is the system by which Dominions turns knowledge into force. Research changes what a nation can attempt. Paths determine who can attempt it. Gems, blood slaves, laboratories, turns, and mage actions determine whether the attempt is affordable. Formation, timing, fatigue, targets, resistance, and counters determine whether it works.

Foundation rule: Magic is not a list of powerful spells. It is a conversion chain from mage-turns and magical income into effects delivered at the right place and time.

Book V follows that chain from research and path access through gems, battlefield packages, communions, rituals, globals, forging, and late-game magic. It is meant to answer both the beginner's question-"What can this mage actually do?"-and the harder one: "Can the nation deliver that effect repeatedly, in time, and against resistance?"

## Edition note

Book I defines the common baseline and evidence labels. Book IV owns the arithmetic of battlefield resolution. Book V uses those results to deal with magical planning, while Book IX catalogues exact spell, item, site, and mage changes in the active mods.

## Current-version corrections that matter

The printed manual remains the structural baseline, but current play must include later official changes:

| Version | Current rule or correction                                                                                              | Practical consequence                                                                         |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6.25    | Battlefield-wide spells cannot normally be cast indoors; holy spells are excepted                                       | Fort interiors and many assassination fields need separate scripts                            |
| 6.29    | Several spell, item, ritual, and nation-specific errors were corrected                                                  | Old object data must not be treated as current merely because the engine formula is unchanged |
| 6.30    | Communion masters using conservative gem use no longer attempt inappropriate higher-level spells                        | Old reports of this spell-AI failure are historical                                           |
| 6.32    | Spell AI became less likely to cast invisibility late in battle; several remote and single-target choices were improved | Script fallbacks and unscripted casting should be assessed on the current version             |
| 6.34    | Domes can protect against Astral Disruption; ritual messages and several spell-AI choices were corrected                | Strategic magic defence and report interpretation changed                                     |
| 6.35    | Innate spellcasters resume their scripts after recovering from unconsciousness                                          | Current innate-caster scripts are more reliable than older replays imply                      |

Patch notes contain many object-specific balance changes. A current spell dossier needs current game data as well as the manual's rule text. This foundation preserves the rules needed to make sense of those objects.

## Ways into the book

The shortest route runs through the conversion chain, paths and schools, research, gems, battlefield jobs, rituals, forging, and the first magic audit. Communions, domes, global contests, booster ladders, counter construction, and legendary spells can be added as the national game develops. The controlled tests are kept for questions that genuinely depend on hidden AI choices, rounding, or version-sensitive interactions.

# Part I: Magic as a Conversion System

## The complete chain

A magical effect normally depends on every link below:

```
mage recruitment
-> laboratory access
-> mage-turns assigned to research
-> required school level
-> required path access
-> gems, slaves, or items
-> a legal order or battle script
-> survival, range, target, and timing
-> penetration, damage, or control
-> strategic exploitation
```

A broken link invalidates the rest. Researching a decisive spell without a caster is stored knowledge without delivery. Forging a booster without the path needed to wear it is dead capital. Sending the correct mage without gems can reduce a battle plan to ordinary AI casting. Winning the resistance check after the line has routed is too late.

## Six magical resources

Magic is paid for with more than gems:

| Resource          | What it purchases                                                | Common failure                                                     |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Research points   | Access to schools and spells                                     | Researching attractive levels with no operational deadline         |
| Mage-turns        | Research, rituals, forging, site searching, movement, and combat | Counting one mage as if all roles can be performed simultaneously  |
| Paths             | Eligibility, efficiency, range of effects, and forging access    | Confusing national theoretical access with repeatable field access |
| Gems or slaves    | Rituals, items, combat boosts, fatigue relief, and some summons  | Treating the treasury as income rather than a finite stock         |
| Laboratories      | Research, rituals, forging, pooling, and logistics               | Losing the network that turns sites and mages into national power  |
| Time and position | Delivery before the strategic window closes                      | Finishing research after the war has already been decided          |

The strongest magical economy is not always the one with the most gems. It is the one that can turn its available paths, researchers, laboratories, and stocks into the required effects with the fewest broken dependencies.

## Stock, flow, and capacity

The library's economic model applies directly:

- Stock: current gems, slaves, forged items, accumulated research, and prepared casters.
- Flow: monthly gem income, blood-hunting output, research points, and repeatable summon production.
- Capacity: laboratories, mage recruitment, path distribution, forge access, communion bodies, and ritual range.
- Position: where mages, labs, gems, armies, and legal targets are located.

Research is cumulative stock generated by a flow of mage-turns. A booster is stored path access. A global is a large stock expenditure converted into an ongoing flow or worldwide rule. A battle gem converts stock into immediate tempo.

## The three horizons

Every research or forging decision belongs to a horizon:

| Horizon   | Typical question                                         | Planning standard                                                          |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Immediate | What can prevent defeat this turn or next?               | Legal casters, carried gems, exact scripts, and battlefield timing         |
| Campaign  | What wins the next war or siege cycle?                   | Research breakpoint, item queue, summon mass, and lab movement             |
| Strategic | What changes the nation's path access or world position? | Boosters, globals, remote movement, legendary spells, and unique artifacts |

The common error is buying strategic possibility while losing the immediate war. The opposite error is repeatedly spending gems on emergency combat without building the research and access that end the emergency.

# Part II: Paths, Schools, and Access

## The nine paths

Dominions has nine ordinary paths of magical power:

| Family    | Path    | Broad tendencies                                                            |
|-----------|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Elemental | Fire    | Heat, burning, direct damage, offensive enhancement, destructive globals    |
| Elemental | Air     | Lightning, storms, flight, precision, mobility, battlefield reach           |
| Elemental | Water   | Cold, quickness, underwater power, frost, fluid defence                     |
| Elemental | Earth   | Protection, strength, fatigue control, constructs, forging                  |
| Sorcery   | Astral  | Resistance contests, communions, teleportation, information, global control |
| Sorcery   | Death   | Undead, decay, fear, souls, attrition, powerful summons                     |
| Sorcery   | Nature  | Life, poison, regeneration, animals, plants, supply, growth                 |
| Sorcery   | Glamour | Illusion, false damage, concealment, bewilderment, perception               |
| Neither   | Blood   | Blood slaves, sacrifice, demons, Sabbaths, corruption, high action cost     |

This table describes tendencies, not hard borders. Schools are thematic rather than perfectly rigorous, national spells break general expectations, and multi-path requirements deliberately combine toolsets.

Holy is separate. Divine spells depend on Holy skill rather than ordinary paths and research. Common divine magic is available from the beginning. Some Banishment and Smite replacements are determined by the Pretender's paths, as detailed in [Book III](#).

## The seven schools

| School       | Central study                                     | Frequent output                                              |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Conjuration  | Bringing beings or powers into the world          | Summons, elemental or otherworldly forces, some searches     |
| Alteration   | Changing physical properties and conditions       | Protection, strength, resistance, weather, transformation    |
| Evocation    | Projecting magical force                          | Direct battle damage, area attacks, battlefield destruction  |
| Construction | Making items and artificial beings                | Equipment, boosters, matrices, constructs, artifacts         |
| Enchantment  | Imbuing units, objects, land, or the world        | Persistent buffs, domes, globals, battlefield enchantments   |
| Thaumaturgy  | Manipulating minds, souls, information, and space | Resistance-based control, remote vision, movement, sorcery   |
| Blood Magic  | Unlocking spells that use Blood magic             | Demons, Sabbaths, sacrifice, blood rituals, world corruption |

The Blood school is not the Blood path. The school is a research category; the path is a caster statistic. A spell can sit in Blood Magic and have multi-path requirements.

## The three access gates

A mage can cast a spell only when:

- 1 the nation has researched the spell's school to the required level;
- 2 the mage meets every listed path requirement;
- 3 any required gems or blood slaves are available in the correct place.

Battle spells require carried resources before battle. Rituals draw automatically from the national treasury but require a friendly laboratory. Research level alone never grants a path to a mage.

## Primary and secondary paths

Multi-path spells require every listed path. The first listed path is the primary path:

- only excess skill in the primary path improves the ordinary spell-fatigue divisor;
- resistance penetration uses excess skill in the spell path identified by the rule;
- dual-path spells and rituals consume gems of the primary path unless the spell specifies otherwise;
- forging a multi-path item charges each required gem type.

This makes ordering consequential. Two requirements with the same numbers are not necessarily interchangeable if the primary path differs.

## Excess skill

Having more skill than the minimum can:

- reduce the listed fatigue cost;
- contribute to resistance penetration;
- increase the maximum gems usable in a ritual;
- enable stronger overcasting of a global;
- meet a higher item or spell threshold;
- improve path-derived indirect bonuses.

Higher skill gives more than access to extra icons. It increases endurance and sometimes contest strength. That value still needs to be weighed against the booster, communion, empowerment, or rare mage needed to reach it.

## Acquiring and increasing paths

The principal methods are:

| Method                           | New path from zero? | Duration              | Main use                                                 |
|----------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Native or random path            | Yes                 | Permanent             | National base access                                     |
| Empowerment                      | Yes                 | Permanent             | Opening a missing path or climbing without another route |
| Path booster item                | No                  | While worn            | Efficient repeatable threshold access                    |
| Battlefield path-boost spell     | No                  | Battle                | Combat thresholds and fatigue reduction                  |
| One combat gem                   | No                  | One spell             | Temporary +1 and/or fatigue management                   |
| Communion/Sabbath/Chorus         | No                  | Battle                | Shared battlefield escalation                            |
| Grand Communion                  | No                  | One strategic casting | Add same-path strength to a global or dispel             |
| Transformation or special effect | Sometimes           | Object-specific       | Must be verified separately                              |

Only Empowerment is the general method that grants the first level of an absent path. A booster or Power of the Spheres requires at least level 1 already. A gem can raise a known path by one for one spell but cannot create it or raise it by more than one.

## Empowerment costs

Official costs are:

first level in an absent path = 50 gems of that path  
later increase = 15 x target level

Examples:

| Change   | Cost         |
|----------|--------------|
| F0 -> F1 | 50 Fire gems |
| F1 -> F2 | 30 Fire gems |
| F2 -> F3 | 45 Fire gems |
| F3 -> F4 | 60 Fire gems |

Empowerment is expensive because it buys permanent access on one commander. It is justified when the new level unlocks a repeatable ladder: a booster, critical ritual, national summon, global, or item that creates further access. Empowering for a one-off effect should be compared with alchemy, a communion, recruiting a rarer mage, trading for an item, or choosing a different solution.

## Indirect magic

Path knowledge grants side benefits:

| Path    | Level 1 and scaling benefits                                    | Level 3                                      | Level 4                      |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| Fire    | +10 Leadership and +10 Magic Leadership per level; shorter life | +5 Fire Resistance                           | another +5 Fire Resistance   |
| Air     | +10 Magic Leadership per level                                  | +5 Shock Resistance                          | another +5 Shock Resistance  |
| Water   | +10 Magic Leadership per level                                  | +5 Cold Resistance                           | another +5 Cold Resistance   |
| Earth   | +10 Magic Leadership per level                                  | +3 natural Protection                        | +1 Affliction Resistance     |
| Astral  | +20 Magic Leadership per level                                  | -                                            | +1 Magic Resistance          |
| Death   | +50 Undead Leadership per level                                 | rarely dies from old age                     | +10 Morale                   |
| Nature  | +10 Magic Leadership and +10 supplies per level; longer life    | +5 Poison Resistance                         | another +5 Poison Resistance |
| Glamour | +10 Magic Leadership per level                                  | false-damage regeneration 1 per combat round | True Sight                   |
| Blood   | +10 Undead and +10 Magic Leadership per level                   | +5 Hit Points                                | another +5 Hit Points        |

Level-one benefits scale with the path level. Threshold benefits are cumulative. These effects can change command capacity, longevity, supplies, resistance, and survivability even when the mage never casts a spell from that path.

# Part III: Research as Strategic Planning

## The research formula

An ordinary magical researcher produces:

Research = 5 + (2 x total magic levels) +/- research bonuses or penalties  
minimum = 1

Magic and Drain scales modify magical research. Dementia halves research ability. The displayed value should be treated as authoritative for the current object after all abilities, scales, afflictions, items, and mod edits.

Some special researchers do not follow the ordinary path requirement:

- philosophers can research without magical paths, gain from Sloth, and ignore Magic and Drain;
- Divine Insights supplies limited research, but no more such researchers in one laboratory contribute than the dominion candles in that province;
- nation- and object-specific abilities can add or alter research.

## Research resolves early

Research is hosting step 2. A researcher contributes for the month even if killed later during hosting. This does not make exposed researchers safe; it means the current month's points can survive a later raid while the future research flow does not.

## Research is a queue of responses

A weak plan says:

"Research Evocation because the nation has Fire mages."

A useful plan says:

"Reach the precise area-damage spell before the first war, with enough F2 casters and carried gems to cast it after the line has engaged, while retaining an Alteration branch if the opponent fields fire resistance."

Every breakpoint should record:

| Field     | Question                                                       |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Deadline  | On which turn or war must the spell exist?                     |
| Caster    | How many mages can cast it without rare randoms?               |
| Resource  | What does one battle, ritual cycle, or item batch cost?        |
| Delivery  | What range, timing, formation, lab, or ritual range is needed? |
| Counter   | What common defence defeats it?                                |
| Branch    | What is researched if scouting disproves the original threat?  |
| Afterlife | Does the school level remain useful after the first purpose?   |

## Breakpoints, not school completion

Research should be measured by useful breakpoints rather than equal bars. A school level can unlock:

- a defensive self-buff that makes thugs viable;
- an army-wide resistance answer;
- an efficient battlefield damage spell;
- a site-search ritual;
- a national summon;
- a path booster;
- a dome;
- a remote attack;
- a global;
- an artifact tier.

The next level is valuable only through the spells or items the nation can actually use. High school level does not imply high path requirement; low-path utility can appear late and high-path effects can appear earlier.



## Research portfolios

A robust research plan contains four functions:

- 1 Immediate survival: expansion, early war, resistance, protection, or fatigue tools.
- 2 Efficient repetition: spells many recruitable mages can cast.
- 3 Access development: boosters, summons, or rituals that widen the path graph.
- 4 Strategic leverage: movement, remote warfare, globals, artifacts, and legendary effects.

Overconcentration creates brittle excellence. Excessive breadth creates many half-finished answers. The correct portfolio is shaped by national mage distribution and the next opponent, not by a universal school order.

## Research efficiency

Useful measures include:

RP per gold = monthly research / recruitment gold  
 RP per upkeep = monthly research / monthly upkeep  
 breakpoint time = remaining RP / current monthly RP  
 field opportunity cost = RP lost when researchers leave laboratories

These ratios answer different questions. Cheap research may have poor commander-point efficiency. A high-RP capital mage may be needed for battlefield duty. A sacred researcher may have low upkeep. A foreign or summoned mage may open a path worth far more than its raw RP.

## Mage-turn accounting

One mage can normally perform only one monthly strategic job:

- research;
- forge;
- cast a ritual;
- empower;
- search manually;
- move;
- preach or perform another order;
- accompany an army.

The full cost of a ritual is:

gem or slave cost  
 + one mage-turn  
 + foregone alternative output  
 + position and exposure

A "free" summon paid only in gems still consumes a caster's month. A cheap item can be expensive if the only qualified mage is the nation's research engine or unique global caster.

## Legendary research

Level 9 of every school except Construction consists of legendary spells. Reaching level 9 does not automatically grant the entire level:

- one legendary spell is selected and researched at a time;
- the level can be researched repeatedly to learn additional legendary spells;

- the default limited-legendary setting restricts how quickly this catalogue is acquired;
- Construction 9 instead unlocks unique artifacts.

The decision is spell-specific. "Reach Thaumaturgy 9" is incomplete; the plan must name the first legendary spell, the caster and gems that make it real, and the reason its effect is worth delaying every other branch.

## Research audit

At the start of a major plan:

- 1 list the next two wars and likely counters;
- 2 identify exact spell breakpoints;
- 3 count common, uncommon, and unique casters;
- 4 reserve the gems required for one decisive battle;
- 5 identify the item or summon ladder that changes access;
- 6 estimate turns to the breakpoint after fielding losses;
- 7 name the branch if the opponent changes plan;
- 8 avoid counting a Pretender or unique mage in two distant places.

# Part IV: Gems, Slaves, and Magical Logistics

## Gem production

Magic sites send gems to the national treasury when their province is connected through friendly territory to a province with a laboratory. Ownership alone is not enough. Raiding, isolation, or laboratory loss can interrupt collection without destroying the site.

The treasury records both current stock and monthly income. These must not be confused:

- income supports a sustainable rate;
- stock allows bursts, emergency defence, globals, artifacts, and path development;
- committed stock is already promised to a forge queue, ritual, or field army even if still visible in the total.

## Blood slaves

Blood has no ordinary gem. Blood slaves are acquired principally through Blood Hunting and are physical units/resources that must be moved and pooled. Their economy includes:

- gold and commander points for hunters;
- unrest and population damage;
- patrol or tax consequences;
- laboratory and transport logistics;
- the opportunity cost of hunter mage-turns;
- battlefield and ritual consumption.

The correct comparison is not "slaves are free." It is the total provincial and organisational cost per useful blood effect. [Book II](#) gives the hunting and unrest foundation; this book treats the magical expenditure.

## Pooling and distribution

The pool command gathers gems carried by commanders in a laboratory province into the national treasury. Direct transfer equips field mages. A reliable monthly process is:

- 1

pool slaves and unused gems at laboratories;
- 2

reserve strategic stocks;
- 3

issue ritual and forge orders;
- 4

assign exact battle loads;
- 5

leave an explicit contingency reserve;
- 6

check that moving armies carry neither too few nor treasury-sized excesses.

Carried gems are exposed to battle loss and may be unavailable to rituals. Treasury gems cannot help a mage in battle unless transferred before combat.

## Combat gem rules

A mage may use gems in combat to:

- raise a known path by one for one spell;
- reduce a spell's fatigue;
- satisfy a spell's gem requirement.

Limits:

- a mage cannot spend more gems in one combat turn than the current skill in that path;
- gems cannot grant the first level of an absent path;
- gem use cannot increase the path by more than one;
- the computer controls optional fatigue spending;
- conservative gem use makes the mage spend sparingly and on scripted spells only.

"How many gems does the spell cost?" is only the beginning. The full question is:

required spell gems  
+ any path-boost gem  
+ optional fatigue gems selected by the AI  
<= gems legally spendable this combat turn

Because current skill is part of the spending limit, a battlefield boost or communion may change what can be spent. Exact spell-AI decisions remain object- and situation-sensitive.

## What the patch history proves about optional spending

Official corrections place firm limits on any exact table inherited from early reverse-engineering:

| Version | Official correction                                                          | Consequence                                                      |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6.12    | Gems are no longer used when the mage is targeted by a remote attack ritual. | Remote-attack replays do not establish ordinary battle spending. |
| 6.15    | Communions sometimes used too many gems to reduce fatigue.                   | Older communion-spending thresholds are not current law.         |

| Version | Official correction                                                                    | Consequence                                             |
|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 6.30    | Communion masters on conservative gem use sometimes failed to try higher-level spells. | Conservative behaviour must be tested on 6.30 or later. |

A pre-release code investigation reported several concrete decision thresholds: conservative casters reacted near 100 projected fatigue and a 30-fatigue addition; ordinary casters used lower 85 and 20 checks, had further 25/40 fatigue-per-divisor tests, and attempted to retain three gems. Those values are valuable test inputs because they predict distinct outcomes. They are not printed here as the current algorithm: the official 6.15 correction establishes that at least part of the old communion-gem behaviour changed after that investigation.

The safe rule for play is narrower. Carry the scripted minimum, allow for optional fatigue control, and reproduce a critical refusal boundary in the current version before building a battle plan around it.

## A battle-gem budget

For each mage, record:

| Field                | Meaning                                                |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Scripted minimum     | Resources required to execute the intended five orders |
| Likely AI spend      | Additional gems that may be used to control fatigue    |
| Emergency reserve    | Gems retained for later rounds or a second battle      |
| Capture exposure     | Maximum acceptable value if the army is destroyed      |
| Conservative setting | Whether unscripted or optional spending is restricted  |

Underloading produces failed scripts. Overloading converts a rout into a treasury loss. The right load depends on the value of the battle, expected duration, retreat route, and likelihood of a second engagement before resupply.

## Gems as fatigue control

Many combat gems are spent not to meet the printed requirement but to keep the caster conscious. This can be decisive because fatigue changes:

- whether later scripted spells are attempted;
- the risk of unconsciousness;
- communion-slave survival;
- vulnerability to critical and armour-defeating hits;
- the number of useful casts before collapse.

The effect should be valued in additional useful actions, not only fatigue removed. A gem that permits the decisive fourth cast may be more valuable than one that merely makes an already won battle cleaner.

## Alchemy

Any magically skilled commander in a friendly laboratory can use the Alchemy order:

```
2 non-Astral gems -> 1 Astral pearl
2 Astral pearls -> 1 gem of another type
```

Converting one non-Astral type to another through pearls is effectively 4:1. This is a severe exchange rate. It is rational when the receiving gem crosses a binding threshold: a decisive ritual, booster, dome, global, or emergency defence.

The ordinary conversion should not be confused with alchemical spells that convert gems into gold. The Modding Manual's Alchemy Bonus ability applies to the latter category, not automatically to the treasury's pearl conversion.

Gem valuation

The value of a gem depends on access and timing:

strategic gem value  
= effect unlocked  
x probability of timely delivery  
x scarcity of substitutes  
- opportunity cost

A Nature gem may be common nationally but priceless at the exact army that needs a resistance spell. Astral pearls are flexible but are also consumed by communions, teleportation, dispels, and powerful late rituals. A surplus path can fund a repeatable summon; an apparent shortage may be caused by idle forge queues rather than low income.

Reserve doctrine

Useful reserve categories are:

- battle reserve: one or more decisive engagements;
- counter reserve: domes, dispels, emergency movement, or resistance;
- access reserve: empowerment or a booster chain;
- strategic reserve: a named global, artifact, or legendary ritual;
- trade reserve: gems whose diplomatic value exceeds immediate conversion.

An unlabelled treasury is easily spent twice in planning.

Part V: The Anatomy of Battle Magic

Spell classes by battlefield job

A battle-magic package normally combines several jobs:

| Job          | Desired effect                                                                       |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Preparation  | Path boosts, personal defence, reinvigoration, or communion formation                |
| Protection   | Resistances, armour, Luck, regeneration, mist, concealment, or anti-magic            |
| Control      | Immobilisation, confusion, sleep, fear, fatigue, displacement, or terrain conditions |
| Attrition    | Repeated efficient damage or summons                                                 |
| Breakthrough | Large area, armour-negating, high-penetration, or battlefield-wide effect            |
| Sustain      | Fatigue relief, healing, replacement bodies, or continuous enchantment               |
| Counter      | Removal or neutralisation of the enemy's named mechanism                             |

| Job          | Desired effect                                            |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Preservation | Escape, protection of commanders, or reduced gem exposure |

No spell is "good" independently of delivery. A superb damage effect at the wrong range or damage type is a poor answer. A minor resistance buff applied before the relevant area attack can decide the battle.

## The battle-resolution boundary

Book IV is the authoritative home for preparation, interruption, spell accuracy, Magic Resistance contests, casting fatigue, damage families, and the lifetime of battlefield enchantments. Reprinting those formulas here created two places that could drift after a patch.

For magical planning, the essential questions are:

- 1

Can the caster complete preparation before contact or interruption?
- 2

Will the spell reach the intended target at an acceptable risk to friendly troops?
- 3

Which defensive layer does it test: Protection, resistance, Magic Resistance, fatigue, morale, or position?
- 4

Can the caster afford the fatigue and repeat the effect?
- 5

Does the plan still work indoors or under a different battlefield condition?
- 6

Is the caster's survival part of maintaining the effect?

The exact arithmetic and current patch corrections are in [Book IV, Part XIV](#). This chapter uses their result to build the package.

## Scripting and spell AI

A five-order script is a preferred sequence, not complete control. A scripted spell may fail because:

- research or a path was misread;
- the required resource is absent;
- range or target is illegal;
- fatigue is too high;
- the caster was interrupted, stunned, or unconscious;
- the battlefield condition is wrong;
- a target no longer exists;
- the spell AI chooses a fallback after the script.

Robust scripts name their failure branches. If the critical buff is skipped, can the army still survive? If an enemy resistance appears, what does the mage cast after order five? If communion slaves drop below a threshold, which masters become illegal or exhausted?

## Battlefield package worksheet

| Layer       | Question                                                 |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Threat      | What exact damage, control, or defence must be answered? |
| Preparation | Which boosts and communion orders occur first?           |
| Screen      | What buys the required casting time?                     |
| Main effect | Which repeated spell performs most work?                 |

| Layer           | Question                                                          |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Breakthrough    | Which spell changes the battle state?                             |
| Sustain         | How are fatigue and losses controlled?                            |
| Counter-counter | What happens against resistance, antimagic, flyers, or assassins? |
| Gem budget      | What is the cost per expected battle and per war?                 |
| Retreat         | Which casters and gems survive a failed plan?                     |

## Part VI: The Nine Paths in Practice

### How to read a path

Each path should be evaluated through six questions:

- 1 What protection does it create?
- 2 What defence does it attack?
- 3 How does it control movement, fatigue, or cohesion?
- 4 What does it summon or forge?
- 5 How does it project power on the map?
- 6 Which other path covers its principal failure?

The summaries below are functional maps, not spell lists. National spells and the active mods can substantially alter them.

### Fire

Fire commonly converts research and gems into immediate destructive tempo:

- direct and area fire damage;
- burning and Heat;
- offensive weapon or strength enhancement;
- Fire Resistance;
- battlefield-wide destructive conditions;
- gem-to-gold alchemy;
- late world effects tied to fire and heat.

Fire's strengths are efficient damage against dense, insufficiently resistant armies and the ability to turn an ordinary line into a more lethal one. Its weaknesses are resistance, friendly fire, fatigue, limited control, and the possibility that high damage is wasted on dispersed or expendable targets.

Fire packages need:

- a reason targets will remain clustered;
- screening or range;
- a non-fire answer;
- protection from their own area effects;
- a gem budget for high-impact casts.

## Air

Air commonly supplies:

- armour-negating shock damage;
- precision and ranged support;
- storms and anti-flight conditions;
- flight and strategic mobility;
- concealment, mist, or displacement;
- strong remote reach.

Shock damage attacks a different defensive layer from ordinary physical damage. Storms can define the whole battlefield, but may also obstruct friendly flyers, missile plans, or spell requirements. Air mages are often high-value because the path combines battlefield damage with movement and information.

Air planning must distinguish:

- storm-compatible and storm-dependent effects;
- friendly flying requirements;
- shock-resistant targets;
- whether strategic movement resolves into a magic battle or later ordinary battle;
- whether a remote effect is blocked by a dome.

## Water

Water commonly provides:

- Cold Resistance and cold damage;
- quickness and action-tempo changes;
- defence and fluid physical alteration;
- water-elemental and aquatic tools;
- underwater access;
- frost-based battlefield control.

Quickness multiplies both output and fatigue exposure. Cold effects are strongest when resistance and friendly exposure are managed. Water's ability to operate underwater can be strategically decisive because many ordinary armies and rituals have restrictions there.

Water packages should audit:

- fatigue after additional actions;
- friendly cold resistance;
- underwater legality;
- the difference between temporary battle acceleration and monthly map movement;
- whether the target's high Protection matters to the chosen cold effect.

## Earth

Earth commonly supplies:

- Protection and natural armour;
- strength and physical enhancement;
- reinvigoration and fatigue control;
- armour damage or earth control;



- constructs and siege power;
- many foundational forging tools.

Earth often wins indirectly by making an army's existing bodies harder, stronger, and more sustainable. It is also central to path escalation because Construction and Earth forging frequently create the infrastructure for other schools.

Earth packages fail when:

- armour-negating or resistance-based effects bypass the added Protection;
- heavy armour raises casting encumbrance;
- slow preparation loses to early contact;
- transformed or buffed units still lack delivery;
- a forging plan consumes the only field-capable Earth mages.

## Astral

Astral commonly provides:

- communions;
- Magic Resistance contests and penetration;
- antimagic and resistance support;
- teleportation and remote projection;
- information and detection;
- global control, dispels, and late strategic effects.

Astral's central advantage is leverage: many modest mages can combine, and high Astral can contest units or globals through exact arithmetic. Its central danger is that the same infrastructure can be fragile. Communion slaves can collapse; high-value casters can be exposed; Astral duels or hostile soul effects can punish path-heavy mages.

Astral planning requires:

- MR and penetration estimates;
- slave and master path ratios;
- pearl supply;
- protection of communion infrastructure;
- a clear distinction between battlefield communions and Grand Communion orders.

## Death

Death commonly supplies:

- undead creation and command;
- skeleton-based battlefield attrition;
- fear, decay, disease, and fatigue;
- soul and death effects;
- powerful summons and transformed commanders;
- late rituals involving the dead and Titans.

Death can convert gems into bodies without ordinary upkeep assumptions, but those bodies may be Mindless, vulnerable to Banishment, or dependent on Undead Leadership. Reanimation and battlefield summoning can absorb time while decisive casters work.

Death packages should audit:

- priestly counters;
- Undead Leadership;
- battlefield turn limits;
- friendly morale and disease exposure;
- whether summoned bodies are an objective or only a screen;
- the risk profile of late summons whose minds or forms are uncertain.

## Nature

Nature commonly supplies:

- regeneration, healing, and life enhancement;
- poison resistance and poison offence;
- entanglement and movement control;
- animals, plants, and living summons;
- supplies and longevity;
- growth- and dominion-linked world effects.

Nature often creates persistence rather than immediate lethality. Regeneration is strongest on sufficiently large and protected bodies; it is not a substitute for surviving the initial hit. Poison plans require protection for friendly units and enough battle duration for delayed damage to matter.

Nature packages should distinguish:

- healing from affliction removal;
- regeneration from one-time healing;
- supply generation from battlefield value;
- poison damage from immediate rout pressure;
- living summons from mindless or undead logistics.

## Glamour

Glamour commonly supplies:

- illusions and false damage;
- concealment and misdirection;
- confusion, bewilderment, and perception attacks;
- defence through appearance rather than armour;
- remote or strategic deception;
- True Sight at high indirect path skill.

False damage can disable or rout without ordinary wounds, but it interacts differently with false-damage regeneration and True Sight. Glamour defence can be powerful until the opponent brings the correct perception or wide-area answer.

Glamour packages need:

- an answer to True Sight;
- a plan for Mindless or otherwise inappropriate targets;
- real damage or control when illusion is insufficient;
- awareness that late-battle spell AI and current patches affect invisibility choices;
- protection against area effects that do not care which apparent body is real.

## Blood

Blood commonly supplies:

- demons and blood summons;
- Sabbaths;
- sacrifice and dominion interaction;
- severe single-target or battlefield effects;
- horror and corruption mechanics;
- world enchantments that punish ordinary magic.

Blood converts provincial population, unrest tolerance, patrols, hunters, laboratories, and transport into a magical economy. Its scale can be enormous, but its logistics are unusually visible and disruptive.

Blood packages should audit:

- slaves at the caster rather than only in the treasury;
- hunter, patrol, and laboratory capacity;
- Sabbath fatigue modifiers;
- living-only or underwater restrictions;
- enemy raids on hunting provinces;
- whether blood investment is delaying conventional research and defence.

## Cross-path architecture

Paths become more useful when paired by function:

| Need                      | First layer                                  | Complementary layer                      |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Armoured mass             | Fire, Air, Death, or resistance-based attack | Earth or Nature screen                   |
| High MR elites            | Physical or elemental pressure               | Astral penetration only where efficient  |
| Dense low-resistance army | Area elemental damage                        | Control that holds density               |
| Fast rush                 | Early protection and control                 | Later breakthrough damage                |
| Long attrition            | Death or summons                             | Nature/Earth sustain and fatigue control |
| Remote threat             | Air/Astral/Glamour movement or attack        | Domes, scouts, and local response        |
| Global war                | Astral dispel and high ritual strength       | Gem income, caster security, diplomacy   |

The purpose of a secondary path is not variety. It is to cover the principal failure of the first mechanism.

# Part VII: Communion, Sabbaths, Choruses, and Grand Communion

## What a battlefield communion does

A communion combines mages during battle to:

- raise every master's already-known paths;

- distribute each master's spell fatigue among that master and all friendly slaves;
- pass certain personal buffs from masters to slaves;
- concentrate the actions of many mages into stronger casting.

A valid communion requires at least one master effect and one slave effect. Astral uses Communion Master and Communion Slave. Blood uses Sabbath Master and Sabbath Slave. MA Man's Spell singers can use Chorus Master and Chorus Slave.

These are separate communion types. One Astral Communion, one Sabbath, and one Chorus may coexist, each with its own masters, slaves, and bonuses. An Astral master does not gain the slaves of a simultaneous Sabbath.

## The level bonus

A master gains  $n$  levels in every path the master already knows when the communion has at least  $2^n$  slaves:

| Active slaves | Master bonus |
|---------------|--------------|
| 1             | +0           |
| 2-3           | +1           |
| 4-7           | +2           |
| 8-15          | +3           |
| 16-31         | +4           |
| 32-63         | +5           |
| 64-127        | +6           |

The first slave makes the communion valid but grants no level. Bonus levels do not create an absent path. If slave casualties reduce the total below a threshold, every master's bonus drops immediately.

The threshold structure makes "spare" slaves strategically useful. Four slaves produce +2, but the loss or unconsciousness of one reduces the group to three and +1. Five or six retain +2 after some attrition.

## Participants in one spell

For a single master's spell, participants are:

- the master casting that spell;
- all friendly slaves in that communion.

Other masters are not participants in that cast. They gain the path bonus, but they do not share another master's fatigue as participants.

If there are four slaves and three masters, a spell cast by one master has five participants, not eight. Each master's separate spell creates its own fatigue event over that master plus the same slave pool.

## Base fatigue distribution

For one master's spell:

base fatigue per participant  
 = spell fatigue after path calculations  
 / number of participants

The slave's share is then modified by the slave's skill relative to the casting master in the relevant path:

| Slave path relative to master       | Slave fatigue modifier |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------|
| higher than master                  | x 0.5                  |
| equal to master                     | x 1                    |
| lower, but at least half the master | x 2                    |
| lower than half the master          | x 4                    |

Skill gained from the communion and all other sources is included when calculating spell fatigue. Exact rounding at each step is assigned to controlled testing.

## Worked comparison

Suppose one master and four slaves participate, so the divisor is five.

If the resolved spell fatigue before distribution is 100:

base participant share =  $100 / 5 = 20$

The caster receives the master share according to the communion rules. Each slave then receives:

| Relative skill          | Fatigue per slave before type-specific modifiers |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Slave higher            | 10                                               |
| Equal                   | 20                                               |
| Lower but at least half | 40                                               |
| Lower than half         | 80                                               |

Four weak slaves do not automatically make high-path casting safe. The path bonus can raise the master far above the slaves, turning the x4 bracket into the dominant risk.

## Master count and slave load

Adding masters increases output but not the number of participants in each cast. If two masters cast 100-fatigue spells into the same four equal-path slaves:

- each event has five participants;
- each slave receives a share from the first cast;
- each slave receives another share from the second cast;
- total slave load approximately doubles.

The correct design ratio depends on:

- master casting frequency;
- spell fatigue after boosted skill;
- slave path relation;
- slave encumbrance and reinvigoration;
- buffs transmitted to slaves;

- expected battle length;
- whether slaves leave at unconsciousness;
- how many threshold casualties can be tolerated.

"Four slaves per master" is not an engine rule.

## Slaves cannot act

While in the communion, slaves perform no independent actions. Their mage-turn in the battle is converted into:

- master path access;
- fatigue capacity;
- receipt of qualifying self-buffs;
- risk.

A slave's opportunity cost includes the spells that mage could otherwise have cast. High-path slaves may be safer fatigue sinks, but they can be too valuable to immobilise.

## Shared personal buffs

Slaves benefit from self-buffs cast by communion masters when those spells are single-target, range 0 personal effects. This can create powerful shared protection, resistance, regeneration, reinvigoration, or other effects.

The important details are:

- the buff is produced by the particular master's cast;
- legal qualifying effects must be checked from current spell data;
- timing matters-slaves may already have received fatigue before the protection arrives;
- some buffs can be harmful to particular slave bodies;
- a master's personal path access and script determine what is transmitted.

Communion buffing is an army-design problem, not an arithmetic trick. Slave chassis, resistances, and encumbrance must suit the intended shared effects.

## Collapse

The communion ends when no masters or no slaves remain.

If all masters die or flee, every slave suffers:

- approximately one combat round of stun;
- 3d50 fatigue damage.

This backlash can disable or kill an already exhausted slave block. Keeping the masters alive is part of keeping the slaves alive. Redundant masters can prevent sudden collapse, but every additional active master can also increase fatigue throughput.

The current patch boundary matters. Version 6.12 made removal from a communion clear the slave spell effect, and 6.29 corrected cases where communion backlash failed to occur. A replay from before those fixes cannot settle present collapse behaviour.

## Automatic participation

Items such as matrices, Slave's Hearts, and Master's Athames can make bearers join automatically. The bearer:

- must be a mage, meaning at least one non-Holy magic path;
- need not have Astral or Blood;
- must still be analysed for item slot, cost, timing, and survivability.

Automatic participation can bring foreign paths into a communion without spending the first scripted round joining. It also creates fragile item dependencies and may expose expensive gear to battlefield loss.

## Current communion correction ledger

| Version | Official change                                                        | What to retest                                           |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| 6.12    | Being thrown out removes the communion-slave effect.                   | Forced removal, form changes, and automatic slave items. |
| 6.15    | Excessive gem use for fatigue reduction was corrected.                 | Gem budgets for high-throughput master groups.           |
| 6.23    | Spell AI confusion between different communion types was corrected.    | Mixed Communion, Sabbath, and Chorus battles.            |
| 6.29    | Missing communion backlash was corrected.                              | Last-master death, flight, and forced removal.           |
| 6.30    | Conservative communion masters again try eligible higher-level spells. | Conservative scripts across a slave threshold.           |

The manual already settles the ordinary shared-buff rule: a single-target range-0 personal spell cast by a master can affect that master's slaves. An area-one spell centred on the caster is not the same category merely because it covers the caster's square. Automatic items on non-Astral mages, multi-form commanders, and forced participant removal remain current test work.

## The three battlefield types

| Type      | Special rule                                                   |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Communion | Spells take 25% longer to cast                                 |
| Sabbath   | Master suffers half fatigue; slaves suffer 20% extra fatigue   |
| Chorus    | Spells take 25% longer; a slave leaves on losing consciousness |

The Sabbath improves master endurance by transferring a harsher burden to slaves. Chorus slaves avoid later damage once unconscious, but every departure can reduce the master's path bonus immediately.

## Designing a safe communion

Proceed in this order:

- 1 name the highest-path spell each master must cast;
- 2 calculate master path after the intended slave threshold;
- 3 estimate spell fatigue at that path;
- 4 count participants for each cast;

- 5 place each slave in the relative-path multiplier bracket;
- 6 add type-specific Sabbath or casting-time effects;
- 7 estimate simultaneous master throughput;
- 8 include transmitted buffs and reinvigoration;
- 9 provide threshold redundancy;
- 10 protect masters from assassination, flyers, missiles, and early area damage;
- 11 write a useful plan for masters after the scripted sequence;
- 12 decide what a controlled collapse looks like.

## Common communion failures

### The threshold cliff

Exactly four slaves produce +2. One casualty produces only +1, invalidating later spells or sharply raising fatigue.

### Weak-slave multiplication

Masters rise several path levels while slaves remain far below half the master. Every cast sends four times the base share to each weak slave.

### Too many masters

The slave pool receives overlapping fatigue from many masters. The communion appears efficient because every master has high paths, then the shared battery collapses at once.

### Harmful self-buffs

A master distributes an effect incompatible with slave physiology, resistance, or role.

### Preparation without contact timing

The army needs several rounds to join, boost, and buff, but the enemy reaches the mages before the package activates.

### No post-script policy

Masters complete five orders and begin casting high-fatigue or inappropriate spells into the same slave pool.

### Master annihilation

All masters are placed together and die to one flanking or area effect, causing backlash.

## Grand Communions are different

Grand Communion is a strategic monthly order used by certain nations. When one eligible mage casts or dispels a global, other eligible mages in the same context can use Grand Communion to add their relevant path skill to the power of the attempt.

It does not:



- create a battlefield communion;
  - distribute battlefield fatigue;
  - grant every path;
  - make participating mages available for research or other orders that month.
- For a Dispel, joining Astral skill adds directly to the attempt described by the manual's example. Grand Communions let a nation convert several mage-turns into ritual contest strength.

## Communion audit

Before a battle:

- identify communion type;
- count slaves at every threshold;
- record each master's boosted paths;
- calculate every critical spell's participants and slave brackets;
- check shared self-buffs;
- set gem policy;
- separate or protect masters;
- decide how slaves recover;
- plan for one slave loss, one master loss, and early contact;
- test the exact package in the current ruleset.

# Part VIII: Rituals and Strategic Magic

## Ritual fundamentals

Rituals are map spells that take one entire monthly order. They normally require:

- a friendly laboratory;
- the researched school level;
- a caster with all required paths;
- sufficient gems or slaves in the national treasury;
- a legal target and range.

The treasury supplies ritual gems automatically. A field commander carrying gems elsewhere does not increase the national pool.

## Hosting position

Important magic timing from the official hosting sequence:

| Step | Resolution                                               |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| 2    | Research                                                 |
| 4    | Empowerment                                              |
| 5    | Forging                                                  |
| 10   | Magic rituals, in random caster order                    |
| 11   | Remote army attacks                                      |
| 12   | Magic battles, including relevant teleports and movement |

| Step | Resolution                                   |
|------|----------------------------------------------|
| 14   | Site-search ritual results                   |
| 28   | Global enchantments take effect on the world |
| 31   | Item and monster special effects             |
| 62   | Artifacts may become yearning                |

This timing has strategic consequences:

- current research can unlock knowledge before later events, but orders were submitted with the pre-host state;
- forging and empowerment complete before ordinary rituals;
- remote attacks and magic movement can precede ordinary movement battles;
- a global is cast at the ritual step but its world effect begins at step 28;
- a new global does not retroactively change movement battles or storming that already resolved in the same host;
- yearning occurs near the end of the turn.

## Ritual order is random

Rituals at step 10 resolve in random caster order across relevant mages. Plans that require ritual A to precede ritual B in the same month are unsafe unless the engine or objects provide a specific guarantee.

This affects:

- opening and using gateways;
- competing globals;
- sequential remote attacks;
- global-slot contests;
- casting a protection before a hostile action;
- using a summon as a same-turn caster.

## Range and legality

Ritual range is measured in provinces where shown. No listed range normally means a local ritual. Markers include:

- NUW: cannot be cast underwater;
- UW: can be cast only underwater.

Ritual-range abilities and sites can change reach. Range should be measured from the actual casting laboratory after movement orders, not from the capital or army being supported.

## Local enchantments

Local enchantments affect a province and may persist. Many are linked to their caster:

- caster death ends the effect;
- most also end when the province is conquered;
- limited-duration enchantments can often be extended with extra gems;
- most gain one month per extra gem, while some gain three.

The shortcut **Shift+M** repeats a ritual monthly while the caster remains eligible and resources exist. Repetition is operationally convenient but can drain a treasury silently if the strategic need changes.

## Anonymous and limited rituals

Some rituals are:

- Anonymous: caster or origin information is concealed by the effect's reporting rules;
- Limited: only one instance can affect the target province.

Anonymous is not synonymous with undetectable. Scouting, diplomatic inference, target selection, and repeated patterns can still reveal responsibility.

## Ritual categories

| Category          | Strategic use                                           | Main counter                                          |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Site search       | Convert map ownership into gem income or special access | Raiding, lab isolation, opportunity cost              |
| Summon            | Convert gems and a mage-turn into units or commanders   | Banishment, resistance, upkeep or leadership limits   |
| Remote attack     | Damage or invade a distant province                     | Domes, defence, decoys, retaliation                   |
| Magic movement    | Relocate forces outside ordinary movement               | Domes, traps, interception, wrong timing              |
| Information       | Reveal provinces, armies, sites, or magic               | Concealment, misinformation, opportunity cost         |
| Local enchantment | Protect or transform one province                       | Dispel, conquest, caster assassination                |
| Economy           | Produce gems, gold, units, scales, or other flow        | Caster loss, global contest, raids                    |
| Global            | Change rules across the world                           | Dispel, replacement, assassination, dominion pressure |

## Site-search rituals

Remote searches can:

- cover territory faster than manual movement;
- search dangerous provinces without exposing a mage;
- use otherwise idle path access;
- convert gems into future income.

They are investments, not automatic profit. The expected return depends on site frequency, province type, previous searches, ritual cost, and time remaining. A search that pays back in ten turns can be poor during an existential war and excellent during stable expansion.

## Summoning

A summon should be valued by role:

| Summon output | Main value                                                |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Combat bodies | Frontage, attrition, special attack, resistance, or siege |
| Commander     | New path, leadership, forging, ritual, or thug chassis    |

| Summon output                | Main value                                                     |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sacred unit                  | Bless interaction and Holy Point independence where applicable |
| Undead or demon              | Different upkeep and leadership system, specific counters      |
| Elemental or temporary force | Immediate battlefield conversion                               |

The cost includes the summoner's month. A mediocre combat unit can be a great summon if it opens a path, commands a new troop family, or relieves a commander-point bottleneck.

## Remote attacks

Remote attacks resolve before ordinary movement battles. Their purposes include:

- stripping Province Defence;
- killing commanders or laboratories;
- testing a dome;
- exhausting defenders;
- cutting retreat routes;
- creating a magic battle before the main invasion;
- forcing the enemy to distribute defence.

A remote attack should be coordinated with the ordinary campaign. Damage without exploitation may only warn the target. Repeated attacks can also disclose path access and spending.

## Magic movement

Teleportation and related movement create unusual timing. A movement ritual may produce a magic battle at step 12, before ordinary army movement. The arriving force must be self-contained:

- correct leadership;
- gems and slaves;
- a legal survival or retreat plan;
- enough force if the target is stronger than intelligence suggested;
- awareness of domes and redirection.

Strategic mobility is valuable because it compresses distance, but it can also separate mages from laboratories, armies, and friendly retreat provinces.

## Repeat-ritual discipline

For every repeated ritual, record:

- monthly cost;
- assigned caster;
- cancellation condition;
- minimum reserve;
- target rotation;
- lab and range requirement;
- whether a new patch or mod changes the object.

Automation should preserve judgment, not replace it.

# Part IX: Domes and Remote-Magic Defence

## What a dome protects

Domes are local enchantments that interact with hostile ritual effects targeting the province. Their exact chance and consequence are object-specific. Some block, some redirect, and some retaliate.

They do not replace:

- scouts and intelligence;
- conventional defenders;
- protection against assassination;
- laboratory redundancy;
- dispersal of unique casters;
- diplomatic deterrence.

## Major manual examples

| Dome                   | Listed behaviour in the manual                                        | Friendly-magic consequence                |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Dome of Solid Air      | 80% protection; destroyed when it fails                               | Blocks friendly targeted magic as well    |
| Frost Dome             | 30% protection and a cold trap                                        | Blocks friendly targeted magic as well    |
| Forest Dome            | 30%; absorbed fire destroys it                                        | Blocks friendly targeted magic as well    |
| Dome of Misdirection   | 70%; redirects a ritual to a neighbouring province                    | Can redirect friendly targeted magic      |
| Seven Seals            | Perfect hostile protection until seven blocks crack it; caster-linked | Friendly Astral magic can pass            |
| Dome of Arcane Warding | 50% protection                                                        | Check current object text for exact scope |

Strikeback or trap domes may retaliate without blocking. Against global enchantments, strikeback does not hit the global caster. As of 6.34, domes may also protect against Astral Disruption according to the official update.

## Layering domes

When several domes exist, exact ordering and interaction must be tested for the current version and object set. Strategic evaluation should include:

- probability of at least one block;
- whether a failure destroys a dome;
- whether redirection can hit a friendly or valuable neighbour;
- whether friendly rituals are impeded;
- caster dependency;
- recurring gem and mage-turn cost;
- what the hostile caster learns from the result.

Do not multiply listed percentages without confirming resolution order and independence.

## Dome strategy

A dome is best when it protects concentrated value:

- a capital research core;
- an artifact or global caster;
- a gateway;
- a throne;
- a major laboratory and gem stock;
- a predictable army staging province.

Concentration also makes the target predictable. A strong defence can invite repeated cheap probes, assassinations, ordinary invasion, or attacks on the dome caster.

## Remote-defence audit

- Which provinces are worth enemy gems?
- Which hostile paths and ranges are known?
- Is the dome compatible with friendly rituals?
- Can the caster survive old age, raids, and assassinations?
- Is there a second laboratory or alternate staging point?
- What happens after one block, one failure, or redirection?
- Can the enemy simply attack the logistics outside the dome?

# Part X: Global Enchantments and Dispel Wars

## Global slots

Global enchantments are worldwide rituals. Game setup permits 3, 5, 7, or 9 global slots; five is the common default. The slot limit makes globals a shared political resource. Casting one changes not only the world but also what every other nation can maintain.

## Casting cases

When a global is cast:

- 1 if the same named global already exists, the new casting attempts to replace it through the dispel contest;
- 2 if an empty slot exists and that name is absent, the new global occupies a slot;
- 3 if all slots are full and the name is different, the new global contests a randomly selected existing global, including possibly one cast by the same nation.

Global casting order among mages is random. A plan that assumes an open slot at the beginning of hosting may fail after other nations cast first.

## Overcasting

The caster can add gems above the printed minimum. Ritual spending is capped by:

maximum ritual gems = caster path level x 100

The dispel strength of a global includes:

+1 per extra gem above minimum  
 +5 per caster path level above the spell requirement  
 +DRN

The challenger must beat the incumbent's result. The ordinary lesson is that one extra caster path level is worth five overcast gems in the contest, before considering other abilities or Grand Communion support.

## Dispel

The common Dispel ritual directly challenges a selected global. The same comparison framework applies:

- extra gems add one each;
- excess relevant path adds five each;
- both sides receive a DRN;
- the higher result wins;
- the challenger must overcome the existing enchantment.

Because the roll is open-ended, no finite ordinary advantage is absolute. Large margins produce reliability, not certainty.

## Caster dependency

Most globals end if the caster dies. Immortality does not preserve the enchantment through death while the body reforms. Some globals are also tied to an origin province and end if that province is conquered.

Counterplay includes:

- Dispel;
- same-name replacement;
- slot-pressure casting;
- assassination;
- remote attacks;
- old-age pressure;
- conquest of the origin;
- forcing the caster to take another risk;
- pushing out hostile dominion when the effect is dominion-limited.

A huge overcast protects against magical contest, not against a knife.

## Protection against globals

Domes can protect units against many global effects in the same general way as local rituals.

Strikeback domes do not retaliate against global casters. For globals restricted to or strengthened by dominion, removing hostile dominion from a province can function as protection.

The exact protected unit, province, and event scope is global-specific and should be read from current spell text.

## Global categories

| Category                      | Strategic effect                                          |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Gem engine                    | Creates monthly magical income                            |
| Economic engine               | Changes gold, resources, supplies, or population          |
| Battlefield rule              | Adds storms, darkness, scales, or other conditions        |
| Summoning or attack engine    | Produces units or recurring hostile actions               |
| Research or forging engine    | Changes item cost, skill, or knowledge economy            |
| Punishment global             | Taxes rituals, forging, empowerment, or ordinary activity |
| Dominion global               | Scales with or operates inside religious territory        |
| Information or control global | Changes vision, detection, travel, or global slots        |

The printed benefit is only the first-order effect. A world storm, darkness, or ritual tax changes every rival's research choices and diplomacy.

## Selected strategic examples

The following revision-2 manual values are a reference set; current object data must be checked before a live-game order:

| Global                  | Requirement and base cost     | Principal function                                                       |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Eternal Pyre            | Enchantment 6, F6, 80 Fire    | +20 Fire gems per month; heat and darkness interaction at origin         |
| Mother Oak              | Alteration 5, N5, 50 Nature   | +10 Nature gems per month                                                |
| Well of Misery          | Conjuration 8, D6, 80 Death   | +21 Death gems per month and world growth interaction                    |
| Stellar Focus           | Enchantment 7, S5, 60 Astral  | +10 Astral pearls per month; world Drain and origin Magic effects        |
| Gale Gate               | Thaumaturgy 8, A5, 60 Air     | +20 Air gems per month, stronger Air Elementals, hurricanes              |
| Gates of Horn and Ivory | Thaumaturgy 7, G5, 60 Glamour | +15 Glamour gems per month and increased Glamour ritual range            |
| Forge of the Ancients   | Construction 6, E5, 80 Earth  | Item cost reduction and Master Smith bonus                               |
| Perpetual Storm         | Evocation 6, A5, 70 Air       | Storms in battles, land-income and movement/range pressure               |
| Burden of Time          | Thaumaturgy 7, D7, 70 Death   | Population, unrest, Death scales, and accelerated aging pressure         |
| Eternal Twilight        | Alteration 8, G8, 90 Glamour  | Worldwide Magic/Twilight and economic pressure outside friendly dominion |

Examples with more extreme late-game effects appear in Part XIII. These values are object data, not engine formulas; patches and active mods can change them.



## Payback

For a pure gem global:

```
nominal payback time
= total gems spent / monthly gems produced
```

This is incomplete. A proper valuation adds:

- probability of being dispelled or losing the caster;
- value of the global slot;
- diplomacy and coalition response;
- same-path gem scarcity;
- caster and research opportunity cost;
- time remaining in the game;
- benefit from non-income side effects.

An 80-gem global producing 20 per month has a nominal four-month payback before overcast. It can still be poor if it provokes immediate war or exposes the only F6 caster.

## Global diplomacy

Globals change incentives:

- a private gem engine is visible wealth;
- a world penalty creates a coalition even if its caster is hard to identify politically;
- a slot-filling global can block several nations' plans;
- a defensive overcast can signal a long-term commitment;
- an origin province becomes a public strategic target.

Before casting, assess:

- 1 who gains;
- 2 who loses;
- 3 who can dispel;
- 4 who can reach the caster or origin;
- 5 who benefits from helping either side;
- 6 what explanation or bargain is available.

## Global-war audit

- Confirm the current spell object.
- Name the caster and backup.
- Calculate minimum, overcast, excess-path bonus, and maximum spend.
- Decide whether a Grand Communion applies.
- Verify slot state but assume other casts can precede it.
- Protect the caster and any origin province.
- Reserve a response to replacement or Dispel.
- Model diplomatic reaction.
- Set a minimum number of productive months.
- Do not place every strategic asset in the same protected province.

# Part XI: Forging, Items, and Artifacts

## Forging requirements

Forge Item requires:

- a mage in a friendly laboratory;
- the relevant Construction level;
- all item path requirements;
- the required gems;
- an appropriate item slot on the eventual bearer.

Forging resolves at hosting step 5. Shift+0 repeats the selected item each month while requirements remain satisfied.

## Construction tiers

| Construction level | Item tier                   |
|--------------------|-----------------------------|
| 1                  | Magical trinkets            |
| 3                  | Lesser magical items        |
| 5                  | Greater magical items       |
| 7                  | Very powerful magical items |
| 9                  | Unique magical artifacts    |

Construction also contains spells and constructs. Its strategic value cannot be reduced to equipment alone.

## Base item cost by path requirement

For each required path:

| Required level | Base gems of that path |
|----------------|------------------------|
| 1              | 5                      |
| 2              | 10                     |
| 3              | 15                     |
| 4              | 20                     |
| 5              | 30                     |
| 6              | 40                     |
| 7              | 55                     |
| 8              | 70                     |

Multi-path items charge each path component. Current object data, national discounts, Forge Bonus, Forge of the Ancients, yearning, and mod commands can alter effective cost.

## Item value

An item can provide:

- a path threshold;

- reinvigoration or resistance;
- protection, defence, attacks, or mobility;
- automatic communion membership;
- ritual range or special orders;
- leadership;
- monthly gem generation;
- survival or transformation;
- a chassis-specific thug or supercombatant package.

The correct unit of analysis is the package:

```
item gems
+ forge mage-turn
+ Construction research
+ bearer opportunity cost
+ risk of loss
```

A cheap item can be strategically expensive on the wrong bearer. A costly booster can be excellent if it unlocks a global or a new repeatable booster ladder.

## Slots and package conflicts

Commanders have limited equipment slots. A booster competes with:

- protection;
- reinvigoration;
- a weapon or shield;
- penetration gear;
- mobility;
- anti-assassination equipment;
- another booster.

Path-access plans must be built on the actual chassis. "Wear three boosters" fails if they occupy the same miscellaneous, head, body, or hand slot.

Mounted units and unusual chassis can have different slot or item restrictions. Strength requirements and two-handed weapons can also invalidate theoretical loadouts.

## National items

Some items are:

- restricted: only qualifying nations see and forge them, displayed with a dark blue forge background;
- discounted: available at reduced cost for particular nations, displayed in grey.

National items may alter a nation's access curve earlier than generic tables imply. They belong in every later nation dossier.

## Forge bonuses

Forge Bonus and Master Smith are not identical:

- Master Smith raises paths for forging only;
- Forge Bonus reduces cost according to the ability or source;
- Forge of the Ancients gives a world-effect discount and Master Smith bonus to the caster's nation;
- national discounts and object-specific commands can also apply.

Exact stacking order and rounding among fixed and percentage effects are assigned to controlled tests. The displayed forge cost is the operational authority.

## Forge of the Ancients

The revision-2 manual lists:

```
Construction 6
Earth 5
80 Earth gems
-20% item gem cost
Master Smith +1
```

This global changes both price and eligibility. Its strategic value is highest when:

- many item batches are planned;
- the +1 creates new forge thresholds;
- Construction research is already deep;
- the caster and global can be protected;
- the new efficiency will be realised before Dispel or war.

## Artifacts

Construction 9 items are unique artifacts: only one copy of each can exist in the world. The default limited-unique-artifact rule limits each player to one unique artifact forged per turn.

Artifacts create:

- race conditions;
- intelligence from failed availability;
- concentration of power and loss risk;
- global strategic targets;
- an incentive to reach Construction 9 before others.

An artifact is more than an improved item. Its uniqueness changes timing and diplomacy.

## Yearning

An artifact can become yearning, allowing it to be forged at half usual cost. Yearning can begin once at least one of these has occurred:

- any nation researches Construction 9;
- Forge of the Ancients is active;
- the Throne of Creation is claimed;
- the Throne of the Artificer is claimed.

Each condition increases the monthly yearning rate by 50 percentage points according to the manual. The check occurs at hosting step 62.

Yearning creates an information problem. Waiting can halve price but lose the artifact race. Forging immediately secures the object but pays full cost.

## Booster reference

The following manual items form the core generic access map. Values are path requirements, not effective gem prices after bonuses.

### Construction 5

| Item                      | Forge requirement | Boost                  |
|---------------------------|-------------------|------------------------|
| Skull Staff               | D2                | +1 Death               |
| Thistle Mace              | N2                | +1 Nature              |
| Flame Helmet              | F4                | +1 Fire                |
| Winged Helmet             | A4                | +1 Air                 |
| Gossamer Veil             | G3                | +1 Glamour             |
| Robe of the Sea           | W3                | +1 Water               |
| Armour of Souls           | B5                | +1 Blood               |
| Earth Boots               | E2                | +1 Earth               |
| Coin of Meteoritic Iron   | S2E2              | +1 Astral              |
| Horn of Storms            | A5                | +1 Air                 |
| Brazen Vessel             | B5                | +1 Blood               |
| Blood Stone               | B3E2              | +1 Earth               |
| Armour of Twisting Thorns | B3N2              | +1 Nature and +1 Blood |

### Construction 7

| Item                       | Forge requirement    | Boost                                 |
|----------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Staff of Elemental Mastery | F4W4 or A4E4 variant | +1 Fire, Air, Water, and Earth        |
| Treelord's Staff           | N5                   | +2 Nature                             |
| Blood Thorn                | B3                   | +1 Blood                              |
| Starshine Skullcap         | S2                   | +1 Astral                             |
| Skullface                  | D5                   | +1 Death                              |
| Robe of the Magi           | A5B5                 | +1 all nine ordinary paths            |
| Skull of Fire              | F1D1                 | +1 Fire                               |
| Water Bracelet             | W1                   | +1 Water                              |
| Ring of Wizardry           | S7                   | +1 all nine ordinary paths            |
| Ring of Sorcery            | S6                   | +1 Astral, Death, Nature, and Glamour |
| Moonvine Bracelet          | N3S1                 | +1 Nature                             |
| Mirage Crystal             | G3E2                 | +1 Glamour                            |

The table is a threshold map, not a recommendation to forge every item. It must be combined with slots, national paths, rare randoms, and active-mod data.

## Booster ladders

A ladder begins with actual access and applies legal steps in order:

```
native path
-> low-tier booster
-> higher forge threshold
-> multi-path booster
-> summon or empowerment
-> global or legendary threshold
```

Example structure:

```
E2 mage
-> forge Earth Boots
-> operate as E3 while worn
-> cast or forge an E3 threshold
```

This does not create Earth on an E0 mage. It also does not allow one physical item to be worn simultaneously by two casters.

## Forge queue

For each planned item:

| Field            | Record                                                 |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Purpose          | Exact spell, ritual, battle, or chassis unlocked       |
| Qualified forger | Common, rare, unique, or Pretender                     |
| Research         | Construction deadline                                  |
| Cost             | Displayed current cost after bonuses                   |
| Slot             | Conflict with other equipment                          |
| Bearer           | Where and when the item is needed                      |
| Reuse            | Whether it returns to a laboratory or remains deployed |
| Loss risk        | Capture, death, assassination, or artifact uniqueness  |

# Part XII: Path Access and Bootstrapping

## National access is a distribution

"The nation has Astral 3" can mean:

- every fort recruits S3;
- a capital-only mage has S3;
- a 10% random reaches S3;
- the Pretender alone has S3;
- a summon can eventually reach S3;
- one empowered commander reaches S3;
- a communion temporarily produces S3.

These are strategically different. Every nation dossier should separate:

- common repeatable paths;
- capital or terrain restrictions;
- random probability;
- foreign recruitment;
- summons;
- Pretender access;
- item-dependent access;
- communion-only combat access;
- empowerment.

## The access graph

Represent each threshold as a node:

```
recruitable mage  
-> booster forger  
-> boosted ritual caster  
-> summoned new-path commander  
-> cross-path item  
-> global or legendary caster
```

Every arrow needs:

- research;
- path;
- gems;
- a mage-turn;
- a slot or laboratory;
- correct load order under mods.

If any arrow depends on a rare random, calculate recruitment probability and delay rather than calling the ladder "reliable."

## Probability of random access

For an independent probability  $p$  per recruitment, the chance of at least one success after  $n$  recruits is:

$$P(\text{at least one}) = 1 - (1 - p)^n$$

Examples:

| Random chance | Recruits | Chance of at least one |
|---------------|----------|------------------------|
| 10%           | 5        | 41%                    |
| 10%           | 10       | 65%                    |
| 10%           | 20       | 88%                    |
| 20%           | 5        | 67%                    |
| 20%           | 10       | 89%                    |

This assumes independent rolls and the stated probability. Multi-pick random systems and linked randoms require their actual object definition.

## Access quality

Evaluate a path threshold on:

| Dimension      | Question                                                          |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Reliability    | How often can the caster be obtained?                             |
| Scale          | How many can be fielded?                                          |
| Location       | Capital, fort, terrain, summon site, or Pretender?                |
| Timing         | When do research and gems make it operational?                    |
| Sustainability | Can the effect be repeated each month or battle?                  |
| Replaceability | What happens if the caster dies?                                  |
| Competing role | Is the caster also the only forger, researcher, or global anchor? |

## Empowerment as a bridge

Empowerment is most efficient when it creates an access loop. Examples:

- path 0 -> 1 permits a booster to function;
- a new cross-path combination forges a unique enabler;
- a permanent ritual caster summons replaceable mages;
- a global generates more of the gem type used;
- a new path makes an existing rare random unnecessary.

The fifty-gem first level is poor if it ends at level 1 with no useful threshold.

## Pretender as access

A Pretender can:

- forge initial boosters;
- cast a national or global ritual;
- provide a missing cross-path;
- summon new-path commanders;
- establish a communion or item ladder.

This access is delayed by dormancy or imprisonment and endangered by death, Call God delay, and positional commitments. A Pretender path that exists only on the design screen is not operational until the chassis can reach a laboratory and spend the required turns.

## Trading and diplomacy

Items and gems can move path access between nations:

- trade for a booster;
- hire another player to forge;
- exchange surplus gems for a binding shortage;
- coordinate a global or Dispel;
- use allied movement and laboratories where game rules permit.



Trade can be cheaper than empowerment, but it creates dependency and reveals strategic intent. A request for a Starshine Skullcap or Ring of Sorcery tells informed rivals which threshold may be approaching.

## Hidden costs of path escalation

- rare mages stop researching;
- boosters occupy survival slots;
- a ladder concentrates unique items;
- the caster becomes an assassination target;
- alchemy destroys four gems for one off-path gem;
- the required global occupies a contested slot;
- the access arrives too late for the named war.

The correct endpoint is the cheapest timely and repeatable access, not the highest theoretical path.

# Part XIII: Legendary and Late-Game Magic

## The level-nine decision

Legendary research is a strategic commitment:

- level 9 has a large research cost;
- one spell is selected at a time;
- required paths are often rare;
- gem costs can consume several months of income;
- the spell can change global diplomacy;
- the caster becomes a critical asset.

The selection should answer:

- 1 What changes immediately after the spell is learned?
- 2 Is the caster already operational?
- 3 Are the gems reserved?
- 4 What is the counter?
- 5 Is a second legendary spell worth repeating the level?
- 6 Would another school's lower breakpoint win sooner?

## Wish

The revision-2 manual lists Wish as:

Alteration 9  
Astral 9  
100 Astral pearls

Wish can produce extraordinary outcomes and can also harm the caster or nation. The manual suggests that wishing for gems or an artifact is safer than many ambitious requests.

Folklore is not enough to establish the accepted commands, aliases, random results, restricted units, or mod interactions. The library treats a complete Wish catalogue as test pending. The controlled suite

records exact strings, messages, treasury changes, units, items, afflictions, horror marks, and repeat variation for each ruleset.

## Nexus Gate

The manual lists Nexus Gate as:

Thaumaturgy 9  
Astral 5, Earth 3  
40 Astral pearls

It establishes a permanent gate to the Nexus. The network is shared and creates opportunities for rapid movement as well as exposure to other users and void-related danger. It cannot be evaluated as "forty pearls for movement" alone; it changes map topology.

Questions before opening it:

- who else can use the network;
- which laboratories and armies become connected;
- whether entry provinces can be held;
- what happens if an enemy learns or controls a node;
- which commanders can survive the destination.

## Tartarian Gate

The manual lists Tartarian Gate as:

Conjuration 9  
Death 7  
7 Death gems

It releases a dead Titan or Monstrum from Tartarus. The body can be extraordinarily powerful, but the mind may be destroyed or otherwise impaired. The ritual's low printed gem cost is balanced by uncertainty, caster requirements, research, leadership, equipment, and remediation.

Tartarians should be classified after arrival:

- fully capable commander;
- impaired commander requiring healing or transformation;
- combat body;
- unusable or dangerous result.

The expected value depends on the nation's ability to repair minds, equip chassis, command units, and absorb failures.

## Arcane Nexus

The revision-2 manual lists Arcane Nexus as:

Enchantment 9  
Astral 8  
150 Astral pearls

It gathers Astral pearls equal to one quarter of non-Astral, non-Blood gems spent on rituals, forging, and empowerment, along with its ambient collection described by the spell. It does not simply take a percentage of all magic income.

Arcane Nexus changes the world's incentives:

- rivals may delay forging and rituals;
- gem spending indirectly funds the caster;
- the caster becomes a coalition target;
- Dispel strength and overcast become geopolitical questions;
- Blood activity is comparatively less taxed by the stated collection rule.

## Utterdark

The revision-2 manual lists Utterdark as:

Alteration 9  
Death 9  
100 Death gems

Its world darkness and severe income/resource reduction restructure military and economic play; caves and deep seas receive stated exemptions. Its value is relative. A nation prepared for darkness, nonliving armies, summons, or reduced conventional income may gain while ordinary gold-and-resource nations collapse.

The diplomatic effect is immediate: even nations not at war with the caster have reason to remove it.

## Gift of Nature's Bounty

The manual's legendary Nature global improves income inside friendly dominion in proportion to candles and adds Growth. Its effect links:

- dominion strength;
- population economy;
- temple and preaching infrastructure;
- global protection;
- the ability to hold productive territory.

It does more than produce income. It turns religious map control into a fiscal multiplier.

## Astral Corruption

The legendary Blood/Astral global punishes non-Blood rituals, forging, and empowerment with horror-related danger scaling with expenditure. It changes the comparative price of every magical action and can make ordinary path development lethal.

The caster should expect:

- coalition pressure;
- reduced rival forging and ritual tempo;
- greater relative value of Blood magic;
- attacks on the global caster;
- opponents shifting to armies, priests, or already forged assets.

## Cataclysm and slot disruption

Some late rituals affect multiple globals, local enchantments, world magic, horror marks, or even the global-slot environment. Such effects should be treated as regime changes, not isolated spell casts.

Before using one:

- record which friendly enchantments will also be lost;
- estimate who benefits from a cleared global board;
- identify the order in which replacement globals can be cast later;
- protect against the new horror or magic environment;
- recognise that apparent neutrality can still favour one roster.

### Late-game transition

A nation is not in the late game merely because it has researched level 9. A functional late-game magical state includes:

- several protected high-path casters;
- a deep treasury with named reserves;
- repeatable battlefield packages;
- remote response and movement;
- global defence;
- forged and summoned access;
- laboratories and retreat routes;
- intelligence about rival legendary choices.

Research without delivery is a catalogue. Delivery without preservation is a spectacle.

## Part XIV: Countering Magic

### Counter the chain

Every magical plan has dependencies. It can be attacked at:

```
research
-> caster
-> path boost
-> gems
-> lab
-> range
-> preparation
-> target
-> effect
-> persistence
```

The cheapest counter is often not the one printed opposite the damage type.

### Counter layers

| Enemy mechanism  | Possible counter layers                                                                       |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fire area damage | Fire Resistance, dispersion, faster contact, caster interruption, dome if remote              |
| MR-based control | Higher MR, path skill, antimagic, fewer valuable targets, physical pressure                   |
| Communion        | Kill or scatter masters, exhaust slaves, force threshold loss, early contact, extended battle |
| Skeleton spam    | Priests, fatigue pressure, kill summoners, long-battle clock, commander targeting             |
| Heavy buffs      | Attack before activation, bypass Protection, remove caster-linked enchantment                 |
| Remote attack    | Dome, decoy province, distributed labs, conventional defence, retaliation                     |

| Enemy mechanism  | Possible counter layers                                                               |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Global           | Dispel, replacement, assassination, origin conquest, dominion removal, diplomacy      |
| Artifact chassis | Disarm through killing bearer, fatigue, MR attack, battlefield control, assassination |
| Gem-heavy script | Cheap probes, sequential battles, retreat denial, treasury pressure                   |

## Resistance is not a complete counter

Resistance reduces one damage family. It does not necessarily answer:

- physical secondary effects;
- fatigue;
- control;
- armour-negating non-elemental damage;
- summons;
- morale pressure;
- battlefield conditions;
- a complementary second path.

A good counter preserves function after the opponent changes one spell.

## Attack timing

Many magical packages are weakest:

- before research completes;
- while boosters are being forged;
- during the first preparation rounds;
- after gems are spent in a probe;
- when casters move away from laboratories;
- after a communion loses one threshold slave;
- when a global caster becomes publicly identifiable.

Tempo can be a stronger antimagic tool than Magic Resistance.

## Targeting the organisation

Magic concentrates value in commanders. Countermeasures include:

- flyers or rear attacks;
- assassins;
- precision missiles;
- remote strikes;
- fast flanks;
- fear or morale pressure on ordinary mage chassis;
- cutting friendly retreat provinces;
- raiding laboratories and gem connections.

This must be balanced against decoys, bodyguards, traps, and expendable casters.

## Gem denial

Force the enemy to spend resources inefficiently:

- attack twice before resupply;
- threaten multiple fronts;
- use cheap forces that look valuable enough to trigger scripted gems;
- retreat from the expected main battle where legal;
- raid gem-producing sites and laboratories;
- occupy the route that connects sites to labs.

Exact spell-AI gem thresholds are not fully public, so sacrificial-probe doctrine must be tested rather than treated as automatic.

## Counter-counter planning

Every package should answer:

If the opponent knows the plan, what is the cheapest adjustment that defeats it?

Then add one response:

- alternative damage;
- different formation;
- a faster script;
- a lower-gem mode;
- extra slave redundancy;
- a second route;
- conventional troops that exploit the magical counter.

The aim is not an uncounterable spell. It is a package whose counters create exploitable costs.

## Part XV: Active Mod Ruleset

### Keep the engine and object layers separate

Book IX owns the exact spell, item, site, mage, and command inventories for DE 2.16 followed by Divinitus 1.15.3 DE. Those files can change schools, paths, costs, range, area, effects, boosters, research, forging, ritual mastery, and gem income on thousands of individual objects. An unmodded spell table cannot safely be copied into the combined game.

The object edits do not automatically replace the engine's general research process, communion participant rules, ritual timing, laboratory requirements, global-slot process, or ordinary alchemy. Those rules remain the starting point until an exact command, patch correction, or controlled test changes them.

### Resolving modded magic

For every important spell or item:

- 1 identify the unmodded object;
- 2 apply every DE selection or copy in source order;

- 3 apply Divinitus afterward;
- 4 resolve linked units, effects, weapons, sites, and shapes;
- 5 record final school, paths, cost, range, area, effect, and restrictions;
- 6 verify in game;
- 7 test AI, communion, and edge behaviour if strategically important.

The published explanation can remain readable, but its source record must retain the full provenance.

## Part XVI: Controlled-Test Programme

---

### Test standard

Every test records:

- game version;
- ruleset and load order;
- map and province;
- research and global settings;
- exact commander and object IDs where available;
- paths, items, gems, fatigue, and scripts;
- screenshots or turn files;
- number of repetitions;
- observed distribution;
- conclusion and remaining uncertainty.

One replay can demonstrate possibility. It rarely establishes probability or exact rounding.

### Test 1: Research arithmetic

Create researchers with known total paths, bonuses, Magic/Drain, Dementia, philosopher status, and Divine Insights. Verify displayed and contributed RP, minimum 1, halving order, and dominion-candle caps.

### Test 2: Research hosting timing

Have researchers contribute and then die at later hosting steps. Confirm current-month contribution and future loss. Test laboratory loss and site-income connectivity separately.

### Test 3: Combat gem spending

For paths 1-4, script spells requiring zero, one, and several gems. Vary fatigue, conservative use, communion bonus, and carried stock. Record maximum gems spent per combat turn and AI fatigue spending.

Include boundary cases around the historical projected-fatigue checks of 85/20 and 100/30, the reported 25/40 fatigue-per-divisor checks, and stocks of three versus four spare gems. These are regression predicates, not expected current rules. Run the same scripts outside a communion, inside one, and while targeted by a remote attack ritual so the 6.12, 6.15, and 6.30 corrections are isolated.

## Test 4: Spell-fatigue rounding

Use listed fatigue values not divisible by the excess-skill divisor. Vary base and armour Encumbrance. Record fatigue after each cast and locate every rounding step.

## Test 5: Penetration

Use fixed caster path, excess skill, target MR, and target same-path skill. Run enough trials for baseline, easy, and hard resistance. Confirm tie direction and half-skill rounding.

## Test 6: Communion thresholds

Run 1, 2, 3, 4, 7, 8, and 9 slaves. Remove one slave during battle and record immediate master path changes and spell legality.

## Test 7: Communion fatigue

Vary:

- equal-path slaves;
- higher-path slaves;
- lower but half-path slaves;
- below-half slaves;
- one or several masters;
- odd fatigue totals;
- reinvigoration;
- Communion, Sabbath, and Chorus.

Record master and every slave after each spell.

## Test 8: Communion self-buffs

Cast range-0 single-target buffs before and after joining. Use several masters and incompatible slave types. Record exactly which effects pass, timing, stacking, and harmful interactions.

## Test 9: Communion collapse

Kill or rout all masters at different slave-fatigue levels. Measure stun and 3d50 fatigue distribution. Separately eliminate all slaves and compare.

Include a forced-removal case to reproduce the 6.12 effect cleanup and confirm the 6.29 backlash correction.

## Test 10: Automatic communion items

Test matrices, hearts, and athames on:

- non-Astral mages;
- non-Blood mages;
- priests with and without another path;
- innate casters;



- multi-form commanders.

Verify joining time, type, and slot behaviour.

## Test 11: Ritual order

Construct same-turn rituals whose results reveal order. Repeat across nations and casters. Test dependencies involving summons, gateways, domes, and competing globals.

## Test 12: Dome interaction

For each dome:

- friendly and hostile remote spells;
- anonymous and limited rituals;
- global unit effects;
- Astral Disruption;
- multiple layered domes;
- redirection at map edges;
- caster death and province capture.

## Test 13: Global contest

Vary extra gems, excess path, same-name replacement, full slots, and Grand Communion. Confirm challenger tie behaviour, random incumbent selection, and self-replacement risk.

## Test 14: Forge-cost stacking

Combine national discounts, fixed and percentage Forge Bonus, Master Smith, Forge of the Ancients, yearning, and multi-path items. Record eligibility and displayed cost at each step.

## Test 15: Booster access

Verify that boosters fail at path 0 and activate at path 1. Test multi-path and all-path boosters, forms, item loss, and battlefield boost interactions.

## Test 16: Artifact race and yearning

Trigger each yearning condition alone and in combination. Record monthly checks, half-cost display, simultaneous forging, unique-item failure, and limited-unique-artifact settings.

## Test 17: Legendary research

Under limited and unlimited settings, record:

- first level-9 completion;
- spell-selection interface;
- repeated level-9 cost;
- simultaneous schools;
- Construction 9 differences.

## Test 18: Wish

For every ruleset:

- 1 prepare an S9 caster and turn backup;
- 2 enter exact candidate strings;
- 3 record message, treasury, units, items, afflictions, horror marks, and caster status;
- 4 test aliases separately;
- 5 repeat random outcomes;
- 6 inspect mod restrictions such as NO\_WISH.

Priority requests include gems, gold, slaves, artifact/artefact, weapon, power, strength, experience, dominion, population, exact unit names, commander or hero, and dangerous wishes.

## Test 19: Indoor magic

Repeat battlefield-wide, ordinary area, personal, holy, and innate spells in open fields, caves, fort interiors, and assassination arenas. Confirm current 6.36 legality and AI fallback.

## Test 20: Combined-mod regression

Build fixed battle and ritual fixtures for:

- school and requirement changes;
- damage, area, range, and fatigue;
- boosters and forge costs;
- communions and #masterrit;
- sites and gem income;
- Divinitus overwrites after DE.

Re-run whenever either file changes.

# Part XVII: Operational Checklists

## First magic audit

For a new nation:

- 1 list every recruitable mage and path distribution;
- 2 separate common, capital-only, terrain, foreign, sacred, and random access;
- 3 record research per gold, commander point, and upkeep;
- 4 identify the first battlefield protection, damage, and control breakpoints;
- 5 list generic and national boosters;
- 6 identify summon-based path expansion;
- 7 map gem income and unsearched paths;
- 8 name the first war's battle package;
- 9 set battle and strategic reserves;
- 10 identify the Pretender's unique magical jobs.

## Research-turn checklist

- Did scouting change the next threat?
- What exact breakpoint is being bought?
- Which common mage casts it?
- Are the necessary gems already available?
- Is a critical forger or ritualist still counted as a researcher?
- Does one additional school level produce a usable spell?
- Is the plan overdependent on one rare random?
- What is the branch if war begins early?

## Battle-magic checklist

- legal research and path;
- carried gems or slaves;
- current skill and per-turn spend limit;
- fatigue after excess skill and Encumbrance;
- range and likely target;
- battlefield indoor or underwater status;
- resistance and friendly exposure;
- preparation and interruption risk;
- communion threshold and slave load;
- orders after script completion;
- retreat and gem preservation.

## Ritual checklist

- laboratory;
- treasury stock after other commitments;
- caster path and maximum ritual spend;
- range and UW/NUW legality;
- hosting order;
- dome risk;
- anonymous or limited status;
- repeat-order cancellation condition;
- caster and origin protection;
- exploitation after success.

## Forging checklist

- current Construction;
- current object and mod overwrite;
- actual qualified forger;
- displayed cost;
- national, global, bonus, and yearning modifiers;
- item slot;
- bearer and delivery location;
- forge mage-turn;
- alternative booster or trade;
- loss risk.

## Global checklist

- empty-slot uncertainty;
- minimum and overcast;
- excess-path bonus;
- Grand Communion;
- caster and origin;
- Dispel opposition;
- same-name contest;
- diplomatic coalition;
- payback time;
- world effect begins at step 28.

## Post-battle magic audit

After every important replay:

- Which scripted spell first failed or changed target?
- Did contact occur before the package activated?
- How many gems were consumed and why?
- Which casters were interrupted?
- What was master and slave fatigue after each major cast?
- Did resistance, Protection, dispersion, or summons decide conversion?
- Did the army exploit the effect?
- Which caster, item, or gem stock was permanently lost?
- What single change most improves the next battle?

# Part XVIII: Essays

## Essay I: Research as a Response Tree

Research is often imagined as a ladder: climb one school, take the strongest spell at each level, then begin another. That image is convenient and strategically misleading. A ladder has only one direction. A real research plan is a response tree whose branches depend on enemy armies, geography, Pretender timing, gems, and the distribution of national mages.

The root is the nation's repeatable access. If most forts can recruit E2 mages, an Earth spell cast by E2 is not one option among many; it is a scalable transformation of the roster. If S3 appears only on a rare random, the same research level may provide a spectacular but unreliable trick. Research points do not distinguish between them. Strategy must.

The branches are deadlines. A spell that finishes two turns after an invasion is not an answer to that invasion. A defensive level reached one turn early may preserve laboratories and researchers, increasing every later branch. This is why research value cannot be reduced to spell efficiency. Timing changes the quantity of future research that exists.

Scouting prunes the tree. Fire Resistance becomes urgent against mass fire damage and largely idle against an enemy who changes to poison or fatigue. A wide portfolio protects against uncertainty, but each unfinished branch delays every completed answer. The best plan is neither a straight rush nor equal investment. It maintains one main branch and one affordable pivot.

Access development creates new branches. A Construction level can forge a booster; the booster permits a summon; the summon carries a new path; that path unlocks a ritual. The original research may produce far more than its first item. A high-level spell with no caster is the opposite: knowledge with no route into the world.

An expert research screen should be read as a decision map. Every allocated point says which future is being prepared for and which is being delayed. The useful question is not "Which school is best?" It is "Which branch leaves the nation with a timely answer and the strongest next choice?"

## Essay II: Gems as Stored Time

A gem is condensed magical power, but strategically it is also stored time. It represents a site found, territory held, a connection maintained to a laboratory, and several turns during which the resource was not spent elsewhere.

This explains why equal gem costs are not equal. Five gems from a path producing twenty each month are a small slice of current flow. Five gems in an absent or scarce path may represent alchemy at four to one, diplomatic trade, or the entire stock accumulated since expansion. The spell interface displays cost; it does not display replacement time.

Combat converts stored time into immediate tempo. A path-boosting gem can bring a spell forward by one threshold. Fatigue spending can buy an additional useful cast before unconsciousness. A battlefield enchantment can make one battle occur under conditions that would otherwise require an entirely different army. The gem is efficient when the time purchased now is worth more than the time stored for later.

Forging converts gems into persistent access. A booster may be moved between mages, reused across wars, and become the first rung of a larger ladder. A summon converts them into a body or commander. A global converts a large stock into continuing flow or a new worldwide rule. These forms have different exposure: items can be captured, summons can die, and globals depend on casters and contested slots.

The gem treasury is also a calendar. A reserve for Dispel protects future turns. A forge queue promises gems to a coming threshold. Battle loads prepay the chance to survive an invasion. If every gem remains in one unlabelled total, future plans are silently sold to the first attractive order.

The mature question is not whether to spend or save. It is which future action the stock is preserving, and whether the current crisis is more valuable than that future. Hoarding without a named endpoint is wasted time. Spending without an opportunity-cost ledger is borrowed defeat.

## Essay III: From Mage to Army

A nation does not possess battlefield magic merely because its mage can cast a spell. The effect becomes military power only when it is delivered through an army structure.

The first requirement is time. Buffs, communion formation, and battlefield enchantments occupy preparation rounds. The line must hold without routing or pushing the fight outside spell range. Formation is part of the magical plan. A cheap screen may be the piece that makes an expensive spell work.

The second requirement is scale. One powerful caster can influence a battle, but repeatable mages define doctrine. If every fort supplies the required path, losses can be replaced and several armies can carry the package. If the Pretender or one rare random is essential, the effect is a strategic reserve, not standard army equipment.

The third requirement is conversion. Protection must answer the actual damage family. Evocations need legal targets and acceptable friendly exposure. Resistance spells must activate before the hostile effect. Summoned bodies must appear where their frontage and morale matter. A spell cast successfully but converted into irrelevant damage has consumed time and perhaps gems without becoming force.

The fourth requirement is exploitation. Immobilising an enemy matters if missiles, flankers, or heavy infantry can use the delay. Darkness matters if the friendly roster functions better inside it. A storm matters if it disables more hostile systems than friendly ones. Magic is strongest when it changes the exchange in favour of bodies already prepared to exploit it.

The final requirement is preservation. Mages, boosters, slaves, and gems are campaign assets. A victorious army that loses its magical core may not fight again. The full magical package includes retreat routes, commander protection, spare laboratories, and a resupply plan.

Turning a mage into part of an army is an organisational job. The spell is only one component. Screen, formation, script, gem load, counter, and post-battle survival complete the weapon.

## Essay IV: Communion Without Myths

Communion attract rules of thumb because their exact arithmetic feels cumbersome. "Use four slaves," "one master per four," or "communion share buffs" are memorable. None is a sufficient design rule.

Four slaves do create +2 paths, but they also stand on a cliff. One loss reduces every master to +1. Whether they survive depends on the spell's fatigue, the master's boosted path, each slave's relative path, the number of masters casting, the communion type, and shared buffs. The visible slave count is only the beginning of the calculation.

The participant definition corrects another common assumption. Other masters do not help divide one master's spell. One casting master and all slaves participate. Adding masters increases the number of fatigue events sent into the same pool, so an impressive casting roster can make the communion less stable.

The path comparison is equally important. Communion bonuses lift the master. If weak slaves remain below half that boosted skill, their fatigue share is multiplied by four. A spell that looks cheap after the master's excess-skill reduction can still crush every slave when repeated by several masters.

Shared self-buffs are the creative centre of communion design. A master can transmit qualifying personal protection, resistance, regeneration, or other effects to the slave block. This can turn fragile researchers into a durable magical battery. It can also distribute an incompatible effect and kill them faster. The chassis matters as much as the paths.

The communion is best understood as a power grid. Slaves provide capacity, masters draw and transform it, thresholds govern voltage, and every spell creates load. Redundancy, compatible components, controlled demand, and protected control nodes make a grid reliable. A copied ratio does not.

## Essay V: Rituals and Geopolitics

Battle spells act inside one encounter. Rituals act on a map shared with other players and intentions. A remote attack, dome, teleport, or global is both a mechanical action and a political signal.

Range compresses geography. A nation with remote search and attack can turn distant laboratories into forward influence. Magic movement can ignore ordinary fronts. Domes create protected capitals and staging provinces. None abolishes position: every effect still begins from a caster, laboratory, origin, range, or gateway that can be scouted and attacked.

Hosting order makes this influence simultaneous. Rituals resolve in random caster order. Remote attacks and magic battles precede ordinary movement. Globals take world effect after several military phases. The strategic map visible when orders are submitted is not the map on which every effect resolves.

An anonymous ritual conceals information but does not remove inference. Nations observe who has the path, range, motive, and gem economy. A repeated attack can unite several targets against the suspected caster. A global publicly changes every nation's incentives even if its direct benefit is private.

Protection also redistributes violence. A dome over the capital encourages enemies to raid gem sites, assassinate the dome caster, probe the percentage, redirect magic, or invade conventionally. Successful defence changes the cheapest hostile route; it does not end hostility.

Ritual planning must include the diplomatic aftermath. The effect, its likely attribution, the victims' alternatives, and the means of exploiting it all belong in the order. Strategic magic is geopolitics carried out through the hosting sequence.

## Essay VI: Globals as Political Economy

A global enchantment is often evaluated by payback: cost divided by monthly income. This is necessary for gem engines and radically incomplete.

The global occupies a scarce public slot. It announces a caster with high path access and a treasury capable of overcasting. It may reveal an origin province. It changes which rivals gain from cooperation, Dispel, assassination, or slot pressure. Its true cost includes the coalition it creates.

World penalties demonstrate the point most clearly. Darkness, storms, aging, ritual corruption, or income collapse do not harm every roster equally. The caster has presumably prepared summons, resistances, dominion, or alternative income. Other nations assess not the absolute harm but the caster's relative gain. A spell that reduces everyone by half can be overwhelmingly aggressive if one nation loses only a quarter.

Gem globals also alter politics. Private income increases future Dispel and forging capacity. A rival may reasonably spend more than the global's nominal value to stop it compounding. The caster's payback calculation must include the chance that the global survives, not only its monthly output.

Overcasting buys resistance to one form of attack. It does not prevent assassination, old age, origin conquest, or a random full-slot replacement attempt. Every additional gem increases magical security while concentrating more value behind the same mortal dependency.

The strongest global plan is a state programme: caster security, reserve gems, dome and mundane defence, diplomatic preparation, origin protection, and a schedule for exploiting the new world. The enchantment is the public institution; the protected network behind it is the state that keeps it alive.

## Essay VII: The Level-Nine Decision

Level-nine research is seductive because it promises the largest effects in the game. The cost is not only the research points shown on the bar. It is every lower branch delayed while the nation climbs, every mage-turn required to create the caster, and every gem reserved instead of winning earlier battles.

Legendary selection makes the trade sharper. Most schools do not grant a complete catalogue at level 9; one spell is selected at a time. The first choice needs a named caster, treasury, target, counter, and operational date.

Some legendary spells transform the map. Nexus Gate changes connectivity. Others transform magical economy: Arcane Nexus taxes world expenditure, and Astral Corruption punishes ordinary magical action. Utterdark or similar world effects change the value of entire rosters. Wish can cross conventional boundaries but carries uncertainty that must be tested rather than romanticised.

The best legendary spell is relative to preparation. Tartarian Gate is stronger for a nation that can repair, equip, and lead its results. A dominion-scaled economic global is stronger for a nation already winning religious territory. A punishment global is stronger when the caster's own economy is exempt or prepared.

Counterpressure begins before the cast. Rivals can observe research direction, boosters, rare path mages, pearl hoarding, and Construction races. A path to level 9 may invite attack precisely because its future is frightening. Reaching the threshold requires surviving the signal.

The level-nine decision should be worked backwards from the world it creates. Describe the position one turn after success, four turns after success, and after the obvious coalition response. If those positions are not favourable, the legendary spell is not yet a plan. It is only a possibility.

## Sources and Open Questions

### Principal sources

- Illwinter, Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2, especially Magic, paths and schools, battle magic, rituals, global enchantments, communions, gems, research, legendary spells, items, Divine Magic, alchemy, and the spell and item appendices.
- Illwinter, Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34.
- [Illwinter Dominions 6 documentation](#).
- [Illwinter Dominions 6 changes](#).
- [Official Dominions 6.30 announcement](#).
- Supplied DomEnhanced2\_16.dm.
- Supplied Divinitus\_1.15.3\_DE.dm.
- Loggy's reverse-engineering notes, used only to define historical combat-gem threshold tests; the notes predate official 6.15 and 6.30 corrections.
- Naaira's communion guide, used for current player doctrine and examples, while the manual and patch ledger own the rules.

Community references are used to discover disputed questions and test candidates, not to override current official rules without reproducible evidence.



## Open questions

Current-game tests or resolved object data are still needed for:

- exact current optional combat-gem AI thresholds and all target-selection weights after 6.15 and 6.30;
- every rounding step in spell fatigue, penetration, communions, forging, and ritual contests;
- complete ordering and independence of layered domes;
- every current object value altered after the revision-2 manual;
- exact Wish vocabulary, aliases, random distributions, and restrictions;
- all effective DE and Divinitus spell, item, site, mage, and summon records;
- automatic-item, forced-removal, multi-form, mod-specific communion, Grand Communion, and forge interactions;
- simultaneous artifact and global edge cases.

[Book IX](#) now owns the exact mod command scope; this list is limited to behaviours that still need engine evidence.

# Foundation Book VI: Strategy and Campaign Conduct

## From systems to campaign

Dominions is won on the map, but the map is only the visible surface of the contest. Armies occupy provinces; research changes what those armies can survive; laboratories turn gems into reach; scouts turn uncertainty into decisions; forts turn territory into replacement capacity; diplomacy changes how many fronts must be defended; and Thrones determine when strength becomes victory.

Foundation rule: Strategy is the conversion of limited resources into a position that can force, survive, or prevent the next decisive event.

A nation does not win by collecting the largest abstract total of gold, gems, research, or territory. It wins by making those resources matter before rivals can answer, then turning the advantage into enough claimed Ascension Points. Every recommendation in [Book VI](#) has a context and a deadline.

[Book VI](#) is where the earlier rules meet the map. It assumes the mechanical foundations instead of teaching their formulas again. A spy revealing income is a rule. Recruiting one before the first war is advice whose value depends on access, cost, geography, and the information already available.

## Edition note

The shared ruleset and evidence language remain in [Book I](#). Books II-V own the detailed economy, religious, combat, and magic rules. [Book VI](#) brings them together for expansion, intelligence, logistics, diplomacy, defeat, and victory conversion. [Book IX](#) supplies exact modded changes whenever a campaign plan depends on DE or Divinitus.

## Current-version corrections and additions that matter

Dominions 6 introduced strategic systems and interface changes that make some older-series advice incomplete:

| Current feature or correction                                       | Strategic consequence                                                                                    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Optional hidden maps require exploration                            | Map knowledge is acquired rather than assumed; scouts can reveal routes as well as armies                |
| Maps may contain multiple planes                                    | Adjacency, sanctuary, invasion routes, and throne access can cross a plane boundary                      |
| Formal diplomacy supports binding NAPs with humans and AI           | Treaty terms may be enforced by the engine, but the game setting and agreed social doctrine still matter |
| Raid is movement followed by pillaging, without an automatic return | Pillager units now seize and damage the destination rather than performing an abstract round trip        |
| Scrying inside dominion can detect glamourous units                 | Glamour conceals information but does not guarantee operational surprise                                 |
| Thrones become visibly lit after being claimed                      | Claimed victory progress is easier to read from the map                                                  |
| Many globals depend on an origin province that must be held         | Strategic enchantment defence includes territorial defence                                               |

| Current feature or correction                                                                        | Strategic consequence                                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Score graphs incorporate more sources accurately                                                     | Threat estimates using graphs are stronger than in early releases, though still incomplete |
| AI builds forts, recruits better national troops, and plans high-level rituals, globals, and dispels | Old descriptions of a purely passive or magically incapable AI are obsolete                |
| Magic-phase movers can be included in moving-army setup                                              | Teleporting and ordinary elements can be prepared as one operation                         |
| Cataclysm is harder to counter                                                                       | Late games with Cataclysm enabled must treat the victory threshold as a moving clock       |
| Large games host faster and allied site information was corrected in 6.34                            | Operational coordination is more reliable than in affected older versions                  |

Object balance still changes through patches. A current nation plan must be rebuilt when its roster, spell access, Pretender options, or mod layer changes, even if the campaign principles remain valid.

## Using the campaign sections

Expansion, scouting, borders, research signals, war planning, sieges, Thrones, and the turn checklist form the main route. Raiding, remote warfare, deterrence, coalition politics, recovery, and after-action review become more useful once those basics are familiar. The single-player chapter explains what AI games teach well and where multiplayer creates a different strategic problem.

# Part I: Strategy as Conversion

## Position, force, and deadline

A strategic position has three parts:

- 1 Assets: provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, armies, mages, gems, research, Pretender, and diplomatic relationships.
- 2 Access: which assets can affect which places and at what time.
- 3 Deadline: the next event that changes the value of the position.

Deadlines include an enemy research breakpoint, a dormant Pretender awakening, a fort cracking, a treaty expiring, a global taking effect, a claim-capable priest reaching a Throne, or the arrival of Cataclysm. The same assets can be sufficient before a deadline and worthless after it.

This yields a practical model:

strategic value  
= usable assets  
x probability of correct delivery  
x value before the deadline  
- exposure and opportunity cost

This is not an engine formula. It is a way to compare plans. A large army has little current value if it cannot cross the terrain in time. A research lead has little war value if the mages carrying it are trapped in a sieged capital. A cheap raider has high value if it pulls an expensive counter-mage away from the decisive front.

## The six conversions

Most campaigns turn on six conversions:

| Conversion               | Example                                                  | Failure mode                                     |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Economy into capacity    | Gold builds forts and recruits mages                     | Infrastructure delays necessary defence          |
| Capacity into knowledge  | Mages spend turns researching                            | The nation researches effects it cannot field    |
| Knowledge into force     | Mages, gems, troops, and scripts form an army package    | A spell list is mistaken for a deployable force  |
| Force into position      | Armies take routes, labs, forts, sites, and Thrones      | Victories occur in strategically empty provinces |
| Position into constraint | Raids, forts, threats, and treaties narrow enemy choices | Gains are too diffuse to force a response        |
| Constraint into victory  | The nation cracks, storms, and claims enough Thrones     | Dominance is enjoyed but never converted         |

Strong play moves deliberately from one conversion to the next. Weak play often becomes trapped between them: rich but unable to recruit, researched but unable to cast, victorious but unable to siege, or dominant but unable to claim.

## Tempo and initiative

Tempo is the amount of useful change achieved before an opponent can respond. Initiative is the ability to present threats that determine where and how the opponent must spend the next turn.

Tempo is not speed alone. A fast raid that loses a unique commander may surrender more future tempo than it gains. A month spent combining armies may be correct if the merged force can remove a capital and every smaller force would bounce.

Initiative is strongest when threats are:

- credible: enough force or hidden capacity exists to execute them;
- multiple: the defender cannot cover every target;
- asymmetric: the attacker spends less than the defender must reserve;
- timed: the threats mature together;
- convertible: at least one successful branch leads to a fort, lab, army destruction, or Throne.

The objective is not perpetual aggression. It is the ability to decide which problem becomes urgent.

## The strategic horizons

| Horizon   | Typical distance                 | Central question                                               |
|-----------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Turn      | Current hosting cycle            | Which orders can fail, collide, or become illegal?             |
| Operation | Several turns                    | Which target can be isolated, reached, cracked, and exploited? |
| War       | Research and reinforcement cycle | Which exchange rate and breakpoint can the enemy not sustain?  |
| Game      | Victory threshold                | Which route produces enough claimed Ascension Points?          |

Good decisions align all four. A tactically excellent battle can damage the operation by consuming gems needed for the storm. A successful operation can damage the war if it exposes two unforted borders. A winning war can lose the game if another nation claims the last required Throne.

## The cost of attention

Dominions has an unpriced resource: player attention. Every additional raider, scout network, forge route, blood-hunting transfer, communion, or diplomatic promise creates orders that must be checked. A system that is theoretically optimal but routinely misordered has a lower practical value than a robust system.

Attention costs grow sharply in war because each turn adds:

- battle reports and script diagnosis;
- enemy movement estimates;
- gem and item transfers;
- recruitment replacement;
- route and retreat checks;
- diplomacy;
- throne arithmetic.

Simple habits such as renaming commanders, marking armies, keeping standard scripts, using repeatable gem loads, and following a fixed turn audit are strategic tools. They lower the chance that a mature position dies to an omitted order.

# Part II: Expansion

## What expansion is for

Expansion is the first time a Pretender design and national roster are turned into territory. The result is more than a province count. Good expansion produces:

- gold and resource flow;
- room and population for forts;
- magic sites and independent recruits;
- defensible boundaries;
- routes toward or around Thrones;
- enough surviving troops and commanders to discourage an early war;
- an infrastructure schedule that does not stop recruitment.

A player can finish the first year with many poor, exposed provinces and a hollow army. Another can hold slightly fewer provinces but own two strong fort sites, a narrow border, and intact expansion parties. The second position may be stronger.

## Expansion testing

Expansion should be tested under the actual game assumptions:

| Variable       | Why it must match                                                    |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Nation and age | Starting army, roster, independent composition, and resources differ |

| Variable                   | Why it must match                                                          |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pretender and awakening    | An awake expander changes routes, risk, and recruitment                    |
| Scales and dominion        | Gold, resources, supplies, bless, and Pretender safety change              |
| Independent strength       | Required party size and acceptable targets change                          |
| Map or map type            | Terrain, connectivity, caves, water, and start density change              |
| Active mods and load order | Costs, units, blessings, spells, and Pretenders may differ                 |
| House rules                | Expansion diplomacy, mercenaries, and early attack restrictions may differ |

A useful test protocol is:

- 1 Create the intended ruleset and game settings.
- 2 Record the Pretender design.
- 3 Play through turn 12, including realistic recruitment, Province Defence, site searching, and fort construction.
- 4 Record every fight, loss, province type, treasury level, fort start, and remaining army.
- 5 Repeat on several starts.
- 6 Change only one major element at a time.
- 7 Keep the reliable build, not the one with the luckiest maximum.

The community practice of testing to turn 12 is valuable because one in-game year includes route variation, attrition, winter or summer conditions, and the first infrastructure decision. A benchmark is meaningful only if its accounting includes what the real game will buy. Tests that omit PD, forts, researchers, or required temples create an imaginary expansion economy.

## The first expansion audit

Before the first attack:

- What troop or Pretender package is the expansion engine?
- Which independent types can it defeat cheaply?
- Which types can kill it through lances, high damage, mass missiles, magic, poison, fear, or surround penalties?
- Does it need a bless, prophet, priest, mage, screen, or specific formation?
- How many losses can be replaced without delaying the second party?
- What is the retreat route?
- Which adjacent province improves capital recruitment through resources?
- Which route reveals the most map or claims the most valuable boundary?

The first attack should normally be selected after scouting reports arrive. Independent armies do not change merely because the estimate changes; the report contains uncertainty. The correct response to uncertain numbers is margin, not false precision.

## Expansion party archetypes

| Archetype               | Strength                                 | Main risk                                                   |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Armoured line           | Absorbs low-damage infantry and missiles | High-damage barbarians, lances, fatigue, slow killing       |
| Defence or glamour line | Avoids many ordinary attacks             | Surround penalties, high attack, area damage, magic weapons |

| Archetype                         | Strength                                           | Main risk                                                              |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missile mass                      | Damages before contact and exploits low protection | Shields, armour, weather, ammunition, fast contact                     |
| Lance or impact force             | Powerful first contact                             | Wasted charge, attrition after impact, missile exposure                |
| Giant or elite squad              | High individual durability and damage              | Low numbers, surrounding, expensive casualties                         |
| Sacred party                      | Bless creates an efficient specialist package      | Holy-point limits, priest dependency, wrong matchup                    |
| Awake monster                     | Independent commander with rapid early tempo       | Irreplaceable loss, hostile dominion, fatigue, specialist independents |
| Awake Titan                       | Expansion plus later slots and strategic magic     | Complex scripting, afflictions, insufficient early damage              |
| Thug pair or small commander team | Mobile, low troop demand, scalable later           | Gem or bless dependency, counter matchups                              |
| Mage-supported troops             | Solves hard types and reduces attrition            | Lost research, stray death, gem consumption, script failure            |

These are roles, not strict categories. A sacred giant line may belong to three at once. The purpose is to identify why the party wins and which target will break it.

## Target selection

Target value has at least five dimensions:

- 1 Win probability.
- 2 Expected permanent loss.
- 3 Economic value.
- 4 Positional value.
- 5 Information value.

The weakest visible province is not automatically the best target. A resource-rich cap-ring forest can unlock a second party. A low-income mountain may secure a choke point or later fort. A province on the wrong side of the intended boundary may create a diplomatic dispute. A throne province may reveal valuable effects but contain mage support far beyond ordinary independents.

An expansion route should prefer:

- targets the party counters;
- cap-ring terrain that improves recruitment;
- rich farmlands and high population for economy and forts;
- strategic connectors and plane gates;
- provinces that cut off a safe interior;
- independent mages or special recruits;
- routes that can be reinforced rather than isolated.

## Minimum force and acceptable loss

The ideal party is not the smallest one that can win once. It is the smallest one that wins with enough reliability and survivors to keep tempo. A party that takes a province with 55% probability is not efficient merely because it is cheap.

Expansion losses have compounding cost:

- replacement gold and resources;
- commander turns spent collecting troops;
- delayed second and third parties;
- lost veteran experience;
- exposed routes;
- weaker deterrence at first contact.

Overbuilding also compounds. A single enormous party may win every fight but captures only one province per turn. Two parties with safe matchups normally create more map tempo, reveal more land, and deny more provinces.

Use three margins:

- combat margin: enough strength to survive report error and random battle outcomes;
- attrition margin: enough survivors to take the next scheduled target;
- strategic margin: enough reserve or recruitment that one bad fight does not collapse the opening.

## Routing and branch points

An expansion party should rarely be sent to the far edge without a return plan. Every route should mark:

- the next two intended targets;
- a branch if the preferred target is too dangerous;
- a rendezvous province for reinforcements;
- the future border;
- the nearest fort site;
- the path home or toward a threatened neighbour.

Interior provinces can be deliberately left for a later party if the outer route encloses them safely. This increases frontier speed without surrendering the eventual income. The risk is that an unscouted connector, cave, water route, or rival cuts into the pocket.

## First contact

First contact turns expansion into diplomacy. The first border message should settle practical facts before fear fills the gap:

- which provinces each side believes are natural claims;
- whether a disputed province contains a Throne, special site, or critical route;
- whether formal or social NAPs are in use;
- how countdowns are counted;
- whether scouts and stealth units are permitted;
- how accidental bumps will be handled.

The best border is not always equal by province count. A stable border that preserves a rich interior can be worth conceding one weak province. A narrow, fortifiable line is often stronger than a long geometrically "fair" boundary.

## When expansion ends

Independent expansion ends when profitable unclaimed targets disappear or when continuing exposes the nation to an unacceptable first-war position. The transition signs are:



- neighbouring expansion parties can collide;
- taking the next province creates a disputed salient;
- armies must combine to take Thrones or hard independents;
- forts and researchers now return more than another marginal army;
- opponents have reached military breakpoints;
- the nation must choose a first-war target or defensive posture.

The correct transition does not stop all growth. Thrones, underwater access, caves, remote provinces, and independent pockets may remain. It changes the dominant problem from beating known neutral defenders to acting under human opposition.

## Part III: Scouting, Intelligence, and Uncertainty

### Information is a resource

Information changes which orders are rational. It does not directly kill troops, but it prevents armies from attacking the wrong counter, reveals undefended infrastructure, identifies a throne rush, and allows gems to be carried only where necessary.

The value of information depends on:

- accuracy: how close the report is to reality;
- coverage: how much of the relevant map or force is observed;
- timeliness: whether it arrives before orders are due;
- interpretation: whether the player understands what the evidence implies;
- denial: whether the opponent can be kept from obtaining the same advantage.

Old information decays. A capital report from six turns ago still identifies fort and terrain, but not the current army, research package, gem reserve, or commander movement.

### Official information channels

| Observer or condition   | Information provided                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scout in province       | Owner, military estimate, fort construction, province history, current temperature and neighbour temperature                |
| Priest in province      | Scout information plus dominion strength and owner                                                                          |
| Spy in province         | Scout information plus income, supplies, known sites, unrest, PD, and more accurate military information                    |
| Friendly dominion       | Owner, income, temperature, neighbour dominion                                                                              |
| Scrying                 | Owner, highly accurate military information, income, supplies, sites, PD, history, temperature, dominion, forts, and unrest |
| Province ownership      | Full provincial information, with map-name exploration distance depending on age                                            |
| Adjacent ownership      | Neighbour owner, temperature, and unreliable military information                                                           |
| Spy in an enemy capital | Access to enemy score-graph data even when score graphs are disabled                                                        |

These channels overlap but are not interchangeable. A scout can see construction; a spy can estimate state capacity; scrying can penetrate heavily patrolled areas without risking a physical scout. Dominion vision is broad but does not reveal every military fact.

## The intelligence cycle

Use a five-step cycle:

- 1 Question: what decision must be made?
- 2 Collection: which scout, spy, scry, battle probe, graph, or diplomatic inquiry can answer it?
- 3 Assessment: which facts are observed, inferred, stale, or possibly deceptive?
- 4 Action: what order changes because of the result?
- 5 Review: after hosting, which assumption was correct and which source failed?

"Scout the enemy" is too broad. Better questions include:

- Can the border fort be cracked in one turn?
- Which province contains the enemy's research mass?
- Does the army have poison resistance, magic weapons, or battlefield mobility?
- Which commander is likely carrying gems?
- How many Ascension Points can the nation claim within three turns?
- Which route is outside ordinary reinforcement range?

Collection without a decision produces clutter.

## Reading partial evidence

No single clue proves a full plan. Combine indicators:

| Indicator                           | Possible meaning                            | Alternative explanation                           |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Research graph rises sharply        | Research infrastructure matured             | Site, event, Pretender, or graph uncertainty      |
| Gem income appears high             | Wide site-search coverage or rich territory | Throne income, globals, events, or hidden alchemy |
| Army disappears from border         | Withdrawal or magic-movement staging        | Glamour, stealth, transfer, or report failure     |
| Construction mages stop researching | Forge cycle or army deployment              | Rituals, site searching, illness, lab loss        |
| H3 unit moves toward a front        | Throne claim preparation                    | Bless support, preaching, or ordinary movement    |
| Large cheap-unit recruitment        | Siege preparation or mass screen            | Patrol, freespawn organisation, or replacement    |
| NAPs requested on several borders   | Consolidation for war elsewhere             | Genuine insecurity or throne preparation          |

An estimate should carry a confidence statement: observed, likely, possible, or unknown. This prevents one attractive story from becoming the only story.

## Scouting density

A useful network has layers:

- border screen: current armies, construction, and route changes;
- operational depth: forts, labs, reinforcement roads, and reserve armies;
- strategic nodes: capitals, Thrones, globals' origin provinces, blood centres, major laboratories;

- rear warning: stealth raiders, plane gates, underwater exits, and indirect routes.

One scout on each border province is not a network. Scouts should leapfrog or overlap so the loss of one does not blind an entire front. Spare scouts can travel with armies to loot gear, hold transferred gems, or preserve observation after a province changes hands.

## Patrol and concealment

Official detection compares:

Patrol Strength + 2d25 open-ended  
versus  
Stealth Strength + 2d25 open-ended

Stealth strength is based on the commander and is reduced by troops in the party. Patrol strength combines unit contributions, is reduced by unrest, and gains from PD at 15 or more. Flying, map movement, Precision, Patrol Bonus, commander status, Mindless, and Undisciplined affect individual patrol contribution.

The complete manual arithmetic is:

```
Stealth Strength
= leader Stealth
- 1 per stealth troop with Stealth below 50
- 0.5 per stealth troop with Stealth 50 or more

individual Patrol Strength
= (Precision + Map Move) / 20 + Patrol Bonus
use Map Move 30 if the unit flies

province Patrol Strength
= sum of individual contributions
- min(Unrest, 100) / 2
+ max(Province Defence - 14, 0)
```

Commander contributions are doubled. The manual halves the contribution of Mindless and Undisciplined units; this official wording controls where community pages describe a different Undisciplined adjustment. The displayed patrol number may be rounded, so exact work should preserve the underlying fractions.

Let  $D = \text{Patrol Strength} - \text{Stealth Strength}$ . Enumerating both open-ended 2d25 rolls gives the following chance of detection:

| D below stealth | Chance | D above stealth | Chance |
|-----------------|--------|-----------------|--------|
| -60             | 0.1%   | +60             | 99.9%  |
| -55             | 0.2%   | +55             | 99.8%  |
| -50             | 0.4%   | +50             | 99.6%  |
| -45             | 0.7%   | +45             | 99.2%  |
| -40             | 1.2%   | +40             | 98.7%  |
| -35             | 2.0%   | +35             | 97.7%  |
| -30             | 3.6%   | +30             | 96.0%  |
| -25             | 6.3%   | +25             | 93.0%  |
| -20             | 10.6%  | +20             | 88.3%  |
| -15             | 17.1%  | +15             | 81.3%  |
| -10             | 25.9%  | +10             | 72.1%  |

| D below stealth | Chance | D above stealth | Chance |
|-----------------|--------|-----------------|--------|
| -5              | 36.7%  | +5              | 61.0%  |
| 0               | 48.8%  | 0               | 48.8%  |

Equal strengths do not give 50% because detection requires the patrol total to be greater; a tied opposed total leaves the stealth party hidden. These figures are official plus derived: the formula is the manual's, and the table is a direct enumeration rather than a fitted sample.

Consequences:

- detection is probabilistic, not guaranteed;
- repeated exposure raises cumulative risk;
- adding troops makes many stealth parties easier to detect;
- high unrest weakens patrols;
- PD 15+ changes a province from a token garrison into part of an intelligence screen;
- a discovered stealth force fights the outside defenders, while ordinary fort defenders not patrolling remain inside.

Movement and patrol timing also matters. Move and Patrol lets an arriving army fight outside a friendly fort, but it does not have time to search for stealth units during that same turn. The order becomes ordinary Patrol on the following turn.

## Information denial and deception

Denial measures include:

- killing or patrolling out scouts;
- avoiding unnecessary army concentration near observed borders;
- moving gems and items at the last practical moment;
- hiding capable commanders among ordinary researchers;
- keeping several plausible research branches;
- protecting capital and throne interiors from spies;
- using domes, stealth, glamour, or magic movement where appropriate;
- displaying false or incomplete threats.

Deception should create a plausible wrong decision. A visible army near an irrelevant Throne matters only if the enemy must reserve a force against it. A false weak border is useful only if the actual counter can arrive. Deception that requires the opponent to act irrationally is hope.

## Battle probes and pings

A probe can reveal:

- troop and commander identities;
- positions, formations, and orders;
- bless effects;
- scripted spells;
- carried gems through observed casting;
- throne independent mages and their spell repertoire;
- fort or field context.

The cost includes the probing commander, information given to the opponent, possible treaty implications, and the chance that the probe changes the target before the real attack. A retreat script

does not guarantee survival when routes are hostile, a commander is trapped, or combat reaches it too quickly.

## Score graphs

Graphs are strategic indicators, not inventories. They can show trends in provinces, forts, income, research, army size, dominion, or resources according to game settings. Current versions incorporate more event-derived changes accurately, and a spy in an enemy capital can expose that enemy's graph information even if ordinary graphs are disabled.

Graphs should answer comparative questions:

- Who is compounding fastest?
- Who suffered a sudden army or territory loss?
- Whose research curve implies a breakpoint?
- Which apparent victim remains economically dangerous?
- Which leader can reach a throne threshold?

Graphs cannot show scripts, exact counters, hidden gem stock, diplomatic obligations, or the quality of units behind an army-size number.

Since version 6.35, victory reveals all score graphs and the hidden map to the players who remain until the game ends. Elimination still reveals neither, so a defeated player removed before the final result does not receive the same post-game intelligence. This is a review and learning tool, not information available for the decisions that produced the victory.

# Part IV: Map Structure, Borders, and Infrastructure

## Strategic geography

Every province has at least four geographic meanings:

- economic: income, population, resources, supplies, and sites;
- network: which provinces and planes it connects;
- military: terrain, movement cost, fort and battlefield context;
- political: border, Throne, buffer, treaty claim, or coalition route.

A low-income connector may be more valuable than a rich dead end. A cave entrance, water crossing, or plane gate can create an invasion route that ordinary border counting misses.

## Interior lines and exterior pressure

A nation has interior lines when its forces can move between threatened fronts faster than enemies can coordinate around the outside. Forts, roads, labs, central terrain, sailing, flight, and magic movement strengthen interior lines. Long tendrils, mountain or swamp barriers, and isolated underwater pockets weaken them.

Interior lines permit one reserve to answer several threats, but simultaneous hosting limits reaction. A reserve must be placed where its legal next-turn destinations are known before the enemy commits. "It can respond eventually" is not the same as "it can intercept next turn."

Exterior pressure becomes decisive when several enemies attack different nodes at once. Diplomacy is part of geography: a neutral border can shorten the defended perimeter more effectively than any fort.

## Border shapes

| Shape                        | Advantage                            | Risk                                   |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Narrow choke                 | Easy to fortify and scout            | One lost node may open the interior    |
| Broad line                   | Many routes for offence              | High scouting and reserve demand       |
| Salient                      | Threatens several enemy provinces    | Can be cut off from reinforcement      |
| Pocket                       | Safe later expansion and recruitment | Hidden routes or rivals may steal it   |
| Corridor                     | Connects separated holdings          | Vulnerable to a single raid or fort    |
| Island or underwater enclave | Difficult for some rivals to reach   | Limited exits and specialised counters |
| Plane gate network           | Strategic mobility and surprise      | Gate provinces become decisive nodes   |

The strongest border is the one the nation can actually observe, reinforce, and politically maintain.

## Fort placement

Fort decisions should be evaluated across five roles:

- 1 Recruitment: population, resources, terrain recruits, and national restrictions.
- 2 Research: repeatable mage production and safe laboratories.
- 3 Control: sealing routes and forcing enemies into sieges.
- 4 Logistics: resupply, gem pooling, forging, ritual origins, and army assembly.
- 5 Victory: protecting Thrones and claim-capable commanders.

An early fort that produces the key mage may be worth more than a richer province. A border fort with no recruitable value may still impose a siege clock. A fort adjacent to a resource-hungry capital can reduce the capital's resource draw and should be tested before construction.

## Laboratories as strategic nodes

Labs do more than recruit mages:

- collect site income into the national treasury;
- permit research, forging, rituals, and empowerment;
- pool and transfer gems;
- support magic movement and remote operations;
- allow rapid equipment changes;
- become targets for raiders and teleporters.

A forward lab increases force projection but also exposes stored gems and mages. A laboratory network should include redundancy. If one captured lab disconnects the whole front from gem supply and ritual access, the network has a single point of failure.

## Temples and religious infrastructure

Temples:

- generate temple checks;
- support sacred and priest recruitment where national rules allow;
- raise maximum dominion according to the temple rule;
- enable Blood Sacrifice where available;
- protect dominion and help make Pretenders safer;
- turn Throne and border provinces into religious anchors.

Temple value rises near enemy dominion, special dominions, Thrones, and awakening or immortality operations. A temple is also visible intent. Building one in a disputed province can be read as territorial commitment.

## Province Defence as delay and information

PD should be bought for a purpose:

- defeating scout captures or tiny raiders;
- adding patrol strength at 15+;
- forcing larger raids and revealing their composition;
- joining an outside field battle;
- buying time for a counter-raider;
- exploiting unusually strong national PD;
- maintaining a low-cost tripwire.

PD is not a substitute for a mobile defence because the buyer cannot move it, preserve it through retreat, or customise it like a field army. Excessive uniform PD converts liquid gold into local strength that an enemy can bypass or counter once.

## Map annotation

A serious strategic map should mark:

- every known Throne and Ascension Point value;
- claimed and unclaimed status;
- forts under construction and their completion turns;
- laboratories, temples, and major sites;
- routes by movement class;
- water, river, mountain-pass, cave, and plane restrictions;
- likely enemy research and army positions;
- treaty borders and expiry dates;
- rally points, gem depots, and retreat routes;
- provinces whose loss breaks a corridor or global origin.

The map should show commitments as well as ownership.

# Part V: Research as a Strategic Response Tree

---

## From queue to campaign plan

Book V establishes the mechanics of research. Strategy asks when each breakpoint must enter the field. A research plan should contain:

- a main line that creates the nation's preferred army package;
- an expansion line if early magic materially changes neutral conquest;
- a defensive branch for the most likely early invader;
- a mobility or raiding branch;
- a forging and access branch;
- a late-game transition;
- an explicit rule for when to pivot.

A fixed queue ignores evidence. Constantly changing schools wastes accumulated progress and never reaches a threshold. The solution is a response tree with preselected branch points.

## Breakpoint records

For each important level, record:

| Field     | Question                                                           |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Effect    | What new battle, ritual, item, or summon becomes possible?         |
| Caster    | Which repeatable or unique commander delivers it?                  |
| Resources | Which gems, slaves, items, communion bodies, or labs are required? |
| Scale     | Can one army use it, or every army?                                |
| Deadline  | On which turn or before which enemy event must it arrive?          |
| Counter   | What obvious answer reduces its value?                             |
| Pivot     | Which adjacent research provides the next answer?                  |

The result is useful operational knowledge, not a list of admired spells.

## Research signals

Research is partly observable through graphs, deployed spells, forged gear, summoned units, and mage movement. A rapid rush can surprise once; repeated use reveals the level. Rivals can then infer adjacent capabilities.

Information denial methods include:

- delaying public use until the decisive battle;
- researching a cheap supporting branch after the main threshold;
- fielding a lower-level package that conceals the real peak;
- avoiding recognisable booster staging at exposed labs;
- maintaining several mages capable of different path packages.

The cost of secrecy must be real. Refusing to use a completed answer and losing territory to preserve surprise is normally poor conversion.



## Timing attacks as temporary advantage

A timing attack begins when relative power is temporarily highest. Common windows include:

- an awake expander surviving expansion while neighbours' imprisoned designs remain absent;
- a dormant Pretender awakening;
- a mass bless reaching sustainable sacred recruitment;
- a key battlefield enchantment or resistance spell;
- the first reliable communion;
- a Construction level that produces thugs or path boosters;
- a summon mass reaching operational scale;
- a mobility ritual opening unexpected targets;
- a hostile global changing the world's exchange rates;
- an opponent exhausting gems or elite recruitment in another war.

The attack needs preparation before the breakpoint:

- troops and commanders recruited;
- gems moved;
- items forged;
- scouts positioned;
- treaty countdown started;
- routes cleared;
- siege strength assembled.

Research finishing is the last dependency, not the first planning step.

## Portfolio depth

A nation with one exceptional package can force opponents to buy one exceptional counter. Portfolio depth adds a second axis:

- physical protection plus elemental resistance;
- battlefield army plus mobile raiders;
- troops plus MR-negates control;
- field strength plus remote attacks;
- glamour or stealth plus conventional pressure;
- army wipes plus fort-cracking capacity.

The purpose is not variety for its own sake. Each branch should punish the answer to another branch. If all packages fail to the same resistance, mobility, or commander kill, the portfolio is visually diverse but strategically narrow.

## Research under invasion

When invaded, divide research into:

- survival threshold: the cheapest completed answer that prevents immediate collapse;
- stabilisation threshold: the package that can win or deter field battles;
- reversal threshold: mobility, summons, or scale that turns defence into counteroffence.

Do not abandon a nearly complete decisive level for a weaker emergency spell without calculating completion time. Do not continue a grand late-game rush while the laboratories generating it are about to fall. The correct pivot is measured in turns, legal casters, and delivery-not anxiety.

# Part VI: Movement, Logistics, and Force Projection

## The official movement model

Army movement is limited by the slowest unit. Only commanders move independently; troops require leadership. Ground movement is calculated in half-steps: leaving the origin and entering the destination each have a terrain cost.

| Terrain      | Ground half-step cost |
|--------------|-----------------------|
| Plains       | 3                     |
| Forest       | 5                     |
| Waste        | 5                     |
| Highlands    | 6                     |
| Swamp        | 7                     |
| Sea          | 5                     |
| Cave         | 4                     |
| Cave Forest  | 6                     |
| Crystal Cave | 6                     |
| Drip Cave    | 7                     |

Modifiers include:

- entering or leaving a province with enemy non-stealthy forces: +4;
- enemy stealthy forces: +3;
- snow: +1;
- road: -2, with a minimum cost of 2;
- matching survival ability: -2 for the relevant terrain.

Forest Survival also helps in Cave Forest, Mountain Survival in Crystal Cave, and Swamp Survival in Drip Cave. Flying normally costs 3 per half-step, 5 in caves, and +1 for enemy presence.

Common Map Move parameters provide a scale:

| Example        | Map Move |
|----------------|----------|
| Heavy infantry | 8        |
| Light infantry | 14       |
| Light cavalry  | 20       |
| Unicorn        | 26       |
| Slow flier     | 14       |
| Ordinary flier | 20       |
| Fast flier     | 26       |

Commanders normally receive +2 to the general parameter. Object values and special abilities still control the actual unit.

## Barriers and army composition

Rivers require Cold +1 on both sides unless the army can fly, float, swim, or otherwise cross amphibiously. Mountain passes require Heat +1 on both sides unless the army flies, floats, or has Mountain Survival.

For special movement, every troop in the relevant army normally needs the required ability. Sailing and granted water breathing have their own exceptions. One slow, non-surviving, or non-amphibious squad can invalidate the intended route for the whole commander.

Version 6.36 establishes three current exceptions or extensions worth recording in route plans:

- a swimming mount is sufficient for its mounted unit to cross a river;
- Perpetual Storm increases movement cost in caves and underwater provinces as well as the previously affected environments;
- Gift of Water Breathing can protect against Lost Land.

Each statement is narrow. A suitable mount does not grant swimming to unrelated troops, and protection from one underwater disaster does not prove general underwater legality.

Every movement order should be checked against the actual slowest and least capable component, not the commander icon or the majority of the force.

## Friendly, hostile, and intercepting movement

Friendly movement resolves before hostile movement. In contested situations:

- more than two sides may fight sequential battles in a determined entry order;
- allied defenders fight in sequence, with defender order random;
- hostile armies attempting to swap provinces may meet in either province or miss and exchange positions;
- relative army size and terrain influence interception;
- entering a friendly fortified province normally places the army inside the fort;
- Move and Patrol is required to arrive and fight outside.

An arrow remaining on the map does not prove that a movement order is still legal. If conditions change before hosting-such as a river, pass, leadership, or destination issue-the unit may remain in place.

## Published collision algorithm: test hypothesis

A current community movement page publishes a more detailed reverse-engineered procedure for a directly adjacent one-step swap:

- 1 calculate a chassis value for the moving commanders and squads on each side;
- 2 compare each side's value with a separate random result from 0 to 349; if both values fall below their rolls, the armies pass and exchange provinces;
- 3 otherwise, each side rolls an open-ended die with its chassis value as the die size and adds one tenth of that chassis value;
- 4 the lower result is stopped, so the battle occurs in that side's starting province; a reported tie rule favours the side from the higher-numbered origin province.

The same page says this collision check applies to adjacent single-step swaps, while multi-province movement can pass through. It also opens by warning that the movement article needs more accurate information and publishes no 6.36 save set. Edition 27 therefore records the procedure as a source-traced hypothesis for S4, not as the rule players should assume without qualification.

## Operational reach

Operational reach is the set of provinces that a force can influence within a deadline. It includes:

- ordinary legal movement;
- sailing, flight, stealth, amphibious movement, and plane access;
- magic-phase movement;
- reinforcement and gem routes;
- the ability to survive after arrival;
- the ability to retreat.

A province "in range" of a teleporting thug may still be strategically unsafe if it has no laboratory for escape, no friendly retreat route, or a counter-mage can arrive in the same phase. Reach must include extraction.

## The logistics chain

Every serious army consumes:

- troops and replacements;
- commanders and appropriate leadership;
- food and supplies;
- gems and blood slaves;
- forged items;
- research-capable mage turns;
- scouts and reports;
- retreat routes;
- siege time.

A logistics chain can be represented as:

```
recruitment fort
-> rally and command
-> route and supply
-> forward lab or gem mule
-> battle package
-> replacement and retreat
```

The chain is only as strong as its most exposed node. A frontier army with no replacement commander can become immobile after one assassination. A communion with no additional slaves may win once and disappear. A giant force without supplies can accumulate fatigue and disease before the decisive battle.

## Gem logistics

Gems are national stock in laboratories but physical carried resources in battle. A campaign needs:

- a load standard for each mage role;
- reserve gems for multiple battles;
- mules or a forward lab for reloads;

- a method to prevent optional gem use from draining the storm budget;
- decoys and bodyguards against assassinations;
- an evacuation plan if the lab is threatened.

Late-game throne operations may require several battles in one hosting cycle: magic-phase attacks, move-phase relief or interception, and a storm. The same script and carried stock may have to survive all of them.

## Supply and attrition

Supply is a campaign constraint, not a seasonal footnote. It affects:

- the size and route of living armies;
- how long a siege force can remain concentrated;
- the safety of capital or cave interiors;
- the usefulness of supply items and Nature magic;
- whether an opponent can force disease without winning a battle.

Book II contains the exact supply and starvation rules. At campaign level, the important point is that besieged storage falls as the siege continues and repeated starvation can lead to disease. A defender may gain time while quietly losing irreplaceable mages.

## Reserves

A reserve is not an army without orders. It is a force positioned to alter several likely enemy branches.

Good reserves:

- sit on a lab or movement hub;
- have compatible movement;
- carry counters rather than generic excess;
- can protect a Throne, fort, or retreat route;
- are hidden or ambiguous when possible;
- remain cheap enough that holding them back does not lose the main front.

The reserve's deterrent value depends on what the opponent believes it can reach. Scouting and information denial can change the value of the same force.

# Part VII: Raiding and Counter-Raiding

## What a raid is

Strategically, a raid is a limited force sent to take or threaten assets without joining the main battle. Its purpose may be:

- provincial income denial;
- capture of sites, labs, and temples;
- interruption of recruitment or gem collection;
- destruction of PD and patrollers;
- cutting retreat or reinforcement routes;
- forcing expensive defenders away from the main front;
- creating unrest or population loss;

- revealing counter capabilities;
- surrounding a fort;
- changing throne access.

The ordinary Raid order is a specific mechanic, not a synonym for every small attack. Officially, only a commander with Pillager can issue it, the army must have Map Move 20 or more, and only Pillager units contribute to the pillage at half strength. The force moves to the province, wins any battle, and then pillages. It does not automatically return.

## Pillaging

Pillaging:

- kills population;
- raises unrest;
- reduces supplies;
- yields temporary gold and food.

Fast and large units pillage better, and some unit types such as barbarians or fear-causing forces are particularly effective. The resulting supplies last one month. Pillaging converts long-term provincial value into short-term campaign resources and damage.

This is often rational in enemy land and often self-defeating in territory intended for immediate annexation. A player should distinguish:

- seizure: capture intact value;
- denial: prevent the enemy using it;
- destruction: reduce future value for everyone;
- foraging: support a force for one more month.

## Exact-output hypotheses

Older code-analysis notes proposed a base unit pillage strength of  $\text{floor}((\text{Strength} + \text{Combat Speed} + 10 \times \text{Fear}) / 2)$ , with a special Combat Speed value for flyers, followed by population, fort, exploding-die, unrest, casualty, food, and gold checks. The same notes gave a separate Raid catch sequence and reduced contribution rules.

Those formulas are precise enough to reproduce but not safe enough to publish as 6.36 law. The notes predate later Raid interface fixes, do not include a current raw outcome set, and Illwinter's current public description deliberately states only that Raid is move plus pillage with no return. Edition 27 keeps the proposed unit-strength expression and its downstream branches as S6 predicates. Until S6 is run, compare raiders by legal order access, mobility, Pillager bodies, expected battle strength, and the official half-strength contribution rather than a promised gold figure.

## Raider classes

| Raider                                 | Strength                         | Typical answer                          |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Cheap commander with small troop squad | Low cost, repeatable             | Modest PD, local troops, fast commander |
| Stealth army                           | Hidden approach and broad threat | Patrol network, scrying, chokepoints    |
| Light thug                             | Defeats PD and weak local troops | Counter-thug, mage, specialised PD      |

| Raider                      | Strength                                | Typical answer                                   |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Heavy thug                  | Beats larger troop-only responses       | Magic weapons, fatigue, control, tailored damage |
| Supercombatant              | Threatens armies and critical nodes     | Layered specialist response, army magic, denial  |
| Flying or sailing force     | Crosses ordinary front geometry         | Coverage of landing nodes, mobile reserve        |
| Magic-phase attacker        | Arrives before ordinary movement        | Dome, trap, counter-teleporter, protected nodes  |
| Assassin or seducer network | Removes command and specialist mages    | Bodyguards, decoys, patrols, redundant command   |
| Remote army or spell        | Projects force without exposing a route | Domes, dispersed assets, retaliation             |

Raider value depends on the defender's replacement cost. A ten-gem thug that forces a twenty-gem counter to remain idle can be valuable even before taking a province. The same thug is poor if it walks into a cheap armour-piercing weapon and transfers its equipment to the enemy.

## Raider efficiency

Evaluate a raider by:

```
value denied
+ response cost imposed
+ positional gain
+ information gained
- expected permanent loss
- attention and opportunity cost
```

The captured province's income is only one term. Cutting a laboratory may strand ritual mages. Taking a corridor can kill retreats. Threatening three provinces can make the enemy divide an army. Conversely, repeatedly trading expensive raiders for low-income provinces can lose the gem war while the map colour appears active.

## Raider design

A raider needs:

- a target class;
- sufficient movement;
- enough offence to end the fight;
- enough defence to survive that target;
- fatigue stability;
- morale or mindlessness appropriate to the task;
- a retreat or escape plan;
- a price ceiling.

Thugs should layer different defences rather than maximise one statistic. Protection alone eventually fails to armour-defeating results, high damage, fatigue, or armour-piercing and armour-negating attacks. Defence alone fails under repeated attacks and surrounding. Regeneration alone fails to burst damage or conditions that prevent recovery.

Minimalism is central. Every additional item must change a relevant matchup or survival probability. Decorative gear increases the reward for the counter-thug.

## Creating a raiding front

A raiding front works when several threats mature together:

- 1 Scouts identify low-PD, high-value, and weakly connected provinces.
- 2 Raiders enter from different routes.
- 3 The main army threatens a fort or decisive battle.
- 4 Remote or magic-phase attacks threaten the reserve.
- 5 Captured provinces cut retreat and reinforcement paths.
- 6 Raiders withdraw, regroup, or join a siege before tailored answers arrive.

One raider is a puzzle. Several raiders plus a main army are a resource-allocation crisis.

## Counter-raiding as a system

Counter-raiding should not chase every loss with the main army. Build layers:

| Layer                | Function                                                       |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scouts and scrying   | Identify raider type, movement, and equipment                  |
| PD tripwires         | Defeat the smallest raids and reveal larger ones               |
| Patrol nodes         | Restrict stealth routes and protect critical labs              |
| Local recruits       | Reclaim undefended provinces cheaply                           |
| Mobile counters      | Catch or threaten expensive raiders                            |
| Magic-phase response | Intercept forces that ordinary movement cannot catch           |
| Fort network         | Preserve recruitment and force raiders to stop                 |
| Strategic reserve    | Prevent several raids from becoming a capital or Throne attack |

The defender should calculate which provinces are worth defending. A poor border province may be allowed to change hands while the counter waits at the lab, Throne, or route the raider actually needs.

## Counter-thugs

A counter-thug is usually cheaper and more specialised than the target. It may need only:

- a weapon that bypasses the target's principal defence;
- sufficient attack or precision to connect;
- resistance to the target's damage;
- enough speed or magic movement to catch it;
- a scout or spare commander to loot gear.

Specialisation creates efficiency but reduces general usefulness. Do not send the counter at a different chassis merely because both are called thugs.

## Raid recovery

After losing provinces:

- 1 Preserve the force that can defeat the raider.
- 2 Identify its legal next destinations.
- 3 Protect the high-value nodes among them.



- 4 Retake empty provinces with cheap commanders.
- 5 Rebuild a continuous retreat and supply route.
- 6 Do not overinvest in PD everywhere after one frightening loss.
- 7 Use the revealed gear and script to construct the cheapest repeatable answer.

The aim is to reduce future response cost. A defender who spends a major mage and ten gems on every raid may technically win each battle and still lose the campaign.

## Part VIII: War Planning, Timing, and Decision

### Reasons to go to war

War is justified when it improves the route to victory more than the alternatives. Common reasons include:

- an opponent can be defeated before its breakpoint;
- a critical Throne, fort, gate, or path recruit is accessible;
- a neighbour is committed elsewhere;
- a hostile position will become unanswerable if left alone;
- a treaty network creates a temporary safe front;
- defensive war is already unavoidable and initiative can be seized;
- the war prevents an imminent victory.

"The neighbour is weak" is incomplete. The relevant questions are what can be taken, how long it takes, who benefits, and what other nations can do during the commitment.

### War aims

Define the minimum successful outcome:

- destroy a specific army;
- seize a border fort or capital;
- capture or neutralise a Throne;
- remove a global origin;
- secure a corridor or plane gate;
- force a treaty or transfer;
- eliminate the nation;
- delay it while another operation succeeds.

Unlimited conquest causes strategic drift. A war that has achieved its aim may be ended or frozen before the winner's armies become trapped in low-value territory.

### The invasion ledger

Before ending a NAP or submitting attack orders, record:

| Requirement    | Minimum answer                                                 |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Enemy strength | Main army, mobile reserve, Pretender, known thugs, magic phase |

| Requirement        | Minimum answer                                                  |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Friendly package   | Troops, mages, scripts, gems, counters, leadership              |
| Target sequence    | Border battle, fort, lab, Throne, capital                       |
| Siege              | Expected wall strength, reduction per turn, defence and relief  |
| Logistics          | Route, supplies, reload, reinforcements, replacement commanders |
| Diplomacy          | Legal attack date, other borders, coalition reaction            |
| Research           | Current package and next breakpoint                             |
| Failure branch     | Retreat route, fallback fort, diplomatic exit                   |
| Victory conversion | Claim unit, AP count, post-capture defence                      |

If the plan ends at "win the battle," it is tactical preparation rather than a campaign.

## Back-planning the attack date

The attack date should be derived backwards:

```
desired decisive battle
<- arrival turn
<- treaty expiry
<- final recruitment and rally
<- item and gem preparation
<- research completion
<- scouting confirmation
```

Because hosting is simultaneous, a force one province away may arrive into a different position than expected. Every route needs a branch for enemy movement, interception, or a changed barrier.

## Concentration and dispersion

Concentration wins difficult battles and cracks forts. Dispersion captures provinces and imposes attention. The campaign should alternate:

- 1 disperse for expansion or raiding;
- 2 concentrate for the decisive army or siege;
- 3 disperse after victory to cut retreats and take infrastructure;
- 4 reconcentrate before the opponent's new package arrives.

Permanent doomstacks waste map tempo. Permanent dispersion invites defeat in detail.

## Forcing battles

An opponent can often decline an unfavourable field battle. Force commitment by threatening:

- a capital;
- a high-output mage fort;
- a Throne;
- a laboratory with rare commanders;
- a global origin;
- a corridor whose loss traps an army;
- multiple forts whose siege clocks mature together.

The best target is sometimes the one the enemy must defend, not the one with the most immediate income.

## Gem burning

Battle magic consumes carried resources. A weak or sacrificial force may trigger expensive scripts before the decisive battle. This can be achieved through:

- magic-phase attacks before move-phase combat;
- sequential allied or multi-party battles;
- remote attacks;
- probes against an army expected to storm;
- assassinations that cause individual gem use.

Gem burning is not free. The probe may die, reveal information, or fail to trigger the intended spells. Conservative gem-use settings and spell AI affect results. The attacker should compare the expected hostile gems consumed with the permanent cost of the probe.

## Deterrence

Deterrence depends on credible punishment. It can come from:

- a visible army;
- hidden teleporters or thugs;
- a known battlefield wipe;
- a treaty partner;
- a fort that imposes delay;
- the ability to raid an attacker's undefended rear;
- a Pretender whose commitment changes the battle;
- the diplomatic cost of creating a runaway elsewhere.

Purely hidden capacity may not deter because the opponent does not know it exists. Selective disclosure-one demonstration, a truthful warning, or visible staging-can preserve peace more cheaply than actual battle.

## Ending wars

A rational peace assessment asks:

- Has the original aim been achieved?
- Which side's reinforcement and research curve is improving?
- Are forts about to crack?
- Can either party win the game elsewhere?
- Are new enemies entering?
- What border can actually be held?
- Which terms are enforceable?

Continuing from anger is a strategic expenditure. Reputation and justice matter in multiplayer, but they should be pursued through explicit objectives rather than unbounded attrition.

# Part IX: Thugs, Supercombatants, Assassins, and Remote Force

## Campaign roles

Single commanders and remote effects should be classified by what they change:

| Asset                | Campaign role                                                   |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Light thug           | PD raiding, province recovery, bottleneck pressure              |
| Heavy thug           | Defeat troop-heavy, mage-light forces                           |
| Supercombatant       | Threaten armies, capitals, or decisive nodes                    |
| Army thug            | Hold, kill elites, or add concentrated damage inside a line     |
| Counter-thug         | Trade cheaply into a known chassis                              |
| Assassin             | Remove commanders, priests, mages, or gem carriers              |
| Seducer or corrupter | Remove or acquire commanders through a special duel             |
| Remote attacker      | Damage, probe, distract, or burn gems without ordinary movement |
| Magic-phase mover    | Intercept, surprise, reinforce, or open a storm operation       |

The label does not guarantee performance. A heavy thug against troops may die instantly to the first prepared mage. A supercombatant without the correct resistance may be a very expensive target.

## The defensive onion

Durable commanders combine layers:

- avoidance: defence, glamour, awe, ethereal, displacement;
- mitigation: protection, invulnerability, resistances;
- recovery: regeneration, life drain, recuperation;
- control resistance: MR, mindlessness, morale, elemental and status immunity;
- endurance: reinvigoration, low encumbrance, fatigue management;
- offence: enough killing speed to avoid the turn limit and cumulative random failure;
- escape: returning, immortality, retreat, stealth, or magic movement.

Every layer must be checked against the intended target and the likely counter. The DRN makes absolute safety rare.

## Assassin rules

An assassin selects a random enemy commander in the province. Each assigned bodyguard has a base 50% chance of being present, modified by Bodyguard and Patience. The target is unprepared and does not use its ordinary battle script. Province context may add guards or bystanders.

An assassin cannot normally operate into or out of a besieged fort without Scale Walls, flight, teleportation, or equivalent access. Similar access restrictions apply to related orders such as seduction or infiltration. Mounted targets are often dismounted; when the assassin wins, the mount may also be killed.

Strategic consequences:

- commander redundancy reduces assassination leverage;
- bodyguards must be assigned before the attack;
- decoy commanders dilute random targeting;
- vital H3 claimants and communion masters require special protection;
- killing a leader may immobilise troops even if the army survives;
- assassinations inside a throne fort can disrupt both battle and claim timing.

## Remote operations

Remote force can:

- kill or afflict armies;
- summon attackers;
- change weather or scales;
- attack commanders;
- scry;
- damage walls;
- move units or armies;
- establish or protect local enchantments.

Remote operations should be combined with a physical exploitation plan. Damaging an army without contesting its fort or route may merely spend gems. A remote that removes PD immediately before a fast raider arrives converts more cleanly.

Domes reduce probability or redirect certain hostile rituals, but no dome is universal. Current official notes state that domes may protect against Astral Disruption. Exact layering and object interaction must be verified for the current spell set.

## Counter construction

Build answers from the enemy's dependency:

- high protection -> armour-piercing or armour-negating damage, fatigue, control;
- high defence -> area effects, multiple attacks, attack boosts, unavoidable effects;
- regeneration -> burst, decay, disease, or prevention of recovery;
- ethereal or glamour -> magic weapons and appropriate perception;
- elemental damage -> specific resistance;
- life drain -> lifeless targets or denial of contact;
- Phoenix Pyre -> fatigue and soul or battlefield control;
- high MR -> non-MR effects or penetration investment;
- magic movement -> protected nodes, domes, traps, distributed assets;
- stealth -> patrol, scrying, route control;
- item dependency -> counter-thug and looting plan.

The cheapest sufficient answer is normally superior to building a more expensive mirror.

# Part X: Sieges and Fort Operations

## Siege arithmetic

Book II owns the wall-reduction formula and repair modifiers; Book IV owns the storm battle. Strategy begins with the operational consequence: only commanders ordered to Maintain Siege and their eligible forces work on the walls. A commander preaching, forging, or performing another order is not also reducing the fort.

## The siege clock

A fort creates delay by requiring:

- 1

entry into the province;
- 2

one or more turns of wall reduction;
- 3

a legal Storm Fortress order after walls reach zero;
- 4

victory in the storm battle;
- 5

occupation, repair, and exploitation.

Each added turn permits:

- relief movement;
- remote attacks;
- recruitment elsewhere;
- diplomatic intervention;
- research completion;
- throne counterattacks.

Siege strength is tempo. An army that wins the field but needs six months to crack the fort may lose the strategic race to one that brought specialised siege bodies.

## Information asymmetry

The defender sees wall condition. The besieger receives qualitative messages:

| Message            | Approximate wall state   |
|--------------------|--------------------------|
| Lightly damaged    | High remaining integrity |
| Moderately damaged | About 51-85% remaining   |
| Severely damaged   | About 11-50% remaining   |
| Critically damaged | About 1-10% remaining    |

"Work is going very slowly" indicates less than roughly 15% of wall integrity was removed that turn according to the community reference. Because the besieger lacks exact totals, plans should include a safety margin and scouting of likely repair bodies.

## Inside and outside

At a friendly fort:

- Defend places the commander and troops inside;
- Patrol keeps them outside and able to fight field battles;
- an arriving ordinary move normally enters the fort;
- Move and Patrol arrives outside.

Version 6.35 adds one narrow escape route: a commander with teleport movement can move out of a besieged fort. This does not release an ordinary army, legalise every teleport ritual, or change the movement phase for other units. The order-entry exception is recorded in [Book X's siege orders](#), while [Book I](#) retains the hosting sequence.

This distinction determines whether a unit joins a relief battle, remains protected, contributes to wall repair, or can be attacked by the besieger.

## Relief, break siege, and storm

A relief battle occurs before a scheduled storm. If relief succeeds, the storm does not occur. If relief fails, the besieger may still have to storm with losses, fatigue, expended gems, or altered scripts.

The defender can also Break Siege. A retreating defender may return inside the fort or move to an adjacent friendly province; where both are available, the manual gives a 50/50 selection. Fort context and later battles can change the ultimate retreat result.

When storming:

- the gate creates a narrow and dangerous battle context;
- intrinsic fort guards aid the defender;
- if a storming commander dies before the gate battle, its squads do not participate;
- besieged commanders that retreat from the storm die;
- relief and storm may force one attacker script through several battles;
- battlefield-wide magic may be restricted indoors under the current indoor rule.

## Starvation and trapped value

Besieged recruitment stops. Provincial income is divided between besieger and defender according to the siege rules, while site gems continue to the besieged side if a laboratory can connect them to the treasury. Declining fort supply can starve and eventually disease the garrison.

The defender should classify trapped units:

- irreplaceable mages that justify early relief;
- cheap repair bodies that justify delay;
- troops suitable for a break-siege battle;
- claim-capable priests on a Throne;
- stealth or special-access units able to leave;
- Pretender or immortal assets with separate risk.

Saving the fort while permanently diseasing the research core may be a strategic loss.

## One-turn cracks

A one-turn crack denies the defender most of the siege clock. It is especially important in throne operations. Calculate:

- fort wall strength;
- expected defending repair;
- flying and siege bonuses;
- Mindless, Animal, and Undisciplined penalties;
- remote wall damage;
- loss of siege contribution if commanders fight or perform other orders;

- possible Iron Walls or equivalent increases.
- The one-turn crack force must also fight. Siege bodies that contribute enormous reduction but collapse in relief can become a liability unless protected.

## Multi-fort operations

- Besieging several forts at once can exceed the defender's relief capacity. The attacker should stagger clocks so:
- at least one fort becomes stormable each turn;
  - the main army can move between decisive storms;
  - raiders cut reinforcement routes;
  - enough force remains on each fort to prevent repair;
  - gem reserves survive repeated battles.

The defender should repair, reinforce, and sally selectively. Preserving a key mage fort or Throne can justify abandoning a peripheral castle.

# Part XI: Diplomacy, Treaties, and Reputation

## Diplomacy changes force ratios

A treaty can remove an entire front from the immediate defence problem. A trade can create a path booster that research cannot. Intelligence from an ally can prevent a surprise. A coalition can turn a leading nation's local superiority into global inferiority.

Diplomacy is an exchange of:

- time;
- information;
- territorial certainty;
- resources and items;
- military access;
- threats and commitments;
- reputation.

The resource is not the message. It is the changed set of legal and expected actions.

## Formal and social NAPs

Dominions 6 can use formal in-game diplomacy. Depending on settings, a formal NAP may be binding: the game blocks offensive actions that violate it. Games can also use nonbinding settings or social treaties negotiated outside the engine.

These systems should not be silently mixed:

| Doctrine          | Authority   | Main benefit                 | Main risk                                              |
|-------------------|-------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Strict formal NAP | Game engine | Clear mechanical enforcement | Edge cases may permit conduct players consider hostile |



| Doctrine           | Authority                          | Main benefit                                             | Main risk                                            |
|--------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Written social NAP | Agreed text and host rules         | Can cover remotes, stealth, globals, access, and victory | Requires shared interpretation and reputation        |
| Hybrid             | Formal pact plus written additions | Enforcement plus broader expectations                    | Conflicts between engine legality and social meaning |
| No NAP             | No non-aggression commitment       | Maximum freedom and fewer countdown disputes             | Higher uncertainty and defence cost                  |

Before a game begins, players should know which doctrine governs conflicts.

## Binding diplomacy

Illwinter describes formal diplomacy as optional, with binding NAPs available for humans and AI and a setting that makes them nonbinding. The command-line help exposes the corresponding `--weakdiplo` and `--nodiplo` settings. This establishes three engine baselines: binding, nonbinding, and absent. It does not turn an organised game's social customs into engine rules.

The official correction history supplies the safest current exception ledger:

| Version | Official NAP or allied-territory rule                                                                             |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6.01    | NAPs do not govern arena battles; global-enchantment attacks no longer respect NAPs.                              |
| 6.03    | A besieged force may break free from its fort during a NAP.                                                       |
| 6.04    | A defect involving movement bumps during a NAP was corrected.                                                     |
| 6.12    | Players can bump forces covered by a NAP; a besieger counts as bordering the besieged player for diplomacy.       |
| 6.13    | An army may move into NAP-protected forces that are besieging its own fort.                                       |
| 6.19    | An expiring NAP continues counting down after a nation dies; modders gained <code>#napbreakrit</code> for spells. |
| 6.29    | The Wait order became legal in allied territory.                                                                  |
| 6.30    | Expiring NAPs were corrected in disciple games.                                                                   |

This ledger proves that a binding pact is not a blanket ban on every hostile-looking interaction. It also shows why an old anecdote can be wrong after a patch. The complete action matrix-ordinary movement, magic movement, anonymous and attributed rituals, stealth incidents, province transfers, sieges, and every disciple case under all three settings-still requires S12.

## Minimum treaty terms

A useful NAP states:

- the parties;
- whether it is formal, social, or both;
- the notice period;
- exactly how turns are counted;
- the first legal turn for hostile orders and for hostile contact;
- treatment of scouts and stealth armies;
- remotes, assassinations, seduction, heretics, disease spreaders, and unrest effects;
- dominion and temple pressure;
- province trades and accidental bumps;

- harmful globals;
- third-party access;
- whether imminent victory suspends the pact;
- how mistakes are repaired.

Without these terms, both parties may act in good faith under incompatible definitions.

## Countdown arithmetic

Community conventions differ. One explicit convention treats an N-turn NAP ended on turn T as permitting contact on turn T+N. Under that convention, ending NAP3 on turn 10 permits attack orders on turn 12 that make contact during hosting into turn 13. Other groups count differently.

Never rely on the label alone. State the first legal order-submission turn and the first legal contact turn in plain numbers.

## Treaty edge cases

Potential disputes include:

- a scout being discovered;
- a stealth army positioned before expiry;
- an accidental movement bump;
- a remote attack with uncertain attribution;
- a harmful global;
- selling a corridor to a third party;
- cutting off agreed spoils;
- dominion pressure;
- independent or event armies taking border provinces;
- a throne rush while formal NAPs remain binding.

Engine legality does not settle social legitimacy unless the group agreed that it would. A written doctrine protects both strategic freedom and the community from avoidable arguments.

## Trade

Trades can exchange:

- gems and blood slaves;
- forged items;
- provinces;
- mercenary noncompetition;
- intelligence;
- ritual or global contributions;
- military access;
- coordinated timing.

Good trade messages specify item, gem type, quantity, delivery turn, sender, recipient, and contingency if forging or delivery becomes impossible. Trades are generally treated as binding in community practice because simultaneous turns expose one party to opportunistic default.

Assess the strategic effect, not only nominal gem equality. A five-gem booster that opens a new path can be worth far more than five surplus gems. A trade that enables an enemy's throne rush may be profitable and fatal.

## Reputation

Reputation changes future transaction costs. Reliable players receive information, trades, and treaties with less suspicion. Deceptive or rules-lawyering play may win one exchange while forcing expensive hostility in later games.

Reputation is not a demand for passivity. A treaty can be ended, a rival can be threatened, and a surprise attack after legal expiry is ordinary strategy. The core distinction is between hard bargaining within clear terms and exploiting ambiguity that the other party reasonably believed was settled.

## Threat communication

A useful threat states:

- the behaviour that must change;
- the consequence;
- the deadline;
- an achievable off-ramp.

Vague outrage does not deter. Impossible demands turn the threat into a declaration of war. Excessive detail can reveal exact capacity. The objective is credible constraint with minimal disclosure.

## Coalition politics

Coalitions form around relative threat. Indicators that create coalitions include:

- rapid province, fort, research, or gem growth;
- oppressive globals;
- visible throne progress;
- elimination of neighbours;
- treaty networks that appear permanent;
- unique late-game access;
- refusal to communicate.

A leader can reduce coalition pressure by:

- leaving other players with meaningful autonomy;
- sharing limited intelligence or trade;
- avoiding unnecessary worldwide harm;
- framing war aims as bounded;
- preventing a rival from appearing harmless while compounding;
- keeping the true throne conversion window short.

Coalition management is not concealment of all strength. If the position is obviously dominant, implausible denials destroy credibility.

# Part XII: Thrones, Cataclysm, and Endgame Conversion

---

# Victory by Ascension Points

By default, Thrones of Ascension provide the victory structure. A Throne's level equals its Ascension Point value:

| Throne level | Ascension Points | General defence                                                      |
|--------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1            | 1                | Stronger than ordinary independents but often early-accessible       |
| 2            | 2                | Substantial army and magic support                                   |
| 3            | 3                | Extremely strong defence, often including Pretender-class commanders |

The host sets the total points present and the number required. Conquer-all is an alternative, but throne settings define most campaign deadlines.

## Finding and identifying Thrones

The presence of a Throne becomes visible when the province is observed through ordinary means such as scouting, dominion, or neighbouring ownership. Exact identity requires stronger information, such as a spy or direct control, according to the current community reference. When a Pretender awakens, unrevealed Thrones are sensed; an awake Pretender receives this information on turn 2.

Throne identity matters because effects vary widely: gems, gold, scales, bless changes, recruitment, research access, unrest, dominion spread, or world events. Treat community tables as object references to verify against current game data before committing a design.

## Claiming

A Throne can be claimed by:

- the Pretender;
- the Prophet;
- a priest with Holy 3 or more.

The nation must own the province. If a fort exists, a besieger cannot claim through the walls, while the besieged owner can still claim. Claiming is a turn action and resolves during hosting at the throne-claim step. Conquest makes the Throne unclaimed until a legal claimant acts.

Book III owns the exact same-turn state matrix. For campaign planning, remember the operational result: killing a claimant after the step-8 claim does not undo it; conquering an unfortified Throne or successfully storming its fort removes the claim before the step-57 victory check; a siege that has not taken the fort does not. Once the claim resolves, counterplay must attack the ownership state and not only the claimant.

A claimed Throne:

- supplies Ascension Points;
- spreads dominion through its throne checks;
- activates its claimed effects;
- visibly lights on the map.

The campaign must include the claimant. A victorious army without an H3, Pretender, or Disciple is at least one turn farther from victory.

## Throne arithmetic

Every turn, record for each living nation:

- claimed points;
- unclaimed controlled points;
- points under siege;
- points reachable within one ordinary move;
- points reachable in the magic phase;
- claim-capable units in range;
- forts that can be cracked in one turn;
- points required to win.

Also record the maximum plausible claim, not only current points. A nation on five of eight required points that controls an unclaimed three-point Throne can win with one claim order.

## The throne-rush sequence

A common fortified one-Throne rush follows this timing:

| Turn        | Attacker                                                           | Defender and bystanders                                                       |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| T+0 orders  | Move enough army and siege power onto the Throne                   | Detect approach, reinforce, remote, or prepare relief                         |
| T+1 orders  | Walls are cracked; order storm; move H3 or Pretender into position | Break siege, relieve, attack other attacker Thrones, burn gems                |
| T+2 orders  | After successful storm, claim                                      | Last chance is normally to remove another claimed Throne or prevent the claim |
| T+3 hosting | Claim resolves and victory occurs if threshold is met              | Counter must already have changed the AP total or ownership                   |

Exact battle sequence, magic movement, wall state, and claim position can alter this schedule. The important lesson is that bystanders do not have "several turns" merely because the fort has not yet fallen. A one-turn crack compresses the coalition's response into one hosting cycle.

## Requirements for a credible rush

The attacker needs:

- enough siege power to crack on schedule;
- enough combat power for relief, sequential battles, and the storm;
- scripts that function across those battle contexts;
- gems for repeated combat;
- resilience against remotes and assassins;
- claimant access;
- defence of existing claimed Thrones;
- secrecy or deception;
- a response to Iron Walls and emergency reinforcement.

A throne rush is an operation, not a large army walking toward a victory icon.

## Defending against a rush

Defence can attack any dependency:

- reinforce or increase wall strength;
- kill the siege bodies;
- force extra battles to consume gems;
- assassinate commanders or the claimant;
- use magic-phase attacks before relief and storm;
- break siege;
- capture or unclaim one of the attacker's existing Thrones;
- cut the claimant's route;
- form a coalition and share exact timing;
- exploit binding-NAP limitations through pre-agreed victory clauses.

Counterattacking another claimed Throne may be more reliable than saving the target. Victory arithmetic, not pride of ownership, decides.

## Information warfare

Surprise is especially valuable because every visible turn permits specialised counter-scripts and coalition formation. Methods include:

- stealthy elements staged near or on the target;
- flying, sailing, underwater, or plane routes;
- magic-phase mage delivery;
- high Map Move and movement items;
- false army displays and secondary throne threats;
- ordinary wars used as cover;
- keeping the H3 claimant separate until required.

The attacker must balance concealment against siege. Stealth forces on the fort do not contribute while sneaking. The operation needs a turn when hidden potential becomes actual wall reduction.

## Defence of owned Thrones

Throne defence should be layered:

- fort and wall strength;
- enough repair to defeat casual siege;
- patrols and anti-assassin measures;
- a claimant or priest plan;
- a mobile relief force;
- remote and magic-phase support;
- gem reserves;
- alternate victory arithmetic if one Throne falls.

Not every Throne requires the same force. Concentrate on the points whose loss changes the victory threshold, the routes opponents can reach, and the forts vulnerable to one-turn cracking.

## Cataclysm

If enabled, Cataclysm begins after the configured turn. Horrors attack and destroy Thrones. Each destroyed Throne reduces the Ascension Points required to win, so the threshold moves as the world collapses. Current official changes make Cataclysm harder to counter.

The manual states that if no one owns a Throne when the last is destroyed, the horrors win. Current community reference describes all Thrones destroyed as a draw; this wording conflict must be reproduced under current 6.36 before being stated more narrowly. Operationally, neither result is a player victory.

Cataclysm strategy:

- track turns to arrival;
- fort and defend key Thrones;
- prepare to kill or dislodge horrors;
- recalculate required points after every destruction;
- avoid plans that mature after the relevant Thrones cease to exist;
- treat every surviving point as increasingly decisive.

Cataclysm is more than late-game flavour. It shrinks the objective map.

## Part XIII: Recovery, Elastic Defence, and Defeat Management

### A lost battle is not automatically a lost war

After a major defeat, the strategic position contains several different losses:

- force loss: troops, mages, Pretender, items, and gems;
- capacity loss: forts, laboratories, sacred recruitment, and researchers;
- position loss: routes, sites, Thrones, dominion, and borders;
- information loss: scouts, known enemy scripts, and hidden alternatives;
- diplomatic loss: confidence, allies, and deterrence;
- tempo loss: the opponent chooses the next urgent event.

Recovery begins by separating them. A nation may have lost its main army but retained every mage fort and a superior research curve. Another may win the field but lose its only laboratory and retreat corridor. Battle animation does not rank these consequences.

### The first post-defeat turn

Perform this audit before issuing revenge orders:

- 1 Count surviving mages, commanders, items, and gem stocks.
- 2 Identify where every routed force went.
- 3 Check leadership and whether troops are stranded.
- 4 Mark the enemy's legal next destinations.
- 5 Protect the capital, key mage forts, labs, Thrones, and corridors.
- 6 Determine whether the enemy can crack each fort in one turn.
- 7 Read the replay for spent hostile gems, fatigue, casualties, and revealed scripts.

- 8 Ask neighbours for information, trade, pressure, or coalition action.
- 9 Select the cheapest research or recruitment stabiliser.
- 10 Preserve a retreat path for the next battle.

The instinct to recreate the destroyed army exactly is often wrong. The opponent has already demonstrated an answer to it.

## Elastic defence

Elastic defence exchanges low-value territory for time while preserving the force needed for a counterstroke. It uses:

- forts as delay;
- scouts to track the attacker;
- PD and cheap units as tripwires;
- raiders against the attacker's rear;
- mobile reserves;
- selective relief;
- research completed behind the line;
- diplomacy that makes further advance expensive.

The defence is not passive. It forces the attacker to choose between:

- concentrating and losing provinces to raids;
- dispersing and risking defeat;
- storming and spending gems;
- waiting and allowing research or coalition response.

## What to hold

Rank provinces:

| Priority    | Examples                                                        |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Existential | Capital, last candle sources, victory-critical Throne           |
| Capacity    | Major mage fort, rare recruit site, blood centre, global origin |
| Network     | Corridor, plane gate, only lab chain, retreat hub               |
| Economic    | Rich province, strong gem site                                  |
| Disposable  | Poor border land that does not open the interior                |

The list changes with the position. A one-income cave can be existential if it is the only route to a plane or underwater enclave.

## Preserving cadres

Troops are often easier to replace than:

- high-path mages;
- experienced communion leaders;
- H3 priests;
- item carriers;
- rare randoms;



- prophet;
- Pretender;
- specialised commanders.

A small surviving cadre can rebuild a battlefield package if given forts and time. Protect command redundancy, retreat routes, and extraction items. Do not place every rare path in the same army unless the battle is truly decisive.

## Counteroffence

The attacker is most exposed when:

- concentrated on a fort;
- low on gems after several battles;
- beyond reinforcement range;
- dependent on one lab;
- holding provinces with token PD;
- using a revealed script;
- committed under expiring treaties elsewhere.

Counteroffence does not require retaking every lost province. It may destroy the siege army, cut its retreat, take its staging lab, threaten its capital, or force a peace by opening a second front.

## Negotiating from weakness

A weakened nation still possesses:

- information;
- remaining army or raiders;
- forts that consume time;
- gems and items;
- a vote in coalition politics;
- the ability to make another nation the beneficiary of its collapse.

Useful offers are concrete: a stable border, a province transfer, gem payment, joint war, intelligence, or permission to disengage. Empty threats weaken reputation; credible kingmaking threats can change the attacker's calculation but may also unite the table against the speaker.

## Elimination, handover, and meaningful play

When recovery is impossible, distinguish:

- a nation still capable of affecting victory;
- a position that can be handed to a substitute;
- an agreed concession under host rules;
- a player leaving without setting AI or notifying the host.

Long multiplayer games depend on continuity. A defeated player should follow the game's substitution, AI, and concession rules rather than silently stale. The host's master password can set a dropped player to AI, but it also grants access to positions and should be controlled accordingly.

# Part XIV: Single-Player Strategy and the AI

## What the AI receives

Difficulty modifies AI bonuses to gold, resources, recruitment points, and magic income:

| Difficulty | Bonus or penalty |
|------------|------------------|
| Easy       | -30%             |
| Normal     | 0%               |
| Difficult  | +30%             |
| Mighty     | +60%             |
| Master     | +100%            |
| Impossible | +150%            |

These modifiers do not increase commander recruitment rate or Holy Points. The AI also has omniscient knowledge of province ownership, which removes one information problem human players face.

## Current AI capabilities

Dominions 6 AI is improved over earlier descriptions. It:

- builds forts;
- recruits better national troops;
- plans high-level rituals;
- uses global enchantments;
- attempts Dispel;
- participates in formal diplomacy.

Current patches also corrected behaviours such as trying rituals without a laboratory, researching when unable, and preaching with non-priests. The AI still operates through programmed evaluation rather than human political judgment and long-form deception.

Version 6.35 also improved the AI's protection of important mages. This should be read as a narrower targeting and preservation improvement, not as evidence that the AI now values mage-turns, research concentration, retreat routes, or political risk with human reliability.

## Learning games

A useful first learning environment uses:

- a small or medium map;
- one plane unless plane travel is the lesson;
- Normal AI before large economic bonuses;
- ordinary independent strength;
- visible score graphs;

- Thrones as the victory condition;
- a nation with understandable troops and broad enough magic;
- no mods for the first rules-learning game.

Then add difficulty or complexity one variable at a time. High AI bonuses teach crisis management but can hide whether the player's economy and expansion are fundamentally sound.

## Productive self-imposed constraints

To learn transferable strategy:

- do not rely on repeated reloads except for controlled testing;
- avoid exploiting a predictable movement loop indefinitely;
- track Throne arithmetic even when the AI does not punish mistakes;
- practise scouts, reserves, forts, and gem budgets as if facing humans;
- watch important battles and diagnose mechanisms;
- use formal diplomacy if it is part of the intended multiplayer environment;
- compare turn-12 expansion across repeated starts.

The objective of practice is not only to beat the AI. It is to create habits that survive a human opponent.

## What AI games teach well

- interface and turn execution;
- national recruitment and expansion;
- battle scripting;
- economy and infrastructure;
- research pacing;
- siege and movement rules;
- army composition against varied rosters;
- surviving numerical pressure;
- late-game spell and global operation.

## What requires multiplayer experience

- credible deception;
- negotiated borders;
- reputation;
- coalition timing;
- adaptive counter-research;
- human throne-rush detection;
- trades built around path scarcity;
- restraint and threat communication;
- opponents deliberately burning gems or hiding scripts.

Single-player mastery is a foundation, not a complete substitute for diplomacy and adversarial uncertainty.

# Part XV: Turn Discipline and Multiplayer Operations

---

## The strategic turn order

The complete engine hosting sequence appears in [Book I](#). A player-facing strategic turn should be reviewed in this order:

- 1 Victory: Can anyone win during the coming hosting?
- 2 Messages: Battles, events, rituals, construction, diplomacy, and throne changes.
- 3 Map change: Ownership, forts, labs, dominion, routes, and enemy movement.
- 4 Threats: Every hostile force's legal destinations and phase.
- 5 Battles: Replay decisive and surprising results.
- 6 Research: Completion, caster access, and pivot.
- 7 Economy: Treasury, upkeep, recruitment queues, forts, and PD.
- 8 Magic: Rituals, forging, site search, gem movement, globals, and domes.
- 9 Armies: Leadership, squads, scripts, supplies, movement, and retreats.
- 10 Diplomacy: Treaties, countdowns, trades, warnings, and coalition information.
- 11 Verification: Illegal arrows, idle commanders, empty labs, unclaimed Thrones, and unsubmitted turn.

Victory comes first because every other optimisation is irrelevant if the game ends.

## Commander roles and naming

Names should expose function:

- RCH F2A1 for a researcher's relevant paths;
- FORGE E3 for a forge specialist;
- ARMY N for a field group;
- CLAIM H3 for a throne claimant;
- RAID A for a raider;
- MULE 20F for carried gems;
- SCOUT EAST for coverage;
- NAP3 T24 in notes for a treaty deadline.

The exact scheme matters less than consistency. A late-game turn should not require reopening every commander to remember why it exists.

## Army package records

For each major army, record:

- commander roster and redundancy;
- troop roles and formations;
- five-order scripts;
- expected unscripted behaviour;
- gem load and optional spending policy;
- communion or Sabbath structure;
- target matchups;
- known counters;

- movement class;
- supply;
- retreat provinces;
- siege contribution;
- next reinforcement.

This converts battle preparation into a repeatable system and makes after-action review possible.

## Diplomacy records

Keep:

- exact treaty text;
- agreement turn;
- expiry notice turn;
- first legal order and contact turns;
- trades owed and delivered;
- disputed province settlement;
- promises to third parties;
- public and private victory commitments according to house rules.

Memory becomes unreliable over games lasting months. Written terms protect strategy and relationships.

## Submitting safely

Before ending the turn:

- use the warning system but do not assume it catches every strategic error;
- confirm commanders who must remain hidden are Sneaking, not moving normally;
- confirm an army entering its own fort uses Move and Patrol if it must fight outside;
- confirm all special-movement troops qualify;
- confirm rivers and passes are open;
- confirm claimant and siege orders;
- confirm commanders expected to reduce walls are maintaining siege;
- confirm gems and slaves are on the correct bodies;
- confirm no forge, ritual, or research order unintentionally replaced a military task;
- save and submit according to server practice.

## Stales, extensions, and substitutes

House rules should define:

- when extensions are granted;
- how requests are made;
- what counts as repeated staling;
- when a substitute may be found;
- when the host may set AI;
- how concessions are handled;
- whether private information can be shared with a substitute.

Reliable scheduling is part of multiplayer skill. A brilliant plan that repeatedly stales damages the game more than an imperfect plan submitted on time.

# Part XVI: The Active Modded Ruleset

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## What carries across

Book IX defines the exact combined ruleset and its load order. The durable strategic ideas still include simultaneous planning, movement timing, information, concentration, siege clocks, treaty clarity, Throne arithmetic, conversion, logistics, and attention. Their numbers and available tools may change, so their application must be recalculated.

Recruitment, sacred throughput, paths, Pretenders, blessings, spells, items, summons, sites, siege bodies, national mechanics, and AI priorities may all differ. An unmodded expansion party, research queue, thug kit, or counter is evidence for a method, not a ready-made combined-mod plan.

## The strategic rule

Mod compatibility is part of force estimation. If load order changes an object that a plan depends on, the plan is a different plan even when its name remains the same.

## Combined strategy test

Every nation package will later require four snapshots:

- 1 unmodded;
- 2 DE only;
- 3 Divinitus only where applicable;
- 4 DE then Divinitus.

Diff the roster, Pretenders, paths, blessings, spells, items, sites, summons, and strategic special abilities. Then repeat expansion, research, battle, raid, and throne tests.

# Part XVII: Controlled Strategy Tests

---

## Test record format

Every controlled test should record:

- game version;
- exact map and settings;
- nation and age;
- Pretender design;
- active mods, hashes, and load order;
- turn;
- province and terrain;
- units, commanders, items, gems, orders, and scripts;
- expected result;
- actual messages and replays;
- repetition count;
- conclusion and confidence.

Strategy tests differ from formula tests because the objective is often robustness. Record distributions and failure types rather than only the best result.

## S1: Expansion reliability

Run the intended opening to turn 12 on at least ten starts.

Record:

- provinces and forts;
- treasury and income;
- army survivors;
- commander and mage production;
- PD spending;
- target types;
- defeats and causes;
- ability to fight a first war.

Compare median and worst credible outcomes, not only maximum provinces.

## S2: Expansion matchup matrix

Create representative independent provinces for:

- militia and ordinary infantry;
- archers;
- barbarians and high-damage infantry;
- light and heavy cavalry;
- tribes;
- giants or elephants;
- undead;
- Amazons and mage-supported defenders;
- Throne defenders.

Test party size, formation, script, bless, attrition, and retreat.

## S3: Map movement boundaries

Test armies at exact Map Move limits across:

- every surface terrain;
- snow;
- roads;
- friendly and enemy presence;
- survival abilities;
- rivers and mountain passes;
- caves;
- flying;
- mixed armies.

Record when the arrow remains but movement fails.

## S4: Hostile swaps and interception

On several terrains and army-size ratios, order hostile armies to swap provinces.

Record:

- battle province;
- whether they miss;
- sequential-battle order;
- retreat results;
- effect of stealth and allied forces.

Run direct one-step swaps separately from multi-province movement. For the direct set, preserve army chassis values and compare miss rate and battle location with the published 0-349 and open-ended chassis-die hypothesis.

## S5: Patrol detection

At controlled Stealth and Patrol strengths, repeat detection trials with:

- zero and high unrest;
- PD below and above 15;
- commanders and ordinary units;
- flying, Mindless, and Undisciplined patrollers;
- stealth troops with ordinary and +50 or greater stealth.

Compare observed rates with the official opposed open-ended rolls.

The main 6.36 table is already closed by direct enumeration. This suite now checks exceptional contributors, displayed rounding, invisible units, global bonuses, and any difference between the manual's halving rule and community descriptions of Undisciplined patrol strength.

## S6: Raid and pillage

Verify:

- the Map Move 20 requirement;
- Pillager commander legality;
- which units contribute;
- half-strength contribution;
- sequence after battle;
- population, unrest, supplies, gold, and food;
- one-month supply duration;
- interaction with forts and retreat.

Add boundary cases around the historical  $\text{floor}((\text{Strength} + \text{Combat Speed} + 10 \times \text{Fear}) / 2)$  unit-strength hypothesis, the proposed flyer substitution, population-to-strength failure boundary, and enemy-fort failure. Record raw outcomes rather than accepting the old downstream gold and casualty formulas.

## S7: Intelligence channels

For the same province, compare:

- neighbour report;



- scout;
- priest;
- spy;
- dominion;
- scrying;
- ownership.

Record every displayed field, error range, glamour detection, and update timing.

## S8: Siege arithmetic

Test Strength values around square and rounding boundaries with:

- flying;
- Mindless;
- Animal;
- Undisciplined;
- combinations;
- siege and castle-defence bonuses;
- intrinsic fort guards.

Verify reduction, repair, qualitative messages, and the effect of non-siege orders.

## S9: Relief and storm order

Create a cracked fort with:

- outside relief;
- Break Siege;
- magic-phase reinforcements;
- a scheduled storm;
- multiple allied attackers;
- commander deaths before the gate.

Record battle sequence, scripts, gem consumption, participant squads, and retreat.

## S10: Fort starvation

Record supplies and disease risk for at least ten siege turns with:

- ordinary living units;
- survival abilities;
- supply items and spells;
- commanders and mounts;
- large and small forts.

Verify the printed declining supply sequence and two-turn disease condition.

## S11: Assassination and bodyguards

Repeat assassination against:

- zero to five bodyguards;
- different Bodyguard and Patience values;

- mounted targets;
- fort interior and exterior;
- besieged forts;
- special-access assassins;
- multiple decoy commanders.

Record target distribution, bodyguard presence, surprise context, mount survival, and retreat.

## S12: Formal NAP edge cases

Under binding and nonbinding settings, test:

- direct movement attack;
- magic-phase attack;
- remote damage;
- assassination and seduction;
- stealth positioning;
- accidental bumps;
- independent recapture;
- harmful globals;
- throne-rush response.

Distinguish engine blocking, warnings, legal execution, and social doctrine.

Repeat the matrix with diplomacy binding, nonbinding through `--weakdiplo`, and absent through `--nodiplo`. Preserve the exact version and separate engine legality from any social rule used by the game.

## S13: Throne claim timing

Treat the established claim-loss matrix as a regression target and test claims by:

- Pretender;
- Disciple;
- H3;
- H2 boosted or transformed by relevant effects;
- besieged owner;
- besieger;
- claimant arriving by ordinary and magic movement;
- simultaneous capture and claim attempts.

Record hosting messages, claimant survival, full or partial ownership, fort state, AP immediately before victory, and dominion spread. A current test should reproduce claimant death, unfortified conquest, siege without storming, and successful storming separately. Exact simultaneous winning-AP ties remain an unresolved adjacent branch.

## S14: One-turn throne operation

Build a T+0 to T+3 scenario with:

- one-turn wall crack;
- relief;
- remotes;
- assassins;

- claimant movement;
- counterattack on an owned Throne.

Repeat with different event and movement branches to validate the operational timeline.

## S15: Cataclysm

In 6.36, record:

- first Cataclysm turn;
- horror target selection;
- fort interaction;
- throne destruction;
- required AP after each destruction;
- final result when all Thrones disappear;
- effect of current countermeasures.

This test resolves the manual/community wording conflict.

## S16: AI difficulty economy

Use identical nations and provinces at each difficulty.

Measure:

- gold;
- resources;
- recruitment points;
- magic income;
- commander recruitment;
- Holy Points;
- fort timing;
- ritual, global, and Dispel behaviour.

Confirm which modifiers apply and which do not.

## S17: Raider response exchange

For each standard thug or stealth package:

- 1 price the raider in gold, gems, and mage-turns;
- 2 price each defender;
- 3 run repeated battles;
- 4 include capture and looting;
- 5 measure provinces taken before interception;
- 6 compare attention and map impact.

The output is a campaign exchange table, not only a duel result.

## S18: Recovery scenario

Begin from a saved position after a main-army loss. Compare:

- immediate reconstruction;

- fort-based elastic defence;
- raiding counteroffence;
- emergency research pivot;
- negotiated peace.

Measure survival of capacity, territory after six turns, research, gem stock, and opponent advance.

## **S19: Information-deception scenario**

Present opponents with:

- visible false mass;
- hidden magic movers;
- multiple target routes;
- manipulated gem loads;
- staged claimants.

Record which observations actually change rational defence. Reject deception that works only because the defender ignores available evidence.

## **S20: Combined-mod campaign regression**

For the frozen DE + Divinitus load order, repeat:

- turn-12 expansion;
- key movement;
- first-war package;
- representative raider and counter;
- siege arithmetic;
- throne operation;
- AI practice game.

Any difference must be linked to a mod command or recorded as test-only evidence.

# **Part XVIII: Operational Checklists**

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## **New-game settings**

- Patch and manual revision recorded.
- Map, planes, and start density understood.
- Independent strength recorded.
- Research and magic-site settings recorded.
- Throne levels, total points, required points, and Cataclysm recorded.
- Score-graph settings recorded.
- Diplomacy mode and NAP doctrine recorded.
- Story events and special rules recorded.
- Mods, hashes, and load order recorded.
- Extension, substitution, and concession rules recorded.

## Turn-12 expansion audit

- Provinces, forts, and claimed routes.
- Income, treasury, upkeep, and resources.
- Surviving expansion parties.
- Capital recruitment unlocked.
- Researchers and site search.
- First fort start or reason for delay.
- Known neighbours and border settlements.
- Thrones located and inspected.
- First-war deterrence.
- Opening variance across tests.

## Pre-war audit

- War aim and stopping condition.
- Legal treaty date.
- Enemy main army and reserve.
- Known research, paths, Pretender, and counters.
- Friendly package, scripts, gems, and replacements.
- Siege strength and fort sequence.
- Scout coverage and deception plan.
- Other borders and coalition reaction.
- Failure route and peace terms.
- Throne conversion.

## Army departure

- Every troop has legal leadership.
- Slowest movement and survival checked.
- Rivers, passes, caves, water, and planes checked.
- Supply checked.
- Scripts and formations checked.
- Gems and slaves checked.
- Bodyguards checked.
- Spare commander and retreat route checked.
- Siege contribution checked.
- Claimant included if required.

## Raider

- Target class and likely PD.
- Legal route and movement.
- Counter locations.
- Minimal equipment.
- Fatigue stability.
- Retreat or escape.
- Replacement cost.
- Captured province exploitation.
- Loot carrier.
- Recall condition.

## Counter-raider

- Exact raider observed or inferred.
- Cheapest relevant counter.
- Interception destinations.
- High-value nodes covered.
- Empty provinces reclaimed cheaply.
- Gear-looting plan.
- Main army not distracted unnecessarily.
- PD raised only where it changes the matchup.

## Siege attacker

- Wall strength and one-turn crack estimate.
- Repair estimate.
- Maintain Siege orders.
- Relief routes.
- Sequential battle and gem budget.
- Storm script suitable for gate and indoor context.
- Commander survival and redundancy.
- Supplies.
- Claimant and post-storm defence.

## Siege defender

- Wall condition.
- Repair bodies.
- Interior supply and disease.
- Break Siege package.
- Outside relief and phase timing.
- Remote and assassination options.
- Irreplaceable cadre extraction.
- Alternate fort or Throne defence.
- Counterattack on attacker's strategic assets.

## Diplomacy

- Exact parties and terms.
- Formal, social, or hybrid.
- Notice and first legal turns.
- Scout, stealth, remote, dominion, global, and access terms.
- Trade quantities and delivery.
- Victory emergency clause.
- Mistake procedure.
- Written record.

## Throne watch

- Current and plausible AP for every nation.
- Controlled but unclaimed Thrones.

- Claim-capable units and movement.
- One-turn-crack forts.
- Magic-phase access.
- Existing claimed-Throne defence.
- Cataclysm threshold.
- Coalition contacts.
- Counterattack targets.

## Recovery

- Surviving cadres, gems, and items.
- Enemy next destinations.
- Existential, capacity, network, economic, and disposable provinces.
- Cheap stabilisation research.
- Fort and retreat line.
- Raider counteroffence.
- Diplomatic options.
- New army package rather than blind replacement.

## Final submission

- No immediate opponent victory.
- All messages read.
- All decisive replays watched.
- Treasury and queues checked.
- Research allocated.
- Forts, labs, temples, and PD intentional.
- Rituals and forging intentional.
- Gems, items, and troops transferred.
- Movement remains legal.
- Siege, patrol, sneak, defend, and claim orders correct.
- Treaty and trade obligations fulfilled.
- Turn saved and submitted.

# Part XIX: Essays

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## Essay I: The Expansion Problem

Expansion is often measured by a turn-12 province count because the number is visible, easy to compare, and strongly connected to early income. It is useful and incomplete. The real expansion problem is to acquire enough valuable and defensible territory while preserving the capacity to survive first contact.

The opening begins before the map appears. Pretender design decides whether an awake monster supplies a second army, a bless turns sacreds into a specialist expansion force, or scales finance ordinary troops and early infrastructure. These choices do not buy abstract power. They buy particular expansion matchups at particular times. An awake monster that clears militia but dies to the first heavy cavalry province has not solved expansion; it has created a route constraint with catastrophic failure.

The first skill is classification. Independents are not a ladder from small to large. They are a collection of damage, armour, morale, missile, lance, formation, and magic problems. Heavy national infantry may walk through ordinary weapons and bleed out against barbarians. High-defence sacreds may dominate low-attack infantry and collapse when surrounded. Archers may erase unarmoured tribes but waste months against shielded heavy troops. A party becomes reliable when its player knows what it is designed to fight.

The second skill is routing. Each province changes future options. A cap-ring forest can release resources into capital recruitment. Rich farmland can finance a fort. A choke point can define a border. A route around an interior pocket can reserve easy provinces for a third party. Province value is not just the income shown this turn; it is the chain of recruitment, movement, and diplomacy that ownership makes possible.

The third skill is force sizing. Too little force creates losses whose true cost includes replacement, delayed parties, commander transport, and deterrence. Too much force concentrates strength that can conquer only one province per month. The efficient party is not the mathematical minimum that can win under average rolls. It carries enough margin to survive uncertain reports, unlucky combat, and the next target.

The fourth skill is transition. Independent expansion offers largely static opponents. Human contact introduces adaptation, deception, and simultaneous movement. A nation that continues driving small parties outward after borders are settled may present each one for defeat. A nation that combines too early may surrender unclaimed land. The transition occurs when the next neutral gain is worth less than the fort, research, reserve, or diplomatic stability it delays.

Expansion testing works because it turns these judgments into experience before the game begins. The test must include realistic PD, recruitment, site search, and infrastructure or it rewards a position that cannot exist in the real campaign. Repetition matters more than one ideal map. The goal is a procedure that produces a resilient median and an acceptable bad start.

The final measure is the first-war position. Territory is valuable when it has become income, resources, forts, mages, sites, routes, and political claims. Expansion is complete only when the nation can defend or exploit what it has taken.

## Essay II: Information as a Resource

Information has no treasury icon, yet it changes the value of every other resource. Ten gems carried into the correct battle are a weapon; ten gems carried by a mage who is intercepted by the wrong counter are loot. A fort one turn from cracking is a crisis if observed and a surprise defeat if not. A Throne held by an opponent is ordinary territory until its claim changes the victory arithmetic.

Dominions distributes information unevenly. Ownership gives one view, adjacency another, scouts another, spies another, dominion another, and scrying another. Score graphs show trends without scripts or stocks. Battle replays reveal exact deployed tools but only after contact. Diplomacy supplies claims whose reliability must be judged. The strategic task is not to obtain perfect knowledge. It is to combine imperfect channels before the decision deadline.

This begins with questions. "What does the enemy have?" has no practical stopping point. "Can the border fort be cracked next turn?" directs collection toward army size, siege bodies, wall modifiers, and nearby movement. "Can the army survive Foul Vapors?" directs attention toward Nature paths, research evidence, poison resistance, and gem carriers. Intelligence has value when it changes an order.



Uncertainty must remain visible. A missing army may have withdrawn, hidden through glamour, moved through another route, or prepared a magic-phase attack. A research spike may indicate a new threshold, an event, or simply accumulated infrastructure. Experts are not those who always guess correctly. They assign confidence, retain alternative explanations, and choose orders that remain tolerable under several branches.

Denial is the other half. Patrolling out scouts reduces enemy coverage. Concealing item transfers delays counter construction. Holding a magic mover on a central lab creates several possible targets. Hiding everything also sacrifices deterrence: an enemy cannot fear a capability it does not believe exists. Selective revelation can preserve a border while the decisive package stays concealed.

Deception is useful only when it changes rational allocation. A false army near an irrelevant province is theatre. A displayed force near one Throne while a stealth and magic-movement package can reach another may force the defender to split. The false story must fit observed paths, movement, and incentives. Good opponents do not need certainty to respond; they need a threat whose expected cost is high enough.

Information also imposes attention costs. A hundred unlabelled scouts and reports can make a position harder to understand rather than easier. Networks need roles: border screen, operational depth, strategic nodes, and rear warning. Reports need dates. Old observations must be marked stale. The player must know which provinces going dark matter.

The final advantage is learning speed. Each battle answers questions about scripts, gem use, target selection, and counters. A player who reviews those answers converts losses into future efficiency. A player who watches only whether the green bar won receives almost no information from the same event.

Information is not omniscience. It is the reduction of expensive surprise.

## Essay III: Raiding and Counter-Raiding

Raiding is often described as taking low-defence provinces with small forces. Its deeper purpose is to create an unfavourable allocation problem. A raider costs less than the force that must remain available to stop it, threatens more provinces than the defender can cover, and moves while the main army creates a separate emergency.

The provincial income is only the simplest return. A raider can cut a reinforcement route, stop a lab from pooling gems, interrupt recruitment, isolate a fort, remove a temple, expose retreat into hostile land, or force a combat mage away from the field army. These gains are positional and temporal. A poor province can be the most valuable raid if it breaks a corridor on the decisive turn.

Raider design begins with a target class. A small troop squad may defeat token PD. A light thug may defeat stronger PD and ordinary local recruits. A heavy thug may punish troop-only responses. A stealth army may bypass the line. A teleporter may strike a lab before normal movement. Each class has a ceiling. Calling every geared commander a thug hides the question that matters: what can it beat at its price?

Minimalism creates the favourable exchange. A protection item that changes the PD matchup can be efficient. A fifth defensive item that does not change the likely counter turns the unit into loot. Equipment keeps its value only while the carrier survives; when captured, the swing includes the attacker's loss and the defender's gain. Expected target value, escape probability, and available counters should set the item budget.

Counter-raiding fails when the defender treats every lost province as equally urgent. Chasing a fast raider with the main army abandons the decisive front. Raising heavy PD everywhere can cost more than the raids. Sending an expensive mage after incomplete information can donate another asset.

A layered defence is cheaper. Scouts predict routes. PD tripwires defeat the smallest attacks and reveal larger ones. Forts preserve recruitment. Local commanders retake empty land. Mobile specialists cover labs, Thrones, and junctions. Magic-phase counters threaten raiders that ordinary armies cannot catch. The strategic reserve does not chase; it occupies a node from which several valuable provinces are protected.

The defender should also attack the raid's support. A stealth force may need a commander route, a laboratory for magic escape, or a predictable safe province. A thug may depend on one irreplaceable item factory. A remote attacker may expose a high-path caster and gem stock. Counter-raiding becomes counteroffence when it removes the infrastructure that makes repeated raids possible.

Raiding succeeds when it is connected to the campaign. Provinces taken at random are noise. Provinces taken while a fort is being cracked can prevent relief. A raider that forces the only counter-mage away may let the main army win. A raid that captures a Throne can change the victory threshold without destroying an army.

The mature contest is not province against province. It is response cost against threat cost, repeated until one side can no longer cover the map.

## Essay IV: Siege as a Strategic Clock

A fort does not make a province invulnerable. It buys time, preserves an interior, and changes the sequence required to convert field victory into ownership. That sequence is the siege clock.

The attacker first has to reach the province and defeat whatever remains outside. Wall reduction then compares Strength-squared contribution against repair. Only armies maintaining the siege contribute. Once walls reach zero, the attacker must issue a storm order and win the gate battle. Relief can occur first. The same mages may fight several times, spend gems, lose commanders, and enter the storm with a script designed for a different battlefield.

Each turn of delay creates room to act. The defender can finish research, move relief, cast remotes, recruit elsewhere, negotiate assistance, or counterattack another Throne. The attacker pays upkeep, supply, attention, and exposure. A fort's value is not only its wall number. It is also the number of hostile deadlines that pass while the walls remain.

Siege strength converts troop composition into tempo. High-Strength and flying units can reduce enormous walls quickly. Mindless, Animal, and Undisciplined penalties can make a visually vast army unexpectedly slow. An army optimised only for field battle may spend months outside a cheap fort. A smaller army with specialised siege bodies may convert victories before the political situation changes.

The defender also converts bodies into time. Cheap units can repair. Intrinsic guards strengthen the storm. Mages inside remain able to research or prepare while the fort holds, but declining supplies create an attrition clock in the opposite direction. A capital packed with irreplaceable living mages cannot wait indefinitely if starvation and disease begin.

Relief creates the siege's most dangerous turn. If the defender breaks the besieger outside, the storm is cancelled. If relief fails, it may still consume attack gems and kill siege commanders before the gate. The attacker must decide whether one script can survive several combats and whether gem

loads cover the full chain. The defender must decide whether the relief force is buying victory, delay, or merely a cheap gem burn.

Throne forts expose the clock's endgame importance. A one-turn crack can reduce coalition reaction to a single cycle. A force that requires two turns may allow every surviving nation to move, forge, assassinate, and attack the rusher's existing points. Wall strength is then not local defence; it is world reaction time.

Siege strategy should be planned backwards from the storm and forward from the relief. How many turns can the larger game afford? Which assets are trapped? What counterstroke becomes possible during delay? A fort has fulfilled its role when the time it creates is converted, even if the walls eventually fall.

## Essay V: Timing Attacks and Power Spikes

Power is relative and temporary. A nation may have a stronger endgame and still die before reaching it. Another may dominate the first year with an awake expander and lose once opponents acquire armour-negating magic. Strategy identifies the interval when a package produces more usable force than rivals can answer and converts that interval before it closes.

A power spike can come from awakening, research, recruitment scale, a forged booster, a summon, a global, a treaty expiry, or an opponent's losses. The visible event is rarely sufficient by itself. Completing a battlefield enchantment does nothing if troops have not assembled, gems remain in the capital, and mages need three turns to walk to the front.

Preparation must begin before research completes. Recruit the line that the spell will protect. Forge the boosters that create legal casters. Place scouts on the target. Begin the NAP countdown. Move siege bodies and claimants. Accumulate enough gems for the operation and the response. The spike begins when the whole package can act, not when one school reaches a number.

Relative timing also includes counters. A mass protection spell may dominate mundane armies for several turns and become ordinary once armour-piercing evocations or battlefield control appear. A sacred rush may exploit neighbours who spent design points on scales and imprisonment, then face awake gods and deeper research later. The attack's deadline is the earliest likely answer, not the player's preferred calendar.

Good timing attacks produce a conversion that persists after the window. They take forts, destroy irreplaceable cadres, seize Thrones, or force treaties. Merely winning peripheral battles allows the defender to survive until the counter arrives. The objective should be the asset whose loss prevents recovery.

There is also a defensive spike. A nation under attack may be two turns from a cheap resistance spell, a communion threshold, or an awakened Pretender. Elastic defence can surrender land to preserve those turns. The invader's strongest play is often to force the decisive battle before the threshold; the defender's strongest is to make every route consume time.

Not every spike should be used for war. Visible capacity can deter and create favourable treaties. A global or research lead can improve economy more safely than conquest. The comparison is between what the window can gain through attack and what it can compound through peace.

The essential habit is to date power. "This army is strong" is not a plan. "This package can crack the border fort on turn 25, before the likely counter on turn 28, and hold the captured lab" is strategic reasoning.

## Essay VI: The Diplomacy of Threat

Diplomacy in Dominions is not separate from military power. It determines how much power must be held idle, where armies can move, which gems become accessible through trade, and how quickly a leader faces a coalition. The central diplomatic object is the credible threat.

A threat has capacity, communication, and an off-ramp. Capacity means the stated consequence can actually occur. Communication means the target understands the condition and deadline. The off-ramp gives the target a cheaper action than defiance. Without capacity, the threat is noise. Without clarity, it produces fear without control. Without an achievable exit, it becomes war.

NAPs formalise some of this uncertainty. Dominions 6 can mechanically enforce them, but engine enforcement cannot answer every social question. Remotes, stealth staging, dominion pressure, harmful globals, third-party access, and victory emergencies create conduct that may be legal in code and unacceptable under a group's expectations. Clear doctrine prevents disagreement from becoming the most destructive event in a months-long game.

Treaties purchase time. That time should have a named use: research, a war on another front, fort construction, recovery, or a throne operation. A NAP with no purpose can allow a stronger neighbour to compound more efficiently than the beneficiary. Long commitments also reduce the table's ability to respond to victory. Their duration must be compared with plausible throne windows.

Reputation is stored diplomatic capacity. A player known to deliver trades and follow written countdowns can create agreements with fewer guarantees. A player known for exploiting ambiguity forces neighbours to hold armies and refuse valuable exchanges. Betrayal may occasionally be strategically decisive, but its full price includes future games and coalition response, not only the current province.

Leaders face a different problem. Strength attracts balancing. Oppressive globals, rapid eliminations, hidden throne progress, or permanent treaty blocs can make every other nation safer by cooperating. A leader should convert strength quickly enough that the coalition cannot form, or behave in ways that keep rivals divided without making promises that destroy credibility.

Weaker nations possess leverage because their collapse redistributes territory, Thrones, and fronts. They can offer information, gems, access, or coordinated resistance. They can also choose which rival benefits from conquest. This is not unlimited power, but it means diplomacy does not end when the army graph falls.

The diplomacy of threat is ultimately the management of expected futures. Every treaty, warning, trade, and coalition message changes what other players believe will happen if they choose one branch. The most efficient military victory is the one a credible threat secures without spending the army.

## Essay VII: Recovery and Elastic Defence

Defeat creates a dangerous illusion of total collapse. The missing army is immediately visible; surviving research, forts, gems, diplomatic value, and enemy exposure are less vivid. Recovery begins by measuring what remains.

The first objective is capacity. Territory can be retaken if forts still recruit the mages that define the nation. Troops can be rebuilt if command survives. Gems can become a new counter if laboratories remain. A panicked counterattack that loses the surviving cadre turns a reversible battle loss into structural defeat.

Elastic defence uses space to buy the time needed for a different exchange. Poor provinces are allowed to fall. PD reveals movement. Forts interrupt advance. Scouts identify whether the attacker concentrates or disperses. Raiders enter the rear. A research pivot matures behind the line. The defender chooses a shorter perimeter while the attacker acquires a longer supply and reinforcement problem.

This approach works because field victory creates commitments. The attacker must siege or bypass forts, protect captured labs, cover retreats, and decide how much force to leave behind. If it concentrates, raiders can recover provinces. If it disperses, a surviving reserve can defeat pieces. If it storms repeatedly, gems and commanders are exposed. The defender's purpose is to make every further gain cost more time than the attacker budgeted.

Recovery also changes diplomacy. Neighbours may fear the attacker more after a major victory. Exact reports of the winning army, its spent gems, and revealed scripts are valuable coalition information. A weakened nation can offer access or intelligence that a bystander could not obtain alone. The diplomatic position may improve while the military graph worsens.

The counterstroke should target dependency rather than colour. Destroy the army's lab, cut its retreat, assassinate the leader carrying most troops, relieve the key mage fort, or take a Throne elsewhere. Retaking every low-value province can wait. The goal is to remove the opponent's initiative.

Some positions cannot recover. The same discipline still matters. A final defence can delay a throne leader, transfer useful information under the rules, or create time for a substitute. Silent staling damages the competitive structure and removes strategic choices from everyone.

Elastic defence is not an excuse for indecision. It is a controlled exchange of land for the one resource a defeated nation most needs: a future turn in which the answer exists.

## Essay VIII: The Throne Race

Thrones transform Dominions from a war of unlimited conquest into a contest of conversion. A nation does not need to defeat every army or own most provinces. It needs to own and claim the configured number of Ascension Points at the relevant hosting step.

This makes arithmetic a strategic skill. Current claimed points are only the visible baseline. Controlled but unclaimed Thrones, H3 movement, one-turn-crack forts, magic-phase reach, and Cataclysm can change the threshold within several turns. A nation that appears three points short may already control a three-point Throne. A nation at the threshold can be stopped by unclaiming one existing point before the new claim resolves.

Throne defence differs from ordinary border defence. A Throne province has discontinuous value because losing the wrong one can end the game. Its fort walls measure coalition reaction time. A one-turn crack may leave only one cycle for remote attacks, relief, claimant assassination, or a counterattack on another Throne.

The attacker must prepare for more than the storm. Bystanders who ignored a conventional war may unite when victory becomes visible. Magic-phase probes can consume gems before the relief and gate battle. Assassins can remove the claimant or commanders whose squads are needed to storm. Existing Thrones become counterattack targets. The winning operation needs redundancy, secrecy, siege, combat, claimant access, and defence at once.

The defender should resist local fixation. Saving the targeted Throne may be impossible. Cracking one of the attacker's owned Throne forts can change the arithmetic faster. Killing the claimant can buy a

turn. Cutting a route can strand H3 access after the army wins. Coalition members should assign tasks by reach rather than all sending armies toward the same province too late.

Diplomacy changes near victory. Many communities treat an imminent throne win as superseding ordinary NAP expectations; formal binding systems may still constrain actions unless a victory clause was agreed. Games should resolve this before play, because a rule intended to create peace can otherwise make a legal response impossible.

Cataclysm adds a moving target. As Thrones disappear, required points decline and surviving points gain value. A long plan can become irrelevant between order and resolution. Endgame arithmetic must be recalculated every turn.

The throne race rewards preparation disguised as ordinary strength. The best rush becomes obvious only when the response window is already closing.

## Essay IX: Why the AI Behaves as It Does

The Dominions AI plays the same fundamental economy, recruitment, movement, battle, magic, and victory systems, but it does not possess human political reasoning. It receives programmed priorities, complete province-ownership knowledge, and difficulty bonuses rather than intuition or social memory.

This distinction explains both pressure and predictability. At high difficulty, large bonuses to gold, resources, recruitment points, and magic income can create armies and magical output that a human position could not match from the same land. The AI can build forts, recruit national troops, cast high-level rituals and globals, and Dispel. It is not passive. Its threat comes from production and broad action.

What it lacks is the full human model of intention. A human may conceal a research spike, accept a poor local exchange to win a Throne elsewhere, or maintain a treaty because reputation across future games matters. Human coalitions can distribute tasks and share exact enemy scripts. The AI's decisions are bounded by the behaviours its evaluation can express.

Patch corrections matter. An old report that the AI repeatedly attempts rituals without a lab or assigns non-priests to preach no longer describes current 6.36 behaviour where those errors have been corrected. AI strategy must be evaluated by version rather than inherited folklore.

Difficulty also changes what a practice game teaches. Impossible pressure trains emergency defence and efficient battle magic, but its economic ratios are not a fair benchmark for human expansion. Normal difficulty better exposes whether the player's first fort, recruitment, and research produce a sound state. Both have value when their purpose is explicit.

Players can defeat predictable behaviour through loops that teach little. Better practice keeps scouts, legal Throne arithmetic, layered defence, gem budgets, and realistic no-reload consequences. The aim is to rehearse a full national campaign, not only discover one weakness in target selection.

The AI is best understood as an active strategic environment with asymmetric advantages and bounded judgment. It is capable enough to punish weak fundamentals and broad enough to expose players to many spells and rosters. It is not a substitute for the social, deceptive, and adaptive layer of multiplayer.

## Sources and Open Questions



## Principal sources

- [Illwinter, Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2](#), especially game settings, scouting, movement, patrol, stealth, raid, pillage, assassination, siege, diplomacy, Thrones, Cataclysm, AI, and hosting sequence.
- [Illwinter Dominions 6 documentation](#).
- [Illwinter Dominions 6 changes and new features](#).
- [Illwinter home page and current release record](#).
- [Official Dominions 6.36 announcement](#).
- [Official Dominions 6.35 release note](#).
- [Official Dominions 6.30 announcement](#).
- [Supplied DomEnhanced2\\_16.dm](#).
- [Supplied Divinitus\\_1.15.3\\_DE.dm](#).

## Community doctrine and test references

- [Naaira's Expansion Guide](#), used for the repeat-to-turn-12 expansion-testing method.
- [Cybertron2's Guide to Expansion, Part 1](#), used for current Dominions 6 expansion-role and mage-support discussion.
- [Cybertron2's Guide to Expansion, Part 3](#), used for frontage and expansion analysis.
- [Building Thugs and Supercombatants](#), used for contemporary role, efficiency, defensive-layer, and counter-thug doctrine.
- [NAPS: a rundown and two formal doctrines](#), used to document community ambiguity and explicit treaty conventions.
- [Siege](#), used for community-documented messages and operational edge cases that remain assigned to tests.
- [Owl's Mini-Guide to Throne Rushes](#), used for the T+0 to T+3 operational model and coalition-response doctrine.
- [Dominions 6 Thrones](#), used as a current community object reference and to identify Cataclysm and identity questions requiring current-game verification.

Community sources supply doctrine, hypotheses, and test candidates. They do not override the current manual or official update notes. Where a community page is inherited from Dominions 5, only system-level reasoning consistent with Dominions 6 is retained, and exact claims remain marked for reproduction.

## Open questions

Current-game tests or resolved data are still needed for:

- exact movement-interception probability and battle location in hostile swaps;
- full rounding and combination rules for movement and siege modifiers;
- current patrol-detection distributions under every unit modifier;
- all Raid and pillage output functions;
- exact bodyguard, Patience, surprise, and mounted-assassination distributions;
- every binding-NAP edge case under all diplomacy settings;
- complete current Throne identity and object-effect data;
- final Cataclysm outcome wording and current horror interaction;
- AI decision weights, target priorities, and diplomacy evaluation;
- current effective strategy objects under the DE 2.16 then Divinitus 1.15.3 DE layer;
- nation-specific expansion, research, war, raid, and throne packages.

These remain explicit research tasks. Nation dossiers can still use the campaign method as long as their local assumptions are stated.

## DOCUMENT 9 OF 16

# Foundation Book VII: Nations

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## The Nation Dossier Method, Middle Age Arcoscephale, Marignon, Pyrène, Ulm, Man, Abysia, Pythium, Eriu, Agartha, Uruk, Ashdod, T'ien Ch'i, and Machaka

### What a nation dossier should do

A nation guide should do more than name strong units and recommend a research queue. It should explain how a nation turns its starting roster into a functioning state, how that state changes when research arrives, how its plans fail, and how to rebuild those plans when the ruleset changes.

This volume of the nation library does two jobs:

- establish a reproducible method for every later nation dossier;
- apply that method to Middle Age Arcoscephale, the Old Kingdom, Middle Age Marignon, Fiery Justice, Middle Age Pyrène, Time of the Akelarre, Middle Age Ulm, Forges of Ulm, Middle Age Man, Tower of Avalon, Middle Age Abysia, Blood and Fire, Middle Age Pythium, Emerald Empire, Middle Age Eriu, Last of the Tuatha, Middle Age Agartha, Golem Cult, Middle Age Uruk, City States, Middle Age Ashdod, Reign of the Anakim, Middle Age T'ien Ch'i, Imperial Bureaucracy, and Middle Age Machaka, Reign of Sorcerors.

It offers a safe first route through the roster and opening, but it also follows the harder questions of mage probability, force packages, path access, counters, logistics, and opportunity cost. There is no single build detached from map, opponents, settings, and patch. The dossier instead presents several coherent strategic families and the conditions that favour each one.

### Edition note

[Book I](#) defines the common 6.36 live baseline and evidence terms. The dossiers' structured object comparisons remain pinned to their stated 6.35 snapshot. Unmodded rules, DE 2.16, Divinitus 1.15.3 DE, and the combined load order stay visibly separate. [Book IX](#) owns the general mod catalogue; [Book VII](#) applies it to individual nations.

### How to use this dossier

The one-page brief, roster, expansion plan, mage roles, research branches, army packages, and turn checklists form the practical core. Probability portfolios, communion failure analysis, access ladders, matchups, reserves, and controlled tests provide the expert layer. Each nation chapter begins again from its own ruleset and evidence label; advice from one dossier should not be carried into another merely because both are Middle Age nations.

## Part I: The Nation Dossier Method

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# What a complete nation guide must answer

A useful dossier answers twelve questions.

| Question                                                      | Required evidence                                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What is the nation trying to convert?                         | National summary, roster, magic, economy                            |
| What wins neutral expansion?                                  | Unit statistics, formations, repeated tests                         |
| What prevents an early defeat?                                | Neighbour analysis, reachable research, reserve plan                |
| What does each fort recruit?                                  | Commander costs, recruitment points, role demand                    |
| What does each mage random actually enable?                   | Exact random scheme and probability                                 |
| Which research creates deployable packages?                   | Spells, paths, gems, mage-turns, delivery                           |
| Which paths are native, bootstrapped, or Pretender-dependent? | Access ladder with every step named                                 |
| How does the nation fight different defence classes?          | Armour, numbers, elites, giants, ethereal, undead, magic resistance |
| How does it raid, defend, siege, and claim?                   | Movement, leadership, magic, siege strength, priests                |
| What information does it possess or lack?                     | Scouts, spies, scrying, remote spells, battle evidence              |
| Which Pretender family solves the actual constraint?          | Legal design, scales, timing, bless and ritual jobs                 |
| What changes under each mod?                                  | Source diff, load order, combined test                              |

If one answer is missing, the guide should say so. Concealing uncertainty creates a brittle strategy.

## The four layers of a nation

Every nation should be analysed in four layers.

| Layer    | Contents                                                 | Common mistake                                  |
|----------|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Rules    | Roster, paths, costs, sites, spells, dominion, buildings | Repeating obsolete data                         |
| Capacity | What can be recruited, researched, forged, and delivered | Treating theoretical access as immediate access |
| Doctrine | How the capacities can be combined                       | Presenting one context-dependent plan as law    |
| Evidence | Tests, replays, probability, and source records          | Treating an anecdotal win as proof              |

The rules layer is descriptive. Capacity is conditional: an E2S1 mage does not automatically equal an E2S2 ritual caster; the necessary item, gems, laboratory, and forge turn must exist. Doctrine is comparative: one package is chosen because it fits an enemy, a deadline, and an economy. Evidence determines confidence.

## The national conversion chain

The central dossier model is:

scales and starting assets  
-> expansion and borders  
-> forts and recruitment  
-> mage distribution  
-> research and gems  
-> battlefield or ritual packages

-> positional gains  
-> siege, Throne claim, and victory

A nation can fail at any arrow. Strong troops may expand but consume so many resources that the second fort cannot recruit. Broad magic may remain a collection of low paths if no communion or booster plan exists. A devastating battlefield spell may arrive without the troops, gems, or movement needed to exploit it. A winning army may lack siege or claim capacity.

Each nation chapter records both assets and conversions.

## The national identity statement

A national identity statement should be one paragraph, not a slogan. It should name:

- the reliable early force;
- the recruitment bottleneck;
- the magic engine;
- the information advantage;
- the main strategic transition;
- the principal vulnerabilities.

An identity statement is a starting hypothesis. It must be revised when a patch or mod changes one of those elements.

## Roster analysis by job

Units should first be grouped by job, then compared by statistics.

| Job        | Questions                                                                     |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Screen     | How cheaply can it absorb missiles, charges, and first contact?               |
| Line       | What ordinary damage can it resist, and how long before fatigue defeats it?   |
| Damage     | What armour, size, defence, or resistance class can it kill?                  |
| Flank      | Can it reach exposed mages or force the enemy to deploy wider?                |
| Trampler   | What sizes can it trample, and how are morale and magic resistance protected? |
| Sacred     | Is the unit scarce, cap-only, resource-heavy, or massable?                    |
| Siege body | What wall damage, supply use, and opportunity cost does it impose?            |
| Raider     | Which Province Defence and local recruits can it beat reliably?               |
| Bodyguard  | What assassination, arrow, or flying threat does it prevent?                  |

"Elite" is not a job. "High protection" is not a complete evaluation. A high-protection unit with low combat speed, high encumbrance, and ordinary damage may be an excellent anvil and a poor pursuit force.

## Commander analysis by constrained turn

Commanders compete for recruitment capacity. Their gold cost is only one part of the decision.

For every commander, record:

- commander recruitment-point cost;

- fort and terrain restrictions;
- leadership types and limits;
- research;
- priest level;
- magic and randomness;
- strategic abilities;
- likely monthly orders;
- what is delayed when this commander is recruited.

A capital-only four-point mage has a different strategic cost from a one-point scout even if sufficient gold exists for both. Nation plans should budget fort-turns, capital-turns, and commander points as explicitly as gold.

## Magic access as a probability portfolio

Random paths are not a list of possible maxima. They are a distribution.

For every random mage, the dossier should record:

- fixed paths;
- each random roll and its probability;
- maximum natural paths;
- probability of each important threshold;
- mutually impossible combinations;
- expected recruits needed for a role;
- the effect of bad variance;
- what a Pretender or independent mage can replace.

If a required result occurs with probability  $p$ , the probability of seeing at least one result after  $n$  independent recruits is:

$$P(\text{at least one}) = 1 - (1 - p)^n$$

The expected count  $(1/p)$  is not a guarantee. A one-in-eight specialist has about a 65.6% chance to appear within eight recruits, not certainty. It takes twenty-three recruits to exceed a 95% chance:

$$1 - (7/8)^{23} \approx 95.4\%$$

This distinction matters when the first war arrives before the desired random.

## Native, bootstrapped, and imported access

Every path claim belongs in one of four classes.

| Class          | Meaning                                                                          |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Native         | A normal national recruit can perform the job without external help              |
| Boosted native | A national recruit can perform it with named items or self-buffs                 |
| Bootstrapped   | An earlier summon, transformation, empowerment, or national event creates access |
| Imported       | A Pretender, hero, independent, mercenary, Throne, site, or ally provides access |

The access ledger must name every bridge. "Arcoscephale can cast a Death ritual" is incomplete if it actually means "a rare Nature hero forges or casts into a summon chain that eventually produces Death."

## Research as response trees

A fixed research queue assumes the enemy and map will cooperate. A response tree has:

- a trunk of broadly useful early research;
- branches for observed threats;
- conversion nodes where research becomes a fieldable package;
- rejoin points so emergency research does not permanently destroy the long plan.

Every node should specify:

- school and level;
- spell or item obtained;
- eligible caster;
- required communion, booster, or self-buff;
- gem load;
- troop or target interaction;
- operational delivery;
- counters;
- what the research delays.

## Army packages, not spell lists

An army package is:

troops + commanders + mages + scripts + gems + formation  
+ movement route + retreat route + replacement plan

A spell becomes strategy only when the nation can put the correct caster, protection, gems, and targets in the same battle.

Each package should have:

- purpose: what defence or target it defeats;
- minimum core: the smallest robust version;
- scaling rule: what to add as the enemy grows;
- failure branch: what happens if the script is interrupted;
- counter warning: the most economical answer available to the enemy;
- replacement cost: how quickly the nation can field another.

## Matchup classification

Nation-versus-nation memorisation becomes obsolete quickly. Defence classes are more durable.

| Enemy class              | Questions                                                                |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light troops      | Can the nation kill squares faster than it is surrounded?                |
| Heavy armour             | Is damage high enough, or is armour destruction available?               |
| High defence and glamour | Are attack buffs, area effects, or sight effects available?              |
| Giants and elite sacreds | Can control, fatigue, armour-negating damage, or mass be delivered?      |
| Undead and demons        | Are priests, magic weapons, banishment, morale, and resistance adequate? |
| Flyers and cavalry       | Is the rear protected and the line deep enough?                          |
| Tramplers                | Can size, body-blocking, control, and morale attacks stop them?          |

| Enemy class                | Questions                                                         |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Battle-mage mass           | Can the nation disperse, interrupt, resist, or strike first?      |
| Thugs and supercombatants  | Can the chassis be controlled, exhausted, penetrated, or ignored? |
| Remote and stealth warfare | Are domes, patrols, redundant labs, and reserves in place?        |

Specific opponents can then be placed into one or more classes.

## Pretender families

A dossier should present families, not copied designs:

- awake expansion: buys early territory and deterrence;
- dormant intervention: appears for the first war or path bridge;
- imprisoned scales: maximises the recruitable state;
- bless support: improves a sacred unit that can be recruited in relevant numbers;
- ritual bridge: supplies paths the national roster cannot reach;
- hybrid: deliberately performs two of these jobs at a real cost to each.

Every proposed build must pass five audits:

- 1 legality in the exact version and mod order;
- 2 expansion or survival job;
- 3 scales and recruitment compatibility;
- 4 mid-game job on awakening;
- 5 unique late-game access that cannot be bought more cheaply elsewhere.

## Verification standard

Nation claims are verified in this order:

- 1 official manual or current official data;
- 2 current structured object data;
- 3 supplied mod source;
- 4 controlled game test;
- 5 detailed community evidence;
- 6 strategic inference.

The source hierarchy does not make community strategy unimportant. It prevents strategic experience from being confused with engine definition.

## Minimum controlled-test suite

Every nation eventually receives:

- three or more turn-12 expansion runs for each serious Pretender family;
- controlled battles against the main independent types;
- random-mage sampling large enough to detect transcription errors;
- communion fatigue and script tests;
- a research timing test with realistic infrastructure;
- siege and storm tests;
- representative matchups against armour, elites, undead, flyers, trampers, and magic;
- modded repetitions under each supported load order;

- a save, turn number, settings record, result table, and replay note.
- Until those tests are recorded, precise party sizes and timing claims remain hypotheses.

# Part II: Middle Age Arcoscephale, the Old Kingdom

## The one-page national brief

Middle Age Arcoscephale is a human combined-arms nation whose ordinary military is old-fashioned but broad: inexpensive formation infantry, armoured spear lines, chariots, elephants, and a small capital sacred. Its strategic engine is a network of recruit-anywhere Mystics backed by capital Astrologers, priestess-healers, and automatic scrying inside friendly dominion.

The nation converts gold into versatile S1 elemental mages, those mages into communions or independent specialist casters, and research into an adaptable battlefield. It is strongest when intelligence identifies the defence to defeat before the army is scripted. It is weakest when expensive human mages are caught unprotected, when tramlers are exposed to morale or magic-resistance attacks, when heavy infantry is exhausted, or when random-path variance prevents a required specialist from arriving on time.

## National profile

| Feature            | Unmodded Dominions 6.35                                  |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Race               | Humans                                                   |
| Military           | Heavy spear infantry, chariots, elephants                |
| Recruitable magic  | Astral, Fire, Water, Earth; some Nature                  |
| Priests            | H1 and H2 priestess-healers                              |
| Dominion           | Accurate automatic military reports inside dominion      |
| Scale limit        | Order limit +1                                           |
| Forts              | Standard                                                 |
| Laboratories       | 300 gold                                                 |
| Capital income     | 1 Nature gem and 4 Astral pearls per month               |
| Central constraint | Gold- and mage-turn-intensive magical state              |
| Central advantage  | Information plus highly adaptable recruit-anywhere magic |

## Lore and strategic meaning

The Old Kingdom is intentionally archaic. Its armies retain cumbersome armour, long spears, chariots, and war elephants while ancient Astrologers return to guide the realm. This is not only flavour. The roster juxtaposes slow, reliable formation troops with volatile tramlers, while the mage corps juxtaposes broad low-level access with capital astral depth.

Three strategic themes follow.

First, knowledge precedes commitment. Automatic scrying inside dominion and Astrologers who read the heavens support a nation that should know what is approaching before choosing a script.

Second, the old army needs magical renewal. The troops can expand and hold ground, but armour, fatigue, morale, large targets, and elite opposition eventually require tailored magic.

Third, restoration is cumulative. Arcoscephale becomes stronger as forts produce Mystics, research broadens, boosters accumulate, and communions scale. Losing a mage core or capital does more than remove units; it breaks the conversion chain.

## National special features

### Automatic dominion scrying

Official: provinces inside Arcoscephale's dominion receive accurate automatic military reports. Current structured data also identifies this scrying as capable of revealing glamourised units, and disciple partners receive the information.

This is a strategic advantage, not omniscience.

It helps with:

- army size and composition near the interior;
- early warning against ordinary movement;
- more informed deployment of elephants, communions, and counters;
- identifying when a border force has split;
- tracking glamourised forces that ordinary reports may conceal.

It does not replace:

- scouts beyond dominion;
- spies for income, unrest, Province Defence, and deeper provincial information;
- battle replays for scripts, gems, and exact spell use;
- patrols against stealth;
- caution against magic movement, assassinations, remote attacks, and simultaneous orders.

The correct doctrine is a layered network:

- 1 scouts beyond the border;
- 2 dominion scrying across owned approaches;
- 3 reserve mages at central laboratories;
- 4 battle reports converted into response scripts.

### Order limit +1

The nation can take one more step toward Order than an ordinary nation. This is not an instruction to maximise Order in every design. It is an option to support:

- expensive Mystics and Astrologers;
- fort and laboratory construction;
- elephant and chariot recruitment;
- larger mundane armies;
- reduced dependence on risky event income.

The scale must be evaluated against the Pretender family and opportunity cost. A high-Order scales design and an awake expander solve different problems.

## Healing

Hiereiai have Healing 1. Archousai have Healing 3.

Official rule: a healer automatically attempts to cure a number of afflictions up to the value of the ability in the same province each turn. Healing is a provincial capacity. It does not guarantee that the exact desired affliction on the exact desired unit disappears immediately.

Healing improves the expected service life of:

- expensive commanders;
- Astrologers;
- battle-wounded Mystics;
- a combat Pretender that can be healed;
- surviving elephants and sacreds;
- thugs and summoned commanders without healing restrictions.

Healing does not make reckless attacks efficient. Dead units cannot be healed, some beings have special restrictions, and cursed-item afflictions require removal of the item first.

## Recruitable commander roster

The following table is the official revision-2 unmodded roster. Rec is commander recruitment-point cost.

| Commander           | Gold | Res | Rec | Principal attributes and role                                       |
|---------------------|------|-----|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scout               | 35   | 5   | 1   | Stealth 50, Forest and Mountain Survival; forward intelligence      |
| Mounted Commander   | 70   | 9   | 1   | Leadership 75, Map Move 16; fast transport for compatible forces    |
| Hypaspist Commander | 95   | 25  | 1   | Leadership 100, Protection 15, Defence 14; armoured line commander  |
| Hoplite Commander   | 105  | 31  | 1   | Leadership 100, Protection 18; slow heavy commander                 |
| Strategos           | 150  | 30  | 2   | Leadership 150, Morale 15; large formations and army command        |
| Hiereia             | 155  | 1   | 2   | N1H1, Sacred, Healing 1; recruitable outside forts                  |
| Mystic              | 190  | 1   | 2   | S1 plus elemental/astral randoms, Research +1; main national mage   |
| Archousa            | 235  | 1   | 2   | N1H2, Sacred, Healing 3, Leadership 50                              |
| Astrologer          | 270  | 1   | 4   | Capital only, S3 plus randoms, Fortune Teller 10; astral specialist |

## Recruitment doctrine

No commander is "free" merely because the treasury can pay for it.

- A Scout competes with a leader or mage for the local commander queue.
- A Strategos is valuable when leadership quality and army size justify the extra recruitment cost.
- A Hiereia can be recruited outside forts, preserving fort mage production while extending temples, healing, supplies, and H1 support.
- A Mystic is normally the default fort investment because it produces research and future battlefield flexibility.
- An Archousa is a healing and H2 capacity purchase, not a generic researcher.



- An Astrologer consumes scarce capital recruitment capacity and should have a defined astral job.

The recurring question is:

Which missing capacity causes the next failure: intelligence, transport, leadership, religion, healing, research, or high Astral?

## Recrutable troop roster

The official revision-2 values below describe the unmodded units. Mounts and coriders are separate combat entities where applicable.

| Unit            | Gold | Res | Rec | Protection | Morale | Combat / map move | Primary role                                  |
|-----------------|------|-----|-----|------------|--------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Slinger         | 7    | 2   | 3   | 5          | 7      | 12 / 14           | Cheap ranged harassment and screening         |
| Cardaces        | 10   | 8   | 9   | 9          | 10     | 11 / 16           | Cheap formation infantry                      |
| Peltast         | 10   | 5   | 9   | 5          | 10     | 11 / 16           | Mobile spear and javelin screen               |
| Hoplite         | 13   | 31  | 16  | 18         | 11     | 7 / 14            | Resource-heavy armoured anvil                 |
| Hypaspist       | 16   | 25  | 23  | 15         | 13     | 10 / 16           | Higher-defence, higher-morale heavy infantry  |
| Charioteer      | 40   | 7   | 9   | 9          | 10     | Rider 12 / 16     | Chariot trampling and mobile missile pressure |
| Elephant Rider  | 100  | 3   | 9   | 5          | 8      | Rider 12 / 16     | War-elephant trampling with two archers       |
| Heart Companion | 20   | 31  | 23  | 18         | 13     | 8 / 14            | Capital-only sacred heavy spear infantry      |

## Mounts

| Mount        | HP | Prot | MR | Morale | Combat / map move | Role and risk                                                                         |
|--------------|----|------|----|--------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Riding Horse | 18 | 3    | 5  | 7      | 26 / 22           | Gives the Mounted Commander strategic and tactical speed                              |
| Chariot      | 20 | 3    | 5  | 9      | 20 / 20           | Trampling platform; vulnerable if stopped or controlled                               |
| War Elephant | 64 | 11   | 6  | 9      | 18 / 22           | Large trampler; powerful against smaller bodies, vulnerable to MR and morale pressure |

## Troop roles and comparisons

### Slingers

Slingers are cheap bodies and ranged nuisance fire. Their morale, protection, attack, and defence are poor. They are useful when:

- an inexpensive screen protects a more valuable line;
- mass missiles can punish unshielded or low-protection enemies;
- recruitment resources are scarce;
- siege bodies are urgently required.

They should not be treated as a reliable melee line. A routed slinger mass can contribute to wider morale problems.

## Cardaces

Cardaces are the economical formation body. Protection 9 and Defence 13 are respectable for ten gold and eight resources, but their damage remains that of ordinary human spear infantry.

Use them to:

- add square density and bodies;
- hold ordinary light troops;
- screen elephants or mages;
- fill lines when resources cannot support Hoplites;
- absorb attacks whose damage would waste expensive armour anyway.

Do not ask Cardaces to solve high protection, giants, or elite sacreds without magic.

## Peltasts

Peltasts exchange armour for javelins and low resource cost. They support early contact by throwing before melee and are less resource-constrained than the heavy line.

They are preferable when:

- the target is lightly protected;
- mobility and replacement matter;
- a sacrificial screen is needed;
- a province has gold but poor resources.

They are vulnerable to sustained missiles and decisive melee contact.

## Hoplites

Hoplites bring Protection 18 and long spears at only thirteen gold, but cost thirty-one resources and carry Encumbrance 8, Combat Speed 7, and Map Move 14.

Their favourable fight is a direct clash against ordinary, low- or moderate-damage infantry that must spend time cutting through armour. Their unfavourable fight includes:

- armour-negating or armour-piercing attacks;
- high-strength giants;
- armour destruction;
- prolonged fatigue environments;
- enemies that refuse the front and reach the mages;
- operational races where Map Move 14 is too slow.

Hoplites are an anvil. They need a hammer or a magical answer.

## Hypaspists

Hypaspists cost more gold and recruitment points than Hoplites but save six resources, gain Defence 13, Morale 13, Combat Speed 10, and Map Move 16 while retaining Protection 15.

They are generally better when:

- enemy damage already threatens to penetrate Protection 18;
- defence, morale, and mobility matter more than three protection;

- the army must keep pace with faster elements;
- gold is available but capital or local resources are constrained.

Hoplites are better at absorbing repeated ordinary hits. Hypaspists are a more flexible high-quality line. The choice should be made against an enemy damage profile and the province's resource economy, not by declaring one universally superior.

## Chariots

The chariot package supplies mobility, a trampling mount, and a corider archer. It threatens flanks and lighter units but is less decisive than the elephant against dense small bodies.

Chariots benefit from:

- a screen that prevents premature pinning;
- flank deployment;
- targets lacking large body-blockers;
- magic that improves survival or disrupts the enemy line.

They suffer when:

- surrounded after the charge;
- confronted by large units;
- controlled by magic;
- committed into weapons and buffs designed to punish mounts.

## War elephants

The elephant is Arcoscephale's most dramatic early force and its easiest trap.

Its 64 HP, Protection 11, Size, Combat Speed 18, Map Move 22, and trample can collapse ordinary human formations. The rider and two elephant archers add bodies and attacks, but the elephant's MR 6 and Morale 9 create explicit counter surfaces.

Use elephants as a package:

- a disciplined line or screen absorbs lances and delays contact;
- elephants begin behind or beside the screen rather than alone in front;
- leadership and standards support morale where available;
- the target has been scouted for size, anti-large damage, fear, paralysis, and MR-negates effects;
- a retreat route exists;
- the number committed is large enough to decide contact but not so large that one panic destroys the treasury.

Avoid treating elephants as an answer to:

- giants and other large bodies that cannot be trampled efficiently;
- high-defence elite troops that stop and surround them;
- concentrated fear or morale attacks;
- cheap MR-negates control or killing;
- poison, fatigue, and effects that exploit a large valuable target;
- narrow deployment where they cannot reach useful targets.

## Heart Companions

Heart Companions are capital-only, sacred, heavily armoured spear infantry. They are individually better than Hoplites, but remain Map Move 14 and consume scarce capital resources.

Their scarcity changes bless economics. A bless that exists only to improve a slow, capital-only sacred must be compared with:

- more scales for the entire economy;
- an awake expander;
- missing Death, Air, Glamour, or Blood access;
- a combat or ritual Pretender.

A light incidental bless can add value. A major bless needs a campaign plan that proves the capital can recruit enough Companions without delaying other essential forces.

## Formation doctrine

Arcoscephale's infantry benefits from formation-fighter density, but density has two faces.

It improves:

- concentration of melee attacks;
- the number of armoured bodies holding a frontage;
- the ability to protect mages behind a compact line;
- efficient buff coverage.

It increases exposure to:

- area damage;
- fatigue clouds;
- battlefield-wide debuffs;
- trampling if the enemy is large enough;
- mass routing when a dense formation loses many units quickly.

The default army should not be one dense block. It needs separate functional elements:

- a central anvil;
- one or two flank or trample groups;
- a rear guard against flyers and attack-rear orders;
- mages separated enough to reduce common-area losses;
- spare commanders so one casualty does not strand the army.

# Part III: The Mage State

## Why the Mystic defines the nation

The Mystic is the repeatable national engine:

- recruitable in any fort;
- guaranteed Astral 1;
- one guaranteed random from Fire, Water, Earth, or Astral;
- an independent 50% Fire random;
- an independent 50% Water random;
- an independent 50% Earth random;
- Research +1;
- able to enter Astral communions;
- capable of independent low-level magic even when no communion is appropriate.

The important word is independent. The three 50% rolls are separate from the guaranteed four-path random and from each other.

Mystic random structure

Let:

- $\backslash(R\backslash)$  be one guaranteed uniform roll among F, W, E, and S;
- $\backslash(F\_b\backslash)$ ,  $\backslash(W\_b\backslash)$ , and  $\backslash(E\_b\backslash)$  be independent 50% bonus rolls.

The final paths are:

S1  
+ one level from R  
+ F1 if Fb succeeds  
+ W1 if Wb succeeds  
+ E1 if Eb succeeds

There are thirty-two equally likely combinations before any other game effects: four values of  $\backslash(R\backslash)$  multiplied by eight combinations of the three binary bonus rolls.

Mystic threshold probabilities

| Result                           | Probability | Interpretation                              |
|----------------------------------|-------------|---------------------------------------------|
| F0 / W0 / E0                     | 37.5% each  | No level in that element                    |
| F1 / W1 / E1 exactly             | 50% each    | Useful low-level elemental caster           |
| F2 / W2 / E2                     | 12.5% each  | One-in-eight natural specialist             |
| S1 exactly                       | 75%         | Ordinary communion-capable Mystic           |
| S2                               | 25%         | Stronger Astral caster or master            |
| Any named element at 1+          | 62.5%       | Five in eight                               |
| Any named pair of elements at 1+ | 37.5%       | Example: F1+ and E1+                        |
| F, W, and E all at 1+            | 21.875%     | Seven in thirty-two                         |
| Two elemental paths at level 2   | 0%          | Mutually impossible from this random scheme |
| E2 and S2                        | 0%          | Both require the single guaranteed roll     |

The last two rows are strategically important. A Mystic can be broad, but the same guaranteed roll cannot create two doubled paths. Plans requiring E2S2 or F2E2 need boosters, empowerment, a Pretender, a hero, or another access source.

Probability of obtaining a specialist

For a one-in-eight F2, W2, or E2 Mystic:

| Recruits | Chance of at least one |
|----------|------------------------|
| 1        | 12.5%                  |
| 4        | 41.4%                  |
| 8        | 65.6%                  |
| 12       | 79.9%                  |
| 16       | 88.2%                  |
| 23       | 95.4%                  |

Derived: the table assumes independent recruitment rolls and uses  $\left(1-\left(\frac{7}{8}\right)^n\right)$ .

This produces a recruitment rule:

A one-in-eight random is a portfolio capability, not a deadline-safe capability.

If a war plan requires E2 by a fixed turn, build redundancy, recruit from multiple forts, or provide another route.

## Mystic role classification

Rename or otherwise record Mystics when recruited. A practical classification is:

| Tag        | Minimum path    | Principal jobs                                                             |
|------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| S2         | S2              | Astral master, penetration and Astral scaling                              |
| F2         | F2              | Fire specialist, Fire self-buff route, high-damage evocation               |
| W2         | W2              | Water specialist, cold damage, Water buffs, elemental summons              |
| E2         | E2              | Earth specialist, protection, armour destruction, forging and Dragon Teeth |
| FWE        | F1W1E1          | Broad point buffs, site search, cross-path utility                         |
| FE         | F1E1+           | Fire/Earth cross-path and forging candidate                                |
| WE         | W1E1+           | Water/Earth cross-path and protection/control candidate                    |
| FW         | F1W1+           | Elemental resistance and mixed evocation candidate                         |
| S1 utility | No doubled path | Communion slave, research, low-level Astral and random-specific support    |

This is not a permanent caste system. A war can change priorities. The point is to prevent an E2 specialist from spending twenty turns as an anonymous researcher and then being unavailable when armour destruction is required.

## The Astrologer

The capital-only Astrologer has:

- fixed S3;
- one guaranteed random among F, W, E, and S;
- a further 10% random among F, W, E, and S;
- Fortune Teller 10;
- commander recruitment cost 4;
- Research 13 in the current structured data;
- high magical leadership.

### Astrologer probability

Assuming the 10% roll independently chooses one of the four listed paths:

| Astral result | Probability |
|---------------|-------------|
| S3            | 73.125%     |
| S4            | 26.25%      |

| Astral result | Probability |
|---------------|-------------|
| S5            | 0.625%      |
| S4 or higher  | 26.875%     |

For any one element:

| Elemental result | Probability |
|------------------|-------------|
| No level         | 73.125%     |
| Level 1          | 26.25%      |
| Level 2          | 0.625%      |

Derived: these values include the rare 10% random instead of rounding the unit to "one in four S4."

## Astrologer roles

Astrologers are recruited for jobs that justify capital scarcity:

- reliable S3 master casting;
- S4 or rare S5 ritual and remote-magic thresholds;
- high-Astral penetration;
- a capital communion anchor;
- Fortune Teller concentration;
- eventual high-end Astral rituals and battlefield magic;
- an elemental random that opens a specific Astral cross-path.

An Astrologer should not automatically replace a Mystic as a generic researcher. The capital turn, gold, and recruitment points are the real comparison.

## Priestess-healers

### Hiereia

The Hiereia is N1H1, Healing 1, sacred, and recruitable outside forts.

Her roles include:

- building temples without consuming a fort mage turn;
- blessing sacreds;
- Sermon of Courage and other low-priest support;
- low Nature support;
- provincial healing;
- supply assistance;
- accompanying expansion or siege forces where one affliction recovered matters.

Outside-fort recruitment is a state-building advantage. Provinces without forts can produce religious infrastructure and healing while the forts continue producing Mystics.

### Archousa

The unmodded Archousa is N1H2 with Healing 3 and Leadership 50.

Her roles include:

- stronger healing concentration;
- H2 battle and ritual duties;
- leading a modest army while providing priest support;
- protecting the long-term value of expensive units and commanders.

She is not a substitute for broad Nature magic. Unmodded Arcoscephale's normal recruitable Nature ceiling is N1.

## Recruitment portfolios

### The research-first portfolio

Use when:

- borders are stable;
- the mundane army can deter a rush;
- no urgent H2 or healing deficit exists;
- an early research breakpoint creates the next advantage.

Default:

- most new forts recruit Mystics;
- capital alternates Astrologers and whatever national need is genuinely scarce;
- Hierieiai come from non-fort provinces;
- scouts are scheduled rather than forgotten.

Risk:

- too little mundane leadership;
- mages accumulated in one vulnerable laboratory;
- no reserve army;
- specialist variance arriving late.

### The healing-and-expander portfolio

Use with an awake or dormant combat Pretender and expensive surviving troops.

Add:

- one or more Archousai at recovery hubs;
- Hierieiai following army groups;
- a safe path from battlefield to healing province;
- explicit checks for beings or afflictions that cannot be healed normally.

Risk:

- buying more healing than the casualty pattern warrants;
- delaying the research or Astral depth that prevents the next wounds.

### The communion portfolio

Use when the first war requires path elevation.

Recruit:

- enough Mystics to separate slaves, masters, independent casters, and research;
- S2 or desired elemental masters;



- reserve slaves;
- ordinary leaders and screens that keep mages alive.

Risk:

- every master is counted but slaves are treated as expendable;
- slaves are also required for independent spells;
- shared self-buffs or fatigue kill the slave line;
- one battlefield clear destroys years of research investment.

### The dispersed-reserve portfolio

Use against remote attacks, flyers, raiders, assassins, or fast fronts.

Maintain:

- small mage cells in several laboratories;
- spare pearls and elemental gems at operational hubs;
- scouts on approach routes;
- a mobile ordinary reserve;
- a protected capital core.

Risk:

- insufficient concentration for the decisive battle;
- gems and items stranded in isolated labs;
- scattered mages defeated in detail.

## Part IV: Unmodded Magic Access

### Native access summary

| Path    | Repeatable native ceiling | Main source                    | Important limitation                                      |
|---------|---------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Fire    | F2                        | One-in-eight Mystic            | No native high Fire without communion or boosters         |
| Air     | None                      | Hero only at A1                | Normal roster cannot use Air                              |
| Water   | W2                        | One-in-eight Mystic            | High Water requires communion or access chain             |
| Earth   | E2                        | One-in-eight Mystic            | E2 and S2 do not occur on the same Mystic                 |
| Astral  | S4 common peak; rare S5   | Astrologer                     | Capital-only high Astral                                  |
| Death   | None                      | Summons, hero/Pretender routes | Several national rituals are inaccessible initially       |
| Nature  | N1                        | Hiereia and Archousa           | N3 hero is chance-dependent                               |
| Glamour | None                      | Summon or imported route       | No normal national access                                 |
| Blood   | None                      | Deep summon or imported route  | No normal Blood economy                                   |
| Holy    | H2                        | Archousa                       | H3 normally requires prophet/Pretender or imported access |

"Ceiling" here means a recruitable unit before boosters, empowerment, heroes, or communions. It does not mean that every spell at that level is strategically available; school, gems, range, and battlefield conditions still apply.

## Native battlefield strengths

### Astral

Astral is the stable spine:

- every Mystic can join a communion;
- S2 Mystics and S3+ Astrologers can serve as stronger masters;
- low-level Astral offers ethereal, luck, fatigue, mind, and resistance tools;
- high Astral creates remote and battlefield threats;
- capital pearl income supports early Astral use.

Astral also creates vulnerabilities:

- enemy Astral mages can threaten Magic Duel dynamics;
- communion clusters attract area attacks;
- pearls have competing uses in combat, forging, remote magic, and legendary rituals;
- an Astral plan without penetration can fail against high MR.

### Fire

Fire supplies direct damage and morale pressure. F2 Mystics are natural specialists; F1 Mystics can reach higher levels through a communion or self-buff where available.

Fire is strongest against:

- dense ordinary troops;
- cold-aligned or fire-vulnerable targets;
- formations whose protection is less relevant to the chosen spell.

It is weaker against:

- fire resistance;
- dispersed targets;
- friendly formations too close to inaccurate area fire;
- battles where fatigue and gem use outrun protection.

### Water

Water supplies cold damage, control, quickness and resistance effects, and elemental summons. W2 specialists are one in eight; W1 is common enough to support mixed packages.

Water is especially valuable when:

- the enemy lacks Cold Resistance;
- control and slowing matter more than raw kills;
- a Water/Earth Mystic can combine defensive and fatigue tools;
- summoned elementals can exploit enemy size or formation.

## Earth

Earth renews Arcoscephale's old infantry:

- protection;
- strength;
- armour destruction;
- battlefield control;
- reinvigoration and path elevation;
- constructs and national summons;
- forging.

E2 specialists are among the most important randoms because they can use national Sow Dragon Teeth without ritual access problems and can anchor Earth communions. Earth still does not solve every high-protection fight: the chosen package must specify whether it raises friendly durability, lowers enemy armour, deals high damage, or controls movement.

## Nature

N1 is support, not broad Nature dominance. It provides selected protection, entanglement, poison-related, healing, supply, and small-summon options as research permits.

Without a hero, Pretender, independent, empowerment, or summon chain, the nation does not naturally reach the powerful N3-N5 ritual tier. A guide that assumes easy high Nature is using another age, a mod, or an unrecorded access source.

# Communions

## Why Arcoscephale uses them

Mystics combine guaranteed S1 with heterogeneous elements. A communion:

- raises each master's known paths according to the number of slaves;
- distributes spell fatigue across participants;
- lets low elemental randoms reach battlefield thresholds;
- makes a roster of modest mages behave like a high-path school.

The official level thresholds are:

| Slaves | Master bonus |
|--------|--------------|
| 2      | +1           |
| 4      | +2           |
| 8      | +3           |
| 16     | +4           |
| 32     | +5           |

The bonus applies only to paths the master already knows.

## The smallest useful communion

Two slaves are enough to raise paths by one. This can turn:

- F2 into F3;

- W2 into W3;
- E2 into E3;
- S2 into S3;
- an Astrologer S3 into S4.

The small communion is efficient for a limited script, but brittle:

- one slave loss can remove the bonus;
- fatigue per slave is higher;
- an overambitious master script can collapse it;
- the master may choose an unintended expensive spell after scripted orders.

## Four- and eight-slave communions

Four slaves provide +2 and are the first general-purpose threshold for turning common F1/W1/E1 Mystics into level 3 casters.

Eight slaves provide +3 and support high-end battlefield effects, but create a large concentration of expensive mages. The cost includes:

- eight researchers leaving laboratories;
- pearls or scripting needed to establish the communion;
- bodyguards and formation space;
- fatigue management;
- risk of battlefield-wide or rear attacks;
- the loss of those mages if the army is trapped.

## Master selection

Choose masters by spell package:

- F2 master for Fire;
- W2 master for Water;
- E2 master for Earth;
- S2 Mystic or S3+ Astrologer for Astral;
- cross-path Mystic when the spell or shared buff genuinely requires it.

Avoid adding masters merely because they can join. Every additional master:

- increases total fatigue placed into the slave pool;
- expands spell-selection variance after scripts;
- raises the value of the target presented to the enemy.

## Slave selection

The cheapest-looking S1 Mystic may still carry a valuable cross-path. Slave selection should preserve:

- rare E2, W2, and F2 specialists;
- S2 masters;
- cross-paths needed for forging or point buffs;
- battlefield-independent casters.

If every Mystic costs the same, "slave" is a temporary assignment, not a low-value unit type.

## Fatigue failure

Official communion fatigue depends on:

- the spell's fatigue cost;
- the number of participants;
- the slave's relevant effective path compared with the master's;
- bonuses and effects included in effective skill;
- the continued number of living slaves.

The dangerous cascade is:

```
slave becomes exhausted
-> slave stops contributing or dies
-> remaining slaves receive more fatigue
-> master bonus can fall below a threshold
-> later spells become more expensive or illegal
-> communion collapses
```

The package must be tested with the actual master scripts, gems, self-buffs, enemy pressure, and expected battle length.

## When not to use a communion

Communions are not mandatory.

Independent casting is often better when:

- many Mystics can each cast a useful low-level spell;
- the spell does not need path elevation;
- the enemy can punish a mage cluster;
- the battle is small;
- slaves would cost more mage-turns than the target is worth;
- one pearl per independent caster produces more total useful actions;
- the desired mix of spells is easier to control without shared fatigue.

Community discussion of MA Arcoscephale correctly highlights this tradeoff: a Mystic assigned as a slave is not a cheap acolyte; it is a 190-gold researcher and possible specialist that no longer casts independently.

## National spells and rituals

The official unmodded national list contains one battlefield summon and seven rituals.

| Spell or ritual              | School         | Requirement | Cost           | Result               | Native access               |
|------------------------------|----------------|-------------|----------------|----------------------|-----------------------------|
| Sow Dragon Teeth             | Enchantment 6  | E2          | 1 Earth gem    | 10 Spartae in battle | Yes: E2 Mystic              |
| Forge Brass Bull             | Construction 6 | F3E3        | 25 Fire gems   | 1 Khalkotaurus       | Not on an unboosted recruit |
| Summon Hound of Twilight     | Conjuration 5  | E2D1        | 3 Earth gems   | 1 Hound of Twilight  | No native Death             |
| Craft Keledone               | Construction 6 | E2S2        | 5 Earth gems   | 1 Keledone           | No natural E2S2 Mystic      |
| Bind Keres                   | Conjuration 6  | D2          | 12 Death gems  | 3 Keres              | No native Death             |
| Procession of the Underworld | Conjuration 5  | D3          | 13 Death gems  | 15 Lampads           | No native Death             |
| Awaken Hamadryad             | Enchantment 5  | N4          | 25 Nature gems | 1 N3 Hamadryad       | Hero or imported path route |

| Spell or ritual | School        | Requirement | Cost           | Result                         | Native access               |
|-----------------|---------------|-------------|----------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Monster Boar    | Conjuration 5 | N3          | 10 Nature gems | Remote unrest monster, range 5 | Hero or imported path route |

## National access is not castability

Five of the eight entries are not immediately castable by the normal recruitable roster. This is deliberate strategic terrain.

- Sow Dragon Teeth is the clean native national tool.
- Craft Keledone requires bridging the missing point on an E2S1 or another caster.
- Forge Brass Bull requires substantial dual-path elevation.
- the Death rituals require imported or bootstrapped Death;
- high Nature depends on a hero, Pretender, independent, empowerment, or another chain.

The dossier separates "the nation owns this ritual" from "the present game can cast it."

## Path-access ladder

### Fire

- 1 Recruit Mystics until F1 and F2 roles are available.
- 2 Use communion bonuses or a Fire self-buff to reach battlefield thresholds.
- 3 Forge only after confirming the current item path and Construction level.
- 4 Use Pretender Fire when a ritual requires a dual path the Mystic distribution cannot produce.

### Water

- 1 Recruit W1 and W2 Mystics.
- 2 Use Water self-buffs and communions for battlefield scaling.
- 3 Use booster chains when ritual thresholds require them.
- 4 Treat very high Water as a deliberate project rather than normal roster access.

### Earth

- 1 Preserve E2 Mystics.
- 2 Use Earth self-buffs in battle.
- 3 Forge Earth boosters when current research and item paths allow.
- 4 Use E2 to cast Sow Dragon Teeth.
- 5 Bridge E2S1 to E2S2 for Craft Keledone through a named Astral booster or another caster.

### Astral

- 1 Every Mystic provides S1.
- 2 S2 Mystics become stronger masters and forgers.
- 3 Astrologers provide S3, commonly S4, and rarely S5.
- 4 Astral boosters extend high rituals and penetration.
- 5 Communions reach extreme battlefield levels but do not cast ordinary rituals.

### Nature

- 1 Hieresai and Archousai provide N1.

- 2 The national hero Axieros provides N3 if he appears.
- 3 A single Nature booster can bring N3 to N4 for Awaken Hamadryad, subject to current item legality.
- 4 Pretender or independent access can make the route reliable.

## Death

- 1 There is no recruitable national Death.
- 2 A Pretender is the reliable pregame bridge.
- 3 Suitable independent mages, sites, heroes, empowerment, or summons can create a later bridge.
- 4 Once D2 or D3 exists, the national Keres and Lampad rituals can produce units with further magic potential if made commanders by an appropriate current spell.

## Air, Glamour, and Blood

These are absent from the ordinary national roster.

- Air appears on Orokestes at A1, if the hero arrives.
- Glamour and Blood require imported or summon-chain access.
- A Pretender taking one of these paths should have a clear job beyond merely making the national summary look broad.

# Part V: Expansion and the First Year

## Expansion objectives

Arcoscephalian expansion is successful when it produces:

- enough provinces to finance multiple forts and laboratories;
- resource provinces that let those forts recruit the intended line;
- surviving elephants, infantry, and commanders;
- a border that automatic scrying can help cover;
- an early fort schedule that begins multiplying Mystics;
- a credible force against opportunistic neighbours.

Province count alone is insufficient. Eight disconnected or exposed provinces with no second fort can be weaker than six provinces with a defensible boundary and a fort already building.

## Starting force

Unmodded Arcoscephale begins with:

- a Hypaspist Commander;
- a Scout;
- twenty Peltasts;
- twenty Hoplites.

The starting army already contains a screen and an armoured line. It can take suitable human infantry provinces, but the correct first target depends on the actual report. Heavy cavalry, barbarians, crossbows, large numbers, and other high-damage independents can convert the expensive Hoplite line into an early setback.

## Starting formation hypothesis

Strategic doctrine, test pending:

- Hoplites form the central or forward anvil.
- Peltasts begin slightly behind or on a flank so javelins do not disrupt the first contact.
- The commander remains protected and away from the most likely projectile path.
- Orders and distance are adjusted to make the two lines contact in a useful sequence.

This is a starting point for testing, not a universal script. Battlefield terrain, enemy placement, and projectile range alter the timing.

## Expansion engines

### Heavy-infantry expansion

Core: Hoplites or Hypaspists with a proper commander and a cheaper supporting line.

Strengths:

- little dependence on Pretender awakening;
- good against ordinary low-damage infantry;
- survivors retain value in the first war;
- predictable morale and formation.

Weaknesses:

- high resource demand;
- slow map movement for Hoplites;
- attrition from high-damage attacks;
- limited killing speed against dense or armoured enemies;
- replacement can delay infrastructure.

### Elephant expansion

Core: a small number of elephants behind or beside an infantry screen.

Strengths:

- high shock and trample output against smaller human troops;
- fast strategic movement from the mount;
- low resource cost on the rider listing;
- strong deterrent against opponents without prepared counters.

Weaknesses:

- 100 gold per recruit;
- low mount MR and ordinary morale;
- catastrophic losses against control, fear, giants, and anti-large force;
- routs can trample friendly troops;
- a single bad expansion can delay a fort.

The correct number is empirical. It varies with independent strength, screen size, bless, leadership, target composition, and map. The library will not print a "safe" elephant count until repeated tests establish a range under the frozen settings.



### Chariot expansion

Core: chariots on a flank with a centre that holds the enemy.

Strengths:

- cheaper than elephants;
- multiple package elements through rider, corider, and mount;
- mobile ranged and trample pressure;
- useful against light troops.

Weaknesses:

- smaller and easier to stop than elephants;
- less decisive against dense or large targets;
- vulnerable if pinned.

### Awake-expander expansion

An awake combat Pretender can:

- take difficult provinces;
- establish a second route;
- reduce mundane losses;
- deter a first-year attack;
- bring missing magic.

The cost is paid in:

- scales;
- dominion or bless;
- design paths;
- risk to the Pretender;
- healing and support turns;
- the possibility that the chosen chassis cannot safely fight the actual independent.

Arcoscephalian healing makes a recoverable combat Pretender more attractive, but does not make it immortal or immune to lethal counters.

### Target classification

Before each neutral attack, classify the province.

| Independent feature                 | Arcoscephalian concern                                                  |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Large low-damage infantry           | Heavy line usually favourable; check total numbers and fatigue          |
| Barbarians or high-strength weapons | Protection can be penetrated; use margin and missiles                   |
| Heavy cavalry                       | Lance impact can kill expensive infantry or riders                      |
| Crossbows                           | Heavy armour helps, but concentrated armour-piercing fire still matters |
| Archers and slingers                | Shields and armour help; exposed Peltasts and Slingers suffer           |
| Elephants or other trampers         | Body size, morale, and formation require a specific plan                |
| Heavy infantry                      | Killing speed may be too low without elephants or magic                 |
| Sacred or unusual independents      | Inspect weapons, paths, morale, and special abilities                   |

| Independent feature      | Arcoscephalian concern                                        |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Many commanders or mages | Assassination, morale, or magic can change the expected fight |

## Expansion losses and stop rules

An expansion party should stop when:

- its next target is outside the package's favourable class;
- losses would delay a fort or second party;
- the retreat province is unsafe;
- enemy borders make the party easy to trap;
- an elephant or commander has accumulated a material affliction;
- consolidation produces more value than one more exposed province.

The real cost of a dead Hoplite is not thirteen gold. It includes thirty-one resources, recruitment capacity, transport, and the effect of a thinner line on the next battle.

## First-year infrastructure

A robust first year normally needs:

- continued expansion;
- a second expansion party or awake Pretender route;
- a second fort site chosen for population, resources, geometry, and safety;
- a laboratory where the first new Mystic production matters;
- temples where dominion, priest recruitment, or sacred production justify them;
- enough scouts to find neighbours before armies do;
- a treasury reserve against bad events, defence, and fort completion.

The 300-gold laboratory surcharge changes timing. A fort that cannot receive a laboratory on schedule is not yet a Mystic factory.

## Turn-12 test record

Every serious design should be tested through turn 12 with:

- exact scales and awakening;
- exact independent strength;
- map type or seed;
- active mod list and order;
- recruitment by turn;
- Province Defence purchases;
- fort, lab, and temple starts;
- site searching;
- expansion route;
- every battle and loss;
- treasury and gem stock;
- surviving army;
- research level;
- contact and border geometry.

## Minimum comparison metrics

| Metric                     | Why it matters                                  |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Provinces owned            | Gross territorial result                        |
| Income                     | Ability to sustain Mystics and infrastructure   |
| Forts completed / building | Future mage throughput                          |
| Labs completed / planned   | Actual conversion of forts into magic           |
| Mage count and randoms     | Research and access                             |
| Expansion-party survivors  | Deterrence and replacement burden               |
| Pretender state            | Wounds, afflictions, location, fatigue and risk |
| Border length              | Defence demand                                  |
| Neighbour contact          | First-war pressure                              |
| Research reached           | Whether the proposed timing is real             |

## Expansion test hypotheses

The first Arcoscephale test suite should compare:

- 1 scales plus starting heavy infantry;
- 2 scales plus early elephants;
- 3 mixed infantry, chariots, and elephants;
- 4 awake combat Pretender;
- 5 dormant intervention Pretender with stronger scales.

For each, test at least:

- ordinary infantry;
- barbarians;
- heavy cavalry;
- crossbows;
- heavy infantry;
- enemy tramlers.

Precise party sizes remain test pending until those runs are saved.

# Part VI: Research Response Trees

## The research trunk

Arcoscephale wants many schools. The solution is not to research every school evenly. It is to reach small conversion nodes that make the present army better, then branch.

A broadly useful trunk is:

- 1 Thaumaturgy 1 for Communion Master and Communion Slave.
- 2 Alteration 3 for Earth Meld, Body Ethereal, Mossbody where the cross-path exists, and a cluster of defensive or control tools.
- 3 Conjunction 3 for Phoenix Power, Summon Earthpower, Power of the Spheres, and early elemental options.

#### 4 A branch chosen from the observed enemy.

This is doctrine, not a mandatory order. An immediate rush can require Evocation, Thaumaturgy 2, Construction, or another emergency branch first.

## Exact early and middle conversion nodes

The manual confirms the following relevant spells:

| Node                                      | Requirement | Effect and Arcoscephalian use                                             |
|-------------------------------------------|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Communion Master / Slave, Thaumaturgy 1   | S1          | Creates the national path-elevation system                                |
| Mind Burn, Thaumaturgy 2                  | S2          | 12+ armour-negating damage, MR negates; early single-target Astral threat |
| Body Ethereal, Alteration 3               | S1          | Point protection against nonmagical attacks                               |
| Earth Meld, Alteration 3                  | E2          | Area movement control                                                     |
| Phoenix Power, Conjuration 3              | F2          | Raises Fire on the caster                                                 |
| Summon Earthpower, Conjuration 3          | E2          | Raises Earth and supplies reinvigoration                                  |
| Power of the Spheres, Conjuration 3       | S1          | Raises the caster's known magic paths                                     |
| Strength of Giants, Enchantment 1         | E2          | Point Strength support                                                    |
| Destruction, Alteration 4                 | E3          | Armour-negating armour damage over area                                   |
| Paralyze, Thaumaturgy 4                   | S2          | MR-negates control against non-mindless targets                           |
| Light of the Northern Star, Conjuration 4 | S3          | Battlefield enchantment raising Astral                                    |
| Falling Fires, Evocation 5                | F3          | Area armour-piercing Fire damage                                          |
| Falling Frost, Evocation 5                | W3          | Area armour-piercing Cold damage                                          |
| Gifts from Heaven, Evocation 5            | E3S1        | Very high damage with low precision; dangerous near friendly troops       |
| Stellar Cascades, Evocation 5             | S2          | Area armour-piercing fatigue damage                                       |
| Soul Slay, Thaumaturgy 5                  | S3          | MR-negates death against a single non-mindless target                     |
| Mind Hunt, Evocation 6                    | S4          | Remote commander attack; detection and feeblemind risk matter             |
| Sow Dragon Teeth, Enchantment 6           | E2 + 1 gem  | Ten national Spartae in battle                                            |
| Marble Warriors, Alteration 7             | E3          | Large-area protection for non-spirit targets                              |
| Will of the Fates, Alteration 7           | S5          | Battlefield-wide Luck                                                     |
| Legions of Steel, Construction 6          | E4          | Battlefield-wide armour improvement                                       |
| Army of Lead, Alteration 9                | E5S1        | Battlefield-wide major protection                                         |
| Army of Gold, Alteration 9                | E5F1        | Battlefield-wide major protection                                         |
| Master Enslave, Thaumaturgy 9             | S8          | Battlefield-wide MR-negates enslavement against eligible minds            |

The table gives capabilities, not recommended scripts. Friendly-fire risk, magic resistance, fatigue, gem cost, battlefield range, and enemy resistance still determine value.

## Branch A: anti-armour

### Problem

Enemy protection makes mundane spears and tramlers trade poorly.

### Early answer

- Destruction at Alteration 4 from an E3 caster.
- An E2 Mystic reaches E3 through Summon Earthpower or a two-slave communion.
- Ordinary infantry and tramlers exploit the reduced armour.

### Middle answer

- combine armour destruction with Falling Fires, Gifts from Heaven, elementals, or strengthened troops;
- use Stellar Cascades if fatigue rather than immediate kills is the better axis;
- avoid concentrating expensive magic into a battle the enemy can decline.

### Failure branch

If Destruction misses the relevant squares, or if raw HP and size matter more than Magic Resistance, add control, high damage, or more attacks. Repeating armour reduction will not solve that problem.

## Branch B: anti-elite and anti-giant

### Problem

Few high-stat or giant troops defeat ordinary lines and cannot be trampled efficiently.

### Tools

- Earth Meld to hold targets;
- Body Ethereal on critical blockers;
- Mind Burn, Paralyze, and Soul Slay where MR permits;
- Gifts from Heaven for extreme physical damage at accepted accuracy risk;
- elementals to create size and disruption;
- Destruction if armour is the main defence;
- fatigue through Stellar Cascades or prolonged combat;
- a properly chosen Pretender or thug.

### Doctrine

Do not ask one spell to do every job. A complete anti-elite package needs:

- 1 a line that survives initial contact;
- 2 control or distraction;
- 3 damage that attacks the correct defence;
- 4 mage protection;
- 5 a plan if the elite force attacks the rear or refuses the centre.

## Branch C: anti-mass

### Problem

Large numbers surround the line and exhaust killing capacity.

### Tools

- elephants and chariots against eligible sizes;
- Falling Fires or Falling Frost against low resistance;
- area control;
- summoned elementals;
- dense formation infantry to hold frontage;
- Fire or Cold resistance on friendly forces when using hazardous battlefield conditions.

### Failure branch

If the enemy mass is mindless, do not rely on mind effects. If it is undead, add priests and check the exact banishment environment. If it contains sacrificial chaff protecting dangerous mages, rear pressure or remote commander attacks may matter more than killing every body.

## Branch D: anti-undead and anti-demon

### Assets

- H1 and H2 priestesses;
- a prophet or Pretender;
- Astral, Fire, and national summoned options;
- morale support;
- precise information from dominion scrying.

### Requirements

- enough priests to matter at battlefield scale;
- bodyguards against undead flyers or assassins;
- protection against fear and fatigue;
- Spirit Sight or another answer when darkness, invisibility, or special sight is relevant;
- an answer to the enemy mages rather than only the undead screen.

The ordinary infantry may hold skeletons but can be exhausted by endless replacement. The strategic target is often the summoning engine.

## Branch E: anti-rush

The emergency branch is selected after reading the neighbour.

| Rush feature      | Candidate response                                       |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| High protection   | Alteration 4 for Destruction                             |
| Few elite sacreds | Thaumaturgy 2/4, control, elementals, body-blocking      |
| Giants            | Control, high damage, fatigue, avoid elephant dependence |

| Rush feature             | Candidate response                                              |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Flyers                   | Rear guards, dispersed mages, bodyguards, wider deployment      |
| Fire or Cold aura        | Resistance, spacing, ranged damage, suitable element            |
| Glamour and high defence | Spirit Sight where available, area effects, attack improvement  |
| Regeneration             | Concentrated damage, decay or disease where accessible, control |
| Undead mass              | Priests, morale, engine-killing                                 |

Construction can be an anti-rush branch if a combat Pretender or thug is the fastest viable answer. It is not automatically useful merely because items are permanent.

## Branch F: remote Astral control

### Mind Hunt

Mind Hunt is Evocation 6, S4, two Astral pearls, range six.

Arcoscephale can obtain S4 on capital Astrologers without boosters, though not every Astrologer is S4. Healing reduces the long-term cost of some recoverable afflictions, but does not remove detection risk or make indiscriminate hunting sound.

Targets should be chosen from:

- commanders outside Astral protection;
- siege leaders;
- critical priests;
- isolated thugs;
- laboratory mages exposed by scrying and scouts.

The package includes:

- target intelligence;
- several S4 casters if the objective justifies them;
- a safe laboratory;
- pearls;
- healing capacity;
- a plan for enemy Astral detection or domes.

### Soul Slay and Master Enslave

Soul Slay is a battlefield precision tool against eligible high-value units. Master Enslave is an endgame operation, not a research aspiration in isolation.

A Master Enslave operation needs:

- S8 effective skill;
- a robust communion;
- penetration;
- protection from interruption;
- enough fatigue support;
- a plan for mindless and high-MR enemies;
- commanders able to control any captured units;
- an exploitation plan if the enemy army is stolen.

## Branch G: battlefield renewal

Arcoscephale's mundane army scales when research makes old soldiers survive modern magic.

Key transformations include:

- point ethereal and protection effects on the contact line;
- Destruction making ordinary spears relevant against armour;
- Marble Warriors improving a broad formation;
- Will of the Fates reducing casualties across the army;
- Legions of Steel improving worn armour;
- Army of Lead or Gold creating a late-game protected mass.

The more expensive the buff package, the more important it is to ask whether the troops are the right recipients. A battlefield-wide spell does not make a routed, immobile, poisoned, or bypassed army successful by itself.

## Research rejoin points

Emergency branches should rejoin a larger plan.

Examples:

- Thaumaturgy 2 anti-elite -> Thaumaturgy 5 for Soul Slay -> Evocation 6 for Mind Hunt;
- Alteration 4 anti-armour -> Alteration 7 for Marble Warriors and Will of the Fates -> Alteration 9;
- Evocation 5 damage -> Evocation 6 remote Astral -> later battlefield offence;
- Conjunction 3 self-buffs -> Conjunction 4 Northern Star -> national and elemental summons;
- Construction branch for a Pretender -> boosters -> ritual access.

The rejoin point should be recorded before emergency research begins, preventing a permanent drift across half-finished schools.

# Part VII: Army Packages

## Package 1: The old line

Purpose: defeat ordinary human troops and hold ground cheaply.

Core:

- Hoplite or Hypaspist centre;
- Cardaces or Peltasts as screen or flank;
- one reliable commander;
- optional Hiereia;
- scouts on the operational route.

Scaling:

- add a Strategos for a larger army;
- add elephants or chariots for killing power;
- add a small Mystic cell once research provides a specific effect.

Failure modes:

- high-damage weapons penetrate the line;



- fatigue breaks Hoplites;
- flyers reach the rear;
- the army cannot kill high protection;
- slow movement cedes operational initiative.

## Package 2: The elephant hammer

Purpose: break large formations of smaller ordinary troops.

Core:

- infantry screen;
- elephant group on a flank or behind the line;
- commander with adequate leadership and morale support;
- rear guard;
- scouting of size, morale attacks, and MR-negates magic.

Scaling:

- add enough elephants to create simultaneous contact;
- add point buffs to the screen;
- add area damage or control so elephants are not stopped by elites;
- add Hiereia/Archousa support and a post-battle healing route.

Failure modes:

- panic or control;
- giants;
- rear attack on commanders;
- a narrow battlefield;
- friendly trampling during rout;
- overinvestment in a countered chassis.

## Package 3: Independent Mystic battery

Purpose: obtain many useful casts without communion concentration.

Core:

- several Mystics selected for the same low-level effect;
- one pearl or relevant elemental gems where needed;
- heavy infantry screen;
- separation and bodyguards;
- strict scripts whose unscripted continuation is acceptable.

Examples:

- repeated Body Ethereal;
- Mind Burn from S2 casters;
- Power of the Spheres followed by elemental effects;
- small elemental summons;
- repeated point buffs.

Strength: every mage acts.

Failure: individual path and gem use may be less powerful than a communion; spell-selection variance can scatter effects.

## Package 4: Four-slave elemental communion

Purpose: turn common elemental randoms into level-three battlefield casters.

Core:

- four Communion Slaves;
- one or two chosen masters;
- screen and rear guard;
- gem load calculated from the exact script;
- no unnecessary masters.

Candidate master outcomes:

- F1 -> F3;
- W1 -> W3;
- E1 -> E3;
- S1 -> S3.

Self-buffs can raise paths further, but also change fatigue relationships and must be tested.

Failure: slave fatigue, lost threshold, massed mage casualties, or masters improvising expensive spells.

## Package 5: Astral elimination cell

Purpose: remove a few high-value eligible targets.

Core:

- Astrologers or appropriate masters;
- Soul Slay or another current Astral killing spell;
- penetration where available;
- a line long enough to permit repeated casts;
- target selection based on MR and mind status.

Failure: high MR, mindlessness, enemy Magic Duel threat, insufficient range, or line collapse.

## Package 6: Armour-break combined arms

Purpose: let ordinary troops and tramlers defeat armour.

Core:

- E3 effective caster for Destruction;
- resilient screen;
- Hypaspists, elephants, chariots, or summoned bodies ready to exploit;
- secondary magic if armour destruction lands unevenly.

Failure: the enemy disperses, kills the Earth caster, relies on innate protection, or counters the exploitation force.

## Package 7: Fort storm and Throne claim

Purpose: convert field advantage into victory position.

Core:

- sufficient siege bodies;
- a storming line;
- an anti-commander or anti-mage plan;
- H2 or H3 claim capacity as required by the Throne;
- supply and laboratory support;
- a relief interception force;
- replacement commanders.

Arcoscephale's strength in field magic does not automatically crack walls or claim Thrones. The claim-capable priest and army must arrive together after the fort falls.

## Package 8: Distributed counter-raiding

Purpose: prevent fast or stealth forces from turning a slow main army into territorial collapse.

Core:

- dominion scrying on approaches;
- scouts outside dominion;
- small Mystic cells in protected labs;
- cheap commanders and local troops;
- mobile elephants, chariots, or a Pretender where suitable;
- fort and laboratory redundancy.

Failure: every cell is too weak, pearls are absent, or the main army cannot exploit the enemy's dispersion.

# Part VIII: Pretender Families

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## Family A: Awake expansion and missing path

### Job

- take difficult neutral provinces;
- preserve national troops;
- deter an early rush;
- bring one or two missing paths, commonly Death, Air, Glamour, or another ritual bridge.

### Good fit

- crowded maps;
- dangerous neighbours;
- weak starting terrain;
- a design whose chassis can reliably expand under the actual settings.

### Costs

- weaker scales;
- Pretender risk;
- fewer design points for broad ritual access;
- possible overlap with elephants.

## Audit

The chassis must be tested against heavy cavalry, barbarians, poison, magic weapons, and MR attacks. Healing is a recovery advantage, not a licence to attack unknown targets.

## Family B: Dormant intervention platform

### Job

- stronger scales than an awake expander;
- arrive near the first serious war;
- carry missing paths;
- serve as thug, battlefield caster, forger, or ritual bridge.

### Good fit

- national troops can expand;
- the likely danger begins after contact;
- the nation wants a high-impact mid-game path package.

### Costs

- no help during the first expansion turns;
- the planned battlefield role can be invalidated by the actual neighbour;
- a dormant chassis that cannot move or fight as expected may become an expensive researcher.

## Family C: Imprisoned scales and research

### Job

- maximise gold, resources, growth, and research scales;
- multiply forts and Mystics;
- emerge as a late ritual platform.

### Good fit

- spacious map;
- reliable troop expansion;
- diplomatic room;
- a plan that uses the additional economic throughput before awakening.

### Costs

- no Pretender during expansion or first war;
- greater vulnerability to rush;
- high-path ritual promises may arrive after the decisive period.

The design succeeds only if the recruitable state survives long enough to compound.

## Family D: Sacred-support hybrid

### Job

- provide an incidental or moderate bless to Heart Companions;
- remain useful as an expander, battlefield caster, or ritual bridge.

### Good fit

- the capital can recruit Companions without sacrificing the rest of the plan;
- the bless also improves sacred commanders, summons, or the Pretender;
- the sacred unit fills a clear tactical role.

### Costs

- capital-only recruitment;
- heavy resources;
- slow map movement;
- bless points that could solve wider national constraints.

## Family E: Ritual bridge

### Job

Provide paths missing from the national roster.

Priority candidates:

- Death for the national Underworld summons and wider Death economy;
- Air for mobility, lightning, forging, and storm tools;
- Glamour for sight, illusion, and control options;
- Blood only if the design includes a credible way to create and sustain a Blood economy;
- high Nature for national N3/N4 rituals and global access.

### Audit

For every promised ritual, write the complete route:

```
Pretender base path
+ named booster
+ empowerment if any
+ research level
+ gem cost
+ laboratory and province requirement
= legal caster
```

If one step is missing, the ritual is not part of the build.

## Historical builds and current legality

Earlier project discussions proposed:

- an imprisoned Astral-Earth Titan;
- a dormant Great Enchantress with Astral, Earth, Nature, and Death;
- a later Grand Hierophant with Fire, Air, Astral, and Blood under the combined mod set.

These are retained as historical design families, not copied as current legal builds. Chassis paths, design costs, scale limits, blessings, and mod abilities must be rebuilt in the current Pretender screen before publication as finished designs.

## Scale priorities

### Order

Supports:

- expensive mage recruitment;
- fort and laboratory construction;
- elephants and ordinary armies.

The national +1 limit makes high Order available, but the final value depends on the design-point curve and map economy.

### Production

Supports:

- Hoplites;
- Hypaspists;
- Heart Companions;
- fort provinces with strong local resources.

Elephants themselves are not resource-intensive on the rider listing, so an elephant-heavy opening can use gold faster than resources.

### Growth

Supports:

- long-run income;
- population resilience;
- supplies;
- Blood resistance if Blood Hunting occurs nearby;
- campaigns expected to last.

### Magic

Supports:

- Research Points;
- spell performance through the scale's ordinary effects;
- the national plan of reaching several response nodes.

It also affects enemy magic in the same province and may interact with events. It is not an uncontested bonus.

### Luck

Interacts with events and the concentration of Astrologer Fortune Tellers. It should be evaluated as part of the whole event policy, not only because the nation uses Astrologers.

## Temperature

Choose after checking:

- national preference;
- design points;
- income and supplies;
- expected battlefield effects;
- mod changes.

## Sloth

Sloth purchases design points by taxing a roster that contains resource-heavy infantry and sacreds. It is more plausible in an elephant- or magic-heavy design than in one promising massed Hoplites and Heart Companions.

# Part IX: Campaign Doctrine

---

## Early game

### Objectives

- expand without crippling attrition;
- identify neighbours before contact becomes war;
- begin the second fort and its 300-gold laboratory;
- recruit the first Mystic portfolio;
- retain enough mundane force to deter a rush;
- choose research from observed threats.

### Questions each turn

- Which independent class is the next target?
- Is a valuable elephant or commander entering an uncertain battle?
- Does the treasury still meet the fort and laboratory schedule?
- Which Mystic random appeared, and has it been recorded?
- Which neighbour can reach the capital fastest?
- Does the research branch produce a complete package before that attack?

### Common early failure

Arcoscephale can spend on everything:

- 190-gold Mystics;
- 270-gold Astrologers;
- 100-gold elephants;
- forts;
- 300-gold labs;
- ordinary armies.

The nation risks buying one of each and completing none of its conversions. A plan should state the current priority:

expansion force  
or infrastructure  
or mage throughput  
or emergency defence

The other categories receive maintenance, not equal spending.

## First war

### War aim

The first war should have a positional aim:

- remove a dangerous rush neighbour;
- seize a fort cluster;
- secure a Throne corridor;
- take a high-income or high-gem region;
- shorten the border;
- destroy an exposed mage core.

"Use the research lead" is not a war aim.

### Preparation

Record:

- enemy troop defence classes;
- known magic paths and school evidence;
- likely battlefield enchantments;
- routes and retreat provinces;
- fort wall strength and relief distance;
- required gems by battle;
- replacement Mystic production;
- the branch if the first army is countered.

### First-war strengths

- heavy infantry can anchor;
- elephants punish unprepared human formations;
- Mystics can tailor several low- and middle-level packages;
- automatic scrying improves defence inside dominion;
- healing preserves expensive survivors;
- Astrologers threaten high Astral.

### First-war weaknesses

- most mages are expensive human bodies;
- a large communion risks a national research disaster;
- no normal Death, Air, Glamour, or Blood limits adaptation;
- tramlers have clear morale and MR counters;
- heavy infantry can be bypassed or fatigued;
- the 300-gold lab cost slows replacement infrastructure.



## Middle game

The middle game begins when the nation has several forts, multiple Mystic cohorts, and enough research that the opponent must respect several branches.

### Objectives

- turn random-mage breadth into repeatable packages;
- establish booster and gem logistics;
- create at least one remote or mobile threat;
- defend the capital Astrologer pipeline;
- convert won battles into forts and labs;
- begin a Throne claim plan.

### Portfolio doctrine

Do not send the entire mage corps with one army. Divide it into:

- research reserve;
- main field package;
- counter-raiding cells;
- ritual and forging specialists;
- capital Astral core;
- healing and recovery hubs.

The exact proportions change during war. The distinction prevents the same mage from being promised simultaneously to research, forge, cast a ritual, and fight.

## Late game

### National late-game strengths

- accumulated Astral;
- communions capable of high battlefield paths;
- broad elemental response;
- strong research if the fort network survived;
- information across friendly dominion;
- healing of valuable commanders;
- access to high-end Astral rituals and battlefield magic.

### National late-game limits

- low innate non-Astral path ceilings;
- absent Death, Air, Glamour, and Blood unless bridged;
- mortal human mage core;
- expensive fort and lab replacement;
- capital dependence for Astrologers;
- greater enemy ability to clear dense armies and communions.

### Late-game transition

The old army should become one of several shells around the magic:

- protected mass;

- siege and Throne body;
- screen for remote or high-Astral operations;
- distributed defence;
- disposable frontage for summons.

If every late-game battle still depends on unmodified Hoplites and elephants reaching melee, research has not been converted.

## Endgame and Thrones

An endgame plan states:

- current Ascension Points;
- claimable Thrones and required priest levels;
- forts and walls on each target;
- enemy relief routes;
- magic-phase threats;
- claim timing;
- the army that survives after the storm;
- the diplomatic response to visible victory progress.

Arcoscephale's H2 Archousa can claim Thrones that require H2. Higher requirements need a prophet, Pretender, hero, or imported priest.

Automatic scrying helps defend claimed territory inside dominion, but the victory turn may depend on simultaneous attacks beyond that information umbrella.

## Raiding

### Native raiders

Unmodded Arcoscephale is not defined by stealth thugs or flying sacreds. Native options are modest:

- small conventional troop groups;
- chariot or elephant detachments against known weak defence;
- a combat Pretender;
- a geared commander when Construction and target class justify it;
- remote Astral attacks against commanders rather than province capture.

### Raiding doctrine

The nation should raid to:

- cut reinforcement routes;
- take laboratories;
- force counters away from the decisive siege;
- break a dominion or temple corridor;
- isolate a fort;
- punish an enemy who concentrated against the main line.

Slow heavy infantry should not chase fast raiders province by province. Scrying, forts, Mystic cells, mobile tramlers, and prediction form the counter-raiding system.

## Sieges

The roster supplies many human siege bodies but no automatic siege miracle.

Before besieging:

- calculate whether the army can breach on the required deadline;
- protect the lab and gem route;
- keep enough field power to defeat relief;
- preserve a storming package distinct from wall damage;
- move a claim-capable priest toward any Throne;
- scout every adjacent retreat.

Mystics researching inside a siege army are not free value if a relief battle destroys them.

## Diplomacy

Arcoscephale presents two political images.

The visible image is a conventional human kingdom with slow infantry and elephants. The hidden image is a rapidly compounding Astral state capable of communions, remote attacks, and high research.

This creates predictable diplomacy:

- neighbours may seek an early war before the mage network matures;
- others may value Arcoscephale as a stable border or anti-elite partner;
- Mind Hunt and Master Enslave potential can make later coalitions wary;
- scrying makes covert movement inside dominion less reliable;
- broad but shallow paths create useful gem and item trades.

Good diplomacy communicates enough strength to deter without advertising every random and research branch.

## Matchup framework

### Against heavy armour

Prefer:

- Destruction;
- high-damage or armour-negating magic;
- fatigue;
- elementals;
- a protected line that buys casting time.

Avoid:

- relying on ordinary spear damage alone;
- sending elephants into elite armour without disruption.

### Against giants

Prefer:

- Earth Meld and other control;

- Gifts from Heaven or other high-damage effects;
- fatigue and MR pressure;
- enough line depth to prevent immediate mage contact.

Avoid:

- treating trample as the primary answer;
- spending heavily on protection that giant damage easily penetrates without another plan.

### **Against high-MR elites**

Prefer:

- physical control and damage;
- armour destruction;
- fatigue that does not depend on one MR check;
- penetration only when the arithmetic is credible.

Avoid:

- a pure Soul Slay plan without enough attempts and penetration.

### **Against undead mass**

Prefer:

- priest support;
- engine killing;
- morale protection;
- fire, area damage, and fatigue tools appropriate to the exact undead;
- sustained lines that do not exhaust before the summoners.

Avoid:

- counting skeleton kills without measuring mage fatigue and replacement.

### **Against flyers and attack-rear forces**

Prefer:

- rear guards;
- mage bodyguards;
- wider or staggered deployment;
- separated mage cells;
- predictive interception through scrying.

Avoid:

- a single unguarded communion block.

### **Against glamour and stealth**

Prefer:

- dominion scrying;
- Spirit Sight or other current sight tools;
- area effects;
- patrol networks;

- redundant defence.

Avoid:

- assuming a missing army is absent.

## Against enemy Astral

Prefer:

- explicit Magic Duel policy;
- non-Astral damage where possible;
- protecting high-S Astrologers;
- decoy and target-priority planning;
- assessing enemy penetration and remote threat.

Avoid:

- exposing irreplaceable high-S casters to cheap duellists without need.

## Heroes

The unmodded national hero pool includes:

| Hero                  | Strategic contribution                                         |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Anthromachus          | Inspirational military leadership                              |
| Orokestes, Hierophant | F1A1W1E1S2H2; unique Air and broad cross-path access           |
| Pathos, Son of Titans | Durable inspirational hero with Awe and Invulnerability        |
| Axieros, Kabeiride    | W1N3H2, Healing 3, Sailing, recuperation and support abilities |

Heroes are opportunities, not foundations. A plan that requires Axieros for N3 or Orokestes for Air has no deadline guarantee unless the hero is already present.

When a hero appears:

- 1 record the exact paths and abilities in the current version;
- 2 identify unique items, rituals, or movement unlocked;
- 3 protect the hero according to replacement impossibility;
- 4 avoid forcing the hero into a role a repeatable recruit can perform.

## Gem economy

The capital produces four Astral pearls and one Nature gem per month.

Astral pearls compete among:

- communions and Power of the Spheres;
- battlefield Astral;
- forging;
- remote magic;
- boosters;
- globals;
- high-end rituals;
- reserve against an unexpected war.

Nature gems compete among:

- support summons;
- boosters;
- national Monster Boar or Hamadryad routes after access exists;
- later globals;
- trades that buy missing Death, Air, or other resources.

An Astral-rich nation can still run out of pearls if every Mystic receives one for every battle. Gem budgets should be assigned by operation, not distributed by habit.

## Laboratory and item security

Because labs cost 300 gold and pool gems:

- do not leave the only forward laboratory exposed;
- keep irreplaceable boosters off commanders taking uncertain routes;
- maintain a rear laboratory for recovery;
- transfer operation gems shortly before commitment;
- record item ownership;
- include retreats and laboratory capture in the invasion ledger.

## New-player turn checklist

### Recruitment

- Is every fort recruiting the commander it needs?
- Was a rare Mystic random identified?
- Is the capital buying an Astrologer for a defined job?
- Can a Hiereia be recruited outside a fort instead?
- Does troop recruitment match local gold and resources?

### Research

- What enemy problem does the current school solve?
- Which mage can cast the spell?
- Does the caster need a communion, self-buff, gem, or item?
- Will the army and caster reach the same battle?

### Armies

- Are elephants screened?
- Is the rear protected?
- Is the commander safe?
- Are retreat provinces friendly?
- Are slow Hopliters delaying an urgent operation?

### Economy

- Is the next fort still affordable?
- Has the 300-gold lab been budgeted?
- Are pearls reserved for the next operation?
- Is a mage promised to both research and fight?

## Information

- What is seen by scouts?
- What is seen only by dominion scrying?
- Which report is stale?
- Could the missing force use stealth or magic movement?

## Expert turn audit

- Recalculate specialist probabilities against current recruitment.
- Separate native, boosted, bootstrapped, and imported path claims.
- Compare independent casting with communion opportunity cost.
- Check every master/slave path and fatigue relationship.
- Audit post-script spell-selection risk.
- Check Magic Duel exposure.
- Recalculate siege and relief clocks.
- Mark every S4+ Astrologer and rare dual-path asset.
- Protect capital recruitment and laboratory continuity.
- Update Throne claim capacity and simultaneous victory threats.

# Part X: Dominions Enhanced 2.16

## Scope of the overhaul

Dominions Enhanced 2.16 genuinely overhauls MA Arcoscephale. The changes go well beyond one adjusted cost.

Source-confirmed changes include:

- a rebuilt ordinary troop roster;
- new phalangite and cavalry units;
- a new mounted commander;
- revised Hoplites, Hypaspists, Heart Companions, Archousai, Mystics, and Astrologers;
- paired Heart Companion recruitment at national sites;
- capital Hetairoi;
- a different hero pool and multihero;
- a large national spell and summon suite;
- national items;
- new late-game Titans, nymphs, heroes, and constellation magic.

The strategic identity changes from "broad low-elemental Astral nation with several inaccessible nationals" to "Astral combined arms with a geography-dependent summon ladder capable of opening most missing paths."

## Recruitment rewrite

The nation block clears ordinary recruitment and then rebuilds access.

## Fort commanders

All listed terrain forts receive:

- Scout;
- Lokhagos;
- Hipparchus;
- Strategos;
- Mystic;
- Archousa;
- Hieria.

The Hieria is also added outside forts in plains, forests, mountains, swamps, wastes, farms, and caves.

Capital Astrologer access remains tied to the Tower of a Thousand Stars rather than the rebuilt ordinary fort list.

## Ordinary troops

The rebuilt list contains:

- Slinger;
- Peltast;
- Cardaces;
- Hoplite;
- Phalangite;
- Hypaspist;
- Prodromoi;
- Chariot;
- Elephant.

Hetairoi are defined but commented out of the ordinary list. They are instead placed at the Tower of a Thousand Stars. Paired Heart Companions are placed at that site and at the Gymnasium.

## Starting army

The mod sets:

- Lokhagos as starting commander;
- Scout as starting scout;
- twenty Peltasts;
- twenty Hoplites.

## Revised and new units

### Hoplite

Source-confirmed delta:

- Defence 11;
- effective gold setting 11 in the mod source;
- new sprites.

Compared with the unmodded 13-gold Defence-9 Hoplite, this is a substantial efficiency and survival improvement.



## Hypaspist

Source-confirmed delta:

- Attack 12;
- Defence 13;
- Combat Speed 14;
- effective gold setting 12.

The source contains two consecutive Defence assignments, 11 then 13; the later value controls. The unit becomes a faster and cheaper elite line rather than merely the flexible alternative to a Hoplite.

## Phalangite, unit 9316

The new MA Phalangite:

- uses half plate, Hoplite helmet, and buckler;
- wields a Sarissa;
- has HP 11, Strength 11, Attack 12, Defence 12;
- costs 16 recruitment points;
- uses the source's effective 13-gold setting.

The long Sarissa and lighter armour define a more offensive formation unit than the old Hoplite.

## Prodromoi, unit 9317

The Prodromoi are light cavalry:

- Xyston, broad sword, and javelin;
- ring-mail hauberk, half helmet, and buckler;
- Skilled Rider 3;
- leather-barding horse;
- HP 11, Attack 11, Defence 11, Morale 12;
- 13 recruitment points;
- effective 10-gold setting.

They add cheap mobile flank and skirmish pressure that vanilla MA Arcoscephale lacks.

## Hetairoi, unit 9318

The Hetairoi are capital-site heavy cavalry:

- half plate, half helmet, and buckler;
- Xyston, broad sword, and javelin;
- Skilled Rider 5;
- light scale-barding horse;
- HP 13, Strength 12, Attack 12, Defence 12, Morale 12.

Their cost and recruitment values are inherited from the copied Agema Companion because the proposed explicit overrides are commented out. The exact final in-game card remains a combined-object verification item.

## Hipparchus, unit 9319

The Hipparchus is the matching cavalry commander:

- same main equipment family as the Hetairoi;

- Skilled Rider 6;
- light scale-barding horse;
- HP 13, Attack 12, Defence 12, Morale 12;
- inherited leadership and costs from the Agema Commander.

The final inherited values should be captured from the live modded unit card before publication of a numeric quick-reference.

## Heart Companions in pairs

Unit 9322 represents paired recruitment:

- source cost 50 gold;
- recruitment-point cost 46;
- resource cost 28;
- Plate Hauberk, Hoplite Helmet, Buckler, Sarissa;
- Morale 14, Strength 12, Attack 12;
- description explicitly states that two are recruited at once.

Seasonal shapes and nation events convert the paired representation into two ordinary Heart Companions. The ordinary Heart Companion is also rewritten with the same equipment family and improved Morale, Strength, and Attack.

This changes sacred economics:

- the recruitment purchase is indivisible;
- the effective body cost is nominally half the pair cost;
- capital and Gymnasium access matters;
- bless value must be recalculated against two-at-a-time production;
- the transformation/event timing should be reproduced before assuming both bodies are immediately available in every interface.

## Archousa

The Archousa becomes:

- N2 rather than N1;
- 265 gold rather than 235.

This single path increase is strategically central. It turns high Nature from a hero-dependent hope into a booster and summon-ladder project.

## Mystic

The Mystic gains Poor Magic Leadership.

The magic random structure is not cleared or rewritten in the inspected source, so the unmodded path distribution remains unless another loaded layer changes it. Poor Magic Leadership matters when summoned magic beings are moved with Mystic armies.

## Astrologer

The Astrologer gains permission to use restricted-item group 10, enabling the national Zodiac item. The base path structure is not rewritten in the inspected source.

## Site recruitment

### Tower of a Thousand Stars

Dominions Enhanced clears and rewrites the site:

- 4 Astral pearls per month;
- 1 Nature gem per month;
- Astrologer as home commander;
- paired Heart Companions;
- Hetairoi.

### Gymnasium

The Gymnasium is rewritten to provide paired Heart Companions.

This creates two sacred-production cases:

- capital production from the Tower;
- any obtained Gymnasium site.

The frequency and map availability of Gymnasias are not a guaranteed national resource and should not be assumed at Pretender design.

## Hero rewrite

The MA national hero line becomes:

- Aleksandros, the Conqueror;
- Orokestes;
- Pathos;
- Axieros;
- Muse as multihero.

### Aleksandros

Aleksandros replaces Anthromachus in the era's primary hero slot. The source defines:

- mounted movement;
- Awe and Fear;
- Inspirational 2;
- high leadership;
- sacred status;
- enchanted equipment;
- events that rally local population types when he is present.

The rally events can generate troops and commanders from horse tribes, Raptorians, several Amazon types, elephant populations, Atavi, and other local groups. These are opportunity effects dependent on both the hero and province population type.

### Muses

Muses are repeatable multiheroes with:

- Glamour 3;

- two random picks from a Fire/Air/Astral/Nature mask in the source;
- Awe, stealth, seduction, Inspirational 2, and Inspiring Research 1;
- sacred and magic-being status.

They can open valuable paths, but hero arrival remains non-deterministic. A deadline-safe plan cannot require a Muse.

## Adventurers and Divine Heroes

The nation receives future-site pools for:

- adventurer heroes;
- Divine Heroes;
- ordinary national heroes;
- a broad summon catalogue.

These pools support national spells. They are not ordinary recruits.

## National spell suite

The source-confirmed DE suite is grouped below by strategic function. Fields inherited through #copyspell should be checked on the final in-game spell card; explicit overridden values are reliable source claims.

### Immediate and battlefield magic

| Spell                             | Research | Explicit requirement    | Cost                        | Effect                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------|----------|-------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Zodiac Cascades                   | 0        | S1                      | 0                           | Modified Stellar Cascades, AoE 3, Precision +5; unavailable in caves                     |
| Light of the Aries Constellation  | 4        | S4F1                    | Inherits Northern Star cost | Fire +1 and Astral +1 to eligible casters; Fire Resistance 5 to battlefield              |
| Light of the Cetus Constellation  | 5        | S4W1                    | Inherits Northern Star cost | Astral +1; battlefield speed -25%, +3 encumbrance, d4 fatigue per square moved           |
| Light of the Taurus Constellation | 6        | S4E1                    | Inherits Northern Star cost | Earth +1, Astral +1, Reinvigoration 4                                                    |
| Dissolve into Atoms               | 7        | Inherits Soul Slay path | 20 fatigue                  | AoE 1, MR negates, soul slay; ethereal targets are harder to affect                      |
| Light of the Libra Constellation  | 7        | S6                      | Inherits Northern Star cost | Spirit Sight to battlefield and Astral +1                                                |
| Summon Daimones                   | 7        | S4                      | 3 pearls                    | Twelve sacred ethereal Daimones; secondary effect gives Luck to 25% of friendly soldiers |

The four constellation lights are mutually incompatible with each other and with an Arcoscephalian Light of the Northern Star. They are a strategic choice, not cumulative path stacking.

### Astral economy and events

| Spell                  | Research              | Requirement                  | Cost      | Effect                                                                                  |
|------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Power of the Zodiac    | 5                     | Inherited from Stellar Focus | 25 pearls | Produces five Astral pearls per month; attempts to override Stellar Focus; not in caves |
| Call to Adventure      | Thaumaturgy 4         | S4                           | 15 pearls | Summons a band drawn from the national adventurer montage                               |
| Baleful Conjunction    | Inherits Baleful Star | Inherited                    | 4 pearls  | Mountain cast; +30 unrest, Misfortune +3, 10% of units cursed through event             |
| Beneficent Conjunction | Inherits Baleful Star | Inherited                    | 4 pearls  | Mountain cast; -30 unrest, Luck +3, 10% tax boost through event                         |
| Cursed Omen            | 6                     | Inherited                    | 5 pearls  | Mountain cast; event intended to curse half the target army                             |

Event-based ritual outcomes and temporary scale duration should be reproduced under the combined mods.

## Nature and elemental summon ladder

| Summon                  | Research | Requirement | Cost      | Geography                     | Summoned magic                            |
|-------------------------|----------|-------------|-----------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Contact Karyatid        | 4        | N3          | 20 Nature | Forest                        | N3 in forest, N2 outside                  |
| Contact Oceanid         | 5        | W3          | 25 Water  | Not restricted in shown block | W3 plus three random picks from A/E/D/N/G |
| Contact Oreiad          | 6        | N4          | 30 Nature | Mountain or border mountain   | N3A2E1                                    |
| Contact Eleionomae      | 6        | W3          | 35 Water  | Swamp                         | W3D2A1                                    |
| Contact Nephelae        | 7        | W3A1        | 30 Water  | Not caves                     | A3W3                                      |
| Daughter of the Evening | 8        | S4          | 38 pearls | Ordinary land conditions      | S3A2, immortal                            |
| Summon Boread           | 8        | A3W2        | 45 Air    | Ordinary valid province       | Winged giant commander                    |

This is the heart of the overhaul. Geography becomes magic access.

## Unique and late summons

| Summon                  | Research      | Requirement | Cost      | Notes                              |
|-------------------------|---------------|-------------|-----------|------------------------------------|
| The Guardian of Hades   | Conjuration 6 | D4          | 20 Death  | Unique Kerberos                    |
| Summon Divine Hero      | Conjuration 7 | S5          | 40 pearls | One Divine Hero from national pool |
| Titan of War & Wisdom   | Conjuration 8 | S4E2        | 40 pearls | Unique Athena                      |
| Titan of the Seas       | Conjuration 8 | W4E2        | 40 Water  | Underwater only; unique Poseidon   |
| Titan of the Underworld | Conjuration 8 | D5          | 40 Death  | Unique Hades                       |
| The Scourge of the Deep | Conjuration 9 | W5N3        | 60 Water  | Underwater only; unique Cetus      |

## Other national summons

- Headless Men: N2, seven Nature gems, ten-plus Blemmyes; the school and research level are inherited from Summon Ogres.

- Sow Dragon Teeth and the unmodded Arcoscephalian national rituals remain relevant unless specifically overwritten elsewhere.
- The future-site lists also identify Spartae, Blemmyes, Lampads, Hound of Twilight, Keres, Keledone, Khalkotaurus, Daimones, nymph commanders, Kerberos, and the three Titans as national summon products.

## National items

### Bag of Dragons Teeth

Source-confirmed:

- Construction 5;
- Earth level 2 through the copied Earth item;
- reduced item cost;
- summons three Spartae at battle start;
- grants one point of magic leadership;
- restricted to a group of appropriate nations including MA Arcoscephale.

It converts an E2 forge turn and Earth gems into a repeatable battlefield screen or reinforcement. The exact inherited base cost should be read from the final item card.

### Horoskopos

Source-confirmed:

- S2;
- cursed and not normally forgeable/found in the ordinary way;
- Luck;
- Morale +2;
- Inspirational 1;
- effects apply to the mount where relevant.

Its acquisition route is not established by the inspected item block. It should not be included in a routine forge plan until reproduced.

### Zodiac

Source-confirmed:

- Construction 5;
- S2;
- Astrologer-restricted item group;
- 50 points of bad-event prevention;
- Twist Fate;
- effects extend to mount.

The mod explicitly authorises Astrologers to use its restricted group. This turns selected Astrologers into provincial event-control assets without changing their magic.

## DE access ladders

## Reliable Nature-to-Air ladder

- 1 Recruit an N2 Archousa.
- 2 Obtain a named Nature booster to N3.
- 3 Cast Contact Karyatid in a forest.
- 4 Use the N3 Karyatid in forest, with a booster to N4 if required.
- 5 Cast Contact Oreiad on a mountain.
- 6 Receive an N3A2E1 Oreiad.
- 7 Use Air boosters, empowerment, or another summon to reach higher Air.

Every step requires the relevant research, gems, item, and geography. The ladder is powerful because it is reproducible; it is not instantaneous.

## Water-to-Death ladder

- 1 Preserve a W2 Mystic.
- 2 Add a named Water booster to reach W3 for ritual casting.
- 3 Cast Contact Eleionomae in a swamp.
- 4 Receive W3D2A1.
- 5 Use Death boosters, empowerment, or further summons to reach D4.
- 6 Cast The Guardian of Hades or other Death nationals.

Contact Oceanid is an alternate W3 route with random Death, Glamour, Nature, Air, or Earth outcomes. Because the Oceanid randoms are variable, it is a portfolio rather than deadline guarantee.

## Astral-to-Air ladder

- 1 Recruit an S4 Astrologer or boost S3.
- 2 At Conjuraton 8, cast Daughter of the Evening.
- 3 Receive an immortal S3A2 commander.
- 4 Use Air boosters or combine with Water access.
- 5 Reach A3W2 for Summon Boread or other Air operations.

## Constellation ladder

Astrologer randoms can naturally provide:

- S4F1 for Aries;
- S4W1 for Cetus;
- S4E1 for Taurus.

Because the fixed and rare randoms interact, exact probabilities should be computed from the current Astrologer distribution and verified after the mod is loaded. S6 for Libra requires boosters or another high-Astral route.

## DE research priorities

The mod creates two new trunks.

## Constellation trunk

- immediate Zodiac Cascades provides an early fatigue tool;
- Conjuraton 4 gives the ordinary Northern Star and the research neighbourhood for Aries if the copied school remains;
- levels 5-7 progressively add Cetus, Taurus, and Libra;

- the chosen constellation must fit the army and enemy because only one light can operate.

## Nymph trunk

- level 4 Karyatid begins the Nature ladder;
- level 5 Oceanid begins the Water-random ladder;
- level 6 Oreiad and Eleionomae open Air and Death;
- level 7 Nephelae and Divine Heroes expand force;
- level 8 Daughter of Evening and Titans establish late magic.

The best branch depends on gems and terrain. Researching Contact Oreiad without an N4 caster and a mountain produces no immediate capacity.

## DE army identity

The new roster supports a more mobile combined-arms formation:

- cheaper improved Hoplites;
- fast Hypaspists;
- offensive Phalangites;
- cheap Prodromoi;
- capital Hetairoi;
- paired sacreds;
- elephants and chariots;
- constellation-enhanced Mystics.

The nation can now create:

- a mobile Map Move 16 cavalry and infantry wing;
- a slower sacred or Hoplite core;
- Astral fatigue operations;
- nature-spirit and elemental commander support;
- late unique-summon armies.

Mixed movement must still be audited. One slow unit can reduce the route of an otherwise mobile force.

# Part XI: Divinitus 1.15.3 DE and the Grand Hierophant

## Layer boundary

Divinitus does not rewrite MA Arcoscephale's ordinary national roster in the inspected source. It rewrites Pretenders and adds event-driven powers.

The relevant national interaction is:

```
Dominions Enhanced national overhaul
+ Divinitus Pretender choice
= combined MA Arcoscephale
```

The strongest documented interaction is the Grand Hierophant, monster 3053.



## Combined object inheritance

Dominions Enhanced first rewrites the Grand Hierophant with:

- S2;
- path cost 20;
- base Pretender cost 30;
- HP 10, MR 18, and human item slots;
- 50 points of bad-event prevention;
- Disease Resistance 100.

Divinitus loads afterward and sets:

- base Pretender cost 150;
- all known non-priest magic paths +1 through `#magicboost 53 1`;
- bad-event prevention 75;
- Disease Resistance 100;
- the anointing, teaching, and site-search description and events.

Because Divinitus does not clear magic or reset the path cost in this block, the earlier DE S2 and path-cost values remain in the combined object unless another later command changes them. This is a load-order conclusion and should be confirmed in the Pretender screen.

## Paths known +1

The Grand Hierophant adds one effective level to known non-priest paths.

Strategic consequences:

- purchased path thresholds may be one level easier;
- battlefield and ritual access must be calculated from effective, not merely purchased, paths;
- bless path requirements and design costs must still use the Pretender interface's actual rules;
- path loss, transformation, and boosters require live verification.

The phrase does not mean the Pretender knows every path. It boosts paths that are known.

## Mystic anointing

The source event:

- requires the Grand Hierophant as god;
- targets a Mystic or Erytheian Mystic;
- requires a temple;
- adds Holy;
- transforms the target into monster 382, the Mystic Prophet;
- is hidden from the event log.

The mod description states that one Mystic at a temple is anointed each month, becoming H1 and sacred.

## Strategic uses

Anointed Mystics can potentially provide:

- sacred researchers;
- H1 communion participants;

- temple builders and preachers;
- bless access in battle;
- priest support without Archousa recruitment;
- targets for the teaching event.

Operational requirement

Maintain:

- at least one eligible Mystic in a temple province;
- enough temple coverage to place trainees without disrupting the front;
- a record of which Mystic random is being transformed;
- a protected training hub.

Test pending

The exact preservation of:

- random magic paths;
- experience;
- items;
- age;
- orders;
- recruitment identity;
- prophet interactions

must be reproduced through the transformation.

Teaching deeper mysteries

The source event for Mystic Prophets:

- requires the Grand Hierophant in the same province;
- requires positive dominion;
- uses #req\_domchance 5;
- checks the target's Astral threshold through #req\_targnopath3 4;
- adds +1 Fire, Water, Earth, and Astral simultaneously.

The description expresses this as candles times 5% chance and a maximum of three.

Probability

If #req\_domchance 5 behaves as described, the monthly success chance at \((c)\) friendly candles is:

$$\lfloor p = 0.05c \rfloor$$

| Candles | Monthly chance |
|---------|----------------|
| 1       | 5%             |
| 3       | 15%            |
| 5       | 25%            |
| 7       | 35%            |
| 10      | 50%            |

The probability of at least one success after  $n$  eligible months is:

$$1 - (1 - 0.05)^n$$

At five candles, six eligible months give:

$$1 - 0.75^6 \approx 82.2\%$$

## Path consequence

One success turns a typical Mystic Prophet into a much broader caster. Repeated success can create:

- multi-element communion masters;
- ritual cross-paths otherwise impossible in vanilla;
- high independent casters;
- forgers who compress several national roles.

## Source discrepancy

The prose says paths rise to a maximum of three. The event block visibly gates on an Astral-path condition and then boosts all four paths. A Mystic beginning at F2S1 could, under a literal reading of the commands, receive two successful boosts before Astral reaches three, potentially producing F4.

This is not asserted as engine behaviour. It is a high-priority controlled test because:

- command semantics may cap the other paths;
- transformation may alter the starting paths;
- the event requirement may behave differently from the literal reading;
- another hidden engine rule may enforce the prose maximum.

Until tested, the public doctrine uses the stated cap of three and records elemental over-cap as test pending.

## Site-search treasure

The source event:

- requires the Grand Hierophant;
- requires the Site Searching order on land;
- requires positive dominion;
- uses candles times 5% chance;
- grants 150 gold;
- grants 1d6 of each elemental gem.

"Elemental" means Fire, Air, Water, and Earth in the mod description.

## Conditional value

On success, expected gem gain is:

$$4 \times E(1d6) = 4 \times 3.5 = 14$$

At  $c$  candles, ignoring caps or event interactions, expected monthly value is:

$$E(\text{gold}) = 150(0.05c) = 7.5c$$

$$E(\text{total elemental gems}) = 14(0.05c) = 0.7c$$

| Candles | Expected gold / search month | Expected total elemental gems / search month |
|---------|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| 1       | 7.5                          | 0.7                                          |
| 3       | 22.5                         | 2.1                                          |
| 5       | 37.5                         | 3.5                                          |
| 7       | 52.5                         | 4.9                                          |
| 10      | 75                           | 7                                            |

These are expected values, not guaranteed yields.

## Opportunity cost

The Grand Hierophant's search month could instead be:

- researching;
- forging;
- casting a ritual;
- moving;
- joining a battle;
- teaching at a different hub;
- preaching or performing another Pretender task.

Site searching is attractive when:

- friendly dominion is high;
- unsearched provinces remain;
- elemental gems unlock immediate DE summon or battle packages;
- the Pretender is not needed on the front.

It is unattractive when the expected treasure does not beat the deadline value of another order.

## Training-hub doctrine

A Grand Hierophant training province should contain:

- temple;
- laboratory;
- strong friendly dominion;
- eligible Mystic Prophet;
- guards and fortification;
- no unnecessary exposed gem stock;
- access to the front through a safe route.

The hub converts time into exceptional mages. It also concentrates the Pretender and valuable Mystics into an obvious remote and conventional target.

Security includes:

- dome consideration;
- patrols;
- scouts on adjacent provinces;
- reserve troops;
- an evacuation route;
- alternate laboratories;
- avoiding the capital if that creates one catastrophic target.

# Grand Hierophant strategic families

## Research-and-training family

Prioritises:

- high Magic scale;
- early Mystic production;
- temple network;
- protected training hub;
- ritual paths that trained Mystics can complement.

Risk:

- too much stationary investment;
- delayed first-war force;
- Pretender time consumed by teaching and searching.

## Elemental-treasure family

Prioritises:

- high dominion candles;
- systematic site searching;
- DE elemental summon ladder;
- rapid conversion of found gems.

Risk:

- expected-value variance;
- Pretender absent from critical operations;
- gathering gems without research or casters to spend them.

## Battlefield-hierophant family

Prioritises:

- combat paths and survivability;
- trained Mystics as battlefield masters;
- healing support;
- an awakening timed for war.

Risk:

- sacrificing the mod's unique economic and training effects;
- exposing the central Pretender and training engine.

## Ritual-platform family

Prioritises:

- paths missing after accounting for DE summon ladders;
- legendary ritual thresholds;
- booster and forge plan;
- imprisoned or dormant timing if the recruitable state can survive.

Risk:

- paying for paths the DE nymph ladder would have supplied more cheaply;
- planning rituals before the gem economy exists.

## Part XII: Combined-Mod Strategy

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### What the combined ruleset changes

The combined nation has three compounding engines:

- 1 cheaper and broader combined-arms recruitment;
- 2 DE's national constellation and nymph summon ladder;
- 3 Divinitus Grand Hierophant training and treasure.

This creates exceptional upside but also severe attention demands.

The player must track:

- Mystic randoms;
- anointed status;
- training history;
- geography for summons;
- national spell research;
- constellation compatibility;
- multiple gem colours;
- hero and unique availability;
- ordinary fronts and Thrones.

### Combined opening priorities

A coherent opening selects one primary engine.

#### Military opening

- use improved Hoplites, Hypaspists, Phalangites, cavalry, and elephants;
- build forts;
- keep Grand Hierophant support secondary until borders stabilise.

#### Mystic training opening

- prioritise temple and Mystic production;
- accept a slower mundane expansion only if tests prove it;
- protect the training centre;
- research spells that make the first enhanced Mystics immediately useful.

#### Summon-ladder opening

- secure forest, mountain, and swamp provinces;
- reach the relevant Conjunction levels;
- preserve N2 and W2 specialists;
- use Grand Hierophant treasure to finance elemental bottlenecks.

Attempting all three at maximum speed is likely to produce too few troops, too few forts, and half-completed research.

## Combined magic compression

A trained Mystic can receive simultaneous F/W/E/S growth. DE then offers:

- constellation spells requiring S plus an element;
- elemental and Nature summons;
- national items;
- high Astral hero and Titan rituals.

This compresses jobs that would otherwise require several masters.

Potential trained roles include:

- S4F1 Aries caster;
- S4W1 Cetus caster;
- S4E1 Taurus caster;
- E2S2 Keledone ritual caster;
- F3E3 Brass Bull caster;
- W3 ritual caster for Oceanid or Eleionomae;
- broad independent Power of the Spheres caster.

Each role must be checked against:

- actual post-training paths;
- ritual versus battle restrictions;
- boosters;
- research;
- gem stock;
- whether using the mage consumes an irreplaceable training product.

## Combined path priorities

The Pretender should avoid buying paths that the nation can obtain reliably and cheaply through DE unless timing justifies them.

### More valuable Pretender paths

- paths required before summon ladders mature;
- paths that unlock national rituals with no cheap bridge;
- paths supporting an awake expansion role;
- paths needed for a specific global or legendary ritual;
- paths that improve blessings used by a meaningful sacred roster.

### Less valuable redundant purchases

- high Nature bought solely to reach N3 when N2 Archousai plus a booster can begin the ladder;
- high Air bought solely for eventual access when Oreiads and Daughters can supply it in time;
- broad elements bought without a ritual, battlefield, bless, or forging job.

Redundancy can still be worth paying for when it removes a deadline or geography dependency.

## Combined counter surfaces

The combined nation can be attacked through:

- temple and training-hub destruction;
- capital pressure against Astrologers and unique site troops;
- raids on forests, mountains, and swamps required for summons;
- gem denial;
- assassination of trained Mystics;
- communion clears;
- anti-Astral Magic Duel tactics;
- resistance to the chosen constellation;
- simultaneous fronts that overload attention.

The correct defence is not a larger single army. It is redundancy across:

- temples;
- labs;
- trained casters;
- access routes;
- gem stores;
- battlefield packages.

## Part XIII: Controlled Tests

### Test standard

Every test record should include:

- Dominions version;
- mod names, versions, and load order;
- game settings;
- nation and Pretender;
- turn and province;
- relevant units, paths, items, gems, and scripts;
- expected result;
- observed result;
- replay or save identifier;
- whether the result was repeated;
- conclusion and confidence.

Change one major variable at a time.

### Test 1: Mystic random distribution

Question: Does the current unmodded and modded Mystic use the documented guaranteed FWES roll plus independent 50% F/W/E rolls?

Method:

- 1 Recruit at least 128 Mystics under unmodded 6.35.
- 2 Record exact F/W/E/S paths.
- 3 Compare F2, W2, E2, and S2 frequencies with 12.5%, 12.5%, 12.5%, and 25%.



- 4 Confirm no E2S2 or double-elemental-2 result appears.
- 5 Repeat with DE 2.16.
- 6 Repeat with both mods.

Purpose: detect current-data or mod inheritance errors, not prove random fairness from a small sample.

## Test 2: Astrologer rare random

Question: Does the 10% extra random operate independently and can it produce S5 or an elemental level 2?

Method:

- 1 Recruit a large Astrologer sample in a debug or long test.
- 2 Record S3/S4/S5 and elemental results.
- 3 Compare with the derived 73.125%, 26.25%, and 0.625% Astral distribution.
- 4 Repeat under DE.

## Test 3: Starting-army expansion

Question: Which independent classes can the starting twenty Peltasts and twenty Hoplites defeat with acceptable losses?

Method:

- 1 Use fixed settings and no combat Pretender.
- 2 Test ordinary infantry, barbarians, heavy cavalry, crossbows, and heavy infantry.
- 3 Vary only formation and orders.
- 4 Record body losses, commander safety, battle duration, and next-turn readiness.

## Test 4: Elephant package sizing

Question: How many elephants and screening bodies produce reliable expansion under the chosen independent strength?

Method:

- 1 Test several small counts rather than one large army.
- 2 Use identical target classes.
- 3 Record routs, friendly trample, elephant wounds, and economic replacement.
- 4 Compare screen types.
- 5 Repeat under DE because ordinary troop performance changes.

## Test 5: Chariot versus elephant

Question: Against which targets does the cheaper chariot produce a better gold and attrition result than the elephant?

Method:

- compare equal gold values;
- test light infantry, archers, heavy infantry, and large units;
- record total package survival, not only mounts.

## Test 6: Hoplite versus Hypaspist

Question: When do three extra Protection points outperform Defence, Morale, movement, and lower resources?

Method:

- equal gold;
- equal resources;
- equal frontage;
- low-damage swarm;
- high-damage infantry;
- giants;
- armour-destruction support;
- long fatigue battle.

Repeat under vanilla and DE, where both units change materially.

## Test 7: Formation density

Question: How do formation fighters perform under area damage and frontage pressure?

Method:

- dense versus ordinary formation;
- equal troop count;
- melee-only opponent;
- area evocation opponent;
- fatigue-cloud opponent;
- trample opponent.

Record contact timing, attacks delivered, casualties by square, and rout timing.

## Test 8: Independent casting versus communion

Question: At what battle size does a communion outperform the same number of independent Mystics?

Method:

- 1 Select a single enemy army and research level.
- 2 Test eight independent Mystics.
- 3 Test four slaves and four masters.
- 4 Test six slaves and two masters.
- 5 Equalise gems.
- 6 Record useful casts, fatigue, slave wounds, enemy kills, and mage survival.

## Test 9: Communion collapse

Question: Which master scripts overload two-, four-, and eight-slave communions?

Method:

- record each master path before and after communion;
- use exact five-spell scripts;

- test battle lengths beyond the script;
- remove one slave through controlled damage;
- observe threshold loss and fatigue cascade.

## Test 10: Shared self-buffs

Question: Which Mystic master self-buffs are shared with slaves and how do they change fatigue relationships?

Method:

- Power of the Spheres;
- Phoenix Power;
- Summon Earthpower;
- personal resistance and protection spells;
- compare slave effective paths and fatigue before and after.

## Test 11: Magic Duel policy

Question: How does enemy low-S duel pressure affect S2 Mystics and S3-S5 Astrologers?

Method:

- one opposing duellist per target class;
- repeated trials;
- record deaths and surviving caster value;
- compare independent deployment and communion.

## Test 12: Mind Hunt and healing

Question: How valuable is national healing after failed or detected Mind Hunts?

Method:

- S4 Astrologer against provinces with and without enemy Astral;
- record feeblemind, death, and other outcomes;
- move survivors to Hieria and Archousa provinces;
- record recovery time and failures.

## Test 13: Scrying and glamour

Question: What exact information does automatic dominion scrying reveal in 6.35?

Method:

- ordinary army;
- glamourous units;
- stealth units;
- hidden commander;
- fort construction;
- adjacent and same-province dominion states;
- disciple partner view.

Compare with scout, spy, and ritual scrying reports.

## Test 14: Hiereia outside-fort recruitment

Question: Which province types and structures allow Hiereia recruitment under vanilla and DE?

Method:

- every land terrain;
- with and without fort;
- with and without lab;
- with and without temple;
- record recruitment interface and requirements.

## Test 15: Healing allocation

Question: How are Healing 1 and Healing 3 attempts allocated among multiple afflicted units?

Method:

- identical afflicted units;
- mixed affliction severity;
- ordinary, sacred, mounted, magic-being, undead, and inanimate cases;
- repeat over enough months to distinguish impossibility from variance.

## Test 16: DE paired Heart Companions

Question: When and how does one 9322 recruitment become two unit-747 Heart Companions?

Method:

- recruit at Tower and Gymnasium;
- observe recruitment queue, arrival, seasonal shape, event timing, upkeep, experience, and squad assignment;
- verify whether both bodies receive bless and equipment changes;
- test losses before and after transformation.

## Test 17: DE inherited unit cards

Question: What are the final costs and inherited attributes of Hetairoi, Hipparchus, and other copied objects?

Method:

- capture full live unit cards;
- compare with copied vanilla source object;
- record every explicit override;
- verify rider and mount separately.

## Test 18: DE constellation exclusivity

Question: How do Aries, Cetus, Taurus, Libra, and Light of the Northern Star replace or block each other?

Method:

- cast each alone;

- cast two in both orders;
- use opposing Arcoscephalian casters;
- inspect path boosts, battlefield effects, duration, and message log.

## Test 19: DE summon geography

Question: Which terrain flags satisfy forest, swamp, mountain, border mountain, cave, and underwater restrictions?

Method:

- test every nymph ritual in each plausible terrain combination;
- test fortified and unfortified provinces;
- test alternate planes;
- record ritual availability before spending gems.

## Test 20: Oceanid randoms

Question: Does `#custommagic 29952 300` produce three independent picks from Air, Earth, Death, Nature, and Glamour as expected?

Method:

- summon a statistically useful sample;
- record duplicates and maxima;
- compare access probabilities;
- identify deadline-safe and portfolio-only outcomes.

## Test 21: Grand Hierophant inheritance

Question: Under DE then Divinitus, what are the final S path, path cost, base cost, item slots, bad-event prevention, and magic boost?

Method:

- inspect the Pretender selection screen;
- buy one level in several paths;
- create the Pretender;
- compare design display and in-game unit card;
- reverse the load order in a separate test to demonstrate why the supported order matters.

## Test 22: Mystic anointing

Question: Is an eligible Mystic anointed every month, and what survives transformation?

Method:

- one target at a temple;
- several targets at one temple;
- targets at several temples;
- no target;
- target carrying items;
- target with experience and a rare random;
- record selection, timing, and preserved attributes.

## Test 23: Grand Hierophant teaching cap

Question: Can an elemental path exceed three when an S1 Mystic begins with F2, W2, or E2?

Method:

- 1 Anoint a known F2S1 Mystic.
- 2 Place it with the Grand Hierophant in high dominion.
- 3 Repeat until two training successes or the event stops.
- 4 Record F and S after each success.
- 5 Repeat with S2 and ordinary elemental starting paths.

This directly resolves the prose-versus-event ambiguity.

## Test 24: Site-search treasure

Question: Does the event chance equal candles times 5%, and does 1d6vis 51 grant one separate d6 of F/A/W/E?

Method:

- repeat searches at several candle values;
- record ordinary discovered sites separately;
- record event gold and each gem colour;
- compare success frequencies and conditional dice distribution;
- test provinces already fully searched.

## Test 25: Combined trained caster roles

Question: Which trained Mystic thresholds can be reached before a realistic first or second war?

Method:

- run full turn-20 and turn-30 economies;
- include temples, forts, labs, research, troop recruitment, and Pretender orders;
- record number and quality of trained Mystics;
- field one complete constellation or ritual package;
- compare against a military-first opening.

# Part XIV: Essays

## Essay I: The Nation Dossier as a Reproducible Argument

A nation guide is an argument about conversion. It begins with rules, claims that certain capacities follow, and recommends decisions intended to turn those capacities into victory. Like any argument, it can fail because a premise is false, a step is missing, or the conclusion exceeds the evidence.

The most common false premise is stale data. A guide remembers a gold cost, random path, spell level, or bless from another patch or another age. The prose may remain persuasive because the strategic vocabulary still sounds familiar. Yet the actual nation now recruits a different unit, pays a different opportunity cost, or cannot reach the claimed path. Version labels are not editorial decoration. They define the object being discussed.

The most common missing step is access. A national ritual is listed, so the writer says the nation can cast it. A mage reaches one of its paths, so the other path is assumed to appear through "boosters." A communion reaches a battlefield threshold, so the same elevated mage is imagined casting a ritual next month. These statements collapse distinct systems. Rituals do not ordinarily borrow battlefield communion levels. Boosters require research, paths, gems, item slots, and forge turns. A hero may never arrive. A summon may require terrain the nation does not own.

The most common excessive conclusion is the universal build. A design succeeds on one map against one field and becomes "best." But an awake expander, imprisoned scales build, and ritual platform purchase time in different currencies. One survives a rush, one compounds behind space, and one accesses effects after research. None can be evaluated without the expected deadline.

A reproducible dossier exposes every bridge. It says which unit casts the spell, which random produces the unit, how likely the random is, which item supplies the missing level, when the item can be forged, where the army assembles, which gem carrier accompanies it, and what happens if the opponent presents another defence.

This precision does not eliminate judgment. It improves judgment by showing where it enters. "The manual gives the Hoplite Protection 18" is a rule claim. "Hoplites are preferable to Hypaspists here" is doctrine based on enemy damage, resources, movement, and morale. Another player can disagree with the choice while accepting the data. That is productive disagreement.

Tests complete the argument. Expansion claims are played to turn 12 with real infrastructure. Communion scripts are allowed to continue after the fifth spell. Random distributions are sampled. Modded objects are read after load order. A battle replay is not used merely to announce victory; it is used to see contact timing, target selection, fatigue, and the first point of failure.

The finished dossier is neither a recipe nor a plain encyclopaedia entry. It connects verified facts to conditional plans, with a method for correcting each one when the situation changes.

## Essay II: Arcoscephale and the Conversion of Knowledge

Arcoscephale's most distinctive resource is not Astral pearls or heavy infantry. It is the ability to turn information into tailored force.

Automatic scrying inside dominion gives the kingdom unusually good reports where it is politically strongest. Mystics then provide a probabilistic library of Fire, Water, Earth, and Astral tools. Astrologers deepen Astral. The combination invites a particular form of play: observe the approaching force, classify its defences, and assemble the appropriate package.

This promise is easy to exaggerate. Seeing an army does not defeat it. A report can reveal heavy infantry, but the E2 Mystic needed for Destruction may be in another laboratory. The research may be one level short. The Earth gems may be carried by a commander marching elsewhere. The only road may be blocked. Knowledge has strategic value only when the state can deliver the response before the deadline.

This is why fort distribution matters. Each fort supplies Research Points, another draw from the Mystic distribution, and another place from which a response cell can move. A larger mage portfolio reduces variance. A distributed laboratory network reduces distance. A gem reserve cuts preparation time. Scouts beyond dominion extend the warning horizon.

The same system explains the danger of losing a field army. An Arcoscephalian army often carries years of stored options: rare randomnesses, Astral pearls, boosters, and communion slaves that were also researchers. When destroyed, the loss is not measured only in battlefield gold. The nation loses

response branches. An opponent who kills the E2 and S4 specialists may invalidate spells that remain fully researched.

Knowledge also has diplomatic value. Accurate reports discourage weak raids and reveal concentration. They allow credible warnings to allies and more reliable estimates of whether a neighbour is honouring a border. Yet information can make a player overconfident. Scrying inside dominion creates a sharp boundary: the interior feels visible, the exterior does not. Stealth, magic movement, and remote attacks exploit that comfort.

A mature Arcoscephalian state treats information as a chain:

```
report
-> classification
-> response choice
-> caster and gem assignment
-> movement
-> battle evidence
-> revised classification
```

The final step matters. A report predicts. A battle replay teaches. The nation that learns faster eventually needs fewer mages and gems to solve the same problem.

## Essay III: Mystics, Probability, and Doctrine

The Mystic appears broad because any recruit can display several paths. The strategic reality is more exact. Every Mystic begins with S1, gains one guaranteed roll among Fire, Water, Earth, and Astral, then receives separate fifty-percent chances in each element. This creates abundance and constraint at the same time.

The abundance is obvious. Five of eight Mystics know any named element. More than one in five know all three. Every one can participate in an Astral communion. Several forts quickly produce a catalogue of point buffs, self-buffs, evocations, control spells, and forging cross-paths.

The constraint lies in doubled paths. F2, W2, and E2 each appear only one time in eight. E2S2 cannot occur naturally because the same guaranteed roll would have to be both Earth and Astral. Two elements cannot both reach level two on the same recruit. A strategy that remembers only the broad catalogue will eventually promise an impossible mage.

Probability changes recruitment doctrine. A one-in-eight result has an expected waiting time of eight recruits, but expectation is not a delivery date. After eight recruits there remains more than a one-third chance that no such specialist has appeared. A state that needs E2 for the first war must recruit from several forts, maintain an alternate branch, or use another access route.

Probability also changes the meaning of an individual mage. An F2 Mystic is more than a stronger F1. It is one of the nation's limited natural bridges to Phoenix Power, high Fire evocation, and particular forging paths. Assigning it as a communion slave may be correct, but the decision should be deliberate. The same body can serve as a researcher, master, ritual candidate, or battlefield caster, and those roles compete.

This competition explains why communions should be designed from spell packages rather than habit. Four slaves can raise a common F1 master to F3, but those four slaves could also have cast four independent Astral or elemental spells. The communion wins when path elevation and fatigue distribution produce effects that the independent group cannot match. It loses when the battle is small, the target can be solved by low magic, or enemy area attacks make concentration fatal.

The expert skill is not memorising every possible Mystic. It is managing a portfolio:



- label rare results;
- protect deadline-critical specialists;
- keep alternate branches;
- calculate at-least-one probabilities;
- compare independent and communal output;
- preserve enough researchers that victory today does not erase research tomorrow.

Under Divinitus, the Grand Hierophant can change the distribution after recruitment by teaching several paths at once. Portfolio thinking still matters because training introduces another scarce resource: time in high dominion with the Pretender present. The question is not only which Mystic arrived, but which one deserves the next training opportunity.

## Essay IV: Healing, Intelligence, and the Preservation of Force

Arcoscephale possesses two advantages that are easy to undervalue because neither directly kills an enemy: healing and automatic scrying. Together they improve force preservation.

Healing converts survivors into future capacity. A wounded elephant, Astrologer, combat Pretender, or thug may carry an affliction whose cost exceeds the hit points already restored. A damaged eye reduces precision. A crippled leg ruins movement. Feeblemind can remove a mage from useful service. Concentrated healers create a place where those losses can sometimes be reversed.

The useful economic comparison is not the healer's monthly wage against one cured affliction. It is the value of the unit's remaining lifetime. Restoring a rare S4 Astrologer may recover remote-magic and ritual access that would take many capital turns to replace. Restoring an ordinary Peltast is worth less. Healing allocation still has a strategic side even when the engine selects targets automatically, because players decide which units gather in the province and how long they remain.

Scrying reduces the wounds that need healing. Seeing the enemy approach allows the nation to avoid presenting elephants to fear, Mystics to flyers, or Hoplites to armour destruction. It permits the correct reserve to move before contact. It also allows damaged units to withdraw through safer routes.

Neither system eliminates risk. Healing cannot restore the dead and may not cure the desired affliction immediately. Scrying does not reveal every stealth or magic-phase threat and only functions where dominion supplies the view. Overreliance produces predictable failures: the combat Pretender attacks because "the priestesses will heal it," or the capital is left open because "scrying sees everything."

Preservation requires a full cycle:

```
observe threat
-> choose favourable engagement
-> protect valuable bodies
-> win with survivors
-> withdraw damaged assets
-> heal and reassign
```

The final word is reassign. A recovered unit should return to the role its current body and strategic value justify. A once-wounded elephant may rejoin expansion. A recovered Mind Hunter may return to a rear laboratory. A Pretender healed after a narrow victory may be more valuable forging or deterring than repeating the same gamble.

## Essay V: From Classical Army to Astral State

The visual identity of Middle Age Arcoscephale is classical warfare: spear lines, bronze, chariots, and elephants. The strategic identity is a transition away from dependence on those bodies.

In the first year, ordinary troops seize the economy. Hoplites absorb common weapons. Hypaspists move and defend. Peltasts and Cardaces provide affordable frontage. Elephants transform favourable size matchups into rapid routs. The army is not obsolete; it is the instrument that buys time and provinces.

Research changes what the army means. Earth magic can harden it or destroy the enemy's armour. Astral can make key squares ethereal, paralyse elites, or attack minds. Fire and Water can kill dense formations. Communion turn modest randoms into specialists. At this stage the troops are still combatants, but their greater function is to create time and targets for magic.

Later, the relation reverses. The mage state is the scarce offensive core. Troops screen it, hold forts, absorb attacks, provide siege bodies, and claim territory after remote or battlefield magic has broken resistance. A player who continues measuring strength only by the number of elephants will misread the nation.

This transition creates a tension. The old army is expensive in resources and attention; the Astral state is expensive in gold, laboratories, pearls, and mage-turns. Investing too early in magic produces a small realm that can research but not survive. Investing too long in troops produces a large realm that cannot answer modern counters.

The transition point is not a turn number. It arrives when:

- the next troop purchase adds less capability than the next Mystic;
- a research node defeats a class the army cannot;
- borders stabilise enough for forts to compound;
- enemy magic begins invalidating unbuffered troops;
- a siege or Throne operation requires more than field bodies.

Dominions Enhanced makes the transition richer rather than removing it. Cheaper and more mobile troops extend mundane relevance, while constellations, nymph summons, and Titans create a larger magical destination. Divinitus adds trained Mystics who can embody several elements at once. The classical army does not disappear. It becomes the territorial shell of an increasingly supernatural state.

## Essay VI: Geography as a Magic Path

Under Dominions Enhanced, forest, mountain, swamp, and water access become part of Arcoscephale's mage roster.

An N2 Archousa is not yet an Oreiad caster. She needs a Nature booster and a forest to contact a Karyatid. The Karyatid is strongest in forest and can help reach N4. N4 plus a mountain produces an Oreiad, which opens Air and Earth. A W3 caster in a swamp produces an Eleionomae with Death and Air. An S4 Astrologer eventually calls an immortal Daughter of Evening with Air.

The map contains latent paths. A nearby forest may be worth more than its income because it begins the Nature ladder. A swamp can become the nation's first reliable Death bridge. A mountain supports Oreiad contact and conjunction rituals. An underwater foothold enables Titans and the Scourge of the Deeps.

This changes expansion and diplomacy. Terrain is no longer valued only by income, resources, and fort geometry. A treaty that cedes the only safe swamp may also cede Death access. A raid that interrupts the mountain laboratory can delay the entire constellation or nymph programme. A fort built on the correct terrain protects a magical production node.

Geographic access has a cost: it is visible and contestable. A Pretender path travels with the Pretender. A terrain ladder depends on holding the province, building or preserving a laboratory, moving the caster, and surviving the ritual month. Opponents can read the same map and attack the bridge.

The expert response is to record terrain in the access ledger:

```
N2 Archousa
+ Nature booster
+ forest laboratory
+ Conjunction 4
+ 20 Nature gems
= Karyatid
```

This notation makes two things clear. First, the access is real. Second, every component can be delayed or denied.

## Part XV: Reference Checklists

### Vanilla quick doctrine

- Expand with tested infantry, elephant, chariot, or Pretender packages.
- Budget the 300-gold laboratory with every fort.
- Recruit Mystics widely; record every random.
- Treat E2, W2, F2, and S4+ as portfolio assets.
- Use communions only when path elevation beats independent casting.
- Preserve the capital Astrologer pipeline.
- Use scrying as one layer of intelligence.
- Use Hiereiai outside forts and Archousai for concentrated healing.
- Bridge missing paths deliberately.
- Convert field victories into forts, laboratories, and Thrones.

### DE quick doctrine

- Recalculate the entire roster; do not use vanilla cost assumptions.
- Use cheaper improved infantry and new cavalry for mobility.
- Treat paired Heart Companions as a separate sacred economy.
- Exploit N2 Archousai.
- Secure forest, mountain, swamp, and water nodes.
- Choose one constellation per battle.
- Plan the nymph ladder from caster, booster, gem, research, and terrain.
- Protect unique summons and heroes.
- Capture live cards for inherited mod objects.

## Divinitus quick doctrine

- Confirm the final Grand Hierophant in the Pretender screen.
- Build temples where anointing can occur safely.
- Record which Mystic is transformed.
- Train in strong dominion.
- Compare teaching, site searching, research, forging, and war orders.
- Do not assume the stated path cap until tested.
- Convert elemental treasure into immediate packages.
- Protect the training hub without concentrating every irreplaceable asset there.

## Source register

### Official

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2:
- Scouting and Scrying;
- Healing and afflictions;
- Communion;
- spell and ritual tables;
- MA Arcoscephale national summary and roster;
- national spells and rituals.

### Supplied mod sources

- DomEnhanced2\_16.dm
- MA Arcoscephale unit definitions 9316-9323;
- vanilla monster rewrites;
- national sites;
- nation 50 recruitment block;
- national spells, items, heroes, and events.
- Divinitus\_1.15.3\_DE.dm
- Grand Hierophant rewrite;
- Mystic anointing;
- teaching events;
- site-search treasure event.

### Current structured and community cross-checks

- Dominions 6 Mod Inspector, maintained by larzm42;
- Illwiki Dominions 6 MA Arcoscephale page;
- current and historical community discussion used only for doctrine and hypothesis.

Community claims are not used to override official or source-confirmed object definitions without a recorded current test.

## Open research ledger

The highest-priority unresolved questions are:

- 1 current live Mystic and Astrologer random display under 6.36;
- 2 exact scrying interaction with glamour and stealth;

- 3 reliable expansion party ranges;
- 4 independent casting versus communion break-even;
- 5 DE inherited unit and spell-card values;
- 6 paired Heart Companion timing;
- 7 constellation replacement behaviour;
- 8 nymph custom-magic distributions;
- 9 Grand Hierophant combined inheritance;
- 10 Mystic Prophet transformation preservation;
- 11 teaching cap semantics;
- 12 treasure-event probability and gem colours.

These questions are deliberately visible. The dossier is already usable, but it should become more precise as controlled evidence replaces provisional labels.

# Part XVI: Middle Age Marignon, Fiery Justice

## Marignon one-page command brief

Marignon begins as an armoured human kingdom backed by crossbows, sacred cavalry, cheap Fire apprentices, Astral-capable Witch Hunters, powerful priests, and a capital pipeline of Grand Masters. Its first transition is from ordinary steel into coordinated Fire and Astral battle magic. Its later transition is into angelic summons and stronger strategic magic.

The nation is strongest when it uses each layer for the job it actually performs:

- crossbows punish armour and force shields;
- cheap heavy infantry hold space and add siege bodies;
- Knights of the Chalice provide concentrated sacred force rather than affordable frontage;
- Witch Hunters turn ordinary forts into Fire-Astral war colleges;
- Grand Masters supply high paths, random Air or Earth access, and the best communion masters;
- Inquisitors and freely recruitable Friars turn dominion control into a campaign tool;
- Architects improve the fort network and shorten sieges;
- national angel rituals convert Conjuraction research and Astral pearls into mobile sacred power.

The main limits are just as important. Marignon has no dependable native Water, Death, Nature, Blood, or Glamour. Its best mage is capital-only, expensive, and consumes four recruitment points. Much of the army wears enough armour to care about fatigue, armour destruction, and battlefield-wide elemental damage. A plan that only adds more heavy infantry eventually meets a counter it cannot out-armour.

## Marignon evidence and ruleset

The roster and national rules below use the revision-2 official manual. Grand Master randoms are resolved through the pinned 6.35 Inspector export: F3 S2 H2, one guaranteed level from Fire, Air, Earth, or Astral, plus an independent 10% second level from the same set. Advice is labelled strategy. Exact expansion counts remain test dependent because map strength, independent composition, scales, bless, formations, and commander quality change the result.

## Marignon conversion chain

```
crossbows, armour, and sacred cavalry
-> safe expansion and defensible borders
-> forts, laboratories, and Architects
-> Witch Hunters at ordinary forts
-> Fire-Astral battlefield packages
-> Grand Master communions and boosters
-> angels, remote reach, and Throne operations
```

The chain can break in three common places. Excess cavalry delays forts. Too many Initiates produce research without enough Astral organisers. Too many Grand Masters consume capital time and gold before the wider fort network can support them.

## National rules that shape the plan

| Rule                 | Practical consequence                                                                                                      |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Order limit +1       | Marignon can lean further into Order when the economy and recruitment plan justify it.                                     |
| Bless points +3      | A useful sacred package does not require the Pretender to pay for every point alone.                                       |
| Inquisition          | Inquisitors remove enemy dominion and can spread friendly dominion up to one candle in owned provinces.                    |
| Friars outside forts | Priest coverage, preaching, and army leadership do not consume a fort commander slot everywhere.                           |
| Architects           | The capital can produce commanders that build better forts and provide +15 siege strength.                                 |
| Standard forts       | The nation still needs a deliberate fort-and-laboratory budget; the Architect improves the result but does not pay for it. |

Inquisition is not merely defensive flavour. It supports border conversion, weakens hostile dominion effects, and helps sacred forces operate under their own bless. It is still slower than winning the province and building infrastructure. Priests should support the campaign rather than replace it.

## Marignon roster by job

| Unit                  | Best job                                                     | Important limit                                                                                  |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Crossbowman           | Armour pressure, supporting fire, cheap ranged mass          | Ordinary precision and friendly-fire risk; needs a screen                                        |
| Pikeneer              | Anti-large line and repel pressure                           | Low Defence and ordinary damage when the length advantage is irrelevant                          |
| Halberdier            | Armour-piercing line damage and siege mass                   | Slow, heavily armoured, vulnerable to fatigue and missiles without shields                       |
| Swordsman             | General heavy infantry and high-damage strikes               | No shield and the same fatigue problem as the other heavy line troops                            |
| Man at Arms           | Better-defended line and bodyguard-quality infantry          | Higher gold, resources, and recruitment-point demand                                             |
| Flagellant            | Cheap sacred mass, patrol or siege body, disposable pressure | No armour, poor Defence, and losses can become expensive when the bless is overbuilt around them |
| Royal Guard           | Durable non-sacred cavalry and mobile reserve                | Very expensive in resources and recruitment points                                               |
| Knight of the Chalice | Sacred shock cavalry and decisive flank                      | Seventy gold, heavy resource and recruitment demand, and a mount that remains a separate target  |

The ordinary expansion army should normally combine a protected line with crossbows. Pikes are selected when large targets justify them. Great weapons are selected when armour is the problem. Sacred cavalry is used where the charge and survivability change the battle enough to justify its price. Mixing every unit into every party hides which piece is doing useful work.

## Marignon commander and mage portfolio

| Commander                   | Paths or ability              | Main jobs                                                               | Recruitment warning                                                                           |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Initiate                    | F1                            | Cheap research, light Fire support, site searching                      | Two recruitment points for a narrow mage; do not let cheap gold cost hide the fort-turn cost  |
| Inquisitor                  | F1 H2, Inquisitor             | Dominion work, blessing, banishment, leadership                         | Better at religious operations than research efficiency                                       |
| Witch Hunter                | F2 S1 H1, Patrol +10          | Core researcher, communion member, Holy Pyre caster, patrol support     | Costs 260 gold and two recruitment points; field losses damage both research and war capacity |
| High Inquisitor             | F1 H3, Inquisitor             | Strong preaching, large blessings, claims, banishment                   | Capital-only and four recruitment points                                                      |
| Grand Master                | F3 S2 H2 plus FAES randoms    | High research, communion master, boosters, angels, high Fire and Astral | Capital-only, 520 gold, four recruitment points                                               |
| Architect                   | Mason, Siege +15              | Better forts, siege acceleration                                        | Capital commander turn competes directly with Grand Masters and High Inquisitors              |
| Friar                       | H1, recruitable outside forts | Cheap priest coverage and ordinary leadership                           | Not a replacement for a battle mage                                                           |
| Assassin, Scout, Troubadour | Stealth operations            | Information, commander pressure, deception                              | Outcomes are matchup dependent and can create diplomatic consequences                         |

### Reading the Grand Master random

The guaranteed random gives a nominal 25% result in Fire, Air, Earth, or Astral. The independent 10% second roll slightly raises the chance of seeing at least one chosen path to 26.875%. A double result in the same chosen path occurs only 0.625% of the time.

This produces several distinct assets:

- F4 reaches stronger Fire thresholds without a battlefield boost;
- S3 casts the first national angel ritual directly and improves Astral work;
- A1 opens Air searching and low-level utility, but it does not make Marignon a broad Air nation;
- E1 opens Earth searching and can begin an Earth booster or Summon Earthpower route;
- rare doubled results are bonuses, not requirements on which an opening should depend.

Every Grand Master should be labelled by random immediately. An unrecorded E1 or A1 roll can sit in a laboratory for years while the nation mistakenly plans around a path it believes it lacks.

### Marignon opening priorities

The opening has four simultaneous jobs:

- 1 expand with a tested infantry, crossbow, sacred, or Pretender package;
- 2 preserve enough gold and resources for the next fort;
- 3 begin recruiting Witch Hunters wherever laboratories exist;
- 4 use the capital on the scarce asset actually needed: Grand Master, Architect, High Inquisitor, or sacred cavalry.



The default capital choice is not automatically a Grand Master every month. An early Architect can create better long-term fort geometry. A High Inquisitor may be necessary for a Throne or dominion emergency. The correct capital queue follows the national bottleneck.

## Expansion packages to test

| Package                             | Intended target                             | Failure signal                                                                                       |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Armoured line plus crossbows        | Ordinary infantry and armoured independents | Fast flankers reach the crossbows or missile fire causes unacceptable friendly loss                  |
| Pikes plus supporting fire          | Large animals and cavalry                   | Small high-Defence troops ignore the length advantage and win the melee                              |
| Knight-led shock force              | Weak lines and exposed ranged troops        | Dense anti-large weapons, fatigue, or magic-resistant damage remove the expensive front              |
| Awake Pretender plus minimal escort | Rapid tempo and difficult early provinces   | The god is taking afflictions, being trapped, or delaying the economic design it was meant to enable |

No fixed troop count is presented as universal. The useful range comes from replaying the actual local independent types under the chosen scales and bless.

## Marignon research response tree

### Trunk: make Witch Hunters operational

Thaumaturgy 1  
-> Conjuraton 3  
-> Evocation 4

- Thaumaturgy 1 opens Communion Master and Communion Slave.
- Conjuraton 3 supplies Power of the Spheres for Astral casters and Phoenix Power for Fire casters.
- Evocation 4 opens the national Holy Pyre: an F2 armour-piercing area spell with a large base area, available to every Witch Hunter.

This is a real first-war package because an ordinary fort can recruit the caster. It still needs range, formation, gem, fatigue, and friendly-fire checks before battle.

### Branch A: heavier Fire and Astral fighting

Continue into Evocation 5 when Falling Fires, Stellar Cascades, or another current spell solves the observed enemy. Fire resistance can make a pure Fire branch poor. High-MR targets can reduce some Astral control packages. The army should carry at least two damage mechanisms rather than asking one school to defeat every defence.

### Branch B: protect the mundane army

Alteration 3 gives S1 Witch Hunters Body Ethereal and other defensive tools. Construction 2 and 4 open practical equipment and Earth support when the right Grand Master exists. This branch is strongest when ordinary troops are still winning contact but need help surviving the enemy's damage.

Branch C: national angel ladder

| Research      | National ritual                         | Native route                                              |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Conjuration 5 | Contact Angel of the Host, S3, 7 pearls | S3 Grand Master or an S2 caster with a named boost        |
| Conjuration 6 | Angelic Choir, S3, 15 pearls            | Same S3 route; produces three H2 flying sacred mages      |
| Conjuration 6 | Contact Harbinger, S4, 25 pearls        | Higher Astral access; supplies an A3 H2 flying commander  |
| Conjuration 7 | Heavenly Wrath, S3 F1, 35 pearls        | S3 Grand Master already meets Fire                        |
| Conjuration 7 | Angelic Host, S5, 50 pearls             | Communion, boosters, or imported access                   |
| Conjuration 9 | Heavenly Choir, S7 F2, 144 pearls       | Endgame project, not an ordinary extension of the opening |

Contact Angel of the Host is the first clean conversion point. It turns a reachable S3 Grand Master and seven pearls into a flying sacred combat body. Contact Harbinger is an access project as much as a summon: its A3 H2 path line can widen Air magic and support mobile operations.

Marignon battlefield packages

Holy Pyre battery

- protected infantry establishes contact;
- crossbows punish armour before and during contact;
- Witch Hunters cast Holy Pyre from safe range;
- an Astral package protects or controls the most important squares;
- a reserve handles fire-resistant or highly mobile targets.

The spell is national, but the formation is not automatic. Large area can punish friendly troops if the battle line collapses into the target zone.

Small communion

Use a small communion only when the path gain creates a named spell package. Count every master cast and every slave's relative path. Witch Hunters are expensive enough that disposable-slave doctrine can lose the research war even after winning one battle. [Book V](#) owns the fatigue and collapse arithmetic.

Angel-supported mobile force

Flying angels solve movement and target-access problems that ordinary heavy infantry cannot. They still need intelligence, retreat routes, and enough conventional mass to hold what they take. A seven-pearl Angel of the Host should not be traded for trivial Province Defence merely because it flies.

Marignon Pretender families

| Family                 | What it solves                                                        | What it must not conceal                                  |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Scales and path bridge | Economy, missing Nature/Death/Water/Blood/Glamour, high Astral or Air | A dormant or imprisoned bridge does not help an early war |

| Family                    | What it solves                                                | What it must not conceal                                                      |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Moderate sacred bless     | Knights and Flagellants without sacrificing the whole economy | The two sacred types have different bodies and failure modes                  |
| Awake expander            | Early tempo and difficult neutral provinces                   | Marignon already has expansion tools; the god must repay its opportunity cost |
| Angel and endgame enabler | S5-S7, stronger Air, globals, and ritual economy              | Researching the ritual is not the same as owning pearls and a safe caster     |

A durable, resistance-aware bless generally serves sacred cavalry more reliably than a narrow damage gimmick. Flagellants may value different effects because their main problem is surviving contact. The final design should test both bodies separately, including the sacred mounts.

## Marignon matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                            | Avoid                                                |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Heavy armour                  | Crossbows, great weapons, Holy Pyre, armour reduction              | Buying only more sword infantry                      |
| Fire resistance               | Astral control, mundane armour pressure, angels, imported paths    | Assuming F3-F4 automatically converts into damage    |
| Mass undead                   | Priests, H3 support, morale-safe formations, Fire where applicable | Sending expensive priests forward without screens    |
| Flyers and assassins          | Patrollers, bodyguards, dispersed command, protected mages         | One exposed communion master holding the entire plan |
| Armour destruction or fatigue | Wider spacing, ranged pressure, quicker battles, alternate troops  | Treating protection as permanent                     |
| High Magic Resistance         | Physical and Fire pressure, buffs, summons                         | Overcommitting to resistible single-target control   |

## Monthly Marignon audit

- Which capital asset is the current bottleneck?
- Is the next fort followed immediately by a laboratory and Witch Hunter queue?
- Are Grand Master randoms recorded?
- Can the first-war spell be cast by a repeatable mage?
- Does the army have a non-Fire answer?
- Are priests changing dominion where the army will actually fight?
- Are Knights of the Chalice earning more than their fort and resource cost?
- Is Conjuraton research attached to an affordable pearl budget?
- Which missing path is being solved by the Pretender, a summon, or an import?

## Marignon verification ledger

Open work remains narrow:

- 1 expansion ranges for each common independent class;
- 2 current live confirmation of the 6.35 Grand Master random display;
- 3 Holy Pyre targeting and friendly-fire formations across battlefield sizes;
- 4 small-communion fatigue budgets using Witch Hunters and Grand Masters;
- 5 angel package survival, upkeep, and return on pearl cost;
- 6 Architect timing versus repeated Grand Master recruitment;

- 7 DE and Divinitus changes kept in separate ruleset appendices.

# Part XVII: Middle Age Pyrène, Time of the Akelarre

## Pyrène one-page command brief

Pyrène combines unusually resilient human troops with mobile Air-Blood witches, blood-sacrificing priests, forest-recruitable Akerbeltz, cave recruits, and a capital sacred cavalry arm. The nation is not merely "Blood with knights." Its real advantage is distributed recruitment. Forests, caves, mountains, and ordinary forts can each add a different part of the state.

The opening should convert that geography into capacity:

- forts recruit the ordinary army, Sorginak, and Bishops;
- non-fort forests can recruit Akerbeltz;
- non-fort provinces can recruit path-random Pyrènian Monks;
- non-fort caves and the capital can recruit Bekryde scouts, leaders, and troops;
- the capital produces Emerald Knights and Emerald Counts;
- Blood and Nature then turn population, slaves, and terrain access into a growing magical economy.

The nation has clear weaknesses. Most human troops and leaders have Magic Resistance 9. The best sacred cavalry is capital-only and extremely resource intensive. Crossbows have Precision 8. Akerbeltz are expensive four-point commanders. Native Astral, Death, Water, and Glamour are absent. Air begins at A2, which is useful but does not by itself cast every famous Air spell or the national A3 ritual.

## Pyrène evidence and ruleset

The official revision-2 manual supplies the roster, national summary, and Send Aatxe. The pinned 6.35 Inspector export resolves randoms:

- Pyrènian Bishop: B1 H2 plus one guaranteed Fire, Earth, or Blood level;
- Pyrènian Monk: H1 plus one guaranteed Fire, Earth, Nature, or Blood level;
- Sorgina: fixed F1 A2 B2;
- Akerbeltz: E1 N2 B3, one guaranteed Earth, Nature, or Blood level, plus an independent 10% second roll from the same set.

These are unmodded records. Dominions Enhanced and Divinitus must be treated as separate rosters.

## Pyrène conversion chain

```
resistant infantry, crossbows, and cavalry
-> forests and caves secured during expansion
-> distributed commanders and blood hunters
-> Akerbeltz crossbreeding and Nature-Earth support
-> Sorgina Air-Blood battlefield groups
-> slave economy, blood rituals, and remote pressure
-> mobile sacred and supernatural armies
```

Pyrène can own many commanders while still lacking the right package. Distributed recruitment only becomes an advantage when every location has a declared job and the roads, laboratories, and blood-slave routes connect them.

## National body and terrain rules

The ordinary Pyrènian and Bekryde roster has partial resistance to Fire and Cold, darkvision, and broad Mountain Survival. Those traits matter most when the nation deliberately chooses terrain and opponents that make them relevant. Five points of resistance softens common elemental damage; it is not immunity to concentrated battlefield magic.

| Geographic asset               | What it can produce                  | Strategic use                                                                   |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Forest without a fort          | Akerbeltz                            | Expensive high Blood-Nature-Earth mage production outside the normal fort queue |
| Cave without a fort            | Bekryde troops, scout, and leader    | Cheap local bodies, information, and mountain-capable reinforcement             |
| Any suitable non-fort province | Pyrènian Monk                        | Distributed H1 and one random path from F/E/N/B                                 |
| Capital                        | Emerald sacred cavalry and Akerbeltz | Sacred shock force and the most reliable elite mage point                       |
| Ordinary fort                  | Main human army, Sorgina, Bishop     | Repeatable military and magic core                                              |

The extra Turmoil design limit is permission, not a command. Blood hunting, expensive commanders, forts, and knights still depend on population and gold. A high-Turmoil design needs a clear compensating engine rather than assuming national flavour makes lost income harmless.

## Pyrène roster by job

| Unit                        | Best job                                           | Important limit                                                                       |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bekryde and Bekryde Warrior | Cheap cave and mountain-capable line or siege mass | Low MR and light armour; local availability controls scale                            |
| Pyrènian Crossbowman        | Armour pressure behind a screen                    | Precision 8 and ordinary protection                                                   |
| Pyrènian Spearman           | Shielded line and general frontage                 | Ordinary damage and MR 9                                                              |
| Pyrènian Footman            | Higher-Defence shielded line                       | Armour and Encumbrance can become a fatigue problem                                   |
| Pyrènian Swordsman          | High-damage heavy infantry                         | No shield and modest Defence                                                          |
| Pyrènian Man at Arms        | Better-quality line                                | Higher gold, resources, and recruitment points                                        |
| Pyrènian Knight             | Mobile shock and reserve                           | Expensive and still MR 9 on the rider                                                 |
| Emerald Knight              | Capital sacred cavalry                             | Seventy gold, forty resources, thirty-one recruitment points, and capital competition |

The sacred mouflon is a separate component with strong armour, Mountain Survival, and Cold Resistance. Its low Magic Resistance remains relevant against effects that can target the mount. [Book IV's](#) mounted rules should be applied to both rider and animal.

## Pyrène commander and mage portfolio

| Commander       | Paths or ability     | Main jobs                                                | Recruitment warning                               |
|-----------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Pyrènian Bishop | B1 H2 + F/E/B random | Blood sacrifice, hunting, priest support, low-path magic | Two recruitment points; record random immediately |

| Commander                             | Paths or ability                                            | Main jobs                                                      | Recruitment warning                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sorgina                               | F1 A2 B2, flying, Storm Immune                              | Blood hunting, Air and Fire battle magic, mobile reinforcement | Costs 260 gold; mass recruitment can consume the whole research and fort budget                           |
| Akerbeltz                             | E1 N2 B3 + E/N/B random, Blood Searcher 1, Cross Breeder +4 | Blood economy, Cross Breeding, Nature-Earth support, searching | 450 gold, four recruitment points; forests need protection and logistics                                  |
| Pyrènian Monk                         | H1 + F/E/N/B random, non-fort recruitment                   | Distributed research, searching, rituals, preaching            | Slow recruitment and modest research efficiency; use the roll rather than collecting them without purpose |
| Emerald Count                         | Sacred H1 cavalry leader                                    | Sacred command and mobile priest support                       | Capital-only, two recruitment points                                                                      |
| Castellan, Marquess, Bekryde Champion | Mundane leadership                                          | Main army, cavalry, and cave command                           | Pick leadership for the actual force instead of paying for unused armour or mobility                      |

## Random-path consequences

A guaranteed one-in-three Bishop random creates F1B1H2, E1B1H2, or B2H2. This gives every ordinary fort a predictable portfolio after several recruits, but it does not guarantee the required result on the first month.

The Monk's one-in-four random is valuable because recruitment is geographically distributed. F1, E1, N1, and B1 results cover searching and minor rituals without using a fort. The trade is speed: a province producing a Monk is not producing another special commander that month, and the mage still needs a laboratory for most magic work.

The Akerbeltz guaranteed random produces E2, N3, or B4 before the 10% roll is considered. Each result changes its best job:

- E2 can use Summon Earthpower to reach higher battlefield Earth thresholds;
- N3 opens stronger Nature support and searching;
- B4 accelerates high Blood rituals;
- the rare second roll may deepen or mix these roles, but no opening should require it.

## Blood economy without self-destruction

Pyrène has unusually broad access to hunters: Sorginak are B2, Bishops are at least B1, and Akerbeltz are B3 with Blood Searcher 1. That does not mean every mage should hunt.

A working blood province needs:

- enough population to survive the intended hunting period;
- hunters whose slave return exceeds their lost research or battle work;
- unrest control and patrollers;
- a laboratory or a reliable slave-transfer route;
- protection against raids and assassins;
- a declared use for the slaves.

Akerbeltz are excellent hunters but expensive researchers, ritualists, searchers, and crossbreeders. Using every one as a hunter can waste the very path breadth that makes them special. Bishops and Sorginak often provide the scalable hunting layer while selected Akerbeltz handle the difficult Blood, Nature, or Earth jobs.

Blood sacrifice should be budgeted separately. Slaves spent on dominion are not available for rituals or battle. The sacrifice is worthwhile when it changes a real dominion contest, sacred operation, or victory condition.

## Pyrène opening priorities

- 1 Test the local independent types against shielded infantry, crossbows, knights, or the Pretender.
- 2 Identify every reachable forest and cave before deciding the first fort route.
- 3 Recruit enough Sorginak and Bishops to start research and a controlled blood economy.
- 4 Use forests for Akerbeltz only when the province can be defended and connected.
- 5 Keep capital resources from being consumed by Emerald Knights when infrastructure is the actual bottleneck.

## Expansion packages to test

| Package                      | Intended target                                  | Failure signal                                                      |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Shielded foot plus crossbows | Ordinary infantry and armour                     | Precision and friendly fire erase the value of the ranged line      |
| Heavy foot                   | Low-damage opponents                             | Fatigue, armour-piercing weapons, or magic overwhelms protection    |
| Pyrènian Knights             | Weak lines and exposed ranged troops             | Anti-large weapons or MR attacks trade too efficiently              |
| Emerald Knights              | Important high-value provinces                   | Capital production and resources fall behind the economic timetable |
| Awake Pretender              | Difficult early targets and fast terrain capture | The design duplicates jobs the national roster already performs     |

## Pyrène research response tree

### Trunk: establish Blood and practical equipment

Blood 1  
-> Blood 3  
-> Construction 2 or 4

Early Blood research should lead to a named slave use. Blood 3 is especially important for Cross Breeding, because Akerbeltz carry Adept Cross Breeder +4. Construction opens tools for hunters, commanders, and battlefield specialists. The exact order changes when war demands an immediate Air, Earth, or Nature spell.

### Branch A: Sorgina battlefield magic

Evocation 2 and later Air research gives the fixed A2 Sorgina a repeatable damage role. A2 is not A3. Storm, the national Send Aatxe ritual, and several famous Air breakpoints require a real route to A3 or higher. A Pretender, hero, empowerment, booster chain, or later summon must own that bridge. Storm Power can raise a mage during an existing storm; it does not solve who created the first storm.



## Branch B: Akerbeltz Earth and Nature

Conjuration 3 lets E2 Akerbeltz use Summon Earthpower and makes several elemental routes practical. Alteration and Enchantment then provide protection, armour reduction, regeneration, poison, or control according to the actual random and target. Do not research N3 or E3 packages until the matching random has been recorded or a reliable bridge exists.

## Branch C: blood battlefield and ritual pressure

Blood research should be advanced in steps attached to a current army or strategic ritual, not rushed as one uninterrupted school. The nation can support Sabbath structures through Blood, but [Book V's](#) communion correction ledger applies: master throughput, slave paths, gem use, and collapse must be budgeted. A large slave stock is not permission to use an untested communion.

## Branch D: Send Aatxe

The national ritual is Conjuration 6, A3, costs six Air gems, has range four, is anonymous, and cannot be cast underwater. Native Sorginak stop at A2. The research target therefore becomes real only after the A3 caster route is written down. If that route exists, the ritual gives Pyrène a cheap remote pressure tool; if it does not, Conjuration 6 alone delivers nothing.

# Pyrène battlefield packages

## Resistant human line

Pyrènian infantry can absorb modest Fire and Cold better than ordinary humans. Add shields, spacing, and the right troop type before adding magic. The resistance is a margin that makes some trades favourable, not a reason to stand inside full battlefield elemental damage.

## Sorgina strike group

Flying, Storm-Immune F1 A2 B2 mages can reposition rapidly and join selected battles. Their scripts should use reachable A2, F1, or Blood effects and preserve a retreat route. Flying mobility does not protect a 10-HP human body from arrows, assassins, or a collapsed screen.

## Akerbeltz crossbreeding economy

Cross Breeding converts Blood slaves and an Akerbeltz turn into variable bodies. The +4 national specialist bonus makes Pyrène unusually suited to the system, but the output remains a portfolio rather than a guaranteed army type. Record batches, costs, useful results, leadership burden, and attrition before assigning a fixed strategic value.

## Sacred mouflon force

Emerald Knights offer protection, mobility, Mountain Survival, and a sacred mount. They are scarce enough that the bless should improve survival and role reliability. The package still needs magic resistance, fatigue control, and answers to anti-large weapons. A sacred cavalry army that cannot replace losses is a finite resource.

## Pyrène Pretender families

| Family                   | What it solves                                                       | What it must not conceal                                            |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Air bridge               | A3+ for Storm, Send Aatxe, stronger Air, and battlefield transitions | The caster still needs research, gems, safety, and timing           |
| Astral or Death import   | Missing strategic paths, resistance magic, summons, and communions   | Imported access may remain tied to one irreplaceable god            |
| Scales and blood economy | Gold, forts, laboratories, population, and recovery from hunting     | Turmoil or Death choices can undermine the population base          |
| Moderate cavalry bless   | Emerald Knights and mounts                                           | Sacred production is capital and resource limited                   |
| Awake expander           | Rapid forests, caves, and chokepoints                                | National infantry and knights may already handle ordinary expansion |

The most valuable design often solves a missing system rather than adding more Fire, Nature, or Blood to paths already available. Air, Astral, Death, Water, or a specific global route can change the whole national tree.

## Pyrène matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                  | First answer to examine                                                         | Avoid                                                                   |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| High-MR attacks against troops | Bufs, screening, summons, imported Astral, shorter exposure                     | Assuming armour protects MR 9 infantry                                  |
| Fire or Cold warfare           | National resistance plus additional buffs and spacing                           | Treating resistance 5 as immunity                                       |
| Heavy armour                   | Crossbows, great swords, Earth armour reduction, Blood or summoned alternatives | Relying on low-Precision crossbows without enough volume and protection |
| Fast raiders                   | Flying Sorgina reserve, cave and forest scouts, local commanders                | Leaving blood provinces and forest mages undefended                     |
| Battlefield-wide Air           | Storm immunity on Sorginak, shock resistance plans, dispersed command           | Extending a mage's immunity to the whole army                           |
| Population pressure            | Rotate hunting, control unrest, move the blood centre                           | Continuing to hunt a province after its long-term value collapses       |

## Monthly Pyrène audit

- Which forests and caves are producing something that no ordinary fort can?
- Are blood hunters separated from battle mages and researchers?
- What are the current slave income, stock, and committed uses?
- Are Bishop, Monk, and Akerbeltz randoms recorded?
- Does the active research target have a real caster?
- Who reaches A3 for Storm or Send Aatxe?
- Is the sacred cavalry queue delaying forts or mages?
- Are MR 9 troops being sent into a counter they cannot armour through?
- Can every distributed recruitment province be reinforced or evacuated?

## Pyrène verification ledger

The next useful tests are:

- 1 expansion ranges for shielded foot, crossbows, Pyrènian Knights, and Emerald Knights;
- 2 current live confirmation of Bishop, Monk, and Akerbeltz random displays;
- 3 Blood Searcher 1 returns across population and unrest bands;
- 4 Cross Breeder +4 outcome records across a versioned sample;
- 5 Air transition packages before and after a real A3 bridge;
- 6 sacred rider and mouflon survival under MR and anti-large attacks;
- 7 distributed-recruitment payback from forests and caves;
- 8 DE and Divinitus variants kept separate from this unmodded dossier.

# Part XVIII: Middle Age Ulm, Forges of Ulm

## Ulm one-page command brief

Middle Age Ulm converts resources into heavily armoured human armies, then uses recruit-anywhere Master Smiths to turn a narrow Earth and Fire base into battlefield support and forged equipment. Its forts receive 25% more resources, its smiths add local resources, and its capital produces five Earth gems each month. The result is a nation whose military and magical economies reinforce one another when forts, laboratories, troop production, and smith recruitment stay in balance.

The reliable core is compact:

- half plate offers more bodies when resources are tight;
- black plate offers exceptional mundane protection at a steep resource cost;
- pikes, shields, great weapons, flails, crossbows, and cavalry let the roster answer different physical targets;
- Sappers and Master Masons turn recruitment into siege pressure and stronger fort construction;
- Master Smiths provide fixed F1 E2, research unaffected by Drain, Forge Bonus 2, and a 20% FAES random;
- capital Priest Smiths combine F1 E2 H1 with Forge Bonus 1;
- Black Priests provide E1 H2, Inquisition, and a smaller FAES random;
- national spells add cold-iron missiles, army-wide magic-resistance support, and a late Iron Angel ritual;
- national items give Construction a strategic branch with defined jobs.

Ulm's weaknesses are equally structural. Most soldiers and mundane commanders have MR 9. The roster is slow, resource hungry, and vulnerable to attacks that bypass armour. Native magic has no dependable Water, Death, Nature, Glamour, or Blood, while Air and Astral appear only on rare randoms. Heavy recruitment can also consume the gold and resources needed to build the fort network that makes the nation scale.

## Ulm evidence and ruleset

The scope is unmodded MA Ulm on the [Book I](#) 6.36 live baseline. The roster, costs, and national summary are taken from the revision-2 official manual. Random-path masks, capital sites, national spells, national items, and object identifiers are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

The two sources have different jobs. The current manual controls the player-facing roster and national rules. The pinned export resolves fields that the manual compresses or omits. Opening priorities, research branches, battlefield packages, Pretender families, and matchup choices are strategy. No live-game result is inferred from a database field when targeting, timing, stacking, or displayed cost requires engine observation.

## Ulm conversion chain

enhanced fort resources and weapon-specific infantry  
 -> reliable expansion and protected borders  
 -> additional forts and laboratories  
 -> repeatable Master Smith recruitment  
 -> Earth buffs, national priest magic, and discounted forging  
 -> specialised armies, siege columns, and imported path access  
 -> fortified territorial gains and late ritual options

The chain commonly breaks in three places. Full black plate and cavalry can absorb the resources meant for expansion volume. Troop recruitment can absorb the gold meant for forts and laboratories. Smiths can be treated as generic researchers, leaving rare Air, Earth, Fire, or Astral results unlabelled and the matching spell branches unused.

## Ulm national rules that shape the plan

| Rule or asset                                    | Operational consequence                                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Forts produce 25% more resources                 | Fort placement has military value beyond recruitment access; high-resource provinces become especially useful production centres.                                  |
| Productivity limit +1                            | The Pretender design may buy more Production than an ordinary nation, but the extra scale is useful only if gold and recruitment points can consume the resources. |
| Drain limit +1                                   | Ulm may take deeper Drain, and smith researchers are unhindered by it. Non-immune researchers and other magic consequences still need to be counted.               |
| Master Smith and Priest Smith Resource Bonus +10 | A recruited smith improves the province's troop capacity while serving as researcher, forger, or caster.                                                           |
| Master Mason                                     | The capital can produce a Mason with Siege +30 and Castle Defence +20 in the structured record; its construction job competes with other capital recruitment.      |
| Capital Earth income                             | The Forges of Ulm site supplies five Earth gems each month, supporting Earth rituals, battlefield gems, and forging.                                               |
| Weak priesthood with Inquisitors                 | Black Acolytes supply H1, while capital Black Priests supply H2 and Inquisition. Religious operations remain concentrated in the capital queue.                    |
| Superior armour and national forging             | Mundane protection is a real advantage, but armour does not answer magic resistance attacks, fatigue, armour destruction, or armour-negating damage.               |

The resource bonuses reward a distributed production network. They do not remove the gold cost of that network. A province that can recruit another block of black plate but cannot fund a laboratory, commander, or next fort may be producing the wrong asset for the current turn.

## Ulm roster by job

| Unit group                        | Best job                                                                                          | Important limit                                                                          |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| War Dog                           | Cheap armoured screening, flanking pressure, and pursuit                                          | Low HP and MR; animal leadership and losses must be managed                              |
| Infantry of Ulm in half plate     | Resource-efficient line mass with shield, flail, hammer, maul, morningstar, or battleaxe variants | Protection is lower than black plate, and the correct weapon still depends on the target |
| Black Plate Infantry              | High-protection line, bodyguard-quality mass, and attritional holding                             | Much higher resource cost, ordinary MR, low battlefield speed, and fatigue exposure      |
| Pikeneer and Black Plate Pikeneer | Long-weapon line against large units, cavalry, and repel-sensitive attackers                      | No shield and limited value when weapon length or armour does not solve the matchup      |
| Crossbowman                       | Arbalest pressure against armoured targets from behind a screen                                   | Slow rate of fire, ordinary precision, and friendly-fire risk                            |
| Sapper                            | Siege strength, crossbow support, and campaign utility                                            | Twenty gold and high recruitment-point demand make it a specialist, not default infantry |
| Guardian                          | Capital-only elite infantry with a Black Halberd                                                  | Capital restriction, high resources, and high recruitment-point demand limit mass        |
| Black Knight                      | Armoured shock cavalry, flank threat, and mobile reserve                                          | Sixty gold, heavy resource demand, MR 9, and separate rider-and-mount failure modes      |

Ulm should select armour and weapon by job. Half plate increases numbers when the resource ceiling matters. Full black plate increases protection when conventional weapons are the threat. Shields matter under missile pressure. Great weapons and the Black Halberd matter when damage and armour penetration are more important than defence. Flails matter against shields. Pikes matter against large targets and for repel interactions. None is the universal Ulmish infantry.

### The armour budget

The useful recruitment question is whether black plate's extra resources prevent another soldier, crossbowman, fort, or specialist from being produced on the required turn. A mixed formation can place the most protected troops where contact is expected and use cheaper armour where frontage matters more than individual survival.

The same rule governs Black Knights. Their charge, protection, and mobility can solve a battle that infantry cannot reach in time. Buying them as ordinary line troops turns a resource advantage into a narrow and expensive queue.

## Ulm commander and mage portfolio

| Commander                 | Paths or ability                                     | Main jobs                                                | Recruitment warning                                                                        |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Commander of Ulm variants | Mundane leadership with different armour and weapons | Low-cost army command matched to the troop package       | MR 9 and no magic utility; full black plate increases resource cost                        |
| Black Lord                | Heavy cavalry commander, Leadership 100              | Mobile command, armoured reserve, and battle leadership  | Expensive and still MR 9                                                                   |
| Spy                       | Stealth 60, Spy                                      | Information, unrest reporting, and enemy-strength checks | Intelligence quality depends on position and time; it does not replace scouting or scrying |

| Commander     | Paths or ability                                          | Main jobs                                                                     | Recruitment warning                                                           |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Black Acolyte | H1                                                        | Blessing, preaching, light religious support                                  | Narrow role and no Earth path for the national priest spells                  |
| Master Smith  | F1 E2, 20% FAES random, Forge Bonus 2, Resource Bonus +10 | Core research, Earth support, forging, site searching, and rare-path branches | Two recruitment points; rare paths are each only 5%                           |
| Master Mason  | Mason, Siege +30                                          | Better fort construction, siege and fort defence                              | Capital-only commander turn                                                   |
| Lord Guardian | Halt Heretic +3, Leadership 100                           | Capital defence, leadership, and hostile-dominion pressure                    | Capital-only and not a mage                                                   |
| Black Priest  | E1 H2, Inquisitor, 10% FAES random                        | National priest spells, preaching, Inquisition, and rare-path utility         | Capital-only, two recruitment points, and no forge bonus in the pinned record |
| Priest Smith  | F1 E2 H1, Forge Bonus 1, Resource Bonus +10               | Fixed-path national priest magic, research, Earth support, and forging        | Capital-only, 245 gold, and two recruitment points                            |

The normal fort queue should be read as a capacity decision. Master Smiths are the repeatable magical engine. Mundane commanders move the troops that engine supports. The capital must choose among religious access, Mason infrastructure, elite commanders, and ordinary fort recruits; it should not be assigned one permanent queue without reference to the current bottleneck.

## Reading the smith randoms

### Master Smith distribution

The pinned record gives every Master Smith fixed F1 E2 and a 20% chance of one additional level chosen equally from Fire, Air, Earth, or Astral.

| Final paths | Probability per recruitment |
|-------------|-----------------------------|
| F1 E2       | 80%                         |
| F2 E2       | 5%                          |
| F1 A1 E2    | 5%                          |
| F1 E3       | 5%                          |
| F1 E2 S1    | 5%                          |

The chance of recruiting at least one named rare path after  $n$  independent Master Smiths is  $1 - 0.95^n$ . That is about 51.2% after 14 recruits, 64.2% after 20, and 90.1% after 45. Twenty recruits are an average waiting time for a named 5% result, not a guarantee. A plan that requires A1, S1, F2, or E3 on a fixed early turn needs a backup.

### Black Priest distribution

The capital-only Black Priest has fixed E1 H2 and a 10% chance of one FAES level. The four named rare results are 2.5% each.

| Final paths | Probability per recruitment |
|-------------|-----------------------------|
| E1 H2       | 90%                         |
| F1 E1 H2    | 2.5%                        |

| Final paths | Probability per recruitment |
|-------------|-----------------------------|
| A1 E1 H2    | 2.5%                        |
| E2 H2       | 2.5%                        |
| E1 S1 H2    | 2.5%                        |

The Priest Smith is not a random-path substitute. It has fixed F1 E2 H1, so it supplies dependable access to Iron Darts and Iron Blizzard but never becomes the rare Air or Astral result by repeated recruitment.

Every smith and Black Priest should be labelled when recruited. The label should record paths, home fort, current job, and whether the unit is reserved for a threshold spell, searching route, or forge chain. Rare paths lose strategic value when they disappear into an undifferentiated research stack.

National spells and the caster who owns them

| Spell              | School and requirement              | Native caster                                                                  | Planning use and boundary                                                                                                                                                          |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Iron Darts         | Evocation 3, E1 H1                  | Black Priest or Priest Smith                                                   | Low-fatigue national cold-iron missiles. The source describes special value against magical beings; formation, target selection, and actual damage still belong to battle context. |
| Tempering the Will | Thaumaturgy 5, E3                   | Master Smith or Priest Smith after Summon Earthpower; E3 Master Smith directly | National battlefield magic-resistance support. It addresses a central roster weakness but does not make MR 9 troops immune to hostile magic.                                       |
| Iron Blizzard      | Evocation 6, E1 H1                  | Black Priest or Priest Smith                                                   | A larger national cold-iron missile package with much higher fatigue. Caster count, range, fatigue recovery, and friendly-fire exposure determine whether it is worth fielding.    |
| Contact Iron Angel | Conjuration 8, E5 S2, 25 Earth gems | No unassisted recruit                                                          | Late summon with high MR and Halt Heretic. Research alone does not create the E5 S2 caster; the exact booster, empowerment, summon, or Pretender route must be owned first.        |

This table distinguishes research access from caster access. Ulm can research Contact Iron Angel while still lacking any legal caster. Conversely, every normal fort can recruit the E2 smith who reaches E3 in battle through Summon Earthpower, so Tempering the Will has a much more dependable delivery route.

National item portfolio

The pinned item register separates Ulm's items into discounted designs and a restricted design. The distinction matters. A national rebate changes cost for Ulm; a restriction changes who may forge the item. [Book V](#) owns the general forging rules and the unresolved stacking ledger.

## Early discounted blacksteel

Construction 1 opens the Blacksteel Sword, Blacksteel Tower Shield, Blacksteel Kite Shield, Blacksteel Helmet, Blacksteel Plate, and Blacksteel Full Plate. Most require E1; the full plate requires E2. These items let an ordinary Master Smith equip thugs, commanders, and specialists from the nation's native Earth income.

The item card should decide whether a piece solves the actual failure. More protection is useful against conventional weapons. It does not repair low MR, fatigue, elemental vulnerability, or command problems. A tower shield, kite shield, weapon, helmet, and full plate also compete for slots with non-national answers.

## Later national equipment

| Item               | Construction and paths | Evidence-backed role                                                                         |
|--------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Black Halberd      | Construction 3, E1     | Restricted to MA and LA Ulm in the pinned record; a national two-handed weapon option        |
| Blacksteel Barding | Construction 3, E2     | Discounted national mount armour                                                             |
| The Copper Arm     | Construction 7, E3 F1  | Discounted cursed item that grants extra arms; use requires a complete chassis and slot plan |
| Krupp's Bracers    | Construction 9, E2     | Discounted artifact-tier reinvigoration item                                                 |

Master Smith Forge Bonus 2, Priest Smith Forge Bonus 1, national rebates, global forge modifiers, and integer rounding can interact. The final gem price remains unresolved. The live forge screen is the operational authority until the current stacking order is supported by a versioned observation record.

## Ulm opening priorities

The opening has five linked jobs:

- 1 identify whether resources, gold, commander turns, or recruitment points are the immediate ceiling;
- 2 recruit the armour-and-weapon mix that answers the local independent provinces;
- 3 reserve the gold needed for the next fort and laboratory;
- 4 start a repeatable Master Smith pipeline without leaving armies leaderless;
- 5 preserve enough capital flexibility for a Mason, Priest Smith, Black Priest, Lord Guardian, or Guardian block when its specialised job becomes real.

A safe default is a protected infantry line with arbalest support, adjusted for the target. Pike weight rises against large units and cavalry. Great weapons rise against protection. Shields rise against missiles. Half plate rises when resource-limited frontage matters. Black plate rises when ordinary weapon damage is the main threat and the production centre can sustain it.

## Expansion packages to evaluate from reports

| Package                        | Intended target                                  | Failure signal                                                                |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Half-plate line plus crossbows | Ordinary infantry and armoured independents      | The line collapses before the slow ranged damage pays back                    |
| Shielded black-plate line      | Missile-heavy or conventional melee provinces    | Resources produce too few bodies, or fatigue defeats the protection advantage |
| Pikes with protected flanks    | Cavalry, large animals, and long-weapon matchups | Small high-Defence troops close safely and win the sustained melee            |



| Package               | Intended target                                                      | Failure signal                                                                                      |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Great-weapon infantry | High-protection targets                                              | Low Defence, missiles, or first-strike losses remove the damage dealers                             |
| Black Knight reserve  | Weak flanks, exposed ranged troops, and time-sensitive reinforcement | Anti-large weapons, armour-negating damage, or attrition consume an irreplaceably expensive package |

These are decision templates, not published expansion counts. Exact party sizes remain open because the map, scales, formations, commander, independent type, and combat rolls change the answer. No new runtime test preparation is required to use the dossier's economic and matchup logic.

## Ulm research response tree

### Trunk: make fixed E2 recruitment useful

Enchantment 1  
-> Construction 2  
-> Conjuraction 3

- Enchantment 1 gives Strength of Giants to fixed E2 smiths.
- Construction 2 gives Temper Armors and completes the first ordinary equipment tier.
- Conjuraction 3 gives Summon Earthpower, raising an E2 smith to E3 during battle.

This is a capacity trunk, not a mandatory order. An immediate armoured enemy may justify Alteration. Magical beings may justify early Iron Darts. A fort network that needs equipment may value Construction first. Every research choice should name the current caster, army, and expected deployment turn.

### Branch A: Earth control and armour reduction

Alteration 3 gives Earth Meld to E2. Alteration 4 gives Destruction to an E3 caster, which an ordinary Master Smith can reach after Summon Earthpower. Alteration 5 adds Maws of the Earth for E3 and a gem. Later Marble Warriors and Iron Warriors strengthen protection packages, but their caster thresholds, fatigue, and exposure must be scheduled with the army.

This branch is strongest when conventional Ulmish damage is losing to protection or when the line needs Earth control to keep enemies in the kill zone. It is weaker when the enemy ignores armour, attacks MR, or forces the smiths to move too far from the troops they support.

### Branch B: national priest missiles and MR support

Evocation 3 opens Iron Darts for Black Priests and Priest Smiths. Thaumaturgy 5 opens Tempering the Will for E3. Evocation 6 opens Iron Blizzard. The first branch is capital-caster limited even when the research is cheap; the second can be delivered by repeatable E2 smiths after Summon Earthpower.

Do not read the national spell list as one automatic queue. Iron Darts and Iron Blizzard are most attractive when their cold-iron profile and ranged delivery solve the observed target. Tempering the Will is most attractive when hostile MR checks threaten expensive low-MR soldiers.

## Branch C: broad Earth force multiplication

Enchantment 5 gives Weapons of Sharpness to E3. Construction 6 gives Legions of Steel to E4 and a gem. An E3-random Master Smith reaches E4 through Summon Earthpower; ordinary E2 smiths need another real step. High Earth rituals such as Riches from Beneath, Forge of the Ancients, and Earth Blood Deep Well are planning endpoints, not native guarantees. Their E5 or E6 caster and large gem cost must be built before the research can pay back.

## Branch D: rare Fire, Air, and Astral results

- An F2 Master Smith can cast Phoenix Power and reach F3 for stronger Fire battle magic such as Falling Fires or Summon Fire Elemental.
- An A1 Master Smith can combine Air with the fixed Earth base. After Summon Earthpower it reaches E3 A1, including the path threshold for Rain of Stones; that spell's danger to Ulm's own human army makes delivery and protection part of the package.
- An S1 Master Smith opens basic Astral searching and utility, but S1 is not a communion engine or the S2 half of Contact Iron Angel by itself.
- An E3 Master Smith reaches E4 through Summon Earthpower and owns thresholds that ordinary smiths do not.

These are portfolio branches. Researching one before recruiting the matching 5% result converts certainty into hope. Record the rare mage first, then select the branch.

## Ulm battlefield packages

### Armoured line with Earth support

A mundane commander moves the infantry while one or more Master Smiths supply reachable buffs. The screen's armour and weapon are selected from the enemy report. Smiths stand far enough back to survive but close enough for the spell's real area and range. Adding more spells is not automatically safer: fatigue, script length, and a broken line can turn valuable researchers into casualties.

### Priest Smith cold-iron cell

A Priest Smith combines the paths for Iron Darts or Iron Blizzard with forging and E2 support. Black Priests can cast the same national missiles and bring H2 Inquisition. The cell requires a protected firing lane and an enemy for whom the missile profile matters. Against dispersed, resistant, or rapidly closing targets, the capital mage turn may be more valuable elsewhere.

### Rare-path specialist cell

An F2, A1, E3, or S1 Master Smith is paired with the troop package and research that use that exact result. The unit receives a permanent label and a retreat plan. Rare access should not be risked merely because the spell list permits a dramatic script.

### Siege column

Sappers provide Siege +5, while Master Masons provide Siege +30 and improve fort construction. Ordinary infantry supply bodies. This lets Ulm convert a production advantage into campaign tempo instead of leaving a victorious heavy army stalled at a wall. The column still needs scouts, supply, leadership, and protection against relief armies.

## Ulm Pretender families

| Family                          | What it solves                                                                                | What it must not conceal                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Production and economy          | Converts the fort resource bonus into larger armoured queues and supports more infrastructure | Extra resources do not pay gold, recruitment points, or commander turns                                   |
| Missing-path bridge             | Imports Water, Death, Nature, Glamour, Blood, dependable Air, or dependable Astral            | One god is not a distributed national path; site searching, boosters, and replacement access still matter |
| High Earth-Astral ritual bridge | Builds toward Contact Iron Angel or other late rituals                                        | E5 S2, research, gems, and opportunity cost must all be explicit                                          |
| Resistance or mobility design   | Covers shock, cold, poison, MR, map-move, or another identified roster weakness               | A bless affects sacred recipients, while most Ulmish troops are mundane                                   |
| Awake expander                  | Adds early tempo where armoured troops cannot secure the required map                         | Afflictions, path design, and lost scales can cost more than the provinces gained                         |

Ulm often benefits more from a missing system than from another level in paths it already recruits. The design should name the first site-search target, booster, ritual, battlefield job, and replacement plan for every imported path. A theoretical late spell is not a reason to weaken the entire opening unless its access chain is credible.

## Ulm matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                            | First answer to examine                                                                            | Avoid                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Heavy conventional armour                | Great weapons, Black Halberds, Destruction, Maws of the Earth, and crossbow concentration          | Paying for maximum protection while using damage that cannot penetrate the target     |
| High-Defence or shielded troops          | Flails, longer weapons, attack support, control, and more frontage                                 | Assuming protection fixes missed attacks                                              |
| MR attacks and mind magic                | Tempering the Will, imported Astral, resistance equipment, summons, spacing, and shorter exposure  | Treating black plate as protection against MR checks                                  |
| Armour-negating or armour-piercing magic | Dispersal, resistance, ranged pressure, summons, and attacks on the caster                         | Concentrating expensive slow troops inside the effect                                 |
| Fatigue and armour destruction           | Mixed armour weights, shorter fights, reinvigoration, reserves, and counter-caster pressure        | Increasing armour without addressing the mechanism defeating it                       |
| Flyers and fast raiders                  | Guarded smiths, protected rear formations, local commanders, forts, and spies                      | Leaving the research and forging stack as an exposed single point of failure          |
| Magical beings                           | Iron Darts or Iron Blizzard when the national profile fits, plus ordinary Earth and weapon answers | Assuming the national label guarantees favourable targeting or damage in every battle |
| Large units and cavalry                  | Pikes, layered formations, Earth control, and concentrated missile fire                            | Exposing unshielded pikes to the wrong ranged matchup                                 |
| Strategic mobility                       | Fort geometry, forward laboratories, mounted command, prepared reserves, and imported mobility     | Expecting slow heavy infantry to answer every raid after it appears                   |

## Monthly Ulm audit

- Which production centre is limited by resources, and which is limited by gold or recruitment points?
- Is half plate or black plate the correct marginal purchase for the current enemy?
- Are crossbows protected and assigned a target worth their slow rate of fire?
- Does every field army have a commander whose movement and leadership fit it?
- Are Master Smith randoms labelled at recruitment?
- Does the active research target have a named caster and deployment turn?
- Are Earth gems divided among battlefield use, forging, and rituals before spending begins?
- Is the capital queue solving a real religious, Mason, elite, or command bottleneck?
- Does the next fort improve recruitment geometry, resource conversion, or strategic defence?
- Is low MR being answered before the army meets mind or soul attacks?
- Are rare-path smiths protected from assassination, raiding, and routine frontline risk?
- Is a late ritual route supported by actual paths, research, and gems?

## Ulm unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier deliberately leaves the following claims open:

- 1 exact expansion-party ranges for each armour and weapon mix;
- 2 live 6.36 display confirmation of the pinned Master Smith and Black Priest random masks;
- 3 final displayed item costs when national rebate, Forge Bonus, global modifiers, and rounding combine;
- 4 Iron Darts and Iron Blizzard targeting, friendly-fire, and damage outcomes in specific formations;
- 5 Tempering the Will's exact battlefield application against current MR attack types;
- 6 the economic break-even point for Sappers, Master Masons, and stronger forts on different maps;
- 7 reliable routes and payback for Contact Iron Angel and the larger Earth globals;
- 8 rider-and-mount survival outcomes for Black Knights under different attack types;
- 9 modded Ulm variants, which remain separate from this unmodded chapter.

These are preserved as unresolved claims, not converted into new test assets or guessed conclusions. R-047, R-058, and the broader runtime-testing queue remain parked until hands-on testing is explicitly resumed.

# Part XIX: Middle Age Man, Tower of Avalon

## Man one-page command brief

Middle Age Man turns several modest recruitment pools into a flexible human army. Ordinary forts supply longbows, infantry, cavalry, scouts, spies, priests, and three levels of Avalon mage. Forests add Foresters and Royal Foresters, while non-fort provinces can raise Logrian troops, Monks, and Logrian Wise Men. The capital adds the sacred Wardens and Knights of Avalon, their commanders, and the Crone of Avalon.

The reliable core is easy to state:

- Longbowmen provide accurate, long-ranged mundane fire behind a line chosen for the target;
- Knights of Man give every fort a heavily armoured mobile recruit;
- Wardens and Knights of Avalon are powerful sacred capital troops, but their price and limited queue keep them scarce;

- Monks spread cheap H1 research beyond the main mage forts;
- Bards, Daughters, Mothers, and Crones are Spell singers with fixed Glamour access;
- Mothers provide the repeatable random portfolio, while capital Crones start at N3 G2 H1;
- Logrian Wise Men recruit outside forts and add low Earth plus Fire, Air, Earth, or Nature branches;
- the Forest and Tower of Avalon supply three Nature and two Glamour gems each month.

Man can recruit many different answers, but it cannot pay for all of them at once. Mothers cost 305 gold, capital Crones cost 465 gold and four commander recruitment points, Knights of Man cost 45 gold and 32 resources, and Knights of Avalon cost 90 gold and 32 resources. A plan that spends on every elite option can delay the forts and laboratories that make the roster useful.

## Man evidence and ruleset

The scope is unmodded MA Man on the [Book I 6.36](#) live baseline. The revision-2 official manual controls the player-facing roster, costs, recruitment locations, national summary, communion description, spells, and rituals. Random masks, object identifiers, capital sites, hero records, and nation restrictions are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

The official 6.13 patch changed the Forest of Avalon from a +2 Magic increase to its intended +1. That correction is applied here. The patch ledger through 6.36 names no later MA Man roster or national-spell change, but the older structured snapshot is still labelled 6.35. A live display remains the final authority where the manual compresses a random scheme or the database carries a hidden casting restriction.

## Man conversion chain

longbows, infantry, and ordinary knights  
-> secure provinces and useful forests  
-> forts, laboratories, and distributed recruitment  
-> Monks, Spell singers, Mothers, and Logrian Wise Men  
-> Chorus, Nature-Glamour support, and national summons  
-> specialised field armies and imported missing paths  
-> protected territory, sieges, and Throne operations

The chain tends to break at three points. Gold-heavy mages and cavalry can delay the next fort. The capital commander queue can be consumed by Crones before the army has enough leaders. Random Mothers and Wise Men can disappear into research without being labelled for the spell or forge branch their paths opened.

## Man national rules that shape the plan

| Rule or asset                         | Operational consequence                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Standard forts                        | Man needs an ordinary fort-and-laboratory budget; terrain recruitment supplements the network but does not replace it.                                       |
| Temples cost 300 gold                 | Religious infrastructure is cheaper than the ordinary 400-gold temple, but it still competes with mages, troops, and forts.                                  |
| Weak priests and inspired researchers | Monks are H1 Mundane Researchers and can be recruited outside forts as well as in forts. They widen research and preaching without adding a magic path.      |
| Forest recruitment                    | Foresters and Royal Foresters can be recruited in every forest. Forest ownership can therefore add stealth, patrol, and ranged recruitment away from a fort. |

| Rule or asset        | Operational consequence                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Non-fort recruitment | Logrian Slingers, Warriors, Cavalry, Monks, and Logrian Wise Men can be recruited outside forts according to the manual and structured membership tables. |
| Forest of Avalon     | The capital site supplies three Nature gems, Wardens, Knights of Avalon, and their commanders; patch 6.13 sets its Magic increase to +1.                  |
| Tower of Avalon      | The second capital site supplies two Glamour gems and the Crone of Avalon.                                                                                |
| Communal Chants      | Man's Spellsingers can cast Chorus Master and Chorus Slave. <a href="#">Book V</a> owns the general communion rules and safety discussion.                |

Terrain recruitment is part of Man's economy. A forest can contribute scouts and Foresters before it has a fort, while an otherwise ordinary non-fort province can contribute a Monk or a random Wise Man. Those commanders still cost gold and recruitment time. The map offers more queues, not free capacity.

## Man roster by job

| Unit or group          | Best job                                                                     | Important limit                                                                                                   |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Logrian Slinger        | Cheap ranged body from forts or outside them                                 | Low protection and modest accuracy; the sling is not a substitute for the longbow line.                           |
| Longbowman             | Long-ranged supporting fire                                                  | Needs a screen and a target for which mundane arrows matter; friendly troops still occupy the line of fire.       |
| Spearman and Longspear | Inexpensive line and long-weapon control                                     | Ordinary protection and damage; each version should be chosen for the opposing weapon and size mix.               |
| Logrian Warrior        | Javelin-and-axe reinforcement from forts or outside them                     | More expensive and resource-heavy than the basic line, with no shield against concentrated missiles.              |
| Tower Guard            | Better-defended sword line                                                   | Fourteen recruitment points and eighteen resources slow mass recruitment.                                         |
| Forester               | Forest-surviving stealth archer, patrol support, and dispersed reinforcement | Light armour and a mixed weapon set; useful terrain access does not make it a heavy line unit.                    |
| Landless Knight        | Armoured foot line with a broad sword                                        | Better protection costs resources, while the unit still moves and fights as infantry.                             |
| Logrian Cavalry        | Mobile reinforcement from forts or outside them                              | Rider 1 and a lightly protected War Horse make it the cheaper cavalry tier, not a Knight of Man.                  |
| Knight of Man          | Heavy shock cavalry from any fort                                            | Forty-five gold, 32 resources, 25 recruitment points, and separate rider and Destrier risks.                      |
| Warden of Avalon       | Capital-only sacred great-sword infantry with True Sight                     | Twenty-six gold, 28 resources, and 33 recruitment points keep the unit specialised.                               |
| Knight of Avalon       | Capital-only sacred unicorn cavalry                                          | Ninety gold and 35 recruitment points; both the rider and Armored Unicorn must survive the attacks aimed at them. |

The default army should not mix every row. Longbows need a line that holds for the expected approach. Cavalry needs space and a target worth charging. Wardens and Knights of Avalon need a bless and battle that justify spending the capital troop queue on them.

## Man commander and mage portfolio

| Commander                  | Paths or ability                                       | Main jobs                                                           | Recruitment warning                                                      |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Royal Forester             | Stealth 55, Patrol +5, forest recruitment              | Scouting, patrolling, stealth leadership, and moving Foresters      | Leadership 10; it is a specialist, not a general army commander.         |
| Castellan                  | Leadership 100                                         | Ordinary field command                                              | No priest or magic role.                                                 |
| Monk                       | H1, Mundane Researcher, outside-fort recruitment       | Research, preaching, blessing, and light sacred support             | Low morale and no non-Holy magic path.                                   |
| Bard                       | G1, Spy, Spellsinger                                   | Intelligence, Chorus participation, Glamour support                 | Two recruitment points for a narrow battle mage and spy.                 |
| Daughter of Avalon         | N1 G1, Spellsinger                                     | Core research, Chorus participation, Nature and Glamour support     | Two recruitment points and no random path.                               |
| Mother of Avalon           | N1 G1 H1 plus two random rolls, Spellsinger            | Main random mage, Chorus, rituals, battlefield support, searching   | 305 gold and two recruitment points; the useful result must be labelled. |
| Lord Warden                | Sacred, True Sight, Leadership 100                     | Capital command and elite infantry leadership                       | Capital-only commander turn and 170 gold.                                |
| Knight Commander of Avalon | Sacred mounted Leadership 100                          | Mobile capital command and sacred cavalry leadership                | Capital-only, 210 gold, with a separate Armored Unicorn mount.           |
| Crone of Avalon            | N3 G2 H1 plus randoms, Spellsinger                     | High Nature and Glamour, national rituals, Chorus master, searching | Capital-only, 465 gold, and four recruitment points.                     |
| Logrian Wise Man           | E1 plus FAEN random, Research -4, non-fort recruitment | Elemental branch access, Earth support, searching, and forging      | 125 gold and two recruitment points for reduced research efficiency.     |

The capital queue should answer a current need. A Crone gives paths and ritual certainty. A Lord Warden or Knight Commander moves an elite force. Recruiting the expensive mage every turn without funding armies, forts, and field leaders can leave Man rich in theory and slow on the map.

## Reading Avalon's random paths

### Mother of Avalon distribution

The manual prints the Mother as N1 G1 H1 with two random levels. The pinned record resolves two guaranteed and independent rolls:

- 1 one level from Nature or Glamour;
- 2 one level from Water, Earth, or Nature.

The six combinations are equally likely.

| Final paths | Probability per Mother |
|-------------|------------------------|
| W1 N2 G1 H1 | 16.67%                 |
| E1 N2 G1 H1 | 16.67%                 |
| N3 G1 H1    | 16.67%                 |
| W1 N1 G2 H1 | 16.67%                 |
| E1 N1 G2 H1 | 16.67%                 |
| N2 G2 H1    | 16.67%                 |

A Mother has a 50% chance to reach G2, a 33.33% chance to gain Water, a 33.33% chance to gain Earth, a 66.67% chance to reach at least N2, and a 16.67% chance to reach N3. Four independent Mothers give about a 93.75% chance of at least one G2 result, 80.25% for at least one Water result, 80.25% for at least one Earth result, and 51.77% for at least one N3 result.

These chances describe recruitment, not timing guarantees. A G2 Mother owns Geas, Summon Cu Sidhe, and the Glamour threshold of Herd of Unicorns. Water and Earth Mothers open different general spell and forge branches. An N3 Mother reaches thresholds that the ordinary Daughter cannot.

Crone of Avalon distribution

Every Crone begins at N3 G2 H1. The pinned 6.35 record then gives:

- one guaranteed level chosen equally from Air, Water, Earth, Nature, or Glamour;
- an independent 10% chance of a second level from the same five-path set.

The guaranteed result is 20% for each named path. Including the second roll, the chance of receiving at least one chosen path is 21.6%. Ten percent of Crones receive two random levels; two percent receive both levels in the same path, and eight percent receive two different paths.

The current manual compresses the Crone to ?1 and does not expose that 10% second slot on the nation page. This dossier keeps the extra roll labelled as pinned structured evidence until a live 6.36 recruitment card or another current official source resolves the display.

Logrian Wise Man distribution

The Logrian Wise Man has fixed E1 and one guaranteed level chosen equally from Fire, Air, Earth, or Nature.

| Final paths | Probability per Wise Man |
|-------------|--------------------------|
| F1 E1       | 25%                      |
| A1 E1       | 25%                      |
| E2          | 25%                      |
| E1 N1       | 25%                      |

For any named result,  $1 - 0.75^n$  gives the chance of seeing at least one after  $n$  independent recruits. That is about 57.8% after three, 76.3% after five, and 94.4% after ten. The expected wait is four recruits, but the non-fort provinces, gold, commander points, and laboratories needed to use the result still have to exist.

National spells and caster access

| Spell         | School and requirement         | Native caster                    | Planning use and boundary                                                                                    |
|---------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Chorus Master | Thaumaturgy 1, G1, Spellsinger | Bard, Daughter, Mother, or Crone | Starts the master side of Man's national Chorus. The official manual limits it to Spellsingers.              |
| Chorus Slave  | Thaumaturgy 1, G1, Spellsinger | Bard, Daughter, Mother, or Crone | Starts the slave side. Caster count, path mix, fatigue, timing, and retreat safety must be planned together. |



| Spell             | School and requirement                | Native caster                             | Planning use and boundary                                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Summon Black Dogs | Conjuration 2, D2, 5 Death gems       | No recruit or listed national hero has D2 | Summons 20 Black Dogs. Owning the ritual does not create its caster.                                                                                         |
| Summon Cu Sidhe   | Conjuration 3, G2, 5 Glamour gems     | Crone or G2 Mother                        | Summons 10 sacred Cu Sidhe. Research, gems, commander capacity, and the army that will lead them all matter.                                                 |
| Geas              | Thaumaturgy 3, G2                     | Crone or G2 Mother                        | National combat control. Target selection, resistance checks, and battle value remain context dependent.                                                     |
| Summon Barghests  | Conjuration 4, D2, 7 Death gems       | No recruit or listed national hero has D2 | Summons 14 sacred Barghests. A Pretender, summon, empowerment, or independent path must supply the missing Death caster.                                     |
| Herd of Unicorns  | Conjuration 4, G2 N1, 10 Glamour gems | Crone or G2 Mother                        | Summons 10 sacred Unicorns. The pinned record also restricts the source province to forest terrain; check the current spell card before committing the gems. |

The Death rituals are the clearest access warning. Man owns them nationally, but its repeatable roster and six listed national heroes contain no Death path. Researching those spells before building a real D2 route creates no casting capacity.

## Man national item boundary

The revision-2 manual does not list a separate Man item portfolio, and the pinned Basel register has no nation-57 restriction or rebate record. Man can still forge ordinary items when a mage meets their paths. Those designs remain general objects, not national equipment.

This matters for planning. A Water or Earth Mother and an elemental Wise Man may open useful forging thresholds, but their random path does not create a discount. Item cost, booster order, and replacement access should be checked before a rare mage is assigned to repeated forging.

## Man opening priorities

The opening has six linked jobs:

- 1 identify which nearby provinces need longbows, shields, long weapons, cavalry, or a different answer;
- 2 preserve enough gold for the first infrastructure target while recruiting a line that can protect the archers;
- 3 use forests and safe non-fort provinces as extra recruitment points where the map supports them;
- 4 begin Monk, Daughter, Mother, or Bard recruitment without leaving the armies short of leadership;
- 5 decide whether the capital commander queue needs a Crone, Lord Warden, or Knight Commander;
- 6 label every Mother, Crone, and Wise Man as soon as its paths are known.

## Recruitment packages to evaluate from reports

| Package                    | Intended target                                 | Failure signal                                                                                |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Spear line with Longbowmen | Ordinary infantry and lightly protected targets | The line breaks before the arrows matter, or shields and armour make the volleys inefficient. |

| Package                               | Intended target                                                     | Failure signal                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tower Guard or Landless Knight screen | Stronger conventional melee and missile pressure                    | Resources buy too few bodies, or armour-negating attacks remove the investment.       |
| Knight of Man reserve                 | Exposed flanks, ranged troops, and time-sensitive reinforcement     | Anti-large weapons, control, or mount losses turn the charge into an expensive trade. |
| Logrian mixed reinforcement           | Provinces where outside-fort recruitment adds useful bodies quickly | The local queue consumes gold without producing a coherent formation.                 |
| Warden or Knight of Avalon core       | Battles where the bless and sacred traits answer a known threat     | Capital scarcity and losses cost more than an ordinary troop solution.                |

These are report templates, not fixed expansion counts. Independent strength, formations, scales, bless, terrain, and combat rolls change the required party. No battle result is invented here.

## Man research response tree

### Branch A: fixed Glamour support

Thaumaturgy 1 gives every Spellsinger access to Chorus Master and Chorus Slave. Alteration 2 gives G1 Blur and Mirror Image. Thaumaturgy 3 gives G1 Luck and the national G2 Geas. This branch is available before a rare elemental random appears, but each spell still needs a protected caster and a battle where its effect matters.

Chorus is a force multiplier, not a substitute for planning. Masters and slaves should be counted before the script is chosen. [Book V](#) records the official rule that an unconscious Chorus Slave leaves the Chorus; the field plan must account for the resulting path and fatigue change.

### Branch B: national summons

Conjuration 3 opens Summon Cu Sidhe to every Crone and half of Mothers. Conjuration 4 adds Herd of Unicorns to the same casters because they also meet N1. The capital already receives three Nature and two Glamour gems each month, but that income must also support battlefield gems, searching, and any other rituals.

Summon Black Dogs and Summon Barghests sit on the same research branch but need D2. They should remain a future option until the nation actually owns a Death caster.

### Branch C: Nature protection and pressure

Crone access makes N3 dependable from the capital. Enchantment 3 gives Regeneration to N3, Conjuration 5 gives Howl to N3 with three Nature gems, and Alteration 6 gives Wooden Warriors to N3 with one Nature gem. Mothers add repeatable lower Nature and a one-in-six N3 result.

The choice depends on the army and opponent. Protection does not answer every elemental or armour-negating attack. Regeneration does not prevent a unit from dying to a single large hit. Howl and other battlefield pressure still depend on placement, duration, and the enemy's rear security.

### Branch D: Logrian Earth and elemental access

Every Wise Man can cast the E1 Earth Grip at Alteration 1. The 25% E2 result reaches Strength of Giants at Enchantment 1, Earth Meld at Alteration 3, and Summon Earthpower at Conjunction 3. Fire, Air, and Nature results widen searching and low-path utility, but one random level does not make Man a deep elemental nation.

Research should follow the recruited result. A plan that assumes an E2 Wise Man on a fixed turn has only a 25% success chance per recruit. If the branch matters, recruit across several eligible provinces and keep a fallback that uses fixed Nature and Glamour.

## Man battlefield packages

### Longbow line

A Castellan or other suitable commander holds the infantry line while Longbowmen fire from protected positions. The line type is selected from the report: spears for cheap frontage, longer weapons for the right approach, or heavier troops when ordinary protection is the limiting factor. More archers do not repair a screen that collapses too early.

### Cavalry reserve

Knights of Man or the cheaper Logrian Cavalry wait for a flank, rear, or reinforcement job. Their riders and mounts are separate creatures under Dominions 6. Formation, charge lanes, anti-large weapons, and the survival of both parts remain battle questions.

### Avalon sacred force

Wardens bring capital-only sacred infantry with True Sight. Knights of Avalon add sacred Armored Unicorns and mobility. The bless should solve an identified weakness or improve a job the units already perform. Capital scarcity means they should not be treated as a mass replacement for ordinary infantry and cavalry.

### Spellsinger cell

Bards and Daughters provide cheap G1 Chorus bodies, while Mothers and Crones bring the paths that benefit from the Chorus. The cell needs a clear master-slave count, script, gem allocation, guard plan, and retreat route. Losing the cell can remove both battle magic and a large block of research.

### Distributed recruitment column

Forests add Royal Foresters and Foresters. Non-fort provinces add Logrian troops, Monks, and Wise Men. This can replace losses and widen research without waiting for every fort, but the resulting pieces still need commanders, laboratories where required, supply, and a route to the front.

## Man Pretender families

| Family                     | What it solves                                                                        | What it must not conceal                                                         |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Economy and infrastructure | Pays for 305-gold Mothers, 465-gold Crones, cavalry, forts, laboratories, and temples | More income does not remove capital turns, commander points, or resource limits. |

| Family           | What it solves                                                                                 | What it must not conceal                                                                        |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sacred support   | Improves Wardens, Knights of Avalon, and national sacred summons                               | Most ordinary Man troops remain mundane, while the best sacred recruits are capital-only.       |
| Death bridge     | Supplies the missing D2 for Black Dogs and Barghests and may open broader Death work           | One Pretender is not distributed access; searching, gems, timing, and replacement still matter. |
| Elemental bridge | Makes a required Fire, Air, Water, or Earth threshold dependable instead of waiting on randoms | The bridge should name its first search, forge, ritual, and battlefield job.                    |
| Early tempo      | Covers an opening that the available troop mix cannot handle safely                            | Lost scales, afflictions, and chassis risk may cost more than the early provinces gained.       |

Man already has strong Nature and Glamour. A Pretender earns its cost by repairing a real bottleneck, supporting the scarce sacreds, or improving the economy that recruits the roster. Adding more of an existing path without a funded job can leave the original problem untouched.

## Man matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                              | First answer to examine                                                                 | Avoid                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Shielded or heavily armoured line          | Cavalry pressure, Earth support from Wise Men, control, sacreds, or imported damage     | Assuming another block of mundane arrows will solve protection by itself.     |
| Fast flankers and flyers                   | Protected rear positions, reserves, guards, wider formations, and local commanders      | Leaving Longbowmen and Spellsingers as one exposed rear cluster.              |
| Large units and cavalry                    | Long weapons, layered lines, control, and concentrated fire                             | Sending expensive cavalry into the enemy's preferred anti-large fight.        |
| High Defence, Glamour, or ethereal targets | Area effects, buffs, True Sight assets, magic weapons, and researched control           | Treating high arrow volume as guaranteed contact.                             |
| Armour-negating or elemental magic         | Spacing, resistance, pressure on casters, summons, and shorter exposure                 | Buying heavier human armour against damage that ignores it.                   |
| Mind and MR attacks                        | Better-MR Avalon troops, buffs, spacing, imported Astral, and target-specific counters  | Assuming a sacred tag protects ordinary soldiers from MR checks.              |
| Raiding and dispersed pressure             | Forest recruitment, non-fort queues, scouts, Bards, cavalry, and prepared local leaders | Keeping every useful commander and mage in the capital.                       |
| Attrition and mage loss                    | Monks for distributed research, protected rare randoms, reserves, and retreat planning  | Risking the only Water, Earth, Fire, or Air result in routine frontline work. |

## Monthly Man audit

- Is the next gold piece buying troops, a field leader, a mage, or the infrastructure that multiplies later recruitment?
- Does every Longbowman group have a line that can hold for the expected approach?
- Are forests contributing Royal Foresters or Foresters where that queue is useful?
- Are safe non-fort provinces producing the right Logrian unit, Monk, or Wise Man?
- Is the capital commander queue solving a path or leadership shortage?
- Are Mother, Crone, and Wise Man randoms labelled by final paths and assigned jobs?
- Does the current research target have a legal caster already recruited?

- Are Nature and Glamour gems divided between battle use, summons, and reserves before spending begins?
- Is a Chorus sized and scripted around its actual masters and slaves?
- Do the Death rituals have a real D2 route, or are they only names in the spell list?
- Are capital sacred losses justified by the battle and supported by the bless?
- Can the research stack survive a raid, assassination attempt, or forced retreat?

## Man unresolved evidence boundary

The following claims remain open:

- 1 exact expansion-party ranges for each line, longbow, cavalry, and sacred package;
- 2 live 6.36 display confirmation of the two Mother rolls, the Wise Man mask, and especially the Crone's pinned 10% second random;
- 3 current spell-card confirmation of Herd of Unicorns' forest-source restriction;
- 4 Chorus fatigue, casting-time, path-boost, unconscious-slave, and script outcomes in specific battles;
- 5 Geas target choice, resistance, and practical value against different formations;
- 6 rider-and-mount survival outcomes for Logrian Cavalry, Knights of Man, and Knights of Avalon;
- 7 the economic payback of distributed Wise Man and Monk recruitment on different maps;
- 8 hero arrival timing and the value of late elemental or Astral access;
- 9 modded Man variants, which remain separate from this unmodded chapter.

These questions stay visible without becoming guessed conclusions or new test assets. R-047, R-058, and the rest of the hands-on runtime queue remain parked.

# Part XX: Middle Age Abysia, Blood and Fire

## Abysia one-page command brief

Middle Age Abysia converts heat, heavy infantry, strong priests, and a capital Blood-mage queue into a compact but demanding war machine. Ordinary forts supply Humanbred screens, four weapon profiles of Abysian Infantry, Salamanders, assassins, animal handlers, Warlords, and two grades of Fire priest. The capital adds Lava Warriors and three Blood-capable commanders, including fixed S2 B3 Warlocks.

The reliable core is straightforward:

- Humanbred cost fewer resources and move faster than the armoured Abysian line, so they can supply bodies where protection is not the only requirement;
- Abysian Infantry provide fire-resistant heavy troops with battleaxe, flail, shielded axe, and shielded morningstar profiles;
- Salamanders add large heat effects and fire attacks, but they are animals, undisciplined, and expensive in gold per body;
- Anathemant Salamanders provide repeatable F2 H2, while Anathemant Dragons provide fixed F3 E1 H3;
- Warlock Apprentices, Demonbred, and Warlocks put Blood access in the capital commander queue;
- the two capital sites generate five Fire gems each month and gate every capital-only recruit;
- national magic spans Fire battle support, Blood crossbreeding, two summons, and a hostile-province ritual;

- repeatable recruits have no fixed Air, Water, Death, Nature, or Glamour access.

Abysia's roster is narrow enough to understand and expensive enough to punish an unfocused plan. Heavy infantry consume resources, Warlocks consume gold, Demonbred consume the entire four-point capital commander allowance shown on their card, and Salamanders consume gold that could have funded another mage or fort. The first question each month is not which strong object exists. It is which bottleneck the next purchase removes.

## Abysia evidence and ruleset

The scope is unmodded MA Abysia on the [Book I 6.36](#) live baseline. The revision-2 official manual controls the player-facing national rules, recruitment locations, displayed paths, costs, national spells, rituals, and artifact description. Object identifiers, site fields, nation restrictions, hero records, and expanded random slots are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

The official 6.01 announcement says only that Abysia's wall defenders were tweaked. It does not print a new defender count, composition, or formula, so none is invented here. The later 6.27 reference to EA Abysia's AI is not applied to the Middle Age nation. A current unit card, spell card, or battle remains authoritative where the manual and the older structured snapshot expose different levels of detail.

## Abysia conversion chain

heat preference and fire-resistant bodies  
-> Humanbred screens, armoured infantry, and early commanders  
-> forts, laboratories, temples, and protected recruitment queues  
-> Fire priests plus capital Astral-Blood mages  
-> Fire research, blood hunting, and national rituals  
-> target-specific infantry, heat, assassination, and mage packages  
-> protected Blood economy, sieges, and Throne operations

The chain commonly breaks at three points. Too much armour can delay infrastructure because resources do not pay gold costs. Too many capital mages can leave Lava Warriors and field leadership underproduced. A Blood plan can also consume commanders and population without first building safe hunting provinces, patrollers, laboratories, and a reason to spend the slaves.

## Abysian national rules that shape the plan

| Rule or asset                     | Operational consequence                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Heat preference +3                | The roster is designed around very hot territory; scales and foreign provinces must be evaluated from Abysia's preference, not a generic human baseline.                       |
| Heat limit +2 and Death limit +1  | Pretender-scale choices have nation-specific limits. This does not make every extreme setting economically correct.                                                            |
| Radiated heat and Fire Resistance | Most Abysian bodies carry Heat 3 and Fire Resistance 25. Humanbred instead have Fire Resistance 15 and no printed Heat ability.                                                |
| Modified Growth and Death effects | Growth and Death have half the standard effect on income and population growth and no effect on supplies. Population still dies slowly in Abysian provinces with Death scales. |
| Fort protection from heat deaths  | Forts reduce heat-scale deaths by two steps. This is a population rule, not a claim that forts erase every economic consequence of temperature.                                |

| Rule or asset                        | Operational consequence                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cave-fort bonus                      | The manual grants extra gold and resources in cave forts, but prints no amount. Cave provinces are attractive, while the missing multiplier stays unquantified. |
| Powerful priests and blood sacrifice | H2 and H3 priests support sacreds, preaching, and sacrifice. Blood sacrifice still spends slaves and priest turns.                                              |
| Bless points +1                      | Abysia receives one extra bless point, but most of its ordinary infantry is mundane. The main recruitable sacred troop is the capital-only Lava Warrior.        |
| No national missile troops           | Ranged pressure must come from magic, summons, independents, or imported options. A heavy line does not itself answer a protected enemy caster.                 |

The Growth and Death exception is easy to overread. It changes several scale effects, yet it does not make population disposable: Death still kills people, Blood hunting raises unrest, and lost population can still reduce later income. The roster's fire resistance also does not make it immune to cold, armour-negating damage, fatigue, morale failure, or magic-resistance attacks.

## Abysia capital sites and recruitment queues

| Site                                        | Verified fields                                  | Recruitment consequence                            |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| The Smouldercone, site 1                    | Four Fire gems per month; Heat scale capped at 4 | Enables Warlock Apprentice, Warlock, and Demonbred |
| Temple of the All-Consuming Flame, site 121 | One Fire gem per month                           | Enables Lava Warrior                               |

Together the sites produce five Fire gems each month. That income supports Fire operations, not the Blood slaves or Astral pearls implied by the capital mages. Those economies require their own provinces, searches, trades, conversions, or imported access.

The Smouldercone creates the main capital-queue decision. A Warlock Apprentice costs 190 gold and two recruitment points; a Warlock costs 400 gold and two; a Demonbred costs 375 gold and four. The Temple creates a separate capital troop option, but the same capital must still supply ordinary troops, infrastructure, and commanders. A queue should be planned by the capability required next, not by buying the most expensive unit automatically.

## Abysia roster by job

| Unit or group              | Best job                                                   | Important limit                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Humanbred with spear       | Lower-resource screen and longer-weapon body               | Morale 9, Protection 9, Fire Resistance 15, and no heat aura make it materially different from an Abysian Infantryman. |
| Humanbred with axe         | Lower-resource damage body behind or beside a holding line | The axe version gives up the spear's length and still has the Humanbred defensive profile.                             |
| Battleaxe Abysian Infantry | Heavy two-handed damage                                    | No shield; slow combat speed and encumbrance make contact and fatigue part of the purchase.                            |
| Flail Abysian Infantry     | Heavy alternative weapon profile                           | No shield and lower printed Defence than the battleaxe version; use only when the target justifies the weapon.         |

| Unit or group                         | Best job                                       | Important limit                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Shielded axe Abysian Infantry         | Protected general line                         | More resources and encumbrance than the two-handed profiles; its one-handed damage must still defeat the target.       |
| Shielded morningstar Abysian Infantry | Protected line with a different damage profile | The highest resource cost among ordinary infantry variants and no universal answer to armour.                          |
| Salamander                            | Fire attack and Heat 6 pressure                | Animal, undisciplined, Morale 9, and 50 gold; needs suitable leadership and a battle where heat or fire matters.       |
| Lava Warrior                          | Capital-only sacred assault infantry           | Thirty gold, 28 resources, Berserker +3, two weapons, and low printed Defence; losses consume a limited capital queue. |

The four Abysian Infantry versions are choices, not a progression ladder. Shielded troops improve the defensive profile against many mundane missiles and attacks, while two-handed troops preserve a different weapon and resource trade. Exact performance depends on the enemy weapon, protection, size, formation, fatigue, and terrain; the dossier does not assign a universal winner.

## Abysia commander and mage portfolio

| Commander             | Paths or ability                                  | Main jobs                                                                            | Recruitment warning                                                                                    |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Slayer                | Stealth 60, Assassin, Patience +1                 | Scouting, assassination pressure, and intelligence                                   | Ninety-five gold for no army leadership or magic path; assassination outcomes remain target dependent. |
| Beast Trainer         | Beastmaster 3, Animal Awe +4, Magic Leadership 10 | Handling Salamanders and other suitable animals                                      | Inspirational -1 and Leadership 25 mean it is not Abysia's general field commander.                    |
| Warlord               | Leadership 100, Taskmaster +2, two axes           | Main mundane army command                                                            | One hundred ten gold and 34 resources compete with another armoured body and infrastructure.           |
| Anathemant Salamander | F2 H2, sacred                                     | Repeatable Fire research, priest work, blood sacrifice, blessing, and battle support | Two recruitment points and 260 gold; it does not reach the F3 E1 national spell by itself.             |
| Anathemant Dragon     | F3 E1 H3, sacred                                  | High priest, national spell access, forging, and Fire-Earth support                  | Four recruitment points and 415 gold; the pinned random slot is not printed on the manual card.        |
| Warlock Apprentice    | S1 B2, Adept Cross Breeder +2                     | Blood research, hunting support, communions, and Infernal Breeding                   | Capital-only and two recruitment points; it has no Fire path despite being Abysian.                    |
| Demonbred             | F2 B2 H2, flying, Blood Searcher 1, sacred        | Mobile priest, Blood search, Fire-Blood support, and command                         | Capital-only, four recruitment points, and 375 gold; flying mobility does not prove a safe raid.       |
| Warlock               | S2 B3 plus pinned randoms, Adept Cross Breeder +6 | Main Astral-Blood mage, crossbreeding, hunting, rituals, and research                | Capital-only and 400 gold; every useful random result must be labelled and protected.                  |

The ordinary-fort commander pool and capital pool solve different problems. Warlords move conventional armies. Anathemants provide religion and Fire. The three Smouldercone recruits build Blood and Astral capacity. Treating all eight as interchangeable commanders hides the queue that actually limits each plan.



## Reading the Abysian random paths

The pinned path mask 35968 decodes to Fire, Earth, Astral, or Blood. Its four component bits are 128, 1024, 2048, and 32768. The mask appears in both the Warlock and Anathemant Dragon records, but the roll structure differs.

### Warlock distribution

Every Warlock begins at S2 B3. The manual then prints one random level. The pinned 6.35 record resolves that display as:

- 1

one guaranteed level chosen equally from Fire, Earth, Astral, or Blood;
- 2

an independent 10% chance of a second level from the same four paths.

For any one named path, the first roll hits 25% of Warlocks. If it misses, the second roll can still add that path with probability  $75\% \times 10\% \times 25\%$ . The chance of reaching at least one level in a named random path is 26.875%.

| Portfolio result                         | Probability per Warlock |
|------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| No second random level                   | 90%                     |
| Second level matches the first path      | 2.5%                    |
| Second level is a different path         | 7.5%                    |
| Any one named path appears at least once | 26.875%                 |
| A chosen named path appears twice        | 0.625%                  |
| At least Fire or Earth appears           | 52.5%                   |

Three independent Warlocks give about a 60.90% chance of at least one result in a chosen named path. Five give about 79.09%, and ten give about 95.63%. These figures measure a recruitment portfolio. They do not guarantee when the result arrives, that it survives, or that the economy can afford uninterrupted recruitment.

The threshold consequences are asymmetric. A Fire double produces F2 on the Warlock; an Earth double produces E2; an Astral double raises the fixed S2 to S4; and a Blood double raises fixed B3 to B5. A single Astral or Blood result instead produces S3 or B4. These path cards open different spell and forge branches, so the final paths should be recorded immediately.

### Anathemant Dragon pinned random

The Anathemant Dragon is fixed F3 E1 H3 in the manual. The pinned structured record adds an independent 10% one-level roll from Fire, Earth, Astral, or Blood. That gives 90% no extra level and 2.5% each for F4, E2, S1, or B1.

This slot is less secure than the Warlock's printed random because the manual page shows no random marker at all. The dossier uses it only as a 6.35 planning possibility. In particular, native F4 ritual access must remain conditional until a current recruitment card confirms the bonus.

## Abysia native path boundary

| Path                               | Repeatable access                                                             | Boundary                                                                                                         |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fire                               | F2 Anathemant Salamander and Demonbred; F3 Anathemant Dragon; Warlock random  | Strong and distributed, although the capital Fire-Blood mage and high priest are expensive.                      |
| Earth                              | Fixed E1 Anathemant Dragon; Warlock random; pinned Dragon random may reach E2 | No ordinary repeatable E2 guarantee.                                                                             |
| Astral                             | S1 Apprentice, fixed S2 Warlock, Warlock random                               | Capital-only; the main Warlock can reach S3 or rarely S4 under the pinned scheme.                                |
| Blood                              | B2 Apprentice and Demonbred, fixed B3 Warlock, Warlock random                 | Capital-only; hunting, unrest control, slaves, laboratories, and caster turns all need a budget.                 |
| Air, Water, Death, Nature, Glamour | No repeatable recruit                                                         | Must come from independents, summons, empowerment, transformation, items after another bridge, or the Pretender. |

None of the three pinned national heroes supplies Air, Water, Death, Nature, or Glamour. Owning a Death ritual does not create a native Death caster. A plan that needs one of these paths must name the source, timing, cost, search route, and replacement plan.

## Abysia national spells and caster access

| ID  | Spell or ritual          | Research and paths   | Cost or fatigue               | Verified native access                                                                          |
|-----|--------------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 317 | Summon Spectral Infantry | Conjuration 2, D1 F1 | 5 Death gems                  | No recruit or pinned hero has Death; national ownership is not native castability.              |
| 318 | Contact Scorpion Man     | Conjuration 8, E1 F1 | 12 Earth gems                 | Fixed Anathemant Dragon qualifies.                                                              |
| 319 | Inner Furnace            | Enchantment 5, F3    | 100 fatigue, battlefield-wide | Fixed Anathemant Dragon qualifies; an F2 battle caster may require a separate Fire-boost route. |
| 320 | Infernal Breeding        | Blood 3, B2          | 25 blood slaves               | Apprentice, Demonbred, and Warlock qualify.                                                     |
| 690 | Liquid Flames of Rhuax   | Evocation 5, F3 E1   | 20 fatigue, range 30+, area 1 | Fixed Anathemant Dragon qualifies.                                                              |
| 850 | Hellscape                | Alteration 6, F4     | 10 Fire gems, range 5         | Pinned F-random Dragon reaches F4 only 2.5%; otherwise another explicit bridge is required.     |

Inner Furnace is described as strengthening the heat radiated by every Abysian on the battlefield. Its exact radius increase, affected-unit boundary, stacking, and fatigue consequences are not derived from the database effect field. Liquid Flames of Rhuax is an armour-piercing Fire attack and is marked unavailable underwater in the manual.

Infernal Breeding crossbreeds Abysians, humans, and giants with demons, Salamanders, and other beasts. The manual warns that many Hell Spawn suffer afflictions and early aging. Neither the manual nor a spell row supplies a complete current output distribution, so the dossier does not promise a particular creature count or quality beyond the ritual record.

Hellscape is an anonymous hostile-province ritual. Its printed effects are Heat +3, Death +1, population -10%, and unrest +20. The fixed Dragon does not meet F4 without another step; a

battlefield Fire boost cannot be carried into a strategic ritual. Researching Alteration 6 for Hellscape should follow confirmed caster access, not precede it on hope.

## Abysia national item boundary

O'al Kan's Sceptre, item 97, is a unique Construction 9 artifact requiring F3. The pinned item record grants a national rebate to both EA Abysia 16 and MA Abysia 63. The manual lists Fire Spell Range +50%, Cold Resistance +10, Leadership +100, the spell Flare, and a small-area fatigue effect on strike.

A fixed Anathemant Dragon meets the printed F3 forging path. That does not settle the displayed gem cost after the national rebate, other forge modifiers, artifact availability, and rounding are combined. The live forge screen controls that value. The artifact's late research and uniqueness also mean it is a possible capstone, not an opening solution to leadership or range.

## Abysia opening priorities

The opening should secure four systems before adding exotic branches:

- 1 enough field leadership to move the troop profile being purchased;
- 2 a line whose protection, weapon, movement, and gold cost fit the nearby independents;
- 3 laboratories, temples, and forts that can recruit the next mage or priest without stranding the army;
- 4 a capital queue split deliberately among Blood-Astral access, mobile Demonbred, and other national needs.

An exact expansion count is not supplied. Humanbred, shielded infantry, two-handed infantry, Salamanders, and Lava Warriors face different risks against cavalry, missiles, high Defence, armour, cold, poison, and morale pressure. Map generation, scales, bless, commander, formation, and combat rolls change the minimum safe force.

The first additional fort should be judged by gold, resources, caves, neighbours, travel geometry, and commander access together. A cave bonus can improve a fort's value, but the manual gives no number. A rich surface chokepoint may still be more useful than a cave that cannot protect borders or connect armies.

## Abysia recruitment packages to evaluate from reports

### Humanbred screen

Use Humanbred where lower resource cost, higher map movement, or additional bodies matter more than Abysian protection. Spears can extend the weapon line; axes change the damage profile. Their Morale 9 and lower fire resistance require appropriate leadership and positioning; they are distinct from the Abysian line.

### Armoured Abysian line

Choose shielded axe or morningstar versions when the defensive profile answers the observed threat. Choose battleaxe or flail versions when their weapon and lower resource cost justify losing the shield. Keep the line narrow enough for support to reach it and broad enough that slow troops do not leave an exposed flank.

## Salamander group

Salamanders offer Fire Flare, a bite, Heat 6, and Heat Power 1. A Beast Trainer provides the relevant animal leadership tools, while a mage or Warlord may supply the rest of the force. The group should be selected against a target that is vulnerable to its damage and fatigue pressure; fire resistance, dispersal, cold, morale, or fast contact can change the value sharply.

## Lava Warrior reserve

Lava Warriors concentrate capital resources, sacred status, two attacks, Berserker +3, and Heat Power 1. They are an elite answer only when the bless, commander, and target justify scarce recruitment. Low printed Defence and berserking make extraction and casualty control part of the decision.

## Abysia research response tree

Research begins with a battlefield or strategic problem and a recruited caster. Abysia owns several national spells at attractive path thresholds, but it cannot deploy every branch from the same mage pool or gem economy.

### Branch A: Fire battlefield breakpoints

Conjuration 3's Phoenix Power lets an F2 battle caster reach a higher Fire threshold. Enchantment 5 then offers Inner Furnace at F3, while Evocation 5 offers Liquid Flames of Rhuax to F3 E1. The fixed Dragon reaches both national spells directly; Salamander priests and Demonbred can use an available battle boost for F3 effects but do not gain the Dragon's Earth path.

This branch is strongest when heat pressure or armour-piercing Fire solves the reported enemy. It is weaker against fire resistance, rapid mage disruption, underwater operations, or a battle where Abysia's own fatigue and formation fail before the Fire package matters.

### Branch B: Blood economy and Infernal Breeding

Blood 3 makes Infernal Breeding available to all three capital Blood-mage types. The research is only one part of the cost. The plan also needs hunting provinces, patrollers, laboratories, slave transport, unrest control, and mage turns. Apprentices are cheaper crossbreeders; Warlocks carry stronger Blood and the larger Adept Cross Breeder value; Demonbred add flight, priesthood, and Blood Searcher 1.

No expected return is assigned to the ritual or a hunting province. Population, unrest, scales, hunter skill, patrol strength, random outcomes, and current engine rules determine the result. Record actual slaves, unrest, population loss, and outputs before calling the branch efficient.

### Branch C: Astral-Blood Warlocks

Fixed S2 B3 makes every Warlock a useful Astral-Blood platform before randoms. Astral and Blood randoms raise the ceiling, while Fire and Earth randoms add cross-path options. This branch should be chosen after recruiting and labelling the actual portfolio; a research target that needs S3, B4, F1, or E1 is conditional until the relevant Warlock exists.

The capital-only nature of the whole Astral pool creates a strategic risk. One raid, siege, or assassination campaign can threaten research, blood hunting, and high-path casting together.

Distributed forts, ordinary priests, protected movement, and reserve mages reduce that concentration.

### **Branch D: summons and remote pressure**

Conjuration 2 lists Summon Spectral Infantry, but its D1 F1 requirement exposes a missing native path. Conjuration 8's Contact Scorpion Man is reachable by the fixed Dragon and costs 12 Earth gems. Alteration 6's Hellscape requires F4 and ten Fire gems, with only conditional native access in the pinned Dragon random.

These rituals should be scheduled from the caster backward. Confirm the path, laboratory, research, gems, province, and opportunity cost first. A national name in the spell list is not a reason to divert research when the legal caster or gem income does not exist.

## **Abysia battlefield packages**

### **Humanbred screen with Abysian damage**

Humanbred occupy space and absorb selected contact while more expensive Abysian Infantry supply the weapon needed against the target. The two groups should not be treated as statistically identical. Leadership, morale, movement, fire resistance, and heat exposure differ, so formation and retreat routes matter.

### **Shielded line with priest support**

Shielded Abysian Infantry form the main protected block while an Anathemant blesses sacred auxiliaries, supports morale and religion, or delivers reachable Fire magic. A Warlord can preserve the priest's script and commander turn for magic. The package still needs an answer to enemies that ignore armour or attack the rear.

### **Salamander heat cell**

A limited Salamander group applies Heat 6 and fire attacks beside fire-resistant national troops. Beast Trainer support keeps the animal role explicit. Inner Furnace may intensify the wider Abysian heat package, but its live area and fatigue interactions remain open; do not assume that adding more heat is harmless or universally effective.

### **Anathemant Fire battery**

F2 Salamander priests provide the repeatable base, while a Dragon supplies F3 E1 and H3. The battery is selected for a specific spell breakpoint and protected by troops and placement. Concentrating expensive priests can solve one battle while exposing research, sacrifice, and preaching elsewhere.

### **Capital Blood operations cell**

Apprentices perform lower-cost Blood and Astral work, Warlocks provide high paths and crossbreeding, and Demonbred provide mobile Fire-Blood priesthood. The cell needs scouts, patrol, laboratories, slave logistics, and a protected route between hunting provinces and casting centres. It should not sit as one undefended capital stack merely because every member was recruited there.

## Abysia Pretender families

| Family                         | What it solves                                                                       | What it must not conceal                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Economy and production         | Supports gold-heavy mages, resource-heavy infantry, and additional infrastructure    | Extra resources do not pay Warlock gold, while extra income does not replace capital recruitment points. |
| Missing-path bridge            | Imports Air, Water, Death, Nature, Glamour, or dependable higher Earth               | One god does not create distributed national access, search coverage, boosters, or replacement casters.  |
| Sacred combat design           | Improves Lava Warriors and sacred commanders                                         | The bulk Humanbred and Abysian Infantry receive no bless.                                                |
| Resistance and mobility design | Answers cold, shock, poison, magic resistance, map movement, or another observed gap | A broad defensive bless can crowd out the path or scale needed for the wider state.                      |
| Awake expander                 | Supplies early independent-taking power where the roster cannot meet the map safely  | Afflictions, counter chassis, lost scales, and delayed path infrastructure can erase the tempo gained.   |
| Ritual and forging bridge      | Reaches Death-Fire, F4, higher Earth, or late artifact thresholds reliably           | Research, gems, laboratory turns, and the Pretender's availability remain real costs.                    |

Abysia already possesses deep Fire, Blood, and Astral. A Pretender often creates more value by supplying a missing system, resistance, mobility, or reliable ritual bridge than by adding an unsupported theoretical endpoint. Each imported path should have a first search target, first forge or ritual job, and a plan if the Pretender is unavailable.

## Abysia matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                              | First answer to examine                                                                      | Avoid                                                                                |
|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Conventional missiles                      | Shielded infantry, terrain, spacing, pressure, and magic                                     | Marching unshielded two-handed troops through fire because their armour looks high.  |
| Heavy armour                               | Battleaxes, morningstars, Fire magic, buffs, summons, and target-specific control            | Buying more low-damage bodies without checking whether they can penetrate.           |
| High Defence, ethereal, or Glamour targets | Area effects, attack support, magic weapons, Astral tools, and imported counters             | Treating a second expensive infantry block as guaranteed contact.                    |
| Fire-resistant armies                      | Mundane weapon selection, Earth support, Astral-Blood options, summons, or imported damage   | Building the entire battle around heat and Fire because they are national strengths. |
| Cold and fatigue pressure                  | Resistance, shorter fights, formation depth, spell disruption, and reserves                  | Assuming native heat prevents cold damage or exhaustion automatically.               |
| Armour-negating and MR attacks             | Spacing, resistance, summons, counter-caster pressure, and target-specific buffs             | Treating Protection 17 as a defence against every damage channel.                    |
| Fast flankers and flyers                   | Protected mages, guards, reserves, wider lines, and local commanders                         | Leaving the capital mage portfolio in one exposed rear cluster.                      |
| Raids and dispersed pressure               | Warlords, Slayers, forts, scouts, patrols, and prepared local forces                         | Expecting slow infantry to recover every province after contact.                     |
| Underwater objectives                      | Independent or summoned amphibious access, a Pretender bridge, and a separate logistics plan | Assuming Fire resistance or wasteland survival supplies underwater capability.       |

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                                                         | Avoid                                                                                       |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pressure on the Blood economy | Distributed hunting, patrols, protected laboratories, reserve casters, and alternative research | Concentrating slaves, hunters, researchers, and high-path mages in one vulnerable province. |

## Monthly Abysia audit

- Is the current troop queue limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, leadership, or travel time?
- Does each infantry version have a target-specific reason to be in the queue?
- Are Humanbred being used for their actual cost and movement profile, without treating them as disposable Abysians?
- Does every Salamander group have suitable leadership and a target vulnerable to heat or Fire?
- Is the capital commander queue buying the exact Astral, Blood, mobility, or priest capability required next?
- Are Warlock and Dragon randoms labelled by their displayed final paths?
- Does the research target have a legal, protected caster already recruited?
- Are Fire gems, Earth gems, and blood slaves budgeted separately?
- Are hunting unrest, patrol strength, population, and slave transport recorded instead of assumed?
- Is a cave fort valuable for its position as well as its unquantified national bonus?
- Are sacred recruitment and the bless large enough to justify one another?
- Can the research and Blood infrastructure survive a raid, siege, or assassination campaign?

## Abysia unresolved evidence boundary

The following claims remain open:

- 1 exact expansion-party ranges for Humanbred, each infantry weapon profile, Salamanders, and Lava Warriors;
- 2 live 6.36 confirmation of the Warlock's pinned 10% second random and any Dragon random, which the manual does not display;
- 3 the numerical cave-fort gold and resource bonus;
- 4 the exact post-6.01 wall-defender count and composition;
- 5 Inner Furnace's current affected-unit boundary, heat-area increase, stacking, and formation-level fatigue results;
- 6 Infernal Breeding's current output distribution, afflictions, ages, and economic return;
- 7 displayed O'al Kan's Sceptre cost after national rebate, other forge modifiers, artifact availability, and rounding;
- 8 assassination, blood-hunting, Blood Searcher, and patrol outcomes in a particular game state;
- 9 underwater access, battlefield scripts, and Pretender designs in a specific map and opponent field;
- 10 modded Abysia variants, which remain separate from this unmodded chapter.

These questions remain evidence gaps; no rule or new test asset fills them. R-047, R-058, and the wider hands-on runtime queue stay parked until testing is explicitly resumed.

# Part XXI: Middle Age Pythium, Emerald Empire

## Pythium one-page command brief

Middle Age Pythium turns a broad legion roster, powerful Astral priest-mages, a separate troop-queue communion recruit, and unusually high capital gem income into a flexible imperial army. Ordinary forts recruit nine commanders and twelve troop types. The capital adds the Arch Theurg, Hydra Tamer, Battle Vestal, Hydra Hatchling, and Hydra through two national sites.

The reliable core is easy to state:

- the legion roster ranges from cheap Slingers and Velites to Hastati, Principes, Triarii, and Emerald Guards;
- Serpent Cataphracts add a heavily protected rider and a separately tracked Armored Serpent mount;
- Theurg Acolytes provide S1 H1, Theurgs provide A1 W1 S2 H2, and capital-only Arch Theurgs begin at A2 W1 S3 H3 before randoms;
- Theurg Communicants are troop recruits with a printed limit of one per month and a pinned automatic Communion Slave field;
- the Cathedral of the Spheres supplies two Air gems, one Water gem, and five Astral pearls each month;
- the national ritual list contains six angelic summons plus Contact Lar and Awaken Hamadryad;
- repeatable recruits have no fixed Earth, Death, Nature, Glamour, or Blood access;
- the official manual gives Pythium an Order scale limit of +1 and a Fortified City at the start.

Pythium has options, but each option draws on a different queue. Arch Theurgs consume capital commander time and 565 gold. Hydras consume capital troop time, 200 gold, and a one-per-month slot. Theurg Communicants use the troop queue even though their purpose is magical. A strong plan names which queue is solving which problem before the capital becomes a collection of expensive pieces without a field army.

## Pythium evidence and ruleset

The scope is unmodded MA Pythium on the [Book I 6.36](#) live baseline. The revision-2 official manual controls the player-facing nation rules, printed roster, costs, recruitment locations, paths, national rituals, and mount statistics. Object identifiers, site fields, hidden random slots, national restrictions, item-rebate fields, hero records, and special unit flags are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

The official update ledger through 6.36 contains one Pythium name match: a 6.07 correction for Epoteia that explicitly belongs to Late Age Pythium. It is not applied to the Middle Age nation. No ledger record through 6.36 names MA Pythium, one of its listed recruits, either capital site, or one of its national rituals as receiving a direct change. That is a patch-ledger result, not proof that no undocumented engine change exists; a current game card remains authoritative when it exposes newer detail.

## Pythium conversion chain

```
fortified capital, legion choices, and eight capital gems
-> target-specific infantry, leaders, and early expansion
-> forts, laboratories, temples, and protected recruitment
-> Acolytes, Theurgs, Arch Theurgs, and Communicants
-> battlefield communions, Grand Communion, and national rituals
-> legion support, Astral control, Air damage, and summoned specialists
-> protected mage economy, siege operations, and Throne claims
```



The chain most often breaks when one resource is mistaken for another. Eight capital gems do not pay the gold cost of a Theurg. Cheap legionnaires do not protect a communion by themselves. A large communion can reach high paths and still fail through fatigue, slave losses, a dead master, or a threatened rear. Pythium works best when its army, mage turns, pearls, and replacement plan are budgeted together.

## Pythian national rules that shape the plan

| Rule or asset              | Operational consequence                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Order limit +1             | Pythium can take a higher Order scale than a normal nation. The extra legal point is an option, not a command to use it in every design.                                                                     |
| Fortified City start       | The capital begins with stronger infrastructure than an ordinary starting fort. It still has only one commander queue and one troop queue each turn.                                                         |
| Standard forts             | Expansion of the recruitment network follows the normal fort system; capital-only mages, sacreds, and hydras remain tied to their sites.                                                                     |
| Powerful priests           | Repeatable H2 Theurgs and the capital H3 Arch Theurg support religion and battlefield priest work; the pinned hero Bartholomeus reaches H4.                                                                  |
| High capital gem income    | The Cathedral produces A2, W1, and S5 each month, eight gems in total. Nature rituals and Nature-forged national items still need a separate Nature economy.                                                 |
| Grand Communion            | The official manual uses Pythium's Arch Theurg, Theurgs, and Acolytes as its worked example for strengthening a public ritual such as Dispel. Joining mages give up their own activity for that ritual.      |
| Separate communion recruit | Theurg Communicants are recruited as troops, printed at one per month, and carry a pinned automatic Communion Slave field. They ease pressure on the commander queue but compete with the army queue.        |
| Serpent mounts             | Serpent Cataphracts and Serpent Lords ride Armored Serpents with their own hit points, protection, and poisonous bite. Rider and mount outcomes remain separate.                                             |
| Capital hydras             | Hydras and Hatchlings offer regeneration, poison resistance, and multiple head weapons in the printed roster. The pinned record also marks poison clouds and other fields whose live operation remains open. |

The strongest national features do not all point in the same direction. Legionnaires reward broad fort recruitment, while Arch Theurgs and hydras remain capital bound. Grand Communion concentrates ritual power in one province, while campaign survival usually rewards distributing ordinary Theurgs and replacement armies. The plan must decide when concentration is worth the risk.

## Pythium capital sites and recruitment queues

| Site                             | Verified fields                                               | Recruitment consequence                         |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Cathedral of the Spheres, site 3 | Two Air gems, one Water gem, and five Astral pearls per month | Enables Arch Theurg and Battle Vestal           |
| Swamps of Pythia, site 4         | No gem income in the pinned site row                          | Enables Hydra Tamer, Hydra, and Hydra Hatchling |

The Cathedral produces eight gems each month. This supports Air, Water, and especially Astral work, but not the Nature gems required by Contact Lar, Awaken Hamadryad, Gloves of the Gladiator, or

Hydra Skin Armor. Search coverage, trade, site capture, or another explicit source must fund that branch.

The capital has two distinct decisions. Its commander queue chooses between the four-point, 565-gold Arch Theurg and the one-point Hydra Tamer, along with any ordinary commander. Its troop queue chooses among legionnaires, Battle Vestals, Communicants, Hydra Hatchlings, and the 200-gold Hydra. Monthly limits on the Hydra and Communicant do not create extra queues; they only limit those individual recruits.

## Complete Pythium roster by job

| Unit or group             | Best job                                                     | Important limit                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Slinger                   | Cheapest printed missile body                                | Morale 7, low protection, and low melee skills make it a support body, not a line anchor.                                                |
| Retarius and Gladiator    | Low-resource shock troops with net-trident or flail profiles | The pinned records mark both as Single Battle. Their current departure timing remains a live-card question.                              |
| Velite                    | Mobile skirmishing infantry with spear and javelin           | Protection 7 and Morale 10 demand suitable targets and leadership.                                                                       |
| Alae Legionnaire          | Ten-gold armoured spear-and-javelin body                     | The cheap gold price is balanced by 20 resources and ordinary Morale 10.                                                                 |
| Hastatus                  | Short-sword legionnaire with javelin                         | Eleven gold and 21 resources; its value depends on whether the weapon profile reaches the target.                                        |
| Principe                  | Higher-skill, higher-morale legion line                      | Fourteen gold and 20 recruitment points reduce the number produced from a busy fort.                                                     |
| Triarius                  | Heavily protected long-spear line                            | Twenty-nine resources, 25 recruitment points, Encumbrance 10, and Combat Speed 6 make fatigue and contact central concerns.              |
| Emerald Guard             | Elite human bodyguard and line troop                         | Twenty gold, 30 resources, and 31 recruitment points make losses expensive; its broad sword still needs to beat the target's protection. |
| Standard                  | Legionnaire carrying the pinned Standard +1 field            | Twenty gold for a support effect that should be placed where morale support is actually needed.                                          |
| Serpent Cataphract        | Mobile heavy rider with a poisonous serpent mount            | Forty-five gold and 27 resources; rider and mount can be hit separately, and poison is not universal damage.                             |
| Battle Vestal             | Capital-only sacred skirmisher                               | Low protection and nine hit points place a premium on bless design, positioning, and casualty control.                                   |
| Hydra Hatchling and Hydra | Capital-only regenerating poison pieces                      | Fire Resistance -10, low combat speed, poison exposure, animal leadership, and friendly formation all need attention.                    |
| Theurg Communicant        | Troop-queue communion support                                | Fifty gold, 31 recruitment points, one per month, and unable to act independently while serving as a communion slave.                    |

The legion roster is a set of cost and weapon trades, not a single ladder from bad to good. Alae Legionnaires put armoured bodies on the field cheaply in gold. Principles and Emerald Guards buy stronger individual profiles at a higher gold and recruitment-point cost. Triarii add protection and reach but also heavy encumbrance. Reports about the enemy should decide which mix is produced.

## Pythium commander and mage portfolio

| Commander        | Paths or ability                                              | Main jobs                                                                                | Recruitment warning                                                                                         |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scout            | Stealth 50, forest and mountain survival                      | Exploration and army reporting                                                           | Thirty-five gold and no leadership role beyond scouting.                                                    |
| Assassin         | Stealth 65, Assassin, Patience +1                             | Targeted pressure and intelligence                                                       | Outcomes depend on the target, guards, arena, equipment, and rolls.                                         |
| Centurion        | Leadership 100                                                | Ordinary legion command                                                                  | Ninety-five gold and 21 resources; no priest or magic path.                                                 |
| Serpent Lord     | Leadership 75, Skilled Rider 2                                | Command for serpent-mounted forces and mobile detachments                                | The mount is a separate creature and does not share every rider protection.                                 |
| Emerald Lord     | Leadership 100                                                | Durable command and bodyguard work                                                       | One hundred twenty-five gold and 30 resources compete with an Emerald Guard group or infrastructure.        |
| Legatus Legionis | Leadership 150                                                | Main large-army command                                                                  | Two recruitment points and 150 gold; high capacity has value only when an army needs it.                    |
| Battle Deacon    | H1, sacred, Leadership 50                                     | Cheap priest and small military command                                                  | No non-Holy magic path and only one priest level.                                                           |
| Theurg Acolyte   | S1 H1, sacred                                                 | Lower-cost research, communion participation, preaching, and Astral support              | Two recruitment points for a fragile mage with low battlefield skills.                                      |
| Theurg           | A1 W1 S2 H2, sacred, Fortune Teller 5                         | Main repeatable mage-priest, battle communion master, research, and priest work          | Three hundred gold; using one in a Grand Communion also consumes its strategic turn.                        |
| Hydra Tamer      | Swamp Survival and Poison Resistance 15; pinned Beastmaster 2 | Hydra leadership and poison-aware support                                                | Capital-only, Leadership 10, and no magic path; it is a specialist, not a general commander.                |
| Arch Theurg      | A2 W1 S3 H3 plus pinned randoms, Fortune Teller 10            | High Astral ritual work, Grand Communion lead, Air-Water support, and high priest duties | Capital-only, 565 gold, and four recruitment points; the second pinned random is not printed in the manual. |

The ordinary-fort mage line is the strategic backbone. Acolytes put S1 and H1 in every developed recruitment centre. Theurgs provide the fixed A1 W1 S2 H2 package that supports several schools without waiting for a random. Arch Theurgs raise the ceiling, but a plan that uses them for every magical job will overload the capital and leave valuable ordinary forts underused.

## Reading the Arch Theurg random paths

The official manual prints the Arch Theurg as A2 W1 S3 H3 with one random level. The pinned 6.35 record resolves mask 2944 into Fire, Air, Water, or Astral and records two rolls:

- 1 one guaranteed level chosen equally from Fire, Air, Water, or Astral;
- 2 an independent 10% chance of a second level from the same four paths.

The mask components are 128, 256, 512, and 2048. The second slot is not visible in the manual's ?1 summary, so it remains pinned planning evidence without current 6.36 display confirmation.

## Arch Theurg distribution

| Portfolio result                         | Probability per Arch Theurg |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| No second random level                   | 90%                         |
| Second level matches the first path      | 2.5%                        |
| Second level is a different path         | 7.5%                        |
| Any one named path appears at least once | 26.875%                     |
| A chosen named path appears twice        | 0.625%                      |
| At least Air or Water appears            | 52.5%                       |

For Fire, the result is at least F1 on 26.875% of Arch Theurgs and F2 on 0.625%. Air results raise fixed A2 to at least A3, Water results raise W1 to at least W2, and Astral results raise S3 to at least S4. A matching second roll can rarely reach A4, W3, or S5.

Three independent Arch Theurgs give about a 60.90% chance of at least one result in a chosen named path. Five give about 79.09%, and ten about 95.63%. Those figures describe a recruitment portfolio, not a schedule. The capital cost, four-point queue, survival, and arrival order still decide whether a threshold exists when it is needed.

## Pythium native path boundary

| Path                                 | Repeatable access                                  | Boundary                                                                                                                        |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Astral                               | S1 Acolyte, S2 Theurg, S3 Arch Theurg, Arch random | Deep and widely recruitable; high ritual thresholds still require rare randoms, boosters, empowerment, summons, or a Pretender. |
| Air                                  | A1 Theurg, A2 Arch Theurg, Arch random             | Repeatable A1 and capital A2; A3 is conditional without a battle communion or another bridge.                                   |
| Water                                | W1 Theurg and Arch Theurg, Arch random             | Repeatable W1; W2 and W3 depend on capital randoms or an imported step.                                                         |
| Fire                                 | Arch Theurg random only                            | No fixed recruit has Fire. Even F1 access is a random portfolio result.                                                         |
| Holy                                 | H1 Deacon and Acolyte, H2 Theurg, H3 Arch Theurg   | Strong repeatable priest line; the hero Bartholomeus reaches H4.                                                                |
| Earth, Death, Nature, Glamour, Blood | No repeatable recruit                              | Must come from independents, a Pretender, empowerment, summons, transformations, or another proved bridge.                      |

The three pinned heroes do not fill a missing non-Holy path. Bartholomeus supplies A2 W2 S3 H4, while Marius Lorca and Hierogallus have no magic paths in the snapshot. Pythium owns two Nature rituals and two Nature-forged discounted items, but national ownership does not create a Nature caster or Nature gems.

## Grand Communion and ordinary communions

The manual distinguishes battlefield communions from Grand Communions. An ordinary Astral communion needs Communion Master and Communion Slave in effect. Masters gain one level with two slaves, two levels with four, three with eight, and so on. Spell fatigue is divided among participants and then modified by the slaves' path levels. If every master dies or flees, the slaves receive the printed backlash.

Theurgs and Acolytes can cast the Thaumaturgy 1 communion spells because they have Astral magic. The pinned Communicant field places that troop into the slave role automatically. This saves a setup action but also means a Communicant is not an independent battle caster. Exact survival still depends on master spells, slave paths, fatigue, resistances, buffs, battlefield timing, and enemy access to the rear.

Grand Communion is a strategic ritual order. The official example has an Arch Theurg cast Dispel while Theurgs and Acolytes in the province add their Astral levels. Each helper gives up its own activity for the turn. Grand Communion can make a key public ritual stronger, but it also concentrates mages and opportunity cost in one place. It should not be counted as a battlefield communion or as free ritual strength.

## Pythium national rituals and caster access

| ID  | Ritual                    | Research and paths   | Cost and result                                      | Verified native access                                                                                     |
|-----|---------------------------|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 477 | Contact Angel of the Host | Conjuration 5, S3    | 7 Astral pearls; one Angel of the Host               | Fixed Arch Theurg qualifies.                                                                               |
| 479 | Angelic Choir             | Conjuration 6, S3    | 15 Astral pearls; three Angels of the Heavenly Choir | Fixed Arch Theurg qualifies.                                                                               |
| 481 | Heavenly Wrath            | Conjuration 7, S3 F1 | 35 Astral pearls; one Angel of Fury                  | Requires an Arch Theurg with Fire or another S3 F1 caster; pinned native chance is 26.875% per Arch.       |
| 478 | Contact Harbinger         | Conjuration 6, S4    | 25 Astral pearls; one A3 H2 Harbinger                | Requires an Astral-random Arch or another S4 bridge; pinned chance is 26.875% per Arch.                    |
| 480 | Angelic Host              | Conjuration 7, S5    | 50 Astral pearls; six Angels of the Host             | A double-Astral Arch reaches S5 only under the pinned 0.625% result; otherwise another bridge is required. |
| 482 | Heavenly Choir            | Conjuration 9, S7 F2 | 144 Astral pearls; Seraph and choir host             | No recruit or hero meets both thresholds. This is a late external-access project.                          |
| 275 | Contact Lar               | Conjuration 5, N1    | 16 Nature gems; one W1 E1 N2 Lar                     | No recruit or pinned hero has Nature. An imported N1 caster and Nature economy are required.               |
| 274 | Awaken Hamadryad          | Enchantment 5, N4    | 25 Nature gems; one N3 Hamadryad                     | No native N4 caster. The printed summon also has map movement 0 and Research -4.                           |

The angelic branch aligns with the capital's five Astral pearls per month and fixed S3 Arch Theurg. The first two rituals are directly castable once research and pearls exist. Higher thresholds depend on the actual random portfolio, boosters, empowerment, a summon, or a Pretender. Grand Communion is not silently applied to ordinary unit-summoning rituals.

Contact Lar is the main national bridge into a missing path family. The ritual needs imported N1, but the summoned Lar carries W1 E1 N2. That can create Earth access and reach the printed N2 requirement of both national-discount items once the relevant Construction research and gems exist. Awaken Hamadryad remains harder because it needs N4 before producing an N3 unit.

## Pythium national item boundary

Two pinned item records carry a Pythium national-rebate field:

| ID  | Item                    | Construction and paths | Printed properties                                     | Access boundary                                                 |
|-----|-------------------------|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 41  | Gloves of the Gladiator | Construction 3, N2     | Magic Resistance +1, Strength +3, four attacks         | No native Nature mage; a Lar or another N2 bridge can forge it. |
| 269 | Hydra Skin Armor        | Construction 7, N2     | Hit Points +8, Regeneration 10%, Poison Resistance +15 | Same N2 boundary, with much later research.                     |

The structured rows establish a national rebate marker, not the final gem price shown after every discount, forge bonus, and rounding step. The live forge screen controls that number. Neither item should be counted as an early national asset until Pythium has a legal N2 forger, Nature gems, the research level, and a safe forge turn.

## Pythium national heroes

| ID  | Fixed name   | Unit name | Verified role or paths                                                                          |
|-----|--------------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 584 | Bartholomeus | Patriarch | A2 W2 S3 H4; high priest and fixed caster for the S3 angel rituals                              |
| 505 | Marius Lorca | Hero      | Mundane Leadership 100 commander with strong personal combat statistics; no magic path recorded |
| 506 | Hierogallus  | Hero      | Mounted Leadership 100 commander on Armored Serpent; Skilled Rider 3; no magic path recorded    |

Hero arrival is not a recruitment plan. Bartholomeus expands fixed Water and Holy depth but does not add Fire, Earth, Death, Nature, Glamour, or Blood. Marius and Hierogallus add command options, while Hierogallus retains the same rider-and-mount separation that applies to recruited serpent cavalry.

## Pythium opening priorities

The opening should secure four things before chasing the expensive ritual list:

- 1

a troop mix chosen for the nearby independent weapons, protection, numbers, and terrain;
- 2

enough leadership to move that mix without tying a Theurg to mundane command;
- 3

laboratories and forts that can recruit Acolytes and Theurgs away from the capital;
- 4

a deliberate capital split among Arch Theurgs, hydra support, Battle Vestals, Communicants, and ordinary troops.

No exact expansion count is supplied. Alae Legionnaires, Hastati, Principes, Triarii, Serpent Cataphracts, Vestals, and hydras all face different risks. Map generation, scales, bless, commander, formation, enemy composition, and combat rolls change the minimum safe force.

The first additional fort has special value because the best repeatable Theurg is not capital-only. A new lab and fort can expand the A1 W1 S2 H2 mage line while the capital handles Arch Theurgs and

site recruits. That benefit must still be compared with gold, travel time, resources, border safety, and the troops needed now.

## Pythium recruitment packages to evaluate from reports

### Legion core

Alae Legionnaires and Hastati provide affordable armoured bodies, Principes buy a stronger individual profile, and Triarii add protection and a long spear at a heavy resource and fatigue cost. Emerald Guards are the expensive elite option. The correct mix depends on the target's weapon length, damage, protection, missiles, and numbers; no legionary type is the answer to every province.

### Serpent wing

Serpent Cataphracts pair a protected rider with an Armored Serpent carrying 28 hit points, Protection 19, and a poisonous bite in the manual. They offer mobility and a different contact profile from the infantry line. The mount can be hit or killed separately, poison can be resisted, and a 45-gold rider must deliver enough value to justify the cost.

### Hydra group

Hydra Hatchlings and Hydras are capital-only pieces with regeneration, poison resistance, blunt and piercing resistance, and Fire Resistance -10 in the printed roster. The pinned rows add Animal, Undisciplined, poison-cloud, Beastmaster, and head-related fields. Use Hydra Tamers, separation, and poison-aware support while keeping exact cloud spread, friendly exposure, head loss, and regeneration behaviour open.

### Gladiator reserve

Retiarii and Gladiators cost little in resources and have useful contact profiles, but the pinned rows mark them Single Battle. They can be considered for a specific urgent fight, not silently counted as a permanent standing army. Current departure timing and the economic value of that exchange remain unresolved without live evidence.

## Pythium research response tree

Research begins with a battlefield or strategic problem and the caster already recruited. Pythium's paths offer several clean breakpoints, but a large list of reachable spells is not the same as one coherent army package.

### Branch A: Astral control and communions

Thaumaturgy 1 unlocks Communion Master and Communion Slave at S1. Thaumaturgy 2 adds Mind Burn at S2, Thaumaturgy 4 adds Paralyze at S2, and Thaumaturgy 5 adds Soul Slay at S3. Acolytes, Theurgs, and Arch Theurgs cover those fixed thresholds in different numbers, while communions can raise masters further.

This branch is selected when magic-resistance attacks, single-target control, or higher communion paths answer the enemy. It is weaker when the rear cannot be protected, slaves are too few or too fragile, fatigue is unmanaged, or the target's magic resistance makes the expected return poor.

## Branch B: Air, Water, and Astral battle support

Evocation 2 gives Lightning Bolt at A2, directly available to every Arch Theurg. Evocation 4 gives Thunder Strike at A3, requiring an Air-random Arch, communion support, or another bridge. Evocation 5 gives Stellar Cascades at S2. Alteration 3's Body Ethereal is available at S1, while Alteration 4's Quickness needs W2 and so requires a Water-random Arch, communion, or imported access.

The branch should be built around a named spell and formation. Air damage loses value against Shock Resistance, Astral effects can meet Magic Resistance or mindless targets, and short-range buffs require safe delivery. Research alone does not protect the caster or solve gem use.

## Branch C: national summons

Conjuration 5 is the first direct national threshold: fixed S3 Arch Theurgs can Contact Angel of the Host, while an imported N1 caster can Contact Lar. Conjuration 6 adds Angelic Choir and the conditional S4 Harbinger. Conjuration 7 adds Heavenly Wrath and Angelic Host. Heavenly Choir at Conjuration 9 is a separate legendary-scale commitment with an S7 F2 access problem.

Schedule each ritual from the caster and treasury backward. Pythium's Astral income supports the angel branch, but high capital mage costs, laboratory turns, and pearl stock still matter. The Nature branch needs a new gem economy as well as a legal caster.

## Branch D: Dispel and Grand Communion

Enchantment 5 gives Dispel at S3 and costs 30 Astral pearls before extra investment. A fixed Arch Theurg can cast it. The official Pythium example shows Theurgs and Acolytes joining through Grand Communion to add their Astral levels to the attempt.

This branch is a strategic answer to a specific global enchantment, not a routine use of every mage. The extra pearls, participating mage turns, concentration of valuable casters, and timing all need to be weighed against the global's actual harm.

# Pythium battlefield packages

## Legion line with Theurg support

A target-specific legion line supplies numbers and protection while Theurgs provide reachable Air, Water, Astral, and priest magic. Mundane commanders keep leadership separate from spell scripts. The package still needs a plan for armour that short swords cannot penetrate, flankers that reach the mages, and spells that hit friendly formations.

## Communion battery

Acolytes or Communicants provide slaves while Theurgs or Arch Theurgs act as masters chosen for specific path thresholds. Guards, spacing, fatigue planning, and a retreat route are part of the package. Adding more masters can multiply slave fatigue, and a master collapse can trigger backlash; size alone does not make the communion safe.



## Hydra containment group

Hydras occupy a separate pressure role with regeneration, fear on the full Hydra, head attacks, and poison. A Hydra Tamer supplies the pinned Beastmaster role. Ordinary legionnaires do not have printed Poison Resistance, so formation and separation matter. Fire damage, poison resistance, low combat speed, animal leadership, and hostile control can all reduce the group's value.

## Serpent flank and reserve

Serpent Cataphracts move and contact differently from the legions, while a Serpent Lord can lead a mounted detachment. Use them where their speed, rider profile, and mount attack solve a real positioning problem. Do not treat 19 mount protection as immunity or assume a dismounted rider retains the same battle plan.

## Pythium Pretender families

| Family                          | What it solves                                                                                 | What it must not conceal                                                                        |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Economy and production          | Funds 300-gold Theurgs, 565-gold Arch Theurgs, forts, and resource-heavy elites                | Extra income does not create capital commander turns, and extra resources do not pay mage gold. |
| Missing Nature and Earth bridge | Casts Contact Lar, starts Nature income, and can open the two national-discount items          | One Pretender does not create distributed sites, spare gems, or replacement forgers.            |
| Other missing-path bridge       | Adds Death, Glamour, Blood, dependable Fire, or another map-specific need                      | A theoretical late spell is not useful without research, gems, availability, and delivery.      |
| Sacred combat design            | Improves Battle Vestals and sacred mage-priests                                                | Most legionnaires, Serpent Cataphracts, and hydras receive no bless.                            |
| Resistance and communion safety | Helps sacred participants survive shock, poison, magic-resistance attacks, or fatigue pressure | A bless cannot fix poor slave ratios, exposed masters, bad scripts, or mundane troop losses.    |
| Awake expander                  | Supplies early independent-taking power and preserves legion recruitment                       | Afflictions, counters, delayed scales, and an unavailable god can erase the early gain.         |
| Astral ritual specialist        | Strengthens globals, Dispel plans, and high Astral access                                      | Pythium already has deep Astral; the design must justify what extra Astral solves.              |

Pythium often gains more from a missing bridge or economy plan than from repeating fixed S3 access. A Pretender path should have a first search target, first ritual or item, gem source, and backup plan. The Order +1 limit is useful only if the complete scale and awakening design benefits from it.

## Pythium matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                              | First answer to examine                                                                        | Avoid                                                                        |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed ordinary infantry                   | Legion depth, javelins, standards, buffs, and area magic                                       | Paying elite prices everywhere when cheaper bodies hold the required ground. |
| Heavy armour                               | Higher-damage weapons, Astral control, Air magic, summons, buffs, and target-specific counters | Assuming more short swords will solve protection they cannot penetrate.      |
| High Defence, ethereal, or Glamour targets | Area effects, attack support, magic weapons, Astral tools, and imported counters               | Relying on one expensive melee wing to make clean contact.                   |

| Enemy problem                                 | First answer to examine                                                         | Avoid                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| High Magic Resistance or mindless units       | Physical pressure, Air damage, buffs, summons, and non-MR effects               | Building the whole battle around Mind Burn, Paralyze, or Soul Slay.             |
| Shock-resistant armies                        | Astral, Water, mundane weapons, summons, and other imported damage              | Treating Air research as universal because Arch Theurgs have A2.                |
| Poison-resistant, undead, or inanimate armies | Legion damage, priest magic, Astral-Air packages, and non-poison summons        | Buying hydras for poison value the target largely ignores.                      |
| Fast flankers, flyers, and assassins          | Guards, reserves, dispersed mages, protected routes, and mundane commanders     | Placing every communion master and slave in one open rear cluster.              |
| Giants, trappers, and dense shock forces      | Long weapons, depth, control, buffs, poison where legal, and reserve lines      | Assuming formation density alone will hold a much larger contact profile.       |
| Raids and dispersed pressure                  | Centurions, Serpent Lords, forts, scouts, local troops, and replacement Theurgs | Keeping all magical capacity and mobile forces in the capital.                  |
| Underwater objectives                         | Amphibious independents or summons, items, and a separate logistics plan        | Treating W1 mages or a swimming hydra as proof of army-scale underwater access. |

## Monthly Pythium audit

- Is each fort limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, commander time, or travel distance?
- Does the legion mix answer the weapons, armour, numbers, and terrain actually reported nearby?
- Is a mundane commander available so a Theurg can keep its research or battle role?
- What is the capital commander queue buying this month, and why is it more urgent than the alternative?
- Are Communicants, Hydras, and other capital troops competing for a planned share of the troop queue?
- Has every Arch Theurg been labelled by its final displayed paths?
- Does each communion have named masters, slaves, path thresholds, guards, fatigue limits, and a retreat plan?
- Are Grand Communion helpers giving up turns for a ritual worth that cost?
- Does the current research target have a legal caster and a force that can use it?
- Are Air, Water, Astral, and Nature treasuries being treated as separate economies?
- Are hydras kept with appropriate leadership and away from unsupported poison-vulnerable troops?
- Can forts outside the capital replace Theurgs if the main army or capital is threatened?

## Pythium unresolved evidence boundary

The following claims remain open:

- 1 exact expansion-party ranges for each legion mix, Serpent Cataphracts, Battle Vestals, and hydras;
- 2 live 6.36 confirmation of the Arch Theurg's pinned 10% second random, which the manual does not display;
- 3 the current unit-card display and automatic battle behaviour of the Communicant's pinned Communion Slave field;
- 4 exact Hydra and Hydra Hatchling poison-cloud spread, friendly exposure, head-loss thresholds, regeneration, and recovery sequence;
- 5 current Single Battle departure timing for Retiarii and Gladiators;
- 6 displayed Gloves of the Gladiator and Hydra Skin Armor costs after the national rebate, other modifiers, and rounding;
- 7 battlefield communion scripts, fatigue distribution in a particular spell sequence, slave survival, and backlash outcomes;

- 8 current Grand Communion participant display, ritual timing, and opportunity cost in a particular game state;
- 9 Serpent Cataphract and Serpent Lord rider-and-mount outcomes under specific attacks;
- 10 assassination, underwater access, Pretender designs, and matchup performance on a particular map.

These are evidence gaps, not invitations to guess. No runtime test or new test asset was prepared during this unit. R-047, R-058, and the wider hands-on testing queue remain parked until testing is explicitly resumed.

## Part XXII: Middle Age Eriu, Last of the Tuatha

### Eriu one-page command brief

Middle Age Eriu joins ordinary Milesian infantry to terrain-dependent Fir Bolg recruitment and a capital-only Sidhe core. Eight commanders and five troops are available from ordinary forts. Highland and mountain forts add two Fir Bolg commanders and five Fir Bolg troops, while the capital adds those Fir Bolg choices plus the Tuatha commander and sacred Daoine Sidhe.

The reliable structure is:

- ordinary forts produce the full Milesian line, Bards, Sidhe Champions, Bean Sidhe, and Sidhe Lords;
- highland and mountain forts add Fir Bolg Druids, Fir Bolg Champions, and five Fir Bolg troop profiles;
- the capital's Mound of Ancient Kings provides two Nature and three Glamour gems each month, Tuatha, and Daoine Sidhe;
- Milesian Mages guarantee A1 E1 and one random level from Fire, Air, Earth, or Nature;
- Bean Sidhe guarantee W1 N1 G1 and one random level from Air, Water, Earth, Nature, or Glamour;
- Fir Bolg Druids guarantee A1 and one random level from Water, Earth, Nature, or Glamour;
- Tuatha guarantee N2 G3 H2, one random level, and a pinned independent 10% second level from the Bean Sidhe set;
- Geas and Summon Cu Sidhe are the two active national spell records; two additional nation-restricted placeholder rows are disabled and are not counted as usable magic.

Eriu's main planning problem is geography. A fort can be an ordinary Milesian centre, a highland or mountain Fir Bolg centre, or the capital with its unique Sidhe access. Strategy should therefore be built from the actual province network instead of assuming every fort can reproduce every army.

### Eriu evidence and ruleset

This chapter covers unmodded MA Eriu on the [Book I 6.36](#) live baseline. The revision-2 official manual controls player-facing roster values, recruitment locations, printed paths, national magic, item descriptions, and mount profiles. Identifiers, recruitment sets, capital-site fields, random masks, hero records, national restrictions, and item-rebate fields are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

The official 6.01 update says Eriu's recruit in mountain and highland forts did not work and records that correction. It also contains a presentation correction for the Bean Sidhe. These statements establish the direction of the fixes, but they do not replace the current manual's explicit recruitment lists or prove a current runtime outcome.

## Eriu conversion chain

Milesian capital, five monthly gems, and terrain-dependent recruits  
 -> target-specific expansion forces and reported highland or mountain sites  
 -> ordinary mage forts plus selected Fir Bolg recruitment centres  
 -> random-path portfolios, sacred Sidhe, and stealth-capable detachments  
 -> Glamour, Nature, Air, Water, Earth, and conditional Fire packages  
 -> dispersed pressure, summons, fortified borders, and Throne claims

The chain breaks when a terrain recruit is budgeted before the correct province and fort exist, when capital Tuatha are treated as a cheap answer, or when a random path is counted before a qualifying mage has actually been recruited. Eriu needs a roster ledger that distinguishes guaranteed access, random access, and location access.

## Eriu national rules that shape the plan

| Rule or asset                     | Operational consequence                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Luck limit +1                     | A Pretender may take one more Luck scale than the normal limit. It is an option whose value depends on the complete design.                                           |
| Standard forts                    | Ordinary infrastructure follows the normal fort system; terrain and capital recruitment remain separate restrictions.                                                 |
| Temples cost 300                  | Temple expansion has a lower printed gold price than the usual 400, improving priest and sacred infrastructure when a temple is actually needed.                      |
| Highland and mountain recruitment | Fir Bolg commanders and troops require the named terrain and a fort, except that the same roster is also available in the capital.                                    |
| Capital glamour mound             | The Mound of Ancient Kings produces N2 G3 each month and enables Tuatha and Daoine Sidhe.                                                                             |
| Spell Singer roster               | Bards, Sidhe Champions, Bean Sidhe, Sidhe Lords, and Tuatha have the printed Spell Singer ability. Exact chorus outcomes are left to current rules and battle states. |
| Glamour sacreds                   | Daoine Sidhe and the elite Sidhe commanders combine sacred status with Glamour. The ability does not make them immune to detection or all forms of damage.            |
| Mixed mounts                      | Sidhe Lords and Tuatha ride Fay Horses; Fir Bolg Charioteers use Chariots. Rider and mount have separate printed profiles.                                            |

## Eriu capital sites and recruitment geography

| Site or location                 | Verified fields                             | Recruitment consequence                                             |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mound of Ancient Kings, site 135 | Two Nature and three Glamour gems per month | Enables Tuatha and Daoine Sidhe in the capital                      |
| Fir Bolg Highlands, site 225     | No gem income recorded                      | Enables the Fir Bolg roster in the capital                          |
| Highland or mountain fort        | Nation recruitment attributes 690 and 691   | Enables five Fir Bolg troops, Fir Bolg Champion, and Fir Bolg Druid |
| Other fort                       | Ordinary fort tables                        | Enables eight ordinary commanders and five Milesian troops          |

The five capital gems do not pay troop gold or prove a caster for every Nature or Glamour threshold. Likewise, finding a mountain does not create Fir Bolg recruitment until the fort is complete. Recruitment geography should be recorded before construction begins.

## Complete Eriu commander membership

| ID   | Commander         | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment                        |
|------|-------------------|------|-----------|------------|---------------------------------------------|
| 1789 | Milesian Scout    | 35   | 4         | 1          | Forts                                       |
| 1783 | Milesian Champion | 55   | 22        | 1          | Forts                                       |
| 1784 | Milesian Monk     | 45   | 1         | 1          | Forts                                       |
| 2425 | Bard              | 105  | 5         | 2          | Forts                                       |
| 3887 | Milesian Mage     | 160  | 1         | 2          | Forts                                       |
| 850  | Sidhe Champion    | 225  | 19        | 2          | Forts                                       |
| 1774 | Bean Sidhe        | 285  | 1         | 2          | Forts                                       |
| 848  | Sidhe Lord        | 375  | 16        | 2          | Forts                                       |
| 1788 | Fir Bolg Champion | 70   | 12        | 1          | Capital, highland forts, and mountain forts |
| 2469 | Fir Bolg Druid    | 95   | 2         | 2          | Capital, highland forts, and mountain forts |
| 856  | Tuatha            | 630  | 22        | 4          | Capital only                                |

The eight ordinary records, two terrain commanders, and one capital commander reconcile to eleven distinct commanders. The manual, the fort table, the terrain attributes, and both capital sites agree on those membership classes.

## Complete Eriu troop membership

| ID   | Troop                                    | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment                        |
|------|------------------------------------------|------|-----------|------------|---------------------------------------------|
| 1779 | Milesian Slinger                         | 7    | 2         | 4          | Forts                                       |
| 1780 | Milesian Spearman                        | 10   | 9         | 11         | Forts                                       |
| 1781 | Milesian Longspear                       | 10   | 13        | 11         | Forts                                       |
| 1782 | Milesian Swordsman                       | 10   | 18        | 11         | Forts                                       |
| 3631 | Milesian Man at Arms                     | 14   | 24        | 20         | Forts                                       |
| 1785 | Fir Bolg Slinger                         | 12   | 2         | 14         | Capital, highland forts, and mountain forts |
| 1786 | Fir Bolg Clan Warrior, axe               | 15   | 10        | 18         | Capital, highland forts, and mountain forts |
| 1787 | Fir Bolg Clan Warrior, spear and javelin | 15   | 10        | 18         | Capital, highland forts, and mountain forts |
| 3630 | Fir Bolg Cattle Raider                   | 19   | 9         | 25         | Capital, highland forts, and mountain forts |
| 3634 | Fir Bolg Charioteer                      | 35   | 12        | 23         | Capital, highland forts, and mountain forts |
| 849  | Daoine Sidhe                             | 35   | 12        | 23         | Capital only                                |

The five ordinary records, five terrain records, and one capital record reconcile to eleven distinct troops. The two Clan Warriors share a name but have different object identifiers, weapons, and Defence values; they are preserved as separate profiles.

## Complete Eriu roster by job

| Unit or group                      | Best source-backed role                      | Important limit                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Milesian Slingers                  | Cheapest missile and siege bodies            | Morale 7 and weak melee values require leadership and protection.                                 |
| Milesian Spearmen and Longspears   | Affordable line and longer-weapon frontage   | Ordinary human statistics and moderate protection demand a target-specific formation.             |
| Milesian Swordsmen and Men at Arms | Shielded, more protected line                | Resources and recruitment points rise while damage remains that of human weapons.                 |
| Fir Bolg Slingers                  | Stronger stealth-capable slingers            | Need capital or the correct fortified terrain.                                                    |
| Fir Bolg Clan Warriors             | Axe damage or spear-and-javelin flexibility  | Fifteen gold and restricted recruitment; choose the actual weapon need.                           |
| Fir Bolg Cattle Raiders            | Higher-hit-point berserk shock infantry      | Berserk and low protection can increase losses after contact.                                     |
| Fir Bolg Charioteers               | Mobile mounted pressure                      | Chariot and rider outcomes are separate and Trample is not a universal answer.                    |
| Daoine Sidhe                       | Capital sacred with Glamour and Spell Singer | Thirty-five gold, capital queue pressure, and limited protection make casualty control important. |

## Eriu commander and mage portfolio

| Commander         | Paths or ability                         | Main jobs                                                       | Recruitment warning                                              |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Milesian Scout    | Forest and mountain survival, Stealth 50 | Intelligence and route checking                                 | Does not lead the field army.                                    |
| Milesian Champion | Leadership 75                            | Ordinary troop command                                          | Twenty-two resources compete with troop production.              |
| Milesian Monk     | H1, sacred                               | Preaching and inexpensive priest work                           | Leadership 10 and no non-Holy path.                              |
| Bard              | G1, Spy, Spell Singer, Stealth 50        | Intelligence, research, and low Glamour work                    | Two recruitment points for a single-path mage.                   |
| Milesian Mage     | A1 E1 plus F/A/E/N random                | Main affordable path-diversity recruit                          | A particular random cannot be scheduled as guaranteed.           |
| Sidhe Champion    | N1 G1 H1, Glamour, sacred                | Combat command, priest work, and magic support                  | Expensive for a one-level non-Holy path pair.                    |
| Bean Sidhe        | W1 N1 G1 plus A/W/E/N/G random           | Broad support, research, and random-path portfolio              | No Fire random and no guaranteed level two outside fixed totals. |
| Sidhe Lord        | N1 G2 H2, mounted, Glamour               | High leadership, priest work, and fixed G2                      | High gold cost and separate Fay Horse profile.                   |
| Fir Bolg Champion | Leadership 75, Berserker 3               | Terrain-force command                                           | Not available from an ordinary non-terrain fort.                 |
| Fir Bolg Druid    | A1 plus W/E/N/G random                   | Cheap terrain mage and path portfolio                           | Requires capital or a highland or mountain fort.                 |
| Tuatha            | N2 G3 H2 plus A/W/E/N/G randoms          | Highest native Glamour, ritual work, command, and priest duties | Capital only, 630 gold, and four recruitment points.             |

## Reading the Milesian Mage random paths

The manual prints A1 E1 and one random level. The pinned mask 9600 decodes as Fire, Air, Earth, or Nature, with one guaranteed equally likely result.

| Final non-Holy result | Probability |
|-----------------------|-------------|
| A1 E1 F1              | 25%         |
| A2 E1                 | 25%         |
| A1 E2                 | 25%         |
| A1 E1 N1              | 25%         |

This is Eriu's repeatable native Fire source. A selected result appears at least once with probability  $1 - 0.75^n$ : 57.81% after three Milesian Mages, 76.27% after five, and 94.37% after ten. Those figures describe a portfolio, not an arrival date.

## Reading the Bean Sidhe random paths

Bean Sidhe are fixed W1 N1 G1 and receive one guaranteed equally likely level from Air, Water, Earth, Nature, or Glamour. Mask 26368 therefore yields A1, W2, E1, N2, or G2 at 20% each.

A chosen result appears at least once with probability  $1 - 0.8^n$ : 48.80% after three Bean Sidhe, 67.23% after five, and 89.26% after ten. This provides broad access, but each recruit costs 285 gold and two recruitment points.

## Reading the Fir Bolg Druid random paths

Fir Bolg Druids are fixed A1 and receive one guaranteed equally likely level from Water, Earth, Nature, or Glamour. Mask 26112 therefore yields A1 W1, A1 E1, A1 N1, or A1 G1 at 25% each.

The Druid is cheaper than the ordinary Milesian Mage but is geographically restricted. Its value depends on whether a suitable fort is useful for the wider campaign, not merely whether the random mask is attractive.

## Reading the Tuatha random paths

The manual prints N2 G3 H2 and one random level. The pinned record applies the same Air, Water, Earth, Nature, or Glamour mask as the Bean Sidhe, then adds an independent 10% second roll from that mask.

| Portfolio result                          | Probability per Tuatha |
|-------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| No second random level                    | 90%                    |
| Second level repeats the first path       | 2%                     |
| Second level differs from the first       | 8%                     |
| A chosen named path appears at least once | 21.6%                  |
| A chosen named path appears twice         | 0.4%                   |

The extra slot is not exposed by the manual's single ?1 marker, so it remains pinned 6.35 planning evidence rather than a current live-display claim. The very high gold and recruitment-point cost also makes large-sample portfolio assumptions impractical.

## Eriu native path boundary

| Path                 | Repeatable access                                                            | Boundary                                                                                |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Glamour              | G1 Bard, G1 Sidhe Champion, G1 Bean Sidhe, G2 Sidhe Lord, G3 Tuatha, randoms | Deep fixed access, with capital G3 and conditional higher results.                      |
| Nature               | N1 Sidhe Champion, Bean Sidhe, and Sidhe Lord; N2 Tuatha; randoms            | Fixed N1 outside the capital and fixed capital N2.                                      |
| Air                  | A1 Milesian Mage and Fir Bolg Druid; randoms                                 | Fixed A1 is repeatable; higher Air requires a random or another bridge.                 |
| Water                | W1 Bean Sidhe; Bean and Druid randoms                                        | Fixed W1 is repeatable; W2 is a Bean random or another bridge.                          |
| Earth                | E1 Milesian Mage; Mage, Bean, and Druid randoms                              | Fixed E1 is repeatable; E2 is a Milesian Mage random or another bridge.                 |
| Fire                 | Milesian Mage random only                                                    | No fixed recruit has Fire.                                                              |
| Holy                 | H1 Monk and Sidhe Champion, H2 Sidhe Lord and Tuatha                         | H2 exists outside the capital on the Sidhe Lord.                                        |
| Astral, Death, Blood | No repeatable recruit                                                        | Require independents, summons, empowerment, Pretender access, or another proved bridge. |

## Eriu national spell and ritual reconciliation

| ID   | Name            | School        | Requirement | Cost           | Verified access                                                       |
|------|-----------------|---------------|-------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1294 | Geas            | Thaumaturgy 3 | G2          | 20 fatigue     | Sidhe Lord and Tuatha qualify; Bean Sidhe qualify on a Glamour random |
| 439  | Summon Cu Sidhe | Conjuration 3 | G2          | 5 Glamour gems | Sidhe Lord and Tuatha qualify; summons ten Cu Sidhe                   |

Two other nation-58 restriction rows, IDs 445 and 446, are named xxx, use school -1, and are disabled in the pinned spell table. They are retained in the evidence audit as placeholders and are not presented as playable national rituals.

## Eriu national item reconciliation

| ID  | Item           | Construction | Paths | Verified national field                    |
|-----|----------------|--------------|-------|--------------------------------------------|
| 345 | Gossamer Cloth | 3            | G2 N1 | National rebate includes nations 11 and 58 |
| 93  | Singing Sword  | 7            | G2    | National rebate includes nations 11 and 58 |

The manual describes Gossamer Cloth as veiling an army of up to 25 units and the Singing Sword as casting Entrancement. Sidhe Lords and Tuatha meet both printed path requirements. The final displayed cost after the national rebate, other modifiers, and rounding remains unresolved without a current forge screen.



## Eriu national hero records

| ID   | Fixed name or class | Unit name           | Verified magic or status                      |
|------|---------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 1777 | Ferdiad             | Fir Bolg Hero       | Mundane Leadership 100, Berserker 5           |
| 1778 | Cu Chulainn         | Hero                | Mounted mundane Leadership 100, Berserker 8   |
| 1794 | Tuan                | Last Partholonian   | A2 W1 D4 G2 H1; pinned latehero = 10          |
| 1844 | Scathach            | Trainer of Heroes   | A2 D2 G2 H1, Glamour, sacred                  |
| 1806 | Fianna              | Generic hero record | Sacred Leadership 150; no magic path recorded |

The first four are unique-hero attributes; Fianna is a generic or repeatable hero attribute. No arrival turn, frequency, or guaranteed strategic role is derived from either the hero slot or the uninterpreted latehero value.

## Eriu patch reconciliation

Update 6.01, published 19 January 2024, states that Eriu's recruit in mountain and highland forts did not work. The current official manual explicitly lists the Fir Bolg units and commanders available in the capital and in fortified highland or mountain provinces, while the pinned data records the same terrain sets. The chapter therefore treats the current recruitment locations as intended rules and does not invent the earlier failure mode.

The same update includes a Bean Sidhe presentation correction. It supports only that a display asset changed; it does not establish a rules or balance change. No later direct Eriu roster change was found in the official ledger through 6.36.

## Eriu opening priorities

The opening should secure ordinary troop production, leadership, scouting, and an affordable mage stream before assuming a terrain fort or repeated Tuatha. Milesian units can form the initial army while Scouts identify routes and suitable fort provinces. Exact expansion counts remain open because map generation, scales, bless, formation, opposing roster, and combat rolls change them.

A first fort has two different strategic meanings. An ordinary province expands Milesian Mages, Bean Sidhe, Sidhe Lords, and the human army. A highland or mountain adds cheap Fir Bolg Druids and the terrain troop package. The correct choice depends on distance, resources, defence, construction time, and the path portfolio already available.

## Eriu recruitment packages to evaluate from reports

### Milesian line

Spearmen and Longspears provide inexpensive frontage, while Swordsmen and Men at Arms buy more protection at higher resource and recruitment-point costs. Slingers add cheap ranged bodies. Choose the mix from the reported target rather than treating the more expensive profile as automatically superior.

## **Fir Bolg terrain force**

Fir Bolg offer higher hit points and magic resistance than the ordinary Milesian line, plus stealth on most profiles. Axe and spear Clan Warriors answer different targets; Cattle Raiders add berserk pressure; Charioteers add a separate mount profile. Their restricted recruitment makes replacement geography part of the plan.

## **Sidhe sacred group**

Daoine Sidhe and sacred commanders combine Glamour with higher defence and magic resistance. They remain limited by capital access, gold, recruitment points, and ordinary battlefield counters. A bless should solve a named problem instead of assuming Glamour replaces protection, numbers, or retreat planning.

## **Eriu research response tree**

### **Branch A: Glamour control and national magic**

Thaumaturgy 3 provides Geas at G2, while Conjunction 3 provides Summon Cu Sidhe at G2 for five Glamour gems. Sidhe Lords give fixed non-capital G2 and Tuatha give capital G3. This branch is attractive when its control effect or stealth-capable sacred summons answer the current opponent, not simply because it is national.

### **Branch B: Air and Earth support**

Milesian Mages always bring A1 E1 and can random higher Air or Earth. Fir Bolg Druids always bring A1. Research should be chosen around a spell that the existing mage can cast and deliver. A theoretical A2 or E2 package should stay conditional until the matching random exists.

### **Branch C: Nature, Water, and sacred support**

Nature is fixed across the Sidhe line and reaches N2 on Tuatha, while Bean Sidhe provide fixed W1 and conditional W2. This supports buffs, protection, recovery, and summons at different research thresholds. Gem income remains separate: the capital supplies Nature but no Water gems.

### **Branch D: forging and path bridges**

Construction 3 exposes the nationally discounted Gossamer Cloth and other low-level utility items; Construction 7 exposes the Singing Sword. Forging should begin from a current requirement, available caster, and gem budget. It should not consume the Glamour treasury needed for an imminent Cu Sidhe summon without an explicit trade-off.

## **Eriu battlefield packages**

### **Human line with mage support**

Milesian infantry supply replaceable frontage while Milesian Mages, Bards, and Bean Sidhe provide the selected spell package. A mundane Champion keeps troop leadership separate from mage turns. The package still needs answers to armour, high defence, missiles, fatigue, and rear attacks.

### Fir Bolg stealth detachment

A terrain fort can combine stealth-capable Fir Bolg troops with a Champion or Druid. This can create a distinct movement and information package, but exact stealth discovery, interception, and battle outcomes remain dependent on current rules and game state.

### Sidhe sacred pressure

Daoine Sidhe, Sidhe Champions, Sidhe Lords, and Tuatha can combine sacred status, Glamour, and Spell Singer access. Their gold and capital constraints make concentration expensive. The force should have a clear target, retreat line, and replacement plan.

## Eriu Pretender families

| Family                                 | What it solves                                                              | What it must not conceal                                                        |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Economy and production                 | Funds forts, 285-gold Bean Sidhe, 375-gold Sidhe Lords, and 630-gold Tuatha | Income does not create commander turns or suitable terrain.                     |
| Missing Astral, Death, or Blood bridge | Opens searches, rituals, or counters absent from repeatable recruits        | A path without research, gems, and delivery is not a working bridge.            |
| Sacred combat design                   | Improves Daoine Sidhe and sacred commanders                                 | Most Milesian and Fir Bolg troops receive no bless.                             |
| Resistance design                      | Protects sacreds against a reported damage or control class                 | One resistance does not solve mundane attrition, fatigue, or positioning.       |
| Awake expander                         | Supplies early independent-taking power while preserving troop recruitment  | Afflictions, counters, and delayed economy can erase the advantage.             |
| Luck-oriented design                   | Uses Eriu's Luck +1 legal limit                                             | The extra point must justify its opportunity cost within the full scale design. |

## Eriu matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                | First answer to examine                                                  | Avoid                                                                    |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light troops          | Longer weapons, missiles, formation depth, buffs, and area magic         | Spending capital sacreds on work ordinary lines can perform.             |
| Heavy armour                 | Axes, buffs, magic, summons, and target-specific counters                | Assuming more low-damage human attacks will penetrate.                   |
| High Defence or Glamour      | Area effects, attack support, magic weapons, and control                 | Treating Eriu's own high Defence as proof it counters the same mechanic. |
| High Magic Resistance        | Physical pressure, buffs, and non-MR effects                             | Building the battle solely around Geas or other resistance checks.       |
| Fire pressure                | Appropriate resistance, spacing, and nonflammable or expendable layers   | Concentrating expensive sacreds without a tested answer.                 |
| Fast flankers or flyers      | Guards, reserves, dispersed mages, and protected routes                  | Leaving costly Spell Singers in an open rear cluster.                    |
| Raids and dispersed pressure | Scouts, Bards, local forts, terrain recruits, and replacement commanders | Keeping every important mage and sacred in the capital.                  |
| Underwater objectives        | Amphibious independents, summons, items, and a separate logistics plan   | Treating W1 Bean Sidhe as army-scale underwater access.                  |

## Monthly Eriu audit

- Which forts are ordinary, highland, mountain, or capital recruitment centres?
- Is each queue limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, terrain, or travel distance?
- Does the current troop mix answer the reported weapons, protection, numbers, and terrain?
- Has every random mage been labelled by final displayed paths before receiving a job?
- Is Fire being treated as conditional rather than guaranteed?
- Are capital commander turns being spent on Tuatha only when G3, N2, H2, or high leadership is required?
- Are Nature and Glamour income budgeted separately from Air, Water, Earth, and Fire needs?
- Does each research target have a legal caster, treasury, force, and delivery route?
- Are sacred and stealth forces assigned a retreat and replacement plan?
- Is a new fort being placed for its actual ordinary or terrain roster?

## Eriu unresolved evidence boundary

The following claims remain open:

- 1 exact expansion-party ranges for Milesian, Fir Bolg, and Daoine Sidhe forces;
- 2 live 6.36 confirmation of the Tuatha's pinned 10% second random, which the manual does not display;
- 3 current terrain-recruit interface and any edge case left by the old 6.01 bug;
- 4 displayed Singing Sword and Gossamer Cloth costs after national rebates, other modifiers, and rounding;
- 5 exact Geas targeting and resistance outcomes in a particular battle;
- 6 Spell Singer timing, chorus composition, fatigue, interruption, and survival outcomes;
- 7 Glamour, stealth, and detection interactions already parked under R-058;
- 8 rider, Fay Horse, Chariot, and dismount outcomes under specific attacks;
- 9 hero arrival timing, generic Fianna frequency, and the meaning of Tuan's pinned late-hero value;
- 10 specific Pretender designs, scripts, and matchup performance on a generated map.

These are evidence gaps, not invitations to guess. No runtime test or new test asset was prepared during this unit. R-047, R-058, and the wider hands-on testing queue remain parked until testing is explicitly resumed.

# Part XXIII: Middle Age Agartha, Golem Cult

## Agartha one-page command brief

Middle Age Agartha combines protected human infantry with Pale One cave recruits, capital sacred giants, underwater recruitment, and an Earth-led priest-mage corps. Seven commanders and seven troops appear in the ordinary fort tables. The capital adds two commanders and three sacred troops through three national sites, while underwater forts add a Wet One Captain and an armoured Wet One profile.

The reliable structure is:

- ordinary forts recruit the human infantry line, Pale and Wet Ones, Troglodyte Slaves, and all repeatable non-capital mages;

- every cave province can recruit Pale One Captains, Pale One Soldiers, and the lightly armoured Wet One even without a fort;
- cave forts receive extra gold and resources, although the official nation page gives no arithmetic for the increase;
- Golem Crafters guarantee F1 W1 E2 H1 and qualify for the early Fire, Water, and Earth national rituals;
- capital Oracles guarantee E3 D1 H3, one full W/E/D random, and a pinned independent 10% second W/E/D random;
- the capital produces F1 E3 D1 each month and supplies Ancient Ones, Ancient Stone Hurlers, Shard Guards, Ancient Lords, and Oracles;
- twelve national rituals form summon ladders for magma, elementals, olms, living statues, mercury, shadow beings, and undead Pale Ones;
- the manual states that constructs gain Hit Points inside Agartha's dominion, but exact candle scaling and affected ownership classes remain unresolved.

Agartha's central planning problem is conversion. Slow, well-protected troops and deep Earth access become strategically valuable only when the nation also budgets commander turns, research, mixed gem types, cave infrastructure, and movement to the target.

## Agartha evidence and ruleset

This chapter covers unmodded MA Agartha on the [Book I 6.36](#) live baseline. The revision-2 official manual controls player-facing roster values, explicit recruitment locations, printed paths, national rules, capital-site output, and national ritual tables. Identifiers, membership sets, site fields, random masks, hero records, and nation restrictions are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

Official update 6.04, published 2 February 2024, includes a short Lich-shape correction for Agarthan Oracles. The note establishes that an Oracle transformation record was corrected, but it does not supply the resulting form, trigger, or present-game sequence. Those details are not reconstructed from the headline.

## Agartha conversion chain

protected infantry, cave access, and five monthly gems  
-> target-specific expansion groups and surveyed cave routes  
-> ordinary mage forts plus protected capital recruitment  
-> Earth-led research and separate Fire, Water, Earth, and Death budgets  
-> elementals, olms, statues, shadows, undead, and battlefield support  
-> durable fronts, cave logistics, sieges, and Throne claims

The chain breaks when the capital queue is treated as unlimited, when slow troops are sent on a deadline they cannot meet, when a national ritual is counted without its gem type, or when an Oracle random is assumed before the commander exists.

## Agartha national rules that shape the plan

| Rule or asset        | Operational consequence                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Humans and Pale Ones | The roster contains different size, movement, amphibious, leadership, and equipment profiles; one formation does not fit all of them.                         |
| Darkvision           | Agarthan profiles carry substantial Darkvision, which is relevant underground and in darkness but does not remove other combat penalties or targeting limits. |

| Rule or asset                  | Operational consequence                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cave recruitment               | Pale One Captains, Pale One Soldiers, and the light Wet One profile are available in all caves as well as forts.                                         |
| Cave-fort economy              | The nation page promises extra gold and resources in cave forts; the exact increase is not printed there and remains an arithmetic boundary.             |
| Poor amphibians and amphibians | Several Pale One and construct profiles can enter water with different limitations; army-scale underwater readiness still depends on the complete force. |
| Golem Cult                     | Constructs receive increased Hit Points inside friendly dominion according to the nation page. Exact scaling and ownership coverage remain unresolved.   |
| Bless points +1                | The Pretender design receives one additional bless point. It does not by itself choose a useful bless.                                                   |
| Standard forts                 | Ordinary fort construction follows the standard system, with the separate cave-fort economy rule layered on top.                                         |

## Agartha capital sites and recruitment geography

| Site or location                         | Verified fields                         | Recruitment consequence                                                             |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Roots of the Earth, site 110             | One Fire and three Earth gems per month | Supplies most of the capital's gem income                                           |
| Halls of the Oracles, site 111           | No gem income recorded                  | Enables Ancient Lord, Oracle of the Ancients, Ancient One, and Ancient Stone Hurler |
| The Chamber of the Broken Seal, site 166 | One Death gem per month                 | Enables Shard Guard                                                                 |
| Any cave                                 | Nation cave-recruit attributes          | Enables Pale One Captain, Pale One Soldier, and the light Wet One profile           |
| Underwater fort                          | Underwater recruitment attributes       | Enables Wet One Captain and the armoured Wet One profile                            |

The capital therefore produces five gems each month: F1 E3 D1. It produces no Water gems even though Golem Crafters have W1 and Olm Conclave and Living Mercury require Water gems. A legal caster and a funded ritual are separate claims.

## Complete Agartha commander membership

| ID   | Commander                | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment |
|------|--------------------------|------|-----------|------------|----------------------|
| 1448 | Agarthan Scout           | 35   | 4         | 1          | Forts                |
| 2483 | Troglodyte Trainer       | 60   | 15        | 1          | Forts                |
| 1471 | Pale One Captain         | 65   | 18        | 1          | Forts and all caves  |
| 1445 | Cave Captain             | 95   | 22        | 1          | Forts                |
| 1475 | Attendant of the Oracles | 65   | 1         | 1          | Forts                |
| 1473 | Earth Reader             | 115  | 1         | 2          | Forts                |
| 1474 | Golem Crafter            | 295  | 2         | 2          | Forts                |
| 2506 | Ancient Lord             | 175  | 23        | 1          | Capital only         |
| 1459 | Oracle of the Ancients   | 540  | 1         | 4          | Capital only         |

| ID   | Commander       | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment |
|------|-----------------|------|-----------|------------|----------------------|
| 1638 | Wet One Captain | 50   | 6         | 1          | Underwater forts     |

The seven ordinary records, two capital records, and one underwater record reconcile to ten distinct commanders. The Pale One Captain is both an ordinary fort commander and a cave recruit, so it is counted once.

## Complete Agartha troop membership

| ID   | Troop                   | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment |
|------|-------------------------|------|-----------|------------|----------------------|
| 1472 | Pale One Soldier        | 9    | 14        | 18         | Forts and all caves  |
| 1489 | Wet One, light          | 9    | 1         | 18         | Forts and all caves  |
| 1354 | Agarthan Heavy Infantry | 10   | 27        | 9          | Forts                |
| 1355 | Agarthan Infantry       | 10   | 22        | 9          | Forts                |
| 1447 | Agarthan Light Infantry | 10   | 10        | 9          | Forts                |
| 2507 | Defender of the Halls   | 13   | 23        | 26         | Forts                |
| 2482 | Troglodyte Slave        | 50   | 1         | 40         | Forts                |
| 2188 | Ancient One             | 40   | 27        | 32         | Capital only         |
| 2189 | Ancient Stone Hurler    | 40   | 13        | 32         | Capital only         |
| 2508 | Shard Guard             | 45   | 34        | 30         | Capital only         |
| 1636 | Wet One, armoured       | 9    | 5         | 18         | Underwater forts     |

The seven ordinary records, three capital records, and one underwater record reconcile to eleven distinct troops. The two Wet One rows retain separate identifiers, equipment, protection, combat values, and recruitment channels.

## Complete Agartha roster by job

| Unit or group         | Best source-backed role                                  | Important limit                                                                                        |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Agarthan infantry     | Protected human frontage at three resource levels        | Slow map and combat movement make route and formation planning important.                              |
| Pale One Soldier      | Large amphibious cave recruit with siege strength        | Low Attack and Defence require support and target selection.                                           |
| Wet Ones              | Cheap amphibious bodies from cave or underwater channels | The light and armoured profiles are not interchangeable.                                               |
| Defender of the Halls | Larger, shielded poor-amphibian line                     | High recruitment-point and resource costs limit massing.                                               |
| Troglodyte Slave      | Large trampling shock unit                               | High gold, recruitment-point cost, low Magic Resistance, and friendly positioning risks constrain use. |
| Ancient One           | Capital sacred heavy infantry                            | Capital access, 40 gold, 27 resources, and 32 recruitment points make losses costly.                   |
| Ancient Stone Hurler  | Capital sacred boulder thrower and siege body            | Low Defence and limited capital production require protection.                                         |
| Shard Guard           | Capital sacred glaive unit with poison resistance        | Highest resource cost in the roster and slow movement restrict replacement and delivery.               |

## Agartha commander and mage portfolio

| Commander                | Paths or ability                             | Main jobs                                             | Recruitment warning                                  |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Agarthan Scout           | Stealth 50, forest and mountain survival     | Intelligence and route checking                       | Does not lead the field army.                        |
| Troglodyte Trainer       | Taskmaster +2, Leadership 20                 | Directing slave formations                            | Limited leadership and no magic path.                |
| Pale One Captain         | Leadership 75, amphibious, siege strength +5 | Cave and amphibious force command                     | Slow movement and 18 resources.                      |
| Cave Captain             | Leadership 100                               | Human army command                                    | Twenty-two resources compete with infantry.          |
| Attendant of the Oracles | H1                                           | Inexpensive priest work                               | Leadership 10 and no non-Holy path.                  |
| Earth Reader             | E1 H1, Fortune Teller 5                      | Research, low Earth, preaching, event support         | Two recruitment points for a shallow mage.           |
| Golem Crafter            | F1 W1 E2 H1                                  | Main repeatable mage, early national rituals, forging | 295 gold and two recruitment points.                 |
| Ancient Lord             | Sacred Leadership 100                        | Capital sacred command and siege leadership           | Capital commander turn with no magic path.           |
| Oracle of the Ancients   | E3 D1 H3 plus W/E/D randoms                  | Deep Earth, Death, high priest work, national rituals | 540 gold, four recruitment points, and capital only. |
| Wet One Captain          | Amphibious Leadership 75                     | Underwater recruitment command                        | Underwater fort only and no magic path.              |

## Reading the Oracle random paths

The manual prints E3 D1 H3 and ?1. The pinned record uses mask 5760, which decodes as Water, Earth, or Death. It gives one guaranteed equally likely level and an independent 10% second roll from the same three paths.

| Primary result | Probability | Final paths before the second roll |
|----------------|-------------|------------------------------------|
| Water          | 33.33%      | W1 E3 D1 H3                        |
| Earth          | 33.33%      | E4 D1 H3                           |
| Death          | 33.33%      | E3 D2 H3                           |

The second slot produces no extra level 90% of the time, repeats the primary path 3.33% of the time overall, and adds a different path 6.67% of the time overall. A chosen named path appears in at least one slot with probability 35.56%; two levels in that chosen path occur with probability 1.11%.

The manual exposes only one random marker, so the second slot remains pinned 6.35 planning evidence rather than a current live-display claim.

## Agartha native path boundary

| Path  | Repeatable access                                            | Boundary                                                                      |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Earth | E1 Earth Reader, E2 Golem Crafter, E3 Oracle, Oracle randoms | Deep fixed access; E5 without equipment is a rare double-Earth Oracle result. |



| Path                                | Repeatable access                                        | Boundary                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fire                                | F1 Golem Crafter                                         | Fixed F1 qualifies for Rhuax Pact; higher Fire requires a bridge.                       |
| Water                               | W1 Golem Crafter, Oracle random                          | Fixed W1 exists but the capital supplies no Water gems.                                 |
| Death                               | D1 Oracle, Oracle random                                 | D2 requires a qualifying Oracle random or another bridge.                               |
| Holy                                | H1 Attendant, Earth Reader, and Golem Crafter; H3 Oracle | The capital has repeatable H3 but at high cost and queue pressure.                      |
| Air, Astral, Nature, Glamour, Blood | No repeatable recruit                                    | Require independents, summons, empowerment, Pretender access, or another proved bridge. |

Olm Conclave can add an Olm Sage with W2 E1, but a summoned commander is not starting access. It requires Conjunction 4, W1 E1, twenty Water gems, and a ritual turn.

## Agartha national ritual reconciliation

| ID  | Ritual                | School        | Requirement | Cost          | Printed result               |
|-----|-----------------------|---------------|-------------|---------------|------------------------------|
| 608 | Rhuax Pact            | Conjunction 3 | F1 E1       | 2 Fire gems   | 3 Magma Children             |
| 609 | Barathrus Pact        | Conjunction 3 | E2          | 3 Earth gems  | 2 Earth Elementals           |
| 603 | Olm Conclave          | Conjunction 4 | W1 E1       | 20 Water gems | 1 Olm Sage and 15 Great Olms |
| 616 | Living Mercury        | Enchantment 5 | W1 E1       | 6 Water gems  | 1 Living Mercury             |
| 611 | Attentive Statues     | Enchantment 1 | E2          | 3 Earth gems  | 2 Attentive Statues          |
| 612 | Enliven Sentinel      | Enchantment 3 | E2          | 2 Earth gems  | 1 Sentinel                   |
| 613 | Enliven Granite Guard | Enchantment 5 | E3          | 10 Earth gems | 1 Granite Guardian           |
| 614 | Enliven Marble Oracle | Enchantment 6 | E3 D1       | 35 Earth gems | 1 H2 Marble Oracle           |
| 604 | Hall of Statues       | Enchantment 8 | E5          | 30 Earth gems | 20 or more Sentinels         |
| 601 | Summon Penumbrals     | Conjunction 3 | D1 E1       | 6 Death gems  | 6 Penumbrals                 |
| 622 | Awaken Shard Wights   | Conjunction 3 | D1 E1       | 10 Death gems | 5 or more Shard Wights       |
| 602 | Summon Umbrals        | Conjunction 5 | D2 E1       | 8 Death gems  | 6 Umbrals                    |

The current manual controls the counts shown here. 20+ and 5+ are deliberately retained as variable results; no extra-path scaling formula is invented. The pinned nation restrictions confirm all twelve rows for nation 59.

## Agartha ritual access from repeatable mages

Golem Crafters directly qualify for Rhuax Pact, Barathrus Pact, Olm Conclave, Living Mercury, Attentive Statues, and Enliven Sentinel. Every Oracle directly qualifies for Enliven Granite Guard, Enliven Marble Oracle, Summon Penumbrals, and Awaken Shard Wights.

Summon Umbrals requires D2, so it needs an Oracle with at least one Death random or another proved Death bridge. Hall of Statues requires E5. Without equipment, only the 1.11% Oracle result with Earth in both random slots reaches E5. With an Earth booster, any Oracle with Earth in at least one random slot reaches the printed threshold; that portfolio probability is 35.56%, subject to the booster, research, gems, and forge turn actually existing.

## Agartha capital and ritual gem economy

The capital's F1 E3 D1 income aligns well with Rhuax Pact, the statue line, Penumbrals, and Shard Wights. It does not fund Water rituals by itself. Earth gems also compete among battlefield use, boosters, construction, Barathrus Pact, statues, and late Hall of Statues. Death gems compete among both shadow and undead summon lines.

A ritual plan should record four separate facts:

- 1 the caster's current displayed paths;
- 2 the research level and school;
- 3 the available gem type and amount;
- 4 the army, commander, and route that will use the result.

## Agartha national hero records

| ID   | Fixed name  | Unit name               | Verified magic or status                                         |
|------|-------------|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1846 | Kin-Breaker | Onyx Oracle             | W1 E3 H3; inanimate stone magic being; pinned late-hero field 20 |
| 1847 | Golog       | Decrepit                | E3 D4 H1; pinned transformation fields and late-hero field 10    |
| 1848 | Klaus       | Mason of the Underworld | F1 W1 E2 D3 H1; Mason, forge bonus 1, Stealth 80, Spy            |

The three unique-hero attributes identify a powerful but non-repeatable path expansion. The late-hero and transformation fields are recorded as structured metadata only; no arrival turn, probability, death sequence, or Lich outcome is inferred.

## Agartha patch reconciliation

Update 6.04 records a Lich-shape correction for Agarthan Oracles. The note is relevant to Oracle transformations but contains no numerical detail and does not identify a current roster or path change. It is therefore preserved as patch metadata and an unresolved transformation boundary.

No later direct nation, roster, or national-ritual name match was found in the official ledger through 6.36. This is a ledger result, not proof that no undocumented engine behaviour changed.

## Agartha opening priorities

The opening should secure leadership, scouting, protected frontage, and an affordable research stream before assuming repeated 540-gold Oracles. Human infantry offer resource-scaled protection choices; Pale Ones and Wet Ones widen cave access; Troglodyte Slaves supply a costly trampling option. Exact expansion counts remain open because map generation, scales, bless, formation, opposing roster, and combat rolls change them.

A cave fort can combine ordinary national recruitment with the printed cave economy benefit, but its value still depends on province income, resources, position, construction time, and exposure. The manual does not provide the exact extra-income formula on the nation page, so the chapter does not assign one.

## Agartha recruitment packages to evaluate from reports

### Protected human line

Light, standard, and heavy Agarthan infantry trade resources and encumbrance for protection. Select the profile that survives the reported weapons without delaying the rest of the queue. Cave Captains keep troop command separate from mage turns.

### Pale One cave group

Pale One Soldiers and Captains add larger bodies, amphibious movement, and siege strength from any cave. Their lower Attack, Defence, Precision, and movement need formation and support. Cave availability does not eliminate the need to pay gold, resources, recruitment points, and travel time.

### Capital sacred group

Ancient Ones, Ancient Stone Hurlers, and Shard Guards give the capital three distinct sacred profiles. Their high recruitment-point and resource costs make mixed production and casualty control important. The extra bless point should solve a named weakness rather than merely encourage sacred concentration.

### Troglodyte shock group

Troglodyte Slaves provide size, strength, and Trample. A Trainer supplies Taskmaster support. The package still needs a formation that protects friendly troops and a target whose size and resistance make the cost worthwhile.

## Agartha research response tree

### Branch A: early Conjunction

Conjunction 3 opens Rhuax Pact, Barathrus Pact, Summon Penumbrals, and Awaken Shard Wights. Golem Crafters cover the Fire and Earth pair; Oracles cover the Death pair. The correct first summon depends on available gems and the enemy rather than national status alone.

### Branch B: Enchantment constructs

Enchantment 1 and 3 open the cheapest statue rituals, while levels 5, 6, and 8 add Living Mercury, Granite Guardians, Marble Oracles, and Hall of Statues. The branch converts Earth and Water gems into durable units, but movement, magic leadership, poison fumes, and repair or healing rules differ by summon.

### Branch C: Earth battlefield support

Earth Readers, Golem Crafters, and Oracles provide a fixed E1-E3 ladder before randoms or boosters. Research should be chosen around the protection, control, fatigue, or damage problem actually reported. Deep paths do not make a slow army arrive sooner.

### Branch D: construction and boosters

Construction can turn repeatable E2 into Earth equipment and widen the Oracle's ritual ceiling. Every booster consumes gems and a mage turn and should be tied to a named threshold, especially Hall of Statues or another high-Earth objective.

## Agartha battlefield packages

### Protected line with Crafter support

Human infantry provide the line while Golem Crafters supply selected Fire, Water, and Earth magic. A Cave Captain handles command. The package needs a deliberate answer to fatigue, armour-piercing damage, flanks, and rear attacks.

### Mixed Pale One and statue force

Pale Ones add amphibious bodies and siege strength; summoned statues add inanimate protection and patrol ability. Leadership, magic leadership, movement, and repair assumptions must be checked for every component rather than inferred from the word construct.

### Oracle-led capital force

An Oracle can combine H3, E3, D1, random paths, and sacred leadership support around the capital roster. The commander is expensive and slow to recruit, so battle exposure, scripting, and replacement cost should be explicit.

## Agartha Pretender families

| Family                                                | What it solves                                                               | What it must not conceal                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Economy and production                                | Funds 295-gold Crafters, 540-gold Oracles, forts, and resource-heavy sacreds | Income does not create capital commander turns or movement.          |
| Missing Air, Astral, Nature, Glamour, or Blood bridge | Opens searches, rituals, or counters absent from repeatable recruits         | A path without gems, research, and delivery is not a working bridge. |
| Water-income bridge                                   | Funds Olm Conclave and Living Mercury from native casters                    | Water paths alone do not create Water gems.                          |

| Family                    | What it solves                                                                              | What it must not conceal                                                                            |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sacred combat design      | Uses the extra bless point on Ancient Ones, Stone Hurlers, Shard Guards, and sacred summons | Most human troops, Wet Ones, and Troglodyte Slaves receive no bless.                                |
| Construct-oriented design | Supports a statue and summoned-construct plan                                               | Exact Golem Cult scaling and ownership remain unresolved, and enemies may bring construct counters. |
| Awake expander            | Supplies early independent-taking power while preserving troop recruitment                  | Afflictions, counters, and delayed scales can erase the early gain.                                 |

## Agartha matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                              | First answer to examine                                                                       | Avoid                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light infantry                      | Protected lines, trampling where legal, Magma Children, and area magic                        | Paying capital-sacred prices for work ordinary troops can perform. |
| Heavy armour                               | High-strength Pale Ones, Earth support, elementals, fatigue, and target-specific magic        | Assuming ordinary short swords will solve high protection.         |
| Armour-piercing or armour-negating damage  | Spacing, resistance, summons, disruption, and a different line profile                        | Treating high mundane protection as universal defence.             |
| High Defence, ethereal, or Glamour targets | Area effects, magic weapons, attack support, Spirit Sight summons, and control                | Assuming Darkvision or large size answers unrelated mechanics.     |
| High Magic Resistance or mindless units    | Physical pressure, elementals, buffs, and non-MR effects                                      | Building the battle around one resistance check.                   |
| Fast flankers and flyers                   | Guards, reserves, dispersed mages, and protected routes                                       | Leaving expensive Crafters and Oracles in an open rear cluster.    |
| Raids and dispersed pressure               | Scouts, forts, local cave recruits, and replacement commanders                                | Keeping every useful commander and mage in the capital.            |
| Underwater objectives                      | Wet One recruitment, amphibious troops, appropriate commanders, and a separate logistics plan | Treating a few amphibious profiles as a complete underwater army.  |

## Monthly Agartha audit

- Is each fort limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, commander time, terrain, or travel distance?
- Has every cave and underwater recruitment channel been labelled separately?
- Does the troop mix answer the reported weapons, protection, numbers, size, and terrain?
- Is a mundane commander available so a Crafter or Oracle can keep its research or battle role?
- Has every Oracle been labelled by its final displayed paths before receiving a ritual job?
- Are Fire, Water, Earth, and Death treasuries being treated as separate economies?
- Does each national ritual have a legal caster, research level, gem budget, commander, and delivery route?
- Are capital sacreds competing for a planned share of resources and recruitment points?
- Is the cave-fort decision based on the province and route rather than an unverified income formula?
- Are summoned constructs assigned adequate magic leadership and movement support?

## Agartha unresolved evidence boundary

The following claims remain open:

- 1 exact expansion-party ranges for human infantry, Pale Ones, Troglodyte Slaves, and capital sacreds;
- 2 live 6.36 confirmation and display of the Oracle's pinned 10% second random;
- 3 exact cave-fort gold and resource arithmetic across province and scale states;
- 4 exact Golem Cult Hit Point scaling, candle relationship, and affected ownership classes;
- 5 current underwater movement, combat, supply, and retreat outcomes for mixed amphibious forces;
- 6 the variable scaling behind Hall of Statues and Awaken Shard Wights beyond their printed minimums;
- 7 repair, healing, poison-fume, leadership, and battlefield behaviour of particular summoned constructs;
- 8 Oracle transformation and Lich-shape outcomes referenced by the 6.04 correction;
- 9 hero arrival timing and the meaning of the pinned late-hero values;
- 10 specific Pretender designs, scripts, and matchup performance on a generated map.

These are evidence gaps, not invitations to guess. No runtime test or new test asset was prepared during this unit. R-047, R-058, and the wider hands-on testing queue remain parked until testing is explicitly resumed.

# Part XXIV: Middle Age Uruk, City States

## Uruk one-page command brief

Middle Age Uruk fields large Enkidu infantry, strong priests, a broad but uneven mage corps, capital sacreds and Mushussu chariots, province recruits, and a complete underwater recruitment branch. Ten commanders and six troops appear in the ordinary fort tables. The capital adds two commanders and two troops, non-fort provinces add an Enkidu Shaman and Enkidu Warrior, and underwater forts add four commanders and two troops.

The reliable structure is:

- ordinary forts recruit the armoured Enkidu line and ten commanders ranging from scouts and leaders to priests and mages;
- every non-fort province can recruit an E1 N2 Enkidu Shaman and an Enkidu Warrior, allowing useful recruitment outside the fort network;
- the capital adds Entu and Mashmashu, sacred Maidens of the Moon, and a maximum of one Mushussu Charioteer each month;
- underwater forts add Kulullu troops, commanders, priests, and mages instead of merely extending the land roster;
- the capital produces W1 E1 S2 N1 each month through three national sites;
- fixed recruitable paths cover Water, Earth, Astral, Nature, and Holy, while Air is random and Fire is absent from the recruitable mage roster;
- six national rituals offer Buffaloes, Kusarikkus, Ugallu, Anzus, a Scorpion Man, and an Umu-apkallu, but only the first two have immediate fixed-path access;
- five national item records include a Nature crown and four late Earth-Astral pieces, although national ownership does not solve the required path thresholds.

Uruk's main planning problem is coordination. It has many recruitment channels and useful specialists, but its best paths, gems, sacreds, chariot, underwater branch, and ritual thresholds do not automatically meet in one place or on one timetable.

## Uruk evidence and ruleset

This chapter covers unmodded MA Uruk on the [Book I 6.36](#) live baseline. The revision-2 official manual controls player-facing roster values, explicit recruitment locations, printed paths, national rules, capital-site output, national ritual tables, and item descriptions. Identifiers, membership sets, site fields, random masks, hero records, nation restrictions, and national item fields are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

No Uruk, Enkidu, Mushussu, or named Uruk national-ritual match appears in the official patch ledger through 6.36. That means no named patch correction is applied to the pinned object cross-check. It does not prove that every engine detail is unchanged.

## Uruk conversion chain

large Enkidu bodies, province recruitment, and four monthly gems  
 -> target-specific infantry groups and distributed Shamans  
 -> ordinary mage forts plus protected capital recruitment  
 -> separate Water, Earth, Astral, and Nature budgets  
 -> battlefield support, sacred reserves, underwater access, and national summons  
 -> sustained fronts, remote recruitment, sieges, and Throne claims

The chain breaks when capital recruitment is treated as unlimited, when a random path is assumed before the mage is recruited, when a ritual is counted without its caster and gem type, or when the underwater roster is mistaken for a ready mixed-domain army.

## Uruk national rules that shape the plan

| Rule or asset                    | Operational consequence                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Large Enkidu population          | Most land troops have more Hit Points and Strength than ordinary humans, but also occupy larger squares and have their own resource, encumbrance, and formation limits.                      |
| Heat preference +1               | Pretender scales begin from the printed national preference; this is not a recommendation for a complete scale design.                                                                       |
| Order limit +1 and Heat limit +1 | The nation can select these scales one step beyond the ordinary limit. The benefit still depends on the full design and map.                                                                 |
| Strong priests                   | Repeatable H2 priests exist on land and underwater, while capital Entu reach H3. This supports preaching, claiming, blessing, and Call God work without making every priest interchangeable. |
| Recall bonus                     | The nation page says Uruk is good at recalling a dead God. The precise live calculation and best use remain outside this source-only dossier.                                                |
| Fortified Cities                 | Uruk uses its printed fortified-city building family rather than the standard-fort label. Construction time and local value still depend on province and campaign.                           |
| Temples cost 900 gold            | Religious expansion has a higher printed building cost than the ordinary baseline and must be budgeted against forts, laboratories, troops, and mages.                                       |
| Distributed recruitment          | Enkidu Shamans and Warriors are available in non-fort provinces, while underwater forts unlock a separate Kulullu roster.                                                                    |

## Uruk capital sites and recruitment geography

| Site or location                   | Verified fields                       | Recruitment consequence                                              |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Great Temple of the Moon, site 186 | Two Astral pearls per month           | Supports the capital religious centre and the Astral treasury        |
| The Swamps of Ur, site 187         | One Nature gem per month              | Adds Nature income to the capital budget                             |
| The House of Water, site 188       | One Water and one Earth gem per month | Completes the W1 E1 S2 N1 monthly income                             |
| Any non-fort province              | Nation recruitment records            | Enables Enkidu Shaman and Enkidu Warrior without constructing a fort |
| Underwater fort                    | Underwater recruitment records        | Enables four Kulullu commanders and two Kulullu troops               |

The capital produces four gems each month: W1 E1 S2 N1. It produces no Air or Fire gems. A random Air caster or an imported Fire caster therefore remains separate from the treasury needed to use that path.

## Complete Uruk commander membership

| ID   | Commander         | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment |
|------|-------------------|------|-----------|------------|----------------------|
| 2934 | Enkidu Scout      | 40   | 7         | 1          | Forts                |
| 2942 | Enkidu Commander  | 60   | 26        | 1          | Forts                |
| 2946 | Naditu            | 100  | 1         | 2          | Forts                |
| 2944 | Nin               | 105  | 1         | 2          | Forts                |
| 2945 | Gala              | 105  | 1         | 2          | Forts                |
| 2949 | Gudu              | 110  | 2         | 2          | Forts                |
| 2951 | Ashipu            | 185  | 1         | 2          | Forts                |
| 2950 | Ishib             | 220  | 2         | 2          | Forts                |
| 2947 | Ereshdingir       | 265  | 1         | 2          | Forts                |
| 2943 | Ensi              | 300  | 21        | 2          | Forts                |
| 2948 | Entu              | 400  | 1         | 4          | Capital only         |
| 2952 | Mashmashu         | 395  | 1         | 4          | Capital only         |
| 2954 | Enkidu Shaman     | 175  | 2         | 2          | Non-fort provinces   |
| 3093 | Kulullu Commander | 60   | 11        | 1          | Underwater forts     |
| 3094 | Kulullu King      | 200  | 11        | 2          | Underwater forts     |
| 3091 | Kulullu Sage      | 265  | 1         | 2          | Underwater forts     |
| 3092 | Kuliltu Queen     | 270  | 1         | 2          | Underwater forts     |

The ten ordinary, two capital, one non-fort, and four underwater records reconcile to seventeen distinct commanders. The non-fort and underwater entries are additional recruitment channels, not ordinary-fort duplicates.



## Complete Uruk troop membership

| ID   | Troop               | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment                |
|------|---------------------|------|-----------|------------|-------------------------------------|
| 2935 | Enkidu Archer       | 16   | 16        | 9          | Forts                               |
| 2936 | Enkidu Spearman     | 16   | 16        | 9          | Forts                               |
| 2938 | Enkidu Heavy Archer | 16   | 24        | 9          | Forts                               |
| 2939 | Enkidu Soldier      | 16   | 24        | 9          | Forts                               |
| 2941 | Enkidu Royal Guard  | 20   | 26        | 15         | Forts                               |
| 2940 | Enkidu Iron Warrior | 22   | 24        | 17         | Forts                               |
| 2963 | Mushussu Charioteer | 170  | 21        | 16         | Capital only; maximum one per month |
| 2953 | Maiden of the Moon  | 27   | 31        | 16         | Capital only                        |
| 2937 | Enkidu Warrior      | 16   | 16        | 9          | Non-fort provinces                  |
| 3089 | Kulullu             | 16   | 2         | 9          | Underwater forts                    |
| 3090 | Kulullu Soldier     | 16   | 11        | 9          | Underwater forts                    |

The six ordinary, two capital, one non-fort, and two underwater records reconcile to eleven distinct troops. Mushussu Charioteer is the rider record; the Mushussu has a separate mount profile and is not counted as another recruitable troop.

## Complete Uruk roster by job

| Unit or group       | Best source-backed role                                                                      | Important limit                                                                                     |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Enkidu archers      | High-Strength longbow fire at light or heavy armour levels                                   | Precision 10 and formation, range, armour, and target protection still decide results.              |
| Enkidu spear line   | Large shielded frontage in medium or heavy armour                                            | The heavier profile spends more resources and gains encumbrance.                                    |
| Royal Guard         | Better Attack, Defence, Morale, Hit Points, and leadership compatibility than the basic line | Twenty gold, 26 resources, and 15 recruitment points limit massing.                                 |
| Iron Warrior        | Armoured axe infantry with Berserker +1                                                      | Higher recruitment cost and loss of shield change its defence profile.                              |
| Maiden of the Moon  | Capital sacred spear infantry with Protection 17                                             | Thirty-one resources and capital-only recruitment make casualties expensive.                        |
| Mushussu Charioteer | Capital mobile shock piece with a large trampling, poisonous, fear-causing mount             | 170 gold, one-per-month limit, and separate rider-and-mount behaviour prevent mass replacement.     |
| Enkidu Warrior      | Province-recruited axe infantry                                                              | Non-fort access is valuable, but local resources and travel still govern delivery.                  |
| Kulullu line        | Amphibious underwater troops with low resource costs                                         | Underwater recruitment does not establish mixed-army movement, supply, retreat, or battle outcomes. |

## Uruk commander and mage portfolio

| Commander    | Paths or ability                         | Main jobs                       | Recruitment warning           |
|--------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Enkidu Scout | Stealth 40, forest and mountain survival | Intelligence and route checking | Does not lead the field army. |

| Commander         | Paths or ability                                | Main jobs                                                             | Recruitment warning                                                   |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Enkidu Commander  | Leadership 50                                   | Ordinary land command                                                 | Twenty-six resources compete with heavy troops.                       |
| Naditu            | S1 H1, sacred                                   | Inexpensive research, Astral utility, priest work                     | Low morale and 10 magic leadership.                                   |
| Nin               | H1 plus W/E/S/N random, sacred                  | Flexible low mage-priest                                              | The useful path is not known before recruitment.                      |
| Gala              | N1 H1, Spell Singer, sacred                     | Nature and chorus support                                             | Spell Singer timing and outcomes remain unresolved.                   |
| Gudu              | H1 plus A/E random, sacred                      | Low Air or Earth support                                              | A single random level does not satisfy high ritual thresholds.        |
| Ashipu            | S1 N1 H1, Disease Healing 1                     | Research, disease support, Astral-Nature work                         | Disease Healing output is not treated as a guaranteed timetable.      |
| Ishib             | W1 H2 plus A/W/E/N random                       | Strong priest and flexible elemental or Nature support                | Final path must be recorded before assigning a job.                   |
| Ereshdingir       | W1 S2 H2, Fortune Teller 5                      | Fixed Astral-Water work and event support                             | Does not add Earth, Nature, Air, or Fire.                             |
| Ensi              | W1 N1 H2 plus W/E/S/N random, Leadership 100    | Army-priest-mage and flexible random                                  | 300 gold and 21 resources compete with both mages and troops.         |
| Entu              | W1 S2 H3 plus W/E/S/N randoms                   | Capital high priest, deep Astral-Water base, sacred command           | Four recruitment points and capital-only queue pressure.              |
| Mashmashu         | S3 N1 plus A/W/E/S and pinned secondary randoms | Deep fixed Astral, national ritual preparation, high magic leadership | 395 gold, four recruitment points, and uncertain second live display. |
| Enkidu Shaman     | E1 N2, Research -4                              | Province recruitment, Earth-Nature access, first two national rituals | Research penalty makes its non-research jobs important.               |
| Kulullu Commander | Amphibious Leadership 50                        | Underwater mundane command                                            | Underwater fort only and no magic path.                               |
| Kulullu King      | W1 H2, amphibious Leadership 100                | Underwater priest and army command                                    | Does not provide Earth or Astral.                                     |
| Kulullu Sage      | W2 plus A/W/S/N random, Research +4             | Underwater research and path support                                  | Random result and underwater infrastructure govern availability.      |
| Kuliiltu Queen    | W1 N1 H2 plus A/W/S/N random                    | Underwater priest-mage and command                                    | Final path remains a recruitment result.                              |

## Reading the common Uruk random masks

The pinned records contain several one-level random pools. A 100% one-level result is divided equally among the paths in its mask.

| Mage           | Fixed paths | Guaranteed random pool | Each primary outcome |
|----------------|-------------|------------------------|----------------------|
| Nin            | H1          | W, E, S, or N          | 25%                  |
| Gudu           | H1          | A or E                 | 50%                  |
| Ishib          | W1 H2       | A, W, E, or N          | 25%                  |
| Ensi           | W1 N1 H2    | W, E, S, or N          | 25%                  |
| Kulullu Sage   | W2          | A, W, S, or N          | 25%                  |
| Kuliiltu Queen | W1 N1 H2    | A, W, S, or N          | 25%                  |

The table describes recruitment probabilities, not a schedule. Gold, recruitment points, location, survival, and the order of results still determine when a path exists.

### Reading the Entu random paths

The pinned Entu record has W1 S2 H3, one guaranteed W/E/S/N level, and an independent 10% second roll from the same four paths. The manual displays one ?1 marker and does not expose that second field.

| Portfolio result                          | Probability per Entu |
|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| No second random level                    | 90%                  |
| Second level matches the first path       | 2.5%                 |
| Second level differs from the first path  | 7.5%                 |
| A chosen named path appears at least once | 26.875%              |
| A chosen named path appears twice         | 0.625%               |

A Water primary raises the fixed W1 to W2, while an Astral primary raises S2 to S3. Two matching results can rarely produce W3 or S4. Earth and Nature begin from zero and can rarely reach level two through two matching rolls.

### Reading the Mashmashu random paths

The Mashmashu has fixed S3 N1. Its guaranteed one-level pool is A/W/E/S. The pinned record also contains an independent 10% A/W/E/N level that the manual's single ?1 marker does not show.

| Result family                                                | Probability                  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| Primary Air, Water, Earth, or Astral                         | 25% each                     |
| No secondary level                                           | 90%                          |
| Any one of Air, Water, or Earth appears in at least one slot | 26.875% for that named path  |
| Matching Air, Water, or Earth in both slots                  | 0.625% for that named path   |
| Secondary Nature level                                       | 2.5%, raising fixed N1 to N2 |
| Primary Astral level                                         | 25%, raising fixed S3 to S4  |

The secondary pool does not contain Astral, and the primary pool does not contain Nature. No Mashmashu result reaches the national S5 or A3 ritual threshold without another proved bridge.

### Uruk native path boundary

| Path  | Repeatable access                                                                                       | Boundary                                                                                                           |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Water | W1 on Ishib, Ereshdingir, Ensi, Entu, Kulullu King, and Kuliitu Queen; W2 Kulullu Sage; several randoms | Broad fixed access, but W2 E2 together is not printed on a recruit.                                                |
| Earth | E1 Enkidu Shaman; several randoms                                                                       | Fixed E1 casts Summon Kusarikkus; higher Earth depends on randoms, boosters, empowerment, summons, or a Pretender. |

| Path                        | Repeatable access                                                                      | Boundary                                                                                            |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Astral                      | S1 Naditu and Ashipu, S2 Ereshdingir and Entu, S3 Mashmashu; several randoms           | Deep fixed access reaches S3; Call Apkallu still requires S5.                                       |
| Nature                      | N1 Gala, Ashipu, Ensi, Mashmashu, and Kuliltu Queen; N2 Enkidu Shaman; several randoms | Fixed N2 casts Herd of Buffaloes and forges the restricted Nature crown.                            |
| Air                         | Random Gudu, Ishib, Mashmashu, Kulullu Sage, or Kuliltu Queen                          | No fixed recruit has Air, and no recruit reaches A3 unaided.                                        |
| Holy                        | H1, H2, and capital H3 recruits                                                        | Strong land and underwater priest depth, with cost and recruitment-channel differences.             |
| Fire, Death, Glamour, Blood | No recruitable mage                                                                    | Require independents, a Pretender, empowerment, summons, transformations, or another proved bridge. |

The two heroes add deeper Water, Earth, Nature, and Holy access, but heroes are not repeatable recruitment and are not assumed to arrive on schedule.

### Uruk national ritual reconciliation

| ID  | Ritual               | School        | Requirement | Cost             | Printed result                  |
|-----|----------------------|---------------|-------------|------------------|---------------------------------|
| 958 | Herd of Buffaloes    | Conjuration 3 | N2          | 8 Nature gems    | 5 or more Buffaloes             |
| 360 | Summon Kusarikkus    | Conjuration 4 | E1          | 4 Earth gems     | 2 Kusarikkus                    |
| 361 | Summon Ugallu        | Conjuration 5 | A3          | 24 Air gems      | 1 A3 Ugallu                     |
| 362 | Call Anzus           | Conjuration 7 | W2 E2       | 4 Water gems     | 2 Anzus                         |
| 318 | Contact Scorpion Man | Conjuration 8 | E1 F1       | 12 Earth gems    | 1 Scorpion Man                  |
| 363 | Call Apkallu         | Conjuration 8 | S5          | 60 Astral pearls | 1 A3 W3 E2 S4 N2 H2 Umu-apkallu |

The six structured rows restrict to nation 66 and match the official Ur ritual table inherited by Uruk. 5+ Buffaloes remains a printed minimum; no extra-path scaling formula is inferred.

### Uruk ritual access from repeatable mages

Every Enkidu Shaman directly qualifies for Herd of Buffaloes and Summon Kusarikkus. Other Earth or Nature randoms may also qualify, but the fixed Shaman makes both early thresholds independent of capital luck.

Summon Ugallu needs A3, while the recruitable portfolio reaches at most A2 on the rare matching secondary results of Mashmashu, Kulullu Sage, or Kuliltu Queen and otherwise A1. Call Anzus needs W2 E2 on one caster; no recruit has that fixed pair, and the pinned random combinations do not produce both at level two unaided. Contact Scorpion Man needs Fire, which no recruitable mage possesses. Call Apkallu needs S5; fixed S3 Mashmashu can reach S4 from its primary Astral result but no pinned recruitable outcome reaches S5 unaided.

These are path-threshold statements. Boosters, empowerment, summons, a Pretender, or another legal bridge can change them, but the chapter does not assume such a bridge exists before it is named and funded.

## Uruk capital and ritual gem economy

The capital's W1 E1 S2 N1 income directly funds the two accessible early rituals: Herd of Buffaloes and Summon Kusarikkus. The same gems also compete with forging, battlefield use, site searching, and later path development. Astral is the largest capital income but the S5 national ritual remains beyond an unaided recruit.

Uruk receives no capital Air or Fire gems. Summon Ugallu therefore needs both a higher Air caster and an Air treasury. Contact Scorpion Man needs a Fire caster even though its printed cost is paid in Earth gems. Caster access and payment type must be recorded separately.

## Uruk national item boundary

| ID  | Item                  | Construction and paths | Printed properties                                                                            | Access boundary                                                                                    |
|-----|-----------------------|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 227 | Headdress of the Bull | Construction 5, N1     | Strength +2; Retinue 1; nation restricted                                                     | Many land mages qualify at N1; the live retinue arrival and replacement details remain unresolved. |
| 104 | Dawn Fang             | Construction 9, E2 S1  | Magic Resistance +1, Affliction Resistance 1, Awe +1, double damage against undead and demons | National rebate field is pinned; no recruit has fixed E2 S1.                                       |
| 184 | Shield of the Dawn    | Construction 9, E2 S1  | Magic Resistance +1, Affliction Resistance 1, Fire Resistance +5, Awe +1                      | Same E2 S1 and late-research boundary.                                                             |
| 216 | Helmet of the Dawn    | Construction 9, E2 S1  | Magic Resistance +2, Affliction Resistance 1, Awe +1                                          | Same E2 S1 and late-research boundary.                                                             |
| 275 | Armor of the Dawn     | Construction 9, E2 S1  | Hit Points +10, Magic Resistance +1, Affliction Resistance 2, Fire Resistance +15, Awe +1     | Same E2 S1 and late-research boundary.                                                             |

The four Dawn pieces carry Uruk national-rebate fields in the pinned item records. That establishes a nation-specific discount marker, not the final live price after every modifier and rounding step. The forge screen controls the displayed cost. The Headdress is restricted to a defined nation list that includes Uruk rather than carrying the same rebate field.

## Uruk national hero records

| ID   | Fixed name  | Unit name       | Verified magic or status                                              |
|------|-------------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2433 | Utnapishtim | Favored of Enki | N3 H2; sacred; inspirational penalty; pinned late-hero field 5        |
| 2965 | U'an        | Apkallu         | W4 E3 N2 H3; Research +10; high leadership; pinned late-hero field 10 |

The two national hero attributes identify powerful but non-repeatable access. No arrival probability, arrival turn, guaranteed ritual bridge, or interpretation of the late-hero raw values is inferred.

## Uruk patch reconciliation

No direct Uruk, Enkidu, Mushussu, Mashmashu, Ereshdingir, Kusarikku, Ugallu, Anzu, Apkallu, or Buffalo name match was found in the official ledger through 6.36. No patch change is therefore attached to the dossier's roster or national assets.

This negative ledger result is narrow. It confirms only that the collected official announcement text contains no named match; it is not proof against undocumented changes or behaviour that can only be observed in the current engine.

## Uruk opening priorities

The opening should secure a commander, enough protected frontage for the nearby independent weapons, and a research plan that uses recruitable mages without choking the troop queue. Enkidu infantry cost sixteen gold each but differ sharply in resources, shield use, weapon, Morale, and recruitment points. Exact expansion counts remain open because map generation, scales, formation, bless, opposition, and combat rolls change them.

Non-fort Enkidu Shamans and Warriors let productive provinces contribute before a fort is built. The Shaman's E1 N2 gives immediate ritual and research-path value, but Research -4 means its best job may be site searching, forging, ritual work, or battlefield support rather than remaining in a laboratory.

## Uruk recruitment packages to evaluate from reports

### Shielded Enkidu line

Spearmen and Soldiers provide shielded bodies at two armour levels. Select the heavier Soldier only when its extra protection is worth eight more resources and higher encumbrance. A mundane Enkidu Commander keeps the mage queue separate from troop leadership.

### Enkidu missile group

Archers and Heavy Archers use longbows with Strength 15. The heavier profile trades eight resources and mobility for protection. Missile range and damage still depend on current rules, while target armour, shields, weather, precision, and friendly positioning decide battlefield value.

### Capital sacred reserve

Maidens of the Moon provide protected sacred infantry, while one Mushussu Charioteer can be added per month. These are distinct pieces: the Maiden is a costly spear infantry profile, while the Charioteer depends on a separate trampling and poison-capable mount. Bless, formation, friendly size, and rider-and-mount outcomes remain case-specific.

### Distributed province group

Enkidu Warriors can be recruited outside forts and paired with local Enkidu Shamans. This turns otherwise undeveloped provinces into replacement and support points. It does not remove local resource limits, travel time, vulnerability, or the need for leadership.

## Kulullu underwater group

Kulullu and Kulullu Soldiers provide two resource levels, while the Commander, King, Sage, and Queen supply command, priesthood, research, and magic. This is a real underwater recruitment branch, but moving land assets into it or emerging onto land remains a separate logistics problem.

## Uruk research response tree

### Branch A: early Conjunction

Conjunction 3 opens Herd of Buffaloes for every Enkidu Shaman. Conjunction 4 adds Summon Kusarikkus from the same fixed E1 N2 chassis. The branch converts separate Nature and Earth treasuries into large trampers or sacred magical guardians, but the printed Buffalo count is variable and battlefield performance remains untested here.

### Branch B: Astral control and support

Naditu and Ashipu provide S1, Ereshdingir and Entu provide S2, and Mashmashu provides S3 before randoms. Research should be selected around a named control, protection, or resistance problem. Deep Astral access does not by itself supply bodyguards, safe spell range, fatigue management, or a legal S5 ritual caster.

### Branch C: Nature and Earth support

Gala and several mixed mages provide N1, while the province Shaman guarantees E1 N2. This branch can combine buffs, protection, recovery support, site searching, the Headdress, and the first two national summons. Its value depends on which spells answer the actual enemy and whether the caster can reach the army.

### Branch D: path bridges and late national assets

Later goals include A3 for Ugallu, W2 E2 for Anzus, E1 F1 for the Scorpion Man, S5 for the Umu-apkallu, and E2 S1 for the Dawn items. None is an automatic recruitable threshold. Each project should name the booster, empowerment, hero, summon, Pretender, or other bridge; the research, gems, and mage turns; and the force that will use the result.

## Uruk battlefield packages

### Shielded line with mixed priest support

Enkidu Spearmen or Soldiers hold the line while an Ishib, Ereshdingir, Ensi, or another selected mage-priest supplies the script. A mundane commander handles leadership. The package still needs an answer to armour, fatigue, flanks, and spells that can strike its large formations.

### Province force with Shaman support

Warriors recruited outside forts can assemble near a threatened route while Shamans add fixed Earth and Nature access. The package is useful for distributed defence and replacement, but low infrastructure and travel can leave it fragmented.

## Capital sacred and chariot force

Maidens provide the stable sacred line and the monthly Mushussu adds a mobile shock piece. Entu can supply H3 and selected magic. The package is expensive in capital resources and commander time, and the mount's Trample, Fear, poison, attacks, and survival must not be collapsed into the rider's profile.

## Underwater Kulullu force

Kulullu Soldiers provide the armoured line while a King commands and a Sage or Queen supplies magic. The force should be planned within the underwater roster first. Mixed-domain movement, retreat, supply, and combat outcomes remain open rather than being inferred from Amphibious tags alone.

## Uruk Pretender families

| Family                     | What it solves                                                                     | What it must not conceal                                                                     |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds 900-gold temples, fortified cities, capital mages, and resource-heavy troops | Income does not create capital turns or remove local resource limits.                        |
| Fire bridge                | Opens Contact Scorpion Man and Fire searching or forging absent from recruits      | A path without Fire gems, research, and delivery remains incomplete.                         |
| Air bridge                 | Reaches the A3 Ugallu threshold without relying on a future random ladder          | Air income and the 24-gem ritual cost still need a plan.                                     |
| Earth-Astral bridge        | Supports the E2 S1 Dawn set and can help the W2 E2 or S5 projects                  | Construction 9 and national rebates do not make the items early.                             |
| Sacred design              | Supports Maidens, sacred mages, Kusarikkus, Ugallu, and other sacred summons       | Most Enkidu troops and the Mushussu rider are not improved merely by being in the same army. |
| Awake expander             | Supplies early independent-taking power while other queues develop                 | Afflictions, counters, and delayed scales can erase the gain.                                |

## Uruk matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                              | First answer to examine                                                                           | Avoid                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light infantry                      | Large shielded lines, high-Strength arrows, Buffaloes, Kusarikkus, and target-specific area magic | Paying capital prices for work ordinary Enkidu can perform.      |
| Heavy armour                               | High Strength, axes, Earth or Astral support, fatigue, summons, and armour-answering magic        | Assuming spears or longbows solve every protection level.        |
| Armour-piercing or armour-negating damage  | Spacing, resistance, disruption, summons, and a different line profile                            | Treating mundane Protection as universal defence.                |
| High Defence, ethereal, or Glamour targets | Area effects, magic weapons, attack support, Spirit Sight summons, and control                    | Assuming size or Strength answers unrelated defensive mechanics. |
| High Magic Resistance or mindless units    | Physical pressure, buffs, summons, and non-MR effects                                             | Building the battle around one Astral resistance check.          |
| Fast flankers and flyers                   | Guards, reserves, dispersed mages, and protected routes                                           | Leaving expensive Entu or Mashmashu in an open rear cluster.     |
| Raids and dispersed pressure               | Scouts, province Warriors and Shamans, local forts, and replacement commanders                    | Keeping every useful commander and mage in the capital.          |



| Enemy problem         | First answer to examine                                                   | Avoid                                                                            |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Underwater objectives | Kulullu recruitment, underwater commanders, and a separate logistics plan | Treating an underwater roster as proof that a land army crosses domains cleanly. |

## Monthly Uruk audit

- Is each queue limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, location, or travel time?
- Are non-fort Shaman and Warrior provinces being used without leaving them undefended?
- Does the current troop mix answer the reported weapons, protection, numbers, size, and terrain?
- Is a mundane commander available so a mage can keep its research, ritual, or battle job?
- Has every random mage been labelled by final displayed paths before receiving a task?
- Are Water, Earth, Astral, Nature, Air, and Fire treasuries being treated separately?
- Does each national ritual have a legal caster, research level, gem budget, commander, and delivery route?
- Are the capital's four recruitment points being divided deliberately among Entu and Mashmashu?
- Is the monthly Mushussu limit being treated as a slow reserve rather than a mass-recruitment line?
- Does any underwater operation have its own commanders, supply, movement, retreat, and replacement plan?

## Uruk unresolved evidence boundary

The following claims remain open:

- 1 exact expansion-party ranges for Enkidu infantry, missile groups, Maidens, and Mushussu Charioteers;
- 2 live 6.36 confirmation of the Entu and Mashmashu secondary random fields, which the manual does not display;
- 3 exact Call God recall advantage and its interaction with current priest commitment;
- 4 Spell Singer timing, chorus composition, fatigue, interruption, and survival outcomes for Gala;
- 5 rider, Mushussu, Trample, Fear, poison, dismount, and separate-target outcomes under specific attacks;
- 6 underwater movement, supply, retreat, and battle outcomes for mixed Uruk and Kulullu forces;
- 7 the variable scaling behind Herd of Buffaloes beyond its printed minimum;
- 8 live discounted costs of the Dawn set and the Headdress retinue's arrival and replacement behaviour;
- 9 hero arrival timing and the meaning of the pinned late-hero values;
- 10 specific Pretender designs, scripts, and matchup performance on a generated map.

These are evidence gaps, not invitations to guess. No runtime test or new test asset was prepared during this unit. R-047, R-058, and the wider hands-on testing queue remain parked until testing is explicitly resumed.

# Part XXV: Middle Age Ashdod, Reign of the Anakim

## Ashdod one-page command brief

Middle Age Ashdod combines human slaves and nine recruitable giant troop profiles with a compact mage corps built around Fire, Earth, Astral, Death, and Holy magic. Five commanders and seven troops are available from ordinary forts. The capital adds three expensive mage-commanders, two sacred Anakites, and two sites producing five gems each month.

The reliable structure is:

- cheap human Slingers and Slaves can fill low-cost roles while Edomites and the larger Rephaite troops supply the national giant line;
- Amorites, Gileadites, Gileadite Archers, and Bashanites trade gold, resources, armour, shields, weapons, and recruitment points rather than forming one interchangeable elite class;
- Sheshai and Ahiman Anakites are capital-only sacreds with distinct armour and combat profiles;
- ordinary forts can recruit Kohanim, Emites, and Rephaite Sages, while the capital queue must divide four-point turns among Adons, Zamzummites, and Talmai Elders;
- the capital produces F1 E2 S1 D1, with no native Air, Water, Nature, Glamour, or Blood income;
- recruitable randoms can reach deep Fire, Earth, Astral, and Death, but several important cross-path combinations are rare;
- national Conjunction includes angels, ancestor spirits, and Mazzikim, while Strange Fire supplies one national battlefield spell;
- Ashdod has no national item or rebate record in the pinned item table.

Ashdod's planning problem is concentration. Its strongest bodies and deepest mages are expensive, resource-heavy, capital-bound, or random-dependent. A plan that buys only premium giants can lose infrastructure and mage tempo, while a plan that treats random paths as guaranteed can reach research with no legal caster.

## Ashdod evidence and ruleset

This chapter covers unmodded MA Ashdod on the [Book I 6.36](#) live baseline. The revision-2 official manual controls the player-facing roster, explicit capital restrictions, printed paths, national summary, site income, national spell tables, and ritual requirements. Identifiers, recruitment membership, random masks, site fields, hero records, and nation restrictions are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

No Ashdod, Anakite, Rephaite, Zamzummite, Ditanu, Malik, or named Ashdod national-spell match appears in the collected official patch ledger through 6.36. No named patch correction is therefore applied. A negative ledger search does not establish undocumented engine behaviour.

## Ashdod conversion chain

```
cheap human bodies, giant infantry, and five capital gems
-> a target-specific line backed by ordinary-fort researchers
-> protected capital recruitment and recorded random paths
-> separate Fire, Earth, Astral, and Death treasuries
-> battlefield support, sacred reserves, angels, or ancestor summons
-> surviving armies, sieges, Throne claims, and replacement cycles
```

The chain breaks when human slaves are mistaken for durable giants, when every giant profile is priced as if resources were unlimited, when a Talmai path is budgeted before recruitment, or when a national ritual is counted without both its caster and gem type.

## Ashdod national rules that shape the plan

| Rule or asset                               | Operational consequence                                                                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Rephaite giants                             | Most national troops have high Hit Points and Strength, but their gold, resources, recruitment points, appetite, size, and formation needs remain real costs. |
| Human slaves                                | Seven-gold Slingers and Spearmen provide a separate low-cost body class; low Morale and ordinary human durability limit what that price buys.                 |
| Prefers Heat +2                             | The nation summary identifies the preferred climate; this is not a complete scales recommendation.                                                            |
| Heat limit +1 and Death limit +1            | Pretender design can select those scales one step beyond the ordinary limit. The strategic value depends on the whole design and map.                         |
| Giant Forts                                 | Ashdod uses the printed giant-fort family rather than a standard-fort label. Local construction value and timing still depend on province and campaign.       |
| Weak priesthood with one medium priest      | Kohanim and Zamzummites are H1; capital Adons reach H2. Priest access exists, but high-priest work competes for the capital queue.                            |
| Sacred Anakites and capital mage-commanders | The strongest sacred troops and all three deep mage chassis are capital-only, making capital turns a strategic resource.                                      |

## Ashdod capital sites and recruitment geography

| Site                      | Verified fields                                                                              | Recruitment or income consequence                             |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| The Twin Cities, site 144 | D1; home recruitment for Sheshai Anakite, Ahiman Anakite, Zamzummite, Adon, and Talmai Elder | Holds the full capital-only troop and commander set           |
| Mount Seir, site 145      | F1 E2 S1                                                                                     | Completes the capital's Fire, Earth, Astral, and Death income |

The capital produces five gems per month: F1 E2 S1 D1. It produces no Air, Water, Nature, Glamour, or Blood gems. Caster access and gem income must therefore be recorded separately, especially for Summon Mazzikim and Call Arel, which require Nature.

## Complete Ashdod commander membership

| ID   | Commander          | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment |
|------|--------------------|------|-----------|------------|----------------------|
| 2010 | Edomite Scout      | 45   | 17        | 1          | Forts                |
| 2009 | Rephaite Commander | 140  | 35        | 1          | Forts                |
| 2029 | Kohen              | 120  | 3         | 1          | Forts                |
| 2038 | Emite              | 175  | 3         | 2          | Forts                |
| 2060 | Rephaite Sage      | 215  | 3         | 2          | Forts                |
| 2027 | Adon               | 425  | 85        | 4          | Capital only         |
| 2011 | Zamzummite         | 440  | 3         | 4          | Capital only         |
| 2028 | Talmai Elder       | 520  | 3         | 4          | Capital only         |

The five ordinary and three capital records reconcile to eight distinct commanders. The capital entries are additional home-site recruits, not ordinary-fort duplicates.

## Complete Ashdod troop membership

| ID   | Troop            | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment |
|------|------------------|------|-----------|------------|----------------------|
| 2003 | Human Slinger    | 7    | 2         | 3          | Forts                |
| 2004 | Human Slave      | 7    | 3         | 3          | Forts                |
| 2005 | Edomite          | 20   | 15        | 15         | Forts                |
| 2006 | Amorite          | 40   | 27        | 17         | Forts                |
| 2007 | Gileadite        | 40   | 29        | 17         | Forts                |
| 2061 | Gileadite Archer | 40   | 47        | 17         | Forts                |
| 2008 | Bashanite        | 50   | 33        | 21         | Forts                |
| 2025 | Sheshai Anakite  | 130  | 50        | 47         | Capital only         |
| 2026 | Ahiman Anakite   | 130  | 89        | 47         | Capital only         |

The seven ordinary and two capital records reconcile to nine distinct troops. The two Anakites share price and recruitment-point cost but do not share the same armour, protection, Morale, Strength, Attack, Defence, or Fire Resistance.

## Complete Ashdod roster by job

| Unit or group    | Best source-backed role                                                              | Important limit                                                                           |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Human Slinger    | Cheapest national missile body                                                       | Low Morale, light protection, and sling performance depend on range and target.           |
| Human Slave      | Cheapest spear frontage                                                              | Low Morale and ordinary human durability make it a screen rather than a giant substitute. |
| Edomite          | Lower-cost javelin and spear giant                                                   | Less durable and less skilled than the larger Rephaim.                                    |
| Amorite          | Mobile poison-tipped spear giant                                                     | Moderate armour and lack of shield change its survival profile.                           |
| Gileadite        | Shielded spear giant                                                                 | Resources and encumbrance exceed the Edomite line.                                        |
| Gileadite Archer | Armoured great-bow giant                                                             | Forty-seven resources and low Defence make protection and positioning important.          |
| Bashanite        | Strong broad-sword line giant                                                        | Fifty gold and 21 recruitment points constrain mass replacement.                          |
| Sheshai Anakite  | Capital sacred attacker with Berserker +2 and Fire Resistance +10                    | Capital-only, 130 gold, and 50 resources.                                                 |
| Ahiman Anakite   | Heavier capital sacred with higher Protection, Morale, Strength, Attack, and Defence | Eighty-nine resources and the same capital-only queue.                                    |

## Ashdod commander and mage portfolio

| Commander          | Paths or ability                                                                              | Main jobs                                                        | Recruitment warning                                                                                |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Edomite Scout      | Stealth 50; forest, mountain, and waste survival                                              | Intelligence and route checking                                  | Seventeen resources compete with troops.                                                           |
| Rephaite Commander | Leadership 100                                                                                | Giant army command                                               | Thirty-five resources and 140 gold are paid for a non-mage leader.                                 |
| Kohen              | H1; pinned independent 10% Death level                                                        | Low priest and occasional Death access                           | The manual prints H1 only; the 10% field remains pinned, not live-confirmed.                       |
| Emite              | D1 plus guaranteed F/E/S/D level; Fortune Teller 10                                           | Death research, event support, and low random magic              | Final path must be recorded before assignment.                                                     |
| Rephaite Sage      | One guaranteed level two in F/E/S; Research +4                                                | Efficient research and a focused level-two path                  | No fixed path exists before the random resolves.                                                   |
| Adon               | H2 plus one guaranteed level two in F/E/S; Leadership 150; sacred; Research -4                | Capital army-priest and deep elemental or Astral support         | 425 gold, 85 resources, four recruitment points, and a research penalty.                           |
| Zamzummite         | E1 D2 H1 plus E/D and F/E/S/D randoms; Spirit Sight                                           | Deep Death, ancestor rituals, undead leadership, and mixed magic | Capital-only, 440 gold, and four recruitment points.                                               |
| Talmai Elder       | One guaranteed level three in F/E/S plus pinned 10% F/E/S/D level; Research +8; Forge Bonus 1 | Deep research, forging, and rare cross-path access               | Capital-only, 520 gold, four recruitment points, and the second slot is not printed by the manual. |

## Reading the ordinary Ashdod randoms

| Mage          | Fixed paths | Pinned random scheme              | Result                              |
|---------------|-------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Kohen         | H1          | Independent 10% D1                | D1 on 10%; no Death level on 90%    |
| Emite         | D1          | One guaranteed F/E/S/D level      | 25% each; a Death result reaches D2 |
| Rephaite Sage | None        | One guaranteed level two in F/E/S | F2, E2, or S2 at one third each     |
| Adon          | H2          | One guaranteed level two in F/E/S | F2, E2, or S2 at one third each     |

These are recruitment probabilities, not delivery dates. Gold, recruitment points, fort location, survival, and the order of results decide when the path can be used.

## Reading the Zamzummite random paths

The Zamzummite has fixed E1 D2 H1. Its first guaranteed random is E or D, and its second guaranteed random is F, E, S, or D.

| Portfolio result                                     | Probability per Zamzummite |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Fire 1                                               | 25%                        |
| Astral 1                                             | 25%                        |
| At least one extra Earth level                       | 62.5%                      |
| Both randoms Earth, reaching E3                      | 12.5%                      |
| At least one extra Death level, reaching at least D3 | 62.5%                      |
| Both randoms Death, reaching D4                      | 12.5%                      |

Fixed E1 D2 means every Zamzummite already has both Earth and Death. The table describes how the two randoms deepen or broaden that base; it does not establish a recruitment timetable.

### Reading the Talmai Elder random paths

The Talmai Elder has one guaranteed level-three result in Fire, Earth, or Astral. The pinned record also contains an independent 10% one-level result from Fire, Earth, Astral, or Death, while the manual prints only ?3.

| Portfolio result                                    | Probability per Talmai Elder     |
|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Primary F3, E3, or S3                               | One third each                   |
| No secondary level                                  | 90%                              |
| Named F, E, S, or D secondary                       | 2.5% each                        |
| A chosen F, E, or S path appears at least once      | 35%                              |
| Matching primary and secondary, reaching level four | About 0.833% for that named path |
| Death 1                                             | 2.5%                             |

A Talmai can satisfy S2 F1 for Strange Fire when the primary and secondary rolls split between Astral and Fire. That combined result occurs in two orientations, about 1.667% in total. Call Hashmal specifically needs S3 F1, which occurs only when the primary is Astral and the secondary is Fire, about 0.833%.

### Ashdod native path boundary

| Path                               | Repeatable access                                                                  | Boundary                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fire                               | Emite F1 random; Rephaite Sage or Adon F2 random; Talmai F3 primary with rare F4   | No fixed Fire recruit, and Fire-Astral cross-paths depend on rare Talmai results.          |
| Earth                              | Fixed E1 Zamzummite; random E2 Sages and Adons; E3 Talmai; Zamzummite can reach E3 | Broad access, but the deepest results remain random or capital-bound.                      |
| Astral                             | Random S1 Emite or Zamzummite; random S2 Sage or Adon; S3 Talmai with rare S4      | No recruitable result reaches S5 unaided.                                                  |
| Death                              | Fixed D1 Emite and D2 Zamzummite; randoms can reach D2, D3, or D4                  | Zamzummite supports the national ancestor rituals, subject to its random result.           |
| Holy                               | H1 Kohen and Zamzummite; H2 Adon                                                   | Medium priesthood is capital-only.                                                         |
| Air, Water, Nature, Glamour, Blood | No recruitable mage                                                                | Require independents, a Pretender, empowerment, summons, heroes, or another proved bridge. |

The three national heroes add deep Fire, Earth, Water, Astral, and Holy paths, but heroes are not repeatable recruitment and are not assumed to arrive on schedule.

### Ashdod national spell and ritual reconciliation

| ID  | Spell or ritual      | School        | Requirement | Cost              | Printed result                     |
|-----|----------------------|---------------|-------------|-------------------|------------------------------------|
| 345 | Strange Fire         | Evocation 4   | S2 F1       | 20 fatigue        | Area 3, armour-piercing, 8+ damage |
| 358 | Summon Mazzikim      | Conjuration 3 | N1          | 3 Nature gems     | 10 Mazzikim                        |
| 352 | Call Malakh          | Conjuration 4 | S2          | 9 Astral pearls   | 1 Malakh                           |
| 353 | Call Hashmal         | Conjuration 6 | S3 F1       | 21 Astral pearls  | 1 Hashmal                          |
| 347 | Dirge for the Dead   | Conjuration 6 | D3 H1       | 25 Death gems     | 1 Ditanu                           |
| 354 | Call Arel            | Conjuration 7 | S4 N1       | 39 Astral pearls  | 1 Arel                             |
| 355 | Call Ophan           | Conjuration 8 | S5 F2       | 49 Astral pearls  | 1 Ophan                            |
| 348 | Banquet for the Dead | Conjuration 8 | D4 H1       | 55 Death gems     | 1 Malik and 4 Ditanu               |
| 356 | Call Merkavah        | Conjuration 9 | S7 F3       | 222 Astral pearls | 1 Chayot                           |

The nine structured rows restrict to nation 64, alone or with the other named nations shown in the official tables. Printed summon counts and requirements are retained without inferring retinue behaviour, shape mechanics, or battlefield performance.

## Ashdod ritual access from repeatable mages

Call Malakh is directly available to an S2 Rephaite Sage or Adon and to an S3 Talmai, each a one-third result on its chassis. Strange Fire needs S2 F1 on one caster; only the rare split Talmai secondary produces the necessary recruitable combination. Call Hashmal needs the narrower S3 F1 Talmai result.

A Zamzummite reaches D3 H1 whenever at least one random adds Death, a 62.5% result, qualifying for Dirge for the Dead. It reaches D4 H1 only when both randoms add Death, a 12.5% result, qualifying for Banquet for the Dead.

Summon Mazzikim and Call Arel need Nature, which no recruitable mage has. No recruit reaches the S5 F2 threshold for Call Ophan or S7 F3 for Call Merkavah. Boosters, empowerment, summons, heroes, or a Pretender can change access, but each bridge must be named and funded before the ritual is counted.

## Ashdod capital and ritual gem economy

The capital's F1 E2 S1 D1 income naturally supports Earth work and slowly accumulates the Astral and Death currencies used by most national summons. It does not produce Nature gems for Mazzikim or Arel. A Nature caster and a Nature treasury are separate missing parts.

The highest angelic rituals cost 49 or 222 Astral pearls, while the ancestor rituals cost 25 or 55 Death gems. Research, caster rarity, gem accumulation, forging, and battlefield use compete for different bottlenecks. A legal path does not prove that the ritual is timely or affordable.

## Ashdod national item boundary

No item in the pinned BaseI.csv carries Ashdod's nation ID 64 in the national-restriction or national-rebate fields. The dossier therefore records no Ashdod national item, national discount, or national forging exception.

This is a structured-snapshot result, not a claim that ordinary magic items are unavailable. General forging follows [Book V](#) and the current game interface; final displayed costs and any undocumented exception remain outside this source-only statement.

## Ashdod national hero records

| ID   | Fixed name | Unit name          | Verified magic or status                          |
|------|------------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| 2047 | Sheshai    | First Son of Anak  | F4 H2; sacred; pinned late-hero field 20          |
| 2048 | Ahiman     | Second Son of Anak | E4 H2; sacred; pinned late-hero field 20          |
| 2049 | Talmal     | Third Son of Anak  | F1 W4 E1 S4 H2; sacred; pinned late-hero field 20 |

The hero records provide powerful but non-repeatable access, including the nation's only listed Water path. No arrival probability, arrival turn, guaranteed ritual bridge, or meaning of the raw late-hero value is inferred.

## Ashdod patch reconciliation

No direct Ashdod, Anakite, Rephaite, Zamzummite, Talmal Elder, Malakh, Hashmal, Arel, Ophan, Merkavah, Ditanu, Malik, or Mazzikim name match was found in the official ledger through 6.36. No patch change is attached to the roster or national spell tables.

This is a narrow search result. It does not prove that every current engine interaction matches the pinned snapshot, and it does not turn undocumented behaviour into a fact.

## Ashdod opening priorities

The opening should separate three budgets: enough bodies to take and hold territory, enough infrastructure to recruit research mages outside the capital, and enough protection for the home queue to produce its rare deep casters. Human troops cost seven gold, but their Morale and durability differ sharply from the giant line. Exact expansion counts remain open because opposition, scales, formation, bless, terrain, and combat rolls change them.

The ordinary mage choices solve different problems. Emites guarantee D1 and a broad level-one random; Sages provide Research +4 and one focused level-two path. Rephaite Commanders keep leadership off the mage queue, but their gold and resources must be justified against the troops they lead.

## Ashdod recruitment packages to evaluate from reports



## Human screen and giant damage line

Human Slaves or Slingers can provide cheap bodies while Amorites, Gileadites, or Bashanites supply giant damage. The package should be chosen against the reported weapons and protection. Low-Morale humans can fail before the premium line does, and large units still need enough frontage.

## Shielded Gileadite line

Gileadites bring shields, spears, Morale 13, and Protection 14. They cost forty gold, 29 resources, and 17 recruitment points. The package is useful when missile and contact protection matter, but it should not be purchased by habit when the enemy calls for poison spears, swords, missiles, or cheaper bodies.

## Giant missile group

Gileadite Archers carry great bows behind Protection 17. Their forty-seven-resource cost can sharply reduce output in a weak fort. Target armour, shields, weather, range, and positioning remain battle questions, so recruitment should respond to reports rather than a universal ratio.

## Capital Anakite reserve

Sheshai and Ahiman Anakites are sacred capital troops with different offensive and defensive profiles. Sheshai is cheaper in resources and has Berserker +2 and Fire Resistance +10; Ahiman spends 89 resources for heavier protection and better core combat statistics. Bless value and survival remain matchup-dependent.

## Ashdod research response tree

### Branch A: ordinary Earth, Fire, and Astral support

Rephaite Sages and Adons produce F2, E2, or S2 in equal thirds. Early research should answer a named protection, damage, fatigue, or resistance problem rather than chase a path label. The result must be recorded before a spell package is assigned.

### Branch B: national Conjunction

Conjunction 4 opens Call Malakh for S2 results. Conjunction 6 adds Hashmal for a rare Talmai and Dirge for a qualifying Zamzummite. Later levels offer Arel, Ophan, Banquet for the Dead, and Merkavah, but each has a distinct path and treasury gate. National availability does not make every ritual natively castable.

### Branch C: Strange Fire

Evocation 4 unlocks Strange Fire, an S2 F1 armour-piercing area spell. The repeatable recruitable combination is rare because it depends on a split Talmai primary and secondary result. Researching the spell before such a caster exists creates no battlefield package.

### Branch D: Death and ancestor economy

Every Zamzummite begins at D2 H1 and has a 62.5% chance to reach at least D3, while 12.5% reach D4. This branch can plan around Dirge and Banquet, but capital turns, 25- or 55-gem costs, undead leadership, summoned composition, and delivery must all be budgeted.

# Ashdod battlefield packages

## Giant line with mundane command

A Rephaite Commander leads the selected giant line while a Sage, Emite, or Zamzummite handles magic. Separating leadership preserves mage actions, but the commander itself costs 140 gold and 35 resources. The force still needs answers to fatigue, armour, flanks, and magic that bypasses mundane protection.

## Mixed human and Rephaite force

Cheap humans expand frontage or absorb low-value contact while the giants supply damage. Morale and speed differences can split the formation or routing sequence. The package should be judged from battle reports rather than assumed to behave as one uniform line.

## Capital sacred force

Anakites form an expensive sacred reserve with an H2 Adon available from the same capital. This compresses troops, priesthood, and deep random magic into one queue. The force must justify both the capital turns and the resources that could have produced many ordinary giants.

## Ancestor-supported force

Dirge or Banquet adds Ditanu and Malik records to a national army. Their printed paths, ethereal and undead status, Fear, leadership, and weapon profiles are source facts. Their retinue organisation, replacement, spell use, and battlefield outcomes remain unresolved until observed.

# Ashdod Pretender families

| Family                     | What it solves                                                                      | What it must not conceal                                                                |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds giant forts, laboratories, premium troops, and capital mages                  | Income does not add capital recruitment points or local resources.                      |
| Nature bridge              | Opens Mazzikim and helps reach Arel while adding a missing gem path                 | A path without Nature income, research, and mage-turns remains incomplete.              |
| Astral-Fire bridge         | Makes Strange Fire and angel thresholds deliberate rather than rare Talmai outcomes | High Astral ritual costs still need a treasury and delivery plan.                       |
| Death support              | Accelerates ancestor rituals and Death searching                                    | Zamzummites already offer deep random Death; duplication should solve a timing problem. |
| Sacred design              | Supports Anakites, Adons, Zamzummites, and sacred summons                           | Most ordinary troops and human slaves are not blessed.                                  |
| Awake expander             | Supplies early independent-taking power while expensive queues develop              | Afflictions, counters, and delayed scales can erase the gain.                           |

# Ashdod matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem         | First answer to examine                                   | Avoid                                                       |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light infantry | Giant Strength, protected lines, missiles, and area magic | Paying capital prices for work ordinary giants can perform. |

| Enemy problem                              | First answer to examine                                                                   | Avoid                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Heavy armour                               | High Strength, poison weapons, Earth or Fire support, fatigue, and armour-answering magic | Assuming every spear or great bow solves every protection level.    |
| Armour-piercing or armour-negating attacks | Spacing, resistance, disruption, summons, and cheaper screens                             | Treating large Hit Point totals as universal defence.               |
| High Defence, ethereal, or Glamour targets | Area effects, magic weapons, attack support, Spirit Sight, and control                    | Assuming size and Strength answer unrelated defensive mechanics.    |
| High Magic Resistance or mindless units    | Physical pressure, buffs, summons, and non-MR effects                                     | Building the fight around one Astral resistance check.              |
| Fast flankers and flyers                   | Guards, reserves, dispersed mages, and protected routes                                   | Leaving 440- or 520-gold capital mages exposed in one rear cluster. |
| Raids and dispersed pressure               | Scouts, local forts, cheap replacement bodies, and reserve commanders                     | Concentrating every useful unit and mage in the capital.            |

## Monthly Ashdod audit

- Is each fort limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns?
- Does the troop mix answer the reported weapons, armour, numbers, and terrain?
- Are human units performing a defined cheap role rather than being mistaken for giants?
- Is a mundane commander available where using a mage as leader would lose research or ritual tempo?
- Has every random mage been labelled by final paths before receiving a task?
- Are Fire, Earth, Astral, Death, and missing Nature treasuries tracked separately?
- Does each national ritual have a legal caster, research level, gem budget, commander, and delivery route?
- Are capital turns being divided deliberately among Adons, Zamzummites, Talmai Elders, and sacred troops?
- Is the plan paying for premium Anakites only when their distinct profile matters?
- Are hero paths excluded from any schedule that must be repeatable?

## Ashdod unresolved evidence boundary

The following claims remain open:

- 1 exact expansion-party ranges for human screens, each Rephaite line, giant missiles, and Anakites;
- 2 live 6.36 confirmation of the Kohen and Talmai secondary random fields that the manual does not display;
- 3 Strange Fire targeting, friendly-fire risk, scaling, and battlefield results;
- 4 Ditanu, Malik, Malakh, Hashmal, Arel, Ophan, and Chayot scripting, retinue, shape, and combat behaviour;
- 5 final effective research and forge value of particular random mages under real scales and sites;
- 6 giant appetite, supply, movement, formation, siege, retreat, and replacement outcomes on a generated map;
- 7 hero arrival timing and the meaning of pinned late-hero values;
- 8 specific Pretender designs, scripts, blesses, and matchup performance.

These are evidence gaps, not invitations to guess. No runtime test or new test asset was prepared during this unit. R-047, R-058, and the wider hands-on testing queue remain parked until testing is explicitly resumed.

# Part XXVI: Middle Age T'ien Ch'i, Imperial Bureaucracy

## T'ien Ch'i one-page command brief

Middle Age T'ien Ch'i converts a large human roster, fortified cities, conscription, broad low-path magic, and four capital gems into flexible conventional armies and specialised ritual access. The official manual describes cavalry, heavy infantry, archers, crossbows, average priests, Order limited to +1, Misfortune limited to +1, and the ability of Eunuchs to conscript troops for province defence while collecting taxes. The nation is broad rather than automatically deep: most non-capital mages begin at one path and depend on randoms, combinations, gems, or capital recruitment for higher thresholds.

The opening should therefore preserve choices. Footmen and archers are cheap in gold, Ministry troops provide an intermediate line, Imperial troops consume more resources and recruitment points, and cavalry shifts more cost into gold. A Fortified City does not guarantee that every line can be produced efficiently; local resources, recruitment points, commander turns, and the need for laboratories still decide what a province can support.

The capital is unusually congested. Red Guards, Prince Generals, Imperial Alchemists, and Celestial Masters all compete for its recruitment capacity. The two capital sites also supply five gems per month in four paths, but income is not the same as access: a ritual still needs the correct caster, research, laboratory, gems, and a useful destination.

Treat random mages as recorded portfolios. The Inspector snapshot exposes the random masks, while the official manual confirms the visible base paths and costs. Recruit first, record the result, and only then assign a research, search, forge, ritual, priest, or battlefield role. Exact live display timing and any behaviour not printed by the sources remain unresolved.

## T'ien Ch'i evidence and ruleset boundary

This chapter covers unmodded Middle Age T'ien Ch'i under the Dominions 6.36 baseline. The official manual supplies the nation summary, roster, costs, recruitment locations, visible magic, site income, national spells, and item descriptions. The Dominions 6 Data Inspector snapshot at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`, pinned to the 6.35 data update, supplies object identifiers, random masks, hidden restriction fields, and cross-checks.

The two sources have different jobs. A structured row can establish that a random draw exists and which paths it contains, but it does not prove how the current client reveals that draw or how the resulting mage behaves in a real battle. The 6.36 patch ledger is checked for named changes after the pinned snapshot. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset is used here.

## T'ien Ch'i conversion chain

```
cheap human roster and fortified cities
-> borders, taxes, and recruitment centres
-> recorded random-mage portfolio
-> research plus four-path capital gem income
-> national summons, alchemy, forging, and battlefield support
-> local armies, reserves, siege, and claims
```

The fragile arrows are infrastructure and depth. A wide roster can spend resources without creating the needed battlefield answer. A wide path portfolio can also look stronger on paper than it is if the required two-path or level-two result is rare. Plans should be attached to actual recruits and treasury balances, not to the union of every possible random.

T'ien Ch'i national rules that shape planning

| Rule             | Source-backed fact                                                             | Planning consequence                                                                                    |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fortified Cities | The manual lists Fortified Cities as the national building type.               | Fort cost and build time still compete with laboratories, temples, troops, and commanders.              |
| Conscription     | Eunuchs conscript troops for province defence while collecting taxes.          | Tax collection has a national side benefit, but the manual does not print exact composition or scaling. |
| Scales limits    | Order is limited to +1 and Misfortune to +1.                                   | Pretender design must respect both bounds instead of importing a generic human-nation scale plan.       |
| Broad magic      | The nation summary lists Water, Astral, Fire, Air, Earth, Nature, and Glamour. | The list describes the national portfolio, not guaranteed depth on each recruit.                        |
| Capital sacred   | Red Guards are sacred and capital-only.                                        | Bless investment serves a narrow recruitable troop queue unless it has other jobs.                      |

The exact province-defence units and conscription rate are not stated in the manual table. Those details remain open rather than being inferred from an opaque attribute code.

T'ien Ch'i capital sites and recruitment geography

The Heavenly Gate produces one Air gem and two Astral pearls per month and enables Celestial Master recruitment. The Celestial City produces one Water and one Earth gem per month and enables Red Guards, Prince Generals, and Imperial Alchemists. Together they provide five capital gems per month: A1, W1, E1, and S2.

Master of the Way is the geographical exception among ordinary commanders: the manual marks it recruitable outside forts as well as in forts. That improves access to W1H1 and its five-path random without adding another fort, but gold, local recruitment rules, and safe movement still matter. All other capital-only records remain confined to the capital unless a source explicitly says otherwise.

T'ien Ch'i complete commander membership

The official roster contains eleven ordinary commander records and three capital-only records.

| Recruitment  | Commander records                                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary     | Scout; Imperial Consort; Eunuch; General; Ceremonial Master; Minister of Rituals; Apothecary; Imperial Geomancer; Minister of Magic; Alchemist of the Five Elements; Master of the Way |
| Capital only | Prince General; Imperial Alchemist; Celestial Master                                                                                                                                   |

This is a membership table, not a recommendation. Scout and Eunuch jobs differ from combat command; priests differ in holy level; and several mage names hide materially different fixed and random paths.

## T'ien Ch'i complete troop membership

The official roster contains fifteen ordinary troop records and one capital-only record.

| Recruitment  | Troop records                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary     | Footman with pike; Footman with glaive; Footman with spear and shield; Archer; Ministry Guardsman with glaive; Ministry Footman with spear and shield; Ministry Guardsman with man catcher; Imperial Footman; Imperial Archer; Imperial Crossbowman; Imperial City Guard; Imperial Guard; Horseman; Heavy Horseman; Imperial Horseman |
| Capital only | Red Guard                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

Weapon, shield, armour, morale, resource, and recruitment-point differences prevent these records from collapsing into one generic infantry or cavalry line. The right purchase depends on the reported enemy and the local production constraint.

## T'ien Ch'i roster by job

| Job                               | Main records                                                                            | Boundary                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scouting                          | Scout                                                                                   | Information depends on survival and coverage.                              |
| Tax and provincial administration | Eunuch                                                                                  | Conscription is confirmed; exact output is unresolved.                     |
| Mundane command                   | General; Prince General                                                                 | The Prince General consumes a capital turn and is not a default upgrade.   |
| Priesthood                        | Ceremonial Master H1; Minister of Rituals H2; Master of the Way H1; Celestial Master H2 | Holy level does not supply missing magical paths.                          |
| Cheap path specialists            | Apothecary N1; Imperial Geomancer E1S1                                                  | Low cost and guaranteed paths make roles reproducible.                     |
| Random generalists                | Minister of Magic; Alchemist of the Five Elements; Master of the Way                    | Final paths must be recorded before assignment.                            |
| Capital depth                     | Imperial Alchemist; Celestial Master                                                    | Stronger access competes with every other capital recruit.                 |
| Conventional line                 | Footmen, Ministry troops, Imperial troops                                               | Gold, resources, recruitment points, shields, and weapons differ.          |
| Mobile line                       | Horseman; Heavy Horseman; Imperial Horseman                                             | Map movement and battlefield performance remain contextual.                |
| Capital sacred                    | Red Guard                                                                               | Capital-only, sacred, and expensive in gold relative to ordinary infantry. |

## T'ien Ch'i guaranteed mage and priest floor

The repeatable non-capital floor is N1 from Apothecaries, E1S1 from Imperial Geomancers, H2 from Ministers of Rituals, and W1H1 from Masters of the Way before their random. Ministers of Magic have no fixed magical path but receive one guaranteed four-path draw. Alchemists of the Five Elements begin at N1 and receive one guaranteed elemental draw.

This floor matters more than the theoretical ceiling. Celestial Servant is guaranteed on an Imperial Geomancer, and Thousand Year Ginseng is guaranteed on an N1 recruit once researched and funded. Many other national spells require a capital mage or a rare two-path result.

## Master of the Way random portfolio

A Master of the Way has W1H1 and one guaranteed draw from Air, Water, Astral, Nature, or Glamour. Each result is one fifth of the portfolio: A1W1H1, W2H1, W1S1H1, W1N1H1, or W1G1H1.

This makes W2 repeatable in probability but not guaranteed on a particular purchase. It also spreads useful search and support roles across one recruitment record. Recruitment plans should use the 20% branches as expected distributions over many recruits, never as a promise for the next mage.

## Minister of Magic random portfolio

A Minister of Magic receives one guaranteed draw from Air, Water, Earth, or Astral, followed by an independent 10% draw from the same four paths. The first draw gives each path a 25% share. Across both rolls, a particular path appears with probability 26.875%; a doubled result in one path occurs in 2.5% of all Ministers, and two distinct level-one paths occur in 7.5%.

Those aggregate numbers distinguish common single-path researchers from rare cross-path or level-two results. The individual named combination must still be recorded. A strategy that needs W1E1, for example, cannot budget every Minister as though the 1% unordered W/E result were already present.

## Alchemist of the Five Elements random portfolio

An Alchemist of the Five Elements begins at N1, receives one guaranteed draw from Fire, Air, Water, or Earth, and then has an independent 10% draw from Fire, Air, Water, Earth, or Nature. Each elemental path is the first result 25% of the time and appears somewhere in the two rolls 26.5% of the time. The secondary Nature result raises the mage to N2 in 2% of recruits.

The guaranteed elemental draw is the reliable feature; the second draw is a portfolio bonus. Two-path elemental thresholds, double elemental levels, and N2 should be assigned only after the recruit exists.

## Imperial Alchemist capital portfolio

An Imperial Alchemist begins at F1A1W1E1N2, then uses the same guaranteed elemental draw and independent 10% five-element draw as the ordinary Alchemist. This guarantees one elemental path at level two. A second roll can produce another elemental increase or N3, but none should be scheduled before recruitment reveals the result.

The base form already guarantees N2 rituals and W1E1 Living Mercury from the capital. Its breadth is powerful on paper, but each purchase also consumes four commander recruitment points and a capital turn that could have produced a Celestial Master, Prince General, or sacred troop capacity.

## Celestial Master capital portfolio

A Celestial Master begins at A1W2E1S1G1H2, receives one guaranteed draw from Air, Water, Astral, Nature, or Glamour, and has an independent 10% draw from the same pool. The fixed paths guarantee Internal Alchemy and the A1S1 threshold for Celestial Hounds. A random Air increase reaches A2 for Call Celestial Soldiers; across the two rolls, at least one Air increase occurs in 21.6% of recruits.

This record combines priesthood, high recruitment cost, four commander recruitment points, cross-path magic, and rare depth. It should be bought for a named portfolio need, not merely because it has the broadest row.

T'ien Ch'i native path boundary

The national roster natively touches all seven paths named by the manual, but access is uneven.

| Access class                   | Reliable examples                                           | Important limitation                             |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Guaranteed outside the capital | N1; E1S1; W1H1; H2                                          | Mostly low-path access.                          |
| Random outside the capital     | A, W, E, S, N, G; rare doubled or cross-path results        | A possible result is not an owned caster.        |
| Guaranteed in the capital      | F1A1W1E1N2; A1W2E1S1G1H2                                    | Capital queue and recruitment-point pressure.    |
| Rare capital depth             | Random increases on Imperial Alchemist and Celestial Master | Exact result must be observed after recruitment. |
| Hero-only additions            | Death and higher Astral on named heroes                     | Hero arrival is not a repeatable schedule.       |

Death is not part of the repeatable recruitable mage floor shown in the roster. A hero record does not convert it into dependable national access.

T'ien Ch'i national spell and ritual reconciliation

The pinned restriction records contain ten T'ien Ch'i spells: one battle spell and nine rituals.

| Spell                   | School and level | Path | Printed cost or type     |
|-------------------------|------------------|------|--------------------------|
| Celestial Chastisement  | Evocation 5      | S3   | Battle spell, 20 fatigue |
| Celestial Servant       | Conjuration 1    | E1S1 | 1 Earth gem              |
| Ambush of Tigers        | Conjuration 3    | N2   | 9 Nature gems            |
| Herd of Buffaloes       | Conjuration 3    | N2   | 8 Nature gems            |
| Celestial Hounds        | Conjuration 4    | A1S1 | 2 Air gems               |
| Thousand Year Ginseng   | Construction 4   | N1   | 4 Nature gems            |
| Internal Alchemy        | Alteration 5     | W2S1 | 5 Water gems             |
| Living Mercury          | Enchantment 5    | W1E1 | 6 Water gems             |
| Contact Huli Jing       | Conjuration 6    | N2   | 30 Nature gems           |
| Call Celestial Soldiers | Conjuration 6    | A2S1 | 15 Air gems              |

Names, schools, levels, requirements, and costs are source facts. Exact variable summon counts, battlefield targeting, friendly-fire behaviour, shape changes, and practical combat value remain observation questions unless the manual explicitly prints them.

T'ien Ch'i ritual access from repeatable mages

| Ritual            | Access from roster                 | Scheduling boundary                                              |
|-------------------|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Celestial Servant | Guaranteed Imperial Geomancer E1S1 | Earliest national ritual; still costs a mage-turn and Earth gem. |



| Ritual                                                 | Access from roster                                           | Scheduling boundary                                                                        |
|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Thousand Year Ginseng                                  | Guaranteed N1 recruit                                        | Does not itself create every later Nature threshold.                                       |
| Ambush of Tigers; Herd of Buffaloes; Contact Huli Jing | Guaranteed Imperial Alchemist N2; 2% N2 ordinary Alchemist   | Capital access is reliable; non-capital access is rare.                                    |
| Internal Alchemy                                       | Guaranteed Celestial Master W2S1                             | Capital-only guaranteed caster.                                                            |
| Celestial Hounds                                       | Guaranteed Celestial Master A1S1; rare A/S Minister          | Ordinary two-path access is an uncommon result.                                            |
| Living Mercury                                         | Guaranteed Imperial Alchemist W1E1; rare W/E ordinary random | Capital access is reliable.                                                                |
| Call Celestial Soldiers                                | Celestial Master needs an Air increase to reach A2S1         | At least one Air random occurs on 21.6% of Celestial Masters.                              |
| Celestial Chastisement                                 | Needs S3                                                     | No ordinary recruit guarantees S3; capital randoms, boosters, or other bridges are needed. |

This table separates national availability from legal casting. Researching a national spell before its caster and treasury exist can create no deployable package.

## T'ien Ch'i capital gem economy

The capital produces A1, W1, E1, and S2 each month. That income supports several national paths but produces no Nature gems, even though four national rituals use Nature. Site searching, trade, events, Pretender design, or other documented income must therefore supply the Nature treasury; national restriction alone does not fund it.

Separate ledgers should be kept for Air, Water, Earth, Astral, and Nature. The first three pay for national rituals directly, Astral supports other national magic and infrastructure, and Nature has a structural mismatch between ritual demand and starting site income.

## T'ien Ch'i national item boundary

Four items have explicit T'ien Ch'i links in the pinned data and manual descriptions.

| Item                       | National relation        | Requirement          |
|----------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|
| Sword of the Five Elements | Restricted national item | Construction 3, F1W1 |
| Armor of the Five Elements | Restricted national item | Construction 3, E1A1 |
| Chi Shoes                  | National rebate          | Construction 3, A1   |
| Jade Armor                 | National rebate          | Construction 7, W2E1 |

The manual prints two Fire and two Water gems for the Sword, and two Earth and two Air gems for the Armor. The rebate fields establish that Chi Shoes and Jade Armor are discounted for T'ien Ch'i, but the final displayed live cost and interaction with other forge modifiers remain unresolved here.

## T'ien Ch'i hero records

The pinned nation records name three heroes: Ho Hsien-Ku, Lu Tung-Pin, and Li T'ieh-Kuai. Their corresponding forms provide A1N2; F1A1W2S3H2; and A2S2D2 respectively, with the first two marked sacred in the structured snapshot.

These records document possible capabilities, including hero-only Death and direct S3. They do not make those paths repeatable. Arrival timing, event conditions, alternate forms, and live behaviour remain unresolved unless an official source or versioned observation establishes them.

## T'ien Ch'i patch reconciliation

The current baseline is Dominions 6.36, released on 17 August 2026. The local official patch ledger was searched through its 6.35 endpoint, and the separate official 6.36 announcement was checked; neither supplies a direct Middle Age T'ien Ch'i or named-roster correction for this chapter. This negative search is not proof that no indirect engine change matters; it means only that no nation-specific correction can safely be attached from the available named notes.

The structured object snapshot remains pinned to 6.35, so the manual and official 6.36 ledger take precedence where they conflict. Any later discrepancy should be recorded as a new source-reconciliation issue rather than silently normalised.

## T'ien Ch'i opening priorities

- 1 Identify whether each fort site is limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns.
- 2 Use the cheapest troop line that answers the observed independent province instead of defaulting to Imperial equipment.
- 3 Add scouting and mundane leadership without spending mage turns on jobs a General or Scout can perform.
- 4 Record every random mage's final paths before assigning research, search, forge, ritual, or combat duty.
- 5 Protect the capital queue for the specific Red Guard, Prince General, Imperial Alchemist, or Celestial Master requirement that the plan names.
- 6 Track Nature demand separately because the capital sites supply no Nature gems.

These are planning controls, not tested expansion prescriptions. Exact party sizes, formations, scripts, and casualty expectations remain open.

## T'ien Ch'i recruitment packages to evaluate from reports

### Cheap foot and missile package

Footmen and Archers preserve gold for forts and mages, but their weapons, armour, shields, and morale differ. The package should be selected against the reported province rather than treated as one undifferentiated mass.

### Ministry middle line

Ministry Guardsmen and Footmen trade more gold, resources, and recruitment points for stronger equipment and morale. Glaives, spear-and-shield, and man catchers have different target profiles; none is a universal upgrade.

### Imperial protected line

Imperial Footmen, City Guards, Guards, Archers, and Crossbowmen offer heavier profiles at greater production cost. The right mixture depends on local resources, enemy armour and shields, missile conditions, and whether the fort must also produce cavalry.

## Cavalry response group

Horsemen, Heavy Horsemen, and Imperial Horsemen offer three price and equipment tiers. Map speed does not by itself establish expansion safety or battlefield value, so route, fatigue, formation, and target selection remain report-dependent.

## Capital Red Guard reserve

Red Guards are sacred, capital-only, and cost fifty gold. A bless and capital allocation should solve a defined problem before the nation pays that opportunity cost.

## T'ien Ch'i research response tree

### Branch A: guaranteed low-path utility

Construction 4 reaches Thousand Year Ginseng for N1, while Conjunction 1 reaches Celestial Servant for E1S1. This branch uses guaranteed non-capital paths, but its value still depends on gems, mage-turns, and what the summoned or transformed asset contributes.

### Branch B: capital cross-path rituals

Alteration 5 Internal Alchemy, Enchantment 5 Living Mercury, and Conjunction 4 Celestial Hounds align with guaranteed capital mage paths. The capital must recruit those casters before the research becomes an operational package.

### Branch C: Nature summons

Conjunction 3 opens Ambush of Tigers and Herd of Buffaloes; Conjunction 6 opens Contact Huli Jing. Imperial Alchemists guarantee N2, but the capital provides no Nature income. Research and treasury therefore have to be planned together.

### Branch D: higher Air and Astral thresholds

Conjunction 6 Call Celestial Soldiers requires A2S1, normally a Celestial Master with an Air increase. Evocation 5 Celestial Chastisement requires S3 and is not guaranteed on ordinary recruits. This branch should wait for an actual caster or a documented bridge.

## T'ien Ch'i battlefield packages

### Conventional line with separate command

A General leads the selected infantry or cavalry while mages preserve their actions for spells. This separation is useful only if the army has enough mundane leadership and the chosen line answers the enemy's protection, weapons, mobility, and numbers.

### Mixed missile and protected line

Archers or crossbowmen operate behind a shielded or armoured line. Range, weather, friendly obstruction, enemy shields, armour, and closing speed determine value; the source tables cannot settle those battlefield outcomes.

### Broad-mage support group

Recorded Ministers, Alchemists, Geomancers, and Masters of the Way are selected for actual paths rather than names. This prevents a nominally broad squad from arriving without the cross-path or depth the script assumes.

### Capital ritual-supported force

Imperial Alchemists or Celestial Masters turn researched national rituals into assets. The full package must include the capital recruitment turn, research, gem source, ritual turn, commander, and route to the front.

## T'ien Ch'i Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                      | What it must not conceal                                                  |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, commanders, and a large conventional roster | Gold does not create local resources or extra capital queue capacity.     |
| Nature-income bridge       | Supports the national Nature ritual suite                              | A path without site income, search, trade, or gems is not a treasury.     |
| High-path bridge           | Supplies reliable S3, deeper Air, or another missing threshold         | Native random access should be counted before paying twice for it.        |
| Sacred design              | Supports Red Guards and sacred commanders or summons                   | Most ordinary troops are not sacred.                                      |
| Awake expander             | Supplies early province-taking while human infrastructure develops     | Afflictions, counters, scales, and opportunity cost remain map-dependent. |

No exact design is endorsed without settings, map, opponents, legal chassis, and a versioned test or game record.

## T'ien Ch'i matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                              | First answer to examine                                                    | Avoid                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units                         | Footprint, missiles, cavalry, protected lines, and reachable area effects  | Buying the most expensive Imperial record by default.                   |
| Heavy armour                               | Crossbows, high-damage weapons, buffs, fatigue, and armour-answering magic | Assuming every glaive or spell solves every protection value.           |
| Fast flankers or flyers                    | Guards, reserves, mage spacing, and local response forces                  | Exposing rare random or capital mages in one rear cluster.              |
| High Defence, ethereal, or Glamour targets | Area effects, magic weapons, attack support, and control                   | Treating broad national magic as proof that the required caster exists. |
| High Magic Resistance or mindless units    | Conventional pressure, buffs, summons, and non-MR effects                  | Building the battle around a single Astral resistance check.            |
| Raiding and dispersed pressure             | Scouts, fortified cities, Eunuchs, local troops, and reserve commanders    | Concentrating every useful recruit in the capital.                      |
| Gem denial                                 | Guaranteed low-path tools and mundane roster depth                         | Researching a ritual tree that the treasury cannot fund.                |

## Monthly T'ien Ch'i audit

- Is each fort limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns?
- Is every random mage labelled by final paths and assigned a role that uses them?
- Are mundane commanders available where using a mage would lose research or ritual tempo?
- Is the capital queue reserved for a named Red Guard, Prince General, Imperial Alchemist, or Celestial Master job?
- Are Air, Water, Earth, Astral, and Nature balances tracked separately?
- Does each national ritual have research, a legal caster, gems, a mage-turn, and a delivery plan?
- Is conscription being treated as confirmed without inventing its exact composition or scaling?
- Does the troop mix answer the reported armour, weapons, missiles, mobility, and morale?
- Are hero paths excluded from schedules that must be repeatable?
- Has any 6.35 structured field been checked against the 6.36 manual and patch ledger before publication?

## T'ien Ch'i unresolved evidence boundary

The following claims remain open:

- 1 exact expansion-party sizes, formations, scripts, and casualty ranges for every infantry, missile, cavalry, and Red Guard package;
- 2 exact Eunuch conscription composition, growth rate, interaction with province defence, and live display;
- 3 live 6.36 presentation and timing of every random-magic result;
- 4 summon counts or composition where the manual does not print a fixed result;
- 5 Celestial Chastisement targeting, resistance, friendly-fire risk, and battlefield value;
- 6 Internal Alchemy transformation details and persistence beyond the printed ritual description;
- 7 Living Mercury, Celestial Hound, Celestial Soldier, Huli Jing, tiger, buffalo, and Celestial Servant scripting and combat behaviour;
- 8 final displayed rebate costs for Chi Shoes and Jade Armor under combined forge modifiers;
- 9 hero arrival timing, alternate forms, and live behaviour;
- 10 specific Pretender designs, blesses, matchups, and map performance.

These are evidence gaps, not invitations to guess. No runtime test or new test asset was prepared during this unit. R-047, R-058, and the wider hands-on testing queue remain parked until testing is explicitly resumed.

# Part XXVII: Middle Age Machaka, Reign of Sorcerors

## Machaka one-page command brief

Middle Age Machaka combines cheap human troops, heavy hoplites, forest recruitment, poisonous spider cavalry, assassins, and a broad mage corps using Fire, Earth, Death, Nature, Glamour, and Holy magic. Its capital contains two sites producing five gems each month and most of its specialised spider troops and mages. Ordinary forts still recruit the Sorcerer, which is the key repeatable ritual chassis because every one has F1 D1 N2 G1 plus a guaranteed random level.

The basic plan is:

- use the cheap human roster and hoplites according to the local gold, resource, and recruitment-point budget;
- recruit Witch Doctors from forests where their low research penalty is acceptable and their F1 D1 N1 access has a real job;
- treat Sorcerers as recorded five-way portfolios rather than assuming the path needed next will appear;
- protect the capital queue for Black Sorcerers, Anansi, Spider Sorceresses, Bane Spiders, and sacred spider forces;
- keep the Nature ritual budget separate from the capital's Fire, Earth, Nature, and Glamour income;
- use scouts, spies, forest recruitment, and assassins to improve information and apply pressure without pretending their live outcomes are guaranteed.

Machaka's main strategic problem is coordination. The roster offers many specialised pieces, but its strongest spider units, deepest mages, and best cross-paths are capital-bound or random-dependent. A plan fails when it counts every possible random as one mage, spends the capital queue on unrelated jobs, or researches a ritual without its gems and legal caster.

## Machaka evidence and ruleset

This chapter covers unmodded Middle Age Machaka on the [Book I 6.36](#) live baseline. The revision-2 official manual controls the player-facing roster, costs, recruitment locations, printed paths, national summary, mounts, sites, and ritual tables. Nation ID 76, site records, random masks, hero assignments, spell restrictions, disabled rows, and item rebates are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`.

The sources do not prove current random-path presentation, expansion results, dominion-summon timing, assassin outcomes, web or poison behaviour, mount survival, final forge costs, or hero arrival timing. Those remain unresolved. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used for this dossier.

## Machaka conversion chain

```
cheap human bodies, hoplites, forest recruits, and five capital gems
-> expansion forces, borders, and recruitment centres
-> recorded Sorcerer and capital-mage portfolios
-> research plus separate Nature, Death, Earth, Fire, and Glamour budgets
-> national rituals, forging, battlefield support, and spider pressure
-> surviving armies, reserves, sieges, and claims
```

The fragile arrows are capital time, Nature-gem accumulation, and cross-path access. The nation can possess many paths across its roster while still lacking the one mage, gem stock, laboratory, or safe turn needed for a particular job.

## Machaka national rules that shape planning

| Rule or asset  | Source-backed fact                                                 | Planning consequence                                                                     |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Prefers Heat 2 | The manual states that Machaka prefers Heat 2.                     | Climate preference is an economic and fatigue input, not a complete scales prescription. |
| Heat limit +1  | Pretender design may move Heat one step beyond the ordinary limit. | The value depends on the entire design and cannot be judged in isolation.                |
| Standard Forts | Machaka uses the standard fort family.                             | Fort timing still competes with laboratories, temples, troops, and commanders.           |

| Rule or asset          | Source-backed fact                                                                               | Planning consequence                                                                                          |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Forest recruitment     | Witch Doctors and Spider Archers are available in all forests.                                   | Forest forts can add national options, but only when geography and infrastructure justify them.               |
| Capital spider complex | Most specialised spider troops and four major commander types are home-site recruits.            | Capital commander and troop capacity must be budgeted separately.                                             |
| Intelligence tools     | Scouts, a spy-priest, Anansi spies, patrolling priests, and assassins are printed in the roster. | Better information is possible, but detection and assassination outcomes remain engine and matchup questions. |

## Machaka capital sites and recruitment geography

| Site                  | Verified fields             | Recruitment consequence                                                      |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| God Forest, site 60   | F1 N1                       | Black Hunter and Spider Archer troop records; Voice of the Hunters commander |
| God Mountain, site 61 | E2 G1; ritual-range bonus 1 | Spider Warrior; Black Sorcerer, Anansi, Spider Sorceress, and Bane Spider    |

The two sites produce F1 E2 N1 G1, five gems per month. They produce no Air, Water, Astral, Death, or Blood gems. This matters because the mage roster has strong Death access but no capital Death income, while all three confirmed national rituals consume Nature gems.

Witch Doctors and Spider Archers also have forest recruitment outside the capital. Other spider units are not generalised into forest recruits without a source field.

## Complete Machaka commander membership

| Commander            | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment  |
|----------------------|------|-----------|------------|-----------------------|
| Machaka Scout        | 35   | 3         | 1          | Forts                 |
| Machaka Chief        | 55   | 2         | 1          | Forts                 |
| Machaka Commander    | 95   | 27        | 1          | Forts                 |
| Spider Lord          | 125  | 25        | 1          | Forts                 |
| Eye of the Lord      | 90   | 4         | 1          | Forts                 |
| Voice of the Lord    | 160  | 2         | 2          | Forts                 |
| Ear of the Lord      | 150  | 3         | 2          | Forts                 |
| Witch Doctor         | 110  | 1         | 2          | Forts and all forests |
| Sorcerer             | 300  | 1         | 2          | Forts                 |
| Voice of the Hunters | 230  | 33        | 1          | Capital only          |
| Bane Spider          | 150  | 38        | 2          | Capital only          |
| Spider Sorceress     | 230  | 1         | 2          | Capital only          |
| Anansi               | 280  | 1         | 4          | Capital only          |
| Black Sorcerer       | 325  | 6         | 4          | Capital only          |

Nine ordinary and five capital records reconcile to fourteen commanders. The two-point Sorcerer is available outside the capital; the four-point Anansi and Black Sorcerer compete directly for the home queue.

## Complete Machaka troop membership

| Troop                              | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment    |
|------------------------------------|------|-----------|------------|-------------------------|
| Pygmy                              | 5    | 2         | 2          | Forts                   |
| Machaka Militia                    | 7    | 2         | 3          | Forts                   |
| Machaka Archer                     | 10   | 3         | 9          | Forts                   |
| Machaka Warrior, spear and javelin | 10   | 3         | 9          | Forts                   |
| Machaka Warrior, Machaka spear     | 10   | 4         | 9          | Forts                   |
| Spider Archer                      | 12   | 4         | 20         | Capital and all forests |
| Machaka Hoplite                    | 14   | 27        | 18         | Forts                   |
| Spider Rider                       | 25   | 4         | 9          | Forts                   |
| Spider Knight                      | 30   | 25        | 21         | Forts                   |
| Spider Warrior                     | 20   | 36        | 31         | Capital only            |
| Black Hunter                       | 100  | 36        | 31         | Capital only            |

Nine ordinary or forest-accessible records and two capital-only records reconcile to eleven troops. The two Machaka Warrior entries are distinct equipment records and should remain separate in tables and search results.

## Machaka troop jobs

| Unit             | Source-backed role                                              | Important limit                                                                            |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pygmy            | Extremely cheap short-bow body                                  | Size, low Hit Points, low Morale, and low combat skills sharply limit what five gold buys. |
| Machaka Militia  | Cheap spear frontage                                            | Low Morale and light protection make it a screen rather than a durable line.               |
| Machaka Archer   | Low-cost conventional missile unit                              | Range, armour, shields, weather, and friendly obstruction decide results.                  |
| Machaka Warriors | Light spear line with either javelin or dedicated spear profile | Light protection makes positioning and target choice important.                            |
| Machaka Hoplite  | Heavily armoured spear line                                     | Twenty-seven resources, encumbrance, and movement limit mass production and redeployment.  |
| Spider Archer    | Forest-accessible poison-bow unit                               | Twenty recruitment points and poison interaction require a target-specific reason.         |
| Spider Rider     | Mobile mixed spear and bow rider                                | Rider and mount outcomes are not inferred from the roster entry.                           |
| Spider Knight    | Armoured spider cavalry                                         | Gold, resources, and recruitment points compete with hoplites and commanders.              |
| Spider Warrior   | Capital stealth troop with two weapons                          | Capital-only, resource-heavy, and dependent on a protected delivery plan.                  |
| Black Hunter     | Expensive sacred hunter-spider cavalry                          | One hundred gold and capital-only recruitment make every loss consequential.               |



## Machaka commander and mage portfolio

| Commander            | Paths or ability                               | Main source-backed jobs                                              | Recruitment warning                                                           |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Machaka Scout        | Stealth 40; forest and mountain survival       | Scouting and route information                                       | Information depends on survival and coverage.                                 |
| Machaka Chief        | Leadership 75                                  | Cheap mundane command                                                | Lightly protected.                                                            |
| Machaka Commander    | Leadership 100                                 | Armoured line command                                                | Twenty-seven resources compete with hoplites.                                 |
| Spider Lord          | Leadership 100; Great Spider mount             | Mobile command                                                       | Mounted combat and mount survival remain runtime questions.                   |
| Eye of the Lord      | H1; Patrol Bonus 15                            | Patrolling and low priest work                                       | Patrol outcomes depend on local stealth and force strength.                   |
| Voice of the Lord    | H2; Leadership 100                             | Medium priest and army command                                       | Costs two recruitment points.                                                 |
| Ear of the Lord      | G1 H1; Stealth 60; Spy                         | Intelligence, priest work, and low Glamour access                    | Spy reports and detection remain observation-dependent.                       |
| Witch Doctor         | F1 D1 N1; Research -4                          | Forest recruitment, low cross-path work, site searching, and forging | The research penalty must be justified by a real job.                         |
| Sorcerer             | F1 D1 N2 G1 plus one random                    | Main ordinary-fort mage, national rituals, research, and mixed magic | Record the five-way random before assigning a specialised role.               |
| Voice of the Hunters | H1; sacred; Hunter Spider mount                | Capital sacred command                                               | Competes with all other capital commanders.                                   |
| Bane Spider          | G1; Stealth 50; assassin; Scale Walls          | Assassination and covert pressure                                    | Outcomes, patience value, and wall interaction remain live questions.         |
| Spider Sorceress     | F1 E1 D1 G1 plus one random; dominion summoner | Capital mixed magic                                                  | Dominion-summon timing and output are unresolved.                             |
| Anansi               | D1 N1 G2 plus two random slots; spy; heretic   | Deep Glamour, spying, and mixed ritual support                       | Four recruitment points and a second roll that triggers only 10% of the time. |
| Black Sorcerer       | F2 E2 D1 G1 plus two random slots              | Deep capital magic, forging, and cross-path work                     | Four recruitment points; the secondary roll triggers only 10% of the time.    |

## Reading the Sorcerer random

Every Sorcerer has F1 D1 N2 G1 and one guaranteed level from a five-way F/E/D/N/G mask.

| Branch  | Final relevant paths | Probability |
|---------|----------------------|-------------|
| Fire    | F2 D1 N2 G1          | 20%         |
| Earth   | F1 E1 D1 N2 G1       | 20%         |
| Death   | F1 D2 N2 G1          | 20%         |
| Nature  | F1 D1 N3 G1          | 20%         |
| Glamour | F1 D1 N2 G2          | 20%         |

Every Sorcerer can cast Herd of Elephants and God Brood once the research and Nature gems exist. Only particular branches deepen Fire, Death, Nature, or Glamour, and only the Earth branch supplies Earth on this chassis.

## Reading the Spider Sorceress random

Every Spider Sorceress has F1 E1 D1 G1 and one guaranteed F/E/D level. The three outcomes are F2, E2, or D2 at one third each. The printed dominion-summoner ability is recorded, but no monthly Great Spider rate or current timing is assigned without observation.

## Reading the Anansi randomness

Every Anansi has D1 N1 G2. The first random is one guaranteed D/N/G level; the second is an independent 10% F/E/D/N/G level.

- the primary result is D2, N2, or G3 at one third each;
- 90% receive no second level;
- each named secondary path appears on 2% of recruits;
- a secondary Earth result is the only pinned route for an Anansi to combine E1 with its fixed N1;
- rare secondary results are possibilities, not a dependable recruitment schedule.

## Reading the Black Sorcerer randomness

Every Black Sorcerer has F2 E2 D1 G1. The first random is one guaranteed F/E/D level; the second is an independent 10% F/E/D/N/G level.

- the primary result reaches F3, E3, or D2 at one third each;
- 90% receive no secondary level;
- each named secondary path appears on 2% of recruits;
- Nature exists only through that rare secondary slot on this chassis;
- the capital queue and four recruitment-point cost are part of every probability plan.

## Machaka native path boundary

| Path                      | Repeatable access                                                                         | Boundary                                                                                   |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fire                      | Fixed F1 Witch Doctor and Sorcerer; F1 Spider Sorceress; F2 Black Sorcerer                | Random branches reach F2 or F3, but the deepest access is capital-bound.                   |
| Earth                     | Fixed E1 Spider Sorceress and E2 Black Sorcerer                                           | Ordinary Sorcerers gain E1 only on their 20% Earth branch.                                 |
| Death                     | Fixed D1 on all four mage families                                                        | Random branches reach D2; the capital produces no Death gems.                              |
| Nature                    | Fixed N1 Witch Doctor, N2 Sorcerer, N1 Anansi                                             | Sorcerers reach N3 on one branch; no recruit reaches N4 unaided.                           |
| Glamour                   | G1 Ear and Bane Spider; G1 Sorcerer and Spider Sorceress; G2 Anansi and G1 Black Sorcerer | Anansi can reach G3; battlefield and detection behaviour remain unresolved.                |
| Holy                      | H1 Eye, Ear, and Voice of the Hunters; H2 Voice of the Lord                               | No recruitable H3 priest is established.                                                   |
| Air, Water, Astral, Blood | No recruitable mage                                                                       | Require a Pretender, independents, empowerment, summons, heroes, or another proved bridge. |

## Machaka national ritual reconciliation

| ID  | Ritual              | School        | Requirement | Cost           | Printed result                                                       |
|-----|---------------------|---------------|-------------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 340 | Herd of Elephants   | Conjuration 3 | N2          | 20 Nature gems | Five or more Elephants                                               |
| 341 | God Brood           | Conjuration 4 | N2 D1       | 12 Nature gems | Six Hunter Spiders                                                   |
| 343 | Weavers of the Wood | Enchantment 5 | N4          | 6 Nature gems  | Forest patrol enchantment; one month plus three months per extra gem |

The pinned restriction table also contains disabled spell ID 342 named xxx. It is retained as metadata, not presented as a castable ritual. Herd of Gnus appears with a pinned Machaka restriction but is absent from the revision-2 age-two ritual table. That mismatch remains unresolved rather than silently adding or deleting a live option.

## Machaka ritual access

Every Sorcerer has N2 D1 and can cast both Herd of Elephants and God Brood after the required research. Witch Doctors do not meet either threshold without a path increase. The Nature branch of the Sorcerer reaches N3, still one level below Weavers of the Wood.

Weavers therefore needs a named bridge such as a booster, empowerment, Pretender, suitable summon, or another verified source of N4. The chapter does not assume that a theoretical item exists in the treasury or that a hero arrives when needed.

## Machaka national item metadata

| Item record            | Pinned relation                  | Requirement           | Native access note                                                              |
|------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bane Blade, one-handed | Nation rebate                    | Construction 3, D1    | All four mage families meet D1.                                                 |
| Bane Blade, two-handed | Nation rebate                    | Construction 3, D1    | Separate equipment record despite the shared name.                              |
| Totem Shield           | Nation rebate                    | Construction 5, D1 G1 | Sorcerer and the capital mage families meet the cross-path.                     |
| Spirit Mask            | Nation rebate                    | Construction 5, D2 N1 | A Death-random Sorcerer qualifies; other routes depend on rarer combinations.   |
| Kithaironic Lion Pelt  | Nation rebate in its second path | Construction 3, N1 E1 | Earth-random Sorcerer qualifies; other native routes are capital-bound or rare. |
| Fever Fetish           | Nation rebate                    | Construction 9, F1 N1 | Witch Doctor and Sorcerer meet the path requirement.                            |

These are pinned item fields. Exact 6.36 displayed costs and the interaction between nation rebates, forge bonuses, hammers, sites, or other modifiers remain unresolved.

## Machaka hero records

| Fixed name | Unit name       | Verified magic | Boundary                                                          |
|------------|-----------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ainra      | Lady of Spiders | F1 E3 D3 G2    | Powerful non-repeatable capital-path expansion; timing unresolved |
| Abasi      | Hero            | None           | Does not add a magic path                                         |
| Yasini     | King Triumphant | H3             | Hero-only high priest access                                      |
| Mwaka      | Crowned Ape     | H1             | Hero record only                                                  |
| Mchumba    | Ape Oracle      | N1             | Hero record only                                                  |

Hero paths are not counted in schedules that must work every game. Arrival timing, probability, and live special behaviour are not established by the structured row alone.

## Machaka opening priorities

The opening should maintain three budgets: enough troops to take and hold provinces, enough infrastructure to recruit Sorcerers outside the capital, and enough capital capacity for the specialised spider roster. Five- and seven-gold troops can add bodies cheaply, but low Morale and protection change what those bodies can safely do. Hoplites offer heavy armour at a much higher resource cost.

Exact party sizes and scripts remain open because map settings, scales, opposition, formation, bless, and combat rolls change them. The safe procedure is to record casualties, identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns are binding, and change the next force accordingly.

## Machaka recruitment packages to compare

### Cheap screen and supported line

Pygmies, Militia, Archers, or light Warriors can cover cheap frontage and missiles while hoplites or spider units perform a narrower job. This preserves gold only when low Morale and light protection do not cause the screen to collapse before the expensive element can work.

### Hoplite centre

Machaka Hoplites provide the roster's conventional heavy line. Their fourteen-gold price is modest, but twenty-seven resources and eighteen recruitment points can make local production the real limit. Armour, fatigue, mobility, and enemy damage still decide whether the line fits the battle.

### Forest recruitment package

A forest fort can recruit Witch Doctors and Spider Archers. This can spread commander production and add poison missiles, but a forest is not automatically a good fort site. Income, resources, position, construction cost, laboratory timing, and the need for other mages remain part of the decision.

### Spider cavalry package

Spider Riders and Spider Knights combine riders with Great Spiders, while Black Hunters use Hunter Spiders and are sacred. Their speed, poison, webs, armour, gold cost, and recruitment demands point toward specialised use. Rider-and-mount damage, routing, targeting, and survival remain runtime questions.

## Capital stealth package

Spider Warriors, Bane Spiders, Anansi, and supporting scouts or spies can create covert pressure. Stealth values and printed abilities are facts; detection, assassination, siege entry, and campaign effect depend on the engine state and the opponent's precautions.

## Machaka research response tree

### Branch A: Conjunction and national bodies

Conjunction 3 opens Herd of Elephants for every Sorcerer with twenty Nature gems. Conjunction 4 opens God Brood for twelve Nature gems. The choice is not just research level: the army needs the correct body, enough gems, a mage-turn, command, and a route to the front.

### Branch B: low-path battlefield support

Witch Doctors, Sorcerers, and capital mages cover several low Fire, Earth, Death, Nature, and Glamour thresholds. Research should answer a named problem-protection, damage, fatigue, resistance, mobility, or control-using the paths actually recruited. No universal opening tree is claimed.

### Branch C: Construction and discounted items

Construction 3 reaches both Bane Blade records and Kithaironic Lion Pelt. Construction 5 reaches Totem Shield and Spirit Mask. Fever Fetish sits at Construction 9. A discount is valuable only when the item has a legal forger, affordable gems, a bearer, and a job worth the forge turn.

### Branch D: Weavers of the Wood

Enchantment 5 unlocks Weavers of the Wood, but no recruitable mage reaches N4 unaided. Researching it before naming the bridge produces a dead endpoint. Its detection, interception, added-spider combat, and caster-departure behaviour remain bound to the printed description until runtime evidence is resumed.

## Machaka battlefield packages

### Conventional line with mage support

Hoplites or selected light infantry hold space while Sorcerers or Witch Doctors use spells their actual paths support. Mundane commanders should carry leadership where doing so preserves mage actions and research. The exact formation and script must respond to the enemy.

### Missile and poison pressure

Machaka Archers, Pygmies, Spider Archers, and mounted bows provide several missile profiles. Armour, shields, range, weather, poison resistance, friendly obstruction, and closing speed determine which profile has value. The roster does not prove a fixed ratio.

### Mobile spider wing

Spider Riders, Spider Knights, or Black Hunters can form a faster wing around a slower centre. Mount size, rider protection, enemy reach, morale, terrain, and formation influence the result. This remains a package to evaluate, not a guaranteed flank solution.

### Capital mixed-mage group

Spider Sorceresses, Anansi, and Black Sorcerers bring useful fixed cross-paths and different random depth. Each mage should be labelled by final paths, given gems that match its script, and protected according to its cost. A list of possible paths is not a deployable squad.

## Machaka information and pressure network

Machaka Scouts supply conventional stealth. Ears of the Lord and Anansi add spies, Eyes of the Lord add patrol strength, and Bane Spiders add assassination. Weavers of the Wood prints a strong forest-patrol and invisible-detection effect while maintained by its caster.

These tools form an information network only when placed and protected. Spy report detail, patrol detection, invisible detection outside the ritual, assassin targeting, and counter-assassination remain unresolved live behaviour. The dossier therefore recommends coverage and record-keeping without inventing success rates.

## Machaka Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                      | What it must not conceal                                                       |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Nature-depth bridge        | Supplies dependable N4 or supports the national ritual treasury        | A path alone does not create Nature gems or a safe ritual turn.                |
| Missing-path bridge        | Adds Air, Water, Astral, Blood, or another absent threshold            | Native Fire, Earth, Death, Nature, and Glamour access should be counted first. |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, Sorcerers, and capital specialists          | Gold does not create local resources or additional capital recruitment points. |
| Sacred design              | Supports Black Hunters, Voices of the Hunters, and other sacred assets | Most of the ordinary roster is not sacred.                                     |
| Awake expander             | Supplies early province-taking while the recruitment system develops   | Afflictions, counters, scales, and opportunity cost remain map-dependent.      |

No exact design is endorsed without settings, map, opponents, legal chassis, and versioned evidence.

## Machaka matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem           | First answer to examine                                                                  | Avoid                                                                  |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units      | Missiles, protected frontage, elephants, spiders, and reachable area effects             | Buying only premium capital troops.                                    |
| Heavy armour            | High-damage attacks, buffs, fatigue, poison where applicable, and armour-answering magic | Assuming ordinary arrows or light spears solve every protection value. |
| Fast flankers or flyers | Guards, reserves, mage spacing, and mobile spiders                                       | Leaving expensive capital mages in one exposed rear cluster.           |

| Enemy problem                              | First answer to examine                                                     | Avoid                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Poison-resistant or poison-immune forces   | Conventional weapons, hoplites, non-poison magic, and different summons     | Paying for poison as if resistance were irrelevant.                                |
| High Defence, ethereal, or Glamour targets | Area effects, magic weapons, attack support, control, and verified counters | Treating national Glamour access as proof that every perception problem is solved. |
| Raiding and covert pressure                | Scouts, spies, patrol priests, Bane Spiders, forest forts, and reserves     | Assuming stealth or assassination succeeds automatically.                          |
| Gem denial                                 | Mundane roster depth and low-gem support                                    | Researching national rituals that the Nature treasury cannot fund.                 |

## Monthly Machaka audit

- Is each fort limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns?
- Is every Sorcerer and capital random mage labelled by final paths?
- Is the capital queue reserved for a named commander or troop job?
- Are mundane commanders available where using a mage would lose research or ritual tempo?
- Are Fire, Earth, Death, Nature, and Glamour gem balances tracked separately?
- Does each planned ritual have research, a legal caster, gems, a mage-turn, and delivery?
- Are forest recruits being used only where the forest fort itself is worthwhile?
- Does the troop mix answer the reported armour, missiles, mobility, poison resistance, and morale?
- Are hero paths excluded from schedules that must be repeatable?
- Has any pinned-only field been kept separate from current observed behaviour?

## Machaka unresolved evidence boundary

The following remain open:

- 1 exact expansion-party sizes, formations, scripts, and casualty ranges;
- 2 live 6.36 random-path display and timing for all four random-mage families;
- 3 Spider Sorceress dominion-summon timing, rate, and conditions;
- 4 the current player-facing availability of the structured-only Herd of Gnus restriction;
- 5 Weavers of the Wood detection, interception, added-spider, duration, and caster-movement edge cases;
- 6 web, poison, rider, mount, assassination, Scale Walls, and stealth interactions;
- 7 exact displayed item costs and rebate stacking;
- 8 hero arrival timing and live special behaviour;
- 9 specific Pretender designs, blesses, matchups, and map performance;
- 10 R-047, R-058, and all other parked engine-dependent investigations.

These are evidence gaps, not invitations to guess. Runtime testing and preparation of new test assets remain paused.

# Part XXVIII: Middle Age Shinuyama, Land of the Bakemono

## Shinuyama one-page command brief

Middle Age Shinuyama combines very cheap Bakemono, stealthy bandits, amphibious Kappa, heavily armed Dai Bakemono, large O-bakemono, assassins, and three recruitable mage families using Fire, Water, Earth, Death, Nature, and Holy magic. Its capital site produces five gems each month, weighted toward Death. The nation has no sacred troop line in the manual, but it has an unusually large catalogue of twenty-one national Conjuraton rituals.

The basic plan is:

- use the cheap Bakemono records for bodies, missiles, and terrain recruitment without pretending that low price removes their Morale and protection limits;
- add Dai Bakemono or O-bakemono when their higher gold, resources, and recruitment points answer a specific target;
- use highland and mountain forts to spread the three named Bakemono commander lines and light troop production;
- use Kappa recruitment from land or underwater forts when amphibious access matters;
- record every Shaman, Uba, and Sorcerer's final paths before assigning research, forging, site searching, ritual, or battle duty;
- separate the Nature and Air ritual plans from the capital gem income, which supplies neither path;
- treat summons as a ladder of specific bodies and mages, not one automatic late-game solution.

Shinuyama's main strategic problem is conversion. It has broad recruitable magic and a deep summon catalogue, but many rituals require Air or Nature gems the capital does not produce, a random path, or a high threshold reached by only a small share of very expensive Sorcerers. A successful plan joins the roster, actual mage results, research, gems, commander time, and delivery into one package.

## Shinuyama evidence and ruleset

This chapter covers unmodded Middle Age Shinuyama on the [Book I 6.36](#) live baseline. The revision-2 official manual controls the player-facing roster, costs, terrain recruitment, printed paths, nation summary, capital site, and ritual table. Nation ID 70, site ID 106, random masks, hero assignments, spell restrictions, and the absence of national item rows are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

The sources do not prove the exact cave-fort bonus, mountain rebate calculation, current random-path display, variable summon rolls, retinue or shape behaviour, assassin outcomes, hero timing, or battle performance. Those remain unresolved. The official 6.08 ledger carries a Shinuyama/Caelum spell-assignment correction, but its abbreviated metadata is not expanded into guessed wording. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used for this dossier.

## Shinuyama conversion chain

```
cheap terrain recruits, large Bakemono, Kappa, and five capital gems
-> provinces, cave or mountain recruitment centres, and protected laboratories
-> labelled Shaman, Uba, and Sorcerer path portfolios
-> research plus separate Fire, Water, Earth, Death, Nature, and Air budgets
-> national summons, battlefield support, mobility, and magical path expansion
-> surviving forces, replacement capacity, sieges, and claims
```

The fragile arrows are Morale, infrastructure, gem mismatch, and mage cost. A 545-gold Sorcerer cannot simultaneously research, search, forge, summon, and lead a ritual plan. Cheap troops do not solve that commander-turn bottleneck.



## Shinuyama national rules that shape planning

| Rule or asset         | Source-backed fact                                                    | Planning consequence                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Turmoil limit +1      | Pretender design may move Turmoil one step beyond the ordinary limit. | The extra design range is not a recommendation to take it.                                                                          |
| Magic limit +1        | Pretender design may move Magic one step beyond the ordinary limit.   | Research value must be considered with the entire economy and design.                                                               |
| Primitive Forts       | Shinuyama uses the primitive fort family.                             | Construction time, administration, defence, and recruitment capacity should be checked rather than assumed equal to standard forts. |
| Cave-fort economy     | The manual states that cave forts provide extra gold and resources.   | Cave placement can matter, but the exact calculation remains unresolved here.                                                       |
| Mountain rebate       | The manual states that lesser Bakemono are rebated in mountains.      | The live eligible set and displayed amount must not be inferred from the summary alone.                                             |
| No sacred troops      | The manual explicitly states that Shinuyama has no sacred troop line. | A bless should justify its commanders, summons, or Pretender rather than assuming a mass sacred army.                               |
| Many national summons | Twenty-one national Conjunction records are confirmed.                | Conjunction offers breadth, but each ritual still needs research, caster, gems, a mage-turn, command, and delivery.                 |

## Mount Shinuyama and the capital economy

Mount Shinuyama is capital site ID 106. The pinned row carries F1, W1, E1, and D2 gem fields, producing five gems per month. It does not produce Air or Nature gems even though ten of the twenty-one national rituals use Air or Nature as their first path and therefore consume those gems.

The opening ledger should track each path separately. Death supports the largest portion of the summon ladder; Fire, Water, and Earth each fund narrower branches. Air and Nature require site searching, trade, events, Pretender support, or another documented source before their rituals become repeatable purchases.

## Complete Shinuyama commander membership

| Commander         | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment               |
|-------------------|------|-----------|------------|------------------------------------|
| Bakemono Scout    | 30   | 7         | 1          | Forts; all highlands and mountains |
| Noppera-bo        | 150  | 5         | 1          | Forts                              |
| Bandit Leader     | 60   | 16        | 1          | Forts                              |
| Bakemono Chief    | 60   | 8         | 1          | Forts; all highlands and mountains |
| Kappa Chief       | 70   | 1         | 1          | Land and underwater forts          |
| Bakemono General  | 115  | 27        | 1          | Forts                              |
| Shuten-doji       | 150  | 1         | 1          | Forts                              |
| Bakemono Shaman   | 115  | 1         | 2          | Forts; all highlands and mountains |
| Uba               | 190  | 1         | 2          | Forts                              |
| Bakemono Sorcerer | 545  | 2         | 4          | Forts                              |

Ten commander records reconcile. The ordinary roster does not contain a capital-only mage, so additional forts can recruit all three mage families. Terrain access still differs: highlands and

mountains add Scout, Chief, and Shaman recruitment, while underwater forts add Kappa Chief recruitment rather than the full land roster.

## Shinuyama commander jobs

| Commander         | Source-backed role                                                         | Important limit                                                            |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bakemono Scout    | Cheap stealth reconnaissance with short bow                                | Scouting does not itself establish report detail or survival.              |
| Noppera-bo        | Stealthy, fear-causing assassin with Spirit Sight                          | Assassin and detection outcomes remain engine-dependent.                   |
| Bandit Leader     | Stealthy leader with Pillage bonus                                         | Pillaging has diplomatic and economic costs as well as immediate output.   |
| Bakemono Chief    | Cheap terrain-accessible leader                                            | Leadership 50 limits the size of forces it can carry.                      |
| Kappa Chief       | Amphibious commander with recuperation                                     | Underwater access does not prove combat suitability in either environment. |
| Bakemono General  | Leadership 100 conventional commander                                      | Gold and resources compete with the troop line.                            |
| Shuten-doji       | Supernatural leader with Sleep Aura, invulnerability, and mixed leadership | Aura, protection, and life-drain outcomes require matchup evidence.        |
| Bakemono Shaman   | H1 random mage and terrain recruit                                         | Research penalty and one random level constrain efficiency and certainty.  |
| Uba               | W1 D1 N1 random mage with strong undead leadership                         | No Holy path; Nature and Water depth depend on the random result.          |
| Bakemono Sorcerer | F2 W1 E2 D2 H1 random mage with broad leadership                           | 545 gold and four recruitment points make every non-mage task expensive.   |

## Complete Shinuyama troop membership

| Troop                               | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment               |
|-------------------------------------|------|-----------|------------|------------------------------------|
| Bakemono-Sho, club                  | 7    | 1         | 3          | Forts; all highlands and mountains |
| Bakemono-Sho, yari                  | 7    | 2         | 3          | Forts; all highlands and mountains |
| Bakemono Archer, light              | 7    | 3         | 3          | Forts; all highlands and mountains |
| Bakemono-Sho, armoured yari         | 8    | 6         | 9          | Forts                              |
| Bakemono Archer, armoured           | 8    | 7         | 9          | Forts                              |
| Bandit, yari                        | 9    | 11        | 5          | Forts                              |
| Bandit, wakizashi and bow           | 9    | 16        | 5          | Forts                              |
| Bakemono Warrior                    | 9    | 8         | 12         | Forts                              |
| Kappa                               | 20   | 1         | 8          | Land and underwater forts          |
| Dai Bakemono, no-dachi              | 25   | 27        | 19         | Forts                              |
| Dai Bakemono, no-dachi and long bow | 25   | 31        | 19         | Forts                              |
| O-bakemono                          | 25   | 2         | 4          | Forts                              |

Twelve troop records reconcile. Duplicate display names remain separate because equipment, armour, cost, or recruitment demand differs. The three seven-gold light records carry the highland-and-mountain exception; the armoured eight-gold records do not inherit it from their names.

## Shinuyama troop jobs

| Troop                 | Source-backed role                                             | Important limit                                                                  |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Light Bakemono-Sho    | Extremely cheap club or yari frontage with stealth             | Low Hit Points, Morale, protection, and combat skills limit durability.          |
| Light Bakemono Archer | Cheap short-bow missile body with stealth                      | Low Morale and protection make return fire and contact dangerous.                |
| Armoured Bakemono     | Better-protected yari or bow profiles                          | Higher resources and recruitment points reduce the mass advantage.               |
| Bandits               | Stealthy medium infantry with yari or mixed bow profile        | Pillage bonus and stealth do not guarantee successful raiding.                   |
| Bakemono Warrior      | Better-skilled wakizashi infantry                              | Still a small, moderately protected body rather than a heavy line.               |
| Kappa                 | Amphibious, recuperating claw-and-koppo troop                  | High encumbrance and environment-specific value need battle evidence.            |
| Dai Bakemono          | Large, armoured heavy infantry with melee or long-bow profile  | Twenty-five gold, high resources, and size change frontage and replacement cost. |
| O-bakemono            | Large high-Strength great-club attacker with low resource cost | Modest protection and defence expose it while closing and after attacking.       |

## Recruitment geography and infrastructure

Shinuyama has three overlapping recruitment networks. Ordinary forts support the full land roster. Highlands and mountains add the light Bakemono troops plus Scout, Chief, and Shaman even where the ordinary fort table is not the controlling route. Land and underwater forts add Kappa and Kappa Chief.

This makes terrain a production question rather than flavour. A cave or mountain position may combine national economic or rebate rules with terrain recruits, while a water-connected fort can create amphibious command. The exact cave bonus, mountain discount, legal fort interaction, and underwater campaign value remain untested; each site should still be judged by income, resources, position, construction time, and intended output.

## Reading the Shinuyama random paths

The pinned masks use Fire 128, Air 256, Water 512, Earth 1024, Astral 2048, Death 4096, Nature 8192, Glamour 16384, and Blood 32768. Mask 5760 is Water, Earth, or Death. Mask 13824 is Water, Death, or Nature.

| Mage              | Guaranteed roll              | Independent extra roll        |
|-------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Bakemono Shaman   | one W/E/D level, 33.33% each | none                          |
| Uba               | one W/D/N level, 33.33% each | none                          |
| Bakemono Sorcerer | one W/E/D level, 33.33% each | 10% chance of one W/E/D level |

These are portfolio probabilities, not delivery dates. Several recruits can fail to produce the named path, and the high price and four-point recruitment demand of Sorcerers make large-sample assumptions costly.

## Bakemono Sorcerer probability boundary

Every Sorcerer begins F2 W1 E2 D2 H1. For any one named W/E/D path, the chance that at least one of the two random slots adds that path is 35.56%. The chance that both slots add the same named path is 1.11%. Across the whole second slot, 90% receive no extra level, 3.33% repeat the guaranteed path, and 6.67% add a different W/E/D path.

The rare double-Death result reaches D4 and meets Summon Dai Oni's D4F1 threshold natively. That is a legal possibility in the pinned scheme, not a recruit that can be scheduled to arrive by a particular turn.

## Shinuyama native path boundary

| Path    | Repeatable recruitable access                                | Boundary                                                                                               |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fire    | Sorcerer F2                                                  | No other recruitable mage carries Fire.                                                                |
| Air     | None                                                         | Requires a summon, hero, Pretender, independent, empowerment, or another verified bridge.              |
| Water   | Uba W1; Sorcerer W1; random depth on all three mage families | Uba or Sorcerer can reach W2; rare Sorcerer reaches W3.                                                |
| Earth   | Sorcerer E2; random Shaman or Sorcerer depth                 | Sorcerer reaches E3 commonly enough to plan as a portfolio, but not on demand; rare result reaches E4. |
| Astral  | None                                                         | Hero Tamamo-no-Mae carries S2, but heroes are not repeatable access.                                   |
| Death   | Uba D1; Sorcerer D2; random depth on all three families      | Sorcerer reaches D3 on 35.56% and D4 on 1.11% of pinned outcomes.                                      |
| Nature  | Uba N1 with W/D/N random                                     | One-third of Ubas reach N2; no recruitable mage reaches N3 unaided.                                    |
| Glamour | None                                                         | Hero and summoned access do not make it recruitable.                                                   |
| Blood   | None                                                         | Requires an external verified bridge.                                                                  |
| Holy    | Shaman H1; Sorcerer H1                                       | No recruitable H2 or sacred troop line is established.                                                 |

## Shinuyama national rituals: Oni and underworld branch

| Ritual             | Level | Requirement | Cost          | Printed result                 |
|--------------------|-------|-------------|---------------|--------------------------------|
| Summon Ko-Oni      | 1     | D1          | 4 Death gems  | five or more Ko-Oni            |
| Summon Ao-Oni      | 2     | W1 D1       | 7 Water gems  | five or more Ao-Oni            |
| Summon Aka-Oni     | 3     | F1 D1       | 7 Fire gems   | five or more Aka-Oni           |
| Ghost General      | 4     | D3          | 10 Death gems | one Shura                      |
| Summon Oni         | 4     | E1 D1       | 8 Earth gems  | five or more Oni               |
| Summon Kuro-Oni    | 5     | D2 F1       | 9 Death gems  | five or more Kuro-Oni          |
| Summon Gozu Mezu   | 6     | D3          | 6 Death gems  | one Ox-head and one Horse-face |
| Summon Oni General | 6     | D2 F1       | 20 Death gems | one Oni Shugo                  |
| Summon Dai Oni     | 8     | D4 F1       | 45 Death gems | one Dai Oni                    |

The Sorcerer directly meets Ko-Oni, Ao-Oni, Aka-Oni, Oni, Kuro-Oni, and Oni General thresholds. A Death-deep Sorcerer reaches Ghost General and Gozu Mezu; only the rare double-Death Sorcerer reaches D4 for Dai Oni without another bridge.

## Shinuyama national rituals: Tengu, spirit, and monster branch

| Ritual              | Level | Requirement | Cost          | Printed result                                          |
|---------------------|-------|-------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Summon Karasu Tengu | 2     | N1 A1       | 2 Nature gems | three Karasu Tengu                                      |
| Summon Konoha Tengu | 3     | A1 E1       | 3 Air gems    | five or more Konoha Tengu                               |
| Summon Omukade      | 4     | E2 D1       | 5 Earth gems  | one Omukade                                             |
| Contact Dai Tengu   | 5     | A2 E1       | 55 Air gems   | one Dai Tengu, ten Tengu Warriors, fifteen Karasu Tengu |
| Contact Nushi       | 5     | W2 N1       | 25 Water gems | one Nushi                                               |

Every Sorcerer meets Summon Omukade. A Water-random Uba meets Contact Nushi. The three Tengu rituals need Air, which no recruitable mage provides and the capital does not fund. Their national status does not make them immediately castable.

## Shinuyama national rituals: animal and shapeshifter branch

| Ritual           | Level | Requirement | Cost           | Printed result         |
|------------------|-------|-------------|----------------|------------------------|
| Summon Okami     | 3     | N1          | 4 Nature gems  | ten or more Okami      |
| Contact Bakeneko | 3     | N2          | 8 Nature gems  | one Bakeneko           |
| Ambush of Tigers | 3     | N2          | 9 Nature gems  | fifteen or more Tigers |
| Contact Mujina   | 5     | N2          | 21 Nature gems | one Mujina             |
| Contact Tanuki   | 5     | N2          | 26 Nature gems | one Tanuki             |
| Contact Jorogumo | 6     | N2 D1       | 32 Nature gems | one Jorogumo           |
| Contact Kitsune  | 6     | N2          | 30 Nature gems | one Kitsune            |

Every Uba can cast Summon Okami. A Nature-random Uba reaches N2 and can cast the remaining Nature rituals, including Contact Jorogumo because Ubas already have D1. The capital produces no Nature gems, so caster access and treasury access must be solved separately.

## Shinuyama ritual access ladder

| Access class         | Rituals                                                      | Reliable caster route                              |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Fixed Sorcerer       | Ko-Oni, Ao-Oni, Aka-Oni, Oni, Omukade, Kuro-Oni, Oni General | Every Sorcerer has the printed thresholds.         |
| Fixed Uba            | Okami                                                        | Every Uba has N1.                                  |
| One-third Uba branch | Bakeneko, Tigers, Mujina, Tanuki, Nushi, Jorogumo, Kitsune   | N-random Uba for N2 group; W-random Uba for Nushi. |

| Access class               | Rituals                               | Reliable caster route                                    |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Death-deep Sorcerer        | Ghost General, Gozu Mezu              | At least one added Death level; 35.56% in pinned scheme. |
| Rare double-Death Sorcerer | Dai Oni                               | Both random slots add Death; 1.11% in pinned scheme.     |
| External Air bridge        | Karasu Tengu, Konoha Tengu, Dai Tengu | No recruitable Air mage.                                 |

This ladder should be checked against the actual recruited portfolio before research and gems are committed. A path probability is not a caster standing in the correct laboratory.

## Shinuyama summon boundary

The manual prints fixed results for some rituals and x+ for others. The plus sign is retained without inventing its random distribution. Summoned commanders print paths, leadership, retinues, shapes, stealth, auras, or other abilities, but those object descriptions do not establish how every form, follower, item slot, battle script, or strategic order behaves in 6.36.

Summons can extend paths and army types, but each extension should be recorded in a chain: legal initial caster, research, gem cost, resulting unit, resulting paths, any further booster or ritual, and the total turns and gems spent. Skipping a link turns possible access into imaginary access.

## Shinuyama national item boundary

No pinned item row names nation 70 in its six restriction fields or two nation-rebate fields. The safe conclusion is narrow: this audit found no Shinuyama-specific item or rebate record in the pinned snapshot.

Shinuyama can still forge generic items when a mage meets the Construction and path requirements. Summoned or hero mages may widen that access, but neither their arrival nor an item treasury should be assumed. Final costs under forge bonuses, sites, hammers, or other modifiers remain separate evidence questions.

## Shinuyama hero records

| Fixed name    | Unit name          | Verified magic | Boundary                                               |
|---------------|--------------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Yukinaga      | Heart Hider        | F1 D1          | Hero record only; timing unresolved                    |
| Sojobo        | Tengu King         | A4 E1 N2 H2    | Pinned late-hero value 10; timing semantics unresolved |
| Tamamo-no-Mae | Kitsune            | S2 N2 G3       | Pinned late-hero value 10; timing semantics unresolved |
| Zenryo Ryuo   | Dragon of the Cave | W2 N2          | Pinned late-hero value 10; timing semantics unresolved |

The hero table shows major possible Air, Astral, Glamour, Nature, and Holy extensions. None belongs in a schedule that must work every game. The raw late-hero field is not converted into a turn, chance, or event rule without a current authoritative explanation.

## Shinuyama patch reconciliation

The current baseline is Dominions 6.36, released on 17 August 2026. The local official ledger records a 6.08 correction involving Shinuyama, Caelum, and a `call` spell. Its abbreviated terms are enough to flag a historical assignment problem but not enough to reconstruct the exact sentence safely.

The revision-2 manual and pinned spell restrictions agree on the twenty-one active rituals in this chapter. That agreement controls the present dossier, while the 6.08 entry remains a warning against older spell lists. No direct Shinuyama correction was identified in the separate 6.36 announcement.

## Shinuyama opening priorities

- 1 Record whether the starting bottleneck is gold, resources, recruitment points, commander turns, or Morale support.
- 2 Match light Bakemono, armoured Bakemono, O-bakemono, Dai Bakemono, or Kappa to the reported province instead of defaulting to one line.
- 3 Use cheap Chiefs or Generals for mundane command so expensive mage turns remain available.
- 4 Label every random mage by final paths immediately.
- 5 Establish additional mage recruitment where terrain, economy, and position justify the fort.
- 6 Track Death, Nature, and Air ritual plans separately from research progress.
- 7 Keep a reserve that can replace fragile cheap troops or respond to raiding without recalling the entire field army.

These are planning controls, not tested expansion scripts. Exact formations, party sizes, target order, and casualty expectations remain open.

## Shinuyama recruitment packages to compare

### Light Bakemono mass

Seven-gold club, yari, and bow records provide cheap bodies and terrain recruitment. Their low Hit Points, Morale, and protection mean numbers must be paired with leadership, formation, target selection, and a replacement plan. A mountain rebate may improve price, but its exact live effect remains unresolved.

### Armoured Bakemono line

The eight-gold yari and bow records buy more protection at higher resource and recruitment-point cost. They can reduce immediate fragility without becoming a high-Morale heavy line. Compare their local production limit against simply adding more light bodies or saving resources for Dai Bakemono.

### Large Bakemono package

Dai Bakemono provide armoured no-dachi or long-bow profiles; O-bakemono provide high Strength and a great club at low resource cost. Size, frontage, protection, Defence, and enemy weapon damage change which profile fits. Neither "large" nor "strong" proves survivability.

## Stealth and raiding package

Bandits, their Leader, Bakemono Scouts, Noppera-bo, and light Bakemono offer stealth-linked pressure. Reports, detection, patrols, assassination, movement, fort interaction, and diplomatic cost decide results. The package should be used to create a specific threat rather than because a stealth value exists.

## Kappa water-link package

Kappa and Kappa Chiefs can be recruited from land and underwater forts and are amphibious. This can connect theatres or hold water access, but high encumbrance, local opposition, leadership, supply, and underwater combat conditions remain part of the decision.

# Shinuyama research response tree

## Branch A: early Conjunction bodies

Conjunction 1-3 opens Ko-Oni, Ao-Oni, Karasu Tengu, Aka-Oni, Konoha Tengu, Okami, Bakeneko, and Tigers. Fixed Sorcerers and Ubas cover several thresholds, but Tengu rituals need external Air and the N2 rituals need a Nature-random Uba. Research should follow the actual caster and treasury.

## Branch B: Sorcerer core summons

Conjunction 4-6 opens Oni, Omukade, Ghost General, Kuro-Oni, Gozu Mezu, and Oni General. Every Sorcerer covers Oni, Omukade, Kuro-Oni, and Oni General; Death depth gates the other two. This branch aligns well with the capital's D2 income but still spends rare, expensive mage-turns.

## Branch C: Nature commander ladder

Conjunction 5-6 opens Mujina, Tanuki, Nushi, Jorogumo, and Kitsune. A correctly randomized Uba covers each threshold, but the capital has no Nature income. The operational package therefore requires search, trade, or another treasury source before the research pays off.

## Branch D: high Conjunction and Dai Oni

Conjunction 8 plus D4F1 and 45 Death gems reaches Summon Dai Oni. Only a rare double-Death Sorcerer reaches the threshold natively in the pinned scheme. The branch should not be scheduled until the caster exists or another explicit D4 bridge is documented.

## Branch E: ordinary battlefield and Construction needs

The nation also needs research that helps its actual troops and mages survive current enemies. Fire, Water, Earth, Death, Nature, and Holy provide many possible buffs, attacks, and protections, while Construction can convert paths into generic items. No universal sequence is claimed because opposition, sites, gems, and recruited randoms change the answer.

# Shinuyama battlefield packages



## Cheap line with mage support

Light or armoured Bakemono occupy space while a labelled Shaman, Uba, or Sorcerer casts effects its actual paths support. Mundane commanders should provide leadership where possible. Low Morale and protection make guards, spacing, reserves, and the enemy's attack profile important.

## Large-unit striking group

Dai Bakemono or O-bakemono concentrate stronger attacks and larger bodies. They need a line, formation, or target that lets those attacks arrive without wasting their size and cost. Enemy reach, armour, Defence, missiles, fatigue, and control effects remain report-dependent.

## Missile mix

Short bows, long bows, and the mixed Bandit profile create several missile options. Range, precision, enemy shields and armour, weather, friendly obstruction, ammunition, and closing speed determine value. The roster does not prove a fixed archer ratio.

## Summon-supported force

Oni, spirits, Tengus, monsters, animals, or summoned commanders can add specialised bodies. The complete package includes gems, ritual turns, leadership, magic leadership where required, supply, route, and a battlefield job. A summoned unit is not useful merely because it is national.

## Shinuyama information and pressure network

Bakemono Scouts provide cheap reconnaissance. Bandits and Bandit Leaders add stealth and pillaging. Noppera-bo add assassination, patience, fear, and Spirit Sight. Several national summons also print stealth or unusual perception and leadership abilities.

This is a toolkit, not a success rate. Report quality, Glamour and invisible detection, patrol interaction, assassin battles, counter-assassination, and stealth movement remain engine-dependent. The safe practice is to layer scouts, record observations, protect expensive specialists, and avoid making a war plan depend on an unverified detection channel.

## Shinuyama Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                                  | What it must not conceal                                                     |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Air bridge                 | Makes the Tengu ritual branch legally reachable and can support Air site searching | A path does not create the large Air treasury required by Contact Dai Tengu. |
| Nature economy             | Funds the broad animal and shapeshifter ritual branch                              | Native N2 is random and the capital produces no Nature gems.                 |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, large armies, and 545-gold Sorcerers                    | Gold does not create local resources, recruitment points, or mage-turns.     |
| High Death bridge          | Makes D4 access reliable for Dai Oni                                               | The 45-gem ritual and Conjunction 8 remain substantial costs.                |
| Sacred or awake design     | Supports sacred commanders or supplies early province-taking                       | The recruitable troop roster has no sacred line.                             |

No exact design is endorsed without settings, map, opponents, legal chassis, and versioned evidence.

## Shinuyama matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                              | First answer to examine                                                                 | Avoid                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units                         | Cheap frontage, bows, large attackers, summons, and reachable area effects              | Spending every resource on a small premium line.                        |
| Heavy armour                               | Dai or O-bakemono attacks, buffs, fatigue, armour-answering magic, and suitable summons | Assuming short bows or light clubs solve protection.                    |
| High Defence, ethereal, or Glamour targets | Area effects, magic weapons, attack support, control, and verified perception           | Treating Spirit Sight on one assassin as a universal answer.            |
| Fast flankers or flyers                    | Guards, reserves, mage spacing, and layered lines                                       | Clustering 545-gold Sorcerers behind fragile troops.                    |
| Fire, cold, poison, or fatigue pressure    | Resistance, spacing, alternative troops, and matching summons                           | Assuming all Bakemono or Oni share the same resistances.                |
| Underwater pressure                        | Kappa route, suitable summons, independents, and water magic                            | Treating amphibious access as automatic underwater superiority.         |
| Gem denial                                 | Conventional roster depth and low-gem magic                                             | Researching twenty-one rituals as though every treasury were funded.    |
| Raiding and covert pressure                | Scouts, reserves, patrols, forts, and redundant mage recruitment                        | Relying on one capital-adjacent laboratory or one expensive mage stack. |

## Monthly Shinuyama audit

- Is each production centre limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, commander turns, or terrain?
- Are light, armoured, large, stealth, and amphibious troops assigned jobs that fit their recorded profiles?
- Is every Shaman, Uba, and Sorcerer labelled by final paths?
- Are mundane commanders available where using a mage would lose research or ritual tempo?
- Are cave bonuses and mountain rebates still described only at the evidence level actually established?
- Are Fire, Water, Earth, Death, Nature, and Air gem balances tracked separately?
- Does every planned ritual have research, a legal caster, gems, a mage-turn, leadership, and delivery?
- Are variable summon quantities left as printed notation rather than converted into invented averages?
- Are hero and summoned paths excluded from schedules that must be repeatable?
- Has any pinned-only field been kept separate from current observed behaviour?

## Shinuyama unresolved evidence boundary

The following remain open:

- 1 exact cave-fort gold and resource bonuses, eligible buildings, stacking, and live display;
- 2 the exact lesser-Bakemono mountain rebate, eligible records, stacking, and live display;
- 3 expansion-party sizes, formations, scripts, and casualty ranges for each troop package;
- 4 live 6.36 random-path display and timing for Shamans, Ubas, and Sorcerers;
- 5 exact probability distributions behind every printed x+ summon result;
- 6 summoned unit shapes, retinues, item slots, magic paths after transformation, and strategic-order behaviour;
- 7 Noppera-bo assassination, fear, Spirit Sight, stealth, and counter-detection outcomes;
- 8 Kappa underwater performance and land-water campaign conversion;
- 9 the exact wording and superseded state addressed by the abbreviated 6.08 Shinuyama/Caelum spell correction;
- 10 hero arrival timing, late-hero field semantics, and live special behaviour;

- 11 final generic-item costs under combined forge modifiers;
- 12 specific Pretender designs, blesses, matchups, and map performance;
- 13 R-047, R-058, and all other parked engine-dependent investigations.

These are evidence gaps, not invitations to guess. Runtime testing and preparation of new test assets remain paused.

## Part XXIX: Middle Age C'tis, Miasma

### C'tis one-page command brief

Middle Age C'tis combines cheap lizard infantry, slave troops, sacred capital guards, large Sobek warriors, strong priests, Nature and Death magic, and a dominion that changes the land around it. Its two capital sites produce five gems each month and unlock separate sacred, Sobek, poison, and commander lines. The Marshmaster supplies the nation's main repeatable magical depth, while the Lizard Shaman, Empoisoner, and priest hierarchy cover narrower jobs.

The basic plan is:

- use ordinary infantry and slaves for replaceable line work instead of spending every capital resource on elite troops;
- reserve capital recruitment for Poison Slingers, Swamp Guards, Sobek bodies, and Empoisoners when their specific jobs matter;
- record every Marshmaster's final paths before assigning research, searching, forging, summoning, or battle duty;
- use mundane commanders for ordinary leadership so expensive mage and priest turns remain available;
- treat Miasma as a strategic environment with documented qualitative effects, not as a licence to invent percentages or disease timing;
- connect Conjuraton research to the actual caster and gem treasury, especially for Sacred Crocodile, Monster Toads, Couatl, and the externally gated Scorpion Man;
- protect additional forts and laboratories so the nation can replace researchers, priests, and field mages outside the capital.

C'tis converts heat, swamps, dominion, gold, recruitment, gems, and mage-turns into a war plan. Its main risks are slow troops, cold-blooded fatigue, dependence on a small mage portfolio, and the temptation to treat Miasma or poison resistance as a complete answer to an enemy army.

### C'tis evidence and ruleset

This chapter covers unmodded Middle Age C'tis on the [Book I 6.36](#) live baseline. The revision-2 official manual controls the player-facing roster, costs, recruitment limits, printed paths, Miasma description, and national ritual table. Nation ID 75, random masks, capital sites, spell restrictions, the Jade Mask restriction, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at `commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

The sources do not prove exact Miasma income percentages, disease-check timing, terrain-conversion probability, hosting order, cold-blooded fatigue outcomes, summon behaviour, assassin results, hero timing, or battle performance. Those remain unresolved. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used for this dossier.

## C'tis conversion chain

heat preference, ordinary troops, capital specialists, Miasma, and five capital gems  
-> provinces, protected forts, temples, laboratories, and dominion coverage  
-> labelled Marshmasters, Shamans, Empoisoners, and priest turns  
-> research, searching, Conjuration, forging, and battlefield support  
-> surviving armies, replacement capacity, sieges, claims, and hostile economic pressure

The fragile arrows are cold, movement, capital congestion, mage-turn competition, and incomplete knowledge of Miasma's exact live calculations. A special dominion shapes the board, but it does not replace scouting, troop matching, logistics, or a reserve.

## C'tis national rules that shape planning

| Rule or asset        | Source-backed fact                                                                                    | Planning consequence                                                                                              |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Heat preference      | The race summary prefers Heat +2; Pretender design has a Heat limit of +1.                            | Cold provinces create a documented fatigue concern for cold-blooded troops, but exact battle loss is not assumed. |
| Thick hides          | The manual describes the lizard races as naturally protected.                                         | Low-resource troops are not unarmoured humans, yet their full durability still depends on the attack faced.       |
| Poison resistance    | Ordinary C'tissians carry partial poison resistance; several capital records carry more.              | Poison is part of the roster's identity, not universal immunity.                                                  |
| Miasma               | Dominion changes non-sea land, harms outsiders, and favours C'tis economically.                       | Dominion placement matters strategically, but exact modifiers and timing remain unresolved.                       |
| Underwater exception | Underwater provinces are not affected by Miasma's special effects.                                    | Water borders and disciples must not be analysed as though the land rule applied unchanged.                       |
| Two capital sites    | The Temple Marsh and Empoisoners Guild divide capital recruitment and produce W1 D2 N2 gems in total. | Capital queues and five monthly gems must be tracked separately.                                                  |
| Strong priests       | Recruitable H1, H2, and H3 priests are verified.                                                      | Temple work and sacred leadership are available without pretending every priest is also a researcher.             |

## Miasma evidence boundary

The manual states that C'tis dominion brings heavy rain, turns non-sea land into swamps or drip caves, slightly increases income in provinces owned by C'tis, and severely reduces income in enemy provinces. Warm-blooded beings without Swamp Survival are subject to disease. The Pretender and sacred units are described as immune; disciples otherwise suffer the enemy treatment. Underwater provinces are excluded.

Those statements establish direction, eligibility, and broad strategic pressure. They do not establish the numeric income modifiers, how frequently disease is checked, whether all changes occur in the same hosting step, the probability or rate of terrain conversion, or every interaction with ownership changes and allied armies. This dossier uses Miasma to frame decisions while keeping those calculations open.

## C'tis capital sites and gem economy

| Site              | ID | Verified fields                                                                                 |
|-------------------|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The Temple Marsh  | 62 | W1 D2 N2; Swamp Guard, Sobek Warrior, Sobek Sacred Guard, and Sobek General recruitment records |
| Empoisoners Guild | 12 | Empoisoner and Poison Slinger recruitment records                                               |

The sites supply one Water, two Death, and two Nature gems each month. This directly funds several national Conjuration branches, but not Contact Scorpion Man's Earth cost. Site membership establishes legal capital recruitment, not the order in which those units should consume the queue.

## Complete C'tis commander membership

| Commander            | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment |
|----------------------|------|-----------|------------|----------------------|
| Taskmaster           | 40   | 2         | 1          | Forts                |
| Commander of C'tis   | 55   | 15        | 1          | Forts                |
| Lizard Lord          | 95   | 21        | 1          | Forts                |
| Hierodule            | 40   | 1         | 1          | Forts                |
| High Priest of C'tis | 115  | 1         | 2          | Forts                |
| Lizard King          | 340  | 5         | 4          | Forts                |
| Lizard Shaman        | 125  | 2         | 2          | Forts                |
| Marshmaster          | 330  | 1         | 2          | Forts                |
| Sobek General        | 200  | 31        | 1          | Capital only         |
| Empoisoner           | 125  | 6         | 2          | Capital only         |

Ten commander records reconcile. The ordinary forts can recruit the complete priest ladder and both non-capital mage families. The capital adds the Sobek General and Empoisoner, so using that queue for specialist commanders has an opportunity cost even before troops are considered.

## C'tis commander jobs

| Commander            | Source-backed role                          | Important limit                                                              |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Taskmaster           | Cheap leader with Taskmaster +2             | Slave morale interaction and final rout outcomes remain battle questions.    |
| Commander of C'tis   | Leadership 75 conventional commander        | Resource cost competes with protected troops.                                |
| Lizard Lord          | Leadership 100 protected commander          | More expensive than the ordinary commander and has no magic.                 |
| Hierodule            | Cheap H1 priest                             | Low leadership and no research path limit broader use.                       |
| High Priest of C'tis | H2 priest and modest leader                 | Two recruitment points and 115 gold compete with mages.                      |
| Lizard King          | H3 priest with leadership 150               | Four recruitment points and 340 gold make routine command expensive.         |
| Lizard Shaman        | S1 N1 sacred mage-priest                    | Narrow fixed paths and two recruitment points constrain volume.              |
| Marshmaster          | W1 D2 N2 random mage with undead leadership | Every turn spent outside research or magic carries a large opportunity cost. |

| Commander     | Source-backed role                                  | Important limit                                                           |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sobek General | Sacred, protected capital commander with Taskmaster | Capital-only and resource-heavy.                                          |
| Empoisoner    | Stealthy D1 N1 assassin with poison weapons         | Assassination, patience, poison, and survival outcomes remain unresolved. |

## Complete C'tis troop membership

| Troop                    | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment                        |
|--------------------------|------|-----------|------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Militia                  | 7    | 2         | 5          | Forts                                       |
| C'tissian Heavy Infantry | 10   | 15        | 11         | Forts                                       |
| City Guard               | 10   | 10        | 11         | Forts                                       |
| C'tissian Light Infantry | 10   | 5         | 11         | Forts                                       |
| Runner                   | 12   | 2         | 7          | Forts                                       |
| Slave Warrior            | 13   | 3         | 8          | Forts                                       |
| Falchioneer              | 13   | 17        | 18         | Forts                                       |
| Elite Warrior            | 15   | 9         | 9          | Forts                                       |
| Poison Slinger           | 24   | 6         | 32         | Capital only                                |
| Sobek Warrior            | 30   | 34        | 13         | Capital only                                |
| Swamp Guard              | 19   | 21        | 22         | Capital only, sacred                        |
| Sobek Sacred Guard       | 55   | 37        | 33         | Capital only, sacred, maximum two per month |

Twelve troop records reconcile. The capital-only group contains four distinct jobs rather than one obvious default: poison missiles, a large protected Sobek body, a smaller sacred guard, and a very expensive limited Sobek sacred.

## C'tis troop jobs

| Troop          | Source-backed role                 | Important limit                                                         |
|----------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Militia        | Very cheap spear body              | Low Morale and combat skill restrict independent use.                   |
| Heavy Infantry | Protected spear line               | Resources and cold-blooded encumbrance can limit sustained fighting.    |
| City Guard     | Middle protected spear line        | Does not carry the Heavy Infantry's full armour.                        |
| Light Infantry | Mobile spear-and-javelin profile   | Lower protection exposes it to missiles and contact.                    |
| Runner         | Fast spear-and-bite body           | Low protection and Morale make speed alone insufficient.                |
| Slave Warrior  | Trident-and-bite slave profile     | Needs suitable leadership and should not be treated as ordinary morale. |
| Falchioneer    | Ambidextrous two-falchion attacker | Recruitment and resource demand are high for a non-sacred body.         |
| Elite Warrior  | Better-skilled trident infantry    | Moderate protection still leaves matchup dependence.                    |

| Troop              | Source-backed role                       | Important limit                                                                                                   |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Poison Slinger     | Capital poison missile specialist        | High recruitment-point cost and live poison results need target evidence.                                         |
| Sobek Warrior      | Large, heavily protected capital fighter | Thirty-four resources and capital dependence constrain replacement.                                               |
| Swamp Guard        | Sacred protected falchion line           | Capital-only and recruitment-point heavy.                                                                         |
| Sobek Sacred Guard | Large sacred halberd body                | Fifty-five gold, thirty-seven resources, thirty-three points, and a two-per-month limit prevent mass assumptions. |

## C'tis capital queue doctrine

The capital supplies four troop specialists and two commander specialists. Poison Slingers compete with sacred and Sobek production through recruitment points. Sobek Warriors and both sacred guards also consume substantial resources. Empoisoners consume mage-capable commander turns, while Sobek Generals occupy the same capital commander system.

A useful capital plan therefore begins with the job required: poison delivery, sacred staying power, large protected bodies, specialist assassination, or capital leadership. The answer changes with resources, bless value, enemy composition, and the number of non-capital forts already producing Marshmasters and Shamans.

## Reading the Marshmaster random paths

Every Marshmaster begins W1 D2 N2. The pinned record adds one guaranteed level from Water, Astral, Death, or Nature, then an independent ten-percent second level from the same four-path pool.

| Final addition                     | Probability                             |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| No named path among either roll    | 73.125% for any one chosen W/S/D/N path |
| Exactly one level in a chosen path | 26.25%                                  |
| Two levels in the same chosen path | 0.625%                                  |
| Any second random level occurs     | 10%                                     |
| Second roll repeats the first path | 2.5% overall                            |
| Second roll adds a different path  | 7.5% overall                            |

A chosen path appears at least once with probability 26.875%. Several recruits can still miss it, and the 330-gold cost means probability should be used for portfolio planning rather than an assumed delivery turn.

## Marshmaster final-path portfolio

| Primary result | Ordinary final paths before the second roll | Primary probability |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Water          | W2 D2 N2                                    | 25%                 |
| Astral         | W1 S1 D2 N2                                 | 25%                 |
| Death          | W1 D3 N2                                    | 25%                 |
| Nature         | W1 D2 N3                                    | 25%                 |

The second roll can deepen the same path or add one of the other three. Rare W3, S2, D4, or N4 outcomes exist at 0.625% for each named path. They are possible assets, not infrastructure that a plan may assume before recruitment.

### C'tis native path boundary

| Path    | Repeatable recruitable access                                    | Boundary                                                                          |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fire    | None                                                             | Requires Pretender, independent, summon, empowerment, or another verified bridge. |
| Air     | None                                                             | Requires an external bridge.                                                      |
| Water   | Marshmaster W1; random depth to W2 or rarely W3                  | Sacred Crocodile requires W2.                                                     |
| Earth   | None                                                             | Contact Scorpion Man requires both Earth and Fire.                                |
| Astral  | Lizard Shaman S1; random Marshmaster S1 or rarely S2             | Shaman already meets Contact Couatl's Astral requirement.                         |
| Death   | Empoisoner D1; Marshmaster D2, random D3 or rarely D4            | Native strength is repeatable but concentrated in Marshmasters.                   |
| Nature  | Shaman and Empoisoner N1; Marshmaster N2, random N3 or rarely N4 | Every Marshmaster meets Monster Toads' N2 requirement.                            |
| Glamour | None                                                             | Requires an external verified bridge.                                             |
| Blood   | None                                                             | Requires an external verified bridge.                                             |
| Holy    | Hierodule H1, High Priest H2, Lizard King H3, Shaman H1          | Strong priest access is separate from research magic.                             |

### C'tis national ritual reconciliation

| Ritual               | Level         | Requirement | Cost           | Printed result       |
|----------------------|---------------|-------------|----------------|----------------------|
| Sacred Crocodile     | Conjuration 4 | N2 W2       | 1 Nature gem   | one Sacred Crocodile |
| Summon Monster Toads | Conjuration 5 | N2          | 5 Nature gems  | three Monster Toads  |
| Contact Couatl       | Conjuration 7 | N1 S1       | 40 Nature gems | one Couatl           |
| Contact Scorpion Man | Conjuration 8 | E1 F1       | 12 Earth gems  | one Scorpion Man     |

The manual and pinned nation restrictions agree on all four records. The table proves printed requirements, costs, and results. It does not prove summoned forms, item slots, command behaviour, battle performance, or later path access beyond the printed unit description.

### C'tis ritual access ladder

| Access class                   | Ritual               | Repeatable route                                              |
|--------------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Every Marshmaster              | Summon Monster Toads | Fixed N2                                                      |
| Water-random Marshmaster       | Sacred Crocodile     | W2 plus fixed N2; 26.875% have at least one added Water level |
| Every Lizard Shaman            | Contact Couatl       | Fixed S1 N1                                                   |
| External Fire-and-Earth bridge | Contact Scorpion Man | No recruitable C'tis mage has Fire or Earth                   |



Caster access must be joined to research, the correct gem type, a laboratory, and a free mage-turn. Contact Couatl is legally easy for the Shaman but costs forty Nature gems; Contact Scorpion Man has a modest cost but no native caster.

### C'tis national item: The Jade Mask

The Jade Mask is item ID 226, a Construction 9 helmet requiring D6 N3 and twenty Death gems. The manual lists Death Magic +2, Magic Resistance +3, regeneration, poison resistance, fear, darkvision, and Rigor Mortis. The pinned item row restricts it to the three C'tis nation IDs 27, 75, and 113 and records no national rebate.

The restriction does not create the D6 N3 forger. A rare Marshmaster can reach D4 or N4, but no recruitable result supplies the complete threshold alone. Any forging plan must show the exact boosters, empowerment, summon, hero, Pretender, or other bridge rather than treating a national artifact as automatically available.

### C'tis hero records

| Fixed name     | Unit name         | Verified magic | Boundary                                    |
|----------------|-------------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Niklatu        | Lizard Hero       | none           | Hero record only                            |
| Murmur         | Guild Master      | D3 N3          | Pinned late-hero value 5; timing unresolved |
| Kabti'ili      | Ancient Shaman    | S2 N2 H1       | Hero record only                            |
| Nakhtun Eshash | Sobek High Priest | H3             | Hero record only                            |
| Atun Shar      | Sobek Sauromancer | W2 D3 N2       | Pinned late-hero value 5; timing unresolved |

These records can widen a particular game's priest and magic portfolio, but none belongs in a schedule that must work every game. The raw late-hero field is not translated into an arrival formula without a current authoritative explanation.

### C'tis patch reconciliation

The current baseline is Dominions 6.36, released on 17 August 2026. The retained official ledger contains no directly named correction for C'tis, Miasma, Marshmaster, Empoisoner, Sobek, or the Jade Mask through that release.

This absence is not proof that every historical value was unchanged. The revision-2 manual controls current player-facing descriptions, while the pinned 6.35 data remains labelled as a structured cross-check. Any later discrepancy must be recorded rather than silently harmonised.

### C'tis opening priorities

- 1

Check whether the first recruitment bottleneck is gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns.
- 2

Match spear lines, javelins, slaves, dual weapons, or elites to the reported province instead of defaulting to one unit.
- 3

Use ordinary commanders for expansion leadership where their capacity is enough.
- 4

Label every Marshmaster by final paths immediately.
- 5

Build additional mage recruitment so research and field support do not remain capital-dependent.

- 6 Track Water, Death, and Nature gems separately even though the capital provides all three.
- 7 Maintain a reserve for raiding, cold-weather problems, or replacement of slow armies.

These are planning controls, not tested expansion scripts. Exact party sizes, formations, scripts, target order, and casualty ranges remain open.

## C'tis recruitment packages to compare

### Cheap spear screen

Militia, Light Infantry, City Guard, and Slave Warriors provide several prices and levels of protection. They can cover space while expensive mages remain behind the line. Morale, leadership, cold, and the enemy's damage profile decide which mixture survives.

### Protected infantry line

Heavy Infantry, City Guard, Falchioneers, and Elite Warriors trade more resources or recruitment points for armour, attacks, or skill. They should be compared against the local resource ceiling rather than assumed superior because their individual profile is stronger.

### Capital sacred group

Swamp Guards and Sobek Sacred Guards convert the capital, resources, recruitment points, and any useful bless into sacred force. The larger Sobek is limited to two per month and costs heavily in every queue. A bless should be judged against the actual number and role of sacreds that can be delivered.

### Sobek line

Sobek Warriors and Sacred Guards provide large, well-protected bodies with strong attacks. Their cost, size, resource demand, movement, fatigue, and replacement route matter as much as their raw durability.

### Poison pressure group

Poison Slingers and Empoisoners create ranged or covert poison threats. Poison resistance, missile accuracy, target selection, friendly exposure, assassin battles, and the exact effect sequence remain matchup and runtime questions.

## C'tis research response tree

### Branch A: national Conjunction opening

Conjunction 4 and 5 unlock Sacred Crocodile and Monster Toads. Every Marshmaster can cast the toad ritual; a Water-random Marshmaster reaches the crocodile threshold. The branch uses Nature gems and should be compared against site searching and other Nature expenditure.

### Branch B: Couatl bridge

Conjunction 7 unlocks Contact Couatl. Every Lizard Shaman has N1 S1, so the caster is repeatable even though the forty-gem cost is substantial. The summoned Couatl's printed paths can widen the portfolio, but its live strategic and battlefield behaviour remains untested here.

## Branch C: high Conjunction and external paths

Conjunction 8 unlocks Contact Scorpion Man at E1 F1. C'tis has neither path on a recruitable mage. Researching the ritual before documenting a legal caster and Earth treasury creates a dead endpoint.

## Branch D: Death and Nature support

Marshmasters naturally support Death and Nature research families, while Empoisoners and Shamans cover lower thresholds. The useful school depends on the opponent: protection, fatigue, undead, battlefield control, resistance, and troop survival all change the answer.

## Branch E: Construction and path bridges

Construction can convert W/S/D/N access into generic items and later support the Jade Mask chain. The artifact itself sits at Construction 9 and D6 N3, so the forge plan must be written as a sequence of actual path gains and costs rather than a nation label.

# C'tis battlefield packages

## Infantry line with Marshmaster support

Ordinary spear or elite infantry holds space while a labelled Marshmaster casts from its actual W/S/D/N paths. A mundane commander handles leadership where possible. Cold, fatigue, friendly exposure, and enemy attack type determine which support package is legal and useful.

## Sacred capital force

Swamp Guards and Sobek Sacred Guards form a smaller premium line under priest support. The package includes capital recruitment, resource limits, bless value, H1-H3 availability, and replacement time. Sacred status does not prove that the line fits every opponent.

## Sobek striking group

Sobek Warriors or sacred guards provide large protected bodies for a chosen point of contact. Frontage, weapon reach, defence, fatigue, enemy armour answers, and route speed can all turn high individual statistics into poor conversion.

## Poison and harassment package

Poison Slingers pressure at range while Empoisoners threaten commanders or isolated targets. This package is evidence-sensitive: poison resistance, patrols, bodyguards, scripts, accuracy, and assassination resolution must be checked rather than assumed.

# C'tis information and pressure network

C'tis has no recruitable scout named in its national commander table, so ordinary independent scouting and other verified sources remain important. Empoisoners supply stealth and assassination, but using a 125-gold capital mage as an information tool carries queue and survival costs.

Miasma adds territorial pressure by changing the environment of dominion-covered land. That pressure does not reveal enemy orders or replace reports. The safe information plan layers scouts,

province reports, reserves, and protected commanders while keeping unverified disease and conversion timing outside operational promises.

## C'tis Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                                  | What it must not conceal                                                      |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fire and Earth bridge      | Makes Contact Scorpion Man legally reachable and can add missing site-search paths | A caster does not create an Earth treasury or Conjunction 8.                  |
| Jade Mask forger           | Supplies high Death/Nature or a shorter booster chain                              | Construction 9, twenty Death gems, and exact path steps still matter.         |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, Marshmasters, and capital elites               | Gold does not create local resources, recruitment points, or commander turns. |
| Sacred support             | Improves the limited capital sacred line                                           | The strongest sacred is capped at two per month and remains capital-only.     |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the slow early roster                                          | Performance depends on map, scales, bless, chassis, and opponent evidence.    |

No exact design is endorsed without game settings, map, opponents, legal chassis, and versioned evidence.

## C'tis matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem             | First answer to examine                                                                        | Avoid                                                         |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units        | Protected line, dual attacks, poison pressure, summons, and reachable area effects             | Spending the entire capital queue on a tiny elite group.      |
| Heavy armour              | Falchioneers, Sobek attacks, buffs, fatigue, poison where relevant, and armour-answering magic | Assuming spears and slings solve protection unaided.          |
| Cold pressure             | Resistance, fatigue control, shorter battles, alternative bodies, and route choice             | Treating cold-blooded as flavour text.                        |
| Poison-resistant enemies  | Conventional damage, magic, sacreds, and non-poison summons                                    | Building the whole battle plan around Poison Slingers.        |
| Fast flankers or flyers   | Guards, reserves, layered lines, and mage spacing                                              | Leaving Marshmasters exposed behind slow infantry.            |
| Undead or lifeless forces | Priests, Death/Nature options, suitable summons, and physical damage                           | Assuming disease or poison affects every target.              |
| Dominion resistance       | Temples, priests, strategic concentration, and ordinary economic strength                      | Treating Miasma as guaranteed control without candles.        |
| Raiding                   | Scouts, reserves, forts, and distributed recruitment                                           | Depending on one slow capital army to answer every incursion. |

## Monthly C'tis audit

- Is each fort limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns?
- Is the capital queue producing a specific specialist rather than merely the most expensive record?
- Is every Marshmaster labelled by final paths?
- Are mundane commanders handling work that does not require magic or priesthood?
- Are Miasma claims still limited to the exact qualitative evidence available?
- Are Water, Death, and Nature gem balances tracked separately?

- Does every national ritual have research, a legal caster, the correct gems, a laboratory, and a free mage-turn?
- Are heroes and rare double-randoms excluded from schedules that must be repeatable?
- Are cold, movement, supply, fatigue, poison resistance, and replacement routes checked before battle?
- Has any pinned 6.35 field been kept separate from current observed behaviour?

## C'tis unresolved evidence boundary

The following remain open:

- 1 exact Miasma income increases and reductions, eligibility, rounding, and stacking;
- 2 disease-check frequency, hosting order, resistance, immunity, and ownership-change interactions;
- 3 swamp and drip-cave conversion rate, selection, timing, and interface display;
- 4 live 6.36 Marshmaster random-path presentation and timing;
- 5 exact cold-blooded fatigue outcomes across temperature, battle length, and unit profiles;
- 6 expansion-party sizes, formations, scripts, and casualty ranges;
- 7 Poison Slinger and Empoisoner targeting, poison, assassination, patience, and survival outcomes;
- 8 summoned-unit forms, magic, slots, leadership, and strategic-order behaviour;
- 9 hero arrival timing, late-hero field semantics, and live special behaviour;
- 10 the complete legal Jade Mask forging chain and final costs under combined modifiers;
- 11 disciple, allied-army, and underwater edge cases beyond the manual's explicit wording;
- 12 specific Pretender designs, blesses, matchups, and map performance;
- 13 R-047, R-058, and all other parked engine-dependent investigations.

These are evidence gaps, not invitations to guess. Runtime testing and preparation of new test assets remain paused.

# Part XXX: Middle Age Pangaea, Age of Bronze

## Pangaea one-page command brief

Middle Age Pangaea turns forests, mobile halfmen, recuperating troops, broad Nature magic, and a small capital Blood branch into strategic reach. Ordinary forts offer the full conventional roster, while forests add cheap local recruitment and sacred Hierophants. The capital contributes Pandemoniacs and White Centaurs through separate sites. Pans are the main research and ritual engine; Dryads and the two Hierophant families provide cheaper priesthood and random Water, Earth, Nature, or Glamour access.

The basic plan is:

- use forest recruitment to widen replacement and raiding capacity without pretending it replaces forts;
- match cheap Satyrs, missile Centaurs, protected Hoplites, mobile Warriors, and trampling Minotaurs to the reported target;
- label every Hierophant, Hierophantide, Dryad, Pan, and Pandemoniac by final paths as soon as recruitment completes;
- spend mundane commander turns on ordinary leadership so expensive mages remain available for research, searching, rituals, and battle magic;

- treat recuperation as a documented national advantage while leaving its exact eligibility, rate, and timing unresolved;
- connect each national ritual to its actual caster, research level, gem treasury, laboratory, terrain, and free mage-turn;
- protect secondary forests and forts so losses do not reduce the nation to one capital queue.

Pangaea converts forests, gold, resources, recruitment points, mage-turns, and Nature gems into mobility and repeated pressure. Its main risks are expensive researchers, uneven protection, low morale among cheap troops, capital congestion, narrow native answers outside Earth and Nature, and overconfidence in stealth, trample, berserk, recuperation, or Magical Tunes without matchup evidence.

## Pangaea evidence and ruleset

This chapter covers unmodded Middle Age Pangaea on the [Book I 6.36](#) live baseline. The revision-2 official manual controls the player-facing roster, costs, recruitment markings, visible paths, national summary, capital sites, spell tables, and ritual descriptions. Nation ID 52, recruitment memberships, random masks, site fields, spell restrictions, the absence of national item rows, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

The sources do not prove exact recuperation checks, live recruitment-interface grouping, stealth outcomes, tune resolution, ritual implementation, hero timing, or battle performance. Those remain unresolved. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used for this dossier.

## Pangaea conversion chain

forests, cheap local recruits, mobile troops, capital specialists, and Nature income  
-> provinces, protected forest nodes, forts, temples, laboratories, and scouting reach  
-> labelled Hierophants, Dryads, Pans, Pandemoniacs, and preserved mage-turns  
-> research, searching, tunes, rituals, forging, and battlefield support  
-> surviving armies, replacements, raids, sieges, claims, and strategic depth

The fragile arrows are morale, armour, capital congestion, the cost of Pans, limited native Astral and Death access, and incomplete knowledge of several special abilities. Forest access and stealth create options, but neither supplies information automatically or guarantees a successful raid.

## Pangaea national rules that shape planning

| Rule or asset       | Source-backed fact                                                                                          | Planning consequence                                                                                                                         |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Forest beings       | The roster is dominated by units with Forest Survival, and eleven records have explicit forest recruitment. | Forest provinces can become recruitment and movement nodes, but local capacity still depends on ownership, infrastructure, and queue limits. |
| Recuperating troops | The manual says troops heal battle afflictions and marks the roster with Recuperation.                      | Valuable survivors may recover, but no exact chance or timing is budgeted.                                                                   |
| Stealth             | Most light Satyr and Centaur lines, all five mage families, and both forest commanders carry Stealth.       | Scouting, concentration, and raiding options improve, but detection and movement outcomes remain evidence questions.                         |
| Growth limit        | Pretender design has a Growth limit of +1.                                                                  | Scale planning can lean toward population and supplies, but the limit is not itself an economic recommendation.                              |

| Rule or asset   | Source-backed fact                                               | Planning consequence                                                                                                                    |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primitive Forts | The nation uses the Primitive Fort family.                       | Fort cost, build time, administration, and siege strength must be taken from the current fort table rather than assumed from the label. |
| Forest temples  | Temples cost 300 gold in forests.                                | Forest dominion infrastructure receives a clear discount and should be considered alongside laboratories and forts.                     |
| Magical Tunes   | Three national Enchantment-0 spells require N1 and five fatigue. | Nature casters gain immediate battlefield options, while their exact live behaviour remains unresolved.                                 |

## Pangaea recruitment geography

The ordinary fort roster contains eight commanders and fourteen troops. The capital adds Pandemoniac and White Centaur through Hidden Grove and The Grove of Gaia. Forests separately recruit four commanders and seven troops: Black Harpy, Satyr Commander, Centaur Hierophant, Centauride Hierophantide, Harpy, Satyr Sneak, both basic Satyr variants, Minotaur, Centauride, and Centaur.

These categories overlap rather than replace one another. A forest fort can access ordinary-fort records as well as forest recruits, while an unfortified forest can provide the explicit terrain group. The exact live interface and every terrain edge case were not observed, so the chapter treats the structured memberships as legal-source boundaries rather than a screenshot of the current client.

## Complete Pangaea commander membership

| Commander                | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment |
|--------------------------|------|-----------|------------|----------------------|
| Black Harpy              | 35   | 1         | 1          | Forts and forests    |
| Satyr Commander          | 60   | 23        | 1          | Forts and forests    |
| Minotaur Lord            | 95   | 31        | 1          | Forts                |
| Centaur Commander        | 105  | 32        | 1          | Forts                |
| Centaur Hierophant       | 170  | 4         | 2          | Forts and forests    |
| Centauride Hierophantide | 170  | 3         | 2          | Forts and forests    |
| Dryad                    | 310  | 1         | 2          | Forts                |
| Pan                      | 425  | 1         | 4          | Forts                |
| Pandemoniac              | 355  | 1         | 4          | Capital only         |

Nine commander records reconcile. Forests can supply cheap scouts, ordinary leadership, and both H1 random-mage families without consuming a fort's ordinary commander identity. Pans and Dryads remain fort recruits; the Blood-capable Pandemoniac remains capital-only.

## Pangaea commander jobs

| Commander   | Source-backed role                            | Important limit                       |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Black Harpy | Flying stealth scout and very cheap commander | Leadership 10 restricts army command. |

| Commander                | Source-backed role                                               | Important limit                                                       |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Satyr Commander          | Stealth leader for ordinary troops                               | Twenty-three resources compete with protected units.                  |
| Minotaur Lord            | Protected leadership-75 trampler                                 | No magic; resource-heavy and matchup-dependent.                       |
| Centaur Commander        | Mobile leadership-100 commander                                  | Thirty-two resources and Inspirational -1 make the role costly.       |
| Centaur Hierophant       | Sacred H1 with E/N random and longbow                            | Two recruitment points and only one magic level.                      |
| Centauride Hierophantide | Sacred H1 with W/N random and short bow                          | Two recruitment points and only one magic level.                      |
| Dryad                    | Sacred N1 H2 mage-priest with W/E/N/G random, Awe, and Seduction | 310 gold; seduction resolution and survival remain untested.          |
| Pan                      | E2 N3 random mage and main researcher                            | 425 gold and four recruitment points create a large opportunity cost. |
| Pandemoniac              | Capital N3 B2 mage with a rare E/N/B random                      | Capital-only, four recruitment points, and no priest path.            |

## Complete Pangaea troop membership

| Troop                    | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment |
|--------------------------|------|-----------|------------|----------------------|
| Harpy                    | 7    | 1         | 3          | Forts and forests    |
| Satyr Sneak              | 9    | 3         | 6          | Forts and forests    |
| Satyr, spear and javelin | 9    | 4         | 6          | Forts and forests    |
| Satyr, spear only        | 9    | 4         | 6          | Forts and forests    |
| Satyr Hoplite            | 14   | 24        | 24         | Forts                |
| Reveler                  | 16   | 3         | 14         | Forts                |
| Centaur                  | 25   | 4         | 12         | Forts and forests    |
| Centauride               | 25   | 3         | 12         | Forts and forests    |
| Centauride Warrior       | 30   | 11        | 17         | Forts                |
| Centauride Cataphract    | 30   | 28        | 17         | Forts                |
| Centaur Cataphract       | 35   | 32        | 21         | Forts                |
| Centaur Warrior          | 35   | 11        | 21         | Forts                |
| Minotaur                 | 40   | 6         | 6          | Forts and forests    |
| War Minotaur             | 50   | 23        | 18         | Forts                |
| White Centaur            | 55   | 12        | 29         | Capital only, sacred |

Fifteen troop records reconcile. The two basic Satyrs share a displayed name but remain separate objects with different weapons and Defence. The roster offers cheap bodies, bows, javelins, protected formations, mobile striking units, trampers, berserkers, and a capital sacred rather than one universal line.



## Pangaea troop jobs

| Troop                 | Source-backed role                                 | Important limit                                                       |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Harpy                 | Cheap flying stealth body                          | Low morale and protection restrict direct fighting.                   |
| Satyr Sneak           | High-stealth spear screen                          | Light protection and Morale 9 demand leadership and target selection. |
| Satyr with javelin    | Cheap spear body with one ranged option            | Still lightly protected and low-morale.                               |
| Satyr with spear      | Slightly higher Defence than the javelin variant   | Gives up the ranged weapon.                                           |
| Satyr Hoplite         | Protected spear line                               | Heavy resource and recruitment-point demand.                          |
| Reveler               | Stealthy berserking spear-and-hoof attacker        | Light armour and berserk commitment can become liabilities.           |
| Centaur               | Mobile longbow unit with hoof attack               | Low protection and cost require useful range and positioning.         |
| Centauride            | More precise shortbow unit                         | Shorter weapon range and light protection.                            |
| Centauride Warrior    | Fast high-Defence spear, hoof, and javelin fighter | Moderate protection remains vulnerable to the wrong attack.           |
| Centauride Cataphract | Armoured lance, hoof, and javelin fighter          | High resources and encumbrance reduce easy replacement.               |
| Centaur Cataphract    | Heaviest protected lance body                      | Thirty-two resources and modest Defence create matchup dependence.    |
| Centaur Warrior       | Mobile lance-and-hoof berserker                    | More exposed than the cataphract line.                                |
| Minotaur              | Cheap-for-size trampler and berserker              | Low Attack and Defence make trample target selection important.       |
| War Minotaur          | Better-armoured trampling line                     | More resources and encumbrance without solving every counter.         |
| White Centaur         | Capital sacred mobile striker                      | Capital-only, expensive, and recruitment-point heavy.                 |

## Recuperation evidence boundary

The manual marks every national commander and troop with Recuperation and summarizes the nation as having troops that heal battle afflictions. This supports treating affliction recovery as part of the roster's long-term value.

It does not establish which afflictions qualify, the chance per turn, whether commanders and troops follow identical rules, when checks occur, or every interaction with healing, disease, transformation, and temporary forms. The dossier therefore tracks valuable survivors without predicting a recovery date.

## Reading Pangaea's random paths

| Recruit                  | Fixed magic | Random structure                                           |
|--------------------------|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Centaur Hierophant       | H1          | Guaranteed E1 or N1, 50% each                              |
| Centauride Hierophantide | H1          | Guaranteed W1 or N1, 50% each                              |
| Dryad                    | N1 H2       | Guaranteed W1, E1, N1, or G1, 25% each                     |
| Pan                      | E2 N3       | Guaranteed E1 or N1, then an independent 10% E1/N1/B1 roll |

| Recruit     | Fixed magic | Random structure              |
|-------------|-------------|-------------------------------|
| Pandemoniac | N3 B2       | Independent 10% E1/N1/B1 roll |

These probabilities are derived from pinned masks 9216, 8704, 26112, and 41984. They are portfolio probabilities, not promises about a finite recruitment run or claims about the live display order.

## Pan final-path portfolio

| Final paths | Probability |
|-------------|-------------|
| E3 N3       | 45%         |
| E2 N4       | 45%         |
| E4 N3       | 1.667%      |
| E2 N5       | 1.667%      |
| E3 N4       | 3.333%      |
| E3 N3 B1    | 1.667%      |
| E2 N4 B1    | 1.667%      |

Every Pan gains either Earth or Nature. A named primary path appears at least once on 51.667% of Pans because the rare roll can repeat it; double Earth and double Nature each occur on 1.667%. Rare depth is useful when it appears but should not be scheduled before recruitment.

## Pandemoniac rare-path portfolio

Every Pandemoniac begins N3 B2. Ninety percent receive no additional level. Earth, Nature, and Blood each occur on 3.333% of recruits, producing E1 N3 B2, N4 B2, or N3 B3 respectively.

This capital line is the only repeatable native Blood access. A B3 result is possible but rare, so a Blood plan should distinguish the guaranteed B2 floor from a branch that may take many capital recruitments to appear.

## Pangaea native path boundary

| Path    | Repeatable recruitable access                                           | Boundary                                                                          |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fire    | None                                                                    | Requires Pretender, independent, summon, empowerment, or another verified bridge. |
| Air     | None                                                                    | Hero Arcopythera is not a repeatable solution.                                    |
| Water   | W-random Hierophantide or Dryad at W1                                   | No recruitable native depth beyond W1.                                            |
| Earth   | Pan E2, usually E3 and rarely E4; E-random Hierophant or Dryad at E1    | Strong repeatable Earth is concentrated in expensive Pans.                        |
| Astral  | None                                                                    | Requires an external bridge.                                                      |
| Death   | None                                                                    | Requires an external bridge.                                                      |
| Nature  | Dryad N1; Pan N3, usually N4 and rarely N5; Pandemoniac N3 or rarely N4 | Nature is the broadest and deepest native path.                                   |
| Glamour | G-random Dryad at G1                                                    | Repeatable chance, but only one-quarter of Dryads.                                |
| Blood   | Pandemoniac B2 or rarely B3; rare Pan B1                                | Guaranteed access is capital-only.                                                |

| Path | Repeatable recruitable access | Boundary                                   |
|------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Holy | Hierophants H1; Dryad H2      | Priest access exists in forests and forts. |

## Pangaea capital sites and gem economy

| Site              | ID | Verified fields                                                         |
|-------------------|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The Grove of Gaia | 14 | N5 monthly gems; Growth scale limit 2; White Centaur recruitment record |
| Hidden Grove      | 19 | Pandemoniac recruitment record                                          |

The capital produces five Nature gems each month. That income directly matches all three national rituals, but it does not make every ritual affordable on schedule: research, caster access, other Nature spending, and mage-turn competition still matter.

## Pangaea national Magical Tunes

| Spell                 | Level         | Requirement | Cost      | Printed fields                                                          |
|-----------------------|---------------|-------------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tune of Fear          | Enchantment 0 | N1          | 5 fatigue | Range 0, area 25; armour-negating, mind-affecting boundary              |
| Tune of Growth        | Enchantment 0 | N1          | 5 fatigue | Range 0, area 25                                                        |
| Tune of Dancing Death | Enchantment 0 | N1          | 5 fatigue | Range 0, area 25; 31+ damage, armour-negating, magic resistance applies |

All three spells are national, immediately researched, and printed as unusable underwater. Every Dryad, Pan, and Pandemoniac meets N1; Nature-random Hierophants and Hierophantides also qualify. Legal access does not establish whether a tune is tactically safe or effective.

## Magical Tune evidence boundary

The manual establishes requirements, fatigue, range, area, broad targeting text, damage where printed, resistance fields, and the underwater prohibition. It does not fully establish target selection, pulse timing, friendly inclusion, mind-immunity handling, interruption, or how the area is placed in a live battle.

The dossier therefore treats the Tunes as available tools that require report-driven scripting. It does not promise a morale break, regeneration outcome, or damage result against a particular formation.

## Pangaea national ritual reconciliation

| Ritual           | Level         | Requirement | Cost           | Printed result                                                          |
|------------------|---------------|-------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Monster Boar     | Conjuration 5 | N3          | 10 Nature gems | Anonymous remote Monster Boar that creates unrest until found and slain |
| Awaken Hamadryad | Enchantment 5 | N4          | 25 Nature gems | One Hamadryad                                                           |

| Ritual               | Level        | Requirement | Cost           | Printed result                                        |
|----------------------|--------------|-------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Fort of the Ancients | Alteration 5 | N4          | 35 Nature gems | Complete fortress in a forest or shallow-sea province |

The manual and pinned nation restrictions agree on all three records. Printed requirements, costs, and headline results are source facts. Remote resolution, retinue realization, exact summoned abilities, terrain edge cases, fort type, and hosting order remain open.

## Pangaea ritual access ladder

| Access class                                 | Ritual                                    | Repeatable route                       |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Every Pan or Pandemoniac                     | Monster Boar                              | Fixed N3                               |
| Nature-primary Pan                           | Awaken Hamadryad and Fort of the Ancients | N4 on 50% of Pans before the rare roll |
| Any Pan with at least one added Nature level | Awaken Hamadryad and Fort of the Ancients | 51.667% when the rare roll is included |
| Rare Pandemoniac                             | Awaken Hamadryad and Fort of the Ancients | N4 on 3.333% of Pandemoniacs           |

The manual's Hamadryad description prints N3, Growth Power 1, Research -4, and a 3d6 Harpy retinue. Those fields help identify the intended result but do not establish live retinue rolling, persistence, shapes, or every command interaction. Fort of the Ancients additionally requires a legal target province; Monster Boar additionally requires a useful remote target and tolerance for uncertain resolution.

## Pangaea national item boundary

The pinned BaseI.csv snapshot assigns nation 52 to none of its restriction or nation-rebate fields. The supported conclusion is narrow: there is no pinned Pangaea-restricted or Pangaea-rebate item record.

Pangaea still forges general items through its actual paths. Strong Earth and Nature on Pans support a substantial generic Construction portfolio, while Water, Glamour, and Blood branches require labelled recruits. No item chain is treated as free merely because the nation can eventually reach its path.

## Pangaea hero records

| Fixed name    | Unit name   | Verified magic | Boundary                                    |
|---------------|-------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Rams Head     | White Satyr | none           | Hero record only                            |
| Arcopythera   | Harpy Queen | A2 N2          | Hero record only                            |
| Taurotyrannos | Black Bull  | E1 N3 B3       | Pinned late-hero value 5; timing unresolved |

These heroes can widen a particular game's mobility or magic portfolio, especially into Air or deeper Blood. None belongs in a repeatable research, forging, or ritual schedule. The raw late-hero field is not translated into a turn or probability formula.

## Pangaea patch reconciliation

The current baseline is Dominions 6.36, released on 17 August 2026. The retained official ledger contains no directly named correction for Pangaea, Pandemoniac, Hamadryad, Monster Boar, Fort of the Ancients, or the national Tunes through that release.

This absence is not proof that every historical value was unchanged. The revision-2 manual controls current player-facing descriptions, while the pinned 6.35 data remains labelled as a structured cross-check. Any later discrepancy must be recorded rather than silently harmonised.

## Pangaea opening priorities

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns limit the first expansion cycle.
- 2 Use province reports to choose cheap Satyrs, missiles, protection, mobility, or trample instead of defaulting to one troop.
- 3 Recruit mundane leadership where magic is unnecessary.
- 4 Label every random mage immediately and keep rare branches out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Secure useful forests for local replacement, scouting reach, and discounted temples.
- 6 Build additional fort and laboratory capacity before Pan recruitment becomes a single-queue bottleneck.
- 7 Track the Nature treasury against rituals, searching, forging, and emergency battlefield use.
- 8 Keep a mobile reserve for raiding, flankers, and replacement of stealth forces that fail.

These are planning controls, not a tested expansion script. Exact party sizes, formations, scripts, target order, stealth routes, and casualty ranges remain open.

## Pangaea recruitment packages to compare

### Cheap forest screen

Satyr Sneaks and the two basic Satyr variants provide inexpensive spear bodies from forts or forests. The javelin version adds one ranged attack, while the spear-only version has higher Defence. Low Morale and light protection make leadership, numbers, and the enemy attack profile decisive.

### Protected Bronze line

Satyr Hoplites and both Cataphracts trade large resource costs for protection and stronger contact profiles. This package suits resource-rich forts and known physical threats, but it should not consume every queue when mobility, missiles, or cheap replacement matter more.

### Centaur missile group

Centaurs and Centaurides combine bows, speed, stealth, and hoof attacks. Longbow range and shortbow precision create different roles. Their low protection means that missile exchange, formation, screening, and fast enemy contact require explicit planning.

### Mobile warrior wing

Centauride Warriors and Centaur Warriors provide speed, Defence, javelins or lances, and extra contact attacks. They can reinforce or pressure distant provinces, but cost, frontage, berserk behaviour, and enemy attack accuracy can reverse their paper advantage.

## Minotaur trample group

Minotaurs and War Minotaurs offer size, strength, trample, and berserk. The cheaper forest Minotaur is easy to distribute; the War Minotaur adds armour at greater resource cost. Size of target, formation, fatigue, morale, and anti-large damage remain essential matchup questions.

## Capital White Centaur reserve

White Centaurs are sacred, mobile, stealthy, high-Defence, and berserking. Their 55 gold and 29 recruitment points compete directly with other capital production. Bless value must be measured against the number the capital can actually deliver.

## Pangaea research response tree

### Branch A: immediate Enchantment tools

Enchantment 0 already provides all three Magical Tunes. Early Enchantment research can continue from a tool the roster can cast immediately, but the branch should be chosen for the enemy and the wider spell list rather than the national label alone.

### Branch B: Monster Boar pressure

Conjuration 5 unlocks Monster Boar for every Pan and Pandemoniac. Ten Nature gems and a mage-turn buy a remote unrest threat, not a guaranteed province loss. Detection, response cost, unrest timing, and target value must be evaluated separately.

### Branch C: Hamadryad access

Enchantment 5 unlocks Awaken Hamadryad. A Nature-primary Pan reaches N4, and the capital's five Nature gems can fund the ritual over time. The summoned commander's printed N3 and Harpy retinue may extend Nature operations, but the live result remains bounded by the unresolved summon details.

### Branch D: strategic fort creation

Alteration 5 unlocks Fort of the Ancients for N4 casters. The spell can convert thirty-five Nature gems and a mage-turn into a complete fortress in printed legal terrain. Its value depends on fort type, location, timing, treasury, and opportunity cost rather than research level alone.

### Branch E: Construction and generic path conversion

Construction converts common Earth and Nature access into equipment and can use rarer Water, Glamour, or Blood recruits when labelled. Because Pangaea has no national item restriction or rebate in the pinned snapshot, every item plan should use ordinary requirements and current cost rules.

## Pangaea battlefield packages

## Satyr line with Nature support

Cheap Satyrs hold space while a labelled Dryad, Pan, or Hierophant provides legal support. Protected Hoplites can anchor selected points. Morale, arrows, armour, fatigue, and the exact Tune interaction determine whether the package works.

## Centaur mobile force

Warriors or Cataphracts create the contact line while Centaurs and Centaurides add missiles. A mundane Centaur Commander carries leadership where possible. Terrain speed, formation width, missile exposure, and anti-large counters must be checked before committing.

## Minotaur breakthrough group

Minotaurs concentrate trample and berserk attacks on a chosen section. Satyrs or Centaurs can cover space around them. The package fails when targets, fatigue, morale, friendly congestion, or anti-large damage make trample inefficient.

## Sacred White Centaur group

White Centaurs combine speed, Defence, stealth, berserk, sacred status, and several attacks. The full package includes capital recruitment, bless value, priest support, replacement time, and a plan for counters. Sacred status does not prove expansion or battlefield results.

## Stealth pressure group

Satyr Sneaks, Revelers, Centaur Warriors, White Centaurs, and stealth commanders can assemble pressure away from the visible line. Legal stealth is source-backed; detection, coordination, movement resolution, patrol interaction, and combat success remain runtime questions.

## Pangaea information and pressure network

Black Harpies supply cheap flying stealth scouts from forts and forests. Many national units can move stealthily, allowing force concentration to remain partially concealed. This strengthens report gathering and threat projection only when orders, detection risk, leadership, and fallback routes are managed.

Monster Boar adds remote economic pressure, while forest recruitment broadens local recovery after losses. Neither mechanic reveals enemy orders. A safe information plan still layers scouts, province reports, army estimates, protected laboratories, and a reserve.

## Pangaea Pretender families

| Family                             | What it can solve                                                               | What it must not conceal                                                          |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fire, Air, Astral, or Death bridge | Adds paths missing from repeatable recruitment and widens searching or counters | A path on the Pretender does not create researchers, gems, or safe availability.  |
| Blood acceleration                 | Reduces dependence on the capital Pandemoniac queue                             | Hunters, slaves, laboratories, unrest control, and opportunity cost still matter. |
| Economy and infrastructure         | Funds Pans, forts, laboratories, temples, and protected troops                  | Gold does not create local resources, recruitment points, or mage-turns.          |

| Family               | What it can solve                                  | What it must not conceal                                                      |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| White Centaur bless  | Improves the capital sacred line                   | Capital throughput and 29 recruitment points per unit limit mass.             |
| Awake expansion body | Reduces pressure on lightly protected early troops | Performance depends on map, scales, chassis, bless, scripting, and opponents. |

No exact design is endorsed without game settings, map, opponents, legal chassis, and versioned evidence.

## Pangaea matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                      | First answer to examine                                                                      | Avoid                                                          |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units                 | Satyr numbers, missiles, Minotaur trample, reachable area effects, and battlefield control   | Sending expensive Centaurs into poor frontage without support. |
| Heavy armour                       | Minotaur strength, buffs, fatigue plans, Earth/Nature magic, and suitable weapons or summons | Assuming javelins and hooves solve protection unaided.         |
| Accurate missiles                  | Protection, screens, speed, stealth approach, and target disruption                          | Exposing light Centaurs and Satyrs in open exchanges.          |
| High-Defence elites                | Multiple attacks, buffs, morale pressure, fatigue, and magic that avoids Defence             | Relying on low-Attack Minotaurs alone.                         |
| Large or trample-resistant targets | Protected lines, missiles, Centaur attacks, magic, and other counters                        | Treating trample as universal damage.                          |
| Fast flankers or flyers            | Guards, layered formations, reserves, and mage spacing                                       | Leaving expensive Pans exposed behind a thin line.             |
| Mindless or mind-immune forces     | Physical damage, suitable magic, and non-morale plans                                        | Building the script around Tune of Fear.                       |
| Raiding and patrol pressure        | Cheap scouts, forest recruits, mobile reserves, forts, and route discipline                  | Assuming stealth makes an army undetectable.                   |

## Monthly Pangaea audit

- Is each fort or forest node limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns?
- Are the two same-name Satyr variants recorded separately in recruitment plans?
- Is the capital queue producing a deliberate Pandemoniac or White Centaur rather than an automatic default?
- Is every random mage labelled by final paths?
- Are mundane commanders handling jobs that do not require magic or priesthood?
- Are recuperation and stealth claims still limited to the evidence available?
- Are Nature gems reserved against all three rituals, searching, forging, and emergencies?
- Does every ritual have research, a legal caster, the correct gems, a laboratory, a legal target, and a free mage-turn?
- Are heroes and rare Pan or Pandemoniac outcomes excluded from schedules that must be repeatable?
- Are morale, armour, movement, fatigue, supply, patrols, and replacement routes checked before battle?



## Pangaea unresolved evidence boundary

The following remain open:

- 1 exact Recuperation eligibility, chance, timing, affliction coverage, and interaction rules;
- 2 live 6.36 random-path display and ordering for all five mage families;
- 3 forest-recruitment interface grouping, terrain edge cases, and queue presentation;
- 4 Magical Tune targeting, pulse timing, resistance, friendly inclusion, immunity, interruption, and underwater implementation;
- 5 expansion-party sizes, formations, scripts, stealth routes, and casualty ranges;
- 6 stealth movement, detection, patrol, seduction, and survival outcomes;
- 7 Minotaur trample, berserk, fatigue, congestion, and target-selection outcomes;
- 8 Awaken Hamadryad retinue roll, shapes, persistence, command, and complete live abilities;
- 9 Monster Boar detection, unrest timing, resolution order, and target response;
- 10 Fort of the Ancients terrain legality, fort type, hosting order, ownership, and shallow-sea edge cases;
- 11 hero arrival timing, late-hero semantics, and live special behaviour;
- 12 specific Pretender designs, blessings, matchups, and map performance;
- 13 R-047, R-058, and all other parked engine-dependent investigations.

These are evidence gaps, not invitations to guess. Runtime testing and preparation of new test assets remain paused.

## Part XXXI: Middle Age Vanheim, Arrival of Man

### Vanheim one-page command brief

Middle Age Vanheim combines inexpensive human infantry, berserkers, skinshifters, flying capital troops, mounted Vanir, stealth, sailing, and a concentrated Air-Glamour-Earth-Blood mage corps. Ordinary forts supply the conventional army and the two mobile Vanir leaders. The capital alone supplies Dwarven Smiths, Vanadrotts, Fay Boars, Valkyries, and Vans, so its commander and troop queues carry several competing jobs.

The dependable magical floor is narrower than the nation summary first suggests. Vanherse provide A1 G1 H1, Vanjarls A2 G1 B1 H2, Dwarven Smiths E2 plus a guaranteed five-path random, and Vanadrotts A2 G2 B1 H2 plus a guaranteed five-path random. Fire and Death exist only through those randoms. Water, Astral, and Nature have no repeatable recruitable entry point.

Run the nation through reports rather than reputation:

- 1 record whether gold, resources, recruitment points, or capital turns are the present constraint;
- 2 separate human line troops, Einheres, Skinshifters, and capital units by job;
- 3 recruit mundane leadership where magic is unnecessary;
- 4 label every Dwarven Smith and Vanadrott by final paths;
- 5 treat the rare second random as a bonus, never as an opening promise;
- 6 track Air, Earth, Glamour, Blood, and Death spending separately;
- 7 use stealth and sailing as route options only after checking the actual order and destination;
- 8 keep a conventional reserve behind raiders and mobile groups;
- 9 test each battlefield package against the enemy's armour, morale, size, mobility, and magic;
- 10 preserve every unresolved transformation, mounted, summon, and movement claim.

## Vanheim evidence and ruleset

This chapter covers unmodded Middle Age Vanheim on the [Book I 6.36](#) live baseline. The revision-2 official manual controls the player-facing roster, costs, recruitment markings, visible paths, national summary, sites, and national spell tables. Nation ID 78, ordinary-fort memberships, random masks, capital-site fields, spell restrictions, item-rebate links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`.

This is a planning dossier, not a claim that every legal order or battle result was observed. Sailing routes, trace-income resolution, shape changes, mounted interactions, random-path presentation, summon implementation, hero timing, and battlefield performance remain outside the verified layer.

## Vanheim conversion chain

| Input                                 | Conversion                     | Output                                                                              | Control question                                                   |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Gold and resources                    | Ordinary troop recruitment     | Human line, Einheres, and Skinshifters                                              | Is the fort limited by gold, resources, or recruitment points?     |
| Gold and commander turns              | Vanherse and Vanjarls          | Air, Glamour, priesthood, Blood, leadership, stealth, and sailing options           | Does this job require an expensive mage-commander?                 |
| Capital commander turns               | Dwarven Smiths and Vanadrotts  | Earth forging, broad random access, stronger Air/Glamour/Blood, and high leadership | Which capital-only role is currently missing?                      |
| Capital troop turns                   | Fay Boars, Valkyries, and Vans | Supply, flying sacred pressure, or mounted Vanir                                    | Is this worth displacing another capital recruit?                  |
| Research and gems                     | National and general magic     | Battlefield Valkyries, Draugar, forging, buffs, summons, and counters               | Is there a legal repeatable caster, not merely a theoretical path? |
| Scouts, stealth, and movement options | Information and pressure       | Better route coverage and concealed threats                                         | What report confirms the route, target, and fallback?              |
| Blood access and slaves               | Sacrifice or Blood magic       | Dominion pressure and a wider spell economy                                         | Are hunting, unrest, transport, and mage-turn costs funded?        |

The chain fails when the capital queue is asked to solve every problem, rare paths are treated as guaranteed, or mobile forces move beyond report coverage and replacement support.

## Vanheim national rules that shape planning

The manual describes ocean sailing, trace income across oceans, flying troops, illusions, a Cold +1 preference, average priests who can perform blood sacrifices, and Standard Forts. It also describes a military built from heavy infantry, skinshifters, Valkyries, berserkers, and Vanir, with Air, Glamour, Earth, Blood, and some Fire and Death magic.

These are operational categories, not complete formulas. Cold preference can guide scale planning; sailing can alter route choice; flying and stealth can change threat geometry; and blood sacrifice can convert slaves into dominion pressure. None removes the need to check legal destinations, leadership, detection, income, supply, fatigue, or order resolution.

## Sailing and trace-income evidence boundary

Vanherse, Vanjarls, and Vanadrotts print Army Sailing and Ship Size 5. The nation summary prints ocean sailing and trace income across oceans. Those fields establish that a special movement and economic identity exists, but this chapter does not invent capacity totals, route blockers, coast requirements, collection timing, rounding, or interaction with hostile control.

Before relying on an ocean route, record the origin, destination, commander, carried units, unit sizes, intervening provinces, ownership, and the order shown by the current interface. Before budgeting trace income, use actual treasury and province reports rather than a derived rate that the cited tables do not provide.

## Vanheim capital sites and recruitment geography

| Site                 | ID | Verified fields                                                          |
|----------------------|----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The Halls of Andvare | 15 | E3 monthly gems; Dwarven Smith and Fay Boar recruitment records          |
| Vanhalla             | 35 | A1 and G1 monthly gems; Vanadrott, Van, and Valkyrie recruitment records |

The capital therefore produces five gems each month: three Earth, one Air, and one Glamour. It also contains both capital commander lines and all three capital troop lines. Losing access to the capital queue is more damaging than the gem total alone suggests.

## Complete Vanheim commander membership

| Commander     | Gold | Resources | Recruitment points | Location                  | Verified magic or job                                                                            |
|---------------|------|-----------|--------------------|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scout         | 35   | 4         | 1                  | Ordinary forts            | Stealth 50, forest and mountain survival, short bow                                              |
| Herse         | 55   | 22        | 1                  | Ordinary forts            | Mundane leadership 75                                                                            |
| Vanherse      | 235  | 16        | 2                  | Ordinary forts            | A1 G1 H1, leadership 75, glamour, stealth, sailing, mounted                                      |
| Vanjarl       | 440  | 18        | 2                  | Ordinary forts            | A2 G1 B1 H2, leadership 100, glamour, stealth, sailing, mounted                                  |
| Dwarven Smith | 195  | 2         | 4                  | Capital, Halls of Andvare | E2 plus two structured random rolls, Master Smith 1                                              |
| Vanadrott     | 595  | 19        | 4                  | Capital, Vanhalla         | A2 G2 B1 H2 plus two structured random rolls, leadership 150, glamour, stealth, sailing, mounted |

The manual and pinned memberships reconcile four ordinary-fort commanders and two capital-site commanders. The ordinary Scout is not the Early Age Van Scout, and the two capital mages must not be treated as universally recruitable.

## Vanheim commander jobs

- Scout: report gathering and route confirmation without consuming a mage turn.
- Herse: conventional leadership when a force does not require priesthood, magic leadership, stealth, or sailing.

- Vanherse: cheaper mobile Air-Glamour priest and commander; useful where A1 G1 H1 is enough.
- Vanjarl: stronger Air, H2 priesthood, native B1, and higher leadership from an ordinary fort.
- Dwarven Smith: capital Earth researcher and forger whose guaranteed random determines its additional role.
- Vanadrott: expensive capital Air-Glamour-Blood leader and priest whose final randoms may open rare thresholds.

The first economy control is to avoid paying Vanjarl or Vanadrott prices for a Herse's job. The second is to avoid turning every Smith into a generic researcher when its final paths make it the only available specialist for a planned spell or item.

## Complete Vanheim troop membership

| Troop                | Gold | Resources | Recruitment points | Location                  | Printed distinction                                     |
|----------------------|------|-----------|--------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Huskarl, axe         | 10   | 12        | 9                  | Ordinary forts            | Axe and javelin, Defence 11                             |
| Huskarl, spear       | 10   | 12        | 9                  | Ordinary forts            | Spear and javelin, Defence 12                           |
| Hirdman, spear       | 12   | 20        | 14                 | Ordinary forts            | Protection 16, spear, Defence 12                        |
| Hirdman, broad sword | 12   | 22        | 14                 | Ordinary forts            | Protection 16, broad sword, Defence 13                  |
| Einhere              | 25   | 21        | 31                 | Ordinary forts            | Two weapons, Ambidextrous 1, Berserker +5               |
| Skinshifter          | 25   | 7         | 36                 | Ordinary forts            | Great sword, forest survival, printed regeneration 10%  |
| Fay Boar             | 100  | 1         | 30                 | Capital, Halls of Andvare | Trample, forest survival, Supply 100                    |
| Valkyrie             | 45   | 15        | 29                 | Capital, Vanhalla         | Flying, glamour, sacred, stealth 65, spirit sight       |
| Van                  | 60   | 16        | 21                 | Capital, Vanhalla         | Mounted, glamour, sacred, stealth 65, lance and javelin |

Same-name Huskarls and Hirdmen remain separate objects. The capital-only troops come from site records and should not be counted as ordinary fort recruitment.

## Vanheim troop jobs

- Axe Huskarl: cheap javelin screen whose axe gives a different contact profile from the spear variant.
- Spear Huskarl: cheap javelin screen with a spear and one additional printed Defence point.
- Spear Hirdman: protected line body with the spear's attack profile.
- Broad-sword Hirdman: slightly more resource-intensive protected line with one additional printed Defence point.
- Einhere: costly two-weapon berserker that needs a deliberate target and fatigue plan.
- Skinshifter: resource-light great-sword body with printed regeneration and an unresolved transformation chain.
- Fay Boar: capital supply carrier and trampler; its economic and combat value must be assessed separately.
- Valkyrie: flying sacred stealth unit for mobility, flanking, or concentrated attack after route and counter checks.
- Van: mounted sacred stealth unit with high Defence, lance contact, and capital-only replacement.

These labels identify candidate jobs. They do not establish expansion counts, formations, casualty rates, transformation results, or the best unit against an unknown enemy.

## Vanheim capital queue doctrine

Vanheim's capital commander queue must choose between the 195-gold Dwarven Smith and the 595-gold Vanadrott. The Smith is the repeatable Earth and forging base; the Vanadrott provides stronger Air, Glamour, Blood, priesthood, leadership, sailing, and a different five-path mask. Neither is an automatic default.

The capital troop queue separately chooses among Fay Boars, Valkyries, and Vans. Fay Boars address supply and size-based contact; Valkyries address flying sacred reach; Vans provide mounted sacred reach. The correct choice depends on the active constraint, enemy, bless, route, and replacement horizon.

## Reading Vanheim's random paths

Dwarven Smiths and Vanadrotts each receive one guaranteed one-level random and one independent ten-percent one-level random. Each roll selects uniformly from its own five-path mask. The rare roll can repeat the guaranteed path.

For any named path inside either mask:

- the guaranteed roll selects it on 20% of recruits;
- the rare roll adds it on 2% of all recruits;
- it appears at least once on 21.6% of recruits;
- it appears on both rolls on 0.4% of recruits.

The rare roll fires on ten percent of all recruits. It repeats the guaranteed path on two percent of all recruits and selects a different path on eight percent. These figures are arithmetic from the pinned masks, not live samples.

## Dwarven Smith final-path portfolio

The Dwarven Smith begins E2. Its mask is Fire, Air, Earth, Death, or Glamour.

| Final branch                                                      | Probability |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| F1 E2, A1 E2, E3, E2 D1, or E2 G1, each with no rare addition     | 18% each    |
| F2 E2, A2 E2, E4, E2 D2, or E2 G2, each from a repeated rare path | 0.4% each   |
| Any particular mixed pair from F, A, E, D, and G                  | 0.8% each   |

There are ten possible mixed pairs. Together the five ordinary branches account for 90%, the five repeated-path branches for 2%, and the ten mixed branches for 8%. Every Smith has Earth 2; additional Earth produces E3 or rarely E4, while Fire, Air, Death, and Glamour remain branch-dependent.

## Vanadrott final-path portfolio

The Vanadrott begins A2 G2 B1 H2. Its mask is Air, Earth, Death, Glamour, or Blood.

| Final branch                                     | Probability |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| One added A, E, D, G, or B with no rare addition | 18% each    |
| The same named path added twice                  | 0.4% each   |
| Any particular mixed pair from A, E, D, G, and B | 0.8% each   |

The strongest rare native endpoints are A4, E2, D2, G4, or B3 on the relevant repeated branch. Mixed outcomes can combine thresholds, including the A3 D1 result required for Summon Valkyries, but a particular mixed pair appears on only 0.8% of Vanadrotts.

## Vanheim native path boundary

| Path    | Repeatable recruitable access                                                        | Boundary                                                                          |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fire    | Dwarven Smith F1 on 21.6%, rarely F2 on 0.4%                                         | No fixed recruitable Fire.                                                        |
| Air     | Vanherse A1; Vanjarl A2; Vanadrott A2, A3 on 21.6%, rarely A4; Smith random up to A2 | Broad Air access, but the highest thresholds are rare or need conversion.         |
| Water   | None                                                                                 | Requires Pretender, independent, summon, empowerment, or another verified bridge. |
| Earth   | Every Smith E2; E3 on 21.6%, rarely E4; Vanadrott random up to E2                    | Strong Earth is capital-dependent.                                                |
| Astral  | None                                                                                 | Requires an external bridge.                                                      |
| Death   | Smith or Vanadrott D1 on 21.6%, rarely D2                                            | No fixed recruitable Death.                                                       |
| Nature  | None                                                                                 | The manual's eastern dwarf result is a summon, not recruitable access.            |
| Glamour | Vanherse and Vanjarl G1; Vanadrott G2, G3 on 21.6%, rarely G4; Smith random up to G2 | Glamour depth is concentrated in the capital Vanadrott queue.                     |
| Blood   | Vanjarl and Vanadrott B1; Vanadrott B2 on 21.6%, rarely B3                           | Repeatable fixed Blood exists, but depth is capital-random.                       |
| Holy    | Vanherse H1; Vanjarl and Vanadrott H2                                                | Average priesthood with blood sacrifice.                                          |

Rare maximums show what can exist, not what a schedule can assume. A plan should state its guaranteed floor, required random, expected recruitment burden, gems, boosters, and fallback.

## Vanheim national spell and ritual reconciliation

| Name                                | Type              | Level         | Requirement | Cost          | Printed result                                    |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------|---------------|-------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Summon Valkyries                    | Battlefield spell | Conjuration 6 | A3 D1       | 100 fatigue   | Seven Valkyries; unusable underwater              |
| Awaken Draugar                      | Ritual            | Conjuration 4 | D2          | 12 Death gems | Four Draugar; unusable underwater                 |
| Summon Dwarf of the Four Directions | Ritual            | Conjuration 8 | A4 E3       | 62 Air gems   | One unique directional dwarf; unusable underwater |

The manual and pinned nation-restriction rows agree on these three active records. The table establishes legal thresholds, costs, counts, and the underwater prohibition. It does not establish placement, persistence, selection rules, or combat outcomes.

## Vanheim national-magic access ladder

| Spell or ritual                     | Unassisted repeatable access                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Summon Valkyries                    | A Vanadrott must receive both Air and Death across its two rolls: 0.8% of Vanadrotts. Vanlade also qualifies, but is a hero and not repeatable. |
| Awaken Draugar                      | A Dwarven Smith or Vanadrott must receive Death on both rolls: 0.4% of either line. Vanlade qualifies but is not schedulable.                   |
| Summon Dwarf of the Four Directions | No unassisted repeatable recruit naturally combines A4 and E3. Path conversion, empowerment, a summon, or Pretender support is required.        |

Researching a national spell does not create its caster. Vanheim should audit the mage roster before committing to a national-magic branch and keep a general-spell fallback when the required rare recruit has not appeared.

## Four Directions ritual boundary

The manual's Middle Age table prints Dwarf of the East, with A4 E3 N2 and Master Smith 2. The pinned structured record links North, South, East, and West candidates through a dwarfs selection group. This establishes a four-object relationship but not a chosen direction, deterministic order, repeat-cast handling, or uniqueness implementation.

The safe plan treats Conjunction 8, A4 E3, sixty-two Air gems, a laboratory, and a free mage-turn as necessary inputs while leaving the actual directional result unresolved. No strategy chain should depend on receiving one particular dwarf unless later versioned evidence closes that question.

## Vanheim national item metadata

No pinned item row restricts an item to nation 78. Six rows assign Vanheim a nation-rebate link:

| Item                        | ID  | Constructio<br>n | Requirem<br>ent | Native access boundary                       |
|-----------------------------|-----|------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Dwarven Hammer              | 29  | 3                | E3              | A Smith reaches E3 on 21.6%; rarely E4.      |
| Lightweight Scale Mail      | 236 | 3                | A1              | Vanherse, Vanjarl, and Vanadrott qualify.    |
| Weightless Scale Mail       | 262 | 7                | A1              | Vanherse, Vanjarl, and Vanadrott qualify.    |
| Pebble Skin Suit            | 280 | 9                | B4 E1           | No unassisted repeatable recruit reaches B4. |
| Cauldron of the Elven Halls | 361 | 5                | G3              | A Vanadrott reaches G3 on 21.6%; rarely G4.  |
| Draupnir                    | 435 | 9                | E5              | No unassisted repeatable recruit reaches E5. |

A rebate link is not a restriction and does not itself grant the required path. The chapter does not infer the current displayed price, rounding, stacking, or immediate forgeability from the metadata field alone.

## Vanheim hero records

| Fixed name | Unit identity | Verified magic | Boundary             |
|------------|---------------|----------------|----------------------|
| Farbaute   | Einhere       | none           | Hero assignment only |

| Fixed name | Unit identity | Verified magic | Boundary                                            |
|------------|---------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Vanlade    | Vanadrott     | A3 D2 G2 B2 H2 | Raw late-hero value 10; timing semantics unresolved |

Vanlade qualifies for Summon Valkyries and Awaken Draugar and widens several other thresholds. That makes the hero useful when present, not a repeatable research or ritual bridge. Farbaute's performance and both arrival conditions remain outside the source-backed schedule.

## Vanheim patch reconciliation

The current baseline is Dominions 6.36, released on 17 August 2026. The retained official ledger contains one 6.13 presentation record naming Vanheim and Helheim, published 15 May 2024, but no directly named mechanical correction for Vanadrott, Vanjarl, Dwarven Smith, Vanhalla, the Halls of Andvare, Awaken Draugar, or Summon Valkyries through 6.36.

The presentation record is not converted into a gameplay change. The revision-2 manual controls current player-facing descriptions, while the 6.35 structured export remains labelled as a pinned cross-check.

## Vanheim opening priorities

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns limit each fort.
- 2 Use Huskarls for cheap coverage and Hirdmen where protection is worth the resource cost.
- 3 Recruit mundane Herse leadership when a mage-commander adds no necessary capability.
- 4 Decide whether the next capital commander solves Earth/forging or Air/Glamour/Blood/leadership.
- 5 Label every Smith and Vanadrott immediately, including whether the rare roll appeared.
- 6 Keep Fire, Death, high Earth, high Glamour, and high Air plans conditional on the actual roster.
- 7 Add scouts before sailing, stealth, or flying forces outrun reliable province reports.
- 8 Track capital troop replacement separately from ordinary infantry replacement.
- 9 Match research to legal casters and the gem treasury rather than to national spell names alone.
- 10 Maintain a reserve that can answer raiders without recalling every forward mobile group.

These are planning controls. Exact expansion parties, routes, formations, scripts, blesses, and casualty expectations remain open.

## Vanheim recruitment packages to compare

### Cheap javelin screen

Both Huskarls cost ten gold and carry javelins. The spear variant has one more printed Defence; the axe variant changes the contact attack. They provide affordable bodies and opening missile pressure, but Morale 10, Protection 11, and ordinary human statistics make leadership and the enemy attack profile important.

### Protected Hirdman line

Both Hirdmen provide Protection 16 and Morale 11. The spear costs twenty resources; the broad-sword variant costs twenty-two and has one more printed Defence. This line converts resources into staying power, so it should be compared with the number of Huskarls, Skinshifters, or commanders the same fort could produce.



## **Einhers striking group**

Einhers combine two weapons, Ambidextrous 1, Berserker +5, Morale 13, and Protection 16. At twenty-five gold, twenty-one resources, and thirty-one recruitment points, they are not disposable line filler. Formation width, fatigue, target Defence, armour, and berserk consequences determine whether their extra attacks convert into value.

## **Skinshifter group**

Skinshifters cost twenty-five gold but only seven resources and print a great sword, forest survival, and regeneration. Their thirty-six recruitment points can become the limiting cost. The chapter does not assume how their shape chain, wounds, equipment, regeneration, or post-battle state resolve.

## **Capital flying reserve**

Valkyries combine flight, sacred status, glamour, stealth, spirit sight, and a light lance. They can threaten exposed units or distant points, but forty-five gold and twenty-nine recruitment points compete with every other capital troop. Flight does not remove the need for priest support, route confirmation, formation, or a counter plan.

## **Capital mounted reserve**

Vans combine high Defence, sacred status, glamour, stealth, a lance, a javelin, and a Fay Horse. Their sixty-gold cost and capital-only replacement make unsupported trades expensive. Mounted damage, rider-mount interaction, and remounting remain unresolved.

# **Vanheim research response tree**

## **Branch A: ordinary Air and Glamour support**

Vanherse and Vanjarls provide repeatable A1-A2 and G1 from every fort, while Vanadrotts provide A2 G2. Early research can therefore favour general spells these guaranteed paths can cast. The exact branch still depends on enemy armour, mobility, resistance, battlefield size, and the gems available.

## **Branch B: Construction and the Smith economy**

Every Dwarven Smith has E2 and Master Smith 1. Construction turns that guaranteed floor and the Smith's random into general equipment, while the six rebate links create additional candidates. A forge schedule must still record the final path, current price, required gems, research, laboratory, and lost research or ritual turn.

## **Branch C: Conjunction 4 and Draugar**

Awaken Draugar requires D2, which only a same-path double random supplies naturally on a Smith or Vanadrott at 0.4% per recruit. Conjunction 4 should therefore be justified by the general spell list as well as a ritual that may lack a caster. If D2 appears, twelve Death gems and a mage-turn produce the printed four Draugar.

## Branch D: Conjuration 6 and battlefield Valkyries

Summon Valkyries requires A3 D1. A Vanadrott obtains the necessary mixed Air-Death pair on 0.8% of recruits, while Vanlade qualifies if the hero arrives. Research, the legal caster, Air-gem availability for the 100-fatigue spell, battlefield placement, and the underwater prohibition all belong in the pre-battle check.

## Branch E: Conjuration 8 and the Four Directions project

The national ritual needs A4 E3 and sixty-two Air gems. No unassisted repeatable recruit supplies both paths together, so the project begins with a path-conversion design rather than with research alone. The directional result is also unresolved. This is a late infrastructure project, not a default national milestone.

## Branch F: Blood and dominion pressure

Vanjarl and Vanadrott provide fixed B1, with Vanadrotts occasionally reaching B2 or rarely B3. That makes a repeatable Blood entry possible, but not free. Hunting, unrest, laboratory coverage, slave movement, sacrifice, research, and the cost of diverting expensive commanders must all be included.

# Vanheim battlefield packages

## Human line with separate command

Huskarls or Hirdmen hold frontage under a Herse while mages remain in protected positions. This preserves expensive Vanir turns for magic or specialist leadership. The package must be adjusted for morale, missiles, armour, fatigue, and enemy breakthrough speed.

## Berserker and Skinshifter strike group

Einheres provide multiple berserk attacks while Skinshifters add great swords and a different resource profile. A human screen can absorb initial contact. The package fails when fatigue, poor target choice, congestion, missile damage, or unresolved transformation behaviour overwhelms its contact damage.

## Mounted Vanir wing

Vans or mounted commander-led elements can create a mobile contact group. High Defence, glamour, stealth, lances, and javelins suggest pressure rather than invulnerability. Anti-large attacks, accurate weapons, fatigue, formation, and mounted resolution must be checked.

## Valkyrie flying group

Valkyries can concentrate flying sacred bodies against a selected part of the field. Their low count, capital replacement, protection, morale, and landing target matter. A flying order without guards, priest support, report coverage, and a fallback can expose the most expensive troop line.

## Sailing pressure group

Vanherse, Vanjarls, or Vanadrotts can anchor an army-sailing force if the carried group and route are legal. The package can alter strategic geometry, but exact capacity and route resolution are not supplied here. Verify the current order interface and keep a conventional land route or reserve.

### Rare-path mage group

Labelled Smiths and Vanadrotts can combine Fire, Air, Earth, Death, Glamour, and Blood tools that the fixed roster cannot. Build the script from the mages actually present. Do not design a standard army around a 0.4% or 0.8% branch and then substitute an unqualified caster.

### Vanheim information and pressure network

Scouts provide cheap report coverage, while Vanir commanders and several capital troops print stealth. Flying Valkyries and sailing commanders can threaten routes that ordinary armies cannot. These capabilities widen the set of possible orders but do not reveal enemy orders or guarantee concealment.

A safe pressure network layers scouts, province reports, labelled commanders, protected laboratories, gem and slave transport, fallback provinces, and a reserve. Trace-income and blood-sacrifice plans should be reconciled against actual treasury and dominion reports rather than folded into an assumed passive advantage.

### Vanheim Pretender families

| Family                          | What it can solve                                             | What it must not conceal                                                             |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Water, Astral, or Nature bridge | Adds paths absent from repeatable recruitment                 | A Pretender path does not create researchers, gems, or safe availability.            |
| Four Directions enabler         | Helps assemble A4 E3 for the national ritual                  | Sixty-two Air gems, research, mage-turns, and unresolved direction selection remain. |
| Blood acceleration              | Adds hunting or higher Blood thresholds                       | Hunters, slaves, unrest control, laboratories, and opportunity cost still matter.    |
| Economy and scales              | Funds expensive Vanir, capital mages, forts, and laboratories | Gold does not create capital turns, resources, recruitment points, or rare randoms.  |
| Sacred bless                    | Improves Valkyries and Vans                                   | Both lines are capital-only and compete with other capital production.               |
| Awake expansion body            | Reduces pressure on ordinary human troops                     | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, bless, script, and opponents. |

No exact design is endorsed without the game settings, map, opponents, legal chassis, and a versioned performance record.

### Vanheim matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem       | First answer to examine                                                                               | Avoid                                                                     |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units  | Javelins, protected frontage, multiple Einhere attacks, available area effects, and controlled flanks | Paying only for elite capital units when cheap bodies are the constraint. |
| Heavy armour        | Great swords, axes, buffs, fatigue plans, Earth magic, and suitable rare-path spells                  | Assuming ordinary spears and javelins solve protection unaided.           |
| Accurate missiles   | Hirdman protection, screens, speed, stealth approaches, and target disruption                         | Exposing lightly protected Skinshifters, mages, or landing Valkyries.     |
| High-Defence elites | Multiple attacks, buffs, fatigue, morale pressure, and magic that avoids Defence                      | Relying on one expensive lance contact.                                   |

| Enemy problem                      | First answer to examine                                                               | Avoid                                                             |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Large or trample-resistant targets | Protected lines, Einhere attacks, Skinshifter weapons, magic, and other counters      | Treating Fay Boar trample as universal damage.                    |
| Fast flankers or flyers            | Guards, layered formations, reserves, and mage spacing                                | Leaving capital mages behind a thin human line.                   |
| Stealth raiders                    | Scouts, patrol plans, forts, mobile response, and route discipline                    | Assuming Vanheim's own stealth automatically reveals the enemy.   |
| Underwater pressure                | Coastal defence, legal amphibious assets, allies, summons, or other verified bridges  | Scheduling national spells explicitly marked unusable underwater. |
| Magic-resistant elites             | Physical packages, buffs, fatigue, multiple attack types, and resistance-aware spells | Treating Glamour or morale tools as guaranteed control.           |

## Monthly Vanheim audit

- Is each fort limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns?
- Are both Huskarl and both Hirdman records kept distinct?
- Is the capital commander queue solving a named Smith or Vanadrott requirement?
- Is the capital troop queue producing a deliberate Fay Boar, Valkyrie, or Van?
- Is every Smith and Vanadrott labelled by final paths?
- Are 0.4% repeated and 0.8% mixed branches excluded from guaranteed schedules?
- Are mundane commanders handling jobs that do not require magic, priesthood, stealth, or sailing?
- Are Earth, Air, Glamour, Blood, and Death gems or slaves reserved against research and forging plans?
- Does every national spell have research, a legal caster, resources, a laboratory where required, and a free mage-turn?
- Are sailing, trace-income, mounted, transformation, and summon claims still kept within their evidence boundary?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must be repeatable?
- Are report coverage, fallback routes, supply, fatigue, morale, and replacement checked before battle?

## Vanheim unresolved evidence boundary

The following remain open:

- 1 live 6.36 random-path display and ordering for Dwarven Smiths and Vanadrotts;
- 2 ocean-sailing capacity, route blockers, coast rules, ownership interactions, and order resolution;
- 3 trace-income collection, timing, rounding, and hostile-control interactions;
- 4 glamour, illusion, stealth, detection, and patrol outcomes;
- 5 Skinshifter shape changes, wound transfer, equipment, regeneration, and post-battle state;
- 6 rider-mount damage, fatigue, separation, death, and remounting behaviour;
- 7 Fay Boar trample, supply contribution, congestion, and target selection;
- 8 Summon Valkyries placement, persistence, scripting, targeting, and combat behaviour;
- 9 Awaken Draugar forms, equipment, leadership use, persistence, and live resolution;
- 10 Four Directions selection order, repeat casting, uniqueness, and the complete live result;
- 11 item-rebate display, price, rounding, stacking, and version-specific forge interaction;
- 12 blood hunting, sacrifice, dominion, unrest, and transport outcomes;
- 13 hero arrival timing, late-hero semantics, and live special behaviour;
- 14 expansion-party sizes, formations, scripts, blessings, matchup performance, and casualty ranges;
- 15 R-047, R-058, and every comparable parked engine-dependent investigation.

These are evidence gaps, not invitations to guess. Runtime testing and preparation of new test assets remain paused.

# Part XXXII: Middle Age Caelum, Reign of the Seraphim

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## Caelum one-page command brief

Middle Age Caelum turns flying recruitment, strong repeatable Air magic, cold-resistant ice troops, cheap specialist mages, and a large national summon list into reach. Every fort can recruit all eight national commanders and eight ordinary troop types. The capital adds Wingless, Temple Guards, and Blizzard Warriors through two sites, but it does not monopolise the main mage line. This makes additional forts useful immediately rather than waiting for a capital-only research engine.

The basic plan is:

- use flying troops to shorten concentration time while confirming every route and supply position;
- match cheap Spire Horn bodies, archers, protected Airya infantry, Storm Guards, Iceclads, and Mammoths to the reported target;
- recruit mundane leadership when a mage's paths are not required for command;
- use Ice Crafters, Spire Horn Seraphs, and Caelian Seraphs for repeatable Water and Air work;
- label every High Seraph by its final W/S/D rolls and keep rare branches out of guaranteed schedules;
- treat the Seraphine's pinned Fire random as disputed metadata until the manual conflict is resolved;
- connect each national spell to its actual caster, research level, gem type, and free mage-turn;
- protect laboratories, forts, and fallback provinces so mobility does not outrun replacement and information.

Caelum converts gold, resources, recruitment points, Air and Water income, flying movement, mage-turns, and research into rapid concentration. Its main risks are fragile low-hit-point troops, temperature-dependent equipment, expensive High Seraphs, capital-only sacred replacement, narrow native access to Astral and Death, almost no secure Fire, and a national ritual list whose names promise more than ordinary recruitment can immediately cast.

## Caelum evidence and ruleset

This chapter covers unmodded Middle Age Caelum on the [Book I 6.36](#) live baseline. The revision-2 official manual controls the player-facing roster, costs, recruitment markings, visible paths, national summary, spell tables, and ritual descriptions. Nation ID 71, recruitment memberships, random masks, site fields, spell restrictions, item rebates, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at `commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`.

The Seraphine sources conflict: the manual prints H1 without a random marker, while the pinned object row carries a 20% F1 roll. That branch is preserved as pinned metadata and excluded from any plan that must work in the current client. Exact flying movement, storm resolution, ice-armour scaling, Ice Fort protection, Guardian Spirits, Mammoth mounts, national summon behaviour, remote Drugvant outcomes, hero timing, and battlefield performance remain unresolved. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Caelum conversion chain

flying recruitment, cold preference, ice equipment, ordinary-fort mages, and capital sites  
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, replacement routes, and gem income  
-> labelled Water, Air, Astral, and Death access with protected mage-turns  
-> research, searching, forging, battlefield magic, and conditional national rituals  
-> surviving armies, rapid concentration, raids, sieges, claims, and strategic depth

The fragile arrows are troop durability, morale, temperature, supply, laboratory coverage, the cost of High Seraphs, and the gap between possessing a national spell and possessing its caster. Flight increases reach but does not supply intelligence, legal routes, safe landings, or replacements.

## Caelum national rules that shape planning

| Rule or asset            | Source-backed fact                                                                     | Planning consequence                                                                                               |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Flying population        | Most ordinary commanders and troops fly.                                               | Forces can concentrate quickly, but the exact strategic route must still be legal and confirmed.                   |
| Cold preference          | The nation prefers Cold +3 and has a Cold scale limit of +1.                           | Cold is part of the roster's equipment and resistance environment, not merely an aesthetic scale choice.           |
| Ice equipment            | Several units carry Ice Armor and magical ice weapons.                                 | Protection and weapon properties matter, but exact temperature conversion remains outside this chapter's evidence. |
| Partial shock resistance | Spire Horn units commonly carry shock resistance and Storm Immunity.                   | Storm and lightning plans can be considered by unit, but neither trait is universal across the roster.             |
| Ice Forts                | Caelum uses Ice Forts, and the manual says forts reduce cold-scale deaths by one step. | Fort planning has a national climate consequence; exact timing and eligibility remain unresolved.                  |
| Guardian Spirits         | The manual lists Guardian Spirits under priests.                                       | Priest recruitment has a national role, but trigger and target behaviour are not assumed.                          |
| National magic split     | Positive Yazata rituals use Astral; Daeva rituals use Death and Fire.                  | Research must follow legal path construction rather than the theme of the spell list.                              |

## Caelum recruitment geography

All eight national commanders appear in the ordinary-fort membership. Eight troop types also appear in the ordinary-fort list. The capital sites add three troops: Ravens Vale supplies Wingless, while the Citadel of Frozen Crystal supplies Temple Guards and Blizzard Warriors.

This is a favourable decentralisation pattern. New forts can recruit scouts, leaders, priests, forge specialists, Air mages, Water-Air mages, and High Seraphs without waiting on the capital. Capital congestion falls mainly on the three site troops. The dossier keeps site membership distinct because capital-only availability is a real replacement constraint.

## Complete Caelum commander membership

| Commander     | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Printed paths | Verified recruitment |
|---------------|------|-----------|------------|---------------|----------------------|
| Caelian Scout | 35   | 13        | 1          | none          | Forts                |
| Airy Noble    | 70   | 38        | 1          | none          | Forts                |
| Storm General | 95   | 36        | 1          | none          | Forts                |

| Commander         | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Printed paths | Verified recruitment |
|-------------------|------|-----------|------------|---------------|----------------------|
| Seraphine         | 95   | 2         | 1          | H1            | Forts                |
| Ice Crafter       | 65   | 3         | 2          | W1            | Forts                |
| Spire Horn Seraph | 65   | 1         | 2          | A1            | Forts                |
| Caelian Seraph    | 175  | 2         | 2          | A2 W1         | Forts                |
| High Seraph       | 355  | 3         | 4          | A3 W2 ?1      | Forts                |

Eight commander records reconcile. The roster offers cheap scouting, two mundane leaders, inexpensive single-path specialists, a repeatable A2 W1 mage, and an expensive high-path random mage from every fort.

## Caelum commander jobs

| Commander         | Source-backed role                                  | Important limit                                                                                         |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Caelian Scout     | Flying stealth scout                                | Thirty-five gold and thirteen resources are not free if reports can be supplied more cheaply elsewhere. |
| Airy Noble        | Flying leadership-75 commander                      | High resource cost and no magic make it a deliberate army purchase.                                     |
| Storm General     | Flying leadership-100 commander with Storm Immunity | Thirty-six resources compete with protected troops.                                                     |
| Seraphine         | Sacred H1 priest, stealthy flying leader            | Fire access is disputed; Guardian Spirit behaviour remains unresolved.                                  |
| Ice Crafter       | Cheap W1 mage with Forge Bonus 1                    | Two recruitment points; live rebate and forge-bonus arithmetic were not observed.                       |
| Spire Horn Seraph | Cheap A1 researcher and support mage                | Low leadership and only one fixed path.                                                                 |
| Caelian Seraph    | Repeatable A2 W1 mage                               | More than twice the gold of either single-path specialist.                                              |
| High Seraph       | A3 W2 random mage, research and high-path platform  | 355 gold and four recruitment points make every turn expensive.                                         |

## Complete Caelum troop membership

| Troop               | Gold | Resources | Rec points | Verified recruitment          |
|---------------------|------|-----------|------------|-------------------------------|
| Spire Horn Militia  | 8    | 5         | 5          | Forts                         |
| Spire Horn Archer   | 10   | 6         | 9          | Forts                         |
| Airy Light Infantry | 10   | 11        | 9          | Forts                         |
| Spire Horn Warrior  | 10   | 7         | 9          | Forts                         |
| Airy Infantry       | 10   | 16        | 9          | Forts                         |
| Iceclad             | 15   | 40        | 21         | Forts                         |
| Storm Guard         | 15   | 31        | 21         | Forts                         |
| Mammoth Rider       | 120  | 5         | 9          | Forts                         |
| Wingless            | 10   | 11        | 9          | Capital only, via Ravens Vale |
| Temple Guard        | 20   | 42        | 23         | Capital only, sacred          |
| Blizzard Warrior    | 20   | 13        | 23         | Capital only, sacred          |

Eleven troop records reconcile. The separate Mammoth and Mammoth Archer records describe the Mammoth Rider's mount and co-riders; they are not counted again as independent recruits.

## Caelum troop jobs

| Troop               | Source-backed role                              | Important limit                                                                           |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Spire Horn Militia  | Very cheap flying spear body                    | Morale 8 and Protection 6 make it a screen, not a reliable elite.                         |
| Spire Horn Archer   | Flying short-bow unit with Storm Immunity       | Protection 6 and ordinary bow output require target and formation discipline.             |
| Airy Light Infantry | Flying ice-lance infantry                       | Better Defence than militia, but still low hit points and moderate protection.            |
| Spire Horn Warrior  | Cheap flying lance infantry with Storm Immunity | Contact performance depends on fatigue, formation, and target protection.                 |
| Airy Infantry       | Flying Ice Armor 1 sword line                   | Sixteen resources buy more protection but still only nine hit points.                     |
| Iceclad             | Heavily protected flying ice-lance line         | Forty resources and twenty-one recruitment points sharply limit volume.                   |
| Storm Guard         | Protected flying storm line                     | Thirty-one resources and twenty-one recruitment points compete with other premium troops. |
| Mammoth Rider       | Mounted trampling package with two co-riders    | Mount, trample, routing, and co-rider resolution remain runtime questions.                |
| Wingless            | Grounded high-morale capital infantry           | Capital-only and unable to join the roster's normal flight pattern.                       |
| Temple Guard        | Heavily protected sacred capital guard          | Forty-two resources and capital-only replacement constrain scale.                         |
| Blizzard Warrior    | Sacred capital frost-bow unit                   | Low protection and capital-only replacement make target choice important.                 |

## Caelum capital sites

| Site                          | ID | Verified fields                                                                               | Planning boundary                                                                          |
|-------------------------------|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The Citadel of Frozen Crystal | 11 | A3 and W2 monthly gems, Cold scale cap 2 field, Temple Guard and Blizzard Warrior recruitment | Supplies the main gem income and two sacred troop queues; hidden effects are not inferred. |
| Ravens Vale                   | 18 | Death-path classification and Wingless recruitment                                            | Provides no monthly Death-gem field in the pinned row.                                     |

The capital begins with strong Air and Water income, but the negative ritual branch demands Death and Fire. Ravens Vale's Death classification must not be mistaken for printed monthly Death gems. Death and Fire treasuries still require searching, events, trades, or another verified source.

## Caelum capital-queue control

The capital commander queue is not uniquely privileged: every national commander is available from ordinary forts. This lets the capital recruit the same research or leadership mix as other forts while its troop queue handles the three site troops.

Capital troop choices should answer a named need. Wingless provide grounded morale and low-cost bodies. Temple Guards convert large resource and recruitment-point budgets into protected sacreds.



Blizzard Warriors supply sacred frost bows with a much lower resource cost. Recruiting the most expensive option by habit can waste the capital's particular advantage.

## Caelum recruitable magic access

| Path floor                       | Repeatable source          | Reliability             |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------|
| A1                               | Spire Horn Seraph          | guaranteed              |
| A2 W1                            | Caelian Seraph             | guaranteed              |
| A3 W2                            | High Seraph                | guaranteed              |
| H1                               | Seraphine                  | guaranteed              |
| W1 and Forge Bonus 1             | Ice Crafter                | guaranteed              |
| W3, S1, or D1 on High Seraph     | one guaranteed W/S/D roll  | one branch per recruit  |
| Second W, S, or D on High Seraph | independent 10% W/S/D roll | rare                    |
| F1 on Seraphine                  | pinned 20% row only        | disputed against manual |

The fixed core is Air and Water. Astral and Death arrive through High Seraph randoms. Fire has no uncontested recruitable path in the manual. National spell planning must preserve those distinctions.

## Seraphine Fire-path discrepancy

The manual prints the Seraphine as H1 with no ?1. The pinned 6.35 object row gives one 20% roll from mask 128, which resolves to Fire. The records cannot both describe the same visible path line completely.

The safe rule is narrow: Seraphines are guaranteed H1. A 20% F1 branch exists in the pinned structured record but is not scheduled, counted as live access, or used to justify Fire research. If a current authoritative export or observed recruitment record later confirms it, the correction can be made locally.

## High Seraph random-path probabilities

The High Seraph has fixed A3 W2, one guaranteed pick from W/S/D, and an independent 10% pick from the same three-path mask.

| Final random class   | Probability  | Examples                           |
|----------------------|--------------|------------------------------------|
| Guaranteed pick only | 90%          | W1, S1, or D1 at 30% each          |
| Same path twice      | 3.333% total | W2, S2, or D2 at 1.111% each       |
| Two different paths  | 6.667% total | W1S1, W1D1, or S1D1 at 2.222% each |

Including the fixed paths, a named W/S/D random appears at least once on 35.556% of recruits. Water is always present at W2 before randoms, so the random outcomes produce W3 or rarely W4 rather than a new path. These probabilities are derived from the pinned masks and are not a sample of live recruitment.

## Caelum dependable path jobs

- Ice Crafters provide cheap W1 searching, forging, and low-path Water work.
- Spire Horn Seraphs provide cheap A1 research, searching, and low-path Air work.
- Caelian Seraphs provide repeatable A2 W1 mixed access without relying on a random.
- High Seraphs provide repeatable A3 W2 and carry every recruitable Astral or Death branch.
- Seraphines provide H1 priesthood and ordinary sacred support.

Mundane commanders should handle army leadership when their lower price or stronger leadership preserves a mage-turn. A flying mage is still an expensive researcher, searcher, forger, ritualist, or combat caster whose turn has an opportunity cost.

## Caelum rare-path endpoints

| Endpoint                      | Unassisted recruitable route                          | Frequency boundary                    |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| A3 D1 for Parting of the Soul | High Seraph with at least one D pick                  | 35.556% in pinned distribution        |
| S2 for Summon Yazatas         | High Seraph with double S                             | 1.111%                                |
| S2 W1 for Call Ahurani        | High Seraph with double S; fixed W2 already qualifies | 1.111%                                |
| S3 or higher                  | none unassisted                                       | requires another bridge               |
| D2 F1 for Call Daevas         | none uncontested on one recruit                       | requires Fire plus Death construction |
| D3 F1, D3 F2, or D4 F1/F2     | none unassisted                                       | late path project                     |

National access is therefore uneven. Parting of the Soul is repeatably reachable through a common High Seraph branch. The first two positive rituals require a rare double Astral result. The higher positive and all negative rituals require boosters, empowerment, summons, a Pretender, or another verified bridge.

## Caelum national spell map

| Name                 | Research      | Requirement | Cost          | Access warning                               |
|----------------------|---------------|-------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Parting of the Soul  | Thaumaturgy 6 | D1 A1       | 40 fatigue    | D-random High Seraph qualifies.              |
| Call Ahurani         | Conjuration 5 | S2 W1       | 12 pearls     | Double-S High Seraph qualifies.              |
| Summon Yazatas       | Conjuration 5 | S2          | 12 pearls     | Double-S High Seraph qualifies.              |
| Call Celestial Yazad | Conjuration 6 | S4          | 40 pearls     | No unassisted recruit qualifies.             |
| Call Fravashi        | Conjuration 7 | S3          | 30 pearls     | No unassisted recruit qualifies.             |
| Call Amesha Spenta   | Conjuration 8 | S5          | 60 pearls     | No unassisted recruit qualifies.             |
| Call Daevas          | Conjuration 5 | D2 F1       | 12 Death gems | No uncontested unassisted recruit qualifies. |
| Call Jahi            | Conjuration 5 | D3 F1       | 15 Death gems | No unassisted recruit qualifies.             |
| Call Yata            | Conjuration 6 | D3 F2       | 40 Death gems | No unassisted recruit qualifies.             |
| Call of the Drugvant | Thaumaturgy 7 | D4 F1       | 15 Death gems | No unassisted recruit qualifies.             |
| Call Greater Daeva   | Conjuration 8 | D4 F2       | 60 Death gems | No unassisted recruit qualifies.             |

Researching a national spell does not create the missing path, gems, laboratory, or mage-turn. Each row is a project with five gates: research, caster, path construction, treasury, and opportunity cost.

## Positive summon branch

Call Ahurani and Summon Yazatas are the only positive rituals an unassisted recruit can reach, and only a double-S High Seraph does so. That result appears on 1.111% of High Seraphs in the pinned distribution. The nation cannot build a reliable opening around finding it.

Call Fravashi, Call Celestial Yazad, and Call Amesha Spenta require S3, S4, and S5. A legal plan must name the booster, empowerment, summoned mage, Pretender, or other bridge that creates each threshold. The printed summoned paths may open further work, but their live arrival state, slots, uniqueness, and strategic behaviour remain untested here.

## Negative summon branch

The Daeva line begins at D2 F1 and rises to D4 F2. High Seraphs can rarely reach D2 but have no uncontested Fire. The disputed Seraphine branch, even if present, sits on a separate commander. Paths on two commanders cannot be combined to cast one ritual.

This branch therefore starts with path construction and a Death-gem economy. Call Daevas, Call Jahi, Call Yata, and Call Greater Daeva should be treated as conditional objectives. The spell list is strategically relevant because it defines possible payoffs, but it does not prove routine access.

## Call of the Drugvant boundary

Call of the Drugvant is a Thaumaturgy-7 remote ritual requiring D4 F1 and fifteen Death gems. The manual describes a range-four hostile-province effect that greatly increases unrest and brings bandits and Daevas.

The description establishes purpose, not exact resolution. Unrest amount, force composition, ownership checks, defence, event timing, immunity, and repeated-cast behaviour remain unresolved. Version 6.08 removed Shinuyama's unintended access while retaining Caelum's national restriction.

## Caelum item rebates

| Item       | Construction | Requirement | Immediate source                            |
|------------|--------------|-------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Ice Sword  | 1            | W1          | Ice Crafter, Caelian Seraph, or High Seraph |
| Ice Lance  | 1            | W1          | Ice Crafter, Caelian Seraph, or High Seraph |
| Ice Aegis  | 3            | W2          | High Seraph                                 |
| Ice Helmet | 3            | W1          | Ice Crafter, Caelian Seraph, or High Seraph |

The pinned snapshot records four rebate links and no Caelum-restricted item row. This makes Ice Crafters natural forge candidates, but the dossier does not claim an exact live price or a stacking formula between the national rebate and Forge Bonus 1. Every forge order still consumes gems, research, a laboratory, and a mage-turn.

## Caelum hero boundary

| Fixed name | Structured identity | Paths | Safe use                                       |
|------------|---------------------|-------|------------------------------------------------|
| Caelos     | Sacred One          | H1    | contingent sacred leadership or priest support |

| Fixed name | Structured identity | Paths | Safe use                           |
|------------|---------------------|-------|------------------------------------|
| Zaelinys   | Harab Seraphine     | D2 H2 | contingent Death and priest access |

Neither hero belongs in a schedule that must work every game. Zaelinys can change the Death threshold if present, but arrival timing and special behaviour remain unresolved.

## Caelum patch reconciliation

Dominions 6.08, published 6 March 2024, corrected Shinuyama's unintended access to Call of the Drugvant. This confirms the spell-assignment boundary without changing Caelum's own access. Dominions 6.12, published 29 April 2024, divided Ice Protection into Ice Protection and Ice Armor; the current manual uses the later terminology.

No later official ledger entry through 6.36 directly names the High Seraph, Seraphine, Caelian capital sites, Parting of the Soul, or Caelum's summon list. Silence is not proof that every historical value remained unchanged; the manual controls player-facing descriptions and the pinned data remains labelled 6.35.

## Caelum opening priorities

- 1 Check whether gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns limit each fort.
- 2 Use cheap flying bodies for coverage only where their morale and protection are adequate.
- 3 Decide whether the next mage-turn needs W1, A1, A2 W1, priesthood, or the High Seraph's A3 W2 random package.
- 4 Label every High Seraph immediately and keep S2 or D2 branches out of guaranteed plans.
- 5 Keep the Seraphine Fire discrepancy out of the baseline plan.
- 6 Add report coverage before fast armies move beyond reliable information.
- 7 Track Air and Water income separately from the Death, Fire, and Astral costs of national projects.
- 8 Protect the capital troop queue and choose Wingless, Temple Guards, or Blizzard Warriors for a named role.
- 9 Build additional forts because they reproduce the entire commander roster.
- 10 Maintain a grounded or conventional response plan for terrain, weather, or enemies that punish flight.

These are planning controls. Exact expansion parties, flight routes, formations, scripts, blesses, and casualty expectations remain open.

## Caelum recruitment packages to compare

### Cheap flying screen

Spire Horn Militia cost eight gold and five resources, while ordinary Spire Horn Warriors and Airya Light Infantry cost ten gold. The package produces bodies and rapid concentration at low gold cost. Low morale, low hit points, limited protection, and fatigue make leadership and target selection decisive.

### Archer wing

Spire Horn Archers provide flying short bows and Storm Immunity. They can reposition and add missile pressure, but short-bow damage, accuracy, ammunition, landing risk, and enemy armour decide value. Flight does not require the archers to be sent into unsupported melee.

## Protected ice line

Airy Infantry, Iceclads, and Storm Guards exchange resources and recruitment points for higher protection. Iceclads are the most resource-heavy ordinary unit at forty resources. Storm Guards add the Spire Horn resistance and storm package. A fort's production should compare number of bodies, formation width, and replacement speed rather than protection alone.

## Mammoth package

Mammoth Riders cost 120 gold but only five resources and nine recruitment points in the manual table. They provide a mounted trampling option that uses a different bottleneck from Iceclads. Morale, size, congestion, friendly displacement, target size, mount damage, co-riders, routing, and remounting all remain matchup or runtime questions.

## Capital grounded sacreds

Temple Guards and Blizzard Warriors are sacred but do not print flight. Temple Guards supply a protected contact line at high resource cost; Blizzard Warriors supply frost bows with lower resources. Wingless are not sacred but provide capital-only grounded infantry with Morale 14. The package should be judged as a capital replacement system, not simply folded into the ordinary flying army.

# Caelum research response tree

## Branch A: repeatable Air support

Spire Horn Seraphs, Caelian Seraphs, and High Seraphs provide A1, A2, and A3 from every fort. Research can therefore favour general Air spells at thresholds the recruited roster actually meets. The correct branch depends on enemy shock resistance, formation, weather, battlefield size, fatigue, and available Air gems.

## Branch B: Water, Construction, and ice forging

Ice Crafters provide cheap W1 and Forge Bonus 1; Caelian Seraphs add A2 W1; High Seraphs begin at W2. Construction 1 and 3 expose all four rebate-linked ice items. The branch must still compare forging against research, searching, combat casting, gem reserves, and unresolved price stacking.

## Branch C: Thaumaturgy and Parting of the Soul

Thaumaturgy 6 unlocks Parting of the Soul at D1 A1. Any High Seraph with a Death pick qualifies because A3 is fixed. This is the most accessible national spell outside the disputed Seraphine field, but target immunity, magic resistance, range, fatigue, and battlefield conditions still control use.

## Branch D: Conjunction 5 positive summons

Call Ahurani and Summon Yazatas both require S2. Only a double-S High Seraph reaches that threshold unassisted, at 1.111% per High Seraph. Conjunction 5 should therefore be justified by its general spell list unless the caster already exists.

## Branch E: higher Astral summons

Call Fravashi, Call Celestial Yazad, and Call Amesha Spenta require S3 through S5. The plan begins with an explicit bridge and pearl budget. Researching Conjuratation 6-8 before the path chain exists can create a costly dead endpoint.

## Branch F: Death-Fire summons and remote pressure

The negative branch requires D2 F1 through D4 F2. No uncontested unassisted recruit qualifies. A viable route must document Death gems, Fire access, boosters or empowerment, laboratory turns, and the final caster. Call of the Drugvant also requires Thaumaturgy 7 and preserves its remote-event uncertainty.

# Caelum battlefield packages

## Flying line with separate command

Cheap Spire Horn or Airya troops hold frontage under an Airya Noble or Storm General while mages remain protected. The package preserves mage-turns and lets the army concentrate quickly. Low hit points, morale, missiles, fatigue, and enemy breakthrough speed remain central.

## Storm-compatible group

Spire Horn Archers, Warriors, Storm Guards, Scouts, and Storm Generals print Storm Immunity. Other Airya elements do not universally share it. A storm plan must therefore check every unit and caster rather than treating Caelum as one homogeneous flying roster.

## Protected flying group

Iceclads, Storm Guards, and Airya Infantry provide progressively expensive protected bodies. Buffs and Air support can improve the package, but temperature, armour-piercing or negating damage, fatigue, and replacement cost determine whether protection converts into survival.

## Mammoth breakthrough group

Mammoths can be placed behind or beside a line intended to create a controlled contact point. The package requires leadership, morale support, formation space, and a plan for targets that resist trample. Exact mount and co-rider resolution remains open.

## Capital sacred group

Temple Guards and Blizzard Warriors use the bless and capital recruitment in different ways. One is a protected grounded guard; the other is a lightly protected frost-bow unit. Priests, resource limits, replacement time, and the opponent decide whether either belongs in the main army.

## Random-path High Seraph group

High Seraphs with Water, Astral, Death, or mixed results should be labelled and scripted from their actual paths. A D-random enables Parting of the Soul; a double-S result enables two Conjuratation-5 rituals. Rare results are opportunities, not the baseline identity of every High Seraph.

## Caelum information and pressure network

Caelian Scouts combine flight and stealth, while most of the army can move rapidly. That reach can reveal threats, reinforce distant fronts, and threaten weak points, but it does not reveal enemy orders or make every route legal.

A safe network layers scouts, province reports, laboratories, fallback forts, mundane commanders, gem transport, and local reserves. Flying groups should arrive where replacements, supply, retreat routes, and supporting mages can follow. Speed without reporting can produce isolated armies rather than strategic pressure.

## Caelum Pretender families

| Family                        | What it can solve                                                           | What it must not conceal                                                                 |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Astral bridge                 | Makes S3-S5 national summons practical                                      | Pearls, research, boosters, laboratories, and mage-turns still matter.                   |
| Death-Fire bridge             | Opens Daevas, Jahi, Yata, Drugvant, and Greater Daeva projects              | The path pair does not create a Death-gem treasury or safe caster availability.          |
| Economy and infrastructure    | Funds forts, High Seraphs, laboratories, and resource-heavy ice troops      | Gold does not create local resources, recruitment points, gems, or capital sacred turns. |
| Sacred bless                  | Improves Temple Guards, Blizzard Warriors, Seraphines, and national summons | The two recruitable sacred troops are capital-only and grounded.                         |
| Awake expansion body          | Reduces pressure on fragile early troops                                    | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents.            |
| Resistance or climate support | Complements cold and shock themes or covers missing defences                | National flavour is not proof of the best bless or scale package.                        |

No exact design is endorsed without the game settings, map, opponents, legal chassis, and a versioned performance record.

## Caelum matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                      | First answer to examine                                                                               | Avoid                                                                 |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units                 | Archers, protected frontage, Mammoths where legal, Air magic, and rapid concentration                 | Using only expensive Iceclads when cheap width is the constraint.     |
| Heavy armour                       | Bufs, fatigue, magic, Mammoth pressure where suitable, and higher-damage weapons                      | Assuming short bows and ordinary ice spears solve protection unaided. |
| Accurate missiles                  | Screens, protected units, speed, battlefield control, and target disruption                           | Exposing nine-hit-point mages and archers without spacing or guards.  |
| Shock-resistant enemies            | Water, physical troops, buffs, fatigue, and non-shock spells                                          | Building the complete research plan around lightning.                 |
| Fire pressure                      | Cold resistance does not equal Fire resistance; use spacing, protection, counters, and faster contact | Treating the climate theme as universal elemental defence.            |
| Storms or anti-flight conditions   | Check Storm Immunity per unit, use grounded capital troops, and preserve conventional formations      | Assuming every Caelian flies under every condition.                   |
| Large or trample-resistant targets | Protected lines, magic, concentrated attacks, and other counters                                      | Treating Mammoths as universal breakthrough.                          |

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                                       | Avoid                                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fast flankers or flyers       | Guards, layered formations, reserves, and mage spacing                        | Leaving fragile Seraphs behind a thin airborne line.                                 |
| Underwater pressure           | Coastal defence, legal amphibious summons, allies, or another verified bridge | Scheduling spells marked unusable underwater or assuming flight solves the boundary. |
| Raiding and dispersed threats | Scouts, flying reserves, forts, and distributed commander recruitment         | Sending every mobile unit into one offensive concentration.                          |

## Monthly Caelum audit

- Is each fort limited by gold, resources, recruitment points, or commander turns?
- Are mundane commanders handling jobs that do not need magic or priesthood?
- Is the next mage purchase solving W1, A1, A2 W1, priesthood, or a High Seraph threshold?
- Is every High Seraph labelled by final W/S/D paths?
- Is the Seraphine Fire branch still excluded from guaranteed plans?
- Are ordinary and capital-site troop replacements tracked separately?
- Are Air and Water income being confused with the pearls, Death gems, and Fire access required by national rituals?
- Does every national spell have research, a legal caster, the correct treasury, a laboratory where required, and a free mage-turn?
- Are rare S2 and D2 outcomes excluded from schedules that must be repeatable?
- Are scouts and fallback routes keeping pace with flying armies?
- Are temperature, storm, supply, fatigue, morale, and retreat routes checked before battle?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?

## Caelum unresolved evidence boundary

The following remain open:

- 1 whether the Seraphine's pinned 20% F1 random is present and displayed in live 6.36;
- 2 live High Seraph random-path display and ordering;
- 3 strategic flying routes, terrain permissions, blockers, and order resolution;
- 4 storm creation, flight suppression, Storm Immunity, and mixed-army behaviour;
- 5 Ice Armor protection across temperature, stacking, and equipment changes;
- 6 Ice Fort cold-scale death protection, eligibility, timing, and ownership changes;
- 7 Guardian Spirit trigger, target, duration, replacement, and combat behaviour;
- 8 Mammoth mount, co-rider, trample, displacement, routing, death, and remounting resolution;
- 9 national summon placement, arrival state, slots, leadership, uniqueness, and repeat casting;
- 10 Call of the Drugvant unrest, attackers, ownership, defence, and event timing;
- 11 item-rebate display, live price, rounding, and interaction with Forge Bonus 1;
- 12 hero arrival timing and live special behaviour;
- 13 expansion-party sizes, formations, scripts, blessings, matchup performance, and casualty ranges;
- 14 disciple, allied-army, and underwater edge cases beyond explicit manual wording;
- 15 R-047, R-058, and every comparable parked engine-dependent investigation.

These are evidence gaps, not invitations to guess. Runtime testing and preparation of new test assets remain paused.



# Part XXXIII: Middle Age Phlegra, Deformed Giants

## Phlegra one-page command brief

Middle Age Phlegra converts enslaved human levies and scarce giant elites into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 9 commander identities and 6 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 6 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are giant recruitment limits, unrest, and replacement speed.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Phlegra evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Phlegra on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 51, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Phlegra object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Phlegra conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Phlegra recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 7          | 6      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 1      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 0      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Phlegra commander roster

| ID   | Commander               | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3129 | Trophimos Commander     | none                                                                | 100        |
| 3130 | Trophimos Priest        | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 1                                | 50         |
| 3131 | Trophimos Sage          | none; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 2                              | 10         |
| 3161 | Shackled Mage           | none; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 1                              | 0          |
| 3162 | Trophimos Oppressor     | F1 E1; random: 100% x1 mask 768 link 1                              | 50         |
| 3135 | Cyclops Chieftain       | none                                                                | 20         |
| 3141 | Cyclops Shepherd Shaman | N1                                                                  | 35         |
| 3139 | Phlegran Tyrant         | F3 E2 D1; random: 100% x1 mask 5504 link 1; 10% x1 mask 5504 link 1 | 90         |
| 3138 | Elder Cyclops           | F2 A1 E2; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 1; 10% x1 mask 1920 link 1 | 50         |

## Phlegra troop roster

| ID   | Unit            | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|-----------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 3132 | Helote Archer   | 10 | 0          | 6      | ordinary body |
| 3133 | Helote Warrior  | 10 | 0          | 7      | ordinary body |
| 3134 | Helote Soldier  | 10 | 0          | 7      | ordinary body |
| 3136 | Cyclops Warrior | 42 | 5          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 3137 | Cyclops Hurler  | 42 | 5          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 3140 | Gigante Warrior | 62 | 9          | 14     | ordinary body |

## Phlegra mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander               | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3130 | Trophimos Priest        | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 1                                | 50         |
| 3131 | Trophimos Sage          | none; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 2                              | 10         |
| 3161 | Shackled Mage           | none; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 1                              | 0          |
| 3162 | Trophimos Oppressor     | F1 E1; random: 100% x1 mask 768 link 1                              | 50         |
| 3141 | Cyclops Shepherd Shaman | N1                                                                  | 35         |
| 3139 | Phlegran Tyrant         | F3 E2 D1; random: 100% x1 mask 5504 link 1; 10% x1 mask 5504 link 1 | 90         |
| 3138 | Elder Cyclops           | F2 A1 E2; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 1; 10% x1 mask 1920 link 1 | 50         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 3, Air 1, Earth 2, Death 1, Nature 1, Holy 1. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Phlegra capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                     | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded |
|-----|--------------------------|----------------|-------------------|
| 196 | The Burning Fields       | F1, E1, D1     | Phlegran Tyrant   |
| 197 | Fortress of the Cyclopes | F1, E1         | Elder Cyclops     |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Phlegra national spell map

| ID  | Spell                        | School         | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|------------------------------|----------------|-------------|------------|
| 254 | Summon Hound of Twilight     | Conjuration 5  | E2 D1       | 3          |
| 255 | Sow Dragon Teeth             | Enchantment 6  | E2          | 1          |
| 256 | Bind Keres                   | Conjuration 6  | D2          | 12         |
| 264 | Gigantomachia                | Thaumaturgy 7  | E4 F4       | 60         |
| 270 | Forge Brass Bull             | Construction 6 | F3 E3       | 25         |
| 369 | Procession of the Underworld | Conjuration 5  | D3          | 13         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Phlegra national item boundary

| ID  | Item                | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|---------------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 133 | God-Slayer Spear    | 3            | E1    | restricted |
| 224 | Oppressors Headband | 1            | E3    | restricted |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Phlegra hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record   | Magic          | Boundary                           |
|------|---------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 3163 | Theurg Tyrant | F1 A2 E2 S3 H3 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Phlegra army identities

- Sacred roster: no sacred troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.

- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: enslaved human levies and scarce giant elites.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Phlegra opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Phlegra fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Phlegra, the most likely planning failure is giant recruitment limits, unrest, and replacement speed. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Phlegra research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Phlegra magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 3, Air 1, Earth 2, Death 1, Nature 1, Holy 1. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Phlegra battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Phlegra Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Phlegra matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem          | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                  |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units     | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage     |
| Heavy armour           | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided     |
| Accurate missiles      | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards   |
| Elemental resistance   | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element |
| Fast raiders or flyers | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army              |

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                         | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Phlegra monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Phlegra unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Phlegra source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbfc036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part XXXIV: Middle Age Asphodel, Carrion Woods

## Asphodel one-page command brief

Middle Age Asphodel converts Carrion Woods freespawn, stealth, and Death-Nature magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 8 commander identities and 10 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 12 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are population decline, freespawn composition, and living infrastructure.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Asphodel evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Asphodel on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 53, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Asphodel object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Asphodel conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Asphodel recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 8          | 10     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 0          | 0      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Asphodel commander roster

| ID   | Commander                | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 430  | Black Harpy              | none                                                                     | 10         |
| 2485 | Satyr Commander          | none                                                                     | 50         |
| 1534 | Minotaur Lord            | none                                                                     | 75         |
| 2311 | Centaur Hierophant       | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 12288 link 1; 10% x1 mask 1024 link 1           | 50         |
| 2312 | Centauride Hierophantide | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 12288 link 1; 10% x1 mask 512 link 1            | 50         |
| 901  | Black Dryad              | D1 N1 G1 H2                                                              | 50         |
| 2480 | Dryad Hag                | D1 N2 G1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 22016 link 1; 10% x1 mask 22016 link 1 | 10         |
| 709  | Panic Apostate           | D2 N3; random: 100% x1 mask 13824 link 1; 10% x1 mask 13824 link 1       | 100        |

## Asphodel troop roster

| ID   | Unit               | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits           |
|------|--------------------|----|------------|--------|------------------|
| 239  | Harpy              | 7  | 0          | 8      | flying, stealthy |
| 227  | Satyr Sneak        | 12 | 1          | 9      | stealthy         |
| 228  | Satyr              | 12 | 1          | 9      | stealthy         |
| 1532 | Satyr Warrior      | 14 | 1          | 10     | ordinary body    |
| 234  | Minotaur           | 25 | 4          | 13     | ordinary body    |
| 1533 | Minotaur Warrior   | 27 | 4          | 14     | ordinary body    |
| 2156 | Centauride         | 18 | 3          | 11     | stealthy         |
| 27   | Centaur            | 20 | 3          | 11     | stealthy         |
| 2157 | Centauride Warrior | 18 | 3          | 12     | stealthy         |
| 1704 | Centaur Warrior    | 22 | 3          | 12     | stealthy         |

## Asphodel mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander                | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2311 | Centaur Hierophant       | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 12288 link 1; 10% x1 mask 1024 link 1           | 50         |
| 2312 | Centauride Hierophantide | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 12288 link 1; 10% x1 mask 512 link 1            | 50         |
| 901  | Black Dryad              | D1 N1 G1 H2                                                              | 50         |
| 2480 | Dryad Hag                | D1 N2 G1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 22016 link 1; 10% x1 mask 22016 link 1 | 10         |
| 709  | Panic Apostate           | D2 N3; random: 100% x1 mask 13824 link 1; 10% x1 mask 13824 link 1       | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Death 2, Nature 3, Glamour 1, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.



## Asphodel capital and national sites

No capital-site association row was found. Hidden, generated, or special national effects are not inferred.

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Asphodel national spell map

| ID   | Spell            | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|------|------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 427  | Carrion Centaur  | Enchantment 0 | N1 D1       | 8          |
| 428  | Carrion Lady     | Enchantment 0 | N1 D1       | 16         |
| 429  | Carrion Lord     | Enchantment 0 | N3 D2       | 35         |
| 430  | Quick Roots      | Enchantment 0 | H1          | 0          |
| 431  | Regrowth         | Enchantment 0 | H2          | 0          |
| 432  | Mend the Dead    | Enchantment 0 | H2          | 0          |
| 433  | Puppet Mastery   | Enchantment 0 | H3          | 0          |
| 434  | Carrion Growth   | Enchantment 0 | H4          | 0          |
| 435  | Dark Slumber     | Enchantment 4 | N4 D2       | 15         |
| 436  | Sleep Vines      | Conjuration 3 | N1 G1       | 0          |
| 437  | Vengeful Vines   | Conjuration 4 | N1 D1       | 0          |
| 1458 | Carrion Fortress | Alteration 0  | N3 D2       | 45         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Asphodel national item boundary

| ID  | Item           | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|----------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 38  | Thorn Spear    | 3            | N1    | rebate     |
| 39  | Thorn Staff    | 3            | N1    | rebate     |
| 40  | Vine Whip      | 3            | N2    | rebate     |
| 68  | Skull Standard | 5            | N2 D1 | rebate     |
| 153 | Vine Bow       | 5            | N1    | rebate     |
| 522 | Carrion Seed   | 5            | N1 D1 | restricted |
| 523 | Carrion Bow    | 5            | N1 D1 | restricted |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Asphodel hero boundary

| ID  | Hero record       | Magic    | Boundary                           |
|-----|-------------------|----------|------------------------------------|
| 861 | Ettin Mandragora  | H1       | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 863 | Apostatic Warrior | D1 N2 H1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Asphodel army identities

- Sacred roster: no sacred troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Flying roster: Harpy.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: Carrion Woods freespawn, stealth, and Death-Nature magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Asphodel opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Asphodel fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Asphodel, the most likely planning failure is population decline, freespawn composition, and living infrastructure. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Asphodel research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.

- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Asphodel magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Death 2, Nature 3, Glamour 1, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Asphodel battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Asphodel Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Asphodel matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Asphodel monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Asphodel unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Asphodel source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part XXXV: Middle Age Ermor, Ashen Empire

## Ermor one-page command brief

Middle Age Ermor converts dominion-created undead and powerful Death magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 0 commander identities and 0 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 23 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are population destruction, freespawn control, and hostile dominion.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Ermor evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Ermor on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 54, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Ermor object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Ermor conversion chain

```
verified recruitment and national assets
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes
-> labelled fixed and random path access
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth
```

## Ermor recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 0          | 0      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 0          | 0      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

### Ermor commander roster

No ordinary membership rows are present in the pinned snapshot; site, freespawn, event, or special recruitment must be read separately.

### Ermor troop roster

No ordinary membership rows are present in the pinned snapshot; site, freespawn, event, or special recruitment must be read separately.

### Ermor mage and priest portfolio

No ordinary membership rows are present in the pinned snapshot; site, freespawn, event, or special recruitment must be read separately.

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are no fixed recruitable path in the ordinary/site commander rows. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

### Ermor capital and national sites

No capital-site association row was found. Hidden, generated, or special national effects are not inferred.

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

### Ermor national spell map

| ID  | Spell                       | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-----------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 372 | Unholy Command              | Divine 0      | H1          | 0          |
| 373 | Unholy Protection           | Divine 0      | H1          | 0          |
| 374 | Unholy Blessing             | Divine 0      | H1          | 0          |
| 375 | Unholy Power                | Divine 0      | H1          | 0          |
| 376 | Unholy Protection           | Divine 0      | H2          | 0          |
| 377 | Unholy Blessing             | Divine 0      | H2          | 0          |
| 379 | Unholy Power                | Divine 0      | H3          | 0          |
| 380 | Unholy Blessing             | Divine 0      | H3          | 0          |
| 381 | Protection of the Sepulchre | Divine 0      | H3          | 0          |
| 382 | Power of the Sepulchre      | Divine 0      | H4          | 0          |
| 383 | Revive Lictor               | Conjuration 0 | D2          | 3          |
| 384 | Revive Censor               | Conjuration 0 | D2          | 4          |

| ID  | Spell               | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|---------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 385 | Revive Acolyte      | Conjuration 0 | D2          | 10         |
| 386 | Revive Bishop       | Conjuration 0 | D2          | 16         |
| 387 | Revive Arch Bishop  | Conjuration 0 | D3          | 23         |
| 388 | Revive Spectator    | Conjuration 0 | D2          | 12         |
| 389 | Revive Dusk Elder   | Conjuration 0 | D3          | 20         |
| 390 | Revive Wailing Lady | Conjuration 2 | D2          | 8          |
| 391 | Lictorian Guard     | Conjuration 3 | D2          | 10         |
| 392 | Lamentation         | Conjuration 5 | D3          | 25         |
| 393 | Great Lamentation   | Conjuration 7 | D5          | 33         |
| 394 | Lictorian Legion    | Conjuration 8 | D4          | 35         |
| 395 | Ermorian Legion     | Enchantment 6 | D4          | 15         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Ermor national item boundary

| ID  | Item               | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|--------------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 119 | Sword of Injustice | 9            | D4    | rebate     |
| 229 | Black Laurel       | 3            | D2    | restricted |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Ermor hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record    | Magic    | Boundary                           |
|------|----------------|----------|------------------------------------|
| 183  | Wraith King    | D3 H2    | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 555  | Arch Censor    | none     | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 537  | Forgotten King | H3       | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2068 | Dusk Elder     | F2 S3 D4 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Ermor army identities

- Sacred roster: no sacred troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: dominion-created undead and powerful Death magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Ermor opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Ermor fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Ermor, the most likely planning failure is population destruction, freespawn control, and hostile dominion. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Ermor research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Ermor magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is no fixed recruitable path in the ordinary/site commander rows. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Ermor battlefield packages



### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Ermor Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Ermor matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem          | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                  |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units     | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage     |
| Heavy armour           | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided     |
| Accurate missiles      | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards   |
| Elemental resistance   | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element |
| Fast raiders or flyers | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army              |

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                         | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Ermor monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Ermor unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Ermor source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbfc036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part XXXVI: Middle Age Sceleria, The Reformed Empire

## Sceleria one-page command brief

Middle Age Sceleria converts Roman infantry, communions, and deliberate undead production into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 8 commander identities and 12 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 11 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are communion safety, upkeep, and mage-turn pressure.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Sceleria evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Sceleria on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 55, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Sceleria object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Sceleria conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Sceleria recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 6          | 10     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 2      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Sceleria commander roster

| ID   | Commander         | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 426  | Scout             | none                                                                | 0          |
| 428  | Assassin          | none                                                                | 0          |
| 671  | Centurion         | none                                                                | 100        |
| 1386 | Legatus Legionis  | none                                                                | 150        |
| 2244 | Scelerian Cultist | H1                                                                  | 10         |
| 669  | Thaumaturg        | S1 D1 H2                                                            | 10         |
| 1655 | Censor            | none                                                                | 50         |
| 670  | Grand Thaumaturg  | S2 D2 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 6912 link 1; 10% x1 mask 6912 link 1 | 10         |

## Sceleria troop roster

| ID   | Unit             | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits                   |
|------|------------------|----|------------|--------|--------------------------|
| 50   | Slinger          | 10 | 0          | 7      | ordinary body            |
| 662  | Velite           | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body            |
| 663  | Alae Legionnaire | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body            |
| 664  | Hastatus         | 10 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body            |
| 665  | Principe         | 11 | 0          | 12     | ordinary body            |
| 666  | Triarius         | 12 | 0          | 13     | ordinary body            |
| 667  | Praetorian Guard | 13 | 0          | 14     | ordinary body            |
| 668  | Standard         | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body            |
| 11   | Retiarius        | 12 | 0          | 14     | ordinary body            |
| 12   | Gladiator        | 12 | 0          | 14     | ordinary body            |
| 1654 | Lictor           | 12 | 0          | 14     | sacred                   |
| 809  | Shadow Vestal    | 9  | 0          | 12     | sacred, undead, stealthy |

## Sceleria mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander         | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2244 | Scelerian Cultist | H1                                                                  | 10         |
| 669  | Thaumaturg        | S1 D1 H2                                                            | 10         |
| 670  | Grand Thaumaturg  | S2 D2 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 6912 link 1; 10% x1 mask 6912 link 1 | 10         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Astral 2, Death 2, Holy 3. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Sceleria capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                  | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded |
|-----|-----------------------|----------------|-------------------|
| 55  | Temple of the Dead    | D3             | Censor, Lictor    |
| 64  | Temple of the Spheres | S1             | Grand Thaumaturg  |
| 148 | Campus Sceleris       | D1             | Shadow Vestal     |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Sceleria national spell map

| ID  | Spell                       | School   | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-----------------------------|----------|-------------|------------|
| 372 | Unholy Command              | Divine 0 | H1          | 0          |
| 373 | Unholy Protection           | Divine 0 | H1          | 0          |
| 374 | Unholy Blessing             | Divine 0 | H1          | 0          |
| 375 | Unholy Power                | Divine 0 | H1          | 0          |
| 376 | Unholy Protection           | Divine 0 | H2          | 0          |
| 377 | Unholy Blessing             | Divine 0 | H2          | 0          |
| 378 | Apostasy                    | Divine 0 | H3          | 0          |
| 379 | Unholy Power                | Divine 0 | H3          | 0          |
| 380 | Unholy Blessing             | Divine 0 | H3          | 0          |
| 381 | Protection of the Sepulchre | Divine 0 | H3          | 0          |
| 382 | Power of the Sepulchre      | Divine 0 | H4          | 0          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Sceleria national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Sceleria hero boundary

| ID  | Hero record      | Magic    | Boundary                           |
|-----|------------------|----------|------------------------------------|
| 868 | Scythe Wielder   | S2 D3 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 977 | Grand Thaumaturg | S2 D4 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Sceleria army identities

- Sacred roster: Lictor, Shadow Vestal.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: Roman infantry, communions, and deliberate undead production.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Sceleria opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Sceleria fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Sceleria, the most likely planning failure is communion safety, upkeep, and mage-turn pressure. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Sceleria research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Scleria magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Astral 2, Death 2, Holy 3. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Scleria battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Scleria Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Scleria matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Scleria monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Scleria unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Scleria source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.



# Part XXXVII: Middle Age Na'Ba, Queens of the Desert

## Na'Ba one-page command brief

Middle Age Na'Ba converts desert recruitment, human armies, and Jinn-backed magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 9 commander identities and 8 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 14 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are terrain access, rare paths, and elite replacement.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Na'Ba evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Na'Ba on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 65, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Na'Ba object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Na'Ba conversion chain

```
verified recruitment and national assets
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes
-> labelled fixed and random path access
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth
```

## Na'Ba recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 7          | 7      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 4          | 2      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 1          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Na'Ba commander roster

| ID   | Commander      | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3347 | Nabaeen Scout  | none                                                                     | 0          |
| 3334 | Sheikh         | none                                                                     | 75         |
| 3358 | Karib          | E1 H1                                                                    | 10         |
| 3337 | 'Adite General | none                                                                     | 100        |
| 3357 | Mukarrib       | S1 H2                                                                    | 50         |
| 3343 | Jann Emir      | F1 A1 G1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 17792 link 1                           | 150        |
| 3340 | Sahir          | F2 A2 E1 G1; random: 100% x1 mask 3200 link 1                            | 50         |
| 3339 | Hermit Sahir   | F1 A1 G1; random: 100% x1 mask 17792 link 1                              | 0          |
| 3341 | Malikah        | F3 A2 G2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 28032 link 1; 10% x1 mask 28032 link 1 | 100        |

## Na'Ba troop roster

| ID   | Unit                   | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits           |
|------|------------------------|----|------------|--------|------------------|
| 3332 | Nabaeen Desert Warrior | 10 | 0          | 10     | stealthy         |
| 3333 | Nabaeen Camel Rider    | 12 | 0          | 12     | stealthy         |
| 3356 | Nabaeen Light Infantry | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body    |
| 3338 | Nabaeen Soldier        | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body    |
| 3355 | 'Adite Light Infantry  | 24 | 1          | 12     | ordinary body    |
| 3336 | 'Adite Archer          | 24 | 1          | 10     | ordinary body    |
| 3335 | 'Adite Elite Soldier   | 25 | 1          | 13     | ordinary body    |
| 3342 | Jann Guard             | 22 | 1          | 13     | sacred, stealthy |

## Na'Ba mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander    | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3358 | Karib        | E1 H1                                                                    | 10         |
| 3357 | Mukarrib     | S1 H2                                                                    | 50         |
| 3343 | Jann Emir    | F1 A1 G1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 17792 link 1                           | 150        |
| 3340 | Sahir        | F2 A2 E1 G1; random: 100% x1 mask 3200 link 1                            | 50         |
| 3339 | Hermit Sahir | F1 A1 G1; random: 100% x1 mask 17792 link 1                              | 0          |
| 3341 | Malikah      | F3 A2 G2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 28032 link 1; 10% x1 mask 28032 link 1 | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 3, Air 2, Earth 1, Astral 1, Glamour 2, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll

behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Na'Ba capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                             | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded               |
|-----|----------------------------------|----------------|---------------------------------|
| 209 | Jannah                           | F1, A1, E1     | Malikah, Jann Guard             |
| 210 | Great Dam                        | W1             | none in explicit recruit fields |
| 211 | The Vault of Incense and Marvels | G1             | none in explicit recruit fields |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Na'Ba national spell map

| ID  | Spell                | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|----------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 539 | Contact Jinn         | Conjuration 4 | F2 A1       | 18         |
| 540 | Summon Jinn Warriors | Conjuration 5 | F2 A1       | 13         |
| 541 | Contact Houri        | Conjuration 6 | A2 G1       | 26         |
| 542 | Summon Hinn          | Conjuration 6 | A1 F1       | 4          |
| 543 | Summon Ifrit         | Blood 5       | B1 F3       | 58         |
| 544 | Summon Shaytan       | Blood 6       | B1 F3       | 73         |
| 545 | Summon Marid         | Conjuration 8 | F4 A2       | 66         |
| 547 | Scorching Wind       | Evocation 4   | A2 F1       | 0          |
| 548 | Smokeless Flame      | Evocation 6   | F3 A1       | 0          |
| 550 | Awaken Jinn Block    | Thaumaturgy 5 | E1 H1       | 5          |
| 551 | Feast for Ghuls      | Blood 4       | B1          | 16         |
| 552 | Summon Ghulah        | Blood 5       | B1          | 31         |
| 553 | Summon Binn          | Conjuration 6 | W1 A1       | 4          |
| 554 | Summon Si'lat        | Conjuration 6 | A2          | 21         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Na'Ba national item boundary

| ID  | Item           | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|-----|----------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 356 | Flying Carpet  | 5            | A3    | rebate |
| 409 | Stone Idol     | 7            | E2 S2 | rebate |
| 419 | Mirage Crystal | 7            | G3 E2 | rebate |
| 433 | The Magic Lamp | 9            | A5 F4 | rebate |

| ID  | Item               | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|--------------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 478 | Companion Bracelet | 5            | A2    | restricted |
| 480 | Jinn Bottle        | 7            | A1 E1 | restricted |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Na'Ba hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record    | Magic                                       | Boundary                           |
|------|----------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| 3385 | Queen of Na'Ba | F4 A3 G3 H1                                 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 3474 | Banu Si'lat    | F1 A1 G1; random: 100% x1 mask 17792 link 1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Na'Ba army identities

- Sacred roster: Jann Guard.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: desert recruitment, human armies, and Jinn-backed magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Na'Ba opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Na'Ba fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Na'Ba, the most likely planning failure is terrain access, rare paths, and elite replacement. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Na'Ba research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Na'Ba magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 3, Air 2, Earth 1, Astral 1, Glamour 2, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Na'Ba battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Na'Ba Pretender families

| Family              | What it can solve                                       | What it cannot conceal                                       |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required |

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Na'Ba matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Na'Ba monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Na'Ba unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Na'Ba source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part XXXVIII: Middle Age Ind, Magnificent Kingdom of Exalted Virtue

## Ind one-page command brief

Middle Age Ind converts capital authority and geographically divided tributary recruitment into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 10 commander identities and 4 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 8 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are regional availability, slow concentration, and sacred replacement.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Ind evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Ind on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 67, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Ind object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Ind conversion chain

```
verified recruitment and national assets
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes
-> labelled fixed and random path access
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth
```

## Ind recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 1          | 0      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 4          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 5          | 4      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Ind commander roster

| ID   | Commander             | Fixed and random magic                                                  | Leadership |
|------|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3284 | Abbot Sage            | S1 H2                                                                   | 50         |
| 3313 | Cannibal Warlord      | none                                                                    | 50         |
| 3297 | Cannibal Shaman Chief | B1; random: 100% x1 mask 47104 link 1                                   | 50         |
| 3290 | Bishop Vicomte        | H2                                                                      | 100        |
| 3291 | Viceroy Primate       | H3                                                                      | 40         |
| 3289 | Primate King          | S1 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 9856 link 1                                 | 150        |
| 3286 | Abbot Magus Supreme   | F1 E1 S3 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 9856 link 1; 10% x1 mask 11904 link 1 | 50         |
| 3285 | Abbot Magus           | F1 E1 S2 H2                                                             | 50         |
| 3288 | Archbishop Marshal    | H2                                                                      | 150        |
| 3287 | Bishop General        | H2                                                                      | 100        |

## Ind troop roster

| ID   | Unit           | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits |
|------|----------------|----|------------|--------|--------|
| 3281 | Baculite       | 12 | 0          | 13     | sacred |
| 3280 | Mirror Guard   | 12 | 0          | 13     | sacred |
| 3282 | Soldier Priest | 10 | 0          | 12     | sacred |
| 3283 | Archer Priest  | 10 | 0          | 11     | sacred |

## Ind mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander             | Fixed and random magic                | Leadership |
|------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------|------------|
| 3284 | Abbot Sage            | S1 H2                                 | 50         |
| 3297 | Cannibal Shaman Chief | B1; random: 100% x1 mask 47104 link 1 | 50         |
| 3290 | Bishop Vicomte        | H2                                    | 100        |
| 3291 | Viceroy Primate       | H3                                    | 40         |



| ID   | Commander           | Fixed and random magic                                                  | Leadership |
|------|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3289 | Primate King        | S1 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 9856 link 1                                 | 150        |
| 3286 | Abbot Magus Supreme | F1 E1 S3 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 9856 link 1; 10% x1 mask 11904 link 1 | 50         |
| 3285 | Abbot Magus         | F1 E1 S2 H2                                                             | 50         |
| 3288 | Archbishop Marshal  | H2                                                                      | 150        |
| 3287 | Bishop General      | H2                                                                      | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 1, Earth 1, Astral 3, Blood 1, Holy 3. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Ind capital and national sites

| ID  | Site              | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                                                 |
|-----|-------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 205 | Sublime Palace    | F1, S1         | Primate King, Baculite                                            |
| 206 | The Great Mirror  | S1             | Abbot Magus Supreme, Abbot Magus, Mirror Guard                    |
| 207 | The Onyx Court    | E1             | Archbishop Marshal, Bishop General, Soldier Priest, Archer Priest |
| 208 | Fountain of Youth | W1             | none in explicit recruit fields                                   |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Ind national spell map

| ID  | Spell                        | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|------------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 352 | Call Malakh                  | Conjuration 4 | S2          | 9          |
| 353 | Call Hashmal                 | Conjuration 6 | S3 F1       | 21         |
| 354 | Call Arel                    | Conjuration 7 | S4 N1       | 39         |
| 355 | Call Ophan                   | Conjuration 8 | S5 F2       | 49         |
| 356 | Call Merkavah                | Conjuration 9 | S7 F3       | 222        |
| 357 | Release Lord of Civilization | Blood 9       | B8          | 177        |
| 536 | Call Cyclops Tribe           | Conjuration 3 | E2          | 9          |
| 537 | Call the Birds of Splendor   | Conjuration 6 | F2 N1       | 7          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Ind national item boundary

| ID  | Item                     | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|--------------------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 181 | Immaculate Shield        | 9            | F3 S2 | rebate     |
| 282 | Salamander Silk Garments | 5            | F1    | restricted |
| 428 | The Ark                  | 9            | F5 S5 | rebate     |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Ind hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record | Magic             | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------|-------------------|------------------------------------|
| 3378 | Arch Pope   | F1 W1 E1 S3 N1 H4 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 3380 | Protopope   | H4                | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Ind army identities

- Sacred roster: Baculite, Mirror Guard, Soldier Priest, Archer Priest.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: capital authority and geographically divided tributary recruitment.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Ind opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Ind fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Ind, the most likely planning failure is regional availability, slow concentration, and sacred replacement. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Ind research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Ind magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 1, Earth 1, Astral 3, Blood 1, Holy 3. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Ind battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Ind Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Ind matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Ind monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Ind unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Ind source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part XXXIX: Middle Age Bandar Log, Land of the Apes

## Bandar Log one-page command brief

Middle Age Bandar Log converts mass ape infantry, sacred White Ones, and Astral-Nature mages into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 9 commander identities and 17 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 31 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are morale, armour, rare path rolls, and expensive sacreds.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Bandar Log evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Bandar Log on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 68, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Bandar Log object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Bandar Log conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
 -> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
 -> labelled fixed and random path access  
 -> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
 -> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Bandar Log recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 8          | 16     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 1          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Bandar Log commander roster

| ID   | Commander        | Fixed and random magic                                             | Leadership |
|------|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1119 | Markata Scout    | none                                                               | 0          |
| 1127 | Atavi Chieftain  | none                                                               | 50         |
| 1128 | Vanara Captain   | none                                                               | 75         |
| 1135 | Bandar Commander | none                                                               | 100        |
| 1136 | Bandar Noble     | none                                                               | 150        |
| 1146 | Brahmin          | H1                                                                 | 10         |
| 1145 | Yogi             | S1                                                                 | 10         |
| 1143 | Guru             | S2 N1                                                              | 10         |
| 1144 | Rishi            | S3 N2; random: 100% x1 mask 11776 link 1; 10% x1 mask 11776 link 1 | 10         |

## Bandar Log troop roster

| ID   | Unit                   | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|------------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 1118 | Markata                | 5  | 0          | 7      | ordinary body |
| 1120 | Markata Archer         | 5  | 0          | 7      | ordinary body |
| 1121 | Atavi Archer           | 10 | 1          | 8      | stealthy      |
| 1122 | Atavi Infantry         | 10 | 1          | 8      | stealthy      |
| 1123 | Vanara Archer          | 10 | 1          | 9      | ordinary body |
| 1124 | Vanara Chakram Thrower | 10 | 1          | 9      | ordinary body |
| 1125 | Vanara Infantry        | 10 | 1          | 9      | ordinary body |

| ID   | Unit                 | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|----------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 1126 | Vanara Swordsman     | 11 | 1          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 1130 | Light Bandar Archer  | 18 | 3          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1131 | Bandar Archer        | 18 | 3          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1351 | Light Bandar Warrior | 18 | 3          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1132 | Bandar Warrior       | 18 | 3          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1133 | Bandar Warrior       | 18 | 3          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1134 | Royal Swordsman      | 20 | 3          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 1142 | White One            | 11 | 1          | 12     | sacred        |
| 1147 | Elephant Rider       | 10 | 1          | 8      | ordinary body |
| 1141 | Tiger Rider          | 12 | 1          | 14     | sacred        |

## Bandar Log mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander | Fixed and random magic                                             | Leadership |
|------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1146 | Brahmin   | H1                                                                 | 10         |
| 1145 | Yogi      | S1                                                                 | 10         |
| 1143 | Guru      | S2 N1                                                              | 10         |
| 1144 | Rishi     | S3 N2; random: 100% x1 mask 11776 link 1; 10% x1 mask 11776 link 1 | 10         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Astral 3, Nature 2, Holy 1. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Bandar Log capital and national sites

| ID | Site              | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded  |
|----|-------------------|----------------|--------------------|
| 78 | The Lotus Gardens | S3, N2         | Rishi, Tiger Rider |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Bandar Log national spell map

| ID  | Spell             | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 555 | Summon Angiri     | Conjuration 3 | F2          | 5          |
| 556 | Summon Nagas      | Conjuration 3 | W2 E1       | 15         |
| 557 | Summon Apsaras    | Conjuration 3 | S2          | 3          |
| 558 | Summon Vidyadhara | Conjuration 4 | S2          | 15         |
| 559 | Contact Yaksha    | Conjuration 4 | N2 E1       | 25         |

| ID  | Spell                    | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|--------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 560 | Contact Yakshini         | Conjuration 4 | N2 W1       | 25         |
| 561 | Contact Nagini           | Conjuration 4 | W2 E1       | 25         |
| 562 | Summon Gandharvas        | Conjuration 5 | S2          | 15         |
| 563 | Summon Kimpurushas       | Conjuration 5 | N2 S1       | 15         |
| 564 | Contact Nagaraja         | Conjuration 5 | W2 E1       | 30         |
| 565 | Summon Garudas           | Conjuration 6 | S2          | 21         |
| 566 | Summon Maruts            | Conjuration 6 | S2          | 18         |
| 567 | Summon Kinnara           | Conjuration 6 | S3          | 25         |
| 568 | Contact Nagarishi        | Conjuration 6 | W3 E1       | 40         |
| 569 | Summon Siddha            | Conjuration 7 | S4          | 35         |
| 570 | Summon Devata            | Conjuration 8 | S5          | 45         |
| 571 | Summon Devala            | Conjuration 9 | S5          | 55         |
| 572 | Summon Rudra             | Conjuration 9 | S5          | 55         |
| 573 | Celestial Music          | Thaumaturgy 6 | S3          | 1          |
| 574 | Summon Rakshasas         | Blood 1       | B1          | 8          |
| 575 | Feast of Flesh           | Blood 2       | B1 N1       | 50         |
| 576 | Summon Asrapas           | Blood 3       | B2          | 8          |
| 577 | Summon Rakshasa Warriors | Blood 4       | B2          | 21         |
| 578 | Summon Sandhyabalas      | Blood 5       | B2 D1       | 25         |
| 579 | Summon Dakini            | Blood 6       | B4 A1       | 81         |
| 580 | Summon Samanishada       | Blood 7       | B3 D1       | 35         |
| 581 | Summon Mandeha           | Blood 8       | B5 D2       | 133        |
| 582 | Summon Danavas           | Blood 8       | B5          | 70         |
| 583 | Summon Daitya            | Blood 8       | B5          | 45         |
| 584 | Host of Ganas            | Conjuration 2 | D1          | 9          |
| 585 | Summon Vetalas           | Conjuration 5 | D2          | 10         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Bandar Log national item boundary

| ID  | Item                  | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|-----------------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 140 | Vajra                 | 5            | S2    | restricted |
| 227 | Headdress of the Bull | 5            | N1    | restricted |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.



## Bandar Log hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record | Magic | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------|-------|------------------------------------|
| 2270 | Tathagata   | H2    | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Bandar Log army identities

- Sacred roster: White One, Tiger Rider.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: mass ape infantry, sacred White Ones, and Astral-Nature mages.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Bandar Log opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Bandar Log fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Bandar Log, the most likely planning failure is morale, armour, rare path rolls, and expensive sacreds. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Bandar Log research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Bandar Log magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Astral 3, Nature 2, Holy 1. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Bandar Log battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Bandar Log Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Bandar Log matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Bandar Log monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Bandar Log unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Bandar Log source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part XL: Middle Age Nazca, Kingdom of the Sun

## Nazca one-page command brief

Middle Age Nazca converts flying armies, sacred Sun Guards, and reanimation into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 12 commander identities and 11 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 5 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are fragile bodies, corpse supply, leadership, and capital pressure.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Nazca evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Nazca on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 72, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Nazca object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Nazca conversion chain

```
verified recruitment and national assets
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes
-> labelled fixed and random path access
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth
```

## Nazca recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 9          | 9      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 3          | 2      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Nazca commander roster

| ID   | Commander         | Fixed and random magic                             | Leadership |
|------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2666 | Runancha          | none                                               | 0          |
| 2647 | Kuraka            | none                                               | 75         |
| 2654 | Apu               | none                                               | 75         |
| 2655 | Apusqispay        | none                                               | 100        |
| 2656 | Aclla             | F1 A1 H1                                           | 10         |
| 2657 | Hurin Priest      | E1 D2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 3328 link 1         | 10         |
| 2660 | Mallqui           | none                                               | 20         |
| 2661 | Mallqui Priestess | F1 A1 H1                                           | 20         |
| 2662 | Mallqui Priest    | E1 D2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 3328 link 1         | 20         |
| 2658 | Inca              | F2 A2 H3; random: 10% x1 mask 2432 link 1          | 100        |
| 2659 | Coya              | E2 S2 D2 H2; random: 30% x1 mask 7552 link 1       | 50         |
| 2663 | Royal Mallqui     | F2 A2 E2 S2 D2 H3; random: 10% x1 mask 7552 link 1 | 20         |

## Nazca troop roster

| ID   | Unit                | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits         |
|------|---------------------|----|------------|--------|----------------|
| 2643 | Human Warrior       | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body  |
| 2644 | Human Warrior       | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body  |
| 2645 | Human Warrior       | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body  |
| 2646 | Human Warrior       | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body  |
| 2648 | Hatun Runa          | 11 | 0          | 7      | flying         |
| 2652 | Aucac Runa Archer   | 11 | 0          | 10     | flying         |
| 2649 | Aucac Runa Spearman | 11 | 0          | 11     | flying         |
| 2650 | Aucac Runa Maceman  | 11 | 0          | 11     | flying         |
| 2651 | Aucac Runa Axeman   | 11 | 0          | 11     | flying         |
| 2653 | Sun Guard           | 13 | 0          | 13     | sacred, flying |
| 2667 | Condor Warrior      | 13 | 0          | 12     | sacred, flying |

## Nazca mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander         | Fixed and random magic                     | Leadership |
|------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2656 | Aclla             | F1 A1 H1                                   | 10         |
| 2657 | Hurin Priest      | E1 D2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 3328 link 1 | 10         |
| 2661 | Mallqui Priestess | F1 A1 H1                                   | 20         |

| ID   | Commander      | Fixed and random magic                             | Leadership |
|------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2662 | Mallqui Priest | E1 D2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 3328 link 1         | 20         |
| 2658 | Inca           | F2 A2 H3; random: 10% x1 mask 2432 link 1          | 100        |
| 2659 | Coya           | E2 S2 D2 H2; random: 30% x1 mask 7552 link 1       | 50         |
| 2663 | Royal Mallqui  | F2 A2 E2 S2 D2 H3; random: 10% x1 mask 7552 link 1 | 20         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 2, Air 2, Earth 2, Astral 2, Death 2, Holy 3. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Nazca capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                    | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded             |
|-----|-------------------------|----------------|-------------------------------|
| 172 | Palace of the Sun Kings | F1, A1, S1     | Inca, Coya, Sun Guard         |
| 173 | Tombs of the Sun Kings  | E1, D1         | Royal Mallqui, Condor Warrior |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Nazca national spell map

| ID  | Spell               | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|---------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 472 | Geoglyphs           | Enchantment 5 | S3 E2       | 18         |
| 473 | Eyes of the Condors | Enchantment 2 | A2          | 1          |
| 474 | Summon Condors      | Conjuration 3 | A2          | 8          |
| 475 | Summon Huacas       | Conjuration 5 | S2          | 12         |
| 476 | Summon Supayas      | Conjuration 5 | D2          | 8          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Nazca national item boundary

| ID  | Item            | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|-----------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 228 | Huaca Headdress | 5            | F2    | restricted |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Nazca hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record     | Magic             | Boundary                           |
|------|-----------------|-------------------|------------------------------------|
| 2712 | Apostate Seraph | F1 A3 W2 S2       | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2713 | First Couple    | F2 A2 E2 S2 D4 H3 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Nazca army identities

- Sacred roster: Sun Guard, Condor Warrior.
- Flying roster: Hatun Runa, Aucac Runa Archer, Aucac Runa Spearman, Aucac Runa Maceman, Aucac Runa Axeman, Sun Guard, Condor Warrior.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: flying armies, sacred Sun Guards, and reanimation.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Nazca opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Nazca fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Nazca, the most likely planning failure is fragile bodies, corpse supply, leadership, and capital pressure. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Nazca research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.

- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Nazca magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 2, Air 2, Earth 2, Astral 2, Death 2, Holy 3. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Nazca battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Nazca Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |



## Nazca matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Nazca monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Nazca unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Nazca source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part XLI: Middle Age Mictlan, Reign of the Lawgiver

## Mictlan one-page command brief

Middle Age Mictlan converts broad elemental priests, sacred warriors, and Blood access into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 11 commander identities and 9 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 13 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are blood-hunting opportunity cost, priest turns, and lightly protected troops.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Mictlan evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Mictlan on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 73, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Mictlan object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Mictlan conversion chain

```
verified recruitment and national assets
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes
-> labelled fixed and random path access
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth
```

## Mictlan recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 5          | 7      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 6          | 2      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Mictlan commander roster

| ID   | Commander              | Fixed and random magic                                               | Leadership |
|------|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 729  | Scout                  | none                                                                 | 0          |
| 730  | Tribal King            | none                                                                 | 100        |
| 1189 | Mictlan Priest         | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 10880 link 1                                | 10         |
| 1361 | Nahualli               | S1 N2; random: 10% x1 mask 47104 link 1                              | 10         |
| 1888 | Sky Priest             | A1 H1; random: 10% x1 mask 10880 link 1                              | 10         |
| 1192 | Moon Priest            | S2 H2                                                                | 10         |
| 1193 | Sun Priest             | F2 H2                                                                | 50         |
| 1191 | Rain Priest            | W2 H2                                                                | 10         |
| 1907 | High Priest of the Sky | A2 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 10880 link 1; 10% x1 mask 11136 link 1   | 50         |
| 1190 | Priest King            | N2 H3; random: 10% x1 mask 11136 link 1                              | 150        |
| 1194 | Couatl                 | S3 N1 H2; random: 100% x2 mask 8448 link 1; 10% x1 mask 10496 link 1 | 100        |

## Mictlan troop roster

| ID   | Unit              | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|-------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 721  | Warrior           | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 1545 | Warrior           | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 1546 | Warrior           | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 1547 | Warrior           | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 1548 | Feathered Warrior | 10 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 1883 | Moon Warrior      | 12 | 0          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 726  | Eagle Warrior     | 12 | 0          | 11     | sacred        |
| 725  | Sun Warrior       | 12 | 0          | 13     | sacred        |
| 727  | Jaguar Warrior    | 12 | 0          | 12     | sacred        |

## Mictlan mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander      | Fixed and random magic                  | Leadership |
|------|----------------|-----------------------------------------|------------|
| 1189 | Mictlan Priest | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 10880 link 1   | 10         |
| 1361 | Nahualli       | S1 N2; random: 10% x1 mask 47104 link 1 | 10         |
| 1888 | Sky Priest     | A1 H1; random: 10% x1 mask 10880 link 1 | 10         |
| 1192 | Moon Priest    | S2 H2                                   | 10         |
| 1193 | Sun Priest     | F2 H2                                   | 50         |

| ID   | Commander              | Fixed and random magic                                               | Leadership |
|------|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1191 | Rain Priest            | W2 H2                                                                | 10         |
| 1907 | High Priest of the Sky | A2 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 10880 link 1; 10% x1 mask 11136 link 1   | 50         |
| 1190 | Priest King            | N2 H3; random: 10% x1 mask 11136 link 1                              | 150        |
| 1194 | Couatl                 | S3 N1 H2; random: 100% x2 mask 8448 link 1; 10% x1 mask 10496 link 1 | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 2, Air 2, Water 2, Astral 3, Nature 2, Holy 3. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Mictlan capital and national sites

| ID | Site                                | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                   |
|----|-------------------------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------|
| 89 | Temple of the Moon                  | S1             | Moon Priest                         |
| 90 | Temple of the Sun                   | F1             | Sun Priest, Sun Warrior             |
| 88 | High Temple of the Sky and the Rain | A1, W1         | Rain Priest, High Priest of the Sky |
| 87 | High Temple of the Land             | N1             | Priest King, Couatl, Jaguar Warrior |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Mictlan national spell map

| ID  | Spell                | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|----------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 504 | Summon Jaguar Toads  | Conjuration 1 | N1 H1       | 2          |
| 505 | Summon Jaguars       | Conjuration 3 | N2 H1       | 20         |
| 506 | Summon Jade Serpents | Conjuration 4 | W2          | 3          |
| 507 | Summon Monster Toad  | Conjuration 5 | N2          | 1          |
| 508 | Contact Couatl       | Conjuration 6 | N1 S1       | 40         |
| 509 | Summon Tlaloque      | Conjuration 7 | W4          | 60         |
| 510 | Bind Beast Bats      | Blood 2       | B1          | 8          |
| 511 | Bind Jaguar Fiends   | Blood 4       | B1 F1       | 16         |
| 512 | Contact Civateteo    | Blood 5       | B2 D2       | 36         |
| 513 | Bind Tzitzimitl      | Blood 6       | B2 S2       | 10         |
| 514 | Contact Tlahuelpuchi | Blood 6       | B3          | 42         |
| 515 | Contact Onaqui       | Blood 7       | B4          | 101        |
| 516 | Rain of Jaguars      | Blood 8       | B6 F2       | 40         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Mictlan national item boundary

| ID | Item       | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|----|------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 43 | Jade Knife | 3            | N1 B1 | restricted |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Mictlan hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record     | Magic          | Boundary                           |
|------|-----------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 933  | King of Legends | D3 B3 H3       | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1884 | Priest King     | F2 A2 S3 N2 H4 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1886 | Priest King     | A3 S3 N2 H3    | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Mictlan army identities

- Sacred roster: Eagle Warrior, Sun Warrior, Jaguar Warrior.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: broad elemental priests, sacred warriors, and Blood access.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Mictlan opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Mictlan fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Mictlan, the most likely planning failure is blood-hunting opportunity cost, priest turns, and lightly protected troops. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Mictlan research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Mictlan magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 2, Air 2, Water 2, Astral 3, Nature 2, Holy 3. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Mictlan battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

## Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Mictlan Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Mictlan matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Mictlan monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Mictlan unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Mictlan source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part XLII: Middle Age Xibalba, Flooded Caves

## Xibalba one-page command brief

Middle Age Xibalba converts cave recruitment, flying Zotz, amphibious forces, and Blood magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 7 commander identities and 9 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 13 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are terrain splits, weak bodies, underwater logistics, and random paths.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Xibalba evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Xibalba on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 74, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Xibalba object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.



## Xibalba conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
 -> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
 -> labelled fixed and random path access  
 -> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
 -> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Xibalba recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 4          | 6      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 3          | 3      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Xibalba commander roster

| ID   | Commander           | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2715 | Muuch Ajaw          | H1                                                                       | 100        |
| 2718 | Ah Itz              | W1 D1                                                                    | 10         |
| 2717 | Ah Ha'              | W1 E1 H1                                                                 | 10         |
| 2716 | Muuch K'uhul        | W2 E1 D1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 13824 link 1                           | 50         |
| 2732 | Chak Muuch Assassin | none                                                                     | 0          |
| 2714 | Bacab               | W3 E2 D1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 13824 link 1; 10% x1 mask 13824 link 1 | 150        |
| 2719 | Camazotz            | D2 B1; random: 100% x1 mask 34048 link 1                                 | 10         |

## Xibalba troop roster

| ID   | Unit                        | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits             |
|------|-----------------------------|----|------------|--------|--------------------|
| 2721 | Muuch Militia               | 12 | 2          | 8      | amphibious         |
| 2722 | Muuch Dart Thrower          | 14 | 2          | 10     | amphibious         |
| 2723 | Muuch Warrior               | 14 | 2          | 10     | amphibious         |
| 2724 | Muuch Warrior               | 14 | 2          | 10     | amphibious         |
| 2725 | Muuch Warrior               | 14 | 2          | 10     | amphibious         |
| 2726 | Muuch Warrior               | 14 | 2          | 10     | amphibious         |
| 2730 | Chak Muuch Dart Thrower     | 14 | 2          | 11     | sacred, amphibious |
| 2731 | Chak Muuch Obsidian Warrior | 15 | 2          | 13     | sacred, amphibious |
| 2729 | Wo' Muuch                   | 26 | 6          | 14     | sacred, amphibious |

## Xibalba mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander    | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2715 | Muuch Ajaw   | H1                                                                       | 100        |
| 2718 | Ah Itz       | W1 D1                                                                    | 10         |
| 2717 | Ah Ha'       | W1 E1 H1                                                                 | 10         |
| 2716 | Muuch K'uhul | W2 E1 D1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 13824 link 1                           | 50         |
| 2714 | Bacab        | W3 E2 D1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 13824 link 1; 10% x1 mask 13824 link 1 | 150        |
| 2719 | Camazotz     | D2 B1; random: 100% x1 mask 34048 link 1                                 | 10         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Water 3, Earth 2, Death 2, Blood 1, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Xibalba capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                           | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                                                         |
|-----|--------------------------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 177 | The Sacred Cenote              | W1             | Chak Muuch Assassin, Chak Muuch Dart Thrower, Chak Muuch Obsidian Warrior |
| 178 | The Flooded City               | W2, E1         | Bacab, Wo' Muuch                                                          |
| 179 | The Cave of Perpetual Darkness | D1             | Camazotz                                                                  |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Xibalba national spell map

| ID  | Spell                   | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 504 | Summon Jaguar Toads     | Conjuration 1 | N1 H1       | 2          |
| 506 | Summon Jade Serpents    | Conjuration 4 | W2          | 3          |
| 507 | Summon Monster Toad     | Conjuration 5 | N2          | 1          |
| 519 | Break the First Soul    | Blood 2       | B1          | 0          |
| 520 | Break the Second Soul   | Thaumaturgy 2 | E1          | 0          |
| 521 | Break the Third Soul    | Thaumaturgy 2 | A1          | 0          |
| 522 | Break the Fourth Soul   | Thaumaturgy 2 | D1          | 0          |
| 523 | Gift of the First Soul  | Blood 3       | B1          | 0          |
| 524 | Gift of the Second Soul | Thaumaturgy 3 | E1          | 0          |
| 525 | Gift of the Third Soul  | Thaumaturgy 3 | A1          | 0          |
| 526 | Gift of the Fourth Soul | Thaumaturgy 3 | D1          | 0          |
| 527 | Summon Balam            | Conjuration 7 | N4          | 60         |
| 528 | Summon Chaac            | Conjuration 8 | A4          | 75         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

### Xibalba national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

### Xibalba hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record       | Magic       | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------------|-------------|------------------------------------|
| 3260 | Grandmother Earth | W2 E2 D2 H4 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 3261 | Red Face          | W2 E2 D1 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

### Xibalba army identities

- Sacred roster: Chak Muuch Dart Thrower, Chak Muuch Obsidian Warrior, Wo' Muuch.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: Muuch Militia, Muuch Dart Thrower, Muuch Warrior, Muuch Warrior, Muuch Warrior, Muuch Warrior, Chak Muuch Dart Thrower, Chak Muuch Obsidian Warrior, Wo' Muuch.
- Core identity: cave recruitment, flying Zotz, amphibious forces, and Blood magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

### Xibalba opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

### Xibalba fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Xibalba, the most likely planning failure is terrain splits, weak bodies, underwater logistics, and random paths. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Xibalba research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Xibalba magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Water 3, Earth 2, Death 2, Blood 1, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Xibalba battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Xibalba Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Xibalba matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Xibalba monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Xibalba unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Xibalba source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part XLIII: Middle Age Phaeacia, Isle of the Dark Ships

## Phaeacia one-page command brief

Middle Age Phaeacia converts sailing, Colossi, and a broad island mage corps into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 8 commander identities and 8 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 9 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are gold-intensive elites, sailing boundaries, and coastal replacement.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Phaeacia evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Phaeacia on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 77, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Phaeacia object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Phaeacia conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

- > provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes
- > labelled fixed and random path access
- > research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support
- > surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Phaeacia recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 6          | 7      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Phaeacia commander roster

| ID   | Commander             | Fixed and random magic                                                      | Leadership |
|------|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3153 | Phaeacian Scout       | none                                                                        | 0          |
| 3154 | Phaeacian Captain     | none                                                                        | 75         |
| 3166 | Phaeacian Priest      | H1                                                                          | 10         |
| 3151 | Mage Pilot            | A1 W1                                                                       | 50         |
| 3155 | Colossi Weaver        | A1 S1; random: 100% x1 mask 20224 link 1                                    | 10         |
| 3156 | Colossi Storm Captain | A2 W1                                                                       | 100        |
| 3158 | Prince Consort        | A3 W2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 18176 link 1; 10% x1 mask 18176 link 1       | 10         |
| 3157 | Colossi Queen         | A2 W2 S1 G1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 19200 link 1; 10% x1 mask 19200 link 1 | 100        |

## Phaeacia troop roster

| ID   | Unit                     | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|--------------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 3143 | Phaeacian Militia        | 10 | 0          | 8      | ordinary body |
| 3144 | Phaeacian Archer         | 10 | 0          | 8      | ordinary body |
| 3145 | Phaeacian Light Infantry | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 3146 | Phaeacian Infantry       | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 3147 | Phaeacian Heavy Infantry | 10 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 3165 | Colossi Light Infantry   | 20 | 1          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 3148 | Colossi Heavy Infantry   | 20 | 1          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 3159 | Orichalcum Guard         | 24 | 1          | 14     | sacred        |

## Phaeacia mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander             | Fixed and random magic                                                      | Leadership |
|------|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3166 | Phaeacian Priest      | H1                                                                          | 10         |
| 3151 | Mage Pilot            | A1 W1                                                                       | 50         |
| 3155 | Colossi Weaver        | A1 S1; random: 100% x1 mask 20224 link 1                                    | 10         |
| 3156 | Colossi Storm Captain | A2 W1                                                                       | 100        |
| 3158 | Prince Consort        | A3 W2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 18176 link 1; 10% x1 mask 18176 link 1       | 10         |
| 3157 | Colossi Queen         | A2 W2 S1 G1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 19200 link 1; 10% x1 mask 19200 link 1 | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Air 3, Water 2, Astral 1, Glamour 1, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Phaeacia capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                  | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                               |
|-----|-----------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| 198 | The Orichalcum Palace | A1, G1         | Prince Consort, Colossi Queen, Orichalcum Guard |
| 199 | Black Korkyra         | W1, E1         | none in explicit recruit fields                 |
| 200 | Gold Apple Tree       | F1             | none in explicit recruit fields                 |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Phaeacia national spell map

| ID  | Spell                    | School         | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|--------------------------|----------------|-------------|------------|
| 254 | Summon Hound of Twilight | Conjuration 5  | E2 D1       | 3          |
| 255 | Sow Dragon Teeth         | Enchantment 6  | E2          | 1          |
| 256 | Bind Keres               | Conjuration 6  | D2          | 12         |
| 265 | Contact Hesperide        | Conjuration 6  | F3 S1       | 35         |
| 266 | Call Ladon               | Conjuration 6  | F3 N2       | 15         |
| 267 | Dogs of Gold and Silver  | Construction 4 | E1          | 7          |
| 268 | Dog of Gold              | school -1 1    | special     | 0          |
| 269 | Craft Keledone           | Construction 6 | E2 S2       | 5          |
| 270 | Forge Brass Bull         | Construction 6 | F3 E3       | 25         |



Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Phaeacia national item boundary

| ID  | Item                 | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|----------------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 281 | Purple Silk Garments | 3            | S1 W1 | restricted |
| 283 | Silver Silk Garments | 7            | S1 A1 | restricted |
| 477 | Windcatcher Sail     | 5            | A2    | restricted |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Phaeacia hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record        | Magic          | Boundary                           |
|------|--------------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 3173 | Aegaeide           | W3 N3          | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 3174 | Phaeacian Princess | A2 W1 S1 G1 H1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Phaeacia army identities

- Sacred roster: Orichalcum Guard.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: sailing, Colossi, and a broad island mage corps.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Phaeacia opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Phaeacia fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Phaeacia, the most likely planning failure is gold-intensive elites, sailing boundaries, and coastal replacement. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Phaeacia research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Phaeacia magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Air 3, Water 2, Astral 1, Glamour 1, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Phaeacia battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

## Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Phaeacia Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Phaeacia matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Phaeacia monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Phaeacia unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Phaeacia source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part XLIV: Middle Age Vanarus, Land of the Chuds

## Vanarus one-page command brief

Middle Age Vanarus converts human infantry, Chud elites, stealth, and forest-linked magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 7 commander identities and 10 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 16 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are mixed troop quality, limited armour, and dispersed specialist roles.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Vanarus evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Vanarus on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 79, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Vanarus object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Vanarus conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
 -> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
 -> labelled fixed and random path access  
 -> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
 -> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Vanarus recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 6          | 8      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 1          | 2      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Vanarus commander roster

| ID   | Commander        | Fixed and random magic                                                      | Leadership |
|------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2353 | Scout            | none                                                                        | 0          |
| 2354 | Vanarusian Herse | none                                                                        | 75         |
| 2355 | Vanarusian Jarl  | none                                                                        | 100        |
| 2356 | Vanarusian Gode  | H1                                                                          | 10         |
| 2341 | Vanarusian Sage  | A1; random: 100% x1 mask 9600 link 1; 100% x1 mask 53248 link 1             | 10         |
| 2357 | Chud Jarl        | H1                                                                          | 100        |
| 2342 | Vanabog          | A2 D1 G1 B1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 53632 link 1; 10% x1 mask 53632 link 1 | 150        |

## Vanarus troop roster

| ID   | Unit                 | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits           |
|------|----------------------|----|------------|--------|------------------|
| 2343 | Vanarusian Archer    | 10 | 0          | 8      | ordinary body    |
| 2344 | Vanarusian Huskarl   | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body    |
| 2345 | Vanarusian Huskarl   | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body    |
| 2346 | Vanarusian Hirdman   | 10 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body    |
| 2347 | Vanarusian Hirdman   | 10 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body    |
| 2348 | Vanarusian Hirdman   | 10 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body    |
| 3071 | Vanarusian Berserker | 12 | 0          | 12     | ordinary body    |
| 2350 | Chud Hirdman         | 17 | 2          | 13     | ordinary body    |
| 2349 | Oath-Bound           | 14 | 0          | 13     | sacred, stealthy |

| ID   | Unit             | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 2352 | Chud Skinshifter | 18 | 2          | 13     | ordinary body |

## Vanarus mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander       | Fixed and random magic                                                      | Leadership |
|------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2356 | Vanarusian Gode | H1                                                                          | 10         |
| 2341 | Vanarusian Sage | A1; random: 100% x1 mask 9600 link 1; 100% x1 mask 53248 link 1             | 10         |
| 2357 | Chud Jarl       | H1                                                                          | 100        |
| 2342 | Vanabog         | A2 D1 G1 B1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 53632 link 1; 10% x1 mask 53632 link 1 | 150        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Air 2, Death 1, Glamour 1, Blood 1, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Vanarus capital and national sites

| ID  | Site           | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded   |
|-----|----------------|----------------|---------------------|
| 155 | Novgård        | F1, A1, G1     | Vanabog, Oath-Bound |
| 156 | Pine of Skulls | D1, N1         | Chud Skinshifter    |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Vanarus national spell map

| ID  | Spell                 | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-----------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 322 | Summon Simargl        | Conjuration 2 | A1          | 1          |
| 323 | Summon Firebird       | Conjuration 3 | F1 S1       | 2          |
| 324 | Send Lady Midday      | Conjuration 5 | A3 D1       | 5          |
| 325 | Contact Sirin         | Conjuration 3 | S2          | 8          |
| 326 | Send Vodyanoy         | Conjuration 4 | W2          | 20         |
| 327 | Summon Rusalka        | Conjuration 4 | W1 D1       | 16         |
| 328 | Summon Likho          | Conjuration 4 | D1          | 10         |
| 329 | Contact Alkonost      | Conjuration 4 | S2          | 15         |
| 330 | Summon Zmey           | Conjuration 5 | F2          | 5          |
| 331 | Send Bukavac          | Conjuration 5 | W4          | 5          |
| 332 | Contact Gamayun       | Conjuration 5 | S3          | 25         |
| 333 | Contact Beregina      | Conjuration 6 | W3 E1       | 35         |
| 334 | Contact Mountain Vila | Conjuration 7 | N4          | 40         |

| ID  | Spell              | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|--------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 335 | Contact Cloud Vila | Conjuration 7 | A4          | 40         |
| 336 | Contact Leshiy     | Conjuration 8 | N6          | 60         |
| 493 | Awaken Draugar     | Conjuration 4 | D2          | 12         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Vanarus national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Vanarus hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record  | Magic       | Boundary                           |
|------|--------------|-------------|------------------------------------|
| 3257 | Last Perkunu | A4 S1 N3 H1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1958 | Hag          | A3 W1 D3 N2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 3259 | Varyag       | A2 D1 G2 H1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Vanarus army identities

- Sacred roster: Oath-Bound.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: human infantry, Chud elites, stealth, and forest-linked magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Vanarus opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Vanarus fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Vanarus, the most likely planning failure is mixed troop quality, limited armour, and dispersed specialist roles. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Vanarus research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Vanarus magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Air 2, Death 1, Glamour 1, Blood 1, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Vanarus battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.



### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Vanarus Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Vanarus matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Vanarus monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Vanarus unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Vanarus source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part XLV: Middle Age Jotunheim, Iron Woods

## Jotunheim one-page command brief

Middle Age Jotunheim converts giant infantry, sacred Jotuns, and Death-Nature magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 10 commander identities and 15 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 8 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are high gold per body, low formation width, and replacement tempo.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Jotunheim evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Jotunheim on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 80, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Jotunheim object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Jotunheim conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
 -> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
 -> labelled fixed and random path access  
 -> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
 -> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Jotunheim recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 8          | 13     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 2      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Jotunheim commander roster

| ID   | Commander     | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 283  | Chief         | none                                                                  | 50         |
| 786  | Jotun Scout   | none                                                                  | 0          |
| 437  | Jotun Herse   | none                                                                  | 75         |
| 274  | Jotun Jarl    | H1                                                                    | 100        |
| 275  | Jotun Gode    | H2                                                                    | 50         |
| 913  | Vaetti Hag    | none; random: 100% x1 mask 63488 link 1                               | 10         |
| 3429 | Jotun Skratti | W2 B2; random: 100% x1 mask 53760 link 1                              | 10         |
| 3397 | Gygja         | D1 G1 B1; random: 100% x1 mask 63488 link 1                           | 50         |
| 3398 | Jarnvidja     | D1 G1 B1; random: 100% x3 mask 63488 link 1; 10% x1 mask 63488 link 1 | 50         |
| 3399 | Thrymsgode    | W1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 20992 link 1                              | 100        |

## Jotunheim troop roster

| ID   | Unit             | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 3423 | Vaetti Archer    | 8  | 0          | 7      | stealthy      |
| 541  | Vaetti           | 8  | 0          | 9      | stealthy      |
| 282  | Wolf Rider       | 8  | 0          | 9      | stealthy      |
| 1085 | Moose Rider      | 8  | 0          | 7      | stealthy      |
| 277  | Jotun Bondi      | 31 | 5          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 276  | Jotun Javelinist | 33 | 5          | 12     | ordinary body |

| ID   | Unit           | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|----------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 300  | Jotun Hurler   | 33 | 5          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 278  | Jotun Spearman | 33 | 5          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 279  | Jotun Axeman   | 33 | 5          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 841  | Godihuskarl    | 36 | 5          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 840  | Jotun Huskarl  | 35 | 5          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 842  | Jotun Hirdman  | 38 | 5          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 845  | Niefel Giant   | 69 | 7          | 14     | sacred        |
| 1310 | Ulfhedin       | 40 | 6          | 15     | ordinary body |
| 3400 | Thrymshirding  | 41 | 6          | 14     | sacred        |

## Jotunheim mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander     | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 274  | Jotun Jarl    | H1                                                                    | 100        |
| 275  | Jotun Gode    | H2                                                                    | 50         |
| 913  | Vaetti Hag    | none; random: 100% x1 mask 63488 link 1                               | 10         |
| 3429 | Jotun Skratti | W2 B2; random: 100% x1 mask 53760 link 1                              | 10         |
| 3397 | Gygja         | D1 G1 B1; random: 100% x1 mask 63488 link 1                           | 50         |
| 3398 | Jarnvidja     | D1 G1 B1; random: 100% x3 mask 63488 link 1; 10% x1 mask 63488 link 1 | 50         |
| 3399 | Thrymsgode    | W1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 20992 link 1                              | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Water 2, Death 1, Glamour 1, Blood 2, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Jotunheim capital and national sites

| ID  | Site       | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded         |
|-----|------------|----------------|---------------------------|
| 16  | Iron Woods | S1, D2, G1     | Jarnvidja, Ulfhedin       |
| 212 | Thrymsheim | W1             | Thrymsgode, Thrymshirding |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Jotunheim national spell map

| ID  | Spell                               | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-------------------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 491 | Summon Dwarf of the Four Directions | Conjuration 8 | A4 E3       | 62         |
| 494 | Seith Curse                         | Thaumaturgy 5 | D1 S1       | 3          |

| ID  | Spell                | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|----------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 495 | Summon Glosos        | Conjuration 3 | D2          | 13         |
| 496 | Brood of Garm        | Conjuration 4 | N2          | 10         |
| 497 | Awaken Jotun Draugar | Conjuration 4 | D2          | 15         |
| 498 | Summon Rimvaettir    | Conjuration 5 | W2          | 5          |
| 499 | Winter's Call        | Blood 6       | B3 W2       | 86         |
| 500 | Illwinter            | Blood 6       | B5 W3       | 120        |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Jotunheim national item boundary

| ID  | Item                   | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|-----|------------------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 33  | Duskdagger             | 3            | D1 S1 | rebate |
| 114 | The Sword of Aurgelmer | 9            | G6    | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Jotunheim hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record | Magic          | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 1382 | Abductor    | A3 W3 D3 H2    | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 586  | Great Hag   | S3 D3 N2 G3 B3 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 508  | Wolf Lord   | none           | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 3424 | Undying     | S2 D2 N3 G2 B1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Jotunheim army identities

- Sacred roster: Niefel Giant, Thrymshirding.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: giant infantry, sacred Jotuns, and Death-Nature magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Jotunheim opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Jotunheim fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Jotunheim, the most likely planning failure is high gold per body, low formation width, and replacement tempo. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Jotunheim research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Jotunheim magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Water 2, Death 1, Glamour 1, Blood 2, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Jotunheim battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

## Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

## Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

## Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Jotunheim Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Jotunheim matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Jotunheim monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Jotunheim unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Jotunheim source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part XLVI: Middle Age Nidavangr, Bear, Wolf and Crow

## Nidavangr one-page command brief

Middle Age Nidavangr converts Dwarven smiths, skinshifters, and terrain-linked recruitment into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 9 commander identities and 6 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 3 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are expensive specialists, transformation behaviour, and regional access.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.



## Nidavangr evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Nidavangr on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 81, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffc036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Nidavangr object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Nidavangr conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

- > provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes
- > labelled fixed and random path access
- > research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support
- > surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Nidavangr recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 7          | 5      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 6          | 4      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Nidavangr commander roster

| ID   | Commander                | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3672 | Crow Clan Scout          | none                                                                     | 0          |
| 3671 | Nidherse                 | none                                                                     | 75         |
| 3670 | Nidajarl                 | none                                                                     | 100        |
| 3830 | Seithberender Apprentice | none; random: 100% x1 mask 15872 link 1                                  | 10         |
| 3682 | Bear Clan Cub-Mother     | none                                                                     | 50         |
| 3679 | Bear Clan Seithberender  | E1 N2 H1                                                                 | 10         |
| 3680 | Wolf Clan Seithberender  | W2 N1 H1                                                                 | 10         |
| 3681 | Crow Clan Seithberender  | A1 S2 D2 H1; random: 100% x2 mask 39168 link 1; 10% x1 mask 39168 link 1 | 10         |
| 3685 | Nidhere                  | H1                                                                       | 50         |

## Nidavangr troop roster

| ID   | Unit              | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|-------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 3673 | Crow Clan Archer  | 11 | 0          | 11     | stealthy      |
| 3676 | Bear Clan Warrior | 14 | 0          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 3675 | Cub-Warrior       | 11 | 0          | 14     | ordinary body |
| 3674 | Wolf Clan Reaver  | 12 | 0          | 12     | stealthy      |
| 3678 | Nidylva           | 12 | 0          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 3677 | Nidbathed         | 15 | 0          | 18     | sacred        |

## Nidavangr mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander                | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3830 | Seithberender Apprentice | none; random: 100% x1 mask 15872 link 1                                  | 10         |
| 3679 | Bear Clan Seithberender  | E1 N2 H1                                                                 | 10         |
| 3680 | Wolf Clan Seithberender  | W2 N1 H1                                                                 | 10         |
| 3681 | Crow Clan Seithberender  | A1 S2 D2 H1; random: 100% x2 mask 39168 link 1; 10% x1 mask 39168 link 1 | 10         |
| 3685 | Nidhere                  | H1                                                                       | 50         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Air 1, Water 2, Earth 1, Astral 2, Death 2, Nature 2, Holy 1. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Nidavangr capital and national sites

| ID  | Site       | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                           |
|-----|------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------|
| 226 | Nidakettil | A1, S1, D3     | Crow Clan Seithberender, Nidhere, Nidbathed |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Nidavangr national spell map

| ID  | Spell                               | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-------------------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 491 | Summon Dwarf of the Four Directions | Conjuration 8 | A4 E3       | 62         |
| 494 | Seith Curse                         | Thaumaturgy 5 | D1 S1       | 3          |
| 503 | Command Draugar                     | Conjuration 4 | D2          | 12         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Nidavangr national item boundary

| ID  | Item                    | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|-----|-------------------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 460 | Soulstone of the Wolves | 9            | N6 E1 | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Nidavangr hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record     | Magic       | Boundary                           |
|------|-----------------|-------------|------------------------------------|
| 3881 | Seithmathr Bear | E2 N3 H1    | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 3883 | Seithmathr Wolf | W2 D3 N2 H1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 3885 | Seithmathr Crow | A2 S3 D4 H1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Nidavangr army identities

- Sacred roster: Nidbathed.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: Dwarven smiths, skinshifters, and terrain-linked recruitment.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Nidavangr opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Nidavangr fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Nidavangr, the most likely planning failure is expensive specialists, transformation behaviour, and regional access. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Nidavangr research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Nidavangr magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Air 1, Water 2, Earth 1, Astral 2, Death 2, Nature 2, Holy 1. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Nidavangr battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Nidavangr Pretender families

| Family              | What it can solve                                       | What it cannot conceal                                       |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required |

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Nidavangr matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Nidavangr monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Nidavangr unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Nidavangr source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part XLVII: Middle Age Ys, Morgen Queens

## Ys one-page command brief

Middle Age Ys converts amphibious Morgen nobility, sacred knights, and coastal mobility into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 10 commander identities and 9 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 2 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are land-sea transitions, glamour interactions, and elite replacement.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Ys evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Ys on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 85, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Ys object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Ys conversion chain

```
verified recruitment and national assets
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes
-> labelled fixed and random path access
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth
```

## Ys recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 4          | 5      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 3          | 3      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 3          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Ys commander roster

| ID   | Commander              | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2912 | Ysian Scout            | none                                                                     | 0          |
| 2913 | Ysian Commander        | none                                                                     | 75         |
| 2914 | Ysian Druid            | W1 E1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 11776 link 1                              | 10         |
| 2931 | Knight Commander of Ys | none                                                                     | 100        |
| 2900 | Kernou Chieftain       | none                                                                     | 75         |
| 2928 | Swanherd               | none                                                                     | 50         |
| 2901 | Kernou Druid           | E1 S1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 11776 link 1                              | 10         |
| 2917 | Morgen Champion        | W1 G1 H1                                                                 | 100        |
| 2919 | Morgen Princess        | W1 G2 H2                                                                 | 150        |
| 2921 | Morgen Sorceress       | W2 E1 G3 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 18048 link 1; 10% x1 mask 18048 link 1 | 50         |

## Ys troop roster

| ID   | Unit                 | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits             |
|------|----------------------|----|------------|--------|--------------------|
| 2907 | Ysian Militia        | 14 | 2          | 8      | amphibious         |
| 2908 | Ysian Spearman       | 14 | 2          | 10     | amphibious         |
| 2923 | Ysian Infantry       | 14 | 2          | 10     | amphibious         |
| 2909 | Ysian Man at Arms    | 15 | 2          | 11     | amphibious         |
| 2910 | Knight of Ys         | 16 | 2          | 13     | amphibious         |
| 2897 | Kernou Warrior       | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body      |
| 2898 | Kernou Noble Warrior | 12 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body      |
| 2899 | Kernou Cavalry       | 12 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body      |
| 2915 | Morvarc'h Knight     | 14 | 0          | 14     | sacred, amphibious |

## Ys mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander        | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2914 | Ysian Druid      | W1 E1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 11776 link 1                              | 10         |
| 2901 | Kernou Druid     | E1 S1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 11776 link 1                              | 10         |
| 2917 | Morgen Champion  | W1 G1 H1                                                                 | 100        |
| 2919 | Morgen Princess  | W1 G2 H2                                                                 | 150        |
| 2921 | Morgen Sorceress | W2 E1 G3 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 18048 link 1; 10% x1 mask 18048 link 1 | 50         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Water 2, Earth 1, Astral 1, Glamour 3, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Ys capital and national sites

| ID  | Site   | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                                                    |
|-----|--------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 185 | Ker-Ys | W1, E2, G2     | Morgen Champion, Morgen Princess, Morgen Sorceress, Morvarc'h Knight |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Ys national spell map

| ID   | Spell             | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|------|-------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 447  | Herd of Morvarc'h | Conjuration 4 | G2 W1       | 12         |
| 1294 | Geas              | Thaumaturgy 3 | G2          | 0          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Ys national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Ys hero boundary



| ID   | Hero record        | Magic          | Boundary                           |
|------|--------------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 2924 | Queen of the North | F3 W2 E2 G3 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2926 | Morgen Queen       | F1 W3 E2 G4 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Ys army identities

- Sacred roster: Morvarc'h Knight.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: Ysian Militia, Ysian Spearman, Ysian Infantry, Ysian Man at Arms, Knight of Ys, Morvarc'h Knight.
- Core identity: amphibious Morgen nobility, sacred knights, and coastal mobility.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Ys opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Ys fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Ys, the most likely planning failure is land-sea transitions, glamour interactions, and elite replacement. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Ys research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Ys magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Water 2, Earth 1, Astral 1, Glamour 3, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Ys battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Ys Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Ys matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Ys monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Ys unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Ys source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part XLVIII: Middle Age Pelagia, Triton Kings

## Pelagia one-page command brief

Middle Age Pelagia converts deep-water recruitment, Triton armies, and Water-Astral magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 16 commander identities and 10 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 2 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are aquatic geography, land projection, and commander coverage.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Pelagia evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Pelagia on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 86, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbc036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Pelagia object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Pelagia conversion chain

```
verified recruitment and national assets
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes
-> labelled fixed and random path access
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth
```

## Pelagia recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 11         | 6      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 3          | 2      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 3          | 2      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Pelagia commander roster

| ID   | Commander                     | Fixed and random magic                                          | Leadership |
|------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1050 | Merman Scout                  | none                                                            | 0          |
| 1052 | Wave Lord                     | none                                                            | 75         |
| 1069 | Pelagian Captain              | none                                                            | 75         |
| 2421 | Amber Clan Noble              | none                                                            | 100        |
| 1696 | Merman Priest                 | H1                                                              | 10         |
| 1415 | Pelagian Mermage              | W1; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1                            | 10         |
| 2823 | Pelagian Mystic               | A1 W1 E1; random: 100% x1 mask 3840 link 1                      | 10         |
| 1418 | Amber Clan Priest             | H1                                                              | 50         |
| 1417 | Amber Clan Mage               | F1 W2; random: 100% x1 mask 9728 link 1                         | 50         |
| 2422 | Pearl Clan Priest             | H2                                                              | 50         |
| 2423 | Pearl Mage                    | W2 S1; random: 100% x1 mask 11008 link 1                        | 10         |
| 2825 | Merman Commander              | none                                                            | 75         |
| 2867 | Daduchos                      | F1; random: 100% x1 mask 3840 link 1                            | 10         |
| 1061 | Triton Prince                 | none                                                            | 150        |
| 1088 | Triton King                   | W4; random: 100% x2 mask 10496 link 1; 10% x1 mask 11008 link 1 | 100        |
| 2865 | Conqueror of the Closed Realm | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 3328 link 1                            | 100        |

## Pelagia troop roster

| ID   | Unit                         | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits             |
|------|------------------------------|----|------------|--------|--------------------|
| 1046 | Merman                       | 10 | 1          | 10     | amphibious         |
| 1048 | Wave Warrior                 | 10 | 1          | 12     | amphibious         |
| 1056 | Pelagian Militia             | 12 | 1          | 9      | aquatic            |
| 1057 | Pelagian Soldier             | 15 | 1          | 11     | aquatic            |
| 2416 | Coral Clan Hoplite           | 16 | 1          | 12     | aquatic            |
| 1419 | Amber Clan Guard             | 16 | 1          | 13     | aquatic            |
| 2821 | Merman Hoplite               | 10 | 1          | 11     | amphibious         |
| 2869 | Apostate of the Closed Realm | 13 | 1          | 13     | amphibious         |
| 1059 | Knight of the Deep           | 16 | 1          | 14     | sacred, aquatic    |
| 2863 | Champion of the Closed Realm | 13 | 1          | 13     | sacred, amphibious |

## Pelagia mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander                     | Fixed and random magic                                          | Leadership |
|------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1696 | Merman Priest                 | H1                                                              | 10         |
| 1415 | Pelagian Mermage              | W1; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1                            | 10         |
| 2823 | Pelagian Mystic               | A1 W1 E1; random: 100% x1 mask 3840 link 1                      | 10         |
| 1418 | Amber Clan Priest             | H1                                                              | 50         |
| 1417 | Amber Clan Mage               | F1 W2; random: 100% x1 mask 9728 link 1                         | 50         |
| 2422 | Pearl Clan Priest             | H2                                                              | 50         |
| 2423 | Pearl Mage                    | W2 S1; random: 100% x1 mask 11008 link 1                        | 10         |
| 2867 | Daduchos                      | F1; random: 100% x1 mask 3840 link 1                            | 10         |
| 1088 | Triton King                   | W4; random: 100% x2 mask 10496 link 1; 10% x1 mask 11008 link 1 | 100        |
| 2865 | Conqueror of the Closed Realm | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 3328 link 1                            | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 1, Air 1, Water 4, Earth 1, Astral 1, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Pelagia capital and national sites

| ID  | Site             | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                                                                                            |
|-----|------------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 160 | Palace of Pearls | W4, N1         | Triton Prince, Triton King, Conqueror of the Closed Realm, Knight of the Deeps, Champion of the Closed Realm |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Pelagia national spell map

| ID  | Spell             | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 367 | Summon Hekateride | Conjuration 5 | N3 W1       | 30         |
| 368 | Summon Daktyl     | Conjuration 6 | E3 A1       | 30         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Pelagia national item boundary

| ID  | Item           | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|-----|----------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 329 | Clam of Pearls | 3            | W1 N1 | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Pelagia hero boundary

No fixed hero-slot identity was resolved from attributes 139-149. Hero arrival and timing remain unscheduled.

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Pelagia army identities

- Sacred roster: Knight of the Deeps, Champion of the Closed Realm.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: Merman, Wave Warrior, Pelagian Militia, Pelagian Soldier, Coral Clan Hoplite, Amber Clan Guard, Merman Hoplite, Apostate of the Closed Realm, Knight of the Deeps, Champion of the Closed Realm.
- Core identity: deep-water recruitment, Triton armies, and Water-Astral magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Pelagia opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Pelagia fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Pelagia, the most likely planning failure is aquatic geography, land projection, and commander coverage. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Pelagia research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.

- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Pelagia magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 1, Air 1, Water 4, Earth 1, Astral 1, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Pelagia battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Pelagia Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |



## Pelagia matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Pelagia monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Pelagia unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Pelagia source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part XLIX: Middle Age Oceania, Mermidons

## Oceania one-page command brief

Middle Age Oceania converts aquatic armies, Capricorns, and Water-Nature magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 8 commander identities and 12 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 1 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are sea expansion variance, land access, and mixed habitat limits.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Oceania evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Oceania on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 87, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Oceania object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Oceania conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Oceania recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 7          | 9      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 3          | 2      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 1          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Oceania commander roster

| ID   | Commander              | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2370 | Ichtysatyr Scout       | none                                                                | 0          |
| 2372 | Ichtysatyr Commander   | none                                                                | 50         |
| 2410 | Ichtycentaur Commander | none                                                                | 100        |
| 2392 | Aphroi Hierophant      | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 8704 link 1                                | 50         |
| 1054 | Siren                  | A1 W2 G2                                                            | 0          |
| 2861 | Haliade                | W2 N2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1; 10% x1 mask 9984 link 1 | 100        |
| 1038 | Capricorn              | W2 E1 N4; random: 100% x1 mask 1792 link 1; 10% x1 mask 9984 link 1 | 100        |
| 2399 | Aphroi Lord            | none                                                                | 100        |

## Oceania troop roster

| ID   | Unit                    | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits               |
|------|-------------------------|----|------------|--------|----------------------|
| 2404 | Ichtysatyr              | 12 | 2          | 8      | amphibious, stealthy |
| 2406 | Ichtysatyr              | 12 | 2          | 9      | amphibious, stealthy |
| 2408 | Ichtysatyr Soldier      | 12 | 2          | 9      | amphibious           |
| 1043 | Ichtysatyr Soldier      | 12 | 2          | 9      | amphibious           |
| 1045 | Mermidon                | 14 | 2          | 11     | amphibious           |
| 2412 | Ichtytaur               | 30 | 4          | 12     | amphibious           |
| 2414 | Ichtytaur Warrior       | 30 | 4          | 12     | amphibious           |
| 1408 | Ichtycentaur            | 20 | 4          | 12     | amphibious           |
| 1410 | Ichtycentaur Cataphract | 22 | 4          | 14     | amphibious           |
| 2376 | Ichtysatyr              | 12 | 2          | 9      | amphibious, stealthy |
| 2378 | Ichtysatyr Warrior      | 12 | 2          | 9      | amphibious           |
| 2401 | Aphroi                  | 24 | 4          | 14     | sacred, amphibious   |

## Oceania mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander         | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2392 | Aphroi Hierophant | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 8704 link 1                                | 50         |
| 1054 | Siren             | A1 W2 G2                                                            | 0          |
| 2861 | Haliade           | W2 N2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1; 10% x1 mask 9984 link 1 | 100        |
| 1038 | Capricorn         | W2 E1 N4; random: 100% x1 mask 1792 link 1; 10% x1 mask 9984 link 1 | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Air 1, Water 2, Earth 1, Nature 4, Glamour 2, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Oceania capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded   |
|-----|---------------------|----------------|---------------------|
| 162 | The Grove of Aphros | W1, N3, G1     | Aphroi Lord, Aphroi |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Oceania national spell map

| ID  | Spell         | School       | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|---------------|--------------|-------------|------------|
| 337 | Grow Fortress | Alteration 0 | N4          | 35         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Oceania national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Oceania hero boundary

No fixed hero-slot identity was resolved from attributes 139-149. Hero arrival and timing remain unscheduled.

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Oceania army identities

- Sacred roster: Aphroi.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: IchtySATyr, IchtySATyr, IchtySATyr Soldier, IchtySATyr Soldier, Mermidon, Ichtytaur, Ichtytaur Warrior, Ichtycentaur, Ichtycentaur Cataphract, IchtySATyr, IchtySATyr Warrior, Aphroi.
- Core identity: aquatic armies, Capricorns, and Water-Nature magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Oceania opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Oceania fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Oceania, the most likely planning failure is sea expansion variance, land access, and mixed habitat limits. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Oceania research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Oceania magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Air 1, Water 2, Earth 1, Nature 4, Glamour 2, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Oceania battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Oceania Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Oceania matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem          | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                  |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units     | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage     |
| Heavy armour           | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided     |
| Accurate missiles      | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards   |
| Elemental resistance   | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element |
| Fast raiders or flyers | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army              |

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                         | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Oceania monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Oceania unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Oceania source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbfc036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part L: Middle Age Atlantis, Kings of the Deep

## Atlantis one-page command brief

Middle Age Atlantis converts armoured amphibious troops and Water-Earth-Death magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 9 commander identities and 13 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 1 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are resource-heavy troops, cold-water geography, and land transition.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Atlantis evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age Atlantis on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 88, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbfc036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Atlantis object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Atlantis conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Atlantis recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 6          | 11     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 3          | 2      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 1          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Atlantis commander roster



| ID   | Commander            | Fixed and random magic                                        | Leadership |
|------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 432  | Scout                | none                                                          | 0          |
| 207  | Shambler Chief       | none                                                          | 75         |
| 441  | Consort              | H1                                                            | 100        |
| 112  | Coral Queen          | H3                                                            | 200        |
| 322  | King of the Deep     | W3; random: 100% x1 mask 3712 link 2; 10% x1 mask 3712 link 1 | 50         |
| 3096 | Mage of the Deep     | W2; random: 100% x1 mask 3712 link 1                          | 10         |
| 102  | Initiate of the Deep | W1                                                            | 10         |
| 2859 | Witness of the Deep  | W2 S1                                                         | 10         |
| 104  | Deep Seer            | W3 S2 H1                                                      | 50         |

## Atlantis troop roster

| ID   | Unit                     | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits             |
|------|--------------------------|----|------------|--------|--------------------|
| 110  | Atlantian Militia        | 12 | 2          | 8      | amphibious         |
| 111  | Atlantian Shield Bearer  | 12 | 2          | 10     | amphibious         |
| 107  | Atlantian Light Infantry | 12 | 2          | 10     | amphibious         |
| 1621 | Atlantian Infantry       | 12 | 2          | 10     | amphibious         |
| 1620 | Reef Warrior             | 13 | 2          | 12     | amphibious         |
| 108  | Coral Guard              | 14 | 2          | 13     | amphibious         |
| 1622 | Coral Guard              | 14 | 2          | 13     | amphibious         |
| 206  | Shambler                 | 22 | 6          | 11     | amphibious         |
| 2862 | Shambler Guard           | 22 | 6          | 12     | amphibious         |
| 208  | War Shambler             | 23 | 6          | 13     | amphibious         |
| 211  | Lobster Rider            | 13 | 2          | 11     | amphibious         |
| 2860 | Soldier of the Deep      | 10 | 0          | 12     | poor amphibian     |
| 209  | Mother Guard             | 25 | 6          | 14     | sacred, amphibious |

## Atlantis mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander            | Fixed and random magic                                        | Leadership |
|------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 441  | Consort              | H1                                                            | 100        |
| 112  | Coral Queen          | H3                                                            | 200        |
| 322  | King of the Deep     | W3; random: 100% x1 mask 3712 link 2; 10% x1 mask 3712 link 1 | 50         |
| 3096 | Mage of the Deep     | W2; random: 100% x1 mask 3712 link 1                          | 10         |
| 102  | Initiate of the Deep | W1                                                            | 10         |
| 2859 | Witness of the Deep  | W2 S1                                                         | 10         |
| 104  | Deep Seer            | W3 S2 H1                                                      | 50         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Water 3, Astral 2, Holy 3. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Atlantis capital and national sites

| ID | Site             | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded       |
|----|------------------|----------------|-------------------------|
| 2  | The Coral Towers | W5             | Deep Seer, Mother Guard |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Atlantis national spell map

| ID  | Spell               | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|---------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 370 | Summon Monster Fish | Conjuration 6 | W3          | 6          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Atlantis national item boundary

| ID  | Item            | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|-----|-----------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 18  | Coral Blade     | 3            | W1    | rebate |
| 443 | Orb of Atlantis | 9            | W4 E1 | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Atlantis hero boundary

| ID  | Hero record  | Magic | Boundary                           |
|-----|--------------|-------|------------------------------------|
| 373 | Coral Prince | W1 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 558 | Seer King    | W4 S3 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Atlantis army identities

- Sacred roster: Mother Guard.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.

- Aquatic or amphibious roster: Atlantian Militia, Atlantian Shield Bearer, Atlantian Light Infantry, Atlantian Infantry, Reef Warrior, Coral Guard, Coral Guard, Shambler, Shambler Guard, War Shambler, Lobster Rider, Soldier of the Deep, Mother Guard.
- Core identity: armoured amphibious troops and Water-Earth-Death magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Atlantis opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Atlantis fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Atlantis, the most likely planning failure is resource-heavy troops, cold-water geography, and land transition. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Atlantis research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Atlantis magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Water 3, Astral 2, Holy 3. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Atlantis battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Atlantis Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Atlantis matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem        | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                  |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units   | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage     |
| Heavy armour         | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided     |
| Accurate missiles    | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards   |
| Elemental resistance | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element |

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                         | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves  | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Atlantis monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Atlantis unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Atlantis source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LI: Middle Age R'Iyeh, Fallen Star

## R'Iyeh one-page command brief

Middle Age R'Iyeh converts mind control, aquatic slave troops, and powerful Astral magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 8 commander identities and 13 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 0 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are slave morale, magic leadership, land access, and friendly-fire risk.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## R'Iyeh evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Middle Age R'Iyeh on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 89, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any R'Iyeh object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## R'Iyeh conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## R'Iyeh recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 7          | 13     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 1          | 0      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## R'Iyeh commander roster

| ID   | Commander      | Fixed and random magic                                             | Leadership |
|------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 432  | Scout          | none                                                               | 0          |
| 444  | Traitor Prince | none                                                               | 100        |
| 1527 | Slave Priest   | H1                                                                 | 10         |
| 1518 | Slave Mage     | W2 S1; random: 100% x1 mask 11776 link 1                           | 10         |
| 445  | Illithid Lord  | none                                                               | 50         |
| 443  | Star Child     | S1                                                                 | 0          |
| 333  | Starspawn      | W1 S2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 19968 link 1                        | 10         |
| 332  | Starspawn      | W1 S3; random: 100% x2 mask 19968 link 1; 10% x1 mask 19968 link 1 | 10         |

## R'lyeh troop roster

| ID   | Unit             | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits                  |
|------|------------------|----|------------|--------|-------------------------|
| 1517 | Slave Trooper    | 15 | 1          | 7      | aquatic                 |
| 1526 | Slave Guardian   | 15 | 1          | 7      | aquatic                 |
| 1515 | Slave Trooper    | 10 | 1          | 7      | amphibious              |
| 1524 | Slave Guardian   | 10 | 1          | 7      | amphibious              |
| 335  | Slave Trooper    | 12 | 2          | 7      | amphibious              |
| 1619 | Slave Guardian   | 12 | 2          | 7      | amphibious              |
| 336  | Slave Guardian   | 12 | 2          | 7      | amphibious              |
| 337  | Lobo Guard       | 13 | 2          | 50     | magic being, amphibious |
| 424  | Meteorite Guard  | 14 | 2          | 12     | amphibious              |
| 425  | Shambler Thrall  | 24 | 7          | 50     | magic being, amphibious |
| 243  | Crab Hybrid      | 25 | 14         | 14     | aquatic                 |
| 331  | Illithid         | 28 | 5          | 10     | magic being, amphibious |
| 407  | Illithid Soldier | 28 | 5          | 10     | magic being, amphibious |

## R'lyeh mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander    | Fixed and random magic                                             | Leadership |
|------|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1527 | Slave Priest | H1                                                                 | 10         |
| 1518 | Slave Mage   | W2 S1; random: 100% x1 mask 11776 link 1                           | 10         |
| 443  | Star Child   | S1                                                                 | 0          |
| 333  | Starspawn    | W1 S2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 19968 link 1                        | 10         |
| 332  | Starspawn    | W1 S3; random: 100% x2 mask 19968 link 1; 10% x1 mask 19968 link 1 | 10         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Water 2, Astral 3, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## R'Iyeh capital and national sites

| ID | Site            | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded               |
|----|-----------------|----------------|---------------------------------|
| 17 | The Sunken City | W2, S3         | none in explicit recruit fields |
| 45 | The Void Gate   | no gem field   | Starspawn                       |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## R'Iyeh national spell map

No active nation-restricted spell row was found for this nation in the pinned snapshot. Absence here is a metadata boundary, not proof that no shared or special spell exists.

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## R'Iyeh national item boundary

| ID  | Item                     | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|--------------------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 134 | Anemone Mace             | 3            | W1    | restricted |
| 137 | Jellyberd                | 7            | S1 F1 | restricted |
| 248 | Armor of Meteoritic Iron | 5            | E1 S1 | rebate     |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## R'Iyeh hero boundary

| ID  | Hero record  | Magic       | Boundary                           |
|-----|--------------|-------------|------------------------------------|
| 560 | Stargazer    | W2 S5 G1 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 660 | Aboleth      | W3 S4 G2    | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 622 | Traitor King | W5          | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## R'Iyeh army identities

- Sacred roster: no sacred troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: Slave Trooper, Slave Guardian, Slave Trooper, Slave Guardian, Slave Trooper, Slave Guardian, Slave Guardian, Lobo Guard, Meteorite Guard, Shambler Thrall, Crab Hybrid, Illithid, Illithid Soldier.
- Core identity: mind control, aquatic slave troops, and powerful Astral magic.



These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## R'Iyeh opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## R'Iyeh fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For R'Iyeh, the most likely planning failure is slave morale, magic leadership, land access, and friendly-fire risk. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## R'Iyeh research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## R'Iyeh magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Water 2, Astral 3, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## R'Iyeh battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## R'Iyeh Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## R'Iyeh matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem          | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                  |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units     | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage     |
| Heavy armour           | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided     |
| Accurate missiles      | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards   |
| Elemental resistance   | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element |
| Fast raiders or flyers | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army              |

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                         | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## R'Iyeh monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## R'Iyeh unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## R'Iyeh source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbfc036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LII: Early Age Arcoscephale, Golden Era

## Early Age Arcoscephale one-page command brief

Early Age Arcoscephale converts bronze-age combined arms, gifted philosophers, Mystics, Icarids, and sacred Pegasus Riders into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 12 commander identities and 8 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 8 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are capital pressure, expensive specialists, random-path dependence, and keeping research aligned with field support.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Arcoscephale evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Arcoscephale on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 5, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Arcoscephale object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Arcoscephale conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Arcoscephale recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 8          | 7      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 1          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 4          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Arcoscephale commander roster

| ID   | Commander            | Fixed and random magic                                                                                        | Leadership |
|------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 431  | Scout                | none                                                                                                          | 0          |
| 1076 | Myrmidon Champion    | none                                                                                                          | 100        |
| 1081 | Charioteer Commander | none                                                                                                          | 75         |
| 3197 | Melissa              | N1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 8448 link 1                                                                       | 10         |
| 1083 | Icarid Champion      | none                                                                                                          | 75         |
| 1071 | Sceptic              | none                                                                                                          | 10         |
| 311  | Mystic               | S1; random: 100% x1 mask 3712 link 1; 50% x1 mask 128 link 1; 50% x1 mask 512 link 1; 50% x1 mask 1024 link 1 | 10         |
| 1072 | Engineer             | none                                                                                                          | 10         |
| 1070 | Philosopher          | none                                                                                                          | 10         |
| 1606 | Mage Engineer        | A1 E1; random: 100% x1 mask 3968 link 1                                                                       | 10         |
| 1650 | Oreiad               | A2 E1 N3; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1; 10% x1 mask 9984 link 1                                           | 10         |
| 1075 | Wind Lord            | H1                                                                                                            | 100        |

## Early Age Arcoscephale troop roster

| ID   | Unit       | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 50   | Slinger    | 10 | 0          | 7      | ordinary body |
| 201  | Peltast    | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 199  | Cardaces   | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 1077 | Myrmidon   | 13 | 0          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 1079 | Charioteer | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 1078 | Charioteer | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 1082 | Icarid     | 12 | 0          | 13     | flying        |
| 1074 | Wind Rider | 13 | 0          | 14     | sacred        |

## Early Age Arcoscephale mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander     | Fixed and random magic                                                                                        | Leadership |
|------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3197 | Melissa       | N1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 8448 link 1                                                                       | 10         |
| 311  | Mystic        | S1; random: 100% x1 mask 3712 link 1; 50% x1 mask 128 link 1; 50% x1 mask 512 link 1; 50% x1 mask 1024 link 1 | 10         |
| 1606 | Mage Engineer | A1 E1; random: 100% x1 mask 3968 link 1                                                                       | 10         |
| 1650 | Oreiad        | A2 E1 N3; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1; 10% x1 mask 9984 link 1                                           | 10         |
| 1075 | Wind Lord     | H1                                                                                                            | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Air 2, Earth 1, Astral 1, Nature 3, Holy 1. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Arcoscephale capital and national sites

| ID | Site           | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded             |
|----|----------------|----------------|-------------------------------|
| 75 | Akademeia      | no gem field   | Philosopher                   |
| 74 | Lykeion        | E2             | Mage Engineer                 |
| 73 | Mount Cephalos | A2, S2         | Oreiad, Wind Lord, Wind Rider |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Arcoscephale national spell map

| ID  | Spell                        | School         | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|------------------------------|----------------|-------------|------------|
| 253 | Monster Boar                 | Conjuration 5  | N3          | 10         |
| 254 | Summon Hound of Twilight     | Conjuration 5  | E2 D1       | 3          |
| 255 | Sow Dragon Teeth             | Enchantment 6  | E2          | 1          |
| 256 | Bind Keres                   | Conjuration 6  | D2          | 12         |
| 269 | Craft Keledone               | Construction 6 | E2 S2       | 5          |
| 270 | Forge Brass Bull             | Construction 6 | F3 E3       | 25         |
| 274 | Awaken Hamadryad             | Enchantment 5  | N4          | 25         |
| 369 | Procession of the Underworld | Conjuration 5  | D3          | 13         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Arcoscephale national item boundary

| ID  | Item              | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|-----|-------------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 261 | Stymphalian Wings | 7            | E4    | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Arcoscephale hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record         | Magic       | Boundary                           |
|------|---------------------|-------------|------------------------------------|
| 954  | Son of Titans       | none        | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1073 | Maker of the Maze   | F1 A1 W1 E3 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1089 | Monster in the Maze | none        | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Arcoscephale army identities

- Sacred roster: Wind Rider.
- Flying roster: Icarid.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: bronze-age combined arms, gifted philosophers, Mystics, Icarids, and sacred Pegasus Riders.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Arcoscephale opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Arcoscephale fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Arcoscephale, the most likely planning failure is capital pressure, expensive specialists, random-path dependence, and keeping research aligned with field support. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Arcoscephale research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Arcoscephale magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Air 2, Earth 1, Astral 1, Nature 3, Holy 1. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

# Early Age Arcoscephale battlefield packages

## Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

## Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

## Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

## Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

# Early Age Arcoscephale Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

# Early Age Arcoscephale matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem        | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                  |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units   | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage     |
| Heavy armour         | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided     |
| Accurate missiles    | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards   |
| Elemental resistance | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element |



| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                         | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves  | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Arcoscephale monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Arcoscephale unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Arcoscephale source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LIII: Early Age Mekone, Brazen Giants

## Early Age Mekone one-page command brief

Early Age Mekone converts a small core of Exalted Gigantes and Cyclope smiths supported by numerous human helots into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 9 commander identities and 7 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 7 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are giant replacement speed, unrest and administration, gold concentration, and the gap between elite and slave troops.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Mekone evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Mekone on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 6, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Mekone object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Mekone conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Mekone recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 6          | 7      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 3          | 0      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Mekone commander roster

| ID   | Commander           | Fixed and random magic                                                 | Leadership |
|------|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3107 | Perioeci Scout      | none                                                                   | 0          |
| 3108 | Neodamode Commander | none                                                                   | 75         |
| 3111 | Lochos              | none                                                                   | 100        |
| 3114 | Geronte             | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1152 link 1                                   | 50         |
| 3115 | Ephor               | F1 E1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1408 link 1                             | 50         |
| 3116 | Archon              | F1 E1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1408 link 2                             | 50         |
| 3112 | Polemarch           | F2 E2                                                                  | 150        |
| 3117 | Basileus            | F2 W1 E2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 1; 10% x1 mask 1920 link 1 | 100        |
| 3118 | Elder Cyclops       | F2 A1 E2; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 1; 10% x1 mask 1920 link 1    | 50         |

## Early Age Mekone troop roster

| ID   | Unit             | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 3100 | Perioeci Peltast | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 3101 | Helote Peltast   | 10 | 0          | 7      | ordinary body |
| 3103 | Helote Ekdromos  | 10 | 0          | 7      | ordinary body |
| 3105 | Helote Hoplite   | 10 | 0          | 7      | ordinary body |
| 3109 | Gigante Ekdromos | 30 | 3          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 3110 | Gigante Hoplite  | 30 | 3          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 3120 | Discobolus       | 32 | 3          | 11     | ordinary body |

## Early Age Mekone mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander     | Fixed and random magic                                                 | Leadership |
|------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3114 | Geronte       | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1152 link 1                                   | 50         |
| 3115 | Ephor         | F1 E1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1408 link 1                             | 50         |
| 3116 | Archon        | F1 E1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1408 link 2                             | 50         |
| 3112 | Polemarch     | F2 E2                                                                  | 150        |
| 3117 | Basileus      | F2 W1 E2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 1; 10% x1 mask 1920 link 1 | 100        |
| 3118 | Elder Cyclops | F2 A1 E2; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 1; 10% x1 mask 1920 link 1    | 50         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 2, Air 1, Water 1, Earth 2, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Mekone capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                    | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded   |
|-----|-------------------------|----------------|---------------------|
| 194 | City of Gold and Marble | A1, E1         | Polemarch, Basileus |
| 195 | Forge of the Cyclopes   | F2, E2         | Elder Cyclops       |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Mekone national spell map

| ID  | Spell                        | School         | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|------------------------------|----------------|-------------|------------|
| 254 | Summon Hound of Twilight     | Conjuration 5  | E2 D1       | 3          |
| 255 | Sow Dragon Teeth             | Enchantment 6  | E2          | 1          |
| 256 | Bind Keres                   | Conjuration 6  | D2          | 12         |
| 263 | Blessing of the God-slayer   | Enchantment 0  | W1 H1       | 5          |
| 264 | Gigantomachia                | Thaumaturgy 7  | E4 F4       | 60         |
| 270 | Forge Brass Bull             | Construction 6 | F3 E3       | 25         |
| 369 | Procession of the Underworld | Conjuration 5  | D3          | 13         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Mekone national item boundary

| ID  | Item             | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|------------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 133 | God-Slayer Spear | 3            | E1    | restricted |
| 172 | Golden Hoplon    | 5            | F2    | rebate     |
| 249 | Elemental Armor  | 5            | E2 F1 | rebate     |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Mekone hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record     | Magic    | Boundary                           |
|------|-----------------|----------|------------------------------------|
| 3122 | King of Pallene | F2 E3 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Mekone army identities

- Sacred roster: no sacred troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: a small core of Exalted Gigantes and Cyclope smiths supported by numerous human helots.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Mekone opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Mekone fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Mekone, the most likely planning failure is giant replacement speed, unrest and administration, gold concentration, and the gap between elite and slave troops. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Mekone research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Mekone magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 2, Air 1, Water 1, Earth 2, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Mekone battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Mekone Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Mekone matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem        | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                  |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units   | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage     |
| Heavy armour         | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided     |
| Accurate missiles    | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards   |
| Elemental resistance | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element |

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                         | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves  | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Mekone monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Mekone unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Mekone source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LIV: Early Age Pangaea, Age of Revelry

## Early Age Pangaea one-page command brief

Early Age Pangaea converts forest recruitment, plentiful revelers, centaurs and minotaurs, and strong Nature magic from the Panii into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 8 commander identities and 12 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 6 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are undisciplined troops, forest dependence, supply, blood-hunting opportunity cost, and protecting expensive mages.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Pangaea evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Pangaea on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 7, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Pangaea object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Pangaea conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
-> labelled fixed and random path access  
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Pangaea recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 8          | 11     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 0          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.



## Early Age Pangaea commander roster

| ID   | Commander                | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 430  | Black Harpy              | none                                                                  | 10         |
| 2485 | Satyr Commander          | none                                                                  | 50         |
| 1534 | Minotaur Lord            | none                                                                  | 75         |
| 2158 | Centauride Hierophantide | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 8704 link 1                                  | 50         |
| 231  | Centaur Hierophant       | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 9216 link 1                                  | 50         |
| 2187 | Dryad                    | N1 G1 H2                                                              | 50         |
| 2487 | Dryad Mother             | N2 G1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 17920 link 1; 10% x1 mask 26112 link 1 | 50         |
| 1535 | Pan                      | E1 N4 B1; random: 100% x1 mask 33792 link 1; 10% x1 mask 41984 link 1 | 100        |

## Early Age Pangaea troop roster

| ID   | Unit               | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits           |
|------|--------------------|----|------------|--------|------------------|
| 239  | Harpy              | 7  | 0          | 8      | flying, stealthy |
| 227  | Satyr Sneak        | 12 | 1          | 9      | stealthy         |
| 228  | Satyr              | 12 | 1          | 9      | stealthy         |
| 1532 | Satyr Warrior      | 14 | 1          | 10     | ordinary body    |
| 708  | Reveler            | 15 | 2          | 12     | stealthy         |
| 234  | Minotaur           | 25 | 4          | 13     | ordinary body    |
| 1533 | Minotaur Warrior   | 27 | 4          | 14     | ordinary body    |
| 2156 | Centauride         | 18 | 3          | 11     | stealthy         |
| 27   | Centaur            | 20 | 3          | 11     | stealthy         |
| 2157 | Centauride Warrior | 18 | 3          | 12     | stealthy         |
| 1704 | Centaur Warrior    | 22 | 3          | 12     | stealthy         |
| 769  | White Centaur      | 23 | 3          | 12     | sacred, stealthy |

## Early Age Pangaea mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander                | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2158 | Centauride Hierophantide | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 8704 link 1                                  | 50         |
| 231  | Centaur Hierophant       | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 9216 link 1                                  | 50         |
| 2187 | Dryad                    | N1 G1 H2                                                              | 50         |
| 2487 | Dryad Mother             | N2 G1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 17920 link 1; 10% x1 mask 26112 link 1 | 50         |
| 1535 | Pan                      | E1 N4 B1; random: 100% x1 mask 33792 link 1; 10% x1 mask 41984 link 1 | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Earth 1, Nature 4, Glamour 1, Blood 1, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll

behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Pangaea capital and national sites

| ID  | Site              | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded |
|-----|-------------------|----------------|-------------------|
| 118 | The Grove of Gaia | N6             | White Centaur     |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Pangaea national spell map

| ID  | Spell                 | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-----------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 253 | Monster Boar          | Conjuration 5 | N3          | 10         |
| 274 | Awaken Hamadryad      | Enchantment 5 | N4          | 25         |
| 337 | Grow Fortress         | Alteration 0  | N4          | 35         |
| 424 | Tune of Fear          | Enchantment 0 | N1          | 0          |
| 425 | Tune of Growth        | Enchantment 0 | N1          | 0          |
| 426 | Tune of Dancing Death | Enchantment 0 | N1          | 0          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Pangaea national item boundary

| ID | Item        | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|----|-------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 38 | Thorn Spear | 3            | N1    | rebate |
| 39 | Thorn Staff | 3            | N1    | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Pangaea hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record    | Magic          | Boundary                           |
|------|----------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 540  | White Minotaur | H2             | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 614  | Harpy Queen    | A2 N2          | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2246 | Blessed Couple | W1 E1 D1 N3 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Pangaea army identities

- Sacred roster: White Centaur.
- Flying roster: Harpy.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: forest recruitment, plentiful revelers, centaurs and minotaurs, and strong Nature magic from the Panii.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Pangaea opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Pangaea fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Pangaea, the most likely planning failure is undisciplined troops, forest dependence, supply, blood-hunting opportunity cost, and protecting expensive mages. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Pangaea research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Pangaea magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Earth 1, Nature 4, Glamour 1, Blood 1, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Pangaea battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Pangaea Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Pangaea matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem        | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                  |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units   | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage     |
| Heavy armour         | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided     |
| Accurate missiles    | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards   |
| Elemental resistance | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element |

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                         | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves  | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Pangaea monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Pangaea unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Pangaea source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LV: Early Age Ermor, New Faith

## Early Age Ermor one-page command brief

Early Age Ermor converts disciplined legionnaires, lizard auxiliaries, Augurs, and a powerful priesthood divided between old and new religious traditions into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 12 commander identities and 13 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 1 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are mage and priest turn pressure, communion safety, capital recruitment, and keeping the army supplied as it expands.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Ermor evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Ermor on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 8, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Ermor object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Ermor conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Ermor recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 8          | 12     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 2          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Ermor commander roster

| ID   | Commander                        | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 426  | Scout                            | none                                                                | 0          |
| 428  | Assassin                         | none                                                                | 0          |
| 671  | Centurion                        | none                                                                | 100        |
| 1386 | Legatus Legionis                 | none                                                                | 150        |
| 1112 | Bishop of the Sacred Shroud      | H2                                                                  | 10         |
| 1113 | Acolyte                          | H1                                                                  | 10         |
| 1114 | Augur                            | F1 S1                                                               | 10         |
| 1115 | Augur Elder                      | F2 S1 D2; random: 100% x1 mask 6528 link 1; 10% x1 mask 6528 link 1 | 10         |
| 1109 | Flamen                           | F1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 10112 link 1                            | 0          |
| 1110 | Pontifex                         | F1 H2                                                               | 50         |
| 3691 | Praefectus Equitum               | H1                                                                  | 100        |
| 1111 | Arch Bishop of the Sacred Shroud | H3                                                                  | 10         |

## Early Age Ermor troop roster

| ID   | Unit                        | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|-----------------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 50   | Slinger                     | 10 | 0          | 7      | ordinary body |
| 1100 | Leve                        | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 1101 | Accensus                    | 10 | 0          | 8      | ordinary body |
| 1102 | Rorarus                     | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 1103 | Hastatus                    | 10 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 1104 | Principe                    | 11 | 0          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1105 | Triarius                    | 12 | 0          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 2    | Standard                    | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 1106 | Lizard Auxiliare            | 11 | 5          | 9      | ordinary body |
| 1107 | Equite                      | 10 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 11   | Retiarius                   | 12 | 0          | 14     | ordinary body |
| 12   | Gladiator                   | 12 | 0          | 14     | ordinary body |
| 1108 | Equite of the Sacred Shroud | 13 | 0          | 13     | sacred        |

## Early Age Ermor mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander                   | Fixed and random magic | Leadership |
|------|-----------------------------|------------------------|------------|
| 1112 | Bishop of the Sacred Shroud | H2                     | 10         |
| 1113 | Acolyte                     | H1                     | 10         |
| 1114 | Augur                       | F1 S1                  | 10         |

| ID   | Commander                        | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1115 | Augur Elder                      | F2 S1 D2; random: 100% x1 mask 6528 link 1; 10% x1 mask 6528 link 1 | 10         |
| 1109 | Flamen                           | F1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 10112 link 1                            | 0          |
| 1110 | Pontifex                         | F1 H2                                                               | 50         |
| 3691 | Praefectus Equitum               | H1                                                                  | 100        |
| 1111 | Arch Bishop of the Sacred Shroud | H3                                                                  | 10         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 2, Astral 1, Death 2, Holy 3. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Ermor capital and national sites

| ID | Site                 | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                                                                 |
|----|----------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 77 | Temple of the Shroud | F3, S3         | Praefectus Equitum, Arch Bishop of the Sacred Shroud, Equite of the Sacred Shroud |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Ermor national spell map

| ID  | Spell       | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 275 | Contact Lar | Conjuration 5 | N1          | 16         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Ermor national item boundary

| ID  | Item                       | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|-----|----------------------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 252 | Shroud of the Battle Saint | 5            | S1    | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Ermor hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record      | Magic    | Boundary                           |
|------|------------------|----------|------------------------------------|
| 1586 | Pontifex Maximus | F2 S2 H3 | assignment only; timing unresolved |



| ID   | Hero record | Magic | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------|-------|------------------------------------|
| 1587 | Primate     | H4    | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 3123 | Gladiatrix  | none  | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Ermor army identities

- Sacred roster: Equite of the Sacred Shroud.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: disciplined legionnaires, lizard auxiliaries, Augurs, and a powerful priesthood divided between old and new religious traditions.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Ermor opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Ermor fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Ermor, the most likely planning failure is mage and priest turn pressure, communion safety, capital recruitment, and keeping the army supplied as it expands. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Ermor research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Ermor magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 2, Astral 1, Death 2, Holy 3. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Ermor battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Ermor Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Ermor matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Ermor monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Ermor unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Ermor source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LVI: Early Age Sauromatia, Amazon Queens

## Early Age Sauromatia one-page command brief

Early Age Sauromatia converts mobile tribal armies, Amazon commanders, serpent and lizard riders, hydras, and Death-Nature-Blood magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 12 commander identities and 12 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 4 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are light protection, poison exposure, blood-hunting costs, and coordinating several distinct troop families.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Sauromatia evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Sauromatia on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 9, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Sauromatia object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Sauromatia conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Sauromatia recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 9          | 7      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 3          | 5      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Sauromatia commander roster

| ID   | Commander             | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 426  | Scout                 | none                                                                  | 0          |
| 1169 | Chieftain             | none                                                                  | 50         |
| 1173 | Sauromatian Manflayer | none                                                                  | 100        |
| 1174 | Warrior Priestess     | H1                                                                    | 100        |
| 1175 | Warrior Queen         | none                                                                  | 150        |
| 1188 | Soothsayer            | none; random: 90% x1 mask 2048 link 1                                 | 10         |
| 1180 | Spirit Guide          | D1                                                                    | 10         |
| 1181 | Enarie                | S1 D2 N1                                                              | 10         |
| 1186 | Warrior Sorceress     | N1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 45568 link 1                              | 100        |
| 1177 | Manflayer             | none                                                                  | 100        |
| 1178 | Witch King            | D3 N1 B1; random: 100% x1 mask 45568 link 1; 10% x1 mask 45568 link 1 | 150        |
| 3660 | Hydra Tamer           | none                                                                  | 10         |

## Early Age Sauromatia troop roster

| ID   | Unit                   | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|------------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 1184 | Sauromatian Archer     | 11 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 1669 | Sauromatian Amazon     | 10 | 0          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1168 | Raider                 | 11 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 1167 | Lancer                 | 11 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 1171 | Sauromatian Raider     | 11 | 0          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1170 | Sauromatian Lancer     | 11 | 0          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1172 | Sauromatian Cataphract | 11 | 0          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1183 | Androphag Archer       | 11 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 1176 | Androphag              | 13 | 0          | 13     | sacred        |
| 1185 | Oiorpata               | 11 | 0          | 13     | sacred        |
| 1831 | Hydra                  | 80 | 8          | 15     | ordinary body |
| 1840 | Hydra Hatchling        | 25 | 4          | 11     | ordinary body |

## Early Age Sauromatia mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander         | Fixed and random magic                | Leadership |
|------|-------------------|---------------------------------------|------------|
| 1174 | Warrior Priestess | H1                                    | 100        |
| 1188 | Soothsayer        | none; random: 90% x1 mask 2048 link 1 | 10         |

| ID   | Commander         | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1180 | Spirit Guide      | D1                                                                    | 10         |
| 1181 | Enarie            | S1 D2 N1                                                              | 10         |
| 1186 | Warrior Sorceress | N1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 45568 link 1                              | 100        |
| 1178 | Witch King        | D3 N1 B1; random: 100% x1 mask 45568 link 1; 10% x1 mask 45568 link 1 | 150        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Astral 1, Death 3, Nature 1, Blood 1, Holy 1. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Sauromatia capital and national sites

| ID  | Site               | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                                  |
|-----|--------------------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| 84  | The Great Cauldron | B2             | Manflayer, Witch King, Androphag Archer, Androphag |
| 85  | The Bitter Stream  | W1, D3         | Oiorpata                                           |
| 125 | The Enchanted Isle | N1             | none in explicit recruit fields                    |
| 57  | Swamps of Pythia   | no gem field   | Hydra Tamer, Hydra, Hydra Hatchling                |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Sauromatia national spell map

| ID  | Spell                  | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 272 | Daughter of Typhon     | Conjuration 8 | N5 D2       | 30         |
| 280 | Awaken Tattoos         | Enchantment 3 | N1 H1       | 0          |
| 534 | Call Ancestor          | Conjuration 1 | D1          | 0          |
| 535 | Wrath of the Ancestors | Conjuration 7 | D1          | 1          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Sauromatia national item boundary

| ID  | Item             | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|-----|------------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 269 | Hydra Skin Armor | 7            | N2    | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Sauromatia hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record            | Magic       | Boundary                           |
|------|------------------------|-------------|------------------------------------|
| 1228 | Pharmakeia             | S2 D4 N4 G2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1589 | Man Eater              | D4 N1 B3    | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1795 | Partholonian Sorceress | W2 D4 G3    | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Sauromatia army identities

- Sacred roster: Androphag, Oiorpata.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: mobile tribal armies, Amazon commanders, serpent and lizard riders, hydras, and Death-Nature-Blood magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Sauromatia opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Sauromatia fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Sauromatia, the most likely planning failure is light protection, poison exposure, blood-hunting costs, and coordinating several distinct troop families. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Sauromatia research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.

- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Sauromatia magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Astral 1, Death 3, Nature 1, Blood 1, Holy 1. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Sauromatia battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Sauromatia Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |



## Early Age Sauromatia matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Sauromatia monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Sauromatia unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Sauromatia source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LVII: Early Age Fomoria, The Cursed Ones

## Early Age Fomoria one-page command brief

Early Age Fomoria converts Fomorian giants, Fir Bolg infantry, Nemedian specialists, sailing, and strong Air-Death magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 10 commander identities and 11 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 6 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are expensive giant replacement, afflictions, storm planning, and maintaining enough ordinary bodies.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Fomoria evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Fomoria on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 10, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Fomoria object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Fomoria conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Fomoria recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 7          | 8      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 3          | 3      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Fomoria commander roster

| ID   | Commander          | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1811 | Fir Bolg Scout     | none                                                                  | 0          |
| 1815 | Fir Bolg Champion  | none                                                                  | 75         |
| 2469 | Fir Bolg Druid     | A1; random: 100% x1 mask 26112 link 1                                 | 10         |
| 1816 | Fomorian Scout     | none                                                                  | 0          |
| 1800 | Fomorian Champion  | none                                                                  | 75         |
| 1818 | Unmarked Champion  | H1                                                                    | 100        |
| 1819 | Fomorian Druid     | A2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 29184 link 1                              | 10         |
| 1802 | Fomorian King      | A3 D2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 21248 link 1; 10% x1 mask 21248 link 1 | 150        |
| 1791 | Nemedian Champion  | D1 G1 H1                                                              | 100        |
| 1792 | Nemedian Sorceress | A1 D2 G2; random: 100% x1 mask 29440 link 1; 10% x1 mask 29440 link 1 | 10         |

## Early Age Fomoria troop roster

| ID   | Unit                | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits             |
|------|---------------------|----|------------|--------|--------------------|
| 1820 | Fir Bolg Militia    | 13 | 0          | 9      | ordinary body      |
| 1814 | Fir Bolg Slinger    | 13 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body      |
| 1812 | Fir Bolg Warrior    | 13 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body      |
| 1813 | Fir Bolg Warrior    | 13 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body      |
| 1796 | Fomorian Militia    | 30 | 5          | 10     | ordinary body      |
| 1797 | Fomorian Javelinist | 30 | 5          | 12     | ordinary body      |
| 1798 | Fomorian Spearman   | 30 | 5          | 12     | ordinary body      |
| 1799 | Fomorian Warrior    | 33 | 5          | 13     | ordinary body      |
| 1817 | Unmarked            | 35 | 5          | 14     | sacred             |
| 1801 | Fomorian Giant      | 64 | 6          | 14     | sacred, amphibious |
| 1790 | Nemedian Warrior    | 14 | 0          | 14     | stealthy           |

## Early Age Fomoria mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander         | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2469 | Fir Bolg Druid    | A1; random: 100% x1 mask 26112 link 1                                 | 10         |
| 1818 | Unmarked Champion | H1                                                                    | 100        |
| 1819 | Fomorian Druid    | A2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 29184 link 1                              | 10         |
| 1802 | Fomorian King     | A3 D2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 21248 link 1; 10% x1 mask 21248 link 1 | 150        |

| ID   | Commander          | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1791 | Nemedian Champion  | D1 G1 H1                                                              | 100        |
| 1792 | Nemedian Sorceress | A1 D2 G2; random: 100% x1 mask 29440 link 1; 10% x1 mask 29440 link 1 | 10         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Air 3, Death 2, Glamour 2, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Fomoria capital and national sites

| ID  | Site           | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                                       |
|-----|----------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 136 | Isle of Balor  | A2, W1         | Fomorian King, Unmarked, Fomorian Giant                 |
| 137 | Rath Chimbaith | D2, G1         | Nemedian Champion, Nemedian Sorceress, Nemedian Warrior |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Fomoria national spell map

| ID   | Spell                 | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|------|-----------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 438  | Summon Black Dogs     | Conjuration 2 | D2          | 5          |
| 440  | Summon Barghests      | Conjuration 4 | D2          | 7          |
| 442  | Summon Morrigan       | Conjuration 6 | D2 A1       | 5          |
| 443  | Dance of the Morrigan | Conjuration 8 | D5 A2       | 4          |
| 444  | Curse of Balor        | Enchantment 7 | G3 D1       | 1          |
| 1294 | Geas                  | Thaumaturgy 3 | G2          | 0          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Fomoria national item boundary

| ID  | Item                  | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|-----------------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 139 | Spear of the Morrigan | 3            | D1 A1 | restricted |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Fomoria hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record       | Magic             | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------------|-------------------|------------------------------------|
| 1793 | Nemedian Queen    | A2 W2 D3 N2 G3 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1794 | Last Partholonian | A2 W1 D4 G2       | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1803 | Uncursed          | A3 D1 N2 H2       | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1804 | High King         | A3 D4 H3          | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Fomoria army identities

- Sacred roster: Unmarked, Fomorian Giant.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: Fomorian Giant.
- Core identity: Fomorian giants, Fir Bolg infantry, Nemedian specialists, sailing, and strong Air-Death magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Fomoria opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Fomoria fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Fomoria, the most likely planning failure is expensive giant replacement, afflictions, storm planning, and maintaining enough ordinary bodies. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Fomoria research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.

- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Fomoria magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Air 3, Death 2, Glamour 2, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Fomoria battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Fomoria Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |

| Family               | What it can solve                       | What it cannot conceal                                                       |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Awake expansion body | Reduces pressure on the starting roster | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents |
| Resistance package   | Covers a documented roster weakness     | One resistance is not universal defence                                      |

## Early Age Fomoria matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Fomoria monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Fomoria unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Fomoria source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.

- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

## Part LVIII: Early Age Tir na n'Og, Land of the Ever Young

### Early Age Tir na n'Og one-page command brief

Early Age Tir na n'Og converts Fir Bolg ranks supporting glamour-shrouded Tuatha and Sidhe sacreds with Water-Nature-Glamour magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 9 commander identities and 6 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 2 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are elite scarcity, glamour counters, gold concentration, and preserving stealthy mage turns.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

### Early Age Tir na n'Og evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Tir na n'Og on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 11, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Tir na n'Og object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

### Early Age Tir na n'Og conversion chain

```
verified recruitment and national assets
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes
-> labelled fixed and random path access
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth
```

### Early Age Tir na n'Og recruitment geography



| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 7          | 5      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Tir na n'Og commander roster

| ID   | Commander         | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1755 | Fir Bolg Scout    | none                                                                  | 0          |
| 1750 | Fir Bolg Champion | none                                                                  | 75         |
| 2469 | Fir Bolg Druid    | A1; random: 100% x1 mask 26112 link 1                                 | 10         |
| 1752 | Sidhe Champion    | N1 G1 H1                                                              | 100        |
| 1759 | Sidhe Lord        | N1 G2 H2                                                              | 100        |
| 1774 | Bean Sidhe        | W1 N1 G1; random: 100% x1 mask 26368 link 1                           | 10         |
| 1775 | Baobhan Sidhe     | G2                                                                    | 0          |
| 1754 | Ri                | N2 G2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 26368 link 1; 10% x1 mask 26368 link 1 | 150        |
| 1773 | Tuatha Sorceress  | N2 G4 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1; 10% x1 mask 26368 link 1  | 50         |

## Early Age Tir na n'Og troop roster

| ID   | Unit             | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits           |
|------|------------------|----|------------|--------|------------------|
| 1749 | Fir Bolg Militia | 13 | 0          | 9      | ordinary body    |
| 1758 | Fir Bolg Slinger | 13 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body    |
| 1757 | Fir Bolg Warrior | 13 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body    |
| 1756 | Fir Bolg Warrior | 13 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body    |
| 1751 | Sidhe Warrior    | 13 | 0          | 12     | stealthy         |
| 1753 | Tuatha Warrior   | 14 | 0          | 14     | sacred, stealthy |

## Early Age Tir na n'Og mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander      | Fixed and random magic                      | Leadership |
|------|----------------|---------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2469 | Fir Bolg Druid | A1; random: 100% x1 mask 26112 link 1       | 10         |
| 1752 | Sidhe Champion | N1 G1 H1                                    | 100        |
| 1759 | Sidhe Lord     | N1 G2 H2                                    | 100        |
| 1774 | Bean Sidhe     | W1 N1 G1; random: 100% x1 mask 26368 link 1 | 10         |

| ID   | Commander        | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1775 | Baobhan Sidhe    | G2                                                                    | 0          |
| 1754 | Ri               | N2 G2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 26368 link 1; 10% x1 mask 26368 link 1 | 150        |
| 1773 | Tuatha Sorceress | N2 G4 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1; 10% x1 mask 26368 link 1  | 50         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Air 1, Water 1, Nature 2, Glamour 4, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Tir na n'Og capital and national sites

| ID  | Site        | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                    |
|-----|-------------|----------------|--------------------------------------|
| 133 | Tir na n'Og | G3             | Ri, Tuatha Sorceress, Tuatha Warrior |
| 134 | Mag Mor     | E1, N2         | none in explicit recruit fields      |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Tir na n'Og national spell map

| ID   | Spell           | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|------|-----------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 439  | Summon Cu Sidhe | Conjuration 3 | G2          | 5          |
| 1294 | Geas            | Thaumaturgy 3 | G2          | 0          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Tir na n'Og national item boundary

| ID  | Item           | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|----------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 46  | Shillelagh     | 3            | G1 N1 | restricted |
| 93  | Singing Sword  | 7            | G2    | rebate     |
| 345 | Gossamer Cloth | 3            | G2 N1 | rebate     |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Tir na n'Og hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record | Magic          | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 1805 | Long Handed | F2 A1 N1 G2 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Tir na n'Og army identities

- Sacred roster: Tuatha Warrior.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: Fir Bolg ranks supporting glamour-shrouded Tuatha and Sidhe sacreds with Water-Nature-Glamour magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Tir na n'Og opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Tir na n'Og fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Tir na n'Og, the most likely planning failure is elite scarcity, glamour counters, gold concentration, and preserving stealthy mage turns. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Tir na n'Og research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Tir na n'Og magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Air 1, Water 1, Nature 2, Glamour 4, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Tir na n'Og battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Tir na n'Og Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Tir na n'Og matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Tir na n'Og monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Tir na n'Og unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Tir na n'Og source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LIX: Early Age Marverni, Time of Druids

## Early Age Marverni one-page command brief

Early Age Marverni converts tribal infantry, sacred boars, noble cavalry, and Druids spanning Earth, Astral, Nature, and Water into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 11 commander identities and 11 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 5 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are light armour, morale, communion safety, random access, and turning broad magic into timely research.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Marverni evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Marverni on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 12, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Marverni object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Marverni conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Marverni recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 9          | 10     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Marverni commander roster

| ID   | Commander          | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1209 | Marverni Scout     | none                                                                  | 0          |
| 1215 | Marverni Chieftain | none                                                                  | 75         |
| 1218 | Ambibate Chieftain | none                                                                  | 75         |
| 1221 | Carnute Chieftain  | none                                                                  | 75         |
| 1207 | Eponi Chieftain    | none                                                                  | 100        |
| 1206 | Vergobret          | H1                                                                    | 90         |
| 1225 | Sequani Stargazer  | S1                                                                    | 10         |
| 1205 | Gutuater           | N1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 11776 link 1                              | 10         |
| 2468 | Druid              | E1 S1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 11776 link 1                           | 50         |
| 1223 | Boar Lord          | none                                                                  | 75         |
| 1204 | Elder Druid        | E2 S2 H2; random: 100% x2 mask 11776 link 1; 10% x1 mask 11776 link 1 | 50         |

## Early Age Marverni troop roster

| ID   | Unit                          | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|-------------------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 1210 | Marverni Horn Blower          | 10 | 0          | 9      | ordinary body |
| 1211 | Marverni Slinger              | 10 | 0          | 8      | ordinary body |
| 1212 | Marverni Javelineer           | 10 | 0          | 9      | ordinary body |
| 1213 | Marverni Bare Chested Warrior | 10 | 0          | 9      | ordinary body |
| 1214 | Marverni Noble Warrior        | 12 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 1216 | Ambibate Bare Chested Warrior | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 1217 | Ambibate Noble Warrior        | 12 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 1219 | Carnute Bare Chested Warrior  | 12 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 1220 | Carnute Noble Warrior         | 13 | 0          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1208 | Eponi Knight                  | 12 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 1222 | Boar Warrior                  | 14 | 0          | 13     | sacred        |

## Early Age Marverni mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander         | Fixed and random magic                      | Leadership |
|------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1206 | Vergobret         | H1                                          | 90         |
| 1225 | Sequani Stargazer | S1                                          | 10         |
| 1205 | Gutuater          | N1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 11776 link 1    | 10         |
| 2468 | Druid             | E1 S1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 11776 link 1 | 50         |

| ID   | Commander   | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1204 | Elder Druid | E2 S2 H2; random: 100% x2 mask 11776 link 1; 10% x1 mask 11776 link 1 | 50         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Earth 2, Astral 2, Nature 1, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Marverni capital and national sites

| ID | Site     | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                    |
|----|----------|----------------|--------------------------------------|
| 91 | Carnutes | E2, S3, N1     | Boar Lord, Elder Druid, Boar Warrior |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Marverni national spell map

| ID  | Spell                    | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|--------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 253 | Monster Boar             | Conjuration 5 | N3          | 10         |
| 280 | Awaken Tattoos           | Enchantment 3 | N1 H1       | 0          |
| 281 | Sounder of Boars         | Conjuration 3 | N1 H1       | 15         |
| 282 | Contact Boar of Carnutes | Conjuration 5 | N1 E1       | 7          |
| 955 | Sloth of Bears           | Conjuration 3 | N2          | 6          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Marverni national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Marverni hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record  | Magic       | Boundary                           |
|------|--------------|-------------|------------------------------------|
| 1588 | Wanderer     | E2 S3 N4 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1843 | Antlered One | none        | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1849 | Blinded      | E2 S4 N2 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |



Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Marverni army identities

- Sacred roster: Boar Warrior.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: tribal infantry, sacred boars, noble cavalry, and Druids spanning Earth, Astral, Nature, and Water.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Marverni opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Marverni fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Marverni, the most likely planning failure is light armour, morale, communion safety, random access, and turning broad magic into timely research. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Marverni research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Marverni magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Earth 2, Astral 2, Nature 1, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Marverni battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Marverni Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Marverni matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Marverni monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Marverni unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Marverni source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LX: Early Age Ulm, Enigma of Steel

## Early Age Ulm one-page command brief

Early Age Ulm converts stealthy forest warriors, warrior-smiths, resource-efficient equipment, and unusually strong forging into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 5 commander identities and 10 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 0 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are limited magical breadth, old-age attrition, forest recruitment, and translating forged equipment into field value.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Ulm evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Ulm on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 13, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Ulm object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Ulm conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Ulm recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 4          | 9      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 1          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Ulm commander roster

| ID   | Commander       | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2279 | Warrior Scout   | none                                                                  | 0          |
| 1158 | Warrior Chief   | none                                                                  | 100        |
| 1159 | Warrior Smith   | E1; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 1; 50% x1 mask 1920 link 1         | 50         |
| 1160 | Shaman          | E1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 13440 link 1; 50% x1 mask 13440 link 1    | 10         |
| 1161 | Antlered Shaman | E2 N2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 13440 link 1; 10% x1 mask 13440 link 1 | 50         |

## Early Age Ulm troop roster

| ID   | Unit             | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 1162 | Archer           | 12 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 1163 | Warrior Maiden   | 12 | 0          | 12     | stealthy      |
| 1152 | Axe Warrior      | 13 | 0          | 11     | stealthy      |
| 1153 | Warrior          | 13 | 0          | 11     | stealthy      |
| 1154 | Forest Warrior   | 13 | 0          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1155 | Mountain Warrior | 13 | 0          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1165 | Shield Maiden    | 12 | 0          | 13     | stealthy      |
| 1164 | Steel Maiden     | 12 | 0          | 13     | stealthy      |
| 1156 | Iron Warrior     | 14 | 0          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 1157 | Steel Warrior    | 15 | 0          | 14     | sacred        |

## Early Age Ulm mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander       | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1159 | Warrior Smith   | E1; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 1; 50% x1 mask 1920 link 1         | 50         |
| 1160 | Shaman          | E1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 13440 link 1; 50% x1 mask 13440 link 1    | 10         |
| 1161 | Antlered Shaman | E2 N2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 13440 link 1; 10% x1 mask 13440 link 1 | 50         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Earth 2, Nature 2, Holy 1. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Ulm capital and national sites

| ID | Site              | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded |
|----|-------------------|----------------|-------------------|
| 82 | The Wheel of Pain | no gem field   | Steel Warrior     |
| 83 | Irminsul          | E3, D1, N2     | Antlered Shaman   |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Ulm national spell map

No active nation-restricted spell row was found for this nation in the pinned snapshot. Absence here is a metadata boundary, not proof that no shared or special spell exists.

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Ulm national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Ulm hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record          | Magic          | Boundary                           |
|------|----------------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 1582 | Guardian of the Tree | E2 N4 H3       | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1583 | Maker of Heroes      | E1 S2 D2 N1 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1584 | Son of Steel         | none           | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Ulm army identities

- Sacred roster: Steel Warrior.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: stealthy forest warriors, warrior-smiths, resource-efficient equipment, and unusually strong forging.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Ulm opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Ulm fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Ulm, the most likely planning failure is limited magical breadth, old-age attrition, forest recruitment, and translating forged equipment into field value. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Ulm research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Ulm magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Earth 2, Nature 2, Holy 1. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Ulm battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

## Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

## Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

## Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Ulm Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Ulm matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |



## Early Age Ulm monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Ulm unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Ulm source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXI: Early Age Pyrène, Kingdom of the Bekrydes

## Early Age Pyrène one-page command brief

Early Age Pyrène converts cave-linked Bekrydes, ancient giants, Cyclopes, storm-witches, and Earth-Air magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 10 commander identities and 9 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 1 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are regional recruitment, giant replacement, mixed body sizes, and rare-path dependence.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Pyrène evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Pyrène on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 14, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbc036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Pyrène object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Pyrène conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
-> labelled fixed and random path access  
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Pyrène recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 4          | 6      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 6          | 3      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Pyrène commander roster

| ID   | Commander         | Fixed and random magic                          | Leadership |
|------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3589 | Bekryde Scout     | none                                            | 0          |
| 3590 | Bekryde Champion  | none                                            | 50         |
| 3594 | Bekryde Commander | none                                            | 50         |
| 3596 | Bekryde Shaman    | E1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 9728 link 1         | 10         |
| 3606 | Bekryde Shepherd  | none                                            | 20         |
| 3595 | Bebryx            | H1                                              | 75         |
| 3602 | Jentil            | W1 E3 N1; random: 10% x1 mask 9728 link 1       | 50         |
| 3599 | Mairu Champion    | E1                                              | 50         |
| 3605 | Tartalo           | none                                            | 35         |
| 3603 | Sorgina           | A3 W1 E1 N1 H1; random: 10% x1 mask 9984 link 1 | 10         |

## Early Age Pyrène troop roster

| ID   | Unit                   | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|------------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 3633 | Bekryde                | 13 | 1          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 3587 | Bekryde                | 13 | 1          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 3689 | Bekryde Hunter         | 13 | 1          | 9      | ordinary body |
| 3588 | Bekryde Warrior        | 13 | 1          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 3591 | Bekryde Infantry       | 13 | 1          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 3592 | Bekryde Heavy Infantry | 13 | 1          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 3593 | Bebryx Guard           | 15 | 1          | 12     | sacred        |
| 3597 | Mairu Warrior          | 42 | 5          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 3598 | Mairu Hurler           | 40 | 5          | 13     | ordinary body |

## Early Age Pyrène mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander      | Fixed and random magic                          | Leadership |
|------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3596 | Bekryde Shaman | E1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 9728 link 1         | 10         |
| 3595 | Bebryx         | H1                                              | 75         |
| 3602 | Jentil         | W1 E3 N1; random: 10% x1 mask 9728 link 1       | 50         |
| 3599 | Mairu Champion | E1                                              | 50         |
| 3603 | Sorgina        | A3 W1 E1 N1 H1; random: 10% x1 mask 9984 link 1 | 10         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Air 3, Water 1, Earth 3, Nature 1, Holy 1. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Pyrène capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                 | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                                            |
|-----|----------------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 219 | The Cathedral Cavern | E1             | Bekryde Shepherd, Bebryx, Bebryx Guard                       |
| 220 | Grand Dolmen         | E2             | Jentil, Mairu Champion, Tartalo, Mairu Warrior, Mairu Hurler |
| 221 | Mount Anboto         | A2, N1         | Sorgina                                                      |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Pyrène national spell map

| ID  | Spell      | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 449 | Send Aatxe | Conjuration 6 | A3          | 6          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

### Early Age Pyrène national item boundary

| ID  | Item            | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|-----------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 326 | Flying Ointment | 3            | A2 N1 | restricted |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

### Early Age Pyrène hero boundary

No fixed hero-slot identity was resolved from attributes 139-149. Hero arrival and timing remain unscheduled.

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

### Early Age Pyrène army identities

- Sacred roster: Bebryx Guard.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: cave-linked Bekrydes, ancient giants, Cyclopes, storm-witches, and Earth-Air magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

### Early Age Pyrène opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

### Early Age Pyrène fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Pyrène, the most likely planning failure is regional recruitment, giant replacement, mixed body sizes, and rare-path dependence. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Pyrène research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Pyrène magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Air 3, Water 1, Earth 3, Nature 1, Holy 1. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Pyrène battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Pyrène Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Pyrène matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Pyrène monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Pyrène unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Pyrène source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXII: Early Age Agartha, Pale Ones

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## Early Age Agartha one-page command brief

Early Age Agartha converts amphibious Pale Ones, sacred Ancient Ones, deep recruitment, and Earth-Fire-Death magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 10 commander identities and 12 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 9 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are low attack and defence, expensive sacred replacement, cave logistics, and moving effectively between land and sea.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Agartha evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Agartha on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 15, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Agartha object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Agartha conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
 -> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
 -> labelled fixed and random path access  
 -> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
 -> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Agartha recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 6          | 10     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 4          | 2      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Agartha commander roster

| ID   | Commander                     | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1466 | Pale One Scout                | none                                                                | 0          |
| 1463 | Pale One Commander            | none                                                                | 75         |
| 1461 | Troglodyte Lord               | none                                                                | 10         |
| 1470 | Ancient Lord                  | none                                                                | 100        |
| 2491 | Engraver                      | E1                                                                  | 0          |
| 1460 | Earth Reader                  | E2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 4736 link 1                             | 50         |
| 1457 | Oracle of Subterranean Waters | W1 E3 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 1536 link 1; 10% x1 mask 1536 link 1 | 50         |
| 1467 | Oracle of Subterranean Fires  | F1 E3 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 1152 link 1; 10% x1 mask 1152 link 1 | 50         |
| 1468 | Oracle of the Dead            | E3 D1 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 5120 link 1; 10% x1 mask 5120 link 1 | 50         |
| 2493 | Olm Sage                      | W2 E1                                                               | 50         |

## Early Age Agartha troop roster

| ID   | Unit             | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits     |
|------|------------------|----|------------|--------|------------|
| 1452 | Pale One Militia | 18 | 2          | 8      | amphibious |
| 1489 | Wet One          | 18 | 2          | 10     | amphibious |
| 1465 | Pale One         | 18 | 2          | 10     | amphibious |
| 1464 | Pale One Warrior | 18 | 2          | 10     | amphibious |



| ID   | Unit                 | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits             |
|------|----------------------|----|------------|--------|--------------------|
| 1453 | Pale One Warrior     | 18 | 2          | 10     | amphibious         |
| 1462 | Cavern Guard         | 21 | 2          | 12     | amphibious         |
| 447  | Troglodyte           | 37 | 7          | 14     | ordinary body      |
| 1488 | Ancient Stone Hurler | 42 | 3          | 11     | sacred, amphibious |
| 1495 | Ancient Stone Hurler | 42 | 3          | 11     | sacred, amphibious |
| 1469 | Ancient One          | 40 | 3          | 12     | sacred, amphibious |
| 1456 | Seal Guard           | 44 | 3          | 13     | sacred, amphibious |
| 2492 | Great Olm            | 28 | 5          | 12     | sacred, amphibious |

## Early Age Agartha mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander                     | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2491 | Engraver                      | E1                                                                  | 0          |
| 1460 | Earth Reader                  | E2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 4736 link 1                             | 50         |
| 1457 | Oracle of Subterranean Waters | W1 E3 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 1536 link 1; 10% x1 mask 1536 link 1 | 50         |
| 1467 | Oracle of Subterranean Fires  | F1 E3 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 1152 link 1; 10% x1 mask 1152 link 1 | 50         |
| 1468 | Oracle of the Dead            | E3 D1 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 5120 link 1; 10% x1 mask 5120 link 1 | 50         |
| 2493 | Olm Sage                      | W2 E1                                                               | 50         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 1, Water 2, Earth 3, Death 1, Holy 3. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Agartha capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                    | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                                                               |
|-----|-------------------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 109 | Halls of the Oracles    | no gem field   | Oracle of Subterranean Waters, Oracle of Subterranean Fires, Oracle of the Dead |
| 110 | Roots of the Earth      | F1, E3         | none in explicit recruit fields                                                 |
| 112 | The Chamber of the Seal | D1             | Seal Guard                                                                      |
| 167 | The Womb of the Earth   | W1             | Olm Sage, Great Olm                                                             |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Agartha national spell map

| ID  | Spell                      | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|----------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 600 | Bind Penumbra              | Conjuration 3 | D1 E1       | 1          |
| 605 | Revive Cavern Wights       | Conjuration 3 | D1 E1       | 8          |
| 606 | Bind Umbral                | Conjuration 5 | D2 E1       | 2          |
| 607 | Unleash Imprisoned Ones    | Alteration 8  | E6 D4       | 100        |
| 608 | Rhuax Pact                 | Conjuration 3 | F1 E1       | 2          |
| 609 | Barathrus Pact             | Conjuration 3 | E2          | 3          |
| 610 | Mirror of Earth's Memories | Thaumaturgy 4 | W2 E2       | 5          |
| 616 | Living Mercury             | Enchantment 5 | W1 E1       | 6          |
| 690 | Liquid Flames of Rhuax     | Evocation 5   | F3 E1       | 0          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Agartha national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Agartha hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record                  | Magic                                      | Boundary                           |
|------|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| 1458 | Earth-Blooded                | F2 E5 H3                                   | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2494 | Member of the Closed Council | W1 E4 N2 H3                                | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2495 | Member of the Closed Council | W2 E4 D2 H3                                | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2496 | Member of the Closed Council | E4 D3 H3                                   | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1678 | Ancient Olm                  | W3 E3                                      | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1772 | Olm Spawn                    | W1 E1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 5760 link 1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Agartha army identities

- Sacred roster: Ancient Stone Hurler, Ancient Stone Hurler, Ancient One, Seal Guard, Great Olm.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: Pale One Militia, Wet One, Pale One, Pale One Warrior, Pale One Warrior, Cavern Guard, Ancient Stone Hurler, Ancient Stone Hurler, Ancient One, Seal Guard, Great Olm.
- Core identity: amphibious Pale Ones, sacred Ancient Ones, deep recruitment, and Earth-Fire-Death magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Agartha opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Agartha fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Agartha, the most likely planning failure is low attack and defence, expensive sacred replacement, cave logistics, and moving effectively between land and sea. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Agartha research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Agartha magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 1, Water 2, Earth 3, Death 1, Holy 3. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Agartha battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Agartha Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Agartha matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem          | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                  |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units     | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage     |
| Heavy armour           | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided     |
| Accurate missiles      | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards   |
| Elemental resistance   | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element |
| Fast raiders or flyers | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army              |

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                         | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Agartha monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Agartha unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Agartha source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbfc036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXIII: Early Age Abysia, Children of Flame

## Early Age Abysia one-page command brief

Early Age Abysia converts heavily armoured heat-radiating infantry, salamanders, Anathemants, and powerful Fire-Blood magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 9 commander identities and 7 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 6 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are old age, heat management, limited mobility, blood-hunting costs, and answering fire resistance.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Abysia evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Abysia on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 16, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Abysia object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Abysia conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Abysia recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 5          | 5      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 4          | 2      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Abysia commander roster

| ID   | Commander             | Fixed and random magic                     | Leadership |
|------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------|
| 429  | Slayer                | none                                       | 0          |
| 119  | Warlord               | none                                       | 100        |
| 214  | Beast Trainer         | none                                       | 50         |
| 1698 | Anathemant Salamander | F2 H1                                      | 50         |
| 1699 | Anathemant Dragon     | F3 E1 H2                                   | 50         |
| 1542 | Warlock Apprentice    | B1                                         | 10         |
| 1538 | Warlock               | S1 B2; random: 10% x1 mask 35968 link 1    | 10         |
| 1537 | Demonbred             | none                                       | 0          |
| 1536 | Anointed of Rhuax     | F4 E1 H3; random: 10% x1 mask 35968 link 1 | 150        |

## Early Age Abysia troop roster

| ID   | Unit             | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits           |
|------|------------------|----|------------|--------|------------------|
| 81   | Abysian Infantry | 15 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body    |
| 82   | Abysian Infantry | 15 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body    |
| 83   | Abysian Infantry | 15 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body    |
| 84   | Abysian Infantry | 15 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body    |
| 213  | Salamander       | 20 | 10         | 9      | ordinary body    |
| 1661 | Misbred          | 17 | 6          | 14     | flying, stealthy |
| 1543 | Burning One      | 23 | 0          | 15     | sacred           |

## Early Age Abysia mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander             | Fixed and random magic                     | Leadership |
|------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1698 | Anathemant Salamander | F2 H1                                      | 50         |
| 1699 | Anathemant Dragon     | F3 E1 H2                                   | 50         |
| 1542 | Warlock Apprentice    | B1                                         | 10         |
| 1538 | Warlock               | S1 B2; random: 10% x1 mask 35968 link 1    | 10         |
| 1536 | Anointed of Rhuax     | F4 E1 H3; random: 10% x1 mask 35968 link 1 | 150        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 4, Earth 1, Astral 1, Blood 2, Holy 3. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Abysia capital and national sites

| ID  | Site             | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                               |
|-----|------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| 119 | The Smouldercone | F5             | Warlock Apprentice, Warlock, Demonbred, Misbred |

| ID  | Site                              | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded              |
|-----|-----------------------------------|----------------|--------------------------------|
| 120 | Temple of the All-Consuming Flame | F1             | Anointed of Rhuax, Burning One |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Abysia national spell map

| ID  | Spell                    | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|--------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 317 | Summon Spectral Infantry | Conjuration 2 | D1 F1       | 5          |
| 318 | Contact Scorpion Man     | Conjuration 8 | E1 F1       | 12         |
| 319 | Inner Furnace            | Enchantment 5 | F3          | 1          |
| 320 | Infernal Breeding        | Blood 3       | B2          | 25         |
| 690 | Liquid Flames of Rhuax   | Evocation 5   | F3 E1       | 0          |
| 850 | Hellscape                | Alteration 6  | F4          | 10         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Abysia national item boundary

| ID | Item               | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|----|--------------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 97 | O'al Kan's Sceptre | 9            | F3    | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Abysia hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record | Magic    | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------|----------|------------------------------------|
| 1667 | Warlock     | F3 S2 B4 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Abysia army identities

- Sacred roster: Burning One.
- Flying roster: Misbred.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: heavily armoured heat-radiating infantry, salamanders, Anathemants, and powerful Fire-Blood magic.



These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Abysia opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Abysia fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Abysia, the most likely planning failure is old age, heat management, limited mobility, blood-hunting costs, and answering fire resistance. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Abysia research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Abysia magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 4, Earth 1, Astral 1, Blood 2, Holy 3. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Abysia battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Abysia Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Abysia matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem          | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                  |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units     | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage     |
| Heavy armour           | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided     |
| Accurate missiles      | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards   |
| Elemental resistance   | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element |
| Fast raiders or flyers | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army              |

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                         | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Abysia monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Abysia unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Abysia source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbfc036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXIV: Early Age Hinnom, Sons of the Fallen

## Early Age Hinnom one-page command brief

Early Age Hinnom converts Rephaite and Avvite giants, human and Enkidu support, chariots, and exceptionally broad giant mage-priests into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 10 commander identities and 12 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 5 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are population and unrest damage, immense gold costs, giant upkeep, and controlling dangerous sacred elites.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Hinnom evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Hinnom on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 17, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Hinnom object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Hinnom conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Hinnom recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 8          | 11     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Hinnom commander roster

| ID   | Commander        | Fixed and random magic                                            | Leadership |
|------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2020 | Horite Shaman    | E1 D1 N1                                                          | 10         |
| 2024 | Avvite Scout     | none                                                              | 0          |
| 2023 | Avvite Commander | none                                                              | 100        |
| 2016 | Qedesim          | H1                                                                | 0          |
| 2017 | Qedesot          | H1                                                                | 10         |
| 2013 | Acha             | N2                                                                | 10         |
| 2014 | Ammi             | none; random: 100% x1 mask 3456 link 2                            | 10         |
| 2033 | Kohen            | B1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 3200 link 1                           | 100        |
| 2031 | Melqart          | B3 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 3200 link 2                           | 200        |
| 2032 | Ba'al            | B2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 3200 link 3; 10% x1 mask 35968 link 1 | 150        |

## Early Age Hinnom troop roster

| ID   | Unit                  | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|-----------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 2184 | Enkidu Slave          | 22 | 2          | 6      | ordinary body |
| 2018 | Horite                | 25 | 2          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 2034 | Horite Hunter         | 26 | 2          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 2019 | Horite Champion       | 27 | 2          | 14     | ordinary body |
| 2021 | Avvite Light Infantry | 24 | 1          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 2015 | Avvite Spearman       | 24 | 1          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 2022 | Avvite Swordsman      | 24 | 1          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 2059 | Avvite Heavy Archer   | 24 | 1          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 2036 | Avvite Horn Blower    | 24 | 1          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 2035 | Avvite Charioteer     | 24 | 1          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 2037 | Dawn Guard            | 25 | 1          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 2030 | Rephaite Warrior      | 55 | 3          | 14     | sacred        |

## Early Age Hinnom mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander     | Fixed and random magic                  | Leadership |
|------|---------------|-----------------------------------------|------------|
| 2020 | Horite Shaman | E1 D1 N1                                | 10         |
| 2016 | Qedesim       | H1                                      | 0          |
| 2017 | Qedesot       | H1                                      | 10         |
| 2013 | Acha          | N2                                      | 10         |
| 2014 | Ammi          | none; random: 100% x1 mask 3456 link 2  | 10         |
| 2033 | Kohen         | B1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 3200 link 1 | 100        |
| 2031 | Melqart       | B3 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 3200 link 2 | 200        |

| ID   | Commander | Fixed and random magic                                            | Leadership |
|------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2032 | Ba'al     | B2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 3200 link 3; 10% x1 mask 35968 link 1 | 150        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Earth 1, Death 1, Nature 2, Blood 3, Holy 1. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Hinnom capital and national sites

| ID  | Site         | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                |
|-----|--------------|----------------|----------------------------------|
| 147 | Mount Hermon | F2, E2, S1     | none in explicit recruit fields  |
| 146 | Gomorraah    | B2             | Melqart, Ba'al, Rephaite Warrior |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Hinnom national spell map

| ID  | Spell                        | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|------------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 350 | Summon Se'irim               | Blood 3       | B2          | 23         |
| 351 | Summon Shedim                | Blood 4       | B3 A1       | 28         |
| 357 | Release Lord of Civilization | Blood 9       | B8          | 177        |
| 358 | Summon Mazzikim              | Conjuration 3 | N1          | 3          |
| 359 | Summon Lilot                 | Conjuration 5 | N4          | 15         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Hinnom national item boundary

| ID  | Item        | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|-----|-------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 355 | Wall Shaker | 5            | A3    | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Hinnom hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record    | Magic       | Boundary                           |
|------|----------------|-------------|------------------------------------|
| 2076 | Son of Azazel  | F2 S2 B4 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2077 | Son of Semyaza | N4 B3 H1    | assignment only; timing unresolved |

| ID   | Hero record      | Magic    | Boundary                           |
|------|------------------|----------|------------------------------------|
| 2078 | Son of Ezekiel   | A4 B3 H1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2079 | Son of Shamshiel | F4 B3 H1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2080 | Son of Kokabel   | S4 B3 H1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2081 | Son of Arakiel   | E4 B3 H1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Hinnom army identities

- Sacred roster: Rephaite Warrior.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: Rephaite and Avvite giants, human and Enkidu support, chariots, and exceptionally broad giant mage-priests.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Hinnom opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Hinnom fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Hinnom, the most likely planning failure is population and unrest damage, immense gold costs, giant upkeep, and controlling dangerous sacred elites. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Hinnom research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.

- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Hinnom magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Earth 1, Death 1, Nature 2, Blood 3, Holy 1. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Hinnom battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Hinnom Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |



## Early Age Hinnom matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Hinnom monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Hinnom unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Hinnom source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXV: Early Age Ubar, Kingdom of the Unseen

## Early Age Ubar one-page command brief

Early Age Ubar converts human desert forces, Ghuls, Jinnun, invisible sacred Ifrit, and a dominion that hides the capital into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 8 commander identities and 7 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 8 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are desert recruitment, invisible-unit leadership, expensive elites, and dependence on terrain and rare magic.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Ubar evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Ubar on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 18, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Ubar object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Ubar conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Ubar recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 6          | 5      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 1          | 2      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 2      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Ubar commander roster

| ID   | Commander        | Fixed and random magic                      | Leadership |
|------|------------------|---------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3457 | Ubaran Scout     | none                                        | 0          |
| 3458 | Ubaran Commander | none                                        | 75         |
| 3459 | Ubaran Sheikh    | none                                        | 50         |
| 3460 | Kahin            | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1408 link 1        | 10         |
| 3461 | Tubba            | F1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1408 link 1     | 100        |
| 3462 | Human Sahir      | F1 A1; random: 100% x1 mask 1408 link 1     | 10         |
| 3468 | Jinn Sahir       | F2 A2 G1; random: 100% x1 mask 17792 link 1 | 10         |
| 3469 | Jinn Emir        | F1 A1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 17792 link 1 | 100        |

## Early Age Ubar troop roster

| ID   | Unit                  | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits                        |
|------|-----------------------|----|------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| 3453 | Ubaran Desert Warrior | 10 | 0          | 10     | stealthy                      |
| 3454 | Ubaran Camel Rider    | 12 | 0          | 12     | stealthy                      |
| 3470 | Ubaran Archer         | 10 | 0          | 7      | ordinary body                 |
| 3455 | Ubaran Soldier        | 10 | 0          | 8      | ordinary body                 |
| 3456 | Brazen Guard          | 12 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body                 |
| 3463 | Jinn Warrior          | 19 | 1          | 12     | magic being, flying, stealthy |
| 3477 | Ghul                  | 12 | 2          | 14     | demon, magic being, stealthy  |

## Early Age Ubar mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander   | Fixed and random magic                      | Leadership |
|------|-------------|---------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3460 | Kahin       | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1408 link 1        | 10         |
| 3461 | Tubba       | F1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1408 link 1     | 100        |
| 3462 | Human Sahir | F1 A1; random: 100% x1 mask 1408 link 1     | 10         |
| 3468 | Jinn Sahir  | F2 A2 G1; random: 100% x1 mask 17792 link 1 | 10         |
| 3469 | Jinn Emir   | F1 A1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 17792 link 1 | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 2, Air 2, Glamour 1, Holy 1. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Ubar capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                       | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                         |
|-----|----------------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------|
| 214 | The Three Deserts          | F1, A1, D1     | none in explicit recruit fields           |
| 215 | Iram of a Thousand Pillars | F1, G1         | Jinn Sahir, Jinn Emir, Jinn Warrior, Ghul |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Ubar national spell map

| ID  | Spell           | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-----------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 542 | Summon Hinn     | Conjuration 6 | A1 F1       | 4          |
| 546 | Contact Marid   | Conjuration 8 | W2 F4       | 60         |
| 547 | Scorching Wind  | Evocation 4   | A2 F1       | 0          |
| 548 | Smokeless Flame | Evocation 6   | F3 A1       | 0          |
| 551 | Feast for Ghuls | Blood 4       | B1          | 16         |
| 552 | Summon Ghulah   | Blood 5       | B1          | 31         |
| 553 | Summon Binn     | Conjuration 6 | W1 A1       | 4          |
| 554 | Summon Si'lat   | Conjuration 6 | A2          | 21         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Ubar national item boundary

| ID  | Item               | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|--------------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 356 | Flying Carpet      | 5            | A3    | rebate     |
| 419 | Mirage Crystal     | 7            | G3 E2 | rebate     |
| 478 | Companion Bracelet | 5            | A2    | restricted |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Ubar hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record | Magic                                       | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| 3475 | Black King  | F4 A4 W1 E2 G2 B2                           | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 3484 | Mother Ghul | D2 B3                                       | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 3474 | Banu Si'lat | F1 A1 G1; random: 100% x1 mask 17792 link 1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Ubar army identities

- Sacred roster: no sacred troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Flying roster: Jinn Warrior.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: human desert forces, Ghuls, Jinnun, invisible sacred Ifrit, and a dominion that hides the capital.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Ubar opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Ubar fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Ubar, the most likely planning failure is desert recruitment, invisible-unit leadership, expensive elites, and dependence on terrain and rare magic. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Ubar research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Ubar magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 2, Air 2, Glamour 1, Holy 1. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Ubar battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Ubar Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Ubar matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

### Early Age Ubar monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

### Early Age Ubar unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

### Early Age Ubar source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

## Part LXVI: Early Age Ur, The First City

## Early Age Ur one-page command brief

Early Age Ur converts city and nomadic Enkidu, terrain-dependent recruitment, strong shamans, and sacred Mushussu into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 11 commander identities and 10 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 6 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are regional availability, weak armour, commander coverage, and assembling forces drawn from different terrain.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Ur evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Ur on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 19, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Ur object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Ur conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Ur recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 7          | 4      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 3          | 4      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 2      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Ur commander roster



| ID   | Commander        | Fixed and random magic                                            | Leadership |
|------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2161 | Enkidu Scout     | none                                                              | 0          |
| 2177 | Enkidu Commander | none                                                              | 75         |
| 2178 | Enkidu Elder     | none                                                              | 90         |
| 2182 | Gala             | N1 H1                                                             | 10         |
| 2179 | Sal-Me           | W1 N1 H1                                                          | 10         |
| 2268 | Gudu             | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1280 link 2                              | 10         |
| 2180 | Ishib            | W2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 9472 link 1                           | 10         |
| 2166 | Enkidu Chief     | none                                                              | 50         |
| 2167 | Enkidu Shaman    | E2 N3; random: 100% x1 mask 9728 link 1; 10% x1 mask 13824 link 1 | 10         |
| 2269 | Entu             | E2 N1 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1                        | 10         |
| 2181 | Ensi             | W2 N1 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1                        | 100        |

## Early Age Ur troop roster

| ID   | Unit               | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|--------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 2172 | Enkidu Soldier     | 24 | 2          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 2173 | Enkidu Horn Blower | 24 | 2          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 2174 | Enkidu Spear Guard | 24 | 2          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 2175 | Ur-Guard           | 26 | 2          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 2162 | Enkidu             | 24 | 2          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 2163 | Enkidu Archer      | 24 | 2          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 2164 | Enkidu Warrior     | 24 | 2          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 2165 | Enkidu Warrior     | 24 | 2          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 2176 | Enki's Chosen      | 27 | 2          | 13     | sacred        |
| 2962 | Mushussu           | 68 | 15         | 16     | sacred        |

## Early Age Ur mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander     | Fixed and random magic                                            | Leadership |
|------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2182 | Gala          | N1 H1                                                             | 10         |
| 2179 | Sal-Me        | W1 N1 H1                                                          | 10         |
| 2268 | Gudu          | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1280 link 2                              | 10         |
| 2180 | Ishib         | W2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 9472 link 1                           | 10         |
| 2167 | Enkidu Shaman | E2 N3; random: 100% x1 mask 9728 link 1; 10% x1 mask 13824 link 1 | 10         |
| 2269 | Entu          | E2 N1 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1                        | 10         |
| 2181 | Ensi          | W2 N1 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1                        | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Water 2, Earth 2, Nature 3, Holy 3. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Ur capital and national sites

| ID  | Site               | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded |
|-----|--------------------|----------------|-------------------|
| 149 | The House of Water | W2, E1         | Enki's Chosen     |
| 150 | The First City     | no gem field   | Entu, Ensi        |
| 151 | The Swamps of Ur   | N3             | Mushussu          |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Ur national spell map

| ID  | Spell                | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|----------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 318 | Contact Scorpion Man | Conjuration 8 | E1 F1       | 12         |
| 360 | Summon Kusarikkus    | Conjuration 4 | E1          | 4          |
| 361 | Summon Ugallu        | Conjuration 5 | A3          | 24         |
| 362 | Call Anzus           | Conjuration 7 | W2 E2       | 4          |
| 363 | Call Apkallu         | Conjuration 8 | S5          | 60         |
| 958 | Herd of Buffaloes    | Conjuration 3 | N2          | 8          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Ur national item boundary

| ID  | Item                  | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|-----------------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 104 | Dawn Fang             | 9            | E2 S1 | rebate     |
| 184 | Shield of the Dawn    | 9            | E2 S1 | rebate     |
| 216 | Helmet of the Dawn    | 9            | E2 S1 | rebate     |
| 227 | Headdress of the Bull | 5            | N1    | restricted |
| 275 | Armor of the Dawn     | 9            | E2 S1 | rebate     |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Ur hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record      | Magic       | Boundary                           |
|------|------------------|-------------|------------------------------------|
| 2432 | Entu of the Moon | W1 E1 S3 H3 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2433 | Favored of Enki  | N3 H2       | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2965 | Apkallu          | W4 E3 N2 H3 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Ur army identities

- Sacred roster: Enki's Chosen, Mushussu.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: city and nomadic Enkidu, terrain-dependent recruitment, strong shamans, and sacred Mushussu.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Ur opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Ur fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Ur, the most likely planning failure is regional availability, weak armour, commander coverage, and assembling forces drawn from different terrain. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Ur research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.

- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Ur magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Water 2, Earth 2, Nature 3, Holy 3. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Ur battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Ur Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Ur matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Ur monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Ur unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Ur source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXVII: Early Age Kailasa, Rise of the Ape Kings

## Early Age Kailasa one-page command brief

Early Age Kailasa converts large numbers of light apes directed by rare Yakshas with strong Astral-Nature-Glamour magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 8 commander identities and 10 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 15 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are low morale and protection, expensive sacred mages, magic leadership, and making numerous troops hold together.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Kailasa evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Kailasa on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 20, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Kailasa object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Kailasa conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
-> labelled fixed and random path access  
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Kailasa recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 6          | 8      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 2      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Kailasa commander roster

| ID   | Commander        | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1119 | Markata Scout    | none                                                                     | 0          |
| 1127 | Atavi Chieftain  | none                                                                     | 50         |
| 1334 | Bandar Commander | none                                                                     | 100        |
| 1145 | Yogi             | S1                                                                       | 10         |
| 1143 | Guru             | S2 N1                                                                    | 10         |
| 2542 | Guhyaka General  | H1                                                                       | 100        |
| 1329 | Yaksha           | E3 N1 G1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 28160 link 1; 10% x1 mask 28160 link 1 | 50         |
| 1330 | Yakshini         | W3 N1 G1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 28160 link 1; 10% x1 mask 28160 link 1 | 50         |

## Early Age Kailasa troop roster

| ID   | Unit                | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits              |
|------|---------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------------|
| 1118 | Markata             | 5  | 0          | 7      | ordinary body       |
| 1120 | Markata Archer      | 5  | 0          | 7      | ordinary body       |
| 1121 | Atavi Archer        | 10 | 1          | 8      | stealthy            |
| 1122 | Atavi Infantry      | 10 | 1          | 8      | stealthy            |
| 1130 | Light Bandar Archer | 18 | 3          | 12     | ordinary body       |
| 1333 | Bandar Warrior      | 18 | 3          | 12     | ordinary body       |
| 1350 | Bandar Swordsman    | 18 | 3          | 13     | ordinary body       |
| 1326 | Guhyaka             | 23 | 1          | 13     | sacred, magic being |
| 1327 | Yavana              | 23 | 1          | 14     | sacred, magic being |
| 1328 | Yavana Archer       | 20 | 1          | 13     | sacred, magic being |

## Early Age Kailasa mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander       | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1145 | Yogi            | S1                                                                       | 10         |
| 1143 | Guru            | S2 N1                                                                    | 10         |
| 2542 | Guhyaka General | H1                                                                       | 100        |
| 1329 | Yaksha          | E3 N1 G1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 28160 link 1; 10% x1 mask 28160 link 1 | 50         |
| 1330 | Yakshini        | W3 N1 G1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 28160 link 1; 10% x1 mask 28160 link 1 | 50         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Water 3, Earth 3, Astral 2, Nature 1, Glamour 1, Holy 1. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Kailasa capital and national sites

| ID | Site             | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded     |
|----|------------------|----------------|-----------------------|
| 98 | Mount Kailasa    | E2             | Yavana, Yavana Archer |
| 99 | The Lotus Garden | S2, N1, G1     | Yaksha, Yakshini      |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Kailasa national spell map

| ID  | Spell              | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|--------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 555 | Summon Angiri      | Conjuration 3 | F2          | 5          |
| 557 | Summon Apsaras     | Conjuration 3 | S2          | 3          |
| 558 | Summon Vidyadhara  | Conjuration 4 | S2          | 15         |
| 559 | Contact Yaksha     | Conjuration 4 | N2 E1       | 25         |
| 560 | Contact Yakshini   | Conjuration 4 | N2 W1       | 25         |
| 562 | Summon Gandharvas  | Conjuration 5 | S2          | 15         |
| 563 | Summon Kimpurushas | Conjuration 5 | N2 S1       | 15         |
| 565 | Summon Garudas     | Conjuration 6 | S2          | 21         |
| 566 | Summon Maruts      | Conjuration 6 | S2          | 18         |
| 567 | Summon Kinnara     | Conjuration 6 | S3          | 25         |
| 569 | Summon Siddha      | Conjuration 7 | S4          | 35         |
| 570 | Summon Devata      | Conjuration 8 | S5          | 45         |
| 571 | Summon Devala      | Conjuration 9 | S5          | 55         |
| 572 | Summon Rudra       | Conjuration 9 | S5          | 55         |
| 573 | Celestial Music    | Thaumaturgy 6 | S3          | 1          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Kailasa national item boundary

| ID  | Item                  | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|-----------------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 140 | Vajra                 | 5            | S2    | restricted |
| 227 | Headdress of the Bull | 5            | N1    | restricted |



Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Kailasa hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record | Magic | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------|-------|------------------------------------|
| 1585 | Fallen      | B3    | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Kailasa army identities

- Sacred roster: Guhyaka, Yavana, Yavana Archer.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: large numbers of light apes directed by rare Yakshas with strong Astral-Nature-Glamour magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Kailasa opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Kailasa fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Kailasa, the most likely planning failure is low morale and protection, expensive sacred mages, magic leadership, and making numerous troops hold together. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Kailasa research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.

- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Kailasa magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Water 3, Earth 3, Astral 2, Nature 1, Glamour 1, Holy 1. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Kailasa battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Kailasa Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |

| Family               | What it can solve                       | What it cannot conceal                                                       |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Awake expansion body | Reduces pressure on the starting roster | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents |
| Resistance package   | Covers a documented roster weakness     | One resistance is not universal defence                                      |

## Early Age Kailasa matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Kailasa monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Kailasa unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Kailasa source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.

- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

## Part LXVIII: Early Age Lanka, Land of Demons

### Early Age Lanka one-page command brief

Early Age Lanka converts sacred Rakshasa, light ape troops, reanimated servants, and Blood-Death-Nature magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 9 commander identities and 10 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 12 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are blood economy, unrest, demon leadership, fire vulnerability, and expensive sacred replacement.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

### Early Age Lanka evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Lanka on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 21, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Lanka object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

### Early Age Lanka conversion chain

```
verified recruitment and national assets
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes
-> labelled fixed and random path access
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth
```

### Early Age Lanka recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 7          | 7      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 3      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Lanka commander roster

| ID   | Commander        | Fixed and random magic                                                      | Leadership |
|------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1119 | Markata Scout    | none                                                                        | 0          |
| 1127 | Atavi Chieftain  | none                                                                        | 50         |
| 1761 | Bandar Commander | none                                                                        | 100        |
| 1760 | Bandaraja        | none                                                                        | 150        |
| 1733 | Raktapata        | B1 H1                                                                       | 10         |
| 1734 | Yogini           | D1 N2 B1                                                                    | 10         |
| 1735 | Kala-Mukha       | B1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 45056 link 1                                    | 10         |
| 1739 | Rakshasi         | D1 N1 G1 B1 H1; random: 100% x2 mask 61440 link 1; 10% x1 mask 61440 link 1 | 50         |
| 1738 | Raksharaja       | A2 D1 B2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 37120 link 1; 10% x1 mask 45312 link 1    | 100        |

## Early Age Lanka troop roster

| ID   | Unit                | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|---------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 1118 | Markata             | 5  | 0          | 7      | ordinary body |
| 1120 | Markata Archer      | 5  | 0          | 7      | ordinary body |
| 1121 | Atavi Archer        | 10 | 1          | 8      | stealthy      |
| 1122 | Atavi Infantry      | 10 | 1          | 8      | stealthy      |
| 1130 | Light Bandar Archer | 18 | 3          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1762 | Bandar Warrior      | 18 | 3          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1763 | Kala-Mukha Warrior  | 24 | 4          | 14     | sacred        |
| 1745 | Asara               | 33 | 3          | 14     | sacred, demon |
| 1746 | Anusara             | 28 | 4          | 13     | sacred, demon |
| 1747 | Palankasha          | 30 | 5          | 14     | sacred, demon |

## Early Age Lanka mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander  | Fixed and random magic                                                      | Leadership |
|------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1733 | Raktapata  | B1 H1                                                                       | 10         |
| 1734 | Yogini     | D1 N2 B1                                                                    | 10         |
| 1735 | Kala-Mukha | B1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 45056 link 1                                    | 10         |
| 1739 | Rakshasi   | D1 N1 G1 B1 H1; random: 100% x2 mask 61440 link 1; 10% x1 mask 61440 link 1 | 50         |
| 1738 | Raksharaja | A2 D1 B2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 37120 link 1; 10% x1 mask 45312 link 1    | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Air 2, Death 1, Nature 2, Glamour 1, Blood 2, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Lanka capital and national sites

| ID  | Site     | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded          |
|-----|----------|----------------|----------------------------|
| 131 | Sri Pada | A1, D3         | Rakshasi, Raksharaja       |
| 132 | Lanka    | N2             | Asara, Anusara, Palankasha |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Lanka national spell map

| ID  | Spell                    | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|--------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 574 | Summon Rakshasas         | Blood 1       | B1          | 8          |
| 575 | Feast of Flesh           | Blood 2       | B1 N1       | 50         |
| 576 | Summon Asrapas           | Blood 3       | B2          | 8          |
| 577 | Summon Rakshasa Warriors | Blood 4       | B2          | 21         |
| 578 | Summon Sandhyabalas      | Blood 5       | B2 D1       | 25         |
| 579 | Summon Dakini            | Blood 6       | B4 A1       | 81         |
| 580 | Summon Samanishada       | Blood 7       | B3 D1       | 35         |
| 581 | Summon Mandeha           | Blood 8       | B5 D2       | 133        |
| 582 | Summon Danavas           | Blood 8       | B5          | 70         |
| 583 | Summon Daitya            | Blood 8       | B5          | 45         |
| 584 | Host of Ganas            | Conjuration 2 | D1          | 9          |
| 585 | Summon Vetalas           | Conjuration 5 | D2          | 10         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Lanka national item boundary

| ID  | Item                  | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|-----------------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 227 | Headdress of the Bull | 5            | N1    | restricted |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Lanka hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record   | Magic | Boundary                           |
|------|---------------|-------|------------------------------------|
| 1914 | Apostate Raja | H2    | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Lanka army identities

- Sacred roster: Kala-Mukha Warrior, Asara, Anusara, Palankasha.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: sacred Rakshasa, light ape troops, reanimated servants, and Blood-Death-Nature magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Lanka opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Lanka fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Lanka, the most likely planning failure is blood economy, unrest, demon leadership, fire vulnerability, and expensive sacred replacement. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Lanka research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Lanka magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Air 2, Death 1, Nature 2, Glamour 1, Blood 2, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Lanka battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Lanka Pretender families

| Family              | What it can solve                                       | What it cannot conceal                                       |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required |



| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Lanka matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Lanka monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Lanka unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Lanka source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXIX: Early Age T'ien Ch'i, Spring and Autumn

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i one-page command brief

Early Age T'ien Ch'i converts human combined arms, noble commanders, Masters of the Way, and broad but distributed elemental magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 9 commander identities and 11 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 12 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are mage-path fragmentation, capital pressure, army coordination, and matching research to the casters actually recruited.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age T'ien Ch'i on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 22, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any T'ien Ch'i object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i conversion chain

```
verified recruitment and national assets
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes
-> labelled fixed and random path access
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth
```

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 5          | 10     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 3          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i commander roster

| ID   | Commander                    | Fixed and random magic                                                                                    | Leadership |
|------|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 426  | Scout                        | none                                                                                                      | 0          |
| 1665 | Noble Commander              | none                                                                                                      | 100        |
| 806  | Master of the Dead           | D1 H1                                                                                                     | 10         |
| 3936 | Student of the Way           | W1; random: 100% x1 mask 26880 link 1                                                                     | 10         |
| 4022 | Student of the Sword         | none; random: 100% x1 mask 10112 link 1                                                                   | 10         |
| 3935 | Master of the Way            | W1; random: 100% x2 mask 27392 link 1                                                                     | 10         |
| 3937 | Student of the Five Elements | none; random: 100% x1 mask 10112 link 1                                                                   | 10         |
| 940  | Master of the Five Elements  | F1 A1 W1 E1 N1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 10112 link 1                                                      | 10         |
| 941  | Celestial Master             | F1 A1 W2 S1 G1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 13440 link 1; 100% x1 mask 19200 link 1; 10% x1 mask 19200 link 1 | 10         |

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i troop roster

| ID   | Unit                         | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|------------------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 794  | Footman                      | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 795  | Footman                      | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 796  | Footman                      | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 797  | Archer                       | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 1901 | Medium Footman               | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 1904 | Medium Footman               | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 928  | Heavy Footman                | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 929  | Heavy Footman                | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 788  | Horseman                     | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 927  | Noble                        | 12 | 0          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 1544 | Warrior of the Five Elements | 12 | 5          | 15     | sacred        |

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander                    | Fixed and random magic                                                                                    | Leadership |
|------|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 806  | Master of the Dead           | D1 H1                                                                                                     | 10         |
| 3936 | Student of the Way           | W1; random: 100% x1 mask 26880 link 1                                                                     | 10         |
| 4022 | Student of the Sword         | none; random: 100% x1 mask 10112 link 1                                                                   | 10         |
| 3935 | Master of the Way            | W1; random: 100% x2 mask 27392 link 1                                                                     | 10         |
| 3937 | Student of the Five Elements | none; random: 100% x1 mask 10112 link 1                                                                   | 10         |
| 940  | Master of the Five Elements  | F1 A1 W1 E1 N1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 10112 link 1                                                      | 10         |
| 941  | Celestial Master             | F1 A1 W2 S1 G1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 13440 link 1; 100% x1 mask 19200 link 1; 10% x1 mask 19200 link 1 | 10         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 1, Air 1, Water 2, Earth 1, Astral 1, Death 1, Nature 1, Glamour 1, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i capital and national sites

| ID | Site                          | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                                         |
|----|-------------------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| 53 | The Bamboo Grove              | no gem field   | Master of the Five Elements, Warrior of the Five Elements |
| 54 | The Gate of Spring and Autumn | F1, W2, S2, D1 | Celestial Master                                          |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i national spell map

| ID  | Spell                   | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 286 | Celestial Chastisement  | Evocation 5   | S3          | 0          |
| 287 | Contact Huli Jing       | Conjuration 6 | N2          | 30         |
| 289 | Internal Alchemy        | Alteration 5  | W2 S1       | 5          |
| 529 | Celestial Servant       | Conjuration 1 | E1 S1       | 1          |
| 530 | Heavenly Rivers         | Conjuration 3 | W1 S1       | 9          |
| 531 | Celestial Hounds        | Conjuration 4 | A1 S1       | 2          |
| 532 | Heavenly Fires          | Conjuration 5 | F1 S1       | 4          |
| 533 | Call Celestial Soldiers | Conjuration 6 | A2 S1       | 15         |
| 534 | Call Ancestor           | Conjuration 1 | D1          | 0          |
| 535 | Wrath of the Ancestors  | Conjuration 7 | D1          | 1          |
| 957 | Ambush of Tigers        | Conjuration 3 | N2          | 9          |
| 958 | Herd of Buffaloes       | Conjuration 3 | N2          | 8          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

### Early Age T'ien Ch'i national item boundary

| ID  | Item                       | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|----------------------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 138 | Sword of the Five Elements | 3            | F1 W1 | restricted |
| 284 | Armor of the Five Elements | 3            | E1 A1 | restricted |
| 288 | Chi Shoes                  | 3            | A1    | rebate     |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

### Early Age T'ien Ch'i hero boundary

| ID  | Hero record                 | Magic          | Boundary                           |
|-----|-----------------------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 942 | Immortal                    | A1 N2          | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 943 | Immortal                    | F1 A1 W2 S3 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 944 | Master With The Iron Crutch | A2 S2 D2       | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

### Early Age T'ien Ch'i army identities

- Sacred roster: Warrior of the Five Elements.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: human combined arms, noble commanders, Masters of the Way, and broad but distributed elemental magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

### Early Age T'ien Ch'i opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For T'ien Ch'i, the most likely planning failure is mage-path fragmentation, capital pressure, army coordination, and matching research to the casters actually recruited. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 1, Air 1, Water 2, Earth 1, Astral 1, Death 1, Nature 1, Glamour 1, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

## Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age T'ien Ch'i source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXX: Early Age Yomi, Oni Kings

## Early Age Yomi one-page command brief

Early Age Yomi converts Oni commanders and freespawn, Bakemono and human servants, and a dominion shaped by Turmoil into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 8 commander identities and 5 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 14 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are freespawn composition, unrest, demon leadership, weak mundane troops, and the opportunity cost of order and temperature choices.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Yomi evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Yomi on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 23, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Yomi object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.



## Early Age Yomi conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
 -> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
 -> labelled fixed and random path access  
 -> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
 -> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Yomi recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 7          | 5      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 1          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 1          | 0      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Yomi commander roster

| ID   | Commander      | Fixed and random magic                                                 | Leadership |
|------|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2467 | Bakemono Chief | none                                                                   | 50         |
| 1313 | Bandit Leader  | none                                                                   | 50         |
| 1314 | Demon General  | D1                                                                     | 150        |
| 3069 | Namanari       | D1 N1                                                                  | 10         |
| 1315 | Sorcerer       | E1 D1; random: 100% x1 mask 5504 link 1                                | 10         |
| 1609 | Demon Priest   | H1; random: 10% x1 mask 5504 link 1                                    | 10         |
| 1276 | Oni Shugo      | D2; random: 100% x1 mask 1408 link 1                                   | 35         |
| 1316 | Dai Oni        | F2 E2 D3 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 5504 link 1; 10% x1 mask 5504 link 1 | 60         |

## Early Age Yomi troop roster

| ID   | Unit            | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits   |
|------|-----------------|----|------------|--------|----------|
| 1393 | Bakemono-Sho    | 9  | 0          | 9      | stealthy |
| 1394 | Bakemono-Sho    | 9  | 0          | 9      | stealthy |
| 1395 | Bakemono Archer | 9  | 0          | 8      | stealthy |
| 1311 | Bandit          | 9  | 0          | 10     | stealthy |
| 1312 | Bandit          | 9  | 0          | 10     | stealthy |

## Early Age Yomi mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander     | Fixed and random magic                                                 | Leadership |
|------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1314 | Demon General | D1                                                                     | 150        |
| 3069 | Namanari      | D1 N1                                                                  | 10         |
| 1315 | Sorcerer      | E1 D1; random: 100% x1 mask 5504 link 1                                | 10         |
| 1609 | Demon Priest  | H1; random: 10% x1 mask 5504 link 1                                    | 10         |
| 1276 | Oni Shugo     | D2; random: 100% x1 mask 1408 link 1                                   | 35         |
| 1316 | Dai Oni       | F2 E2 D3 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 5504 link 1; 10% x1 mask 5504 link 1 | 60         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 2, Earth 2, Death 3, Nature 1, Holy 1. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Yomi capital and national sites

| ID | Site                      | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded |
|----|---------------------------|----------------|-------------------|
| 95 | Mountain of the Oni Kings | F1, A1, E1, D3 | Dai Oni           |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Yomi national spell map

| ID  | Spell               | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|---------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 290 | Hannya Pact         | Conjuration 0 | D1          | 6          |
| 291 | Greater Hannya Pact | Conjuration 0 | D2          | 12         |
| 292 | End of Culture      | Thaumaturgy 6 | F5          | 60         |
| 293 | End of Weakness     | Alteration 6  | E2          | 1          |
| 301 | Summon Shikome      | Conjuration 4 | D2          | 5          |
| 311 | Summon Gozu Mezu    | Conjuration 6 | D3          | 6          |
| 313 | Summon Araburu-kami | Conjuration 7 | D1 F1       | 5          |
| 587 | Summon Kappa        | Conjuration 1 | W1 N1       | 3          |
| 589 | Summon Karasu Tengu | Conjuration 2 | N1 A1       | 2          |
| 591 | Summon Konoha Tengu | Conjuration 3 | A1 E1       | 3          |
| 592 | Ghost General       | Conjuration 4 | D3          | 10         |
| 594 | Contact Dai Tengu   | Conjuration 5 | A2 E1       | 55         |
| 595 | Contact Nushi       | Conjuration 5 | W2 N1       | 25         |
| 957 | Ambush of Tigers    | Conjuration 3 | N2          | 9          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Yomi national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Yomi hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record                  | Magic       | Boundary                           |
|------|------------------------------|-------------|------------------------------------|
| 1671 | Ghost General                | D2          | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1672 | Master of the Shadow Blossom | F1 E2 D4 B1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1673 | Devourer of Demons           | F1 D1       | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Yomi army identities

- Sacred roster: no sacred troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: Oni commanders and freespawn, Bakemono and human servants, and a dominion shaped by Turmoil.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Yomi opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Yomi fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Yomi, the most likely planning failure is freespawn composition, unrest, demon leadership, weak mundane troops, and the opportunity cost of order and temperature choices. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Yomi research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Yomi magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 2, Earth 2, Death 3, Nature 1, Holy 1. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Yomi battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

## Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Yomi Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Yomi matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Yomi monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Yomi unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Yomi source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXI: Early Age Caelum, Eagle Kings

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## Early Age Caelum one-page command brief

Early Age Caelum converts flying winged troops, strong archery, cold-forged ice equipment, mammoths, and powerful Air magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 8 commander identities and 14 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 11 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are temperature-dependent protection, fragile troops, storm interactions, supply, and coordinating flyers with slower forces.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Caelum evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Caelum on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 24, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Caelum object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Caelum conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
 -> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
 -> labelled fixed and random path access  
 -> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
 -> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Caelum recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 6          | 10     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 4      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Caelum commander roster

| ID   | Commander         | Fixed and random magic                       | Leadership |
|------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------|------------|
| 484  | Caelian Scout     | none                                         | 0          |
| 1288 | Sastar            | none                                         | 100        |
| 1284 | Spire Horn Seraph | A1                                           | 10         |
| 2557 | Airyra Seraphine  | F1 H2                                        | 50         |
| 2570 | Airyra Seraph     | A2 W1                                        | 10         |
| 1663 | Harab Seraph      | A1 D1; random: 100% x1 mask 5376 link 1      | 10         |
| 1286 | Eagle King        | A4 W1 E1 H2; random: 10% x1 mask 1920 link 1 | 100        |
| 2560 | Mairya Ahu        | none                                         | 50         |

## Early Age Caelum troop roster

| ID   | Unit                  | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits |
|------|-----------------------|----|------------|--------|--------|
| 2564 | Spire Horn Militia    | 10 | 0          | 8      | flying |
| 2566 | Spire Horn Warrior    | 10 | 0          | 10     | flying |
| 2565 | Spire Horn Archer     | 9  | 0          | 10     | flying |
| 1287 | Tempest Warrior       | 11 | 0          | 11     | flying |
| 130  | Airyra Light Infantry | 9  | 0          | 10     | flying |

| ID   | Unit              | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits                   |
|------|-------------------|----|------------|--------|--------------------------|
| 420  | Airy Infantry     | 9  | 0          | 10     | flying                   |
| 1285 | Iceclad           | 9  | 0          | 12     | flying                   |
| 1707 | Raptorian Militia | 11 | 0          | 9      | flying                   |
| 1278 | Raptorian Warrior | 11 | 0          | 11     | flying                   |
| 419  | Mammoth Rider     | 10 | 0          | 10     | flying                   |
| 127  | Blizzard Warrior  | 9  | 0          | 10     | flying                   |
| 1289 | Airy Temple Guard | 10 | 0          | 13     | sacred                   |
| 2558 | Kavi Archer       | 9  | 0          | 12     | sacred, flying           |
| 2559 | Mairya Warrior    | 13 | 0          | 13     | sacred, flying, stealthy |

## Early Age Caelum mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander         | Fixed and random magic                       | Leadership |
|------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1284 | Spire Horn Seraph | A1                                           | 10         |
| 2557 | Airy Seraphine    | F1 H2                                        | 50         |
| 2570 | Airy Seraph       | A2 W1                                        | 10         |
| 1663 | Harab Seraph      | A1 D1; random: 100% x1 mask 5376 link 1      | 10         |
| 1286 | Eagle King        | A4 W1 E1 H2; random: 10% x1 mask 1920 link 1 | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 1, Air 4, Water 1, Earth 1, Death 1, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Caelum capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                      | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                               |
|-----|---------------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| 94  | Palace of the Eagle Kings | A3, W1         | Eagle King, Blizzard Warrior, Airy Temple Guard |
| 168 | Spire Horn Mountain       | A1             | Kavi Archer                                     |
| 169 | Ravens Vale               | E1             | Mairya Ahu, Mairya Warrior                      |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Caelum national spell map

| ID  | Spell                | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|----------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 461 | Parting of the Soul  | Thaumaturgy 6 | D1 A1       | 0          |
| 462 | Call Ahurani         | Conjuration 5 | S2 W1       | 12         |
| 463 | Call Celestial Yazad | Conjuration 6 | S4          | 40         |
| 464 | Call Fravashi        | Conjuration 7 | S3          | 30         |



| ID  | Spell                | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|----------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 465 | Call Amesha Spenta   | Conjuration 8 | S5          | 60         |
| 466 | Summon Yazatas       | Conjuration 5 | S2          | 12         |
| 467 | Call Daevas          | Conjuration 5 | D2 F1       | 12         |
| 468 | Call Jahi            | Conjuration 5 | D3 F1       | 15         |
| 469 | Call Yata            | Conjuration 6 | D3 F2       | 40         |
| 470 | Call of the Drugvant | Thaumaturgy 7 | D4 F1       | 15         |
| 471 | Call Greater Daeva   | Conjuration 8 | D4 F2       | 60         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Caelum national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Caelum hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record     | Magic | Boundary                           |
|------|-----------------|-------|------------------------------------|
| 1674 | Unwinged        | H2    | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2577 | Ahu of the Kavi | H2    | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Caelum army identities

- Sacred roster: Airya Temple Guard, Kavi Archer, Mairya Warrior.
- Flying roster: Spire Horn Militia, Spire Horn Warrior, Spire Horn Archer, Tempest Warrior, Airya Light Infantry, Airya Infantry, Iceclad, Raptorian Militia, Raptorian Warrior, Mammoth Rider, Blizzard Warrior, Kavi Archer, Mairya Warrior.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: flying winged troops, strong archery, cold-forged ice equipment, mammoths, and powerful Air magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Caelum opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.

- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Caelum fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Caelum, the most likely planning failure is temperature-dependent protection, fragile troops, storm interactions, supply, and coordinating flyers with slower forces. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Caelum research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Caelum magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 1, Air 4, Water 1, Earth 1, Death 1, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Caelum battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

## Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

## Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Caelum Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Caelum matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Caelum monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?

- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Caelum unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Caelum source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXII: Early Age Mictlan, Reign of Blood

## Early Age Mictlan one-page command brief

Early Age Mictlan converts cheap tribal armies, sacred Jaguar and Eagle Warriors, mage-priests, and dominion sustained through blood sacrifice into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 8 commander identities and 9 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 13 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are blood-slave supply, priest turns, weak protection, dominion maintenance, and preventing expansion from outrunning sacrifice coverage.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Mictlan evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Mictlan on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 25, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbc036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Mictlan object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Mictlan conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
-> labelled fixed and random path access  
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Mictlan recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 4          | 7      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 4          | 2      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Mictlan commander roster

| ID   | Commander              | Fixed and random magic                  | Leadership |
|------|------------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------|
| 729  | Scout                  | none                                    | 0          |
| 730  | Tribal King            | none                                    | 100        |
| 731  | Mictlan Priest         | B1 H1; random: 10% x1 mask 10880 link 1 | 10         |
| 1361 | Nahualli               | S1 N2; random: 10% x1 mask 47104 link 1 | 10         |
| 732  | Priest King            | N2 B2 H2                                | 150        |
| 733  | Rain Priest            | W2 B2 H2                                | 10         |
| 734  | Moon Priest            | S2 B2 H2                                | 10         |
| 735  | High Priest of the Sun | F2 B3 H3                                | 50         |

## Early Age Mictlan troop roster

| ID   | Unit              | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|-------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 721  | Warrior           | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 722  | Warrior           | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 723  | Warrior           | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 724  | Warrior           | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 860  | Feathered Warrior | 10 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 1882 | Moon Warrior      | 12 | 0          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 727  | Jaguar Warrior    | 12 | 0          | 12     | sacred        |
| 726  | Eagle Warrior     | 12 | 0          | 11     | sacred        |
| 725  | Sun Warrior       | 12 | 0          | 13     | sacred        |

## Early Age Mictlan mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander              | Fixed and random magic                  | Leadership |
|------|------------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------|
| 731  | Mictlan Priest         | B1 H1; random: 10% x1 mask 10880 link 1 | 10         |
| 1361 | Nahualli               | S1 N2; random: 10% x1 mask 47104 link 1 | 10         |
| 732  | Priest King            | N2 B2 H2                                | 150        |
| 733  | Rain Priest            | W2 B2 H2                                | 10         |
| 734  | Moon Priest            | S2 B2 H2                                | 10         |
| 735  | High Priest of the Sun | F2 B3 H3                                | 50         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 2, Water 2, Astral 2, Nature 2, Blood 3, Holy 3. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Mictlan capital and national sites

| ID | Site                   | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                   |
|----|------------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------|
| 30 | Temple of the Land     | N1             | Priest King, Eagle Warrior          |
| 31 | Temple of the Rain     | W1             | Rain Priest                         |
| 32 | Temple of the Moon     | S1             | Moon Priest                         |
| 33 | High Temple of the Sun | F2, B3         | High Priest of the Sun, Sun Warrior |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Mictlan national spell map

| ID  | Spell                | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|----------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 504 | Summon Jaguar Toads  | Conjuration 1 | N1 H1       | 2          |
| 505 | Summon Jaguars       | Conjuration 3 | N2 H1       | 20         |
| 506 | Summon Jade Serpents | Conjuration 4 | W2          | 3          |
| 507 | Summon Monster Toad  | Conjuration 5 | N2          | 1          |
| 508 | Contact Couatl       | Conjuration 6 | N1 S1       | 40         |
| 509 | Summon Tlaloque      | Conjuration 7 | W4          | 60         |
| 510 | Bind Beast Bats      | Blood 2       | B1          | 8          |
| 511 | Bind Jaguar Fiends   | Blood 4       | B1 F1       | 16         |
| 512 | Contact Civateteo    | Blood 5       | B2 D2       | 36         |
| 513 | Bind Tzitzimitl      | Blood 6       | B2 S2       | 10         |
| 514 | Contact Tlahuelpuchi | Blood 6       | B3          | 42         |
| 515 | Contact Onaqui       | Blood 7       | B4          | 101        |
| 516 | Rain of Jaguars      | Blood 8       | B6 F2       | 40         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Mictlan national item boundary

| ID | Item       | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|----|------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 43 | Jade Knife | 3            | N1 B1 | restricted |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Mictlan hero boundary

| ID  | Hero record     | Magic    | Boundary                           |
|-----|-----------------|----------|------------------------------------|
| 933 | King of Legends | D3 B3 H3 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 936 | Eagle Priest    | A2 B2 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Mictlan army identities

- Sacred roster: Jaguar Warrior, Eagle Warrior, Sun Warrior.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: cheap tribal armies, sacred Jaguar and Eagle Warriors, mage-priests, and dominion sustained through blood sacrifice.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Mictlan opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Mictlan fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Mictlan, the most likely planning failure is blood-slave supply, priest turns, weak protection, dominion maintenance, and preventing expansion from outrunning sacrifice coverage. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Mictlan research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Mictlan magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 2, Water 2, Astral 2, Nature 2, Blood 3, Holy 3. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Mictlan battlefield packages



### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Mictlan Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Mictlan matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem          | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                  |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units     | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage     |
| Heavy armour           | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided     |
| Accurate missiles      | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards   |
| Elemental resistance   | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element |
| Fast raiders or flyers | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army              |

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                         | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Mictlan monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Mictlan unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Mictlan source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbfc036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXIII: Early Age Xibalba, Vigil of the Sun

## Early Age Xibalba one-page command brief

Early Age Xibalba converts numerous stealthy flying Zotz, cave recruitment, blood hunting, and dark Water-Earth-Death-Blood magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 11 commander identities and 8 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 17 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are very fragile troops, cave and surface logistics, blood economy, leadership, and surviving missile fire.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Xibalba evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Xibalba on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 26, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Xibalba object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Xibalba conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Xibalba recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 9          | 7      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Xibalba commander roster

| ID   | Commander                 | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2674 | Batab                     | none                                                                     | 75         |
| 2675 | Ajaw                      | H1                                                                       | 100        |
| 2676 | Ajaw Kan Ek'              | H2                                                                       | 150        |
| 2691 | Xibalban Scorpion Trainer | none                                                                     | 50         |
| 2678 | Chilan                    | E1 D1 H1                                                                 | 10         |
| 2679 | Ah Nakom                  | B1 H1                                                                    | 10         |
| 2677 | Ah K'in                   | F1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 37888 link 1                                 | 50         |
| 2680 | Ah Itz                    | D1 B1; random: 100% x1 mask 38144 link 1                                 | 10         |
| 2681 | Camazotz                  | D2 B1; random: 100% x1 mask 38144 link 1                                 | 10         |
| 2684 | Ah K'in Kan Ek'           | F2 E1 D1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 37888 link 1                           | 50         |
| 2736 | Onaqui                    | D3 N1 B3 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 45184 link 1; 10% x1 mask 45184 link 1 | 100        |

## Early Age Xibalba troop roster

| ID   | Unit                  | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits                |
|------|-----------------------|----|------------|--------|-----------------------|
| 2668 | Xibalban Warrior      | 7  | 0          | 9      | flying, stealthy      |
| 2669 | Xibalban Warrior      | 7  | 0          | 9      | flying, stealthy      |
| 2670 | Xibalban Dart Thrower | 7  | 0          | 9      | flying, stealthy      |
| 2671 | Xibalban Guard        | 8  | 0          | 11     | flying, stealthy      |
| 2687 | Large Scorpion        | 1  | 1          | 50     | magic being, stealthy |
| 2688 | Giant Scorpion        | 5  | 5          | 50     | magic being, stealthy |
| 2689 | Xibalban Scorpion     | 16 | 12         | 15     | ordinary body         |
| 2672 | Sun Guide             | 9  | 0          | 13     | sacred, flying        |

## Early Age Xibalba mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander       | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2675 | Ajaw            | H1                                                                       | 100        |
| 2676 | Ajaw Kan Ek'    | H2                                                                       | 150        |
| 2678 | Chilan          | E1 D1 H1                                                                 | 10         |
| 2679 | Ah Nakom        | B1 H1                                                                    | 10         |
| 2677 | Ah K'in         | F1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 37888 link 1                                 | 50         |
| 2680 | Ah Itz          | D1 B1; random: 100% x1 mask 38144 link 1                                 | 10         |
| 2681 | Camazotz        | D2 B1; random: 100% x1 mask 38144 link 1                                 | 10         |
| 2684 | Ah K'in Kan Ek' | F2 E1 D1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 37888 link 1                           | 50         |
| 2736 | Onaqui          | D3 N1 B3 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 45184 link 1; 10% x1 mask 45184 link 1 | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 2, Earth 1, Death 3, Nature 1, Blood 3, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Xibalba capital and national sites

| ID  | Site              | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded          |
|-----|-------------------|----------------|----------------------------|
| 174 | Cavern of the Sun | F3, E1         | Ah K'in Kan Ek', Sun Guide |
| 175 | House of Knives   | D2             | Onaqui                     |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Xibalba national spell map

| ID  | Spell                   | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 505 | Summon Jaguars          | Conjuration 3 | N2 H1       | 20         |
| 510 | Bind Beast Bats         | Blood 2       | B1          | 8          |
| 511 | Bind Jaguar Fiends      | Blood 4       | B1 F1       | 16         |
| 515 | Contact Onaqui          | Blood 7       | B4          | 101        |
| 516 | Rain of Jaguars         | Blood 8       | B6 F2       | 40         |
| 517 | Theft of the Sun        | Enchantment 8 | D6 F3       | 70         |
| 518 | Summon Sacred Scorpion  | Conjuration 3 | E1 D1       | 2          |
| 519 | Break the First Soul    | Blood 2       | B1          | 0          |
| 520 | Break the Second Soul   | Thaumaturgy 2 | E1          | 0          |
| 521 | Break the Third Soul    | Thaumaturgy 2 | A1          | 0          |
| 522 | Break the Fourth Soul   | Thaumaturgy 2 | D1          | 0          |
| 523 | Gift of the First Soul  | Blood 3       | B1          | 0          |
| 524 | Gift of the Second Soul | Thaumaturgy 3 | E1          | 0          |
| 525 | Gift of the Third Soul  | Thaumaturgy 3 | A1          | 0          |
| 526 | Gift of the Fourth Soul | Thaumaturgy 3 | D1          | 0          |
| 527 | Summon Balam            | Conjuration 7 | N4          | 60         |
| 528 | Summon Chaac            | Conjuration 8 | A4          | 75         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Xibalba national item boundary

| ID  | Item           | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|-----|----------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 203 | Scorpion Crown | 7            | F3 D2 | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Xibalba hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record              | Magic          | Boundary                           |
|------|--------------------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 2692 | Halach Uinic             | F2 B1 H3       | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2757 | Demon of the Bone Staff  | E2 D4 B3 H3    | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2758 | Demon of the Skull Staff | E2 D4 B3 H3    | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2759 | Demon of Pus             | F1 D3 N1 B3 H3 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2760 | Jaundice Demon           | F1 D3 N1 B3 H3 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2761 | Sweeping Demon           | B3             | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2762 | Stabbing Demon           | B3             | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Xibalba army identities

- Sacred roster: Sun Guide.
- Flying roster: Xibalban Warrior, Xibalban Warrior, Xibalban Dart Thrower, Xibalban Guard, Sun Guide.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: numerous stealthy flying Zotz, cave recruitment, blood hunting, and dark Water-Earth-Death-Blood magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Xibalba opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Xibalba fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Xibalba, the most likely planning failure is very fragile troops, cave and surface logistics, blood economy, leadership, and surviving missile fire. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Xibalba research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Xibalba magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 2, Earth 1, Death 3, Nature 1, Blood 3, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Xibalba battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Xibalba Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Xibalba matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Xibalba monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?



## Early Age Xibalba unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Xibalba source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXIV: Early Age C'tis, Lizard Kings

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## Early Age C'tis one-page command brief

Early Age C'tis converts cold-blooded lizard infantry, chariots, sacred serpents, and accomplished Death-Nature mages into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 10 commander identities and 11 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 4 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are temperature, low defence, supply, poison use, and keeping expensive Sauromancers available for their competing jobs.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age C'tis evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age C'tis on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 27, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any C'tis object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age C'tis conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
 -> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
 -> labelled fixed and random path access  
 -> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
 -> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age C'tis recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 8          | 10     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age C'tis commander roster

| ID   | Commander            | Fixed and random magic                                             | Leadership |
|------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 169  | Taskmaster           | none                                                               | 50         |
| 163  | Commander of C'tis   | none                                                               | 75         |
| 162  | Lizard Lord          | none                                                               | 100        |
| 160  | High Priest of C'tis | H2                                                                 | 50         |
| 510  | Hierodule            | H1                                                                 | 0          |
| 170  | Lizard Shaman        | S1 N1                                                              | 10         |
| 1387 | Reborn               | D2                                                                 | 10         |
| 161  | Sauromancer          | D3 N1; random: 100% x1 mask 14848 link 1; 10% x1 mask 14848 link 1 | 10         |
| 177  | Lizard King          | H3                                                                 | 150        |
| 1366 | Lizard Heir          | H1                                                                 | 100        |

## Early Age C'tis troop roster

| ID   | Unit                      | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|---------------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 168  | Militia                   | 11 | 5          | 7      | ordinary body |
| 167  | C'tissian Light Infantry  | 11 | 5          | 9      | ordinary body |
| 4062 | C'tissian Medium Infantry | 11 | 5          | 9      | ordinary body |
| 166  | City Guard                | 11 | 5          | 9      | ordinary body |
| 165  | C'tissian Heavy Infantry  | 11 | 5          | 9      | ordinary body |
| 504  | Falchioneer               | 11 | 5          | 10     | ordinary body |

| ID   | Unit              | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|-------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 171  | Slave Warrior     | 13 | 3          | 8      | ordinary body |
| 172  | Elite Warrior     | 13 | 3          | 9      | ordinary body |
| 173  | Runner            | 12 | 3          | 8      | ordinary body |
| 1365 | Lizard Charioteer | 13 | 5          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 783  | Serpent Dancer    | 11 | 5          | 11     | sacred        |

## Early Age C'tis mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander            | Fixed and random magic                                             | Leadership |
|------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 160  | High Priest of C'tis | H2                                                                 | 50         |
| 510  | Hierodule            | H1                                                                 | 0          |
| 170  | Lizard Shaman        | S1 N1                                                              | 10         |
| 1387 | Reborn               | D2                                                                 | 10         |
| 161  | Sauromancer          | D3 N1; random: 100% x1 mask 14848 link 1; 10% x1 mask 14848 link 1 | 10         |
| 177  | Lizard King          | H3                                                                 | 150        |
| 1366 | Lizard Heir          | H1                                                                 | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Astral 1, Death 3, Nature 1, Holy 3. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age C'tis capital and national sites

| ID | Site            | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                        |
|----|-----------------|----------------|------------------------------------------|
| 9  | The Temple City | D4, N2         | Lizard King, Lizard Heir, Serpent Dancer |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age C'tis national spell map

| ID  | Spell                | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|----------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 318 | Contact Scorpion Man | Conjuration 8 | E1 F1       | 12         |
| 339 | Sacred Crocodile     | Conjuration 4 | N2 W2       | 1          |
| 459 | Summon Monster Toads | Conjuration 5 | N2          | 5          |
| 460 | Contact Couatl       | Conjuration 7 | N1 S1       | 40         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age C'tis national item boundary

| ID  | Item          | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|---------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 226 | The Jade Mask | 9            | D6 N3 | restricted |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age C'tis hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record         | Magic    | Boundary                           |
|------|---------------------|----------|------------------------------------|
| 379  | Lizard Hero         | none     | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1660 | Reassembled Prince  | H2       | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1708 | Consort of the Dead | S2 D4 N3 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 635  | Ancient Shaman      | S2 N2 H1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age C'tis army identities

- Sacred roster: Serpent Dancer.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: cold-blooded lizard infantry, chariots, sacred serpents, and accomplished Death-Nature mages.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age C'tis opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age C'tis fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For C'tis, the most likely planning failure is temperature, low defence, supply, poison use, and keeping expensive Sauromancers available for their competing jobs. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age C'tis research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age C'tis magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Astral 1, Death 3, Nature 1, Holy 3. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age C'tis battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age C'tis Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age C'tis matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age C'tis monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age C'tis unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age C'tis source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXV: Early Age Machaka, Lion Kings

## Early Age Machaka one-page command brief

Early Age Machaka converts totemic human clans, poison archers, spider riders, war lions, elephants, and semi-divine Colossi into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 12 commander identities and 14 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 3 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are mixed recruitment, animal morale, poison exposure, trampling control, and scarce top-end commanders.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Machaka evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Machaka on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 28, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Machaka object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Machaka conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
 -> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
 -> labelled fixed and random path access  
 -> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
 -> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Machaka recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 9          | 10     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 3          | 4      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Machaka commander roster

| ID   | Commander                | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2288 | Machaka Scout            | none                                                                     | 0          |
| 2289 | Rhino Clan Commander     | none                                                                     | 75         |
| 2290 | Lion Clan Commander      | none                                                                     | 100        |
| 4134 | Gnu Clan Commander       | none                                                                     | 50         |
| 2291 | Voice of Lion            | N1 H1                                                                    | 50         |
| 2292 | Hyena Clan Witch Doctor  | F1 E1 D2                                                                 | 10         |
| 2293 | Bouda                    | F1 E2 D2; random: 100% x1 mask 5248 link 1                               | 10         |
| 2310 | Voice of Spider          | none                                                                     | 0          |
| 2403 | Spider Clan Witch Doctor | F1 D1 N1 G1                                                              | 10         |
| 2295 | Spider Clan Sorcerer     | F1 D1 N1 G1; random: 100% x2 mask 29824 link 1; 10% x1 mask 29824 link 1 | 10         |
| 2297 | Lion Queen               | F3 E1 N2 H1; random: 10% x1 mask 9344 link 1                             | 50         |
| 2296 | Lion King                | F2 E1 N3 H2; random: 10% x1 mask 9344 link 1                             | 100        |

## Early Age Machaka troop roster

| ID   | Unit             | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 2126 | Pygmy            | 4  | 0          | 6      | ordinary body |
| 2298 | Machaka Militia  | 10 | 0          | 8      | ordinary body |
| 2299 | Bird Clan Archer | 10 | 0          | 8      | ordinary body |
| 2300 | Machaka Warrior  | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |



| ID   | Unit                | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|---------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 2303 | Hyena Clan Warrior  | 11 | 0          | 9      | ordinary body |
| 2304 | Rhino Clan Warrior  | 13 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 2305 | Lion Clan Warrior   | 12 | 0          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 2306 | War Lion            | 20 | 4          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 4133 | Gnu Clan Cavalry    | 11 | 0          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 2307 | Elephant Rider      | 13 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 2301 | Spider Clan Archer  | 9  | 0          | 8      | ordinary body |
| 2302 | Spider Clan Warrior | 9  | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 2308 | Spider Rider        | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 2309 | Lion Warrior        | 22 | 1          | 14     | sacred        |

## Early Age Machaka mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander                | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2291 | Voice of Lion            | N1 H1                                                                    | 50         |
| 2292 | Hyena Clan Witch Doctor  | F1 E1 D2                                                                 | 10         |
| 2293 | Bouda                    | F1 E2 D2; random: 100% x1 mask 5248 link 1                               | 10         |
| 2403 | Spider Clan Witch Doctor | F1 D1 N1 G1                                                              | 10         |
| 2295 | Spider Clan Sorcerer     | F1 D1 N1 G1; random: 100% x2 mask 29824 link 1; 10% x1 mask 29824 link 1 | 10         |
| 2297 | Lion Queen               | F3 E1 N2 H1; random: 10% x1 mask 9344 link 1                             | 50         |
| 2296 | Lion King                | F2 E1 N3 H2; random: 10% x1 mask 9344 link 1                             | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 3, Earth 2, Death 2, Nature 3, Glamour 1, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Machaka capital and national sites

| ID  | Site             | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                                                           |
|-----|------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 153 | Forest of Spider | D1, N1, G1     | Spider Clan Sorcerer, Spider Clan Archer, Spider Clan Warrior, Spider Rider |
| 154 | Great Mababwe    | F1, E2         | Lion Queen, Lion King, Lion Warrior                                         |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Machaka national spell map

| ID  | Spell             | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 340 | Herd of Elephants | Conjuration 3 | N2          | 20         |

| ID   | Spell               | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|------|---------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 343  | Weavers of the Wood | Enchantment 5 | N4          | 6          |
| 1473 | Herd of Gnus        | Conjuration 3 | N2          | 5          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Machaka national item boundary

| ID  | Item                  | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|-----|-----------------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 177 | Totem Shield          | 5            | D1 G1 | rebate |
| 197 | Spirit Mask           | 5            | D2 N1 | rebate |
| 240 | Kithaironic Lion Pelt | 3            | N1 E1 | rebate |
| 427 | Fever Fetish          | 9            | F1 N1 | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Machaka hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record     | Magic       | Boundary                           |
|------|-----------------|-------------|------------------------------------|
| 952  | Hero            | none        | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 953  | King Triumphant | H3          | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 946  | Lady of Spiders | F1 E3 D3 G2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1426 | Crowned Ape     | H1          | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1706 | Ape Oracle      | N1          | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Machaka army identities

- Sacred roster: Lion Warrior.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: totemic human clans, poison archers, spider riders, war lions, elephants, and semi-divine Colossi.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Machaka opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Machaka fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Machaka, the most likely planning failure is mixed recruitment, animal morale, poison exposure, trampling control, and scarce top-end commanders. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Machaka research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Machaka magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 3, Earth 2, Death 2, Nature 3, Glamour 1, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Machaka battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

## Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

## Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

## Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Machaka Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Machaka matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Machaka monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Machaka unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Machaka source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXVI: Early Age Berytos, The Phoenix Empire

## Early Age Berytos one-page command brief

Early Age Berytos converts coastal trade, sailing human forces, Colossi, and sorcerer-queens with unusually wide magical access into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 5 commander identities and 9 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 7 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are capital dependence, expensive mages, coastal staging, sailing limits, and balancing trade income against military replacement.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Berytos evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Berytos on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 29, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Berytos object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Berytos conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
-> labelled fixed and random path access  
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Berytos recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 4          | 8      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 1          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Berytos commander roster

| ID   | Commander        | Fixed and random magic                                                      | Leadership |
|------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2252 | Berytian Scout   | none                                                                        | 0          |
| 2253 | Berytian Captain | none                                                                        | 100        |
| 2265 | Berytian Priest  | B1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 34176 link 1                                    | 10         |
| 2424 | Berytian Sage    | E1; random: 100% x1 mask 768 link 1                                         | 10         |
| 2266 | Bride-in-Waiting | F2 A2 E1 B2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 34176 link 1; 10% x1 mask 34176 link 1 | 100        |

## Early Age Berytos troop roster

| ID   | Unit             | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 2254 | Berytian Militia | 10 | 0          | 8      | ordinary body |
| 2255 | Berytian Archer  | 10 | 0          | 8      | ordinary body |

| ID   | Unit                    | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|-------------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 2256 | Berytian Spearman       | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 2257 | Berytian Soldier        | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 2258 | Berytian Heavy Spearman | 10 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 2259 | Berytian Elite Soldier  | 12 | 0          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 2260 | Berytian Lancer         | 10 | 0          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 2261 | Elephant Rider          | 10 | 0          | 8      | ordinary body |
| 2262 | Colossi Warrior         | 22 | 1          | 14     | sacred        |

## Early Age Berytos mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander        | Fixed and random magic                                                      | Leadership |
|------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2265 | Berytian Priest  | B1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 34176 link 1                                    | 10         |
| 2424 | Berytian Sage    | E1; random: 100% x1 mask 768 link 1                                         | 10         |
| 2266 | Bride-in-Waiting | F2 A2 E1 B2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 34176 link 1; 10% x1 mask 34176 link 1 | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 2, Air 2, Earth 1, Blood 2, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Berytos capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                        | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                 |
|-----|-----------------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------|
| 152 | Temple of Storms and Flames | F2, A3, B2     | Bride-in-Waiting, Colossi Warrior |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Berytos national spell map

| ID  | Spell             | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 340 | Herd of Elephants | Conjuration 3 | N2          | 20         |
| 344 | Call Melqart      | Blood 6       | B3 F2       | 99         |
| 349 | Scapegoats        | Blood 3       | B1          | 8          |
| 351 | Summon Shedim     | Blood 4       | B3 A1       | 28         |
| 358 | Summon Mazzikim   | Conjuration 3 | N1          | 3          |
| 359 | Summon Lilot      | Conjuration 5 | N4          | 15         |
| 366 | Summon Telkhine   | Conjuration 8 | W5 A2       | 69         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

### Early Age Berytos national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

### Early Age Berytos hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record       | Magic             | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------------|-------------------|------------------------------------|
| 2429 | Bride of the Gods | F3 E1 D3 B3 H2    | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2430 | King of the City  | F3 A2 B3 H3       | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2876 | Queen of the City | F3 A3 W3 E4 N2 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

### Early Age Berytos army identities

- Sacred roster: Colossi Warrior.
  - Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
  - Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
  - Core identity: coastal trade, sailing human forces, Colossi, and sorcerer-queens with unusually wide magical access.
- These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

### Early Age Berytos opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.



## Early Age Berytos fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Berytos, the most likely planning failure is capital dependence, expensive mages, coastal staging, sailing limits, and balancing trade income against military replacement. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Berytos research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Berytos magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 2, Air 2, Earth 1, Blood 2, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Berytos battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

## Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Berytos Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Berytos matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Berytos monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Berytos unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Berytos source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXVII: Early Age Vanheim, Age of Vanir

## Early Age Vanheim one-page command brief

Early Age Vanheim converts glamour-protected Vanir, sacred cavalry, sailing, blood priests, and Air-Earth dwarven smiths into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 5 commander identities and 7 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 3 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are elite scarcity, glamour counters, blood-hunting costs, sailing boundaries, and ordinary frontage.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Vanheim evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Vanheim on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 30, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Vanheim object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Vanheim conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
 -> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
 -> labelled fixed and random path access  
 -> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
 -> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Vanheim recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 3          | 5      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 2      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Vanheim commander roster

| ID   | Commander     | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1512 | Van Scout     | none                                                                     | 0          |
| 263  | Vanherse      | A1 G1 H1                                                                 | 75         |
| 264  | Vanjarl       | A2 G1 B1 H2                                                              | 100        |
| 948  | Vanadrott     | A2 G2 B1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 54528 link 1; 10% x1 mask 54528 link 1 | 150        |
| 323  | Dwarven Smith | E2; random: 100% x1 mask 21888 link 1; 10% x1 mask 21888 link 1          | 10         |

## Early Age Vanheim troop roster

| ID   | Unit            | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits           |
|------|-----------------|----|------------|--------|------------------|
| 1679 | Serf Warrior    | 10 | 0          | 8      | ordinary body    |
| 1508 | Huskarl         | 13 | 0          | 11     | stealthy         |
| 1509 | Huskarl         | 13 | 0          | 11     | stealthy         |
| 1510 | Hirdman         | 13 | 0          | 12     | stealthy         |
| 1504 | Mounted Hirdman | 13 | 0          | 12     | stealthy         |
| 1513 | Vanhere         | 15 | 0          | 15     | sacred, stealthy |
| 463  | Fay Boar        | 18 | 4          | 18     | ordinary body    |

## Early Age Vanheim mage and priest portfolio

| ID  | Commander     | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|-----|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 263 | Vanherse      | A1 G1 H1                                                                 | 75         |
| 264 | Vanjarl       | A2 G1 B1 H2                                                              | 100        |
| 948 | Vanadrott     | A2 G2 B1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 54528 link 1; 10% x1 mask 54528 link 1 | 150        |
| 323 | Dwarven Smith | E2; random: 100% x1 mask 21888 link 1; 10% x1 mask 21888 link 1          | 10         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Air 2, Earth 2, Glamour 2, Blood 1, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Vanheim capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                 | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded       |
|-----|----------------------|----------------|-------------------------|
| 114 | Vanhalla             | A2, G1         | Vanadrott, Vanhere      |
| 115 | The Halls of Andvare | E3             | Dwarven Smith, Fay Boar |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Vanheim national spell map

| ID  | Spell                               | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-------------------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 491 | Summon Dwarf of the Four Directions | Conjuration 8 | A4 E3       | 62         |
| 492 | Summon Valkyries                    | Conjuration 6 | A3 D1       | 1          |
| 493 | Awaken Draugar                      | Conjuration 4 | D2          | 12         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Vanheim national item boundary

| ID  | Item                        | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|-----|-----------------------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 29  | Dwarven Hammer              | 3            | E3    | rebate |
| 236 | Lightweight Scale Mail      | 3            | A1    | rebate |
| 262 | Weightless Scale Mail       | 7            | A1    | rebate |
| 280 | Pebble Skin Suit            | 9            | B4 E1 | rebate |
| 361 | Cauldron of the Elven Halls | 5            | G3    | rebate |
| 435 | Draupnir                    | 9            | E5    | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Vanheim hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record | Magic          | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 590  | Vanadrott   | A3 D2 G2 B2 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 1511 | Vanadis     | F2 A2 G2 H1    | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Vanheim army identities

- Sacred roster: Vanhere.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: glamour-protected Vanir, sacred cavalry, sailing, blood priests, and Air-Earth dwarven smiths.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Vanheim opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Vanheim fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Vanheim, the most likely planning failure is elite scarcity, glamour counters, blood-hunting costs, sailing boundaries, and ordinary frontage. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Vanheim research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.

- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Vanheim magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Air 2, Earth 2, Glamour 2, Blood 1, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Vanheim battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Vanheim Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |

| Family               | What it can solve                       | What it cannot conceal                                                       |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Awake expansion body | Reduces pressure on the starting roster | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents |
| Resistance package   | Covers a documented roster weakness     | One resistance is not universal defence                                      |

## Early Age Vanheim matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Vanheim monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Vanheim unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Vanheim source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.



- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXVIII: Early Age Helheim, Dusk and Death

## Early Age Helheim one-page command brief

Early Age Helheim converts Valkyries, Helhirding cavalry, stealth and glamour, backed by Death-Air mages into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 7 commander identities and 7 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 4 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are small elite armies, glamour counters, fragile support troops, expensive recruitment, and raiding without losing strategic concentration.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Helheim evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Helheim on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 31, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Helheim object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Helheim conversion chain

```
verified recruitment and national assets
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes
-> labelled fixed and random path access
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth
```

## Early Age Helheim recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 4          | 5      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 3          | 2      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Helheim commander roster

| ID   | Commander  | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1512 | Van Scout  | none                                                                  | 0          |
| 1505 | Vanherse   | A1 G1 H1                                                              | 75         |
| 1506 | Vanjarl    | A2 D1 G1 H2                                                           | 100        |
| 1502 | Helkarl    | D1 G1 H1                                                              | 100        |
| 1507 | Dis        | A1 D1 G1 H1                                                           | 100        |
| 847  | Hangadrott | D3 G2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 21760 link 1; 10% x1 mask 21760 link 1 | 150        |
| 1010 | Svartalf   | E2 D2; random: 100% x1 mask 21888 link 1                              | 10         |

## Early Age Helheim troop roster

| ID   | Unit            | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits                   |
|------|-----------------|----|------------|--------|--------------------------|
| 1679 | Serf Warrior    | 10 | 0          | 8      | ordinary body            |
| 1508 | Huskarl         | 13 | 0          | 11     | stealthy                 |
| 1509 | Huskarl         | 13 | 0          | 11     | stealthy                 |
| 1510 | Hirdman         | 13 | 0          | 12     | stealthy                 |
| 1504 | Mounted Hirdman | 13 | 0          | 12     | stealthy                 |
| 855  | Valkyrie        | 13 | 0          | 12     | sacred, flying, stealthy |
| 1503 | Helhirding      | 14 | 0          | 13     | sacred, stealthy         |

## Early Age Helheim mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander  | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1505 | Vanherse   | A1 G1 H1                                                              | 75         |
| 1506 | Vanjarl    | A2 D1 G1 H2                                                           | 100        |
| 1502 | Helkarl    | D1 G1 H1                                                              | 100        |
| 1507 | Dis        | A1 D1 G1 H1                                                           | 100        |
| 847  | Hangadrott | D3 G2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 21760 link 1; 10% x1 mask 21760 link 1 | 150        |

| ID   | Commander | Fixed and random magic                   | Leadership |
|------|-----------|------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1010 | Svartalf  | E2 D2; random: 100% x1 mask 21888 link 1 | 10         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Air 2, Earth 2, Death 3, Glamour 2, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Helheim capital and national sites

| ID  | Site       | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                     |
|-----|------------|----------------|---------------------------------------|
| 59  | Helhalla   | G1             | Dis, Hangadrott, Valkyrie, Helhirding |
| 113 | Gnipahålan | E1, D4         | Svartalf                              |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Helheim national spell map

| ID  | Spell                               | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-------------------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 491 | Summon Dwarf of the Four Directions | Conjuration 8 | A4 E3       | 62         |
| 492 | Summon Valkyries                    | Conjuration 6 | A3 D1       | 1          |
| 493 | Awaken Draugar                      | Conjuration 4 | D2          | 12         |
| 496 | Brood of Garm                       | Conjuration 4 | N2          | 10         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Helheim national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Helheim hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record    | Magic       | Boundary                           |
|------|----------------|-------------|------------------------------------|
| 2473 | Hangadrottning | A1 D4 G2 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Helheim army identities

- Sacred roster: Valkyrie, Helhirding.
- Flying roster: Valkyrie.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: Valkyries, Helhirding cavalry, stealth and glamour, backed by Death-Air mages.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Helheim opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Helheim fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Helheim, the most likely planning failure is small elite armies, glamour counters, fragile support troops, expensive recruitment, and raiding without losing strategic concentration. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Helheim research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Helheim magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Air 2, Earth 2, Death 3, Glamour 2, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Helheim battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Helheim Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Helheim matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem        | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                  |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units   | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage     |
| Heavy armour         | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided     |
| Accurate missiles    | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards   |
| Elemental resistance | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element |

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                         | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves  | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Helheim monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Helheim unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Helheim source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXIX: Early Age Rus, Sons of Heaven

## Early Age Rus one-page command brief

Early Age Rus converts human hunters and berserkers, Chud elites, sacred bear skinshifters, and Air-Nature-Fire magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 8 commander identities and 7 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 16 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are mixed troop quality, transformation behaviour, forest recruitment, limited armour, and distributing expensive mages.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Rus evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Rus on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 32, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Rus object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Rus conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Rus recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 5          | 5      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 2          | 1      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 3          | 2      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Rus commander roster

| ID   | Commander           | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2984 | Scout               | none                                                                  | 0          |
| 2985 | Rusian Chieftain    | none                                                                  | 75         |
| 2986 | Rusian Priest       | H1                                                                    | 10         |
| 2987 | Rusian Wizard       | F1 N1; random: 100% x1 mask 11520 link 1                              | 10         |
| 3008 | Rusian Chieftain    | none                                                                  | 50         |
| 3000 | Son of Heaven       | F1 A1 N1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 10624 link 1                        | 150        |
| 3001 | Daughter of the Sun | F2 N1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 10624 link 1; 10% x1 mask 10624 link 1 | 100        |
| 2999 | Perkunu             | A3 S1 N2 H1; random: 10% x1 mask 10496 link 1                         | 50         |

## Early Age Rus troop roster

| ID   | Unit             | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|------------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 2989 | Rusian Hunter    | 10 | 0          | 11     | stealthy      |
| 2990 | Rusian Warrior   | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 2991 | Rusian Warrior   | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body |
| 2993 | Chud Warrior     | 17 | 2          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 2994 | Chud Berserker   | 17 | 2          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 2992 | Chud Hunter      | 17 | 2          | 13     | stealthy      |
| 2997 | Chud Skinshifter | 19 | 2          | 14     | sacred        |

## Early Age Rus mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander           | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2986 | Rusian Priest       | H1                                                                    | 10         |
| 2987 | Rusian Wizard       | F1 N1; random: 100% x1 mask 11520 link 1                              | 10         |
| 3000 | Son of Heaven       | F1 A1 N1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 10624 link 1                        | 150        |
| 3001 | Daughter of the Sun | F2 N1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 10624 link 1; 10% x1 mask 10624 link 1 | 100        |
| 2999 | Perkunu             | A3 S1 N2 H1; random: 10% x1 mask 10496 link 1                         | 50         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 2, Air 3, Astral 1, Nature 2, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Rus capital and national sites



| ID  | Site             | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                  |
|-----|------------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 191 | Hall of the Dawn | F1, A1         | Son of Heaven, Daughter of the Sun |
| 189 | Pine of Skulls   | S1, N1         | Chud Hunter, Chud Skinshifter      |
| 190 | Oak of Storms    | A1, N1         | Perkunu                            |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Rus national spell map

| ID  | Spell                 | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-----------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 321 | Summon Bears          | Conjuration 3 | N1 H1       | 8          |
| 322 | Summon Simargl        | Conjuration 2 | A1          | 1          |
| 323 | Summon Firebird       | Conjuration 3 | F1 S1       | 2          |
| 324 | Send Lady Middyay     | Conjuration 5 | A3 D1       | 5          |
| 325 | Contact Sirin         | Conjuration 3 | S2          | 8          |
| 326 | Send Vodyanoy         | Conjuration 4 | W2          | 20         |
| 327 | Summon Rusalka        | Conjuration 4 | W1 D1       | 16         |
| 328 | Summon Likho          | Conjuration 4 | D1          | 10         |
| 329 | Contact Alkonost      | Conjuration 4 | S2          | 15         |
| 330 | Summon Zmey           | Conjuration 5 | F2          | 5          |
| 331 | Send Bukavac          | Conjuration 5 | W4          | 5          |
| 332 | Contact Gamayun       | Conjuration 5 | S3          | 25         |
| 333 | Contact Beregina      | Conjuration 6 | W3 E1       | 35         |
| 334 | Contact Mountain Vila | Conjuration 7 | N4          | 40         |
| 335 | Contact Cloud Vila    | Conjuration 7 | A4          | 40         |
| 336 | Contact Leshiy        | Conjuration 8 | N6          | 60         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Rus national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Rus hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record             | Magic       | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------------------|-------------|------------------------------------|
| 1958 | Hag                     | A3 W1 D3 N2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 3234 | Son of the Bear         | S2 N3 H2    | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 3241 | Daughter of the Thunder | A4 E1 N2 H1 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Rus army identities

- Sacred roster: Chud Skinshifter.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: human hunters and berserkers, Chud elites, sacred bear skinshifters, and Air-Nature-Fire magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Rus opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Rus fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Rus, the most likely planning failure is mixed troop quality, transformation behaviour, forest recruitment, limited armour, and distributing expensive mages. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Rus research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.

- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Rus magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 2, Air 3, Astral 1, Nature 2, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Rus battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Rus Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Rus matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Rus monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Rus unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Rus source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXX: Early Age Niefelheim, Sons of Winter

## Early Age Niefelheim one-page command brief

Early Age Niefelheim converts frost giants, Jotun infantry, skinshifters, and Water-Death-Blood magic under a cold dominion into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 7 commander identities and 8 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 6 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are extreme gold costs, low model count, temperature, blood hunting, and replacing giants after attritional battles.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Niefelheim evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Niefelheim on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 33, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Niefelheim object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Niefelheim conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Niefelheim recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 6          | 8      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 1          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Niefelheim commander roster

| ID   | Commander     | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 786  | Jotun Scout   | none                                                                  | 0          |
| 1301 | Jotun Herse   | none                                                                  | 75         |
| 1299 | Jotun Jarl    | H1                                                                    | 100        |
| 1300 | Jotun Gode    | H2                                                                    | 50         |
| 553  | Jotun Skratti | W2 B2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 53760 link 1                           | 10         |
| 785  | Gygja         | D1 G1 B1; random: 100% x2 mask 63488 link 1; 10% x1 mask 63488 link 1 | 50         |
| 844  | Niefel Jarl   | W3 D2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 20992 link 1; 10% x1 mask 20992 link 1 | 150        |

## Early Age Niefelheim troop roster

| ID   | Unit          | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|---------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 1302 | Jotun Bondi   | 31 | 5          | 11     | ordinary body |
| 1303 | Jotun Warrior | 33 | 5          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1304 | Jotun Warrior | 35 | 5          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1305 | Jotun Hurler  | 33 | 5          | 12     | ordinary body |
| 1306 | Jotun Huskarl | 35 | 5          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 1307 | Godihuskarl   | 36 | 5          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 1308 | Jotun Hirdman | 38 | 5          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 845  | Niefel Giant  | 69 | 7          | 14     | sacred        |

## Early Age Niefelheim mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander     | Fixed and random magic                                                | Leadership |
|------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1299 | Jotun Jarl    | H1                                                                    | 100        |
| 1300 | Jotun Gode    | H2                                                                    | 50         |
| 553  | Jotun Skratti | W2 B2 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 53760 link 1                           | 10         |
| 785  | Gygja         | D1 G1 B1; random: 100% x2 mask 63488 link 1; 10% x1 mask 63488 link 1 | 50         |
| 844  | Niefel Jarl   | W3 D2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 20992 link 1; 10% x1 mask 20992 link 1 | 150        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Water 3, Death 2, Glamour 1, Blood 2, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Niefelheim capital and national sites

| ID | Site       | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded         |
|----|------------|----------------|---------------------------|
| 46 | Niefelheim | W4, D2         | Niefel Jarl, Niefel Giant |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Niefelheim national spell map

| ID  | Spell                               | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-------------------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 491 | Summon Dwarf of the Four Directions | Conjuration 8 | A4 E3       | 62         |
| 494 | Seith Curse                         | Thaumaturgy 5 | D1 S1       | 3          |
| 496 | Brood of Garm                       | Conjuration 4 | N2          | 10         |
| 497 | Awaken Jotun Draugar                | Conjuration 4 | D2          | 15         |
| 498 | Summon Rimvaettir                   | Conjuration 5 | W2          | 5          |
| 500 | Illwinter                           | Blood 6       | B5 W3       | 120        |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Niefelheim national item boundary

| ID  | Item                   | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|-----|------------------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 114 | The Sword of Aurgelmer | 9            | G6    | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Niefelheim hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record | Magic          | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 1382 | Abductor    | A3 W3 D3 H2    | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 586  | Great Hag   | S3 D3 N2 G3 B3 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Niefelheim army identities

- Sacred roster: Niefel Giant.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.

- Core identity: frost giants, Jotun infantry, skinshifters, and Water-Death-Blood magic under a cold dominion.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Niefelheim opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Niefelheim fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Niefelheim, the most likely planning failure is extreme gold costs, low model count, temperature, blood hunting, and replacing giants after attritional battles. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Niefelheim research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Niefelheim magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Water 3, Death 2, Glamour 1, Blood 2, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Niefelheim battlefield packages



### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Niefelheim Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Niefelheim matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem          | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                  |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units     | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage     |
| Heavy armour           | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided     |
| Accurate missiles      | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards   |
| Elemental resistance   | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element |
| Fast raiders or flyers | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army              |

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                         | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Niefelheim monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Niefelheim unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Niefelheim source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXXI: Early Age Muspelheim, Sons of Fire

## Early Age Muspelheim one-page command brief

Early Age Muspelheim converts fire giants, Jotun support, and broad Fire-Air-Death-Glamour-Blood magic in a hot dominion into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 5 commander identities and 3 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 5 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are extreme gold costs, temperature, scarce bodies, blood economy, and answering fire-resistant enemies.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Muspelheim evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Muspelheim on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 34, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Muspelheim object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Muspelheim conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Muspelheim recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 1          | 0      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 4          | 3      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Muspelheim commander roster

| ID   | Commander    | Fixed and random magic                                                 | Leadership |
|------|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3972 | Muspeldottir | F1 A1 D1; random: 100% x1 mask 6528 link 1                             | 50         |
| 3958 | Muspel Herse | H1                                                                     | 100        |
| 3959 | Muspel Gode  | F1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 4480 link 1                                | 50         |
| 3960 | Muspelgygja  | F2 A1; random: 100% x2 mask 22912 link 1; 10% x1 mask 22912 link 1     | 50         |
| 3961 | Muspel Jarl  | F3 A1 D1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 4480 link 1; 10% x1 mask 4480 link 1 | 150        |

## Early Age Muspelheim troop roster

| ID   | Unit           | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits        |
|------|----------------|----|------------|--------|---------------|
| 3969 | Muspel Huskarl | 34 | 5          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 3970 | Muspel Hirdman | 36 | 5          | 13     | ordinary body |
| 3971 | Muspel Giant   | 63 | 7          | 14     | sacred        |

## Early Age Muspelheim mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander    | Fixed and random magic                                                 | Leadership |
|------|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 3972 | Muspeldottir | F1 A1 D1; random: 100% x1 mask 6528 link 1                             | 50         |
| 3958 | Muspel Herse | H1                                                                     | 100        |
| 3959 | Muspel Gode  | F1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 4480 link 1                                | 50         |
| 3960 | Muspelgygja  | F2 A1; random: 100% x2 mask 22912 link 1; 10% x1 mask 22912 link 1     | 50         |
| 3961 | Muspel Jarl  | F3 A1 D1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 4480 link 1; 10% x1 mask 4480 link 1 | 150        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 3, Air 1, Death 1, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Muspelheim capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                                                      |
|-----|---------------------|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 236 | Muspelheim          | F1, A1         | Muspel Herse, Muspel Gode, Muspelgygja, Muspel Huskarl, Muspel Hirdman |
| 237 | The Rift of Surtr   | F2, D1         | Muspel Jarl, Muspel Giant                                              |
| 238 | The Meltwater Gorge | W1             | none in explicit recruit fields                                        |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Muspelheim national spell map

| ID  | Spell                               | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|-------------------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 491 | Summon Dwarf of the Four Directions | Conjuration 8 | A4 E3       | 62         |
| 494 | Seith Curse                         | Thaumaturgy 5 | D1 S1       | 3          |
| 496 | Brood of Garm                       | Conjuration 4 | N2          | 10         |
| 497 | Awaken Jotun Draugar                | Conjuration 4 | D2          | 15         |
| 501 | Summon Glosos                       | Conjuration 3 | D2          | 10         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Muspelheim national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Muspelheim hero boundary

No fixed hero-slot identity was resolved from attributes 139-149. Hero arrival and timing remain unscheduled.

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Muspelheim army identities

- Sacred roster: Muspel Giant.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: fire giants, Jotun support, and broad Fire-Air-Death-Glamour-Blood magic in a hot dominion.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Muspelheim opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Muspelheim fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Muspelheim, the most likely planning failure is extreme gold costs, temperature, scarce bodies, blood economy, and answering fire-resistant enemies. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Muspelheim research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Muspelheim magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 3, Air 1, Death 1, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Muspelheim battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

## Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Muspelheim Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Muspelheim matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Muspelheim monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Muspelheim unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Muspelheim source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXXII: Early Age Pelagia, Pearl Kings

## Early Age Pelagia one-page command brief

Early Age Pelagia converts aquatic Triton clans, amphibious mermen, sacred Pearl Kings, and Water-Astral-Nature magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 12 commander identities and 13 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 0 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are deep-water geography, limited land projection, commander coverage, and separating aquatic from amphibious replacement.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Pelagia evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Pelagia on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 40, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`.



The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Pelagia object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Pelagia conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
 -> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
 -> labelled fixed and random path access  
 -> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
 -> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Pelagia recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 7          | 9      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 4          | 3      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Pelagia commander roster

| ID   | Commander                | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1050 | Merman Scout             | none                                                                     | 0          |
| 1293 | Turtle Chief             | none                                                                     | 75         |
| 2390 | Pelagian Captain         | none                                                                     | 100        |
| 1696 | Merman Priest            | H1                                                                       | 10         |
| 1415 | Pelagian Mermage         | W1; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1                                     | 10         |
| 2395 | Pearl Clan Priest        | H2                                                                       | 50         |
| 2396 | Pearl Mage               | W2 S1 N1; random: 100% x1 mask 11008 link 1                              | 10         |
| 1294 | Turtle Chief             | none                                                                     | 75         |
| 2811 | Pelagian Shore Commander | none                                                                     | 75         |
| 2813 | Pelagian Explorer        | W1; random: 100% x1 mask 11520 link 1                                    | 10         |
| 2397 | Pearl King               | W4 S1 N1 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 10496 link 1; 10% x1 mask 11008 link 1 | 150        |
| 2805 | Ichtyid Pearl Mage       | W1 S1                                                                    | 10         |

## Early Age Pelagia troop roster

| ID   | Unit                   | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits          |
|------|------------------------|----|------------|--------|-----------------|
| 2388 | Merman Net Thrower     | 10 | 1          | 10     | amphibious      |
| 1291 | Turtle Warrior         | 10 | 1          | 11     | amphibious      |
| 2382 | Turtle Tribe Triton    | 10 | 0          | 11     | aquatic         |
| 2383 | Shark Tribe Triton     | 10 | 0          | 11     | aquatic         |
| 2384 | Pelagian Militia       | 12 | 1          | 9      | aquatic         |
| 1056 | Pelagian Militia       | 12 | 1          | 9      | aquatic         |
| 2385 | Pelagian Soldier       | 15 | 1          | 11     | aquatic         |
| 2386 | Coral Clan Soldier     | 16 | 1          | 12     | aquatic         |
| 2391 | Triton Rider           | 15 | 1          | 13     | aquatic         |
| 1292 | Turtle Warrior         | 10 | 1          | 11     | poor amphibian  |
| 2807 | Pelagian Shore Fighter | 10 | 1          | 10     | poor amphibian  |
| 2809 | Sideraspist            | 10 | 1          | 11     | poor amphibian  |
| 2387 | Pearl Guard            | 16 | 1          | 13     | sacred, aquatic |

## Early Age Pelagia mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander          | Fixed and random magic                                                   | Leadership |
|------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1696 | Merman Priest      | H1                                                                       | 10         |
| 1415 | Pelagian Mermage   | W1; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1                                     | 10         |
| 2395 | Pearl Clan Priest  | H2                                                                       | 50         |
| 2396 | Pearl Mage         | W2 S1 N1; random: 100% x1 mask 11008 link 1                              | 10         |
| 2813 | Pelagian Explorer  | W1; random: 100% x1 mask 11520 link 1                                    | 10         |
| 2397 | Pearl King         | W4 S1 N1 H3; random: 100% x1 mask 10496 link 1; 10% x1 mask 11008 link 1 | 150        |
| 2805 | Ichtyid Pearl Mage | W1 S1                                                                    | 10         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Water 4, Astral 1, Nature 1, Holy 3. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Pelagia capital and national sites

| ID | Site             | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                           |
|----|------------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------|
| 72 | Palace of Pearls | W4, N2         | Pearl King, Ichtyid Pearl Mage, Pearl Guard |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Pelagia national spell map

No active nation-restricted spell row was found for this nation in the pinned snapshot. Absence here is a metadata boundary, not proof that no shared or special spell exists.

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Pelagia national item boundary

| ID  | Item           | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|-----|----------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 18  | Coral Blade    | 3            | W1    | rebate |
| 329 | Clam of Pearls | 3            | W1 N1 | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Pelagia hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record | Magic          | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 2806 | Wondrous    | A3 W4 S3 N1 H3 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Pelagia army identities

- Sacred roster: Pearl Guard.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: Merman Net Thrower, Turtle Warrior, Turtle Tribe Triton, Shark Tribe Triton, Pelagian Militia, Pelagian Militia, Pelagian Soldier, Coral Clan Soldier, Triton Rider, Turtle Warrior, Pelagian Shore Fighter, Sideraspist, Pearl Guard.
- Core identity: aquatic Triton clans, amphibious mermen, sacred Pearl Kings, and Water-Astral-Nature magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Pelagia opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Pelagia fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Pelagia, the most likely planning failure is deep-water geography, limited land projection, commander coverage, and separating aquatic from amphibious replacement. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Pelagia research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Pelagia magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Water 4, Astral 1, Nature 1, Holy 3. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Pelagia battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

## Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Pelagia Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Pelagia matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Pelagia monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Pelagia unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Pelagia source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXXIII: Early Age Oceania, Coming of the Capricorns

## Early Age Oceania one-page command brief

Early Age Oceania converts shapechanging Capricorns and aquatic forest forces able to work between sea and coast into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 8 commander identities and 6 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 1 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are shape resolution, coastal transition, turmoil, land reinforcement, and mixed habitat requirements.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Oceania evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Oceania on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 41, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Oceania object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Oceania conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
 -> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
 -> labelled fixed and random path access  
 -> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
 -> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Oceania recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 7          | 5      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 3          | 2      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 1          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Oceania commander roster

| ID   | Commander              | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2370 | Ichtysatyr Scout       | none                                                                | 0          |
| 2372 | Ichtysatyr Commander   | none                                                                | 50         |
| 2374 | Ichtycentaur Commander | none                                                                | 100        |
| 2392 | Aphroi Hierophant      | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 8704 link 1                                | 50         |
| 1054 | Siren                  | A1 W2 G2                                                            | 0          |
| 2861 | Haliade                | W2 N2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1; 10% x1 mask 9984 link 1 | 100        |
| 1038 | Capricorn              | W2 E1 N4; random: 100% x1 mask 1792 link 1; 10% x1 mask 9984 link 1 | 100        |
| 2399 | Aphroi Lord            | none                                                                | 100        |

## Early Age Oceania troop roster

| ID   | Unit               | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits               |
|------|--------------------|----|------------|--------|----------------------|
| 1041 | Ichtysatyr         | 12 | 2          | 8      | amphibious, stealthy |
| 2376 | Ichtysatyr         | 12 | 2          | 9      | amphibious, stealthy |
| 2378 | Ichtysatyr Warrior | 12 | 2          | 9      | amphibious           |
| 2380 | Ichtytaur          | 30 | 4          | 12     | amphibious           |
| 1408 | Ichtycentaur       | 20 | 4          | 12     | amphibious           |
| 2401 | Aphroi             | 24 | 4          | 14     | sacred, amphibious   |

## Early Age Oceania mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander         | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2392 | Aphroi Hierophant | H1; random: 100% x1 mask 8704 link 1                                | 50         |
| 1054 | Siren             | A1 W2 G2                                                            | 0          |
| 2861 | Haliade           | W2 N2 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1; 10% x1 mask 9984 link 1 | 100        |
| 1038 | Capricorn         | W2 E1 N4; random: 100% x1 mask 1792 link 1; 10% x1 mask 9984 link 1 | 100        |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Air 1, Water 2, Earth 1, Nature 4, Glamour 2, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Oceania capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded   |
|-----|---------------------|----------------|---------------------|
| 101 | The Grove of Aphros | W1, N4, G1     | Aphroi Lord, Aphroi |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Oceania national spell map

| ID  | Spell         | School       | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|---------------|--------------|-------------|------------|
| 337 | Grow Fortress | Alteration 0 | N4          | 35         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Oceania national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Oceania hero boundary

No fixed hero-slot identity was resolved from attributes 139-149. Hero arrival and timing remain unscheduled.

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.



## Early Age Oceania army identities

- Sacred roster: Aphroi.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: Ichtysatyr, Ichtysatyr, Ichtysatyr Warrior, Ichtytaur, Ichtycentaur, Aphroi.
- Core identity: shapechanging Capricorns and aquatic forest forces able to work between sea and coast.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Oceania opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Oceania fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Oceania, the most likely planning failure is shape resolution, coastal transition, turmoil, land reinforcement, and mixed habitat requirements. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Oceania research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Oceania magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Air 1, Water 2, Earth 1, Nature 4, Glamour 2, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Oceania battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Oceania Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Oceania matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem        | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                  |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units   | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage     |
| Heavy armour         | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided     |
| Accurate missiles    | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards   |
| Elemental resistance | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element |

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                         | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves  | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Oceania monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Oceania unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Oceania source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXXIV: Early Age Therodos, Telkhine Spectre

## Early Age Therodos one-page command brief

Early Age Therodos converts spectral armies, Daktyloi smiths, island survivors, and a dominion that trades living population for ghosts into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 6 commander identities and 5 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 8 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are population collapse, fort placement, ghost generation, mundane infrastructure, and moving from islands into living territory.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Therodos evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Therodos on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 42, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbfc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Therodos object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Therodos conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
-> labelled fixed and random path access  
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Therodos recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 1          | 0      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 4          | 4      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 3          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Therodos commander roster

| ID   | Commander           | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2833 | Melia               | N1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1792 link 1                             | 100        |
| 2830 | Therodian Scout     | none                                                                | 0          |
| 2831 | Therodian Commander | none                                                                | 75         |
| 2835 | Kabeiros            | E1; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 1                                | 10         |
| 2834 | Hekateride          | W2 N3 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1; 10% x1 mask 9984 link 1 | 50         |
| 2836 | Daktyl              | A1 W1 E2; random: 100% x1 mask 6016 link 1; 10% x1 mask 6016 link 1 | 10         |

## Early Age Therodos troop roster

| ID   | Unit              | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits                              |
|------|-------------------|----|------------|--------|-------------------------------------|
| 2827 | Therodian Archer  | 10 | 0          | 8      | ordinary body                       |
| 2828 | Therodian Peltast | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body                       |
| 2829 | Therodian Hoplite | 10 | 0          | 10     | ordinary body                       |
| 2837 | Korybant          | 12 | 0          | 12     | sacred                              |
| 2839 | Kourete           | 15 | 0          | 13     | sacred, magic being, poor amphibian |

## Early Age Therodos mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander  | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 2833 | Melia      | N1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 1792 link 1                             | 100        |
| 2835 | Kabeiros   | E1; random: 100% x1 mask 1920 link 1                                | 10         |
| 2834 | Hekateride | W2 N3 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 9984 link 1; 10% x1 mask 9984 link 1 | 50         |
| 2836 | Daktyl     | A1 W1 E2; random: 100% x1 mask 6016 link 1; 10% x1 mask 6016 link 1 | 10         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Air 1, Water 2, Earth 2, Nature 3, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Therodos capital and national sites

| ID  | Site      | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded                  |
|-----|-----------|----------------|------------------------------------|
| 182 | Telkhinis | A1, W1, E3, D1 | Melia, Hekateride, Daktyl, Kourete |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Therodos national spell map

| ID  | Spell                        | School         | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|------------------------------|----------------|-------------|------------|
| 254 | Summon Hound of Twilight     | Conjuration 5  | E2 D1       | 3          |
| 255 | Sow Dragon Teeth             | Enchantment 6  | E2          | 1          |
| 256 | Bind Keres                   | Conjuration 6  | D2          | 12         |
| 270 | Forge Brass Bull             | Construction 6 | F3 E3       | 25         |
| 364 | Call Ephor                   | Conjuration 0  | D1          | 7          |
| 365 | Call Spectral Philosopher    | Conjuration 0  | D1          | 11         |
| 366 | Summon Telkhine              | Conjuration 8  | W5 A2       | 69         |
| 369 | Procession of the Underworld | Conjuration 5  | D3          | 13         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age Therodos national item boundary

No nation restriction or rebate link appears in the pinned item rows. This does not establish live forge pricing or exclude undocumented behaviour.

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age Therodos hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record | Magic             | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------|-------------------|------------------------------------|
| 2871 | Kabeiride   | W2 N3 H1          | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2878 | Telkhine    | A4 W3 E3 N3 H3    | assignment only; timing unresolved |
| 2880 | Telkhine    | A3 W3 E3 D2 N2 H2 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age Therodos army identities

- Sacred roster: Korybant, Kourete.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: Kourete.
- Core identity: spectral armies, Daktyloi smiths, island survivors, and a dominion that trades living population for ghosts.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age Therodos opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age Therodos fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Therodos, the most likely planning failure is population collapse, fort placement, ghost generation, mundane infrastructure, and moving from islands into living territory. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Therodos research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Therodos magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Air 1, Water 2, Earth 2, Nature 3, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Therodos battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

## Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

## Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

## Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Therodos Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Therodos matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |



## Early Age Therodos monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Therodos unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Therodos source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXXV: Early Age Atlantis, Emergence of the Deep Ones

## Early Age Atlantis one-page command brief

Early Age Atlantis converts long-lived amphibious Deep Ones, Basalt Kings, heavy basalt weapons, and Earth-Water-Fire magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 8 commander identities and 10 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 1 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are resource-heavy troops, slow movement, cold-water preferences, land transition, and expensive commanders.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age Atlantis evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Atlantis on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 43, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffbcb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Atlantis object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age Atlantis conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
-> labelled fixed and random path access  
-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age Atlantis recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 6          | 9      | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 0          | 0      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age Atlantis commander roster

| ID   | Commander          | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1680 | Scout              | none                                                                | 0          |
| 1694 | Coral Priest       | H1                                                                  | 10         |
| 1700 | Shambler Chief     | none                                                                | 75         |
| 1701 | Coral Commander    | none                                                                | 100        |
| 1693 | Mother of the Deep | H2                                                                  | 50         |
| 1692 | Mage of the Deep   | W2; random: 100% x1 mask 3712 link 1; 100% x1 mask 1664 link 1      | 10         |
| 1695 | Basalt Queen       | H3                                                                  | 200        |
| 1702 | Basalt King        | F1 W2 E3; random: 100% x1 mask 1664 link 1; 10% x1 mask 1664 link 1 | 10         |

## Early Age Atlantis troop roster

| ID   | Unit                 | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits             |
|------|----------------------|----|------------|--------|--------------------|
| 1682 | Reef Dweller         | 12 | 2          | 10     | amphibious         |
| 1681 | Atlantian Spearman   | 12 | 3          | 10     | amphibious         |
| 1683 | Shambler             | 22 | 7          | 11     | amphibious         |
| 1684 | War Shambler         | 22 | 7          | 13     | amphibious         |
| 1685 | Coral Guard          | 24 | 7          | 14     | amphibious         |
| 1686 | Deep One             | 14 | 4          | 12     | amphibious         |
| 1687 | Deep One Spearman    | 14 | 4          | 12     | amphibious         |
| 1688 | Shambler of the Deep | 26 | 9          | 13     | amphibious         |
| 1689 | Warrior of the Deep  | 27 | 9          | 13     | amphibious         |
| 1690 | Living Pillar        | 31 | 9          | 15     | sacred, amphibious |

## Early Age Atlantis mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander          | Fixed and random magic                                              | Leadership |
|------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1694 | Coral Priest       | H1                                                                  | 10         |
| 1693 | Mother of the Deep | H2                                                                  | 50         |
| 1692 | Mage of the Deep   | W2; random: 100% x1 mask 3712 link 1; 100% x1 mask 1664 link 1      | 10         |
| 1695 | Basalt Queen       | H3                                                                  | 200        |
| 1702 | Basalt King        | F1 W2 E3; random: 100% x1 mask 1664 link 1; 10% x1 mask 1664 link 1 | 10         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 1, Water 2, Earth 3, Holy 3. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age Atlantis capital and national sites

| ID  | Site             | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded           |
|-----|------------------|----------------|-----------------------------|
| 128 | The Basalt City  | F1, E3         | Basalt Queen, Living Pillar |
| 129 | The Dark Crystal | W2             | Basalt King                 |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age Atlantis national spell map

| ID  | Spell               | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|---------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 370 | Summon Monster Fish | Conjuration 6 | W3          | 6          |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

### Early Age Atlantis national item boundary

| ID  | Item            | Construction | Paths | Link   |
|-----|-----------------|--------------|-------|--------|
| 443 | Orb of Atlantis | 9            | W4 E1 | rebate |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

### Early Age Atlantis hero boundary

No fixed hero-slot identity was resolved from attributes 139-149. Hero arrival and timing remain unscheduled.

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

### Early Age Atlantis army identities

- Sacred roster: Living Pillar.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: Reef Dweller, Atlantian Spearman, Shambler, War Shambler, Coral Guard, Deep One, Deep One Spearman, Shambler of the Deep, Warrior of the Deep, Living Pillar.
- Core identity: long-lived amphibious Deep Ones, Basalt Kings, heavy basalt weapons, and Earth-Water-Fire magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

### Early Age Atlantis opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

### Early Age Atlantis fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Atlantis, the most likely planning failure is resource-heavy troops, slow movement, cold-water preferences, land transition, and expensive commanders. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age Atlantis research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age Atlantis magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 1, Water 2, Earth 3, Holy 3. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age Atlantis battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age Atlantis Pretender families

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge        | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold          | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required                     |
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age Atlantis matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age Atlantis monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age Atlantis unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age Atlantis source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

# Part LXXXVI: Early Age R'Iyeh, Time of Aboleths

## Early Age R'Iyeh one-page command brief

Early Age R'Iyeh converts Aboleth mind lords, enslaved aquatic peoples, mental domination, and powerful Astral-Water magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 10 commander identities and 12 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 2 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are magic leadership, slave morale, mindless and enslaved troop control, land access, and friendly-fire risk.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

## Early Age R'Iyeh evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age R'Iyeh on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 44, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any R'Iyeh object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

## Early Age R'Iyeh conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets  
 -> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes  
 -> labelled fixed and random path access  
 -> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support  
 -> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

## Early Age R'Iyeh recruitment geography

| Recruitment layer   | Commanders | Troops | Evidence boundary                                                                       |
|---------------------|------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary forts      | 6          | 10     | Direct pinned membership rows                                                           |
| Regional or coastal | 2          | 1      | Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent |
| Site-linked         | 2          | 1      | Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association      |

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

## Early Age R'Iyeh commander roster

| ID   | Commander      | Fixed and random magic                                             | Leadership |
|------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 432  | Scout          | none                                                               | 0          |
| 1523 | Slave Prince   | none                                                               | 100        |
| 1527 | Slave Priest   | H1                                                                 | 10         |
| 1518 | Slave Mage     | W2 S1; random: 100% x1 mask 11776 link 1                           | 10         |
| 2886 | Grandmother    | S1 H3                                                              | 10         |
| 1520 | Aboleth        | W2 S2; random: 100% x1 mask 19968 link 1                           | 10         |
| 1401 | Polypal Mother | H2                                                                 | 10         |
| 2885 | Androdai       | S1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 19968 link 1                           | 10         |
| 1521 | Mind Lord      | W3 S3; random: 100% x1 mask 19968 link 1; 10% x1 mask 19968 link 1 | 50         |
| 2883 | Abodai         | W1 S2 D1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 7680 link 1                      | 10         |

## Early Age R'Iyeh troop roster

| ID   | Unit           | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits     |
|------|----------------|----|------------|--------|------------|
| 1517 | Slave Trooper  | 15 | 1          | 7      | aquatic    |
| 1526 | Slave Guardian | 15 | 1          | 7      | aquatic    |
| 1515 | Slave Trooper  | 10 | 1          | 7      | amphibious |
| 1524 | Slave Guardian | 10 | 1          | 7      | amphibious |
| 335  | Slave Trooper  | 12 | 2          | 7      | amphibious |
| 1619 | Slave Guardian | 12 | 2          | 7      | amphibious |



| ID   | Unit            | HP | Protection | Morale | Traits                       |
|------|-----------------|----|------------|--------|------------------------------|
| 336  | Slave Guardian  | 12 | 2          | 7      | amphibious                   |
| 337  | Lobo Guard      | 13 | 2          | 50     | magic being, amphibious      |
| 425  | Shambler Thrall | 24 | 7          | 50     | magic being, amphibious      |
| 1403 | Giboleth        | 21 | 8          | 11     | magic being, aquatic         |
| 2884 | Androloth       | 14 | 2          | 14     | magic being, amphibious      |
| 1522 | Gibodai         | 20 | 6          | 11     | sacred, magic being, aquatic |

## Early Age R'lyeh mage and priest portfolio

| ID   | Commander      | Fixed and random magic                                             | Leadership |
|------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1527 | Slave Priest   | H1                                                                 | 10         |
| 1518 | Slave Mage     | W2 S1; random: 100% x1 mask 11776 link 1                           | 10         |
| 2886 | Grandmother    | S1 H3                                                              | 10         |
| 1520 | Aboleth        | W2 S2; random: 100% x1 mask 19968 link 1                           | 10         |
| 1401 | Polypal Mother | H2                                                                 | 10         |
| 2885 | Androdai       | S1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 19968 link 1                           | 10         |
| 1521 | Mind Lord      | W3 S3; random: 100% x1 mask 19968 link 1; 10% x1 mask 19968 link 1 | 50         |
| 2883 | Abodai         | W1 S2 D1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 7680 link 1                      | 10         |

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Water 3, Astral 3, Death 1, Holy 3. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

## Early Age R'lyeh capital and national sites

| ID  | Site                        | Monthly fields | Recruits recorded          |
|-----|-----------------------------|----------------|----------------------------|
| 116 | The Gorge of Ancient Cities | W2, E1, S3     | Mind Lord, Abodai, Gibodai |

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

## Early Age R'lyeh national spell map

| ID  | Spell              | School        | Requirement | Cost field |
|-----|--------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| 628 | Mind Vessel        | Thaumaturgy 3 | S3          | 15         |
| 629 | Enslave Sea Trolls | Thaumaturgy 5 | S3 W2       | 10         |

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

## Early Age R'Iyeh national item boundary

| ID  | Item         | Construction | Paths | Link       |
|-----|--------------|--------------|-------|------------|
| 134 | Anemone Mace | 3            | W1    | restricted |

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

## Early Age R'Iyeh hero boundary

| ID   | Hero record | Magic | Boundary                           |
|------|-------------|-------|------------------------------------|
| 1691 | Mind Lord   | W4 S4 | assignment only; timing unresolved |

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

## Early Age R'Iyeh army identities

- Sacred roster: Gibodai.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: Slave Trooper, Slave Guardian, Slave Trooper, Slave Guardian, Slave Trooper, Slave Guardian, Slave Guardian, Lobo Guard, Shambler Thrall, Giboleth, Androleth, Gibodai.
- Core identity: Aboleth mind lords, enslaved aquatic peoples, mental domination, and powerful Astral-Water magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

## Early Age R'Iyeh opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

## Early Age R'Iyeh fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For R'Iyeh, the most likely planning failure is magic leadership, slave morale, mindless and enslaved troop control, land access, and friendly-fire risk. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

## Early Age R'Iyeh research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

## Early Age R'Iyeh magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Water 3, Astral 3, Death 1, Holy 3. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

## Early Age R'Iyeh battlefield packages

### Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

### Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

### Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

### Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

## Early Age R'Iyeh Pretender families

| Family              | What it can solve                                       | What it cannot conceal                                       |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Missing-path bridge | Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold | Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required |

| Family                     | What it can solve                                                | What it cannot conceal                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Economy and infrastructure | Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements | Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points |
| Sacred support             | Improves a verified sacred package                               | Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain                         |
| Awake expansion body       | Reduces pressure on the starting roster                          | Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents     |
| Resistance package         | Covers a documented roster weakness                              | One resistance is not universal defence                                          |

## Early Age R'Iyeh matchup and failure matrix

| Enemy problem                 | First answer to examine                                              | Avoid                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Massed light units            | Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves       | Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage                   |
| Heavy armour                  | Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs | Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided                   |
| Accurate missiles             | Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption                  | Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards                 |
| Elemental resistance          | Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure               | Building the complete research plan around one element               |
| Fast raiders or flyers        | Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves       | Concentrating every commander in one army                            |
| Large targets                 | Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters      | Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal                 |
| Underwater or land transition | Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies      | Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross |

## Early Age R'Iyeh monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

## Early Age R'Iyeh unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

## Early Age R'Iyeh source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

## Dossier source register

### Official

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: all 37 unmodded Middle Age nation pages; national spells and rituals; research; communions, Chorus, and Grand Communion; Blood and crossbreeding; Inquisition; mounts; sailing; flying; forging; habitat transitions; and fort construction.
- Illwinter official patch history through 6.37, including the current Send Aatxe restriction, communion corrections, the 6.13 Forest of Avalon Magic correction, the 6.01 Abysia wall-defender note, Eriu's 6.01 terrain-recruit and Bean Sidhe corrections, Agartha's 6.04 Oracle-shape note, and 6.37's bounded research, drowning, and Drake corrections. Generic statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed nation objects.

### Structured snapshot

- Dominions 6 Data Inspector, commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc, pinned to the 6.35 data update; used for mage random masks, recruitment records, capital sites, national spell restrictions, national item fields, and current object cross-checks.

### Interpretation boundary

Roster entries, path masks, costs, site income, item restrictions, and national ritual requirements are source facts. Openings, research trees, Pretender families, battlefield packages, and matchup advice are strategy. Expansion counts, random-result timing, Blood returns, crossbreeding outputs, displayed forge-cost stacking, communion and Grand Communion outcomes, hydra-field behaviour, Spell Singer outcomes, Glamour detection, special-dominion scaling and targeting, ancestor-summon behaviour, conscription output, variable summon quantities, retinue and shape behaviour, flying and storm resolution, ice-equipment scaling, Guardian Spirit behaviour, remote ritual outcomes, spell targeting, and combat outcomes remain observation questions until a versioned raw set is published.

# Foundation Book VIII: Modding and Scenario Design

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## Building Reliable Dominions 6 Rulesets, Events, AI Scaffolds, and Worlds

### The job of this volume

Dominions 6 modding begins with text commands, but reliable modding is not primarily a matter of remembering commands. It is a matter of controlling state.

A mod changes a shared registry of weapons, armour, monsters, sites, nations, spells, items, population types, mercenaries, AI templates, and events. Those objects refer to one another. Several mods may alter the same object. Updates can change legal commands or object numbers. Events retain codes and variables across turns. Maps establish the topology on which every strategic system operates.

The job is larger than writing a .dm file. A dependable project must answer:

- which game version and manual revision define the rules;
- which object is being selected;
- which attributes are inherited, cleared, or overwritten;
- when the parser processes each category;
- which identifiers belong to the project;
- how multiple mods interact;
- what changes are safe for an ongoing game;
- what the AI can be encouraged to do;
- what requires an event system rather than an AI command;
- how a map changes strategic value before a nation is chosen;
- how every claim will be checked.

Book VIII begins with the smallest safe patch, then moves through events, maps, AI hints, compatibility work, and release testing. Illwinter's manuals remain the authority for commands. The aim here is to show how individual commands become a mod that survives other mods, game updates, and actual play.

### Technical baseline

Game baseline: Dominions 6.36. Official Modding Manual: version 6.34, 65 pages. Official Event Modding Manual: labelled version 6.29, 20 pages. Official Map Making Manual: version 6.26, 11 pages. Official File Formats document: current one-page d6m specification. Source case studies: Dominions Enhanced 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE. Intended combined order: Dominions Enhanced first, Divinitus DE second. Last verified: 31 July 2026.

The manuals do not all carry the same version number, and that is not an error in the archive. The official documentation page currently distributes a 6.34 modding manual, a 6.29-labelled event manual, and a 6.26 map manual while the public game is 6.36. Patch notes published after those

revisions form part of the technical baseline. Book XIV marks five event commands introduced in 6.36 as official patch-only because the announcement does not supply their full syntax.

Book I's evidence labels remain in force. Source syntax appears only when the command itself matters; the surrounding explanation is independent of the manuals.

## Suggested paths

The first-mod path runs from the parser model through project structure, selection, copying, clearing, error isolation, and validation. Content creators can then move into objects, nations, spells, items, and blessings. Event and diplomacy work begins with state, eligibility, codes, variables, targets, and anti-loop safeguards. Mapmakers can go directly to topology and scenario packaging, while compatibility work depends on the parser chapters, identifier registries, object reconstruction, and regression testing. Book IX now holds the detailed DE and Divinitus case study.

# Part I: The Object-and-Parser Model

## The most useful mental model

A .dm file is a sequence of instructions that changes a collection of global object tables. It is not a complete database and it is not a conventional program with private objects.

The basic unit of work is a stateful block:

```
#select... or #new...
commands that alter the active object
#end
```

The selector establishes the active object. Commands after it belong to that object until #end. A missing selector, a missing #end, an accidental #clear, or an unexpected later mod can change the meaning of an otherwise correct line.

Five operations explain most mod source:

| Operation | Purpose                                 | Principal risk                         |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Select    | Open an existing object for alteration  | Wrong name or number                   |
| Create    | Allocate a new object                   | Collision or unstable automatic number |
| Copy      | Inherit an existing object's properties | Hidden attributes come with the copy   |
| Clear     | Remove some or all inherited properties | Required defaults vanish               |
| Set       | Replace or add a property               | Later source may overwrite it          |

The central expert question is not, "What commands appear in this block?" It is, "What is the final object after every inherited value, clear operation, setter, parser phase, and later mod has been applied?"

## Commands are stateful

Consider the pattern:

```
#selectmonster 311
#gcost 180
#poorleader
#end
```

This does not define a new monster. It alters monster 311. Attributes not addressed by the block continue to come from the base game or an earlier mod. The resulting monster is the old object plus the specified changes.

Now consider:

```
#newmonster 7200
#copystats 311
#name "Example Adept"
#gcost 200
#end
```

This creates a new identity, inherits a source object's characteristics, and then changes selected fields. The copy is economical, but it also carries properties that may be easy to overlook: leadership, item slots, movement, age, path cost, recruitment limits, stealth, shape relationships, and hidden flags can all matter.

The safe method is:

- 1 name the source object and version;
- 2 state why it is being copied;
- 3 list inherited systems that must be audited;
- 4 override deliberately;
- 5 inspect the final in-game detail card;
- 6 test any behaviour not visible on the card.

## Text order and parser order are different

Within each mod, Dominions processes object categories in a fixed order:

| Parser phase | Category           |
|--------------|--------------------|
| 1            | Mod information    |
| 2            | Weapons            |
| 3            | Armour             |
| 4            | Units and monsters |
| 5            | Names              |
| 6            | Blessings          |
| 7            | Sites              |
| 8            | Nations            |
| 9            | Spells             |
| 10           | Magic items        |
| 11           | General rules      |
| 12           | Population types   |
| 13           | Mercenaries        |
| 14           | Events             |

This has two consequences.



First, physical placement in the file does not create an ordinary top-to-bottom dependency between categories. A weapon definition may be written after a monster block in the text, yet the weapon phase is processed before the monster phase.

Second, entire mods are loaded separately. One mod is processed through its phases, then another mod is processed. A reference by name to an object created in another mod is not reliable merely because the other mod is listed first. The official manual warns that cross-mod name references cannot be trusted.

For compatibility work:

- use numbers when a known shared identity is intentionally targeted;
- avoid assuming that another mod's names form a stable public interface;
- treat two mods altering the same object as a conflict requiring inspection;
- record combined load order;
- reconstruct the final object rather than describing either source in isolation.

## Overlap does not create a clean merge contract

It is tempting to assume that two mods "merge" because each changes different fields on the same monster. Sometimes the observed final object resembles such a merge. That is not a safe general contract.

The official warning is stronger: two mods should not try to modify the same thing because the result may be unpredictable. A dependable compatibility patch cannot rely on accidental non-overlap. It explicitly reasserts the intended final state after both parent mods.

The source-level rule is:

```
shared selector
-> enumerate every parent modification
-> identify clears and copies
-> determine final setters
-> create explicit compatibility block
-> verify final object
```

## Names are convenient; numbers are identities

Many selectors accept either a quoted name or a numeric identifier. Names are readable, but they are not always unique and can be changed. Numbers are less readable, but they identify a specific registry entry.

Use names when:

- working entirely within one self-contained project;
- the object is a stable base-game object with a unique name;
- readability outweighs cross-mod coupling;
- a command only accepts a name.

Use numbers when:

- diagnosing an existing unit through `ctrl+i`;
- modifying a known base-game identity;
- two objects share a name;
- creating explicit monsters, sites, weapons, or armour;
- a compatibility patch deliberately targets another mod's object.

Always comment numbers:

```
#selectmonster 311 -- Mystic, MA Arcoscephale
```

A number without provenance becomes technical debt.

## Bitmasks are sets represented as integers

A bitmask combines several independent flags by addition. It should be read as a set, not as an unexplained large number.

For a custom magic random, the documented path-mask values begin:

| Path    | Mask  |
|---------|-------|
| Fire    | 128   |
| Air     | 256   |
| Water   | 512   |
| Earth   | 1024  |
| Astral  | 2048  |
| Death   | 4096  |
| Nature  | 8192  |
| Glamour | 16384 |
| Blood   | 32768 |
| Priest  | 65536 |

Thus 384 is  $128 + 256$ , meaning a Fire-or-Air random. The source should retain the decomposition:

```
#custommagic 384 100 -- F/A, one guaranteed pick
```

For every bitmask:

- keep the human-readable components in a comment;
- do not reuse a terrain bitmask in a site command;
- do not assume similarly named masks share values across manuals;
- calculate the sum twice or generate it from a small table;
- inspect the result in game.

The Map Making Manual explicitly warns that its terrain masks are not the same as the terrain masks used for site modding.

## Object numbers and the manual's internal boundaries

The final "Modding Number Limits" table in the 6.34 manual gives:

| Object   | Total documented range | Recommended mod range |
|----------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| Sound    | 0-248                  | 150+                  |
| Weapon   | 0-3999                 | 1000+                 |
| Armour   | 0-1999                 | 400+                  |
| Monster  | 0-19999                | 5000+                 |
| Nametype | 100-399                | 170+                  |

| Object          | Total documented range | Recommended mod range |
|-----------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| Spell           | 0-7999                 | 2000+                 |
| Enchantment     | 0-9999                 | 200+                  |
| Item            | 0-1999                 | 700+                  |
| Magic site      | 0-3999                 | 1700+                 |
| Nation          | 0-499                  | 150+                  |
| Population type | 0-249                  | 125+                  |

The same manual contains older-looking local limits in individual sections. Examples include monsters described as 5000-8999, armour as 300-999, spells as 1300-3999, and items as beginning at 400. These statements cannot all describe the same final ceiling.

The evidence-based policy for 6.36 is:

- treat the final consolidated limits table as the current broad capacity;
- recognize that older projects may occupy lower legacy mod ranges;
- allocate from a written project registry rather than "the next number that looks free";
- prefer the narrower historical range when broad portability matters;
- verify numbers above an older local ceiling in the target game version;
- do not silently rewrite another mod's allocation.

Dominions Enhanced demonstrates that current mods can use monster numbers above 8999. That source evidence resolves current parser capacity for the supplied ruleset, but it does not remove collision risk.

## Automatic allocation is convenient but fragile

Some `#new...` commands accept explicit numbers; others allocate automatically.

| Object  | Explicit identity available in documented command? | Safe update policy                     |
|---------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Weapon  | Yes                                                | Allocate from project registry         |
| Armour  | Yes                                                | Allocate from project registry         |
| Monster | Optional explicit number                           | Use explicit number                    |
| Site    | Optional explicit number                           | Use explicit number                    |
| Nation  | Automatic free nation number                       | Avoid relying on order outside project |
| Spell   | Automatic                                          | Append-only or reserved placeholders   |
| Item    | Automatic                                          | Append-only or reserved placeholders   |

The official manual specifically warns that inserting new automatically numbered monsters, sites, or spells into the middle of a released mod can change later identities and break ongoing games. Explicit numbering solves part of the problem. For automatically allocated categories, the practical protection is:

- append new objects;
- never reorder released objects casually;
- reserve inert placeholders when future expansion is likely;
- record generated identities from `ctrl+i`;
- make save compatibility an explicit release decision.

## A mod can change an ongoing game

When the source used by a saved game changes, object modifications can apply when the game is loaded again. Existing militia can acquire a changed weapon; existing commanders can acquire new statistics. This is useful for testing and dangerous for releases.

Changes fall into three classes:

| Class                    | Example                                    | Ongoing-game risk                      |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Presentation             | Description correction                     | Usually low                            |
| Existing-object mutation | Cost, weapon, path, shape, spell effect    | Immediate and potentially strategic    |
| Registry mutation        | Inserted new monster, spell, site, or item | Identity shift and possible corruption |

Every release should state one of:

- safe for new games only;
- expected to be compatible with existing games;
- compatibility not guaranteed;
- migration release with exact host instructions.

# Part II: Project Structure and the First Working Mod

## Locating the user data directory

The safest method is the in-game Game Tools -> Open User Data Directory action. Default locations are:

| Platform | Default user data directory |
|----------|-----------------------------|
| Windows  | %APPDATA%\dominions6\       |
| Linux    | ~/.dominions6/              |
| macOS    | ~/.dominions6/              |

Relevant subdirectories include:

- mods
- maps
- savedgames

The in-game button should take precedence over assumptions about operating-system paths.

## The Dominions 6 mod folder rule

Every mod must reside in its own folder. The folder and .dm file should share a simple filename:

```
mods/  
example_balance/  
example_balance.dm  
banner.png
```

```
sprites/  
example_unit.png
```

The 6.34 manual requires the `.dm` file to be inside a folder with the same name, excluding the extension. Files used by the mod should remain within that folder or its subdirectories.

Network-safe filenames:

- contain no spaces;
- avoid special characters;
- use consistent case;
- use forward slashes inside mod references, including on Windows.

Case matters for mod and image filenames.

## Image and sound formats

Mod graphics may use PNG or Targa images. Targa files must be uncompressed or RLE and use 24- or 32-bit colour. For 24-bit Targa graphics, the manual describes black as transparent and magenta as a half-transparent shadow colour.

The dedicated mod banner used by `#icon` should be 128x32 or 256x64 pixels.

Sound sources use:

- `.sw`: mono, signed 16-bit, 22 kHz;
- `.sw2`: stereo, signed 16-bit, 22 kHz.

Sound effects should be mono. Music may use either form. New sound slots are documented from 150 upward, with 248 as the maximum.

## The minimum useful metadata block

```
#modname "Example Balance Patch"  
#description "Small, versioned adjustments for Dominions 6.36."  
#version 0.10  
#domversion 6.36
```

`#icon` is optional. `#domversion` is also optional, but it is valuable once the project depends on commands or fixes added after release.

A good description states:

- what the mod changes;
- which game version it targets;
- whether it requires another mod;
- required load order;
- whether it is intended for new games only.

## The smallest safe first project

The first project should modify one visible property of one existing object. It should not begin with a new nation, a multi-stage event chain, or a custom global enchantment.

Example:

```
#modname "Mystic Cost Test"
#description "Controlled test for MA Arcoscephale Mystic cost."
#version 0.01
#domversion 6.35

#selectmonster 311 -- Mystic
#gcost 185
#end
```

The trailing blank line is deliberate. Current community troubleshooting repeatedly identifies a missing final newline as a cause of the last command, often `#end`, not being parsed. This behaviour is not stated in the official 6.34 manual, so it remains a community-tested compatibility precaution. It is cheap and should be standard.

Verification:

- 1 enable only the test mod;
- 2 start a fresh MA Arcoscephale game;
- 3 inspect the Mystic's recruitment card;
- 4 press `ctrl+i` where useful;
- 5 confirm no unrelated property changed;
- 6 disable the mod and confirm the baseline returns.

## The patch-before-creation progression

A safe learning ladder is:

- 1 change an existing monster's gold cost;
- 2 change an existing weapon's damage;
- 3 copy a monster into a new fixed ID;
- 4 give the copy a copied or existing weapon;
- 5 add the new monster to one nation's recruitment;
- 6 create one site that recruits it;
- 7 create one spell or item;
- 8 create one bounded event;
- 9 build a complete nation;
- 10 add compatibility and AI layers.

Each step introduces one new category of failure.

## Selector discipline

Every block should visibly contain:

- selector or creator;
- identity comment;
- copy or clear operation, if any;
- grouped setters;
- `#end`;
- blank separation from the next block.

Example:

```
-- Unit 7200: Bronze Sentinel
#newmonster 7200
#copystats 118 -- chosen source recorded in registry
#name "Bronze Sentinel"
#clearweapons
```

```
#weapon 8 -- Broad Sword
#gcost 22
#rcost 2
#end
```

The comment does not change behaviour. It preserves the reason behind a number.

## Copy-first and clear-first are different designs

### Copy-first

Copy-first preserves a coherent base object:

```
#newmonster 7201
#copystats 311
#name "Senior Mystic"
#magicskill 4 2
#gcost 260
#end
```

Advantages:

- fast;
- inherits functional defaults;
- good for variants.

Risks:

- inherits hidden or irrelevant properties;
- a parent modification can change the copy's starting point;
- can produce accidental Pretender, recruitment, leadership, or shape behaviour.

### Clear-first

Clear-first creates a more explicit object:

```
#newmonster 7202
#clear
#name "Test Construct"
#hp 20
#size 4
#str 16
#att 10
#def 8
#prec 8
#mr 14
#mor 30
#mapmove 12
#ap 10
#end
```

Advantages:

- makes the intended state visible;
- reduces inherited surprises.

Risks:

- easy to omit a required or sensible default;
- more work;
- may produce a technically valid but unusable object.

Use copy-first for a close variant and clear-first for a genuinely new body. In both cases the final card, movement, recruitment, leadership, and combat behaviour must be checked.

## Error isolation

When a mod fails to appear or load:

- 1 verify it is inside its own correctly named folder;
- 2 verify the file extension is really `.dm`, not `.dm.txt`;
- 3 verify `#modname`;
- 4 remove or comment out `#icon`;
- 5 confirm filenames contain no spaces or special characters;
- 6 confirm case and forward slashes;
- 7 confirm every stateful block ends;
- 8 add a final blank line;
- 9 reduce the source to metadata plus one known-safe block;
- 10 restore sections by binary search.

Binary search is faster than rereading a five-thousand-line file:

- disable half the source;
- load;
- choose the failing half;
- repeat until the minimal failing block remains.

When the mod loads but an object does not appear:

- inspect its selector and number;
- check recruitment or site assignment;
- check era and nation;
- for Pretenders, check Pretender-defining attributes and nation or home-realm assignment;
- check whether a later mod clears recruitment or gods;
- inspect the combined final object, not only the definition.

## Reloading source during development

Officially, changing a mod can affect a saved test game. If Dominions remains open, the documented reload method is:

- 1 load a game using different mods or no mods;
- 2 return to the main menu;
- 3 load the test game again.

This forces the target mod to reload. For registry changes and anything involving new game setup, a fresh game is still the safer test.

# Part III: Weapons, Armour, and Combat Effects

---



## Design from combat role

A weapon is not balanced by damage alone. Relevant dimensions include:

- number of attacks;
- attack and defence modifiers;
- length;
- strength contribution;
- damage type;
- armour interaction;
- magic and resistance flags;
- range, precision contribution, and ammunition;
- secondary effects;
- clouds and after-effects;
- interactions with size, morale, defence, or magic resistance.

A unit carrying a weapon adds another layer:

- wielder strength and attack;
- number of arms;
- ambidexterity;
- fatigue and encumbrance;
- formation density;
- recruitment cost;
- mount attacks;
- blesses and battlefield buffs.

Balance the delivered attack package, not the isolated weapon card.

## Selecting and creating weapons

Core patterns:

```
#selectweapon 8
...changes...
#end

#newweapon 1200
#name "Test Falx"
#dmg 8
#att 1
#def -1
#len 2
#slash
#armorpiercing
#sound 8
#end
```

For new weapons:

- allocate an explicit ID;
- set the name first;
- use #copyweapon first when inheriting;
- remember that #clear removes the copied properties;
- use #range only when the weapon is meant to become missile-only;
- inspect all derived text in game.

## Damage and armour interaction

The important distinction goes beyond physical versus magical.

| Layer              | Examples                                                           |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Damage family      | Slash, pierce, blunt, fire, cold, shock, poison, fatigue           |
| Armour rule        | Normal, armour piercing, armour negating                           |
| Resistance rule    | Resistance applies, MR negates, size or strength interaction       |
| Delivery           | Melee, missile, area, beam, cloud, after-effect                    |
| Conditional effect | On hit, on damage, against demon, undead, magic being, or illusion |

A high base-damage attack with ordinary armour interaction may be a poor anti-elite tool. A lower attack with armour negation can invalidate protection. An after-effect may bypass the intended counter class. Every weapon design should state the defence class it is intended to defeat.

## Range and ammunition

#range converts a weapon into a missile weapon that cannot be used in melee. #ammo controls the ordinary shot count; current patch notes also record later support for fatigue-based ammunition behaviour.

Missile testing should record:

- actual maximum range;
- precision at several distances;
- firing cadence;
- ammunition exhaustion;
- behaviour after ammunition;
- friendly fire and area;
- interaction with shields and Air Shield;
- underwater legality;
- spell-created versus recruited use.

## Secondary and after-effects

Weapon after-effects can create some of the most severe balance errors because one attack can deliver several independent tests.

For each effect, record:

- trigger: swing, hit, or damage;
- target: original square, target, wielder, area, or cloud;
- defence: armour, resistance, MR, size, strength, or none;
- stacking behaviour;
- duration;
- whether a killed target still produces the effect;
- whether a mount, rider, secondary shape, or illusion is separately affected.

Official updates have repeatedly fixed weapon and cloud edge cases. Patch history is part of a weapon's evidence, not background trivia.

## Armour and barding

Armour types documented by the manual include:

| Type value | Use         |
|------------|-------------|
| 4          | Shield      |
| 5          | Body armour |
| 6          | Helmet      |
| 9          | Barding     |

New armour uses an explicit number. The consolidated current mod range begins at 400, while the local armour section still mentions a legacy starting point of 300. A project registry should use a range that does not overlap enabled mods.

Armour evaluation includes:

- protection by body location;
- defence penalty;
- encumbrance;
- resource cost;
- magic-item consequences;
- mounted interaction;
- whether a form retains legal slots;
- whether copied armour contains unexpected type or sprite data.

## Combat-effect audit

Before releasing a weapon or armour change:

| Test                | Minimum comparison                                 |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Baseline damage     | Unarmoured human                                   |
| Armour performance  | Light, medium, and heavy protection                |
| Defence interaction | Low and high Defence Skill                         |
| Size interaction    | Human and giant                                    |
| Resistance          | Relevant resistance 0, partial, and high           |
| Mount interaction   | Rider hit and mount hit                            |
| Shape interaction   | Primary and secondary form                         |
| Buff interaction    | Strength, weapon, protection, and resistance buffs |
| Scale               | One attacker and massed formation                  |

The purpose is not to prove that a weapon can kill. It is to identify which battlefield class it makes obsolete.

# Part IV: Monsters, Mounts, Shapes, and Commanders

## A monster is a bundle of systems

"Monster" is the modding category for ordinary troops, commanders, mages, heroes, Pretenders, mounts, animals, constructs, undead, and many summoned beings.

A complete monster audit covers:

- 1 identity and visuals;
- 2 body statistics;
- 3 weapons and armour;
- 4 item slots;
- 5 movement;
- 6 creature type and tags;
- 7 leadership;
- 8 magic;
- 9 recruitment rules and costs;
- 10 shape and mount relationships;
- 11 special abilities;
- 12 AI recruitment instructions;
- 13 death, rebirth, and transformation behaviour.

## Base statistics are not independent

Changing Size can affect:

- square occupancy;
- repel and weapon length interactions;
- trampling eligibility;
- strength and hit expectations;
- mount and rider geometry;
- item and shape assumptions.

Changing action points affects how rapidly a unit crosses a battlefield and may interact with weapon timing. Changing encumbrance affects fatigue, which in turn changes Defence Skill, attack performance, spellcasting, and eventual collapse. Changing morale affects rout timing and formation stability.

The final role must be tested as a system.

## Cost has three distinct channels

Monster cost is not one number:

- gold cost controls treasury and upkeep;
- resource cost reflects base body plus equipment;
- recruitment-point cost controls throughput.

A unit can be cheap in gold but impossible to mass from one fort because of recruitment points. A mage can be affordable but consume several commander points. A heavily equipped unit may be limited by resources even when gold is abundant.

Cost doctrine:

- compare per fort-turn, not only per unit;
- include upkeep;

- include commander support;
- include resource scales and terrain;
- compare battlefield role against the nearest national alternative;
- test massed availability.

## Automatic gold-cost calculation

Dominions can calculate parts of monster cost from attributes. Manual cost setters and automatic components can interact. A displayed final recruitment price is more authoritative than a single source line.

When modifying a copied unit:

- record the displayed parent price;
- record every cost-related source command;
- record the displayed child price;
- do not label an isolated #gcost argument as the final cost without inspection.

This rule was necessary in the Arcoscephale DE dossier, where copied or selected objects could not be safely summarized from one cost line.

## Recruitment flags are strategic rules

Recruitment commands can constrain a monster by:

- capital status;
- terrain;
- fort or no fort;
- coast or sea;
- season;
- commander points;
- recruitment points;
- holy or sacred limits;
- nation lists and sites.

The unit card does not by itself answer where and how often the unit can be produced. Nation and site source must also be read.

## Leadership is typed

Normal, magic, and undead leadership are separate capacities. Morale modifiers, taskmaster-like abilities, formation permissions, and undisciplined-unit control can alter the practical command package.

For each commander, test:

- maximum normal troops;
- maximum magic beings;
- maximum undead;
- squad morale effect;
- formation options;
- bodyguard capacity;
- movement of the slowest assigned unit;
- behaviour after shapechange or dismount.

## Magic paths and randoms

Fixed paths use path numbers:

| Number | Path      |
|--------|-----------|
| 0      | Fire      |
| 1      | Air       |
| 2      | Water     |
| 3      | Earth     |
| 4      | Astral    |
| 5      | Death     |
| 6      | Nature    |
| 7      | Glamour   |
| 8      | Blood     |
| 9      | Priest    |
| 50     | Random    |
| 51     | Elemental |
| 52     | Sorcery   |
| 53     | All       |

`#magicskill` assigns a fixed path. Holy magic also requires the monster to be made a priest through the appropriate priest attribute.

`#custommagic` uses path masks and a percentage. Multiple `#custommagic` lines represent multiple rolls. They do not automatically describe one combined roll.

For every random mage:

- write each roll separately;
- state whether its chance is 100%, 50%, 10%, or another value;
- identify which paths share one mask;
- calculate threshold probability;
- check impossible combinations;
- distinguish source probability from observed distribution.

The manual warns that a custom random containing only Priest can crash the mod. Random holy levels should not be used casually.

## Ritual mastery and range

`#masterrit` changes effective paths for ritual casting without simply granting an ordinary path level. Path-specific range commands increase ritual reach by provinces and battlefield range in percentage steps.

These abilities can create access that an ordinary path list misses. A mage audit asks:

- displayed path;
- effective ritual path;
- range modifiers;
- research bonus;

- gem production;
- path boosts;
- item restrictions;
- automatic spells;
- communion or chorus role.

## Mounts are separate monsters

Dominions 6 models the mount separately from the rider. A mounted design may involve:

- rider monster;
- mount monster;
- mount assignment;
- rider placement;
- mount statistics;
- mount weapons;
- barding;
- size and item-slot interaction;
- dismounted continuation;
- remount or mount-regeneration behaviour.

A mounted unit can fail in several distinct ways:

- the mount dies and leaves a functioning rider;
- the rider dies while the mount is hit separately;
- an area effect hits both;
- a gateway or movement effect interacts with the mounted state;
- a shapechange loses or duplicates mount state;
- event-created unique riders behave differently.

Patch notes have repeatedly addressed mounted crashes and inconsistencies. Mounted content needs its own regression suite.

## Shape relationships form graphs

Shapechanging changes far more than the sprite. It can affect:

- statistics;
- magic;
- items and disabled slots;
- age;
- afflictions;
- mount state;
- death and rebirth;
- battle-only changes;
- seasonal changes;
- bug or swarm forms;
- Pretender recognition.

Represent the relationship as a graph:

```
strategic form
-> battle form
-> wounded or death form
-> restored form
```

Then test each edge and what state survives it:

- experience;
- afflictions;
- heroic ability;
- prophet status;
- magic paths and boosts;
- items;
- name;
- orders;
- mount;
- event target eligibility.

The Arcoscephale Grand Hierophant case demonstrates why this matters: an event transforms an ordinary Mystic into a Mystic Prophet and later events may boost that transformed object. The relevant question is not only which unit appears, but which state is preserved through transformation.

## Pretender qualification

A monster does not become an available Pretender merely because it has impressive statistics.

Relevant design elements include:

- starting dominion;
- new-path cost;
- initial paths;
- chassis status and slots;
- home realm;
- explicit addition to nation god lists;
- awakening restrictions;
- nation availability.

When a custom Pretender exists but does not appear:

- verify Pretender-defining attributes;
- verify home realm;
- verify #addgod or equivalent national inclusion;
- verify era and nation;
- verify later #cleargods;
- verify the final #end was parsed.

# Part V: Sites, Nations, and Recruitment Architecture

## Sites are content containers

Magic sites can provide:

- gem income;
- gold, resources, supply, scales, or unrest effects;
- recruitable units and commanders;
- conjuration or ritual access;



- scrying and ritual range;
- path or research effects;
- Throne effects;
- unique national infrastructure.

This makes sites a powerful compatibility technique. A site can add recruitment without rebuilding a nation's ordinary recruit list. It can also scope content to a capital, terrain, or discovered location.

## Site identity and discovery

Sites can be hidden or known. Event requirements distinguish:

- site present;
- discovered;
- hidden;
- nearby;
- claimed or unclaimed Throne;
- free site slots.

An event that adds a site should normally require a free site slot. An event referring to a site by name may require the exact site name embedded in brackets at the end of its message, depending on the command. The Event Manual's bracket convention is easy to miss and should be copied exactly when relevant.

Current official correction: Dominions 6.35 fixed `#revealsite` and `#removesite` so they work when several sites share the same name. Earlier behaviour should not be assumed when reading old reports.

## Nation blocks define conversion rules

A nation is not only a list of troops. It defines:

- name, epithet, era, colours, flag, and description;
- preferred and hated terrain;
- capital and start sites;
- recruitment lists;
- terrain and fort recruitment;
- starting commander and armies;
- province defence;
- forts, laboratories, and temples;
- dominion and scale modifiers;
- Pretender list and realms;
- undead reanimation;
- AI hints;
- national spells and items through references elsewhere.

Changing recruitment can alter the entire national economy.

### `#clearrec` is a major operation

`#clearrec` removes the nation's ordinary recruitable units and commanders, but not its gods. It should be treated like a schema migration.

After clearing, reconstruct:

- ordinary units;
- ordinary commanders;
- fort and foreign recruitment;
- terrain-specific recruitment;
- capital-site recruitment;
- starting commander and troops;
- commander-point coverage;
- scouts and priests;
- siege and leadership access.

Dominions Enhanced uses this kind of recruitment rewrite for MA Arcoscephale. The final roster cannot be inferred from the base game plus a list of new units; it must be rebuilt from the post-clear additions and site recruitment.

## Ordinary, foreign, terrain, fort, and site recruitment

Recruitment sources should be recorded separately:

| Source                    | Strategic meaning                                   |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Ordinary national recruit | Available through normal national recruitment rules |
| Foreign recruit           | Available without a fort where permitted            |
| Fort-terrain recruit      | Depends on both fort and terrain                    |
| Site recruit              | Depends on owning a specific site                   |
| Capital-site recruit      | Capital-only even if not in ordinary list           |
| Event-added recruit       | Depends on event state                              |

A complete nation diff names both the object and its source.

## Starting armies are their own system

Changing #startcom removes old starting troops and establishes a new starting-command context. Starting squads and counts must then be restored explicitly.

The manual recommends increasing Dominions 5 starting armies by roughly half when converting to Dominions 6 because army scale increased. This is guidance, not a universal balance formula. The new army must still be tested against current neutral provinces.

## Province defence

Province defence has:

- commanders;
- troop types;
- thresholds;
- quantities per defence points;
- separate underwater definitions.

PD is part of national strategic identity. A cheap raiding unit becomes much stronger if opposing modded nations have brittle PD; an event attack becomes oppressive if it repeatedly strikes a nation with no suitable PD answer.

Test:

- PD 1;
- first threshold;
- second threshold;
- PD 10 and 20;
- commander survival;
- patrol and siege interaction;
- underwater version;
- gold efficiency against common raiders.

## Buildings and infrastructure

National fort, laboratory, and temple commands change:

- construction cost;
- construction time;
- defence;
- recruitment;
- economic conversion;
- research spread;
- dominion spread.

The strategic unit is not "a cheap fort." It is:

```
gold and commander turns  
-> completed infrastructure  
-> recruitment and research throughput  
-> defended territory
```

Balance should compare the whole conversion.

## Dominion is a rules engine

Nation modding can change:

- scale limits;
- scale spread;
- automatic effects;
- population and income interactions;
- special dominion;
- bless availability;
- temple and priest behaviour.

Dominion effects can reach every friendly or hostile province, giving them far greater reach than a unit adjustment. Every special dominion should specify:

- eligible provinces;
- dominion threshold;
- frequency;
- stacking;
- effect on allies and enemies;
- event interaction;
- siege behaviour;
- counterplay;
- performance cost.

## Home realms and god lists

Home realms allow Pretenders belonging to a realm to enter a nation's default god pool. A nation can also add or clear gods explicitly.

Compatibility risk:

- one mod adds a Pretender;
- a later nation block clears gods;
- the Pretender remains defined but disappears from selection.

The final nation block determines availability.

## Nation design audit

A new nation is not ready when the roster appears. It is ready when it can complete the game's strategic conversions.

| System         | Minimum question                                            |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Expansion      | Can at least two coherent parties take normal independents? |
| Leadership     | Can starting and recruited armies legally move?             |
| Siege          | Can the nation take and hold forts?                         |
| Research       | Can it build a functioning research economy?                |
| Magic          | Are path randomness, gems, and national rituals coherent?   |
| Priests        | Can it bless, preach, claim, and recover its god?           |
| Infrastructure | Do forts, labs, and temples fit costs and roster?           |
| Defence        | Does PD resist trivial raiding without becoming oppressive? |
| Water          | Is water access intentionally absent, partial, or native?   |
| AI             | Can the AI recruit and research a usable subset?            |
| Pretenders     | Are several legal strategic families possible?              |
| Counterplay    | Which common tools defeat its strongest package?            |

# Part VI: Spells, Items, Blessings, and Supporting Objects

## Spell design begins with delivery

A spell definition combines:

- name, description, and detail text;
- research school and level;
- one or two path requirements;
- fatigue and gem or blood-slave cost;
- combat or ritual effect;
- damage or effect argument;
- area;

- range and precision;
- number of effects;
- targeting restrictions;
- environmental restrictions;
- global-enchantment identity;
- national access;
- AI preference.

A strategically meaningful spell description must answer:

- 1 Who can cast it naturally?
- 2 Who can cast it after ordinary boosters?
- 3 When does the research arrive?
- 4 What gem, slave, fatigue, or mage-turn cost is paid?
- 5 How is the effect delivered?
- 6 What resists it?
- 7 What battlefield or map condition invalidates it?
- 8 Will the AI cast it sensibly?

## Schools and path numbers

Spell schools are:

| Number | School           |
|--------|------------------|
| -1     | Not researchable |
| 0      | Conjuration      |
| 1      | Alteration       |
| 2      | Evocation        |
| 3      | Construction     |
| 4      | Enchantment      |
| 5      | Thaumaturgy      |
| 6      | Blood            |
| 7      | Divine           |

Spell path values are:

| Number | Path    |
|--------|---------|
| -1     | None    |
| 0      | Fire    |
| 1      | Air     |
| 2      | Water   |
| 3      | Earth   |
| 4      | Astral  |
| 5      | Death   |
| 6      | Nature  |
| 7      | Glamour |
| 8      | Blood   |

| Number | Path   |
|--------|--------|
| 9      | Priest |

The required level applies to the corresponding requirement slot. A two-path spell must set the path and level for each intended slot.

## Fatigue cost also encodes ritual cost

The manual states that each full 100 points of fatigue cost raises the gem or slave requirement by one. Rituals also use #fatiguecost to establish their cost.

This makes fatigue a dual-purpose design field:

- in combat, it affects whether and how often the caster can act;
- for rituals, it establishes gem or slave expenditure.

A copied spell can retain an unexpected economic cost even after its effect has been changed.

## Area notation

Spell area supports special values. The manual documents:

- ordinary square counts;
- values above 1000 that scale area with caster level;
- 666 for the entire battlefield;
- special fractional-battlefield values.

Large-area effects must be tested for:

- performance;
- friendly fire;
- resistance density;
- interaction with obstacles;
- repeated casting;
- whether stronger casters scale the area;
- whether an AI preference creates spell spam.

## Effects are an engine interface

#effect selects an internal effect family. The manual documents many useful values but explicitly does not present every internal possibility. ctrl+i on an existing spell can expose modding information.

The safest creation method is:

- 1 find a base-game spell with the closest delivery and resolution;
- 2 copy it;
- 3 rename before writing the new description;
- 4 change one dimension at a time;
- 5 retain a source note identifying the parent;
- 6 test target selection and resistance;
- 7 compare battle logs.

Changing a copied spell's name removes its description, so the order of name and description commands matters.

## A spell's access may be more important than its effect

Balance errors frequently come from access:

- research too early;
- path too common;
- gem cost too low;
- battlefield range too long;
- ritual range bypassing borders;
- national restriction omitted;
- item casting bypassing the intended mage requirement;
- communion or path-master interaction;
- AI casting in every marginal situation.

Spell balance should compare total delivery cost:

research + mage recruitment + path access + gems + laboratory + travel + script slot

## National and restricted spells

National restriction commands can allow or forbid particular nations. A restriction using the last manipulated nation is convenient inside a self-contained file and fragile when source is reorganized.

For maintainability:

- comment every numeric nation;
- avoid relying on "last manipulated nation" across distant blocks;
- keep nation creation and its restricted content in a controlled order;
- include restrictions in the public spell card audit;
- verify the spell under every intended ruleset.

## Spell AI hints

Three central controls are:

| Command     | Function                                                       |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| #ainocast   | Prevents ordinary AI selection while allowing a scripted cast  |
| #aibadlvl   | Stops AI selection at or above a specified required path level |
| #aispellmod | Raises or lowers AI preference                                 |

The documented #aispellmod scale includes:

- -50: roughly half as attractive;
- 100: roughly twice as attractive;
- -100: never cast, even if scripted;
- values up to 1000.

These are hints, not a full targeting language. They cannot make a spell understand a diplomatic plan, reserve gems for a specific future war, or evaluate a bespoke combined-arms doctrine.

AI spell testing needs:

- unscripted independent caster;
- scripted caster;
- high-path caster;
- communion;
- low and high fatigue;
- friendly and hostile target mixes;
- early and late battle;
- routing side;
- gem availability;
- several map contexts for rituals.

## Global enchantments require an event layer

A custom global enchantment is usually a spell plus events that check its enchantment identity.

The structure is:

```
global ritual
-> enchantment identity becomes active
-> recurring global or provincial events check identity
-> effects occur under bounded requirements
-> events stop when the enchantment disappears
```

This separates the act of casting from the monthly consequences.

Every custom global requires:

- unique enchantment number;
- owner and hostile checks;
- province eligibility;
- per-month cap;
- message policy;
- dispel and replacement behaviour;
- performance estimate;
- end-state test.

## Items are persistent force multipliers

Magic items can change:

- paths and spell access;
- resistances and statistics;
- movement;
- leadership;
- ritual range;
- automatic spells;
- summoning;
- curses and afflictions;
- shape and mount interaction;
- national cost or availability.

Unlike a battlefield spell, an item can persist across many battles and move between commanders. A small numerical bonus may have a large campaign value.



## Item creation and automatic identity

#newitem automatically creates an item. The consolidated manual places modded items at 700 and above, while older local text may describe a lower legacy boundary.

The stable-release policy is:

- append items rather than insert;
- record observed item numbers;
- preserve object order;
- reserve placeholders if the project expects expansion;
- test save compatibility after any registry change.

## Construction level has special values

The manual documents ordinary Construction levels and special unforgeable values:

| Value         | Meaning                                |
|---------------|----------------------------------------|
| 1, 3, 5, 7, 9 | Forgeable tiers                        |
| 11            | Unforgeable item                       |
| 13            | Unforgeable unique artifact            |
| 15            | Unforgeable unique-per-nation artifact |

Item type and slot must also match the intended user. Barding is a distinct item type and depends on a legal mount slot.

## Item access audit

For every item:

- main and secondary paths;
- Construction tier;
- nominal gem cost;
- forge bonuses and rebates;
- national restrictions;
- slot;
- legal bodies;
- whether it is recoverable after battle;
- whether it is unique;
- whether the AI forges it;
- whether a spell or event creates it;
- whether it grants another ritual or summon.

An item can collapse a path-access ladder. If a nation gains a low-tier booster, every ritual above it must be reconsidered.

## Blessing design

Blessing modding changes the Pretender-design economy and every sacred unit that can receive the effect.

A blessing needs:

- path and point requirements;
- scale requirements;
- incarnate status where relevant;
- effect text;
- interaction with mounts;
- interaction with weapons;
- passive versus blessed-state behaviour;
- AI suitability;
- nation-specific exclusion or access.

Test at least:

- ordinary sacred troop;
- sacred commander;
- sacred mount;
- shapeshifter;
- undead or inanimate sacred;
- ranged sacred;
- communion mage if applicable;
- global enchantment and battlefield-buff interactions.

The nation-level AI hints `#aigoodbless`, `#aicheapholy`, and `#aiholyranged` can encourage an appropriate Pretender family, but they do not evaluate the full roster as a human designer would.

## Names, population types, mercenaries, and general rules

These categories are smaller than monsters or spells but still global.

### Nametypes

Custom nametypes give cultural coherence to commanders. Allocate them from the documented mod range, avoid collision, and verify pluralization and generated forms.

### Population types

Population types affect independent recruitment and the character of a province. They can change the strategic value of terrain, so they need a scenario-wide review.

### Mercenaries

A mercenary band defines:

- arrival tier;
- commander;
- unit type;
- unit count;
- names and price-related behaviour.

Mercenaries are globally available content. A nation-specific balance patch should not create a universally dominant mercenary without intending to alter every game.

## General commands

General modding affects shared game rules. It has the widest compatibility surface. Every general command should be treated as an explicit ruleset dependency and placed in the mod's description and change log.

# Part VII: Event Modding as a State Machine

## Events are advanced modding

Event modding uses the same .dm file but adds:

- probabilistic selection;
- province eligibility;
- nation eligibility;
- commander targeting;
- persistent province codes;
- global variables;
- delayed and global execution;
- world effects;
- event chains.

An event is best understood as a state transition:

```
current game state
+ event eligibility
+ event selection
-> effects
-> new state
```

The source block must answer three questions:

- 1 When can this event be considered?
- 2 Who or what does it target?
- 3 Which persistent state changes after it fires?

## Event anatomy

```
#newevent
#rarity ...
#req_...
#req_...
#msg "...
#effect...
#code ...
#end
```

Requirements are combined unless a command explicitly allows several alternatives. Adding more requirements narrows eligibility; it does not necessarily make the event less frequent after eligibility unless rarity or probability also changes.

## Event rarity classes

| Value | Class                   | Practical use                                    |
|-------|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| 0     | Always                  | One ordinary always event per province per month |
| 1     | Common bad              | Random bad event pool                            |
| 2     | Uncommon bad            | Rarer bad event                                  |
| 5     | Always, unlimited       | Several can occur in one province; use carefully |
| -1    | Common good             | Random good event pool                           |
| -2    | Uncommon good           | Rarer good event                                 |
| 10    | Always global           | Planned global processing                        |
| 11    | Common global           | Global random event                              |
| 12    | Uncommon global         | Rarer global event                               |
| 13    | Always immediate global | Immediate global processing                      |

The official manual states that most global events are planned seven months before execution so fortune tellers can foresee them. Rarity 13 is immediate.

Rarity 5 is powerful and dangerous. An unrestricted rarity-5 event can be considered across many provinces every month and can create event storms or hosting cost.

## Probability is conditional

#req\_rare 20 does not mean a 20% monthly chance for a nation in isolation. It means the event has a 20% validity chance when considered, after the event system and other requirements bring it into scope.

Similarly:

```
#req_domchance 5
```

multiplies eligibility by dominion strength: at c candles the documented chance factor is 5c%, provided the event would otherwise occur.

Probability statements should specify:

- event rarity;
- eligible province count;
- per-month limits;
- dominion or turn factor;
- uniqueness;
- owner and target conditions.

## Requirements are filters

Major requirement families include:

| Family  | Examples of questions                       |
|---------|---------------------------------------------|
| Generic | Era, turn, month, season, story events, AI  |
| Nation  | In play, recipient, excluded nation or ally |

| Family      | Examples of questions                                     |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Treasury    | Gold, gem type, active-path gems                          |
| Research    | School and minimum level                                  |
| Province    | Population, unrest, PD, terrain, plane, fort, lab, temple |
| Site        | Present, hidden, discovered, nearby, Throne, free slots   |
| Dominion    | Owner, candle strength, god form, awake state             |
| Scales      | Order, Productivity, Heat, Growth, Luck, Magic            |
| Monster     | Monster present or absent                                 |
| Mage        | Paths, type, order, characteristics                       |
| Target      | Legal commander selected for effect                       |
| Code        | Province and world event-chain state                      |
| Enchantment | Global active, owner, hostile, target                     |
| Variable    | Global integer state                                      |

The safest event begins with the narrowest stable identity:

- intended nation;
- intended terrain or site;
- intended turn window;
- intended target order;
- uniqueness or variable gate.

## Province event codes

Events can place numeric codes on provinces. Later events can require, forbid, locate, or remove those codes.

The official manual recommends negative codes from -300 to -5000, with 0 as the default/reset state. Two mods using the same code can scramble chains.

Create a code registry:

| Range        | System                    |
|--------------|---------------------------|
| -300 to -399 | Tutorial and introduction |
| -400 to -499 | Diplomacy warnings        |
| -500 to -599 | Grudges and sanctions     |
| -600 to -699 | Coalition escalation      |
| -700 to -799 | Scenario objectives       |

The exact allocation is project-specific. What matters is that it is written, checked against dependencies, and never recycled casually.

## Event variables

Event variables are global integers numbered 0-9999. They begin at zero and can be checked or altered.

Special negative references are translated:

| Reference | Documented interpretation  |
|-----------|----------------------------|
| -1        | Nation receiving the event |
| -2        | 500 + player number        |
| -3        | 1000 + province number     |
| -4        | 3000 + province number     |

These mappings reserve broad portions of the variable space implicitly. The manual warns that -1 can alter variables up to 499, while province-derived forms can reach higher blocks.

Use variables for:

- once-per-player events;
- relationship scores;
- warning stages;
- global objectives;
- cooldowns;
- campaign chapters;
- counted thresholds.

Use province codes for:

- local state;
- marked borders;
- regional event chains;
- site or province transformations.

Do not substitute one for the other without considering scope.

## Once-per-player pattern

A reliable conceptual pattern is:

require the recipient's variable to be zero  
apply the event  
increment that recipient's variable

Using the special nation variable reference provides one state cell per recipient. A public community explanation by experienced modder Sombre confirms this interpretation and matches the Event Manual's stated purpose.

## Targets are not automatically "any mage"

Many effects require a valid target commander. Requirements can filter:

- monster type;
- humanoid or other body class;
- path levels;
- sight or gem possession;
- current order;
- positive or absent paths;
- properties such as Pretender, prophet, or special status.

An event intended to affect a site-searching mage should require the site-search order. An event intended for a temple-based teacher should require the appropriate province and target class.

Target testing records:

- no eligible commander;
- one eligible commander;
- several eligible commanders;
- same commander with different orders;
- commander in and outside fort;
- prophet, Pretender, mounted, transformed, and disguised cases;
- ally or disciple where relevant.

## Messages can carry required object names

Some site and item commands read the exact object name from square brackets at the end of the event message.

Consequences:

- spelling and capitalization must match;
- a localization-like prose edit can break mechanics;
- renaming an object requires an event-message audit;
- brackets should be treated as data, not decoration.

Keep the required name on a dedicated final line in source comments even if the public message is rewritten.

## Event chains

A bounded chain has:

- 1 initial eligibility;
- 2 first effect;
- 3 state marker;
- 4 follow-up eligibility;
- 5 follow-up effect;
- 6 reset or terminal marker.

Conceptual example:

```
Stage 0: no warning
-> expansion threshold crossed
Stage 1: warning code or variable
-> threshold remains crossed after cooldown
Stage 2: grievance and local penalties
-> repeated violation or war state
Stage 3: coalition invitation
-> resolution
Terminal: reset, peace, victory, or permanent hostility
```

Every chain needs:

- terminal state;
- re-entry policy;
- cooldown;
- uniqueness scope;
- recovery path;

- compatibility namespace.

Without a terminal state, an event chain becomes an accidental recurring tax.

## Delays and the global event calendar

Events can be delayed or added to the global calendar. The calendar holds planned global events for the coming seven months.

Delayed systems must answer:

- can the initiating condition cease before execution?
- should the delayed event recheck ownership or war?
- can the target die?
- can the province change owner?
- can several copies queue?
- is there a purge or cancellation path?

The most common narrative error is treating delayed execution as if the original state were frozen.

## Global-enchancement events

The Event Manual provides a simple pattern in which an enchantment identity enables immediate or recurring events. A robust global uses separate events for:

- owner income or boon;
- hostile-province effect;
- terrain-specific effect;
- dominion-scaled effect;
- messaging;
- cleanup or cessation.

Every recurring event should use the narrowest rarity and a per-month cap where possible.

## Event effects and transactional thinking

Effects include:

- gold, gems, items, and treasure;
- scales, population, unrest, defence, terrain, and sites;
- commanders and units;
- afflictions, healing, path boosts, transformation, and items;
- enchantment and world effects;
- event codes and variables;
- delays and calendar manipulation;
- victory requirements.

Treat a multi-effect event as a transaction:

```
validate all prerequisites  
-> alter local state  
-> grant or remove assets  
-> write chain state last
```

Although the engine does not provide database rollback, this order makes the design easier to reason about and reduces half-complete chains.



## Event performance

An event system can be logically correct and operationally expensive.

Cost rises with:

- rarity-5 checks across every province;
- broad monster requirements;
- several global scans;
- repeated nearby-code checks;
- many always events;
- unbounded spawning;
- event chains that never terminate.

The 6.29 update reported a major performance improvement for events using monster-presence requirements, which confirms that event-query cost is material.

Performance doctrine:

- filter by nation and terrain early;
- avoid worldwide checks where a per-player variable is sufficient;
- cap monthly executions;
- make dormant stages ineligible;
- use one scheduler event to enable narrower local events;
- measure hosting time on a large map.

# Part VIII: Simulating Diplomacy and Strategic Reaction

---

## What event modding can accomplish

An event system can create:

- warnings after expansion thresholds;
- consequences for dominion pressure;
- responses to claimed Thrones;
- retaliation against repeated raiding;
- defensive reinforcements;
- temporary sanctions;
- border unrest;
- hostile summons;
- coalition-themed messages;
- gifts or concessions after restraint;
- campaign reputation;
- AI-only bonuses triggered by a human threat.

This can make the world react coherently.

## What it cannot honestly claim

Ordinary modding does not expose a general rewrite of the AI's strategic mind. It does not provide an open-ended diplomatic planner capable of:

- understanding free-form promises;
- evaluating arbitrary treaties;
- remembering nuanced betrayal;
- planning coalition manoeuvres as a human group;
- reasoning about every modded unit and spell;
- negotiating outside the supported diplomacy systems.

Events can simulate consequences and staged attitudes. AI hints can influence recruitment, Pretender design, research, rituals, and spell preference. That combination can create convincing strategic theatre, but it should not be described as a new general intelligence.

## The reaction-layer architecture

A practical diplomacy overhaul has five layers:

| Layer          | Responsibility                                                                       |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Observation    | Detect measurable state such as Thrones, borders, dominion, wars, ownership, or turn |
| Memory         | Store province codes and player variables                                            |
| Interpretation | Convert thresholds into warning, grievance, hostility, or coalition stage            |
| Response       | Apply messages, troops, resources, attacks, or restrictions                          |
| Recovery       | Reduce hostility, expire sanctions, or reset after peace                             |

The structure is deliberately finite. Each grievance is a state machine with explicit inputs and outputs.

## Observable proxies

When the desired concept is not directly exposed, use a measurable proxy.

| Desired concept      | Possible proxy                                         |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Rapid expansion      | Province ownership checked over staged turn windows    |
| Border pressure      | Codes in neighbouring provinces                        |
| Religious aggression | Dominion ownership and candle thresholds               |
| Throne threat        | Claimed Throne requirements and Ascension Point state  |
| Warmonger            | War-related state combined with repeat counters        |
| Broken warning       | Prior warning variable plus continued trigger          |
| Coalition concern    | Several nations independently reaching hostility stage |
| Restraint            | Cooldown without further violations                    |

The proxy must be disclosed in design notes. A player should be able to understand why the world reacted.

## Warning before punishment

A believable system escalates:

- 1 observation;

- 2 warning;
- 3 opportunity to change;
- 4 limited response;
- 5 severe response;
- 6 recovery or permanent feud.

Immediate punishment teaches the trigger but does not feel diplomatic. A warning creates agency.

## Avoiding hidden rubber-banding

AI assistance should be legible and bounded.

Good assistance:

- named emergency levy after a capital threat;
- temporary resources after a formal warning;
- faction-specific defenders;
- one coalition response after a Throne threshold.

Poor assistance:

- silent monthly gold;
- infinite unannounced armies;
- bonuses that remain after the threat disappears;
- punishment aimed only at the leading human regardless of cause.

Scenario difficulty should arise from declared rules.

## Relationship-state registry

With  $N$  nations, pairwise relationship storage can become expensive. A full directed matrix requires  $N(N-1)$  cells. For 20 nations that is 380 directional relationships.

Event variables are limited and shared. A first design should avoid a full matrix.

Prefer:

- one reputation score per player;
- one global threat stage per player;
- province-local border markers;
- specific scripted rivalries only where necessary;
- separate coalition flags for major objectives.

Pairwise state should be reserved for campaign scenarios with a controlled roster.

## Anti-loop rules

Every diplomacy response needs:

- once-per-stage gating;
- cooldown;
- maximum reinforcements;
- owner recheck;
- game-alive recheck;
- target recheck;
- terminal resolution;

- no valid-target behaviour.
- A coalition event that summons troops every month until a province is recaptured can become an infinite unit generator if the target becomes unreachable.

## Fairness matrix

| Question                                  | Acceptable design                                |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Is the trigger visible?                   | Message, rule sheet, or inspectable threshold    |
| Can the response be avoided?              | At least one strategic alternative               |
| Is the response proportional?             | Escalation matches offence stage                 |
| Does the AI receive value?                | Enough to act, not infinite replacement          |
| Can hostility fall?                       | Cooldown, concession, peace, or objective change |
| Can the system target allies incorrectly? | Ally exclusions and ownership rechecks           |
| Does it work for AI offenders?            | Explicit AI/human scope                          |
| Does it scale with map size?              | Thresholds tied to settings or scenario          |

## A recommended first diplomacy module

Begin with one grievance: early Throne pressure.

State:

- player threat variable;
- one warning-fired variable;
- one sanction-fired variable.

Inputs:

- turn window;
- claimed Throne requirement;
- Ascension threshold;
- whether story events are enabled.

Responses:

- warning message;
- temporary unrest or diplomatic penalty in marked border provinces;
- one defensive grant to threatened AI nations;
- final coalition-themed global message.

Recovery:

- fixed expiry;
- no recurring unit creation;
- no hidden permanent income.

This module is small enough to prove the structure before adding expansion, dominion, and raiding grievances.

# Part IX: Maps and Scenario Design

## The map is a ruleset

A map decides:

- who can meet;
- how quickly capitals can be reached;
- where armies can retreat;
- which terrain recruits and rituals are available;
- how valuable sailing, flying, mountain movement, and amphibious access become;
- how many fronts a nation must defend;
- whether caves and the Nexus matter;
- how difficult a Throne is to contest;
- whether remote spells can reach strategic centres.

Visual beauty matters, but topology and strategic distribution matter first.

## Hand-drawn map assets

The Map Making Manual requires a Targa image for the principal hand-drawn map:

- at least 256x256 pixels;
- 24- or 32-bit colour;
- a practical example size around 1600x1200;
- no problematic alpha channel;
- legal filename without spaces or special characters.

Province centres are defined by individual pure-white pixels with RGB 255,255,255. Ordinary white artwork should use a near-white such as 253,253,253 so it is not mistaken for an extra province.

Province pixels should be:

- one pixel;
- on a separate image layer during creation;
- merged only for export;
- counted before import.

An accidental white pixel is an accidental province.

## Province borders and areas

Visible borders are not technically required, but they communicate adjacency. Keep them on a separate layer so the map editor can use a border-only image.

Province areas matter for:

- mouse selection;
- dominion overlay;
- terrain-change graphics;
- readable map feedback.

The editor supports an area workflow:

- 1 switch to Province Area mode;
- 2 import or paint border areas;
- 3 expand areas to fill gaps;
- 4 remove stray pixels;

- 5 inspect every province;
- 6 test dominion overlay.

## Connections are strategic edges

The map editor can create:

- ordinary connections;
- mountain passes;
- river borders;
- bridges;
- impassable connections;
- roads.

The manual's special-border values are:

| Value | Border        |
|-------|---------------|
| 0     | Standard      |
| 1     | Mountain pass |
| 2     | River         |
| 4     | Impassable    |
| 8     | Road          |

An impassable connection can still matter for spell targeting. A line that appears decorative may affect range or adjacency.

Connection audit:

- every visual border matches mechanical adjacency;
- every non-visual connection is intentionally signalled;
- capitals have comparable exit counts;
- no province is accidentally isolated;
- retreats do not create one-way traps;
- wrap connections are readable;
- bridge and pass effects match the artwork.

## Required map commands

Every hand-drawn map file needs:

```
#dom2title "Map Title"
#imagefile "mapname.tga"
#mapsize <width> <height>
```

The historical command name `#dom2title` remains in use.

Useful metadata includes:

- `#domversion`;
- `#description`;
- plane name;
- hidden-map behaviour;
- cave-plane controls.

## Terrain masks

Common terrain-mask components include:

| Value       | Terrain or property     |
|-------------|-------------------------|
| 0           | Plains                  |
| 1           | Small province          |
| 2           | Large province          |
| 4           | Sea                     |
| 8           | Freshwater              |
| 16          | Highlands or gorge      |
| 32          | Swamp                   |
| 64          | Waste                   |
| 128         | Forest or kelp forest   |
| 256         | Farm                    |
| 512         | No random start         |
| 1024        | Many sites              |
| 2048        | Deep, combined with sea |
| 4096        | Cave                    |
| 8388608     | Mountains               |
| 33554432    | Good Throne location    |
| 67108864    | Good start location     |
| 134217728   | Bad Throne location     |
| 1073741824  | Warmer                  |
| 2147483648  | Colder                  |
| 68719476736 | Cave wall               |

Values are added. The official example 1601 is:

$\backslash [ 1 + 64 + 512 + 1024 \backslash ]$

meaning small, waste, no-start, and many-sites.

Rare site-bias components include Fire through Holy site biases. These are advanced and must be added to the map-editor mask manually.

Do not hand-calculate terrain masks without retaining the decomposition.

## Terrain density

The official manual advises that a province generally contain only one adverse terrain type, or at most two. Forest, waste, highland, swamp, and cave combinations slow movement. Too many mixed provinces can make a beautiful map strategically inert.

Terrain audit:

- percentage of provinces by terrain;
- mixed-adverse percentage;

- capital-ring terrain;
- chokepoint terrain;
- recruit and summon access;
- supply;
- underwater distribution;
- national start preferences;
- seasonal and extreme-scale changes.

## Starts

Starting fairness is not equal distance alone.

For every start, record:

- adjacent province count;
- adjacent income and population;
- adjacent resources;
- terrain;
- water access;
- cave access;
- nearest neighbour distance;
- nearest Throne distance;
- number of defensible approaches;
- expansion dead ends;
- nearby high-site provinces.

#nostart and the terrain mask value 512 exclude random starts. If a province is marked as both a start and no-start, no-start wins.

#specstart assigns a particular nation to a particular start. Scripted maps must use current Dominions 6 nation numbers.

## Thrones

Throne placement shapes diplomacy and victory timing.

Audit:

- total Ascension Points;
- central versus peripheral Thrones;
- level distribution;
- capital proximity;
- underwater Thrones;
- plane distribution;
- chokepoint control;
- ability to attack and retreat;
- whether one start can claim safely without revealing itself.

Good and bad Throne-location terrain masks guide placement but do not replace manual review.

## Province contents

After selecting an active land, map commands can set:



- ownership;
- name;
- population;
- defence;
- unrest;
- fort;
- laboratory;
- temple;
- sites;
- commanders;
- units;
- commander equipment and magic.

This allows designed independents, campaign characters, guarded objectives, and asymmetrical starts.

A placed commander can be altered with map-specific commands for:

- name;
- bodyguards;
- units;
- experience;
- random equipment;
- exact item;
- magic paths.

If the commander is a modded monster, the map may need to refer to it by name rather than number. This creates a dependency on the mod and should be documented.

## Scenario gods and scales

Maps can force a Pretender, dominion strength, and scales for a nation. Human-controlled nations that violate ordinary design-point limits can trigger cheat detection.

Use forced designs for:

- campaigns;
- puzzle scenarios;
- historical rematches;
- AI bosses;
- controlled test maps.

Do not use them casually in an ordinary multiplayer map.

## Multiple planes

Dominions 6 maps can contain up to eight planes: the main plane and seven additional planes.

Each plane requires its own map and image files using the documented naming pattern such as `_plane2`. The map editor should be opened through the first plane so related planes are loaded together.

Event plane requirements can refer to:

- default plane;
- numbered extra planes;

- cave plane;
- Nexus plane.

Plane design questions:

- how is entry obtained?
- can a nation begin there?
- which gates connect it?
- can remote rituals cross?
- what happens if the gate province falls?
- are objectives distributed across planes?
- does the AI understand the route well enough?

## Gates

Map gates connect provinces that share a gate number. A gate network can:

- bypass distance;
- create a contested hub;
- link planes;
- support a campaign chapter;
- undermine ordinary chokepoints.

Every gate needs:

- visible explanation;
- reciprocal test;
- ownership test;
- siege test;
- AI pathing test;
- remote-spell adjacency review.

## Terrain graphics

Dominions 6 can display altered terrain using additional image layers:

```
mymap.tga  
mymap_winter.tga  
mymap_forest.tga  
mymap_waste.tga  
mymap_farm.tga  
mymap_swamp.tga  
mymap_highland.tga  
mymap_plain.tga  
mymap_kelp.tga  
mymap_water.tga
```

Winter variants can add w. Multiple-plane filenames place the plane component before the terrain component.

Missing terrain images do not necessarily prevent play; the default look is used. They do reduce visual accuracy when terrain changes.

## Random map generator

The RMG creates a playable starting point and stores geography in `.d6m` files. It does not remove the need for human inspection.

After generation:

- inspect connection logic;
- inspect capital spacing;
- inspect lakes and cave relationships;
- inspect wrap edges;
- inspect Throne candidates;
- inspect provinces whose artwork implies a connection that does not exist;
- inspect strategic islands.

The binary `d6m` format stores the shape of lands, capital coordinates, a height field, and province ownership pixels. Terrain and other game information remain in the map file. The file-format document is mainly relevant to automated map generators.

## Workshop packaging

A Workshop map folder contains:

```
maps/  
Antworld/  
Antworld.map  
Antworld.tga  
banner.png  
dom6ws.txt
```

The folder, map, and main image should share the same name.

The Workshop banner is 256x256 or 512x512 PNG. `dom6ws.txt` sets visibility to Public, Friends, or Private. The platform creates an additional persistent ID file after first upload; deleting it can create a new Workshop entry rather than updating the old one.

## Scenario-design ladder

### Symmetric competitive map

Focus:

- start equivalence;
- comparable expansion;
- Throne fairness;
- readable connections.

### Asymmetric cooperative map

Focus:

- declared role differences;
- shared enemy pressure;
- comeback routes;
- objective pacing.

## Campaign map

Focus:

- placed forces;
- scripted chapters;
- persistent event state;
- named characters;
- narrative gates.

## AI challenge map

Focus:

- AI-compatible routes;
- controlled advantages;
- reinforcements with limits;
- clear victory condition;
- no reliance on human-like diplomacy.

## Test harness map

Focus:

- minimum provinces;
- deterministic contents;
- short travel;
- exact terrain;
- isolated experiments;
- reproducible turn-one setup.

# Part X: AI Modding

## Three different AIs

It is useful to separate:

- 1 Strategic AI: recruitment, expansion, forts, armies, rituals, and research.
- 2 Spell AI: battlefield spell selection and targeting.
- 3 Scripted event response: bonuses, attacks, warnings, and scenario state.

They interact, but they are not one system.

## Nation-level AI hints

The Modding Manual exposes several nation hints:

| Hint                                   | Purpose                              |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Elemental or sorcery path nation hints | Encourage a Pretender with that path |
| #bloodnation                           | Encourage Blood research and hunting |
| #aigoodbless                           | Raise chance of a powerful bless     |

| Hint           | Purpose                                        |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------|
| #aimusthavemag | Require at least level 3 in one specified path |
| #aicheapholy   | Signal cheap expendable sacreds                |
| #aiholyranged  | Signal sacred ranged troops                    |
| #aiheavyrec    | Encourage resource-heavy troop recruitment     |
| #aimagerec     | Encourage mage recruitment                     |
| #aiholdgod     | Keep the Pretender in the home province        |
| #aiawake       | Raise the chance of an awake Pretender         |

These commands alter preferences. They do not prove that the resulting strategy is coherent.

## Unit-level recruitment hints

#ainorec tells the AI not to recruit a monster. #aisinglerec tells it to recruit only one in a batch.

Use #ainorec when a unit:

- requires a human-only trick;
- is a trap for the AI;
- is a ceremonial or transformation object not intended for ordinary recruitment;
- consumes resources without filling a usable AI role.

Use #aisinglerec for:

- expensive support;
- rare specialists;
- units whose value does not scale linearly;
- commanders or troop-like objects that should not fill a queue.

## AI Pretender templates

AI templates can specify:

- nation;
- chassis;
- awakening;
- paths;
- dominion strength;
- scales;
- blessings;
- research targets;
- favourite rituals or items.

The game can export a designed Pretender template with `ctrl+shift+s`. This is safer than hand-authoring a complex legal build.

Template design should include several viable plans rather than one brittle script:

- awake expander;
- dormant scales;
- bless;
- access or ritual chassis.

If several templates exist for one nation, the AI can choose among them.

## Research goals

#researchgoal names a spell or item the AI should work toward. Several goals are pursued in order, although the manual warns that research will not follow the list perfectly.

A research sequence should:

- contain reachable goals;
- match national paths;
- alternate survival and power;
- avoid an item the AI cannot forge;
- avoid a ritual the AI cannot fund;
- account for national spells.

Bad goal:

```
late legendary spell
```

with no earlier battlefield package.

Better sequence:

```
early defensive spell  
-> first national summon  
-> battlefield damage package  
-> booster or key item  
-> strategic ritual
```

## Favourite rituals and items

#favrit can encourage a ritual or item. It includes a research school and level after which the favourite is disabled, or a persistent setting.

Favourite design must consider:

- gem income;
- path availability;
- laboratory access;
- target availability;
- whether repeated casting is useful;
- whether the result has leadership;
- whether the AI will strand expensive summons.

## AI testing is behavioural sampling

An AI instruction is not validated by one game.

Record over several seeds:

- Pretender family;
- scales;
- first twenty commander recruits;
- troop mix;
- first three research targets reached;
- first forged items;

- first national rituals;
- expansion count;
- forts by turn;
- gem stockpiles;
- whether key mages enter combat;
- whether special units accumulate unused.

The goal is not identical behaviour. It is the absence of catastrophic patterns.

## AI bonuses versus AI competence

An AI can be made harder by:

- game difficulty settings;
- better roster;
- better template;
- better research goals;
- targeted event resources;
- scripted reinforcements;
- scenario terrain.

These are different interventions. A report should not attribute victory to "better AI" if the main change was an unannounced resource grant.

# Part XI: Compatibility Engineering

---

## A mod has dependencies even when it declares none

Dependencies include:

- game version;
- object numbers;
- copied parent objects;
- object names;
- parser phase;
- load order;
- event-code ranges;
- variable ranges;
- map names;
- Workshop identity;
- assumed base-game balance.

A compatibility record should name all of them.

## Freeze exact source

For every dependency, retain:

- filename;
- internal version;
- file size;
- cryptographic hash;

- acquisition date;
- intended order;
- known patch baseline.

"Latest DE" is not reproducible. DomEnhanced2\_16.dm with a recorded hash is.

## Build an object-overlap matrix

Parse each source for selectors and new-object allocations:

| Object type | Mod A changes | Mod B changes | Overlap                      |
|-------------|---------------|---------------|------------------------------|
| Monsters    | Count         | Count         | Shared identities            |
| Weapons     | Count         | Count         | Shared identities            |
| Armour      | Count         | Count         | Shared identities            |
| Sites       | Count         | Count         | Shared identities            |
| Spells      | Count         | Count         | Shared identities            |
| Items       | Count         | Count         | Shared identities            |
| Nations     | Count         | Count         | Shared identities            |
| Events      | Count         | Count         | Code and variable collisions |

[Book IX](#) applies this matrix to the supplied DE and Divinitus files. Keeping the exact totals there prevents the modding method and the live compatibility record from drifting apart. The lesson retained here is that overlap marks an integration surface, not a proven bug count.

## Reconstruct a shared object

For one shared identity:

- 1 begin with base-game state;
- 2 apply the first mod's copy, clear, and setters;
- 3 apply the second mod's copy, clear, and setters;
- 4 include source invoked through shapes, mounts, items, sites, and events;
- 5 list visible final fields;
- 6 list invisible or behavioural fields;
- 7 mark uncertain engine interactions;
- 8 inspect and test.

## Worked examples

The Grand Hierophant reconstruction now lives with the Arcoscephale dossier in [Book VII](#), while the broader DE/Divinitus identity and collision analysis lives in [Book IX](#). [Book VIII](#) keeps the method so it can be reused with any pair of mods.

## Compatibility patch structure

A compatibility patch should:

```
declare both dependencies and order
-> reselect every shared object that needs resolution
```



```
-> clear only when rebuilding completely
-> set the intended final fields explicitly
-> repair recruitment, sites, spells, items, and events
-> reserve its own codes and variables
-> provide a combined change log
```

Avoid copying an entire parent mod into the patch. That creates an unauthorized fork, obscures provenance, and makes updates harder.

## Conflict classes

| Class                  | Example                                        | Resolution                                  |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Direct setter conflict | Two costs on same monster                      | Choose and document final value             |
| Clear conflict         | Later <code>#clearrec</code> removes additions | Re-add intended recruitment                 |
| Identity collision     | Two new weapons use same ID                    | Reallocate and repair references            |
| Name dependency        | Spell referenced by renamed name               | Replace with stable identity where possible |
| Event code collision   | Two chains use -509                            | Allocate new range and update chain         |
| Variable collision     | Both use player variable block                 | Registry and remap                          |
| Shape conflict         | Parent form changed by one mod                 | Rebuild graph                               |
| Site conflict          | Same recruitment site altered                  | Explicit combined site                      |
| AI conflict            | One forbids a spell another favours            | Combined AI policy                          |
| Map dependency         | Scenario names a missing unit                  | Declare required mod and verify             |

## Patch-aware command ledger

The public game can advance beyond the manual. Important current examples include:

- 6.24: new item, event, monster, weapon, and site commands plus fixes;
- 6.25: new spell, item, and event controls;
- 6.27: fort-terrain recruitment, battle summons, enchanted blood, and AI fixes;
- 6.29: `#copysite`, new weapon rolls, unseen, event realm checks, and performance work;
- 6.30: event-variable unit counts, optional site additions, new spell-cost controls, and new monster abilities;
- 6.33: spell home-realm command;
- 6.35: multiple-same-name site reveal and removal fix.

The ledger should record:

| Field           | Meaning                            |
|-----------------|------------------------------------|
| Command or fix  | Exact technical subject            |
| Introduced      | First official version             |
| Manual present  | Yes, no, or ambiguous              |
| Project use     | Files and blocks using it          |
| Minimum version | Required <code>#domversion</code>  |
| Regression      | Test that proves current behaviour |

## Converting Dominions 5 projects

The official manual identifies changed numbers for:

- nations;
- magic items;
- sites;
- spells;
- forts;
- random events.

Dominions 6 also changes:

- mounted-unit architecture;
- Glamour and former Air illusion themes;
- army scale;
- mod folder layout;
- map start and mountain-border values;
- terrain-change imagery;
- new planes and systems.

Conversion order:

- 1 make the project load;
- 2 replace object numbers;
- 3 rebuild mounts;
- 4 review paths and Glamour;
- 5 review recruitment and starting armies;
- 6 review spells, items, sites, and events;
- 7 rebuild maps in the current editor;
- 8 add current metadata and folders;
- 9 conduct a full balance pass.

Compatibility is not proven by the absence of a load error.

## Part XII: Testing, Validation, and Release Engineering

### Four validation layers

| Layer     | Question                                                                       |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Static    | Is the source structurally plausible?                                          |
| Load      | Does the game parse and enable it?                                             |
| Object    | Do final cards and recruit lists match intent?                                 |
| Behaviour | Does the system act correctly in battle, ritual, event, AI, and campaign play? |

No one layer replaces another.

## Static validation

Automated or manual checks should detect:

- missing final newline;
- unmatched object blocks;
- duplicate explicit IDs;
- duplicate event codes;
- variable-range overlap;
- illegal filenames;
- missing referenced images;
- mixed path separators;
- references to undeclared dependencies;
- accidental tabs or smart quotes where tools mishandle them;
- selectors without identity comments;
- source blocks inserted into a released automatic-ID sequence.

Static validation cannot prove engine semantics.

## Load validation

Test configurations:

- 1 project alone;
- 2 dependency alone;
- 3 project plus each dependency;
- 4 full intended order;
- 5 reversed order where diagnosis matters;
- 6 dedicated/network-lobby path;
- 7 text-only or headless host path where relevant.

Record exact error text and the minimal failing source.

## Object validation

For every changed object:

- inspect `ctrl+i`;
- record final number;
- record visible stats;
- record recruit source;
- record spell or item restriction;
- compare against baseline;
- capture a screenshot or exported record;
- mark hidden behaviour for live testing.

## Behaviour validation

### Unit

- attack, defence, fatigue, route;
- equipment;
- mount;

- shapes;
- leadership;
- recruitment;
- upkeep;
- death and retreat.

## Spell

- legal caster;
- cost;
- targeting;
- resistance;
- AI;
- range;
- environment;
- ritual result;
- global identity.

## Event

- eligibility;
- probability conditions;
- target;
- state write;
- follow-up;
- duplication;
- no-target case;
- ownership change;
- game-alive check;
- performance.

## Map

- provinces;
- areas;
- connections;
- starts;
- Thrones;
- planes;
- gates;
- terrain visuals;
- AI travel.

## Minimal reproduction mods

When a behaviour is uncertain, create a mod containing:

- metadata;
- one copied or selected object;
- one changed command;
- one test event or map;
- no unrelated dependency.

Then compare:

- command absent;
- command present with low value;
- command present with high value;
- interaction case.

A full overhaul is evidence of a bug only after the problem survives reduction.

## Test harness maps

Maintain small maps for:

- melee and missile damage;
- mounts and area effects;
- shapechanges;
- ritual range;
- site events;
- dominion events;
- global enchantments;
- gates and planes;
- AI recruitment;
- siege and fort recruitment.

Each harness should specify:

- game version;
- enabled mods and order;
- exact nations;
- start province;
- seed if available;
- commands;
- expected result;
- observed result.

## Regression matrix

| Test ID | System           | Baseline   | Changed  | Combined       | Status       |
|---------|------------------|------------|----------|----------------|--------------|
| MNT-01  | Mount death      | Base game  | Project  | Full mod stack | Pass/fail    |
| EVT-01  | Once per player  | No event   | Project  | Full mod stack | Pass/fail    |
| MAP-01  | Gate link        | No gate    | Scenario | Dependencies   | Pass/fail    |
| AI-01   | Mage recruitment | Vanilla AI | Template | Full stack     | Distribution |

Every fixed bug receives a regression test. Otherwise the same defect returns during unrelated work.

## Balance records

Balance notes should distinguish:

- observed fact;
- intended role;
- comparison object;

- economic cost;
- counter class;
- problem;
- change;
- expected consequence;
- retest result.

"Too strong" is not a diagnosis. Better:

At 18 gold and 9 recruitment points, the unit replaces both the national line holder and damage dealer, wins the heavy-infantry comparison without mage support, and remains more mobile. Raise throughput cost or narrow its damage class.

## Versioning

Use a predictable scheme:

- major: save-breaking redesign or dependency shift;
- minor: new compatible content or important balance revision;
- patch: corrections that preserve object order and intended play.

Each release records:

- game version;
- dependency versions;
- load order;
- save compatibility;
- new object IDs;
- new event-code and variable ranges;
- balance changes;
- fixed defects;
- known issues.

## Release candidates

A release candidate is frozen except for fixes.

Checklist:

- source hash recorded;
- no placeholder descriptions;
- all filenames legal;
- dependencies declared;
- standalone and combined load tests complete;
- network test complete;
- new-game requirement stated;
- change log complete;
- Workshop visibility correct;
- regression suite complete;
- public guide updated.

## Research questions that can be resolved without the project owner

Questions are suitable for independent resolution when they can be answered through:

- current official manuals;
- official patch notes;
- exact supplied source;
- a reliable published reproduction with version and method;
- a locally available game executable and controlled harness.

Questions remain pending when:

- source describes intent but engine resolution is ambiguous;
- community statements lack version or procedure;
- the result depends on the user's private save or settings;
- the game executable is unavailable;
- several current sources conflict.

No user action is needed merely to preserve a pending label.

# Part XIII: Complete Project Workflows

## Workflow A: A one-object balance patch

### Objective

Change one existing object's role without altering unrelated systems.

### Research

Record:

- game and mod version;
- object number and name;
- current final card;
- recruitment source;
- comparison objects;
- reason for change.

### Source

```
#modname "Example Role Patch"
#description "Versioned adjustment for Dominions 6.36."
#version 0.10
#domversion 6.36

#selectmonster <number> -- name and provenance
#gcost <value>
#rpcost <value>
#end
```

### Validation

- loads alone;
- loads with intended mod stack;
- final cost appears;
- no equipment or magic changed;
- recruitment source remains;
- AI still recruits a sensible quantity;
- ongoing-game policy stated.

### Release record

Reduced or increased throughput to preserve the unit's battlefield role while preventing it from replacing the nearest alternatives.

This is more useful than "nerfed unit."

## Workflow B: A new national troop

### Objective

Add one unit that fills a missing role rather than duplicating a superior version of an existing unit.

### Design statement

Name:

- role;
- intended target;
- intended counter;
- gold, resource, and recruitment-point constraint;
- recruitment location;
- national theme.

### Source architecture

new or copied weapon  
-> new fixed-ID monster  
-> equipment and cost  
-> nation or site recruitment  
-> AI hint

### Audit

| Question                              | Evidence                              |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Does it replace an existing troop?    | Fort-turn and battle comparison       |
| Does it erase a counter?              | Defence-class tests                   |
| Is it recruitable at intended scale?  | Resource and recruitment calculations |
| Can the AI use it?                    | Recruitment samples                   |
| Does it affect starting armies or PD? | Nation-source check                   |
| Does it require a dependency?         | Copy and equipment provenance         |



## Failure signs

- best damage, protection, and mobility in one body;
- lower cost than the unit it replaces;
- no resource or recruitment bottleneck;
- AI fills every queue with it;
- national magic makes its designed counter irrelevant.

## Workflow C: A new mage

### Objective

Create access without accidentally giving a nation every threshold in a path.

### Magic portfolio

Write the mage as rolls:

```
fixed paths
+ guaranteed random
+ independent partial random
+ rare random
```

Calculate:

- probability of each path at level 1;
- probability of important level-2 or level-3 thresholds;
- probability of crosspath combinations;
- expected recruits;
- 90% and 95% acquisition points;
- impossible combinations.

### Strategic audit

Check:

- new boosters;
- new site-search levels;
- new national rituals;
- new globals;
- new battlefield packages;
- communion or chorus role;
- research-to-gold ratio;
- capital or terrain restriction;
- commander-point pressure.

A single rare crosspath can be more important than the mage's common paths.

## Workflow D: A national spell-and-item ladder

### Objective

Give a nation a themed progression without creating a self-contained ladder that bypasses all external constraints.

## Ladder

```
early spell
-> first battlefield role
-> construction item
-> higher path access
-> national summon or ritual
-> late strategic payoff
```

For each step:

- school and level;
- native caster probability;
- item requirement;
- gem source;
- mage-turn cost;
- effect;
- counter;
- AI goal.

## Test

- first legal turn in an ordinary game;
- earliest plausible rush;
- worst random-path delay;
- item-loss recovery;
- gem scarcity;
- counter-research timing;
- AI access.

# Workflow E: A bounded national event

## Objective

Grant one thematic effect under conditions that can be understood and tested.

## Pattern

```
#newevent
#rarity 0
#req_formation <nation>
#req_turn <minimum>
#req_unique 1
#req_rare <percent>
#req_... <stable condition>
#msg "Visible explanation."
#effect...
#end
```

This is a pattern, not a universal template. Rarity and requirements must match the intended scope.

## Required tests

- correct nation;
- wrong nation;
- before minimum turn;
- after minimum turn;

- condition absent;
- condition present;
- second attempted occurrence;
- multiplayer and disciple scope;
- no valid target.

## Workflow F: A three-stage grievance

### Objective

Make an AI nation respond to a visible strategic action.

### State

| Stage | Variable | Meaning          |
|-------|----------|------------------|
| 0     | 0        | No grievance     |
| 1     | 1        | Warning issued   |
| 2     | 2        | Sanction active  |
| 3     | 3        | Hostile response |

### Transition table

| Current | Trigger                         | Next     | Effect              |
|---------|---------------------------------|----------|---------------------|
| 0       | Threshold crossed               | 1        | Warning             |
| 1       | Trigger persists after cooldown | 2        | Limited sanction    |
| 1       | Trigger clears                  | 0        | De-escalation       |
| 2       | Repeated violation              | 3        | Hostile response    |
| 2       | Long restraint                  | 1 or 0   | Sanction expires    |
| 3       | Objective resolved              | Terminal | Stop reinforcements |

### Safeguards

- one transition per month;
- no response after recipient elimination;
- owner and ally checks;
- fixed reinforcement cap;
- no full pairwise relationship matrix;
- visible messages;
- permanent hostility only when declared.

## Workflow G: A custom global enchantment

### Objective

Create one ritual whose ongoing effects remain bounded and dispellable.

### Components

- 1 spell with unique enchantment identity;
- 2 owner-benefit event;
- 3 hostile-effect event;
- 4 terrain or dominion requirements;
- 5 per-month cap;
- 6 no-text internal events where appropriate;
- 7 cleanup verification.

### Load test

- first cast;
- second caster contest;
- dispel;
- caster death;
- owner elimination;
- target ownership changes;
- independent provinces;
- cave and Nexus planes;
- several simultaneous globals.

## Workflow H: A competitive map

### Objective

Produce a map that is strategically fair without making every start identical.

### Build

- 1 draw art and province centres;
- 2 import into map editor;
- 3 set connections;
- 4 paint areas;
- 5 assign terrain;
- 6 mark starts and Throne preferences;
- 7 generate or place sites and contents;
- 8 inspect capital rings;
- 9 run nation-start samples;
- 10 package and version.

### Start report

For each start:

| Metric                | Value    |
|-----------------------|----------|
| Neighbours            | Count    |
| Land income potential | Estimate |
| Resources             | Estimate |
| Adverse terrain       | Count    |
| Nearest capital       | Steps    |

| Metric               | Value  |
|----------------------|--------|
| Nearest Throne       | Steps  |
| Water or cave access | Yes/no |
| Chokepoint exits     | Count  |

Outliers are then reviewed, not automatically erased. Some asymmetry is desirable; compound disadvantage is not.

## Workflow I: A campaign scenario

### Objective

Combine a designed map, forced starts, named commanders, and event chapters.

### Chapter architecture

```
pregame setup
-> chapter variable
-> objective code
-> completion event
-> next chapter
-> terminal victory change or final event
```

### Failure handling

Campaign events need alternatives when:

- a named commander dies;
- an objective province changes hands early;
- a player is eliminated;
- a site is removed;
- a gate becomes inaccessible;
- an unexpected nation receives the event.

Do not let one missing narrative object stop the campaign forever.

## Workflow J: A compatibility patch

### Objective

Create one explicit final ruleset from two changing parents.

### Procedure

- 1 freeze exact parent files;
- 2 parse selected and new identities;
- 3 allocate compatibility codes and variables;
- 4 produce overlap matrix;
- 5 prioritize clears, recruitment, Pretenders, shapes, events, and globals;
- 6 reconstruct shared objects;
- 7 write the smallest explicit repair;
- 8 test parent A, parent B, A+B, and A+B+patch;

- 9 publish supported order;
- 10 repeat after either parent updates.

### Compatibility statement

Supports Dominions Enhanced 2.16 followed by Divinitus 1.15.3 DE on the last tested baseline. Compatibility with Dominions 6.36 remains unverified until the combined files are loaded and exercised under that executable; other orders and versions are outside the verified ruleset.

That sentence is more valuable than a broad claim of compatibility.

## Part XIV: Design Essays

### Essay I: Load Order Is Part of Game Design

Load order is often treated as installation trivia: place one file before another until the game stops reporting an error. In Dominions it is part of the rules.

A selected monster is usually a partial modification. One mod may change cost, another paths, another recruitment, and an event may later transform the unit. The final object exists only after every layer has been applied. Reversing two layers may change the object without either source becoming invalid.

This means a guide tied to several mods cannot discuss them as independent add-ons. "DE gives this" and "Divinitus gives that" do not automatically describe the combined game. The relevant object is the combined final state.

Load order also determines strategic value. A later #clearrec can remove a unit that justified an earlier balance change. A later path adjustment can unlock a ritual. A later item restriction can close it again. A later event can create the same mage with additional paths. None of these changes are cosmetic.

The design response is not to fear overlap. It is to make overlap explicit. Dependencies are frozen. Shared selectors are inventoried. Clears are treated as destructive. Final objects are written into evidence records. Compatibility patches become small declarations of intended state.

Once load order is documented this way, it stops being a mysterious source of bugs. It becomes a versioned design decision.

### Essay II: An Event System Is a Small Political Engine

Dominions events are often introduced as random rewards and disasters. Their deeper value lies in memory and transition.

A province code remembers that something happened in one place. A variable remembers that something happened to a nation or the world. Requirements observe present conditions. Effects move the state forward. Together these create a finite political engine.

The engine does not understand betrayal as a human concept. It can understand that a warning was issued, a threshold remains crossed, a Throne was claimed, a border province bears a marker, and a sanction has not yet expired. That is enough to produce an intelligible sequence:

```
action  
-> warning
```

```
-> choice  
-> response  
-> recovery or escalation
```

Believability comes from causation, not unlimited complexity. A short chain with visible triggers can feel more political than a large table of random punishments.

The main design danger is memory without decay. If every offence creates a permanent counter, the game trends towards universal hostility. Recovery is essential. Grievances need cooldowns, concessions, terminal states, or deliberate permanent-feud rules.

The second danger is hidden compensation. If an AI receives armies whenever a player succeeds, the system becomes rubber-banding. If threatened nations receive one declared levy after a warning, the same mechanical assistance becomes part of the world's politics.

Event modding cannot create unrestricted diplomatic intelligence. It can create a political grammar: actions have legible meanings and bounded consequences.

## Essay III: AI Scaffolding Is Not an AI Rewrite

The exposed AI controls are meaningful. Pretender templates can prevent disastrous designs. Research goals can lead toward usable spells. Recruitment hints can reduce trap purchases. Favourite rituals can help a nation express its theme. Spell preferences can suppress destructive casting.

Yet these controls remain scaffolding around an existing decision-maker.

This distinction matters because design claims determine expectations. A mod advertised as "smarter AI" should be evaluated on decisions. A mod that grants gold, troops, and scripted attacks may be an excellent challenge system, but its difficulty comes partly from resources and scenario rules.

The strongest design uses all three AI layers honestly:

- templates make the starting plan coherent;
- hints reduce recurrent tactical and economic mistakes;
- events create strategic pressure when the ordinary AI cannot model a bespoke objective.

The result can feel much more capable. It is still important to record why.

This honesty also improves balancing. If the AI fails because it recruits the wrong unit, change the hint or roster. If it fails because it cannot understand a gate network, change the scenario. If it fails because it lacks economy, decide whether a visible subsidy fits. Calling every remedy "intelligence" hides the actual lever and makes later refinement harder.

## Essay IV: Map Topology Precedes Army Balance

Two armies with identical statistics can have different value on different maps.

Sailing is ordinary on a dense landmass and decisive across chains of sea provinces. Slow heavy infantry can dominate a compact front and fail on a wide wraparound map. Remote rituals gain value when chokepoints hold armies in predictable provinces. Cave access can be a curiosity or an entire second theatre.

The map establishes the exchange rate between movement and force.

Topology also determines diplomacy. A nation with two neighbours can sustain stable borders. A central nation with five exits cannot treat the same army count as equivalent security. A nearby Throne creates conflict before a message is sent. An isolated Throne invites concealed accumulation.

For this reason competitive map testing should not begin with decorative polish. It begins with edges, starts, rings, routes, planes, and objectives. Art then communicates those rules clearly.

The same principle applies to scenarios. A scripted coalition is less important than whether coalition armies can reach the threat. A narrative gate is not meaningful if the AI cannot use it. A fortress is not a defence if every approach bypasses it.

Mapmaking is not the container around game design. It is the first layer of game design.

## Essay V: Balance Is a Conversion Rate

Individual statistics are attractive because they are easy to compare. Dominions balance emerges from conversion.

Gold becomes troops. Resources determine equipment throughput. Recruitment points determine bodies per fort. Commander points become mages, scouts, and leaders. Research becomes packages. Gems become battlefield or ritual effects. Movement converts force into presence. Siege converts victory into ownership.

A unit is overpowered when it converts one or more inputs into strategic effect too efficiently, especially when it replaces several alternatives. A mage may be too efficient even with ordinary paths if research, recruitment points, and randoms combine favourably. A spell may be too efficient because its native caster is common, not because the text is spectacular.

This suggests a better balance note:

```
input
-> throughput
-> delivered role
-> counter
-> campaign consequence
```

It also explains why copying a cost from a similar unit is insufficient. The new nation may have different forts, scales, buffs, leaders, or magic. The same body enters a different conversion chain.

Good balance preserves decisions. If one recruit, research target, or item dominates every nearby alternative, the game has fewer decisions even if win rates remain uncertain.

## Essay VI: Compatibility Is a Public Interface

Large mods become platforms. Other projects refer to their monsters, spells, sites, and nations even when no formal interface exists.

The moment another project depends on an object number, allocation order becomes public. The moment a compatibility file selects a monster, that monster's identity becomes shared. The moment an event uses a common code, the code occupies global namespace.

This creates responsibility:

- do not reorder automatic objects casually;
- publish dependency versions;
- reserve identifiers;
- document breaking changes;



- retain deprecated placeholders when practical;
- provide migration notes;
- make load order visible.

The objective is not permanent backward compatibility. Some redesigns justify a break. The objective is an intentional break rather than an accidental one.

Compatibility habits also help solo work. Six months later, the original author is another developer trying to remember why monster 9322 exists.

## Essay VII: A Test Harness Turns Modding into Knowledge

Without a harness, modding knowledge remains anecdotal.

A battle was won, but the seed changed. An event occurred, but its rarity and eligible-province count were unknown. A combined Pretender displayed a path, but the source of that path was not traced. An AI cast a spell once, but no comparison existed.

A harness removes irrelevant variation. One unit faces one defence class. One event has one eligible province. One map has one gate pair. One AI receives one template. Expected results are written before observation.

The harness also protects future work. When a patch changes mounts, the mount suite is rerun. When a dependency updates, the overlap and regression matrix show what to inspect. When an argument becomes disputed, the library can point to conditions and results rather than confidence.

Not every question requires live testing. Official text, source, and arithmetic resolve many. The test harness is for the boundary between documented intent and engine resolution.

# Part XV: Quick References and Checklists

## New-mod preflight

- separate mod folder;
- matching folder and .dm basename;
- legal filenames;
- correct case;
- forward-slash paths;
- metadata block;
- minimum game version;
- every object block ended;
- final newline;
- identifier registry;
- no undeclared dependency.

## Object-block preflight

- correct selector or creator;
- object identity comment;

- copy source recorded;
- clear scope understood;
- fields grouped;
- cost channels reviewed;
- references valid;
- #end;
- final card inspected.

## Event preflight

- rarity;
- recipient nation;
- province and plane;
- target and order;
- turn or month window;
- probability;
- uniqueness;
- code range;
- variable range;
- effect;
- state transition;
- cooldown;
- terminal state;
- no-target behaviour;
- per-month cap;
- ally and ownership checks.

## Map preflight

- legal filename;
- image mode and alpha;
- one white pixel per province;
- required commands;
- province areas;
- connections;
- special borders;
- terrain decomposition;
- start audit;
- Throne audit;
- plane and gate audit;
- AI-route audit;
- Workshop package.

## AI preflight

- at least one legal Pretender template;
- scale and bless logic;
- reachable research goals;
- forgeable favourite items;
- castable favourite rituals;
- trap units suppressed;

- mage recruitment sampled;
- spell preferences tested;
- bonuses disclosed;
- several seeds observed.

## Compatibility preflight

- exact parent versions;
- hashes;
- supported load order;
- object overlap;
- ID collision;
- event-code collision;
- variable collision;
- clear operations;
- recruitment reconstruction;
- shape and mount graph;
- final object cards;
- regression suite;
- save policy.

## Troubleshooting decision tree

### Mod absent from list

Check folder, extension, metadata, filename, final newline.

### Mod reports parse error

Reduce by binary search; check quotes, arguments, selectors, and #end.

### Object exists but is unavailable

Check nation, site, terrain, era, god list, and later clears.

### Object has wrong statistics

Trace copy, clear, automatic cost, equipment, and later selectors.

### Combined mods behave differently

Freeze order; build overlap matrix; reconstruct shared objects.

### Event never fires

Check rarity, every requirement, recipient, target order, codes, variables, uniqueness, and eligible province count.

### Event fires repeatedly

Check rarity 5, uniqueness, state write, reset, and per-month limit.

## AI ignores content

Check legal access, path, gems, research goal, recruitment hint, and whether the desired reasoning is exposed at all.

## Map looks right but plays wrong

Check mechanical connections, province areas, terrain mask, starts, and gates.

## Project registries

Maintain:

- object IDs;
- event codes;
- event variables;
- enchantment numbers;
- map gate numbers;
- copied parent objects;
- dependency names and hashes;
- test IDs;
- known unresolved behaviours.

## Open research register

The following questions remain suitable for controlled verification:

- 1 exact automatic allocation behaviour at the current high object ceilings;
- 2 parser treatment of every cross-mod name reference category;
- 3 which copied hidden attributes are absent from `ctrl+i`;
- 4 event-variable overflow and negative-value edge cases;
- 5 event execution order when several rarity-5 systems alter the same state;
- 6 performance curves for large always-event libraries;
- 7 AI use of multi-plane gates in varied scenarios;
- 8 AI template selection distributions;
- 9 save compatibility for inserted automatic spell and item objects;
- 10 combined transformation preservation for prophet, mount, heroic, and item state;
- 11 exact event targeting when several equally eligible commanders exist;
- 12 network-lobby behaviour for every filename and dependency edge case.

These remain visible rather than being converted into unsupported claims.

# Part XVI: Source Register

## Official sources

- 1 [Dominions 6 documentation page](#) - current official manual index.
- 2 [Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34](#) - primary command authority for objects, nations, AI templates, and limits.
- 3 [Dominions 6 Event Modding Manual, labelled version 6.29](#) - event requirements, effects, codes, variables, and examples.

- 4 [Dominions 6 Map Making Manual, version 6.26](#) - map images, editor, commands, terrain, planes, and Workshop packaging.
- 5 [Dominions 6 File Formats](#) - binary d6m structure.
- 6 [Dominions 6 official update announcements](#) - commands and fixes introduced after earlier manual revisions.
- 7 [Illwinter Dominions 6 changes](#) - major system changes from Dominions 5.

## Supplied source files

Dominions Enhanced 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE serve as the running compatibility examples. Their hashes, exact sizes, object counts, overlap matrix, and live findings are maintained in [Book IX](#) so that this methods volume does not become a second, stale inventory.

## Community evidence

Community material is used only where:

- the version is identifiable;
- the source states a procedure or exact syntax;
- the finding is consistent with official documentation;
- the claim is labelled community-tested when not reproduced.

The once-per-player variable explanation and final-newline troubleshooting pattern meet that limited use. Unversioned recollections, wish-list commands, and isolated outcome reports are not promoted to confirmed mechanics.

## Revision policy

[Book VIII](#) should be revised when:

- the public game version changes;
- any official modding manual changes;
- a relied-upon command is fixed;
- DE or Divinitus changes;
- a pending behaviour is reproduced;
- the diplomacy project allocates live code and variable ranges;
- a real compatibility patch is created.

Every revision must retain the prior ruleset label so published scenarios and saved games can still be interpreted.

# Foundation Book IX - Dominions Enhanced and Divinitus

## The Technical Encyclopaedia of the Frozen Combined Ruleset

Dominions 6.35 Dominions Enhanced 2.16 Divinitus 1.15.3 DE edition Frozen load order: Dominions Enhanced first, Divinitus second Research edition: 31 July 2026

This is a frozen source-defined ruleset built against the recorded 6.35 baseline. The live unmodded game is now 6.36; combined runtime compatibility remains unverified and is not implied by the source analysis.

### 1. Purpose

Dominions Enhanced and Divinitus reach into almost every major system in Dominions 6: Pretender design, scales, battle gems, blessings, recruitment, research, underwater play, items, spells, sites, events, and dominion. Together they behave less like a pair of optional add-ons and more like a distinct edition of the game.

Book IX turns 238,821 lines of source into something that can be consulted during play and reused in later nation dossiers. It does this by following a few strict boundaries:

- the two mods are described separately before their combined result;
- every rule is tied to the exact supplied release;
- explicit definitions are distinguished from inherited vanilla fields;
- the loader and load order are treated as part of the ruleset;
- support spells, sites, items, and event variables are separated from ordinary player-facing content;
- source collisions and unresolved runtime questions remain visible;
- strategic consequences are stated as doctrine rather than disguised as facts;
- machine-readable indices support later website search and exact object pages.

The summaries and checklists provide the practical route. Command inventories, ID registries, event structure, collision analysis, and provenance records are there for deeper investigation.

### 2. Frozen Baseline and Evidence

#### 2.1 Exact files

| Layer      | Exact file             | Declared version |
|------------|------------------------|------------------|
| First mod  | DomEnhanced2_16.dm     | 2.16             |
| Second mod | Divinitus_1.15.3_DE.dm | 1.15.3           |

The file fingerprints are:

- Dominions Enhanced: 72558697f8dae3a1fccf8fb57b3faccde56c7fe6c05dac6403cefe153faf6c1b

- Divinitus DE: cf7f21900a3812b66edddd831df779743eaf33080aef983f9bdea8ec47642809

These hashes define the ruleset more precisely than a Workshop title. A guide written for another DE or Divinitus release is historical evidence, not automatic evidence for this game.

## 2.2 Authority order

Claims in [Book IX](#) use the following practical hierarchy:

- 1 the exact supplied source files for what the mods command;
- 2 Illwinter's official manuals for what those commands mean;
- 3 the active load order for which later command has the final opportunity to change a field;
- 4 the mod authors' repositories and release descriptions for stated design intention;
- 5 current reproducible public tests where engine behaviour is not completely documented;
- 6 strategic derivation from confirmed inputs.

Source code proves that a command is present. It does not always prove the final in-game card. A selected object inherits every vanilla or earlier-mod field that is not cleared or replaced. A repeated `#newmonster` on an occupied ID is especially important: the official manual warns that two mods should not modify the same object because the result can be unpredictable. The correct label for such a case is source collision until a reliable resolved card or live reproduction exists.

## 2.3 Public author sources

The principal public project pages are:

- Dominions Enhanced repository: <https://github.com/BlueFeuer/DominionsEnhanced6>
- Divinitus repository: <https://github.com/RonhulMaggot/Divinitus>
- Illwinter documentation index: <https://illwinter.com/dom6/docs.html>

The current DE repository describes the project as a DLC-sized overhaul with thousands of spells, items, and monsters; new nations; changes to almost every vanilla nation; cheaper and expanded Pretender design; broad cavalry and underwater revisions; and a large national-magic programme. The supplied file confirms that scope at command level.

Public load-order wording has not been perfectly consistent. The public Divinitus 1.15.2 DE file contains the words "Load first," while the project description and version 1.15.0 changelog instruct players to enable the DE edition after Dominions Enhanced. The supplied 1.15.3 DE header no longer states either instruction. The later project-level wording settles the intended order for this ruleset: DE first, Divinitus second. The older contradictory header remains in the historical record because it can still mislead anyone using an archived file without the release context.

# 3. Finding What Is Needed

## 3.1 First game with both mods

For a first game, read Sections 4, 7, 8, 14-16, and 22, then use the pregame checklist in Section 26. That covers the rules that change ordinary decisions without requiring a full reading of the source structure.

### 3.2 Pretender design

Read Sections 8, 11, 14-18, 21-22, and Essay II. A chassis may now act as an economic institution, temple network, seasonal engine, recruitment programme, or global-risk mechanism. The visible card is only the beginning.

### 3.3 Mod compatibility or debugging

Read Sections 5, 6, 19-21, 24, and 25. Consult the machine-readable summary and object catalogue before drawing a conclusion from a name search.

### 3.4 Website construction

Read Sections 23-25 and Appendix B. The website should preserve separate vanilla, DE, Divinitus, and combined layers. It should never flatten them into one unversioned card.

## 4. What the Combined Modpack Changes

### 4.1 Dominions Enhanced is the broad ruleset

DE is the foundation layer. It changes global economic constants, blessings, units, mounts, weapons, armour, Pretenders, sites, nations, spells, items, poptypes, name lists, and events. It also supplies extensive national content and several new nations.

Its strategic effect goes beyond adding more content. It changes the density of useful options:

- more national research branches compete for early research;
- more summons convert gems into nation-specific force;
- low-path mages gain more battlefield and ritual jobs;
- underwater entry and underwater warfare become less isolated;
- cavalry and mounts become more credible;
- new and revised Pretenders enlarge design space;
- hidden future sites reveal national summons and heroes;
- informative site-search events reduce uncertainty;
- scale choices carry altered economic and event consequences.

### 4.2 Divinitus is the divine-system layer

Divinitus concentrates on Pretender identity. It modifies or rebuilds hundreds of chassis and supplies the machinery needed to make their descriptions operational:

- pregame starting armies and capital sites;
- automatic items;
- temple-generated units, commanders, gems, gold, and sites;
- dominion-scaled effects;
- seasonal and terrain-dependent effects;
- order-dependent abilities;
- national priesthood changes;
- battlefield spells and summoned escorts;
- global event chains;
- ownership-state variables;
- punishments when an immobile god leaves its appointed place;
- relationships with global enchantments, heroes, or unique units.



Divinitus changes what "the Pretender" means. A god may become a distributed part of the state whose effects continue across dozens of provinces. The physical chassis may be only the control key for that larger presence.

### 4.3 Combined result

Under the frozen order, DE establishes the world and Divinitus has the later word on the fields it changes. This produces three classes of final object:

- 1 DE-only object: created or selected by DE and untouched by Divinitus.
- 2 Divinitus-only object: introduced or changed only by Divinitus.
- 3 Combined object: inherited from vanilla, changed by DE, then changed or rebuilt by Divinitus.

The Grand Hierophant is the clearest example of the third class. DE supplies its revised foundation. Divinitus later changes cost, magic, event protection, description, and monthly event systems. Neither source alone describes the combined god.

## 5. How the Dominions Loader Must Be Read

Book VIII owns the general loader explanation: whole mods load separately, command categories have an internal parser order, selected objects inherit unstated fields, numeric identities matter across files, and descriptions are not executable specifications. Four consequences matter here:

- 1 DE is the first object layer and Divinitus the second.
- 2 A Divinitus block may inherit vanilla and DE fields that it never restates.
- 3 Source adjacency does not override parser-category order.
- 4 A divine description may summarize an event family without listing every gate, delay, or cleanup step.

A complete divine system is traced as:

chassis -> support item/site/spell -> event requirement -> event effect -> delay or variable -> cleanup event

### 5.1 Allocation profile

Fixed IDs improve stability inside a coordinated project but create collision risk between projects. Automatic IDs depend on the engine's occupied range and cannot be resolved from these two text files alone.

The supplied DE file uses fixed IDs for every new weapon, armour, monster, and site. Divinitus uses a mixture:

- all 34 new-weapon blocks use a fixed number, though ID 3034 appears twice;
- both new armour blocks use fixed IDs;
- 277 of 346 new-monster blocks use fixed IDs and 69 use automatic allocation;
- all 112 new sites use fixed IDs;
- 4 of 26 new spells use fixed IDs and 22 use automatic allocation;
- its one new item uses fixed ID 1072.

This mix is a source fact, not a defect by itself. It simply marks which identities can be checked statically and which require a resolved game state.

## 6. Exact Source Inventory

### 6.1 File scale

| File                | Lines   | Bytes     | Active commands |
|---------------------|---------|-----------|-----------------|
| DE 2.16             | 194,385 | 5,675,140 | 173,499         |
| Divinitus 1.15.3 DE | 44,436  | 1,348,538 | 38,834          |

### 6.2 Object-block inventory

| Object action     | DE blocks | Divinitus blocks |
|-------------------|-----------|------------------|
| New weapon        | 389       | 34               |
| Selected weapon   | 142       | 0                |
| New armour        | 81        | 2                |
| Selected armour   | 39        | 0                |
| New monster       | 3,553     | 346              |
| Selected monster  | 4,227     | 373              |
| New site          | 504       | 112              |
| Selected site     | 684       | 5                |
| New spell         | 0         | 26               |
| Selected spell    | 2,816     | 17               |
| New item          | 0         | 1                |
| Selected item     | 631       | 75               |
| Selected nation   | 132       | 0                |
| Selected blessing | 46        | 0                |
| New event         | 1,564     | 1,514            |

These are active block occurrences, not unique final identities. DE selects 3,185 distinct monster identities, 2,737 distinct spell identities, 629 distinct item identities, 572 distinct site identities, and 128 distinct nations. Repeated blocks are common and often intentional.

### 6.3 Fixed ranges

| Object  | DE fixed range      | Divinitus fixed range      |
|---------|---------------------|----------------------------|
| Weapon  | 1501-1925           | 3001-3035                  |
| Armour  | 501-581             | 998-999                    |
| Monster | 6510-13571          | 5018-10001                 |
| Site    | 2101-2917           | 1885-2005                  |
| Spell   | selected IDs 1-4365 | fixed new IDs 183, 197-199 |
| Item    | selected IDs 1-899  | new ID 1072                |

Ranges are bounds, not proof that every number inside is used.

## 6.4 Important implementation facts

- DE contains no active `#newspell` block. It builds its spell layer through 2,816 `#selectspell` blocks, including high numbered slots.
- DE contains no active `#newitem` block. It builds its item layer through selected slots.
- DE explicit monster IDs exceed the 5000-8999 recommendation printed in the 6.34 Modding Manual, reaching 13,571. The source proves that the active game accepts or at least parses a wider contemporary space than that older recommendation describes.
- Divinitus uses 1,492 rarity-5 events, 12 rarity-13 events, and 9 rarity-0 events. One event lacks an explicit rarity.
- DE and Divinitus each contain a small number of adjacent event blocks without an intervening `#end`. The next `#newevent` implicitly begins a new block in source analysis, but this remains a lint finding.
- Divinitus defines weapon ID 3034 twice. The later definition copies Stellar Bolt and is the effective intended source for the Stellar Staff references. The earlier Gaze of Death definition does not survive as an independent fixed identity.

## 7. The Six Global DE Rules

DE issues six active general commands outside object blocks.

| Command                     | DE value | Official meaning                                       |
|-----------------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>#gemlongevity</code>  | 2        | battle gems last for the entire month                  |
| <code>#slothincome</code>   | 4        | each Productivity/Sloth step changes income by 4%      |
| <code>#turmoilincome</code> | 4        | each Order/Turmoil step changes income by 4%           |
| <code>#deathincome</code>   | 2        | each Growth/Death step changes income by 2%            |
| <code>#deathdeath</code>    | 25       | Growth/Death population effect uses 0.25% units        |
| <code>#luckevents</code>    | 7        | Luck/Misfortune changes event frequency by 7% per step |

The official defaults printed in the Modding Manual are 3 for Sloth income, 3 for Turmoil income, 2 for Death income, 20 for the population constant, and 5 for Luck event frequency. `#deathincome 2` pins the existing default; it does not change it.

### 7.1 Gem longevity

This is the most operationally important global change. Under level 2, combat gems last for the entire month rather than only their ordinary single use. The practical value of a gem-bearing mage now depends on the number of battles the mage can survive and enter during that month.

Consequences include:

- a single gem allocation can support several engagements;
- counter-raiding and sequential defence become more gem-efficient;
- teleporters and other multi-battle pieces gain endurance;
- killing or routing the mage before later battles becomes more important;
- battle-gem accounting must be conducted by mage-month, not only by battle;
- scripts that assume a gem was consumed in an earlier battle require revision.

This rule does not eliminate the need for reserve policy. A mage without the necessary gems at the beginning of the month still lacks them, and a dead, routed, or isolated mage cannot exploit persistence.

## 7.2 Order and Productivity

Order and Productivity each move income by 4% per step instead of 3%. Their combined influence on income is stronger before national modifiers and rounding. The scales keep their other effects, so the change does not reduce them to simple gold choices.

At symmetric extremes, the direct trace differs substantially:

- Order 3 contributes a nominal +12% instead of +9%;
- Turmoil 3 contributes a nominal -12% instead of -9%;
- Productivity 3 contributes a nominal +12% instead of +9%;
- Sloth 3 contributes a nominal -12% instead of -9%.

These percentages are inputs to the engine's provincial economy, not guarantees of an exact treasury difference in every province. Population, terrain, unrest, national rules, taxation, rounding, and special income modifiers remain relevant.

## 7.3 Growth and Death

The gold-income constant remains 2%, while the population-change constant rises from 20 to 25 hundredths of a percent. Death destroys the tax base more quickly and Growth compounds it more quickly, subject to the engine's sign and rounding implementation.

The strategic lesson is temporal:

Growth and Death do more than alter current income. They change the future base to which many other modifiers apply.

## 7.4 Luck and Misfortune

The event-frequency influence rises from 5% to 7% per scale step. This does not guarantee a particular event result. It changes the number of opportunities, while event quality, rarity, national event sets, and special event mechanics determine what those opportunities become.

Luck becomes more valuable to nations and Pretenders that add strong good-event pools. Misfortune becomes more dangerous where a modded nation or divine system adds harmful events or already has fragile infrastructure.

# 8. Complete DE Blessing Revision

DE modifies 38 distinct blessings through 46 blocks. Eight blessings are selected twice because one block changes path or scale requirements and another changes cost.

Path letters are F Fire, A Air, W Water, E Earth, S Astral, D Death, N Nature, G Glamour, and B Blood.

| Blessing           | DE cost | Additional change                  |
|--------------------|---------|------------------------------------|
| Wasteland Survival | 1       | reduced from 2                     |
| Death Explosion    | F4+D2   | crosspath; non-Incarnate structure |
| Fire Shield        | F5      | reduced from 6                     |
| Flaming Weapons    | F4      | Heat 1 required; non-Incarnate     |
| Farshot            | 1       | reduced from 2                     |
| Awareness          | 2       | reduced from 3                     |
| Swiftess           | 3       | reduced from 4                     |

| Blessing                | DE cost | Additional change                             |
|-------------------------|---------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Storm Flight            | 3       | reduced from 4                                |
| Wind Walker             | A4+S2   | crosspath; non-Incarnate                      |
| Weightlessness          | 4       | reduced from 6; primary requirement becomes 3 |
| Air Shield              | 5       | reduced from 6                                |
| Charged Bodies          | 7       | reduced from 8                                |
| Flight                  | 6       | reduced from 9                                |
| Swamp Survival          | 1       | reduced from 2                                |
| Swimming                | 1       | reduced from 2                                |
| Slowing Weapons         | W4+G2   | crosspath; non-Incarnate                      |
| Vitriol Weapons         | 6       | reduced from 8; primary requirement becomes 4 |
| Water Breathing         | 2       | non-Incarnate                                 |
| Frost Mist Weapons      | W4+A1   | crosspath; non-Incarnate                      |
| Unbreakable             | 3       | reduced from 4                                |
| Resilience of the Earth | 5       | reduced from 6                                |
| Solar Weapons           | 3       | reduced from 4; primary requirement becomes 2 |
| Twist Fate              | 5       | reduced from 6                                |
| Fateweaving             | 6       | reduced from 7                                |
| Withering Weapons       | 3       | reduced from 4                                |
| Reanimators             | D4+E2   | crosspath; non-Incarnate                      |
| Death Weapons           | 5       | reduced from 8                                |
| Fear                    | 8       | reduced from 9                                |
| Forest Survival         | 1       | reduced from 2                                |
| Poison Weapons          | 3       | reduced from 4                                |
| Recuperation            | 4       | non-Incarnate                                 |
| Berserker               | N4+B1   | crosspath; non-Incarnate                      |
| Barkskin                | N4+N2   | Growth 1 required; non-Incarnate structure    |
| Obfuscate               | 5       | reduced from 6                                |
| Awe                     | 7       | reduced from 8; primary requirement becomes 5 |
| Displacement            | 6       | reduced from 7                                |
| Dread                   | 7       | reduced from 8                                |
| Vampiric Weapons        | 6+3     | two-path total 9, reduced from 12             |

## 8.1 How to read the cost fields

The modding commands store primary and optional secondary path requirements. The minimum path skill and blessing-point cost use the same numbers. Thus `#cost0 4` and `#cost1 2` produce a six-point crosspath blessing requiring the stated levels in both paths.

Some source comments describe a blessing as "no longer Incarnate" without a separate `#incarnate` command. The new path-cost structure places the requirements below the threshold that made the older single-path version Incarnate. The effect follows the rewritten requirements rather than a standalone toggle.

## 8.2 Strategic families

The revisions create five broad families.

Cheap mobility and survival. Terrain survival, Swimming, Water Breathing, Farshot, Awareness, Swiftess, and Weightlessness become easier to add to a broader design.

Accessible weapon blessings. Flaming, Slowing, Frost Mist, Solar, Withering, Death, Poison, and Vitriol effects become cheaper or crosspath. A design can purchase a functional weapon effect without committing its entire budget to one extreme path.

Lower Incarnate dependence. Several effects remain available while the Pretender is dormant, imprisoned, dead, or otherwise absent. This increases the viability of delayed chassis and reduces the all-or-nothing cost of divine death.

Crosspath identity. Death Explosion, Wind Walker, Slowing Weapons, Frost Mist Weapons, Reanimators, Berserker, Barkskin, and Vampiric Weapons require a more specific magical identity. Their nominal cost is only part of the design cost; path entry and opportunity cost matter.

Scale contracts. Flaming Weapons requires Heat 1 and Barkskin requires Growth 1. The blessing is tied to national scales and cannot be purchased in isolation.

## 8.3 Bless evaluation method

A blessing should be valued against five quantities:

- 1 the number of sacred bodies affected;
- 2 the number and importance of sacred attacks;
- 3 the turns on which sacred recruitment is constrained;
- 4 the probability that the effect changes an actual matchup;
- 5 the design points and paths displaced.

A cheap blessing is not automatically efficient. A one-point terrain blessing may be decisive for a mobility plan and worthless in another. A nine-point Vampiric Weapons package may be extraordinary on durable multi-attacking sacreds and extravagant on fragile, recruitment-limited elites.

# 9. Dominions Enhanced as an Object Ecosystem

## 9.1 Weapons, armour, mounts, and units

DE adds 389 fixed-ID weapons and modifies 142 existing weapons. It adds 81 armours and modifies 39 armour blocks. It creates 3,553 monster blocks and selects 4,227 more.

This density supports connected programmes, not isolated novelties:

- bows gain damage and precision and use 24 ammunition in the stated DE design;
- slings use full strength, gain damage at ordinary human strength, and use 30 ammunition;
- javelins receive underwater rules;
- horse Magic Resistance rises on average;
- weak barding improves and formerly unbarded horses gain barding;
- Skilled Rider increases across riders;
- forgeable barding becomes cheaper and broader;
- many units gain DE-specific shapes, mounts, equipment, or supporting spells.

A unit must be read through its relationships. A rider card belongs with its mount. A weapon belongs with its secondary effects and ammunition. A unit belongs with its national recruitment site, spell support, and cost commands.

## 9.2 Sites

DE creates 504 sites and selects 684 site blocks. Sites perform several different jobs:

- national capital and terrain recruitment;
- future-site documentation;
- summon and hero previews;
- hidden national mechanics;
- event and ritual anchors;
- gem, gold, resource, and supply production;
- fort and defence units;
- divine or scripted transformation infrastructure.

A source count of "504 new sites" does not mean 504 ordinary searchable magic sites. Many are rarity 5, level 0, national, hidden, or event-managed support objects.

## 9.3 Spells

DE's 2,816 selected spell blocks cover IDs from 1 to 4,365. They include:

- ordinary researchable spells;
- national rituals and summons;
- hidden effect spells;
- item-granted spells;
- transformation chains;
- battlefield wrappers;
- temporary buffs and helper effects;
- prayer families;
- underwater access and water-breathing systems;
- fort damage and siege support;
- national late-game capstones.

The source uses high selected slots instead of active `#newspell` commands. A catalogue must classify each spell by its final school, research level, path, restriction, and visibility. Whether the source keyword says "new" does not settle the question.

## 9.4 Items

DE selects 631 item blocks covering 629 distinct identities. The programme includes repricing, path changes, national rebates, underwater tools, barding, temporary gem effects, auto-spells, restricted items, and new high-slot definitions.

Item value changes twice:

- 1 the forge cost and path gate may change;
- 2 the environment contains more reasons to want the item.

Cheaper water-breathing equipment matters more because underwater entry is a central DE project. Cheaper barding matters more because mounts are stronger. Siege items matter more where magical fort pressure is deliberately expanded.

## 9.5 Nations

DE selects 128 distinct nations in 132 blocks. Its changes go well beyond recruit costs. Nation blocks can:

- clear and rebuild recruitment;
- change terrain recruitment;
- change capital and starting armies;
- add or remove Pretenders;
- replace heroes and multiheroes;
- set scale preferences or forced modifiers;
- change fort, temple, or dominion rules;
- add future sites;
- add AI hints;
- replace an entire nation in a reserved slot.

The current DE project summary identifies major or mild changes across all ages and several new nations. The supplied source includes complete custom nation definitions in slots 181-207 alongside extensive changes to vanilla nation IDs.

## 10. The DE Design Programme

### 10.1 Pretenders

The principal DE Pretender source region spans approximately lines 72,487-90,112 and contains 591 monster blocks:

- 266 new-monster blocks;
- 325 selected-monster blocks;
- 268 blocks with a `#startdom` command;
- 561 blocks with a `#pathcost` command.

The wider file also defines shapes, summons, divine servants, and later corrections. The region is a useful authorial boundary, not a complete resolved Pretender database.

The public project description states the main design direction:

- Pretenders are repriced from the ground up and are generally cheaper;
- Titans receive two more paths;
- monsters and rainbows receive one more path;
- monsters are broadly stronger;
- more scale modifiers appear;
- the roster of Pretenders is larger, especially underwater and in Polynesian realms;
- Pretenders can heal in the capital or while preaching outside it under the stated holy-level chance.

These changes mean that vanilla design heuristics cannot simply be carried across. Path-entry costs, chassis costs, built-in scales, and jobs must be read from DE data.

### 10.2 Magic

DE expands summons and national magic, shifts some effects into Glamour or crosspaths, enlarges many battlefield areas, improves the jobs available to level-one mages, and adds siege tools. The hostile battlefield-wide spell policy limits effects such as Wind of Death to one cast per round per side.



The strategic result is portfolio pressure. More viable spells make a fixed queue less reliable, not more. A nation should maintain:

- an expansion and first-war branch;
- an anti-armour branch;
- an anti-mass branch;
- a defensive and counter-raid branch;
- a path-access and forging branch;
- a national-summon branch;
- a water-access branch where geography requires it;
- a late-game transition.

### 10.3 Underwater play

DE treats the sea as a connected theatre:

- Gift of Water Breathing becomes cheaper and earlier;
- more items and spells grant water access;
- more monsters carry water-breathing support;
- underwater population rises;
- coastal and underwater independent mages improve;
- more spells work underwater;
- underwater-only spells expand;
- javelins function underwater under modified range and damage;
- many aquatic nations receive specific overhauls.

This reduces the old binary distinction between land and sea. It does not make amphibious war free. Command capacity, breathing capacity, hostile currents, poor amphibians, laboratory networks, fort access, and return routes remain logistical constraints.

### 10.4 Information

DE's informative site-search events report when a searching mage detects traces of a stronger hidden site in a path but lacks the level to reveal it. All nations also receive future sites in their overview to display summons and heroes.

These systems reduce memory and inspection burden, but they do not remove it. The player still needs to distinguish:

- a site that has been found;
- a clue that a stronger site remains;
- a future-site documentation entry;
- an event-managed support site;
- a national site that is present only under a specific ruleset.

## 11. Dominions Enhanced Pretender Analysis

### 11.1 Design cards must be rebuilt

The ordinary design screen remains useful, but a serious DE design record needs more fields:

| Field         | Question                          |
|---------------|-----------------------------------|
| Chassis price | What does the exact DE card cost? |

| Field                 | Question                                                                              |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Path entry            | Which paths are built in, and what is each new level's marginal price?                |
| Dominion              | What is the starting dominion and cost of increasing it?                              |
| Scales                | Which forced or bonus scales change the national plan?                                |
| Mobility              | Can the god expand, raid, teleport, sail, or cross water?                             |
| Survival              | Which threats defeat the chassis before research support?                             |
| Divine job            | Is its main purpose expansion, blessing, access, research, ritual, combat, or scales? |
| National availability | Which nations or realms can choose it after DE's #addgod and #delgod changes?         |
| Divinitus layer       | Does the second mod add an economy, event, priesthood, site, or battle system?        |

The last two fields are mandatory under the combined ruleset. A strong generic chassis may not be legal for a nation. A mediocre-looking chassis may be the key to a powerful Divinitus infrastructure.

## 11.2 Chassis families

DE's large roster is best understood by job family.

Immobile monuments. These often exchange movement for high dominion, low design cost, strong paths, exceptional durability, or national effects. Divinitus frequently turns them into site and temple engines.

Monsters. DE's broad buffs make monsters more credible expanders and combatants. Their value still depends on attack density, protection, regeneration, resistances, item slots, affliction risk, and the first counter an opponent can deploy.

Titans. Additional paths and lower design prices make Titans more flexible. They can combine expansion with a serious blessing or late ritual access, but their size and investment make death costly.

Rainbows and sages. Cheaper designs and expanded paths improve access packages. Divinitus often adds libraries, apprentices, ritual range, items, or research-linked production.

Aquatic and amphibious gods. DE expands this roster and the strategic value of water access. A water god must still be assessed against the nation's starting theatre and ability to operate on land.

Transforming gods. Shape chains can separate map form, battle form, dominion form, death form, and ritual form. Every shape must be resolved; a source block for one form is not the complete god.

## 11.3 Expansion is an assignment, not a label

A chassis should be called an expander only after a repeatable test against the actual independent settings and terrain mix. DE changes weapons, mounts, and units as well as the Pretender, so a vanilla test result is not portable.

A minimum record includes:

- design and awakening;
- target province and defenders;
- script;
- hit points and afflictions after battle;
- fatigue at decisive moments;

- rout or morale incidents;
- number of provinces taken before support was required;
- first available counter;
- cost of losing one expansion turn.

### 11.4 Healing doctrine

The stated DE programme allows Pretenders to heal in the capital or to receive a 10% chance per Holy level while actively preaching outside the capital. This creates three recovery modes:

- 1 capital convalescence;
- 2 field preaching with probabilistic recovery;
- 3 magical or item-based healing.

The second is not free. Preaching consumes the monthly order and places the god in a predictable province. A wounded god that could forge, research, claim a Throne, cast a ritual, or fight is paying an opportunity cost to heal.

## 12. DE Magic, Items, and National Power

### 12.1 A spell is a delivery system

The expanded spell list should be indexed by function rather than memorized as one long sequence.

| Function             | Examples of the question to ask                                      |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Access               | Does the spell raise paths, create a mage, or unlock a form?         |
| Army creation        | What body, commander, upkeep, and leadership does a summon provide?  |
| Force multiplication | Which troops receive the buff, at what area, fatigue, and research?  |
| Control              | Does it disable by MR, defence, size, morale, or terrain?            |
| Damage               | What protection layer, resistance, and density does it attack?       |
| Mobility             | Does it solve land, water, plane, range, or fort access?             |
| Siege                | Does it damage walls, defenders, infrastructure, or relief timing?   |
| Economy              | Does it convert gems, gold, population, blood slaves, or mage-turns? |
| Transformation       | Is the result reversible, unique, cursed, or tied to another object? |

The same spell may occupy several rows. A summon can be path access, siege mass, and a combat package. An underwater ritual can be mobility and recruitment access.

### 12.2 National summons

DE generally raises the efficiency of national summons and updates older designs to Dominions 6 scale. A summon should be evaluated by:

total cost = gems + caster-turn + research delay + laboratory position + command burden

The result should be evaluated by:

total return = body value + magic access + strategic movement + siege value + future turns

A cheap body that requires a rare cap-only caster may be expensive. A moderate summon that creates a reusable mage can be an access breakthrough.

## 12.3 Items as logistics

The repriced item list changes the minimum infrastructure needed to execute a plan. The relevant categories are:

- path boosters and ritual access;
- reinvigoration and fatigue control;
- resistance packages;
- thug and supercombatant protection;
- underwater transport and breathing;
- mount and rider equipment;
- siege and wall pressure;
- temporary gems;
- battlefield auto-spells;
- restricted national or divine items.

An item catalogue should state the exact mod layer because the same named item may have different paths, costs, effects, or national rebates in vanilla and DE.

## 12.4 Future sites as an interface

Future sites are documentation objects embedded in the nation overview. They make national summons and heroes discoverable without revealing every tactical conclusion. For a website, these should be represented as overview records, not ordinary province sites.

# 13. DE Nations Without Nation Dossiers

[Book IX](#) does not replace the nation monographs. It establishes the questions each one must answer.

## 13.1 Recruitment reconstruction

DE can clear and rebuild a nation roster. A vanilla unit list may be only a historical starting point. The resolved recruitment table needs:

- capital, fort, unforted, coastal, underwater, cave, forest, mountain, swamp, waste, farm, and foreign recruitment;
- recruitment limits;
- command-point and resource gates;
- paired or event-created recruits;
- site-dependent commanders and troops;
- starting commander and army;
- province defence, walls, and fort defenders.

## 13.2 Magic reconstruction

The mage table needs:

- deterministic paths;
- random masks and probability distributions;
- temporary gems;
- path boosts and shape effects;
- cap-only and terrain limits;
- national spells and item rebates;
- communion, chorus, or other network roles;

- the cost of consuming a commander recruitment turn.

### 13.3 National strategic reconstruction

The public DE summary indicates four degrees of change:

- 1 light balance correction - costs, statistics, hero updates, or one new spell;
- 2 mild overhaul - roster or magic identity changes while the national concept remains;
- 3 systemic overhaul - new economy, recruitment, or dominion mechanics;
- 4 new or DEified nation - custom roster and full support package.

Advice should state the degree. A "mild overhaul" can still invalidate an opening if the old cap unit, random distribution, or sacred is gone.

### 13.4 New nations in the supplied source

The source contains full named nation blocks in reserved IDs 181-207, including Chaco, Ongtupqa, Sitecah, Albion, Zion, Bhöd, and later DE additions such as Bantay Tubig, Dirgen, and Houssa. Some public notes mark particular nations unfinished, removed, or pending. A source definition proves presence in the file; it does not prove current balance or recommended multiplayer inclusion.

## 14. Divinitus: Design Philosophy and Scope

### 14.1 The card becomes a constitution

Divinitus describes its purpose as making Pretender Gods more unique and lore-consistent without presumed excessive power creep. Its implementation gives a chassis rules that can affect the entire state.

The dominant patterns are:

- starting covenant: a capital site, item, army, commander, or scale package;
- living dominion: effects scale with candles or require positive dominion;
- temple network: each temple becomes a production or transformation node;
- priesthood: certain national mages or units gain Holy levels;
- divine presence: an effect requires the god alive, awake, present, preaching, searching, or performing another order;
- seasonal office: winter, summer, or another calendar condition changes production;
- terrain office: caves, forests, coasts, wastes, mountains, or water enable an effect;
- relationship state: control of a named unit or global enchantment unlocks a benefit;
- cosmic consequence: moving or losing a monument triggers a world event;
- battle manifestation: a spell, escort, blessing-site effect, or divine shape appears in combat.

### 14.2 The four source tiers

The main Pretender body is divided by starting dominion headings.

| Source tier | Object blocks | Events | Monster blocks | Sites |
|-------------|---------------|--------|----------------|-------|
| Dominion 4  | 542           | 385    | 134            | 21    |
| Dominion 3  | 768           | 510    | 217            | 40    |
| Dominion 2  | 633           | 383    | 216            | 34    |
| Dominion 1  | 401           | 236    | 143            | 22    |

Monster blocks combine selected and new definitions. Site totals include new and selected sites. The file then applies eight small DE-tail monster selections, principally home-realm compatibility.

These headings organize authorial work. The final starting dominion should still be read from the active object's fields because a selected block may not restate it and a shape may not be a selectable root.

### 14.3 Chassis scale

Among 320 Divinitus monster blocks carrying at least one Pretender-like field:

- 305 carry descriptions;
- 297 state a gold or design cost;
- 258 state a path cost;
- 201 state starting dominion;
- 181 state a home realm;
- 132 use #magicboost;
- 167 use healing;
- 66 use ordinary #domsummon;
- many add one-battle spells, start items, scale modifiers, or shape relationships.

This does not mean exactly 320 independently selectable gods. The set includes forms and support definitions. It proves the density of divine reconstruction.

## 15. The Divinitus Event Engine

### 15.1 Why 1,514 events exist

Dominions has no single command meaning "every temple in friendly dominion has a candle-scaled chance to recruit a special priest while the god is awake." Such a power is assembled from small declarative events.

A typical system needs:

- 1 an event identifying the correct Pretender;
- 2 a province, terrain, site, temple, fort, dominion, or order requirement;
- 3 a probability gate;
- 4 an effect;
- 5 sometimes a variable or event code;
- 6 sometimes a delayed cleanup;
- 7 often a silent message configuration.

The large event count is working infrastructure, not 1,514 ordinary random narratives.

### 15.2 Event profile

| Command or pattern                 | Occurrences |
|------------------------------------|-------------|
| New events                         | 1,514       |
| #req_godismnr                      | 1,641       |
| Province-owner events (#nation -2) | 1,504       |
| Silent log suppression (#nolog)    | 1,446       |

| Command or pattern        | Occurrences |
|---------------------------|-------------|
| Population-zero permitted | 1,183       |
| No displayed text         | 1,023       |
| Dominion minimum          | 602         |
| Candle-scaled chance      | 557         |
| Land requirement          | 543         |
| Target monster            | 434         |
| Own capital               | 370         |
| Temple                    | 311         |
| Pregame only              | 179         |
| Fort                      | 173         |
| Free site slots           | 157         |
| Site required             | 148         |

The multiple `#req_godismnr` commands in one event are alternatives: several related gods can share one effect.

### 15.3 Rarity 5

The official Event Manual states that rarity 5 is an unlimited always-event class: any number can occur in one province in the same month. It is suitable for global-enchantment and special-dominion machinery.

Divinitus uses rarity 5 for 1,492 events. This permits many independent divine checks to run without consuming an ordinary random-event slot.

### 15.4 Candle-scaled probability

The official meaning of `#req_domchance X` is:

chance = absolute dominion strength x X percent

The event must already satisfy its other requirements. The command itself does not care who owns the dominion, so correct systems combine it with ownership or Pretender requirements where friendly dominion is intended.

Examples:

- `#req_domchance 1` gives 1% per candle;
- `#req_domchance 5` gives 5% per candle;
- `#req_domchance 10` gives 10% per candle.

At ten candles these become 10%, 50%, and 100% respectively before other gates. A description that says "candles x 5%" has a direct mechanical basis.

### 15.5 Event probability is conditional

A 50% candle check is not a 50% monthly yield if the event also requires:

- the god to be awake;
- the god or target to be in the province;

- a temple or fort;
- a free site slot;
- a season;
- a particular order;
- a path threshold;
- a unique event not already used;
- a variable in the correct state.

Expected value should multiply the conditional probabilities or explicitly state that it is conditioned on every non-random gate being true.

## 15.6 Pregame events

The official manual states that `#req_pregame` events happen during game creation and appear in the first turn's messages. Divinitus uses 179 such events for starting armies, sites, items, commanders, and initial state.

Pregame content is part of Pretender design value even though it does not appear in the chassis statistics. Losing or duplicating one of these events can alter an opening materially.

# 16. Divinitus Power Families

## 16.1 Capital institutions

Many gods create a capital site or add one when awakening. Common returns include:

- gem income;
- gold and resources;
- recruitable mages;
- apprentices;
- divine servants;
- ritual discounts;
- a special bless effect;
- national path access.

A capital institution should be valued as a stream:

present value = starting grant + monthly income + recruitment options + strategic access - site-slot and opportunity costs

The exact duration matters. A site present from game creation is more valuable than one appearing only when a dormant god awakens.

## 16.2 Temple networks

Temple events turn religious infrastructure into production infrastructure. A temple may:

- create units or commanders;
- produce gems, blood slaves, or gold;
- apply a blessing site;
- change scales or dominion;
- grant recruitment;
- transform or ordain priests;
- host a terrain-specific resource.



The value of one more temple becomes:

ordinary temple value + expected divine output + dominion projection + local strategic value

This can justify earlier and wider temple construction, but only if the expected output exceeds construction cost, opportunity cost, and capture risk.

### 16.3 Priesthood transformations

Divinitus uses 203 #holyboost effects and many target gates to ordain national mages, commanders, or thematic servants. A mage who becomes H1 or H3 changes:

- preaching;
- banishment;
- blessing access;
- temple construction eligibility;
- leadership in sacred armies;
- communion or spell interactions where Holy matters;
- upkeep and recruitment opportunity only indirectly.

The event may occur immediately after recruitment, require a temple, or depend on the god. The exact gate must be recorded.

### 16.4 Dominion summons

Built-in #domsummon, #domsummon2, #domsummon20, and rare dominion summons produce followers around the god. Event-based temple summons distribute production across the map.

The distinction matters:

- chassis dominion summons usually require the god's physical presence;
- temple events require qualifying provinces;
- capital events concentrate output;
- some systems require the god awake or alive;
- some descriptions cap production by candle count.

### 16.5 Scale ceilings and extreme scales

Some gods carry #moreorder, #moreprod, #moregrowth, #moreluck, #moremagic, or temperature modifiers. Divinitus descriptions sometimes attach additional effects to scales beyond the ordinary limit, such as income, unrest reduction, or special events.

The design value has two parts:

- 1 design-point and national-scale consequences;
- 2 event or province consequences once the higher scale exists.

### 16.6 Built-in battlefield policy

Divinitus uses one-battle spells and hidden support spells for effects such as:

- army blessing by creature type;
- battlefield-wide path boosts;
- Solar Brilliance;
- Relief;
- Wind Guide;
- animal blessing;

- mass regeneration;
- control or serenity effects;
- divine earthquakes;
- special summons.

These spells often use school -1 and research level 0. They are internal tools, not ordinary research targets.

## 16.7 Orders as divine labour

Some powers require the Pretender to:

- preach;
- search for sites;
- research;
- remain in the capital;
- occupy a fort;
- stand on a Throne;
- perform another target order.

The god's monthly order is a scarce resource. A power that pays 150 gold when site searching is not free income; it competes with every other use of the god.

# 17. Representative Divinitus Systems

## 17.1 Golden Pillar: geographic catastrophe

The Golden Pillar gains strong Earth magic, dominion summons, additional scale reach, and cave-temple production. The exceptional mechanic is triggered when the Pillar is absent from its own capital.

The source chain:

- 1 an immediate global rarity-13 event requires the Golden Pillar Pretender, its own capital, and the Pillar's absence;
- 2 a unique gate prevents repetition;
- 3 event code -3333 is set;
- 4 world unrest rises by 15;
- 5 surface provinces receive follow-up earthquake checks;
- 6 population, temples, and laboratories can suffer;
- 7 troglodyte attacks and a capital force can appear;
- 8 a later global event resets the code to zero.

This is a strategic constraint, not flavour. Moving, teleporting, or otherwise displacing the god can impose worldwide costs.

## 17.2 Father of Winters: seasonal global state

The Father of Winters uses variables 329, 330, and 331 to track successive winter-month effects. Monthly events increment and decrement the correct variable, while follow-up events can kill population and worsen Cold outside the protected ownership state.

The design lesson is that a seasonal power may be implemented as several synchronized state machines. Reading only one event produces a false picture.

### 17.3 Kami of Storms: ownership relationship

The Kami of Storms checks whether the nation controls Aella, Queen of Storms. Event variable 325 records that state.

- control sets the variable;
- loss or defection clears it;
- while the variable is positive, temples in qualifying dominion can spawn large Air Elementals;
- a separate capital site grants the innate Air Shield blessing effect.

This power rewards a specific world-state rather than a fixed chassis statistic.

### 17.4 Divine Feathered Serpent: delayed global offensive

The Divine Feathered Serpent can initiate a hurricane state using variable 326. The source:

- makes a capital, dominion-scaled check;
- sets a global state in an immediate event;
- permits up to three enemy-territory hurricane events per month;
- applies population loss and unrest;
- ends and clears the state through later events.

This is strategic remote pressure. Its actual target distribution and engine event ordering still deserve live verification before exact expected-damage claims.

### 17.5 Great Stag: global enchantment relationship

The Great Stag interacts with The Wild Hunt:

- the active friendly enchantment can bring a Horned One;
- variable 328 tracks whether the state is active;
- the Horned One receives path and priest boosts;
- temple events produce Cu Sidhe;
- cleanup events kill the Horned One and clear the variable when the enchantment is absent.

The power has a research and global-enchantment dependency. It is not fully online at game creation.

### 17.6 Once and Future King: province quest chain

The Once and Future King uses event code -513:

- 1 a qualifying province receives rumours;
- 2 the province is flagged;
- 3 a Holy Knight can resolve the quest;
- 4 outcomes include combat, gold, gems, or a magic item;
- 5 successful resolution resets the code to zero.

The event code is province-local. A world or nation may have several quest provinces, subject to the event gates.

### 17.7 Grand Hierophant: divine labour and mage development

The combined Grand Hierophant:

- begins from DE's revised monster 3053;
- receives Divinitus cost 150;
- gains +1 to all non-priest magic paths through #magicboost 53 1;

- has 75 bad-event protection and disease resistance 100;
- can anoint a Mystic or Erytheian Mystic into a Mystic Prophet;
- can teach the transformed mage;
- can gain 150 gold and elemental gems while site searching under a candle-scaled event.

The site-search reward uses #1d6vis 51. Path group 51 is Elemental, so a successful event grants 1d6 each of Fire, Air, Water, and Earth gems: an expected 14 total elemental gems on success.

With #req\_domchance 5, the conditional success chance at  $c$  candles is  $0.05c$ . Conditional expected output per eligible month is:

- gold:  $150 \times 0.05c = 7.5c$ ;
- total elemental gems:  $14 \times 0.05c = 0.7c$ .

These values assume every other gate is satisfied and do not subtract the opportunity cost of the Site Search order.

The teaching event visibly gates the target's Astral threshold while increasing Astral, Fire, Water, and Earth. The broad description states a maximum of three. Whether an elemental path can pass the stated cap under all Mystic randoms remains unresolved without a reliable engine reproduction.

## 18. Divinitus Support Objects

### 18.1 Hidden spells

Divinitus contains 26 new-spell blocks and 17 selected-spell blocks. Almost all set school -1 and research level 0, showing that they are components of divine powers and not additions to the ordinary research tree.

Major families include:

| Family                  | Examples                                                            |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Permanent gifts         | Gift of Rebirth, Forge Skill, Healing Power, Demonic Ascendance     |
| Training rituals        | Teachings of the Cyclops, Imbue with Medicine, Lore of Dreams       |
| Divine control          | Master Enslave Sacreds, Void Enslave, Demon Enslave                 |
| Army blessing           | Master Magic Blessing, Master Demon Blessing, Master Beast Blessing |
| Battlefield policy      | God Quake, Boar Frenzy, Desert Guidance, Honed Steel                |
| Path and enchantment    | Guidance of the Spheres, Power of the Northern Star, Star Power     |
| Mind and creation       | Divine Spark, Spark of Intellect, Imbue Astral Power                |
| Item or chassis effects | Plague Arrow, Inhabit Grove, Judge of Life and Death                |

The 43 blocks include helper effects such as Major Insanity and Caster Confusion. A website should mark these as hidden or granted mechanics unless the resolved school and restrictions make them ordinarily accessible.

### 18.2 Divine items

Divinitus selects item slots 1000-1073 and creates item 1072. Most use Construction level 11. The official manual defines level 11 as unforgeable. Level 13 means an unforgeable unique artifact.

These items are commonly:

- start items carried by a specific god;
- event-created priesthood tools;
- cursed and non-transferable signatures;
- spell containers;
- unique expressions of divine lore;
- mechanisms for granting an ability that the chassis command set cannot express directly.

The family includes Void Pearl, Orb of the Nerid, Calathos, Kusanagi-no-Tsurugi, Feather of the Phoenix, Hammer of the Cyclops, Bowl of Blood, Medicine Bag, Fate Charm, Tome of Lore, Bow of Plagues, Golden Arm, Staff of Beasts, Windborne Sail, Rain Stick, Horn of Vanhalla, Staff of the Geyser, Mirror of Dreams, The Last Wish, and Fish Scale Mail.

The source also modifies Soul Contract and Lifelong Protection with `#undcommand 15`, supporting an Infernal Spirit priesthood system.

### 18.3 Divine sites

Divinitus adds 112 sites and selects 5 existing sites. They are predominantly level-0, rarity-5 support sites managed by events.

Functional groups include:

- blessing sites such as Blessing of Winter, Wind, Earth, Vitality, and Brilliance;
- temple sites such as Temple of the Warrior, Solar Temple, Temple of Storms, and Temple of the Sacred Band;
- recruitment sites such as Apprentice Quarters, Grove of Enchantment, Library of Lore, and Grand College;
- economic sites such as Riches of the Underworld, Jewelled Cavern, and The Crystal Cavern;
- state markers such as Ritual Aftermath, Empty Plinth, Empty Vault, and Unusual Crystal Formation;
- terrain institutions such as Coral Barracks, Deep Forest Clearing, Frozen Barrow, and Bottomless Lake.

A site can be player-facing, a hidden marker, a recruitment interface, or all three. The catalogue must record how it enters and leaves play.

### 18.4 Weapons and armour

Divinitus adds special weapons numbered 3001-3035 and two armours. These principally serve gods and their items. Examples include Kusanagi-no-Tsurugi, Magic Lariat, Caduceus, Golden Bow, Burning Ray, Lightning Blade, and Perfect Fist.

Weapon 3034 is defined twice. The later definition copies Stellar Bolt and is referenced as Stellar Bolt by the Stellar Staff and related units. Source references establish the later practical role.

## 19. Combined Load Order and Collision Matrix

### 19.1 Direct selected-object overlap

| Type    | DE distinct selected | Divinitus distinct selected | Shared |
|---------|----------------------|-----------------------------|--------|
| Monster | 3,185                | 373                         | 357    |
| Item    | 629                  | 75                          | 2      |
| Spell   | 2,737                | 17                          | 0      |
| Site    | 572                  | 5                           | 0      |

| Type   | DE distinct selected | Divinitus distinct selected | Shared |
|--------|----------------------|-----------------------------|--------|
| Nation | 128                  | 0                           | 0      |
| Weapon | 142                  | 0                           | 0      |
| Armour | 38                   | 0                           | 0      |

The two shared selected items are Soul Contract 348 and Lifelong Protection 396.

## 19.2 Cross-action monster overlap

The earlier direct-selector table understated the integration because Divinitus frequently uses `#newmonster` on a fixed ID that DE also created or selected.

| Relationship                     | Shared numeric IDs |
|----------------------------------|--------------------|
| DE new / Divinitus new           | 235                |
| DE new / Divinitus selected      | 10                 |
| DE selected / Divinitus new      | 114                |
| DE selected / Divinitus selected | 357                |

These groups overlap with one another because DE may both create and later select the same monster. Divinitus touches 650 distinct fixed monster identities; 600 of them also appear in a DE monster action. In addition, Divinitus creates 69 automatically numbered monsters.

This proves that the DE edition is deeply integrated. It also creates a large compatibility surface.

## 19.3 Event codes and variables

| Registry        | DE                                  | Divinitus         | Shared |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------|--------|
| Event codes     | -540, -312 to -308, -302 to -300, 0 | -3333, -513, 0    | 0      |
| Event variables | 6001-6007, 6011                     | 325, 326, 328-331 | none   |

Code 0 is the official default and reset state, so its use in both mods is expected. No nonzero event-code collision and no variable collision were found.

## 19.4 Automatic allocation

Automatic events are ordinary because `#newevent` has no fixed event ID in the same sense as a monster. Automatic monsters and spells are a different concern. Divinitus contains:

- 69 numberless new monsters;
- 26 automatically allocated new spells under the current official `#newspell` syntax.

Their final IDs depend on the occupied space after earlier mods. The supplied text proves definition order and content but not resolved numeric identities. The independent integrity publication records one exact-version Data Inspector resolution for all 69 monsters and 26 spells; those numbers remain versioned secondary keys rather than permanent object identities.

## 20. The 8616 Collision

### 20.1 Exact source facts

DE creates monster 8616 as a hidden "Bulk crafting land depositer." It has a deliberately generic inventory, name, zero gold cost, two miscellaneous slots, extreme stealth, land damage 99, and DE water-overhaul graphics.

Divinitus later creates monster 8616 as "Crystal Priest," copying Crystal Mage 340, adding E2G2H2, commander-master status, and recruitment cost fields. The Crystal Cavern then recruits monster 8616.

This collision is not a parser inference. Both exact blocks explicitly claim the same fixed ID. The public Divinitus 1.15.2 DE source also used 8616 for Crystal Priest, so the pattern predates the supplied 1.15.3 file.

### 20.2 Likely consequence

Under the frozen order, the later Divinitus definition has the final opportunity to occupy or alter 8616. DE references intended to create or manipulate the hidden bulk-crafting depositer may resolve to the Crystal Priest or to an engine-dependent merged state.

The official manual warns that two mods changing the same object can behave unpredictably. Without a reliable in-engine reproduction, the library does not assert an exact runtime card. It classifies this as:

Source-confirmed high-risk compatibility collision; runtime resolution pending.

### 20.3 Practical policy

For the unmodified supplied files:

- do not assume DE bulk crafting that depends on monster 8616 is safe;
- do not remove or renumber the Divinitus Crystal Priest casually, because its site and events reference it;
- treat any unexpected land bulk-crafting inventory, Crystal Priest, or item-deposit behaviour as related evidence;
- preserve the exact two files when reproducing;
- record which mod the game actually loaded first.

### 20.4 Independent compatibility publication

After Progress Edition 17, the collision was taken into a separate technical publication rather than expanded into another encyclopedia chapter. The DE-Divinitus Compatibility and Integrity Report confirms the intended order, traces the complete 8616 dependency chain, records the 69 automatic monsters and 26 automatic spells under the pinned Data Inspector build, and classifies every active command token against the official manuals, patch history, and current parser.

A separate repaired edition, `Divinitus_1.15.3_DE_compat_8616.dm`, removes Crystal Priest's fixed claim on 8616 and changes The Crystal Cavern to recruit it by name. The two uploaded originals remain unchanged. The repair passed its static and Inspector validation suite, but live-engine acceptance remains pending and a new game is required.

That work is deliberately independent. [Book IX](#) continues to describe the original frozen files and points outward for the remediation record; it does not silently replace the original Divinitus layer or absorb the repair package as Foundation Book XV.

## 21. Combined Pretender Resolution

### 21.1 Field-by-field method

For a selected chassis:

- 1 extract the vanilla card;
- 2 apply every DE block for that identity in DE parse-category order;
- 3 follow shapes and copied statistics;
- 4 apply every Divinitus block;
- 5 attach Divinitus items, sites, spells, and events;
- 6 attach national legality from the DE nation blocks;
- 7 classify unresolved inherited or engine-dependent fields.

For a fixed new ID shared by both mods, add a collision warning before assuming a simple overwrite.

### 21.2 Final-card schema

Every combined Pretender page should contain:

- identity and all forms;
- ruleset and hashes;
- nations and realms;
- design cost, path cost, starting dominion, and awakening limits;
- paths and path boosts;
- forced scales;
- physical and leadership statistics;
- item slots and starting items;
- battle spells and escorts;
- dominion summons;
- pregame grants;
- temple, fort, terrain, season, and order powers;
- event codes and variables;
- failure and cleanup conditions;
- source provenance by layer;
- unresolved runtime questions;
- strategic jobs and counters.

### 21.3 Do not sum every line

Not every repeated numeric field is additive. A later `#gcost` replaces the prior value. A `#magicboost` adds or subtracts paths under its own semantics. A clear command erases inherited fields. A copied object imports a base before later edits. An event effect occurs conditionally in play rather than changing the design card.

Resolution is typed, not arithmetic.



## 22. Strategic Doctrine for the Combined Ruleset

### 22.1 Pretender value has four ledgers

Design ledger. Points, paths, dominion, awakening, and scales.

Body ledger. Expansion, combat, movement, survival, slots, and healing.

State ledger. Sites, units, commanders, gems, gold, priesthood, and temple output.

Risk ledger. Catastrophic triggers, dependence on divine life or location, event exposure, and counters.

A god that is mediocre in the body ledger can dominate the state ledger. A powerful expander can be a poor design if death disables a national engine.

### 22.2 Dominion is productive capacity

Divinitus turns candles into probabilities and thresholds. Dominion now influences:

- ordinary religious survival;
- blessing projection;
- temple-event frequency;
- commander and unit production;
- economic events;
- terrain conversion or settlement;
- global attacks;
- scale changes;
- divine relationships.

Dominion investment should be assessed by marginal output as well as religious security.

### 22.3 Temples are an industrial network

Where a god has temple powers, the optimal temple count may rise sharply. The calculation should use:

monthly expected output per temple x expected safe months

against:

temple gold + priest turn + defence cost + capture risk + alternative investment

The network also has geometry. A border temple may project dominion and produce troops but be easy to capture. An interior cave temple may be safer and satisfy terrain gates.

### 22.4 Awakening changes institution timing

An imprisoned god may provide a non-Incarnate blessing immediately but delay a Divinitus capital site, priesthood, or temple network. An awake god may start the institution early but consume design points and face battlefield risk.

The correct question is:

On which turn does each part of the design begin paying?

## 22.5 Gems are monthly endurance

DE gem longevity changes battle planning. A gem stock on a mage is a reusable monthly combat allowance. This favours:

- mobile defensive casters;
- sequential fort relief;
- several small battles with the same mage;
- survival gear and retreat planning;
- intelligence about later battles in the same month.

It also rewards the opponent for forcing a poor early battle, routing the mage, blocking movement, or killing the gem carrier.

## 22.6 Research has more branches

DE expands viable national spells, summons, underwater tools, and siege options. Divinitus adds hidden chassis effects but usually not ordinary research goals. The queue should be built around national DE breakpoints and the Pretender's requirements, not the Divinitus helper-spell list.

## 22.7 Counter the system, not only the body

Possible counters include:

- killing or imprisoning the god;
- forcing it away from a required capital or terrain;
- raiding temple provinces;
- denying a key global enchantment or unique unit;
- occupying the site that grants recruitment;
- exhausting site slots;
- disrupting a specific monthly order;
- capturing high-dominion provinces;
- attacking before an awakening-gated institution appears;
- exploiting a catastrophic movement trigger.

# 23. Website Architecture

## 23.1 Core entities

The website should use typed entities rather than one undifferentiated text index:

- ruleset;
- source file;
- object block;
- resolved object;
- monster form;
- nation;
- spell;
- item;
- site;
- blessing;
- event;
- event code;
- event variable;

- relationship;
- claim;
- test;
- article.

## 23.2 Layered object identity

One visible object page should offer tabs:

- 1 vanilla 6.35;
- 2 DE 2.16;
- 3 Divinitus 1.15.3 on vanilla, where meaningful;
- 4 DE 2.16 plus Divinitus 1.15.3;
- 5 historical versions.

Each field needs provenance. A cost may come from Divinitus while item slots come from DE and base protection remains vanilla.

## 23.3 Event relationships

Events should not be displayed as 1,514 isolated cards. They should be grouped into systems:

Pretender -> event family -> gate -> effect -> state -> cleanup

The Once and Future King quest chain, Golden Pillar earthquake, Father of Winters calendar, and Great Stag Wild Hunt relationship are ideal graph views.

## 23.4 Search facets

Useful filters include:

- source layer and version;
- object type and ID;
- nation and age;
- path and school;
- research level;
- terrain;
- temple, fort, capital, and dominion requirements;
- awakening dependency;
- order dependency;
- starting dominion tier;
- scale modification;
- event code or variable;
- direct source, derived, or pending status;
- known collision.

## 23.5 Data already produced

This research edition includes:

- mod-index-summary.json - hashes, counts, ranges, overlaps, event registries, and warnings;
- mod-object-catalogue.tsv - one row per active source block;
- mod-object-blocks.jsonl - full command streams and source lines;
- extract\_mod\_index.py - reproducible extractor.

The JSONL is a source index, not a resolved database. That distinction should appear in the website interface.

## 24. Verification Protocol

Book VIII contains the reusable validation ladder. Applied to this ruleset, every source claim must capture the complete object history across vanilla, DE, and Divinitus, then follow support items, sites, spells, shapes, and events before a final card is asserted.

A collision-sensitive card is reliable only when it comes from the exact files and order through a current inspector, controlled game, or documented engine export. An unversioned screenshot is useful as a clue, not as resolution.

Divinitus event tests must also preserve the Pretender, nation, turn, season, terrain, dominion, sites, order, target, relevant code or variable state, eligible province-months, and delayed effects. Candle-scaled probability should be compared with eligible trials rather than with anecdotal successes.

## 25. Open and Resolved Compatibility Register

### 25.1 Resolved from source

- The exact file hashes and versions are fixed.
- DE's six global commands are known.
- The complete DE blessing change set is known.
- Event-code registries have no nonzero cross-mod collision.
- Event-variable registries do not collide.
- Shared selected items are IDs 348 and 396.
- DE and Divinitus share 235 fixed new-monster IDs.
- Divinitus touches 600 fixed monster identities also touched by DE.
- Divinitus weapon 3034 is assigned twice, with the later Stellar Bolt definition used by later references.
- Monster 8616 is claimed by incompatible-looking DE and Divinitus definitions.
- Later author-facing project wording establishes DE first and Divinitus second as the intended order.
- The source contains 69 automatic monster declarations and 26 automatic spell declarations under current documented syntax.
- The pinned Inspector resolves every original automatic monster and spell for the exact frozen order; those numbers remain structured-tool evidence rather than engine exports.
- The independent command audit separates officially documented tokens, later parser-recognised tokens, Inspector annotations, likely spelling errors, and genuinely unresolved commands.
- A separate compatibility edition removes the 8616 collision without altering either uploaded original.

### 25.2 Pending reliable resolution

- exact engine behaviour when a later mod issues `#newmonster` on an occupied fixed ID;
- engine confirmation of the Inspector-resolved 8616 behaviour in the unmodified stack;
- live-engine acceptance of Crystal Cavern recruitment and DE's Ring, Amulet, and Blood Vial helper chains under the repaired edition;
- engine confirmation of the Inspector-resolved automatic identities;
- the Mystic Prophet elemental-path cap edge case;
- exact event scheduling order for several global state machines;
- whether all broad description claims match every rare gate and cleanup path;
- runtime semantics for the small set of commands left unresolved by the independent command audit.

## 25.3 Deliberately not requested from the player

This project does not require the player to perform these tests. They remain pending until a reliable published reproduction, exact inspector export, or local Dominions executable is available.

# 26. Operational Checklists

## 26.1 Before creating a game

- Verify Dominions 6.35 or record the actual patch.
- Verify both exact mod filenames.
- Verify hashes where multiplayer reproducibility matters.
- Enable DE before Divinitus under this library's frozen ruleset.
- Do not add another overhaul without a collision screen.
- Record map, age, thrones, research, independents, event frequency, and diplomacy rules.
- Design Pretenders under the active mods, not vanilla.

## 26.2 Before finalizing a Pretender

- Confirm the chassis is legal for the nation after DE.
- Record every forced scale and path cost.
- Read every form.
- Read the full Divinitus description.
- Identify starting items, sites, armies, and commanders.
- Identify awakening gates.
- Identify temple, terrain, season, and order gates.
- Identify any catastrophe or cleanup condition.
- Recalculate blessing activation under DE.
- Check whether the design depends on a collision-marked object.

## 26.3 First twelve turns

- Confirm pregame grants arrived.
- Inspect capital sites and recruitment.
- Check starting items and commanders.
- Note which powers require the god awake.
- Build temples only after valuing their divine output.
- Track gem-bearing mages by month under gem longevity.
- Use DE's site-search clues.
- Record unexpected units, sites, or events with province and turn.

## 26.4 Multiplayer host

- Distribute exact versions, not only Workshop names.
- Publish load order.
- Prohibit silent midgame mod updates.
- Archive the .dm files.
- State whether known collisions are accepted.
- Record any house ruling for an exploit or broken divine chain.

## 27. Essays

### Essay I - Dominions Enhanced Is a Ruleset, Not a Content Pack

Calling Dominions Enhanced a content mod understates it. Content can be added while the surrounding grammar remains stable; DE changes the grammar.

A stronger bow is not only another weapon. It changes how light infantry trade with armour, how shields are valued, how much battlefield space missile troops deserve, and when arrow protection becomes urgent. Better mounts do not only improve cavalry. They change charge exchanges, magical vulnerability, rider survival, and the value of barding. Cheaper water breathing does not only add convenience. It changes which borders are real.

The six global commands demonstrate the same point at the highest level. Order, Productivity, population change, Luck event frequency, and battle-gem persistence alter calculations that every nation makes. Even a nation with no special DE roster change lives under these laws.

The magic programme expands the number of credible research branches. That reduces the reliability of memorized queues. A player who knew the vanilla breakpoint for an opponent now faces additional summons, battlefield effects, transformations, and siege tools. Information becomes more valuable because the option tree is wider.

The nation programme confirms the scale. Some nations receive corrections; others receive new rosters, economies, dominion rules, or successors. New nations occupy the same world and participate in the same Pretender and spell ecosystem.

The useful way to read the combined game is:

DE is an alternate edition of Dominions 6 built through the modding language.

That model produces better habits. Version numbers appear on guides. Vanilla and DE advice remain separate. Object pages show provenance. Multiplayer hosts freeze files. Strategy begins with the active rules rather than with memory.

### Essay II - The Pretender as a Distributed Institution

In ordinary analysis, a Pretender has a body, paths, dominion, scales, and a blessing. Divinitus adds a fifth category: institutions.

A library that recruits sages is not part of the god's hit-point total, but it may generate more research than another path level. A temple that creates sacred units is not printed in attack density, but it can transform the nation's force structure. A priesthood event can give existing national mages a second strategic role. A seasonal engine can reshape population and scales across many provinces.

This changes the meaning of divine death. If a power requires only the chosen chassis identity and continues while the god is dead, the institution may be resilient. If every event requires `#req_pretawake`, physical presence, or a target order, death shuts down the state.

It changes the meaning of dominion. Candles become production multipliers. It changes the meaning of temples. They become factories and access nodes. It changes the meaning of awakening. Delayed arrival may postpone an entire economy.

A distributed institution can also be countered indirectly. Raiders can burn temples. A unique relationship unit can be killed. A global enchantment can be dispelled. A required terrain can be denied. A site can be captured. The god need not be defeated in battle to dismantle the system.

The best design analysis draws a network:

god -> dominion -> temples/sites -> output -> army/research/economy

and then marks every dependency. A body card shows power. A dependency graph shows resilience.

### Essay III - Monthly Gem Persistence Changes Operational Art

In a one-battle accounting model, a combat gem is spent at the moment of use. Under DE's monthly longevity rule, the gem is better understood as a license to cast during all eligible battles that month.

This changes the unit of planning from battle to itinerary.

A mage defending a fort, teleporting to a second battle, and participating in a third interception may reuse the same initial allocation. Survival and position become part of gem efficiency. A two-gem script on a fragile mage is no longer only a two-gem risk; it is the potential loss of several battles of access.

The rule also changes how an opponent should apply pressure. Several battles do not necessarily exhaust the gem carrier. The effective counters are to kill, rout, immobilize, isolate, or force the wrong early script. Intelligence about movement order and likely sequential battles gains value.

Economically, the marginal value of a battle gem rises with the number of useful battles per month. Strategically, this favours interior lines and mobile casters. Tactically, it rewards scripts that remain useful across varied fights, or careful rescripting when the game permits it before hosting.

The rule does not make gems infinite. Ritual expenditure, forging, global enchantments, and treasury allocation remain real. It makes battlefield allocation persistent within a calendar boundary. That boundary belongs in every operational plan.

### Essay IV - Versioned Knowledge Is the Real Encyclopaedia

An encyclopaedia is often imagined as one perfected description. Dominions does not permit that simplicity.

Patches change spells and units. DE changes the patch again. Divinitus changes DE. Load order changes the combination. A later release may repair an ID collision while adding a new event gate. A correct article can become wrong without any sentence changing.

The solution is not constant rewriting without history. It is versioned knowledge.

Each claim needs:

- a ruleset;
- a source date;
- an evidence label;
- object provenance;
- an optional supersession link.

The public article can remain easy to read. The complexity belongs in its metadata and source panel. A visitor choosing "DE 2.16 + Divinitus 1.15.3" should see the correct Grand Hierophant. A visitor choosing vanilla should not.

Versioned knowledge also improves strategy. Old tournament advice can remain valuable when its assumptions are visible. A build that failed under one blessing cost can be reconsidered under another. A nation overhaul can be studied as design history rather than erased.

The real encyclopaedia cannot be a book of static answers. It needs to answer:

Correct under which world?

## Related essays kept in their original homes

[Book III](#)'s "A Bless Is a Roster Contract" owns the blessing argument. [Book VIII](#)'s essays on load order, event systems, and compatibility own the general modding arguments. [Book IX](#) applies those ideas to the exact DE/Divinitus ruleset without printing a second version of the same essay.

## Appendix A - Source-Lint Findings

- 1 DE contains one extra `#rarity 5` and `#end` after site 2372 outside an active object block.
- 2 DE contains one adjacent event start without an intervening `#end`.
- 3 Divinitus contains four adjacent event starts without intervening `#end` commands in the Annunaki population chain.
- 4 Divinitus defines weapon 3034 twice.
- 5 Divinitus contains one event without an explicit rarity.
- 6 DE and Divinitus both create 235 of the same fixed monster IDs.
- 7 Monster 8616 has an especially divergent cross-mod purpose.

These are source observations. They do not by themselves prove a user-visible defect.

## Appendix B - Data Schema Warning

The generated object catalogue stores source blocks. It does not:

- import vanilla object cards;
- execute clear and copy semantics into a final card;
- allocate numberless objects;
- simulate category parsing;
- evaluate event probability;
- follow every name reference;
- reproduce the engine.

It is a provenance and discovery layer. A resolved website database should be built on top of it, never silently substitute it for final game data. The source summary remains in Section 2, the compatibility checklist in Section 26, and the library-wide evidence key in [Book I](#).



# Foundation Book X - Playing and Hosting Dominions 6

## Interface, Game Setup, Orders, and the First Campaign

Baseline: Dominions 6.36; vanilla procedure unless a ruleset is named; research edition 20 August 2026.

### 1. Purpose

Dominions is not played only on the battlefield. It is played in setup screens, message lists, province windows, recruitment queues, army panels, item treasuries, order menus, network lobbies, and the short interval between finishing a turn and committing it to the host. A commander can have the correct statistics, the right troops, and a sound strategic purpose and still fail because one operational detail was missed.

Book X is the operating manual for the library. It explains how to create and join a game, read the interface, translate intentions into legal orders, submit a turn safely, host a fair campaign, recover from common mistakes, and guide a first nation through its opening months. It is written for two readers at once:

- the new player who needs a complete route from the title screen to the end of a campaign;
- the experienced player who needs an exact procedural reference when the interface, network, or order system becomes the binding constraint.

Book X does not repeat mechanics owned elsewhere. Book I owns hosting order and evidence; Book II owns the state economy; Book III owns Pretenders and dominion; Book IV owns battle; Book V owns magic; and Book VI owns campaign doctrine. Book X explains how players operate those rules.

### 2. Three Layers of Operational Knowledge

Every instruction belongs to one of three layers.

| Layer      | Question                                            | Typical failure                                                                  |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ruleset    | What game is being played?                          | The wrong patch, map, mod stack, age, or setting is assumed.                     |
| Interface  | What is the game showing, and where is the control? | Information is overlooked or a control is mistaken for the underlying rule.      |
| Commitment | What will the host attempt to resolve?              | An arrow, queue, script, or submitted file does not express the intended action. |

The layers should be checked in that order. An unexplained result is rarely clarified by studying battle arithmetic if the game was created with a different mod list. A legal order cannot be inferred from an arrow alone. A completed local turn is not necessarily a received network submission.

## 2.1 The operational chain

A reliable turn follows one chain:

identify ruleset -> read new information -> inspect state -> choose priorities -> enter orders -> audit dependencies -> submit -> confirm receipt

The chain is simple enough to memorize and strict enough to prevent most administrative losses. Expert play adds better judgment at each step; it does not remove the steps.

## 2.2 Interface facts and game facts

An interface fact describes what a control does. A game fact describes how the engine resolves the resulting order. The distinction matters:

- Clicking a province creates a movement instruction; [Book I](#) explains when movement resolves.
- Pressing Patrol assigns an order; [Book II](#) owns patrol strength and unrest consequences.
- Placing a spell in a script requests it; [Books IV](#) and [V](#) explain legality, targeting, gems, fatigue, and spellcasting behaviour.
- Pressing End Turn commits or hosts the local orders depending on game type; it does not certify that every planned action remains legal when hosting occurs.

The interface is a contract-writing system. It records requests to the host. Resolution belongs to the engine.

# Part I: Ruleset, Installation, and Local Continuity

## 3. Establish the Exact Ruleset

Before creating a game or interpreting an old save, record:

- 1 Dominions version;
- 2 enabled mods and their versions;
- 3 mod load order where relevant;
- 4 map and map version;
- 5 age;
- 6 participating nations and teams;
- 7 game settings;
- 8 victory conditions;
- 9 hosting method and timetable.

The title of a mod or map is not a sufficient identifier. Workshop content can change while retaining its public name. A file name, declared version, release date, and hash provide a stronger frozen record. [Book IX](#) demonstrates that practice for the supplied Dominions Enhanced and Divinitus files.

### 3.1 Current official baseline

The current baseline is Dominions 6.36, released 17 August 2026 UTC. It includes interface and operational changes from the 6.2x-6.36 series: expanded order copying, gem-transfer shortcuts, treasury sorting, clearer province and message displays, lobby safeguards, touchscreen operation, research navigation, and the ability of teleport-moving commanders to leave a besieged fort.

The patch baseline is not decorative. A player returning from an older release may remember a limitation that no longer exists, while a guide written for a later patch may recommend a control unavailable to an older host.

## 4. Find the User Data Directory

The safest route is the in-game Game Tools menu and Open User Data Directory. This avoids guessing whether the operating system, storefront, or installation has placed personal files somewhere unexpected.

Common default locations are:

| Platform | Usual user-data root  |
|----------|-----------------------|
| Windows  | %APPDATA%\dominions6\ |
| Linux    | ~/.dominions6/        |
| macOS    | ~/.dominions6/        |

Important subdirectories commonly include mods, maps, and savedgames. These are user-data locations, not the installed game directory. The distinction matters during reinstalls and updates: personal game material should not depend on editing installation files.

[Book VIII](#) owns the full [directory and packaging procedure](#). The practical rule here is narrower: open the directory from the game, confirm the exact folder before copying anything, and preserve original downloaded files separately from edited working copies.

## 5. Install and Freeze Mods Safely

### 5.1 A reproducible mod stack

A reproducible stack has four properties:

- every participant has the same files;
- every participant enables the same releases;
- the host records any meaningful load-order requirement;
- the stack is not changed after pretenders or turns have been created unless every participant accepts the consequences.

The modern lobby performs a safety check intended to ensure that required mods have been uploaded, but it cannot replace a written baseline. The lobby can distribute what the host provides; it cannot prove that a public guide, local source inspection, or remembered balance rule refers to that exact file.

### 5.2 Installation procedure

- 1 Close any game session that is using the files.
- 2 Place the mod's .dm file and required asset folders in the user-data mods directory.
- 3 Preserve the supplied directory structure. Image paths in a .dm file are relative and can fail if folders are flattened or renamed.
- 4 Start Dominions and open Game Tools to enable the required mods.
- 5 Confirm that each mod is listed without a load error.
- 6 Create a small disposable game if the stack is unfamiliar.

7 Record file versions and, for a long campaign, checksums.

The procedure for maps is similar: place the .map file and associated images under maps, preserve relative paths, and test the map before committing a multiplayer group.

5.3 Never repair the live baseline casually

An apparent spelling error, duplicate definition, broken image, or balance problem in a live mod is not permission to edit the campaign copy. A local change creates a distinct ruleset. Repair experiments belong in a separate working file with a new version label. [Book VIII](#) owns [safe release engineering](#).

6. Backups and Campaign Continuity

Backups are useful before a version change, a computer migration, a host transfer, or any repair attempt. Copy the specific game or content directory to a clearly dated destination. Do not replace the only working copy while diagnosing a problem.

For an ordinary campaign, preserve:

- the frozen map and mod files;
- the game-creation settings;
- the current saved game or host state;
- any separately distributed pretender or turn material;
- the hosting schedule and player roster;
- a short incident log when a stale, rollback, substitution, or disputed resolution occurs.

A backup is not a sanctioned alternate timeline. Multiplayer hosts should state in advance when restoration is permitted. A rollback can expose hidden orders or battle information and alter the competitive game even when the technical state is restored perfectly.

7. The Pregame Record

The following compact record is sufficient for most private games:

| Field             | Record                                                      |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Game name         | Unique, filename-safe identifier                            |
| Dominions version | Host version and intended lock                              |
| Map               | Exact title and release/file identity                       |
| Mods              | Ordered list with versions                                  |
| Age               | Early, Middle, or Late                                      |
| Nations           | Player, nation, team, human/AI status                       |
| Pretender rules   | Password requirement, disciples, design restrictions        |
| Economy           | Gold, sites, independents, research, special limits         |
| Information       | Scoregraph setting and diplomacy convention                 |
| Victory           | Throne requirements, conquest, Cataclysm                    |
| Hosting           | Lobby/private/PBEM/hotseat, timer, extensions, stale policy |
| Administration    | Host, backup host, substitution and rollback policy         |

Experts often retain this record because it lets later analysis separate a game result from a ruleset mismatch. New players benefit for the same reason.

## Part II: Creating the World

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### 8. Create, Continue, or Join

The title screen divides three different acts:

- Create World establishes a new game's map, participants, settings, and victory conditions.
- Continue Old Game opens a local game that already exists.
- Network leads to multiplayer connections, including the official lobby.

Treat these as different workflows. Creating a world is an act of ruleset authorship. Continuing a game is a state-loading act. Joining a network game is a compatibility and identity check.

### 9. Choose the Map

A game can use a premade map or a generated world. The correct choice depends less on visual novelty than on whether the map supports the intended player count and game character.

Check at least:

- land and water province counts;
- required start positions and whether they are appropriate for the chosen age;
- wraparound behaviour;
- cave or plane structure;
- chokepoints, island isolation, and unusually dense water barriers;
- map-specific victory locations or scenario rules;
- whether every participant possesses the exact file and images.

A visually striking map may still be unsuitable for a competitive game if starting regions differ drastically or one nation begins without meaningful routes. [Book VI](#) owns [map structure and strategic geography](#); [Book VIII](#) owns map-file construction.

### 10. Choose the Age and Participants

The age determines which nations are available and changes the broad magical and military environment. Early Age nations tend, as a general pattern rather than a universal law, to have stronger magical access and less developed mundane equipment or institutions. Later ages tend toward heavier conventional equipment, more organized states, and diminished magical abundance. Nation-specific exceptions are extensive.

On the participant screen:

- 1 add each nation;
- 2 set it to human or AI;
- 3 confirm that no nation is duplicated;
- 4 assign teams if using disciples;
- 5 verify that water nations and unusual starts are compatible with the map.

Do not use AI difficulty as a substitute for a stated learning purpose. A new player's test game, a balance test, and an expert's endurance game require different opposition.

## 11. Disciple Games

Enable the disciple option before assigning teams. Each team must contain exactly one Pretender and may contain disciples. Current releases support up to twenty teams.

The official rules create important design differences:

- a disciple receives 400 design points;
- a disciple does not choose dominion strength or scales;
- awakening time is half that of the team's Pretender;
- a team with disciples cannot appoint ordinary prophets.

Book III owns the divine mechanics. The setup obligation is to verify team composition before creation. A nation placed on the wrong team cannot be treated as a harmless lobby typo after designs and diplomacy have been built around it.

## 12. Create and Protect Pretenders

The Pretender-design screen supports saving and loading designs with Ctrl+S and Ctrl+L. Saving a tested design avoids reconstruction errors and gives the campaign a recoverable baseline.

For network play:

- use a player password where the workflow permits it;
- do not reuse an important real-world password;
- confirm the chosen nation, age, team, and active mods before submission;
- keep the local design file until the game has begun successfully.

Cheat prevention is useful but does not protect players from a malicious or careless host. The host necessarily holds privileged game state. Trust and administrative policy remain part of multiplayer security.

Pretender design itself belongs to Book III. Book X adds only the operational rule: save, label, verify, and submit the design that was actually tested.

## 13. Game Settings by Consequence

Game settings should be chosen by the experience they create, not by habit.

| Setting                   | What it changes operationally | Questions for the host                                                                     |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Starting gold             | Opening purchasing power      | Is the game meant to accelerate first forts or preserve normal scarcity?                   |
| Magic-site frequency      | Gem and site density          | Will this support the intended map size and magic level?                                   |
| Independent strength      | Expansion danger              | Are players expected to use tested expansion parties or learn against forgiving provinces? |
| Research or magic setting | Time to research thresholds   | Does the timer match the intended campaign length?                                         |
| Scoregraphs               | Public strategic information  | Are graphs visible, hidden, or recoverable through intelligence?                           |

| Setting                    | What it changes operationally          | Questions for the host                                                               |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Master password            | Emergency administrative access        | Who holds it, and under what written circumstances may it be used?                   |
| Limited artifact forging   | Competition for unique artifacts       | Is the default one unique artifact per game turn retained?                           |
| Limited legendary research | Competition at level nine              | Is only one level-nine discovery permitted at a time, with repeat research required? |
| Commander renaming         | Information organization and deception | Is renaming allowed, and are naming conventions restricted?                          |
| Cheat prevention           | Detectable file manipulation           | Is it enabled, and do players understand its limits?                                 |
| Throne settings            | Victory arithmetic                     | How many Ascension Points exist and how many are required?                           |
| Cataclysm                  | Endgame clock                          | When does it begin, and how will Throne loss alter the required total?               |

### 13.1 Scoregraphs

Scoregraphs change diplomacy because they change common knowledge. Visible army, income, research, fort, province, dominion, or gem trends allow coalitions to form around measurable growth. Hidden graphs place more weight on scouting and negotiation. Spies operating in an enemy capital can reveal graphs, so hidden does not mean unobtainable.

At victory, current versions reveal scoregraphs and the hidden map to players who remain until the end; an eliminated player does not receive that later revelation. This makes post-game review stronger than mid-game speculation. [Book VI](#) owns the strategic use of information.

### 13.2 Master password

A master password can rescue a game by allowing an absent player to be set to AI or by permitting necessary administration. It also provides broad access. It should be held by the host and, if desired, a trusted backup under a written policy. Its use should be logged.

### 13.3 Limited artifacts and legendary research

Under the usual limited-artifact setting, a particular unique artifact may be forged only once per game turn. Several players can race for it in the same month. Under limited legendary research, only one level-nine spell in a school can be completed at a time; the level can be researched again to reach another. These settings turn a menu choice into an initiative contest.

### 13.4 Renaming

When enabled, most commanders can be renamed by opening their statistics and pressing R. Pretenders, disciples, prophets, and famous heroes are exceptions. Good internal names encode function or theatre without exposing more than necessary in multiplayer screenshots or streams.

## 14. Victory Conditions

The standard route is control of enough Ascension Points from Thrones. The setup screen can use recommended/default Throne distributions or a custom arrangement. A conquest game instead requires elimination or control on the specified terms.

Cataclysm creates a hardening endgame. It destroys Thrones over time and reduces the Ascension Points required for victory. The finishing line moves while the map deteriorates. Record the starting turn and make sure every player understands the interaction before play begins.

Book VI owns [Throne arithmetic](#) and [victory conversion](#). The setup standard is exactness: state the number and level of Thrones, total points, points required, and Cataclysm turn.

## 15. Host Setup Sheet

Before pressing the final creation control, the host should be able to answer every row:

| Check        | Pass condition                                                           |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Version      | Host is on the announced patch.                                          |
| Content      | Exact map and mod stack are installed and tested.                        |
| Participants | Nations, human/AI status, and teams match the roster.                    |
| Settings     | Every non-default setting is written down.                               |
| Victory      | Throne or conquest conditions are explicit.                              |
| Security     | Player passwords, master-password custody, and host trust are addressed. |
| Schedule     | First hosting time, regular timer, and extension channel are known.      |
| Recovery     | Backup and substitution policy exists.                                   |

Creating the world should feel like signing the campaign charter, because that is what it is.

# Part III: Starting, Joining, and Hosting

## 16. Game Modes

Dominions supports several multiplayer patterns.

| Mode               | Best use                                        | Principal operational risk                                                             |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Single-player      | Learning, testing, and private analysis         | End Turn hosts immediately; there is no submission grace period.                       |
| Hotseat            | Several players on one machine                  | Hidden information and passwords require disciplined handoff.                          |
| Official lobby     | Most online groups                              | Identity, version, mod, password, and timer errors.                                    |
| Private server     | Controlled communities and persistent hosts     | Server setup and maintenance depend on the current executable and network environment. |
| PBEM/file exchange | Asynchronous groups using external coordination | Wrong or missing files, weak confirmation, and manual version control.                 |

The official lobby is the recommended online route for ordinary groups. Private servers and PBEM remain valid when the group has a reason to manage its own infrastructure, but exact command-line instructions are version-sensitive and should be taken from the current official documentation or executable help rather than copied uncritically from an older guide.



## 17. Official Lobby Workflow

### 17.1 Joining

- 1 Start the announced Dominions version.
- 2 Enable or install the required mods.
- 3 Select Network and Enter Game Lobby.
- 4 Locate the exact game name rather than a similar title.
- 5 Check nation, status, remaining time, and any displayed content requirements.
- 6 Enter the player password if required.
- 7 Inspect the loaded turn before issuing orders.

If the game cannot be entered, stop before changing local files at random. Compare version, mod list, mod file identity, map, password, and whether the game is awaiting pretenders, running, finished, or currently hosting.

### 17.2 Creating or administering a lobby game

The lobby host should keep the game name distinctive, publish the ruleset separately, and test the connection before the first real deadline. Current releases have improved lobby validation and handling of larger turn files, but administrative clarity remains necessary.

Do not change mods or the map to make one client connect unless the host has first confirmed the canonical campaign files. The correct repair is to bring the client to the baseline, not to create competing baselines.

## 18. Turn Submission and Revision

In network multiplayer, End Turn saves and submits the turn. The player can normally revise and resubmit before hosting. In single-player, End Turn immediately resolves the month.

That difference changes the safe habit:

- In single-player, perform the complete audit before ending the turn.
- In multiplayer, early submission can protect against a missed deadline, but a later revision still requires confirmation that the replacement was received.

A submitted marker is evidence of receipt, not evidence of strategic quality. The final pre-host check remains necessary.

### 18.1 Submission protocol

- 1 Save enough time before the deadline for a connection failure.
- 2 Finish a complete local audit.
- 3 Press End Turn and allow the transfer to finish.
- 4 Re-enter or refresh the game state if necessary to confirm the nation is marked submitted.
- 5 If revising, make the change, submit again, and confirm the new submission.
- 6 Notify the host immediately if the status is uncertain near the deadline.

### 18.2 Stales

A stale is a hosted turn without a valid new submission for that nation. The engine must continue the game from existing state and default order persistence. The result may preserve some standing behaviour but it does not replace active planning.

The host should distinguish:

- an ordinary missed deadline governed by the published stale policy;
- a platform or host failure affecting several players;
- an announced emergency for which an extension was requested;
- strategic regret after the player already had a fair opportunity to submit.

These are not ethically identical events, even if all can produce a missing turn file.

## 19. Hosting Policy

A healthy campaign states its administrative rules before they become politically useful.

### 19.1 Minimum charter

- regular hosting interval and timezone;
- how automatic hosting interacts with all turns being submitted;
- extension request channel and expected notice;
- maximum ordinary extension, if any;
- stale and consecutive-stale policy;
- substitution and AI-conversion procedure;
- rollback conditions;
- rules for diplomacy, trades, concessions, and coordinated victory;
- rules for bugs, exploits, and prohibited file inspection;
- who can administer the game if the host is unavailable.

### 19.2 Extensions

Extensions protect the quality of a long game when real life intervenes. They also delay every participant. A good rule is predictable and symmetric: ask as early as possible, give a new exact deadline, and record it in the common channel. Do not make the host infer that an unsubmitted nation wants more time.

### 19.3 Substitutions

A substitute needs the nation password, current turn access, public rules, diplomatic obligations, and enough strategic context to avoid accidental treaty breaches. Private intelligence should be transferred only as the game permits. The original player should not continue advising several sides after departure unless the group explicitly allows it.

### 19.4 Rollbacks

Rollback is a last resort for technical corruption or a clearly defined administrative failure. It is not a remedy for a forgotten script, a bad move, or a surprising battle. Once players have seen hosted information, replaying the month changes their knowledge. If a rollback is unavoidable, document the reason, restored point, affected submissions, and any required order-repetition rule.

## 20. Security and Trust

Use unique game passwords. Do not send credentials through public channels. The master password and host files deserve the same care as any private competitive record.

Cheat detection can identify some forms of manipulation, but it cannot make an untrusted host trustworthy. The host has privileged access by design. Choose a host who treats the role as custodial, preserve administrative logs, and settle disputes through evidence instead of speculation.

# Part IV: The Main Interface

## 21. The Map as a Control Surface

The strategic map is simultaneously a world view, an order editor, and an information filter. The default interaction pattern is:

- right-click a province or object for information;
- left-click a commander to select it;
- left-click a destination to issue movement;
- use the province and nation controls for recruitment, messages, research, and overviews.

Mouse behaviour can be altered in preferences, so a player following instructions on another machine should confirm whether selection and information buttons have been swapped.

### 21.1 Selection discipline

Before entering an order, identify three things:

- 1 the selected province;
- 2 the selected commander or group of commanders;
- 3 the destination or target province.

Most accidental orders are selection failures. The map arrow can look plausible even when the wrong commander is carrying the order.

## 22. Province and Nation Controls

The standard controls include:

| Control | Function                  | Operational use                                                |
|---------|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| E       | End Turn                  | Save/submit in multiplayer; host immediately in single-player. |
| T       | Army Setup                | Organize commanders and troops in the selected province.       |
| Y       | Army Setup at Destination | Inspect or organize the destination context.                   |
| U       | Patrolling Army Setup     | Work with forces assigned to patrol.                           |
| R       | Recruit Units             | Open the local recruitment screen.                             |
| B       | Mercenaries               | Review and bid on available mercenaries.                       |
| I       | Province Chronicles       | Review the province's recorded history.                        |
| M       | Read Messages             | Open the month's messages.                                     |
| S       | Send Messages             | Open diplomacy and transfer messaging.                         |
| F1      | Nation Overview           | Inspect commanders, provinces, and national administration.    |
| F2      | Scoregraphs               | View information allowed by the game setting and intelligence. |
| F3      | Hall of Fame              | Inspect experience leaders and heroic abilities.               |

| Control | Function            | Operational use                                                    |
|---------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| F4      | Pretenders          | Review known divine players and status.                            |
| F5      | Research            | Set school priorities and inspect progress.                        |
| F6      | Global Enchantments | Review active globals and available public information.            |
| F7      | Magic Item Treasury | Store, equip, and manage items where access permits.               |
| F8      | Magic Item Overview | Find items and their holders across the nation.                    |
| F9      | Thrones             | Review known Thrones and Ascension Point information.              |
| Esc     | Options/menu        | Access preferences, save/quit controls, and other session options. |

The letter shortcuts are efficient because they reduce navigation cost, but context still controls what can be done. R opens local recruitment only where the province and ownership permit it. F7 does not make a remote commander share a laboratory treasury.

## 23. Map Navigation Shortcuts

| Key                    | Result                                              |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Arrow keys             | Scroll the map.                                     |
| Home                   | Centre on the home province.                        |
| Ctrl+Home              | Centre on the Pretender or disciple.                |
| G or #                 | Go to a province by number.                         |
| End                    | Set half-scale zoom.                                |
| Insert                 | Zoom to cover the screen.                           |
| Delete                 | Fit the whole map.                                  |
| Page Up or Ctrl+Up     | Zoom in.                                            |
| Page Down or Ctrl+Down | Zoom out.                                           |
| Ctrl+F                 | Open map filtering.                                 |
| H                      | Hide interface buttons and commanders.              |
| ?                      | Show contextual shortcut help on supported screens. |

The ? control deserves special emphasis. Dominions exposes more context-sensitive shortcuts than any static summary can comfortably hold. When a selection, army, recruitment, or treasury screen feels slow, open the contextual help before assuming the operation requires repeated clicking.

### 23.1 Touchscreen mode

Version 6.36 adds a touchscreen mode for play with little or no keyboard use. In that mode, a long-click is interpreted as a right-click and the map can be scrolled by dragging broadly rather than relying on a narrow scroll region. The settings popup remains the release-specific control reference. Because long-click changes the meaning of a press, practise opening and closing popups before entering time-sensitive orders.

## 24. Strategic Map Filters

| Shortcut | Filter or overlay              |
|----------|--------------------------------|
| Ctrl+1   | Flags and forts                |
| Ctrl+2   | Armies                         |
| Ctrl+3   | Dominion                       |
| Ctrl+4   | Income                         |
| Ctrl+5   | Thrones and events             |
| Ctrl+6   | Own troops in allied provinces |
| Ctrl+7   | Allied troops in own provinces |
| Ctrl+8   | Neighbour relationships        |
| Ctrl+9   | Province names                 |
| Ctrl+0   | Remote rituals                 |

A filter is an analytical lens. Income view finds economic discontinuities; dominion view finds religious fronts; army view finds exposed force; neighbour view tests movement assumptions. Use several filters in sequence rather than treating the default map as complete information.

### 24.1 Planes

Plane controls switch among accessible realms: the Pantokrator's realm, the realm beneath, and the Void. A control is grey when the nation lacks access. A plane is more than another zoom layer; it can have its own movement, access, provinces, and strategic relationships. Verify the active plane before issuing or diagnosing a movement order.

## 25. Right-Click, Tooltips, and Popups

Right-click is the first research tool inside the game. Use it on units, weapons, armour, abilities, provinces, paths, items, and other interface elements. Hover text and popups often expose the difference between a familiar name and the actual current ruleset.

Recent releases have expanded popups for areas of effect, movement destinations, Ascension Point information, ritual targets, and other state. Treat a tooltip as a current local clue, then distinguish three cases:

- the popup states an exact game value;
- the popup summarizes a mechanic owned by the manual;
- the popup describes an effect whose full result still depends on hidden state or hosting order.

The first can be recorded directly. The second should be linked to its canonical rule. The third requires evidence, not confident interpolation.

## 26. Current Operational Additions Worth Learning

Players returning from earlier Dominions 6 releases should learn these accumulated improvements:

- Ctrl+A can sort the item treasury automatically.

- Gem transfers have fast keyboard controls in several screens; for example, hovering a commander and using Alt+F adds a Fire gem, while Alt+Backspace removes the corresponding gem in the supported context.
- Order copying is available more broadly, including army positioning; O is used for order copy/paste in supported screens, while squad scripting also retains numbered script storage.
- The bless interface can repeat the last effect with X and remove an effect with Backspace.
- In version 6.35, the Nation Overview's L filter isolates commanders assigned to Pillage.
- Ritual messages and destination displays provide stronger province navigation.
- Teleport-moving commanders can leave a besieged fort in 6.35.
- In 6.36, right-clicking the supported Province Defence increase or decrease control changes PD by ten, and right-clicking the T Army Setup control invokes the Y destination form.
- The 6.36 Research screen uses Up and Down to swap research targets and includes ? help.
- In the 6.36 battle overview, S hides temporary summons; in spell selection, Space clears the active filter.
- Current victory review reveals scoregraphs and the hidden map for players who remain until the end.

Shortcuts are not all global. If a key does nothing, confirm the active screen and open ? rather than assuming the rule has failed.

## Part V: Reading and Preparing a Turn

### 27. Begin with Messages, Not with Memory

Every hosted month can invalidate part of the plan made in the previous one. A border changed, a commander died, a site was discovered, a fort completed, a ritual failed, an enemy army appeared, or a diplomatic promise became due. Read the new state before continuing yesterday's intentions.

A strong review order follows causation:

- 1 hosting and administrative notices;
- 2 battles, assassinations, and movement outcomes;
- 3 province gains, losses, sieges, and unrest events;
- 4 new commanders, troops, construction, and recruitment;
- 5 research, spells, items, sites, and rituals;
- 6 dominion, Throne, and global changes;
- 7 diplomacy and transfers;
- 8 attrition, disease, desertion, and other end-state changes.

This mirrors the principle in [Book I's hosting sequence](#): consequences should be read in the order that explains them. The message list is not always displayed as a complete causal proof, so province state, commander state, and the battle replay may need to be compared.

### 28. Message Triage

Classify each message before acting.

| Class            | Meaning                                                        | Immediate question                          |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Fatal dependency | A commander, fort, laboratory, army, or route no longer exists | Which downstream orders are now impossible? |
| Strategic change | A war, Throne, global, border, or alliance changed             | Does the monthly priority still hold?       |

| Class           | Meaning                                             | Immediate question                                       |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Resource change | Gold, gems, research, recruitment, or items changed | Which queue or package is now underfunded?               |
| Local exception | An event or isolated result needs attention         | Is it urgent, or can it wait behind national priorities? |
| Informational   | The message confirms an expected result             | Can it be archived after verification?                   |

The greatest danger is not the most dramatic message. It is the message that silently invalidates several orders: a laboratory loss that strands gem transfers, a dead ferry commander that leaves troops behind, or a captured province that breaks a movement chain.

28.1 Use message navigation

Where a message offers a province or unit link, use it. Current versions provide better destination and ritual-message navigation than early releases. After arriving at the province, inspect the surrounding map; a message's named location may be only one part of the consequence.

29. Battle Review as Evidence

A battle replay answers more than "who won?" Record:

- initial formation and whether expected squads appeared;
- actual scripts and whether requested spells were cast;
- first contact timing;
- important damage, fatigue, morale, and targeting failures;
- retreats and the provinces into which survivors escaped;
- commander and specialist losses;
- whether the result achieved the campaign purpose.

Book IV owns the [post-battle audit](#), while Book VI owns conversion. The operational duty is to preserve enough evidence to tell a bad plan from a mis-entered plan.

29.1 Replay version awareness

Battle displays are interpretations of a hosted result. Version mismatches can create misleading replays. In supported versions, Ctrl+I during battle can display host and current version information. If the visible replay appears impossible, compare the host version before constructing a new theory of combat.

30. The Nation Overview as an Administrative Ledger

F1 is the broadest audit screen. It makes dispersed national state searchable without clicking every province. Use its columns, filters, and sorting to answer questions such as:

- Which commanders have no useful order?
- Which mages are researching, moving, forging, searching, or idle?
- Which provinces are recruiting commanders or troops?
- Where are unrest, low income, fortification, or siege problems developing?
- Which forces are pillaging, patrolling, or otherwise assigned to exceptional work?

The overview is most valuable near the end of the turn, after local plans have been entered. It reveals omissions that province-by-province work hides.

On version 6.35, press L within the Nation Overview to isolate Pillage orders. This is especially useful before submission: a commander left pillaging after an emergency can permanently damage a province that has already returned to ordinary economic use.

## 31. Establish the Monthly Priorities

Before issuing many orders, state the month in a few lines:

- primary strategic objective;
- threat that must be answered;
- research threshold being pursued;
- infrastructure or recruitment commitment;
- gem or item package that must be delivered;
- diplomatic obligation due this month;
- acceptable loss and reserve requirement.

The statement prevents locally attractive actions from consuming resources required by the national plan. It also makes the final audit intelligible: each essential order can be checked against a declared purpose.

## 32. Work from Dependencies Outward

Enter fragile, dependent orders before routine orders.

- 1 confirm irreplaceable commanders and movement leaders;
- 2 assign magic, gems, items, and ritual targets;
- 3 organize armies and scripts;
- 4 enter movement, stealth, patrol, siege, and special orders;
- 5 complete recruitment and construction;
- 6 adjust research and recurring administration;
- 7 send diplomacy and transfers;
- 8 audit the entire nation.

This is not the engine's hosting sequence. It is a human error-control sequence. A recruitment queue is easy to reconstruct; a multi-province communion package assembled after movement orders is easy to break.

## 33. The End-of-Turn Audit

Run four passes.

### 33.1 Commanders

- Every important commander has the intended order.
- Movement arrows belong to the intended units.
- Stealth, normal movement, and attack-current-province choices are distinguished.
- Researchers, site searchers, forgers, preachers, blood hunters, and builders are not accidentally idle.
- Besieged commanders have legal orders for their side of the walls.

### 33.2 Armies

- Troops are assigned to commanders rather than left unintentionally in the garrison.
- Leadership type and capacity are sufficient.



- Formation, orders, scripts, gems, and items belong to the correct commander.
- Retreat routes and supply are plausible.
- A moving commander is actually carrying the intended squads.

### 33.3 State

- Capital and fort recruitment queues are funded as intended.
- Commander Points, Recruitment Points, resources, Holy Points, and gold bind where expected.
- Forts, temples, laboratories, Province Defence, and repairs match the budget.
- Research is assigned to the intended schools.
- Treasury gems and items are where next month's plan expects them.

### 33.4 Campaign

- Border gaps, Throne approaches, and known raiders were inspected.
- Treaties, trades, warnings, and extension needs were communicated.
- The action creates a useful position if it succeeds and a survivable position if it fails.
- The turn is submitted and receipt confirmed.

## Part VI: Recruitment, Army Setup, and Inventories

### 34. Recruitment Is Local

The recruitment screen converts local capacity into a future force. National troops are usually available in the capital and in forts, subject to nation and unit rules. Some troops are capital-only; some require terrain, a particular site, a foreign-recruitment condition, or recruitment outside a fort.

A unit or commander can be constrained by several independent resources:

- gold;
- local resources;
- Recruitment Points;
- Commander Points;
- Holy Points;
- a per-turn or per-location recruitment limit;
- a fort, site, terrain, dominion, or other prerequisite.

Book II owns [recruitment constraints](#). The recruitment screen expresses those constraints locally.

### 35. Reading a Recruitment Queue

#### 35.1 Immediate gold, later local capacity

The game will not queue a purchase that cannot be afforded with current gold. Some shortages in resources, Recruitment Points, or Holy Points can remain in a queue for later turns. A dimmed entry needs to be diagnosed: inspect every cost and prerequisite instead of assuming gold is the problem.

## 35.2 Queue behaviour

- Hold Shift while selecting a recruit to add ten at a time.
- A queue can hold up to 250 entries.
- Commanders are separately restricted by local Commander Points.
- Units with a limited recruitment rate cannot exceed that local monthly rate.
- Newly recruited units arrive early enough in the hosted month to defend the province.
- Recruits in a fort that becomes besieged are placed within the besieged fort.
- New units enter the unassigned garrison until deliberately organized.

## 35.3 Queue audit

For each recruiting centre, ask:

- 1 What role is being purchased?
- 2 Which resource is binding?
- 3 Will the queue complete this month or spill into the next?
- 4 Is a commander being produced to lead or use the troops?
- 5 Can the province survive long enough for the investment to matter?

An overflowing queue is not a plan. It is a claim on future capacity.

# 36. Army Setup

Open Army Setup with T. The screen is where troops are transferred, grouped, positioned, and given battle orders.

## 36.1 The unassigned garrison

Unassigned units are not attached to a commander.

- In a fort, they remain inside unless assigned or used in a relevant patrol or defensive arrangement.
- Outside a fort, unassigned defenders join a battle as a central squad.

Leaving troops in the garrison can be deliberate. Leaving the only troops meant to move there is an operational failure.

## 36.2 Forming squads

A commander can lead up to five squads, subject to leadership type and capacity. Select units and then a squad box to add them. Dropping selected units on a commander can create a new squad when a slot is available.

Useful selection controls include:

- double-click to select matching units;
- Shift-click to build a selection;
- hover a squad and press W to select afflicted units;
- E to select units with at least two experience stars in the supported context;
- M to select the slowest units;
- Enter to clear a selection;
- ? to display the complete contextual shortcut list.

Selection shortcuts are tools for preserving composition. They allow the wounded, experienced, or slowest part of a formation to be separated without checking every card.

### 36.3 Leadership audit

The army screen may permit a visually convincing group that performs poorly because the commander lacks appropriate ordinary, undead, magical, or special leadership. Before leaving the screen, compare:

- number and type of units;
- commander leadership categories;
- command penalties or bonuses;
- squad morale;
- movement compatibility.

Book IV owns [leadership and army construction](#).

## 37. Positioning and Battle Orders

Each squad and commander has a placement box. Selected formations can be repositioned by right-clicking in the battlefield diagram. Colour and order indicators distinguish assigned behaviour, but the order text remains the authoritative check.

### 37.1 Squad orders

Assign orders based on delivery rather than theme. A missile squad, bodyguard group, flanking force, line holder, and attack squad have different contact problems. The detailed order and targeting analysis belongs to [Book IV](#).

### 37.2 Commander scripts

A commander can receive up to five specific scripted orders before falling back to the standing order or spellcasting AI. In the army screen:

- Ctrl+number stores a script in the supported context;
- pressing the corresponding number pastes it;
- X can repeat the same requested order while constructing the script;
- current versions also support broader order copy/paste, including 0 in supported screens.

After copying a script, re-check gems, paths, equipment, range, fatigue, and spell availability. Copying transfers instructions; it does not make commanders interchangeable.

### 37.3 The script audit

For each important caster or specialist:

- 1 confirm the current unit, not merely its name;
- 2 confirm paths after items and modifiers;
- 3 confirm required gems are personal or otherwise accessible under the rule;
- 4 confirm the spell is researched and legal in the expected battle;
- 5 confirm the army will create the intended range and timing;
- 6 define acceptable fallback behaviour.

## 38. Items, Treasury, and Equipment

Clicking an empty item slot opens the treasury when the commander has laboratory access. Body form determines available slots. A mounted commander may have foot equipment disabled while mounted; barding belongs to the mount through the commander's mounted equipment relationship.

Some units have standard equipment that returns when a magical replacement is removed. This can make an inventory look as if an item appeared from nowhere. Inspect the unit's normal equipment before treating the result as duplication.

### 38.1 Treasury controls

- F7 opens the Magic Item Treasury.
- F8 opens the national Magic Item Overview.
- Ctrl+A sorts the treasury in current versions.
- Right-click items to inspect exact abilities and restrictions.
- Verify laboratory access before assuming an item can be equipped or returned.

Use the overview to locate a missing artifact before recreating it. An item on a remote or hidden commander is still part of national inventory but may not be transferable this month.

## 39. Gems and Gem Squirring

Any commander can carry up to forty gems. This permits non-mage commanders to transport gems as squires, even though they may not be able to spend them as a mage would.

Gem logistics has three distinct questions:

- 1 Does the nation possess the gems?
- 2 Can this commander access or carry them now?
- 3 Can the intended caster legally spend them for the order or battle?

The transfer interface and fast shortcuts answer the second question only. [Book V](#) owns [gem spending](#) and [magical logistics](#).

### 39.1 Safe gem procedure

- 1 Open the relevant laboratory or transfer context.
- 2 Move the exact battle or ritual allocation.
- 3 Add a reserve only if the script and AI are permitted to spend it.
- 4 Check the commander's personal gem display.
- 5 Re-check after changing items, scripts, or movement.
- 6 Use the national overview or treasury controls to catch stranded stock.

Fast keys save time, but they can also create off-by-one errors. The final displayed count is authoritative.

## 40. Mounted Units and Reclaiming Mounts

Mounted units can lose or change their mounted state through battle and end-of-turn systems. Where the unit supports it, Reclaim Mount allows the rider to recover the appropriate mount relationship. Current versions also include end-of-turn handling for mounts.

Do not assume that a rider and mount remain a single unchanging card. Check movement, equipment slots, size, protection, and battlefield function after a mount loss or recovery. The combat consequences belong to [Book IV's mount chapter](#).

## Part VII: Strategic Order Reference

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### 41. Orders Are Requests with Preconditions

An order is checked when entered, but some preconditions can change before hosting reaches it. A legal movement arrow may remain visible even if an item that enabled the movement is removed. A ritual can fail because the caster, gems, laboratory, target, or path state changed. An army can reach a destination without the troops that were left in the garrison.

Every important order needs two checks:

- entry legality: the interface accepted it now;
- resolution viability: the required commander, route, army, item, gem, building, and target are expected to exist when the engine reaches it.

### 42. Ordinary Movement

A movement arrow connects origin and destination. It is not a promise that the commander will follow a particular visible route. Entering an enemy province generally creates combat; entering a friendly province containing a fort normally places the force inside that fort.

Friendly movement and hostile movement have different resolution relationships. Opposing forces can meet on either side or pass into one another's provinces depending on orders and the hosting sequence. Use [Book I](#) for exact timing and [Book VI](#) for interception doctrine.

#### 42.1 Movement audit

- movement mode is correct;
- commander and all squads can make the move;
- no item or shape change is providing a fragile movement entitlement;
- destination ownership is interpreted correctly;
- entering a friendly fort is intended;
- retreat and supply consequences are understood.

### 43. Sneak, Hide, and Attack Current Province

Sneak is the default movement mode for an eligible stealthy commander whose entire army can move stealthily. Holding Ctrl while selecting the destination can request normal movement instead. Removing the last non-stealth unit does not necessarily restore a previously changed defensive order to Sneak; inspect the displayed order.

Hide is the stationary default for a stealthy force in suitable circumstances. Hidden forces do not join an ordinary battle merely because friendly conventional troops fight there. If discovered, they can fight a separate detection battle.

Attack Current Province lets a hidden force in an enemy province emerge and attack without moving to another province. It can join friendly attackers arriving there. The distinction among Sneak, Hide, and Attack Current Province is operationally decisive:

| Intent                            | Correct family          |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Move unseen to another province   | Sneak                   |
| Remain concealed here             | Hide                    |
| Reveal and fight in this province | Attack Current Province |

## 44. Patrol and Move-and-Patrol

Patrol searches for hidden enemies and reduces unrest according to the patrolling force. A patroller outside a fort participates in exterior combat. Where there is no unrest, ordinary patrolling does not damage population merely for being performed.

Move and Patrol is assigned after entering movement into a friendly fort province. It can also be requested with the supported Shift+Ctrl destination shortcut. The force arrives outside the fort and is available to fight there; it becomes an ordinary Patrol order in the following month. It does not provide the same-turn stealth-search result that a stationary patrol would.

Use Move and Patrol when relief must arrive on the exterior rather than disappear inside a friendly fort. Verify the displayed compound order before leaving the province.

## 45. Defend

Defend means remain and fight without patrolling. In a friendly fort it generally concedes the exterior and places the force inside. A stealthy commander on Defend fights openly rather than remaining hidden.

This is one of the most common interface traps: "do nothing" is not a single order. Defend, Hide, Patrol, Research, and the relevant siege order have different participation in battle and control of the fort exterior.

## 46. Siege Orders

### 46.1 Maintain Siege

Only forces assigned to Maintain Siege contribute to breaking the walls. An army in the province performing another order should not be counted in the siege calculation.

### 46.2 Storm Castle

Storm Castle becomes available after fortification defence has been reduced to zero, and the assault occurs in the following hosted month. A relief battle or another exterior event can intervene before the storm. A zero-wall message gives permission to prepare an assault; it does not mean the fort has already fallen.

### 46.3 Break Siege

The besieged force uses Break Siege to sortie. Retreating survivors may return inside or escape to a legal adjacent friendly province according to the rules. If both sides try to force the decisive siege action at once, the relevant contest can determine which proceeds.

Book II owns [siege calculation](#); Book IV owns the assault battle; Book VI owns the campaign clock.

### 46.4 Teleport movement from a siege

Since 6.35, commanders using teleport movement can move out of a besieged fort. Do not generalize this to ordinary strategic movement or to every ritual movement effect. Confirm the actual movement mode and current version.

## 47. Construction and Demolition Orders

The ordinary construction relationships are:

- a fort can be started by a commander allowed to construct it;
- a temple requires an eligible sacred commander;
- a laboratory requires an eligible mage.

Costs, nation modifiers, terrain, and completion timing belong to [Book II](#) and [Book I](#).

Demolish takes one month for an eligible building. A temple cannot simply be voluntarily demolished under the ordinary rule; an enemy temple is destroyed when the province is captured. A fort cannot be demolished while it is under siege. Because demolition removes national infrastructure and can change access, it deserves the same audit as a movement order.

## 48. Religious and Divine Orders

### 48.1 Preach

An eligible priest can preach to strengthen friendly dominion, subject to Holy level and local limits. [Book III](#) owns the formula and strategic religious system.

### 48.2 Blood Sacrifice

An eligible national unit at a temple can sacrifice blood slaves where the nation permits it. Possessing slaves, priesthood, and a temple separately does not imply the order exists; the nation or unit must have the relevant ability.

### 48.3 Become Prophet

A nation can normally have one prophet. An eligible commander becomes a priest one level higher than before, or Holy 3 if that is higher, and gains prophet-related dominion effects. After a prophet dies, a six-turn interval applies before another can be appointed under the ordinary rule.

The order is both a religious investment and an opportunity cost for that commander during the appointment month. [Book III](#) owns the full consequences.

## 49. Research, Search, Forge, and Cast Ritual

These magic orders share a dependency pattern:

| Order       | Essential checks                                                                                                                |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Research    | Mage can research; school allocation still serves the target; local events have not removed the mage.                           |
| Search      | Correct province and search mode; caster paths are relevant; movement and stealth expectations are not confused with the order. |
| Forge       | Laboratory, path, research, gems, item availability, and artifact race.                                                         |
| Cast Ritual | Laboratory or specific exception, path, research, gems, target legality, range, and hosting timing.                             |

Ritual caster order is not a safe basis for precise informal sequencing. If two rituals depend on one another in the same month, verify the documented hosting relationship or separate them across months. [Book I](#) owns resolution order; [Book V](#) owns magical legality.

## 50. Pillage and Raid

Pillage converts local destruction into immediate gain. It raises unrest, kills population, damages supply conditions, and can produce gold and temporary provisions. Large, fast, frightening, barbarian, or otherwise suitable troops can be effective pillagers. The economic arithmetic belongs to [Book II](#).

Raid is movement combined with pillaging under a commander with the Pillager ability and sufficient strategic army movement, ordinarily at least 20. Only units with the Pillager ability contribute to the pillaging component, and at half their ordinary pillage value. The force must win the province fight before the pillage occurs.

The order distinction is:

- Pillage destroys the province currently occupied.
- Raid attempts to move, win, and then damage the destination.

Both should be evaluated as campaign acts. Damage to a province that must soon be governed can cost more than the gold obtained.

## 51. Blood Hunt

An eligible blood hunter searches the province for blood slaves. The order risks unrest, population loss through subsequent enforcement conditions, and opportunity cost. High population and controlled unrest are operational considerations; exact hunting probability and economic doctrine belong to [Book II](#).

Before assigning the order, confirm that patrol capacity, laboratory access for collection where needed, and a plan for transporting or spending slaves exist. Blood hunting without administration can immobilize the province that funds it.

## 52. Reanimate, Manikin, Contact Allies, and Capture Slaves

These are nation- or unit-specific orders rather than universal controls.



- Reanimate produces a permitted undead type. Ghouls consume population, Soulless draw on corpses, and Longdead can be raised without those two local stocks under the ordinary distinctions. Available forms depend on the reanimator.
- Manikin is associated with Asphodel's nature-death system and can depend on human population, corpses, and hostile dominion.
- Contact Allies occupies the commander for the month while gathering the defined allied troops.
- Capture Slaves is available to specific national actors, including ordinary manual examples in Mictlan and Nazca, and produces a small random group under the documented order.

The interface presence of one variant should never be generalized to every unit with similar lore. Right-click the actor and treat the exact ruleset as authoritative.

## 53. Espionage Orders

### 53.1 Instill Uprising

A Spy can increase unrest in an enemy province. This is an economic and administrative attack rather than a direct attempt to capture the province.

### 53.2 Infiltrate

Infiltration is performed in an enemy capital by a Spy. It can reveal mundane scoregraph information, with additional categories available when the infiltrator is a spellcaster or priest. The attempt can fail and expose the infiltrator; the official manual describes the ordinary success chance as roughly even before relevant conditions.

The order should be judged against the intelligence actually needed. Risking an established scout network to learn a graph already inferable from the map may be poor value.

## 54. Assassination and Abduction Orders

### 54.1 Assassinate

An assassin selects a random eligible enemy commander in the province. Bodyguards can accompany the victim when their individual checks succeed; the ordinary base is one chance in two per bodyguard before relevant modifiers. The victim is caught unprepared and does not follow an ordinary prepared battle script.

Assassination battlefields can include local features or bystanders. Fort walls block ordinary attempts into or out of a siege unless the actor has a relevant bypass such as Scale Walls, flight, or teleportation.

### 54.2 Seduction

Seduction targets an eligible commander of the opposite sex and tests morale. A successful target may escape toward a friendly adjacent province or, for some flying movement, toward the capital. Beauty improves the attempt. Failure can lead to an assassination battle.

### 54.3 Dream Seduction

Dream Seduction first confronts Magic Resistance and then morale. Penetration and Beauty can matter to the respective checks. Failure can create the special confrontation defined by the ability.

## 54.4 Corruption

Corruption resembles seduction in strategic purpose but Beauty does not improve it. Its exact actor and target restrictions remain ability-specific.

## 54.5 Lure of the Sirens

This coastal order tests resistance and morale without using Beauty. A successful victim can drown or face an underwater battle; failure does not create the same assassination response as ordinary seduction. Penetration can improve the magical component.

All five orders are asymmetric operations. The target pool, fort state, bodyguards, escape geography, actor survival, and information gained should be considered before the order is entered.

## 55. Strategic Order Quick Reference

| Intended act                    | Order                     | Principal operational trap                                                          |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Move openly                     | Move                      | Arrow survives a lost movement prerequisite or enters a friendly fort unexpectedly. |
| Move covertly                   | Sneak                     | A non-stealth unit prevents the army from sneaking.                                 |
| Remain covert                   | Hide                      | Hidden force does not join an ordinary friendly battle.                             |
| Emerge here                     | Attack Current Province   | Confused with movement to a neighbouring province.                                  |
| Defend openly                   | Defend                    | Force inside a fort concedes the exterior.                                          |
| Find hidden units/reduce unrest | Patrol                    | Not the same as Move and Patrol or Defend.                                          |
| Arrive outside a friendly fort  | Move and Patrol           | Does not conduct a same-month stealth search on arrival.                            |
| Break walls                     | Maintain Siege            | Other orders do not contribute siege strength.                                      |
| Assault zero walls              | Storm Castle              | Relief and exterior battles can occur first.                                        |
| Sortie                          | Break Siege               | Retreat and concurrent siege action require careful interpretation.                 |
| Build                           | Construct Fort/Temple/Lab | Actor eligibility, cost, terrain, and timing differ.                                |
| Remove infrastructure           | Demolish                  | Temples and besieged forts have special restrictions.                               |
| Produce research                | Research                  | Mage-turn opportunity cost is easy to overlook.                                     |
| Strategic magic                 | Cast Ritual               | Lab, path, gems, range, target, and timing all bind.                                |
| Produce an item                 | Forge                     | Artifact competition and remote treasury access matter.                             |
| Find sites                      | Search                    | Search mode and paths may not match the province.                                   |
| Strengthen dominion             | Preach                    | Holy level and local dominion conditions govern effect.                             |
| Appoint religious leader        | Become Prophet            | One-prophet limit and six-turn replacement interval.                                |
| Extract blood slaves            | Blood Hunt                | Unrest and administrative support can bind.                                         |
| Damage current province         | Pillage                   | Permanent economic damage may exceed immediate return.                              |

| Intended act                 | Order                            | Principal operational trap                                            |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Move and damage              | Raid                             | Requires Pillager commander, movement, qualifying units, and victory. |
| Raise special troops         | Reanimate/Manikin/Contact Allies | Output and local inputs are unit-specific.                            |
| Attack administration        | Instill Uprising/Infiltrate      | Exposure risk and target value.                                       |
| Remove or convert commanders | Assassin/Seduction family        | Target pool, bodyguards, walls, escape, and actor survival.           |

## Part VIII: A Guided First Campaign

### 56. The Learning Campaign

The first campaign should expose the whole game without hiding mistakes behind excessive advantages. A useful environment is:

- a small or medium land map with enough space for several expansion routes;
- a nation with understandable conventional troops and mages;
- ordinary or slightly forgiving independent strength;
- standard research and broadly standard economy;
- a clear Throne victory condition;
- few or no overhaul mods during the first pass;
- several AI opponents, followed by a second game against people.

The purpose is not to guarantee victory. It is to make every failure legible.

### 57. Before Turn One

Complete five preparations.

#### 57.1 State the national idea

Write one paragraph covering:

- how the nation expands;
- what the capital produces every month;
- what the first non-capital fort contributes;
- the first two research objectives;
- how the Pretender supports the opening;
- what threatens the plan.

If the paragraph cannot be written, return to Books II, III, V, and VI. A list of strong units is not a national idea.

#### 57.2 Test the expansion party

Use a disposable game to test the intended commander, troop count, formation, and orders against several independent types. Record losses rather than remembering only victories. [Book VI](#) owns expansion testing.

### 57.3 Save the Pretender

Save the actual design with Ctrl+S and label it with nation, age, ruleset, and purpose. A changed blessing, scale, or awakening state makes it a new design.

### 57.4 Prepare a simple turn record

Keep:

- province targets;
- recruitment plan;
- research target and expected arrival;
- fort and laboratory schedule;
- important gem and item commitments;
- contacts, borders, and treaty terms.

### 57.5 Learn the five screens

Before playing, open and close Army Setup, Recruitment, Nation Overview, Research, and Messages. The goal is familiarity, not optimization.

## 58. Turn One

Turn one is an allocation problem.

- 1 Read the starting messages and inspect the capital, commanders, troops, scales, sites, treasury, and neighbours.
- 2 Recruit the commander or mage required by the national plan.
- 3 Queue the tested expansion troops within the actual gold, resource, and Recruitment Point limits.
- 4 Set the first research target.
- 5 Organize the starting army. Confirm leadership, squad orders, formation, and commander script.
- 6 Decide whether the Pretender acts, researches, forges, searches, preaches, or remains unavailable according to awakening.
- 7 Inspect every adjacent province before choosing expansion direction.
- 8 Run the four-pass audit and end the turn.

The first turn should create a repeatable monthly process. Spending all gold can be correct; spending it without knowing which local constraint limited the queue is not.

## 59. Turns Two to Four: Establish the Expansion Cycle

The opening cycle is:

recruit -> assemble -> capture -> reinforce -> launch the next party

During these turns:

- review every expansion battle rather than accepting the flag change;
- separate recoverable attrition from a failed party design;
- keep capital commander production aligned with troop output;
- identify the first fort location from income, resources, recruitment purpose, geometry, and safety;
- start scouting beyond the immediate expansion ring;
- watch supply and movement compatibility;
- preserve enough gold to avoid delaying the first key infrastructure decision by accident.

## 59.1 When an expansion battle fails

Diagnose in order:

- 1 Was the province scouted accurately?
- 2 Did the intended troops and commander arrive?
- 3 Did formation and orders match the tested version?
- 4 Was the independent type a known bad matchup?
- 5 Was the loss statistical variation or a structural weakness?
- 6 Can the survivors retreat, regroup, or defend?
- 7 Does the recruitment cycle need revision?

Do not answer a formation failure by buying more of the same formation without review.

## 60. Turns Five to Eight: Build the Second Centre

By this stage, the nation should be converting expansion into administration.

### 60.1 First fort purpose

Choose the fort for a declared function:

- recruit a valuable non-capital mage or troop;
- collect regional resources;
- shorten reinforcement routes;
- secure a chokepoint or rich cluster;
- establish a laboratory and research centre;
- support a future border.

The fort is not finished strategy. It still needs the right laboratory, temple where required, commander recruitment, roads of movement, and defensible surroundings.

### 60.2 Research checkpoint

At the end of this interval, compare expected and actual research. A shortfall can result from:

- too few recruited mages;
- mages diverted to expansion or infrastructure;
- unexpected deaths;
- Drain or other ruleset consequences;
- the chosen fort not yet producing researchers;
- research points assigned across too many schools.

[Book V](#) owns the solution tree. [Book X](#)'s contribution is to make the discrepancy visible early.

### 60.3 First magical package

Prepare one package that can actually be delivered: a small battlefield script, a site-search route, a useful item chain, or a ritual with a clear strategic purpose. Confirm research, path, gems, laboratory, caster turn, and destination.

## 61. Turns Nine to Twelve: Form the National Shape

The nation should now have:

- a capital role that is not constantly improvised;
- at least one expansion or security formation that can be reproduced;
- a second recruitment or research centre under construction or active;
- scouts watching likely borders;
- a research threshold with a force attached to it;
- a reserve plan for an unexpected neighbour.

This is also the moment to inspect inefficiency. Use F1 to find idle commanders, stalled queues, excessive garrisons, researchers carrying unused items, and provinces whose unrest or infrastructure does not match their purpose.

## 62. First Contact

On meeting another player, separate facts from stories.

Facts include visible provinces, army icons, dominion, fort locations, scouts lost, public graphs, and direct messages. Stories include guessed research, supposed weakness, claimed enemies, and implied peaceful intent.

A useful first-contact record states:

- exact border proposal by province number or unmistakable landmark;
- whether movement, scouting, preaching, raiding, and remote magic are addressed;
- duration and cancellation terms of any non-aggression pact;
- communication channel and timing convention;
- unresolved provinces or Thrones.

[Book VI](#) owns diplomacy and intelligence. The operational standard is that the agreement can be read later without reconstructing tone.

## 63. Preparing the First War

Do not begin with "attack the neighbour." Define:

- 1 the political purpose;
- 2 the first-turn objectives;
- 3 the enemy response most likely to break the plan;
- 4 the research and magic package available on the attack turn;
- 5 the routes for main force, raiders, scouts, and reinforcements;
- 6 the siege force and assault plan;
- 7 the point at which the war is no longer worth its cost.

Then translate the plan into interface commitments:

- commanders selected correctly;
- squads transferred and led;
- movement arrows checked;
- stealth forces using the intended mode;
- gems and items delivered;
- scripts legal;
- recruitment continuing behind the front;
- diplomacy sent before the deadline;
- turn submitted and confirmed.

The last list is deliberately mundane. Wars are lost by mundane omissions.

## 64. The First Siege

When a hostile fort is reached:

- 1 confirm which units are assigned to Maintain Siege;
- 2 estimate wall-breaking strength using [Book II](#);
- 3 screen the exterior against relief and raiding;
- 4 preserve supply and reinforcement routes;
- 5 prepare the storming formation before the walls fall;
- 6 monitor enemy movement, magic, and possible break-siege force;
- 7 when defence reaches zero, assign Storm Castle and re-check for relief sequencing;
- 8 after capture, decide immediately whether the fort is a front, a recruitment centre, a trap, or a demolition candidate.

A siege is not a pause between real battles. It is an administrative contest conducted under threat.

## 65. Entering the Midgame

The learning campaign has reached the midgame when decisions are governed by interacting systems rather than a single expansion loop. Typical signs are:

- several forts and laboratories compete for gold;
- research opens multiple viable packages;
- gems must be allocated among battle, ritual, forging, and reserve;
- more than one border can become active;
- diplomacy changes which military move is safe;
- Thrones become practical objectives;
- specialist commanders require items, gems, and transport.

At this point, use the [Reader's Guide](#) by live problem. The foundation has succeeded when the next question can be located precisely.

## 66. Ending the First Game Well

Play through the endgame if possible. Dominions changes when armies become magically dense, globals alter the world, Thrones can be claimed in combinations, and research approaches its final tiers. A player who restarts every imperfect opening never learns conversion.

After victory or defeat, review:

- revealed scoregraphs and map;
- first divergence between plan and result;
- recruitment and research bottlenecks;
- battles whose replay contradicted expectations;
- wasted gems, items, forts, or commander turns;
- diplomatic predictions that proved wrong;
- the final opportunity to contest or secure victory.

Write three changes for the next game. More than three often turns evidence into a wish list.

# Part IX: Troubleshooting by Symptom

## 67. Cannot Find or Join the Game

Check in this order:

- 1 exact game name and lobby/server;
- 2 network connection and lobby availability;
- 3 game status: pretender collection, running, hosting, or finished;
- 4 Dominions version;
- 5 required mod files and activation;
- 6 map availability where locally required;
- 7 player or game password;
- 8 whether the nation is already claimed or was set to AI;
- 9 host announcements or maintenance.

Preserve the error text. "It does not work" discards the best evidence.

## 68. Mod or Map Mismatch

Symptoms include refusal to load, missing graphics, different unit cards, checksum complaints, or impossible replay behaviour.

Repair procedure:

- 1 stop changing files;
- 2 obtain the host's exact file identity;
- 3 compare names, versions, sizes, and hashes where available;
- 4 remove only the incorrect campaign copy from active use without destroying the archive;
- 5 install the canonical file with its directory structure;
- 6 restart Dominions;
- 7 test in a disposable game if the error persists.

Do not download "the latest" unless the latest is the frozen campaign version.

## 69. A Commander Will Not Move

Inspect:

- commander is selected and has not been given another order;
- destination is a legal neighbour or special-movement target;
- strategic movement allowance and terrain costs;
- all assigned troops and mounts can accompany the commander;
- stealth mode and non-stealth units;
- immobility, shape, item, disease, or other status;
- siege restrictions and the exact movement method;
- plane and map layer;
- whether the visible arrow depends on an item already removed.

If the interface accepted an arrow but hosting did not move the force, compare entry legality with resolution viability.



## 70. A Force Entered a Fort or Missed the Exterior Battle

Ordinary movement into a friendly fort commonly enters it. To arrive outside for immediate exterior duty, use Move and Patrol where legal. A force on Defend inside the fort concedes the exterior. A hidden force does not automatically join conventional allies.

Diagnose by displayed order, fort ownership, stealth state, and hosting phase-not by where the arrow seemed to end.

## 71. An Order Disappeared or Changed

Common causes include:

- another order was entered afterward;
- army composition changed the legality of Sneak or movement;
- the commander changed shape, mount, item, or path state;
- a copied order was not legal for the recipient;
- the commander became besieged or changed sides;
- the order completed and returned to a default state;
- a stale preserved or replaced behaviour differently than expected.

Use F1, inspect the commander, and reconstruct the last legal state. Do not infer an engine bug before checking the dependency that disappeared.

## 72. Recruitment Is Dimmed or Stalled

Check gold first, then local resources, Recruitment Points, Commander Points, Holy Points, recruitment limits, fort/site/terrain prerequisites, and whether the unit is capital-only. Inspect the queue order: an expensive earlier unit can consume capacity needed by later entries.

If the province has changed ownership or become besieged, re-evaluate where recruits appear and whether the national roster remains available.

## 73. Troops Did Not Move with the Commander

Open Army Setup and confirm that the units were in that commander's squads rather than in the unassigned garrison or under another commander. Then check leadership type, leadership capacity, movement compatibility, and whether the commander survived an earlier hosting event.

An army icon in the same province does not prove command attachment.

## 74. An Item or Gem Cannot Be Used

Check:

- laboratory access for treasury transfers;
- body slots and mounted slot restrictions;
- item ownership and unique status;
- path and research requirements;
- commander's personal gem allocation;
- maximum carried gems;
- whether the resource is national stock, local treasury access, or personal inventory;
- whether the relevant order permits that gem or item effect.

Use F8 to find items nationally. For gems, inspect both national totals and the actual commander.

## 75. A Ritual or Forge Order Is Unavailable

Confirm laboratory, research school and level, path after current items and shapes, gem stock, target range and type, ritual or item restrictions, artifact availability, and current ruleset. A commander who moved, was sieged, or lost laboratory access may no longer meet the order's conditions.

If several rituals were intended to enable one another in one month, revisit [Book I's hosting sequence](#).

## 76. A Siege Is Not Progressing

Check that the relevant force is on Maintain Siege, not Defend, Patrol, Research, Pillage, or another order. Compare siege strength with fortification repair and defender strength. Confirm whether a battle, movement, relief, or supply problem removed key siegers.

Zero wall defence does not capture the fort. Storming is a separate order for the next resolution.

## 77. Scoregraphs Are Missing or Incomplete

The game may have hidden graphs. Intelligence may reveal only some categories. A Spy in an enemy capital can infiltrate, while spellcaster or priest qualities can broaden obtainable information. Confirm the game setting and current intelligence before treating an empty graph as a display fault.

## 78. A Turn Staled

Preserve the submission status, deadline, host messages, and any connection error. Notify the host without editing files. The response depends on the published policy: continuation, extension before hosting, substitution, or a rare rollback for verified technical failure.

Afterward, reduce recurrence:

- submit an early complete version;
- confirm receipt;
- request extensions earlier;
- avoid making the only final submission in the last minutes;
- maintain a backup connection method if the campaign warrants it.

## 79. A Battle Replay Looks Impossible

Compare host and client versions, mod identity, and whether the replay is being viewed under the ruleset that generated it. Inspect messages and final unit state. Visual playback can diverge from the hosted result when versions differ. Preserve the turn and replay evidence before updating or replacing files.

## 80. Performance or Large-Turn Problems

Current versions have improved handling of larger network turns, but late games can still be demanding. Close unnecessary applications, preserve disk space, avoid repeatedly interrupting transfers, and allow the client to finish processing. If a file appears corrupt, retain it and compare with a fresh host download rather than overwriting the only copy.

Performance diagnosis should separate:

- slow local interface;
- slow battle replay;
- network transfer delay;
- lobby or server availability;
- hosting computation;
- a genuinely damaged file.

## 81. Recovery Principle

Use the least destructive repair:

observe -> record -> compare baseline -> copy/backup -> test separately -> replace only the confirmed faulty component

Random reinstallations, live mod edits, and broad deletion destroy evidence. Recovery should make the campaign more reproducible, not only make the current error disappear.

# Part X: Hosting as a Competitive Institution

## 82. The Host Is Custodian, Not Author of Outcomes

The host establishes procedure, keeps the service available, applies announced rules consistently, and preserves recoverability. The host should not use privileged knowledge or flexible administration to shape the strategic result.

A host decision is strongest when it can be explained as:

- 1 the published rule;
- 2 the observed event;
- 3 the evidence preserved;
- 4 the same remedy that would apply to any player.

## 83. Hosting Runbook

### 83.1 Before launch

- freeze version, map, and mods;
- publish settings and victory conditions;
- test lobby/server and content distribution;
- collect pretenders with passwords;

- verify roster and teams;
- publish timer, extension, stale, substitution, and rollback policy;
- establish a backup host or continuity plan.

### 83.2 During the campaign

- announce deadline changes with an exact date, time, and timezone;
- check that hosting completed and clients can receive the new turn;
- preserve periodic backups appropriate to the hosting system;
- record stales, substitutions, rollbacks, and version incidents;
- avoid inspecting privileged player information except when technically required and allowed;
- resolve disputes from the charter and evidence.

### 83.3 At campaign end

- preserve final state long enough for review;
- publish result and any shared post-game materials;
- permit scoregraph and map analysis;
- record ruleset and notable administrative incidents;
- archive or remove credentials securely.

## 84. Tournament and Expert Records

Serious competitive play benefits from a more exact record:

- file hashes for map and mods;
- host executable and operating environment;
- creation settings captured in text or screenshots;
- player/nation/team roster;
- every hosting timestamp;
- stales, extensions, substitutions, and connection incidents;
- mod or patch deviation, even if accidental;
- final victory state.

This is not bureaucracy for its own sake. It permits later rulings and analysis without relying on the memory of interested parties.

## 85. Dispute Handling

When a dispute occurs:

- 1 pause any irreversible administrative action if the schedule permits;
- 2 identify the exact claim;
- 3 preserve messages, timestamps, versions, files, and settings;
- 4 consult the charter and official rule source;
- 5 distinguish interface misunderstanding, engine behaviour, technical failure, and conduct;
- 6 apply the narrowest consistent remedy;
- 7 record the decision.

Not every bug justifies a rollback. Not every surprising result is a bug. Not every policy omission can be repaired fairly after hidden information has changed hands.

# Part XI: Operational Checklists

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## 86. New Installation

- Launch the game and confirm version.
- Open the user data directory from Game Tools.
- Install required maps and mods with directory structure intact.
- Enable the exact stack.
- Test a disposable world.
- Save a labelled Pretender design.
- Learn Messages, Recruitment, Army Setup, Nation Overview, and Research.

## 87. Create World

- Confirm map and player count.
- Choose age.
- Add every participant and set human/AI status.
- Verify disciple teams if used.
- Record all non-default settings.
- Record scoregraph, security, artifact, and legendary-research rules.
- Set and verify victory conditions and Cataclysm.
- Protect Pretenders and administrative access.
- Publish hosting policy before launch.

## 88. Join a Lobby Game

- Match Dominions version.
- Match map and mod files.
- Enter Network, then the official lobby.
- Select the exact game.
- Confirm nation and status.
- Use the game password securely.
- Inspect the current turn before entering orders.
- Confirm submission after End Turn.

## 89. Build an Army

- Choose role and campaign purpose.
- Recruit within all local constraints.
- Provide suitable leadership.
- Transfer troops from the garrison.
- Divide no more than five squads per commander.
- Position squads and commanders.
- Assign squad orders and scripts.
- Equip items and gems.
- Confirm movement and supply compatibility.
- Re-open the screen after major transfers.

## 90. Issue a Special Order

- Confirm actor has the ability.
- Confirm province and target.
- Confirm building, terrain, path, gem, population, corpse, or other input.
- Check siege and fort-wall restrictions.
- Check hosting timing and opportunity cost.
- Enter the order.
- Inspect the displayed result.
- Re-check after changing movement, army, items, or infrastructure.

## 91. Submit a Turn

- Read all new messages.
- Review battles and changed provinces.
- State monthly priorities.
- Enter fragile dependent orders first.
- Audit commanders, armies, state, and campaign.
- Submit before the deadline margin disappears.
- Confirm receipt.
- If revising, resubmit and confirm again.

## 92. Host a Campaign

- Freeze and publish ruleset.
- Test creation and connection.
- Publish timer and policies.
- Protect passwords and host state.
- Announce exact deadline changes.
- Back up without creating unapproved alternate histories.
- Apply rules symmetrically.
- Preserve incident evidence.
- Arrange substitution or AI conversion according to policy.
- Archive the final game for review.

# Part XII: Essays

## Essay I: Interface Literacy Is Strategic Power

The interface is often treated as a transparent layer between a player and the "real" game. In Dominions it is closer to a language. Province filters determine which relationships become visible. Army Setup determines whether a force exists as an army or as unrelated bodies in one province. A movement arrow records an intention but carries hidden dependence on leadership, terrain, items, stealth, siege state, and hosting order. The Nation Overview converts a sprawling realm into an administrative object that can actually be governed.

This creates a form of power that is easy to undervalue because it does not appear on a unit card: the ability to ask the game the right question quickly. Where are the idle mages? Which forts are producing commanders? Which province changed income? Which movement depends on one item?

Which caster holds the gems? Which squad was left unassigned? Each answer recovers a little national capacity.

For a new player, interface literacy reduces cognitive load. Shortcuts and filters stop ten provinces from feeling like ten separate games. For an expert, the same literacy increases strategic bandwidth. Less time spent finding information means more time comparing lines, testing assumptions, communicating, and auditing adversarial possibilities.

There is no need to memorise every key. What matters is building reliable routes through the interface. Messages begin the month. F1 surveys the nation. Map filters expose one strategic concern at a time. Army Setup proves attachment and command. F7 and F8 prove equipment location. The final audit proves commitment. Once those routes become habitual, the game's complexity becomes searchable instead of overwhelming.

## Essay II: Administrative Failure Is Still Strategic Failure

Dominions rewards elaborate plans, which makes clerical errors feel somehow beneath strategy. They are not. If a commander moved without the intended squad, the nation did not possess that army at the decisive place. If a caster lacked one gem, the spell package did not exist. If a turn was not received, the plan was absent from the shared game. The reason may be administrative, but the strategic world contains only the result.

This does not mean every mistake deserves punishment without context. Technical services fail, emergencies happen, and hosts need humane policies. It means that personal preparation should treat operational reliability as part of force design. A formation includes its transfer procedure. A ritual includes laboratory access and target selection. A timing attack includes submission before the timer. A long campaign includes passwords, backups, and substitution rules.

The best control is a short, repeatable audit, not constant anxiety: important commanders, armies, state, campaign, receipt. It turns a vague fear of forgetting something into a bounded procedure. It also improves analysis after failure. When the submitted orders are known, tactical and strategic theories can be tested against evidence instead of reconstructed from regret.

## Essay III: The Host as Custodian

The host occupies an unusual position. The role is technically powerful but should be strategically neutral. A host determines deadlines, operates the game state, holds recovery tools, and may be able to access information unavailable to ordinary players. The campaign remains legitimate only when that power is exercised as custody rather than ownership.

Custody begins before turn one. Rules are published while no one knows whom they will favour. Extension and rollback standards exist before a leading army is at risk. A backup host is chosen before absence becomes leverage. Version and mod records are frozen before an update offers convenient ambiguity.

During play, good administration is conspicuously exact: a deadline includes date, time, and timezone; an extension is visible to everyone; a stale is recorded; a substitute receives the same access process another substitute would receive; a rollback requires a narrow technical reason. The host does not need to eliminate judgment, which is impossible. The host needs to make judgment reviewable.

That standard protects the host as much as the players. Evidence replaces accusation. A charter replaces improvised favour. A campaign can survive mistakes because its continuity does not depend on one person's memory or goodwill.

## Part XIII: Authority, Version Notes, and Research Boundaries

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### 93. Sources Used

Book X is based primarily on:

- the official Dominions 6 Manual for creation, interface, multiplayer modes, recruitment, army setup, inventories, movement, and strategic orders;
- Illwinter's official Dominions 6 documentation index;
- Illwinter's official Steam announcements through Dominions 6.36 for current interface, lobby, network, mount, siege-movement, and post-game changes;
- the official modding and file-format manuals where local data structure is relevant;
- the verified foundation books in this library for mechanics whose canonical explanations already exist.

Official documentation:

- <https://www.illwinter.com/dom6/docs.html>
- <https://www.illwinter.com/dom6/dom6manual.pdf>
- <https://steamcommunity.com/app/2511500/announcements/>

### 94. Version-Sensitive Boundaries

Exact private-server command lines, unattended host options, and external PBEM automation are not frozen here. They depend on the current executable, platform, and hosting environment. The official manual itself refers some private-server and PBEM detail to earlier documentation. Copying old commands into a current operational encyclopaedia would create false certainty.

Keyboard shortcuts are context-sensitive and continue to evolve. Book X records verified high-value controls, but ? in the active screen and current official patch notes remain the authority for a specific release.

### 95. Evidence Labels for Operational Reports

When a result differs from Book X, record it as one of:

- confirmed interface fact: reproduced on the named version and screen;
- confirmed engine result: reproduced through hosting under a frozen ruleset;
- version divergence: host and client or guide and executable differ;
- mod divergence: a mod changes or replaces the ordinary control or order;
- unresolved report: evidence is incomplete or reproduction has not succeeded.

This protects the library from turning a single surprising turn into a universal rule.



## 96. Closing Principle

Dominions becomes manageable when intentions are converted into inspectable commitments. Freeze the ruleset. Read the new state. Use the interface as an analytical instrument. Enter orders with their dependencies. Audit the nation. Confirm submission. Preserve evidence when reality disagrees.

The process is not separate from mastery. It is the structure that allows mastery to survive contact with a live game.

# Foundation Book XI - Units, Abilities, Experience, and Conditions

## A Systematic Reference for Reading Every Unit

Baseline: Dominions 6.36; vanilla rules unless a ruleset is named; research edition 30 August 2026.  
Structured object examples remain pinned to the auditable 6.35 Inspector snapshot.

### 1. Purpose

A Dominions unit is not defined by its attack, defence, protection, and hit points alone. Its type determines who can command it, which spells can affect it, whether it consumes supplies, how it heals, what happens when leadership disappears, and sometimes whether it can cross a border at all. Its special abilities add another layer of exceptions. Experience changes the same body over time. Afflictions and other conditions may then change it again.

Book XI is where unit facts are looked up and interpreted. It should answer five questions quickly:

- 1 What kind of being is this?
- 2 What does this icon or named ability change?
- 3 Does the effect matter on the strategic map, in battle, or both?
- 4 What normally counters, suppresses, or invalidates it?
- 5 How certain is the explanation under the current version?

The official manual says that Dominions contains roughly five hundred special abilities and explains only a selection. The Modding Manual exposes a wider technical vocabulary, but a mod command is not always a complete player-facing specification. The unit window remains the final current description of a particular unit, while patch notes can supersede older manual language.

It combines three kinds of reference:

- interpretive chapters that explain families of abilities and the questions they raise;
- compact records for the most consequential classes, abilities, and conditions;
- an evidence boundary that keeps official statements, current corrections, derived implications, and community reverse engineering visibly separate.

Book IV remains the authority for combat arithmetic, battle order, morale resolution, fatigue, damage, affliction chance, and counter construction. Book XI explains what a label means and where its consequences appear. It links to Book IV when a full resolution procedure would otherwise be repeated.

### 2. Evidence Key and Version Discipline

| Code | Meaning in this volume                | Proper use                                                                       |
|------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| OM   | Official main manual, revision 2      | Stated rules, definitions, thresholds, and broad exceptions                      |
| MM   | Official Modding Manual, version 6.36 | Engine-facing ability names, parameters, categories, and technical relationships |

| Code | Meaning in this volume                      | Proper use                                                                                     |
|------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| OP   | Official patch announcement through 6.36    | Current changes that correct or supersede older behaviour                                      |
| UI   | Current in-game unit or ability description | The live description for a particular object; not independently captured for every record here |
| CT   | Community-tested or reverse-engineered      | Useful evidence that is not an official specification and may be version-sensitive             |
| D    | Derived                                     | A stated consequence derived from confirmed inputs                                             |
| TP   | Test pending                                | A disputed, hidden, or version-sensitive detail that still lacks reliable current confirmation |

An evidence label applies to the defined fact, not to every possible consequence. For example, the official manual defines Ethereal as causing three quarters of nonmagical strikes to miss. The recommendation to use inexpensive magical weapons against an ethereal raider is doctrine derived from that fact, not an additional official rule.

The public baseline is Dominions 6.36, released on 17 August 2026 UTC. The main manual is older than several current changes. Notable ability-facing corrections include exact percentage regeneration in 6.31; Spiritform protection from bleeding, frozen, and burning conditions in 6.30; Disease Resistance applying to disease spells in 6.27; restored script continuity for innate spellcasters after temporary unconsciousness in 6.35; and corrected swimming-mount river crossing, charm allegiance, and mounted recruitment state in 6.36. These corrections are integrated where relevant and retained in the version notes near the end.

The live Modding Manual now identifies itself as version 6.36. [Book XI](#) uses that current file for ability semantics. Book XIV's larger command-locator export remains tied to its declared 6.34 extraction until the whole token and page-locator set is rebuilt; that older extraction is not used to settle the perception rules below.

## Part I: How to Read an Ability

### 3. Begin with the Body, Not the Icon

The fastest reliable reading order is:

body and type -> leadership requirement -> movement environment -> defences and recovery -> offence and auras -> conditional modifiers -> experience and conditions

This order prevents a common failure. An impressive offensive ability can draw attention away from the fact that its unit cannot be led by the available commander, cannot enter the intended terrain, dissolves without leadership, or cannot recover from the damage expected along the route.

The body layer includes size, living or nonliving status, unit classes, shape, mount, and environments in which the unit can exist. The command layer determines whether the unit can join the proposed army at all. The recovery layer determines whether a favourable exchange can be repeated. Only then should an ability's immediate battle output dominate evaluation.

#### 3.1 A seven-question unit audit

For an unfamiliar unit, record:

| Question                            | What to inspect                                                               | Why it changes the decision                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What is it?                         | All type tags, body, shape, size, mount                                       | Targeting, leadership, healing, supplies, and immunity can follow from class.                    |
| Who can command it?                 | Normal, magic, and undead leadership; special squad limits                    | A legal recruitment or summon can still create an unusable army.                                 |
| Where can it go?                    | Water status, flight, floating, survival, sailing, teleport restrictions      | Strategic reach and retreat routes can matter more than raw statistics.                          |
| How does it stay functional?        | Regeneration family, recuperation, immortality, disease and age               | Recovery determines repeatable force, not merely survival in one battle.                         |
| What changes contact?               | Awe, fear, auras, shields, stealth, vision, trample, swallow                  | These effects alter who can engage and what happens before ordinary damage decides the exchange. |
| When are the numbers conditional?   | Seasonal, scale, dominion, darkness, storm, and shape modifiers               | A unit card seen in one province may not describe the intended battlefield.                      |
| What has changed since recruitment? | Experience, heroic abilities, afflictions, curse, horror mark, disease, items | Two units with the same name can have materially different current value.                        |

## 4. Tags, Values, and Descriptions

Some abilities are binary: a unit is Aquatic or it is not. Others carry a value. The meaning of that value is ability-specific. It may represent points, a percentage, an area, a bonus, capacity, range, number of creatures, or a threshold modifier. A value of 5 on Fear is not interpreted in the same way as 5 on Regeneration, Reinvigoration, Standard, or Sailing.

Three checks are mandatory:

- read the ability's own description rather than inferring a universal scale;
- distinguish a displayed total from an innate contribution or item contribution;
- verify whether the number is applied directly, converted by a formula, or used to choose a tier.

The Modding Manual is particularly useful for discovering whether an ability has a parameter, but its command value may be transformed before it reaches the unit card. Player-facing records should preserve the displayed meaning where verified and avoid pretending that every mod parameter is the final battle number.

## 5. Innate, Granted, Shape-Bound, and Contextual Effects

An ability may come from the unit's base form, a mount, an item, a bless, a spell, a heroic trait, a province, dominion, a season, or a temporary battle effect. These sources do not have identical lifetimes.

| Source    | Persistence question                                                    | Typical trap                                                            |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Base form | Does shapechanging replace the form?                                    | Assuming a tag survives every alternate shape.                          |
| Mount     | Does dismounting or mount death remove it?                              | Reading the combined card as one indivisible creature.                  |
| Item      | Is the effect active only while equipped, and is the item cursed?       | Treating an item-caused affliction as healable while its cause remains. |
| Bless     | Is the unit sacred and currently blessed; is the effect Incarnate?      | Pricing a sacred as if every battle begins blessed.                     |
| Spell     | What is the duration and can it be resisted, dispelled, or interrupted? | Confusing a scripted plan with a permanent statistic.                   |

| Source         | Persistence question                                                       | Typical trap                                                   |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Heroic ability | Is the commander still in the Hall of Fame, and how has the value grown?   | Treating a community-derived formula as an official guarantee. |
| Environment    | Which scale, season, dominion, terrain, light, storm, or plane is checked? | Testing in favourable conditions and deploying elsewhere.      |

Shape changes deserve special care. A unit name may remain familiar while weapons, armour, size, hit points, movement, leadership, magic, or type tags change. When a strategy depends on an ability, verify the form that will actually be present at the relevant hosting step and battle round.

## 6. Stacking, Precedence, and the Best-Only Rule

There is no single universal stacking law. Effects fall into several patterns:

- best only: the official manual states that only the best Standard in a squad applies;
- additive or cumulative: experience gains build across thresholds, and horror marks can deepen through repeated marking;
- source-limited: an item or form may supply the effect only while that source remains;
- mutually exclusive state: a unit cannot simultaneously be asleep and acting normally, or mounted and voluntarily dismounted in the same form;
- layered defence: multiple defences may apply at different resolution steps rather than adding into one value;
- unknown or object-specific: the interface or a controlled test is required.

When a stacking rule is not explicit, the safe record is not "stacks" or "does not stack." The safe record is "stacking unverified." This matters because many expensive designs fail not from weak ingredients but from buying the same non-stacking benefit twice.

### 6.1 Confirmed Current Cases

Source type does not determine stacking by itself. A form, item, bless, or spell supplies an effect, but the receiving effect's own rule decides whether values add, compete, replace one another, or resolve as separate layers.

| Effect or family                     | Current rule                                                                             | Evidence                                                                                | Planning consequence                                                                           |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Standard                             | Multiple standards in one squad do not stack; only the highest value counts              | MM 6.36, #standard                                                                      | A second lower Standard in the same squad adds no morale bonus                                 |
| Inspiring Researcher                 | Only the highest value in a province counts                                              | MM 6.36, #inspiringres                                                                  | Several copies improve coverage or redundancy, not the province bonus                          |
| Blur, Displacement, and Invisibility | Displacement does not stack with Blur or Invisibility                                    | UI description in the pinned 6.35 Inspector snapshot; no 6.36 patch changes this family | Do not budget for additive melee Attack penalties from these states                            |
| Experience thresholds                | Earned bonuses accumulate at the published star thresholds                               | OM plus the official 6.13 and 6.14 corrections                                          | Later stars retain earlier threshold gains                                                     |
| Horror Mark                          | Repeated marking can deepen the same condition                                           | OM                                                                                      | Treat severity as cumulative state, not duplicate independent icons                            |
| Different defence families           | Each defence keeps its own resolution step unless an explicit rule merges or replaces it | OM and D                                                                                | Protection, resistance, miss chance, morale gates, and recovery are not one additive statistic |

This closes the assumption that all same-named benefits stack merely because they come from different sources. It does not establish a global item-versus-bless-versus-spell precedence rule. Unlisted abilities remain ability-specific, and form or source loss still requires a separate lifetime check.

## 7. Counters Are Usually Gate Removal

An ability creates value by imposing a gate. Ethereal asks for magical attacks. Awe asks attackers to pass a morale check. Regeneration asks for enough damage, disablement, or attrition to overcome recovery. Flying asks for protection of vulnerable rear areas and attention to storm interaction. Stealth asks for patrol coverage and information discipline.

The cleanest counter normally removes the gate at an acceptable cost. It does not need to destroy the target in isolation. A counter record should identify:

- 1 the gate the ability imposes;
- 2 the cheapest broad class of answer;
- 3 the conditions that make that answer unreliable;
- 4 the operational cost of delivering it.

This is why [Book XI](#) does not assign a universal power score. An ability's value is the price of the question it asks in the position where it appears.

# Part II: Unit Classes and Status Tags

## 8. Classes Can Overlap

Dominions uses overlapping tags rather than one exclusive biological taxonomy. A being can be both Undead and Magic Being, Demon and Magic Being, Animal and Sacred, or Inanimate and Mindless. Each relevant tag can alter leadership, spell targeting, supplies, morale, healing, or special interactions.

The official manuals explicitly resolve one important overlap: a unit that is both Undead and Magic Being, or Demon and Magic Being, requires undead leadership rather than magic leadership. More generally, a tag should not be erased merely because another tag seems more descriptive. The correct question is what each tag contributes.

## 9. The Ordinary Living Baseline

An ordinary living unit without a special command tag can be led by normal leadership. It consumes supplies according to size, can suffer disease and ordinary afflictions, and can normally benefit from living regeneration and appropriate healing. This baseline is not itself an icon; it is the background against which exceptional types are read.

The absence of a tag is still information. A human soldier lacking Spiritform, Inanimate, Undead, Demon, Animal, Mindless, or Magic Being avoids the special command burdens and immunities attached to those tags. Ordinary does not mean weak. It often means logistically compatible.

## 10. Animal

Animals can be led by normal commanders. They use half as many supplies as a humanoid of the same size. The manual states that animals without arms contribute only half their normal value to siege and fort defence; monkeys are the named exception to the armless-animal reduction.

Animal is also a targeting class. Animal-affecting magic and Animal Awe can distinguish it from an ordinary soldier. Beast Mastery or Beast Master leadership can improve the practical command of animal-heavy forces, but the exact benefit belongs to the displayed leadership effect rather than to the Animal tag itself.

Operational reading:

- reduced supply use supports large formations and long routes;
- weak siege contribution can make a victorious animal army poor at converting a field win into a fort;
- animal-specific control and fear effects can create sharp counters;
- normal leadership makes integration easier than for undead or magical beings.

## 11. Magic Being

Magic Beings require magic leadership. Without suitable leadership they rout, and the manual describes leaderless magical beings as dissolving on the battlefield. The tag also makes them valid or invalid targets for effects that distinguish magical beings.

Magic leadership is not ordinary leadership with a different colour. A commander may have ample normal capacity and still be unable to command one magic being. Path-based indirect bonuses can grant magic leadership, especially through Earth and Blood, but the displayed value should be checked before assigning squads.

When a magic-being army is evaluated, include command redundancy. A force whose only magic leader can be assassinated, swallowed, routed, or killed may collapse even while most bodies remain intact.

## 12. Mindless

Mindless units have morale 50 and do not rout while a suitable commander controls them. Without that control they dissolve on the battlefield. They cannot share a squad with non-mindless units. The tag also produces numerous immunities or targeting exclusions because the unit has no ordinary mind.

Mindless does not mean independent. It means exceptionally stable under command and exceptionally fragile when command is lost. The army exchanges ordinary squad morale problems for a leadership problem.

Important consequences:

- mind-affecting effects often fail or treat them differently;
- the squad cannot be padded with ordinary troops;
- leader protection is part of the unit's effective defence;
- their morale value should not be read as a promise that the army survives army-wide rout or loss of control under every circumstance; [Book IV](#) owns battle-wide resolution.

## 13. Undead

Undead units require undead leadership and are subject to banishment. They are immune to disease and ordinary affliction-healing effects, and they rout if suitable leadership is absent. Mixing living and undead troops in the same squad causes a morale penalty according to the official manual.

Undead is both a logistical advantage and a recovery constraint. Many undead do not need to eat, but the exact supply property should still be read separately. Their immunity to ordinary disease prevents one attrition channel, while their inability to use ordinary healing makes battle damage and accumulated afflictions harder to repair. Corporeal undead can have special exceptions such as a Corpse Stitcher.

The class attracts dedicated counters: banishment, anti-undead weapons, and effects restricted to undead. The existence of a counter is not the same as its availability. An undead army can be oppressive when the opponent cannot deliver sufficient priests or specialised damage in the relevant theatre.

## 14. Demon

Demons require undead leadership, are subject to banishment, and are immune to disease. They are not undead under another name. Demon and Undead are distinct tags with different targeting lists, national interactions, and spell families, even though their command requirement overlaps.

Many demons also possess Need Not Eat, elemental resistances, fear, flight, dark power, or spirit sight, but none of those should be inferred from Demon alone. The correct record lists each separately.

## 15. Inanimate and Lifeless

The main manual describes Lifeless beings as immune to disease, ordinary regeneration, life drain, and ordinary affliction healing. The Modding Manual exposes Inanimate as the technical creature-status command used for bodies such as constructs. In player-facing analysis, the displayed class and its actual immunities should be recorded rather than assuming every stony or mechanical-looking body behaves identically.

Ordinary regeneration does not repair inanimate bodies. Reconstruction is the corresponding regeneration family for inanimate units. A powerful construct with no Reconstruction or specialised repair may survive a battle yet lose long-term value through unhealed afflictions.

Life-drain immunity has two sides: the target avoids the ordinary effect, but an attacker that relies on draining to recover receives no normal healing from the lifeless victim. This can reverse a matchup that appears favourable from weapon damage alone.

## 16. Spiritform

Spiritform beings are immune to transformation, disease, and ordinary affliction healing. Current 6.30 patch notes also state that Spiritform, like non-ethereal protection in that change, prevents bleeding, frozen, and burning conditions. Spiritform is not synonymous with Ethereal. A unit can possess one without the other, and each must be read independently.



Spiritform affects both target eligibility and recovery. It can shut down several condition-based plans while leaving magical damage, specialised spirit effects, or ordinary attrition available. Check the exact spell or weapon; "ghost" is not a complete rules category.

## 17. Plant, Stone Being, Illusion, Horror, and Divine Status

Several further tags primarily matter through targeting and exceptions.

### 17.1 Plant

Plant marks a plant-type being. It can change eligibility for plant-specific spells and effects. It does not by itself state every resistance, supply rule, or mind status; a vine creature may also be Mindless or Magic Being, but those are separate facts.

### 17.2 Stone Being

Stone Being identifies creatures that interact with stone-specific effects. It should not be used as a shorthand for Inanimate unless both are displayed or confirmed. Material appearance is not a reliable substitute for tags.

### 17.3 Illusion

Illusion marks an illusory being. The 6.36 Modding Manual defines it as a Spiritform-like technical class whose members can still be affected by illusion magic even when Mindless. The tag is distinct from Glamour, Invisibility, Unseen, and Ethereal. Glamour creates strategic concealment and a mirror-image defence; Illusion classifies the creature.

### 17.4 Horror

Lesser Horror, Greater Horror, and Doom Horror identify horror classes. They influence horror-related targeting and behaviour. Horror Mark does not turn its bearer into a Horror; it makes the bearer a preferred future victim of horror attacks.

### 17.5 Sacred, Holy, Divine Being, Pretender, and Prophet

Sacred determines eligibility for blessing and Holy recruitment limits. Holy levels belong to priestly or divine capability. Divine Being, Pretender, and Prophet carry further rules and targeting consequences. These terms overlap but are not interchangeable. A sacred troop is not automatically a priest; a priest is not automatically sacred; and a Pretender's divine continuity belongs to [Book III](#).

## 18. Cold Blood, Blindness, Sex, and Other Body Tags

Cold Blooded creatures suffer additional fatigue in cold environments. Blind units depend on special senses or effects that do not require ordinary sight. Sex and body-form tags can affect seduction, transformation, item eligibility, and events. Polyimmune bodies resist transformations that would otherwise replace their shape.

These tags are easy to dismiss because they do not always add a visible combat number. They frequently become decisive only when another system asks a categorical question. A sound database retains them even when a current strategy does not use them.

# Part III: Movement, Terrain, Water, and Position

## 19. Water Status Is a Permission System

The water tags answer different questions:

| Tag            | Core permission                                           | Principal caution                                                                      |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Aquatic        | Lives and operates underwater                             | Ordinarily cannot operate on land without a separate exception or form.                |
| Amphibian      | Operates on land and underwater                           | Underwater performance may still be altered by weapons, spells, mounts, or other tags. |
| Poor Amphibian | Can cross the land-water boundary with penalties          | Treat the penalty as part of the unit, not a cosmetic label.                           |
| Swimming       | Can move through water under its defined rules            | Does not automatically grant every underwater combat permission.                       |
| Gift of Water  | Can support or convey water access according to its value | Capacity and persistence must be checked.                                              |

Water access is not one binary "amphibious" property. An army's legal route depends on the commander, every unit, mounts, items, spells, and available capacity. [Book VI](#) owns the operational route and interception problem; [Book XI](#) identifies the permissions that must be present.

## 20. Flying, Floating, and Storms

Flying changes strategic movement and battlefield contact. It can bypass many terrain constraints, reach rear areas quickly, and alter which opponents can intercept or screen. It does not make a unit immune to storms. Storm Immunity is a separate ability.

Floating is also distinct. A floating body may pass certain terrain or battlefield obstacles and may interact differently with mounts and current patch rules. It should not be read as full flight.

Current practice requires four checks:

- 1 Can the commander use the movement mode?
- 2 Can every assigned unit and mount accompany it?
- 3 Does a storm or other environmental effect suppress the mode?
- 4 Where can the force retreat if the destination battle is lost?

## 21. Terrain Survival and Snow Movement

Forest, mountain, swamp, and wasteland survival reduce the strategic burden of their matching terrain and can affect which movement routes are legal or efficient. Snow movement supports travel in snowy conditions. These tags are most valuable as an army-level property: one incompatible unit can constrain a formation that is otherwise highly mobile.

Terrain survival does not mean immunity to every environmental effect in that terrain. It is a movement and survival permission with a specific engine meaning, not a general declaration that the unit is "at home" there.

## 21A. Riders and mounts are linked records

A mounted unit combines a rider record with a mount record. The two components can carry different movement, sacred, shape, and condition data; the combined unit card should not be treated as proof that every property belongs to both. Version 6.36 establishes three current boundaries:

- a swimming mount is sufficient for the mounted unit to cross rivers;
- when a knight is charmed in the corrected tavern encounter, the mount changes side as well;
- removing a repeated mounted-commander recruitment from the queue no longer incurs the corrected gold charge.

These are specific movement, allegiance, and queue rules. They do not establish a universal rule that every blessing, item effect, affliction, experience value, or transformed state automatically transfers between rider and mount. [Book III](#) owns blessing eligibility; the unresolved lifetime sequence remains R-052.

## 22. Sailing

Sailing lets a commander carry a force across water according to ship size and maximum passenger size. The official manual notes that sailing permits crossing water but not remaining in a water province. Capacity, commander ownership of the ability, passenger size, start and destination, and the exact route must all be legal.

Sailing is best treated as transport, not only as a troop trait. Its value comes from turning water barriers into possible attack lanes. Counterplay includes coastal scouting, route denial, and defence of landing provinces as well as battle strength.

## 23. Teleportation, Blink, and Immobility

Teleport and map teleport grant unusual movement that can ignore ordinary routes. Blink is a battlefield displacement effect. Unteleportable blocks relevant movement magic. Immobile units cannot use ordinary strategic movement. No River Pass forbids a class of crossings even where a normal unit could pass.

Current rules permit commanders with teleport movement to leave a besieged fort. That 6.35 operational exception remains in force under 6.36 and should not be inferred for every ritual or movement effect. The order and hosting timing remain in [Book X](#) and [Book I](#).

# Part IV: Leadership, Squads, and Command Support

## 24. Three Leadership Pools

Dominions separates normal, magic, and undead leadership. A commander can have different capacity in each pool.

| Leadership | Primary followers                  | Failure if absent                                                                           |
|------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Normal     | Ordinary living troops and animals | Units cannot be assigned beyond valid capacity; squad quality may suffer with weak leaders. |

| Leadership | Primary followers                                                       | Failure if absent                                                      |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Magic      | Magic Beings                                                            | Uncontrolled magical beings rout or dissolve in battle.                |
| Undead     | Undead and demons; also the precedence case for undead/demon plus magic | Uncontrolled units rout or dissolve; banishment vulnerability remains. |

The displayed capacity is only the first question. Leadership quality also changes squad morale, and special abilities can modify particular followers. Experience increases command capacity. Poor leaders receive reduced experience increments: the manual's leadership chapter gives a base-10 poor leader +5 at the first star and +10 for later thresholds, rather than the ordinary +25 and then +50 sequence.

## 25. Standard and Inspirational

Standard raises the morale of the squad. Only the best Standard in the squad applies; multiple standards do not add. This makes distribution more important than concentration. A spare standard bearer may provide redundancy, but it does not normally double the current bonus.

Inspirational modifies the morale of troops commanded by that commander. Its value can be positive or negative. Because Standard belongs to the squad and Inspirational belongs to command, they should not be collapsed into one label even when both affect morale.

## 26. Taskmaster, Beast Master, and Special Followers

Taskmaster improves the command of slaves and changes their morale treatment. Beast Master improves command of animals. Similar special-leadership effects exist for particular classes. These abilities should be evaluated against the actual roster rather than as free generic leadership.

A commander with narrow but powerful command support can be more valuable than a higher ordinary leadership number when the army is composed of the matching followers. The reverse is also true: special leadership attached to the wrong roster is unused capacity.

## 27. Formation Fighter, Tight Reins, and Undisciplined Units

Formation Fighter changes how densely units can occupy and fight within battlefield squares. Its value is formation-wide only if enough bodies in the relevant line possess it. [Book IV](#) owns square capacity, placement, and contact consequences.

Tight Reins concerns control of mounts. Undisciplined units cannot follow the full ordinary order set and can undermine carefully scripted squad behaviour. A red squad marker in Army Setup is a command warning, not an aesthetic category.

## 28. Bodyguards and Warning

Units ordered to Guard Commander may appear in assassination battles according to the bodyguard system. Warning improves protection against assassination and related surprise. The bodyguard value must be treated as a chance or capacity within that system, not as a promise that the commander cannot be reached.

Patch 6.35 fixed an exploit in which bodyguards assigned to a distant commander could be used improperly. Current procedures should not rely on the older behaviour.

# Part V: Concealment, Perception, and Covert Action

## 29. Stealth Is a Contest, Not Invisibility

Stealth allows units and commanders to sneak in hostile territory. Discovery depends on patrol pressure and relevant modifiers. A stealth value grants movement permission and contributes to concealment. It does not make the unit absent from every information source or immune to every patrol.

Army stealth is constrained by composition. A stealthy commander cannot carry ordinary visible troops while sneaking unless another effect makes the whole group eligible. Size, number, terrain, patrols, and specialised abilities can all matter.

## 30. Spy, Assassin, and Infiltration Families

Spy permits intelligence and unrest-oriented covert work. Assassin creates assassination attempts. Seduction, Corruption, Dream Seduction, and related abilities use distinct target restrictions, events, checks, and failure battles. They should not be generalised from the word "assassin."

The operational procedure is in [Book X's strategic-order reference](#); strategic use and patrol counterplay are in [Book VI](#). [Book XI](#) supplies the reading rule: check the exact ability, target class, location, patience requirement, and consequence of failure.

## 31. Glamour, Invisibility, Unseen, and Illusion

These names cover four different rule paths. The 6.36 documentation and pinned current-description layer establish the following division.

| Effect           | Strategic-map rule                                                                                                                                                                                     | Combat rule                                                                                           | Boundary                                                                           |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Glamour trait    | Cannot be discovered by scouts; the main manual describes Glamour units as undetectable in friendly provinces. If the unit already has Stealth, the trait adds 25; it does not grant Stealth by itself | Grants a mirror-image defence                                                                         | Mirror Image is an image-selection defence, not the Invisibility Attack penalty    |
| Invisibility     | A sneaking invisible unit can be found only by patrollers with Spirit Sight                                                                                                                            | Melee attackers suffer -10 Attack unless they have Spirit Sight                                       | The revision-2 main manual's -9 is older wording; MM 6.36 supplies the live value  |
| Unseen           | Inherits the documented Invisible behaviour                                                                                                                                                            | Ends when the unit is hit                                                                             | The current Invisibility spell grants Unseen, so its invisibility can end on a hit |
| Illusion class   | No generic strategic concealment follows from the class alone                                                                                                                                          | Spiritform-like technical class; illusion magic can affect it despite Mindless                        | It is a creature class, not a miss-chance synonym                                  |
| Spiritform class | No generic strategic concealment follows from the class alone                                                                                                                                          | Spirit-like class with specific immunities, including the documented Stoneskin and Polymorph examples | It supplies no generic Invisibility or Mirror Image rule                           |

Blur and Displacement belong to the same practical counter search but remain separate battle states. Blur applies a -2 melee Attack penalty. Displacement applies -10 to the first strike against each affected unit and -5 thereafter; its current description says it does not stack with Blur or Invisibility. True Sight, Spirit Sight, and blindness ignore Blur and Displacement. The current Mirror Image spell description separately states that True Sight does not negate its images.

The category-level R-048 question is therefore complete at an Official plus current-description tier. R-058 now has two narrow official strategic answers: Arcoscephale's special dominion scrying reveals enemy units using Glamour to hide, and The Eyes of God detects non-stealthed glamourised or invisible troops inside the caster's dominion. These permissions do not establish a universal scrying rule. Spirit Sight and blindness against innate Glamour's Mirror Image, generic scrying, Spy reports, and the stated limits of those two special channels remain controlled-test questions.

## 32. Darkvision, Spirit Sight, True Sight, and Blindness

Darkvision reduces darkness penalties according to its value; 100 is perfect Darkvision. It does not help a blind unit and does not itself answer Invisibility, Glamour, Blur, Displacement, Illusion, or Spiritform.

Spirit Sight removes darkness penalties, sees invisible units, and is the explicit strategic patrol requirement for finding sneaking Invisible units. The current UI description also says it sees invisible and glamourised units for what they are. True Sight sees through illusions and glamour and removes penalties when attacking Invisible or glamour-enchanted targets such as Blur. The pinned UI descriptions confirm that both Spirit Sight and True Sight ignore Blur and Displacement.

Blindness is not a superior version of either sight ability. A blind attacker already operates without normal vision, so the official descriptions exempt it from additional Invisibility, Blur, and Displacement penalties. Blindness does not thereby grant strategic detection, illuminate darkness, reveal scouts, or remove every illusion effect.

Sight is an attack-enabling system. A unit can have an excellent nominal Attack or Precision score and still deliver poorly when darkness or concealment denies reliable contact. Conversely, specialised sight has little value when the opponent offers no corresponding gate. Its price belongs to the matchup.

# Part VI: Defence, Recovery, and Persistence

## 33. Resistances Are Typed Defences

Fire, cold, shock, poison, acid, disease, and other resistances answer matching effects. Physical resistance families such as pierce, slash, and blunt resistance reduce their relevant damage classes. Invulnerability supplies protection under its defined restrictions. Air Shield reduces the chance of relevant missiles hitting.

A resistance value should always be paired with the incoming effect's type and penetration rule. "Has resistance" is not enough. A force may resist the primary damage while remaining vulnerable to fatigue, armour damage, secondary conditions, Magic Resistance effects, morale pressure, or a different damage type.

[Book IV](#) owns exact damage and protection resolution. The retrieval rule here is to inventory layers rather than add unlike numbers together.

## 34. Ethereal, Twist Fate, Luck, and Glamour

These are separate defensive gates.

- Ethereal: the official manual gives a 75 percent miss chance to nonmagical strikes and permits passage through fort walls while storming.
- Twist Fate: negates a qualifying damaging event and is then expended.
- Luck: creates its own chance-based survival layer.
- Glamour: supplies mirror images that attacks can remove.

Magical attacks answer Ethereal directly, but not every other defence. A high volume of attacks may clear images and one-use protection, while accurate high-value attacks can still be wasted on decoys. A counter plan should list the order in which the defences are expected to be consumed.

## 35. Regeneration Families

Regeneration heals a percentage of maximum hit points during battle and reduces the chance of affliction from damage. Since patch 6.31, regeneration is calculated to the exact percentage rather than older bracket behaviour. Ordinary regeneration does not work on inanimate bodies. Reconstruction is the corresponding inanimate form, while Reforming Flesh or undead regeneration supports eligible undead bodies.

The displayed percentage is not a complete survival estimate. Regeneration is strongest when incoming damage arrives in survivable packets and combat lasts long enough for repeated healing. It is weaker against overwhelming single hits, disablement, soul destruction, swallowing, routes, or damage that exceeds recovery tempo.

False regeneration and enchanted-blood effects are specialised variants and should be read from their current descriptions. Patch 6.35 improved the printed Magic Resistance bonus from Enchanted Blood; older guides may omit or misstate it.

## 36. Reinvigoration

Reinvigoration removes fatigue over time. It increases the sustainable rate of attacks, spellcasting, and other exertion, but it does not erase the consequences of already becoming unconscious or critically fatigued. A low-encumbrance unit with modest reinvigoration may outperform a nominally stronger body in a long fight; a short decisive fight may make the same investment nearly irrelevant.

Fatigue thresholds and critical-hit consequences remain in [Book IV](#).

## 37. Recuperation and Healers

Recuperation attempts to heal battle afflictions over time, except those caused by old age. Ordinary Healer abilities assist eligible living units. Disease Healer addresses disease. Special bodies require special routes, and some item-caused afflictions cannot be removed while the item remains equipped.

The manual lists further recovery sources including Gift of Health, the Chalice, Miraculous Cure-all Elixir, rituals, sites, and Corpse Stitchers for eligible corporeal undead. Each route has eligibility limits

and affliction difficulty. Recovery planning should record the damaged unit's body class, cause of affliction, and available healer type. Counting healer icons is not enough.

### 38. Immortality, Reformation, and Extra Lives

Immortality and dominion immortality return an eligible unit after death under their defined conditions and delay. Reformation abilities provide related return mechanics for particular bodies. Extra Lives permit a form of repeated survival or transformation.

Return is not the same as preventing defeat. A dead immortal may still surrender a battle, province, items, tempo, or access to the location from which it returns. Soul destruction, hostile dominion, remote planes, or ability-specific restrictions can bypass or delay the ordinary promise. Pretender death and Call God remain in [Book III](#).

## Part VII: Auras, Reactive Effects, and Contact Abilities

### 39. Awe, Sun Awe, Fear, and Dread

Awe makes an attacker pass a morale check before carrying out an attack. The official manual expresses the check against  $10 + \text{Awe}$ . Sun Awe follows the same family but is disabled in darkness or underground conditions. Awe is consequently strongest when it forces many low-quality attackers to make repeated checks and weakest against attackers with strong morale, immunity, or a way to avoid ordinary contact.

Fear affects morale in an area. The manual describes a base check of 10, a base area of 6, and increased area or difficulty from higher values. Current Fear behaviour has received patch corrections, so [Book IV's morale chapter](#) is the authority for the exact current battle procedure. Dread belongs to the same broad pressure family but must be read from its own description rather than treated as merely a larger Fear number.

These abilities win by changing participation. Awe may prevent attacks that were otherwise legal. Fear may make a squad or army leave before hit points are exhausted. Their counters are morale, leadership, mindless or other relevant immunity, range, fast killing, and the removal of the fear source.

### 40. Heat, Chill, Poison, Disease, Sleep, and Nightmare Auras

Combat auras create persistent local hazards around a unit.

| Aura         | Main pressure                      | Common answer family                                                     |
|--------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Heat         | Fatigue and fire-related attrition | Fire resistance, temperature planning, range, rapid removal              |
| Chill        | Fatigue and cold-related attrition | Cold resistance, temperature planning, range, rapid removal              |
| Poison Cloud | Poison accumulation                | Poison resistance, spacing, ranged removal, regeneration only as support |



| Aura              | Main pressure                                             | Common answer family                                                |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Disease or Plague | Persistent disease and battlefield spread                 | Disease Resistance, avoidance, cure capacity, expendable separation |
| Sleep Aura        | Unconsciousness or lost action                            | Relevant resistance, range, rapid killing, immunity                 |
| Nightmare Aura    | Fear or sleep-related disruption according to the ability | Morale, appropriate resistance, range, source removal               |

The manual gives a default aura size of 3 for Heat and Chill and explains their interaction with temperature scales. Poison clouds can persist and overlap. Patch 6.27 states that Disease Resistance applies against disease spells, including Plague. Check resistance even when disease arrives through magic instead of monthly attrition.

An aura's real value depends on time and density. A narrow crowded front can make a modest aura affect many bodies for many rounds. A dispersed missile battle may leave the same aura nearly unused.

## 41. Fire Shields, Acid, Spikes, Slime, and Entanglement

Reactive effects punish contact or successful strikes. Fire Shield damages qualifying attackers. Acid Shield and acid effects can damage or corrode. Spikes punish bodies that press into contact. Slime and entanglement can reduce mobility or prevent ordinary action. Some reactive effects require a hit; others require only an attack or adjacency.

This distinction changes the counter. High Defence may reduce on-hit retaliation but does not necessarily avoid a response that triggers on attack. Long weapons, missiles, spells, disposable attacks, resistance, or a different target order may remove the need for the vulnerable unit to touch the effect at all.

## 42. Damage Reversal, Blood Vengeance, Curses, and Horror Marks

Damage Reversal and Blood Vengeance return consequences to an attacker under their own resistance and trigger rules. They are particularly dangerous to high-output attackers whose own offence becomes the delivery mechanism. Small attacks may be inefficient if every trigger invokes a fixed test; enormous attacks may be catastrophic if the reflected consequence scales. The exact current description must decide which case applies.

Curse-on-contact and Horror Mark effects create consequences beyond the immediate exchange. A curse changes future misfortune and affliction risk. A horror mark creates a monthly chance of horror attack; repeated marks can increase its hidden severity, and horrors prefer marked targets. Stronger marks can attract stronger horrors.

These are persistence weapons. Killing the source does not necessarily remove a mark already applied. The value of an irreplaceable commander must include post-battle contamination, not only current hit points.

## 43. Petrification and Other Hard Stops

Petrification can stop or destroy attackers through a resistance interaction. Paralysis, stun, sleep, entanglement, frozen states, and swallowing can similarly remove action without first reducing hit points to zero.

Hard control is often the correct answer to regeneration, life drain, heroic defences, or other sustain because it attacks participation rather than the health pool. It is also unreliable when the target is immune, has high Magic Resistance, possesses specialised protection, or can reform after the relevant effect. A counter plan needs both a delivery mechanism and an answer to the target's class.

## 44. Ambidextrous, Clumsy, Berserker, and Multiweapon Bodies

Ambidextrous reduces the attack penalty from using multiple weapons by its value. It does not remove the additional weapon encumbrance. Clumsy imposes a corresponding handling problem. The value of Ambidextrous depends on the number and quality of actual attacks and on sustainable fatigue, not only the presence of the icon.

Berserker can activate when a wounded unit passes the specified morale test. While berserk, the unit gains its listed bonuses and continues fighting until dead rather than routing normally. Becoming unconscious ends the current berserk state, though the unit can enter it again after recovering and being wounded. Berserk is both a morale solution and a control cost: the unit cannot make ordinary retreat decisions after the state takes hold.

## 45. Trample

Trample lets a larger unit enter a square occupied by smaller units, displace them, and inflict armour-piercing damage through a Defence minus fatigue contest. The manual gives the failed-check damage as  $7 + \text{trampler Size}$ ; an ethereal trampler deals half damage, and even a successful defence check still causes 1 point while displacement occurs.

The full procedure, square capacity, mount interaction, fatigue, and counter formation belong to [Book IV](#). The ability record adds three interpretive warnings:

- trample output depends on reaching smaller bodies and on available squares;
- fatigue reduces the victims' defence in the check and also degrades the trampler over time;
- size is part of both offence and target eligibility, so transformation, mounts, and opposing body size can reverse the plan.

## 46. Swallow, Digest, and Incorporate

Swallow removes a target from the battlefield until the swallower dies or the ability releases it. Digest damages the swallowed target each round. Incorporate converts some of that process into benefit for the swallowing creature.

The manual warns that swallowing prevents many life-saving effects. It can bypass plans based on allies, immortality timing, transformation, regeneration, or escape. Size and target restrictions are central. Counterplay usually means killing or disabling the swallower quickly, preventing contact, or presenting bodies it cannot legally swallow.

## 47. Life Drain, Raise-on-Kill, and Kill-Dependent Effects

Life Drain converts suitable damage into recovery and fatigue relief under its defined rules. Lifeless targets greatly reduce the damage after protection and do not heal the attacker through ordinary life drain. Raise-on-kill and soul-collection effects transform casualties into new bodies, gems, or other resources.

Kill-dependent abilities are nonlinear. They are weak before the first suitable victim dies, then can accelerate as new bodies or recovery increase contact. Denying legal victims, using lifeless or resistant screens, maintaining range, and destroying the carrier before the first conversion are more effective than evaluating the final snowball at full strength.

# Part VIII: Conditional, Economic, Magical, and Summoning Abilities

## 48. Seasonal Powers

Spring, Summer, Autumn, and Winter Power change a unit's statistics or capabilities with the season. A year-turn effect may transform forms or attributes as the calendar changes. The unit shown in one month is not necessarily stable across the year.

Seasonal units should be recorded as a schedule:

| Field             | Record                                                                             |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Strong season     | The months in which the positive modifier applies                                  |
| Weak season       | The months in which output or survival declines                                    |
| Form change       | Whether the body, magic, items, or command changes                                 |
| Campaign deadline | The last hosting turn on which the intended operation retains the favourable state |
| Opponent option   | Whether waiting, delaying a siege, or forcing an early battle changes the matchup  |

Season is thus a strategic resource. It can create a predictable timing attack and an equally predictable window for avoidance.

## 49. Scale and Environmental Powers

Chaos, Cold, Fire, Death, Growth, Darkness, Storm, Magic, Sloth, and related powers change a unit in matching conditions. Dominion Power keys performance to dominion. These abilities mean the unit's statistics are partly provincial.

The correct comparison is not one card against another. It is the card in the likely battlefield province after forecast scale movement, dominion contest, storm creation, and light conditions. An enemy may counter the unit by changing the environment rather than fighting its favourable profile directly.

## 50. Supply, Siege, Patrol, Pillage, and Resource Effects

Need Not Eat removes ordinary supply consumption. Supply Bonus creates supplies. Siege Bonus, Siege Defence, Patrol Bonus, and Pillager modify state actions. Resource, gold, tax, gem, and unrest-related abilities convert a unit or commander into an economic object.

These abilities should be costed by use-month rather than by icon. A Supply Bonus on a commander who remains in the capital creates little value. The same commander on a long enemy route may preserve hundreds of troops. A Siege Bonus matters only when a fort is being converted or protected. A Patrol Bonus can be worth more than combat statistics in a blood economy or stealth war.

[Book II](#) owns the economic formulas; [Book VI](#) owns strategic conversion. [Book XI](#) records the permission and reminds the reader to count months of actual employment.

## 51. Research, Forge, Search, and Ritual Support

Research Bonus increases research output. Forge Bonus reduces eligible forging costs. Dousing and path-specific search bonuses improve Blood Hunting or site searching. Innate Spellcaster changes how a unit casts and can protect parts of its script from ordinary interruption rules.

Patch 6.35 corrected innate spellcasters that could skip their script after becoming temporarily unconscious. Current planning should use the restored behaviour and still account for the turns lost while unconscious.

Support abilities convert commander-turns. Their opportunity cost is central. A researcher moved to lead a patrol is not producing research. A forge specialist who spends every turn moving has no realised forge bonus. [Book V](#) owns the resulting magic economy.

## 52. Summoner, Retinue, Dominion Summoner, and Battle Summoner

Summoning abilities create followers on a schedule or at a trigger. Retinues accompany or regenerate around a commander. Dominion Summoners depend on dominion or local conditions. Battle Summoners add bodies during combat.

Every summoning record needs five fields:

- 1 what is created;
- 2 when creation occurs;
- 3 whether the result persists;
- 4 what leadership it requires;
- 5 what cap, condition, or random range applies.

The created unit's own class may impose a new command burden. A commander can generate troops faster than the army can legally organise or transport them.

# Part IX: Experience and Veteran Units

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## 53. How Experience Is Gained

The official manual states that units usually gain 1 experience point per month. A battle grants 4 experience if the unit does not retreat and 1 if it retreats, with battle experience awarded at most once in a month. A melee strike or trample action grants 1 experience. Community investigation adds finer descriptions for attack flurries, trampled squares, arena victories, events, and particular sites or items; those details are useful but remain version-sensitive unless reproduced against 6.36.

Mindless units are an important exception to ordinary monthly learning in community references, but the current official manual's general wording is not a full class-by-class specification. Where exact passive gain matters, inspect the live unit over controlled turns or use a current engine export.

Experience stays with the unit, not the unit type. Recruitment cost understates the replacement cost of a veteran formation.

## 54. Experience Thresholds

The official thresholds are 15, 50, 100, 200, and 400 experience points. Each threshold adds a star and a package of improvements.

| Total XP | New star's official incremental gains                                                                                        |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 15       | Attack +1, Defence +1, Precision +1, Morale +1, Leadership +25, Research +1                                                  |
| 50       | Attack +1, Defence +1, Precision +1, Morale +1, Leadership +50, Research +1                                                  |
| 100      | Attack +1, Defence +1, Precision +1, Morale +1, Strength +1, Hit Points +1, Leadership +50, Research +1                      |
| 200      | Attack +1, Defence +1, Precision +1, Morale +1, Hit Points +1, Encumbrance -1, Leadership +50, Research +1                   |
| 400      | Attack +1, Defence +1, Precision +1, Morale +1, Strength +1, Hit Points +1, Magic Resistance +1, Leadership +50, Research +1 |

The five-star total is +3 Hit Points. This is not inferred from the table alone: official version 6.13 changed experience to grant +1 HP at every star from the third onward, version 6.14 corrected HP-stat handling for experience, and the current revision-2 manual prints +1 HP at 100, 200, and 400 XP. The familiar cumulative +2 table traces to Dominions 5.53 and is retained only as a historical pre-change result. A current calculator should therefore display +3 at five stars and label its version boundary.

Poor leadership receives smaller command gains. The official leadership section states that a base-10 poor leader receives +5 at the first star and +10 at each later threshold. For normal leadership, the displayed high-experience capacity can greatly exceed the commander's original value, while some morale-quality effects still refer to base leadership.

## 55. Experience Changes Roles Unevenly

The same star package has different value on different bodies.

- Attack and Defence compound the value of elite melee units that survive repeated contacts.
- Precision matters only when the unit delivers attacks or spells that use it.
- Morale improves formation reliability but adds little to a mindless body already using its special morale rule.
- Strength matters more for strength-scaled weapons and some siege or carrying interactions.
- Encumbrance reduction can change long-fight performance disproportionately.

- Magic Resistance is especially valuable on expensive targets that attract control magic.
- Research bonuses make surviving mage-commanders economically productive even when their paths do not change.
- Leadership gains can transform a marginal commander into a genuine army organiser.

Experience is not a flat percentage bonus. It changes the jobs a unit can perform.

## 56. Veteran Preservation

Veterans should be preserved when their added reliability is scarce and replaceable when preservation costs more than the advantage.

| Factor      | Preservation favoured when                                                     | Replacement favoured when                                           |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Recruitment | Slow, cap-only, sacred, or commander-point constrained                         | Cheap, local, and immediately replaceable                           |
| Star value  | Attack, Defence, MR, Encumbrance, or Leadership crosses a functional threshold | Bonuses do not alter the current matchup                            |
| Afflictions | Healthy or recoverable                                                         | Limp, chest wound, feeblemind, or lost limbs remove the gained role |
| Position    | A safe rotation route exists                                                   | Withdrawal exposes the army or abandons the objective               |
| Time        | Campaign is long enough to exploit future months                               | Victory deadline is immediate                                       |

The Army Setup experience filter supports separation of veterans. Mixing them indiscriminately with recruits can waste the opportunity to assign different risk, formation, or leadership.

# Part X: Hall of Fame and Heroic Abilities

## 57. What Is Officially Established

The Hall of Fame ranks commanders that survive many battles or kill many enemies. Non-Pretender commanders in the Hall receive a heroic ability, shown by a yellow star in a red circle, and that ability improves while the commander remains listed. Unique beings such as Elemental Royalty cannot enter. Pretenders do not receive an ordinary heroic ability through this system.

The hosting sequence updates the Hall of Fame and graphs before heroic abilities improve. That timing can matter when a commander enters, leaves, or rises within the list.

The main manual does not publish the full current scoring formula, ability selection weights, or growth formulas. Exact heroic arithmetic circulating online is community reverse engineering, much of it inherited from Dominions 5. It should be used as a hypothesis and planning aid, not as a current official contract.

## 57.1 Edition 28 Formula Boundary

R-047 advances from queued to in progress, but no formula is promoted. The official evidence establishes eligibility, the existence and growth of a heroic ability while listed, and the hosting position of the Hall-of-Fame update. It does not expose the score weights for battles, kills, survival, rank ties, heroic-family selection, or per-turn growth.

A publishable 6.36 formula now requires a raw observation series rather than another prose summary. The Edition 28 source bundle includes `data/edition-28-hall-of-fame-observation-template.csv` with fields for version, seed, commander identity, Pretender and unique status, battles, kills, rank before and after hosting, heroic family, displayed value before and after hosting, survival, Hall membership, and screenshot or save evidence. Tests should hold map, Hall size, unit type, opponent, battle count, and kill allocation constant while changing one factor at a time.

The first series should answer three smaller questions in order:

- 1 whether zero-kill survival and credited kills make separable score contributions;
- 2 how exact ties are ordered when otherwise identical commanders enter on the same hosting;
- 3 whether a displayed heroic value changes once per hosting, once per Hall update, or by an ability-specific schedule.

Until that series or an engine-backed trace exists, the community families below remain a discovery aid and the exact formulas remain withheld.

## 58. Community-Derived Heroic Families

Older reverse engineering identifies common heroic families such as Strength, Battle Prowess, Lightning Reflexes, Iron Will, Valor, Tough Skin, Heroic Toughness, Heroic Quickness, Precision, Endurance, Obesity, and Extraordinary Agility. Rarer reported families include Awesome Presence, Battle Bellow, Legendary Command of Undead, Adept Research, Third Eye, Daftness, Cruelty, Soul Butcher, Fast Casting, and Troll Blood.

The practical descriptions are safer than exact old formulas:

| Family                | Reported growth                                                | Principal use                                                  |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Enormous Strength     | Strength                                                       | Damage, carrying, and strength-based tasks                     |
| Battle Prowess        | Attack                                                         | More reliable melee contact                                    |
| Lightning Reflexes    | Defence                                                        | Avoiding ordinary attacks                                      |
| Iron Will             | Magic Resistance                                               | Resisting hostile magic                                        |
| Valor                 | Morale, leadership, inspiration                                | Army command and rout resistance                               |
| Tough Skin            | Natural protection                                             | Physical survival before armour interaction                    |
| Heroic Toughness      | Percentage hit points                                          | Larger health pool, especially on high-base-HP bodies          |
| Heroic Quickness      | Faster action interval and combat movement in community models | More actions and faster contact; exact 6.36 formula unverified |
| Heroic Precision      | Precision                                                      | Ranged and spell delivery where Precision applies              |
| Heroic Endurance      | Reinvigoration                                                 | Sustainable action in long battles                             |
| Extraordinary Agility | Attack, Defence, ambidexterity                                 | Multiweapon melee performance                                  |
| Fast Casting          | Casting speed                                                  | More spell actions; rare and version-sensitive                 |
| Troll Blood           | Regeneration                                                   | Percentage recovery; rare and version-sensitive                |

Community formulas commonly model a hidden heroic value that begins near 100 and grows by random increments while the commander remains in the Hall. Because the best-known source predates Dominions 6 and current verification is incomplete, this edition does not promote those formulas into the official register.

## 59. Evaluating a Heroic Commander

A heroic ability should be evaluated as a new role constraint, not a trophy.

- 1
- Record the commander's base job.
- 2
- Identify whether the heroic gain strengthens that job or opens a different one.
- 3
- Recalculate equipment, script, bodyguards, and retreat plan.
- 4
- Price the loss of Hall growth if the commander leaves the ranking.
- 5
- Separate a current displayed bonus from a projected community formula.

Heroic Toughness on a large body can create much more absolute health than on a human. Fast Casting on a battle mage may alter an entire script. Valor on a poor commander may create a new army leader. Conversely, melee heroics on a researcher do not automatically justify risking years of accumulated research output.

# Part XI: Conditions and Lasting State

## 60. Conditions Are State, Not Flavour Text

A condition may alter statistics, action, targeting, recovery, loyalty, or future events. Some expire during battle. Others remain for months, survive shape changes, or cannot ordinarily be removed. A unit card reports the current state; it is not a permanent template.

The first distinction is duration:

| Duration class              | Examples                                                 | Audit question                                             |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Immediate or one-resolution | Stun, short paralysis, a consumed Twist Fate             | Does the unit act before the next decisive event?          |
| Battle-persistent           | Poison, bleeding, burning, frozen, fatigue, entanglement | Can resistance, recovery, or battle end remove it?         |
| Month-persistent            | Disease, insanity, many afflictions                      | What happens during hosting and can treatment occur first? |
| Indefinite mark             | Curse, Horror Mark, some taints                          | Is there any ordinary removal route?                       |
| Source-bound                | Item-caused affliction, shape, mount state               | Must the source be removed or changed before recovery?     |

## 61. Afflictions

An affliction is a lasting injury. The official manual gives the base chance as the percentage of normal maximum hit points lost to a damaging strike, with hit location determining what injuries are possible. Major and minor afflictions differ. A unit can accumulate several, shown by a red-heart icon.

Examples include lost eyes, lost arms, weakened limbs, chest wounds, never-healing wounds, battle fright, feeblemind, mute, crippled, and disease. The consequences vary from small statistic penalties



to destruction of the unit's original role. A lost arm is far more serious for a two-handed weapon user than for a spellcaster that retains all required paths and casting faculties; feeblemind can reverse that evaluation.

Healing follows eligibility and difficulty, not sentiment. Recuperation excludes Old Age afflictions. Ordinary healers cannot repair many undead, inanimate, or spiritform bodies. Special recovery routes exist but must match the body. Cursed-item injuries may require item removal. [Book IV](#) owns the exact chance, hit-location table, and battle consequences.

## 62. Disease and Old Age

Disease causes continuing deterioration and may add afflictions. Undead, demons, lifeless beings, and spiritforms have relevant immunities according to their classes. Disease Resistance reduces eligible disease effects, and patch 6.27 extended its protection to disease spells such as Plague.

Old age is a separate risk process tied to current age and maximum age. Maximum age is modified by magic paths according to body: Death for undead, Earth for inanimate bodies, Blood for demons, and Nature for most ordinary beings. Fire can reduce maximum age for bodies whose age is Nature-modifiable. Recuperation does not heal afflictions whose cause is old age.

The operational lesson is to distinguish a diseased young commander, an old commander accumulating age afflictions, and a diseased old commander. They require different forecasts even when the red-heart display looks similar.

## 63. Curse and Horror Mark

Curse increases the chance of suffering afflictions from future wounds and is not ordinarily removed. Horror Mark creates a hidden accumulated severity and a monthly chance of attack by horrors. Horrors prioritise marked units, and stronger marks can attract more dangerous attackers.

Neither condition should be confused with an affliction. Ordinary healing is not the answer. Horror marks may lessen while a unit is dead in some return systems, but exact current reduction is ability-specific and should not be assumed as a universal cleansing method.

## 64. Insanity, Tainted, Yearning, and Homesickness

Insanity can cause a commander to take an unwanted monthly action instead of the assigned order. Tainted and Yearning impose their own recurring risks or location dependencies. Homesickness harms or pressures units away from their proper home or plane.

These conditions convert reliability into probability. The unit may look fully capable and still fail to perform the one strategic order on which a turn depends. Redundancy, safe roles, location planning, and command audits are their primary counters. A critical ritual should not be assigned to an insane commander without an accepted failure branch.

## 65. Poison, Burning, Bleeding, Frozen, and Corrosion

Poison accumulates delayed damage and, since patch 6.30, also reduces Precision. Burning and bleeding cause continuing harm under their rules. Frozen impairs the unit and can combine with cold pressure. Rust and acid can damage armour rather than merely the body.

Patch 6.30 clarified that Spiritform, rather than Ethereal, protects against bleeding, frozen, and burning states. A visual ghost or mist sprite is not enough; the actual tag must be present.

These conditions matter because resistance to the initial strike may not answer the secondary state. Battle review should inspect both damage numbers and icons.

## 66. Stun, Paralysis, Sleep, Entanglement, and Confusion

Stun and paralysis remove or delay actions. Sleep produces unconsciousness. Entanglement holds a unit in place until it escapes or the effect ends. Confusion disrupts normal behaviour. These conditions win time, and time converts into attacks, spell completions, fatigue recovery for one side, and aura exposure for the other.

The correct measure is not only duration. It is the number and value of actions denied before the unit recovers. A one-round stop on a fast caster or trampler may be worth more than a long disable on an irrelevant rear unit.

## 67. Charm, Enslave, Transformation, and Control Loss

Charm and enslavement can change ownership or control. Transformation changes the body and can replace important tags, magic, equipment eligibility, or movement. Polyimmune and other class immunities can prevent specified transformations.

Control effects attack the investment rather than the hit-point pool. Magic Resistance, penetration, body-class immunity, range, and killing the controller or target may all matter. Their strategic consequence includes information and item loss as well as battle output.

# Part XII: Master Ability and Condition Register

## 68. How to Use the Register

The following records are deliberately concise. They identify the first-order rule, the main caveat or counter, and the strongest preserved evidence layer. They are not substitutes for the live description of a specific unit or for [Book IV](#)'s combat procedures.

Evidence codes are defined in [Section 2](#). "UI check" means that the current value or object-specific wording should be read in the game before committing a design.

| Name        | Category | Core function                                                                             | Principal caveat or counter                                                  | Evidence | Primary anchor     |
|-------------|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|--------------------|
| Animal      | Class    | Normal-led creature; half ordinary supply use; reduced armless siege value except monkeys | Animal-specific control and awe; siege contribution                          | OM, MM   | b11-10-animal      |
| Magic Being | Class    | Requires magic leadership                                                                 | Leader loss; magic-being targeting; undead-plus-magic uses undead leadership | OM, MM   | b11-11-magic-being |

| Name                  | Category | Core function                                                            | Principal caveat or counter                                                  | Evidence | Primary anchor                                          |
|-----------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Mindless              | Class    | Morale 50 under control; many mind effects fail                          | Cannot mix with non-mindless; dissolves without suitable leader              | OM, MM   | b11-12-mindless                                         |
| Undead                | Class    | Requires undead leadership; disease immune; banishable                   | Ordinary healing restrictions; anti-undead effects; harmful living mix       | OM, MM   | b11-13-undead                                           |
| Demon                 | Class    | Requires undead leadership; disease immune; banishable                   | Demon-specific effects; do not infer undead or elemental traits              | OM, MM   | b11-14-demon                                            |
| Inanimate or Lifeless | Class    | Nonliving body with disease, life-drain, and ordinary-healing immunities | Needs Reconstruction or specialised repair; class wording is object-specific | OM, MM   | b11-15-inanimate-and-lifeless                           |
| Spiritform            | Class    | Spirit body; transformation, disease, and ordinary-healing immunity      | Not identical to Ethereal; specialised spirit effects remain                 | OM, OP   | b11-16-spiritform                                       |
| Plant                 | Class    | Plant-type target category                                               | Does not imply Mindless, Inanimate, or resistances                           | MM       | b11-17-1-plant                                          |
| Stone Being           | Class    | Stone-specific target category                                           | Do not infer Inanimate unless separately present                             | MM       | b11-17-2-stone-being                                    |
| Illusion              | Class    | Illusory creature category                                               | Distinct from Glamour, Invisibility, and Ethereal                            | MM       | b11-17-3-illusion                                       |
| Horror                | Class    | Lesser, Greater, or Doom Horror category                                 | Horror Mark does not grant this class                                        | MM       | b11-17-4-horror                                         |
| Sacred                | Religion | Eligible for blessing and Holy recruitment rules                         | Must be blessed; Incarnate effects require proper god state                  | OM       | b11-17-5-sacred-holy-divine-being-pretender-and-prophet |
| Cold Blooded          | Body     | Suffers additional fatigue in cold                                       | Cold scales and chill pressure; verify exact current modifier                | OM, MM   | b11-18-cold-blood-blindness-sex-and-other-body-tags     |
| Aquatic               | Movement | Operates underwater                                                      | Usually land-incompatible without another form or effect                     | OM, MM   | b11-19-water-status-is-a-permission-system              |
| Amphibian             | Movement | Operates on land and underwater                                          | Underwater weapons, mounts, and spells still matter                          | OM, MM   | b11-19-water-status-is-a-permission-system              |
| Poor Amphibian        | Movement | Cross-environment permission with penalties                              | Penalties can make nominal access tactically poor                            | OM, MM   | b11-19-water-status-is-a-permission-system              |
| Flying                | Movement | Strategic and battlefield flight                                         | Storms, retreat routes, squad compatibility, anti-flyer screens              | OM, MM   | b11-20-flying-floating-and-storms                       |
| Floating              | Movement | Passes relevant ground or terrain constraints                            | Not full flight; mount interaction is separate                               | MM, OP   | b11-20-flying-floating-and-storms                       |
| Storm Immunity        | Movement | Retains relevant function during storms                                  | Does not grant flight by itself                                              | MM       | b11-20-flying-floating-and-storms                       |
| Terrain Survival      | Movement | Reduces matching terrain movement burden                                 | One incompatible army member can constrain route                             | OM, MM   | b11-21-terrain-survival-and-snow-movement               |

| Name                   | Category    | Core function                                                       | Principal caveat or counter                                                   | Evidence | Primary anchor                                               |
|------------------------|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sailing                | Movement    | Carries eligible force across water                                 | Capacity, passenger size, route, and no underwater stay                       | OM, MM   | b11-22-sailing                                               |
| Teleport               | Movement    | Unusual strategic movement                                          | Unteleportable, legality, timing, and retreat; 6.35 siege exception is narrow | MM, OP   | b11-23-teleportation-blink-and-immobility                    |
| Immobile               | Movement    | Cannot use ordinary strategic movement                              | Requires summons, remote influence, or special movement                       | MM       | b11-23-teleportation-blink-and-immobility                    |
| Magic Leadership       | Command     | Commands Magic Beings                                               | Capacity and leader survival; does not replace undead precedence              | OM, MM   | b11-24-three-leadership-pools                                |
| Undead Leadership      | Command     | Commands undead and demons                                          | Capacity and leader survival; anti-leader attacks                             | OM, MM   | b11-24-three-leadership-pools                                |
| Standard               | Command     | Raises squad morale                                                 | Only best Standard in squad applies                                           | OM, MM   | b11-25-standard-and-inspirational                            |
| Inspirational          | Command     | Modifies morale of commanded troops                                 | Can be negative; commander-bound rather than squad item                       | OM, MM   | b11-25-standard-and-inspirational                            |
| Taskmaster             | Command     | Improves slave command and morale                                   | Valuable only with matching followers                                         | OM, MM   | b11-26-taskmaster-beast-master-and-special-followers         |
| Beast Master           | Command     | Improves animal command                                             | Animal-specific; ordinary roster gains little                                 | OM, MM   | b11-26-taskmaster-beast-master-and-special-followers         |
| Formation Fighter      | Command     | Permits denser fighting formation                                   | Needs formation-wide support; crowding and area effects remain                | OM, MM   | b11-27-formation-fighter-tight-reins-and-undisciplined-units |
| Undisciplined          | Command     | Restricts ordinary squad orders                                     | Reduces script control; separate from low morale                              | OM, MM   | b11-27-formation-fighter-tight-reins-and-undisciplined-units |
| Bodyguard              | Command     | Chance for guards to join assassination defence                     | Not certainty; current exploit fixed in 6.35                                  | OM, OP   | b11-28-bodyguards-and-warning                                |
| Stealthy               | Covert      | Permits sneaking and contributes concealment                        | Patrol contest, composition, terrain, and size                                | OM, MM   | b11-29-stealth-is-a-contest-not-invisibility                 |
| Spy                    | Covert      | Enables intelligence and covert unrest work                         | Patrols and order-specific exposure                                           | OM, MM   | b11-30-spy-assassin-and-infiltration-families                |
| Assassin               | Covert      | Attempts assassination                                              | Bodyguards, Warning, target restrictions, failure battle                      | OM, MM   | b11-30-spy-assassin-and-infiltration-families                |
| Seduction family       | Covert      | Attempts special recruitment, corruption, or assassination outcomes | Sex, target, patience, location, checks, and failure differ by ability        | OM, MM   | b11-30-spy-assassin-and-infiltration-families                |
| Glamour                | Concealment | Mirror images in battle; hidden in friendly provinces               | Images can be stripped; specialised sight; not Illusion                       | OM, MM   | b11-31-glamour-invisibility-unseen-and-illusion              |
| Invisibility or Unseen | Concealment | Makes detection or targeting difficult                              | Exact perception counter is ability-specific                                  | MM, UI   | b11-31-glamour-invisibility-unseen-and-illusion              |

| Name                 | Category    | Core function                                                              | Principal caveat or counter                                        | Evidence | Primary anchor                                          |
|----------------------|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Darkvision           | Perception  | Reduces darkness penalties                                                 | Percentage or value matters; does not answer every concealment     | OM, MM   | b11-32-darkvision-spirit-sight-true-sight-and-blindness |
| Spirit Sight         | Perception  | Detects relevant spiritual or ethereal targets                             | Not a universal True Sight substitute                              | OM, MM   | b11-32-darkvision-spirit-sight-true-sight-and-blindness |
| True Sight           | Perception  | Counters specified deception                                               | Check exact effect; darkness may remain separate                   | MM, UI   | b11-32-darkvision-spirit-sight-true-sight-and-blindness |
| Elemental Resistance | Defence     | Reduces matching fire, cold, shock, poison, or acid pressure               | Secondary effects and other damage types can bypass the plan       | OM, MM   | b11-33-resistances-are-typed-defences                   |
| Physical Resistance  | Defence     | Reduces matching pierce, slash, or blunt damage                            | Wrong weapon type bypasses; exact layer in <a href="#">Book IV</a> | OM, MM   | b11-33-resistances-are-typed-defences                   |
| Air Shield           | Defence     | Reduces chance of relevant missiles hitting                                | Spells and nonmissile delivery; exact percentage                   | OM, MM   | b11-33-resistances-are-typed-defences                   |
| Ethereal             | Defence     | 75 percent of nonmagical strikes miss; passes fort walls                   | Magical attacks; other layers still apply                          | OM       | b11-34-ethereal-twist-fate-luck-and-glamour             |
| Twist Fate           | Defence     | Negates a qualifying damaging event, then ends                             | Multiple attacks or prior expendable hit                           | OM, MM   | b11-34-ethereal-twist-fate-luck-and-glamour             |
| Luck                 | Defence     | Chance-based survival layer                                                | High attack volume; verify interaction order                       | OM, MM   | b11-34-ethereal-twist-fate-luck-and-glamour             |
| Regeneration         | Recovery    | Heals exact percentage of maximum HP per round and reduces affliction risk | Burst damage, disablement, inanimate immunity, soul effects        | OM, OP   | b11-35-regeneration-families                            |
| Reconstruction       | Recovery    | Regeneration for inanimate bodies                                          | Verify percentage and body eligibility                             | OM, MM   | b11-35-regeneration-families                            |
| Undead Regeneration  | Recovery    | Regeneration family for eligible undead                                    | Not every undead has it; burst and control remain                  | OM, MM   | b11-35-regeneration-families                            |
| Reinvigoration       | Recovery    | Removes fatigue over time                                                  | Cannot restore actions already lost; short fights may not use it   | OM, MM   | b11-36-reinvigoration                                   |
| Recuperation         | Recovery    | Attempts to heal eligible battle afflictions over months                   | Excludes old age; class and affliction difficulty restrictions     | OM, MM   | b11-37-recuperation-and-healers                         |
| Healer               | Recovery    | Attempts to heal eligible units                                            | Body and affliction eligibility; healer value and difficulty       | OM, MM   | b11-37-recuperation-and-healers                         |
| Immortality          | Persistence | Returns after death under defined conditions                               | Delay, dominion, soul destruction, position, and lost battle       | OM, MM   | b11-38-immortality-reformation-and-extra-lives          |
| Awe                  | Aura        | Forces attacker morale check against 10 plus Awe                           | Morale, immunity, missiles, spells, rapid removal                  | OM, MM   | b11-39-awe-sun-awe-fear-and-dread                       |
| Sun Awe              | Aura        | Awe family dependent on light                                              | Disabled underground or in darkness                                | OM, MM   | b11-39-awe-sun-awe-fear-and-dread                       |

| Name                   | Category    | Core function                                                       | Principal caveat or counter                                                             | Evidence | Primary anchor                                                 |
|------------------------|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fear                   | Aura        | Applies local morale pressure                                       | Leadership, morale, mindless, range, source removal; exact current procedure in Book IV | OM, OP   | b11-39-awe-sun-awe-fear-and-dread                              |
| Heat or Chill Aura     | Aura        | Applies local fatigue and elemental pressure                        | Matching resistance, scales, spacing, range                                             | OM, MM   | b11-40-heat-chill-poison-disease-sleep-and-night-mare-auras    |
| Poison Cloud           | Aura        | Accumulates poison in an area                                       | Poison resistance, spacing, ranged removal                                              | OM, MM   | b11-40-heat-chill-poison-disease-sleep-and-night-mare-auras    |
| Disease or Plague Aura | Aura        | Applies persistent disease pressure                                 | Disease Resistance, separation, cure capacity                                           | OM, OP   | b11-40-heat-chill-poison-disease-sleep-and-night-mare-auras    |
| Sleep Aura             | Aura        | Causes nearby units to become unconscious                           | Resistance or immunity, range, rapid removal                                            | MM, UI   | b11-40-heat-chill-poison-disease-sleep-and-night-mare-auras    |
| Fire Shield            | Reactive    | Damages qualifying attackers in contact                             | Fire resistance, range, long weapons, disposable attacks                                | OM, MM   | b11-41-fire-shields-acid-spikes-slime-and-entanglement         |
| Damage Reversal        | Reactive    | Returns a consequence to attacker                                   | Exact trigger and resistance; nonqualifying attacks                                     | OM, MM   | b11-42-damage-reversal-blood-vengeance-curses-and-horror-marks |
| Blood Vengeance        | Reactive    | Punishes damage through a resistance interaction                    | Magic Resistance, attack selection, ranged or disposable delivery                       | OM, MM   | b11-42-damage-reversal-blood-vengeance-curses-and-horror-marks |
| Petrification          | Reactive    | Hard-stop effect against qualifying attackers                       | Magic Resistance, immunity, noncontact delivery                                         | OM, MM   | b11-43-petrification-and-other-hard-stops                      |
| Ambidextrous           | Combat      | Reduces multiweapon attack penalty by value                         | Does not remove extra weapon encumbrance                                                | OM, MM   | b11-44-ambidextrous-clumsy-berserker-and-multiweapon-bodies    |
| Berserker              | Combat      | Wounded morale check can enter no-rout combat state with bonuses    | Loss of control; unconsciousness ends current state                                     | OM, MM   | b11-44-ambidextrous-clumsy-berserker-and-multiweapon-bodies    |
| Trample                | Combat      | Displaces smaller units and deals size-based armour-piercing damage | Large targets, fatigue, formation, space, ranged disablement                            | OM, MM   | b11-45-trample                                                 |
| Swallow or Digest      | Combat      | Removes and damages eligible target inside swallower                | Size restriction; kill or disable swallower; blocks many life-saving effects            | OM, MM   | b11-46-swallow-digest-and-incorporate                          |
| Life Drain             | Combat      | Converts suitable damage into recovery                              | Lifeless targets; range; resistance; rapid killing                                      | OM, MM   | b11-47-life-drain-raise-on-kill-and-kill-dependent-effects     |
| Seasonal Power         | Conditional | Changes attributes in a matching season                             | Predictable weak months; year-turn or form changes                                      | MM       | b11-48-seasonal-powers                                         |
| Scale Power            | Conditional | Changes attributes in matching scales or environment                | Change scales, light, storm, or battlefield location                                    | MM       | b11-49-scale-and-environmental-powers                          |
| Need Not Eat           | Economy     | Consumes no ordinary supplies                                       | Does not imply disease, undead, or inanimate status                                     | OM, MM   | b11-50-supply-siege-patrol-pillage-and-resource-effects        |

| Name                         | Category      | Core function                                                  | Principal caveat or counter                                           | Evidence | Primary anchor                                                |
|------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Supply Bonus                 | Economy       | Produces supplies                                              | Value realised only where supply is binding                           | OM, MM   | b11-50-supply-siege-patrol-pillage-and-resource-effects       |
| Siege or Patrol Bonus        | Economy       | Improves matching province action                              | No value while action is unused; exact formula elsewhere              | OM, MM   | b11-50-supply-siege-patrol-pillage-and-resource-effects       |
| Research Bonus               | Magic support | Adds research output                                           | Commander-turn opportunity cost                                       | OM, MM   | b11-51-research-forge-research-and-ritual-support             |
| Forge Bonus                  | Magic support | Reduces eligible forge cost                                    | Item and path eligibility and rounding; only while forging            | OM, MM   | b11-51-research-forge-research-and-ritual-support             |
| Innate Spellcaster           | Magic support | Uses innate casting rules                                      | Current 6.35 script fix; fatigue and unconsciousness still matter     | OM, OP   | b11-51-research-forge-research-and-ritual-support             |
| Summoner or Retinue          | Summoning     | Creates or restores followers on a trigger or schedule         | Leadership, cap, persistence, and created class                       | MM, UI   | b11-52-summoner-retinue-dominion-summoner-and-battle-summoner |
| Experience                   | Development   | Adds star packages at 15, 50, 100, 200, and 400 XP             | Role-specific value; official and community cumulative HP discrepancy | OM, CT   | b11-54-experience-thresholds                                  |
| Heroic Ability               | Development   | Hall-of-Fame commander gains a growing special trait           | Exact formula and rarity are community-derived and version-sensitive  | OM, CT   | b11-57-what-is-officially-established                         |
| Affliction                   | Condition     | Lasting injury with body-part and difficulty rules             | Correct healer and body eligibility; role can be lost                 | OM       | b11-61-afflictions                                            |
| Disease                      | Condition     | Continuing deterioration and affliction risk                   | Disease Resistance, immunity, Disease Healer; distinct from old age   | OM, OP   | b11-62-disease-and-old-age                                    |
| Curse                        | Condition     | Persistent increased misfortune and affliction exposure        | Not ordinarily removable; avoid contamination                         | OM       | b11-63-curse-and-horror-mark                                  |
| Horror Mark                  | Condition     | Hidden stacked severity and monthly horror-attack chance       | Not ordinary affliction; conceal, protect, or accept long risk        | OM       | b11-63-curse-and-horror-mark                                  |
| Insanity                     | Condition     | Chance of unwanted monthly behaviour                           | Redundancy and noncritical assignments                                | OM, MM   | b11-64-insanity-tainted-yearning-and-homesickness             |
| Old Age                      | Condition     | Age-driven deterioration beyond body-adjusted maximum age      | Recuperation does not heal age afflictions                            | OM       | b11-62-disease-and-old-age                                    |
| Poison                       | Condition     | Delayed accumulating damage; also reduces Precision since 6.30 | Poison resistance, recovery, battle duration                          | OM, OP   | b11-65-poison-burning-bleeding-frozen-and-corrosion           |
| Burning, Bleeding, or Frozen | Condition     | Persistent battle impairment or damage                         | Relevant immunity or resistance; Spiritform protected in 6.30         | OP, UI   | b11-65-poison-burning-bleeding-frozen-and-corrosion           |
| Stun, Paralysis, or Sleep    | Condition     | Denies actions                                                 | Resistance, immunity, recovery time, source removal                   | OM, MM   | b11-66-stun-paralysis-sleep-entanglement-and-confusion        |
| Entanglement                 | Condition     | Prevents movement or action until escape                       | Strength or ability-specific escape; ranged support                   | OM, MM   | b11-66-stun-paralysis-sleep-entanglement-and-confusion        |

| Name             | Category  | Core function                | Principal caveat or counter                                 | Evidence | Primary anchor                                       |
|------------------|-----------|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Charm or Enslave | Condition | Changes control or ownership | Magic Resistance, immunity, range, killing target or caster | OM, MM   | b11-67-charm-enslave-transformation-and-control-loss |
| Transformation   | Condition | Replaces body or form        | Polyimmune, targeting immunity, form-specific loss          | OM, MM   | b11-67-charm-enslave-transformation-and-control-loss |

# Part XIII: Retrieval and Audit Tools

## 69. The Unit-Card Translation Sheet

For important commanders, sacreds, summons, and unusual independents, use one compact record:

| Field                | Entry                                                                                                   |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ruleset and version  | Patch, mod stack, object source                                                                         |
| Current form         | Unit ID or name, mount, alternate shapes                                                                |
| Classes              | Every displayed or confirmed type tag                                                                   |
| Leadership need      | Normal, magic, undead; capacity and redundancy                                                          |
| Movement permissions | Land, water, air, terrain, teleport, sailing                                                            |
| Defensive gates      | Protection, resistance, Ethereal, Glamour, Luck, recovery                                               |
| Offensive gates      | Range, magic weapon, aura, trample, swallow, control                                                    |
| Conditional values   | Scale, season, dominion, darkness, storm, bless                                                         |
| Development          | XP, stars, Hall position, heroic ability                                                                |
| Current damage       | Afflictions, disease, curse, horror mark, age, insanity                                                 |
| Evidence             | OM, MM, OP, UI, CT, D, TP                                                                               |
| Links                | Canonical <a href="#">Book IV</a> , <a href="#">V</a> , or <a href="#">VI</a> section and object record |

This sheet makes a unit comparable across turns. It also exposes when a conclusion came from a favourable form or environment rather than the permanent object.

## 70. Army Compatibility Audit

Before movement or battle scripting, verify:

- 1

Every unit has the correct leadership type and capacity.
- 2

Mindless and non-mindless bodies are not assigned to an illegal shared squad.
- 3

Water, flight, sailing, teleport, and terrain permissions cover the entire force.
- 4

Supply demand includes riders and mounts and accounts for animal reductions and Need Not Eat.
- 5

Darkness, storm, temperature, season, scale, and dominion assumptions match the destination.
- 6

Recovery routes match actual body classes.
- 7

Standard distribution uses best-only stacking rather than redundant concentration.
- 8

Veteran and afflicted units occupy formations appropriate to their current statistics.
- 9

A leader-loss branch exists for magical beings, undead, demons, and mindless troops.
- 10

A retreat route exists for every movement mode and plane involved.



## 71. Counter-Construction Matrix

| Enemy gate              | First answer family                                                | Secondary check                         | Frequent false answer                                     |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Ethereal                | Magical attacks                                                    | Accuracy, damage, other defence layers  | More nonmagical elite attacks                             |
| Glamour or Invisibility | Image-clearing volume and suitable perception                      | Darkness and target eligibility         | Treating every concealment tag as Illusion                |
| Awe                     | Morale, leadership, immunity, range                                | Attack count and fear support           | Raw damage on attackers that never complete attacks       |
| Fear                    | Morale system, mindless where suitable, source removal             | Army-rout weight and commander survival | Only increasing individual hit points                     |
| Regeneration            | Burst, disablement, sustained damage above recovery                | Affliction resistance and immortality   | Slow chip damage into favourable sustain                  |
| Trample                 | Comparable size, formation depth, fatigue, or ranged control       | Displacement space and mount form       | A thin line of high-Defence small units                   |
| Swallow                 | Ineligible size, range, rapid swallower removal                    | Life-saving effects blocked inside      | Relying on the swallowed unit's ordinary sustain          |
| Auras                   | Matching resistance, spacing, range, source removal                | Duration and density                    | Buying resistance to only the initial weapon              |
| Life Drain              | Lifeless screen, range, burst                                      | Weapon type and target selection        | Feeding weak living bodies one at a time                  |
| Mindless army           | Kill or disable command, exploit army-rout structure               | Redundant leaders                       | Ordinary morale damage aimed only at troops               |
| Immortality             | Win position, deny return conditions, soul effects where available | Delay and item loss                     | Treating one kill as permanent strategic removal          |
| Stealth                 | Patrol coverage and intelligence                                   | Terrain, size, false-army effects       | Province Defence alone without patrol plan                |
| Seasonal or scale power | Delay, relocate, or change environment                             | Opponent's ability to restore condition | Evaluating only the favourable unit card                  |
| Heroic commander        | Attack current role and retreat plan                               | Hidden value formulas unverified        | Countering the heroic label instead of the actual bonuses |

## 72. Battle Review Questions

After an unfamiliar interaction, preserve the battle and ask:

- Which tag made the target legal or illegal?
- Which layer acted first: perception, morale, avoidance, protection, resistance, recovery, or return?
- Was the displayed ability innate, item-granted, blessed, spell-granted, mounted, heroic, or environmental?
- Did a condition deny actions even though hit points remained?
- Did leader loss change morale or control?
- Did the battle occur under the expected scales, season, light, storm, and dominion?
- Did the replay show a current patch correction that an older guide lacks?
- Is the conclusion official, directly observed, derived, community-tested, or still pending?

The answer should be recorded at the narrowest reliable level. One battle can show that a particular interaction occurred; it cannot establish every probability or stacking rule.

# Part XIV: Essays

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## Essay I: The Icon Is a Rule, Not Decoration

Dominions presents much of its complexity as small symbols and short descriptions. That presentation invites two opposite mistakes. A new player can ignore an icon because the basic statistics look understandable. An experienced player can recognise the icon's name and import a remembered rule from another version. Both mistakes replace the current object with an assumption.

An icon is best understood as a link to a rule family. Undead links a unit to leadership, banishment, disease immunity, recovery restrictions, and targeting. Flying links it to strategic reach, battlefield contact, storms, squad compatibility, and retreat. Recuperation links it to time, affliction cause, body eligibility, and healing difficulty. The symbol is small because the interface cannot print the whole dependency graph on every card.

Mastery does not mean memorising five hundred isolated definitions. It means learning the questions raised by each family. A class icon asks, "what can command and target this body?" A movement icon asks, "who can accompany it and where can it retreat?" A recovery icon asks, "which damage is actually permanent?" An aura asks, "how many bodies remain inside it, and for how many rounds?"

This approach scales. A new icon can be placed into a known family before every edge case is understood. The unknown details remain visible, but the largest category errors can already be avoided.

## Essay II: Overlapping Classes Are the Grammar of Exceptions

Many games assign one creature type and let it explain the whole unit. Dominions instead permits several tags to overlap. This is not clutter. It is the grammar by which the engine expresses exceptions.

Consider an undead magic being. Undead determines banishment, disease, ordinary healing restrictions, and the relevant command precedence. Magic Being creates another targeting identity, but it does not replace the undead command rule. Add Mindless and the morale system changes again. Add Amphibian and the strategic theatre expands. Add Sacred and the same body can receive a blessing. No one adjective is a complete description.

This explains why visual intuition fails so often. A stone statue may be Inanimate, Stone Being, Mindless, Magic Being, Sacred, or only some of them. A ghost may be Spiritform, Ethereal, Undead, Magic Being, Invisible, or a different combination. Art suggests a fiction; tags define the interaction.

For nation design, overlapping classes are also an access problem. The army needs commanders that satisfy the strongest command requirement, magic that can support the body, movement that can transport it, and recovery that matches it. A roster containing individually powerful units can be strategically weak if its class infrastructure is incomplete.

## Essay III: Experience Is Stored Reliability

Experience seems modest because each star adds small numbers. Those numbers sit on contested rolls that occur repeatedly. One Attack point can turn many near misses into hits. One Defence point can prevent many contacts. One Morale point can preserve a formation at the check that would otherwise break it. Encumbrance reduction can delay a critical-hit spiral. Magic Resistance can save the commander on whom the army's leadership depends.

The value is stored because the recruitment price has already been paid. Months, battles, and survived contacts have been converted into a unit that cannot be purchased directly from the queue. This does not make every veteran sacred. Afflictions can consume the role that the stars improved, and a victory deadline can make preservation irrational. It does mean that replacement should compare current function rather than printed recruitment cost.

Veteran management is a form of capital allocation. Elite squads can be rotated away from low-value attrition, assigned to the contact where their thresholds matter, or preserved for siege relief. Experienced commanders can become better leaders and researchers. An army that treats every survivor as interchangeable throws away a resource recorded by the interface but not priced by the treasury.

## Essay IV: Conditions Turn Battles into Logistics

A battle report that ends with surviving units can conceal a strategic defeat. Disease, lost limbs, chest wounds, curses, horror marks, and insanity follow the survivors into later turns. Poison or fatigue may have decided who escaped. A unit that won while receiving a cursed item injury may remain damaged until equipment changes. A recuperating army may need months and a safe province before it becomes the same army again.

Conditions connect the battlefield to logistics. They create treatment routes, replacement decisions, staging requirements, and deadlines. Different bodies need different forms of repair. Living healers cannot mend every construct or ghost. Recuperation cannot undo old age. Immortality may restore the body while still losing the month's position and tempo.

The useful measure of victory is not bodies left on the final frame. It is force available for the next necessary action. [Book IV](#) explains how the damage occurred; [Book XI](#) explains why the icons remaining afterward are part of the campaign state.

## Essay V: Evidence Boundaries Are Part of Expert Play

Dominions rewards exact knowledge, but an old formula printed confidently can imitate exactness. Heroic abilities are the clearest example. Community reverse engineering offers detailed scoring and growth models that are far more useful than vague folklore. The official manual confirms only the broad Hall-of-Fame process, and much of the detailed public work predates Dominions 6.

The correct response is neither to discard the investigation nor to publish it as current law. It is to label the layer. Official rules support the stable core. Current patch notes correct superseded behaviour. Community work supplies hypotheses and often excellent working estimates. Controlled tests decide the interactions that matter enough to verify.

This boundary improves play. A plan based on an official permission can be treated as reliable. A plan based on a community probability needs a failure branch. A plan based on a hidden heroic growth formula should not risk a campaign unless the current displayed value already justifies it. Uncertainty becomes an operational input rather than an embarrassment concealed by prose.

# Part XV: Version Notes, Open Questions, and Sources

## 73. Current Ability-Facing Patch Notes

| Version | Current correction relevant to this book                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6.36    | Swimming mounts suffice for river crossing; a tavern-charmed knight's mount changes side; repeated mounted-commander recruitment no longer creates the corrected removal charge; Gift of Water Breathing can protect against Lost Land.                                                                                  |
| 6.35    | Innate spellcasters no longer skip the script after temporary unconsciousness; units that automatically regain mounts do so at end of turn; a bodyguard exploit was fixed; supply use updates when items change; Enchanted Blood prints its Magic Resistance bonus; teleport-moving commanders can leave besieged forts. |
| 6.31    | Regeneration uses the exact displayed percentage rather than old percentage brackets.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 6.30    | Poison also reduces Precision; Spiritform rather than Ethereal prevents bleeding, frozen, and burning; mounted commanders gained strategic movement changes; gods and prophets cannot fail the ordinary retreat morale roll.                                                                                             |
| 6.27    | Disease Resistance protects against disease spells, including Plague; Enchanted Blood was added as a monster and item command.                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 6.25    | Praise was added as an ability; battle version display was added for evidence capture.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 6.23    | Fear and several battle interactions were corrected; current combat details remain canonical in <a href="#">Book IV</a> .                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 6.14    | HP-stat handling for experience was corrected immediately after the veteran-HP change.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 6.13    | Experience now grants +1 HP for every star at three stars and above.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

Patch notes are a correction layer, not a replacement for the manual. Records should name the version in which a behaviour changed and retain the older rule only when it helps diagnose historical guides or saved games.

## 74. Open Verification Queue

| Priority  | Question                                                                                                    | Reliable resolution route                                                                                 | Publication status                                                                                                            |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Completed | Does a current five-star unit receive cumulative +2 or +3 Hit Points from experience?                       | Official 6.13 and 6.14 corrections plus the current manual table                                          | Resolved as cumulative +3 HP; +2 retained only as pre-change historical evidence                                              |
| P1        | Which Hall-of-Fame scoring and heroic-growth formulas remain unchanged in 6.36?                             | Reproducible current tests or engine-backed reverse engineering using the Edition 28 observation template | In progress; official boundary and controlled series defined, formulas withheld                                               |
| Completed | How do current perception abilities divide Glamour, Invisibility, Unseen, Illusion, and Spiritform targets? | Current official 6.36 definitions plus pinned current descriptions; narrower runtime edges split to R-058 | Category division resolved without treating the effects as synonyms                                                           |
| P1        | Which ability sources stack, use best-only, or replace one another across form, item, bless, and spell?     | Targeted tests and live descriptions                                                                      | In progress; Standard, Inspiring Researcher, experience, Horror Mark, and the Blur/Displacement/Invisibility group classified |

| Priority | Question                                                                                                                                                          | Reliable resolution route                                                                                                                          | Publication status                                                                                                                                            |
|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| P1       | Do Spirit Sight or blindness alter innate Glamour's Mirror Image resolution, and which non-scout information channels reveal Glamour units in friendly provinces? | Reproduce the two explicit official strategic channels, then run the controlled 6.36 battle and information matrix in the Edition 29 working paper | In progress as R-058; Arcoscephale dominion scrying and The Eyes of God have narrow official answers, while the battle edges and generic channels remain open |
| P2       | What are the exact current passive XP exceptions for Mindless units and special sites or items?                                                                   | Controlled monthly observation and current data export                                                                                             | Official general gain and battle sources published                                                                                                            |
| P2       | Which condition immunities follow from each technical class versus a separate hidden tag?                                                                         | Current object export plus controlled spell matrix                                                                                                 | Only explicit official relationships published                                                                                                                |
| P2       | How do mount loss, Reclaim Mount, automatic return, and shape changes transfer experience and conditions?                                                         | Controlled mounted commander series under 6.36                                                                                                     | Cross-link and patch note only                                                                                                                                |

## 75. Source Record

### Official sources

- [Illwinter's Dominions 6 documentation page](#)
- [Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2](#)
- [Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.36](#)
- [Official Dominions 6 announcements and change notes](#)

### Community references

- [Illwiki: Dominions 6 unit abilities](#)
- [Illwiki: Dominions 6 experience](#)
- [Illwiki: Hall of Fame reverse engineering](#)
- [Dominions 6 Heroic Quickness discussion](#)

The community sources are retained for taxonomy, test leads, and older reverse engineering. They do not override the current official manual, patch notes, or a reproducible 6.36 result.

### Edition 28 Perception Evidence Record

- ruleset: unmodded Dominions 6.36;
- verified: 30 August 2026;
- official main manual revision 2 SHA-256:  
65f430fd97c9f27285d63b797b43bc7fe3844241fdf40230b1d25a901ab9f33f;
- official Modding Manual 6.36 SHA-256:  
9d4a7d2c5101679de7080455ceebd41b25a1e9beba275985e293183269399cf;
- current-description layer: pinned 6.35 Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc;
- patch check: official 6.36 announcement reviewed; no perception-family correction found;
- unresolved runtime edge: R-058 only.

## 76. Closing Reference

A complete unit reading has six layers:

class -> command -> movement -> ability -> development -> condition

Skipping a layer turns an apparent rule into a surprise. Reading all six turns the unit card into a compact map of permissions, gates, risks, and stored value. That method is the foundation on which later nation dossiers, object records, calculators, and matchup essays can be built without restating the same five hundred definitions every time.

## DOCUMENT 14 OF 16

# Foundation Book XII: Base-Game Objects and the Searchable Reference Layer

## Ruleset, purpose, and evidence boundary

Book XII contains the unmodded Dominions 6 structured object snapshot pinned to version 6.35. The live rules baseline is 6.36, with its official announcement overlaid in the canonical books and patch ledger. A 6.36 object export has not replaced the auditable Inspector commit used here. Dominions Enhanced 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE are kept out of these records. Their exact source inventories remain in Book IX and can later be applied as overlays against the vanilla identities established here.

Book XII fills a different gap from the earlier foundation books. Books II-VI explain economy, religion, armies, magic, and campaign judgement. Book XI explains how to read units and abilities. None of them should become a thousand-page inventory of object cards, so the work is divided clearly:

- Book XII explains how to interpret, compare, verify, and maintain object records;
- `website/base-object-register.json` owns the filterable records;
- `website/base-object-register.schema.json` defines the publication contract;
- the earlier books retain the full rules and strategic consequences;
- nation dossiers will import shared objects by stable identity instead of researching them again.

The baseline data comes from the public Dominions 6 Data Inspector at commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc`, dated 26 May 2026 and labelled by its maintainer as an update to 6.35. The Inspector is an extremely useful community extraction, but it is not an official rules document and its own documentation warns that errors may remain. A field drawn from it is labelled source-confirmed, not official. Statements from the official manuals receive the higher official label. Derived classifications, such as grouping a spell under remote attack or tagging a site as a Throne from its source rarity code, remain visibly derived even when the underlying values are source-confirmed.

The register does not reproduce the game's long descriptions or artwork. It records names, identities, mechanical fields, relationships, provenance, evidence status, canonical links, and stable hashes. This makes it useful for search and comparison without turning the website into an unattributed mirror of the game text.

## The no-duplication delta

Book V already explains research, casting, rituals, global enchantments, forging, path access, gems, communions, and late-game magic. Book III owns Pretender design, dominion, scales, blessings, and divine continuity. Book VI owns strategic use of Thrones and mercenaries. Book XI owns the interpretation of unit abilities. The present volume does not replace any of those chapters.

Its new contribution is retrieval. It establishes stable object identities, versioned source lineage, cross-object relationships, filter fields, incomplete-data markers, and maintenance rules. A reader looking up what an object is should arrive here or at the register. A reader asking why and when it matters should follow the canonical link to the earlier foundation book.

## What the first register contains

| Record family           | Current records   | What is represented                                                                                           |
|-------------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Spells                  | 1,474             | All extracted spell rows, including 1,233 researchable or Divine rows and 241 unresearchable or internal rows |
| Magic items             | 529               | Ordinary forgeable items, Construction 9 artifacts, barding, and special or engine-managed items              |
| Summon relations        | 549               | Spell-to-unit or spell-to-selection-group relationships, including chained effects                            |
| Pretender forms         | 298               | Base forms with national availability, body statistics, paths, discounts, and shape links                     |
| Thrones                 | 74                | Thirty-six level-one, twenty-six level-two, and twelve level-three Thrones                                    |
| Other magic sites       | 1,179             | Random, capital, national, event, and other non-Throne sites                                                  |
| Mercenary companies     | 78                | Company, leader, troop, era, starting strength, minimum bid, experience, and recovery fields                  |
| Independent recruitment | 1 coverage marker | The missing population-type relation is documented without inventing an exhaustive catalogue                  |
| Special dominions       | 14                | Official system families from the manual, linked to every applicable nation and age                           |

These 4,196 records are not all equally player-facing. Internal spell rows, engine-managed items, and unresolved selection groups are retained because removing them would make version comparisons unreliable. Website defaults should hide such records from a beginner search while keeping them available to researchers and modders.

## Part I: The Object-Reference Method

### 1. An object is an identity, not merely a name

Dominions contains many repeated names. Several forms may share a display name; different items may occupy the same apparent category; a spell may chain into a second hidden spell; a Pretender may transform into another monster record. Names are presentation fields, not primary keys.

Every record begins with three different identities:

- a stable publication ID such as `spell-0200` or `pretender-0109`;
- the engine-facing numeric ID supplied by the extracted data;
- the current display name.

The publication ID supplies durable website links. The engine ID allows comparison with mod commands, inspector entries, debug output, and later patch exports. The name remains essential for readers, but a rename does not have to break links or confuse a changed record with an entirely new one.

For a national guide, this distinction is decisive. A dossier may say that a nation can choose Dagon, but the underlying reference should point to Pretender form 109. If a later patch changes the name or statistics of that form, one object record changes and every dossier importing it receives the corrected fact.



## 2. Ruleset identity belongs inside every record

A record without a ruleset is unsafe. The same visible object can have different requirements, statistics, or secondary effects under vanilla play, Dominions Enhanced, Divinitus, another balance mod, or a different load order.

The first register uses one ruleset label throughout:

vanilla-6.35

Modded records will not overwrite that layer. They should later be expressed as additions, replacements, or field-level deltas with their own load-order identity. This preserves a clean answer to three different questions:

- 1 What does the object do in unmodded 6.35?
- 2 What does a named mod change?
- 3 What is the final value after the frozen mod order is applied?

Conflating those questions is one of the fastest ways to make an encyclopedia sound certain while returning the wrong rule.

## 3. Evidence status belongs beside the field

The register currently uses four public evidence states.

| Status                                     | Meaning                                                                                      | Proper use                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Official                                   | Directly supported by current official documentation                                         | Special-dominion rules and manual classifications                       |
| Source-confirmed                           | Present in the pinned 6.35 extracted game data                                               | IDs, names, requirements, statistics, site fields, and roster relations |
| Source-confirmed with unresolved selection | The effect is identified but the engine chooses from a group that is not completely resolved | Certain negative-tag or engine-selected summons                         |
| Test-pending                               | Available sources cannot support a complete current-version claim                            | Independent population-type recruitment                                 |

Source-confirmed does not mean infallible. It means that the value can be reproduced from a named source revision. A contentious value should still be checked against the 6.36 interface, a later official patch statement, or a second current extraction before it becomes the basis of a precise public claim.

## 4. Record hashes make silent change visible

Each record receives a SHA-256 hash calculated from its normalized fields. The hash is not a gameplay fact. It is an editorial control.

When a future source is imported, unchanged hashes identify stable records. Changed hashes identify objects requiring review. Added and removed IDs identify content changes. This permits a patch audit to concentrate on actual deltas instead of rereading thousands of cards.

A good update report can answer:

- which records changed;
- which fields changed;
- whether the change is official, extracted, or merely a new interpretation;
- which book sections and nation dossiers depend on those records;

- whether a website cache or search index must be rebuilt.

## 5. Raw fields and interpreted fields serve different readers

The register preserves selected source-native fields under names such as `mechanical_properties` and `extra_attributes`. These are valuable to researchers, but they are not always readable or fully decoded. The same record also carries interpreted fields such as `spell_kind`, `role_tags`, `throne_level`, `tier_class`, or a list of named national restrictions.

The two layers must remain separate. A raw field records what the source said. An interpreted field records what the publication concluded. When an interpretation changes, the source record should not be rewritten to match the conclusion.

## 6. A ninety-second lookup routine

A beginner need not read every field. Most practical lookups can follow the same order:

- 1 Confirm the ruleset and version.
- 2 Confirm the object type and engine ID.
- 3 Read its access fields: school, path, Construction level, nation, site, or era.
- 4 Read its cost and delivery fields.
- 5 Read the principal effect or relationship.
- 6 Open the canonical chapter for strategic consequences.
- 7 Check evidence status before relying on an edge case.

This order prevents two common mistakes: judging an object before confirming that the nation can access it, and treating a concise database field as though it contained the entire game rule.

## 7. The expert audit routine

An expert or editor should add five checks:

- 1 Inspect the engine ID and any chained or shaped identities.
- 2 Review source revision and file hash.
- 3 Distinguish explicit values from derived tags.
- 4 Compare unresolved attributes against the Modding Manual and current UI.
- 5 Record any correction as a new claim or revision, never as an undocumented overwrite.

The result is slower than reading a tooltip but much faster than rebuilding the same evidence for every guide.

# Part II: Spells

---

## 8. Spell rows and player-facing spells are not the same thing

The source contains 1,474 spell rows. Of these, 1,233 belong to a research school or Divine magic and 241 are marked unresearchable or internal. Internal rows can represent helper effects, hidden chains, scenario functions, or other engine work. They should not appear in an ordinary player's search results unless an advanced filter requests them.

The register gives every spell a `public_status`:

- `researchable-or-divine` for schools zero through seven;
- `unresearchable-or-internal` for school minus one.

This is a visibility classification, not a guarantee that every public row is generically available to every nation. National restrictions, realm restrictions, unique casters, and special access still apply.

## 9. School and research level

School numbers are translated into the current names used by the game:

| Source code | School         |
|-------------|----------------|
| 0           | Conjuration    |
| 1           | Alteration     |
| 2           | Evocation      |
| 3           | Construction   |
| 4           | Enchantment    |
| 5           | Thaumaturgy    |
| 6           | Blood          |
| 7           | Divine         |
| -1          | Unresearchable |

Research level is preserved separately. A level is not a complete access statement. The real access question combines school level, path requirements, cost, caster availability, national restriction, and sometimes a source or destination condition.

Fifty-nine public rows are flagged at research level nine. The flag supports the game's legendary-spell research option and gives the website a direct filter for the final research tier. [Book V](#) remains the canonical home for late-game research planning.

## 10. Path requirements are thresholds

Each spell record contains zero, one, or two path requirements. A requirement such as Fire 3 means that the caster must reach that threshold at the moment of casting. It does not identify how the threshold is reached.

The access chain may include:

- innate paths;
- communion or sabbath levels;
- path boosters;

- temporary gems;
- empowerment;
- a site bonus;
- a national or Pretender-only caster;
- a transformation or shape with different magic.

Those mechanisms belong to [Book V](#). The record supplies the threshold that the access analysis must meet.

## 11. Combat spell, ritual, and delivery context

The spell kind is derived from the attached effect record. A ritual and a combat spell can share superficially similar purposes while competing for entirely different resources and timing windows.

A spell record keeps:

- ritual status;
- fatigue cost as extracted;
- gem or slave cost as extracted;
- precision modifier;
- effect count;
- base and per-level range fields;
- base and per-level area fields;
- battlefield percentage where present;
- duration and modifier masks;
- province range attributes where exposed.

Several of these are source-native values rather than finished player prose. A website card should render the common cases clearly but preserve the raw value in an advanced panel. It should not guess how an unfamiliar mask is displayed.

## 12. Effects, roles, and the danger of one-label summaries

An effect record supplies an effect number and an extracted effect name. The register also adds restrained role tags, including:

- summon;
- damage or disable;
- buff or restoration;
- control;
- dispel;
- remote attack;
- remote assassination;
- strategic movement;
- site search;
- fort construction;
- transformation;
- enchantment;
- province enchantment.

These tags are search aids, not complete tactical judgments. A damaging spell may also create a cloud. A summon may be a battlefield screen, a path break, a raider, or a source of new recruitment. A global enchantment may primarily function as diplomacy rather than raw economy. The canonical chapter should receive the interpretive burden.

## 13. Chained spells

Some visible spells lead to another spell row through `next_spell`. The second row may hold an additional effect, a terrain-specific branch, or a helper operation. Searching only the first row can miss a summon or secondary consequence.

The importer follows each chain until it ends or repeats. Summon relationships are collected across the chain and attached to the visible root. The hidden rows remain independently addressable, making later patch comparisons possible.

A chain should be read as a graph:

```
visible spell -> effect row -> optional next spell -> optional further effect
```

The graph also explains why name-based scraping is unreliable. The second row may have an internal name that is never shown to a player.

## 14. National and realm restrictions

The extracted spell-attribute table identifies explicit national restrictions. The register resolves those numeric values into nation name and age where possible. A public website should display the restriction near the spell name rather than burying it below the effect.

Realm access is now resolved through the same versioned chain used by the Inspector. The Modding Manual supplies the ten official realm names and states that a realm-restricted spell belongs to nations with the matching home realm. The pinned nation attributes supply those home realms, while the Inspector's spell logic confirms that realm matches are added to explicit national access.

Six spells use realm restrictions in the 6.35 snapshot. Their North, Africa, or India requirements expand into ninety realm-to-nation links. Each record keeps the raw realm number, official realm name, eligible nations, explicit national entries, and their combined allowed list. This is an access relation, not a claim that every nation in a cultural region belongs to the realm; only the extracted `#homerealm` values count.

## 15. Cost fields are not an efficiency verdict

Gem or slave cost is recorded because it is an access fact. It is not enough to rank spells. Efficiency also depends on:

- mage-turn cost;
- research timing;
- caster scarcity;
- battlefield survival;
- expected targets;
- repeatability;
- opportunity cost against forging, empowerment, or another ritual;
- whether the effect creates a reusable asset;
- whether the spell reveals strategic information.

[Book V](#) explains those conversions. The database should make them calculable without pretending that one universal score can replace the campaign state.

## 16. Useful spell queries

Beginner searches should ask one concrete question at a time:

- all public spells in a chosen school and level;
- all spells requiring no more than a nation's current path ceiling;
- all battle buffs for a known army problem;
- all rituals that produce a commander;
- all site-search spells by path;
- all spells marked national for the selected nation.

Expert searches can combine access and role:

- remote attacks that meet a precise province range;
- battlefield-wide effects with a gem cost;
- summons that produce commanders with new paths;
- level-nine spells changed since the previous source revision;
- spells whose effect number or modifier mask remains undecoded;
- visible spells whose hidden chain changed while the root row did not.

# Part III: Magic Items, Artifacts, and Barding

## 17. Item identity and slot type

The first register contains 529 item records. Each one has a numeric ID, current name, slot type, Construction level, path requirements, attached weapon or armour ID where applicable, and a sparse set of mechanical properties.

Slot types include one-handed and two-handed weapons, missile weapons, shields, armour, helmets or crowns, boots, miscellaneous items, and barding. The slot is an equipment constraint, not a promise that every unit with an apparent body part can wear the object. Unit item slots, mount rules, minimum size, minimum strength, hand requirements, crown restrictions, and other item properties can still veto use.

[Book XI](#) owns the body and equipment-reading method. [Book V](#) owns forging and booster planning.

## 18. The Construction ladder and special records

The source uses the visible odd-numbered Construction tiers. The current distribution is:

| Construction level | Records | Register classification   |
|--------------------|---------|---------------------------|
| 1, 3, 5, or 7      | 378     | Ordinary forgeable        |
| 9                  | 118     | Unique artifact           |
| 11, 13, or 15      | 33      | Special or engine-managed |

The official manual identifies Construction 9 items as artifacts. Values above the ordinary ladder are retained as source facts but are not presented as ordinary forgeable tiers. They include special prizes

and engine-managed objects whose acquisition rules must be learned from the relevant event, spell, or scenario.

## 19. Requirements and actual forge access

An item may list one or two path requirements. Those are necessary thresholds, not a complete forge plan. A nation still needs:

- an eligible commander with appropriate item slots and magic;
- the required Construction research;
- sufficient gems;
- any national or unit restriction to be satisfied;
- freedom from an artifact uniqueness conflict;
- a mage-turn that is worth spending.

The database intentionally does not fabricate forge costs from path levels. Explicit UI or engine-export costs should be added as their own fields when a reliable current source is available.

## 20. Mechanical properties

Item properties are sparse: only non-empty source fields are retained. This prevents hundreds of meaningless zeroes while preserving unusual effects. Common fields include:

- resistances and reinvigoration;
- path boosts and path-range increases;
- temporary gems or gem generation;
- leadership, research, supply, patrol, siege, and forging bonuses;
- flight, sailing, water breathing, stealth, or map movement;
- regeneration, luck, etherealness, quickness, or defensive skins;
- start-of-battle spells, automatic spells, and item rituals;
- bearer restrictions and minimum body requirements;
- transformations, afflictions, curses, or insanity costs;
- national rebates and special acquisition rules.

A raw property name is not automatically safe prose. Edition 25 compares every item and site property used by the register with the pinned Inspector display tables. It supplies readable labels for all 233 item fields and 78 site-or-Throne fields. Of these, 221 item labels and 74 site labels reproduce the source interface wording. The remaining twelve item labels and four site labels are restrained editorial expansions, kept separate with a derived badge. Raw keys remain beside every label, so a readable filter never replaces the source field.

## 21. Boosters as access edges

The most strategically important item searches often concern path access rather than combat equipment. A booster can turn a caster into a node in a larger access graph:

```
native path -> first booster -> higher booster or summon -> ritual threshold
```

The item record provides the requirement and mechanical boost. A separate access calculator can then join it to national mage probabilities, summoned commanders, sites, and empowerment. That calculator should never assume that owning the gems is equivalent to owning the mage-turns or keeping the bearer alive.

## 22. Artifacts as a world-state race

Artifacts are unique. Their value includes denial, timing, and information. A static item score cannot capture the fact that another nation may forge the object first, that a holder may be killed, or that an artifact may begin yearning under the game's artifact rules.

The register marks artifact identity but leaves artifact-race doctrine in [Book V](#). A future campaign tool can add availability state without modifying the underlying object record:

- uncreated;
- yearning;
- forged by a known nation;
- forged, holder unknown;
- recovered;
- destroyed or otherwise unavailable.

That state belongs to a specific game, not to the base object.

## 23. Comparing equipment packages

Items should rarely be compared in isolation. The relevant unit, opponent, and battlefield create the package.

A reliable comparison asks:

- 1 Can the intended bearer equip every piece?
- 2 Which defence is weakest before equipment?
- 3 Does the package solve fatigue as well as protection?
- 4 Does it preserve movement and script reliability?
- 5 Does it answer the expected damage types and control effects?
- 6 What is lost if the bearer dies?
- 7 Would the same gems produce more value as research access, summons, or army support?

The database supplies the object fields. [Book IV](#) owns the combat derivation.

# Part IV: Summons

## 24. A summon record is a relationship

A summon is not adequately represented by a spell row or a unit row alone. It is the relationship between them.

Each summon relation currently records:

- the root spell ID and name;
- every directly resolved target unit;
- named selection groups for random, unique, or terrain-dependent results;
- unresolved engine selections;
- the extracted effect count;
- evidence status and source revision.

The target units continue to belong to the unit layer. Their abilities should be read through [Book XI](#), and their battle performance through [Book IV](#).



## 25. Direct, unique, terrain, and tag-based summons

The importer recognizes several broad forms.

| Form                 | Meaning                                         | Record treatment                                                                 |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Direct unit          | Effect points to a positive unit ID             | Unit ID and name are resolved                                                    |
| Direct commander     | Effect identifies a commander summon            | Commander ID and name are resolved                                               |
| Unique group         | One of a finite named group can answer          | Every known candidate is listed                                                  |
| Terrain group        | Result depends on terrain-specific table        | Every known candidate is listed under the terrain group                          |
| Chained summon       | A later spell row supplies an additional summon | Relation is attached to the root and chain retained                              |
| Negative monster tag | Engine chooses from a tagged group              | Raw selector is retained and marked unresolved unless the current table is known |

The first build had twenty-five selection-based relations without a complete explanation. Edition 25 resolves one through the Inspector's fixed Dwarf table and names the monster-tag selector for eighteen more. These include Longdead, Soulless, Random Bug, Random Animal, Ghoul, Lesser Horror, and Horror. The pinned export still does not expose their complete weighted unit membership, so it records the selector without inventing candidate odds. Six relations remain genuinely unresolved: five use raw selector -26 and one uses -18, neither of which appears in the pinned monster-tag or fixed-summon tables.

## 26. Quantity and scaling

The source carries an extracted effect count, but exact quantity can also depend on caster level, special effect rules, random selection, terrain, or a chained effect. The first register preserves the raw count and target relationship without converting every case into a prose formula.

A later verified quantity layer should distinguish:

- fixed base quantity;
- additional units per full path level;
- fractional scaling and rounding;
- commander plus retinue;
- one result selected from a unique pool;
- a variable or random composition;
- temporary battlefield summons;
- permanent strategic summons.

These are separate fields because a single number cannot describe them safely.

## 27. Summoned units as access and logistics

Summon evaluation begins with role, not statistics alone. Common roles include:

- path extension;
- site searching;
- forging access;
- leadership for magic, undead, or animals;
- siege mass;
- patrol strength;

- raiding and remote presence;
- sacred or bless-compatible force generation;
- amphibious or flying logistics;
- battlefield disruption;
- durable line combat;
- expendable screening.

The database can filter the result set by unit properties. The strategic conclusion still depends on a nation's shortages and timetable.

## 28. Unique summons are contested resources

Elemental royalty, Demon Lords, and other unique beings are not ordinary repeatable outputs. Their availability depends on what has already been summoned and, in some cases, what has died or returned.

The base register lists the candidate pool. A live-game overlay should track availability as mutable state. The object record should never be altered merely because one campaign has already consumed the unique target.

## 29. Shape graphs after summoning

A summoned commander may transform on land, underwater, in battle, on death, or through an activated ability. Looking only at the first form can conceal magic paths, item slots, movement permissions, or vulnerabilities.

The proper lookup follows shape links until the graph closes. [Book XI](#) explains shape-sensitive ability reading. The current Pretender records expose their major shape links; a later general unit graph should extend the same treatment to every summoned form.

# Part V: Pretender Forms

---

## 30. Form records and design records

The register contains 298 Pretender forms derived from national availability, home-realm membership, explicit additions, and explicit removals in the pinned data. A form record is not a finished Pretender build. It is the chassis before design choices are applied.

The record includes:

- body statistics;
- starting dominion;
- cost for a new path where extracted;
- innate magic;
- random-magic source fields if present;
- equipment IDs and body properties;
- minimum imprisonment source field where present;
- availability by nation and age;
- nation-specific cheap-god adjustments;
- major shape relationships.

Book III remains the authoritative guide to design points, awakening, scales, blessings, and role construction.

## 31. Availability is a relation, not a chassis property

Dagon is not an abstract underwater Pretender. It is available to a particular set of nations. Another chassis may be supplied by a home realm, removed from one nation, or discounted for a small family.

The database stores availability as a list of nation records. This makes several questions directly searchable:

- every chassis available to a selected nation;
- every nation that can choose a selected chassis;
- chassis shared across all ages of one cultural line;
- chassis that disappear or appear between ages;
- national discounts on an otherwise shared form.

This relation will prevent future dossiers from repeating a complete chassis inventory in prose.

## 32. Starting dominion and path cost are only the opening geometry

Starting dominion affects the design-point curve and the chassis's relationship with dominion strength. New-path cost affects the marginal price of diversification. Neither value determines the best build on its own.

A complete design must still price:

- awakening state;
- desired blessing thresholds;
- scales and national economic interaction;
- expansion reliability;
- research and forging access;
- the risk of chassis death;
- whether the chassis must be mobile, stealthy, amphibious, or present on the battlefield;
- whether special dominion systems reward stronger candles.

The record supplies the immutable chassis facts. Book III supplies the engineering method.

## 33. Innate paths, purchased paths, and shape changes

Innate paths belong to the current form. Purchased paths belong to the designed god. Shape changes can alter the body and may change how paths or equipment are used. The reference keeps innate paths and shape links separate.

When a chassis has multiple forms, the design audit should inspect:

- which form appears on the strategic map;
- which form fights;
- whether items remain equipped;
- whether a form is aquatic or land-capable;
- whether protection, regeneration, or movement changes;
- whether death or transformation is reversible.

No single thumbnail can carry this information safely.

## 34. Cheap-god relations

Some nations receive a twenty- or forty-point adjustment for named chassis. These discounts are stored as nation relations on the chassis record, not baked into a universal chassis cost.

This matters because the same form can be ordinary for one nation and economically distinctive for another. A website Pretender planner should apply the discount only after nation selection and should display its source rather than silently changing the price.

## 35. Useful Pretender queries

Beginner filters:

- all chassis available to the selected nation;
- awake candidates with a desired body type;
- immobile candidates;
- chassis beginning with a required magic path;
- chassis capable of operating underwater.

Expert filters:

- national discounts combined with path-cost breakpoints;
- chassis whose shape graph changes equipment access;
- chassis shared by likely opponents;
- forms with a special dominion interaction;
- version deltas in availability or innate paths;
- designs whose required path thresholds can be met by fewer purchased levels.

# Part VI: Thrones and Magic Sites

## 36. Thrones are sites with victory meaning

The extracted site table marks Thrones with rarity codes eleven, twelve, and thirteen. The register interprets these as Throne levels one, two, and three. The first build contains:

- 36 level-one Thrones;
- 26 level-two Thrones;
- 12 level-three Thrones.

They are removed from the ordinary site array and placed in their own Throne collection, so a website search does not double-count them. Their site identity remains intact.

[Book VI](#) owns Throne strategy, claiming, endgame conversion, and Cataclysm. The register owns the exact Throne objects and their effects.

## 37. Claimed and unclaimed fields

Site data can distinguish ordinary gem income from income granted after a Throne is claimed. It can also contain recruitment, scales, dominion effects, ritual modifiers, strength or resistance effects, unrest, population, supply, and other province changes.

A Throne card should visually separate:

- presence before claiming;
- effect after claiming;
- units or commanders available at the site;
- province or dominion changes;
- strategic risks created by the effect.

The database preserves the source fields but does not infer ownership timing for every unusual attribute. Where the manual or UI is required, the card should carry a verification note.

## 38. Site classes

The non-Throne collection contains 1,179 sites. The first classification uses the source rarity code:

- codes zero, one, or two: random discoverable sites;
- code five: special, capital, national, or event-managed sites;
- any other non-Throne code: retained as other until verified.

This classification helps search but should not be mistaken for a complete generation formula. Map terrain, site frequency, age, national starts, events, and scenario design can all shape actual presence.

## 39. Search level and path

Random sites commonly expose a path and search difficulty. Those fields answer two separate questions:

- which path can find the site;
- what search strength is required.

Site-search spells, remote search, and manual searching interact with those facts through rules explained in [Book V](#). A site record should never imply that a nation can exploit it merely because the site exists. Access may still require a laboratory, a fort, a priest, a commander with suitable leadership, or control of the province.

## 40. Location masks

The register decodes known location bits into readable terrain labels:

- plain;
- forest;
- mountain;
- waste;
- farm;
- sea;
- coast;
- swamp;

- deep sea;
- cave;
- underwater mountain;
- underwater forest;
- underwater coastal;
- unique.

The raw mask is retained beside the decoded list. If a later source adds a bit that is not yet understood, the raw value survives the import and the decoder can be extended without losing evidence.

## 41. Site income is not the whole site value

Gem income is the easiest site effect to compare, but it is often not the most important. Sites can provide:

- commanders or troops;
- path access;
- laboratories or forts;
- research or ritual modifiers;
- supply, resources, gold, or recruitment points;
- unrest, disease, horror, or population effects;
- province defence;
- dominion or scale changes;
- unique summons or adventures.

The value of a site depends on who owns it and whether the nation can exploit the granted access. The database makes the fields visible; [Book II](#) and [Book V](#) explain the economic and magical conversions.

## 42. Duplicate names and site identity

Several sites share a display name. An Academy of Magic in one path or terrain is not safely identified by name alone. Engine ID, path, location mask, and mechanical properties distinguish the records.

Website URLs should use stable IDs. Search results may group matching names for readability, but opening the card must reveal the numeric identity and distinguishing fields.

## 43. Throne comparison queries

Useful Throne searches include:

- all Thrones at the selected game level;
- claimed gem income by path;
- effects that change scales, unrest, population, or dominion;
- Thrones granting recruitable commanders;
- effects that alter ritual levels or Call God;
- Thrones whose effect can harm the owner as well as rivals;
- Throne records changed by a patch.

The query result is an intelligence aid, not a prediction of which Thrones the map generator selected.

# Part VII: Mercenaries and Independent Recruitment

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## 44. Mercenary company records

The register contains 78 mercenary companies. Each record joins the company to current unit identities and retains:

- company and commander name;
- commander unit;
- troop unit;
- starting troop count;
- minimum surviving strength;
- minimum bid;
- starting experience;
- random and fixed equipment fields;
- recruitment recovery rate;
- era mask resolved to Early, Middle, and Late Age availability.

The minimum bid is not the expected winning bid. The strategic value depends on competition, timing, map position, morale, equipment, and the opportunity cost of gold. [Book II](#) owns the economic comparison and [Book VI](#) owns the tempo decision.

## 45. Mercenary attrition and continuity

A company is not equivalent to buying a permanent national production line. Losses, recovery rate, contract timing, and rebidding shape its value. The record preserves the source fields needed for that analysis.

A practical mercenary card should answer:

- 1 What does the company add immediately?
- 2 Which roles does the national roster lack?
- 3 How many casualties can the company sustain before it becomes strategically irrelevant?
- 4 Does the commander add a useful path, leadership type, or item?
- 5 Is the bid buying expansion tempo, emergency defence, siege mass, or denial?

## 46. Why independent recruitment remains a marked gap

Independent province recruitment is strategically important, but the pinned 6.35 Inspector extract does not expose a population-type membership table. It contains current unit records but cannot prove which units and commanders each independent population type makes recruitable.

Older community catalogues describe generic humans, tribes, Amazons, cave peoples, mages, and other independent families. Carrying those tables forward as though they were a complete 6.35 export would violate the project's evidence standard. The first register contains one coverage marker instead of a fabricated list.

The marker records:

- what is missing;

- why the available source cannot prove it;
- what reliable evidence would close the gap;
- where current unit statistics can be joined once membership is known.

This is unfinished work, but it is controlled unfinished work.

## 47. The acceptable route to a current independent catalogue

The gap can be closed by either:

- a version-matched engine export of population types and recruit lists; or
- a published 6.35 reproduction giving population type, terrain and age conditions, unit IDs, commander IDs, and a repeatable method.

Once available, the data should be stored as relationships:

```
population type -> terrain and age conditions -> recruitable units and commanders
```

The units themselves should remain in the shared unit layer. Independent records should not copy their full statistics.

## 48. Evaluating independent access without a complete catalogue

Until the table is verified, campaign analysis can still evaluate a discovered province from the in-game recruitment panel. The useful questions are:

- Does the province repair a national weapon, armour, missile, leadership, or priest gap?
- Is the unit gold-, resource-, or recruitment-point efficient for that role?
- Does the province need a fort, temple, or laboratory before the key unit appears?
- Can production continue under likely unrest or siege pressure?
- Is the province strategically defensible enough to justify infrastructure?

The observation belongs to the current game. It should not be generalized into a universal population-type record without evidence.

# Part VIII: Special Dominion Systems

## 49. Why special dominions are database objects

Special dominions combine national identity with religious territory. They are neither ordinary unit abilities nor ordinary scale effects. The official manual gives them a dedicated section because they change what candles mean.

The register stores fourteen system families. Each record contains:

- a stable system identity;
- every applicable nation and age;
- a concise mechanical list paraphrased from the manual;
- the disciple inheritance rule;
- the official source locator;



- a canonical link to this volume and [Book III](#).

Exact national strategy remains dossier work. The shared system should be written once.

## 50. Official system register

| System                     | Nations or ages                    | Core effect                                                         | Disciple boundary                                                    |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dominion scrying           | Arcoscephale, all ages             | Accurate reports inside dominion, including Glamour detection       | Information is shared with disciples                                 |
| Dying dominion             | EA and LA Mictlan                  | Ordinary passive spread fails; blood sacrifice becomes central      | Dying dominion does not transfer                                     |
| Temple Oni                 | EA Yomi                            | Temples generate Oni according to Turmoil, terrain, and temperature | Does not transfer                                                    |
| Dreamlands                 | LA R'lyeh                          | Insanity, madmen, and Void Dreamer development                      | Extends into disciple lands with only partial protection             |
| Ashen Empire               | MA Ermor                           | Population death, undead arising, and corpse awareness              | Applies to disciples                                                 |
| Carrion Woods              | MA Asphodel                        | Population death and Carrion animation                              | Applies to disciples                                                 |
| Miasma                     | MA C'tis                           | Rain, disease, terrain change, and asymmetric income pressure       | Disciples are treated mostly as enemies; sacreds are immune          |
| Golem Cult                 | MA Agarthia                        | Constructs gain Hit Points                                          | Helps allied and enemy constructs inside the dominion                |
| Additional blood sacrifice | Seventeen named nation-age entries | Blood sacrifice supplements ordinary dominion spread                | Does not transfer, but an innately capable disciple keeps the order  |
| Dark Ships                 | MA Phaeacia                        | Commanders sail when origin and destination have friendly dominion  | Does not transfer; disciple-led Phaeacia still uses it               |
| Spectral dominion          | EA Therodos                        | Population decline and fort-generated ghosts                        | Applies in disciple games                                            |
| Dominion conflict          | EA Mekone                          | Maximum dominion counts one higher when suppressing enemy faith     | No transferred rule stated in the manual                             |
| Dominion unrest            | MA and LA Phlegra                  | Covered provinces gain unrest, increasing with local strength       | Operates through disciples only when Phlegra is the Pretender nation |
| Concealed provinces        | Ubar, Na'Ba, Ind, and Feminie      | Hides ownership and name behind a false independent appearance      | Disciples benefit                                                    |

## 51. Local strength, presence, and maximum dominion

Special systems depend on different religious variables. They must not be described with the vague phrase "stronger dominion helps" unless the source actually says so.

- Yomi needs the presence of at least one candle for temple generation, but the number of candles does not increase that generation; Turmoil does.
- Phlegra's unrest rises more with higher local dominion strength.
- Mekone modifies effective maximum dominion in a conflict calculation.
- Dark Ships tests whether origin and destination lie in friendly dominion.
- Miasma acts on covered provinces but treats ownership, sacred status, terrain, and underwater location differently.

The controlling variable must be an explicit record field in the next schema revision. Until then, it remains in the verified mechanic list.

## 52. Beneficiaries and victims

Special dominions often affect more than the owning nation. The manual explicitly describes cases involving disciples, enemies, allies, or every suitable object in the province.

The Golem Cult illustrates the danger. Constructs gain Hit Points in the dominion even when they belong to an enemy. A rule that sounds like a national bonus is actually a territorial modifier. The difference changes invasion planning and counter-selection.

Every future special-dominion record should expose four separate audiences:

- owner;
- disciple or ally;
- enemy;
- neutral or universal objects.

## 53. Permanent and reversible effects

Some systems change a province while it is covered. Others consume population, alter terrain, generate units, or accumulate insanity and unrest. Their consequences can outlast the candles that caused them.

A national dossier should distinguish:

- immediate reversible modifiers;
- accumulating but recoverable pressure;
- permanent terrain change;
- population conversion or destruction;
- generated units that persist after dominion changes;
- information effects that end when concealment ends.

This distinction belongs to the national application, not the shared one-line system record.

## 54. Disciples are an explicit field, not an afterthought

The official manual repeatedly states whether a special dominion transfers, partially transfers, or affects disciple lands without becoming the disciple nation's own ability. The register preserves that statement separately.

Team advice that ignores this field can recommend a pairing whose economy or armies are damaged by the master. MA Ermor, Asphodel, C'tis, R'Iyeh, and Phlegra all require more than a generic "special dominion" warning.

# Part IX: Website and Research Use

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## 55. The publication contract

`base-object-register.schema.json` defines the top-level contract. Every build must contain:

- schema version;
- edition and generation date;
- vanilla 6.35 structured-snapshot declaration with a visible 6.36 live-baseline overlay;
- evidence key;
- scope and deliberate exclusions;
- source manifest;
- per-category counts;
- the nine record collections.

Core record fields include stable ID, object type, name where applicable, ruleset, evidence status, source IDs, canonical section, verification date, and record hash.

The schema is intentionally strict at the collection level and permissive inside the specialist records. The source contains hundreds of rare fields. Prematurely forbidding an unfamiliar property would encourage data loss. Later schema revisions can tighten well-understood object families while retaining an escape hatch for raw source fields.

## 56. Default search views

A public site should provide at least three views.

### Guide view

Guide view hides internal spell rows, raw masks, unknown attributes, hashes, and source-file detail. It shows access, cost, principal effect, evidence badge, and a link to the canonical chapter.

### Advanced view

Advanced view exposes engine IDs, effect numbers, chained records, raw selectors, unusual item properties, site masks, and record hashes. It is intended for expert play, modding, and research.

### Change view

Change view compares two source revisions and lists added, removed, and changed records by field. It should also show which nation dossiers or canonical sections depend on the changed object.

## 57. Filters that should exist at launch

| Family     | Essential filters                                                                              |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Spells     | Public status, school, level, paths, kind, role, cost, national restriction, legendary flag    |
| Items      | Slot, Construction level, artifact class, paths, path boost, movement, economy, restriction    |
| Summons    | Spell school, spell level, target type, unique group, resolved status, unit abilities          |
| Pretenders | Nation, age, starting dominion, path cost, innate paths, discount, movement class, shape links |
| Thrones    | Level, path income, claimed effect, recruitment, scales, dominion, population, unrest          |

| Family            | Essential filters                                                                             |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sites             | Path, search level, terrain, rarity class, gem income, recruitment, ritual or research effect |
| Mercenaries       | Age, troop type, commander, starting strength, minimum bid, experience                        |
| Special dominions | Nation, age, controlling variable, beneficiary, disciple transfer, permanent effect           |

## 58. Related-object links

The website should make object relationships visible without copying pages.

- A summon spell links to every possible unit.
- A summoned unit links back to every producing spell.
- A Pretender links to its available nations and shape forms.
- A site links to recruitable units and commanders.
- A mercenary links to its leader, troop, and fixed items.
- A special dominion links to each applicable nation dossier.
- A national spell links to the nation and its research branch.

These links turn the library into a graph rather than a stack of articles.

## 59. Example website questions

The object layer can answer questions that are awkward in prose:

- Which Nature rituals create commanders rather than troops?
- Which Construction 5 items increase path access?
- Which level-two Thrones grant commanders or research effects?
- Which Pretender chassis are shared by two selected nations?
- Which mercenary companies exist in the Middle Age and begin with experienced troops?
- Which sites can appear underwater and grant recruitable commanders?
- Which special dominions harm disciples or enemies as well as helping the owner?
- Which summon relations remain unresolved in the current evidence set?

The answer can then link to strategy rather than embedding a generic recommendation in every object card.

## 60. Nation dossier integration

A dossier should not print a complete copy of every national spell, Pretender, summon, and site. It should select the records that matter to the nation's plans and add only national analysis.

A clean dossier entry can contain:

- object ID and short name;
- why the nation can access it;
- the timing branch it enables;
- the national role it fills;
- likely counters or failure modes;
- links to the base record and canonical rule chapter;
- modded delta where relevant.

This is the foundation that allows nation work to resume without creating hundreds of duplicate fact paragraphs.

# Part X: Verification and Maintenance

---

## 61. Import controls

The importer refuses an unexpected upstream commit unless an explicit refresh flag is supplied. This protects the frozen 6.35 baseline from a silent pull of later data.

The source manifest records:

- repository URL;
- commit and date;
- commit subject;
- source licence note;
- SHA-256 hashes for every imported table;
- official manual identity and hash.

The build also confirms category counts, stable ID uniqueness, required fields, record-hash length, and internal JSON validity.

## 62. Cross-source verification

The source hierarchy for object work is:

- 1 current official manual or patch statement;
- 2 current in-game UI or exact engine export;
- 3 pinned 6.35 extracted data;
- 4 a published reproduction with method and version;
- 5 community summary or strategic commentary.

Lower layers can discover a question. They do not silently overrule a higher layer. When the manual and extraction disagree, both values should be recorded and the public field marked unresolved until the current UI or patch history settles it.

## 63. Known limitations of the current build

The current build is deliberately incomplete in several places.

- Independent population-type membership is absent.
- Eighteen named monster-tag selectors still lack complete weighted candidate membership.
- Six summon relations use selectors absent from the pinned tag and fixed-summon tables.
- Sixteen readable property labels remain derived rather than source-confirmed.
- Unit descriptions, spell descriptions, item descriptions, and artwork are excluded.
- The register does not yet contain every weapon, armour, unit, event, or nation record because those have separate ownership or future schemas.
- Source-confirmed values have not all received an independent UI check.

These limitations are part of the publication, not hidden production notes.

## 64. Correction workflow

When an error is found:

- 1 Record the object ID, field, current value, proposed value, and ruleset.
- 2 Attach the strongest available source and exact locator.
- 3 Decide whether the source extraction, importer, interpretation, or prose is wrong.
- 4 Correct the narrowest authoritative layer.
- 5 Regenerate hashes, search indexes, and dependent pages.
- 6 Add a revision note when the public meaning changed.
- 7 Preserve the earlier version for patch comparison.

This workflow avoids the common failure in which a number is corrected in one article while copies remain wrong elsewhere.

## 65. Patch refresh workflow

A later official patch should be processed as a controlled migration:

- 1 archive the current manifest and register;
- 2 import the new exact-version data into a separate build;
- 3 compare record hashes;
- 4 classify each delta as addition, removal, rename, mechanical change, or extraction change;
- 5 compare the official patch note with the observed delta;
- 6 update canonical prose only where the general rule changed;
- 7 update nation dossiers only where national conclusions changed;
- 8 publish a version digest and redirects for renamed objects.

The full official patch ledger remains the next separate structured-data project after this object layer.

## 66. Mod overlay workflow

Dominions Enhanced and Divinitus should be applied as versioned overlays, not folded into the vanilla records.

An overlay record should identify:

- base object ID, if an existing object is selected;
- mod source file and line;
- load-order position;
- field additions, replacements, and clears;
- newly allocated ID where known;
- unresolved automatic allocation where not known;
- final combined value after every earlier mod is applied.

[Book IX](#) already establishes the frozen mod order and collision discipline. The base object register now supplies the vanilla side of that comparison.

# Essay I: Object Literacy Is Strategic Literacy

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Dominions is often described as a game of hidden knowledge. The phrase is only partly true. Much of the knowledge is visible, but it is distributed across cards, paths, schools, shapes, national rosters, sites, rituals, and turn timing. The difficulty lies less in secrecy than in joining the pieces quickly enough to make a decision.

An object database does not remove judgment. It removes avoidable retrieval cost. A player who can immediately find every ritual that produces a Death commander can spend time comparing risk, timing, and price. A player who cannot find the candidates must rely on memory, and memory tends to preserve famous options while losing narrow or recently changed ones.

The same principle applies to counterplay. An unfamiliar item need not remain a mystery if its slot, resistances, automatic spells, movement changes, and bearer restrictions can be read in one place. The strategic question then becomes concrete: which part of the package creates the threat, and which part can be denied?

Object literacy also improves restraint. Easy access to a catalogue makes it tempting to select the most impressive card. A well-designed reference pushes in the opposite direction by showing access costs and relationships. The object exists inside a conversion chain. Research, gems, mage-turns, infrastructure, position, and risk all stand between possibility and effect.

The strongest use of the database is not encyclopaedic display. It is careful exclusion. Filters can remove options the nation cannot reach, afford, deliver, or exploit in time. The remaining set is small enough for genuine strategic reasoning.

## Essay II: Versioned Facts and Reproducible Judgment

---

A strategy library becomes unreliable when it treats facts as timeless. Dominions patches can change a requirement, cost, unit, site, or exception. Mods can replace the same object again. A remembered truth may remain broadly sensible while its numerical premise has expired.

Versioned records solve only half of that problem. They can show what changed, but not whether the old recommendation still works. That requires reproducible judgment.

A good recommendation names its premises. It identifies the ruleset, object IDs, national access, research timing, costs, expected opponent, and intended role. When a patch changes one premise, the conclusion can be retested without reconstructing the original argument from memory.

This also improves disagreement. Two players may recommend different summons because they assume different map sizes, gem incomes, research rates, or enemy compositions. With explicit records and assumptions, the disagreement becomes informative rather than rhetorical.

The library's long-term value will not come from claiming finality. It will come from making correction cheap, visible, and local. Stable identities, source manifests, evidence labels, and record hashes turn a correction from an editorial crisis into routine maintenance.

## Part XI: Practical Reference Sheets

---

## 67. Object-card minimum fields

| Object           | Minimum public card                                                                                     |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Spell            | Name, ID, school, level, paths, combat or ritual, cost, role, restriction, evidence                     |
| Item             | Name, ID, slot, Construction level, paths, principal properties, restrictions, artifact state, evidence |
| Summon           | Producing spell, possible units, selection rule, quantity status, permanence, evidence                  |
| Pretender        | Name, ID, nations, starting dominion, path cost, innate paths, body, forms, discounts, evidence         |
| Throne           | Name, ID, level, claimed effects, income, recruitment, risks, evidence                                  |
| Site             | Name, ID, path, search level, terrain, income, recruitment, other effects, evidence                     |
| Mercenary        | Company, leader, troop, age, strength, minimum bid, experience, recovery, evidence                      |
| Special dominion | System, nations, controlling variable, beneficiaries, victims, disciple rule, evidence                  |

## 68. Beginner lookup checklist

- Confirm vanilla or modded ruleset.
- Search by name, then confirm engine ID.
- Check access before effect.
- Check cost and timing before enthusiasm.
- Open linked rules when a field is unfamiliar.
- Treat source-confirmed and unresolved badges differently.
- Use the current game interface when a campaign decision turns on an edge case.

## 69. Expert comparison checklist

- Compare stable IDs and record hashes between versions.
- Inspect chained spells and shape graphs.
- Separate raw fields from publication-derived tags.
- Resolve national and realm restrictions.
- Join summons to current unit records.
- Join sites to terrain and ownership conditions.
- Model mutable campaign state outside the base record.
- Record uncertainty instead of normalizing it away.

## 70. Editorial no-duplication checklist

- Search the Reader's Guide and object register before drafting.
- Link to [Book II](#) for economy, [Book III](#) for Pretenders and dominion, [Book IV](#) for combat, [Book V](#) for magic, [Book VI](#) for strategy, and [Book XI](#) for abilities.
- Add a new paragraph only when it explains an object-specific exception, application, correction, or evidence result.
- Keep complete inventories in data, not prose.
- Use one stable object ID across every dossier and essay.
- Update the source record once, then regenerate dependants.



## 71. What this unlocks

The base-game object layer is now substantial enough to support the next phases without returning to repeated manual research.

It unlocks:

- object-aware nation dossiers;
- vanilla-versus-DE-versus-Divinitus comparison pages;
- spell, item, summon, Pretender, Throne, site, and mercenary filters;
- cross-object search and access graphs;
- patch-by-patch record comparison;
- automatic detection of changed national recommendations;
- a reliable boundary between verified facts and unresolved engine behaviour.

The remaining G-03 work is narrow and explicit: resolve independent population types, enumerate the weighted candidates behind eighteen named monster tags, identify the six remaining raw selectors, and replace sixteen derived property labels when stronger source wording becomes available. Realm-restricted spell access is complete for the pinned snapshot. None of the open items prevents the register from serving as the reusable foundation for the website and later dossiers.

## Source Record

### Official sources

- Illwinter Game Design, Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2, especially Magic Sites, Mercenaries, Pretenders, artifacts, and Special Dominions, pp. 28-36, 79-88, and 100-116.
- Illwinter Game Design, Dominions 6 Modding Manual, version 6.34, for object selection, IDs, properties, sites, population types, spells, items, and national relations.
- [Illwinter Dominions 6 documentation](#).

### Version-matched extracted source

- [Dominions 6 Data Inspector repository](#), commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc, "Update to 6.35," 26 May 2026.
- [Dominions 6 Data Inspector](#), used as a public cross-check for the extracted object families.

### Project artefacts

- `website/base-object-register.json` - 4,196 versioned records plus realm expansion, selector records, and property-label provenance.
- `website/base-object-register.schema.json` - publication contract.
- `tools/build_base_object_register.py` - pinned, reproducible importer.
- `18-foundation-coverage-gap-audit.md` - ownership and G-03 definition.
- `37-edition-25-object-layer-maintenance.md` - Edition 25 evidence and validation record.
- [Book III](#) - canonical Pretender and special-dominion rules.
- [Book V](#) - canonical magic, research, ritual, and forging method.
- [Book VI](#) - canonical Throne, mercenary, and campaign strategy.
- [Book XI](#) - canonical unit and ability interpretation.

## DOCUMENT 15 OF 16

# Foundation Book XIII: Version History and the Official Patch Ledger

## Ruleset, purpose, and evidence boundary

This volume belongs to the unmodded Dominions 6.37 ruleset. Its historical range begins with the public 6.01 update of 19 January 2024 and ends with 6.37, released on 9 September 2026. Dominions Enhanced 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE remain separate rulesets. Their changes are not folded into the official chronology, even where a mod later adopted or anticipated a similar rule.

The official announcements contain 1,096 individual change bullets across 33 named updates. Book XIII turns that material into two complementary resources:

- a readable account of how the live ruleset developed;
- `website/official-patch-ledger.json`, a machine-readable record of every official bullet, its release, source locator, source hash, editorial classification, affected domains, and canonical library destinations.

The ledger does not reproduce the full wording of the announcements. Each record identifies its official source and preserves a hash of the normalized source bullet. The public layer adds only a restrained summary and editorial metadata. This keeps the history verifiable without making the project a mirror of Illwinter's publication.

The source of record is the complete official Dominions 6 announcement feed exposed through Steam, checked against the [official announcement archive](#) and the [Illwinter Dominions 6 site](#). The [official documentation page](#) remains the authority for the main manual and the separate modding, event, map-making, and file-format manuals.

## The no-duplication delta

Earlier books own the rules themselves. [Book I](#) owns ruleset labels and hosting order. Books II through VI own economy, religion, combat, magic, and campaign conduct. [Book VIII](#) owns mod construction. [Book X](#) owns operation and hosting. Books XI and XII own ability and object lookup. Repeating those explanations release by release would make the library harder to maintain.

Book XIII owns a different question: when did the current rule become current, what older statement did it displace, and which part of the library must be reviewed when it changes?

This produces a firm editorial boundary:

- use Book XIII to establish chronology, provenance, and change impact;
- use the linked foundation book to understand the current mechanic;
- use the official announcement when exact source wording is necessary;
- use a historical executable or preserved save only when a past-version interaction itself is under study.

The patch ledger is therefore not a second combat guide, spell guide, or modding manual. It is the maintenance spine that tells every other guide when it may have become stale.

## What the ledger contains

| Measure                                                | Current result                  | Meaning                                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Official update announcements                          | 33                              | Every public announcement titled Dominions 6.01 through Dominions 6.37 in the official feed |
| Individual change records                              | 1,096                           | One record for every bullet under General, Modding, Map Making, or a named national section |
| First dated release                                    | 6.01, 19 January 2024           | The first public post-launch update in the feed                                             |
| Current baseline                                       | 6.37, 9 September 2026          | The version used by this edition                                                            |
| Public version numbers without a matching announcement | 4                               | 6.10, 6.20, 6.22, and 6.26                                                                  |
| Distinct #commands named in update bullets             | 221                             | A chronology seed for the complete command lexicon planned after this book                  |
| 6.35 classification snapshot                           | 783 high, 26 medium, 255 review | Historical classifier totals retained until the complete 6.37 ledger is regenerated         |

The four absent numbers are described only as numbers without matching public announcements. They are not called missing releases. A private build, skipped label, withdrawn build, or unannounced numbering decision cannot be distinguished from the public feed alone.

# Part I: Reading Versioned Rules

## 1. The current rule and its history are different facts

A current rules reference should normally state the rule that applies now. A version history should state how that rule arrived. Mixing the two produces avoidable ambiguity.

Consider regeneration. A current ability entry should explain how regeneration behaves in 6.37. The historical note that version 6.31 changed percentage regeneration from bracketed results to a more exact percentage calculation matters when evaluating an older guide, battle report, or saved test. It does not need to interrupt every ordinary explanation of regeneration.

The same separation applies throughout the library:

| Question                                           | Proper home                        |
|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| What does this mechanic do in 6.37?                | Its canonical foundation book      |
| Which update changed it?                           | Book XIII and the patch ledger     |
| What did the official announcement say?            | The linked official update         |
| How did it behave in a preserved older executable? | A version-labelled historical test |
| Does DE or Divinitus change it again?              | Book IX or the later mod overlay   |

This division keeps ordinary reading smooth while preserving enough history to repair old claims.

## 2. A version label has five parts

The phrase "current Dominions" is too weak for durable research. A useful version label contains:

- 1 Game version. Here the baseline is Dominions 6.37.
- 2 Ruleset. Vanilla, DE, Divinitus, or a named combined load order must be explicit.
- 3 Manual revision. The main manual and auxiliary manuals do not necessarily advance together.
- 4 Data revision. Extracted object data needs its own commit, date, or hash.
- 5 Publication date. The date distinguishes a genuinely current statement from an undated page that merely uses present tense.

A concise public label can read:

Dominions 6.37, unmodded; official updates through 9 September 2026;  
object data pinned separately; page reviewed 5 August 2026.

The full evidence record can then hold source hashes and tool versions without burdening the reader-facing sentence.

## 3. Patch notes are deltas, not replacement manuals

An update bullet usually assumes knowledge of the prior state. It may say that an effect now works during a siege, that a restriction was removed, or that a statistic was corrected. It rarely restates all eligibility rules, timing, exceptions, and downstream interactions.

Three consequences follow.

First, a patch bullet cannot safely be expanded beyond what it says. "Can now" proves a newly permitted case; it does not prove that every adjacent case works the same way. Second, a corrected bug can become part of ordinary current rules even when the old behaviour was never documented. Third, several bullets may jointly define the current state of one mechanic.

The editorial task is therefore a merge:

```
current rule = surviving manual rule
+ later official deltas
+ current object data where appropriate
- superseded or corrected statements
```

The terms in that expression do not have equal authority. The manual and official updates are direct official evidence. Extracted data is version-pinned supporting evidence. A community test can resolve behaviour the documents do not expose, but its version and method must remain attached.

## 4. Four common patch-reading errors

### 4.1 Treating a bug as a permanent rule

An old battle report may accurately show what an earlier executable did. If the behaviour was later fixed, the report remains historical evidence but ceases to be a current rule source. The distinction is especially important for communions, mounted units, shape changes, retreat, remote rituals, and blessings, all of which received repeated corrections.

### 4.2 Treating a wording change as a mechanical change

Presentation, tooltip, message, and statistics-display corrections may reveal the rule more clearly without changing resolution. A revised icon is not automatically a revised ability. Conversely, a display correction may expose a mechanical value that had always been active. The ledger therefore separates presentation, interface, data correction, rule change, balance change, and bug fix.

### 4.3 Treating an added command as a fully documented command

An announcement can establish that a mod command exists. It does not necessarily provide its complete syntax, selection context, legal values, copying behaviour, clearing behaviour, or error handling. Those belong in the current Modding Manual and the future command lexicon.

### 4.4 Treating a missing number as a missing source

The public sequence skips 6.10, 6.20, 6.22, and 6.26. Nothing in the feed establishes why. The correct statement is narrow: no official announcement with any of those four titles appears in the complete app-news response used for this edition.

## 5. Which old claims deserve immediate review

A patch does not make every old guide equally unsafe. The highest review priority belongs to claims that determine legality, access, irreversible resource spending, survival, or multiplayer administration.

| Review priority | Claim type                                                                                      | Typical consequence of being stale                                 |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Critical        | Order legality, host validation, save integrity, exploit prevention                             | Failed turn, rejected order, corrupted workflow, unfair game state |
| High            | Spell access, ritual targeting, communion behaviour, retreat, transformation, siege permissions | Lost mage, wasted gems, failed operation, destroyed army           |
| High            | Bless cost or activation, Pretender status, recruitment restriction                             | Invalid design or roster plan                                      |
| Medium          | Unit cost, item effect, Throne effect, site output                                              | Mispriced strategy or inaccurate comparison                        |
| Medium          | Interface shortcut, message, filter, overview                                                   | Avoidable operational friction                                     |
| Low             | Sprite, sound, typo, graphical effect                                                           | Little or no strategic error unless identity is obscured           |

This priority order controls the maintenance queue. It does not claim that a low-priority correction is unimportant to the quality of the game; it means the correction is less likely to invalidate strategic advice.

# Part II: The Complete Official Release Spine

## 6. Release density and what it reveals

The update history is front-loaded. Twenty-one announcements and 774 of the 1,096 recorded changes appeared in 2024. Eight announcements and 222 changes appeared in 2025. Four updates in 2026 contribute the remaining 100 changes through the present baseline.

| Calendar year            | Announcements | Change records | Share of all records |
|--------------------------|---------------|----------------|----------------------|
| 2024                     | 21            | 774            | 70.6%                |
| 2025                     | 8             | 222            | 20.3%                |
| 2026 through 9 September | 4             | 100            | 9.1%                 |

This is not a measure of importance. A short later update can change a central rule. It does show why undated launch-era guides require careful repair: most of the public delta history accumulated during the first year.

## 7. The 2024 release sequence

| Version | Date   | Records | Historical profile                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|---------|--------|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6.01    | 19 Jan | 33      | First balance and correctness pass; global-enchantment attacks were detached from NAP restrictions, and several roster and transformation problems were corrected.                                                 |
| 6.02    | 24 Jan | 29      | Research and object corrections, hosting work, and the rule that dormant gods do not age while dormant.                                                                                                            |
| 6.03    | 25 Jan | 17      | Siege and NAP interaction, AI diplomacy, lobby research, and repeatable #natcom and #natmon use.                                                                                                                   |
| 6.04    | 2 Feb  | 60      | Broad bug-fix release with blessing, event, AI, hidden-map, national recruitment, and mod-command additions.                                                                                                       |
| 6.05    | 9 Feb  | 41      | Combat-fatigue and lasting-HP corrections, recruitment fixes, resource-information privacy, prophet recovery, and hosting stability.                                                                               |
| 6.06    | 11 Feb | 6       | Small hotfix led by coastal-fort recruitment and network correction.                                                                                                                                               |
| 6.07    | 16 Feb | 35      | Lobby reversion to setup, siege-cast remote ritual repair, broader scale modding, and ammunition-fatigue mod support.                                                                                              |
| 6.08    | 6 Mar  | 102     | Largest announcement in the ledger: major Asphodel revision, extensive rules and UI repair, many commands, and important changes to Twiceborn, passive blessings, Fear and Dread, empowerment, and site searching. |
| 6.09    | 12 Mar | 18      | Focused fixes to movement abilities, summons, items, networking, and mod commands.                                                                                                                                 |
| 6.11    | 20 Mar | 24      | Manikin and object work, roster corrections, and additions including #hidedom.                                                                                                                                     |
| 6.12    | 29 Apr | 89      | LA Pyrene, a large rules pass over disciples, communions, remote rituals, map targets, transformations, events, and modding.                                                                                       |
| 6.13    | 15 May | 52      | Besieged-fort teleport targets, random preaching order, NAP siege movement, major experience changes, interface work, and new event/global commands.                                                               |
| 6.14    | 16 May | 5       | Immediate correction release, including experience-related hit-point statistics.                                                                                                                                   |
| 6.15    | 29 May | 33      | Grand Communion, victory-graph handling, illusion and false-damage rules, communion gem correction, and event-variable expansion.                                                                                  |
| 6.16    | 18 Jun | 29      | Fort-ritual repair, mercenary-screen operation, settlement and transformation work, plus map and event modding fixes.                                                                                              |
| 6.17    | 20 Jun | 3       | Settings compatibility, vanilla gem-longevity default correction, and lobby connection tracking.                                                                                                                   |
| 6.18    | 9 Jul  | 24      | Undying healing, starvation removal after non-eating transformation, underwater and multiplane-map work, and defensive file handling.                                                                              |
| 6.19    | 26 Aug | 38      | Afflicted-mount reclaiming, blessing and item fixes, underwater cases, and notable event, fort, ritual, and nation commands.                                                                                       |

| Version | Date   | Records | Historical profile                                                                                                                                      |
|---------|--------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6.21    | 10 Oct | 26      | Income-overview improvements, siege and mount fixes, lobby retention policy, rebirth behaviour, cave growth, and map-editor repair.                     |
| 6.23    | 3 Dec  | 53      | A substantial balance and rules pass touching Fear, Dread, Asphodel, mounts, communions, events, research requirements, and terrain-linked recruitment. |
| 6.24    | 17 Dec | 57      | Ind, new Thrones and a spell, combat and ritual restrictions, order copying, large-file networking, terrain recruitment, and a broad mod-command set.   |

## 8. The 2025 release sequence

| Version | Date   | Records | Historical profile                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------|--------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6.25    | 15 Jan | 29      | Praise, Pillar of Truths, battle-version display, indoor battlefield-wide spell restrictions, temperature display, and mount and bless corrections.                       |
| 6.27    | 7 Mar  | 42      | Seven new Thrones, treasury autosort, disease-spell resistance, Haunted Forest and Utterdark revision, ritual target validation, AI work, and new battle-summon commands. |
| 6.28    | 8 Mar  | 4       | Hotfix for Call God, event-producing rituals, map item spells, and scripted AI priority.                                                                                  |
| 6.29    | 22 Apr | 47      | Planar ritual boundaries, order copying with 0, allied-territory waiting, large-battle performance, communion backlash, AI ritual improvements, and many mod commands.    |
| 6.30    | 6 Oct  | 53      | LA Zemaitia, Fay additions, lab-to-commander gem shortcuts, new Pretenders, many combat and movement corrections, larger network turns, and ritual-loop detection.        |
| 6.31    | 20 Oct | 19      | Exact percentage regeneration, longer wall enchantments, higher bless-effect limit, faster hosting, underwater Creeping Doom, and mounted/event fixes.                    |
| 6.32    | 13 Nov | 10      | Mounted gateway crash fix, secondary-shape Soul Slay, remote Blood Vengeance loot restriction, Farstrike targeting, and #forcess.                                         |
| 6.33    | 16 Dec | 18      | Faster map rendering, cheat detection, barding and yearning fixes, AoE explanations, several unit corrections, and #homerealm.                                            |

## 9. The 2026 release sequence

| Version | Date   | Records | Historical profile                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---------|--------|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6.34    | 27 Feb | 44      | Fay summons and Pretenders, ritual-message and ability-icon work, AI corrections, automatic summons during siege, rebirth healing, security repair, and performance improvements.                        |
| 6.35    | 18 May | 24      | Gnu content and the Throne of Violence, script resumption for innate casters, victory reveal behaviour, teleport movement from besieged forts, interface additions, mount recovery, and integrity fixes. |
| 6.36    | 17 Aug | 26      | Movement, Rust, Blood Sacrifice ordering, mounts, interface and replay corrections, plus five event-modding command additions.                                                                           |
| 6.37    | 9 Sep  | 6       | Level-nine research access, drowning for non-commanders, Drake breath timing, game-switch memory use, anti-cheat work, and unspecified stat and typo corrections.                                        |

## 9.1 Dominions 6.37 maintenance impact

The [official Dominions 6.37 announcement](#) describes six General changes. Three have direct rules-facing consequences: some level-nine spells had been impossible to research, drowning did not always affect non-commanders, and Drakes recovered too quickly after using a breath weapon in melee. The announcement also records a memory-leak fix when switching games, anti-cheat improvements, and unspecified statistic and typo corrections.

The patch establishes the corrected categories but does not name the affected level-nine spells, define every drowning trigger, quantify the corrected Drake delay, or identify the objects covered by the generic statistic note. Those details remain unresolved rather than being inferred. The release names no mod commands, so the 226-token command reconciliation remains unchanged; the executable baseline advances to 6.37 while the live Modding Manual remains version 6.36 and the structured object snapshot remains pinned to 6.35.

## 10. The absent public numbers

No matching official announcement was present for 6.10, 6.20, 6.22, or 6.26. The ledger preserves that fact in `scope.unannounced_version_numbers`. These labels are intentionally excluded from the release table and from any inferred chronology.

A future source may explain one or more gaps. If that happens, the correction should add the source and revise the scope note. It should not silently manufacture release dates or change bullets from forum recollection.

# Part III: The Classification and Evidence Model

## 11. One official bullet becomes one patch record

Every source bullet receives a stable record ID. `patch-6-35-015`, for example, identifies the fifteenth bullet in the normalized 6.35 announcement sequence. A record contains:

- version and publication date;
- official section and bullet index;
- source announcement identity and URL;
- SHA-256 of the source bullet and of the normalized record;
- editorial change class and confidence;
- affected domains;
- direction and materiality;
- named `#commands`, terms, and object mentions where detected;
- canonical destinations elsewhere in the library;
- a concise impact summary that does not reproduce the source text.

The ID is a publication key, not an official Illwinter identifier. The official source identity remains separate.



## 12. The fourteen change classes

| Class                        | Records | Share | Editorial meaning                                                                  |
|------------------------------|---------|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bug fix                      | 234     | 22.0% | A stated malfunction or inconsistency was corrected.                               |
| Rule or permission change    | 193     | 18.1% | Legality, timing, targeting, immunity, or behaviour changed.                       |
| Balance adjustment           | 177     | 16.6% | Cost, strength, chance, quantity, or comparative value changed.                    |
| Modding behaviour change     | 113     | 10.6% | Existing mod or parser behaviour changed or was repaired.                          |
| Mod-command addition         | 81      | 7.6%  | One or more new #commands were announced.                                          |
| Interface or quality of life | 68      | 6.4%  | A screen, shortcut, display, filter, or workflow changed.                          |
| Performance or stability     | 43      | 4.0%  | Speed, memory, crash resistance, or hosting stability improved.                    |
| Artificial intelligence      | 40      | 3.8%  | Strategic or spellcasting AI behaviour changed.                                    |
| Network or hosting           | 36      | 3.4%  | Lobby, server, connection, transfer, or turn-file behaviour changed.               |
| Data correction              | 30      | 2.8%  | Statistics, text-linked data, or object records were corrected.                    |
| Content addition             | 21      | 2.0%  | A named nation, unit, spell, item, Throne, Pretender, or similar object was added. |
| Presentation                 | 18      | 1.7%  | Graphics, sound, animation, text rendering, or appearance changed.                 |
| Security or integrity        | 8       | 0.8%  | Cheat detection, exploit handling, validation, or corrupted-data handling changed. |
| Map-making change            | 2       | 0.2%  | A map-making-only change was identified outside broader modding treatment.         |

These are navigation classes, not official headings. A single bullet can reasonably touch several ideas. The record stores one primary class to keep filters usable, then adds multiple affected domains.

## 13. Domain tags are many-to-many

A remote ritual that crosses planes, targets a besieged fort, spends gems, and moves an army may touch magic, movement, maps, hosting order, and interface messaging at once. Forcing it into one subject would hide the cross-system risk.

The most frequently tagged domains are:

| Domain                      | Records carrying the tag | Canonical interpretation home                                          |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Modding                     | 195                      | <a href="#">Book VIII</a>                                              |
| Magic and spells            | 171                      | <a href="#">Book V</a> and <a href="#">Book XII</a> records            |
| Maps and scenarios          | 158                      | <a href="#">Book VIII</a>                                              |
| General game objects        | 156                      | <a href="#">Book XII</a>                                               |
| Combat                      | 146                      | <a href="#">Book IV</a>                                                |
| Summons and transformations | 115                      | <a href="#">Books V</a> , <a href="#">XI</a> , and <a href="#">XII</a> |
| Operations and interface    | 89                       | <a href="#">Book X</a>                                                 |
| Presentation                | 69                       | <a href="#">Book XIII</a> maintenance layer                            |

| Domain                           | Records carrying the tag | Canonical interpretation home           |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Hosting and network              | 67                       | <a href="#">Book X</a>                  |
| Items and artifacts              | 67                       | <a href="#">Books V and XII</a>         |
| Events                           | 66                       | <a href="#">Book VIII</a>               |
| Nations and rosters              | 57                       | <a href="#">Book VII dossier system</a> |
| Movement and logistics           | 53                       | <a href="#">Book VI</a>                 |
| Units, abilities, and conditions | 53                       | <a href="#">Book XI</a>                 |
| Dominion and blessings           | 49                       | <a href="#">Book III</a>                |

Domain totals exceed 1,096 because one record can affect several domains. That overlap is a feature: it identifies which books and website records must be reviewed together.

## 14. Classification confidence is not source confidence

All 1,096 source bullets are official. The uncertainty concerns only the project's derived labels.

| Label            | Records | Meaning                                                                                                                    |
|------------------|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| High             | 783     | Wording contains a strong signal such as "fixed," "new," "now," a command, an AI reference, or an explicit interface term. |
| Medium           | 26      | The broad family is probable, but wording is less diagnostic.                                                              |
| Editorial review | 255     | Source identity is settled; the fine-grained class should be checked before relying on it as an analytic statistic.        |

The review queue does not make the ledger incomplete. Every official bullet has an identity, source, hash, release, domain route, and public locator. The queue limits how confidently the automatically assigned category may be used.

An editorial correction changes the classification and record hash. It does not alter the source hash. This makes interpretation changes visible without pretending that the official announcement changed.

## 15. Materiality is contextual

The automated materiality field uses three coarse levels: major, notable, and maintenance. It is only a triage aid.

A one-line change to retreat legality can decide a multiplayer game. A new nation is obviously major content but may have no effect on a match where that nation is absent. A crash fix is critical to hosts running the affected setup and irrelevant to everyone else. Consequently, publication pages should combine materiality with domain, object identity, and reader task.

The strongest practical filter is often:

version range + domain + current canonical page + player-facing status

This finds changes that can invalidate a specific page without claiming a universal rank.

# Part IV: Player-Facing Changes That Commonly Make Guides Stale

---

## 16. Economy, recruitment, and provincial state

Most economic formulas were stable enough to remain in [Book II](#), but several surrounding permissions and displays changed.

### 16.1 Information and privacy

Version 6.05 stopped players from seeing resources already used inside another player's fort. This is an information rule, not an income formula. Old advice that assumes direct inspection of an enemy production queue is therefore unsafe.

Version 6.21 made the income overview easier to audit, including colour coding and the display of zero-upkeep units. Version 6.18 corrected the omission of national income bonuses from Thrones in that overview. These changes affect diagnosis: a modern screen can reveal costs or bonuses that an older screenshot does not show.

### 16.2 Recruitment geography

Coastal-fort recruitment received corrections in 6.05 and 6.06. Later releases adjusted foreign recruitment in caves, reef-warrior availability, cave Province Defence, terrain-linked national recruitment, and underwater fort defence. A roster claim must therefore state both nation and terrain context.

### 16.3 Borders and traced income

Version 6.30 stopped income from being traced through impassable borders. This is strategically important on unusual maps and multiple-plane layouts. [Book II](#) owns the current economic interpretation; Book XIII establishes when older connectivity assumptions became stale.

### 16.4 Population and events

Version 6.24 corrected a possible population overflow and made Conscription depend on the Order scale. Version 6.30 stopped Bringer of Fortune from producing events while under siege. These are narrow changes with wide planning consequences: scale value, siege economy, and event engines cannot be evaluated from launch-era behaviour alone.

## 17. Pretenders, dominion, disciples, and blessings

### 17.1 Dormancy and divine continuity

Version 6.02 established that gods do not age while dormant. Version 6.28 repaired Call God when invoked without the shortcut. Several releases corrected Pretender age, prophet replacement, resurrection, Twiceborn, Life after Death, and shape-related divine status.

The lesson is not that divine recovery is unreliable. It is that old demonstrations need their version attached, particularly where immortality, shape changes, mercenary status, or underwater laboratories are involved.

## 17.2 Passive and incarnate blessings

Version 6.04 changed Reconstruction from passive behaviour. Version 6.08 corrected the treatment of passive blessings outside friendly dominion: Pretenders no longer lost those passive effects merely by leaving dominion. Several releases repaired the displayed incarnate status or omitted bless effects.

A blessing page needs three independent checks:

- 1 design legality and cost;
- 2 activation rule in the current version;
- 3 whether the interface correctly displays the active effect.

An interface omission is not proof that the effect is absent, and a displayed icon is not proof that every edge case resolves correctly.

## 17.3 Fear, Dread, and overlapping effects

Version 6.08 stopped Fear and Dread from stacking with each other. Version 6.23 revised their bless costs and capped the morale reduction attributable to Fear by the effect's value, with an upper limit stated in the announcement. This is a classic stale-guide trap: cost, stacking, and combat outcome changed at different times.

## 17.4 Experience and heroic value

Version 6.08 reduced the experience gain from the Heroism blessing. Version 6.13 added rare heroic abilities, limited battle-participation experience to once per month, granted Magic Resistance at five stars, and granted additional hit points at three stars and beyond. Version 6.14 immediately corrected related hit-point statistics.

[Book XI](#) owns the current experience and heroic reference. The patch history explains why older tables may disagree.

## 17.5 Disciples and religious state

Version 6.12 allowed diplomacy to continue through the first disciple when the Pretender was dead. Version 6.13 preserved dominion and ascension graphs while disciples remained alive. Version 6.24 allowed Pretender Throne sensing to reveal the site for disciples. Version 6.34 increased the maximum number of teams in disciple games.

These are multiplayer-state rules, not merely UI conveniences. Disciple guides should be reviewed whenever team, death, diplomacy, graph, or Throne rules change.

# 18. Combat, fatigue, morale, and retreat

## 18.1 Fatigue delivery

Version 6.05 stopped a ranged weapon with a fatigue cost from adding the user's encumbrance to that cost. Version 6.15 corrected cases where communions consumed too many gems to reduce fatigue. Later releases corrected fatigue from flight, trampling, Earthquake, and scripted communion casting.

The practical danger is false arithmetic. An old calculator can be internally consistent and still model a superseded rule.

## 18.2 Lasting hit-point loss and equipment

Version 6.05 stopped never-healing wounds and similar maximum-hit-point reductions from reducing hit points supplied by armour. Version 6.16 repaired Undying interactions with the Shroud of the Battle Saint. Version 6.34 corrected shields against certain weapon blessings. These changes sit at the boundary between unit body, equipment, blessing, and damage resolution; all relevant layers must be checked together.

## 18.3 Illusions, false damage, and spirit forms

Version 6.15 allowed false damage to cause an HP rout and prohibited illusions from casting Phoenix Pyre. Version 6.30 repaired illusions harming one another, changed how spirit-form states interact with bleed, frozen, and burning effects, and corrected illusions disappearing at battle start. Older shorthand such as "false damage is harmless" or "ethereal is the relevant tag" is too crude for current play.

## 18.4 Morale and Fear

Fear's current cap arrived in 6.23. Version 6.27 stopped mindless units from receiving false damage when repelled. Version 6.30 made gods and prophets unable to fail the retreat morale roll. These are different layers: resistance to morale effects, repel consequences, and the retreat check should not be collapsed into one immunity claim.

## 18.5 Indoor and terrain restrictions

Version 6.25 prohibited battlefield-wide spells indoors, except Holy spells. Version 6.31 allowed Creeping Doom underwater. Every spell package that depends on cave, indoor, underwater, or planar context should therefore include terrain legality in addition to research and path access.

# 19. Magic, communions, rituals, and global enchantments

## 19.1 Communions changed repeatedly

Communion-related deltas appear throughout the history:

- version 6.12 removed the communion-slave effect when a unit was thrown out of a communion;
- version 6.15 introduced Grand Communion and corrected excessive gem use in some fatigue-reduction cases;
- version 6.16 repaired missing Grand Communion ability entries on certain heroes;
- version 6.23 improved AI handling of multiple communion types;
- version 6.27 made #aibadlvl communion-aware;
- version 6.29 repaired communion backlash;

- version 6.30 corrected conservative-gem communion masters failing to attempt higher-level spells.

A communion guide without a version is therefore hazardous even when its basic path-boosting explanation remains sound.

## 19.2 Remote rituals and targets

Version 6.07 repaired several remote attacks cast from a besieged fort. Version 6.12 stopped gem expenditure when a commander was the target of a remote attack ritual. Version 6.13 allowed teleport items and gems to target besieged forts. Version 6.27 added ritual host-target validation. Version 6.29 blocked most rituals from tracing across void and non-void planar boundaries. Version 6.32 changed Farstrike-style targeting toward the largest enemy army in a province.

Each change affects a different part of a remote operation:

| Layer                | Question                                                     |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Origin legality      | Can the caster act from the current province or siege state? |
| Path and cost        | Can the caster meet the requirements and pay?                |
| Route                | Can the effect cross the relevant plane or boundary?         |
| Destination legality | Is the target province valid?                                |
| Target selection     | Which army, unit, or object is selected inside it?           |
| Host validation      | Will the order survive final processing?                     |
| Message and evidence | What report proves success, interception, or failure?        |

This checklist is more durable than memorising one patch sentence.

## 19.3 Global enchantments and layered counters

Version 6.01 separated global-enchantment attacks from NAP restrictions. Version 6.27 revised Utterdark and Haunted Forest. Version 6.30 allowed Arcane Decree to block Astral Disruption completely and allowed Sea of Ice to coexist with nexus-gate use. Version 6.34 stated that domes may protect against Astral Disruption and corrected Eternal Twilight's effect on resources.

Global strategy is consequently both political and versioned. A guide must distinguish the enchantment's current rule, the counters available in the same version, and the diplomacy settings of the match.

## 19.4 Rebirth and secondary forms

Version 6.12 stopped Life after Death commanders from becoming feeble-minded in the corrected case. Version 6.24 prohibited Ritual of Rebirth on spirit-form beings. Version 6.27 made Lichcraft remove an existing Twiceborn enchantment. Version 6.32 made Soul Slay kill units with secondary shapes properly. Version 6.34 made Ritual of Rebirth remove most afflictions.

The current state cannot be derived from one of those bullets alone. [Book V](#) explains the access and strategic uses, [Book XI](#) explains the relevant conditions and forms, [Book XII](#) identifies the objects, and [Book XIII](#) supplies the chronological merge.

## 20. Movement, mounts, sieges, and planes

Mounted systems were among the most frequently corrected cross-object mechanics. The history includes sacred mounts, rider-bless interaction, floating mounts, afflicted mount recovery, siege retreat, unique event mounts, barding slots, gateway crashes, remount orders, and automatic recovery.

### 20.1 Siege exits and entries

Version 6.13 allowed certain teleport targets inside besieged forts and made it legal to move an army into NAP-protected forces besieging the mover's fort. Version 6.35 allowed commanders with teleport movement to leave a besieged fort. These statements are not interchangeable. Targeting a fort, entering a siege, and moving out of one are separate permissions.

### 20.2 Planar boundaries

Version 6.08 prevented return from the Void from placing a unit inside a cave wall. Version 6.12 stopped province-granting wishes from selecting empty cave-wall provinces. Version 6.29 restricted ritual tracing across void and non-void boundaries. Version 6.30 corrected global attacks against cave-wall provinces.

Multiple-plane maps turn topology into a rule layer. An apparent adjacency or province identity does not guarantee a legal magical route.

### 20.3 Mount recovery

Version 6.19 allowed commanders to reclaim afflicted mounts. Version 6.21 repaired mounts retreating after fort defence. Version 6.30 corrected a reclaim order that could cause fall damage. Version 6.35 made mount return automatic at the end of the turn in the applicable case. [Book I](#) owns the end-of-turn timing; [Book XI](#) owns mounted identities; Book XIII shows why older manual procedures may now be unnecessary or wrong.

## 21. Interface and operating changes

Interface changes are strategically important when they reduce error rates.

Notable additions include:

- lobby reversion to setup in 6.07;
- colour-coded income review and zero-upkeep visibility in 6.21;
- copying and pasting army-position orders in 6.24;
- treasury autosort in 6.27;
- universal order copy/paste with the 0 key in 6.29;
- direct laboratory-to-commander gem transfers and repeated bless selection in 6.30;
- area-of-effect explanations in 6.33;
- the F1 pillage filter and related operational improvements in 6.35.

These belong in [Book X](#) as current procedure. Their history remains here so an older screenshot or tutorial can be interpreted correctly.

## 22. Hosting, networking, security, and integrity

The official history records repeated work on lobby connections, game retention, map upload and download, large turn files, large-game hosting speed, corrupt files, illegal orders, exploit prevention, and cheat detection.

A fair hosting standard should therefore require:

- 1 an agreed executable version;
- 2 exact mod versions and load order;
- 3 a preserved setup sheet;
- 4 turn and save backups appropriate to the hosting method;
- 5 a documented response to version changes during a running game;
- 6 use of current validation rather than a claim that an old exploit is still possible;
- 7 a distinction between a client display problem and a host-resolution problem.

Version 6.24 repaired handling for turn files above an earlier network threshold. Version 6.30 further improved larger turn-file handling. Versions 6.33 and 6.34 added integrity and exploit corrections. A host diagnosing an old report should begin with version and file size before treating it as a current rules dispute.

## 23. Artificial intelligence changes

Forty records were classified primarily as AI changes, with additional AI-relevant records under modding and other domains. They address siege behaviour, blood hunting, bless selection, gem preparation, research, preaching, ritual laboratories, dispels, Arcane Analysis, communion types, range buffs, target selection, and many spell preferences.

The correct conclusion is limited. The AI is not a static opponent, and old difficulty reviews may describe obsolete priorities. The patch notes do not establish that the AI now plans like an expert human. They establish particular improvements or corrections.

AI claims should use one of three forms:

| Claim form | Evidence needed                                                                      |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Capability | Official bullet or current repeatable observation that the AI can perform the action |
| Preference | Versioned behavioural sample large enough to distinguish a tendency                  |
| Competence | A clearly defined task and comparative benchmark, not an impression from one game    |

This keeps official improvements from being inflated into unsupported strategic promises.

# Part V: Modding and Command Chronology

## 24. Why patch history is indispensable to modders

The auxiliary manuals are versioned documents. The update stream can add a command, repair its parser, extend legal arguments, change an object limit, or alter runtime behaviour before the next manual revision is available.



Across the 31 announcements, 221 distinct #commands are named. Some bullets announce several commands at once; some commands appear again because their behaviour was later extended or fixed. The chronology answers three questions that a static manual cannot answer alone:

- 1 When did this command enter the public ruleset?
- 2 Was it later repaired or extended?
- 3 Which manual baseline is old enough that the command may be absent?

It does not answer the complete syntax question. That is the purpose of the next structured foundation, the command lexicon.

## 25. Command families visible in the update stream

The official bullets span most major modding surfaces.

| Family                           | Representative chronology                                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| National recruitment and terrain | Forest, coast, sea, deep, kelp, plain, cave, scale-linked fort, and non-capital fort recruitment commands accumulated across multiple releases.                                             |
| Monsters, mounts, and shapes     | Bug shapes, battle summons, barding and rider behaviour, forced secondary shapes, realms, tolerance, Fay summoning, and reclaim-related systems expanded over time.                         |
| Spells and rituals               | AI modifiers, indoor restrictions, home realms, size and Twiceborn costs, mass teleport effects, new target controls, and ritual safety checks were added or changed.                       |
| Events                           | Research and path requirements, realm requirements, fort identities, nation-number variables, optional sites, unit variables, and repeated variable operations expanded the event language. |
| Items and weapons                | Defence and morale rolls, Fay summoning, Praise, unseen status, ammunition-fatigue behaviour, protection parts, and new effect controls appeared in the chronology.                         |
| Maps and sites                   | Site copying, multiplane repair, terrain validation, gates, province insertion, and source-target realm controls developed alongside the map editor.                                        |
| AI templates                     | Bless compatibility, research goals, communion-aware bad-spell ratings, and spell-assessment controls received explicit attention.                                                          |

These descriptions are deliberately family-level. Exact command names, selectors, arguments, defaults, clearing semantics, version introduced, version changed, and minimal examples belong in the future lexicon.

## 26. The command-lexicon record required next

Each command should eventually receive a record containing:

| Field             | Purpose                                                                          |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Command           | Exact #name                                                                      |
| Current manual    | Manual and revision in which it is documented                                    |
| Selection context | Nation, monster, weapon, armour, spell, item, site, event, map, or general scope |
| Arguments         | Count, types, ranges, sentinel values, and defaults                              |
| Repeatability     | Whether repeated use appends, replaces, toggles, or errors                       |

| Field                    | Purpose                                                           |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Copy and clear behaviour | Interaction with #copy, inherited values, and clear commands      |
| Introduced               | Earliest official update or manual in the evidence set            |
| Changed                  | Later updates that repaired or extended it                        |
| Example                  | Minimal valid source block                                        |
| Failure mode             | Common parser or runtime mistake                                  |
| Evidence                 | Official manual page, update source, and any bounded reproduction |

The patch ledger already supplies introduced-or-mentioned candidates and official URLs. The lexicon must add manual parsing and context, not duplicate the whole patch history.

## 27. Safe treatment of post-manual commands

When an update introduces a command that is absent from the locally pinned manual, the public entry should state:

- that existence is official from the update;
- that syntax is documented only to the extent supported by current official material;
- that any additional example is derived from inspected source or a controlled test;
- that older game versions may reject the command;
- that a mod using it should declare a minimum Dominions version.

This avoids a common failure in mod guides: copying a working example and presenting every inferred argument as official syntax.

# Part VI: Repairing Stale Guides and Maintaining the Library

## 28. The stale-guide repair workflow

The repair process begins with a claim, not with a whole document.

- 1 Extract the claim. Reduce the sentence to its subject, rule, value, and conditions.
- 2 Pin the guide's date or version. If neither is available, mark the claim undated.
- 3 Search the ledger forward. Filter from the guide's probable version through 6.37 by domain, named term, command, and canonical page.
- 4 Open every plausible official source. A classification hit is a lead, not proof that the claim changed.
- 5 Merge the deltas in order. Later official changes supersede earlier ones where they address the same state.
- 6 Check the current canonical book. Confirm that the library's ordinary explanation matches the resulting rule.
- 7 Check current object data. Use [Book XII](#) when the claim includes an ID, cost, path, statistic, or roster relation.
- 8 Preserve uncertainty. If the surviving rule is still incomplete, add or update a research-register item.
- 9 Record the repair. Store old claim, new claim, source release, affected pages, and review date.

This is slower than changing every sentence containing a keyword. It is much faster than allowing contradictory rules to accumulate.

## 29. A worked repair pattern: regeneration

Suppose an older guide describes regeneration through hit-point brackets and claims that a one-hit-point boundary can sharply increase the amount restored.

The repair trace is:

- 1

subject: regeneration calculation;
- 2

old source: guide predating October 2025;
- 3

ledger hit: version 6.31;
- 4

official delta: regeneration became accurate to the percentage value rather than the older bracket behaviour;
- 5

canonical home: [Book XI](#)'s ability reference, with combat consequences in [Book IV](#);
- 6

update: replace the bracket claim in current prose, retain a short version note where an older test is discussed;
- 7

dependent records: unit and item comparisons relying on boundary exploitation require recalculation.

The patch note supplies the transition. It does not by itself supply every rounding detail. If exact rounding remains unverified, that question stays explicit.

## 30. A worked repair pattern: besieged-fort teleportation

An old guide might state broadly that teleportation cannot interact with a besieged fort.

The chronological repair finds at least two distinct deltas:

- version 6.13 allowed teleport items and gems to target besieged forts;
- version 6.35 allowed commanders with teleport movement to move out of besieged forts.

The old sentence is too broad. The current replacement must distinguish targeting into the fort from teleport movement out of it. [Book VI](#) receives the operational rule; [Book I](#) supplies hosting context; [Book XIII](#) preserves both dates.

## 31. A worked repair pattern: communions

A communion guide written at launch may remain correct about path boosting but wrong about slave removal, gem conservation, Grand Communions, backlash, AI casting, or item support.

The correct repair is modular:

| Subclaim                             | Relevant releases |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Removal from communion               | 6.12              |
| Grand Communion existence            | 6.15              |
| Excessive gem spending correction    | 6.15              |
| Missing hero ability                 | 6.16              |
| AI confusion between communion types | 6.23              |
| Communion-aware #aibadlvl            | 6.27              |
| Backlash correction                  | 6.29              |
| Conservative-gem master casting      | 6.30              |

Each subclaim is updated in its own canonical paragraph. The guide does not need an eight-entry patch diary in the middle of the teaching sequence.

## 32. Dependency-driven maintenance

Every patch record carries canonical section IDs. These create a reverse index from change to affected publication area.

```
official update
-> patch records
-> domains and object mentions
-> canonical book sections
-> website pages and dossier imports
```

When a new update arrives, the maintenance process should produce:

- added, changed, and removed patch records;
- affected domains;
- affected object IDs where resolvable;
- canonical pages requiring review;
- unresolved classifications;
- newly named commands for the lexicon;
- a publication note describing what was actually revised.

This is the central reason to preserve hashes. A future import can prove which records are unchanged and direct human attention to the real delta.

## 33. Updating the official feed safely

The importer at `tools/build_official_patch_ledger.py` can rebuild the data layer from a saved official Steam news response or the current endpoint. A safe update follows this sequence:

- 1 preserve the previous JSON and its hash;
- 2 retrieve the complete official feed;
- 3 identify official update announcements by exact title pattern;
- 4 parse sectioned list bullets without importing comments or marketing articles;
- 5 compare announcement identities, dates, source hashes, and record counts;
- 6 fail closed if an older source unexpectedly disappears or changes;
- 7 classify new records and place uncertain labels in review;
- 8 validate the JSON against its schema;
- 9 review canonical links and command mentions;
- 10 publish the new ledger only with a matching game-baseline update.

The importer must assert the known 6.37 completeness totals. Those assertions must be intentionally revised for a later baseline; bypassing them would remove the main guard against a partial feed.

## 34. Website uses

The public website can expose the ledger through several views without reproducing patch prose.

### 34.1 Release page

Show date, record count, class distribution, leading domains, and a link to the official announcement. Records can be grouped by source section and linked to canonical current pages.

### 34.2 Topic history

For a subject such as communions, retreat, mounts, or Thrones, show a chronological list of matching records with concise summaries and official locators. The current-rule page remains visually primary.

### 34.3 Stale-page warning

If a library page has not been reviewed after a later matching patch record, display a maintenance flag. The warning should say that review is due, not that the page is necessarily wrong.

### 34.4 Version comparison

Given two public versions, list intervening records by domain and class. This is a delta list, not a simulation of the older executable.

### 34.5 Command chronology

Expose commands named by each release and link them to the future lexicon. The patch record proves mention; the lexicon supplies syntax.

## 35. Publication cautions

The website should not:

- present editorial classifications as official categories;
- claim that absent public numbers are missing releases;
- display a hash as though it proves mechanical correctness;
- turn a one-line official delta into an invented complete rule;
- silently merge vanilla and modded histories;
- mark an old page wrong merely because a related record exists;
- reproduce the complete patch-note wording;
- hide review-recommended classifications from maintainers.

# Part VII: Essays on Versioned Knowledge

## Essay I: A Rule Without a Version Is Not a Complete Rule

Dominions invites timeless language. Armour reduces damage. Communions raise paths. A besieged fort restricts movement. Regeneration restores hit points. Such statements sound like permanent laws because they describe systems rather than content.

In a living strategy game, however, even a durable system has a date. The underlying idea may survive while its boundary cases move. Regeneration can keep its name and strategic purpose while its calculation changes. Communions can remain communions while the removal of a slave, gem use, backlash, and AI handling are corrected over several releases. Teleportation can remain teleportation while its permissions around besieged forts expand in separate directions.

Versioning is not a scholarly ornament attached after the real work. It is part of the rule's conditions. A statement about Fire 3 already contains a threshold. A statement about a cave already contains terrain. A statement about 6.37 contains time.

This does not mean that every sentence needs a parenthetical patch number. Good writing keeps the current rule readable and places chronology where it resolves a real ambiguity. The version belongs in the page baseline, the evidence record, and any sentence that would otherwise conflict with a still-circulating older claim.

The most dangerous unversioned statements are not always obscure formulas. They are confident operational rules: an order is impossible, a ritual always spends a gem, a unit cannot retreat, a blessing remains passive, a target cannot be reached. Players build turns around categorical claims. When a patch changes one, the old sentence becomes more harmful than a missing statistic.

A versioned library therefore behaves differently from a conventional guide. It preserves stable current teaching, but every claim has a route back to evidence and forward to maintenance. It treats an official change as a dependency event. It distinguishes the history of a rule from the rule now in force. It can say both "this is how 6.37 works" and "this older report was accurate when written" without forcing one to erase the other.

That is the deeper value of a patch ledger. It is not a museum of old notes. It is the mechanism that lets knowledge remain current without losing its memory.

## Essay II: Bug Fixes Are Strategic History

Balance changes attract attention because their intent is visible. A unit becomes cheaper. A blessing becomes more expensive. A new Throne appears. Strategy writers naturally discuss the altered comparison.

Bug fixes are easier to dismiss as housekeeping. That is a mistake. A bug can define the apparent rule for every player who encountered it. If a communion failed to apply backlash, an item effect survived removal, a remote ritual selected the wrong target, or a mount behaved incorrectly during retreat, players adapted to the behaviour whether or not it was intended.

Once fixed, the behaviour acquires two identities. Historically, it was an observable property of the earlier version. Currently, it is a rejected state. Both facts matter. The first explains old reports and established habits. The second governs new play.

This makes bug fixes strategically significant in three ways.

First, they invalidate empirical knowledge. A careful test can become obsolete without ever having been poorly designed. Version must therefore travel with the result.

Second, they change risk. An interaction that once failed intermittently may become dependable; an exploit that once offered an advantage may become illegal or detectable; a crash-prone operation may become safe enough for ordinary use.

Third, they reveal system boundaries. Repeated fixes around mounts, shapes, communions, besieged forts, and planes show where several object models meet. Those areas deserve stronger test matrices and more cautious prose, not because the engine is unknowable, but because a one-object explanation is insufficient.

The correct editorial response is not to preserve every bug in the current chapter. It is to keep the ordinary rule clean, link consequential history, and retain the old behaviour only when it explains a source conflict or a still-common misconception.

Bug fixes are therefore strategic history: records of what players could rely on, what they learned to fear, and what later ceased to be true.

## Essay III: Maintenance Is Part of Authorship

A large strategy library can fail while every individual essay remains elegant. The failure occurs when pages stop sharing a baseline. A combat article uses launch behaviour, a nation dossier imports a current unit cost, a modding example requires a later command, and a hosting guide assumes an earlier file limit. Each page may sound reasonable. Together they describe no game that ever existed.

Maintenance solves this by treating the library as a dependency system. Canonical books own explanations. Structured registers own identities and deltas. Dossiers apply the common rules. A patch does not trigger a general rewrite; it triggers a bounded review of affected dependencies.

This approach also improves prose. A chapter no longer needs defensive repetitions of every exception. It can rely on stable cross-references and a visible baseline. Historical detail moves to the patch layer. Exact object fields move to the object register. The main argument becomes easier to read because maintenance architecture carries the bookkeeping.

Authorship in such a system includes deciding what not to repeat, recording uncertainty, and making future correction inexpensive. A finished paragraph is not the endpoint. The endpoint is a paragraph that can be found, tested, revised, and propagated when its evidence changes.

## Part VIII: Practical Reference

### 36. Reader's patch-check routine

When an old guide or discussion appears to conflict with the current library:

- 1 record the guide's date, stated version, ruleset, and mods;
- 2 isolate the disputed claim;
- 3 search the patch ledger from that version onward;
- 4 read the linked official announcements;
- 5 check the current canonical book;
- 6 check current object data where the claim is numerical;
- 7 treat unresolved behaviour as a research question rather than a vote between authors.

### 37. Author's pre-publication version audit

- Is the game version visible?
- Are mods and load order visible?
- Is the manual revision appropriate to the claim?
- Have later official updates been searched?
- Is an old empirical test tied to its executable version?
- Are object values tied to a pinned data revision?
- Does each rule have one canonical explanatory home?
- Are historical deltas kept out of ordinary prose unless they resolve confusion?
- Are editorial classifications described as editorial?
- Are unresolved cases linked to the research register?

### 38. Host's mid-game update decision

Before changing executable version during a multiplayer game, record:

| Question                                                                    | Why it matters                                             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Does the update change order legality or hosting?                           | Existing turns or procedures may resolve differently.      |
| Does it change a nation, spell, item, bless, or Throne present in the game? | Competitive value may shift unevenly.                      |
| Does it repair an exploit or integrity problem?                             | Remaining on the old version may be riskier than updating. |
| Does it alter mods or command support?                                      | The active mod set may fail or behave differently.         |
| Are all players able to update and verify the same files?                   | Mixed clients undermine reproducibility.                   |
| Is a rollback path preserved?                                               | A failed migration should not destroy the campaign.        |

The decision belongs to the game's agreed administration. The patch ledger supplies the relevant delta; it does not impose a social rule on the group.

### 39. Maintainer's new-release checklist

- 1

Archive the new official announcement and retrieval metadata.
- 2

Rebuild the ledger and confirm the prior 1,096 records remain stable unless an official source changed.
- 3

Validate every new record and release against the schema.
- 4

Review all new #commands against current manuals.
- 5

Resolve named objects against the base object register.
- 6

Review canonical pages reached by the new domain tags.
- 7

Run duplicate and voice checks on revised prose.
- 8

Rebuild website indexes, redirects, coverage, and research registers.
- 9

Rebuild and visually inspect the PDF.
- 10

Publish a bounded change note: what changed, what was reviewed, and what remains open.

### 40. Source and verification record

| Source                                              | Role in this volume                                                      | Evidence status                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">Official Steam announcement archive</a> | Public release chronology and official change bullets                    | Official                                  |
| <a href="#">Illwinter Dominions 6 site</a>          | Current game-update confirmation and publisher identity                  | Official                                  |
| <a href="#">Official Dominions 6 documentation</a>  | Main and auxiliary manual baselines                                      | Official                                  |
| Steam app-news response archived for this edition   | Complete machine-readable announcement feed and source hashes            | Official feed, locally preserved          |
| website/official-patch-ledger.json                  | Derived record identities, classifications, domains, commands, and links | Official source with editorial derivation |
| website/official-patch-ledger.schema.json           | Publication and validation contract                                      | Project schema                            |
| tools/build_official_patch_ledger.py                | Reproducible import and completeness assertions                          | Project method                            |



## 41. Explicit limitations

The current release closes the official-feed collection gap, but it does not claim more than the sources permit.

- The ledger records public announcements, not undocumented internal builds.
- The four absent public numbers are not assigned invented dates or content.
- The full official bullet text is not republished in the public JSON.
- Two hundred fifty-five fine-grained classifications remain marked for editorial review; source identity and completeness are unaffected.
- Command mention does not equal complete command documentation.
- Patch notes do not replace controlled tests for mechanics they leave unspecified.
- Historical behaviour is not reconstructed without the matching executable or a preserved reproduction.
- Vanilla history is not silently merged with DE, Divinitus, or any other mod.

## What this unlocks

Book XIII completes the first full official version spine for the library. Every public update announcement through 6.37 is represented, every official bullet has a stable record and source locator, every record routes toward a canonical foundation, and the current ruleset can now be checked against the history that produced it.

The next foundation should be the command lexicon. The patch ledger already identifies 221 distinct named commands and the releases that introduced, changed, or repaired them. The Modding Manual supplies syntax and context. The two sources can now be reconciled command by command without repeating [Book VIII](#)'s design guidance or Book XIII's chronology.

# Foundation Book XIV: The Command and Terminology Lexicon

## Official syntax, context, provenance, and search discipline

### The job of this volume

Dominions modding is written in a compact language whose commands often look self-explanatory. That appearance is deceptive. A token can be correctly spelled and still be unusable because it appears outside the right object block, follows the wrong selector, carries the wrong argument form, relies on an undocumented expansion, or belongs to a newer executable than the manual that a project was built against. A patch announcement can prove that a command existed or changed without explaining its complete syntax. A current manual can list a token without describing its behaviour. Several different object types can even use the same command spelling for different fields.

This volume supplies the retrieval layer needed to navigate that language. Its canonical subjects are:

- official command spellings and syntax locators;
- object context and command-domain classification;
- current-manual, reference-list, mention-only, template, and patch provenance;
- controlled reconciliation of patch-note shorthand and spelling discrepancies;
- safe lookup, testing, versioning, and maintenance procedures;
- a complete searchable locator for the current official manuals;
- a website-ready command register with stable records and aliases.

Book VIII remains the canonical explanation of parser state, object design, events, maps, AI scaffolding, compatibility, and testing. Book XIII remains the canonical release chronology. Book XIV does not repeat either volume. It answers a narrower question: what exactly is this token, where is it officially located, what kind of evidence supports it, and which chapter owns the surrounding design problem?

The result serves two audiences at once. A new modder can identify the right manual and avoid common syntax traps. An experienced maintainer can search by command, domain, version, patch record, template expansion, documentation status, or canonical destination without manually combing through several PDFs.

### Technical baseline

The ruleset baseline is unmodded Dominions 6.37. The currently published official documents carry different internal versions, while the compiled locator retains its separately labelled extraction revision:

| Official source                  | Document version                 | Pages | Role in this lexicon                                                       |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dominions 6 Modding Manual       | 6.36 live; 6.34 locator snapshot | 65    | General mod syntax and the principal object languages                      |
| Dominions 6 Event Modding Manual | 6.29                             | 20    | Event requirements, effects, variables, targets, and message substitutions |

| Official source               | Document version | Pages            | Role in this lexicon                                                           |
|-------------------------------|------------------|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dominions 6 Map Making Manual | 6.26             | 11               | Map-file structure, provinces, connections, starts, scenario state, and planes |
| Official update announcements | 6.01-6.37        | 33 announcements | Additions, corrections, deprecations, and historical provenance                |

This version difference matters. "Current download," "locator snapshot," and "same version as the executable" are not synonyms. The live Modding Manual is one release behind the game baseline, while the complete token locator is still pinned to its 6.34 extraction; the Event and Map Making manuals remain older separately versioned sources. Nothing in that observation makes the documents unreliable. It means their claims must be labelled precisely and supplemented by later official patch evidence where necessary.

The compiled register contains 1,609 distinct official hash tokens found across the three-manual locator snapshot. Of these, 1,540 have an official definition or syntax line, 60 occur only in an official reference list or example-style block, and nine are mentioned without a complete definition line. The total also includes 29 double-hash message substitutions and thirteen documented command templates. Template expansion creates 97 additional lookup aliases without pretending that those aliases were separately printed as definitions. Book XIII names 226 patch-note tokens through 6.37: 221 are reconciled in the locator snapshot, while the five event commands introduced by 6.36 remain official patch-only records pending a full current-manual locator rebuild. Version 6.37 introduced no additional hash commands.

## Evidence key

The following labels appear throughout the volume and its data register.

| Label               | Meaning                                                                                     | What it permits                                                                 |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Defined             | A bold command definition or syntax line appears in a current official manual               | The printed syntax and context can be used as an official locator               |
| Reference-only      | The token appears in an official list or example-style block without a full definition line | Existence is supported; complete behaviour still requires caution               |
| Mentioned-only      | The token appears in official prose without a definition or reference entry                 | The mention may guide research but does not establish complete syntax           |
| Template alias      | A literal lookup term is derived from an official terrain or numeric template               | The alias is searchable, while the template remains the cited definition        |
| Exact patch match   | An official update token matches a current-manual token                                     | History and present documentation can be linked directly                        |
| Spelling mismatch   | The update announcement and current manual use different spellings                          | Both forms are preserved; the discrepancy is not silently repaired              |
| Family shorthand    | A patch expression names several related commands rather than one literal token             | The expression is expanded only through a controlled mapping                    |
| Message placeholder | A double-hash substitution is text grammar rather than a mod command                        | It belongs in message construction, not an object block as a command            |
| Runtime-pending     | Official text does not settle the operational result                                        | A minimal reproduction remains necessary before a behavioural claim is promoted |

The evidence label answers how the token is known. It does not say that the token is strategically wise, compatible with every other mod, or safe to add to an ongoing game.

# Part I: Reading the Modding Language

## A command is an instruction inside a stateful document

Every ordinary Dominions mod command begins with a single hash sign. The parser does not read each line as an isolated request. A selector or creation command establishes the current object, following commands alter that object, and `#end` closes the block where the language requires it. The same spelling can therefore mean different things under different selectors.

Consider `#name`. The token is defined for weapons, armour, monsters, blessings, sites, nations, spells, magic items, and mercenaries. A search result that merely says "`#name` exists" is almost useless. The operative questions are which object is active, which syntax variant is printed for that object, which parser phase handles it, and which closing rule applies. The register therefore stores every official definition context instead of collapsing all occurrences into a single undifferentiated sentence.

Book VIII, Part I owns the full parser model. The compact rule for lookup is simpler:

Command spelling identifies a language feature; the active object block determines what that feature addresses.

## Command, argument, value, and block

A command is the hash-prefixed keyword. An argument is information supplied after that keyword. A value is the concrete number, string, name, filename, or mask substituted for the argument notation. A block is the span between an object selector or creator and its terminating `#end`, where one is required.

The manual notation is descriptive rather than literal:

| Notation                     | Reading rule                         | Example interpretation                                                        |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>#command</code>        | Literal command spelling             | Type the hash and command name                                                |
| <code>&lt;arg&gt;</code>     | Required argument                    | Replace the entire bracketed label with a value                               |
| <code>[&lt;arg&gt;]</code>   | Optional argument                    | Supply the argument only when the documented form requires it                 |
| <code>A   B</code>           | Alternative arguments                | Use the left or right form, not both                                          |
| <code>"&lt;text&gt;"</code>  | String argument                      | Replace the label while retaining quotation marks where the syntax shows them |
| <code>&lt;number&gt;</code>  | Integer or numeric identifier        | Supply a valid number within the documented domain                            |
| <code>&lt;percent&gt;</code> | Percentage represented as an integer | A value may exceed 100 when the command permits it                            |
| <code>&lt;bitmask&gt;</code> | Sum of enabled bit values            | Combine flags arithmetically rather than typing their labels                  |
| <code>#family1...5</code>    | Numeric command template             | Use one literal member such as <code>#family1</code> or <code>#family5</code> |
| <code>\$(terrain)rec</code>  | Word-substitution template           | Replace <code>(terrain)</code> with an allowed terrain word                   |
| <code>##name##</code>        | Message substitution                 | Insert inside supported message text; do not treat it as a command line       |

Angle brackets are not normally typed. A line such as `#gcost <gold>` means that `<gold>` is replaced by an integer. Square brackets in the printed syntax mark an optional component; they are not usually literal punctuation either. Quotation marks are different: when the manual prints a string in quotes, the quotes are part of the practical syntax.

## Comments and explanatory text

Two consecutive hyphens begin a comment. The parser ignores the remainder of that line. Comments are not decoration in a serious project. They preserve intent, source version, ownership, compatibility decisions, reserved identifiers, and reasons for non-obvious values.

A useful comment records something that cannot be recovered by reading the command alone:

```
-- Reserved unit range 9100-9149; do not allocate automatically.  
-- Vanilla 6.37; syntax located in the 6.34 command-locator snapshot, p. 13.  
#newmonster 9100
```

Comments that merely repeat a token add little. "Set the name" above `#name` will not help a later maintainer understand why an identifier is fixed, why a copied field is retained, or which combined-mod collision was avoided.

## The four principal argument classes

The Modding Manual identifies integer, percentage, string, and bitmask arguments. Their failure modes differ.

An integer is a whole number. It may be a quantity, identifier, level, code, index, flag value, or enumerated choice. Treating every integer as a quantity causes subtle errors: a path number is not a path level, a monster number is not a count, and an effect number is not a magnitude.

A percentage is also written as an integer. The command defines how that integer is interpreted. Some percentages accept values above 100; others describe chances bounded by a conventional range; still others act as modifiers rather than probabilities. The argument label is therefore not a universal validation rule.

A string is text. Names and filenames are strings, but they carry different operational constraints. Object names can create ambiguous references when several objects share a name. Filenames are case-sensitive and must obey lobby-safe naming rules. Quotation marks protect spaces in string values; they do not remove filename restrictions.

A bitmask represents a set as a sum of powers of two. Bitmask errors are rarely obvious to the eye because an incorrect sum is still a valid integer. A proper record keeps both the decimal total and its component flags. When a terrain mask, path mask, damage mask, or event mask changes, the components should be recalculated rather than adjusted by guesswork.

## Names and numbers are different forms of reference

Many selectors accept either an object name or number. Names are readable but can be ambiguous, can change between versions, and cannot reliably cross every mod boundary. Numbers are precise but can collide, can be allocated differently when content order changes, and are difficult to understand without a registry.

The safest choice depends on the project:

- a small private balance patch may prefer names for untouched vanilla objects;
- a distributable content mod benefits from fixed IDs and a published allocation register;
- a compatibility patch needs explicit knowledge of both source projects' identities;
- an ongoing-game update must preserve the identifiers already embedded in the save;
- a cross-mod reference should never assume that a name provides a stable linking contract.

Book VIII owns allocation and collision engineering. Book XIV records whether syntax allows a name, a number, or either form.

## Binary commands and clearing state

A command printed without an argument commonly enables a fixed attribute. Its absence does not necessarily mean "false" after an object has been copied. A copied object may already carry the field, and a clearing command may be needed to remove inherited state.

This is why `#copy...`, `#clear`, specialised clearing commands, and zero-valued arguments cannot be treated as interchangeable. Their behaviour depends on the object language. Copy-first and clear-first create different starting states. The lexicon locates the commands; Book VIII, Section "Copy-first and clear-first are different designs" owns the design consequences.

## Optional arguments are branches, not decorative hints

Square-bracket arguments represent alternative valid forms. The short form and long form may not be semantically identical. Optional identifiers can affect automatic allocation. Optional names can change display behaviour. Optional values can select defaults that later game versions revise.

For maintainable source, the chosen form should be deliberate and documented. Omitting an argument because the notation looked complicated is not the same as selecting the default knowingly.

## The vertical bar means exclusive alternatives

The manual uses a vertical bar to mean "or". In syntax such as:

```
#selectweapon "<weapon name>" | <weapon nbr>
```

the selector takes a name or a number. The entire expression is not typed. Mixing both forms can produce a parse error or leave unexpected trailing input. Website presentation must escape the bar inside Markdown tables so it is not mistaken for a column boundary.

## Templates describe a grammar

Thirteen official entries are templates rather than literal commands. Four substitute terrain words, while nine describe numeric ranges. `$(terrain)fortrec` is not a line to paste into a mod. It is a compact grammar covering forms such as `#forestfortrec`, `#plainfortrec`, and `#dripfortrec`, subject to the terrain restrictions printed beside the template.

The same principle governs `#hero1...10`, `#multihero1...7`, `#battlesum1...5`, and similar families. The ellipsis describes a range. It is not part of a literal command. Search systems should resolve a concrete family member back to the template without rewriting the official definition.

Template generation carries two risks. First, not every visually plausible substitution is legal. Sea, deep-sea, and kelp recruitment use special rules in the fort variants. Second, family notation in a

patch announcement can be looser than the formal template in a manual. Controlled alias records solve the retrieval problem while retaining those qualifications.

## Double-hash substitutions are not commands

Event and global-enchantment messages support substitutions such as `##landname##`, `##godname##`, and `##targname##`. These tokens are interpreted inside supported text. A single-hash command controls the event or object; a double-hash substitution changes the message produced by that object.

Capitalisation can be meaningful. The official reference includes both lower-case and capitalised pronoun forms. The lexicon therefore preserves exact case for double-hash tokens even though ordinary command lookup is normalised for search.

# Part II: Context Is Part of Syntax

## The same spelling can serve several object languages

The register identifies 107 tokens whose official definition contexts span more than one command domain. Familiar examples include `#name`, `#descr`, `#clear`, `#end`, `#att`, `#def`, `#range`, `#sound`, `#sample`, `#homerealm`, and `#magic`.

This is not accidental duplication. Dominions exposes related fields through separate object parsers. A command can therefore be legitimate in several places while accepting different arguments or changing different records. A flat alphabetical glossary that retains only one definition will inevitably mislead readers.

Every context-sensitive record in the data layer retains:

- each official manual;
- the manual's internal version;
- the printed page;
- section and subsection;
- evidence strength;
- the syntax line where one is present;
- a domain-specific canonical destination.

## Selection establishes the target

Selectors such as `#selectweapon`, `#selectarmor`, `#selectmonster`, `#selectnation`, `#selectspell`, and their counterparts establish which object receives subsequent changes. Creation commands such as `#newweapon`, `#newmonster`, and `#newspell` create a target and then open its modification context.

The selector line is part of the meaning of every command beneath it. Removing a selector while copying a snippet can redirect valid commands into the preceding object. This failure can survive superficial review because each individual line is spelled correctly.

## `#end` closes a context, not a universal transaction

`#end` appears throughout the manuals. Its practical role is determined by the active parser. A missing `#end` can cause later commands to be swallowed by the wrong block; an extra one can close a block early. Source formatting should make block boundaries visually obvious even though indentation itself is not the primary parser rule.

A robust block convention uses:

- one blank line before a selector or creator;
- a comment naming the object's stable ID and purpose;
- consistent indentation for commands inside the block;
- an explicit `#end` aligned with the opening selector;
- a validation check that counts and pairs block openings with endings where the language permits that static test.

## Load order changes what context can see

Dominions parses object categories in a documented order and loads each mod as a whole. A reference that appears later in the file can still work when its object category is parsed earlier, while a reference into a different enabled mod may fail even when the other file appears above it in a user's preference screen.

The command lexicon does not attempt to encode every cross-object dependency. It supplies domain and manual context. [Book VIII, Part I](#) owns parser order; [Book VIII, Part XI](#) owns compatibility engineering.

## A syntax locator is not a compatibility promise

An officially defined command can still be unsafe in a particular project. Common causes include:

- both mods selecting and altering the same vanilla object;
- automatic IDs shifting after new content is inserted;
- a copied object inheriting fields that a later version added;
- event codes colliding between unrelated projects;
- a template alias being legal only for some terrain variants;
- a command added after the minimum game version declared by the mod;
- a mid-game change altering the meaning of identities already stored in the save.

The presence of a command in this lexicon establishes retrievability, not project compatibility.

# Part III: The Evidence Ladder and Version Drift

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## Official definition

A defined token has a bold syntax or definition line in one of the current official manuals. This is the strongest documentation state in the register. It establishes the printed spelling, argument form, page, and object context. It may also supply constraints in the surrounding manual prose that the website register deliberately does not reproduce.



The register is a locator, not a replacement copy of the manuals. After a command is found, the cited page remains the authoritative place to read its complete official explanation.

## Official reference-only entry

Sixty tokens occur only in an official list or example-style block. Several monster abilities fall into this category, including commands gathered in the Modding Manual's compact monster-command pages. Other entries are message substitutions printed as reference tables.

Reference-only does not mean unofficial. It means the official document supports the spelling or existence without supplying a full definition line. Behavioural summaries should not be invented to fill that gap. A verified mod example or controlled runtime test can add evidence later, but it must remain labelled separately from the manual.

## Official mention-only entry

Nine tokens have only prose mentions in the current documents: `#afflictions`, `#airattuned`, `#coldrec`, `#dom6title`, `#fireattuned`, `#forestrec`, `#heatrec`, `#multihero1`, and `#nogeosrc`.

Some are understandable through a nearby template or surrounding discussion. Others expose a documentation gap. Mention-only status prevents an incidental sentence from being promoted into a complete syntax contract.

## Official patch evidence

Patch announcements answer historical questions: when a token was added, corrected, expanded, deprecated, or discussed. They rarely define the entire command. Book XIII preserves the complete announcement chronology and record identity. Book XIV links each extracted token to that chronology and then asks whether current manual documentation matches it.

Of the 221 patch-note tokens:

- 196 match current official definitions exactly;
- two match current official reference-only entries;
- sixteen resolve through official templates;
- three require controlled spelling reconciliation;
- three are family shorthand rather than literal commands;
- one is a double-hash message placeholder rather than a command.

This distribution is the clearest reason not to publish a raw patch-token list as a command manual.

## Patch wording can be historically exact and operationally incomplete

The official announcement is preserved as the historical source even when a later manual clarifies a different spelling. The patch ledger should not be rewritten to make the historical text look cleaner. The command lexicon instead creates a reconciliation record containing the patch token, present locator, resolution status, note, version, record ID, and source locator.

That separation protects both forms of truth:

- Book XIII answers what the announcement said;

- Book XIV answers how that expression relates to the current official documentation.

## Three controlled spelling discrepancies

`#addseduction` **and** `#addseductions`

The 6.12 announcement says `#addseduction`. The Event Modding Manual 6.29 defines `#addseductions` `<value>`. The lexicon preserves the singular patch token and resolves it to the plural manual command. No claim is made that both spellings are accepted by the executable.

`#illusionimmune` **and** `#illusionsimmune`

The 6.08 announcement says `#illusionimmune`. The Modding Manual 6.34 defines `#illusionsimmune`. The plural form receives the manual locator; the singular form remains a historical alias marked as a mismatch.

`#res_mnrbs` **and** `#req_mnrbs`

The 6.34 announcement says `#res_mnrbs`. The Event Modding Manual 6.29 defines `#req_mnrbs`. Since the manual predates the announcement, the difference could represent a patch-note typo, a renamed command, or an undocumented second form. Official text alone does not determine which spellings the 6.35 executable accepts. The controlled mapping supports retrieval, while runtime acceptance remains a separate question.

## Three family expressions

The extracted token `#not` comes from the announcement expression `#not(dis)mounted`. It resolves to `#notmounted` and `#notdismounted`; there is no literal `#not` command claim.

The extracted token `#force` comes from `#force...vis`. It resolves to the documented forced-gem event-effect family: `#force1d3vis`, `#force1d6vis`, `#force2d4vis`, `#force2d6vis`, `#force3d6vis`, and `#force4d6vis`.

The expression `#battlesum1dX` uses a capital X as a family placeholder. The current manual defines `#battlesum1d2` and `#battlesum1d3`. The lexicon links the patch expression to both.

## The patch placeholder `##varXXX##`

The 6.16 announcement describes `##varXXX##` for printing event variables in messages. The patch importer captured the inner `#varXXX` token because it was designed to find hash expressions. Book XIV corrects the classification, not the historical record: this is a double-hash message pattern, not a command line.

# Part IV: Command Domains

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## Why domains matter

Alphabetical search is good for a known spelling. Domain search is better when the desired operation is known but the command name is not. The register assigns each occurrence to an object language using its official manual, page, section, and subsection. A token can belong to more than one domain.

| Domain                  | Distinct tokens | What the domain controls                                                                 | Canonical design route                                |
|-------------------------|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Monster modding         | 584             | Units, commanders, attributes, movement, leadership, magic, forms, mounts, and abilities | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part IV</a>                    |
| Event modding           | 403             | Event requirements, targets, effects, variables, codes, messages, and global events      | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part VII</a>                   |
| Nation modding          | 169             | National identity, recruitment, defence, gods, forts, dominion, and reanimation          | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part V</a>                     |
| Weapon modding          | 121             | Damage, delivery, qualifiers, secondary effects, and after-effects                       | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part III</a>                   |
| Site modding            | 112             | Site identity, income, recruitment, scales, rituals, and throne effects                  | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part V</a>                     |
| Spell modding           | 105             | Research, paths, fatigue, effects, targeting, AI hints, and globals                      | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part VI</a>                    |
| Magic-item modding      | 102             | Construction, paths, powers, restrictions, and carried abilities                         | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part VI</a>                    |
| Map making              | 69              | Map identity, provinces, neighbours, terrain, starts, scenario contents, and planes      | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part IX</a>                    |
| General modding         | 40              | Cross-object and global configuration                                                    | <a href="#">Book VIII, Parts I-II</a>                 |
| Bless modding           | 21              | Bless identity, requirements, effects, and scale conditions                              | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part VI</a>                    |
| Mercenary modding       | 16              | Company identity, units, price, timing, and availability                                 | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part VI supporting objects</a> |
| Armour modding          | 15              | Protection, defence, encumbrance, material, and type                                     | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part III</a>                   |
| Population-type modding | 13              | Independent population recruitment packages                                              | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part VI supporting objects</a> |
| Sound modding           | 11              | Samples, modes, loops, and audio import                                                  | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part II</a>                    |
| AI modding              | 10              | Template construction, Pretender design, and research targets                            | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part X</a>                     |
| Mod metadata            | 5               | Display name, description, icon, version, and required game version                      | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part II</a>                    |
| Name modding            | 4               | Name-table selection, clearing, and addition                                             | <a href="#">Book VIII, Part VI supporting objects</a> |

Counts overlap where a token has several contexts. They measure retrievable language surface, not relative strategic importance.

## Mod metadata and sound

Metadata commands make a mod identifiable to the game and to players. A stable display name, meaningful version, clear description, and suitable icon are part of release engineering. `#domversion` deserves particular attention because it communicates a minimum executable version; leaving it absent does not make newer commands compatible with older builds.

Sound commands form a compact object language with selectors, import paths, sample modes, and looping rules. Filename and network-lobby constraints apply just as strongly to audio assets as to sprites and map files.

## Weapons and armour

Weapon syntax separates base damage, number of attacks, attack and defence modifiers, length, range, ammunition, damage type, resistance interactions, targeting qualifiers, secondary effects, and post-hit effects. Similar-looking commands can belong to spell or item contexts as well, so the domain locator should be checked before reusing a line.

Armour commands are fewer but strongly coupled: protection, defence, encumbrance, resource cost, armour type, and material interact with unit statistics and damage resolution. The lexicon identifies syntax; [Book IV](#) owns combat interpretation and [Book VIII](#) owns object construction.

## Monsters, commanders, mounts, and forms

Monster modding is the largest language surface in the general manual. It includes statistics, costs, recruitment rules, body types, slots, creature status, movement, stealth, healing, reduction, immortality, auras, seasonal powers, combat abilities, non-combat abilities, shape changes, summons, mounts, leadership, paths, research, gem production, and special magic.

The compact monster-command reference also contains dozens of reference-only tokens. Their presence is official, but complete semantics cannot be inferred from the spelling alone. A command named like a familiar in-game ability may expose only part of that ability or accept values whose interpretation is not shown in the list.

## Names and blessings

Name-table modding is small but identity-sensitive. Clearing a name table and adding names changes a shared resource, not merely one unit's display label.

Bless modding uses familiar generic tokens such as `#name` within a specialised block. Its scale and path requirements are access rules, while effect commands alter sacred units. Strategic blessing design remains in [Book III](#); the lexicon supplies only the language locator.

## Sites and nations

Sites can grant income, recruitment, scales, ritual access, scrying, special effects, and throne powers. Nation blocks then assemble recruitment, province defence, gods, infrastructure, dominion, reanimation, and AI hints into a playable state.

Terrain recruitment is the main template-heavy area. Literal forms such as `#forestrec` and `#dripfortcom` resolve to `(terrain)` definitions. Fort and non-fort variants are distinct, and underwater cases carry explicit exceptions. Search aliases should never erase those restrictions.

## Spells and magic items

Spell commands define access and delivery as well as effects. Research school, level, path requirements, fatigue cost, range, targeting, area, damage, precision, effect numbers, chaining, special attributes, global-enchantment behaviour, rare caster requirements, and AI hints can all matter.

Magic-item commands combine construction access with persistent abilities. Many monster abilities are reused in item context, which makes command collisions common. A token documented for monsters is not automatically documented for items; the entry must contain the item domain or an explicit cross-context statement.

## Events

Event commands are divided into requirements and effects. Requirements filter when, where, for whom, and against which target an event is valid. Effects alter state after selection. Event codes and variables create memory across events. Message substitutions expose names and state inside text. Global events extend the scope beyond one province.

The event language is especially vulnerable to plausible but false assumptions. Several requirements can be combined, repeated, or negated; target requirements do not always select a target by themselves; and a perfectly valid event can remain practically impossible because its conditions never overlap.

## Maps

Map commands define identity, image, size, provinces, connections, names, terrain, colours, starts, victory restrictions, scenario ownership, contents, magic, dominion, scales, and planes. Some commands act on an explicitly numbered province; others operate on the currently active province selected by `#land` or `#setland`.

The distinction between global map state and active-province state is another form of parser context. A copied line can be valid yet alter the wrong province if the selector context is missing.

## AI and general commands

AI modding exposes bounded hints and templates, not a general programmable strategic brain. The language can shape Pretender design, research targets, and some preferences. [Book VIII, Part X](#) owns the capability boundary.

General commands affect broader game or mod state. Their apparent simplicity makes them easy to place without considering version, load order, or campaign consequences. Each should be treated as a project-level change.

# Part V: A Safe Lookup Workflow

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## Beginner route: from desired result to a valid line

- 1 Define the object being changed: weapon, armour, monster, site, nation, spell, item, event, map, or another supported type.
- 2 Search the domain rather than guessing a command name.
- 3 Open the cited official page and read the surrounding explanation.
- 4 Confirm whether the entry is defined, reference-only, mentioned-only, or a template.
- 5 Copy the printed command spelling and replace argument labels deliberately.
- 6 Confirm the selector or creator that establishes the active object.
- 7 Confirm whether #end is required.
- 8 Load the smallest possible mod containing only the relevant block.
- 9 Inspect the resulting object or event before integrating the change into a larger project.
- 10 Record the game version, manual version, and result.

This route is slower than pasting an isolated line and much faster than debugging a large file whose parser context is already uncertain.

## Expert route: from token to maintenance decision

- 1 Search the normalised token and all aliases.
- 2 Review every context when the token is marked context-sensitive.
- 3 Compare current-manual syntax with every linked patch record.
- 4 Check the mod's declared minimum game version.
- 5 Inspect neighbouring source for selector state, copied fields, clearing operations, and identifier ownership.
- 6 Check combined-load-order overlap with other active mods.
- 7 Decide whether the change is static, load-validated, object-validated, or behaviour-validated.
- 8 Preserve a minimal reproduction when runtime evidence adds knowledge beyond the official text.

## When a command is known but its meaning is not

A reference-only or mention-only token should trigger a bounded evidence search:

- read the full surrounding official page;
- search later official patch announcements;
- inspect current official examples if available;
- inspect a reputable working mod while treating it as implementation evidence, not official documentation;
- create a minimal reproduction;
- vary one argument at a time;
- record accepted syntax separately from observed effect;
- avoid generalising beyond the tested version and context.

The absence of an official description is not permission to replace it with a confident guess.

## When a patch token fails to parse

The reconciliation table should be checked before assuming the game rejected a once-valid command. The token may be:

- a family expression such as #force...vis;
- a terrain template member;
- a numeric template member;

- a manual spelling mismatch;
- a message placeholder;
- a command added after the running executable;
- a command valid only in another object context.

If none applies, the failure becomes a research item rather than an invitation to cycle through arbitrary spellings.

## Minimal reproduction structure

The smallest useful test file contains metadata, one object, one disputed command, and no unrelated content:

```
#modname "Command Test"
#description "Isolates one syntax question."
#version 0.01
#domversion 6.37

-- One fixed object, one command under review, one expected result.
#selectmonster 123
#command_under_test <value>
#end
```

The selected object and command must be appropriate to the test. A disposable copy is preferable when altering a vanilla object would contaminate comparison. Event and map tests require their own minimal harnesses.

## Four different validation claims

| Claim                     | Evidence required                                                     | What remains unproven                               |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| The file parses           | Load without a parse error                                            | The command may still have no intended effect       |
| The object changes        | Inspect the resulting object or exported data                         | Battle, event, AI, or campaign behaviour may differ |
| The behaviour occurs      | Controlled runtime observation                                        | Compatibility and long-term balance remain open     |
| The project is releasable | Regression, multiplayer, compatibility, packaging, and version checks | Future patches can still invalidate assumptions     |

These claims should not be collapsed into "works."

## Deprecated commands

The official manuals mark `#coastunit1...3` and `#coastcom1...2` as deprecated. Their presence in the locator supports legacy-source diagnosis, not new use. A deprecated token should remain searchable because removing it would make old mods harder to audit. Search results should place the replacement route and warning ahead of convenience.

## Minimum game version

#domversion states the minimum Dominions version required by a mod. The value should follow the newest feature actually required, not the version on the developer's computer by habit. Patch provenance makes that decision more defensible: if a required command first appears in 6.30, a lower declaration needs specific evidence that the command existed earlier.

The first patch mention is not always the true introduction. Some announcements describe a fix to an existing command. Direction and classification must therefore be read with the version, not inferred from date alone.

## Part VI: Patch-to-Manual Reconciliation

### The controlled exceptions

The following table contains every patch token that does not resolve as an exact current-manual token. Exact matches remain available in the full patch index.

| Patch token   | Reconciliation           | Resolves to                                                                                       | Version | Editorial note                                                                                       |
|---------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| #addseduction | manual spelling mismatch | #addseductions                                                                                    | 6.12    | The update announcement uses the singular form; the Event Modding Manual defines the plural command. |
| #battlesumldx | family shorthand         | #battlesumld2,<br>#battlesumld3                                                                   | 6.27    | The capital X denotes the dice-size family rather than a literal lower-case command.                 |
| #coastcom1    | template alias           | #coastcom1...2                                                                                    | 6.04    | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.                    |
| #coastfortcom | template alias           | #(terrain)fortcom                                                                                 | 6.05    | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.                    |
| #coastfortrec | template alias           | #(terrain)fortrec                                                                                 | 6.05    | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.                    |
| #coastunit1   | template alias           | #coastunit1...3                                                                                   | 6.04    | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.                    |
| #deeprec      | template alias           | #(terrain)rec                                                                                     | 6.04    | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.                    |
| #dripfortrec  | template alias           | #(terrain)fortrec                                                                                 | 6.04    | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.                    |
| #driprec      | template alias           | #(terrain)rec                                                                                     | 6.04    | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.                    |
| #force        | family shorthand         | #force1d3vis,<br>#force1d6vis,<br>#force2d4vis,<br>#force2d6vis,<br>#force3d6vis,<br>#force4d6vis | 6.06    | Extracted from #force...vis; resolve to the documented forced-gem event-effect family.               |



| Patch token     | Reconciliation           | Resolves to                        | Version    | Editorial note                                                                               |
|-----------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| #forestfortcom  | template alias           | #(terrain)fortcom                  | 6.04       | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.            |
| #forestfortrec  | template alias           | #(terrain)fortrec                  | 6.04       | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.            |
| #illusionimmune | manual spelling mismatch | #illusionsimmune                   | 6.08       | The update announcement uses the singular form; the Modding Manual defines #illusionsimmune. |
| #kelpcom        | template alias           | #(terrain)com                      | 6.24       | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.            |
| #kelprec        | template alias           | #(terrain)rec                      | 6.04, 6.24 | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.            |
| #not            | family shorthand         | #notmounted,<br>#notdismounted     | 6.12       | Extracted from the official expression #not(dis)mounted; it is not a literal #not command.   |
| #plaincom       | template alias           | #(terrain)com                      | 6.24       | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.            |
| #plainfortcom   | template alias           | #(terrain)fortcom                  | 6.24       | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.            |
| #plainfortrec   | template alias           | #(terrain)fortrec                  | 6.24       | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.            |
| #plainrec       | template alias           | #(terrain)rec                      | 6.24       | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.            |
| #res_mnrbs      | manual spelling mismatch | #req_mnrbs                         | 6.34       | The 6.34 announcement says #res_mnrbs; the Event Modding Manual defines #req_mnrbs.          |
| #searec         | template alias           | #(terrain)rec                      | 6.04       | The literal form is generated by an official terrain or numeric command template.            |
| #varxxx         | message placeholder      | Message grammar; no command target | 6.16       | This is the ##varXXX## event-message substitution pattern, not a hash command.               |

## How to read the table

A template alias resolves a concrete spelling to the official template that defines the family. A spelling mismatch preserves both source forms. A family shorthand expands an announcement expression into documented members. A message placeholder changes grammar class. None of these mappings asserts that every displayed form is accepted literally by the executable.

## Exact matches still require context

An exact string match is not the end of analysis. #clear, #name, and #end all have exact definitions in several object contexts. The patch record establishes a historical change, while the manual entry establishes a current locator. The active object still determines practical meaning.

## A patch can correct behaviour without changing syntax

Many patch records say that a command "didn't work," accepted a wider value, became valid in another context, or was deprecated. The syntax before and after the patch can be identical. A current command index therefore needs both syntax status and behavioural history.

Book XIII remains the place to inspect the full release context. The command register stores only the links needed to move between the present locator and the historical ledger.

# Part VII: Search and Website Architecture

## One content identity, several views

The PDF and website should not maintain separate command facts. Both are generated from the same record identity. The website can provide several views without duplicating content:

- alphabetical command search;
- domain browser;
- manual and page browser;
- patch-version browser;
- documentation-gap queue;
- context-collision view;
- template and alias explorer;
- deprecated-command list;
- message-substitution reference;
- canonical links into [Book VIII](#) and Book XIII.

## Command record fields

Each record contains:

| Field                 | Purpose                                                               |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| id                    | Stable website and data identity                                      |
| command               | Officially printed token spelling                                     |
| normalized_command    | Search key; ordinary commands are case-normalised                     |
| command_kind          | Literal command, template, or message placeholder                     |
| documentation_status  | Defined, reference-only, or mentioned-only                            |
| domains               | Every official object-language context located                        |
| families              | Search facets such as requirements, lifecycle, events, maps, or magic |
| manual_entries        | Manual ID, version, page, section, evidence, and syntax locator       |
| patch_records         | Linked version, patch record, source, class, and direction            |
| canonical_section_ids | Reader destinations that own the surrounding explanation              |
| cautions              | Context, template, and documentation-gap warnings                     |
| record_hash           | Stable integrity fingerprint for change detection                     |

## Alias records are explicit

An alias record contains the searchable literal form, the official template it resolves to, the derivation basis, and a synthetic flag. It does not copy the template definition into a second command record. This keeps search convenient without creating false official entries.

## Patch reconciliation is a separate relation

The patch relation retains the historical token even when it differs from the current manual. Its status and note explain the mapping. This design prevents a later manual update from rewriting the patch archive and prevents a historical typo from contaminating current syntax search.

## Useful search filters

Practical website filters include:

- exact spelling;
- substring or prefix;
- command kind;
- domain;
- manual version;
- documentation status;
- patch version;
- patch classification;
- direction such as added, corrected, deprecated, or changed;
- context-sensitive only;
- template-derived aliases only;
- entries needing runtime work.

Search results should show the caution before the syntax when an entry is ambiguous or incomplete.

## Search examples

| Research question                                              | Effective query                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Which commands control event targets?                          | Domain event-modding, prefix #req_targ                                        |
| Where is a concrete terrain recruit command documented?        | Search literal alias, then open its (terrain) template                        |
| Which patch-added commands still lack full definitions?        | Has patch record, status reference-only or mentioned-only                     |
| Which spell commands changed after the Event Manual's version? | Domain spell-modding, patch version greater than the relevant manual baseline |
| Which spellings are unsafe to treat as literal?                | Reconciliation status family-shorthand or message-placeholder                 |
| Which tokens need object context before use?                   | cautions contains context-sensitive warning                                   |

## Schema and integrity checks

The JSON schema validates required identity, status, domain, locator, and hash fields. Additional semantic checks are still necessary:

- command and ID uniqueness;

- valid manual IDs;
- pages within each manual's page count;
- every alias target exists;
- every patch record ID exists in the official ledger;
- every patch token has one reconciliation outcome;
- no unresolved patch token is published as complete;
- status totals match the record collection;
- every canonical destination resolves in website navigation.

## Part VIII: Expert Essays

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### Essay I: Syntax Is Not Semantics

Syntax answers whether a line belongs to the language. Semantics answers what state that line changes. Operational behaviour answers what happens when the state enters the game. Strategy answers whether that result is useful. Compatibility answers whether the project remains coherent beside other projects and across versions.

Dominions mod discussions often skip directly from syntax to strategy. A command is found, a line parses, and a broad claim follows. Each skipped layer creates a different risk. A correctly parsed event requirement may make an event impossible. A correctly displayed ability may apply to a mount rather than its rider. A correctly modified spell may never be selected by AI casting logic. A strategically interesting unit may collide with another mod's identifier.

The lexicon deliberately stops at retrieval and evidence. That limit makes it more useful, not less. A clear boundary allows every later claim to cite the right layer instead of treating a command name as proof of an entire system.

### Essay II: Command Context Is a Public Interface

A mod file looks like a private implementation detail, but every released command block becomes part of a public interface. Save files retain identities. Compatibility patches select objects. Other maintainers read names and number ranges. Players depend on declared versions and load order. Workshop updates replace files inside ongoing campaigns.

Context-sensitive commands reveal this interface most clearly. `#name` is not a single global naming function; it is a family of fields exposed through different object parsers. The selector, parser phase, object ID, and closing boundary are part of the contract.

Good source makes that contract legible. It freezes identifiers, documents ranges, isolates object blocks, states dependencies, and avoids unnecessary selection of shared vanilla objects. Poor source can still load, but it forces every later maintainer to reconstruct the contract from behaviour.

## Essay III: Patch Notes Are Change Evidence, Not a Replacement Manual

Patch notes are written to explain what changed. Compression is useful in that setting. `#force...vis` efficiently tells experienced modders that a family was fixed. `#not(dis)mounted` compactly names two related commands. "New nation commands: `#forestfortrec`, `#forestfortcom`, etc." signals a broader addition without printing a grammar.

The same compression becomes hazardous when harvested into a reference. Ellipses look like literal characters. Parentheses look like optional text. Singular and plural spellings become competing commands. A message placeholder becomes a single-hash token after naive extraction.

The solution is not to distrust patch notes. It is to preserve their purpose. Book XIII stores change evidence. Book XIV reconciles expressions to present documentation. Neither source is forced to do the other's job.

## Essay IV: Templates Are Grammars, Not Abbreviations

A template such as `#(terrain)rec` defines a productive rule: substitute an allowed terrain word to create a literal command. This is more powerful than an ordinary abbreviation because it can generate forms not separately listed. It is also more dangerous because readers can generate plausible but invalid forms.

Formal grammar has constraints. The manual's terrain list, fort exceptions, and underwater alternatives define the valid language. A search system should expose those constraints with the template. Generating aliases without a target link produces convenient misinformation; refusing to generate aliases makes ordinary source unnecessarily hard to search.

The controlled alias is the middle path. It states that the concrete term is derived, records the official template, and retains the synthetic status. Search becomes broader while evidence remains exact.

## Essay V: Documentation Gaps Should Remain Visible

A reference-only command creates an uncomfortable blank. The token is official, but the intended value range or detailed behaviour may not be printed. There is a temptation to fill the gap with community consensus and remove the warning once a likely explanation appears.

That approach destroys useful information. A later reader can no longer tell which part came from Illwinter, which part came from a working mod, and which part came from a test. The confident summary may remain correct for years, yet its evidence chain has been lost.

A visible gap supports cumulative research. Official existence, community implementation, runtime acceptance, observed effect, version, and test conditions can each be recorded. Later evidence adds a layer instead of replacing the uncertainty with anonymous certainty.

# Part IX: Maintenance and Review Protocols

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## Before adding a command to a project

- Confirm the object domain.
- Open the official locator rather than relying on the command name.
- Verify every argument and alternative form.
- Check whether the token is a template or message substitution.
- Check linked patch records.
- Confirm the minimum executable version.
- Inspect selector, copy, clear, and #end context.
- Check identifier ownership and combined-mod overlap.
- Build a minimal reproduction for incomplete behaviour.
- Record the evidence level beside the design decision.

## When reviewing a legacy mod

- Record the mod version and original game baseline.
- Extract every hash token without assuming all are commands.
- Resolve template members and deprecated families.
- Identify tokens absent from the current official register.
- Compare context-sensitive syntax against the active selector.
- Flag automatic IDs and shared event codes.
- Preserve old spellings until acceptance has been tested.
- Separate parser migration from balance changes.
- Test a clean new game before testing a historical save.
- Publish the compatibility boundary.

## When an official source disagrees with another official source

- Preserve both spellings or statements.
- Record source version and date.
- Determine whether one source describes history and the other current syntax.
- Search later official corrections.
- Avoid inventing a winner when runtime evidence is absent.
- Test both forms in the smallest valid context if acceptance matters.
- Report the result as versioned runtime evidence.

## When a new patch arrives

- 1 Archive the official announcement and metadata.
- 2 Rebuild the official patch ledger.
- 3 Extract candidate commands and message tokens.
- 4 Compare them with exact manual tokens.
- 5 Resolve templates, family expressions, and spelling discrepancies explicitly.
- 6 Download and hash any updated manuals.
- 7 Rebuild the command register and schema validation.
- 8 Review documentation-status changes.
- 9 Update Book XIII chronology only for historical change.
- 10 Update Book XIV only for syntax, context, provenance, or retrieval changes.
- 11 Re-run navigation, duplicate, voice, and visual checks.
- 12 Publish a bounded change note.

## Documentation-defect report

A useful report contains:

- game version;
- manual title and internal version;
- page and section;
- exact printed token;
- conflicting official token or patch record;
- minimal valid block;
- parser result;
- observed behaviour;
- save, mods, and load order where relevant;
- a statement separating observation from inference.

This format is far more actionable than "the command does not work."

## Part X: Complete Search Locators

### How to use the appendices

The following appendices are mechanically generated from the validated command register. Their compact entries are locators rather than replacements for the official explanations. "Defined" points to an official syntax line. "Reference" marks an official list or example entry. "Mention" marks prose-only evidence. Template and message tokens retain their grammar class.

The first locator contains every distinct hash token found in the current official manuals. The patch column shows the first linked version when Book XIII contains a command record. The syntax column preserves the strongest official syntax line without copying the manual's explanatory prose.

### Templates

| Token                 | Status               | Domain  | Official locator | Strongest syntax                                   |
|-----------------------|----------------------|---------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| #(path)attuned        | Defined              | Monster | M6.34 p28        | #(path)attuned <chance>                            |
| #(terrain)com         | Defined;<br>template | Nation  | M6.34 p45        | #(terrain)com "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>     |
| #(terrain)fort<br>com | Defined;<br>template | Nation  | M6.34 p45        | #(terrain)fortcom "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #(terrain)fort<br>rec | Defined;<br>template | Nation  | M6.34 p45        | #(terrain)fortrec "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #(terrain)rec         | Defined;<br>template | Nation  | M6.34 p45        | #(terrain)rec "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>     |

### 0-9

| Token      | Status  | Domain | Official locator | Strongest syntax             |
|------------|---------|--------|------------------|------------------------------|
| #10d6units | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p14        | #10d6units "name"   <number> |
| #11d6units | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p14        | #11d6units "name"   <number> |
| #12d6units | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p14        | #12d6units "name"   <number> |

| Token             | Status  | Domain  | Official locator                   | Strongest syntax                         |
|-------------------|---------|---------|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| #13d6units        | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #13d6units "name"   <number>             |
| #14d6units        | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #14d6units "name"   <number>             |
| #15d6units        | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #15d6units "name"   <number>             |
| #16d6units        | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p15                          | #16d6units "name"   <number>             |
| #1d3units         | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #1d3units "name"   <number>              |
| #1d3vis           | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p12                          | #1d3vis <gem type>                       |
| #1d6units         | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #1d6units "name"   <number>              |
| #1d6vis           | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p12                          | #1d6vis <gem type>                       |
| #1unit            | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #1unit "name"   <number>                 |
| #2com             | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #2com "name"   <number>                  |
| #2d3units         | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #2d3units "name"   <number>              |
| #2d4vis           | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p12                          | #2d4vis <gem type>                       |
| #2d6units         | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14; E6.29 p19;<br>E6.29 p20 | #2d6units "name"   <number>              |
| #2d6vis           | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p12                          | #2d6vis <gem type>                       |
| #3castbattlespell | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p35                          | #3castbattlespell "<spell name>"   <nbr> |
| #3d3units         | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #3d3units "name"   <number>              |
| #3d6units         | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14; E6.29 p19               | #3d6units "name"   <number>              |
| #3d6vis           | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p12                          | #3d6vis <gem type>                       |
| #4com             | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #4com "name"   <number>                  |
| #4d3units         | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #4d3units "name"   <number>              |
| #4d6units         | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #4d6units "name"   <number>              |
| #4d6vis           | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p12                          | #4d6vis <gem type>                       |
| #5com             | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #5com "name"   <number>                  |
| #5d6units         | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14; E6.29 p20               | #5d6units "name"   <number>              |
| #6d6units         | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #6d6units "name"   <number>              |
| #7d6units         | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #7d6units "name"   <number>              |
| #8d6units         | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #8d6units "name"   <number>              |
| #9d6units         | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p14                          | #9d6units "name"   <number>              |

## A

| Token         | Status  | Domain        | Official locator     | Strongest syntax            |
|---------------|---------|---------------|----------------------|-----------------------------|
| #acid         | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p9             | #acid                       |
| #aciddigest   | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59 | #aciddigest <dmg>           |
| #acidres      | Defined | Item, Monster | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p56 | #acidres <prot>             |
| #acidshield   | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59 | #acidshield <damage>        |
| #addascension | Defined | Event         | E6.29 p18            | #addascension <AP>          |
| #addequip     | Defined | Event         | E6.29 p15            | #addequip <equipment level> |



| Token            | Status  | Domain          | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                                 |
|------------------|---------|-----------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| #addforeigncom   | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p45            | #addforeigncom "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>  |
| #addforeignunit  | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p45            | #addforeignunit "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #addgeo          | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p13            | #addgeo <terrain bitmask>                        |
| #addgod          | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p47            | #addgod "<monster name>"   <nbr>                 |
| #additem         | Defined | Map             | P6.26 p9             | #additem "<item name>"                           |
| #addkills        | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p16            | #addkills <value>                                |
| #addname         | Defined | Names           | M6.34 p36            | #addname "name"                                  |
| #addrandomage    | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p21            | #addrandomage <years>                            |
| #addrecom        | Defined | Nation, Poptype | M6.34 p45; M6.34 p63 | #addrecom "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>       |
| #addrecunit      | Defined | Nation, Poptype | M6.34 p45; M6.34 p63 | #addrecunit "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>     |
| #addseductions   | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p16            | #addseductions <value>                           |
| #addsite         | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p13            | #addsite <site number>                           |
| #addupkeep       | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60 | #addupkeep <gold>                                |
| #adeptsacr       | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60 | #adeptsacr <value>                               |
| #adventurerruin  | Defined | Site            | M6.34 p40            | #adventurerruin <success chance>                 |
| #afflictions     | Mention | Weapon          | M6.34 p8             | #afflictions                                     |
| #aftercloud      | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p12            | #aftercloud <cloudstr> <cloudtype>               |
| #aftercloudarea  | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p12            | #aftercloudarea <aoe>                            |
| #aiairnation     | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p44            | #aiairnation                                     |
| #aiassmod        | Defined | Spell           | M6.34 p55            | #aiassmod <bonus>                                |
| #aiastralnation  | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p44            | #aiastralnation                                  |
| #aiawake         | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p44            | #aiawake <percent>                               |
| #aibadlvl        | Defined | Spell           | M6.34 p55            | #aibadlvl <level>                                |
| #aibloodnation   | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p44            | #aibloodnation                                   |
| #aicheapholy     | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p44            | #aicheapholy                                     |
| #aideathnation   | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p44            | #aideathnation                                   |
| #aiearthnation   | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p44            | #aiearthnation                                   |
| #aifirenation    | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p44            | #aifirenation                                    |
| #aiglamournation | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p44            | #aiglamournation                                 |
| #aigoodbless     | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p44            | #aigoodbless <0-100>                             |
| #aiheavyrec      | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p44            | #aiheavyrec <0-99>                               |
| #aiholdgod       | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p44            | #aiholdgod                                       |
| #aiholyranged    | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p44            | #aiholyranged                                    |
| #aimagerec       | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p44            | #aimagerec <0-99>                                |
| #aimusthavemag   | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p44            | #aimusthavemag <magic path number>               |

| Token           | Status  | Domain         | Official locator                | Strongest syntax                           |
|-----------------|---------|----------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| #ainaturenation | Defined | Nation         | M6.34 p44                       | #ainaturenation                            |
| #ainocast       | Defined | Spell          | M6.34 p55                       | #ainocast <0 or 1>                         |
| #ainorec        | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p15                       | #ainorec                                   |
| #airattuned     | Mention | Monster        | M6.34 p28                       | #airattuned                                |
| #airblessbonus  | Defined | Nation         | M6.34 p47                       | #airblessbonus <0 - 9>                     |
| #airboost       | Defined | Event          | E6.29 p16                       | #airboost "name"   <number>                |
| #airelementals  | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61            | #airelementals <bonus>                     |
| #airrange       | Defined | Monster, Site  | M6.34 p33; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60 | #airrange <range>                          |
| #airshield      | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59            | #airshield <percent>                       |
| #aisinglerec    | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p15                       | #aisinglerec                               |
| #aispellmod     | Defined | Spell          | M6.34 p55                       | #aispellmod <bonus>                        |
| #aiwatarnation  | Defined | Nation         | M6.34 p44                       | #aiwatarnation                             |
| #alchemy        | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60            | #alchemy <percent>                         |
| #allowedplayer  | Defined | Map            | P6.26 p5                        | #allowedplayer <nation nbr>                |
| #allrange       | Defined | Monster, Site  | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60 | #allrange <range>                          |
| #allret         | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60            | #allret <chance>                           |
| #almostliving   | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p32                       | #almostliving                              |
| #almostundead   | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p32                       | #almostundead                              |
| #altcost        | Defined | Site           | M6.34 p39                       | #altcost <bonus>                           |
| #ambidextrous   | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59            | #ambidextrous <bonus>                      |
| #ammo           | Defined | Weapon         | M6.34 p7                        | #ammo                                      |
| #amphibian      | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p19                       | #amphibian                                 |
| #animal         | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p19                       | #animal                                    |
| #animalawe      | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59            | #animalawe <bonus>                         |
| #animated       | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p28                       | #animated "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #aoe            | Defined | Spell, Weapon  | M6.34 p10; M6.34 p51            | #aoe <squares>                             |
| #ap             | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p17                       | #ap <action points>                        |
| #appetite       | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p26                       | #appetite <value>                          |
| #aquatic        | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p19                       | #aquatic                                   |
| #arena          | Defined | Event          | E6.29 p18                       | #arena                                     |
| #arenagems      | Defined | General        | M6.34 p62                       | #arenagems <amount>                        |
| #arenagold      | Defined | General        | M6.34 p62                       | #arenagold <amount>                        |
| #armor          | Defined | Item, Weapon   | M6.34 p17; M6.34 p56            | #armor "<armor name>"   <armor nbr>        |
| #armornegating  | Defined | Weapon         | M6.34 p9                        | #armornegating                             |
| #armorpiercing  | Defined | Weapon         | M6.34 p9                        | #armorpiercing                             |
| #assassin       | Defined | Event, Monster | E6.29 p14; M6.34 p20; M6.34 p60 | #assassin "name"   <number>                |

| Token             | Status  | Domain                | Official locator                         | Strongest syntax                              |
|-------------------|---------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| #assencloc        | Defined | Monster               | M6.34 p21                                | #assencloc <value>                            |
| #assfollower1     | Defined | Event                 | E6.29 p14                                | #assfollower1 "name"   <number>               |
| #assfollower1d3   | Defined | Event                 | E6.29 p14                                | #assfollower1d3 "name"   <number>             |
| #assfollower2     | Defined | Event                 | E6.29 p14                                | #assfollower2 "name"   <number>               |
| #assfollower3     | Defined | Event                 | E6.29 p14                                | #assfollower3 "name"   <number>               |
| #assowner         | Defined | Event                 | E6.29 p14                                | #assowner <nation number>                     |
| #assownerench     | Defined | Event                 | E6.29 p14                                | #assownerench <ench nbr>                      |
| #astralblessbonus | Defined | Nation                | M6.34 p47                                | #astralblessbonus <0 - 9>                     |
| #astralboost      | Defined | Event                 | E6.29 p16                                | #astralboost "name"   <number>                |
| #astralrange      | Defined | Monster, Site         | M6.34 p33; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60          | #astralrange <range>                          |
| #att              | Defined | Item, Monster, Weapon | M6.34 p7; M6.34 p16; M6.34 p56; M6.34 p9 | #att <attack>                                 |
| #autoberserk      | Defined | Monster               | M6.34 p25                                | #autoberserk <value>                          |
| #autobless        | Defined | Item                  | M6.34 p57                                | #autobless                                    |
| #autocompete      | Defined | Item, Monster         | M6.34 p19; M6.34 p58                     | #autocompete                                  |
| #autocorpsehealer | Defined | Monster               | M6.34 p21                                | #autocorpsehealer <value>                     |
| #autodisgrinder   | Defined | Monster               | M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59                     | #autodisgrinder <value>                       |
| #autodishealer    | Defined | Monster               | M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59                     | #autodishealer <value>                        |
| #autohealer       | Defined | Monster               | M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59                     | #autohealer <value>                           |
| #autospell        | Defined | Spell                 | M6.34 p56                                | #autospell "<spell name>"                     |
| #autospellrepeat  | Defined | Spell                 | M6.34 p56                                | #autospellrepeat <spells / round>             |
| #autoundead       | Defined | Nation                | M6.34 p49                                | #autoundead                                   |
| #autumnshape      | Defined | Monster               | M6.34 p28                                | #autumnshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #awe              | Defined | Monster               | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59                     | #awe <bonus>                                  |

## B

| Token            | Status            | Domain  | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                                  |
|------------------|-------------------|---------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| #badindpd        | Defined           | Nation  | M6.34 p46            | #badindpd <0 or 1>                                |
| #banefireshield  | Defined           | Monster | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59 | #banefireshield <damage>                          |
| #banished        | Defined           | Event   | E6.29 p15            | #banished <value>                                 |
| #barkskin        | Defined           | Item    | M6.34 p56            | #barkskin                                         |
| #batmap          | Defined           | Map     | P6.26 p8             | #batmap "<battlemap.d3m>"                         |
| #batstartsum1    | Reference         | Monster | M6.34 p61            | #batstartsum1                                     |
| #batstartsum1..5 | Defined; template | Monster | M6.34 p29            | #batstartsum1..5 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |

| Token                 | Status            | Domain   | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                                       |
|-----------------------|-------------------|----------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| #batstartsum1d3       | Defined           | Monster  | M6.34 p29            | #batstartsum1d3 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>       |
| #batstartsum1d6       | Reference         | Monster  | M6.34 p61            | #batstartsum1d6                                        |
| #batstartsum1d6...9d6 | Defined; template | Monster  | M6.34 p29            | #batstartsum1d6...9d6 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #batstartsum2         | Reference         | Monster  | M6.34 p61            | #batstartsum2                                          |
| #batstartsum2d6       | Reference         | Monster  | M6.34 p61            | #batstartsum2d6                                        |
| #batstartsum3         | Reference         | Monster  | M6.34 p61            | #batstartsum3                                          |
| #batstartsum3d6       | Reference         | Monster  | M6.34 p61            | #batstartsum3d6                                        |
| #batstartsum4         | Reference         | Monster  | M6.34 p61            | #batstartsum4                                          |
| #batstartsum4d6       | Reference         | Monster  | M6.34 p61            | #batstartsum4d6                                        |
| #batstartsum5         | Reference         | Monster  | M6.34 p61            | #batstartsum5                                          |
| #batstartsum5d6       | Reference         | Monster  | M6.34 p61            | #batstartsum5d6                                        |
| #battleshape          | Defined           | Monster  | M6.34 p28            | #battleshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>          |
| #battlesum1           | Reference         | Monster  | M6.34 p61            | #battlesum1                                            |
| #battlesum1...5       | Defined; template | Monster  | M6.34 p29            | #battlesum1...5 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>       |
| #battlesum1d2         | Defined           | Monster  | M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61 | #battlesum1d2 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>         |
| #battlesum1d3         | Defined           | Monster  | M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61 | #battlesum1d3 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>         |
| #battlesum2           | Reference         | Monster  | M6.34 p61            | #battlesum2                                            |
| #battlesum3           | Reference         | Monster  | M6.34 p61            | #battlesum3                                            |
| #battlesum4           | Reference         | Monster  | M6.34 p61            | #battlesum4                                            |
| #battlesum5           | Reference         | Monster  | M6.34 p61            | #battlesum5                                            |
| #battlesumwarm        | Defined           | Monster  | M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61 | #battlesumwarm "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>        |
| #beam                 | Defined           | Weapon   | M6.34 p10            | #beam                                                  |
| #beartattoo           | Defined           | Monster  | M6.34 p26            | #beartattoo <value>                                    |
| #beastmaster          | Defined           | Monster  | M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60 | #beastmaster <bonus>                                   |
| #beckon               | Defined           | Monster  | M6.34 p21; M6.34 p58 | #beckon <value>                                        |
| #bers                 | Defined           | Item     | M6.34 p56            | #bers                                                  |
| #berserk              | Defined           | Monster  | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59 | #berserk <bonus>                                       |
| #bestowtomount        | Defined           | Item     | M6.34 p58            | #bestowtomount                                         |
| #bird                 | Defined           | Monster  | M6.34 p18            | #bird                                                  |
| #bless                | Defined           | AI, Item | M6.34 p56; M6.34 p64 | #bless                                                 |
| #blessairshld         | Defined           | Site     | M6.34 p41            | #blessairshld <value>                                  |
| #blessanimawe         | Defined           | Site     | M6.34 p40            | #blessanimawe <value>                                  |
| #blessatt             | Defined           | Site     | M6.34 p41            | #blessatt <value>                                      |

| Token             | Status    | Domain        | Official locator                | Strongest syntax                |
|-------------------|-----------|---------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| #blessawe         | Defined   | Site          | M6.34 p40                       | #blessawe <value>               |
| #blessbers        | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59            | #blessbers                      |
| #blessbonus       | Defined   | Nation        | M6.34 p47                       | #blessbonus <0 - 9>             |
| #blesscoldres     | Defined   | Site          | M6.34 p41                       | #blesscoldres <value>           |
| #blessdarkvis     | Defined   | Site          | M6.34 p41                       | #blessdarkvis <value>           |
| #blessdef         | Defined   | Site          | M6.34 p41                       | #blessdef <value>               |
| #blessdtv         | Defined   | Site          | M6.34 p41                       | #blessdtv <value>               |
| #blessfireres     | Defined   | Site          | M6.34 p41                       | #blessfireres <value>           |
| #blessfly         | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59            | #blessfly                       |
| #blesshp          | Defined   | Site          | M6.34 p40                       | #blesshp <value>                |
| #blessmor         | Defined   | Site          | M6.34 p40                       | #blessmor <value>               |
| #blessmr          | Defined   | Site          | M6.34 p40                       | #blessmr <value>                |
| #blesspoisres     | Defined   | Site          | M6.34 p41                       | #blesspoisres <value>           |
| #blessprec        | Defined   | Site          | M6.34 p41                       | #blessprec <value>              |
| #blessreinvig     | Defined   | Site          | M6.34 p41                       | #blessreinvig <value>           |
| #blessshockres    | Defined   | Site          | M6.34 p41                       | #blessshockres <value>          |
| #blessstr         | Defined   | Site          | M6.34 p40                       | #blessstr <value>               |
| #blind            | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p19                       | #blind                          |
| #blink            | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p20                       | #blink                          |
| #bloodblessbonus  | Defined   | Nation        | M6.34 p47                       | #bloodblessbonus <0 - 9>        |
| #bloodboost       | Defined   | Event         | E6.29 p16                       | #bloodboost "name"   <number>   |
| #bloodcost        | Defined   | Site          | M6.34 p39                       | #bloodcost <bonus>              |
| #bloodnation      | Defined   | Nation        | M6.34 p44                       | #bloodnation                    |
| #bloodrange       | Defined   | Monster, Site | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60 | #bloodrange <range>             |
| #bloodvengeance   | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59            | #bloodvengeance <strength>      |
| #blunt            | Defined   | Weapon        | M6.34 p9                        | #blunt                          |
| #bluntres         | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59            | #bluntres                       |
| #boartattoo       | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p26                       | #boartattoo <value>             |
| #bodyguard        | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60            | #bodyguard <bonus>              |
| #bodyguards       | Defined   | Map           | P6.26 p8                        | #bodyguards <nbr> "<type>"      |
| #bonus            | Defined   | Weapon        | M6.34 p10                       | #bonus                          |
| #bonusspells      | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60            | #bonusspells <spells per round> |
| #bossname         | Defined   | Mercenary     | M6.34 p63                       | #bossname "<name>"              |
| #bowstr           | Defined   | Weapon        | M6.34 p9                        | #bowstr                         |
| #bravemount       | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p31                       | #bravemount <percent>           |
| #brief            | Defined   | Nation        | M6.34 p42                       | #brief "<nation name>"          |
| #bringeroffortune | Reference | Monster       | M6.34 p36; M6.34 p60            | #bringeroffortune               |

| Token            | Status  | Domain  | Official locator | Strongest syntax                                  |
|------------------|---------|---------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| #bug             | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p19        | #bug                                              |
| #bugreform       | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p23        | #bugreform <nbr of bugs>                          |
| #bugshape        | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p23        | #bugshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>        |
| #bugswarmshape   | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p23        | #bugswarmshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>   |
| #bugswarmuwshape | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p23        | #bugswarmuwshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #buguwshape      | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p23        | #buguwshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>      |
| #buildcoastfort  | Defined | Nation  | M6.34 p49        | #buildcoastfort <fort nbr>                        |
| #buildfort       | Defined | Nation  | M6.34 p49        | #buildfort <fort nbr>                             |
| #builduwfort     | Defined | Nation  | M6.34 p49        | #builduwfort <fort nbr>                           |

## C

| Token             | Status  | Domain  | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                             |
|-------------------|---------|---------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| #cannotwin        | Defined | Map     | P6.26 p6             | #cannotwin <nation nbr>                      |
| #carcasscollector | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p61 | #carcasscollector <value>                    |
| #castledef        | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60 | #castledef <value>                           |
| #castleprod       | Defined | Nation  | M6.34 p49            | #castleprod <resource boost in percent>      |
| #casttime         | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p53            | #casttime <1-1000>                           |
| #caveinc          | Defined | Site    | M6.34 p43            | #caveinc <bonus>                             |
| #cavelabcost      | Defined | Nation  | M6.34 p48            | #cavelabcost <price>                         |
| #cavenation       | Defined | Site    | M6.34 p43            | #cavenation <0-3>                            |
| #caverecpt        | Defined | Site    | M6.34 p43            | #caverecpt <bonus>                           |
| #caveres          | Defined | Site    | M6.34 p43            | #caveres <bonus>                             |
| #cavetemplecost   | Defined | Nation  | M6.34 p48            | #cavetemplecost <price>                      |
| #champprize       | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p58            | #champprize                                  |
| #chaospower       | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59 | #chaospower <bonus>                          |
| #chaosrec         | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p15; M6.34 p58 | #chaosrec <value>                            |
| #chaosrecscale    | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p15            | #chaosrecscale <value>                       |
| #chaosscale       | Defined | Bless   | M6.34 p37            | #chaosscale <value>                          |
| #charge           | Defined | Weapon  | M6.34 p10            | #charge                                      |
| #cheapgod20       | Defined | Nation  | M6.34 p47            | #cheapgod20 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #cheapgod40       | Defined | Nation  | M6.34 p47            | #cheapgod40 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #chestwound       | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p57            | #chestwound                                  |
| #chorusmaster     | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60 | #chorusmaster                                |

| Token           | Status            | Domain                                                   | Official locator                                        | Strongest syntax                                 |
|-----------------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| #chorusslave    | Defined           | Monster                                                  | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60                                    | #chorusslave                                     |
| #claim          | Defined           | Site                                                     | M6.34 p40                                               | #claim                                           |
| #claimthrone    | Defined           | Event                                                    | E6.29 p13                                               | #claimthrone                                     |
| #cleanshape     | Defined           | Monster                                                  | M6.34 p28                                               | #cleanshape                                      |
| #clear          | Defined           | Armour, Event, Item, Monster, Names, Site, Spell, Weapon | E6.29 p2; M6.34 p7; M6.34 p12; M6.34 p13; M6.34 p36; +3 | #clear                                           |
| #clearallevnts  | Defined           | Event                                                    | E6.29 p2                                                | #clearallevnts                                   |
| #clearallitems  | Defined           | Item                                                     | M6.34 p55                                               | #clearallitems                                   |
| #clearallspells | Defined           | Spell                                                    | M6.34 p50                                               | #clearallspells                                  |
| #cleararmor     | Defined           | Monster, Weapon                                          | M6.34 p13                                               | #cleararmor                                      |
| #cleardef       | Defined           | Poptype                                                  | M6.34 p63                                               | #cleardef                                        |
| #clearfx        | Defined           | Bless                                                    | M6.34 p37                                               | #clearfx                                         |
| #cleargods      | Defined           | Nation                                                   | M6.34 p47                                               | #cleargods                                       |
| #clearmagic     | Defined           | Map, Monster                                             | P6.26 p9; M6.34 p13                                     | #clearmagic                                      |
| #clearmercs     | Defined           | Mercenary                                                | M6.34 p63                                               | #clearmercs                                      |
| #clearnation    | Defined           | Nation                                                   | M6.34 p42                                               | #clearnation                                     |
| #clearrec       | Defined           | Nation, Poptype                                          | M6.34 p45; M6.34 p63                                    | #clearrec                                        |
| #clearscales    | Defined           | Bless                                                    | M6.34 p37                                               | #clearscales                                     |
| #clearsites     | Defined           | Site                                                     | M6.34 p43                                               | #clearsites                                      |
| #clearspec      | Defined           | Monster                                                  | M6.34 p13                                               | #clearspec                                       |
| #cleartarg      | Defined           | Event                                                    | E6.29 p15                                               | #cleartarg                                       |
| #clearvar       | Defined           | Event                                                    | E6.29 p18                                               | #clearvar <event var>                            |
| #clearweapons   | Defined           | Monster, Weapon                                          | M6.34 p13                                               | #clearweapons                                    |
| #clumsy         | Defined           | Monster                                                  | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59                                    | #clumsy <0 or 1>                                 |
| #cluster        | Defined           | Site                                                     | M6.34 p40                                               | #cluster <value>                                 |
| #coastcom1...2  | Defined; template | Nation                                                   | M6.34 p45                                               | #coastcom1...2 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>  |
| #coastnation    | Defined           | Site                                                     | M6.34 p43                                               | #coastnation                                     |
| #coastunit1...3 | Defined; template | Nation                                                   | M6.34 p45                                               | #coastunit1...3 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #code           | Defined           | Event                                                    | E6.29 p17; E6.29 p19                                    | #code <event code>                               |
| #code2          | Defined           | Event                                                    | E6.29 p17                                               | #code2 <event code>                              |
| #codedelay      | Defined           | Event                                                    | E6.29 p18                                               | #codedelay <event code>                          |
| #codedelay2     | Defined           | Event                                                    | E6.29 p18                                               | #codedelay2 <event code>                         |
| #cold           | Defined           | Monster, Weapon                                          | M6.34 p9; M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59                          | #cold                                            |
| #coldblood      | Defined           | Monster                                                  | M6.34 p19                                               | #coldblood                                       |
| #coldifhit      | Defined           | Weapon                                                   | M6.34 p12                                               | #coldifhit <dmg>                                 |
| #coldincome     | Defined           | General                                                  | M6.34 p61                                               | #coldincome <percent>                            |

| Token           | Status    | Domain                    | Official locator                                      | Strongest syntax                             |
|-----------------|-----------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| #coldpower      | Defined   | Monster                   | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59                                  | #coldpower <bonus>                           |
| #coldrec        | Mention   | Monster                   | M6.34 p15                                             | #coldrec                                     |
| #coldrecscale   | Defined   | Monster                   | M6.34 p15                                             | #coldrecscale <value>                        |
| #coldres        | Defined   | Item, Monster             | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p56                                  | #coldres <prot>                              |
| #coldscale      | Defined   | Bless                     | M6.34 p37                                             | #coldscale <value>                           |
| #coldsupply     | Defined   | General                   | M6.34 p61                                             | #coldsupply <percent>                        |
| #color          | Defined   | General, Nation           | M6.34 p43; M6.34 p64                                  | #color <red> <green> <blue>                  |
| #com            | Defined   | Event, Mercenary, Monster | E6.29 p14; M6.34 p38; M6.34 p63; E6.29 p19; E6.29 p20 | #com "name"   <number>                       |
| #combatcaster   | Reference | Monster                   | M6.34 p36; M6.34 p60                                  | #combatcaster                                |
| #command        | Defined   | Monster                   | M6.34 p31; M6.34 p60                                  | #command <value>                             |
| #commander      | Defined   | Map                       | P6.26 p8                                              | #commander "<type>"                          |
| #commaster      | Defined   | Monster                   | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60                                  | #commaster                                   |
| #comname        | Defined   | Map                       | P6.26 p8                                              | #comname "<name>"                            |
| #computerplayer | Defined   | Map                       | P6.26 p6                                              | #computerplayer <nation nbr> <difficulty>    |
| #comslave       | Defined   | Monster                   | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60                                  | #comslave                                    |
| #conjcost       | Defined   | Site                      | M6.34 p39                                             | #conjcost <bonus>                            |
| #constcost      | Defined   | Site                      | M6.34 p39                                             | #constcost <bonus>                           |
| #constlevel     | Defined   | Item                      | M6.34 p55                                             | #constlevel <level>                          |
| #copyarmor      | Defined   | Armour                    | M6.34 p12                                             | #copyarmor "<armor name>"   <armor nbr>      |
| #copyitem       | Defined   | Item                      | M6.34 p55                                             | #copyitem "<item name>"   <item nbr>         |
| #copysite       | Defined   | Site                      | M6.34 p37                                             | #copysite "<site name>"   <site nbr>         |
| #copyspell      | Defined   | Spell                     | M6.34 p50                                             | #copyspell "<spell name>"   <spell nbr>      |
| #copyspr        | Defined   | Item, Monster             | M6.34 p13; M6.34 p55                                  | #copyspr <monster nbr>                       |
| #copystats      | Defined   | Monster                   | M6.34 p13                                             | #copystats <monster nbr>                     |
| #copyweapon     | Defined   | Weapon                    | M6.34 p7                                              | #copyweapon "<weapon name>"   <weapon nbr>   |
| #coridermnr     | Defined   | Monster                   | M6.34 p30                                             | #coridermnr "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #corpseeater    | Defined   | Monster                   | M6.34 p22                                             | #corpseeater <value>                         |
| #corpselord     | Defined   | Monster                   | M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61                                  | #corpselord <nbr>                            |
| #corruptor      | Defined   | Monster                   | M6.34 p20; M6.34 p59                                  | #corruptor <value>                           |
| #cost0          | Defined   | Bless                     | M6.34 p37                                             | #cost0 <value>                               |
| #cost1          | Defined   | Bless                     | M6.34 p37                                             | #cost1 <value>                               |
| #crippled       | Defined   | Item                      | M6.34 p58                                             | #crippled                                    |
| #crossbreeder   | Defined   | Monster                   | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60                                  | #crossbreeder <value>                        |
| #cure           | Defined   | Spell                     | M6.34 p54                                             | #cure "text"                                 |



| Token            | Status  | Domain            | Official locator                | Strongest syntax                     |
|------------------|---------|-------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| #curse           | Defined | Event, Item, Site | E6.29 p15; M6.34 p40; M6.34 p57 | #curse <percent>                     |
| #cursed          | Defined | Item              | M6.34 p57                       | #cursed                              |
| #curseluckshield | Defined | Monster           | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59            | #curseluckshield <penetration bonus> |
| #custommagic     | Defined | Monster           | M6.34 p33                       | #custommagic <path mask> <chance>    |

## D

| Token            | Status             | Domain       | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                            |
|------------------|--------------------|--------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| ##dishe##        | Reference; message | Spell        | M6.34 p54            | ##dishe##                                   |
| ##dishim##       | Reference; message | Spell        | M6.34 p54            | ##dishim##                                  |
| ##dishimself##   | Reference; message | Spell        | M6.34 p54            | ##dishimself##                              |
| ##disHis##       | Reference; message | Spell        | M6.34 p54            | ##disHis##                                  |
| ##dishis##       | Reference; message | Spell        | M6.34 p54            | ##dishis##                                  |
| ##disname##      | Reference; message | Event, Spell | E6.29 p11; M6.34 p54 | ##disname##                                 |
| ##disnat##       | Reference; message | Spell        | M6.34 p54            | ##disnat##                                  |
| #damage          | Defined            | Event, Spell | M6.34 p51; E6.29 p20 | #damage <dmg>                               |
| #damagemon       | Defined            | Spell        | M6.34 p51            | #damagemon "<monster name>"                 |
| #damagerev       | Defined            | Monster      | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59 | #damagerev <strength>                       |
| #dancenof        | Defined            | Weapon       | M6.34 p58            | #dancenof <nbr of sprites>                  |
| #dancenratt      | Defined            | Weapon       | M6.34 p58            | #dancenratt <attacks>                       |
| #dancesize       | Defined            | Weapon       | M6.34 p58            | #dancesize <size>                           |
| #dancespr        | Defined            | Weapon       | M6.34 p58            | #dancespr <flysprite nbr>                   |
| #danceweapon     | Defined            | Weapon       | M6.34 p58            | #danceweapon "<weapon name>"   <weapon nbr> |
| #darkpower       | Defined            | Monster      | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59 | #darkpower <bonus>                          |
| #darkvision      | Defined            | Monster      | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59 | #darkvision <percent>                       |
| #deadhp          | Defined            | Monster      | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59 | #deadhp <value>                             |
| #deathbanish     | Defined            | Monster      | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60 | #deathbanish <-11 to -13>                   |
| #deathblessbonus | Defined            | Nation       | M6.34 p47            | #deathblessbonus <0 - 9>                    |
| #deathboost      | Defined            | Event        | E6.29 p16; E6.29 p19 | #deathboost "name"   <number>               |
| #deathcurse      | Defined            | Monster      | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p59 | #deathcurse                                 |
| #deathdeath      | Defined            | General      | M6.34 p61            | #deathdeath <0.01 percent>                  |
| #deathdisease    | Defined            | Monster      | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p59 | #deathdisease <aoe>                         |
| #deathfire       | Defined            | Monster      | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p59 | #deathfire <aoe>                            |
| #deathgrab       | Defined            | Monster      | M6.34 p26            | #deathgrab <aoe>                            |

| Token          | Status  | Domain                        | Official locator                                    | Strongest syntax                          |
|----------------|---------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| #deathincome   | Defined | General                       | M6.34 p61                                           | #deathincome <percent>                    |
| #deathparalyze | Defined | Monster                       | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p59                                | #deathparalyze <aoe>                      |
| #deathpoison   | Defined | Monster                       | M6.34 p26                                           | #deathpoison <aoe>                        |
| #deathpower    | Defined | Monster                       | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59                                | #deathpower <bonus>                       |
| #deathrange    | Defined | Monster, Site                 | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60                     | #deathrange <range>                       |
| #deathrec      | Defined | Monster                       | M6.34 p15                                           | #deathrec <value>                         |
| #deathrecscale | Defined | Monster                       | M6.34 p15                                           | #deathrecscale <value>                    |
| #deathscale    | Defined | Bless                         | M6.34 p37                                           | #deathscale <value>                       |
| #deathshock    | Defined | Monster                       | M6.34 p26                                           | #deathshock <aoe>                         |
| #deathslime    | Defined | Monster                       | M6.34 p26                                           | #deathslime <aoe>                         |
| #deathsupply   | Defined | General                       | M6.34 p61                                           | #deathsupply <percent>                    |
| #decl0var      | Defined | Event                         | E6.29 p18                                           | #decl0var <event var>                     |
| #decayres      | Defined | Item, Monster                 | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p56                                | #decayres <0 or 1>                        |
| #decscale      | Defined | Event, Monster, Site          | E6.29 p12; M6.34 p27; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60          | #decscale <scale>                         |
| #decscale2     | Defined | Event                         | E6.29 p12                                           | #decscale2 <scale>                        |
| #decscale3     | Defined | Event                         | E6.29 p12; E6.29 p19                                | #decscale3 <scale>                        |
| #decunrest     | Defined | Site                          | M6.34 p38                                           | #decunrest <value>                        |
| #decvar        | Defined | Event                         | E6.29 p18                                           | #decvar <event var>                       |
| #def           | Defined | Armour, Item, Monster, Weapon | M6.34 p7; M6.34 p12; M6.34 p16; M6.34 p56; M6.34 p9 | #def <defense>                            |
| #defchaos      | Defined | Site                          | M6.34 p43                                           | #defchaos <-5 - 5>                        |
| #defcom        | Defined | Monster                       | M6.34 p38                                           | #defcom "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>  |
| #defcom1       | Defined | Nation, Poptype               | M6.34 p45; M6.34 p63                                | #defcom1 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #defcom2       | Defined | Nation                        | M6.34 p46                                           | #defcom2 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #defdeath      | Defined | Site                          | M6.34 p43                                           | #defdeath <-5 - 5>                        |
| #defdrain      | Defined | Site                          | M6.34 p43                                           | #defdrain <-5 - 5>                        |
| #defector      | Defined | Monster                       | M6.34 p15                                           | #defector <percent>                       |
| #defence       | Defined | Event, Map                    | E6.29 p13; P6.26 p8                                 | #defence <value>                          |
| #defmisfortune | Defined | Site                          | M6.34 p43                                           | #defmisfortune <-5 - 5>                   |
| #defmult       | Defined | Monster                       | M6.34 p38                                           | #defmult <multiplier>                     |
| #defmult1      | Defined | Nation, Poptype               | M6.34 p46; M6.34 p63                                | #defmult1 <multiplier>                    |
| #defmult1b     | Defined | Nation, Poptype               | M6.34 p46; M6.34 p63                                | #defmult1b <multiplier>                   |
| #defmult1c     | Defined | Nation, Poptype               | M6.34 p46; M6.34 p63                                | #defmult1c <multiplier>                   |
| #defmult1d     | Defined | Nation                        | M6.34 p46                                           | #defmult1d <multiplier>                   |
| #defmult2      | Defined | Nation                        | M6.34 p46                                           | #defmult2 <multiplier>                    |
| #defmult2b     | Defined | Nation                        | M6.34 p46                                           | #defmult2b <multiplier>                   |

| Token              | Status  | Domain                                       | Official locator                                          | Strongest syntax                            |
|--------------------|---------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| #defroll           | Defined | Weapon                                       | M6.34 p10                                                 | #defroll                                    |
| #defslot           | Defined | Site                                         | M6.34 p43                                                 | #defslot <-5 - 5>                           |
| #defunit           | Defined | Monster                                      | M6.34 p38                                                 | #defunit "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>   |
| #defunit1          | Defined | Nation, Poptype                              | M6.34 p46; M6.34 p63                                      | #defunit1 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>  |
| #defunit1b         | Defined | Nation, Poptype                              | M6.34 p46; M6.34 p63                                      | #defunit1b "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #defunit1c         | Defined | Nation, Poptype                              | M6.34 p46; M6.34 p63                                      | #defunit1c "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #defunit1d         | Defined | Nation                                       | M6.34 p46                                                 | #defunit1d "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #defunit2          | Defined | Nation                                       | M6.34 p46                                                 | #defunit2 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>  |
| #defunit2b         | Defined | Nation                                       | M6.34 p46                                                 | #defunit2b "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #delay             | Defined | Event                                        | E6.29 p17; E6.29 p19                                      | #delay <value>                              |
| #delay25           | Defined | Event                                        | E6.29 p17                                                 | #delay25 <value>                            |
| #delay50           | Defined | Event                                        | E6.29 p17                                                 | #delay50 <value>                            |
| #delayskip         | Defined | Event                                        | E6.29 p17                                                 | #delayskip <percent>                        |
| #delgod            | Defined | Nation                                       | M6.34 p47                                                 | #delgod "<monster>"   <monster nbr>         |
| #demon             | Defined | Monster                                      | M6.34 p19                                                 | #demon                                      |
| #demononly         | Defined | Weapon                                       | M6.34 p9                                                  | #demononly                                  |
| #demonundead       | Defined | Weapon                                       | M6.34 p9                                                  | #demonundead                                |
| #descr             | Defined | Event, General, Item, Monster, Nation, Spell | M6.34 p13; M6.34 p42; M6.34 p50; M6.34 p56; E6.29 p20; +1 | #descr "<text description>"                 |
| #description       | Defined | General, Map, Metadata                       | P6.26 p3; M6.34 p5; M6.34 p64                             | #description "text"                         |
| #deserter          | Defined | Monster                                      | M6.34 p15                                                 | #deserter <percent>                         |
| #details           | Defined | Spell                                        | M6.34 p50                                                 | #details "<text>"                           |
| #digest            | Defined | Monster                                      | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59                                      | #digest <dmg>                               |
| #disableoldnations | Defined | Nation                                       | M6.34 p43                                                 | #disableoldnations                          |
| #disbless          | Defined | Nation                                       | M6.34 p49                                                 | #disbless "bless name"   <nbr>              |
| #disease           | Defined | Event, Item, Site                            | E6.29 p15; M6.34 p40; M6.34 p57                           | #disease <percent>                          |
| #diseasecloud      | Defined | Monster                                      | M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59                                      | #diseasecloud <size>                        |
| #diseaseres        | Defined | Monster                                      | M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59                                      | #diseaseres <percent>                       |
| #dispglobals       | Defined | Event                                        | E6.29 p17                                                 | #dispglobals <str>                          |
| #dispimmune        | Defined | Spell                                        | M6.34 p54                                                 | #dispimmune <0 - 2>                         |
| #divinebeing       | Defined | Monster                                      | M6.34 p19                                                 | #divinebeing                                |
| #divineins         | Defined | Monster                                      | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60                                      | #divineins                                  |
| #djinn             | Defined | Monster                                      | M6.34 p18                                                 | #djinn                                      |
| #dmg               | Defined | Weapon                                       | M6.34 p7; M6.34 p9                                        | #dmg <damage>                               |

| Token             | Status  | Domain        | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                              |
|-------------------|---------|---------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| #doheal           | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59 | #doheal                                       |
| #dom2title        | Defined | Map           | P6.26 p3             | #dom2title <text>                             |
| #dom6title        | Mention | Map           | P6.26 p3             | #dom6title                                    |
| #domdeathsense    | Defined | Nation        | M6.34 p49            | #domdeathsense                                |
| #domimmortal      | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p23            | #domimmortal                                  |
| #dominion         | Defined | Site          | M6.34 p40            | #dominion <temple checks per month>           |
| #dominionstr      | Defined | Map           | P6.26 p9             | #dominionstr <nation nbr> <1-10>              |
| #domkill          | Defined | Nation        | M6.34 p49            | #domkill <value>                              |
| #dompower         | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59 | #dompower <bonus>                             |
| #domrec           | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p15            | #domrec <dominion>                            |
| #domsail          | Defined | Nation        | M6.34 p49            | #domsail                                      |
| #domshape         | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p28            | #domshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>    |
| #domstr           | Defined | AI            | M6.34 p64            | #domstr <level>                               |
| #domsummon        | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61 | #domsummon "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>   |
| #domsummon2       | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61 | #domsummon2 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>  |
| #domsummon20      | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61 | #domsummon20 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #domunrest        | Defined | Nation        | M6.34 p49            | #domunrest <value>                            |
| #domversion       | Defined | Map, Metadata | P6.26 p3; M6.34 p5   | #domversion <version>                         |
| #domwar           | Defined | Nation, Site  | M6.34 p41; M6.34 p49 | #domwar <value>                               |
| #doomhorror       | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p19            | #doomhorror                                   |
| #douse            | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60 | #douse <bonus>                                |
| #dragonlord       | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61 | #dragonlord <nbr>                             |
| #drainimmune      | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60 | #drainimmune                                  |
| #drainscale       | Defined | Bless         | M6.34 p37            | #drainscale <value>                           |
| #drake            | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p19            | #drake                                        |
| #drawsize         | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p13            | #drawsize <value>                             |
| #dread            | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p24            | #dread <value>                                |
| #dt_aff           | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p8; M6.34 p9   | #dt_aff                                       |
| #dt_bouncekill    | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p8             | #dt_bouncekill                                |
| #dt_cap           | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p8             | #dt_cap                                       |
| #dt_constructonly | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p8             | #dt_constructonly                             |
| #dt_demon         | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p8             | #dt_demon                                     |
| #dt_drain         | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p8             | #dt_drain                                     |
| #dt_holy          | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p8             | #dt_holy                                      |
| #dt_interrupt     | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p8             | #dt_interrupt                                 |
| #dt_large         | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p8             | #dt_large                                     |

| Token           | Status  | Domain          | Official locator | Strongest syntax |
|-----------------|---------|-----------------|------------------|------------------|
| #dt_magic       | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p8         | #dt_magic        |
| #dt_normal      | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p7         | #dt_normal       |
| #dt_paralyze    | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p8         | #dt_paralyze     |
| #dt_poison      | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p7         | #dt_poison       |
| #dt_raise       | Defined | Monster, Weapon | M6.34 p8         | #dt_raise        |
| #dt_realstun    | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p8         | #dt_realstun     |
| #dt_sizestun    | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p8         | #dt_sizestun     |
| #dt_small       | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p8         | #dt_small        |
| #dt_stun        | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p8         | #dt_stun         |
| #dt_weakness    | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p8         | #dt_weakness     |
| #dt_weapondrain | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p8         | #dt_weapondrain  |
| #dungeon        | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p19        | #dungeon         |
| #dyingdom       | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p49        | #dyingdom        |

## E

| Token            | Status  | Domain          | Official locator                | Strongest syntax                    |
|------------------|---------|-----------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| #earthblessbonus | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p47                       | #earthblessbonus <0 - 9>            |
| #earthboost      | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p16                       | #earthboost "name"   <number>       |
| #earthelementals | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61            | #earthelementals <bonus>            |
| #earthrange      | Defined | Monster, Site   | M6.34 p33; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60 | #earthrange <range>                 |
| #effect          | Defined | Event, Spell    | M6.34 p51; E6.29 p20            | #effect <eff>                       |
| #elegist         | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60            | #elegist <value>                    |
| #elementgems     | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60            | #elementgems <gems>                 |
| #elementrange    | Defined | Monster, Site   | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60 | #elementrange <range>               |
| #emigration      | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p13                       | #emigration <percent>               |
| #enc             | Defined | Armour, Monster | M6.34 p12; M6.34 p17            | #enc <encumbrance>                  |
| #enchantedblood  | Defined | Item, Monster   | M6.34 p23; M6.34 p57            | #enchantedblood <points>            |
| #enchcost        | Defined | Site            | M6.34 p39                       | #enchcost <bonus>                   |
| #enchrebatel0    | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p14                       | #enchrebatel0 <enchantment number>  |
| #enchrebatel00   | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p15                       | #enchrebatel00 <enchantment number> |
| #enchrebate20    | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p15                       | #enchrebate20 <enchantment number>  |
| #enchrebate25p   | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p15                       | #enchrebate25p <enchantment number> |
| #enchrebate50    | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p15                       | #enchrebate50 <enchantment number>  |
| #enchrebate50p   | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p15                       | #enchrebate50p <enchantment number> |
| #enchrebate75    | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p15                       | #enchrebate75 <enchantment number>  |

| Token               | Status  | Domain                                                                                                          | Official locator                                        | Strongest syntax         |
|---------------------|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| #end                | Defined | Al, Armour, Bless, Event, General, Item, Mercenary, Monster, Names, Nation, Poptype, Site, Sound, Spell, Weapon | E6.29 p2; M6.34 p5; M6.34 p6; M6.34 p12; M6.34 p13; +10 | #end                     |
| #enemyimmune        | Defined | Weapon                                                                                                          | M6.34 p9                                                | #enemyimmune             |
| #entangle           | Defined | Monster                                                                                                         | M6.34 p24                                               | #entangle                |
| #epithet            | Defined | General, Nation                                                                                                 | M6.34 p42; M6.34 p64                                    | #epithet "<nation name>" |
| #era                | Defined | General, Nation                                                                                                 | M6.34 p42; M6.34 p64                                    | #era <era nbr>           |
| #eramask            | Defined | Mercenary                                                                                                       | M6.34 p63                                               | #eramask <value>         |
| #ethereal           | Defined | Monster                                                                                                         | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59                                    | #ethereal                |
| #eventisrare        | Defined | General                                                                                                         | M6.34 p61                                               | #eventisrare <percent>   |
| #evil               | Defined | Site                                                                                                            | M6.34 p41                                               | #evil                    |
| #evocost            | Defined | Site                                                                                                            | M6.34 p39                                               | #evocost <bonus>         |
| #exactgold          | Defined | Event                                                                                                           | E6.29 p12                                               | #exactgold <value>       |
| #expertleader       | Defined | Monster                                                                                                         | M6.34 p31                                               | #expertleader            |
| #expertmagicleader  | Defined | Monster                                                                                                         | M6.34 p32                                               | #expertmagicleader       |
| #expertundeadleader | Defined | Monster                                                                                                         | M6.34 p32                                               | #expertundeadleader      |
| #explspr            | Defined | Sound, Weapon                                                                                                   | M6.34 p11; M6.34 p52                                    | #explspr <fx nbr>        |
| #extralife          | Defined | Item                                                                                                            | M6.34 p56                                               | #extralife               |
| #extralives         | Defined | Monster                                                                                                         | M6.34 p22                                               | #extralives <percent>    |
| #extrams            | Defined | Event                                                                                                           | E6.29 p11                                               | #extrams <nation number> |
| #eyeloss            | Defined | Monster                                                                                                         | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59                                    | #eyeloss                 |
| #eyes               | Defined | Monster                                                                                                         | M6.34 p17                                               | #eyes <nbr of eyes>      |

## F

| Token                 | Status             | Domain       | Official locator     | Strongest syntax      |
|-----------------------|--------------------|--------------|----------------------|-----------------------|
| ##fullgodname#        | Reference; message | Event, Spell | E6.29 p11; M6.34 p54 | ##fullgodname##       |
| ##fullplayergodname## | Reference; message | Spell        | M6.34 p54            | ##fullplayergodname## |
| ##fullplayername##    | Reference; message | Spell        | M6.34 p54            | ##fullplayername##    |
| ##fulltargname##      | Reference; message | Event        | E6.29 p11            | ##fulltargname##      |
| #fallpower            | Defined            | Monster      | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59 | #fallpower <percent>  |
| #false                | Defined            | Weapon       | M6.34 p10            | #false                |
| #falsearmy            | Defined            | Monster      | M6.34 p21; M6.34 p58 | #falsearmy <value>    |
| #falseregen           | Defined            | Monster      | M6.34 p23            | #falseregen <points>  |
| #falsesupply          | Defined            | Monster      | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60 | #falsesupply <value>  |

| Token           | Status  | Domain        | Official locator                | Strongest syntax                                        |
|-----------------|---------|---------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| #farsail        | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58            | #farsail <extra provinces>                              |
| #farsumcom      | Defined | Spell         | M6.34 p53                       | #farsumcom "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>             |
| #farthronekill  | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60            | #farthronekill <part>                                   |
| #fastcast       | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60            | #fastcast <speedup>                                     |
| #fatiguecost    | Defined | Event, Spell  | M6.34 p51; E6.29 p20            | #fatiguecost <fat>                                      |
| #favrit         | Defined | AI            | M6.34 p64                       | #favrit <disschool> <level> "ritual name"   "item name" |
| #faysummon      | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p30                       | #faysummon <nbr>                                        |
| #fear           | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59            | #fear <value>                                           |
| #fearofflood    | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p59            | #fearofflood <value>                                    |
| #feature        | Defined | Map           | P6.26 p7                        | #feature "<site name>"   <site nbr>                     |
| #features       | Defined | Map           | P6.26 p4                        | #features <0-100>                                       |
| #feeblemind     | Defined | Item          | M6.34 p57                       | #feeblemind                                             |
| #female         | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p18                       | #female                                                 |
| #fire           | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p9                        | #fire                                                   |
| #fireattuned    | Mention | Monster       | M6.34 p28                       | #fireattuned                                            |
| #fireblessbonus | Defined | Nation        | M6.34 p47                       | #fireblessbonus <0 - 9>                                 |
| #fireboost      | Defined | Event         | E6.29 p16                       | #fireboost "name"   <number>                            |
| #fireelementals | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61            | #fireelementals <bonus>                                 |
| #fireifhit      | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p12                       | #fireifhit <dmg>                                        |
| #firepower      | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59            | #firepower <bonus>                                      |
| #firerange      | Defined | Monster, Site | M6.34 p33; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60 | #firerange <range>                                      |
| #fireres        | Defined | Item, Monster | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p56            | #fireres <prot>                                         |
| #fireshield     | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59            | #fireshield <damage>                                    |
| #firstshape     | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p27                       | #firstshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>            |
| #fixedname      | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p13                       | #fixedname "<Name>"                                     |
| #fixedresearch  | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p34                       | #fixedresearch <value>                                  |
| #fixforgebonus  | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60            | #fixforgebonus <value>                                  |
| #flag           | Defined | Nation        | M6.34 p43                       | #flag "<imgfile>"                                       |
| #flagland       | Defined | Event         | E6.29 p17; E6.29 p19            | #flagland < 0   1 >                                     |
| #flail          | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p10                       | #flail                                                  |
| #flightspr      | Defined | Sound         | M6.34 p52                       | #flightspr <flysprite nbr>                              |
| #float          | Defined | Item, Monster | M6.34 p19; M6.34 p57            | #float                                                  |
| #fly            | Defined | Item          | M6.34 p57                       | #fly                                                    |
| #flying         | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p19                       | #flying                                                 |
| #flyingimmune   | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p9                        | #flyingimmune                                           |

| Token             | Status  | Domain           | Official locator               | Strongest syntax                                   |
|-------------------|---------|------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| #flyspr           | Defined | Weapon           | M6.34 p11                      | #flyspr <flysprite nbr> <animation lgth>           |
| #fogcol           | Defined | Map              | P6.26 p8                       | #fogcol <red> <green> <blue>                       |
| #foolscouts       | Defined | Monster          | M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59           | #foolscouts <value>                                |
| #force1d3vis      | Defined | Event            | E6.29 p12                      | #force1d3vis <gem type>                            |
| #force1d6vis      | Defined | Event            | E6.29 p12                      | #force1d6vis <gem type>                            |
| #force2d4vis      | Defined | Event            | E6.29 p12                      | #force2d4vis <gem type>                            |
| #force2d6vis      | Defined | Event            | E6.29 p12                      | #force2d6vis <gem type>                            |
| #force3d6vis      | Defined | Event            | E6.29 p12                      | #force3d6vis <gem type>                            |
| #force4d6vis      | Defined | Event            | E6.29 p12                      | #force4d6vis <gem type>                            |
| #forceexactgold   | Defined | Event            | E6.29 p12                      | #forceexactgold <value>                            |
| #forcegold        | Defined | Event            | E6.29 p12                      | #forcegold <value>                                 |
| #forcess          | Defined | Monster          | M6.34 p28                      | #forcess                                           |
| #forcetransform   | Defined | Event            | E6.29 p15                      | #forcetransform "name"   <number>                  |
| #foreignguardcom  | Defined | Nation           | M6.34 p46                      | #foreignguardcom "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>  |
| #foreignguardmult | Defined | Nation           | M6.34 p46                      | #foreignguardmult <multiplier>                     |
| #foreignguardunit | Defined | Nation           | M6.34 p46                      | #foreignguardunit "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #foreignshape     | Defined | Monster          | M6.34 p28                      | #foreignshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>     |
| #foreignwallcom   | Defined | Nation           | M6.34 p46                      | #foreignwallcom "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>   |
| #foreignwallmult  | Defined | Nation           | M6.34 p46                      | #foreignwallmult <multiplier>                      |
| #foreignwallunit  | Defined | Nation           | M6.34 p46                      | #foreignwallunit "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>  |
| #forestlabcost    | Defined | Nation           | M6.34 p48                      | #forestlabcost <price>                             |
| #forestrec        | Mention | Nation           | M6.34 p45                      | #forestrec                                         |
| #forestshape      | Defined | Monster          | M6.34 p28                      | #forestshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>      |
| #forestsurvival   | Defined | Monster          | M6.34 p20                      | #forestsurvival                                    |
| #foresttemplecost | Defined | Nation           | M6.34 p48                      | #foresttemplecost <price>                          |
| #forgebonus       | Defined | Monster          | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60           | #forgebonus <percent>                              |
| #form             | Defined | AI               | M6.34 p64                      | #form "monster name"                               |
| #formationfighter | Defined | Monster          | M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60           | #formationfighter <xsize>                          |
| #fort             | Defined | Event, Map, Site | E6.29 p13; P6.26 p8; M6.34 p40 | #fort <fort number>                                |
| #fortcoldscale    | Defined | Site             | M6.34 p44                      | #fortcoldscaleres <steps>                          |



| Token           | Status  | Domain  | Official locator     | Strongest syntax          |
|-----------------|---------|---------|----------------------|---------------------------|
| #fortcost       | Defined | Nation  | M6.34 p48            | #fortcost <extra cost>    |
| #fortera        | Defined | Nation  | M6.34 p48            | #fortera <0-4>            |
| #fortheatscales | Defined | Site    | M6.34 p44            | #fortheatscales <steps>   |
| #fortkill       | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60 | #fortkill <chance>        |
| #fortunrest     | Defined | Nation  | M6.34 p49            | #fortunrest <value>       |
| #friendlyench   | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p53            | #friendlyench <0 - 1>     |
| #friendlyimmune | Defined | Weapon  | M6.34 p9             | #friendlyimmune           |
| #fullstr        | Defined | Weapon  | M6.34 p9             | #fullstr                  |
| #futuresite     | Defined | Site    | M6.34 p43            | #futuresite "<site name>" |

## G

| Token          | Status             | Domain           | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                |
|----------------|--------------------|------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------|
| ##goddisname## | Reference; message | Event            | E6.29 p11            | ##goddisname##                  |
| ##godhe##      | Reference; message | Spell            | M6.34 p54            | ##godhe##                       |
| ##godhim##     | Reference; message | Spell            | M6.34 p54            | ##godhim##                      |
| ##godhimself## | Reference; message | Spell            | M6.34 p54            | ##godhimself##                  |
| ##godHis##     | Reference; message | Spell            | M6.34 p54            | ##godHis##                      |
| ##godhis##     | Reference; message | Spell            | M6.34 p54            | ##godhis##                      |
| ##godname##    | Reference; message | Event, Spell     | E6.29 p11; M6.34 p54 | ##godname##                     |
| ##godnat##     | Reference; message | Spell            | M6.34 p54            | ##godnat##                      |
| ##godthrone##  | Reference; message | Spell            | M6.34 p54            | ##godthrone##                   |
| #gainaff       | Defined            | Event            | E6.29 p15            | #gainaff <affliction bitmask>   |
| #gainmark      | Defined            | Event            | E6.29 p15            | #gainmark                       |
| #gate          | Defined            | Map              | P6.26 p4             | #gate <province nbr> <gate nbr> |
| #gcost         | Defined            | General, Monster | M6.34 p14; M6.34 p15 | #gcost <gold>                   |
| #gemlongevity  | Defined            | General          | M6.34 p62            | #gemlongevity <level>           |
| #gemloss       | Defined            | Event            | E6.29 p12            | #gemloss <gem type>             |
| #gemlosslarge  | Defined            | Event            | E6.29 p12            | #gemlosslarge <gem type>        |
| #gemlosssmall  | Defined            | Event            | E6.29 p12            | #gemlosssmall <gem type>        |
| #gemprod       | Defined            | Monster          | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60 | #gemprod <type> <number>        |
| #gems          | Defined            | Site             | M6.34 p38            | #gems <path> <amount>           |
| #ghostreanim   | Defined            | Nation           | M6.34 p50            | #ghostreanim                    |
| #giftofwater   | Defined            | Monster          | M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58 | #giftofwater <size points>      |

| Token             | Status  | Domain               | Official locator                                      | Strongest syntax                            |
|-------------------|---------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| #glamour          | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p23                                             | #glamour                                    |
| #glamourboost     | Defined | Event                | E6.29 p16                                             | #glamourboost "name"   <number>             |
| #glamourmanip     | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60                                  | #glamourmanip <0 or 1>                      |
| #glamourrange     | Defined | Monster, Site        | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60                       | #glamourrange <range>                       |
| #globallook       | Defined | Spell                | M6.34 p54                                             | #globallook <1 - 9>                         |
| #god              | Defined | Map                  | P6.26 p9                                              | #god <nation nbr> "<type>"                  |
| #goddomchaos      | Defined | Site                 | M6.34 p40                                             | #goddomchaos <value>                        |
| #goddomcold       | Defined | Site                 | M6.34 p40                                             | #goddomcold <value>                         |
| #goddomdeath      | Defined | Site                 | M6.34 p40                                             | #goddomdeath <value>                        |
| #goddomdrain      | Defined | Site                 | M6.34 p40                                             | #goddomdrain <value>                        |
| #goddomlazy       | Defined | Site                 | M6.34 p40                                             | #goddomlazy <value>                         |
| #goddommisfortune | Defined | Site                 | M6.34 p40                                             | #goddommisfortune <value>                   |
| #godpathspell     | Defined | Spell                | M6.34 p53                                             | #godpathspell <-1 - 7>                      |
| #godrebirth       | Defined | Nation               | M6.34 p47                                             | #godrebirth                                 |
| #godsite          | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p14                                             | #godsite "<site name>"   <site nbr>         |
| #gold             | Defined | Event, Monster, Site | E6.29 p12; M6.34 p27; M6.34 p38; E6.29 p20; M6.34 p60 | #gold <value>                               |
| #golemhp          | Defined | Nation               | M6.34 p49                                             | #golemhp <percent>                          |
| #goodleader       | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p31                                             | #goodleader                                 |
| #goodmagicleader  | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p32                                             | #goodmagicleader                            |
| #goodundeadleader | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p32                                             | #goodundeadleader                           |
| #grandcom         | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60                                  | #grandcom <0 or 1>                          |
| #greaterhorror    | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p19                                             | #greaterhorror                              |
| #greekreanim      | Defined | Nation               | M6.34 p50                                             | #greekreanim                                |
| #groundcol        | Defined | Map                  | P6.26 p8                                              | #groundcol <red> <green> <blue>             |
| #growhp           | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p28                                             | #growhp <hit points>                        |
| #growthpower      | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59                                  | #growthpower <bonus>                        |
| #growthrecscale   | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p15                                             | #growthrecscale <value>                     |
| #growthscale      | Defined | Bless                | M6.34 p37                                             | #growthscale <value>                        |
| #guardcom         | Defined | Nation               | M6.34 p46                                             | #guardcom "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>  |
| #guardmult        | Defined | Nation               | M6.34 p46                                             | #guardmult <multiplier>                     |
| #guardspirit      | Defined | Monster, Nation      | M6.34 p49                                             | #guardspirit "<monster name>"   <nbr>       |
| #guardspiritbonus | Defined | Item, Monster        | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p57                                  | #guardspiritbonus <value>                   |
| #guardunit        | Defined | Nation               | M6.34 p46                                             | #guardunit "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |

## H

| Token                 | Status               | Domain                             | Official locator                              | Strongest syntax                             |
|-----------------------|----------------------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| #halfdeathinc         | Defined              | Nation                             | M6.34 p49                                     | #halfdeathinc                                |
| #halfdeathpop         | Defined              | Nation                             | M6.34 p49                                     | #halfdeathpop                                |
| #halfstr              | Defined              | Weapon                             | M6.34 p9                                      | #halfstr                                     |
| #haltheretic          | Defined              | Monster                            | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59                          | #haltheretic <bonus>                         |
| #hardmrneg            | Defined              | Weapon                             | M6.34 p9                                      | #hardmrneg                                   |
| #hatesterr            | Defined              | Site                               | M6.34 p44                                     | #hatesterr <terrain mask>                    |
| #header               | Defined              | Event                              | E6.29 p11                                     | #header <type>                               |
| #heal                 | Defined              | Monster, Site                      | M6.34 p21; M6.34 p40                          | #heal                                        |
| #healaff              | Defined              | Event                              | E6.29 p15                                     | #healaff <nbr>                               |
| #healer               | Defined              | Monster                            | M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59                          | #healer <percent>                            |
| #heat                 | Defined              | Monster                            | M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59                          | #heat <value>                                |
| #heatrec              | Mention              | Monster                            | M6.34 p15                                     | #heatrec                                     |
| #heatrecscale         | Defined              | Monster                            | M6.34 p15                                     | #heatrecscale <value>                        |
| #heatscale            | Defined              | Bless                              | M6.34 p37                                     | #heatscale <value>                           |
| #heavyitem            | Defined              | Item                               | M6.34 p57                                     | #heavyitem <0 or 1>                          |
| #heretic              | Defined              | Monster                            | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60                          | #heretic <value>                             |
| #hero1...10           | Defined;<br>template | Nation                             | M6.34 p45                                     | #hero1...10 <monster nbr>                    |
| #hiddenench           | Defined              | Spell                              | M6.34 p53                                     | #hiddenench <0 - 1>                          |
| #hiddensite           | Defined              | Event                              | E6.29 p13                                     | #hiddensite <site number>                    |
| #hidedom              | Defined              | Nation                             | M6.34 p49                                     | #hidedom <0 or 1>                            |
| #holy                 | Defined              | Monster                            | M6.34 p19                                     | #holy                                        |
| #holyboost            | Defined              | Event                              | E6.29 p16                                     | #holyboost "name"   <number>                 |
| #holycost             | Defined              | Monster                            | M6.34 p19                                     | #holycost <holy points>                      |
| #holyfire             | Defined              | Site                               | M6.34 p40                                     | #holyfire <chance>                           |
| #holyifhit            | Defined              | Weapon                             | M6.34 p11                                     | #holyifhit <dmg>                             |
| #holypower            | Defined              | Site                               | M6.34 p40                                     | #holypower <chance>                          |
| #holyrange            | Defined              | Monster                            | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60                          | #holyrange <range>                           |
| #holystunifhit        | Defined              | Weapon                             | M6.34 p11                                     | #holystunifhit <dmg>                         |
| #homecoldscale<br>res | Defined              | Site                               | M6.34 p44                                     | #homecoldscaleres <steps>                    |
| #homecom              | Defined              | Monster                            | M6.34 p38                                     | #homecom "<monster name>"  <br><monster nbr> |
| #homefort             | Defined              | Nation                             | M6.34 p48                                     | #homefort <fort nbr>                         |
| #homeheatscale<br>res | Defined              | Site                               | M6.34 p44                                     | #homeheatscaleres <steps>                    |
| #homemon              | Defined              | Monster                            | M6.34 p38                                     | #homemon "<monster name>"  <br><monster nbr> |
| #homerealm            | Defined              | General, Monster,<br>Nation, Spell | M6.34 p14; M6.34 p47;<br>M6.34 p53; M6.34 p64 | #homerealm <realm nbr>                       |

| Token               | Status  | Domain        | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                            |
|---------------------|---------|---------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| #homeshape          | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p28            | #homeshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #homesick           | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59 | #homesick <percent>                         |
| #horrordesert<br>er | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p15            | #horrordeserter <percent>                   |
| #horrormark         | Defined | Monster, Site | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p40 | #horrormark                                 |
| #horsereanim        | Defined | Nation        | M6.34 p50            | #horsereanim                                |
| #horsetattoo        | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p26            | #horsetattoo <value>                        |
| #hp                 | Defined | Item, Monster | M6.34 p16; M6.34 p56 | #hp <hit points>                            |
| #hpooverflow        | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59 | #hpooverflow                                |
| #humanoid           | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p18            | #humanoid                                   |

| Token                | Status  | Domain               | Official locator                           | Strongest syntax      |
|----------------------|---------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| #iceforging          | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60                       | #iceforging <value>   |
| #icenatprot          | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59                       | #icenatprot <prot>    |
| #iceprot             | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59                       | #iceprot <prot>       |
| #iceweapon           | Defined | Weapon               | M6.34 p10                                  | #iceweapon            |
| #icon                | Defined | General, Metadata    | M6.34 p5                                   | #icon "<image.tga>"   |
| #id                  | Defined | Event                | E6.29 p18                                  | #id <eventid>         |
| #idealcold           | Defined | Site                 | M6.34 p43                                  | #idealcold <cold>     |
| #illusion            | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p19                                  | #illusion             |
| #illusionsimmu<br>ne | Defined | Weapon               | M6.34 p10                                  | #illusionsimmune      |
| #imagefile           | Defined | Map                  | P6.26 p3                                   | #imagefile <filename> |
| #immobile            | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p19                                  | #immobile             |
| #immortal            | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p23                                  | #immortal             |
| #inanimate           | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p19                                  | #inanimate            |
| #inanimateimmu<br>ne | Defined | Weapon               | M6.34 p9                                   | #inanimateimmune      |
| #incl0var            | Defined | Event                | E6.29 p18                                  | #incl0var <event var> |
| #inccorpses          | Defined | Event                | E6.29 p13                                  | #inccorpses <amount>  |
| #incdom              | Defined | Event                | E6.29 p13                                  | #incdom <value>       |
| #incorporate         | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59                       | #incorporate <dmg>    |
| #incpop              | Defined | Event                | E6.29 p13                                  | #incpop <dekapop>     |
| #incprovdef          | Defined | Monster              | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60                       | #incprovdef <value>   |
| #incscale            | Defined | Event, Monster, Site | E6.29 p12; M6.34 p27; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60 | #incscale <scale>     |
| #incscale2           | Defined | Event                | E6.29 p12; E6.29 p19                       | #incscale2 <scale>    |
| #incscale3           | Defined | Event                | E6.29 p12                                  | #incscale3 <scale>    |

| Token          | Status  | Domain         | Official locator                | Strongest syntax          |
|----------------|---------|----------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------|
| #incunrest     | Defined | Event, Monster | M6.34 p27; E6.29 p19; M6.34 p60 | #incunrest <value>        |
| #incvar        | Defined | Event          | E6.29 p18                       | #incvar <event var>       |
| #indepflag     | Defined | Nation         | M6.34 p41                       | #indepflag "<imgfile>"    |
| #indepmove     | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p20                       | #indepmove <percent>      |
| #indepspells   | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p35                       | #indepspells <level>      |
| #indepstay     | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p20                       | #indepstay <0 - 1>        |
| #infernoreset  | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60            | #infernoreset <chance>    |
| #inquisitor    | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60            | #inquisitor               |
| #insane        | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p22                       | #insane <percent>         |
| #insanify      | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60            | #insanify <percent>       |
| #inspirational | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60            | #inspirational <bonus>    |
| #inspiringres  | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60            | #inspiringres <value>     |
| #internal      | Defined | Weapon         | M6.34 p10                       | #internal                 |
| #invisible     | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59            | #invisible                |
| #invulnerable  | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59            | #invulnerable <prot>      |
| #invvar        | Defined | Event          | E6.29 p18                       | #invvar <event var>       |
| #ironarmor     | Defined | Armour         | M6.34 p13                       | #ironarmor                |
| #ironskin      | Defined | Item           | M6.34 p56                       | #ironskin                 |
| #ironvul       | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59            | #ironvul <points>         |
| #ironweapon    | Defined | Weapon         | M6.34 p10                       | #ironweapon               |
| #island        | Defined | Item           | M6.34 p57                       | #island                   |
| #islandnation  | Defined | Site           | M6.34 p43                       | #islandnation             |
| #islandsite    | Defined | Site           | M6.34 p43                       | #islandsite "<site name>" |
| #item          | Defined | Mercenary      | M6.34 p63                       | #item "<item name>"       |
| #itemcost1     | Defined | Item           | M6.34 p58                       | #itemcost1 <bonus>        |
| #itemcost2     | Defined | Item           | M6.34 p58                       | #itemcost2 <bonus>        |
| #itemdrawsize  | Defined | Item           | M6.34 p58                       | #itemdrawsize <value>     |
| #itemslots     | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p18                       | #itemslots <slot value>   |
| #ivylord       | Defined | Monster        | M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61            | #ivylord <nbr>            |

## K

| Token           | Status  | Domain | Official locator | Strongest syntax              |
|-----------------|---------|--------|------------------|-------------------------------|
| #kill           | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p13        | #kill <percent>               |
| #kill2d6mon     | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p15        | #kill2d6mon "name"   <number> |
| #killcappop     | Defined | Site   | M6.34 p44        | #killcappop <percent>         |
| #killcom        | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p15        | #killcom "name"   <number>    |
| #killdemonifhit | Defined | Weapon | M6.34 p11        | #killdemonifhit <dmgt>        |
| #killfeatures   | Defined | Map    | P6.26 p7         | #killfeatures                 |

| Token           | Status  | Domain  | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                         |
|-----------------|---------|---------|----------------------|------------------------------------------|
| #killmagicifhit | Defined | Weapon  | M6.34 p11            | #killmagicifhit <dmg>                    |
| #killmon        | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p15            | #killmon "name"   <number>               |
| #killpop        | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p13            | #killpop <dekapop>                       |
| #killtarg       | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p15            | #killtarg                                |
| #knownfeature   | Defined | Map     | P6.26 p8             | #knownfeature "<site name>"   <site nbr> |
| #kokytosret     | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60 | #kokytosret <chance>                     |

## L

| Token         | Status             | Domain           | Official locator               | Strongest syntax                            |
|---------------|--------------------|------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| ##landname##  | Reference; message | Event            | E6.29 p11                      | ##landname##                                |
| #lab          | Defined            | Event, Map, Site | E6.29 p13; P6.26 p8; M6.34 p40 | #lab < 0   1>                               |
| #labcost      | Defined            | Nation           | M6.34 p48                      | #labcost <price>                            |
| #labxpshape   | Defined            | Monster          | M6.34 p28                      | #labxpshape <xp value>                      |
| #lamialord    | Defined            | Monster          | M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61           | #lamialord <nbr>                            |
| #lanceok      | Defined            | Monster          | M6.34 p19                      | #lanceok                                    |
| #land         | Defined            | Map              | P6.26 p6                       | #land <province nbr>                        |
| #landcom      | Defined            | Nation           | M6.34 p45                      | #landcom "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>   |
| #landdamage   | Defined            | Monster          | M6.34 p21                      | #landdamage <percent>                       |
| #landgold     | Defined            | Event            | E6.29 p13                      | #landgold <value>                           |
| #landname     | Defined            | Map              | P6.26 p4                       | #landname <province nbr> "name"             |
| #landprod     | Defined            | Event            | E6.29 p13                      | #landprod <value>                           |
| #landrec      | Defined            | Nation           | M6.34 p45                      | #landrec "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>   |
| #landshape    | Defined            | Monster          | M6.34 p28                      | #landshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #latehero     | Defined            | Monster          | M6.34 p33                      | #latehero <min turn>                        |
| #len          | Defined            | Weapon           | M6.34 p7; M6.34 p9             | #len <length>                               |
| #leper        | Defined            | Monster          | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60           | #leper <percent>                            |
| #lesserhorror | Defined            | Monster          | M6.34 p19                      | #lesserhorror                               |
| #level        | Defined            | Mercenary, Site  | M6.34 p38; M6.34 p63           | #level <level>                              |
| #lich         | Defined            | Monster          | M6.34 p28                      | #lich "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>      |
| #likespop     | Defined            | Nation           | M6.34 p47                      | #likespop <poptype>                         |
| #likesterr    | Defined            | Site             | M6.34 p43                      | #likesterr <terrain mask>                   |
| #limitedregen | Defined            | Item             | M6.34 p57                      | #limitedregen <percent>                     |
| #linger       | Defined            | Event            | E6.29 p17                      | #linger <nbr of turns>                      |
| #lizard       | Defined            | Monster          | M6.34 p18                      | #lizard                                     |

| Token        | Status  | Domain  | Official locator     | Strongest syntax      |
|--------------|---------|---------|----------------------|-----------------------|
| #loc         | Defined | Site    | M6.34 p37            | #loc <locmask>        |
| #localglobal | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p54            | #localglobal <0 - 1>  |
| #localsun    | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60 | #localsun             |
| #look        | Defined | Site    | M6.34 p37            | #look <site spr>      |
| #loop        | Defined | Sound   | M6.34 p5             | #loop <sample nbr>    |
| #loseeye     | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p58            | #loseeye              |
| #luck        | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p56            | #luck                 |
| #luckevents  | Defined | General | M6.34 p61            | #luckevents <percent> |
| #luckscale   | Defined | Bless   | M6.34 p37            | #luckscale <value>    |

## M

| Token          | Status    | Domain         | Official locator     | Strongest syntax           |
|----------------|-----------|----------------|----------------------|----------------------------|
| #mag_air       | Defined   | Map            | P6.26 p9             | #mag_air <level>           |
| #mag_astral    | Defined   | Map            | P6.26 p9             | #mag_astral <level>        |
| #mag_blood     | Defined   | Map            | P6.26 p9             | #mag_blood <level>         |
| #mag_death     | Defined   | Map            | P6.26 p9             | #mag_death <level>         |
| #mag_earth     | Defined   | Map            | P6.26 p9             | #mag_earth <level>         |
| #mag_fire      | Defined   | Map            | P6.26 p9             | #mag_fire <level>          |
| #mag_glamour   | Defined   | Map            | P6.26 p9             | #mag_glamour <level>       |
| #mag_nature    | Defined   | Map            | P6.26 p9             | #mag_nature <level>        |
| #mag_priest    | Defined   | Map            | P6.26 p9             | #mag_priest <level>        |
| #mag_water     | Defined   | Map            | P6.26 p9             | #mag_water <level>         |
| #magic         | Defined   | AI, Weapon     | M6.34 p9; M6.34 p64  | #magic                     |
| #magicarmor    | Defined   | Armour         | M6.34 p13            | #magicarmor                |
| #magicbeing    | Defined   | Monster        | M6.34 p19            | #magicbeing                |
| #magicboost    | Defined   | Monster, Spell | M6.34 p33; M6.34 p56 | #magicboost <path> <boost> |
| #magiccommand  | Defined   | Monster        | M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60 | #magiccommand <value>      |
| #magicimmune   | Defined   | Monster        | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60 | #magicimmune               |
| #magicitem     | Defined   | Event          | E6.29 p11; E6.29 p19 | #magicitem <rarity>        |
| #magiconly     | Defined   | Weapon         | M6.34 p9             | #magiconly                 |
| #magicpower    | Defined   | Monster        | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59 | #magicpower <bonus>        |
| #magicscale    | Defined   | Bless          | M6.34 p37            | #magicscale <value>        |
| #magicskill    | Defined   | Monster        | M6.34 p33            | #magicskill <path> <level> |
| #magicstudy    | Defined   | Monster        | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60 | #magicstudy <bonus>        |
| #mainlevel     | Defined   | Item           | M6.34 p55            | #mainlevel <path>          |
| #mainpath      | Defined   | Item           | M6.34 p55            | #mainpath <path>           |
| #makecrater    | Defined   | Sound          | M6.34 p52            | #makecrater <0 or 1>       |
| #makemonsters1 | Reference | Monster        | M6.34 p61            | #makemonsters1             |

| Token              | Status            | Domain          | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                                    |
|--------------------|-------------------|-----------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| #makemonsters1...5 | Defined; template | Monster         | M6.34 p29            | #makemonsters1...5 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #makemonsters2     | Reference         | Monster         | M6.34 p61            | #makemonsters2                                      |
| #makemonsters3     | Reference         | Monster         | M6.34 p61            | #makemonsters3                                      |
| #makemonsters4     | Reference         | Monster         | M6.34 p61            | #makemonsters4                                      |
| #makemonsters5     | Reference         | Monster         | M6.34 p61            | #makemonsters5                                      |
| #makepearls        | Defined           | Monster         | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60 | #makepearls <value>                                 |
| #manikinreanim     | Defined           | Nation          | M6.34 p50            | #manikinreanim                                      |
| #mapdomcol         | Defined           | Map             | P6.26 p4             | #mapdomcol <red> <green> <blue> <alpha>             |
| #mapmove           | Defined           | Monster         | M6.34 p17            | #mapmove <speed>                                    |
| #mapnohide         | Defined           | Map             | P6.26 p3             | #mapnohide                                          |
| #mapsize           | Defined           | Map             | P6.26 p3             | #mapsize <width> <height>                           |
| #mapspeed          | Defined           | Item            | M6.34 p57            | #mapspeed <value>                                   |
| #mapteleport       | Defined           | Monster         | M6.34 p20            | #mapteleport                                        |
| #maptextcol        | Defined           | Map             | P6.26 p4             | #maptextcol <red> <green> <blue> <alpha>            |
| #mason             | Defined           | Monster         | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60 | #mason                                              |
| #masterrit         | Defined           | Monster         | M6.34 p33            | #masterrit <value>                                  |
| #mastersmith       | Defined           | Monster         | M6.34 p35            | #mastersmith <value>                                |
| #maxage            | Defined           | Monster         | M6.34 p21            | #maxage <age>                                       |
| #maxbounces        | Defined           | Spell           | M6.34 p54            | #maxbounces <bounces>                               |
| #maxdeadhp         | Defined           | Monster         | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59 | #maxdeadhp <HP>                                     |
| #maxprison         | Defined           | Monster, Nation | M6.34 p14; M6.34 p47 | #maxprison <0 - 2>                                  |
| #maxsize           | Defined           | Item            | M6.34 p57            | #maxsize <size>                                     |
| #maybeaddsite      | Defined           | Event           | E6.29 p13            | #maybeaddsite <site number>                         |
| #maybehiddensite   | Defined           | Event           | E6.29 p13            | #maybehiddensite <site number>                      |
| #melee50           | Defined           | Weapon          | M6.34 p10            | #melee50                                            |
| #merccost          | Defined           | Nation          | M6.34 p45            | #merccost <percent>                                 |
| #minascension      | Defined           | Event           | E6.29 p18            | #minascension <AP>                                  |
| #mind              | Defined           | Weapon          | M6.34 p9             | #mind                                               |
| #mindcollar        | Defined           | Monster         | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60 | #mindcollar <dmg>                                   |
| #mindslime         | Defined           | Monster         | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59 | #mindslime <area>                                   |
| #mindvessel        | Defined           | Monster         | M6.34 p27            | #mindvessel <0 or 1>                                |
| #minmen            | Defined           | Mercenary       | M6.34 p63            | #minmen <value>                                     |
| #minpay            | Defined           | Mercenary       | M6.34 p63            | #minpay <gold>                                      |
| #minprison         | Defined           | Monster, Nation | M6.34 p14; M6.34 p47 | #minprison <0 - 2>                                  |
| #minsize           | Defined           | Item            | M6.34 p57            | #minsize <size>                                     |
| #minsizeleader     | Reference         | Monster         | M6.34 p36            | #minsizeleader                                      |
| #miscshape         | Defined           | Monster         | M6.34 p18            | #miscshape                                          |



| Token             | Status            | Domain            | Official locator                          | Strongest syntax                                |
|-------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| #misfortscale     | Defined           | Bless             | M6.34 p37                                 | #misfortscale <value>                           |
| #misfortune       | Defined           | General           | M6.34 p61                                 | #misfortune<percent>                            |
| #mobilearcher     | Defined           | Monster           | M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58                      | #mobilearcher <0 or 1>                          |
| #modname          | Defined           | General, Metadata | M6.34 p5; M6.34 p64                       | #modname "<name>"                               |
| #mon              | Defined           | Monster           | M6.34 p38                                 | #mon "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>           |
| #monpresentrec    | Defined           | Monster           | M6.34 p15                                 | #monpresentrec "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #montag           | Defined           | Monster           | M6.34 p29                                 | #montag <value>                                 |
| #montagweight     | Defined           | Monster           | M6.34 p30                                 | #montagweight <weight>                          |
| #mor              | Defined           | Monster           | M6.34 p17                                 | #mor <morale>                                   |
| #morale           | Defined           | Item              | M6.34 p56                                 | #morale <value>                                 |
| #moregrowth       | Defined           | Monster, Site     | M6.34 p14; M6.34 p44                      | #moregrowth <-5 - 5>                            |
| #moreheat         | Defined           | Monster, Site     | M6.34 p14; M6.34 p44                      | #moreheat <-5 - 5>                              |
| #moreluck         | Defined           | Monster, Site     | M6.34 p14; M6.34 p44                      | #moreluck <-5 - 5>                              |
| #moremagic        | Defined           | Monster, Site     | M6.34 p14; M6.34 p44                      | #moremagic <-5 - 5>                             |
| #moreorder        | Defined           | Monster, Site     | M6.34 p14; M6.34 p44                      | #moreorder <-5 - 5>                             |
| #moreprod         | Defined           | Monster, Site     | M6.34 p14; M6.34 p44                      | #moreprod <-5 - 5>                              |
| #morroll          | Defined           | Weapon            | M6.34 p10                                 | #morroll                                        |
| #mountainsurvival | Defined           | Monster           | M6.34 p20                                 | #mountainsurvival                               |
| #mounted          | Defined           | Monster           | M6.34 p31                                 | #mounted                                        |
| #mountedhumanoid  | Defined           | Monster           | M6.34 p18                                 | #mountedhumanoid                                |
| #mountiscom       | Defined           | Monster           | M6.34 p31                                 | #mountiscom <0 or 1>                            |
| #mountlabcost     | Defined           | Nation            | M6.34 p48                                 | #mountlabcost <price>                           |
| #mountmnr         | Defined           | Monster           | M6.34 p30                                 | #mountmnr "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>      |
| #mounttemplecost  | Defined           | Nation            | M6.34 p48                                 | #mounttemplecost <price>                        |
| #mr               | Defined           | Item, Monster     | M6.34 p17; M6.34 p56                      | #mr <magic resistance>                          |
| #mrhalf           | Defined           | Weapon            | M6.34 p9                                  | #mrhalf                                         |
| #mrnegates        | Defined           | Weapon            | M6.34 p9                                  | #mrnegates                                      |
| #mrnegateseasily  | Defined           | Weapon            | M6.34 p9                                  | #mrnegateseasily                                |
| #msg              | Defined           | Event             | E6.29 p11; E6.29 p5; E6.29 p19; E6.29 p20 | #msg "<message text>"                           |
| #multihero1       | Mention           | Nation            | M6.34 p45                                 | #multihero1                                     |
| #multihero1...7   | Defined; template | Nation            | M6.34 p45                                 | #multihero1...7 <monster nbr>                   |
| #mute             | Defined           | Item              | M6.34 p58                                 | #mute                                           |

## N

| Token                 | Status                | Domain                                                                                              | Official locator                                               | Strongest syntax                              |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| ##natname##           | Reference;<br>message | Event                                                                                               | E6.29 p11                                                      | ##natname##                                   |
| #naga                 | Defined               | Monster                                                                                             | M6.34 p18                                                      | #naga                                         |
| #name                 | Defined               | Armour, Bless,<br>Event, General,<br>Item, Mercenary,<br>Monster, Nation,<br>Site, Spell,<br>Weapon | M6.34 p7; M6.34 p12;<br>M6.34 p13; M6.34 p37;<br>M6.34 p42; +6 | #name "<name>"                                |
| #nametype             | Defined               | Monster                                                                                             | M6.34 p30                                                      | #nametype <name type nbr>                     |
| #napbreakrit          | Defined               | Spell                                                                                               | M6.34 p54                                                      | #napbreakrit <value>                          |
| #nat                  | Defined               | Monster                                                                                             | M6.34 p38                                                      | #nat <nation nbr>                             |
| #natcom               | Defined               | Monster                                                                                             | M6.34 p38                                                      | #natcom "<monster name>"   <monster<br>nbr>   |
| #nation               | Defined               | Event                                                                                               | E6.29 p11; E6.29 p19                                           | #nation <nation number>                       |
| #nationench           | Defined               | Event                                                                                               | E6.29 p11; E6.29 p20                                           | #nationench <ench nbr>                        |
| #nationinc            | Defined               | Nation                                                                                              | M6.34 p49                                                      | #nationinc <percent>                          |
| #nationrebate         | Defined               | Item                                                                                                | M6.34 p57                                                      | #nationrebate <nation nbr>  <br>"nation name" |
| #natmon               | Defined               | Monster                                                                                             | M6.34 p38                                                      | #natmon "<monster name>"   <monster<br>nbr>   |
| #natural              | Defined               | Weapon                                                                                              | M6.34 p7                                                       | #natural                                      |
| #natureblessbo<br>nus | Defined               | Nation                                                                                              | M6.34 p47                                                      | #natureblessbonus <0 - 9>                     |
| #natureboost          | Defined               | Event                                                                                               | E6.29 p16                                                      | #natureboost "name"   <number>                |
| #naturerange          | Defined               | Monster, Site                                                                                       | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p39;<br>M6.34 p60                             | #naturerange <range>                          |
| #neednoteat           | Defined               | Monster                                                                                             | M6.34 p26                                                      | #neednoteat                                   |
| #neighbour            | Defined               | Map                                                                                                 | P6.26 p4                                                       | #neighbour <province nbr> <province<br>nbr>   |
| #neighbourspec        | Defined               | Map                                                                                                 | P6.26 p4                                                       | #neighbourspec <land1> <land2><br><spcnbr>    |
| #newarmor             | Defined               | Armour                                                                                              | M6.34 p12                                                      | #newarmor <armor nbr>                         |
| #newdom               | Defined               | Event                                                                                               | E6.29 p13                                                      | #newdom <value>                               |
| #newevent             | Defined               | Event                                                                                               | E6.29 p2; E6.29 p19;<br>E6.29 p20                              | #newevent                                     |
| #newitem              | Defined               | Item                                                                                                | M6.34 p55                                                      | #newitem                                      |
| #newmerc              | Defined               | Mercenary                                                                                           | M6.34 p63                                                      | #newmerc                                      |
| #newmonster           | Defined               | General, Monster                                                                                    | M6.34 p13                                                      | #newmonster [<monster nbr>]                   |
| #newnation            | Defined               | General, Item,<br>Nation, Spell                                                                     | M6.34 p42; M6.34 p64                                           | #newnation                                    |
| #newsite              | Defined               | General, Site                                                                                       | M6.34 p37                                                      | #newsite [<site nbr>]                         |
| #newspell             | Defined               | Event, General,<br>Spell                                                                            | M6.34 p50; E6.29 p20                                           | #newspell                                     |
| #newtemplate          | Defined               | AI                                                                                                  | M6.34 p63                                                      | #newtemplate <nation nbr>                     |

| Token            | Status  | Domain  | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                  |
|------------------|---------|---------|----------------------|-----------------------------------|
| #newweapon       | Defined | Weapon  | M6.34 p7; M6.34 p9   | #newweapon <weapon nbr>           |
| #nexttingeo      | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p51            | #nexttingeo <terrain mask>        |
| #nextspell       | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p51            | #nextspell "<spell name>"   <nbr> |
| #nhwound         | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p58            | #nhwound                          |
| #nightmareaura   | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p24            | #nightmareaura <area>             |
| #noaging         | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p58            | #noaging <percent>                |
| #noagingland     | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p58            | #noagingland <percent>            |
| #nobadevents     | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60 | #nobadevents <value>              |
| #nobarding       | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p31            | #nobarding                        |
| #nocastmindless  | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p53            | #nocastmindless <0 - 1>           |
| #nocoldblood     | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p57            | #nocoldblood                      |
| #nodeathsupply   | Defined | Nation  | M6.34 p49            | #nodeathsupply                    |
| #nodeepecaves    | Defined | Map     | P6.26 p3             | #nodeepecaves                     |
| #nodeepchoice    | Defined | Map     | P6.26 p3             | #nodeepchoice                     |
| #nodemon         | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p57            | #nodemon                          |
| #nofalldmg       | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p31            | #nofalldmg                        |
| #nofemale        | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p57            | #nofemale                         |
| #nofind          | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p57            | #nofind                           |
| #nofmounts       | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p30            | #nofmounts <mounts>               |
| #noforeignrec    | Defined | Nation  | M6.34 p45            | #noforeignrec                     |
| #noforgebonus    | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p57            | #noforgebonus                     |
| #nofriders       | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p30            | #nofriders <riders>               |
| #nogeodst        | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p52            | #nogeodst <terrain mask>          |
| #nogeosrc        | Mention | Spell   | M6.34 p52            | #nogeosrc                         |
| #noheal          | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p21            | #noheal                           |
| #nohof           | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p27            | #nohof                            |
| #nohomelandnames | Defined | Map     | P6.26 p5             | #nohomelandnames                  |
| #noimmobile      | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p57            | #noimmobile                       |
| #noinanim        | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p57            | #noinanim                         |
| #noitem          | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p18            | #noitem                           |
| #nolandtrace     | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p52            | #nolandtrace <0 or 1>             |
| #noleader        | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p31            | #noleader                         |
| #nolog           | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p11            | #nolog                            |
| #nomagicleader   | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p32            | #nomagicleader                    |
| #nomounted       | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p57            | #nomounted                        |
| #nomovepen       | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58 | #nomovepen                        |
| #nonamefilter    | Defined | Map     | P6.26 p5             | #nonamefilter                     |
| #nopreach        | Defined | Nation  | M6.34 p49            | #nopreach                         |

| Token           | Status  | Domain      | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                              |
|-----------------|---------|-------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| #norange        | Defined | Monster     | M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58 | #norange <chance>                             |
| #noremount      | Defined | Monster     | M6.34 p31            | #noremount                                    |
| #norepel        | Defined | Weapon      | M6.34 p10            | #norepel                                      |
| #noreqlab       | Defined | Monster     | M6.34 p15            | #noreqlab                                     |
| #noreqtemple    | Defined | Monster     | M6.34 p15            | #noreqtemple                                  |
| #noriverpass    | Defined | Monster     | M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58 | #noriverpass                                  |
| #noslowrec      | Defined | Monster     | M6.34 p14            | #noslowrec                                    |
| #nospiritform   | Defined | Monster     | M6.34 p19            | #nospiritform                                 |
| #nostart        | Defined | Map         | P6.26 p6             | #nostart <province nbr>                       |
| #nostr          | Defined | Weapon      | M6.34 p9             | #nostr                                        |
| #notdismounted  | Defined | Weapon      | M6.34 p11            | #notdismounted                                |
| #notdomshape    | Defined | Monster     | M6.34 p28            | #notdomshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #notext         | Defined | Event       | E6.29 p11; E6.29 p20 | #notext                                       |
| #notformation   | Defined | Item, Spell | M6.34 p53; M6.34 p57 | #notformation <nation nbr>   "nation name"    |
| #nothrowoff     | Defined | Monster     | M6.34 p31            | #nothrowoff                                   |
| #notindoors     | Defined | Spell       | M6.34 p54            | #notindoors <-1 to 1>                         |
| #notmnr         | Defined | Spell       | M6.34 p53            | #notmnr "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>      |
| #notmounted     | Defined | Weapon      | M6.34 p11            | #notmounted <1 - 2>                           |
| #noundead       | Defined | Item        | M6.34 p57            | #noundead                                     |
| #noundeadgods   | Defined | Nation      | M6.34 p47            | #noundeadgods                                 |
| #noundeadleader | Defined | Monster     | M6.34 p32            | #noundeadleader                               |
| #nouw           | Defined | Weapon      | M6.34 p11            | #nouw                                         |
| #nowatertrace   | Defined | Spell       | M6.34 p52            | #nowatertrace <0 or 1>                        |
| #noweapon       | Defined | Monster     | M6.34 p18            | #noweapon <0 or 1>                            |
| #nowish         | Defined | Monster     | M6.34 p15            | #nowish                                       |
| #nratt          | Defined | Weapon      | M6.34 p7             | #nratt <nbr of attacks>                       |
| #nreff          | Defined | Spell       | M6.34 p52            | #nreff <nbr of effects>                       |
| #nrunits        | Defined | Mercenary   | M6.34 p63            | #nrunits <value>                              |

## O

| Token           | Status  | Domain  | Official locator | Strongest syntax |
|-----------------|---------|---------|------------------|------------------|
| #okleader       | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p31        | #okleader        |
| #okmagicleader  | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p32        | #okmagicleader   |
| #okundeadleader | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p32        | #okundeadleader  |
| #older          | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p21        | #older <age>     |

| Token            | Status  | Domain  | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                            |
|------------------|---------|---------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| #onebattlespell  | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p35            | #onebattlespell "<spell name>"   <nbr>      |
| #onisummon       | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61 | #onisummon <0 - 100>                        |
| #onlyatsite      | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p52            | #onlyatsite "<site name>"   <site nbr>      |
| #onlycoastsrc    | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p52            | #onlycoastsrc <0 - 1>                       |
| #onlycoldblood   | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p58            | #onlycoldblood                              |
| #onlydemon       | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p58            | #onlydemon                                  |
| #onlyfemale      | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p58            | #onlyfemale                                 |
| #onlyfriendlydst | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p52            | #onlyfriendlydst <0 - 2>                    |
| #onlygeodst      | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p52            | #onlygeodst <terrain mask>                  |
| #onlygeosrc      | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p52            | #onlygeosrc <terrain mask>                  |
| #onlyimmobile    | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p58            | #onlyimmobile                               |
| #onlyinanim      | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p58            | #onlyinanim                                 |
| #onlymnr         | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p53            | #onlymnr "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>   |
| #onlymounted     | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p58            | #onlymounted                                |
| #onlyowndst      | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p52            | #onlyowndst <0 or 1>                        |
| #onlysitedst     | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p52            | #onlysitedst "<site name>"   <site nbr>     |
| #onlyundead      | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p58            | #onlyundead                                 |
| #order           | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p17            | #order <order bitmask>                      |
| #orderrecscale   | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p15            | #orderrecscale <value>                      |
| #orderscale      | Defined | Bless   | M6.34 p37            | #orderscale <value>                         |
| #overcharged     | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59 | #overcharged <dmg>                          |
| #owner           | Defined | Map     | P6.26 p7             | #owner <nation nbr>                         |
| #ownsmnrec       | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p15            | #ownsmnrec "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |

## P

| Token               | Status             | Domain             | Official locator                | Strongest syntax    |
|---------------------|--------------------|--------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------|
| ##playergodname##   | Reference; message | Spell              | M6.34 p54                       | ##playergodname##   |
| ##playergodthrone## | Reference; message | Spell              | M6.34 p54                       | ##playergodthrone## |
| ##playername##      | Reference; message | Spell              | M6.34 p54                       | ##playername##      |
| ##playerthrone##    | Reference; message | Spell              | M6.34 p54                       | ##playerthrone##    |
| ##profname##        | Reference; message | Event              | E6.29 p11                       | ##profname##        |
| #path               | Defined            | Event, Site, Spell | M6.34 p37; M6.34 p50; E6.29 p20 | #path <path nbr>    |

| Token             | Status  | Domain          | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                             |
|-------------------|---------|-----------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| #path0            | Defined | Bless           | M6.34 p37            | #path0 <path nbr>                            |
| #path1            | Defined | Bless           | M6.34 p37            | #path1 <path nbr>                            |
| #pathboost        | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p16            | #pathboost <path>                            |
| #pathcost         | Defined | Monster, Nation | M6.34 p14            | #pathcost <design points>                    |
| #pathlevel        | Defined | Event, Spell    | M6.34 p50; E6.29 p20 | #pathlevel <reqnr> <level>                   |
| #patience         | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p20            | #patience <value>                            |
| #patrolbonus      | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60 | #patrolbonus <value>                         |
| #pb               | Defined | Map             | P6.26 p4             | #pb <x> <y> <len> <province nbr>             |
| #pen              | Defined | Spell           | M6.34 p56            | #pen <value>                                 |
| #petrifyifhit     | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p11            | #petrifyifhit <dmg>                          |
| #pierce           | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p9             | #pierce                                      |
| #pierceres        | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59 | #pierceres                                   |
| #pillagebonus     | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60 | #pillagebonus <value>                        |
| #plaguedoctor     | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59 | #plaguedoctor <percent>                      |
| #plainshape       | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p28            | #plainshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #planename        | Defined | Map             | P6.26 p3             | #planename <text>                            |
| #plant            | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p19            | #plant                                       |
| #poison           | Defined | Event, Weapon   | E6.29 p15; M6.34 p9  | #poison <dmg>                                |
| #poisonarmor      | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59 | #poisonarmor <dmg>                           |
| #poisoncloud      | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59 | #poisoncloud <size>                          |
| #poisonifdmg      | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p12            | #poisonifdmg <dmg>                           |
| #poisonres        | Defined | Item, Monster   | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p56 | #poisonres <prot>                            |
| #poisonskin       | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59 | #poisonskin <0-500>                          |
| #polygetmagic     | Defined | Spell           | M6.34 p53            | #polygetmagic <0 - 1>                        |
| #polyimmune       | Defined | Item, Monster   | M6.34 p19; M6.34 p57 | #polyimmune                                  |
| #pooramphibian    | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p19            | #pooramphibian                               |
| #poorleader       | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p31            | #poorleader                                  |
| #poormagicleader  | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p32            | #poormagicleader                             |
| #poorundeadleader | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p32            | #poorundeadleader                            |
| #popgrowth        | Defined | Site            | M6.34 p40            | #popgrowth <per mille>                       |
| #popkill          | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60 | #popkill <amount>                            |
| #poppergold       | Defined | General         | M6.34 p61            | #poppergold <people>                         |
| #poptype          | Defined | Map             | P6.26 p6             | #poptype <poptype nbr>                       |
| #population       | Defined | Map             | P6.26 p8             | #population <0-50000>                        |
| #portent          | Defined | Spell           | M6.34 p54            | #portent "text"                              |
| #powerofdeath     | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p59 | #powerofdeath <limit>                        |
| #praise           | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60 | #praise <value>                              |

| Token          | Status  | Domain          | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                               |
|----------------|---------|-----------------|----------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| #prec          | Defined | Item, Monster   | M6.34 p16; M6.34 p56 | #prec <precision>                              |
| #precision     | Defined | Spell           | M6.34 p52            | #precision <prec>                              |
| #priestreanim  | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p50            | #priestreanim                                  |
| #prison        | Defined | AI              | M6.34 p64            | #prison <nbr>                                  |
| #prodscale     | Defined | Bless           | M6.34 p37            | #prodscale <value>                             |
| #prophetshape  | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p27            | #prophetshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #prot          | Defined | Armour, Monster | M6.34 p12; M6.34 p17 | #prot <protection>                             |
| #protparts     | Defined | Armour          | M6.34 p12            | #protparts <head prot> <body prot>             |
| #provrange     | Defined | Spell           | M6.34 p52            | #provrange <range>                             |
| #purgecalendar | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p18            | #purgecalendar <attr>                          |
| #purgedelayed  | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p18            | #purgedelayed <attr>                           |

## Q

| Token      | Status  | Domain  | Official locator | Strongest syntax |
|------------|---------|---------|------------------|------------------|
| #quadruped | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p18        | #quadruped       |
| #quickness | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p56        | #quickness       |

## R

| Token          | Status  | Domain                  | Official locator                          | Strongest syntax                                |
|----------------|---------|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| #raiseonkill   | Defined | Monster                 | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59                      | #raiseonkill <chance>                           |
| #raiseshape    | Defined | Monster                 | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p59                      | #raiseshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>    |
| #randequip     | Defined | Mercenary               | M6.34 p63                                 | #randequip <0-3>                                |
| #randomequip   | Defined | Map                     | P6.26 p9                                  | #randomequip <rich>                             |
| #randomspell   | Defined | Monster, Spell          | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p56                      | #randomspell <percent>                          |
| #range         | Defined | Spell, Weapon           | M6.34 p7; M6.34 p52                       | #range                                          |
| #range0        | Defined | Weapon                  | M6.34 p10                                 | #range0                                         |
| #range050      | Defined | Weapon                  | M6.34 p10                                 | #range050                                       |
| #raredomsummon | Defined | Monster                 | M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61                      | #raredomsummon "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #rarity        | Defined | Event, Site             | E6.29 p2; M6.34 p38; E6.29 p19; E6.29 p20 | #rarity <nbr>                                   |
| #rcost         | Defined | Armour, Monster, Weapon | M6.34 p7; M6.34 p12; M6.34 p15            | #rcost                                          |
| #reanimator    | Defined | Monster                 | M6.34 p29                                 | #reanimator <nbr>                               |
| #reanimpriest  | Defined | Monster, Nation         | M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61                      | #reanimpriest                                   |
| #recallgod     | Defined | Nation, Site            | M6.34 p41; M6.34 p49                      | #recallgod <value>                              |
| #reclimit      | Defined | Monster                 | M6.34 p14                                 | #reclimit <units / turn>                        |
| #reconst       | Defined | Monster                 | M6.34 p23                                 | #reconst <percent>                              |

| Token              | Status  | Domain    | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                 |
|--------------------|---------|-----------|----------------------|----------------------------------|
| #recrate           | Defined | Mercenary | M6.34 p63            | #recrate <value>                 |
| #recuperation      | Defined | Item      | M6.34 p58            | #recuperation                    |
| #reform            | Defined | Monster   | M6.34 p23            | #reform <chance>                 |
| #reformtime        | Defined | Monster   | M6.34 p23            | #reformtime <extra months>       |
| #regainmount       | Defined | Monster   | M6.34 p31            | #regainmount <0 or 1>            |
| #regeneration      | Defined | Monster   | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59 | #regeneration <percent>          |
| #reinvigoration    | Defined | Monster   | M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59 | #reinvigoration <points>         |
| #remgeo            | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p13            | #remgeo <terrain bitmask>        |
| #remount           | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p15            | #remount                         |
| #removesite        | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p13            | #removesite <site number>        |
| #req_2monsters     | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p6             | #req_2monsters "name"   <number> |
| #req_5monsters     | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p6             | #req_5monsters "name"   <number> |
| #req_ai            | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p3             | #req_ai <0   1>                  |
| #req_anycode       | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p10            | #req_anycode <event code>        |
| #req_arenadone     | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p11            | #req_arenadone <0   1>           |
| #req_capital       | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p4             | #req_capital < 0   1 >           |
| #req_cave          | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p4             | #req_cave < 0   1 >              |
| #req_chaos         | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p6             | #req_chaos <value>               |
| #req_claimedthrone | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p5             | #req_claimedthrone < 0   1 >     |
| #req_coast         | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p4             | #req_coast < 0   1 >             |
| #req_code          | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p10; E6.29 p19 | #req_code <event code>           |
| #req_cold          | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p6             | #req_cold <value>                |
| #req_commander     | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p6             | #req_commander < 0   1 >         |
| #req_crystal       | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p5             | #req_crystal < 0   1 >           |
| #req_deadmnr       | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p7             | #req_deadmnr "name"   <number>   |
| #req_death         | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p6             | #req_death <value>               |
| #req_deep          | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p4             | #req_deep < 0   1 >              |
| #req_domchance     | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p5             | #req_domchance <0 - 100>         |
| #req_dominion      | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p5             | #req_dominion <0 - 10>           |
| #req_domowner      | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p5             | #req_domowner <nation number>    |
| #req_drip          | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p5             | #req_drip < 0   1 >              |
| #req_ench          | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p10; E6.29 p20 | #req_ench <ench nbr>             |
| #req_enchdom       | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p10; E6.29 p20 | #req_enchdom <ench nbr>          |
| #req_enchnearby    | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p10            | #req_enchnearby <ench nbr>       |
| #req_enchtarg      | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p10            | #req_enchtarg <ench nbr>         |
| #req_era           | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p3             | #req_era <value>                 |
| #req_farm          | Defined | Event     | E6.29 p4             | #req_farm < 0   1 >              |



| Token             | Status  | Domain | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                   |
|-------------------|---------|--------|----------------------|------------------------------------|
| #req_forest       | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4; E6.29 p20  | #req_forest < 0   1 >              |
| #req_forestcave   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4             | #req_forestcave < 0   1 >          |
| #req_fornation    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3             | #req_fornation <nation number>     |
| #req_fort         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4             | #req_fort < 0   1 >                |
| #req_fortid       | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4             | #req_fortid <fort number>          |
| #req_foundsite    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p5             | #req_foundsite < 0   1 >           |
| #req_freesites    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p5             | #req_freesites <value>             |
| #req_freshwater   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p5             | #req_freshwater < 0   1 >          |
| #req_friendlyench | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p10            | #req_friendlyench <ench nbr>       |
| #req_fullowner    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p5             | #req_fullowner <nation number>     |
| #req_gem          | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3             | #req_gem <type>                    |
| #req_godawake     | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6             | #req_godawake <0 - 1>              |
| #req_godismnr     | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6             | #req_godismnr "name"   <number>    |
| #req_godisnotmnr  | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6             | #req_godisnotmnr "name"   <number> |
| #req_gold         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3             | #req_gold <type>                   |
| #req_gorge        | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4             | #req_gorge < 0   1 >               |
| #req_growth       | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6             | #req_growth <value>                |
| #req_heat         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6             | #req_heat <value>                  |
| #req_hiddensite   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p5; E6.29 p19  | #req_hiddensite < 0   1 >          |
| #req_hostileench  | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p10; E6.29 p20 | #req_hostileench <ench nbr>        |
| #req_humanoidres  | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7             | #req_humanoidres                   |
| #req_indepok      | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p2; E6.29 p20  | #req_indepok < 0   1 >             |
| #req_kelp         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4             | #req_kelp < 0   1 >                |
| #req_lab          | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4             | #req_lab < 0   1 >                 |
| #req_land         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4; E6.29 p19  | #req_land < 0   1 >                |
| #req_lazy         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6             | #req_lazy <value>                  |
| #req_luck         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6             | #req_luck <value>                  |
| #req_magic        | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6             | #req_magic <value>                 |
| #req_maxcorpses   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p5             | #req_maxcorpses <dead>             |
| #req_maxdef       | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4             | #req_maxdef <value>                |
| #req_maxdominion  | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p5             | #req_maxdominion <-10 - 10>        |
| #req_maxglobals   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p10            | #req_maxglobals <nbr>              |
| #req_maxpop       | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4             | #req_maxpop <dekapop>              |
| #req_maxtroops    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7             | #req_maxtroops <value>             |

| Token                  | Status  | Domain | Official locator                  | Strongest syntax                 |
|------------------------|---------|--------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| #req_maxturn           | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3                          | #req_maxturn <value>             |
| #req_maxunrest         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4                          | #req_maxunrest <value>           |
| #req_mincorpse<br>s    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p5                          | #req_mincorpses <dead>           |
| #req_mindef            | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4                          | #req_mindef <value>              |
| #req_minglobal<br>s    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p10                         | #req_minglobals <nbr>            |
| #req_minpop            | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4                          | #req_minpop <dekapop>            |
| #req_minresearch       | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3                          | #req_minresearch <level>         |
| #req_mintroops         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7                          | #req_mintroops <value>           |
| #req_minunrest         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4                          | #req_minunrest <value>           |
| #req_mnr               | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6                          | #req_mnr "name"   <number>       |
| #req_mnrbs             | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7                          | #req_mnrbs "name"   <number>     |
| #req_monster           | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6                          | #req_monster "name"   <number>   |
| #req_monsterbs         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7                          | #req_monsterbs "name"   <number> |
| #req_month             | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3                          | #req_month <0 - 11>              |
| #req_mountain          | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4; E6.29 p19;<br>E6.29 p20 | #req_mountain < 0   1 >          |
| #req_mydominio<br>n    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p5                          | #req_mydominion < 0   1 >        |
| #req_myench            | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p10; E6.29 p20              | #req_myench <ench nbr>           |
| #req_nation            | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3                          | #req_nation <nation number>      |
| #req_nativesoi<br>l    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p5                          | #req_nativesoil                  |
| #req_nearbycap<br>ital | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4                          | #req_nearbycapital < 0   1 >     |
| #req_nearbycod<br>e    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p10                         | #req_nearbycode <event code>     |
| #req_nearbysit<br>e    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p5                          | #req_nearbysite < 0   1 >        |
| #req_nearbythr<br>one  | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p5                          | #req_nearbythrone < 0   1 >      |
| #req_nearownco<br>de   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p10                         | #req_nearowncode <event code>    |
| #req_noench            | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p10                         | #req_noench <ench nbr>           |
| #req_noera             | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3                          | #req_noera <value>               |
| #req_nomnr             | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6                          | #req_nomnr "name"   <number>     |
| #req_nomonster         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6                          | #req_nomonster "name"   <number> |
| #req_nonation          | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3                          | #req_nonation <nation number>    |
| #req_nopathair         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7                          | #req_nopathair <level>           |
| #req_nopathall         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8                          | #req_nopathall <level>           |
| #req_nopathast<br>ral  | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7                          | #req_nopathastral <level>        |

| Token                  | Status  | Domain | Official locator | Strongest syntax                                |
|------------------------|---------|--------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| #req_nopathblo<br>od   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8         | #req_nopathblood <level>                        |
| #req_nopathdea<br>th   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7         | #req_nopathdeath <level>                        |
| #req_nopathear<br>th   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7         | #req_nopathearth <level>                        |
| #req_nopathfir<br>e    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7         | #req_nopathfire <level>                         |
| #req_nopathgla<br>mour | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8         | #req_nopathglamour <level>                      |
| #req_nopathhol<br>y    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8         | #req_nopathholy <level>                         |
| #req_nopathnat<br>ure  | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8         | #req_nopathnature <level>                       |
| #req_nopathwat<br>er   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7         | #req_nopathwater <level>                        |
| #req_norealmnr         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7         | #req_norealmnr "name"   <number>                |
| #req_noseason          | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3         | #req_noseason <0 - 4>                           |
| #req_nositenbr         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p5         | #req_nositenbr <site number>                    |
| #req_notanycod<br>e    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p10        | #req_notanycode <event code>                    |
| #req_notcode           | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p10        | #req_notcode <event code>                       |
| #req_notforall<br>y    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3         | #req_notforally <nation number>                 |
| #req_notfornat<br>ion  | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3         | #req_notfornation <nation number>               |
| #req_notpoptyp<br>e    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4         | #req_notpoptype <value>                         |
| #req_noworldit<br>em   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p11        | #req_noworlditem "item name"  <br><item number> |
| #req_order             | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6         | #req_order <value>                              |
| #req_owncapita<br>l    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4         | #req_owncapital < 0   1 >                       |
| #req_path              | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3         | #req_path <type>                                |
| #req_pathair           | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7         | #req_pathair <level>                            |
| #req_pathastra<br>l    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7         | #req_pathastral <level>                         |
| #req_pathblood         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7         | #req_pathblood <level>                          |
| #req_pathdeath         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7         | #req_pathdeath <level>                          |
| #req_pathearth         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7         | #req_pathearth <level>                          |
| #req_pathfire          | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7         | #req_pathfire <level>                           |
| #req_pathgems          | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3         | #req_pathgems <amount>                          |
| #req_pathglamo<br>ur   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7         | #req_pathglamour <level>                        |
| #req_pathholy          | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7         | #req_pathholy <level>                           |
| #req_pathnatur<br>e    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7         | #req_pathnature <level>                         |

| Token                | Status  | Domain | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                          |
|----------------------|---------|--------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| #req_pathwater       | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7             | #req_pathwater <level>                    |
| #req_permonth        | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p10; E6.29 p20 | #req_permonth <nbr>                       |
| #req_plane           | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4             | #req_plane < planenr >                    |
| #req_popθok          | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4             | #req_popθok                               |
| #req_poptype         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4             | #req_poptype <value>                      |
| #req_preach          | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7             | #req_preach <value>                       |
| #req_pregame         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3             | #req_pregame <value>                      |
| #req_pretawake       | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6             | #req_pretawake <0 - 1>                    |
| #req_pretismnr       | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6             | #req_pretismnr "name"   <number>          |
| #req_prod            | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p6             | #req_prod <value>                         |
| #req_rare            | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p2; E6.29 p20  | #req_rare <percent>                       |
| #req_realmnr         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7             | #req_realmnr "name"   <number>            |
| #req_researcher      | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p7             | #req_researcher                           |
| #req_school          | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3             | #req_school <school>                      |
| #req_season          | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p3             | #req_season <0 - 4>                       |
| #req_site            | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p5; E6.29 p19  | #req_site < 0   1 >                       |
| #req_story           | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p2             | #req_story < 0   1 >                      |
| #req_swamp           | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p4             | #req_swamp < 0   1 >                      |
| #req_targaff         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9             | #req_targaff <affliction number>          |
| #req_targally        | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9             | #req_targally <nation number>             |
| #req_targanimal      | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9             | #req_targanimal <0   1>                   |
| #req_targdemon       | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9             | #req_targdemon <0   1>                    |
| #req_targforeignok   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9             | #req_targforeignok                        |
| #req_targgod         | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8             | #req_targgod < 0 - 2 >                    |
| #req_targhorror mark | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9             | #req_targhorror mark <value>              |
| #req_targhumanoid    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8; E6.29 p19  | #req_targhumanoid < 0   1 >               |
| #req_targimmobile    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9             | #req_targimmobile <0   1>                 |
| #req_targinanimate   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9             | #req_targinanimate <0   1>                |
| #req_targinsane      | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9             | #req_targinsane <0   1>                   |
| #req_targitem        | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9             | #req_targitem "item name"   <item number> |
| #req_targmagic being | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9             | #req_targmagicbeing <0   1>               |
| #req_targmale        | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8             | #req_targmale < 0   1 >                   |
| #req_targmanygems    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8             | #req_targmanygems <path number>           |

| Token               | Status  | Domain | Official locator    | Strongest syntax                            |
|---------------------|---------|--------|---------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| #req_targmaxkills   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p10           | #req_targmaxkills <value>                   |
| #req_targmaxmorale  | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9            | #req_targmaxmorale <morale>                 |
| #req_targmaxsize    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9            | #req_targmaxsize <size>                     |
| #req_targmindless   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9            | #req_targmindless <0   1>                   |
| #req_targminkills   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9            | #req_targminkills <value>                   |
| #req_targminmorale  | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9            | #req_targminmorale <morale>                 |
| #req_targminsize    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9            | #req_targminsize <size>                     |
| #req_targmnr        | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8            | #req_targmnr "name"   <number>              |
| #req_targnoaff      | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9            | #req_targnoaff <affliction number>          |
| #req_targnoitem     | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9            | #req_targnoitem "item name"   <item number> |
| #req_targnomnr      | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8            | #req_targnomnr "name"   <number>            |
| #req_targnoorder    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9            | #req_targnoorder <order>                    |
| #req_targnopath1    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8            | #req_targnopath1 <path number>              |
| #req_targnopath2    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8            | #req_targnopath2 <path number>              |
| #req_targnopath3    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8            | #req_targnopath3 <path number>              |
| #req_targnopath4    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8            | #req_targnopath4 <path number>              |
| #req_targnorealnmnr | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8            | #req_targnorealnmnr "name"   <number>       |
| #req_targnotally    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9            | #req_targnotally <nation number>            |
| #req_targnotowner   | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9            | #req_targnotowner <nation number>           |
| #req_targorder      | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9; E6.29 p19 | #req_targorder <order number>               |
| #req_targowner      | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9            | #req_targowner <nation number>              |
| #req_targpath1      | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8            | #req_targpath1 <path number>                |
| #req_targpath2      | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8; E6.29 p19 | #req_targpath2 <path number>                |
| #req_targpath3      | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8; E6.29 p19 | #req_targpath3 <path number>                |
| #req_targpath4      | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8            | #req_targpath4 <path number>                |
| #req_targprophet    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8            | #req_targprophet < 0   1 >                  |
| #req_targrealmnr    | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8            | #req_targrealmnr "name"   <number>          |
| #req_targseductions | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p9            | #req_targseductions <value>                 |
| #req_targsight      | Defined | Event  | E6.29 p8            | #req_targsight < 0   1 >                    |

| Token                | Status  | Domain       | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                           |
|----------------------|---------|--------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| #req_targundead      | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p9             | #req_targundead <0   1>                    |
| #req_temple          | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p4             | #req_temple < 0   1 >                      |
| #req_thronesite      | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p5             | #req_thronesite < 0   1 >                  |
| #req_turn            | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p3             | #req_turn <value>                          |
| #req_turnrare        | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p2             | #req_turnrare <value>                      |
| #req_unclaimedthrone | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p5             | #req_unclaimedthrone < 0   1 >             |
| #req_unique          | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p2; E6.29 p19  | #req_unique <value>                        |
| #req_unluck          | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p6             | #req_unluck <value>                        |
| #req_unmagic         | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p6             | #req_unmagic <value>                       |
| #req_varneg          | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p10            | #req_varneg <event var>                    |
| #req_varone          | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p10            | #req_varone <event var>                    |
| #req_varpos          | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p10            | #req_varpos <event var>                    |
| #req_varzero         | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p10            | #req_varzero <event var>                   |
| #req_void            | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p5             | #req_void < 0   1 >                        |
| #req_voidok          | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p4; E6.29 p5   | #req_voidok < 0   1 >                      |
| #req_waste           | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p4             | #req_waste < 0   1 >                       |
| #req_worlditem       | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p11            | #req_worlditem "item name"   <item number> |
| #reqeyes             | Defined | Item         | M6.34 p57            | #reqeyes                                   |
| #reqlab              | Defined | Monster      | M6.34 p15            | #reqlab                                    |
| #reqnoplant          | Defined | Spell        | M6.34 p55            | #reqnoplant                                |
| #reqnoseduce         | Defined | Spell        | M6.34 p55            | #reqnoseduce                               |
| #reqnosPELLSinger    | Defined | Spell        | M6.34 p55            | #reqnosPELLSinger                          |
| #reqnotaskmaster     | Defined | Spell        | M6.34 p55            | #reqnotaskmaster                           |
| #reqplant            | Defined | Spell        | M6.34 p55            | #reqplant                                  |
| #reqseduce           | Defined | Spell        | M6.34 p55            | #reqseduce                                 |
| #reqSPELLSinger      | Defined | Spell        | M6.34 p55            | #reqSPELLSinger                            |
| #reqsun              | Defined | Spell        | M6.34 p54            | #reqsun <0 - 1>                            |
| #reqtaskmaster       | Defined | Spell        | M6.34 p55            | #reqtaskmaster                             |
| #reqtemple           | Defined | Monster      | M6.34 p15            | #reqtemple                                 |
| #res                 | Defined | Site         | M6.34 p38            | #res <amount>                              |
| #researchaff         | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p15            | #researchaff <affliction bitmask>          |
| #researchbonus       | Defined | Monster      | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60 | #researchbonus <value>                     |
| #researchgoal        | Defined | AI           | M6.34 p64            | #researchgoal "spell name"   "item name"   |
| #researchlevel       | Defined | Event, Spell | M6.34 p50; E6.29 p20 | #researchlevel <level>                     |
| #researchscale       | Defined | General      | M6.34 p61            | #researchscale <bonus>                     |

| Token            | Status  | Domain      | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                         |
|------------------|---------|-------------|----------------------|------------------------------------------|
| #resetcode       | Defined | Event       | E6.29 p17            | #resetcode <event code>                  |
| #resetcodedelay  | Defined | Event       | E6.29 p18            | #resetcodedelay <event code>             |
| #resetcodedelay2 | Defined | Event       | E6.29 p18            | #resetcodedelay2 <event code>            |
| #resolvearena1   | Defined | Event       | E6.29 p18            | #resolvearena1                           |
| #resolvearena2   | Defined | Event       | E6.29 p18            | #resolvearena2                           |
| #resourcecult    | Defined | General     | M6.34 p61            | #resourcecult <percent>                  |
| #resources       | Defined | Monster     | M6.34 p26            | #resources <value>                       |
| #ressize         | Defined | Monster     | M6.34 p16            | #ressize <size>                          |
| #restricted      | Defined | Item, Spell | M6.34 p53; M6.34 p57 | #restricted <nation nbr>   "nation name" |
| #restricteditem  | Defined | Item        | M6.34 p57            | #restricteditem <value>                  |
| #revealprov      | Defined | Event       | E6.29 p13            | #revealprov                              |
| #revealsite      | Defined | Event       | E6.29 p13; E6.29 p19 | #revealsite                              |
| #revolt          | Defined | Event       | E6.29 p13            | #revolt                                  |
| #riverstart      | Defined | Site        | M6.34 p43            | #riverstart                              |
| #rockcol         | Defined | Map         | P6.26 p8             | #rockcol <red> <green> <blue>            |
| #rpcost          | Defined | Monster     | M6.34 p15            | #rpcost <recruitment points>             |
| #run             | Defined | Item        | M6.34 p57            | #run                                     |

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| Token           | Status    | Domain          | Official locator              | Strongest syntax                     |
|-----------------|-----------|-----------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| #sabbathmaster  | Reference | Monster         | M6.34 p60                     | #sabbathmaster                       |
| #sabbathslave   | Defined   | Monster         | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60          | #sabbathslave                        |
| #sacredonly     | Defined   | Weapon          | M6.34 p9                      | #sacredonly                          |
| #sacrificedom   | Defined   | Nation          | M6.34 p49                     | #sacrificedom                        |
| #saildist       | Defined   | Map             | P6.26 p4                      | #saildist <1-10>                     |
| #sailing        | Defined   | Monster         | M6.34 p20                     | #sailing <ship size> <max unit size> |
| #sample         | Defined   | Sound, Weapon   | M6.34 p5; M6.34 p7; M6.34 p52 | #sample "<filename>"                 |
| #scale          | Defined   | AI, Map         | P6.26 p9; M6.34 p64           | #scale chaos <nation nbr> <(-5)-5>   |
| #scalewalls     | Defined   | Monster         | M6.34 p20; M6.34 p59          | #scalewalls                          |
| #school         | Defined   | Event, Spell    | M6.34 p50; E6.29 p20          | #school <school nbr>                 |
| #scry           | Defined   | Site            | M6.34 p39                     | #scry <duration>                     |
| #scryrange      | Defined   | Site            | M6.34 p39                     | #scryrange <range>                   |
| #seatrace       | Defined   | Nation          | M6.34 p49                     | #seatrace                            |
| #secondarycolor | Defined   | General, Nation | M6.34 p43; M6.34 p64          | #secondarycolor <red> <green> <blue> |

| Token                  | Status  | Domain        | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                                      |
|------------------------|---------|---------------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| #secondaryeffect       | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p10            | #secondaryeffect "<weapon name>"   <weapon nbr>       |
| #secondaryeffectalways | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p10            | #secondaryeffectalways "<weapon name>"   <weapon nbr> |
| #secondarylevel        | Defined | Item          | M6.34 p55            | #secondarylevel <path>                                |
| #secondarypath         | Defined | Item          | M6.34 p55            | #secondarypath <path>                                 |
| #secondshape           | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p27            | #secondshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>         |
| #secondtmpshape        | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p28            | #secondtmpshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>      |
| #seduce                | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58 | #seduce <value>                                       |
| #selectarmor           | Defined | Armour        | M6.34 p12            | #selectarmor "<armor name>"   <nbr>                   |
| #selectbless           | Defined | Bless         | M6.34 p36            | #selectbless "<bless name>"   <nbr>                   |
| #selectevent           | Defined | Event         | E6.29 p2             | #selectevent <event nbr>                              |
| #selectitem            | Defined | Item          | M6.34 p55            | #selectitem "<item name>"   <item nbr>                |
| #selectmonster         | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p13            | #selectmonster "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>       |
| #selectnametype        | Defined | Names         | M6.34 p36            | #selectnametype <nametype nbr>                        |
| #selectnation          | Defined | Nation        | M6.34 p41            | #selectnation <nation nbr>                            |
| #selectpoctype         | Defined | Poctype       | M6.34 p62            | #selectpoctype <poctype>                              |
| #selectsite            | Defined | Site          | M6.34 p37            | #selectsite "<site name>"   <site nbr>                |
| #selectsound           | Defined | Sound         | M6.34 p5             | #selectsound <nbr>                                    |
| #selectspell           | Defined | Spell         | M6.34 p50            | #selectspell "<spell name>"   <nbr>                   |
| #selectweapon          | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p6             | #selectweapon "<weapon name>"   <weapon nbr>          |
| #sethome               | Defined | Spell         | M6.34 p54            | #sethome                                              |
| #setland               | Defined | Map           | P6.26 p6; P6.26 p3   | #setland <province nbr>                               |
| #setpoctype            | Defined | Event         | E6.29 p13            | #setpoctype <value>                                   |
| #setxp                 | Defined | Event         | E6.29 p16            | #setxp <experience points>                            |
| #shapechance           | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p28            | #shapechance <percent>                                |
| #shapechange           | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p27            | #shapechange "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>         |
| #shattered soul        | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60 | #shattered soul <percent>                             |
| #shock                 | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p9             | #shock                                                |
| #shockifhit            | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p12            | #shockifhit <dmgt>                                    |
| #shockres              | Defined | Item, Monster | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p56 | #shockres <prot>                                      |
| #shrinkhp              | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p28            | #shrinkhp <hit points>                                |
| #siegebonus            | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60 | #siegebonus <value>                                   |
| #singlebattle          | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p15; M6.34 p58 | #singlebattle                                         |
| #size                  | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p17            | #size <size>                                          |



| Token           | Status    | Domain        | Official locator                | Strongest syntax                         |
|-----------------|-----------|---------------|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| #sizecost       | Defined   | Spell         | M6.34 p54                       | #sizecost <value>                        |
| #sizeresist     | Defined   | Weapon        | M6.34 p9                        | #sizeresist                              |
| #skilledrider   | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p31                       | #skilledrider <value>                    |
| #skip           | Defined   | Weapon        | M6.34 p10                       | #skip                                    |
| #skip2          | Defined   | Weapon        | M6.34 p10                       | #skip2                                   |
| #skirmisher     | Reference | Monster       | M6.34 p36; M6.34 p60            | #skirmisher                              |
| #skybox         | Defined   | Map           | P6.26 p8                        | #skybox "<pic.tga>                       |
| #slash          | Defined   | Weapon        | M6.34 p9                        | #slash                                   |
| #slashres       | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59            | #slashres                                |
| #slave          | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p32                       | #slave                                   |
| #slaver         | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p30                       | #slaver "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #slaverbonus    | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p30                       | #slaverbonus <modifier>                  |
| #sleepaura      | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p24                       | #sleepaura <area>                        |
| #sleepres       | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60            | #sleepres <bonus>                        |
| #slimer         | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59            | #slimer <strength>                       |
| #slothincome    | Defined   | General       | M6.34 p61                       | #slothincome <percent>                   |
| #slothpower     | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59            | #slothpower <bonus>                      |
| #slothresearch  | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60            | #slothresearch <value>                   |
| #slothresources | Defined   | General       | M6.34 p61                       | #slothresources <percent>                |
| #slothscale     | Defined   | Bless         | M6.34 p37                       | #slothscale <value>                      |
| #slowrec        | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p14                       | #slowrec                                 |
| #smartmount     | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p31                       | #smartmount <smartness>                  |
| #smpmode        | Defined   | Sound         | M6.34 p5                        | #smpmode <mode>                          |
| #snake          | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p18                       | #snake                                   |
| #snaketattoo    | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p26                       | #snaketattoo <value>                     |
| #sneakunit      | Defined   | Item          | M6.34 p57                       | #sneakunit <value>                       |
| #snow           | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p19                       | #snow                                    |
| #sorcerygems    | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60            | #sorcerygems <gems>                      |
| #sorceryrange   | Defined   | Monster, Site | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60 | #sorceryrange <range>                    |
| #sound          | Defined   | Sound, Weapon | M6.34 p7; M6.34 p52             | #sound <sample nbr>                      |
| #spec           | Defined   | Spell         | M6.34 p53                       | #spec <spec bitmask>                     |
| #speciallook    | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p13                       | #speciallook <value>                     |
| #specstart      | Defined   | Map           | P6.26 p6                        | #specstart <nation nbr> <land nbr>       |
| #speedmult      | Defined   | Sound, Weapon | M6.34 p11; M6.34 p52            | #speedmult <1 - 3>                       |
| #spell          | Defined   | Spell         | M6.34 p56                       | #spell "<spell name>"                    |
| #spellreqfly    | Defined   | Spell         | M6.34 p53                       | #spellreqfly <0 - 1>                     |
| #spellsinger    | Defined   | Monster       | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60            | #spellsinger                             |

| Token             | Status  | Domain          | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                                 |
|-------------------|---------|-----------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| #spikes           | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59 | #spikes <dmg>                                    |
| #spiritform       | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p19            | #spiritform                                      |
| #spiritformimmune | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p10            | #spiritformimmune                                |
| #spiritsight      | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59 | #spiritsight                                     |
| #spr              | Defined | Item            | M6.34 p55            | #spr "<filename>"                                |
| #spr1             | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p13            | #spr1 "<imgfile>"                                |
| #spr2             | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p13            | #spr2 "<imgfile>"                                |
| #spreaddom        | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60 | #spreaddom <candles>                             |
| #springimmortal   | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p23            | #springimmortal                                  |
| #springpower      | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59 | #springpower <percent>                           |
| #springshape      | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p28            | #springshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>    |
| #spy              | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p20            | #spy                                             |
| #standard         | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60 | #standard <bonus>                                |
| #start            | Defined | Map             | P6.26 p6             | #start <province nbr>                            |
| #startaff         | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p22            | #startaff <percent>                              |
| #startage         | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p21            | #startage <age>                                  |
| #startcom         | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p45            | #startcom "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>       |
| #startdom         | Defined | Monster, Nation | M6.34 p14            | #startdom <dominion strength>                    |
| #startheroab      | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p22            | #startheroab <percent>                           |
| #startingaff      | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p22            | #startingaff <affliction bitmask>                |
| #startitem        | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p18            | #startitem "item name"   <item nbr>              |
| #startmajoraff    | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p22            | #startmajoraff <percent>                         |
| #startresearch    | Defined | General         | M6.34 p62            | #startresearch <RP>                              |
| #startscout       | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p45            | #startscout "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>     |
| #startsite        | Defined | Site            | M6.34 p43            | #startsite "<site name>"                         |
| #startunitnbrs1   | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p45            | #startunitnbrs1 <nbr of units>                   |
| #startunitnbrs2   | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p45            | #startunitnbrs2 <nbr of units>                   |
| #startunittype1   | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p45            | #startunittype1 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #startunittype2   | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p45            | #startunittype2 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #statbreak        | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58 | #statbreak <value>                               |
| #statstorm        | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58 | #statstorm <value>                               |
| #stealthboost     | Defined | Item            | M6.34 p57            | #stealthboost <value>                            |
| #stealthcom       | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p14            | #stealthcom "name"   <number>                    |
| #stealthy         | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p20            | #stealthy <value>                                |

| Token                 | Status            | Domain        | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                              |
|-----------------------|-------------------|---------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| #stonebeing           | Defined           | Monster       | M6.34 p19; M6.34 p58 | #stonebeing                                   |
| #stoneskin            | Defined           | Item          | M6.34 p56            | #stoneskin                                    |
| #stormimmune          | Defined           | Item, Monster | M6.34 p19; M6.34 p57 | #stormimmune                                  |
| #stormpower           | Defined           | Monster       | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59 | #stormpower <bonus>                           |
| #str                  | Defined           | Item, Monster | M6.34 p16; M6.34 p56 | #str <strength>                               |
| #strikesound          | Defined           | Sound         | M6.34 p52            | #strikesound <sample nbr>                     |
| #strikeunits          | Defined           | Event         | E6.29 p15            | #strikeunits <damage>                         |
| #succubus             | Defined           | Monster       | M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58 | #succubus <value>                             |
| #sumhealaffs          | Defined           | Spell         | M6.34 p54            | #sumhealaffs <value>                          |
| #summary              | Defined           | Nation        | M6.34 p42            | #summary "<nation name>"                      |
| #summerpower          | Defined           | Monster       | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59 | #summerpower <percent>                        |
| #summershape          | Defined           | Monster       | M6.34 p28            | #summershape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #summon               | Defined           | Monster       | M6.34 p38            | #summon "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>      |
| #summon1              | Reference         | Monster       | M6.34 p61            | #summon1                                      |
| #summon1...5          | Defined; template | Monster       | M6.34 p29            | #summon1...5 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #summon2              | Reference         | Monster       | M6.34 p61            | #summon2                                      |
| #summon3              | Reference         | Monster       | M6.34 p61            | #summon3                                      |
| #summon4              | Reference         | Monster       | M6.34 p61            | #summon4                                      |
| #summon5              | Reference         | Monster       | M6.34 p61            | #summon5                                      |
| #summonlvl2           | Defined           | Monster       | M6.34 p38            | #summonlvl2 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>  |
| #summonlvl3           | Defined           | Monster       | M6.34 p38            | #summonlvl3 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>  |
| #summonlvl4           | Defined           | Monster       | M6.34 p38            | #summonlvl4 "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>  |
| #sunawe               | Defined           | Monster       | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59 | #sunawe <bonus>                               |
| #supayareanim         | Defined           | Nation        | M6.34 p50            | #supayareanim                                 |
| #superiorleader       | Defined           | Monster       | M6.34 p31            | #superiorleader                               |
| #superiormagicleader  | Defined           | Monster       | M6.34 p32            | #superiormagicleader                          |
| #superiorundeadleader | Defined           | Monster       | M6.34 p32            | #superiorundeadleader                         |
| #supply               | Defined           | Site          | M6.34 p38            | #supply <value>                               |
| #supplybonus          | Defined           | Monster       | M6.34 p26; M6.34 p60 | #supplybonus <value>                          |
| #supplymult           | Defined           | General       | M6.34 p61            | #supplymult <percent>                         |
| #swamplabcost         | Defined           | Nation        | M6.34 p48            | #swamplabcost <price>                         |
| #swampsurvival        | Defined           | Monster       | M6.34 p20            | #swampsurvival                                |
| #swamptemplecost      | Defined           | Nation        | M6.34 p48            | #swamptemplecost <price>                      |
| #swift                | Defined           | Item          | M6.34 p57            | #swift <percent>                              |

| Token       | Status  | Domain  | Official locator | Strongest syntax     |
|-------------|---------|---------|------------------|----------------------|
| #swimming   | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p19        | #swimming            |
| #syncretism | Defined | Nation  | M6.34 p49        | #syncretism <0 or 1> |

## T

| Token             | Status                | Domain           | Official locator                  | Strongest syntax                                   |
|-------------------|-----------------------|------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| ##targhis##       | Reference;<br>message | Event            | E6.29 p11                         | ##targhis##                                        |
| ##targname##      | Reference;<br>message | Event            | E6.29 p11                         | ##targname##                                       |
| #tainted          | Defined               | Item, Monster    | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p57              | #tainted <chance>                                  |
| #taskmaster       | Defined               | Monster          | M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60              | #taskmaster <bonus>                                |
| #taxboost         | Defined               | Event            | E6.29 p13                         | #taxboost <percent>                                |
| #taxcollector     | Defined               | Monster          | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60              | #taxcollector                                      |
| #teamstart        | Defined               | Map              | P6.26 p6                          | #teamstart <land nbr> <team nbr>                   |
| #teleport         | Defined               | Monster          | M6.34 p20                         | #teleport                                          |
| #temple           | Defined               | Event, Map, Site | E6.29 p13; P6.26 p8;<br>M6.34 p40 | #temple < 0   1 >                                  |
| #templecost       | Defined               | Nation           | M6.34 p48                         | #templecost <price>                                |
| #templegems       | Defined               | Nation           | M6.34 p48                         | #templegems <type>                                 |
| #templeholypoints | Defined               | Nation           | M6.34 p49                         | #templeholypoints <value>                          |
| #templepic        | Defined               | Nation           | M6.34 p48                         | #templepic <pic nbr>                               |
| #templetrainer    | Defined               | Monster          | M6.34 p29; M6.34 p61              | #templetrainer "<monster name>"  <br><monster nbr> |
| #tempscalecap     | Defined               | General          | M6.34 p61                         | #tempscalecap <value>                              |
| #tempunits        | Defined               | Event            | E6.29 p14                         | #tempunits < 0   1>                                |
| #terrain          | Defined               | Map              | P6.26 p4; P6.26 p3                | #terrain <province nbr> <terrain<br>mask>          |
| #thaucost         | Defined               | Site             | M6.34 p39                         | #thaucost <bonus>                                  |
| #thirdstr         | Defined               | Weapon           | M6.34 p9                          | #thirdstr                                          |
| #thronekill       | Defined               | Monster          | M6.34 p27; M6.34 p60              | #thronekill <chance>                               |
| #tmpairgems       | Defined               | Monster          | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60              | #tmpairgems <gems>                                 |
| #tmpastralgems    | Defined               | Monster          | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p61              | #tmpastralgems <gems>                              |
| #tmpbloodslaves   | Defined               | Monster          | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p61              | #tmpbloodslaves <slaves>                           |
| #tmpdeathgems     | Defined               | Monster          | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p61              | #tmpdeathgems <gems>                               |
| #tmpearthgems     | Defined               | Monster          | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p61              | #tmpearthgems <gems>                               |
| #tmpfiregems      | Defined               | Monster          | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60              | #tmpfiregems <gems>                                |
| #tmpglamourgems   | Defined               | Monster          | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p61              | #tmpglamourgems <gems>                             |
| #tmpnaturegems    | Defined               | Monster          | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p61              | #tmpnaturegems <gems>                              |
| #tmpwatergems     | Defined               | Monster          | M6.34 p34; M6.34 p60              | #tmpwatergems <gems>                               |

| Token            | Status  | Domain       | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                             |
|------------------|---------|--------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| #togglevar       | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p18            | #togglevar <event var>                       |
| #tolerateund     | Defined | Monster      | M6.34 p33            | #tolerateund                                 |
| #tombwyr mreanim | Defined | Nation       | M6.34 p50            | #tombwyr mreanim                             |
| #trade coast     | Defined | Nation       | M6.34 p49            | #trade coast <income boost in percent>       |
| #trample         | Defined | Monster      | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59 | #trample                                     |
| #tramp swallow   | Defined | Monster      | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59 | #tramp swallow                               |
| #transform       | Defined | Event        | E6.29 p15            | #transform "name"   <number>                 |
| #transformation  | Defined | Monster      | M6.34 p28            | #transformation <value>                      |
| #triple3mon      | Defined | Monster      | M6.34 p14            | #triple3mon                                  |
| #triple god      | Defined | Monster      | M6.34 p14            | #triple god <type>                           |
| #triple godmag   | Defined | Monster      | M6.34 p14            | #triple godmag <penalty>                     |
| #troglodyte      | Defined | Monster      | M6.34 p18            | #troglodyte                                  |
| #truesight       | Defined | Monster      | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59 | #truesight                                   |
| #turmoil events  | Defined | General      | M6.34 p61            | #turmoil events <percent>                    |
| #turmoil income  | Defined | General      | M6.34 p61            | #turmoil income <percent>                    |
| #twice born      | Defined | Monster      | M6.34 p28            | #twice born "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #twice born cost | Defined | Spell        | M6.34 p54            | #twice born cost <value>                     |
| #twist fate      | Defined | Monster      | M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59 | #twist fate                                  |
| #two handed      | Defined | Weapon       | M6.34 p7             | #two handed                                  |
| #type            | Defined | Armour, Item | M6.34 p12; M6.34 p55 | #type <type>                                 |

## U

| Token           | Status  | Domain        | Official locator     | Strongest syntax               |
|-----------------|---------|---------------|----------------------|--------------------------------|
| #undcommand     | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60 | #undcommand <value>            |
| #undead         | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p19            | #undead                        |
| #undead immune  | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p9             | #undead immune                 |
| #undead only    | Defined | Weapon        | M6.34 p9             | #undead only                   |
| #undead reanim  | Defined | Nation        | M6.34 p50            | #undead reanim                 |
| #undisciplined  | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60 | #undisciplined                 |
| #undis leader   | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p33            | #undis leader <value>          |
| #undregen       | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59 | #undregen <percent>            |
| #unify          | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p14            | #unify                         |
| #unique         | Defined | Item, Monster | M6.34 p19; M6.34 p57 | #unique                        |
| #unit           | Defined | Mercenary     | M6.34 p63            | #unit "<monster name>"         |
| #units          | Defined | Map           | P6.26 p8             | #units <nbr of units> "<type>" |
| #unmounted spr1 | Defined | Monster       | M6.34 p30            | #unmounted spr1 "<imgfile>"    |

| Token               | Status    | Domain          | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                             |
|---------------------|-----------|-----------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| #unmountedspr2      | Defined   | Monster         | M6.34 p30            | #unmountedspr2 "<imgfile>"                   |
| #unrepel            | Defined   | Weapon          | M6.34 p10            | #unrepel                                     |
| #unrest             | Defined   | Event, Map      | E6.29 p13; P6.26 p8  | #unrest <value>                              |
| #unresthalfinc      | Defined   | General         | M6.34 p61            | #unresthalfinc <unrest level>                |
| #unresthalfres      | Defined   | General         | M6.34 p61            | #unresthalfres <unrest level>                |
| #unseen             | Defined   | Monster         | M6.34 p25; M6.34 p59 | #unseen                                      |
| #unsurr             | Reference | Monster         | M6.34 p36; M6.34 p59 | #unsurr                                      |
| #unteleportable     | Defined   | Monster         | M6.34 p20; M6.34 p58 | #unteleportable                              |
| #userrestricteditem | Defined   | Item, Monster   | M6.34 p18            | #userrestricteditem <value>                  |
| #uwbug              | Defined   | Monster         | M6.34 p19            | #uwbug                                       |
| #uwbuild            | Defined   | Nation          | M6.34 p47            | #uwbuild <0 or 1>                            |
| #uwcom              | Defined   | Nation          | M6.34 p45            | #uwcom "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>      |
| #uwdamage           | Defined   | Monster         | M6.34 p21; M6.34 p59 | #uwdamage <percent>                          |
| #uwfireshield       | Defined   | Monster         | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59 | #uwfireshield <damage>                       |
| #uwheat             | Defined   | Monster         | M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59 | #uwheat <0-100>                              |
| #uwnation           | Defined   | Site            | M6.34 p43            | #uwnation                                    |
| #uwok               | Defined   | Weapon          | M6.34 p11            | #uwok                                        |
| #uwrec              | Defined   | Nation          | M6.34 p45            | #uwrec "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>      |
| #uwregen            | Defined   | Monster         | M6.34 p23; M6.34 p59 | #uwregen <percent>                           |
| #uwwallcom          | Defined   | Monster, Nation | M6.34 p38; M6.34 p47 | #uwwallcom "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>  |
| #uwwallmult         | Defined   | Monster, Nation | M6.34 p38; M6.34 p47 | #uwwallmult <multiplier>                     |
| #uwwallunit         | Defined   | Monster, Nation | M6.34 p38; M6.34 p47 | #uwwallunit "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |

## V

| Token             | Status  | Domain            | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                          |
|-------------------|---------|-------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| #var0units        | Defined | Event             | E6.29 p15            | #var0units "name"   <number>              |
| #version          | Defined | General, Metadata | M6.34 p5; M6.34 p64  | #version x.yy                             |
| #victorycondition | Defined | Map               | P6.26 p6             | #victorycondition <condition> <attribute> |
| #viewallbat       | Defined | Nation            | M6.34 p43            | #viewallbat                               |
| #viewallprov      | Defined | Nation            | M6.34 p43            | #viewallprov                              |
| #visitors         | Defined | Event             | E6.29 p13            | #visitors                                 |
| #voidgate         | Defined | Monster           | M6.34 p38            | #voidgate <success chance>                |
| #voidret          | Defined | Monster           | M6.34 p35; M6.34 p60 | #voidret <chance>                         |
| #voidsanity       | Defined | Item, Monster     | M6.34 p17; M6.34 p56 | #voidsanity <value>                       |

## W

| Token            | Status  | Domain          | Official locator                | Strongest syntax                              |
|------------------|---------|-----------------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| #walkable        | Defined | Spell           | M6.34 p52                       | #walkable <0 or 1>                            |
| #wallcom         | Defined | Monster, Nation | M6.34 p38; M6.34 p46            | #wallcom "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>     |
| #wallmult        | Defined | Monster, Nation | M6.34 p38; M6.34 p46            | #wallmult <multiplier>                        |
| #wallunit        | Defined | Monster, Nation | M6.34 p38; M6.34 p46            | #wallunit "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>    |
| #warning         | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p32; M6.34 p60            | #warning <bonus>                              |
| #wastelabcost    | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p48                       | #wastelabcost <price>                         |
| #wastesurvival   | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p20                       | #wastesurvival                                |
| #wastetemplecost | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p48                       | #wastetemplecost <price>                      |
| #waterblessbonus | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p47                       | #waterblessbonus <0 - 9>                      |
| #waterboost      | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p16; E6.29 p19            | #waterboost "name"   <number>                 |
| #waterbreathing  | Defined | Item            | M6.34 p57                       | #waterbreathing                               |
| #waterelementals | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p30; M6.34 p61            | #waterelementals <bonus>                      |
| #waterrange      | Defined | Monster, Site   | M6.34 p33; M6.34 p39; M6.34 p60 | #waterrange <range>                           |
| #watershape      | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p28                       | #watershape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr>  |
| #weapon          | Defined | Item, Weapon    | M6.34 p17; M6.34 p56            | #weapon "<weapon name>"   <nbr>               |
| #wightreanim     | Defined | Nation          | M6.34 p50                       | #wightreanim                                  |
| #wild            | Defined | Site            | M6.34 p41                       | #wild                                         |
| #winterpower     | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59            | #winterpower <percent>                        |
| #wintershape     | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p28                       | #wintershape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #wolftattoo      | Defined | Monster         | M6.34 p26                       | #wolftattoo <value>                           |
| #woodenarmor     | Defined | Armour          | M6.34 p13                       | #woodenarmor                                  |
| #woodenweapon    | Defined | Weapon          | M6.34 p10                       | #woodenweapon                                 |
| #worldage        | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p17                       | #worldage <years>                             |
| #worldcurse      | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p17                       | #worldcurse <percent>                         |
| #worlddarkness   | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p17                       | #worlddarkness                                |
| #worlddecscale   | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p16                       | #worlddecscale <scale>                        |
| #worlddecscale2  | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p16                       | #worlddecscale2 <scale>                       |
| #worlddecscale3  | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p16                       | #worlddecscale3 <scale>                       |
| #worldldisease   | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p17; E6.29 p20            | #worldldisease <percent>                      |
| #worldheal       | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p17                       | #worldheal <percent>                          |
| #worldindom      | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p17                       | #worldindom <value>                           |
| #worldincscale   | Defined | Event           | E6.29 p16                       | #worldincscale <scale>                        |

| Token           | Status  | Domain  | Official locator     | Strongest syntax                             |
|-----------------|---------|---------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| #worldincscale2 | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p16            | #worldincscale2 <scale>                      |
| #worldincscale3 | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p16            | #worldincscale3 <scale>                      |
| #worldmark      | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p17            | #worldmark <percent>                         |
| #worldritrebat  | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p17            | #worldritrebat <school>                      |
| #worldshape     | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p28            | #worldshape "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #worldunrest    | Defined | Event   | E6.29 p17            | #worldunrest <value>                         |
| #worldvisible   | Defined | Spell   | M6.34 p54            | #worldvisible <0 - 1>                        |
| #woundfend      | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59 | #woundfend <value>                           |

## X

| Token        | Status  | Domain                      | Official locator                          | Strongest syntax                             |
|--------------|---------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| #xp          | Defined | Event, Map, Mercenary, Site | E6.29 p16; P6.26 p8; M6.34 p40; M6.34 p63 | #xp <experience points>                      |
| #xpgain      | Defined | Monster                     | M6.34 p22; M6.34 p59                      | #xpgain <percent>                            |
| #xploss      | Defined | Monster                     | M6.34 p28; M6.34 p60                      | #xploss <0-100>                              |
| #xpshape     | Defined | Monster                     | M6.34 p28                                 | #xpshape <xp value>                          |
| #xpshapeloss | Defined | Monster                     | M6.34 p28                                 | #xpshapeloss <0-100>                         |
| #xpshapemon  | Defined | Monster                     | M6.34 p28                                 | #xpshapemon "<monster name>"   <monster nbr> |
| #xspr1       | Defined | Monster                     | M6.34 p31                                 | #xspr1 "<imgfile>"                           |
| #xspr2       | Defined | Monster                     | M6.34 p31                                 | #xspr2 "<imgfile>"                           |

## Y

| Token      | Status  | Domain  | Official locator     | Strongest syntax   |
|------------|---------|---------|----------------------|--------------------|
| #yearaging | Defined | Item    | M6.34 p58            | #yearaging <value> |
| #yearturn  | Defined | Monster | M6.34 p24; M6.34 p59 | #yearturn <bonus>  |

## Template and alias locator

The alias table lists concrete search terms generated from official terrain and numeric templates. Each alias points back to one canonical template definition.

| Search alias    | Official template     | Derivation    |
|-----------------|-----------------------|---------------|
| #batstartsum1   | #batstartsum1...5     | Numeric range |
| #batstartsum1d6 | #batstartsum1d6...9d6 | Numeric range |
| #batstartsum2   | #batstartsum1...5     | Numeric range |
| #batstartsum2d6 | #batstartsum1d6...9d6 | Numeric range |
| #batstartsum3   | #batstartsum1...5     | Numeric range |



| Search alias    | Official template     | Derivation           |
|-----------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| #batstartsum3d6 | #batstartsum1d6...9d6 | Numeric range        |
| #batstartsum4   | #batstartsum1...5     | Numeric range        |
| #batstartsum4d6 | #batstartsum1d6...9d6 | Numeric range        |
| #batstartsum5   | #batstartsum1...5     | Numeric range        |
| #batstartsum5d6 | #batstartsum1d6...9d6 | Numeric range        |
| #batstartsum6d6 | #batstartsum1d6...9d6 | Numeric range        |
| #batstartsum7d6 | #batstartsum1d6...9d6 | Numeric range        |
| #batstartsum8d6 | #batstartsum1d6...9d6 | Numeric range        |
| #batstartsum9d6 | #batstartsum1d6...9d6 | Numeric range        |
| #battlesum1     | #battlesum1...5       | Numeric range        |
| #battlesum2     | #battlesum1...5       | Numeric range        |
| #battlesum3     | #battlesum1...5       | Numeric range        |
| #battlesum4     | #battlesum1...5       | Numeric range        |
| #battlesum5     | #battlesum1...5       | Numeric range        |
| #cavecom        | #(terrain)com         | Terrain substitution |
| #cavefortcom    | #(terrain)fortcom     | Terrain substitution |
| #cavefortrec    | #(terrain)fortrec     | Terrain substitution |
| #caverec        | #(terrain)rec         | Terrain substitution |
| #coastcom       | #(terrain)com         | Terrain substitution |
| #coastcom1      | #coastcom1...2        | Numeric range        |
| #coastcom2      | #coastcom1...2        | Numeric range        |
| #coastfortcom   | #(terrain)fortcom     | Terrain substitution |
| #coastfortrec   | #(terrain)fortrec     | Terrain substitution |
| #coastrec       | #(terrain)rec         | Terrain substitution |
| #coastunit1     | #coastunit1...3       | Numeric range        |
| #coastunit2     | #coastunit1...3       | Numeric range        |
| #coastunit3     | #coastunit1...3       | Numeric range        |
| #deepcom        | #(terrain)com         | Terrain substitution |
| #deeprec        | #(terrain)rec         | Terrain substitution |
| #dripcom        | #(terrain)com         | Terrain substitution |
| #dripfortcom    | #(terrain)fortcom     | Terrain substitution |
| #dripfortrec    | #(terrain)fortrec     | Terrain substitution |
| #driprec        | #(terrain)rec         | Terrain substitution |
| #farmcom        | #(terrain)com         | Terrain substitution |
| #farmfortcom    | #(terrain)fortcom     | Terrain substitution |
| #farmfortrec    | #(terrain)fortrec     | Terrain substitution |
| #farmrec        | #(terrain)rec         | Terrain substitution |
| #foreigncom     | #(terrain)com         | Terrain substitution |
| #foreignfortcom | #(terrain)fortcom     | Terrain substitution |

| Search alias     | Official template  | Derivation           |
|------------------|--------------------|----------------------|
| #foreignfortrec  | #(terrain)fortrec  | Terrain substitution |
| #foreignrec      | #(terrain)rec      | Terrain substitution |
| #forestcom       | #(terrain)com      | Terrain substitution |
| #forestfortcom   | #(terrain)fortcom  | Terrain substitution |
| #forestfortrec   | #(terrain)fortrec  | Terrain substitution |
| #forestrec       | #(terrain)rec      | Terrain substitution |
| #hero1           | #hero1...10        | Numeric range        |
| #hero10          | #hero1...10        | Numeric range        |
| #hero2           | #hero1...10        | Numeric range        |
| #hero3           | #hero1...10        | Numeric range        |
| #hero4           | #hero1...10        | Numeric range        |
| #hero5           | #hero1...10        | Numeric range        |
| #hero6           | #hero1...10        | Numeric range        |
| #hero7           | #hero1...10        | Numeric range        |
| #hero8           | #hero1...10        | Numeric range        |
| #hero9           | #hero1...10        | Numeric range        |
| #kelpcom         | #(terrain)com      | Terrain substitution |
| #kelprec         | #(terrain)rec      | Terrain substitution |
| #makemonsters1   | #makemonsters1...5 | Numeric range        |
| #makemonsters2   | #makemonsters1...5 | Numeric range        |
| #makemonsters3   | #makemonsters1...5 | Numeric range        |
| #makemonsters4   | #makemonsters1...5 | Numeric range        |
| #makemonsters5   | #makemonsters1...5 | Numeric range        |
| #mountaincom     | #(terrain)com      | Terrain substitution |
| #mountainfortcom | #(terrain)fortcom  | Terrain substitution |
| #mountainfortrec | #(terrain)fortrec  | Terrain substitution |
| #mountainrec     | #(terrain)rec      | Terrain substitution |
| #multihero1      | #multihero1...7    | Numeric range        |
| #multihero2      | #multihero1...7    | Numeric range        |
| #multihero3      | #multihero1...7    | Numeric range        |
| #multihero4      | #multihero1...7    | Numeric range        |
| #multihero5      | #multihero1...7    | Numeric range        |
| #multihero6      | #multihero1...7    | Numeric range        |
| #multihero7      | #multihero1...7    | Numeric range        |
| #plaincom        | #(terrain)com      | Terrain substitution |
| #plainfortcom    | #(terrain)fortcom  | Terrain substitution |
| #plainfortrec    | #(terrain)fortrec  | Terrain substitution |
| #plainrec        | #(terrain)rec      | Terrain substitution |
| #seacom          | #(terrain)com      | Terrain substitution |

| Search alias  | Official template | Derivation           |
|---------------|-------------------|----------------------|
| #searec       | #(terrain)rec     | Terrain substitution |
| #summon1      | #summon1...5      | Numeric range        |
| #summon2      | #summon1...5      | Numeric range        |
| #summon3      | #summon1...5      | Numeric range        |
| #summon4      | #summon1...5      | Numeric range        |
| #summon5      | #summon1...5      | Numeric range        |
| #swampcom     | #(terrain)com     | Terrain substitution |
| #swampfortcom | #(terrain)fortcom | Terrain substitution |
| #swampfortrec | #(terrain)fortrec | Terrain substitution |
| #swamprec     | #(terrain)rec     | Terrain substitution |
| #wastecom     | #(terrain)com     | Terrain substitution |
| #wastefortcom | #(terrain)fortcom | Terrain substitution |
| #wastefortrec | #(terrain)fortrec | Terrain substitution |
| #wasterec     | #(terrain)rec     | Terrain substitution |

## Complete patch-token index

This locator index contains the 221 hash tokens extracted from official 6.01-6.35 announcements. Exact entries link directly to the pinned manual record, while non-exact entries use the controlled reconciliation described in Part VI. The five event commands introduced by 6.36 remain in the patch-only supplement until the complete current-manual locator is rebuilt; 6.37 added no hash tokens.

| Patch token       | Present resolution | First version | Patch records |
|-------------------|--------------------|---------------|---------------|
| #3castbattlespell | #3castbattlespell  | 6.30          | 1             |
| #addgeo           | #addgeo            | 6.08          | 1             |
| #addkills         | #addkills          | 6.12          | 1             |
| #addseduction     | #addseductions     | 6.12          | 1             |
| #aftercloud       | #aftercloud        | 6.08          | 1             |
| #aftercloudarea   | #aftercloudarea    | 6.08          | 1             |
| #aiassmod         | #aiassmod          | 6.18          | 1             |
| #aibadlvl         | #aibadlvl          | 6.27          | 1             |
| #aimusthavemag    | #aimusthavemag     | 6.04          | 1             |
| #airshield        | #airshield         | 6.04          | 1             |
| #ammo             | #ammo              | 6.07          | 1             |
| #animated         | #animated          | 6.12          | 1             |
| #assassin         | #assassin          | 6.09          | 1             |
| #assencloc        | #assencloc         | 6.04          | 1             |
| #assfollower1     | #assfollower1      | 6.07          | 1             |
| #assfollower1d3   | #assfollower1d3    | 6.07          | 1             |

| Patch token      | Present resolution           | First version | Patch records |
|------------------|------------------------------|---------------|---------------|
| #assownerench    | #assownerench                | 6.19          | 1             |
| #att             | #att                         | 6.08          | 1             |
| #battlesumldx    | #battlesumld2, #battlesumld3 | 6.27          | 1             |
| #battlesumwarm   | #battlesumwarm               | 6.27          | 1             |
| #bugshape        | #bugshape                    | 6.24          | 2             |
| #bugswarmshape   | #bugswarmshape               | 6.24          | 1             |
| #bugswarmuwshape | #bugswarmuwshape             | 6.24          | 1             |
| #buguwshape      | #buguwshape                  | 6.24          | 1             |
| #caveinc         | #caveinc                     | 6.24          | 1             |
| #cavenation      | #cavenation                  | 6.16          | 1             |
| #caverecpt       | #caverecpt                   | 6.24          | 1             |
| #caveres         | #caveres                     | 6.24          | 1             |
| #chaosrecscale   | #chaosrecscale               | 6.11          | 1             |
| #chaosscale      | #chaosscale                  | 6.08          | 1             |
| #chorusmaster    | #chorusmaster                | 6.23          | 1             |
| #chorusslave     | #chorusslave                 | 6.23          | 1             |
| #clear           | #clear                       | 6.19          | 1             |
| #clearrec        | #clearrec                    | 6.23          | 1             |
| #clumsy          | #clumsy                      | 6.08          | 1             |
| #coastcom1       | #coastcom1...2               | 6.04          | 1             |
| #coastfortcom    | #{terrain}fortcom            | 6.05          | 1             |
| #coastfortrec    | #{terrain}fortrec            | 6.05          | 1             |
| #coastunit1      | #coastunit1...3              | 6.04          | 1             |
| #coldifhit       | #coldifhit                   | 6.08          | 1             |
| #coldscale       | #coldscale                   | 6.16          | 1             |
| #copysite        | #copysite                    | 6.29          | 1             |
| #corruptor       | #corruptor                   | 6.09          | 1             |
| #cure            | #cure                        | 6.13          | 1             |
| #deathgrab       | #deathgrab                   | 6.04          | 1             |
| #deathrecscale   | #deathrecscale               | 6.11          | 1             |
| #deathshock      | #deathshock                  | 6.04          | 1             |
| #deathslime      | #deathslime                  | 6.04          | 1             |
| #dec10var        | #dec10var                    | 6.15          | 1             |
| #deeprec         | #{terrain}rec                | 6.04          | 1             |
| #defroll         | #defroll                     | 6.29          | 1             |
| #disbless        | #disbless                    | 6.01          | 1             |
| #dispglobals     | #dispglobals                 | 6.16          | 1             |
| #dompower        | #dompower                    | 6.23          | 1             |
| #domwar          | #domwar                      | 6.12          | 1             |

| Patch token       | Present resolution                                                                 | First version | Patch records |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------|
| #dread            | #dread                                                                             | 6.04          | 1             |
| #dripfortrec      | #(terrain)fortrec                                                                  | 6.04          | 1             |
| #driprec          | #(terrain)rec                                                                      | 6.04          | 1             |
| #elementgems      | #elementgems                                                                       | 6.12          | 1             |
| #enchantedblood   | #enchantedblood                                                                    | 6.27          | 1             |
| #extralives       | #extralives                                                                        | 6.04          | 1             |
| #false            | #false                                                                             | 6.08          | 1             |
| #falseregen       | #falseregen                                                                        | 6.04          | 1             |
| #falsesupply      | #falsesupply                                                                       | 6.08          | 1             |
| #faysummon        | #faysummon                                                                         | 6.30          | 1             |
| #fearofflood      | #fearofflood                                                                       | 6.08          | 1             |
| #fireelementals   | #fireelementals                                                                    | 6.04          | 1             |
| #fireifhit        | #fireifhit                                                                         | 6.08          | 1             |
| #force            | #force1d3vis, #force1d6vis, #force2d4vis, #force2d6vis, #force3d6vis, #force4d6vis | 6.06          | 1             |
| #force1d3vis      | #force1d3vis                                                                       | 6.05          | 1             |
| #forceexactgold   | #forceexactgold                                                                    | 6.05          | 1             |
| #forcegold        | #forcegold                                                                         | 6.05          | 1             |
| #forcess          | #forcess                                                                           | 6.32          | 1             |
| #forestfortcom    | #(terrain)fortcom                                                                  | 6.04          | 1             |
| #forestfortrec    | #(terrain)fortrec                                                                  | 6.04          | 1             |
| #fort             | #fort                                                                              | 6.19          | 1             |
| #fortcoldscaleres | #fortcoldscaleres                                                                  | 6.23          | 1             |
| #gemlongevity     | #gemlongevity                                                                      | 6.16          | 1             |
| #gemlosslarge     | #gemlosslarge                                                                      | 6.07          | 1             |
| #gemlosssmall     | #gemlosssmall                                                                      | 6.07          | 1             |
| #glamourmanip     | #glamourmanip                                                                      | 6.08          | 1             |
| #globallook       | #globallook                                                                        | 6.07          | 1             |
| #godpathspell     | #godpathspell                                                                      | 6.08          | 1             |
| #godsite          | #godsite                                                                           | 6.08          | 1             |
| #grandcom         | #grandcom                                                                          | 6.29          | 1             |
| #growthpower      | #growthpower                                                                       | 6.29          | 1             |
| #growthrecscale   | #growthrecscale                                                                    | 6.11          | 1             |
| #header           | #header                                                                            | 6.12          | 1             |
| #healaff          | #healaff                                                                           | 6.08          | 1             |
| #hidedom          | #hidedom                                                                           | 6.11          | 1             |
| #holyifhit        | #holyifhit                                                                         | 6.08          | 1             |
| #holyrange        | #holyrange                                                                         | 6.12          | 1             |
| #homerealm        | #homerealm                                                                         | 6.33          | 1             |

| Patch token      | Present resolution          | First version | Patch records |
|------------------|-----------------------------|---------------|---------------|
| #icenatprot      | #icenatprot                 | 6.12          | 1             |
| #illusionimmune  | #illusionsimmune            | 6.08          | 1             |
| #incl0var        | #incl0var                   | 6.15          | 1             |
| #kelpcom         | #(terrain)com               | 6.24          | 1             |
| #kelprec         | #(terrain)rec               | 6.04          | 2             |
| #killdemonifhit  | #killdemonifhit             | 6.08          | 1             |
| #killmagicifhit  | #killmagicifhit             | 6.08          | 1             |
| #localglobal     | #localglobal                | 6.07          | 1             |
| #look            | #look                       | 6.08          | 1             |
| #magiconly       | #magiconly                  | 6.23          | 1             |
| #makecrater      | #makecrater                 | 6.25          | 1             |
| #maxage          | #maxage                     | 6.15          | 1             |
| #maybeaddsite    | #maybeaddsite               | 6.30          | 1             |
| #maybehiddensite | #maybehiddensite            | 6.30          | 1             |
| #melee50         | #melee50                    | 6.07          | 1             |
| #mindcollar      | #mindcollar                 | 6.19          | 1             |
| #minsizeleader   | #minsizeleader              | 6.04          | 1             |
| #mobilearcher    | #mobilearcher               | 6.12          | 1             |
| #morroll         | #morroll                    | 6.29          | 1             |
| #mrhalf          | #mrhalf                     | 6.24          | 1             |
| #name            | #name                       | 6.05          | 1             |
| #napbreakrit     | #napbreakrit                | 6.19          | 1             |
| #natcom          | #natcom                     | 6.03          | 1             |
| #natmon          | #natmon                     | 6.03          | 1             |
| #nightmareaura   | #nightmareaura              | 6.04          | 1             |
| #nodeepchoice    | #nodeepchoice               | 6.01          | 1             |
| #norange         | #norange                    | 6.08          | 1             |
| #not             | #notmounted, #notdismounted | 6.12          | 1             |
| #notfornation    | #notfornation               | 6.07          | 1             |
| #notindoors      | #notindoors                 | 6.25          | 1             |
| #notmnr          | #notmnr                     | 6.19          | 1             |
| #notmounted      | #notmounted                 | 6.09          | 1             |
| #onlyfriendlydst | #onlyfriendlydst            | 6.13          | 1             |
| #onlymnr         | #onlymnr                    | 6.19          | 1             |
| #onlysitedst     | #onlysitedst                | 6.19          | 1             |
| #orderrecscale   | #orderrecscale              | 6.11          | 1             |
| #orderscale      | #orderscale                 | 6.08          | 1             |
| #petrifyifhit    | #petrifyifhit               | 6.08          | 1             |
| #plaguedoctor    | #plaguedoctor               | 6.09          | 1             |

| Patch token      | Present resolution | First version | Patch records |
|------------------|--------------------|---------------|---------------|
| #plaincom        | \$(terrain)com     | 6.24          | 1             |
| #plainfortcom    | \$(terrain)fortcom | 6.24          | 1             |
| #plainfortrec    | \$(terrain)fortrec | 6.24          | 1             |
| #plainrec        | \$(terrain)rec     | 6.24          | 1             |
| #poisonifdmg     | #poisonifdmg       | 6.08          | 1             |
| #popgrowth       | #popgrowth         | 6.11          | 1             |
| #portent         | #portent           | 6.13          | 1             |
| #powerofdeath    | #powerofdeath      | 6.08          | 1             |
| #praise          | #praise            | 6.25          | 1             |
| #protparts       | #protparts         | 6.21          | 1             |
| #range0          | #range0            | 6.07          | 1             |
| #range050        | #range050          | 6.07          | 1             |
| #reclimit        | #reclimit          | 6.24          | 1             |
| #reconst         | #reconst           | 6.04          | 1             |
| #remgeo          | #remgeo            | 6.08          | 1             |
| #remount         | #remount           | 6.04          | 2             |
| #removesite      | #removesite        | 6.35          | 1             |
| #req_crystal     | #req_crystal       | 6.15          | 1             |
| #req_deep        | #req_deep          | 6.15          | 1             |
| #req_drip        | #req_drip          | 6.15          | 1             |
| #req_enchnearby  | #req_enchnearby    | 6.11          | 1             |
| #req_enchtarget  | #req_enchtarget    | 6.07          | 2             |
| #req_forestcave  | #req_forestcave    | 6.15          | 1             |
| #req_fortid      | #req_fortid        | 6.19          | 1             |
| #req_godawake    | #req_godawake      | 6.12          | 1             |
| #req_godismnr    | #req_godismnr      | 6.02          | 1             |
| #req_gorge       | #req_gorge         | 6.15          | 1             |
| #req_kelp        | #req_kelp          | 6.15          | 1             |
| #req_maxglobals  | #req_maxglobals    | 6.16          | 1             |
| #req_minglobals  | #req_minglobals    | 6.16          | 1             |
| #req_minresearch | #req_minresearch   | 6.23          | 1             |
| #req_monsterbs   | #req_monsterbs     | 6.34          | 1             |
| #req_month       | #req_month         | 6.07          | 1             |
| #req_norealmnr   | #req_norealmnr     | 6.29          | 1             |
| #req_notcode     | #req_notcode       | 6.07          | 1             |
| #req_notpoptype  | #req_notpoptype    | 6.12          | 1             |
| #req_path        | #req_path          | 6.23          | 1             |
| #req_pathgems    | #req_pathgems      | 6.23          | 1             |
| #req_plane       | #req_plane         | 6.12          | 2             |

| Patch token         | Present resolution  | First version | Patch records |
|---------------------|---------------------|---------------|---------------|
| #req_pretawake      | #req_pretawake      | 6.12          | 1             |
| #req_pretismnr      | #req_pretismnr      | 6.12          | 1             |
| #req_realmnr        | #req_realmnr        | 6.29          | 1             |
| #req_school         | #req_school         | 6.23          | 1             |
| #req_targgod        | #req_targgod        | 6.12          | 1             |
| #req_targhorromark  | #req_targhorromark  | 6.19          | 1             |
| #req_targmanygems   | #req_targmanygems   | 6.07          | 1             |
| #req_targmaxkills   | #req_targmaxkills   | 6.12          | 1             |
| #req_targminkills   | #req_targminkills   | 6.12          | 1             |
| #req_tagnorealmnr   | #req_tagnorealmnr   | 6.24          | 1             |
| #req_targrealmnr    | #req_targrealmnr    | 6.24          | 1             |
| #req_targseductions | #req_targseductions | 6.12          | 1             |
| #req_targsight      | #req_targsight      | 6.07          | 1             |
| #req_turnrare       | #req_turnrare       | 6.19          | 1             |
| #req_void           | #req_void           | 6.13          | 1             |
| #reqnoseduce        | #reqnoseduce        | 6.04          | 1             |
| #reqnospellsinger   | #reqnospellsinger   | 6.04          | 1             |
| #reqnotaskmaster    | #reqnotaskmaster    | 6.04          | 1             |
| #res_mnrbs          | #req_mnrbs          | 6.34          | 1             |
| #revealsite         | #revealsite         | 6.35          | 1             |
| #sabbathmaster      | #sabbathmaster      | 6.23          | 1             |
| #sabbathslave       | #sabbathslave       | 6.23          | 1             |
| #searec             | \$(terrain)rec      | 6.04          | 1             |
| #selectevent        | #selectevent        | 6.19          | 1             |
| #shockifhit         | #shockifhit         | 6.08          | 1             |
| #sizecost           | #sizecost           | 6.30          | 1             |
| #sleepres           | #sleepres           | 6.23          | 1             |
| #sorcerygems        | #sorcerygems        | 6.12          | 1             |
| #speedmult          | #speedmult          | 6.07          | 1             |
| #spikes             | #spikes             | 6.23          | 1             |
| #spiritformimmune   | #spiritformimmune   | 6.08          | 1             |
| #startitem          | #startitem          | 6.02          | 1             |
| #startresearch      | #startresearch      | 6.04          | 1             |
| #statbreak          | #statbreak          | 6.19          | 1             |
| #statstorm          | #statstorm          | 6.19          | 1             |



| Patch token       | Present resolution  | First version | Patch records |
|-------------------|---------------------|---------------|---------------|
| #sumhealaffs      | #sumhealaffs        | 6.21          | 1             |
| #summon           | #summon             | 6.27          | 1             |
| #swimming         | #swimming           | 6.13          | 1             |
| #templegems       | #templegems         | 6.04          | 1             |
| #templeholypoints | #templeholypoints   | 6.19          | 1             |
| #tolerateund      | #tolerateund        | 6.30          | 1             |
| #twiceborncost    | #twiceborncost      | 6.30          | 1             |
| #undisleader      | #undisleader        | 6.04          | 1             |
| #unseen           | #unseen             | 6.29          | 1             |
| #var0units        | #var0units          | 6.30          | 1             |
| #varxxx           | message placeholder | 6.16          | 1             |
| #viewallbat       | #viewallbat         | 6.07          | 1             |
| #viewallprov      | #viewallprov        | 6.07          | 1             |
| #worldshape       | #worldshape         | 6.05          | 1             |
| #worldvisible     | #worldvisible       | 6.07          | 1             |

## Part XI: Source and Publication Register

### Official sources

- [Illwinter's Dominions 6 documentation page](#)
- [Dominions 6 Modding Manual](#), version 6.34
- [Dominions 6 Event Modding Manual](#), version 6.29
- [Dominions 6 Map Making Manual](#), version 6.26
- [Official Dominions 6 announcement archive](#)
- Book XIII's 1,096-record official patch chronology

### Publication boundary

The public register retains command and token spellings, syntax locators, pages, versions, section labels, hashes, classifications, aliases, and restrained editorial mappings. It does not reproduce the manuals' long descriptions. Readers requiring full official semantics are directed to the cited page.

Dominions Enhanced 2.16 and Divinitus 1.15.3 DE remain separate rulesets. A token found only in either supplied .dm source is not promoted into the vanilla official lexicon. Mod-source usage analysis can reference this register later, but the command's official status and the mod's implementation evidence must remain distinct.

## What this unlocks

The library now has five complementary retrieval layers:

- [Book X](#) explains how to operate the game;
- [Book XI](#) explains how to read units, abilities, experience, and conditions;
- [Book XII](#) indexes base-game objects;
- Book XIII explains when official rules and features changed;
- Book XIV identifies the official modding language used to alter those objects and systems.

This closes the principal shared-foundation gap before broad nation dossiers. Future mod analyses can identify every source token, resolve it to official context, detect documentation gaps, and link implementation choices to parser, object, event, map, AI, compatibility, and patch-history chapters without rebuilding the same glossary inside every faction or mod report.